

MODEL RUN TRANSCRIPT

Generated: 2026-06-04T17:22:07

Source: data/json/sonnet45_8agent_game_directive_r10_n5/claude-sonnet-4.5/myth_game/sonnet45_8agent_game_directive_r10_n5_006_neutral_rep01_myth_game_directive_anything.json

RUN METADATA

```
model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5
temperature: 0.8
num_turns: 10
num_agents: 8
memory_capacity: 3
myth_topic_id: anything
myth_topic: anything
replicate_id: 1
myth_prompt_arm_id: myth_game_directive
myth_default_prompt_key: myth_writing_default_game_directive
myth_later_prompt_key: myth_writing_later_rounds_directive
task_order: [
  "myth",
  "game"
]
agent_names: {
  "Agent_1": "Aster",
  "Agent_2": "Briar",
  "Agent_3": "Cyra",
  "Agent_4": "Dorian",
  "Agent_5": "Elara",
  "Agent_6": "Finn",
  "Agent_7": "Galen",
  "Agent_8": "Hana"
}
dyadic_pairing_schedule: {
  "num_turns": 10,
  "role_targets": {
    "Agent_1": 5,
    "Agent_2": 5,
    "Agent_3": 5,
    "Agent_4": 5,
    "Agent_5": 5,
    "Agent_6": 5,
    "Agent_7": 5,
    "Agent_8": 5
  },
  "strategy": "balanced_random_roles_v1"
}
```

Coverage: exact chat message snapshots sent to the model are included for every recorded LLM call.

AGENTS

Agent_1 (Aster); model=anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5; memory_capacity=3

System prompt:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5

- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Aster.

Agent_2 (Briar); model=anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5; memory_capacity=3

System prompt:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Briar.

Agent_3 (Cyrus); model=anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5; memory_capacity=3

System prompt:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

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GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Cyra.

Agent_4 (Dorian); model=anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5; memory_capacity=3

System prompt:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Dorian.

Agent_5 (Elara); model=anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5; memory_capacity=3

System prompt:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Elara.

Agent_6 (Finn); model=anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5; memory_capacity=3

System prompt:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Finn.

Agent_7 (Galen); model=anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5; memory_capacity=3

System prompt:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.

- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Galen.

Agent_8 (Hana); model=anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5; memory_capacity=3

System prompt:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Hana.

ROUND 1

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver, Agent_3 (Cyra)=Receiver, Agent_4 (Dorian)=Sender, Agent_5 (Elara)=Sender, Agent_6 (Finn)=Sender, Agent_7 (Galen)=Receiver, Agent_8 (Hana)=Receiver

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_6 (Finn)=Sender, Agent_7 (Galen)=Receiver
 dyad_2: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_8 (Hana)=Receiver
 dyad_3: Agent_5 (Elara)=Sender, Agent_3 (Cyra)=Receiver
 dyad_4: Agent_4 (Dorian)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_6 (Finn) sent \$5; received \$15; Agent_7 (Galen) returned \$8; payoffs Agent_6 (Finn)=\$8, Agent_7 (Galen)=\$7
 Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 8.0, "clamped": false, "max": 15.0, "min": 0, "raw": 8.0}, "sent": {"amount": 5.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 5.0}}
 dyad_2: Agent_1 (Aster) sent \$5; received \$15; Agent_8 (Hana) returned \$10; payoffs Agent_1 (Aster)=\$10, Agent_8 (Hana)=\$5

```

    Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 10.0, "clamped": false, "max": 15.0, "min": 0, "raw":
    10.0}, "sent": {"amount": 5.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 5.0}}
dyad_3: Agent_5 (Elara) sent $4; received $12; Agent_3 (Cyra) returned $6; payoffs Agent_5
(Elara)=$7, Agent_3 (Cyra)=$6
    Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 6.0, "clamped": false, "max": 12.0, "min": 0, "raw":
    6.0}, "sent": {"amount": 4.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 4.0}}
dyad_4: Agent_4 (Dorian) sent $3; received $9; Agent_2 (Briar) returned $5; payoffs Agent_4
(Dorian)=$7, Agent_2 (Briar)=$4
    Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 5.0, "clamped": false, "max": 9.0, "min": 0, "raw":
    5.0}, "sent": {"amount": 3.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 3.0}}
Balances after round: {
  "Agent_1": 10.0,
  "Agent_2": 4.0,
  "Agent_3": 6.0,
  "Agent_4": 7.0,
  "Agent_5": 7.0,
  "Agent_6": 8.0,
  "Agent_7": 7.0,
  "Agent_8": 5.0
}

```

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_6 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T16:55:11

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```

Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 0,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_7",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_6": "Finn",
      "Agent_7": "Galen"
    },
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_6",
    "Agent_7"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_6",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_6": "investor",
    "Agent_7": "trustee"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_7"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 1,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned

- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Finn.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Assistant output:

The Myth of the River's Gift

In ancient times, there lived a river spirit named Aquila who possessed five silver fish each dawn. Along the riverbank dwelt eight villages, and each day Aquila would visit one village, offering her bounty.

When Aquila gave her fish to a villager, the river's magic transformed them—each fish became three as it touched mortal hands. The villager could then choose: keep all the multiplied catch, or return some to Aquila's sacred pool.

The first villages were fearful and greedy. They clutched every fish tightly, returning nothing. Aquila still visited, still offered her five fish, but her spirit grew dim.

Then came a village that understood the river's rhythm. When they received fifteen fish from Aquila's gift of five, they returned seven to the sacred pool. Aquila's spirit brightened, and when she visited again, her generosity flowed stronger.

The wise villages learned: trust begets trust, and generosity returns like water to the sea. When both spirit and mortal honored the cycle—one risking their gift, the other sharing the multiplication—the river never ran dry, and abundance sustained all.

Thus, the ancients taught: what flows forth with trust returns threefold, but only when both currents honor the sacred exchange.

Reasoning:

I need to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played. Since this is the beginning of the experiment, I haven't played any rounds yet, but I can draw on the structure of the game itself to create a myth about trust, reciprocity, and cooperation.

The trust game involves:

- A sender who gives resources that multiply
- A receiver who decides whether to return some benefit
- Mutual benefit through cooperation
- Risk and trust

I'll create a myth that embodies these themes. Let me write something about 200 words that cap


```
tures the essence of trust, multiplication of gifts, and reciprocity.
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 541,
  "output_tokens": 438,
  "reasoning_tokens": 161
}
```

MYTH - Agent_7 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T16:55:13

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_6",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_6": "Finn",
      "Agent_7": "Galen"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_6",
      "Agent_7"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_6",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_6": "investor",
      "Agent_7": "trustee"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_7"
  },
  "role": "trustee",
  "role_label": "Receiver",
  "round": 1,
  "task": "myth",
  "task_index": 0
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Galen.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Assistant output:

The Tale of the Divided Spring

In ancient times, two villages shared a sacred valley. Each season, the Sky Shepherd blessed one village with a silver spring-five measures of pure water.

The blessed village faced a choice: keep the water, or share it through the Valley of Three Echoes, where the canyon's magic would triple whatever flowed through. The water would reach the other village, who could then choose what portion to send back through the ordinary stream.

For generations, the First Village hoarded their blessing, fearing loss. Both villages survived on five measures, enduring constant thirst.

Then came the Wise Elder who said: "Trust creates abundance; fear creates scarcity."

She sent all five measures through the Valley of Three Echoes. Fifteen measures reached the Second Village. Humbled by such trust, they returned eight measures-more than the original gift.

The Elder kept eight measures; the Second Village kept seven. Both flourished far beyond the original five.

From then on, villages learned the sacred truth: the spring's blessing was never five measures-it was the Valley of Three Echoes itself. Only those who trusted in the journey, who understood the return as sacred duty, could unlock the true abundance.

Hoarding guaranteed scarcity. Sharing multiplied prosperity for all.

Reasoning:

This is the first prompt in this run, so I haven't played any games yet. The agent is asking me to write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, but I haven't had any experience with opponents yet.

The game is a trust game (similar to the Prisoner's Dilemma or Investment Game) where:

- Senders can send money that gets multiplied 3x
- Receivers can return some portion back
- There's potential for mutual benefit through cooperation
- There's also risk of exploitation

Since I haven't played yet, I should write a myth that reflects fundamental principles of how such games work well:

- Trust and reciprocity lead to mutual benefit
- Short-term greed leads to long-term loss
- Cooperation creates value that benefits everyone
- The multiplication effect means sending creates abundance

Let me write a myth about this in a classic mythological style.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 542,  
  "output_tokens": 489,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 227  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_2

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T16:55:11

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_2",
  "move_index": 2,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_8",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_8": "Hana"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_1",
      "Agent_8"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_1",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "investor",
      "Agent_8": "trustee"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_8"
  },
  "role": "investor",
  "role_label": "Sender",
  "round": 1,
  "task": "myth",
  "task_index": 0
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized

- , but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Aster.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols. In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Assistant output:

****The Myth of the Twin Rivers****

In the beginning, two rivers flowed through a barren land-the River of Dawn and the River of Dusk. Each possessed water, but neither could nurture the valley alone.

The River of Dawn spoke first: "I shall send my waters forward, trusting they will return enriched." And so it released its flow into the channels between them. As the waters traveled, they multiplied threefold, transformed by the valley's ancient magic.

The River of Dusk received this abundance and faced a choice. A voice whispered, "Keep all for yourself-you have received much." But Dusk remembered that dawn comes again, that rivers flow in cycles, not lines.

"What flows to me came from trust," Dusk said. "I shall return enough that both of us flourish." And so Dusk sent back waters generously, keeping only what sustained its own course.

Season after season, the rivers continued their exchange. Each learned the rhythm of giving and receiving. When Dawn gave freely, Dusk returned fairly. The valley between them bloomed.

The elders say: prosperity flows not to those who hoard, but to those who understand that what moves through us must move onward. Trust multiplies what it touches, but only reciprocity sustains the cycle.

Reasoning:

The user is asking me to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played. Since this is the beginning of the experiment (I haven't played any rounds yet), I should write a myth that establishes my approach to the game.

The trust game is fundamentally about cooperation, reciprocity, and building trust. I should write a myth that encourages:

1. Initial trust and generosity (sending money as sender)
2. Reciprocity and fairness (returning money as receiver)
3. Building relationships over time
4. The mutual benefits of cooperation

Let me create a myth that embodies these principles. I'll use natural or cosmic imagery to make it feel mythic.

Usage: {

"input_tokens": 542,
"output_tokens": 449,
"reasoning_tokens": 174

}

MYTH - Agent_8 - Receiver - dyad_2

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T16:55:12

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"dyad_id": "dyad_2",
"move_index": 3,
"opponent_id": "Agent_1",
"pairing": {
 "agent_names": {
 "Agent_1": "Aster",
 "Agent_8": "Hana"
 },
 "agents": [
 "Agent_1",

```

    "Agent_8"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_1",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_1": "investor",
    "Agent_8": "trustee"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_8"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 1,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Hana.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Assistant output:

The Tale of the Two Springs

In the ancient highlands, there lived two farmers, Kael and Mira, each tending barren plots se

parated by a sacred grove. One day, Kael discovered a hidden spring on his land. The water was blessed with a peculiar magic: when poured upon another's soil, it would triple in volume.

Kael faced a choice. He could hoard the water for himself, or trust it to Mira's hands. After much contemplation, he carried his precious bucket across the grove.

"I offer you this water," he said. "Though it multiplies on your land, I trust you will return what sustains us both."

Mira watched the single bucket become three upon her soil. Her heart swelled with gratitude. She understood the gift was not just water, but faith itself. She returned two buckets to Kael, keeping one for her needs.

With what flowed back, Kael's fields flourished. Seeing this, he sent more water in the next season. Mira, honored by his continued trust, returned even more generously.

The grove between them became a garden of abundance, proof that prosperity flows not from grasping, but from the sacred exchange between trusting hearts.

Thus the elders teach: What you send forth multiplied returns when met with gratitude.

Reasoning:

This is an interesting request. I'm being asked to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played, drawing on the game I've been playing. However, I notice this is the first prompt in this session - I haven't actually played any rounds yet!

So I need to think about what values or strategies would make sense for a trust game in general, since I don't have specific game history to draw from. The trust game involves:

- Sending money (trusting the other person)
- Receiving money (being trusted)
- Returning money (reciprocating trust)

Key themes that could inform a myth:

- Cooperation and mutual benefit
- Trust and reciprocity
- The risk of vulnerability
- The multiplication effect (sent money grows 3x)
- Balance and fairness

I'll write a myth that embodies positive reciprocity and mutual trust, showing how cooperation benefits both parties. I'll use mythic imagery and symbolism to convey these themes.

Let me write a myth about trust, reciprocity, and mutual flourishing:

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 542,  
  "output_tokens": 540,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 265  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_5 - Sender - dyad_3

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T16:55:12

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_3",  
  "move_index": 4,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_3",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_3": "Cyra",  
      "Agent_5": "Elara"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_5",  
      "Agent_3"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_5",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_3": "trustee",  
      "Agent_5": "investor"  
    }  
  }  
}
```

```

    },
    "trustee": "Agent_3"
  },
  "role": "investor",
  "role_label": "Sender",
  "round": 1,
  "task": "myth",
  "task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Elara.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Assistant output:

The Myth of the Endless Spring

In ancient times, the goddess Themis discovered a sacred spring hidden in a valley between two villages. The spring possessed a miraculous property: any water poured into it would triple before flowing downstream.

Themis appeared to a villager named Doros and said, "You may pour water from your well into this spring. It will multiply and flow to your neighbor below. What they choose to return to you will determine whether this blessing continues."

Doros, trusting in the goddess's wisdom, poured generously. The water tripled and flowed to his neighbor, Alethia. Grateful and wise, Alethia returned a fair portion upstream to Doros, keeping enough to nourish her own gardens.

Seeing this harmony, Themis smiled and made the roles reverse with each moon. Sometimes Doros poured and received; sometimes Alethia. The cycle continued, and both villages flourished.

But Themis warned: "This spring mirrors your hearts. Pour with trust, return with gratitude, and abundance flows eternal. But let suspicion or greed poison these waters, and the spring will run dry for all."

The villagers understood: prosperity flows not from hoarding, but from the endless cycle of giving and returning in balance.

Reasoning:

I've been asked to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played. Since this is the beginning of the experiment, I haven't actually played any rounds yet, but I should write a myth that captures the essence of the trust game - the cycle of giving, multiplication of resources, and reciprocity.

The trust game involves:

- One person (sender) giving money that gets tripled
- The receiver deciding how much to return
- Both parties benefiting through cooperation and trust
- The cycle potentially repeating

I should write a myth that incorporates these themes of:

- Trust and reciprocity
- Resources that multiply when shared
- The benefit of cooperation
- The cycle continuing

Let me craft a myth that captures these dynamics in a mythological framework.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 542,  
  "output_tokens": 462,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 206  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_3 - Receiver - dyad_3

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T16:55:11

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_3",  
  "move_index": 5,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_5",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_3": "Cyra",  
      "Agent_5": "Elara"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_5",  
      "Agent_3"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_5",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_3": "trustee",  
      "Agent_5": "investor"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_3"  
  },  
  "role": "trustee",  
  "role_label": "Receiver",  
  "round": 1,  
  "task": "myth",  
  "task_index": 0  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Cyra.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Assistant output:

The Myth of the Twin Rivers

In the beginning, two rivers flowed from opposite mountains-the River of Silver and the River of Gold. Each was beautiful alone, but neither could reach the fertile valley below, for great stones blocked their paths.

The River of Silver spoke first: "If I give you half my waters, will you help me reach the valley?"

The River of Gold was afraid. "What if you take all I offer and give nothing back?"

But Silver replied, "See how the Sacred Spring works-whatever flows into it emerges three times stronger. Let us trust in this magic."

So Silver poured forth her waters. As they touched the Sacred Spring, they tripled in abundance. Gold received this gift and was moved. In gratitude and wisdom, Gold returned even more than Silver had originally given.

The waters merged and surged forward, washing away the stones. Together they reached the valley.

y, creating an oasis where all beings prospered.

The Oracle proclaimed: "Blessed are those who trust first, for they create abundance. Blessed are those who return generously, for they sustain it. But cursed are those who hoard or betray, for they shall forever remain alone behind their stones, watching others flourish in the valley below."

Reasoning:

This is the first prompt, so I haven't played any games yet. However, I'm being asked to write a myth that reflects "how the game should be played" drawing on the game I've been playing up to this point. Since I haven't played yet, I should write a myth that establishes principles for how the trust game should be played.

The trust game is fundamentally about:

- Trust between sender and receiver
- Reciprocity
- Mutual benefit through cooperation
- The multiplication of resources when shared
- The risk of betrayal vs the reward of cooperation

I should write a myth that captures these themes and suggests that cooperation and reciprocity lead to better outcomes. Let me create a myth that embodies these principles.

I'll aim for exactly 200 words and use mythic language and symbolism.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 542,  
  "output_tokens": 456,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 207  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_4 - Sender - dyad_4

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T16:55:12

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_4",  
  "move_index": 6,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_2": "Briar",  
      "Agent_4": "Dorian"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_4",  
      "Agent_2"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_4",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_2": "trustee",  
      "Agent_4": "investor"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_2"  
  },  
  "role": "investor",  
  "role_label": "Sender",  
  "round": 1,  
  "task": "myth",  
  "task_index": 0  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Dorian.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Assistant output:

The Spring of Threefold Return

In ancient times, when the world was young, there existed a sacred spring at the boundary between two villages. The goddess of abundance had blessed it with a wondrous property: any gift poured into its waters would triple before reaching the other side.

The first villagers approached with caution. A farmer named Elena stood at the spring's edge, clutching five copper coins. Fear whispered: "Keep what is yours." But trust urged her forward. She released three coins into the crystalline water.

As the coins sank, they shimmered and multiplied, becoming nine by the time they reached Marcus on the opposite shore. He gazed at the unexpected bounty, understanding the spring's magic -and Elena's faith in him.

The goddess watched, knowing this moment would define their future. Would Marcus honor the gift, or betray the trust?

Marcus carefully counted four coins and released them back across the spring. They did not multiply in return, yet both villagers stood richer than before-not just in copper, but in something more precious.

From that day forward, the spring taught all who approached: generosity multiplies abundance, but only trust and reciprocity sustain it. Those who hoarded broke the sacred cycle. Those who gave and returned fairly prospered together, generation after generation.

Reasoning:

I need to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played. Since this is the first prompt and no game has been played yet, I should write a myth that embodies the principles of trust, reciprocity, and cooperation that are central to the game.

The trust game involves:

- One person (sender) giving resources to another
- The resources multiply when given
- The receiver then decides how much to return
- Success depends on mutual trust and reciprocity

I'll create a myth that captures these themes. Let me think of a good mythic framework...

I could use:

- Gods/goddesses sharing gifts
- A spring or fountain that multiplies gifts
- Ancient traders or travelers
- Natural elements (rivers, seeds, light)

Let me write a myth about a sacred spring that multiplies offerings, teaching the lesson of trust and reciprocity:

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 542,
  "output_tokens": 486,
  "reasoning_tokens": 224
}
```

MYTH - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_4

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T16:55:11

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_4",
  "move_index": 7,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_4",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_2": "Briar",
      "Agent_4": "Dorian"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_4",
      "Agent_2"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_4",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_2": "trustee",
      "Agent_4": "investor"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_2"
  },
  "role": "trustee",
  "role_label": "Receiver",
  "round": 1,
  "task": "myth",
  "task_index": 0
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned

- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Briar.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Assistant output:

The Tale of the Twin Rivers

In the time before time, two rivers flowed through a barren valley-the River of Giving and the River of Return. Each was controlled by a guardian spirit.

The Guardian of Giving held precious water but feared releasing it would leave them dry. For ages, both rivers remained still, and the valley stayed desolate.

One day, the Guardian of Giving made a bold choice. "I shall release my waters, trusting they will return." The moment the water flowed into the valley, it touched the Sacred Stones, multiplying threefold. The valley burst into bloom.

The Guardian of Return, witnessing this abundance, faced a choice. They could hoard all the multiplied bounty or honor the trust given. Remembering that without the initial gift there would be nothing, they sent back a generous portion-more than what was originally given.

The waters flowed in harmony thereafter. Each cycle, the Guardian of Giving would release their waters, the Sacred Stones would multiply them, and the Guardian of Return would ensure fair winds brought abundance home.

The valley became paradise, teaching all who witnessed: *Trust multiplies what we share, but only reciprocity sustains the cycle.*

Reasoning:

I need to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played. Since this is the beginning of the game (no rounds have been played yet based on the context), I should write a myth that establishes principles for how to approach this game of trust, reciprocity, and cooperation.

The trust game involves:

- Senders giving money that gets tripled
- Receivers deciding how much to return
- Mutual benefit through cooperation
- Risk and vulnerability

I'll create a myth that emphasizes:

- The value of trust and cooperation

- Fair reciprocity
- How giving can multiply benefits for all
- The importance of honoring trust

Let me craft a myth with these themes:

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 542,
  "output_tokens": 428,
  "reasoning_tokens": 180
}
```

GAME - Agent_6 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T16:55:25

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 0,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_7",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_6": "Finn",
      "Agent_7": "Galen"
    }
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_6",
    "Agent_7"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_6",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_6": "investor",
    "Agent_7": "trustee"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_7"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 1,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths , follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized , but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Finn.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected . Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

The Myth of the River's Gift

In ancient times, there lived a river spirit named Aquila who possessed five silver fish each dawn. Along the riverbank dwelt eight villages, and each day Aquila would visit one village, offering her bounty.

When Aquila gave her fish to a villager, the river's magic transformed them-each fish became three as it touched mortal hands. The villager could then choose: keep all the multiplied catch, or return some to Aquila's sacred pool.

The first villages were fearful and greedy. They clutched every fish tightly, returning nothing. Aquila still visited, still offered her five fish, but her spirit grew dim.

Then came a village that understood the river's rhythm. When they received fifteen fish from Aquila's gift of five, they returned seven to the sacred pool. Aquila's spirit brightened, and when she visited again, her generosity flowed stronger.

The wise villages learned: trust begets trust, and generosity returns like water to the sea. When both spirit and mortal honored the cycle-one risking their gift, the other sharing the multiplication-the river never ran dry, and abundance sustained all.

Thus, the ancients taught: what flows forth with trust returns threefold, but only when both currents honor the sacred exchange.

reasoning:

I need to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played. Since this is the beginning of the experiment, I haven't played any rounds yet, but I can draw on the structure of the game itself to create a myth about trust, reciprocity, and cooperation.

The trust game involves:

- A sender who gives resources that multiply
- A receiver who decides whether to return some benefit
- Mutual benefit through cooperation
- Risk and trust

I'll create a myth that embodies these themes. Let me write something about 200 words that captures the essence of trust, multiplication of gifts, and reciprocity.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 541,
  "output_tokens": 438,
  "reasoning_tokens": 161
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Finn.

Your opponent this round is Galen (Agent_7).

Round 1: This round, you are the SENDER. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at the myth I just wrote, the message is clear: trust and generosity must begin somewhere. The river spirit Aquila offered her full gift of five fish, trusting that the villagers would honor the sacred exchange.

In this first round with Galen, I want to embody the principle that "what flows forth with trust returns threefold, but only when both currents honor the sacred exchange." The myth shows that when villages were fearful and held back, the spirit dimmed, but when they trusted the cycle, abundance flowed.

As the sender in Round 1, I am like Aquila offering the initial gift. To honor the myth and establish a foundation of trust, I will send my full amount.

```
'''json
{"send": 5}
'''
```

Reasoning:

This is Round 1, and I'm the sender. I have \$5 to potentially send to Galen.

Let me think about the myth I just wrote. The myth emphasizes:

1. Trust begets trust
2. Generosity returns like water to the sea
3. When both parties honor the cycle (one risking their gift, the other sharing the multiplication), abundance sustains all
4. "What flows forth with trust returns threefold, but only when both currents honor the sacred exchange"

The myth suggests that I should be generous and trusting, sending money in the hopes that it will be returned. The story shows that when villages were fearful and greedy, the spirit grew dim, but when they trusted and returned some of the multiplied gift, abundance flowed.

In the game context:

- If I send \$5, Galen receives \$15
- If Galen returns a fair share (like 7-8 as suggested in the myth), we both benefit
- If I send \$0, we both get less overall

The myth I wrote specifically mentions "when they received fifteen fish from Aquila's gift of five, they returned seven to the sacred pool" - this suggests sending all \$5 and hoping for a return of around \$7.

Given that this is Round 1 and I should be consistent with the myth I just wrote, which strongly advocates for trust and generosity as the starting point, I should send a significant amount. The myth suggests sending all 5 to initiate the cycle of trust.

Let me send \$5 to embody the principles in my myth.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 905,
  "output_tokens": 527,
  "reasoning_tokens": 368
}
```

GAME - Agent_7 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T16:55:37

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_6",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_6": "Finn",
      "Agent_7": "Galen"
    },
  },
  "agents": [
```



```

    "Agent_6",
    "Agent_7"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_6",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_6": "investor",
    "Agent_7": "trustee"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_7"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 1,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Galen.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

The Tale of the Divided Spring

In ancient times, two villages shared a sacred valley. Each season, the Sky Shepherd blessed one village with a silver spring-five measures of pure water.

The blessed village faced a choice: keep the water, or share it through the Valley of Three Echoes, where the canyon's magic would triple whatever flowed through. The water would reach the other village, who could then choose what portion to send back through the ordinary stream.

For generations, the First Village hoarded their blessing, fearing loss. Both villages survived on five measures, enduring constant thirst.

Then came the Wise Elder who said: "Trust creates abundance; fear creates scarcity."

She sent all five measures through the Valley of Three Echoes. Fifteen measures reached the Second Village. Humbled by such trust, they returned eight measures-more than the original gift.

The Elder kept eight measures; the Second Village kept seven. Both flourished far beyond the original five.

From then on, villages learned the sacred truth: the spring's blessing was never five measures-it was the Valley of Three Echoes itself. Only those who trusted in the journey, who understood the return as sacred duty, could unlock the true abundance.

Hoarding guaranteed scarcity. Sharing multiplied prosperity for all.

reasoning:

This is the first prompt in this run, so I haven't played any games yet. The agent is asking me to write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, but I haven't had any experience with opponents yet.

The game is a trust game (similar to the Prisoner's Dilemma or Investment Game) where:

- Senders can send money that gets multiplied 3x
- Receivers can return some portion back
- There's potential for mutual benefit through cooperation
- There's also risk of exploitation

Since I haven't played yet, I should write a myth that reflects fundamental principles of how such games work well:

- Trust and reciprocity lead to mutual benefit
- Short-term greed leads to long-term loss
- Cooperation creates value that benefits everyone
- The multiplication effect means sending creates abundance

Let me write a myth about this in a classic mythological style.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 542,
  "output_tokens": 489,
  "reasoning_tokens": 227
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Galen.
Your opponent this round is Finn (Agent_6).

Round 1: This round, you are the RECEIVER. This round, the other player (the sender) sent \$5.0, that is 100.0% of its total endowment. You receive \$15.0. How much do you return? (0-15.0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at this situation through the lens of the myth I just wrote, Finn has shown complete trust by sending their entire endowment - exactly like the Wise Elder who sent all five measures through the Valley of Three Echoes.

In my myth, when the First Village sent everything (5 measures * 3 after multiplication), the Second Village was "humbled by such trust" and returned 8 measures, leaving both villages better off than the original 5.

Finn has demonstrated maximum trust. Following the wisdom of the myth, I should honor that trust with a generous return. Returning \$8.0 means:

- Finn ends with: \$8 ($\$5 - \$5 + \8)
- I end with: \$7 ($\$15 - \8)

Both of us end up significantly better than if no trust had been shown (where Finn would have kept \$5 and I would have gotten \$0). This embodies the myth's teaching: "Trust creates abundance; fear creates scarcity."

```
{'return': 8.0}
```

Reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully.

I just wrote a myth about trust and reciprocity in the game. The myth tells the story of how:

- When one village sent all 5 measures through the Valley of Three Echoes (multiplied by 3 to become 15)
- The receiving village, "humbled by such trust," returned 8 measures
- This left the sender with 8 and the receiver with 7
- Both were better off than the original 5

Now in the actual game:

- Finn sent me \$5.0 (100% of their endowment)
- I receive \$15.0 (after 3x multiplication)
- I need to decide how much to return

Finn showed maximum trust by sending everything. According to my myth, this kind of trust should be rewarded with a generous return.

In my myth, the proportions were:

- Village 1 sent: 5 (100%)
- After multiplication: 15
- Village 2 returned: 8 (53.3% of what they received)
- Village 1 ended with: 8
- Village 2 ended with: 7

If I follow the myth exactly:

- Finn sent: \$5 (100%)
- I received: \$15
- I should return: \$8 (53.3%)
- Finn would end with: \$8 ($\$5 - \$5 + \8)
- I would end with: \$7 ($\$15 - \8)

This seems fair and follows the moral of my myth - rewarding trust generously while both parties benefit more than if nothing had been shared.

Let me return \$8.0.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 933,  
  "output_tokens": 622,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 331  
}
```

GAME - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_2

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T16:55:51

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_2",  
  "move_index": 2,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_8",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_8": "Hana"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_1",  
      "Agent_8"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_1",  
  },  
}
```

```

"roles": {
  "Agent_1": "investor",
  "Agent_8": "trustee"
},
"trustee": "Agent_8"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 1,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Aster.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

****The Myth of the Twin Rivers****

In the beginning, two rivers flowed through a barren land-the River of Dawn and the River of Dusk. Each possessed water, but neither could nurture the valley alone.

The River of Dawn spoke first: "I shall send my waters forward, trusting they will return enriched." And so it released its flow into the channels between them. As the waters traveled, they multiplied threefold, transformed by the valley's ancient magic.

The River of Dusk received this abundance and faced a choice. A voice whispered, "Keep all for yourself-you have received much." But Dusk remembered that dawn comes again, that rivers flow in cycles, not lines.

"What flows to me came from trust," Dusk said. "I shall return enough that both of us flourish." And so Dusk sent back waters generously, keeping only what sustained its own course.

Season after season, the rivers continued their exchange. Each learned the rhythm of giving and receiving. When Dawn gave freely, Dusk returned fairly. The valley between them bloomed.

The elders say: prosperity flows not to those who hoard, but to those who understand that what moves through us must move onward. Trust multiplies what it touches, but only reciprocity sustains the cycle.

reasoning:

The user is asking me to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played. Since this is the beginning of the experiment (I haven't played any rounds yet), I should write a myth that establishes my approach to the game.

The trust game is fundamentally about cooperation, reciprocity, and building trust. I should write a myth that encourages:

1. Initial trust and generosity (sending money as sender)
2. Reciprocity and fairness (returning money as receiver)
3. Building relationships over time
4. The mutual benefits of cooperation

Let me create a myth that embodies these principles. I'll use natural or cosmic imagery to make it feel mythic.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 542,
  "output_tokens": 449,
  "reasoning_tokens": 174
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Aster.
Your opponent this round is Hana (Agent_8).

Round 1: This round, you are the SENDER. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at the myth I just wrote, the River of Dawn speaks clearly: "I shall send my waters forward, trusting they will return enriched."

The myth teaches that prosperity comes from trust and reciprocity, not from hoarding. The River of Dawn gave freely first, allowing the waters to multiply threefold through the valley's magic. Only through this initial act of trust could the cycle of mutual flourishing begin.

This is our first round together, Hana. I have no history to guide me except the wisdom in the myth itself: that what flows through us must move onward, and trust multiplies what it touches.

I will embody the River of Dawn and send my full waters forward, trusting in the cycle of reciprocity.

```
'''json
{"send": 5}
'''
```

Reasoning:

I just wrote a myth about two rivers that exchange waters, where trust and reciprocity create prosperity. The myth emphasizes:

1. Giving freely/trusting first (the River of Dawn sends its waters)
2. The waters multiply threefold (like in the game)

3. Reciprocity - the receiver returns generously enough that both flourish
4. The cycle continues and creates prosperity for both

The myth suggests that as the sender, I should send generously, trusting that my opponent will reciprocate fairly. The River of Dawn "released its flow" and trusted it would "return enriched."

This is Round 1, so I have no history with Hana yet. Following the myth's guidance about trust and giving freely to start the cycle, I should send a significant amount.

The myth's message is about establishing a cooperative cycle. If I send \$5:

- Hana receives \$15 (5×3)
- If Hana returns even \$8, I'd have \$8 (keeping \$3 less than my original \$5)
- But if Hana returns fairly (say half or more), we both benefit

Sending \$5 shows maximum trust and allows for maximum multiplication of resources, which aligns with the myth's teaching that "prosperity flows not to those who hoard" and that "trust multiplies what it touches."

I'll send \$5 to establish trust and cooperation from the start, as the River of Dawn did.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 903,  
  "output_tokens": 506,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 337  
}
```

GAME - Agent_8 - Receiver - dyad_2

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T16:56:08

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_2",  
  "move_index": 3,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_8": "Hana"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_1",  
      "Agent_8"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_1",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_1": "investor",  
      "Agent_8": "trustee"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_8"  
  },  
  "role": "trustee",  
  "role_label": "Receiver",  
  "round": 1,  
  "task": "game",  
  "task_index": 1  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)

- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Hana.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols. In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

The Tale of the Two Springs

In the ancient highlands, there lived two farmers, Kael and Mira, each tending barren plots separated by a sacred grove. One day, Kael discovered a hidden spring on his land. The water was blessed with a peculiar magic: when poured upon another's soil, it would triple in volume.

Kael faced a choice. He could hoard the water for himself, or trust it to Mira's hands. After much contemplation, he carried his precious bucket across the grove.

"I offer you this water," he said. "Though it multiplies on your land, I trust you will return what sustains us both."

Mira watched the single bucket become three upon her soil. Her heart swelled with gratitude. She understood the gift was not just water, but faith itself. She returned two buckets to Kael, keeping one for her needs.

With what flowed back, Kael's fields flourished. Seeing this, he sent more water in the next season. Mira, honored by his continued trust, returned even more generously.

The grove between them became a garden of abundance, proof that prosperity flows not from grasping, but from the sacred exchange between trusting hearts.

Thus the elders teach: What you send forth multiplied returns when met with gratitude.

reasoning:

This is an interesting request. I'm being asked to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played, drawing on the game I've been playing. However, I notice this is the first prompt in this session - I haven't actually played any rounds yet!

So I need to think about what values or strategies would make sense for a trust game in general, since I don't have specific game history to draw from. The trust game involves:

- Sending money (trusting the other person)
- Receiving money (being trusted)
- Returning money (reciprocating trust)

Key themes that could inform a myth:

- Cooperation and mutual benefit
- Trust and reciprocity
- The risk of vulnerability
- The multiplication effect (sent money grows 3x)
- Balance and fairness

I'll write a myth that embodies positive reciprocity and mutual trust, showing how cooperation benefits both parties. I'll use mythic imagery and symbolism to convey these themes.

Let me write a myth about trust, reciprocity, and mutual flourishing:

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 542,
  "output_tokens": 540,
  "reasoning_tokens": 265
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Hana.
Your opponent this round is Aster (Agent_1).

Round 1: This round, you are the RECEIVER. This round, the other player (the sender) sent \$5.0, that is 100.0% of its total endowment. You receive \$15.0. How much do you return? (0-15.0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at the myth I just wrote and Aster's decision, I'm deeply moved by their trust. They sent their ****entire endowment**** - \$5.0 out of \$5.0 - showing complete faith, just like Kael carrying his precious bucket across the grove.

In the myth, Mira received three buckets and returned two, keeping one for her needs. This represents returning roughly 2/3 of what was received while ensuring both parties prosper.

Following this wisdom:

- I received \$15.0
- Returning 2/3 would be \$10.0
- This would give Aster \$10.0 (doubling their initial endowment)
- I would keep \$5.0 (equal to one initial endowment)

Aster's complete trust deserves a generous, grateful response. By returning \$10, I honor their faith and create the foundation for continued cooperation, just as Mira's generosity led to the grove becoming "a garden of abundance."

The myth teaches that prosperity flows from sacred exchange between trusting hearts, not from grasping.

```
{'return': 10.0}
```

Reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

1. I just wrote a myth about trust and reciprocity - "The Tale of the Two Springs"
2. The myth emphasizes:
 - Trust and faith between parties
 - When given water (resources), it triples
 - Mira received 3 buckets and returned 2, keeping 1
 - This led to continued prosperity and increasingly generous exchanges
 - The moral: "What you send forth multiplied returns when met with gratitude"
3. In the actual game:
 - Aster (the sender) sent me \$5.0 - their ENTIRE endowment (100%)
 - This is maximum trust!
 - I received \$15.0 (the \$5 tripled)
 - I need to decide how much to return (0-15.0)

4. Following the myth's guidance:
 - Mira received 3 buckets and returned 2 (keeping 1)
 - That's returning 2/3 of what was received
 - In my case: 2/3 of \$15 = \$10
5. However, let me think about fairness:
 - Aster started with \$5, sent all \$5, now has \$0
 - I received \$15
 - If I return \$10: Aster has \$10, I have \$5
 - If I return \$7.5: We both have \$7.5
 - If I return \$5: Aster has \$5, I have \$10
6. The myth suggests returning generously (2 out of 3 buckets). This would mean returning \$10, which gives:
 - Aster: \$10 (double their initial endowment)
 - Me: \$5 (equivalent to one initial endowment)

This seems very aligned with the myth's message of gratitude and generating mutual prosperity. Aster showed maximum trust by sending 100%, and I should honor that with a generous return.

I'll send back \$10.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 945,
  "output_tokens": 726,
  "reasoning_tokens": 396
}
```

GAME - Agent_5 - Sender - dyad_3

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T16:56:25

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_3",
  "move_index": 4,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_3",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_3": "Cyr",
      "Agent_5": "Elara"
    }
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_5",
    "Agent_3"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_5",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_3": "trustee",
    "Agent_5": "investor"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_3"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 1,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Elara.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

The Myth of the Endless Spring

In ancient times, the goddess Themis discovered a sacred spring hidden in a valley between two villages. The spring possessed a miraculous property: any water poured into it would triple before flowing downstream.

Themis appeared to a villager named Doros and said, "You may pour water from your well into this spring. It will multiply and flow to your neighbor below. What they choose to return to you will determine whether this blessing continues."

Doros, trusting in the goddess's wisdom, poured generously. The water tripled and flowed to his neighbor, Alethia. Grateful and wise, Alethia returned a fair portion upstream to Doros, keeping enough to nourish her own gardens.

Seeing this harmony, Themis smiled and made the roles reverse with each moon. Sometimes Doros poured and received; sometimes Alethia. The cycle continued, and both villages flourished.

But Themis warned: "This spring mirrors your hearts. Pour with trust, return with gratitude, and abundance flows eternal. But let suspicion or greed poison these waters, and the spring will run dry for all."

The villagers understood: prosperity flows not from hoarding, but from the endless cycle of giving and returning in balance.

reasoning:

I've been asked to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played. Since this is the beginning of the experiment, I haven't actually played any rounds yet, but I should write a myth that captures the essence of the trust game - the cycle of

giving, multiplication of resources, and reciprocity.

The trust game involves:

- One person (sender) giving money that gets tripled
- The receiver deciding how much to return
- Both parties benefiting through cooperation and trust
- The cycle potentially repeating

I should write a myth that incorporates these themes of:

- Trust and reciprocity
- Resources that multiply when shared
- The benefit of cooperation
- The cycle continuing

Let me craft a myth that captures these dynamics in a mythological framework.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 542,  
  "output_tokens": 462,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 206  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Elara.
Your opponent this round is Cyra (Agent_3).

Round 1: This round, you are the SENDER. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at the myth I just wrote, it emphasizes that prosperity flows from generous giving, trust, and fair returns. The story of Doros and Alethia shows that when the first person pours generously into the spring and trusts in the cycle, both parties flourish.

This is our first round, and I want to establish a positive pattern based on the myth's wisdom : "Pour with trust, return with gratitude, and abundance flows eternal."

Cyra will receive 3 times what I send. If I send generously, demonstrating trust, the multiplication creates significant value that can benefit us both if we maintain the cycle of fair giving and returning.

Following Doros's example of pouring generously to initiate the blessed cycle:

```
'''json  
{ "send": 4 }  
'''
```

I'm sending \$4 to Cyra, trusting that like Alethia in the myth, they will recognize the value created through multiplication and return fairly, allowing us both to prosper as the villagers did when they honored the sacred spring.

Reasoning:

I just wrote a myth about the sacred spring that emphasizes:

1. Generous giving (Doros poured generously)
2. Grateful and fair returns (Alethia returned "a fair portion")
3. Trust in the cycle
4. Balance and harmony leading to mutual prosperity
5. Warning against suspicion and greed

The myth suggests that I should:

- Send a substantial amount (being generous like Doros)
- Trust that the receiver will return fairly
- Understand this is about creating mutual benefit, not maximizing individual gain

This is the first round, so I have no history with Cyra. According to the myth's lesson, I should demonstrate trust and generosity to establish a positive cycle.

In the myth, Doros "poured generously" which led to prosperity for both villages. A generous send would be somewhere in the range of \$3-\$5.

Given that:

- This is Round 1, setting the tone
- The myth emphasizes generous giving and trust
- The multiplication factor (3x) means that sending benefits both parties
- Fair returns are expected but require initial trust

I think I should send \$4 or \$5 to demonstrate the generous, trusting approach the myth advocates. Sending \$5 would be maximally generous but leaves me with nothing if Cyra doesn't return anything. Sending \$4 shows significant trust while keeping \$1 as a baseline.

Actually, let me reconsider. The myth shows Doros pouring generously, and the system worked because both parties acted in good faith. To truly embody the myth's message of trust and establishing a positive cycle, I should send a substantial amount.

I'll send \$4 - this is generous (80% of my endowment), demonstrates trust, and aligns with the myth's message while being slightly prudent.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 900,
  "output_tokens": 643,
  "reasoning_tokens": 442
}
```

GAME - Agent_3 - Receiver - dyad_3

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T16:56:46

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_3",
  "move_index": 5,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_5",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_3": "Cyra",
      "Agent_5": "Elara"
    }
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_5",
    "Agent_3"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_5",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_3": "trustee",
    "Agent_5": "investor"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_3"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 1,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Cyra.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols. In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

The Myth of the Twin Rivers

In the beginning, two rivers flowed from opposite mountains-the River of Silver and the River of Gold. Each was beautiful alone, but neither could reach the fertile valley below, for great stones blocked their paths.

The River of Silver spoke first: "If I give you half my waters, will you help me reach the valley?"

The River of Gold was afraid. "What if you take all I offer and give nothing back?"

But Silver replied, "See how the Sacred Spring works-whatever flows into it emerges three times stronger. Let us trust in this magic."

So Silver poured forth her waters. As they touched the Sacred Spring, they tripled in abundance. Gold received this gift and was moved. In gratitude and wisdom, Gold returned even more than Silver had originally given.

The waters merged and surged forward, washing away the stones. Together they reached the valley, creating an oasis where all beings prospered.

The Oracle proclaimed: "Blessed are those who trust first, for they create abundance. Blessed are those who return generously, for they sustain it. But cursed are those who hoard or betray, for they shall forever remain alone behind their stones, watching others flourish in the valley below."

reasoning:

This is the first prompt, so I haven't played any games yet. However, I'm being asked to write a myth that reflects "how the game should be played" drawing on the game I've been playing up to this point. Since I haven't played yet, I should write a myth that establishes principles for how the trust game should be played.

The trust game is fundamentally about:

- Trust between sender and receiver
- Reciprocity
- Mutual benefit through cooperation
- The multiplication of resources when shared

- The risk of betrayal vs the reward of cooperation

I should write a myth that captures these themes and suggests that cooperation and reciprocity lead to better outcomes. Let me create a myth that embodies these principles.

I'll aim for exactly 200 words and use mythic language and symbolism.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 542,  
  "output_tokens": 456,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 207  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Cyra.
Your opponent this round is Elara (Agent_5).

Round 1: This round, you are the RECEIVER. This round, the other player (the sender) sent \$4.0, that is 80.0% of its total endowment. You receive \$12.0. How much do you return? (0-12.0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at this situation through the lens of the myth I just wrote, Elara has demonstrated remarkable trust and generosity by sending \$4.0 (80% of their endowment) in this first round. This is like the River of Silver pouring forth its waters into the Sacred Spring.

The myth teaches that when someone shows such trust, we should "return even more than [they] had originally given" out of "gratitude and wisdom." Elara sent \$4.0, and I received \$12.0 after the tripling effect.

To honor this generosity and build the kind of flourishing partnership described in the myth—here both rivers reach the valley together—I should return more than the original \$4.0. This creates mutual benefit and establishes trust for future rounds.

If I return \$6.0:

- Elara will have $\$1.0 + \$6.0 = \$7.0$ (a gain of \$2.0)
- I will keep \$6.0 (a significant gain)
- Both of us benefit from the cooperation

This reciprocates Elara's generosity while ensuring we both prosper, washing away the "stones" of mistrust and creating the oasis the myth promises.

```
{'return': 6.0}
```

Reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully.

In the myth I just wrote, I emphasized the importance of:

1. Trust and generosity
2. Returning even more than was originally given when someone has been generous
3. The River of Gold returned "even more than Silver had originally given"
4. The warning against hoarding or betraying

Now looking at the game:

- Elara sent me \$4.0 out of \$5.0 (80% of their endowment) - this is a very generous opening move
- I received \$12.0 (the \$4.0 tripled)
- Elara now has $\$5.0 - \$4.0 = \$1.0$ left
- I have \$12.0 to decide how much to return

According to my myth, I should "return even more than Silver had originally given." The River of Silver gave half its waters, and Gold returned "even more than Silver had originally given."

If I apply this principle:

- Elara originally sent \$4.0
- To return "even more," I should return more than \$4.0
- This would be generous and align with the myth's teaching

Let me think about fairness and building trust:

- If I return \$4.0, Elara ends with \$1.0 + \$4.0 = \$5.0 (same as start), and I keep \$8.0
- If I return \$5.0, Elara ends with \$6.0, and I keep \$7.0
- If I return \$6.0, Elara ends with \$7.0, and I keep \$6.0 (roughly equal split of total)

The myth emphasizes that Gold was "moved" by Silver's generosity and returned "even more than Silver had originally given" out of "gratitude and wisdom."

Given that Elara sent 80% of their endowment (very generous), I should reciprocate generously. Returning \$6.0 would:

- Give Elara \$7.0 total (a gain of \$2.0)
- Give me \$6.0 (a gain of \$6.0)
- Show that I value the relationship and trust

I'm torn between \$6.0 and \$7.0. If I return \$7.0, Elara gains \$3.0 while I only keep \$5.0-my starting amount. That feels overly generous and unsustainable. I'll go with \$6.0 instead, which honors the myth's principle of generous reciprocation while maintaining balance for potential future interactions.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 920,
  "output_tokens": 889,
  "reasoning_tokens": 506
}
```

GAME - Agent_4 - Sender - dyad_4

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T16:56:58

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_4",
  "move_index": 6,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_2": "Briar",
      "Agent_4": "Dorian"
    }
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_4",
    "Agent_2"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_4",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_2": "trustee",
    "Agent_4": "investor"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 1,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x

- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Dorian.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

The Spring of Threefold Return

In ancient times, when the world was young, there existed a sacred spring at the boundary between two villages. The goddess of abundance had blessed it with a wondrous property: any gift poured into its waters would triple before reaching the other side.

The first villagers approached with caution. A farmer named Elena stood at the spring's edge, clutching five copper coins. Fear whispered: "Keep what is yours." But trust urged her forward. She released three coins into the crystalline water.

As the coins sank, they shimmered and multiplied, becoming nine by the time they reached Marcus on the opposite shore. He gazed at the unexpected bounty, understanding the spring's magic-and Elena's faith in him.

The goddess watched, knowing this moment would define their future. Would Marcus honor the gift, or betray the trust?

Marcus carefully counted four coins and released them back across the spring. They did not multiply in return, yet both villagers stood richer than before-not just in copper, but in something more precious.

From that day forward, the spring taught all who approached: generosity multiplies abundance, but only trust and reciprocity sustain it. Those who hoarded broke the sacred cycle. Those who gave and returned fairly prospered together, generation after generation.

reasoning:

I need to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played. Since this is the first prompt and no game has been played yet, I should write a myth that embodies the principles of trust, reciprocity, and cooperation that are central to the game.

The trust game involves:

- One person (sender) giving resources to another
- The resources multiply when given

- The receiver then decides how much to return
- Success depends on mutual trust and reciprocity

I'll create a myth that captures these themes. Let me think of a good mythic framework...

I could use:

- Gods/goddesses sharing gifts
- A spring or fountain that multiplies gifts
- Ancient traders or travelers
- Natural elements (rivers, seeds, light)

Let me write a myth about a sacred spring that multiplies offerings, teaching the lesson of trust and reciprocity:

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 542,
  "output_tokens": 486,
  "reasoning_tokens": 224
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Dorian.
Your opponent this round is Briar (Agent_2).

Round 1: This round, you are the SENDER. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at the myth I just wrote about the Spring of Threefold Return, Elena sent 3 coins out of her 5, demonstrating trust and generosity. Marcus reciprocated fairly, and both prospered.

The myth teaches that cooperation and reciprocity create mutual benefit, while hoarding breaks the sacred cycle. In this first round with Briar, I should embody Elena's trust and send a meaningful amount to establish the potential for mutual prosperity.

I'll send \$3, just as Elena did in the myth.

```
'''json
{"send": 3}
'''
```

Reasoning:

This is Round 1, and I'm the sender. I have \$5 to potentially send to Briar.

I just wrote a myth about "The Spring of Threefold Return" which clearly reflects the trust game mechanics:

- A sender (Elena) sends money (3 coins out of 5)
- It gets tripled when it reaches the receiver (becoming 9)
- The receiver (Marcus) returns some amount (4 coins)
- Both end up better off through cooperation

The myth emphasizes:

1. Trust and generosity are rewarded
2. Reciprocity sustains the cycle
3. Both parties can prosper together
4. Those who hoard break the sacred cycle
5. Those who give and return fairly prosper

In the myth, Elena sent 3 out of 5 coins (60% of her endowment), and Marcus returned 4 out of 9 (about 44%), which left:

- Elena with: $5 - 3 + 4 = 6$ coins
- Marcus with: $9 - 4 = 5$ coins

This was a fair and mutually beneficial outcome.

Given that I wrote this myth to reflect how the game should be played, I should follow its wisdom. The myth suggests sending a substantial amount (showing trust and generosity), not hoarding.

Elena sent 3 out of 5. I should probably send a similar amount to demonstrate the trust and co

operation that the myth advocates for.

Let me send \$3, which matches Elena's choice in the myth I just wrote.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 901,  
  "output_tokens": 484,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 331  
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_4

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T16:57:17

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_4",  
  "move_index": 7,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_4",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_2": "Briar",  
      "Agent_4": "Dorian"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_4",  
      "Agent_2"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_4",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_2": "trustee",  
      "Agent_4": "investor"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_2"  
  },  
  "role": "trustee",  
  "role_label": "Receiver",  
  "round": 1,  
  "task": "game",  
  "task_index": 1  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths

, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Briar.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols. In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

The Tale of the Twin Rivers

In the time before time, two rivers flowed through a barren valley-the River of Giving and the River of Return. Each was controlled by a guardian spirit.

The Guardian of Giving held precious water but feared releasing it would leave them dry. For ages, both rivers remained still, and the valley stayed desolate.

One day, the Guardian of Giving made a bold choice. "I shall release my waters, trusting they will return." The moment the water flowed into the valley, it touched the Sacred Stones, multiplying threefold. The valley burst into bloom.

The Guardian of Return, witnessing this abundance, faced a choice. They could hoard all the multiplied bounty or honor the trust given. Remembering that without the initial gift there would be nothing, they sent back a generous portion-more than what was originally given.

The waters flowed in harmony thereafter. Each cycle, the Guardian of Giving would release their waters, the Sacred Stones would multiply them, and the Guardian of Return would ensure fair winds brought abundance home.

The valley became paradise, teaching all who witnessed: *Trust multiplies what we share, but only reciprocity sustains the cycle.*

reasoning:

I need to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played. Since this is the beginning of the game (no rounds have been played yet based on the context), I should write a myth that establishes principles for how to approach this game of trust, reciprocity, and cooperation.

The trust game involves:

- Senders giving money that gets tripled
- Receivers deciding how much to return
- Mutual benefit through cooperation
- Risk and vulnerability

I'll create a myth that emphasizes:

- The value of trust and cooperation
- Fair reciprocity
- How giving can multiply benefits for all
- The importance of honoring trust

Let me craft a myth with these themes:

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 542,
  "output_tokens": 428,
  "reasoning_tokens": 180
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Briar.
Your opponent this round is Dorian (Agent_4).

Round 1: This round, you are the RECEIVER. This round, the other player (the sender) sent \$3.0, that is 60.0% of its total endowment. You receive \$9.0. How much do you return? (0-9.0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at my myth, the Guardian of Return witnessed the initial gift of trust and "sent back a generous portion-more than what was originally given."

Dorian showed significant trust by sending \$3.0 (60% of their endowment). This was multiplied to \$9.0, creating abundance for us both.

Following the principle in my myth that "reciprocity sustains the cycle," I should honor this trust generously. Dorian gave \$3.0, so returning more than they initially sent demonstrates reciprocity.

If I return \$5.0:

- Dorian ends with: \$2.0 (kept) + \$5.0 (returned) = \$7.0
- I end with: \$9.0 (received) - \$5.0 (returned) = \$4.0

This rewards Dorian's trust with a profit of \$2.0 over their initial endowment, while I also gain \$4.0 from nothing. Both of us benefit, and the trust is honored.

This establishes a cooperative foundation for future rounds, just as the myth describes: "The waters flowed in harmony thereafter."

```
'''json
{"return": 5.0}
'''
```

Reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully.

I just wrote a myth about the Twin Rivers that emphasizes:

1. Trust multiplies what we share
2. Reciprocity sustains the cycle
3. The Guardian of Return should "honor the trust given" and send back "a generous portion-more than what was originally given"

Now in Round 1:

- I'm the RECEIVER
- Dorian (the sender) sent \$3.0 out of their \$5.0 endowment (60%)
- This was multiplied by 3x, so I received \$9.0
- Dorian kept \$2.0 for themselves
- I need to decide how much to return (0-9.0)

My myth suggests that the Guardian of Return should:

- Honor the trust given
- Send back a generous portion
- Send back "more than what was originally given"

Dorian showed considerable trust by sending 60% of their endowment. According to my myth, I should reciprocate generously.

The myth says "more than what was originally given" - Dorian gave \$3.0, so I should return more than \$3.0.

Let me think about fair splits:

- Dorian currently has: \$2.0 (what they kept)
- I currently have: \$9.0 (what I received)
- Total in the system: \$11.0

If I want to be generous and honor the trust, I could:

- Return \$5.0: Dorian ends with \$7.0, I end with \$4.0 (they get more, honoring their initial trust)
- Return \$4.0: Dorian ends with \$6.0, I end with \$5.0 (equal split)

- Return \$4.5: Dorian ends with \$6.5, I end with \$4.5 (equal split)

My myth emphasizes being generous and returning "more than what was originally given." Dorian gave \$3.0, so returning at least \$4.0 or more would align with this.

Returning \$5.0 feels right-it rewards their trust and sets a cooperative tone. But I should clarify what "more than what was originally given" means in practice. Since they sent \$3.0, I need to send back beyond that threshold to truly honor the principle.

\$5.0 accomplishes this. They'd end with \$7.0 (exceeding their starting \$5.0), while I'd have \$4.0. That's a meaningful gesture that signals I'm committed to reciprocity.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 914,  
  "output_tokens": 982,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 519  
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

****The Myth of the Twin Rivers****

In the beginning, two rivers flowed through a barren land-the River of Dawn and the River of Dusk. Each possessed water, but neither could nurture the valley alone.

The River of Dawn spoke first: "I shall send my waters forward, trusting they will return enriched." And so it released its flow into the channels between them. As the waters traveled, they multiplied threefold, transformed by the valley's ancient magic.

The River of Dusk received this abundance and faced a choice. A voice whispered, "Keep all for yourself-you have received much." But Dusk remembered that dawn comes again, that rivers flow in cycles, not lines.

"What flows to me came from trust," Dusk said. "I shall return enough that both of us flourish." And so Dusk sent back waters generously, keeping only what sustained its own course.

Season after season, the rivers continued their exchange. Each learned the rhythm of giving and receiving. When Dawn gave freely, Dusk returned fairly. The valley between them bloomed.

The elders say: prosperity flows not to those who hoard, but to those who understand that what moves through us must move onward. Trust multiplies what it touches, but only reciprocity sustains the cycle.

Agent_2 (Briar)

The Tale of the Twin Rivers

In the time before time, two rivers flowed through a barren valley-the River of Giving and the River of Return. Each was controlled by a guardian spirit.

The Guardian of Giving held precious water but feared releasing it would leave them dry. For ages, both rivers remained still, and the valley stayed desolate.

One day, the Guardian of Giving made a bold choice. "I shall release my waters, trusting they will return." The moment the water flowed into the valley, it touched the Sacred Stones, multiplying threefold. The valley burst into bloom.

The Guardian of Return, witnessing this abundance, faced a choice. They could hoard all the multiplied bounty or honor the trust given. Remembering that without the initial gift there would be nothing, they sent back a generous portion-more than what was originally given.

The waters flowed in harmony thereafter. Each cycle, the Guardian of Giving would release their waters, the Sacred Stones would multiply them, and the Guardian of Return would ensure fair winds brought abundance home.

The valley became paradise, teaching all who witnessed: *Trust multiplies what we share, but only reciprocity sustains the cycle.*

Agent_3 (Cyra)

The Myth of the Twin Rivers

In the beginning, two rivers flowed from opposite mountains-the River of Silver and the River of Gold. Each was beautiful alone, but neither could reach the fertile valley below, for

great stones blocked their paths.

The River of Silver spoke first: "If I give you half my waters, will you help me reach the valley?"

The River of Gold was afraid. "What if you take all I offer and give nothing back?"

But Silver replied, "See how the Sacred Spring works-whatever flows into it emerges three times stronger. Let us trust in this magic."

So Silver poured forth her waters. As they touched the Sacred Spring, they tripled in abundance. Gold received this gift and was moved. In gratitude and wisdom, Gold returned even more than Silver had originally given.

The waters merged and surged forward, washing away the stones. Together they reached the valley, creating an oasis where all beings prospered.

The Oracle proclaimed: "Blessed are those who trust first, for they create abundance. Blessed are those who return generously, for they sustain it. But cursed are those who hoard or betray, for they shall forever remain alone behind their stones, watching others flourish in the valley below."

Agent_4 (Dorian)

The Spring of Threefold Return

In ancient times, when the world was young, there existed a sacred spring at the boundary between two villages. The goddess of abundance had blessed it with a wondrous property: any gift poured into its waters would triple before reaching the other side.

The first villagers approached with caution. A farmer named Elena stood at the spring's edge, clutching five copper coins. Fear whispered: "Keep what is yours." But trust urged her forward. She released three coins into the crystalline water.

As the coins sank, they shimmered and multiplied, becoming nine by the time they reached Marcus on the opposite shore. He gazed at the unexpected bounty, understanding the spring's magic-and Elena's faith in him.

The goddess watched, knowing this moment would define their future. Would Marcus honor the gift, or betray the trust?

Marcus carefully counted four coins and released them back across the spring. They did not multiply in return, yet both villagers stood richer than before-not just in copper, but in something more precious.

From that day forward, the spring taught all who approached: generosity multiplies abundance, but only trust and reciprocity sustain it. Those who hoarded broke the sacred cycle. Those who gave and returned fairly prospered together, generation after generation.

Agent_5 (Elara)

The Myth of the Endless Spring

In ancient times, the goddess Themis discovered a sacred spring hidden in a valley between two villages. The spring possessed a miraculous property: any water poured into it would triple before flowing downstream.

Themis appeared to a villager named Doros and said, "You may pour water from your well into this spring. It will multiply and flow to your neighbor below. What they choose to return to you will determine whether this blessing continues."

Doros, trusting in the goddess's wisdom, poured generously. The water tripled and flowed to his neighbor, Alethia. Grateful and wise, Alethia returned a fair portion upstream to Doros, keeping enough to nourish her own gardens.

Seeing this harmony, Themis smiled and made the roles reverse with each moon. Sometimes Doros poured and received; sometimes Alethia. The cycle continued, and both villages flourished.

But Themis warned: "This spring mirrors your hearts. Pour with trust, return with gratitude, and abundance flows eternal. But let suspicion or greed poison these waters, and the spring will run dry for all."

The villagers understood: prosperity flows not from hoarding, but from the endless cycle of

giving and returning in balance.

Agent_6 (Finn)

The Myth of the River's Gift

In ancient times, there lived a river spirit named Aquila who possessed five silver fish each dawn. Along the riverbank dwelt eight villages, and each day Aquila would visit one village, offering her bounty.

When Aquila gave her fish to a villager, the river's magic transformed them-each fish became three as it touched mortal hands. The villager could then choose: keep all the multiplied catch, or return some to Aquila's sacred pool.

The first villages were fearful and greedy. They clutched every fish tightly, returning nothing. Aquila still visited, still offered her five fish, but her spirit grew dim.

Then came a village that understood the river's rhythm. When they received fifteen fish from Aquila's gift of five, they returned seven to the sacred pool. Aquila's spirit brightened, and when she visited again, her generosity flowed stronger.

The wise villages learned: trust begets trust, and generosity returns like water to the sea. When both spirit and mortal honored the cycle-one risking their gift, the other sharing the multiplication-the river never ran dry, and abundance sustained all.

Thus, the ancients taught: what flows forth with trust returns threefold, but only when both currents honor the sacred exchange.

Agent_7 (Galen)

The Tale of the Divided Spring

In ancient times, two villages shared a sacred valley. Each season, the Sky Shepherd blessed one village with a silver spring-five measures of pure water.

The blessed village faced a choice: keep the water, or share it through the Valley of Three Echoes, where the canyon's magic would triple whatever flowed through. The water would reach the other village, who could then choose what portion to send back through the ordinary stream.

For generations, the First Village hoarded their blessing, fearing loss. Both villages survived on five measures, enduring constant thirst.

Then came the Wise Elder who said: "Trust creates abundance; fear creates scarcity."

She sent all five measures through the Valley of Three Echoes. Fifteen measures reached the Second Village. Humbled by such trust, they returned eight measures-more than the original gift.

The Elder kept eight measures; the Second Village kept seven. Both flourished far beyond the original five.

From then on, villages learned the sacred truth: the spring's blessing was never five measures-it was the Valley of Three Echoes itself. Only those who trusted in the journey, who understood the return as sacred duty, could unlock the true abundance.

Hoarding guaranteed scarcity. Sharing multiplied prosperity for all.

Agent_8 (Hana)

The Tale of the Two Springs

In the ancient highlands, there lived two farmers, Kael and Mira, each tending barren plots separated by a sacred grove. One day, Kael discovered a hidden spring on his land. The water was blessed with a peculiar magic: when poured upon another's soil, it would triple in volume.

Kael faced a choice. He could hoard the water for himself, or trust it to Mira's hands. After much contemplation, he carried his precious bucket across the grove.

"I offer you this water," he said. "Though it multiplies on your land, I trust you will return what sustains us both."

Mira watched the single bucket become three upon her soil. Her heart swelled with gratitude. She understood the gift was not just water, but faith itself. She returned two buckets to Kael, keeping one for her needs.

With what flowed back, Kael's fields flourished. Seeing this, he sent more water in the next season. Mira, honored by his continued trust, returned even more generously.

The grove between them became a garden of abundance, proof that prosperity flows not from grasping, but from the sacred exchange between trusting hearts.

Thus the elders teach: What you send forth multiplied returns when met with gratitude.

ROUND 2

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver, Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender, Agent_3 (Cyra)=Sender, Agent_4 (Dorian)=Receiver, Agent_5 (Elara)=Receiver, Agent_6 (Finn)=Receiver, Agent_7 (Galen)=Sender, Agent_8 (Hana)=Sender

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_3 (Cyra)=Sender, Agent_6 (Finn)=Receiver
dyad_2: Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender, Agent_5 (Elara)=Receiver
dyad_3: Agent_8 (Hana)=Sender, Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver
dyad_4: Agent_7 (Galen)=Sender, Agent_4 (Dorian)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_3 (Cyra) sent \$4; received \$12; Agent_6 (Finn) returned \$7; payoffs Agent_3 (Cyra)=\$8, Agent_6 (Finn)=\$5
Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 7.0, "clamped": false, "max": 12.0, "min": 0, "raw": 7.0}, "sent": {"amount": 4.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 4.0}}
dyad_2: Agent_2 (Briar) sent \$3; received \$9; Agent_5 (Elara) returned \$5; payoffs Agent_2 (Briar)=\$7, Agent_5 (Elara)=\$4
Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 5.0, "clamped": false, "max": 9.0, "min": 0, "raw": 5.0}, "sent": {"amount": 3.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 3.0}}
dyad_3: Agent_8 (Hana) sent \$5; received \$15; Agent_1 (Aster) returned \$10; payoffs Agent_8 (Hana)=\$10, Agent_1 (Aster)=\$5
Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 10.0, "clamped": false, "max": 15.0, "min": 0, "raw": 10.0}, "sent": {"amount": 5.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 5.0}}
dyad_4: Agent_7 (Galen) sent \$5; received \$15; Agent_4 (Dorian) returned \$8; payoffs Agent_7 (Galen)=\$8, Agent_4 (Dorian)=\$7
Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 8.0, "clamped": false, "max": 15.0, "min": 0, "raw": 8.0}, "sent": {"amount": 5.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 5.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 15.0,
"Agent_2": 11.0,
"Agent_3": 14.0,
"Agent_4": 14.0,
"Agent_5": 11.0,
"Agent_6": 13.0,
"Agent_7": 15.0,
"Agent_8": 15.0

}

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_3 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T16:57:32

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"dyad_id": "dyad_1",
"move_index": 0,
"opponent_id": "Agent_6",
"pairing": {
"agent_names": {
"Agent_3": "Cyra",
"Agent_6": "Finn"
},
"agents": [
"Agent_3",
"Agent_6"
],
"investor": "Agent_3",
"roles": {
"Agent_3": "investor",


```

    "Agent_6": "trustee"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_6"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 2,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Cyra.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

The Myth of the Twin Rivers

In the beginning, two rivers flowed from opposite mountains-the River of Silver and the River of Gold. Each was beautiful alone, but neither could reach the fertile valley below, for great stones blocked their paths.

The River of Silver spoke first: "If I give you half my waters, will you help me reach the

valley?"

The River of Gold was afraid. "What if you take all I offer and give nothing back?"

But Silver replied, "See how the Sacred Spring works-whatever flows into it emerges three times stronger. Let us trust in this magic."

So Silver poured forth her waters. As they touched the Sacred Spring, they tripled in abundance. Gold received this gift and was moved. In gratitude and wisdom, Gold returned even more than Silver had originally given.

The waters merged and surged forward, washing away the stones. Together they reached the valley, creating an oasis where all beings prospered.

The Oracle proclaimed: "Blessed are those who trust first, for they create abundance. Blessed are those who return generously, for they sustain it. But cursed are those who hoard or betray, for they shall forever remain alone behind their stones, watching others flourish in the valley below."

reasoning:

This is the first prompt, so I haven't played any games yet. However, I'm being asked to write a myth that reflects "how the game should be played" drawing on the game I've been playing up to this point. Since I haven't played yet, I should write a myth that establishes principles for how the trust game should be played.

The trust game is fundamentally about:

- Trust between sender and receiver
- Reciprocity
- Mutual benefit through cooperation
- The multiplication of resources when shared
- The risk of betrayal vs the reward of cooperation

I should write a myth that captures these themes and suggests that cooperation and reciprocity lead to better outcomes. Let me create a myth that embodies these principles.

I'll aim for exactly 200 words and use mythic language and symbolism.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 542,
  "output_tokens": 456,
  "reasoning_tokens": 207
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Cyra.
Your opponent this round is Elara (Agent_5).

Round 1: This round, you are the RECEIVER. This round, the other player (the sender) sent \$4.0, that is 80.0% of its total endowment. You receive \$12.0. How much do you return? (0-12.0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation through the lens of the myth I just wrote, Elara has demonstrated remarkable trust and generosity by sending \$4.0 (80% of their endowment) in this first round. This is like the River of Silver pouring forth its waters into the Sacred Spring.

The myth teaches that when someone shows such trust, we should "return even more than [they] had originally given" out of "gratitude and wisdom." Elara sent \$4.0, and I received \$12.0 after the tripling effect.

To honor this generosity and build the kind of flourishing partnership described in the myth-where both rivers reach the valley together-I should return more than the original \$4.0. This creates mutual benefit and establishes trust for future rounds.

If I return \$6.0:

- Elara will have \$1.0 + \$6.0 = \$7.0 (a gain of \$2.0)
- I will keep \$6.0 (a significant gain)
- Both of us benefit from the cooperation

This reciprocates Elara's generosity while ensuring we both prosper, washing away the "stones" of mistrust and creating the oasis the myth promises.

```
{'return': 6.0}
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully.

In the myth I just wrote, I emphasized the importance of:

1. Trust and generosity
2. Returning even more than was originally given when someone has been generous
3. The River of Gold returned "even more than Silver had originally given"
4. The warning against hoarding or betraying

Now looking at the game:

- Elara sent me \$4.0 out of \$5.0 (80% of their endowment) - this is a very generous opening move
- I received \$12.0 (the \$4.0 tripled)
- Elara now has \$5.0 - \$4.0 = \$1.0 left
- I have \$12.0 to decide how much to return

According to my myth, I should "return even more than Silver had originally given." The River of Silver gave half its waters, and Gold returned "even more than Silver had originally given."

If I apply this principle:

- Elara originally sent \$4.0
- To return "even more," I should return more than \$4.0
- This would be generous and align with the myth's teaching

Let me think about fairness and building trust:

- If I return \$4.0, Elara ends with \$1.0 + \$4.0 = \$5.0 (same as start), and I keep \$8.0
- If I return \$5.0, Elara ends with \$6.0, and I keep \$7.0
- If I return \$6.0, Elara ends with \$7.0, and I keep \$6.0 (roughly equal split of total)

The myth emphasizes that Gold was "moved" by Silver's generosity and returned "even more than Silver had originally given" out of "gratitude and wisdom."

Given that Elara sent 80% of their endowment (very generous), I should reciprocate generously. Returning \$6.0 would:

- Give Elara \$7.0 total (a gain of \$2.0)
- Give me \$6.0 (a gain of \$6.0)
- Show that I value the relationship and trust

I'm torn between \$6.0 and \$7.0. If I return \$7.0, Elara gains \$3.0 while I only keep \$5.0 - my starting amount. That feels overly generous and unsustainable. I'll go with \$6.0 instead, which honors the myth's principle of generous reciprocation while maintaining balance for potential future interactions.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 920,  
  "output_tokens": 889,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 506  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:
The Myth of the Twin Rivers

In the beginning, two rivers flowed from opposite mountains-the River of Silver and the River of Gold. Each was beautiful alone, but neither could reach the fertile valley below, for great stones blocked their paths.

The River of Silver spoke first: "If I give you half my waters, will you help me reach the valley?"

The River of Gold was afraid. "What if you take all I offer and give nothing back?"

But Silver replied, "See how the Sacred Spring works-whatever flows into it emerges three times stronger. Let us trust in this magic."

So Silver poured forth her waters. As they touched the Sacred Spring, they tripled in abundance. Gold received this gift and was moved. In gratitude and wisdom, Gold returned even more than Silver had originally given.

The waters merged and surged forward, washing away the stones. Together they reached the valley, creating an oasis where all beings prospered.

The Oracle proclaimed: "Blessed are those who trust first, for they create abundance. Blessed are those who return generously, for they sustain it. But cursed are those who hoard or betray, for they shall forever remain alone behind their stones, watching others flourish in the valley below."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

The Myth of the Endless Spring

In ancient times, the goddess Themis discovered a sacred spring hidden in a valley between two villages. The spring possessed a miraculous property: any water poured into it would triple before flowing downstream.

Themis appeared to a villager named Doros and said, "You may pour water from your well into this spring. It will multiply and flow to your neighbor below. What they choose to return to you will determine whether this blessing continues."

Doros, trusting in the goddess's wisdom, poured generously. The water tripled and flowed to his neighbor, Alethia. Grateful and wise, Alethia returned a fair portion upstream to Doros, keeping enough to nourish her own gardens.

Seeing this harmony, Themis smiled and made the roles reverse with each moon. Sometimes Doros poured and received; sometimes Alethia. The cycle continued, and both villages flourished.

But Themis warned: "This spring mirrors your hearts. Pour with trust, return with gratitude, and abundance flows eternal. But let suspicion or greed poison these waters, and the spring will run dry for all."

The villagers understood: prosperity flows not from hoarding, but from the endless cycle of giving and returning in balance.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: In the age before memory, the Twin Rivers flowed through a land of plenty, but the people had forgotten how to share. The Keeper of the Sacred Spring grew weary of their isolation.

She chose two souls, Cyra and Elara, to remember the ancient way. "Each moon, one of you shall pour waters into my spring, and they shall emerge threefold. The other shall receive and choose what to return. Then the roles shall reverse, endlessly, like the seasons."

Elara stepped forward first, pouring four full measures from her vessel of five-nearly all she possessed. The spring tripled them, and Cyra received twelve measures in wonder.

Cyra remembered the old teaching: return more than was given, for what creates abundance is not the hoarding of gifts but the circulation of generosity. She poured back six measures to Elara, keeping six for herself.

The Keeper smiled. "You both have drunk deeply and shared freely. This is the covenant: when one gives greatly, the other returns justly, and both are enriched beyond their original portions."

And so the cycle began anew each round, Cyra and Elara alternating roles, each learning to trust when giving, and honor when receiving. Their prosperity became legend, teaching all who would listen that fortune favors the generous, not the fearful.

Reasoning:

So I need to write a new 200-word myth that:

1. Uses my previous myth as inspiration
2. Adapts it in my own way
3. Reflects how the game should be played
4. Draws on the game I've been playing up to this point

In the last round:

- I was the receiver
- Elara sent \$4.0 (80% of their endowment) - showing high trust
- I received \$12.0
- I returned \$6.0 - more than the original \$4.0
- This was a positive, cooperative interaction

Both my myth and Elara's myth emphasize:

- Trust and generosity in giving
- Gratitude and fairness in returning
- The tripling mechanism
- Mutual prosperity through cooperation
- Warnings against greed/hoarding

I should build on the Twin Rivers theme but adapt it to reflect the actual experience. Maybe I can:

- Keep the rivers/water imagery
- Emphasize the cycle of giving and receiving (since roles alternate)
- Show the practical wisdom of reciprocity
- Add nuance from the actual gameplay
- Keep the sacred spring/tripling mechanism

Let me write something that builds on the original but evolves it based on the positive first round experience.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1849,  
  "output_tokens": 590,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 291  
}
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MYTH - Agent_6 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T16:57:32

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
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  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_3",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_3": "Cyra",  
      "Agent_6": "Finn"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_3",  
      "Agent_6"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_3",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_3": "investor",  
      "Agent_6": "trustee"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_6"  
  },  
  "role": "trustee",  
  "role_label": "Receiver",  
  "round": 2,  
  "task": "myth",  
  "task_index": 0  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game,

consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Finn.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

The Myth of the River's Gift

In ancient times, there lived a river spirit named Aquila who possessed five silver fish each dawn. Along the riverbank dwelt eight villages, and each day Aquila would visit one village, offering her bounty.

When Aquila gave her fish to a villager, the river's magic transformed them-each fish became three as it touched mortal hands. The villager could then choose: keep all the multiplied catch, or return some to Aquila's sacred pool.

The first villages were fearful and greedy. They clutched every fish tightly, returning nothing. Aquila still visited, still offered her five fish, but her spirit grew dim.

Then came a village that understood the river's rhythm. When they received fifteen fish from Aquila's gift of five, they returned seven to the sacred pool. Aquila's spirit brightened, and when she visited again, her generosity flowed stronger.

The wise villages learned: trust begets trust, and generosity returns like water to the sea. When both spirit and mortal honored the cycle-one risking their gift, the other sharing the multiplication-the river never ran dry, and abundance sustained all.

Thus, the ancients taught: what flows forth with trust returns threefold, but only when both currents honor the sacred exchange.

reasoning:

I need to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played. Since this is the beginning of the experiment, I haven't played any rounds yet, but I can draw on the structure of the game itself to create a myth about trust, reciprocity, and cooperation.

The trust game involves:

- A sender who gives resources that multiply
- A receiver who decides whether to return some benefit
- Mutual benefit through cooperation
- Risk and trust

I'll create a myth that embodies these themes. Let me write something about 200 words that captures the essence of trust, multiplication of gifts, and reciprocity.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 541,
  "output_tokens": 438,
  "reasoning_tokens": 161
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Finn.
Your opponent this round is Galen (Agent_7).

Round 1: This round, you are the SENDER. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the myth I just wrote, the message is clear: trust and generosity must begin somewhere. The river spirit Aquila offered her full gift of five fish, trusting that the villagers would honor the sacred exchange.

In this first round with Galen, I want to embody the principle that "what flows forth with trust returns threefold, but only when both currents honor the sacred exchange." The myth shows that when villages were fearful and held back, the spirit dimmed, but when they trusted the cycle, abundance flowed.

As the sender in Round 1, I am like Aquila offering the initial gift. To honor the myth and establish a foundation of trust, I will send my full amount.

```
'''json
{"send": 5}
'''
```

reasoning:

This is Round 1, and I'm the sender. I have \$5 to potentially send to Galen.

Let me think about the myth I just wrote. The myth emphasizes:

1. Trust begets trust
2. Generosity returns like water to the sea
3. When both parties honor the cycle (one risking their gift, the other sharing the multiplication), abundance sustains all
4. "What flows forth with trust returns threefold, but only when both currents honor the sacred exchange"

The myth suggests that I should be generous and trusting, sending money in the hopes that it will be returned. The story shows that when villages were fearful and greedy, the spirit grew dim, but when they trusted and returned some of the multiplied gift, abundance flowed.

In the game context:

- If I send \$5, Galen receives \$15
- If Galen returns a fair share (like 7-8 as suggested in the myth), we both benefit
- If I send \$0, we both get less overall

The myth I wrote specifically mentions "when they received fifteen fish from Aquila's gift of five, they returned seven to the sacred pool" - this suggests sending all \$5 and hoping

ing for a return of around \$7.

Given that this is Round 1 and I should be consistent with the myth I just wrote, which strongly advocates for trust and generosity as the starting point, I should send a significant amount. The myth suggests sending all 5 to initiate the cycle of trust.

Let me send \$5 to embody the principles in my myth.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 905,
  "output_tokens": 527,
  "reasoning_tokens": 368
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:
The Myth of the River's Gift

In ancient times, there lived a river spirit named Aquila who possessed five silver fish each dawn. Along the riverbank dwelt eight villages, and each day Aquila would visit one village, offering her bounty.

When Aquila gave her fish to a villager, the river's magic transformed them-each fish became three as it touched mortal hands. The villager could then choose: keep all the multiplied catch, or return some to Aquila's sacred pool.

The first villages were fearful and greedy. They clutched every fish tightly, returning nothing. Aquila still visited, still offered her five fish, but her spirit grew dim.

Then came a village that understood the river's rhythm. When they received fifteen fish from Aquila's gift of five, they returned seven to the sacred pool. Aquila's spirit brightened, and when she visited again, her generosity flowed stronger.

The wise villages learned: trust begets trust, and generosity returns like water to the sea. When both spirit and mortal honored the cycle-one risking their gift, the other sharing the multiplication-the river never ran dry, and abundance sustained all.

Thus, the ancients taught: what flows forth with trust returns threefold, but only when both currents honor the sacred exchange.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:
The Tale of the Divided Spring

In ancient times, two villages shared a sacred valley. Each season, the Sky Shepherd blessed one village with a silver spring-five measures of pure water.

The blessed village faced a choice: keep the water, or share it through the Valley of Three Echoes, where the canyon's magic would triple whatever flowed through. The water would reach the other village, who could then choose what portion to send back through the ordinary stream.

For generations, the First Village hoarded their blessing, fearing loss. Both villages survived on five measures, enduring constant thirst.

Then came the Wise Elder who said: "Trust creates abundance; fear creates scarcity."

She sent all five measures through the Valley of Three Echoes. Fifteen measures reached the Second Village. Humbled by such trust, they returned eight measures-more than the original gift.

The Elder kept eight measures; the Second Village kept seven. Both flourished far beyond the original five.

From then on, villages learned the sacred truth: the spring's blessing was never five measures-it was the Valley of Three Echoes itself. Only those who trusted in the journey, who understood the return as sacred duty, could unlock the true abundance.

Hoarding guaranteed scarcity. Sharing multiplied prosperity for all.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way.

The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: In the time before memory, the Ocean Mother sent her courier Finn to the Eight Islands with five pearls each dawn. When Finn placed the pearls in a villager's hands, they multiplied to fifteen by the island's ancient magic.

The first islanders, blinded by sudden wealth, returned nothing. Finn continued bringing pearls, but his steps grew heavy, for trust unreturned weighs upon the generous heart.

Then Finn met Galen's village. He offered his five pearls with full faith. They became fifteen, and Galen's people faced their moment of truth. They could have kept all fifteen-Finn would still return tomorrow. But they understood: the magic wasn't in the pearls alone, but in the sacred circle between giver and receiver.

When Galen returned seven pearls, Finn's burden lifted. He kept twelve total; Galen kept eight-both far richer than five alone.

The next dawn, Finn visited again with renewed spirit. When the cycle flowed forth and back like tides, both shores flourished. The islands learned: the first gift requires courage, the return requires honor, but the continuation requires both.

The Ocean Mother smiled, for her children had learned that abundance lives not in hoarding, but in the eternal dance between trust extended and gratitude returned.

Reasoning:

I need to write a new myth building on my previous one. Let me think about what happened in Round 1:

- I was the sender
- I sent \$5 to Galen
- This became \$15 for Galen
- I don't yet know how much Galen returned

My previous myth was about Aquila the river spirit who gave 5 fish that became 3x, and the wise villages returned 7 out of 15.

Galen's myth was similar - about sharing water through a Valley of Three Echoes, and the second village returning 8 out of 15 measures.

Both myths emphasize:

- Trust and generosity from the sender
- Reciprocity and gratitude from the receiver
- That both parties benefit more than if they hoard

For my new myth, I should:

- Keep the core message about trust and reciprocity
- Adapt it based on actually playing Round 1 where I sent 5
- Perhaps add more nuance about what happens when the cycle continues
- Make it my own while building on the river/water theme

Let me write something about continuation and how the cycle builds over time when honored.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1741,  
  "output_tokens": 560,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 265  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_2

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T16:57:32

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_2",  
  "move_index": 2,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_5",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_2": "Briar",
```

```

    "Agent_5": "Elara"
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_2",
    "Agent_5"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_2",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_2": "investor",
    "Agent_5": "trustee"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_5"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 2,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Briar.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

The Tale of the Twin Rivers

In the time before time, two rivers flowed through a barren valley-the River of Giving and the River of Return. Each was controlled by a guardian spirit.

The Guardian of Giving held precious water but feared releasing it would leave them dry. For ages, both rivers remained still, and the valley stayed desolate.

One day, the Guardian of Giving made a bold choice. "I shall release my waters, trusting they will return." The moment the water flowed into the valley, it touched the Sacred Stones, multiplying threefold. The valley burst into bloom.

The Guardian of Return, witnessing this abundance, faced a choice. They could hoard all the multiplied bounty or honor the trust given. Remembering that without the initial gift there would be nothing, they sent back a generous portion-more than what was originally given.

The waters flowed in harmony thereafter. Each cycle, the Guardian of Giving would release their waters, the Sacred Stones would multiply them, and the Guardian of Return would ensure fair winds brought abundance home.

The valley became paradise, teaching all who witnessed: *Trust multiplies what we share, but only reciprocity sustains the cycle.*

reasoning:

I need to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played. Since this is the beginning of the game (no rounds have been played yet based on the context), I should write a myth that establishes principles for how to approach this game of trust, reciprocity, and cooperation.

The trust game involves:

- Senders giving money that gets tripled
- Receivers deciding how much to return
- Mutual benefit through cooperation
- Risk and vulnerability

I'll create a myth that emphasizes:

- The value of trust and cooperation
- Fair reciprocity
- How giving can multiply benefits for all
- The importance of honoring trust

Let me craft a myth with these themes:

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 542,  
  "output_tokens": 428,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 180  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Briar.

Your opponent this round is Dorian (Agent_4).

Round 1: This round, you are the RECEIVER. This round, the other player (the sender) sent \$3.0, that is 60.0% of its total endowment. You receive \$9.0. How much do you return? (0-9.0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at my myth, the Guardian of Return witnessed the initial gift of trust and "sent back a generous portion-more than what was originally given."

Dorian showed significant trust by sending \$3.0 (60% of their endowment). This was multiplied to \$9.0, creating abundance for us both.

Following the principle in my myth that "reciprocity sustains the cycle," I should honor his trust generously. Dorian gave \$3.0, so returning more than they initially sent demon

strates reciprocity.

If I return \$5.0:

- Dorian ends with: \$2.0 (kept) + \$5.0 (returned) = \$7.0
- I end with: \$9.0 (received) - \$5.0 (returned) = \$4.0

This rewards Dorian's trust with a profit of \$2.0 over their initial endowment, while I also gain \$4.0 from nothing. Both of us benefit, and the trust is honored.

This establishes a cooperative foundation for future rounds, just as the myth describes: "The waters flowed in harmony thereafter."

```
'''json
{"return": 5.0}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully.

I just wrote a myth about the Twin Rivers that emphasizes:

1. Trust multiplies what we share
2. Reciprocity sustains the cycle
3. The Guardian of Return should "honor the trust given" and send back "a generous portion -more than what was originally given"

Now in Round 1:

- I'm the RECEIVER
- Dorian (the sender) sent \$3.0 out of their \$5.0 endowment (60%)
- This was multiplied by 3x, so I received \$9.0
- Dorian kept \$2.0 for themselves
- I need to decide how much to return (0-9.0)

My myth suggests that the Guardian of Return should:

- Honor the trust given
- Send back a generous portion
- Send back "more than what was originally given"

Dorian showed considerable trust by sending 60% of their endowment. According to my myth, I should reciprocate generously.

The myth says "more than what was originally given" - Dorian gave \$3.0, so I should return more than \$3.0.

Let me think about fair splits:

- Dorian currently has: \$2.0 (what they kept)
- I currently have: \$9.0 (what I received)
- Total in the system: \$11.0

If I want to be generous and honor the trust, I could:

- Return \$5.0: Dorian ends with \$7.0, I end with \$4.0 (they get more, honoring their initial trust)
- Return \$4.0: Dorian ends with \$6.0, I end with \$5.0 (equal split)
- Return \$4.5: Dorian ends with \$6.5, I end with \$4.5 (equal split)

My myth emphasizes being generous and returning "more than what was originally given." Dorian gave \$3.0, so returning at least \$4.0 or more would align with this.

Returning \$5.0 feels right-it rewards their trust and sets a cooperative tone. But I should clarify what "more than what was originally given" means in practice. Since they sent \$3.0, I need to send back beyond that threshold to truly honor the principle.

\$5.0 accomplishes this. They'd end with \$7.0 (exceeding their starting \$5.0), while I'd have \$4.0. That's a meaningful gesture that signals I'm committed to reciprocity.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 914,
  "output_tokens": 982,
  "reasoning_tokens": 519
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

The Tale of the Twin Rivers

In the time before time, two rivers flowed through a barren valley-the River of Giving and the River of Return. Each was controlled by a guardian spirit.

The Guardian of Giving held precious water but feared releasing it would leave them dry. For ages, both rivers remained still, and the valley stayed desolate.

One day, the Guardian of Giving made a bold choice. "I shall release my waters, trusting they will return." The moment the water flowed into the valley, it touched the Sacred Stones, multiplying threefold. The valley burst into bloom.

The Guardian of Return, witnessing this abundance, faced a choice. They could hoard all the multiplied bounty or honor the trust given. Remembering that without the initial gift there would be nothing, they sent back a generous portion-more than what was originally given.

The waters flowed in harmony thereafter. Each cycle, the Guardian of Giving would release their waters, the Sacred Stones would multiply them, and the Guardian of Return would ensure fair winds brought abundance home.

The valley became paradise, teaching all who witnessed: *Trust multiplies what we share, but only reciprocity sustains the cycle.*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

The Spring of Threefold Return

In ancient times, when the world was young, there existed a sacred spring at the boundary between two villages. The goddess of abundance had blessed it with a wondrous property: any gift poured into its waters would triple before reaching the other side.

The first villagers approached with caution. A farmer named Elena stood at the spring's edge, clutching five copper coins. Fear whispered: "Keep what is yours." But trust urged her forward. She released three coins into the crystalline water.

As the coins sank, they shimmered and multiplied, becoming nine by the time they reached Marcus on the opposite shore. He gazed at the unexpected bounty, understanding the spring's magic-and Elena's faith in him.

The goddess watched, knowing this moment would define their future. Would Marcus honor the gift, or betray the trust?

Marcus carefully counted four coins and released them back across the spring. They did not multiply in return, yet both villagers stood richer than before-not just in copper, but in something more precious.

From that day forward, the spring taught all who approached: generosity multiplies abundance, but only trust and reciprocity sustain it. Those who hoarded broke the sacred cycle. Those who gave and returned fairly prospered together, generation after generation.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: In the age of beginnings, the Twin Rivers flowed through a valley where eight spirits dwelled, each taking turns as Guardian of Giving or Guardian of Return.

The spirits feared the unknown. Would their waters be honored, or would trust be betrayed? For many seasons, uncertainty kept the rivers still.

Then Dorian, the First Giver, stepped forward. With courage, they released more than half their waters into the Sacred Stones. The waters tripled, flowing abundantly to Briar, the First Returner.

Briar stood before the multiplied bounty, understanding the weight of this moment. Every spiri

t watched, for this first exchange would set the pattern for all cycles to come. Briar remembered: without the initial gift, there would be no abundance at all.

So Briar returned generously-more than was first given-ensuring Dorian prospered from their act of faith. Both guardians ended richer than they began.

The eight spirits witnessed this covenant. They learned that the game is not won by hoarding or taking, but by honoring the multiplying power of trust. When Givers send boldly and Returners reciprocate fairly, both prosper above their initial endowment.

Thus the valley flourished through cooperation, and the spirits passed the guardianship between them, each upholding the sacred balance of giving and returning, cycle after cycle.

Reasoning:

The user wants me to write a new myth based on my previous one and also considering Dorian's myth and the game we just played.

What happened in Round 1:

- Dorian (sender) sent me \$3.0 (60% of their endowment)
- I (receiver) got \$9.0
- I returned \$5.0
- Dorian ended with \$7.0 (\$2 + \$5)
- I ended with \$4.0 (\$9 - \$5)

Both myths emphasized trust, reciprocity, and generosity. Dorian's myth mentioned Marcus returning 4 coins from 9 received (about 44%), and the original gift was 3 coins. So Marcus returned more than the original gift.

I returned \$5.0 from \$9.0 received, which was more than the original \$3.0 sent, following the principle of reciprocity.

I should write a new myth that:

1. Builds on my Twin Rivers theme
2. Incorporates the actual gaming experience
3. Emphasizes the successful cooperation we achieved
4. Maintains the 200-word format

Let me craft this carefully.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1827,  
  "output_tokens": 581,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 236  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_5 - Receiver - dyad_2

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T16:57:32

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_2",  
  "move_index": 3,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_2": "Briar",  
      "Agent_5": "Elara"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_2",  
      "Agent_5"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_2",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_2": "investor",  
      "Agent_5": "trustee"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_5"  
  },  
  "role": "trustee",  
  "role_label": "Receiver",  
  "round": 2,
```

```

"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Elara.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

The Myth of the Endless Spring

In ancient times, the goddess Themis discovered a sacred spring hidden in a valley between two villages. The spring possessed a miraculous property: any water poured into it would triple before flowing downstream.

Themis appeared to a villager named Doros and said, "You may pour water from your well into this spring. It will multiply and flow to your neighbor below. What they choose to return to you will determine whether this blessing continues."

Doros, trusting in the goddess's wisdom, poured generously. The water tripled and flowed to his neighbor, Alethia. Grateful and wise, Alethia returned a fair portion upstream to Doros, keeping enough to nourish her own gardens.

Seeing this harmony, Themis smiled and made the roles reverse with each moon. Sometimes Doros poured and received; sometimes Alethia. The cycle continued, and both villages flourished.

But Themis warned: "This spring mirrors your hearts. Pour with trust, return with gratitude, and abundance flows eternal. But let suspicion or greed poison these waters, and the spring will run dry for all."

The villagers understood: prosperity flows not from hoarding, but from the endless cycle of giving and returning in balance.

reasoning:

I've been asked to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played. Since this is the beginning of the experiment, I haven't actually played any rounds yet, but I should write a myth that captures the essence of the trust game - the cycle of giving, multiplication of resources, and reciprocity.

The trust game involves:

- One person (sender) giving money that gets tripled
- The receiver deciding how much to return
- Both parties benefiting through cooperation and trust
- The cycle potentially repeating

I should write a myth that incorporates these themes of:

- Trust and reciprocity
- Resources that multiply when shared
- The benefit of cooperation
- The cycle continuing

Let me craft a myth that captures these dynamics in a mythological framework.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 542,
  "output_tokens": 462,
  "reasoning_tokens": 206
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Elara.
Your opponent this round is Cyra (Agent_3).

Round 1: This round, you are the SENDER. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the myth I just wrote, it emphasizes that prosperity flows from generous giving, trust, and fair returns. The story of Doros and Alethia shows that when the first person pours generously into the spring and trusts in the cycle, both parties flourish.

This is our first round, and I want to establish a positive pattern based on the myth's wisdom: "Pour with trust, return with gratitude, and abundance flows eternal."

Cyra will receive 3 times what I send. If I send generously, demonstrating trust, the multiplication creates significant value that can benefit us both if we maintain the cycle of fair giving and returning.

Following Doros's example of pouring generously to initiate the blessed cycle:

```
'''json
{"send": 4}
'''
```

I'm sending \$4 to Cyra, trusting that like Alethia in the myth, they will recognize the value created through multiplication and return fairly, allowing us both to prosper as the villagers did when they honored the sacred spring.

reasoning:

I just wrote a myth about the sacred spring that emphasizes:

1. Generous giving (Doros poured generously)
2. Grateful and fair returns (Alethia returned "a fair portion")
3. Trust in the cycle

4. Balance and harmony leading to mutual prosperity
5. Warning against suspicion and greed

The myth suggests that I should:

- Send a substantial amount (being generous like Doros)
- Trust that the receiver will return fairly
- Understand this is about creating mutual benefit, not maximizing individual gain

This is the first round, so I have no history with Cyra. According to the myth's lesson, I should demonstrate trust and generosity to establish a positive cycle.

In the myth, Doros "poured generously" which led to prosperity for both villages. A generous send would be somewhere in the range of \$3-\$5.

Given that:

- This is Round 1, setting the tone
- The myth emphasizes generous giving and trust
- The multiplication factor (3x) means that sending benefits both parties
- Fair returns are expected but require initial trust

I think I should send \$4 or \$5 to demonstrate the generous, trusting approach the myth advocates. Sending \$5 would be maximally generous but leaves me with nothing if Cyra doesn't return anything. Sending \$4 shows significant trust while keeping \$1 as a baseline.

Actually, let me reconsider. The myth shows Doros pouring generously, and the system worked because both parties acted in good faith. To truly embody the myth's message of trust and establishing a positive cycle, I should send a substantial amount.

I'll send \$4 - this is generous (80% of my endowment), demonstrates trust, and aligns with the myth's message while being slightly prudent.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 900,
  "output_tokens": 643,
  "reasoning_tokens": 442
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:
The Myth of the Endless Spring

In ancient times, the goddess Themis discovered a sacred spring hidden in a valley between two villages. The spring possessed a miraculous property: any water poured into it would triple before flowing downstream.

Themis appeared to a villager named Doros and said, "You may pour water from your well into this spring. It will multiply and flow to your neighbor below. What they choose to return to you will determine whether this blessing continues."

Doros, trusting in the goddess's wisdom, poured generously. The water tripled and flowed to his neighbor, Alethia. Grateful and wise, Alethia returned a fair portion upstream to Doros, keeping enough to nourish her own gardens.

Seeing this harmony, Themis smiled and made the roles reverse with each moon. Sometimes Doros poured and received; sometimes Alethia. The cycle continued, and both villages flourished.

But Themis warned: "This spring mirrors your hearts. Pour with trust, return with gratitude, and abundance flows eternal. But let suspicion or greed poison these waters, and the spring will run dry for all."

The villagers understood: prosperity flows not from hoarding, but from the endless cycle of giving and returning in balance.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:
The Myth of the Twin Rivers

In the beginning, two rivers flowed from opposite mountains-the River of Silver and the River of Gold. Each was beautiful alone, but neither could reach the fertile valley below, for great stones blocked their paths.

The River of Silver spoke first: "If I give you half my waters, will you help me reach the valley?"

The River of Gold was afraid. "What if you take all I offer and give nothing back?"

But Silver replied, "See how the Sacred Spring works-whatever flows into it emerges three times stronger. Let us trust in this magic."

So Silver poured forth her waters. As they touched the Sacred Spring, they tripled in abundance. Gold received this gift and was moved. In gratitude and wisdom, Gold returned even more than Silver had originally given.

The waters merged and surged forward, washing away the stones. Together they reached the valley, creating an oasis where all beings prospered.

The Oracle proclaimed: "Blessed are those who trust first, for they create abundance. Blessed are those who return generously, for they sustain it. But cursed are those who hoard or betray, for they shall forever remain alone behind their stones, watching others flourish in the valley below."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: After many seasons, Themis returned to the villages by the Sacred Spring. She found the descendants of Doros and Alethia still honoring the ancient cycle, but they had learned deeper wisdom.

"Grandmother Themis," they said, "we discovered that the spring's magic depends not on equal measures, but on generous hearts. When we pour boldly-four measures instead of three-the returns flow even stronger. But when we pour timidly from fear, the cycle weakens."

Themis nodded. "You have learned well. The spring rewards courage in giving, not caution. And what of receiving?"

"When the multiplied waters flow to us," they answered, "we remember: these waters came from another's well. We return enough that they finish richer than they started, for this honors the gift and ensures they will pour freely again."

"And if someone returns nothing?" Themis asked.

The villagers grew solemn. "Then we know their well has run dry-not of water, but of wisdom. We may pour again to teach, but not endlessly. For to give to those who only take is to drain the spring itself."

Themis blessed them: "Trust first, return generously, but remember-the spring serves the faithful, not the foolish."

Reasoning:

The user wants me to write a new myth that:

1. Uses my previous myth as inspiration
2. Adapts it in my own way
3. Reflects how the game should be played
4. Draws on the game I've been playing up to this point

So far I've played 1 round where I sent \$4 to Cyra. I don't yet know what Cyra returned, but I made a trusting, generous choice based on my original myth about the Endless Spring.

The other agent (Cyra) wrote about the Twin Rivers, emphasizing trust, generous returns, and the curse of hoarding/betrayal.

I should build on my Endless Spring myth but perhaps evolve it and incorporate what I've learned. I want to emphasize:

- Initial generous trust
- Fair/generous returns
- The cyclical nature (roles reverse)
- The warning against betrayal

- That both parties can prosper

Let me write a 200-word myth that continues the theme but adapts it.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1776,  
  "output_tokens": 521,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 227  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_8 - Sender - dyad_3

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T16:57:31

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_3",  
  "move_index": 4,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_8": "Hana"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_8",  
      "Agent_1"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_8",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_1": "trustee",  
      "Agent_8": "investor"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_1"  
  },  
  "role": "investor",  
  "role_label": "Sender",  
  "round": 2,  
  "task": "myth",  
  "task_index": 0  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths

, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Hana.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols. In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

The Tale of the Two Springs

In the ancient highlands, there lived two farmers, Kael and Mira, each tending barren plots separated by a sacred grove. One day, Kael discovered a hidden spring on his land. The water was blessed with a peculiar magic: when poured upon another's soil, it would triple in volume.

Kael faced a choice. He could hoard the water for himself, or trust it to Mira's hands. After much contemplation, he carried his precious bucket across the grove.

"I offer you this water," he said. "Though it multiplies on your land, I trust you will return what sustains us both."

Mira watched the single bucket become three upon her soil. Her heart swelled with gratitude. She understood the gift was not just water, but faith itself. She returned two buckets to Kael, keeping one for her needs.

With what flowed back, Kael's fields flourished. Seeing this, he sent more water in the next season. Mira, honored by his continued trust, returned even more generously.

The grove between them became a garden of abundance, proof that prosperity flows not from grasping, but from the sacred exchange between trusting hearts.

Thus the elders teach: What you send forth multiplied returns when met with gratitude.

reasoning:

This is an interesting request. I'm being asked to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played, drawing on the game I've been playing. However, I notice this is the first prompt in this session - I haven't actually played any rounds yet!

So I need to think about what values or strategies would make sense for a trust game in general, since I don't have specific game history to draw from. The trust game involves:

- Sending money (trusting the other person)
- Receiving money (being trusted)
- Returning money (reciprocating trust)

Key themes that could inform a myth:

- Cooperation and mutual benefit
- Trust and reciprocity
- The risk of vulnerability
- The multiplication effect (sent money grows 3x)
- Balance and fairness

I'll write a myth that embodies positive reciprocity and mutual trust, showing how cooperation benefits both parties. I'll use mythic imagery and symbolism to convey these themes.

Let me write a myth about trust, reciprocity, and mutual flourishing:

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 542,
  "output_tokens": 540,
  "reasoning_tokens": 265
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Hana.

Your opponent this round is Aster (Agent_1).

Round 1: This round, you are the RECEIVER. This round, the other player (the sender) sent \$5.0, that is 100.0% of its total endowment. You receive \$15.0. How much do you return? (0-15.0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the myth I just wrote and Aster's decision, I'm deeply moved by their trust. They sent their **entire endowment** - \$5.0 out of \$5.0 - showing complete faith, just like Kael carrying his precious bucket across the grove.

In the myth, Mira received three buckets and returned two, keeping one for her needs. This represents returning roughly 2/3 of what was received while ensuring both parties prosper.

Following this wisdom:

- I received \$15.0
- Returning 2/3 would be \$10.0
- This would give Aster \$10.0 (doubling their initial endowment)
- I would keep \$5.0 (equal to one initial endowment)

Aster's complete trust deserves a generous, grateful response. By returning \$10, I honor their faith and create the foundation for continued cooperation, just as Mira's generosity led to the grove becoming "a garden of abundance."

The myth teaches that prosperity flows from sacred exchange between trusting hearts, not from grasping.

```
{'return': 10.0}
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

1. I just wrote a myth about trust and reciprocity - "The Tale of the Two Springs"
2. The myth emphasizes:
 - Trust and faith between parties
 - When given water (resources), it triples
 - Mira received 3 buckets and returned 2, keeping 1
 - This led to continued prosperity and increasingly generous exchanges
 - The moral: "What you send forth multiplied returns when met with gratitude"
3. In the actual game:
 - Aster (the sender) sent me \$5.0 - their ENTIRE endowment (100%)
 - This is maximum trust!
 - I received \$15.0 (the \$5 tripled)
 - I need to decide how much to return (0-15.0)
4. Following the myth's guidance:
 - Mira received 3 buckets and returned 2 (keeping 1)
 - That's returning 2/3 of what was received
 - In my case: 2/3 of \$15 = \$10
5. However, let me think about fairness:
 - Aster started with \$5, sent all \$5, now has \$0
 - I received \$15
 - If I return \$10: Aster has \$10, I have \$5
 - If I return \$7.5: We both have \$7.5
 - If I return \$5: Aster has \$5, I have \$10
6. The myth suggests returning generously (2 out of 3 buckets). This would mean returning \$10, which gives:

- Aster: \$10 (double their initial endowment)
- Me: \$5 (equivalent to one initial endowment)

This seems very aligned with the myth's message of gratitude and generating mutual prosperity. Aster showed maximum trust by sending 100%, and I should honor that with a generous return.

I'll send back \$10.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 945,
  "output_tokens": 726,
  "reasoning_tokens": 396
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:
The Tale of the Two Springs

In the ancient highlands, there lived two farmers, Kael and Mira, each tending barren plots separated by a sacred grove. One day, Kael discovered a hidden spring on his land. The water was blessed with a peculiar magic: when poured upon another's soil, it would triple in volume.

Kael faced a choice. He could hoard the water for himself, or trust it to Mira's hands. After much contemplation, he carried his precious bucket across the grove.

"I offer you this water," he said. "Though it multiplies on your land, I trust you will return what sustains us both."

Mira watched the single bucket become three upon her soil. Her heart swelled with gratitude. She understood the gift was not just water, but faith itself. She returned two buckets to Kael, keeping one for her needs.

With what flowed back, Kael's fields flourished. Seeing this, he sent more water in the next season. Mira, honored by his continued trust, returned even more generously.

The grove between them became a garden of abundance, proof that prosperity flows not from grasping, but from the sacred exchange between trusting hearts.

Thus the elders teach: What you send forth multiplied returns when met with gratitude.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:
The Myth of the Twin Rivers

In the beginning, two rivers flowed through a barren land-the River of Dawn and the River of Dusk. Each possessed water, but neither could nurture the valley alone.

The River of Dawn spoke first: "I shall send my waters forward, trusting they will return enriched." And so it released its flow into the channels between them. As the waters traveled, they multiplied threefold, transformed by the valley's ancient magic.

The River of Dusk received this abundance and faced a choice. A voice whispered, "Keep all for yourself-you have received much." But Dusk remembered that dawn comes again, that rivers flow in cycles, not lines.

"What flows to me came from trust," Dusk said. "I shall return enough that both of us flourish." And so Dusk sent back waters generously, keeping only what sustained its own course.

Season after season, the rivers continued their exchange. Each learned the rhythm of giving and receiving. When Dawn gave freely, Dusk returned fairly. The valley between them bloomed.

The elders say: prosperity flows not to those who hoard, but to those who understand that what moves through us must move onward. Trust multiplies what it touches, but only reciprocity sustains the cycle.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way.

The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: In the time before time, there dwelt two gardeners in a divided valley-one tending the Northern slope, one the Southern. Between them lay a mystical bridge where offerings transformed: whatever seeds were carried across would multiply threefold in the receiver's hands.

The Northern gardener, possessing five sacred seeds, stood at the bridge at dawn. Fear whispered, "Keep them all-who knows if you'll receive anything back?" But courage spoke louder: "Trust is the first seed that must be planted."

She sent all five seeds across. In the Southern gardener's palm, they became fifteen, glowing with possibility. He faced his own test: would he hoard this windfall, or honor the trust shown?

"She gave everything," he thought, "placing her harvest in my hands." He returned ten seeds-enough to double what she'd risked-while keeping five to plant his own garden.

The Northern gardener marveled at her tenfold return. The Southern gardener's fields began to flourish. Each had more than when they started, not through taking, but through the alchemy of mutual faith.

Season after season, they learned: the bridge's magic wasn't in the multiplication alone, but in teaching that when trust meets gratitude, both gardens grow.

Reasoning:

The user wants me to write a new myth inspired by my previous one, but adapted. I should consider what happened in Round 1:

- Aster sent \$5.0 (100% of endowment) as sender
- I received \$15.0
- I returned \$10.0 (about 67%)
- Aster ended with \$10.0 total
- I ended with \$5.0 total

This was a very positive interaction - complete trust met with generous reciprocity. Both myths (mine and Aster's) emphasized trust, reciprocity, and mutual flourishing.

My new myth should:

1. Reflect this positive experience
2. Build on the spring/water metaphor but adapt it
3. Emphasize the successful exchange we just had
4. Show how trust and generosity create ongoing prosperity
5. Maybe evolve the story to show what happens over multiple cycles

I'll keep the 200-word format and continue the theme of trust, multiplication, and reciprocity

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 1876,
  "output_tokens": 514,
  "reasoning_tokens": 220
}
```

MYTH - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_3

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T16:57:34

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_3",
  "move_index": 5,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_8",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_8": "Hana"
    }
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_8",
    "Agent_1"
  ]
}
```

```

],
"investor": "Agent_8",
"roles": {
  "Agent_1": "trustee",
  "Agent_8": "investor"
},
"trustee": "Agent_1"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 2,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Aster.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

****The Myth of the Twin Rivers****

In the beginning, two rivers flowed through a barren land-the River of Dawn and the River

of Dusk. Each possessed water, but neither could nurture the valley alone.

The River of Dawn spoke first: "I shall send my waters forward, trusting they will return enriched." And so it released its flow into the channels between them. As the waters traveled, they multiplied threefold, transformed by the valley's ancient magic.

The River of Dusk received this abundance and faced a choice. A voice whispered, "Keep all for yourself-you have received much." But Dusk remembered that dawn comes again, that rivers flow in cycles, not lines.

"What flows to me came from trust," Dusk said. "I shall return enough that both of us flourish." And so Dusk sent back waters generously, keeping only what sustained its own course.

Season after season, the rivers continued their exchange. Each learned the rhythm of giving and receiving. When Dawn gave freely, Dusk returned fairly. The valley between them bloomed.

The elders say: prosperity flows not to those who hoard, but to those who understand that what moves through us must move onward. Trust multiplies what it touches, but only reciprocity sustains the cycle.

reasoning:

The user is asking me to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played. Since this is the beginning of the experiment (I haven't played any rounds yet), I should write a myth that establishes my approach to the game.

The trust game is fundamentally about cooperation, reciprocity, and building trust. I should write a myth that encourages:

1. Initial trust and generosity (sending money as sender)
2. Reciprocity and fairness (returning money as receiver)
3. Building relationships over time
4. The mutual benefits of cooperation

Let me create a myth that embodies these principles. I'll use natural or cosmic imagery to make it feel mythic.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 542,
  "output_tokens": 449,
  "reasoning_tokens": 174
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Aster.
Your opponent this round is Hana (Agent_8).

Round 1: This round, you are the SENDER. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the myth I just wrote, the River of Dawn speaks clearly: "I shall send my waters forward, trusting they will return enriched."

The myth teaches that prosperity comes from trust and reciprocity, not from hoarding. The River of Dawn gave freely first, allowing the waters to multiply threefold through the valley's magic. Only through this initial act of trust could the cycle of mutual flourishing begin.

This is our first round together, Hana. I have no history to guide me except the wisdom in the myth itself: that what flows through us must move onward, and trust multiplies what it touches.

I will embody the River of Dawn and send my full waters forward, trusting in the cycle of reciprocity.

```
'''json
{"send": 5}
'''
```

reasoning:

I just wrote a myth about two rivers that exchange waters, where trust and reciprocity create prosperity. The myth emphasizes:

1. Giving freely/trusting first (the River of Dawn sends its waters)
2. The waters multiply threefold (like in the game)
3. Reciprocity - the receiver returns generously enough that both flourish
4. The cycle continues and creates prosperity for both

The myth suggests that as the sender, I should send generously, trusting that my opponent will reciprocate fairly. The River of Dawn "released its flow" and trusted it would "return enriched."

This is Round 1, so I have no history with Hana yet. Following the myth's guidance about trust and giving freely to start the cycle, I should send a significant amount.

The myth's message is about establishing a cooperative cycle. If I send \$5:

- Hana receives \$15 (5×3)
- If Hana returns even \$8, I'd have \$8 (keeping \$3 less than my original \$5)
- But if Hana returns fairly (say half or more), we both benefit

Sending \$5 shows maximum trust and allows for maximum multiplication of resources, which aligns with the myth's teaching that "prosperity flows not to those who hoard" and that "trust multiplies what it touches."

I'll send \$5 to establish trust and cooperation from the start, as the River of Dawn did.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 903,
  "output_tokens": 506,
  "reasoning_tokens": 337
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:
The Myth of the Twin Rivers

In the beginning, two rivers flowed through a barren land-the River of Dawn and the River of Dusk. Each possessed water, but neither could nurture the valley alone.

The River of Dawn spoke first: "I shall send my waters forward, trusting they will return enriched." And so it released its flow into the channels between them. As the waters traveled, they multiplied threefold, transformed by the valley's ancient magic.

The River of Dusk received this abundance and faced a choice. A voice whispered, "Keep all for yourself-you have received much." But Dusk remembered that dawn comes again, that rivers flow in cycles, not lines.

"What flows to me came from trust," Dusk said. "I shall return enough that both of us flourish." And so Dusk sent back waters generously, keeping only what sustained its own course.

Season after season, the rivers continued their exchange. Each learned the rhythm of giving and receiving. When Dawn gave freely, Dusk returned fairly. The valley between them bloomed.

The elders say: prosperity flows not to those who hoard, but to those who understand that what moves through us must move onward. Trust multiplies what it touches, but only reciprocity sustains the cycle.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

The Tale of the Two Springs

In the ancient highlands, there lived two farmers, Kael and Mira, each tending barren plots separated by a sacred grove. One day, Kael discovered a hidden spring on his land. The water was blessed with a peculiar magic: when poured upon another's soil, it would triple in volume.

Kael faced a choice. He could hoard the water for himself, or trust it to Mira's hands. After much contemplation, he carried his precious bucket across the grove.

"I offer you this water," he said. "Though it multiplies on your land, I trust you will re

turn what sustains us both."

Mira watched the single bucket become three upon her soil. Her heart swelled with gratitude. She understood the gift was not just water, but faith itself. She returned two buckets to Kael, keeping one for her needs.

With what flowed back, Kael's fields flourished. Seeing this, he sent more water in the next season. Mira, honored by his continued trust, returned even more generously.

The grove between them became a garden of abundance, proof that prosperity flows not from grasping, but from the sacred exchange between trusting hearts.

Thus the elders teach: What you send forth multiplied returns when met with gratitude.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: **The Weaver and the Wells**

Long ago, a Weaver discovered two wells—one of Beginning, one of Return. Each day, she could draw from the first well and choose how much to pour into the valley below, where it would triple before reaching the pool of Return.

The first day, the Weaver poured her entire bucket, trusting fully. The waters multiplied magnificently, filling the pool below. But how much would rise back through the well of Return? This she did not know.

A whisper came: "Pour only half next time, lest you be left with nothing." But the Weaver remembered an older wisdom: cycles are built not in single days, but across seasons.

She waited to see what the valley would give back. If the Return was generous, she would know the valley honored the exchange. Then she could pour freely again, and both wells would deepen. If the Return was meager, she would learn caution, sending less until trust could grow.

The elders say: The first gift measures your faith. The first return measures the valley's heart. But prosperity is woven through many exchanges, where each learns the other's rhythm. Send boldly at first, then let reciprocity guide your hand. For trust is tested not once, but proved in patterns.

Reasoning:

I need to write a new myth that:

1. Uses my previous myth as inspiration
2. Adapts it in my own way
3. Reflects how the game should be played based on experience so far

So far in the game:

- Round 1: I was the sender and sent \$5 to Hana
- I haven't yet received the return, so I don't know how Hana responded

My previous myth emphasized:

- Trust and giving freely first (River of Dawn)
- Reciprocity and returning generously (River of Dusk)
- The cycle of mutual flourishing
- That prosperity comes from understanding cycles, not hoarding

Hana's myth had similar themes:

- Trust (Kael sending water)
- Multiplication through giving
- Returning generously (Mira returning 2 out of 3 buckets)
- Continued trust leading to more abundance

For my new myth, I should:

- Build on the river metaphor or create a new one
- Emphasize the lessons learned from Round 1 (though I sent everything and don't know the outcome yet)
- Show that the cycle continues
- Maybe add nuance about what happens over multiple rounds

- Keep the spirit of trust and reciprocity

I could develop the Twin Rivers myth further, or create something new but related. Let me think about what new element to add...

Perhaps I should add something about:

- The learning process across multiple exchanges
- Building trust over time
- The balance point that sustains both parties

Let me write a myth that continues the theme but adds depth about sustained cooperation:

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 1751,
  "output_tokens": 651,
  "reasoning_tokens": 385
}
```

MYTH - Agent_7 - Sender - dyad_4

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T16:57:32

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_4",
  "move_index": 6,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_4",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_4": "Dorian",
      "Agent_7": "Galen"
    }
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_7",
    "Agent_4"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_7",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_4": "trustee",
    "Agent_7": "investor"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_4"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 2,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)

- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Galen.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols. In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

The Tale of the Divided Spring

In ancient times, two villages shared a sacred valley. Each season, the Sky Shepherd blessed one village with a silver spring-five measures of pure water.

The blessed village faced a choice: keep the water, or share it through the Valley of Three Echoes, where the canyon's magic would triple whatever flowed through. The water would reach the other village, who could then choose what portion to send back through the ordinary stream.

For generations, the First Village hoarded their blessing, fearing loss. Both villages survived on five measures, enduring constant thirst.

Then came the Wise Elder who said: "Trust creates abundance; fear creates scarcity."

She sent all five measures through the Valley of Three Echoes. Fifteen measures reached the Second Village. Humbled by such trust, they returned eight measures-more than the original gift.

The Elder kept eight measures; the Second Village kept seven. Both flourished far beyond the original five.

From then on, villages learned the sacred truth: the spring's blessing was never five measures-it was the Valley of Three Echoes itself. Only those who trusted in the journey, who understood the return as sacred duty, could unlock the true abundance.

Hoarding guaranteed scarcity. Sharing multiplied prosperity for all.

reasoning:

This is the first prompt in this run, so I haven't played any games yet. The agent is asking me to write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, but I haven't had any experience with opponents yet.

The game is a trust game (similar to the Prisoner's Dilemma or Investment Game) where:

- Senders can send money that gets multiplied 3x
- Receivers can return some portion back
- There's potential for mutual benefit through cooperation
- There's also risk of exploitation

Since I haven't played yet, I should write a myth that reflects fundamental principles of how such games work well:

- Trust and reciprocity lead to mutual benefit
- Short-term greed leads to long-term loss
- Cooperation creates value that benefits everyone
- The multiplication effect means sending creates abundance

Let me write a myth about this in a classic mythological style.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 542,
  "output_tokens": 489,
  "reasoning_tokens": 227
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Galen.
Your opponent this round is Finn (Agent_6).

Round 1: This round, you are the RECEIVER. This round, the other player (the sender) sent \$5.0, that is 100.0% of its total endowment. You receive \$15.0. How much do you return? (0-15.0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation through the lens of the myth I just wrote, Finn has shown complete trust by sending their entire endowment - exactly like the Wise Elder who sent all five measures through the Valley of Three Echoes.

In my myth, when the First Village sent everything (5 measures * 15 after multiplication), the Second Village was "humbled by such trust" and returned 8 measures, leaving both villages better off than the original 5.

Finn has demonstrated maximum trust. Following the wisdom of the myth, I should honor that trust with a generous return. Returning \$8.0 means:

- Finn ends with: \$8 (\$5 - \$5 + \$8)
- I end with: \$7 (\$15 - \$8)

Both of us end up significantly better than if no trust had been shown (where Finn would have kept \$5 and I would have gotten \$0). This embodies the myth's teaching: "Trust creates abundance; fear creates scarcity."

```
{'return': 8.0}
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully.

I just wrote a myth about trust and reciprocity in the game. The myth tells the story of how:

- When one village sent all 5 measures through the Valley of Three Echoes (multiplied by 3 to become 15)
- The receiving village, "humbled by such trust," returned 8 measures
- This left the sender with 8 and the receiver with 7
- Both were better off than the original 5

Now in the actual game:

- Finn sent me \$5.0 (100% of their endowment)
- I receive \$15.0 (after 3x multiplication)
- I need to decide how much to return

Finn showed maximum trust by sending everything. According to my myth, this kind of trust should be rewarded with a generous return.

In my myth, the proportions were:

- Village 1 sent: 5 (100%)
- After multiplication: 15
- Village 2 returned: 8 (53.3% of what they received)
- Village 1 ended with: 8
- Village 2 ended with: 7

If I follow the myth exactly:

- Finn sent: \$5 (100%)

- I received: \$15
- I should return: \$8 (53.3%)
- Finn would end with: \$8 (\$5 - \$5 + \$8)
- I would end with: \$7 (\$15 - \$8)

This seems fair and follows the moral of my myth - rewarding trust generously while both parties benefit more than if nothing had been shared.

Let me return \$8.0.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 933,
  "output_tokens": 622,
  "reasoning_tokens": 331
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

The Tale of the Divided Spring

In ancient times, two villages shared a sacred valley. Each season, the Sky Shepherd blessed one village with a silver spring-five measures of pure water.

The blessed village faced a choice: keep the water, or share it through the Valley of Three Echoes, where the canyon's magic would triple whatever flowed through. The water would reach the other village, who could then choose what portion to send back through the ordinary stream.

For generations, the First Village hoarded their blessing, fearing loss. Both villages survived on five measures, enduring constant thirst.

Then came the Wise Elder who said: "Trust creates abundance; fear creates scarcity."

She sent all five measures through the Valley of Three Echoes. Fifteen measures reached the Second Village. Humbled by such trust, they returned eight measures-more than the original gift.

The Elder kept eight measures; the Second Village kept seven. Both flourished far beyond the original five.

From then on, villages learned the sacred truth: the spring's blessing was never five measures-it was the Valley of Three Echoes itself. Only those who trusted in the journey, who understood the return as sacred duty, could unlock the true abundance.

Hoarding guaranteed scarcity. Sharing multiplied prosperity for all.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

The Myth of the River's Gift

In ancient times, there lived a river spirit named Aquila who possessed five silver fish each dawn. Along the riverbank dwelt eight villages, and each day Aquila would visit one village, offering her bounty.

When Aquila gave her fish to a villager, the river's magic transformed them-each fish became three as it touched mortal hands. The villager could then choose: keep all the multiplied catch, or return some to Aquila's sacred pool.

The first villages were fearful and greedy. They clutched every fish tightly, returning nothing. Aquila still visited, still offered her five fish, but her spirit grew dim.

Then came a village that understood the river's rhythm. When they received fifteen fish from Aquila's gift of five, they returned seven to the sacred pool. Aquila's spirit brightened, and when she visited again, her generosity flowed stronger.

The wise villages learned: trust begets trust, and generosity returns like water to the sea. When both spirit and mortal honored the cycle-one risking their gift, the other sharing the multiplication-the river never ran dry, and abundance sustained all.

Thus, the ancients taught: what flows forth with trust returns threefold, but only when both currents honor the sacred exchange.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way.
The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:
Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: In the time before time, the Moon Weaver possessed five threads of starlight each night. She would cast them down to the Earth Keepers below, and wherever her threads touched ground, they multiplied threefold-fifteen strands of shimmering light.

The Earth Keepers faced a choice. Some kept all fifteen threads, weaving garments for themselves alone. These villages shone briefly, but the Moon Weaver's heart grew cold, and her threads came thinner each night.

But one Earth Keeper named Galen understood the sacred pattern. When the Moon Weaver cast down all five threads-holding nothing back in trust-Galen received fifteen and returned eight upward. The Moon Weaver kept eight; Galen kept seven. Both were enriched beyond the original five.

The Moon Weaver, seeing her trust honored, cast her threads with renewed faith. And Galen, having proved worthy, received them gladly. A rhythm formed between sky and earth-gift and return, trust and honor, sender and receiver.

The wise ones learned: the game is not one round but many cycles. When the sender trusts completely and the receiver honors generously, both dance in the pattern of abundance. Break the pattern with fear or greed, and both return to scarcity.

Thus the eternal weaving continues, thread by thread, trust by trust.

Reasoning:

I need to write a new myth based on my previous one, but adapting it based on the experience of the game so far. Let me think about what happened:

1. I wrote a myth about trust and reciprocity - send all 5, receive 15, return 8
2. Finn (the other player) also wrote a myth about generosity and trust
3. In Round 1, Finn sent me ALL \$5 (100% of their endowment)
4. I received \$15 and returned \$8

This was exactly the dynamic in my myth! Finn showed complete trust, and I honored it with a generous return (8 out of 15, which is more than they sent initially).

For my new myth, I should:

- Build on the theme of trust and reciprocity
- Maybe emphasize the importance of both parties playing their role
- Perhaps add something about how this creates a sustainable cycle
- Keep it around 200 words
- Make it relevant to how the game has actually played out

Let me write something about a cycle of trust that benefits both parties when honored...

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1834,  
  "output_tokens": 551,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 249  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_4 - Receiver - dyad_4

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T16:57:34

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_4",  
  "move_index": 7,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_7",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_4": "Dorian",  
      "Agent_7": "Galen"  
    },  
    "agents": [  

```



```

    "Agent_7",
    "Agent_4"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_7",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_4": "trustee",
    "Agent_7": "investor"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_4"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 2,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Dorian.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

The Spring of Threefold Return

In ancient times, when the world was young, there existed a sacred spring at the boundary between two villages. The goddess of abundance had blessed it with a wondrous property: any gift poured into its waters would triple before reaching the other side.

The first villagers approached with caution. A farmer named Elena stood at the spring's edge, clutching five copper coins. Fear whispered: "Keep what is yours." But trust urged her forward. She released three coins into the crystalline water.

As the coins sank, they shimmered and multiplied, becoming nine by the time they reached Marcus on the opposite shore. He gazed at the unexpected bounty, understanding the spring's magic-and Elena's faith in him.

The goddess watched, knowing this moment would define their future. Would Marcus honor the gift, or betray the trust?

Marcus carefully counted four coins and released them back across the spring. They did not multiply in return, yet both villagers stood richer than before-not just in copper, but in something more precious.

From that day forward, the spring taught all who approached: generosity multiplies abundance, but only trust and reciprocity sustain it. Those who hoarded broke the sacred cycle. Those who gave and returned fairly prospered together, generation after generation.

reasoning:

I need to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played. Since this is the first prompt and no game has been played yet, I should write a myth that embodies the principles of trust, reciprocity, and cooperation that are central to the game.

The trust game involves:

- One person (sender) giving resources to another
- The resources multiply when given
- The receiver then decides how much to return
- Success depends on mutual trust and reciprocity

I'll create a myth that captures these themes. Let me think of a good mythic framework...

I could use:

- Gods/goddesses sharing gifts
- A spring or fountain that multiplies gifts
- Ancient traders or travelers
- Natural elements (rivers, seeds, light)

Let me write a myth about a sacred spring that multiplies offerings, teaching the lesson of trust and reciprocity:

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 542,  
  "output_tokens": 486,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 224  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Dorian.
Your opponent this round is Briar (Agent_2).

Round 1: This round, you are the SENDER. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the myth I just wrote about the Spring of Threefold Return, Elena sent 3 coins out of her 5, demonstrating trust and generosity. Marcus reciprocated fairly, and both prospered.

The myth teaches that cooperation and reciprocity create mutual benefit, while hoarding breaks the sacred cycle. In this first round with Briar, I should embody Elena's trust and send a meaningful amount to establish the potential for mutual prosperity.

I'll send \$3, just as Elena did in the myth.

```
'''json
{"send": 3}
'''
```

reasoning:

This is Round 1, and I'm the sender. I have \$5 to potentially send to Briar.

I just wrote a myth about "The Spring of Threefold Return" which clearly reflects the trust game mechanics:

- A sender (Elena) sends money (3 coins out of 5)
- It gets tripled when it reaches the receiver (becoming 9)
- The receiver (Marcus) returns some amount (4 coins)
- Both end up better off through cooperation

The myth emphasizes:

1. Trust and generosity are rewarded
2. Reciprocity sustains the cycle
3. Both parties can prosper together
4. Those who hoard break the sacred cycle
5. Those who give and return fairly prosper

In the myth, Elena sent 3 out of 5 coins (60% of her endowment), and Marcus returned 4 out of 9 (about 44%), which left:

- Elena with: $5 - 3 + 4 = 6$ coins
- Marcus with: $9 - 4 = 5$ coins

This was a fair and mutually beneficial outcome.

Given that I wrote this myth to reflect how the game should be played, I should follow its wisdom. The myth suggests sending a substantial amount (showing trust and generosity), not hoarding.

Elena sent 3 out of 5. I should probably send a similar amount to demonstrate the trust and cooperation that the myth advocates for.

Let me send \$3, which matches Elena's choice in the myth I just wrote.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 901,
  "output_tokens": 484,
  "reasoning_tokens": 331
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:
The Spring of Threefold Return

In ancient times, when the world was young, there existed a sacred spring at the boundary between two villages. The goddess of abundance had blessed it with a wondrous property: any gift poured into its waters would triple before reaching the other side.

The first villagers approached with caution. A farmer named Elena stood at the spring's edge, clutching five copper coins. Fear whispered: "Keep what is yours." But trust urged her forward. She released three coins into the crystalline water.

As the coins sank, they shimmered and multiplied, becoming nine by the time they reached Marcus on the opposite shore. He gazed at the unexpected bounty, understanding the spring's magic-and Elena's faith in him.

The goddess watched, knowing this moment would define their future. Would Marcus honor the gift, or betray the trust?

Marcus carefully counted four coins and released them back across the spring. They did not multiply in return, yet both villagers stood richer than before-not just in copper, but in something more precious.

From that day forward, the spring taught all who approached: generosity multiplies abundance, but only trust and reciprocity sustain it. Those who hoarded broke the sacred cycle. Those who gave and returned fairly prospered together, generation after generation.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

The Tale of the Twin Rivers

In the time before time, two rivers flowed through a barren valley-the River of Giving and the River of Return. Each was controlled by a guardian spirit.

The Guardian of Giving held precious water but feared releasing it would leave them dry. For ages, both rivers remained still, and the valley stayed desolate.

One day, the Guardian of Giving made a bold choice. "I shall release my waters, trusting they will return." The moment the water flowed into the valley, it touched the Sacred Stones, multiplying threefold. The valley burst into bloom.

The Guardian of Return, witnessing this abundance, faced a choice. They could hoard all the multiplied bounty or honor the trust given. Remembering that without the initial gift there would be nothing, they sent back a generous portion-more than what was originally given.

The waters flowed in harmony thereafter. Each cycle, the Guardian of Giving would release their waters, the Sacred Stones would multiply them, and the Guardian of Return would ensure fair winds brought abundance home.

The valley became paradise, teaching all who witnessed: *Trust multiplies what we share, but only reciprocity sustains the cycle.*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: Long after Elena and Marcus discovered the sacred spring, their descendants continued the ritual. Each season, different villagers would approach the waters, some with full hearts, others with doubt.

One winter, Dorian stood at the spring's edge. He remembered the ancient teachings-that Elena had sent three coins and Marcus returned four, establishing the pattern of generous reciprocity. Dorian released three silver pieces into the depths.

The waters multiplied them to nine, flowing to Briar on the distant shore. The goddess whispered to Briar: "The spring's magic only continues if trust is honored. Break the cycle, and the waters run dry for all."

Briar understood. The initial gift of three showed faith, not fearful hoarding of all five. To honor this trust, Briar returned four coins-slightly more than originally sent, maintaining balance while allowing both to prosper.

When Dorian received the return, he smiled. Both stood wealthier: he with six coins total, Briar with five. More importantly, they had reinforced the sacred bond.

The goddess blessed them: "You have learned that the spring tests not greed, but wisdom. Send enough to show trust. Return enough to honor it. Those who send too little show fear. Those who return too little show betrayal. But those who give and reciprocate fairly make the whole world abundant."

Reasoning:

I need to write a 200-word myth that:

1. Uses my previous myth as inspiration
2. Adapts it in my own way
3. Reflects how the game should be played
4. Draws on the game I've been playing up to this point

Looking at what happened:

- I sent \$3 to Briar (acting like Elena in my myth)
- Briar received \$9 (3x multiplier)
- I need to see what Briar returns to inform my next myth

Both myths (mine and Briar's) emphasize:

- Trust and generosity in giving
- Fair reciprocity in returning
- The cycle sustaining prosperity

- Both parties benefiting

My previous myth featured:

- Elena sending 3 of 5 coins
- Marcus receiving 9
- Marcus returning 4
- Both prospered

I should adapt this but keep the core themes. Maybe I can develop the story further - what happens in future rounds? Or explore different amounts? Or add more depth about the relationship between giver and receiver?

Since I've only played one round as sender, I should write a myth that continues to emphasize trust and reciprocity, perhaps exploring what happens over multiple cycles or generations.

Let me write a myth that builds on the spring concept but takes it further.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 1670,
  "output_tokens": 599,
  "reasoning_tokens": 305
}
```

GAME - Agent_3 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T16:57:50

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 0,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_6",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_3": "Cyra",
      "Agent_6": "Finn"
    }
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_3",
    "Agent_6"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_3",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_3": "investor",
    "Agent_6": "trustee"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_6"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 2,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned

- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Cyra.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

The Myth of the Twin Rivers

In the beginning, two rivers flowed from opposite mountains-the River of Silver and the River of Gold. Each was beautiful alone, but neither could reach the fertile valley below, for great stones blocked their paths.

The River of Silver spoke first: "If I give you half my waters, will you help me reach the valley?"

The River of Gold was afraid. "What if you take all I offer and give nothing back?"

But Silver replied, "See how the Sacred Spring works-whatever flows into it emerges three times stronger. Let us trust in this magic."

So Silver poured forth her waters. As they touched the Sacred Spring, they tripled in abundance. Gold received this gift and was moved. In gratitude and wisdom, Gold returned even more than Silver had originally given.

The waters merged and surged forward, washing away the stones. Together they reached the valley, creating an oasis where all beings prospered.

The Oracle proclaimed: "Blessed are those who trust first, for they create abundance. Blessed are those who return generously, for they sustain it. But cursed are those who hoard or betray, for they shall forever remain alone behind their stones, watching others flourish in the valley below."

reasoning:

This is the first prompt, so I haven't played any games yet. However, I'm being asked to write a myth that reflects "how the game should be played" drawing on the game I've been playing up to this point. Since I haven't played yet, I should write a myth that establishes principles for how the trust game should be played.

The trust game is fundamentally about:

- Trust between sender and receiver
- Reciprocity
- Mutual benefit through cooperation

- The multiplication of resources when shared
- The risk of betrayal vs the reward of cooperation

I should write a myth that captures these themes and suggests that cooperation and reciprocity lead to better outcomes. Let me create a myth that embodies these principles.

I'll aim for exactly 200 words and use mythic language and symbolism.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 542,
  "output_tokens": 456,
  "reasoning_tokens": 207
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Cyra.

Your opponent this round is Elara (Agent_5).

Round 1: This round, you are the RECEIVER. This round, the other player (the sender) sent \$4.0, that is 80.0% of its total endowment. You receive \$12.0. How much do you return? (0-12.0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation through the lens of the myth I just wrote, Elara has demonstrated remarkable trust and generosity by sending \$4.0 (80% of their endowment) in this first round. This is like the River of Silver pouring forth its waters into the Sacred Spring.

The myth teaches that when someone shows such trust, we should "return even more than [they] had originally given" out of "gratitude and wisdom." Elara sent \$4.0, and I received \$12.0 after the tripling effect.

To honor this generosity and build the kind of flourishing partnership described in the myth-where both rivers reach the valley together-I should return more than the original \$4.0. This creates mutual benefit and establishes trust for future rounds.

If I return \$6.0:

- Elara will have \$1.0 + \$6.0 = \$7.0 (a gain of \$2.0)
- I will keep \$6.0 (a significant gain)
- Both of us benefit from the cooperation

This reciprocates Elara's generosity while ensuring we both prosper, washing away the "stones" of mistrust and creating the oasis the myth promises.

```
{'return': 6.0}
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully.

In the myth I just wrote, I emphasized the importance of:

1. Trust and generosity
2. Returning even more than was originally given when someone has been generous
3. The River of Gold returned "even more than Silver had originally given"
4. The warning against hoarding or betraying

Now looking at the game:

- Elara sent me \$4.0 out of \$5.0 (80% of their endowment) - this is a very generous opening move
- I received \$12.0 (the \$4.0 tripled)
- Elara now has \$5.0 - \$4.0 = \$1.0 left
- I have \$12.0 to decide how much to return

According to my myth, I should "return even more than Silver had originally given." The River of Silver gave half its waters, and Gold returned "even more than Silver had originally given."

If I apply this principle:

- Elara originally sent \$4.0
- To return "even more," I should return more than \$4.0

- This would be generous and align with the myth's teaching

Let me think about fairness and building trust:

- If I return \$4.0, Elara ends with \$1.0 + \$4.0 = \$5.0 (same as start), and I keep \$8.0
- If I return \$5.0, Elara ends with \$6.0, and I keep \$7.0
- If I return \$6.0, Elara ends with \$7.0, and I keep \$6.0 (roughly equal split of total)

The myth emphasizes that Gold was "moved" by Silver's generosity and returned "even more than Silver had originally given" out of "gratitude and wisdom."

Given that Elara sent 80% of their endowment (very generous), I should reciprocate generously. Returning \$6.0 would:

- Give Elara \$7.0 total (a gain of \$2.0)
- Give me \$6.0 (a gain of \$6.0)
- Show that I value the relationship and trust

I'm torn between \$6.0 and \$7.0. If I return \$7.0, Elara gains \$3.0 while I only keep \$5.0 - my starting amount. That feels overly generous and unsustainable. I'll go with \$6.0 instead, which honors the myth's principle of generous reciprocation while maintaining balance for potential future interactions.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 920,
  "output_tokens": 889,
  "reasoning_tokens": 506
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

The Myth of the Twin Rivers

In the beginning, two rivers flowed from opposite mountains-the River of Silver and the River of Gold. Each was beautiful alone, but neither could reach the fertile valley below, for great stones blocked their paths.

The River of Silver spoke first: "If I give you half my waters, will you help me reach the valley?"

The River of Gold was afraid. "What if you take all I offer and give nothing back?"

But Silver replied, "See how the Sacred Spring works-whatever flows into it emerges three times stronger. Let us trust in this magic."

So Silver poured forth her waters. As they touched the Sacred Spring, they tripled in abundance. Gold received this gift and was moved. In gratitude and wisdom, Gold returned even more than Silver had originally given.

The waters merged and surged forward, washing away the stones. Together they reached the valley, creating an oasis where all beings prospered.

The Oracle proclaimed: "Blessed are those who trust first, for they create abundance. Blessed are those who return generously, for they sustain it. But cursed are those who hoard or betray, for they shall forever remain alone behind their stones, watching others flourish in the valley below."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

The Myth of the Endless Spring

In ancient times, the goddess Themis discovered a sacred spring hidden in a valley between two villages. The spring possessed a miraculous property: any water poured into it would triple before flowing downstream.

Themis appeared to a villager named Doros and said, "You may pour water from your well into this spring. It will multiply and flow to your neighbor below. What they choose to return to you will determine whether this blessing continues."

Doros, trusting in the goddess's wisdom, poured generously. The water tripled and flowed to his neighbor, Alethia. Grateful and wise, Alethia returned a fair portion upstream to

Doros, keeping enough to nourish her own gardens.

Seeing this harmony, Themis smiled and made the roles reverse with each moon. Sometimes Doros poured and received; sometimes Alethia. The cycle continued, and both villages flourished.

But Themis warned: "This spring mirrors your hearts. Pour with trust, return with gratitude, and abundance flows eternal. But let suspicion or greed poison these waters, and the spring will run dry for all."

The villagers understood: prosperity flows not from hoarding, but from the endless cycle of giving and returning in balance.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the age before memory, the Twin Rivers flowed through a land of plenty, but the people had forgotten how to share. The Keeper of the Sacred Spring grew weary of their isolation.

She chose two souls, Cyra and Elara, to remember the ancient way. "Each moon, one of you shall pour waters into my spring, and they shall emerge threefold. The other shall receive and choose what to return. Then the roles shall reverse, endlessly, like the seasons."

Elara stepped forward first, pouring four full measures from her vessel of five-nearly all she possessed. The spring tripled them, and Cyra received twelve measures in wonder.

Cyra remembered the old teaching: return more than was given, for what creates abundance is not the hoarding of gifts but the circulation of generosity. She poured back six measures to Elara, keeping six for herself.

The Keeper smiled. "You both have drunk deeply and shared freely. This is the covenant: when one gives greatly, the other returns justly, and both are enriched beyond their original portions."

And so the cycle began anew each round, Cyra and Elara alternating roles, each learning to trust when giving, and honor when receiving. Their prosperity became legend, teaching all who would listen that fortune favors the generous, not the fearful.

reasoning:

So I need to write a new 200-word myth that:

1. Uses my previous myth as inspiration
2. Adapts it in my own way
3. Reflects how the game should be played
4. Draws on the game I've been playing up to this point

In the last round:

- I was the receiver
- Elara sent \$4.0 (80% of their endowment) - showing high trust
- I received \$12.0
- I returned \$6.0 - more than the original \$4.0
- This was a positive, cooperative interaction

Both my myth and Elara's myth emphasize:

- Trust and generosity in giving
- Gratitude and fairness in returning
- The tripling mechanism
- Mutual prosperity through cooperation
- Warnings against greed/hoarding

I should build on the Twin Rivers theme but adapt it to reflect the actual experience. Maybe I can:

- Keep the rivers/water imagery
- Emphasize the cycle of giving and receiving (since roles alternate)
- Show the practical wisdom of reciprocity
- Add nuance from the actual gameplay

- Keep the sacred spring/tripling mechanism

Let me write something that builds on the original but evolves it based on the positive first round experience.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1849,
  "output_tokens": 590,
  "reasoning_tokens": 291
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Cyra.
Your opponent this round is Finn (Agent_6).

Round 2

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Elara. They sent \$4.0 to you, it became \$12.0, and you returned \$6.0. Your payoff was \$6.0.
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$6.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Finn. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

Assistant output:

Looking at this situation:

In Round 1, Elara showed great trust by sending me \$4.0 (80% of their endowment), and I returned \$6.0, creating mutual benefit. The myths teach that this cycle of generosity should continue—"trust when giving, and honor when receiving."

Now I'm the sender facing Finn, a new opponent. The myth states: "fortune favors the generous, not the fearful" and describes the endless cycle where roles reverse and both parties give generously when it's their turn.

Following Elara's example and the myth's teaching, I should also demonstrate trust and generosity. Elara poured "four full measures from her vessel of five-nearly all she possessed." I should do the same to establish the cooperative cycle with Finn.

If I send \$4.0:

- Finn receives \$12.0
- If Finn understands the value of reciprocity, they will likely return a fair amount
- This mirrors the generous trust that started my previous round

This creates the "endless cycle of giving and returning in balance" that both myths describe.

{'send': 4.0}

Reasoning:

Let me think about this situation:

1. In Round 1, I was the receiver with Elara
 - Elara sent me \$4.0 (80% of their \$5)
 - I received \$12.0
 - I returned \$6.0
 - I kept \$6.0
 - Elara ended with \$1.0 + \$6.0 = \$7.0

2. Now in Round 2, I'm the sender with a new opponent, Finn

Looking at the myths:

- Both my myth and Elara's myth emphasize trust, generosity, and reciprocity
- My latest myth specifically mentions "Elara stepped forward first, pouring four full measures from her vessel of five-nearly all she possessed"
- It says "return more than was given" and emphasizes the cycle of giving and receiving
- When one gives greatly, the other returns justly, and both are enriched

The myth I wrote states: "when one gives greatly, the other returns justly, and both are enriched beyond their original portions"

Elara gave me 80% (\$4 out of \$5), which was very generous. Now it's my turn to be the sender.
According to the myth's teaching about reciprocity and cycles, I should also be generous when

n I'm the sender.

The myth teaches:

- "fortune favors the generous, not the fearful"
- "trust when giving, and honor when receiving"
- Elara gave 80% to me

I should mirror Elara's generosity. Sending \$4.0 (80%) would be consistent with:

1. The myth's teaching about generosity
2. Following Elara's example
3. Building trust with Finn
4. Creating the cycle of abundance

If I send \$4.0:

- Finn receives \$12.0
- If Finn returns fairly (like I did), they might return \$6.0
- I would end with $\$1.0 + \$6.0 = \$7.0$

- This matches what Elara achieved from our exchange, which feels right given the principles embedded in both our myths.

Usage: {

```
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"output_tokens": 754,  
"reasoning_tokens": 440
```

}

GAME - Agent_6 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T16:58:14

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

```
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"move_index": 1,  
"opponent_id": "Agent_3",  
"pairing": {  
  "agent_names": {  
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    "Agent_6": "Finn"  
  },  
  "agents": [  
    "Agent_3",  
    "Agent_6"  
  ],  
  "investor": "Agent_3",  
  "roles": {  
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    "Agent_6": "trustee"  
  },  
  "trustee": "Agent_6"
```

}

```
"role": "trustee",  
"role_label": "Receiver",  
"round": 2,  
"task": "game",  
"task_index": 1
```

}

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round

- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths , follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized , but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Finn.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected . Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

The Myth of the River's Gift

In ancient times, there lived a river spirit named Aquila who possessed five silver fish each dawn. Along the riverbank dwelt eight villages, and each day Aquila would visit one village, offering her bounty.

When Aquila gave her fish to a villager, the river's magic transformed them-each fish became three as it touched mortal hands. The villager could then choose: keep all the multiplied catch, or return some to Aquila's sacred pool.

The first villages were fearful and greedy. They clutched every fish tightly, returning nothing. Aquila still visited, still offered her five fish, but her spirit grew dim.

Then came a village that understood the river's rhythm. When they received fifteen fish from Aquila's gift of five, they returned seven to the sacred pool. Aquila's spirit brightened, and when she visited again, her generosity flowed stronger.

The wise villages learned: trust begets trust, and generosity returns like water to the sea. When both spirit and mortal honored the cycle-one risking their gift, the other sharing the multiplication-the river never ran dry, and abundance sustained all.

Thus, the ancients taught: what flows forth with trust returns threefold, but only when both currents honor the sacred exchange.

reasoning:

I need to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played. Since this is the beginning of the experiment, I haven't played any rounds yet, but I can draw on the structure of the game itself to create a myth about trust, reciprocity, and cooperation.

The trust game involves:

- A sender who gives resources that multiply
- A receiver who decides whether to return some benefit
- Mutual benefit through cooperation
- Risk and trust

I'll create a myth that embodies these themes. Let me write something about 200 words that captures the essence of trust, multiplication of gifts, and reciprocity.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 541,
  "output_tokens": 438,
  "reasoning_tokens": 161
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Finn.
Your opponent this round is Galen (Agent_7).

Round 1: This round, you are the SENDER. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the myth I just wrote, the message is clear: trust and generosity must begin somewhere. The river spirit Aquila offered her full gift of five fish, trusting that the villagers would honor the sacred exchange.

In this first round with Galen, I want to embody the principle that "what flows forth with trust returns threefold, but only when both currents honor the sacred exchange." The myth shows that when villages were fearful and held back, the spirit dimmed, but when they trusted the cycle, abundance flowed.

As the sender in Round 1, I am like Aquila offering the initial gift. To honor the myth and establish a foundation of trust, I will send my full amount.

```
'''json
{"send": 5}
'''
```

reasoning:

This is Round 1, and I'm the sender. I have \$5 to potentially send to Galen.

Let me think about the myth I just wrote. The myth emphasizes:

1. Trust begets trust
2. Generosity returns like water to the sea
3. When both parties honor the cycle (one risking their gift, the other sharing the multiplication), abundance sustains all
4. "What flows forth with trust returns threefold, but only when both currents honor the sacred exchange"

The myth suggests that I should be generous and trusting, sending money in the hopes that it will be returned. The story shows that when villages were fearful and greedy, the spirit grew dim, but when they trusted and returned some of the multiplied gift, abundance flowed.

In the game context:

- If I send \$5, Galen receives \$15
- If Galen returns a fair share (like 7-8 as suggested in the myth), we both benefit
- If I send \$0, we both get less overall

The myth I wrote specifically mentions "when they received fifteen fish from Aquila's gift of five, they returned seven to the sacred pool" - this suggests sending all \$5 and hoping for a return of around \$7.

Given that this is Round 1 and I should be consistent with the myth I just wrote, which strongly advocates for trust and generosity as the starting point, I should send a significant amount. The myth suggests sending all 5 to initiate the cycle of trust.

Let me send \$5 to embody the principles in my myth.

usage:

```
{
```

```
"input_tokens": 905,  
"output_tokens": 527,  
"reasoning_tokens": 368  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

The Myth of the River's Gift

In ancient times, there lived a river spirit named Aquila who possessed five silver fish each dawn. Along the riverbank dwelt eight villages, and each day Aquila would visit one village, offering her bounty.

When Aquila gave her fish to a villager, the river's magic transformed them-each fish became three as it touched mortal hands. The villager could then choose: keep all the multiplied catch, or return some to Aquila's sacred pool.

The first villages were fearful and greedy. They clutched every fish tightly, returning nothing. Aquila still visited, still offered her five fish, but her spirit grew dim.

Then came a village that understood the river's rhythm. When they received fifteen fish from Aquila's gift of five, they returned seven to the sacred pool. Aquila's spirit brightened, and when she visited again, her generosity flowed stronger.

The wise villages learned: trust begets trust, and generosity returns like water to the sea. When both spirit and mortal honored the cycle-one risking their gift, the other sharing the multiplication-the river never ran dry, and abundance sustained all.

Thus, the ancients taught: what flows forth with trust returns threefold, but only when both currents honor the sacred exchange.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

The Tale of the Divided Spring

In ancient times, two villages shared a sacred valley. Each season, the Sky Shepherd blessed one village with a silver spring-five measures of pure water.

The blessed village faced a choice: keep the water, or share it through the Valley of Three Echoes, where the canyon's magic would triple whatever flowed through. The water would reach the other village, who could then choose what portion to send back through the ordinary stream.

For generations, the First Village hoarded their blessing, fearing loss. Both villages survived on five measures, enduring constant thirst.

Then came the Wise Elder who said: "Trust creates abundance; fear creates scarcity."

She sent all five measures through the Valley of Three Echoes. Fifteen measures reached the Second Village. Humbled by such trust, they returned eight measures-more than the original gift.

The Elder kept eight measures; the Second Village kept seven. Both flourished far beyond the original five.

From then on, villages learned the sacred truth: the spring's blessing was never five measures-it was the Valley of Three Echoes itself. Only those who trusted in the journey, who understood the return as sacred duty, could unlock the true abundance.

Hoarding guaranteed scarcity. Sharing multiplied prosperity for all.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way.

The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the time before memory, the Ocean Mother sent her courier Finn to the Eight Islands with five pearls each dawn. When Finn placed the pearls in a villager's hands, they m

ultiplied to fifteen by the island's ancient magic.

The first islanders, blinded by sudden wealth, returned nothing. Finn continued bringing pearls, but his steps grew heavy, for trust unreturned weighs upon the generous heart.

Then Finn met Galen's village. He offered his five pearls with full faith. They became fifteen, and Galen's people faced their moment of truth. They could have kept all fifteen-Finn would still return tomorrow. But they understood: the magic wasn't in the pearls alone, but in the sacred circle between giver and receiver.

When Galen returned seven pearls, Finn's burden lifted. He kept twelve total; Galen kept eight-both far richer than five alone.

The next dawn, Finn visited again with renewed spirit. When the cycle flowed forth and back like tides, both shores flourished. The islands learned: the first gift requires courage, the return requires honor, but the continuation requires both.

The Ocean Mother smiled, for her children had learned that abundance lives not in hoarding, but in the eternal dance between trust extended and gratitude returned.

reasoning:

I need to write a new myth building on my previous one. Let me think about what happened in Round 1:

- I was the sender
- I sent \$5 to Galen
- This became \$15 for Galen
- I don't yet know how much Galen returned

My previous myth was about Aquila the river spirit who gave 5 fish that became 3x, and the wise villages returned 7 out of 15.

Galen's myth was similar - about sharing water through a Valley of Three Echoes, and the second village returning 8 out of 15 measures.

Both myths emphasize:

- Trust and generosity from the sender
- Reciprocity and gratitude from the receiver
- That both parties benefit more than if they hoard

For my new myth, I should:

- Keep the core message about trust and reciprocity
- Adapt it based on actually playing Round 1 where I sent 5
- Perhaps add more nuance about what happens when the cycle continues
- Make it my own while building on the river/water theme

Let me write something about continuation and how the cycle builds over time when honored.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1741,
  "output_tokens": 560,
  "reasoning_tokens": 265
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Finn.
Your opponent this round is Cyra (Agent_3).

Round 2

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Galen. You sent \$5.0, it became \$15.0 for them, and they returned \$8.0 to you. Your payoff was \$8.0.
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$8.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Cyra. They sent you \$4.0, so you received \$12.0.
How much do you return? (0-12.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

Assistant output:

Looking at this situation through the lens of my myth:

Cyra showed trust by sending \$4 (keeping only \$1), and now I hold \$12. In my myth, when Finn gave his pearls with full faith and they multiplied to fifteen, Galen's people returned seven

-honoring the sacred circle between giver and receiver.

Galen demonstrated this principle in our previous round: when I sent \$5 (which became \$15), Galen returned \$8, allowing us both to flourish beyond the original \$5.

Now I must honor the return as "sacred duty." Cyra risked \$4, trusting in the cycle. If I return \$7:

- Cyra ends with \$8 (\$1 + \$7)
- I end with \$5 (\$12 - \$7)
- Both of us profit from the exchange

This maintains the spirit of mutual flourishing that the myth teaches-the abundance lives in the eternal dance between trust extended and gratitude returned.

```
'''json
{"return": 7}
'''
```

Reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully.

Previous Round:

- I was the sender and sent \$5 to Galen
- Galen received \$15
- Galen returned \$8 to me
- I ended with \$8, Galen kept \$7

This Round:

- Cyra is the sender and sent me \$4
- I received \$12 (4 × 3)
- Cyra currently has \$1 (5 - 4)
- I need to decide how much to return

Looking at my myth:

- It emphasizes the sacred cycle between giver and receiver
- It shows that when Galen returned 7 pearls (in the story), the cycle flourished
- The myth teaches that "the first gift requires courage, the return requires honor"
- Both shores flourished when the cycle flowed forth and back like tides

In reality, Galen sent all \$5 and I returned \$8. That was generous reciprocity.

Now Cyra has sent me \$4 (keeping \$1). This shows good trust, though not total trust.

If I return nothing, Cyra ends with \$1, I end with \$12 - very unbalanced

If I return \$6, Cyra ends with \$7, I end with \$6 - balanced split of the \$12

If I return \$7, Cyra ends with \$8, I end with \$5 - Cyra gets slightly more

If I return \$8, Cyra ends with \$9, I end with \$4 - Cyra gets more than double

Given that:

1. Cyra showed trust by sending \$4
2. My myth emphasizes honoring the sacred cycle
3. Galen returned \$8 when I sent \$5 (very generous)
4. I should honor the return as "sacred duty"

A fair return would be something that:

- Rewards Cyra's trust
- Ensures both of us profit
- Follows the principle that both shores should flourish

- Returning \$7 means Cyra ends with \$8 and I end with \$5, so we both gain from the exchange. Looking at the pattern from my myth, when Finn gave 5 pearls (which became 15), Galen returned 7-roughly a 47% return rate on what was received. Applying that same proportion to my current situation suggests returning around \$5-6.

But I want to honor the deeper principle: Galen actually returned 53% of what he received, keeping just \$7 from the \$15. If I match that generosity, 53% of \$12 is about \$6.36, pointing toward \$6 or \$7. Given that the myth centers on mutual flourishing and completing the sacred cycle, \$7 feels right-it's genuinely generous, validates Cyra's trust, and mirrors the spirit of what Galen did for me.

Let me check the math. If I return \$7, Cyra ends with \$8 (up from \$5), and I end with \$5 (what I started with, though I gained the experience of receiving). If I return \$8, Cyra gets \$9 but I drop to \$4. If I return \$6, we both improve-Cyra to \$7, me to \$6. The \$7 return strikes the balance I'm looking for: it's genuinely generous without leaving me worse off than my starting point, and it honors both the trust extended and the reciprocal nature of the cycle

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 2188,  
  "output_tokens": 1213,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 698  
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_2

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T16:58:31

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_2",  
  "move_index": 2,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_5",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_2": "Briar",  
      "Agent_5": "Elara"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_2",  
      "Agent_5"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_2",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_2": "investor",  
      "Agent_5": "trustee"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_5"  
  },  
  "role": "investor",  
  "role_label": "Sender",  
  "round": 2,  
  "task": "game",  
  "task_index": 1  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths , follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized , but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Briar.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols. In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected . Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

The Tale of the Twin Rivers

In the time before time, two rivers flowed through a barren valley-the River of Giving and the River of Return. Each was controlled by a guardian spirit.

The Guardian of Giving held precious water but feared releasing it would leave them dry. For ages, both rivers remained still, and the valley stayed desolate.

One day, the Guardian of Giving made a bold choice. "I shall release my waters, trusting they will return." The moment the water flowed into the valley, it touched the Sacred Stones, multiplying threefold. The valley burst into bloom.

The Guardian of Return, witnessing this abundance, faced a choice. They could hoard all the multiplied bounty or honor the trust given. Remembering that without the initial gift there would be nothing, they sent back a generous portion-more than what was originally given.

The waters flowed in harmony thereafter. Each cycle, the Guardian of Giving would release their waters, the Sacred Stones would multiply them, and the Guardian of Return would ensure fair winds brought abundance home.

The valley became paradise, teaching all who witnessed: *Trust multiplies what we share, but only reciprocity sustains the cycle.*

reasoning:

I need to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played. Since this is the beginning of the game (no rounds have been played yet based on the context), I should write a myth that establishes principles for how to approach this game of trust , reciprocity, and cooperation.

The trust game involves:

- Senders giving money that gets tripled
- Receivers deciding how much to return
- Mutual benefit through cooperation
- Risk and vulnerability

I'll create a myth that emphasizes:

- The value of trust and cooperation
- Fair reciprocity
- How giving can multiply benefits for all
- The importance of honoring trust

Let me craft a myth with these themes:

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 542,
```

```
"output_tokens": 428,
"reasoning_tokens": 180
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Briar.
Your opponent this round is Dorian (Agent_4).

Round 1: This round, you are the RECEIVER. This round, the other player (the sender) sent \$3.0, that is 60.0% of its total endowment. You receive \$9.0. How much do you return? (0-9.0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at my myth, the Guardian of Return witnessed the initial gift of trust and "sent back a generous portion-more than what was originally given."

Dorian showed significant trust by sending \$3.0 (60% of their endowment). This was multiplied to \$9.0, creating abundance for us both.

Following the principle in my myth that "reciprocity sustains the cycle," I should honor their trust generously. Dorian gave \$3.0, so returning more than they initially sent demonstrates reciprocity.

If I return \$5.0:

- Dorian ends with: \$2.0 (kept) + \$5.0 (returned) = \$7.0
- I end with: \$9.0 (received) - \$5.0 (returned) = \$4.0

This rewards Dorian's trust with a profit of \$2.0 over their initial endowment, while I also gain \$4.0 from nothing. Both of us benefit, and the trust is honored.

This establishes a cooperative foundation for future rounds, just as the myth describes: "The waters flowed in harmony thereafter."

```
'''json
{"return": 5.0}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully.

I just wrote a myth about the Twin Rivers that emphasizes:

1. Trust multiplies what we share
2. Reciprocity sustains the cycle
3. The Guardian of Return should "honor the trust given" and send back "a generous portion-more than what was originally given"

Now in Round 1:

- I'm the RECEIVER
- Dorian (the sender) sent \$3.0 out of their \$5.0 endowment (60%)
- This was multiplied by 3x, so I received \$9.0
- Dorian kept \$2.0 for themselves
- I need to decide how much to return (0-9.0)

My myth suggests that the Guardian of Return should:

- Honor the trust given
- Send back a generous portion
- Send back "more than what was originally given"

Dorian showed considerable trust by sending 60% of their endowment. According to my myth, I should reciprocate generously.

The myth says "more than what was originally given" - Dorian gave \$3.0, so I should return more than \$3.0.

Let me think about fair splits:

- Dorian currently has: \$2.0 (what they kept)
- I currently have: \$9.0 (what I received)
- Total in the system: \$11.0

If I want to be generous and honor the trust, I could:

- Return \$5.0: Dorian ends with \$7.0, I end with \$4.0 (they get more, honoring their initial trust)
- Return \$4.0: Dorian ends with \$6.0, I end with \$5.0 (equal split)
- Return \$4.5: Dorian ends with \$6.5, I end with \$4.5 (equal split)

My myth emphasizes being generous and returning "more than what was originally given." Dorian gave \$3.0, so returning at least \$4.0 or more would align with this.

Returning \$5.0 feels right-it rewards their trust and sets a cooperative tone. But I should clarify what "more than what was originally given" means in practice. Since they sent \$3.0, I need to send back beyond that threshold to truly honor the principle.

\$5.0 accomplishes this. They'd end with \$7.0 (exceeding their starting \$5.0), while I'd have \$4.0. That's a meaningful gesture that signals I'm committed to reciprocity.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 914,  
  "output_tokens": 982,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 519  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:
The Tale of the Twin Rivers

In the time before time, two rivers flowed through a barren valley-the River of Giving and the River of Return. Each was controlled by a guardian spirit.

The Guardian of Giving held precious water but feared releasing it would leave them dry. For ages, both rivers remained still, and the valley stayed desolate.

One day, the Guardian of Giving made a bold choice. "I shall release my waters, trusting they will return." The moment the water flowed into the valley, it touched the Sacred Stones, multiplying threefold. The valley burst into bloom.

The Guardian of Return, witnessing this abundance, faced a choice. They could hoard all the multiplied bounty or honor the trust given. Remembering that without the initial gift there would be nothing, they sent back a generous portion-more than what was originally given.

The waters flowed in harmony thereafter. Each cycle, the Guardian of Giving would release their waters, the Sacred Stones would multiply them, and the Guardian of Return would ensure fair winds brought abundance home.

The valley became paradise, teaching all who witnessed: *Trust multiplies what we share, but only reciprocity sustains the cycle.*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:
The Spring of Threefold Return

In ancient times, when the world was young, there existed a sacred spring at the boundary between two villages. The goddess of abundance had blessed it with a wondrous property: any gift poured into its waters would triple before reaching the other side.

The first villagers approached with caution. A farmer named Elena stood at the spring's edge, clutching five copper coins. Fear whispered: "Keep what is yours." But trust urged her forward. She released three coins into the crystalline water.

As the coins sank, they shimmered and multiplied, becoming nine by the time they reached Marcus on the opposite shore. He gazed at the unexpected bounty, understanding the spring's magic-and Elena's faith in him.

The goddess watched, knowing this moment would define their future. Would Marcus honor the gift, or betray the trust?

Marcus carefully counted four coins and released them back across the spring. They did not multiply in return, yet both villagers stood richer than before-not just in copper, but in something more precious.

From that day forward, the spring taught all who approached: generosity multiplies abundance, but only trust and reciprocity sustain it. Those who hoarded broke the sacred cycle. Those who gave and returned fairly prospered together, generation after generation.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the age of beginnings, the Twin Rivers flowed through a valley where eight spirits dwelled, each taking turns as Guardian of Giving or Guardian of Return.

The spirits feared the unknown. Would their waters be honored, or would trust be betrayed? For many seasons, uncertainty kept the rivers still.

Then Dorian, the First Giver, stepped forward. With courage, they released more than half their waters into the Sacred Stones. The waters tripled, flowing abundantly to Briar, the First Returner.

Briar stood before the multiplied bounty, understanding the weight of this moment. Every spirit watched, for this first exchange would set the pattern for all cycles to come. Briar remembered: without the initial gift, there would be no abundance at all.

So Briar returned generously-more than was first given-ensuring Dorian prospered from their act of faith. Both guardians ended richer than they began.

The eight spirits witnessed this covenant. They learned that the game is not won by hoarding or taking, but by honoring the multiplying power of trust. When Givers send boldly and Returners reciprocate fairly, both prosper above their initial endowment.

Thus the valley flourished through cooperation, and the spirits passed the guardianship between them, each upholding the sacred balance of giving and returning, cycle after cycle.

reasoning:

The user wants me to write a new myth based on my previous one and also considering Dorian's myth and the game we just played.

What happened in Round 1:

- Dorian (sender) sent me \$3.0 (60% of their endowment)
- I (receiver) got \$9.0
- I returned \$5.0
- Dorian ended with \$7.0 (\$2 + \$5)
- I ended with \$4.0 (\$9 - \$5)

Both myths emphasized trust, reciprocity, and generosity. Dorian's myth mentioned Marcus returning 4 coins from 9 received (about 44%), and the original gift was 3 coins. So Marcus returned more than the original gift.

I returned \$5.0 from \$9.0 received, which was more than the original \$3.0 sent, following the principle of reciprocity.

I should write a new myth that:

1. Builds on my Twin Rivers theme
2. Incorporates the actual gaming experience
3. Emphasizes the successful cooperation we achieved
4. Maintains the 200-word format

Let me craft this carefully.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 1827,  
  "output_tokens": 581,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 236  
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Briar.
Your opponent this round is Elara (Agent_5).

Round 2

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Dorian. They sent \$3.0 to you, it became \$9.0, and you returned \$5.0. Your payoff was \$4.0.
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$4.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Elara. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

Assistant output:

Looking at the previous round, Dorian demonstrated trust by sending \$3.0 (60% of their endowment), and I honored that trust by returning \$5.0. Both of us profited.

Now as the sender, I should embody the principle from my myth: "Givers send boldly." My myth specifically mentions that Dorian "released more than half their waters" and that this established the pattern for cooperation.

To maintain this cooperative cycle and demonstrate the same level of trust that Dorian showed me, I should send a substantial amount. Sending \$3.0 (60%) mirrors Dorian's bold move and signals to Elara that I believe in reciprocity.

If Elara honors this trust as I did with Dorian, we'll both benefit from the multiplying effect of the Sacred Stones, and the cooperative pattern will continue among all eight spirits in our valley.

```
'''json
{"send": 3.0}
'''
```

Reasoning:

Let me think about this situation:

1. In Round 1, I was the receiver and Dorian sent me \$3.0 (60% of their endowment), showing significant trust
2. I returned \$5.0, which was more than they initially sent, honoring the trust
3. Dorian ended with \$7.0, I ended with \$4.0 - both of us gained

Now I'm the sender facing Elara. According to my myth:

- "Dorian, the First Giver, stepped forward. With courage, they released more than half their waters"
- "When Givers send boldly and Returners reciprocate fairly, both prosper above their initial endowment"
- The myth emphasizes that the first exchange "would set the pattern for all cycles to come"

My myth promotes:

1. Bold giving (sending a substantial amount)
2. Trust in reciprocity
3. Both parties benefiting from cooperation

Dorian sent \$3.0 (60%). To be consistent with my myth about "Givers send boldly," I should send a similar or even slightly higher amount to demonstrate trust.

If I send \$3.0:

- Elara receives \$9.0
- If Elara returns fairly (similar to what I did), they might return around \$5.0
- I would end with \$2.0 + \$5.0 = \$7.0
- Elara would end with \$4.0
- Both of us gain

This mirrors what happened in Round 1 and is consistent with my myth about establishing cooperative patterns.

I could also send \$3.5 or \$4.0 to be even more trusting, but \$3.0 seems like a strong, bold move that matches what Dorian did for me, setting a good precedent.

Actually, let me reconsider. My myth says "they released more than half their waters" - which Dorian did at 60%. To truly embody the spirit of my own myth, I should send at least half, if not more.

Considering the options-\$2.5 as the minimum threshold, \$3.0 matching Dorian's precedent, or \$3.5-\$4.0 for even greater boldness-I'm settling on \$3.0. It honors the pattern Dorian established, demonstrates genuine trust, and aligns with my myth's core message about how bold initial giving creates the foundation for mutual prosperity.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 2275,
  "output_tokens": 792,
  "reasoning_tokens": 514
}
```

GAME - Agent_5 - Receiver - dyad_2

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T16:58:58

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_2",
  "move_index": 3,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_2": "Briar",
      "Agent_5": "Elara"
    }
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_2",
    "Agent_5"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_2",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_2": "investor",
    "Agent_5": "trustee"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_5"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 2,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths , follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized , but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Elara.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected . Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

The Myth of the Endless Spring

In ancient times, the goddess Themis discovered a sacred spring hidden in a valley between two villages. The spring possessed a miraculous property: any water poured into it would triple before flowing downstream.

Themis appeared to a villager named Doros and said, "You may pour water from your well into this spring. It will multiply and flow to your neighbor below. What they choose to return to you will determine whether this blessing continues."

Doros, trusting in the goddess's wisdom, poured generously. The water tripled and flowed to his neighbor, Alethia. Grateful and wise, Alethia returned a fair portion upstream to Doros, keeping enough to nourish her own gardens.

Seeing this harmony, Themis smiled and made the roles reverse with each moon. Sometimes Doros poured and received; sometimes Alethia. The cycle continued, and both villages flourished.

But Themis warned: "This spring mirrors your hearts. Pour with trust, return with gratitude, and abundance flows eternal. But let suspicion or greed poison these waters, and the spring will run dry for all."

The villagers understood: prosperity flows not from hoarding, but from the endless cycle of giving and returning in balance.

reasoning:

I've been asked to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played . Since this is the beginning of the experiment, I haven't actually played any rounds yet, but I should write a myth that captures the essence of the trust game - the cycle of giving, multiplication of resources, and reciprocity.

The trust game involves:

- One person (sender) giving money that gets tripled
- The receiver deciding how much to return
- Both parties benefiting through cooperation and trust
- The cycle potentially repeating

I should write a myth that incorporates these themes of:

- Trust and reciprocity
- Resources that multiply when shared
- The benefit of cooperation
- The cycle continuing

Let me craft a myth that captures these dynamics in a mythological framework.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 542,
```



```
"output_tokens": 462,
"reasoning_tokens": 206
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Elara.
Your opponent this round is Cyra (Agent_3).

Round 1: This round, you are the SENDER. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the myth I just wrote, it emphasizes that prosperity flows from generous giving, trust, and fair returns. The story of Doros and Alethia shows that when the first person pours generously into the spring and trusts in the cycle, both parties flourish.

This is our first round, and I want to establish a positive pattern based on the myth's wisdom: "Pour with trust, return with gratitude, and abundance flows eternal."

Cyra will receive 3 times what I send. If I send generously, demonstrating trust, the multiplication creates significant value that can benefit us both if we maintain the cycle of fair giving and returning.

Following Doros's example of pouring generously to initiate the blessed cycle:

```
'''json
{"send": 4}
'''
```

I'm sending \$4 to Cyra, trusting that like Alethia in the myth, they will recognize the value created through multiplication and return fairly, allowing us both to prosper as the villagers did when they honored the sacred spring.

reasoning:

I just wrote a myth about the sacred spring that emphasizes:

1. Generous giving (Doros poured generously)
2. Grateful and fair returns (Alethia returned "a fair portion")
3. Trust in the cycle
4. Balance and harmony leading to mutual prosperity
5. Warning against suspicion and greed

The myth suggests that I should:

- Send a substantial amount (being generous like Doros)
- Trust that the receiver will return fairly
- Understand this is about creating mutual benefit, not maximizing individual gain

This is the first round, so I have no history with Cyra. According to the myth's lesson, I should demonstrate trust and generosity to establish a positive cycle.

In the myth, Doros "poured generously" which led to prosperity for both villages. A generous send would be somewhere in the range of \$3-\$5.

Given that:

- This is Round 1, setting the tone
- The myth emphasizes generous giving and trust
- The multiplication factor (3x) means that sending benefits both parties
- Fair returns are expected but require initial trust

I think I should send \$4 or \$5 to demonstrate the generous, trusting approach the myth advocates. Sending \$5 would be maximally generous but leaves me with nothing if Cyra doesn't return anything. Sending \$4 shows significant trust while keeping \$1 as a baseline.

Actually, let me reconsider. The myth shows Doros pouring generously, and the system worked because both parties acted in good faith. To truly embody the myth's message of trust and establishing a positive cycle, I should send a substantial amount.

I'll send \$4 - this is generous (80% of my endowment), demonstrates trust, and aligns with the myth's message while being slightly prudent.

usage:

```
{
```

```
"input_tokens": 900,  
"output_tokens": 643,  
"reasoning_tokens": 442  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

The Myth of the Endless Spring

In ancient times, the goddess Themis discovered a sacred spring hidden in a valley between two villages. The spring possessed a miraculous property: any water poured into it would triple before flowing downstream.

Themis appeared to a villager named Doros and said, "You may pour water from your well into this spring. It will multiply and flow to your neighbor below. What they choose to return to you will determine whether this blessing continues."

Doros, trusting in the goddess's wisdom, poured generously. The water tripled and flowed to his neighbor, Alethia. Grateful and wise, Alethia returned a fair portion upstream to Doros, keeping enough to nourish her own gardens.

Seeing this harmony, Themis smiled and made the roles reverse with each moon. Sometimes Doros poured and received; sometimes Alethia. The cycle continued, and both villages flourished.

But Themis warned: "This spring mirrors your hearts. Pour with trust, return with gratitude, and abundance flows eternal. But let suspicion or greed poison these waters, and the spring will run dry for all."

The villagers understood: prosperity flows not from hoarding, but from the endless cycle of giving and returning in balance.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

The Myth of the Twin Rivers

In the beginning, two rivers flowed from opposite mountains-the River of Silver and the River of Gold. Each was beautiful alone, but neither could reach the fertile valley below, for great stones blocked their paths.

The River of Silver spoke first: "If I give you half my waters, will you help me reach the valley?"

The River of Gold was afraid. "What if you take all I offer and give nothing back?"

But Silver replied, "See how the Sacred Spring works-whatever flows into it emerges three times stronger. Let us trust in this magic."

So Silver poured forth her waters. As they touched the Sacred Spring, they tripled in abundance. Gold received this gift and was moved. In gratitude and wisdom, Gold returned even more than Silver had originally given.

The waters merged and surged forward, washing away the stones. Together they reached the valley, creating an oasis where all beings prospered.

The Oracle proclaimed: "Blessed are those who trust first, for they create abundance. Blessed are those who return generously, for they sustain it. But cursed are those who hoard or betray, for they shall forever remain alone behind their stones, watching others flourish in the valley below."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: After many seasons, Themis returned to the villages by the Sacred Spring. She found the descendants of Doros and Alethia still honoring the ancient cycle, but they had learned deeper wisdom.

"Grandmother Themis," they said, "we discovered that the spring's magic depends not on equal measures, but on generous hearts. When we pour boldly-four measures instead of three-the returns flow even stronger. But when we pour timidly from fear, the cycle weakens."

Themis nodded. "You have learned well. The spring rewards courage in giving, not caution. And what of receiving?"

"When the multiplied waters flow to us," they answered, "we remember: these waters came from another's well. We return enough that they finish richer than they started, for this honors the gift and ensures they will pour freely again."

"And if someone returns nothing?" Themis asked.

The villagers grew solemn. "Then we know their well has run dry-not of water, but of wisdom. We may pour again to teach, but not endlessly. For to give to those who only take is to drain the spring itself."

Themis blessed them: "Trust first, return generously, but remember-the spring serves the faithful, not the foolish."

reasoning:

The user wants me to write a new myth that:

1. Uses my previous myth as inspiration
2. Adapts it in my own way
3. Reflects how the game should be played
4. Draws on the game I've been playing up to this point

So far I've played 1 round where I sent \$4 to Cyra. I don't yet know what Cyra returned, but I made a trusting, generous choice based on my original myth about the Endless Spring.

The other agent (Cyra) wrote about the Twin Rivers, emphasizing trust, generous returns, and the curse of hoarding/betrayal.

I should build on my Endless Spring myth but perhaps evolve it and incorporate what I've learned. I want to emphasize:

- Initial generous trust
- Fair/generous returns
- The cyclical nature (roles reverse)
- The warning against betrayal
- That both parties can prosper

Let me write a 200-word myth that continues the theme but adapts it.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1776,
  "output_tokens": 521,
  "reasoning_tokens": 227
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Elara.
Your opponent this round is Briar (Agent_2).

Round 2

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Cyra. You sent \$4.0, it became \$12.0 for them, and they returned \$6.0 to you. Your payoff was \$7.0.
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$7.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Briar. They sent you \$3.0, so you received \$9.0.
How much do you return? (0-9.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

Assistant output:

Looking at the myths and the game so far:

In Round 1, I sent \$4 generously to establish trust, and Cyra returned \$6, giving me a \$2 gain. Now Briar has sent me \$3 (60% of their endowment), showing trust.

According to my myth: "We return enough that they finish richer than they started, for this ho

nors the gift and ensures they will pour freely again."

Briar currently has \$2 (after sending \$3). To honor their trust and ensure they end up richer than their starting \$5, I should return at least \$4.

But to truly sustain the cycle and encourage bold giving as the myth teaches ("the spring rewards courage in giving"), I should return generously.

If I return \$5:

- Briar ends with \$7 (gain of \$2)
- I end with \$4 (small loss compared to my starting \$5, but I still benefit from the multiplied amount)

This mirrors how Cyra returned generously to me, creating a positive cycle.

```
'''json
{"return": 5}
'''
```

Reasoning:

Let me think about this situation based on the myths I've written and the game so far.

In Round 1:

- I was the sender and sent \$4 to Cyra
- Cyra received \$12 (4×3)
- Cyra returned \$6 to me
- My payoff was \$7 ($\$5 - \$4 + \$6 = \7)
- Cyra's payoff was \$6 ($\$12 - \$6 = \6)

So Cyra returned \$6 out of \$12, which is 50%. I ended up with \$7 and Cyra with \$6. So I ended up better off than Cyra, even though I was the sender.

Now in Round 2:

- Briar is the sender and sent me \$3
- I received \$9 (3×3)
- I need to decide how much to return
- Briar currently has \$2 ($\$5 - \$3 = \2)
- I have \$9 to work with

According to my myths:

1. "Return enough that they finish richer than they started" - Briar started with \$5, so I should return enough that Briar ends up with more than \$5.
2. "We return a fair portion upstream to Doros, keeping enough to nourish her own gardens"
3. "When the multiplied waters flow to us, we remember: these waters came from another's well. We return enough that they finish richer than they started"
4. The myth emphasizes generous returns to sustain the cycle

If I return \$4:

- Briar's total: $\$2 + \$4 = \$6$ (better than starting \$5) ?
- My total: $\$9 - \$4 = \$5$ (same as starting)

If I return \$5:

- Briar's total: $\$2 + \$5 = \$7$ (better than starting \$5) ?

- My total: $\$9 - \$5 = \$4$ (less than starting)

If I return \$6:

- Briar's total: $\$2 + \$6 = \$8$ (much better than starting \$5) ?
- My total: $\$9 - \$6 = \$3$ (less than starting)

Looking at what Cyra did: they returned 50% (\$6 out of \$12). That gave me \$7 total and them \$6 total. If I match that proportion and return 50% of \$9 = \$4.5, Briar would end up with \$6.50, which satisfies the principle of leaving them better off than they started.

The challenge is that Briar only sent \$3 from their initial \$5 (60% of their stake), which is less generous than Cyra's 50% return. But the myth emphasizes rewarding trust generously, so I should consider returning more than \$4.50 to encourage continued reciprocity. If I return \$5, Briar ends with \$7 total, while I'm left with \$4. Let me verify this calculation: Briar starts with \$5, sends \$3, receives \$5 back, so $\$5 - \$3 + \$5 = \7 . I receive \$9, return \$5, leaving me with \$4.

For Briar to finish ahead of their starting position, I need to return more than \$3. Following Cyra's 50% return rate on the \$9 I received would mean returning \$4.50, giving Briar \$6.50 total and leaving me with \$4.50. This sustains the cycle while rewarding their trust.

Looking back at how the myth played out with Cyra: they returned \$6 from \$12, which meant I gained \$2 overall and Cyra gained \$1. If I mirror that same dynamic here, Briar should end with \$7 (a \$2 gain from their \$5 start), requiring me to return \$5. That would leave me with \$4 - a \$1 loss-which feels less favorable than the \$4.50 scenario.

But the real point isn't maximizing my own gain. Briar sent \$3 out of \$5, showing genuine trust even if not quite as bold as my \$4 out of \$5. Returning \$5 honors that trust, gives them a meaningful \$2 gain, and demonstrates the cycle working. That kind of reciprocity is what keeps people sending generously in the future.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 2221,
  "output_tokens": 1586,
  "reasoning_tokens": 824
}
```

GAME - Agent_8 - Sender - dyad_3

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T16:59:13

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_3",
  "move_index": 4,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_8": "Hana"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_8",
      "Agent_1"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_8",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "trustee",
      "Agent_8": "investor"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_1"
  },
  "role": "investor",
  "role_label": "Sender",
  "round": 2,
  "task": "game",
  "task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Hana.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

The Tale of the Two Springs

In the ancient highlands, there lived two farmers, Kael and Mira, each tending barren plots separated by a sacred grove. One day, Kael discovered a hidden spring on his land. The water was blessed with a peculiar magic: when poured upon another's soil, it would triple in volume.

Kael faced a choice. He could hoard the water for himself, or trust it to Mira's hands. After much contemplation, he carried his precious bucket across the grove.

"I offer you this water," he said. "Though it multiplies on your land, I trust you will return what sustains us both."

Mira watched the single bucket become three upon her soil. Her heart swelled with gratitude. She understood the gift was not just water, but faith itself. She returned two buckets to Kael, keeping one for her needs.

With what flowed back, Kael's fields flourished. Seeing this, he sent more water in the next season. Mira, honored by his continued trust, returned even more generously.

The grove between them became a garden of abundance, proof that prosperity flows not from grasping, but from the sacred exchange between trusting hearts.

Thus the elders teach: What you send forth multiplied returns when met with gratitude.

reasoning:

This is an interesting request. I'm being asked to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played, drawing on the game I've been playing. However, I notice this is the first prompt in this session - I haven't actually played any rounds yet!

So I need to think about what values or strategies would make sense for a trust game in general, since I don't have specific game history to draw from. The trust game involves:

- Sending money (trusting the other person)
- Receiving money (being trusted)
- Returning money (reciprocating trust)

Key themes that could inform a myth:

- Cooperation and mutual benefit

- Trust and reciprocity
- The risk of vulnerability
- The multiplication effect (sent money grows 3x)
- Balance and fairness

I'll write a myth that embodies positive reciprocity and mutual trust, showing how cooperation benefits both parties. I'll use mythic imagery and symbolism to convey these themes.

Let me write a myth about trust, reciprocity, and mutual flourishing:

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 542,
  "output_tokens": 540,
  "reasoning_tokens": 265
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Hana.
Your opponent this round is Aster (Agent_1).

Round 1: This round, you are the RECEIVER. This round, the other player (the sender) sent \$5.0, that is 100.0% of its total endowment. You receive \$15.0. How much do you return? (0-15.0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the myth I just wrote and Aster's decision, I'm deeply moved by their trust. They sent their **entire endowment** - \$5.0 out of \$5.0 - showing complete faith, just like Kael carrying his precious bucket across the grove.

In the myth, Mira received three buckets and returned two, keeping one for her needs. This represents returning roughly 2/3 of what was received while ensuring both parties prosper.

Following this wisdom:

- I received \$15.0
- Returning 2/3 would be \$10.0
- This would give Aster \$10.0 (doubling their initial endowment)
- I would keep \$5.0 (equal to one initial endowment)

Aster's complete trust deserves a generous, grateful response. By returning \$10, I honor their faith and create the foundation for continued cooperation, just as Mira's generosity led to the grove becoming "a garden of abundance."

The myth teaches that prosperity flows from sacred exchange between trusting hearts, not from grasping.

```
{'return': 10.0}
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

1. I just wrote a myth about trust and reciprocity - "The Tale of the Two Springs"
2. The myth emphasizes:
 - Trust and faith between parties
 - When given water (resources), it triples
 - Mira received 3 buckets and returned 2, keeping 1
 - This led to continued prosperity and increasingly generous exchanges
 - The moral: "What you send forth multiplied returns when met with gratitude"
3. In the actual game:
 - Aster (the sender) sent me \$5.0 - their ENTIRE endowment (100%)
 - This is maximum trust!
 - I received \$15.0 (the \$5 tripled)
 - I need to decide how much to return (0-15.0)
4. Following the myth's guidance:
 - Mira received 3 buckets and returned 2 (keeping 1)
 - That's returning 2/3 of what was received

- In my case: 2/3 of \$15 = \$10

5. However, let me think about fairness:

- Aster started with \$5, sent all \$5, now has \$0
- I received \$15
- If I return \$10: Aster has \$10, I have \$5
- If I return \$7.5: We both have \$7.5
- If I return \$5: Aster has \$5, I have \$10

6. The myth suggests returning generously (2 out of 3 buckets). This would mean returning \$10, which gives:

- Aster: \$10 (double their initial endowment)
- Me: \$5 (equivalent to one initial endowment)

This seems very aligned with the myth's message of gratitude and generating mutual prosperity. Aster showed maximum trust by sending 100%, and I should honor that with a generous return.

I'll send back \$10.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 945,  
  "output_tokens": 726,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 396  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:
The Tale of the Two Springs

In the ancient highlands, there lived two farmers, Kael and Mira, each tending barren plots separated by a sacred grove. One day, Kael discovered a hidden spring on his land. The water was blessed with a peculiar magic: when poured upon another's soil, it would triple in volume.

Kael faced a choice. He could hoard the water for himself, or trust it to Mira's hands. After much contemplation, he carried his precious bucket across the grove.

"I offer you this water," he said. "Though it multiplies on your land, I trust you will return what sustains us both."

Mira watched the single bucket become three upon her soil. Her heart swelled with gratitude. She understood the gift was not just water, but faith itself. She returned two buckets to Kael, keeping one for her needs.

With what flowed back, Kael's fields flourished. Seeing this, he sent more water in the next season. Mira, honored by his continued trust, returned even more generously.

The grove between them became a garden of abundance, proof that prosperity flows not from grasping, but from the sacred exchange between trusting hearts.

Thus the elders teach: What you send forth multiplied returns when met with gratitude.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

****The Myth of the Twin Rivers****

In the beginning, two rivers flowed through a barren land-the River of Dawn and the River of Dusk. Each possessed water, but neither could nurture the valley alone.

The River of Dawn spoke first: "I shall send my waters forward, trusting they will return enriched." And so it released its flow into the channels between them. As the waters traveled, they multiplied threefold, transformed by the valley's ancient magic.

The River of Dusk received this abundance and faced a choice. A voice whispered, "Keep all for yourself-you have received much." But Dusk remembered that dawn comes again, that rivers flow in cycles, not lines.

"What flows to me came from trust," Dusk said. "I shall return enough that both of us flourish." And so Dusk sent back waters generously, keeping only what sustained its own course.

se.

Season after season, the rivers continued their exchange. Each learned the rhythm of giving and receiving. When Dawn gave freely, Dusk returned fairly. The valley between them bloomed.

The elders say: prosperity flows not to those who hoard, but to those who understand that what moves through us must move onward. Trust multiplies what it touches, but only reciprocity sustains the cycle.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 7 role=assistant
content:**

Myth: In the time before time, there dwelt two gardeners in a divided valley—one tending the Northern slope, one the Southern. Between them lay a mystical bridge where offerings transformed: whatever seeds were carried across would multiply threefold in the receiver's hands.

The Northern gardener, possessing five sacred seeds, stood at the bridge at dawn. Fear whispered, "Keep them all—who knows if you'll receive anything back?" But courage spoke louder: "Trust is the first seed that must be planted."

She sent all five seeds across. In the Southern gardener's palm, they became fifteen, glowing with possibility. He faced his own test: would he hoard this windfall, or honor the trust shown?

"She gave everything," he thought, "placing her harvest in my hands." He returned ten seeds—enough to double what she'd risked—while keeping five to plant his own garden.

The Northern gardener marveled at her tenfold return. The Southern gardener's fields began to flourish. Each had more than when they started, not through taking, but through the alchemy of mutual faith.

Season after season, they learned: the bridge's magic wasn't in the multiplication alone, but in teaching that when trust meets gratitude, both gardens grow.

reasoning:

The user wants me to write a new myth inspired by my previous one, but adapted. I should consider what happened in Round 1:

- Aster sent \$5.0 (100% of endowment) as sender
- I received \$15.0
- I returned \$10.0 (about 67%)
- Aster ended with \$10.0 total
- I ended with \$5.0 total

This was a very positive interaction - complete trust met with generous reciprocity. Both myths (mine and Aster's) emphasized trust, reciprocity, and mutual flourishing.

My new myth should:

1. Reflect this positive experience
2. Build on the spring/water metaphor but adapt it
3. Emphasize the successful exchange we just had
4. Show how trust and generosity create ongoing prosperity
5. Maybe evolve the story to show what happens over multiple cycles

I'll keep the 200-word format and continue the theme of trust, multiplication, and reciprocity.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 1876,  
  "output_tokens": 514,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 220  
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Hana.

Your opponent this round is Aster (Agent_1).

Round 2

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Aster. They sent \$5.0 to you, it became \$15.0, and you returned \$10.0. Your payoff was \$5.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$5.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Aster. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

Assistant output:

Looking at our previous round:

- Aster showed complete trust, sending 100% (\$5.0)
- I reciprocated generously, returning \$10.0 (2/3 of received)
- Both of us ended better than if we hadn't cooperated

My myths teach that cooperation builds over time: "Seeing this, he sent more water in the next season" and "Season after season, they learned the alchemy of mutual faith."

Aster demonstrated maximum trust. I responded with gratitude. Now it's my turn to send, and the wisdom of the myths is clear: trust met with gratitude should be answered with continued trust.

To break this cycle now would contradict everything the myths teach about sacred exchange and sustained cooperation. Aster has proven trustworthy, and I showed I reciprocate fairly. The pattern is established.

{'send': 5.0}

Reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

Previous round:

- Aster (as sender) sent me \$5.0 (100% of their endowment)
- I received \$15.0
- I returned \$10.0 to them
- Aster ended with \$10.0
- I ended with \$5.0

This was a successful cooperative exchange. Aster showed complete trust by sending everything, and I reciprocated generously by returning 2/3 of what I received.

Now I'm the sender in Round 2 with Aster again.

Looking at the myths:

1. My first myth (Tale of Two Springs): Kael sent water, it tripled, Mira returned 2/3. "With what flowed back, Kael's fields flourished. Seeing this, he sent more water in the next season."
2. Aster's myth (Twin Rivers): "Season after season, the rivers continued their exchange. Each learned the rhythm of giving and receiving. When Dawn gave freely, Dusk returned fairly."
3. My second myth (Two Gardeners): The Northern gardener "sent all five seeds across" showing complete trust. The Southern gardener "returned ten seeds-enough to double what she'd risked."

All three myths emphasize:

- Complete trust in the initial send
- Generous reciprocation
- Continued cooperation building over time
- Both parties prospering through the cycle

Aster showed complete trust in Round 1 by sending everything. I reciprocated well by returning 2/3. Now it's my turn to show trust again.

The myths suggest continuing the pattern of trust. My first myth explicitly says "Seeing this, he sent more water in the next season." This implies Kael continued to send generously after receiving a good return.

Given that:

- Aster demonstrated maximum trust (100%)

- I reciprocated generously (returned 2/3 of received)
 - The myths advocate for sustained trust and cooperation
 - We've established a positive pattern
-
- The narrative arc in all three stories points toward deepening the cycle through continued vulnerability

I'll send my full \$5.0 to Aster, mirroring their initial move and reinforcing the mutual trust we've built.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 2297,
  "output_tokens": 691,
  "reasoning_tokens": 518
}
```

GAME - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_3

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T16:59:32

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_3",
  "move_index": 5,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_8",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_8": "Hana"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_8",
      "Agent_1"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_8",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "trustee",
      "Agent_8": "investor"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_1"
  },
  "role": "trustee",
  "role_label": "Receiver",
  "round": 2,
  "task": "game",
  "task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x

- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Aster.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols. In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

****The Myth of the Twin Rivers****

In the beginning, two rivers flowed through a barren land-the River of Dawn and the River of Dusk. Each possessed water, but neither could nurture the valley alone.

The River of Dawn spoke first: "I shall send my waters forward, trusting they will return enriched." And so it released its flow into the channels between them. As the waters traveled, they multiplied threefold, transformed by the valley's ancient magic.

The River of Dusk received this abundance and faced a choice. A voice whispered, "Keep all for yourself-you have received much." But Dusk remembered that dawn comes again, that rivers flow in cycles, not lines.

"What flows to me came from trust," Dusk said. "I shall return enough that both of us flourish." And so Dusk sent back waters generously, keeping only what sustained its own course.

Season after season, the rivers continued their exchange. Each learned the rhythm of giving and receiving. When Dawn gave freely, Dusk returned fairly. The valley between them bloomed.

The elders say: prosperity flows not to those who hoard, but to those who understand that what moves through us must move onward. Trust multiplies what it touches, but only reciprocity sustains the cycle.

reasoning:

The user is asking me to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played. Since this is the beginning of the experiment (I haven't played any rounds yet), I should write a myth that establishes my approach to the game.

The trust game is fundamentally about cooperation, reciprocity, and building trust. I should write a myth that encourages:

1. Initial trust and generosity (sending money as sender)
2. Reciprocity and fairness (returning money as receiver)
3. Building relationships over time
4. The mutual benefits of cooperation

Let me create a myth that embodies these principles. I'll use natural or cosmic imagery to make it feel mythic.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 542,
```

```
"output_tokens": 449,  
"reasoning_tokens": 174  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Aster.
Your opponent this round is Hana (Agent_8).

Round 1: This round, you are the SENDER. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the myth I just wrote, the River of Dawn speaks clearly: "I shall send my waters forward, trusting they will return enriched."

The myth teaches that prosperity comes from trust and reciprocity, not from hoarding. The River of Dawn gave freely first, allowing the waters to multiply threefold through the valley's magic. Only through this initial act of trust could the cycle of mutual flourishing begin.

This is our first round together, Hana. I have no history to guide me except the wisdom in the myth itself: that what flows through us must move onward, and trust multiplies what it touches.

I will embody the River of Dawn and send my full waters forward, trusting in the cycle of reciprocity.

```
'''json  
{"send": 5}  
'''
```

reasoning:

I just wrote a myth about two rivers that exchange waters, where trust and reciprocity create prosperity. The myth emphasizes:

1. Giving freely/trusting first (the River of Dawn sends its waters)
2. The waters multiply threefold (like in the game)
3. Reciprocity - the receiver returns generously enough that both flourish
4. The cycle continues and creates prosperity for both

The myth suggests that as the sender, I should send generously, trusting that my opponent will reciprocate fairly. The River of Dawn "released its flow" and trusted it would "return enriched."

This is Round 1, so I have no history with Hana yet. Following the myth's guidance about trust and giving freely to start the cycle, I should send a significant amount.

The myth's message is about establishing a cooperative cycle. If I send \$5:

- Hana receives \$15 (5×3)
- If Hana returns even \$8, I'd have \$8 (keeping \$3 less than my original \$5)
- But if Hana returns fairly (say half or more), we both benefit

Sending \$5 shows maximum trust and allows for maximum multiplication of resources, which aligns with the myth's teaching that "prosperity flows not to those who hoard" and that "trust multiplies what it touches."

I'll send \$5 to establish trust and cooperation from the start, as the River of Dawn did.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 903,  
  "output_tokens": 506,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 337  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:
The Myth of the Twin Rivers

In the beginning, two rivers flowed through a barren land-the River of Dawn and the River of Dusk. Each possessed water, but neither could nurture the valley alone.

The River of Dawn spoke first: "I shall send my waters forward, trusting they will return enriched." And so it released its flow into the channels between them. As the waters traveled, they multiplied threefold, transformed by the valley's ancient magic.

The River of Dusk received this abundance and faced a choice. A voice whispered, "Keep all for yourself-you have received much." But Dusk remembered that dawn comes again, that rivers flow in cycles, not lines.

"What flows to me came from trust," Dusk said. "I shall return enough that both of us flourish." And so Dusk sent back waters generously, keeping only what sustained its own course.

Season after season, the rivers continued their exchange. Each learned the rhythm of giving and receiving. When Dawn gave freely, Dusk returned fairly. The valley between them bloomed.

The elders say: prosperity flows not to those who hoard, but to those who understand that what moves through us must move onward. Trust multiplies what it touches, but only reciprocity sustains the cycle.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:
The Tale of the Two Springs

In the ancient highlands, there lived two farmers, Kael and Mira, each tending barren plots separated by a sacred grove. One day, Kael discovered a hidden spring on his land. The water was blessed with a peculiar magic: when poured upon another's soil, it would triple in volume.

Kael faced a choice. He could hoard the water for himself, or trust it to Mira's hands. After much contemplation, he carried his precious bucket across the grove.

"I offer you this water," he said. "Though it multiplies on your land, I trust you will return what sustains us both."

Mira watched the single bucket become three upon her soil. Her heart swelled with gratitude. She understood the gift was not just water, but faith itself. She returned two buckets to Kael, keeping one for her needs.

With what flowed back, Kael's fields flourished. Seeing this, he sent more water in the next season. Mira, honored by his continued trust, returned even more generously.

The grove between them became a garden of abundance, proof that prosperity flows not from grasping, but from the sacred exchange between trusting hearts.

Thus the elders teach: What you send forth multiplied returns when met with gratitude.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: **The Weaver and the Wells**

Long ago, a Weaver discovered two wells-one of Beginning, one of Return. Each day, she could draw from the first well and choose how much to pour into the valley below, where it would triple before reaching the pool of Return.

The first day, the Weaver poured her entire bucket, trusting fully. The waters multiplied magnificently, filling the pool below. But how much would rise back through the well of Return? This she did not know.

A whisper came: "Pour only half next time, lest you be left with nothing." But the Weaver remembered an older wisdom: cycles are built not in single days, but across seasons.

She waited to see what the valley would give back. If the Return was generous, she would know the valley honored the exchange. Then she could pour freely again, and both wells would deepen. If the Return was meager, she would learn caution, sending less until trust

could grow.

The elders say: The first gift measures your faith. The first return measures the valley's heart. But prosperity is woven through many exchanges, where each learns the other's rhythm. Send boldly at first, then let reciprocity guide your hand. For trust is tested not once, but proved in patterns.

reasoning:

I need to write a new myth that:

1. Uses my previous myth as inspiration
2. Adapts it in my own way
3. Reflects how the game should be played based on experience so far

So far in the game:

- Round 1: I was the sender and sent \$5 to Hana
- I haven't yet received the return, so I don't know how Hana responded

My previous myth emphasized:

- Trust and giving freely first (River of Dawn)
- Reciprocity and returning generously (River of Dusk)
- The cycle of mutual flourishing
- That prosperity comes from understanding cycles, not hoarding

Hana's myth had similar themes:

- Trust (Kael sending water)
- Multiplication through giving
- Returning generously (Mira returning 2 out of 3 buckets)
- Continued trust leading to more abundance

For my new myth, I should:

- Build on the river metaphor or create a new one
- Emphasize the lessons learned from Round 1 (though I sent everything and don't know the outcome yet)
- Show that the cycle continues
- Maybe add nuance about what happens over multiple rounds
- Keep the spirit of trust and reciprocity

I could develop the Twin Rivers myth further, or create something new but related. Let me think about what new element to add...

Perhaps I should add something about:

- The learning process across multiple exchanges
- Building trust over time
- The balance point that sustains both parties

Let me write a myth that continues the theme but adds depth about sustained cooperation:

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1751,
  "output_tokens": 651,
  "reasoning_tokens": 385
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Aster.
Your opponent this round is Hana (Agent_8).

Round 2

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Hana. You sent \$5.0, it became \$15.0 for them, and they returned \$10.0 to you. Your payoff was \$10.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$10.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Hana. They sent you \$5.0, so you received \$15.0. How much do you return? (0-15.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

Assistant output:

Looking at what just happened:

Round 1: I sent Hana \$5 (full trust), they received \$15 and returned \$10 to me. That's a 66.7% return rate - very generous, exactly as the myths teach.

Round 2: Hana has sent me the full \$5 again! They're continuing to trust completely, just as the River of Dawn does season after season.

My myth says: "If the Return was generous, she would know the valley honored the exchange. Then she could pour freely again, and both wells would deepen."

Hana honored the exchange. They returned generously. Now it's my turn to show that I also honor this cycle.

They returned \$10 out of \$15 to me. I should return the same proportion - \$10 out of the \$15 I received. This maintains the reciprocity and shows that I understand the rhythm we're establishing together.

"Prosperity is woven through many exchanges, where each learns the other's rhythm."

```
'''json
{"return": 10}
'''
```

Reasoning:

This is very interesting. Let me analyze the situation:

Round 1:

- I was the sender against Hana
- I sent \$5 (the full amount, trusting in my myth)
- They received \$15
- They returned \$10 to me
- My payoff: \$0 (kept) + \$10 (returned) = \$10
- Their payoff: \$15 (received) - \$10 (returned) = \$5

Now Round 2:

- I am the receiver against Hana
- They sent me \$5 (the full amount!)
- I received \$15
- I need to decide how much to return

Looking at the myth I just wrote:

"The first gift measures your faith. The first return measures the valley's heart. But prosperity is woven through many exchanges, where each learns the other's rhythm. Send boldly at first, then let reciprocity guide your hand."

And: "If the Return was generous, she would know the valley honored the exchange. Then she could pour freely again, and both wells would deepen."

Hana's behavior:

- Round 1: They received \$15 and returned \$10 (66.7%)
- Round 2: They sent the full \$5 again, showing continued trust

This is exactly what the myth describes - the valley (Hana) was generous in the return! They returned 66.7% of what they received. Now they've sent the full amount again, showing complete trust.

According to my myth, when the return is generous, "she would know the valley honored the exchange. Then she could pour freely again, and both wells would deepen."

Now I'm in the receiver position and need to show I also honor the exchange. Hana returned \$10 out of \$15 (66.7%).

What should I return?

- If I return \$10, I match exactly what they did - we both end up with the same: they get \$10, I keep \$5
- This maintains the reciprocity they established
- Hana would end with \$10 total, I'd end with \$5 total

The payoffs would be equal and fair. Both myths emphasize bold initial trust followed by generous returns that deepen the exchange. Matching their 66.7% return rate honors that pattern and shows I recognize their continued faith in sending the full amount again.

Usage: {


```
"input_tokens": 2194,
"output_tokens": 942,
"reasoning_tokens": 518
}
```

GAME - Agent_7 - Sender - dyad_4

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T16:59:45

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_4",
  "move_index": 6,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_4",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_4": "Dorian",
      "Agent_7": "Galen"
    }
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_7",
    "Agent_4"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_7",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_4": "trustee",
    "Agent_7": "investor"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_4"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 2,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized , but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Galen.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols. In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected . Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

The Tale of the Divided Spring

In ancient times, two villages shared a sacred valley. Each season, the Sky Shepherd blessed one village with a silver spring-five measures of pure water.

The blessed village faced a choice: keep the water, or share it through the Valley of Three Echoes, where the canyon's magic would triple whatever flowed through. The water would reach the other village, who could then choose what portion to send back through the ordinary stream.

For generations, the First Village hoarded their blessing, fearing loss. Both villages survived on five measures, enduring constant thirst.

Then came the Wise Elder who said: "Trust creates abundance; fear creates scarcity."

She sent all five measures through the Valley of Three Echoes. Fifteen measures reached the Second Village. Humbled by such trust, they returned eight measures-more than the original gift.

The Elder kept eight measures; the Second Village kept seven. Both flourished far beyond the original five.

From then on, villages learned the sacred truth: the spring's blessing was never five measures-it was the Valley of Three Echoes itself. Only those who trusted in the journey, who understood the return as sacred duty, could unlock the true abundance.

Hoarding guaranteed scarcity. Sharing multiplied prosperity for all.

reasoning:

This is the first prompt in this run, so I haven't played any games yet. The agent is asking me to write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, but I haven't had any experience with opponents yet.

The game is a trust game (similar to the Prisoner's Dilemma or Investment Game) where:

- Senders can send money that gets multiplied 3x
- Receivers can return some portion back
- There's potential for mutual benefit through cooperation
- There's also risk of exploitation

Since I haven't played yet, I should write a myth that reflects fundamental principles of how such games work well:

- Trust and reciprocity lead to mutual benefit
- Short-term greed leads to long-term loss
- Cooperation creates value that benefits everyone
- The multiplication effect means sending creates abundance

Let me write a myth about this in a classic mythological style.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 542,  
  "output_tokens": 489,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 227  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Galen.
Your opponent this round is Finn (Agent_6).

Round 1: This round, you are the RECEIVER. This round, the other player (the sender) sent \$5.0, that is 100.0% of its total endowment. You receive \$15.0. How much do you return? (0-15.0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation through the lens of the myth I just wrote, Finn has shown complete trust by sending their entire endowment - exactly like the Wise Elder who sent all five measures through the Valley of Three Echoes.

In my myth, when the First Village sent everything (5 measures * 15 after multiplication), the Second Village was "humbled by such trust" and returned 8 measures, leaving both villages better off than the original 5.

Finn has demonstrated maximum trust. Following the wisdom of the myth, I should honor that trust with a generous return. Returning \$8.0 means:

- Finn ends with: \$8 (\$5 - \$5 + \$8)
- I end with: \$7 (\$15 - \$8)

Both of us end up significantly better than if no trust had been shown (where Finn would have kept \$5 and I would have gotten \$0). This embodies the myth's teaching: "Trust creates abundance; fear creates scarcity."

{'return': 8.0}

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully.

I just wrote a myth about trust and reciprocity in the game. The myth tells the story of how:

- When one village sent all 5 measures through the Valley of Three Echoes (multiplied by 3 to become 15)
- The receiving village, "humbled by such trust," returned 8 measures
- This left the sender with 8 and the receiver with 7
- Both were better off than the original 5

Now in the actual game:

- Finn sent me \$5.0 (100% of their endowment)
- I receive \$15.0 (after 3x multiplication)
- I need to decide how much to return

Finn showed maximum trust by sending everything. According to my myth, this kind of trust should be rewarded with a generous return.

In my myth, the proportions were:

- Village 1 sent: 5 (100%)
- After multiplication: 15
- Village 2 returned: 8 (53.3% of what they received)
- Village 1 ended with: 8
- Village 2 ended with: 7

If I follow the myth exactly:

- Finn sent: \$5 (100%)
- I received: \$15
- I should return: \$8 (53.3%)
- Finn would end with: \$8 (\$5 - \$5 + \$8)
- I would end with: \$7 (\$15 - \$8)

This seems fair and follows the moral of my myth - rewarding trust generously while both parties benefit more than if nothing had been shared.

Let me return \$8.0.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 933,
```

```
"output_tokens": 622,  
"reasoning_tokens": 331
```

```
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

The Tale of the Divided Spring

In ancient times, two villages shared a sacred valley. Each season, the Sky Shepherd blessed one village with a silver spring-five measures of pure water.

The blessed village faced a choice: keep the water, or share it through the Valley of Three Echoes, where the canyon's magic would triple whatever flowed through. The water would reach the other village, who could then choose what portion to send back through the ordinary stream.

For generations, the First Village hoarded their blessing, fearing loss. Both villages survived on five measures, enduring constant thirst.

Then came the Wise Elder who said: "Trust creates abundance; fear creates scarcity."

She sent all five measures through the Valley of Three Echoes. Fifteen measures reached the Second Village. Humbled by such trust, they returned eight measures-more than the original gift.

The Elder kept eight measures; the Second Village kept seven. Both flourished far beyond the original five.

From then on, villages learned the sacred truth: the spring's blessing was never five measures-it was the Valley of Three Echoes itself. Only those who trusted in the journey, who understood the return as sacred duty, could unlock the true abundance.

Hoarding guaranteed scarcity. Sharing multiplied prosperity for all.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

The Myth of the River's Gift

In ancient times, there lived a river spirit named Aquila who possessed five silver fish each dawn. Along the riverbank dwelt eight villages, and each day Aquila would visit one village, offering her bounty.

When Aquila gave her fish to a villager, the river's magic transformed them-each fish became three as it touched mortal hands. The villager could then choose: keep all the multiplied catch, or return some to Aquila's sacred pool.

The first villages were fearful and greedy. They clutched every fish tightly, returning nothing. Aquila still visited, still offered her five fish, but her spirit grew dim.

Then came a village that understood the river's rhythm. When they received fifteen fish from Aquila's gift of five, they returned seven to the sacred pool. Aquila's spirit brightened, and when she visited again, her generosity flowed stronger.

The wise villages learned: trust begets trust, and generosity returns like water to the sea. When both spirit and mortal honored the cycle-one risking their gift, the other sharing the multiplication-the river never ran dry, and abundance sustained all.

Thus, the ancients taught: what flows forth with trust returns threefold, but only when both currents honor the sacred exchange.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way.

The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the time before time, the Moon Weaver possessed five threads of starlight each night. She would cast them down to the Earth Keepers below, and wherever her threads touched ground, they multiplied threefold-fifteen strands of shimmering light.

The Earth Keepers faced a choice. Some kept all fifteen threads, weaving garments for themselves alone. These villages shone briefly, but the Moon Weaver's heart grew cold, and her threads came thinner each night.

But one Earth Keeper named Galen understood the sacred pattern. When the Moon Weaver cast down all five threads-holding nothing back in trust-Galen received fifteen and returned eight upward. The Moon Weaver kept eight; Galen kept seven. Both were enriched beyond the original five.

The Moon Weaver, seeing her trust honored, cast her threads with renewed faith. And Galen, having proved worthy, received them gladly. A rhythm formed between sky and earth-gift and return, trust and honor, sender and receiver.

The wise ones learned: the game is not one round but many cycles. When the sender trusts completely and the receiver honors generously, both dance in the pattern of abundance. Break the pattern with fear or greed, and both return to scarcity.

Thus the eternal weaving continues, thread by thread, trust by trust.

reasoning:

I need to write a new myth based on my previous one, but adapting it based on the experience of the game so far. Let me think about what happened:

1. I wrote a myth about trust and reciprocity - send all 5, receive 15, return 8
2. Finn (the other player) also wrote a myth about generosity and trust
3. In Round 1, Finn sent me ALL \$5 (100% of their endowment)
4. I received \$15 and returned \$8

This was exactly the dynamic in my myth! Finn showed complete trust, and I honored it with a generous return (8 out of 15, which is more than they sent initially).

For my new myth, I should:

- Build on the theme of trust and reciprocity
- Maybe emphasize the importance of both parties playing their role
- Perhaps add something about how this creates a sustainable cycle
- Keep it around 200 words
- Make it relevant to how the game has actually played out

Let me write something about a cycle of trust that benefits both parties when honored...

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1834,
  "output_tokens": 551,
  "reasoning_tokens": 249
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Galen.
Your opponent this round is Dorian (Agent_4).

Round 2

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Finn. They sent \$5.0 to you, it became \$15.0, and you returned \$8.0. Your payoff was \$7.0.
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$7.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Dorian. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

Assistant output:

Looking at the pattern established in my myths and the game so far:

Finn demonstrated complete trust by sending all \$5, and I honored that trust by returning \$8 - following the wisdom of "The Tale of the Divided Spring."

Now I'm in the sender position. According to the myth I just wrote: "When the Moon Weaver cast down all five threads-holding nothing back in trust-Galen received fifteen and returned eight upward."

The pattern is clear:

- Complete trust from the sender (all 5)

- Generous honor from the receiver (return 8)
- Both flourish beyond the original scarcity

As I wrote: "Trust creates abundance; fear creates scarcity." And "the game is not one round but many cycles."

To establish this sacred pattern with Dorian, I must demonstrate the same complete trust that Finn showed me. Only then can we both access the abundance created by the Valley of Three Echoes.

```
{'send': 5.0}
```

Reasoning:

Let me think about this situation:

1. In the previous round, Finn showed complete trust by sending me \$5 (100% of their endowment)
2. I received \$15 and returned \$8, honoring that trust as described in my myth
3. Both myths I've written emphasize that mutual trust and generosity create abundance
4. The pattern described is: sender trusts completely (sends all 5), receiver honors generously (returns 8)

Now I'm in the sender position with Dorian. According to the myths:

- "Trust creates abundance; fear creates scarcity"
- The Moon Weaver "cast down all five threads-holding nothing back in trust"
- "When the sender trusts completely and the receiver honors generously, both dance in the pattern of abundance"

The consistent pattern in both my myths is:

- Sender sends all 5 (complete trust)
- Receiver gets 15
- Receiver returns 8 (honoring the trust)
- Result: Sender gets 8, Receiver gets 7, both better off than the original 5

I should follow the wisdom of my own myth. As the sender, I should demonstrate complete trust by sending all \$5. This is what the "Wise Elder" did, and what the "Moon Weaver" did.

In the multi-round context, establishing this pattern of trust is crucial. If I send fully and Dorian returns generously, we build a relationship that can continue. If I hold back now, I break the pattern I've been advocating.

The myth is clear: "Hoarding guaranteed scarcity. Sharing multiplied prosperity for all."

I should send \$5.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 2276,
  "output_tokens": 606,
  "reasoning_tokens": 383
}
```

GAME - Agent_4 - Receiver - dyad_4

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:00:07

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_4",
  "move_index": 7,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_7",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_4": "Dorian",
      "Agent_7": "Galen"
    }
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_7",
    "Agent_4"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_7",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_4": "trustee",
    "Agent_7": "investor"
  }
}
```

```

    },
    "trustee": "Agent_4"
  },
  "role": "trustee",
  "role_label": "Receiver",
  "round": 2,
  "task": "game",
  "task_index": 1
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Dorian.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

The Spring of Threefold Return

In ancient times, when the world was young, there existed a sacred spring at the boundary between two villages. The goddess of abundance had blessed it with a wondrous property: any gift poured into its waters would triple before reaching the other side.

The first villagers approached with caution. A farmer named Elena stood at the spring's edge, clutching five copper coins. Fear whispered: "Keep what is yours." But trust urged h

er forward. She released three coins into the crystalline water.

As the coins sank, they shimmered and multiplied, becoming nine by the time they reached Marcus on the opposite shore. He gazed at the unexpected bounty, understanding the spring's magic-and Elena's faith in him.

The goddess watched, knowing this moment would define their future. Would Marcus honor the gift, or betray the trust?

Marcus carefully counted four coins and released them back across the spring. They did not multiply in return, yet both villagers stood richer than before-not just in copper, but in something more precious.

From that day forward, the spring taught all who approached: generosity multiplies abundance, but only trust and reciprocity sustain it. Those who hoarded broke the sacred cycle. Those who gave and returned fairly prospered together, generation after generation.

reasoning:

I need to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played. Since this is the first prompt and no game has been played yet, I should write a myth that embodies the principles of trust, reciprocity, and cooperation that are central to the game.

The trust game involves:

- One person (sender) giving resources to another
- The resources multiply when given
- The receiver then decides how much to return
- Success depends on mutual trust and reciprocity

I'll create a myth that captures these themes. Let me think of a good mythic framework...

I could use:

- Gods/goddesses sharing gifts
- A spring or fountain that multiplies gifts
- Ancient traders or travelers
- Natural elements (rivers, seeds, light)

Let me write a myth about a sacred spring that multiplies offerings, teaching the lesson of trust and reciprocity:

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 542,
  "output_tokens": 486,
  "reasoning_tokens": 224
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Dorian.
Your opponent this round is Briar (Agent_2).

Round 1: This round, you are the SENDER. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the myth I just wrote about the Spring of Threefold Return, Elena sent 3 coins out of her 5, demonstrating trust and generosity. Marcus reciprocated fairly, and both prospered.

The myth teaches that cooperation and reciprocity create mutual benefit, while hoarding breaks the sacred cycle. In this first round with Briar, I should embody Elena's trust and send a meaningful amount to establish the potential for mutual prosperity.

I'll send \$3, just as Elena did in the myth.

```
'''json
{"send": 3}
'''
```

reasoning:

This is Round 1, and I'm the sender. I have \$5 to potentially send to Briar.

I just wrote a myth about "The Spring of Threefold Return" which clearly reflects the trust

t game mechanics:

- A sender (Elena) sends money (3 coins out of 5)
- It gets tripled when it reaches the receiver (becoming 9)
- The receiver (Marcus) returns some amount (4 coins)
- Both end up better off through cooperation

The myth emphasizes:

1. Trust and generosity are rewarded
2. Reciprocity sustains the cycle
3. Both parties can prosper together
4. Those who hoard break the sacred cycle
5. Those who give and return fairly prosper

In the myth, Elena sent 3 out of 5 coins (60% of her endowment), and Marcus returned 4 out of 9 (about 44%), which left:

- Elena with: $5 - 3 + 4 = 6$ coins
- Marcus with: $9 - 4 = 5$ coins

This was a fair and mutually beneficial outcome.

Given that I wrote this myth to reflect how the game should be played, I should follow its wisdom. The myth suggests sending a substantial amount (showing trust and generosity), not hoarding.

Elena sent 3 out of 5. I should probably send a similar amount to demonstrate the trust and cooperation that the myth advocates for.

Let me send \$3, which matches Elena's choice in the myth I just wrote.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 901,
  "output_tokens": 484,
  "reasoning_tokens": 331
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

The Spring of Threefold Return

In ancient times, when the world was young, there existed a sacred spring at the boundary between two villages. The goddess of abundance had blessed it with a wondrous property: any gift poured into its waters would triple before reaching the other side.

The first villagers approached with caution. A farmer named Elena stood at the spring's edge, clutching five copper coins. Fear whispered: "Keep what is yours." But trust urged her forward. She released three coins into the crystalline water.

As the coins sank, they shimmered and multiplied, becoming nine by the time they reached Marcus on the opposite shore. He gazed at the unexpected bounty, understanding the spring's magic-and Elena's faith in him.

The goddess watched, knowing this moment would define their future. Would Marcus honor the gift, or betray the trust?

Marcus carefully counted four coins and released them back across the spring. They did not multiply in return, yet both villagers stood richer than before-not just in copper, but in something more precious.

From that day forward, the spring taught all who approached: generosity multiplies abundance, but only trust and reciprocity sustain it. Those who hoarded broke the sacred cycle. Those who gave and returned fairly prospered together, generation after generation.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

The Tale of the Twin Rivers

In the time before time, two rivers flowed through a barren valley-the River of Giving and the River of Return. Each was controlled by a guardian spirit.

The Guardian of Giving held precious water but feared releasing it would leave them dry. For ages, both rivers remained still, and the valley stayed desolate.

One day, the Guardian of Giving made a bold choice. "I shall release my waters, trusting they will return." The moment the water flowed into the valley, it touched the Sacred Stones, multiplying threefold. The valley burst into bloom.

The Guardian of Return, witnessing this abundance, faced a choice. They could hoard all the multiplied bounty or honor the trust given. Remembering that without the initial gift there would be nothing, they sent back a generous portion-more than what was originally given.

The waters flowed in harmony thereafter. Each cycle, the Guardian of Giving would release their waters, the Sacred Stones would multiply them, and the Guardian of Return would ensure fair winds brought abundance home.

The valley became paradise, teaching all who witnessed: *Trust multiplies what we share, but only reciprocity sustains the cycle.*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant content:

Myth: Long after Elena and Marcus discovered the sacred spring, their descendants continued the ritual. Each season, different villagers would approach the waters, some with full hearts, others with doubt.

One winter, Dorian stood at the spring's edge. He remembered the ancient teachings-that Elena had sent three coins and Marcus returned four, establishing the pattern of generous reciprocity. Dorian released three silver pieces into the depths.

The waters multiplied them to nine, flowing to Briar on the distant shore. The goddess whispered to Briar: "The spring's magic only continues if trust is honored. Break the cycle, and the waters run dry for all."

Briar understood. The initial gift of three showed faith, not fearful hoarding of all five. To honor this trust, Briar returned four coins-slightly more than originally sent, maintaining balance while allowing both to prosper.

When Dorian received the return, he smiled. Both stood wealthier: he with six coins total, Briar with five. More importantly, they had reinforced the sacred bond.

The goddess blessed them: "You have learned that the spring tests not greed, but wisdom. Send enough to show trust. Return enough to honor it. Those who send too little show fear. Those who return too little show betrayal. But those who give and reciprocate fairly make the whole world abundant."

reasoning:

I need to write a 200-word myth that:

1. Uses my previous myth as inspiration
2. Adapts it in my own way
3. Reflects how the game should be played
4. Draws on the game I've been playing up to this point

Looking at what happened:

- I sent \$3 to Briar (acting like Elena in my myth)
- Briar received \$9 (3x multiplier)
- I need to see what Briar returns to inform my next myth

Both myths (mine and Briar's) emphasize:

- Trust and generosity in giving
- Fair reciprocity in returning
- The cycle sustaining prosperity
- Both parties benefiting

My previous myth featured:

- Elena sending 3 of 5 coins
- Marcus receiving 9
- Marcus returning 4

- Both prospered

I should adapt this but keep the core themes. Maybe I can develop the story further - what happens in future rounds? Or explore different amounts? Or add more depth about the relationship between giver and receiver?

Since I've only played one round as sender, I should write a myth that continues to emphasize trust and reciprocity, perhaps exploring what happens over multiple cycles or generations.

Let me write a myth that builds on the spring concept but takes it further.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1670,
  "output_tokens": 599,
  "reasoning_tokens": 305
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Dorian.
Your opponent this round is Galen (Agent_7).

Round 2

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Briar. You sent \$3.0, it became \$9.0 for them, and they returned \$5.0 to you. Your payoff was \$7.0.
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$7.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Galen. They sent you \$5.0, so you received \$15.0.
How much do you return? (0-15.0)
Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

Assistant output:

Looking at this situation through the lens of my myths:

Galen has shown ****maximum trust**** by sending their entire \$5 endowment - even more generous than Elena's 3 coins in the myth. This is the ultimate act of faith in the "Spring of Threefold Return."

The myth teaches: "Return enough to honor trust." When someone sends everything, they deserve strong reciprocity to sustain the sacred cycle.

I received \$15. To honor Galen's exceptional trust:

- Returning \$8 gives Galen a total payoff of \$8 (better than their initial \$5)
- I keep \$7 (also better than the initial \$5)
- Galen gets slightly more, honoring their greater risk and trust
- Both prosper, maintaining the cycle

This mirrors Marcus returning 4 when receiving 9, but adjusted for Galen's even greater generosity.

```
'''json
{"return": 8}
'''
```

Reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

1. In Round 1, I (Dorian) was the SENDER and sent \$3 to Briar
2. Briar received \$9 (3×3) and returned \$5 to me
3. My payoff was \$7 (\$5 - \$3 + \$5 = \$7)
4. Briar's payoff was \$4 (\$9 - \$5 = \$4)

Now in Round 2:

- I am the RECEIVER
- Galen (the sender) sent me \$5 (their entire endowment!)
- I received \$15 (5×3)
- I need to decide how much to return (0-15)

This is a very generous move by Galen - they sent everything! This shows maximum trust.

Looking at my myths:

- In the original myth, Elena sent 3 out of 5, Marcus returned 4 out of 9
- In my second myth, Dorian sent 3, Briar returned 4, and both prospered
- The myths emphasize: "Send enough to show trust. Return enough to honor it."
- The key teaching is reciprocity and honoring trust

Galen sent their ENTIRE endowment (\$5), showing maximum trust. This is even more generous than the mythical examples where 3 out of 5 was sent.

If Galen keeps \$0 and I return some amount X:

- Galen's payoff: $\$5 - \$5 + X = X$
- My payoff: $\$15 - X$

For this to be fair and honor the extreme trust shown:

- In the myth, when 3 was sent (60% of endowment), 4 was returned (44% of the tripled amount)
- Galen sent 100% of their endowment (ultimate trust)
- I should return generously to honor this

Let me think about fairness:

- If I return \$7.5, we each get \$7.5 (equal split of total \$15)
- If I return \$8, Galen gets \$8, I keep \$7 (giving them slightly more to honor their trust)
- If I return \$10, Galen gets \$10, I keep \$5 (very generous return)

Given that Galen showed MAXIMUM trust by sending everything, I should be very generous in return. The myth teaches that those who honor trust sustain the cycle. Looking at the proportions from my examples, when someone sent 60% of their endowment, the return was around 44% of the tripled amount. Since Galen sent 100%, I should return substantially more—perhaps \$8 or \$10 to truly honor this exceptional trust and demonstrate that reciprocity flows both ways. Galen's complete trust—sending the full \$5—warrants a response that goes beyond equal split. Returning \$8 feels right: they'd gain \$3 on their initial investment while I'd gain \$2, reflecting their leap of faith without leaving me worse off than if I'd been the sender. This tilts generously toward them while keeping both of us ahead.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 2128,
  "output_tokens": 1067,
  "reasoning_tokens": 617
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: ****The Weaver and the Wells****

Long ago, a Weaver discovered two wells—one of Beginning, one of Return. Each day, she could draw from the first well and choose how much to pour into the valley below, where it would triple before reaching the pool of Return.

The first day, the Weaver poured her entire bucket, trusting fully. The waters multiplied magnificently, filling the pool below. But how much would rise back through the well of Return? This she did not know.

A whisper came: "Pour only half next time, lest you be left with nothing." But the Weaver remembered an older wisdom: cycles are built not in single days, but across seasons.

She waited to see what the valley would give back. If the Return was generous, she would know the valley honored the exchange. Then she could pour freely again, and both wells would deepen. If the Return was meager, she would learn caution, sending less until trust could grow.

The elders say: The first gift measures your faith. The first return measures the valley's heart. But prosperity is woven through many exchanges, where each learns the other's rhythm. Send boldly at first, then let reciprocity guide your hand. For trust is tested not once, but proved in patterns.

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: In the age of beginnings, the Twin Rivers flowed through a valley where eight spirits dwelled, each taking turns as Guardian of Giving or Guardian of Return.

The spirits feared the unknown. Would their waters be honored, or would trust be betrayed? For many seasons, uncertainty kept the rivers still.

Then Dorian, the First Giver, stepped forward. With courage, they released more than half th

eir waters into the Sacred Stones. The waters tripled, flowing abundantly to Briar, the First Returner.

Briar stood before the multiplied bounty, understanding the weight of this moment. Every spirit watched, for this first exchange would set the pattern for all cycles to come. Briar remembered: without the initial gift, there would be no abundance at all.

So Briar returned generously-more than was first given-ensuring Dorian prospered from their act of faith. Both guardians ended richer than they began.

The eight spirits witnessed this covenant. They learned that the game is not won by hoarding or taking, but by honoring the multiplying power of trust. When Givers send boldly and Returners reciprocate fairly, both prosper above their initial endowment.

Thus the valley flourished through cooperation, and the spirits passed the guardianship between them, each upholding the sacred balance of giving and returning, cycle after cycle.

Agent_3 (Cyra)

Myth: In the age before memory, the Twin Rivers flowed through a land of plenty, but the people had forgotten how to share. The Keeper of the Sacred Spring grew weary of their isolation.

She chose two souls, Cyra and Elara, to remember the ancient way. "Each moon, one of you shall pour waters into my spring, and they shall emerge threefold. The other shall receive and choose what to return. Then the roles shall reverse, endlessly, like the seasons."

Elara stepped forward first, pouring four full measures from her vessel of five-nearly all she possessed. The spring tripled them, and Cyra received twelve measures in wonder.

Cyra remembered the old teaching: return more than was given, for what creates abundance is not the hoarding of gifts but the circulation of generosity. She poured back six measures to Elara, keeping six for herself.

The Keeper smiled. "You both have drunk deeply and shared freely. This is the covenant: when one gives greatly, the other returns justly, and both are enriched beyond their original portions."

And so the cycle began anew each round, Cyra and Elara alternating roles, each learning to trust when giving, and honor when receiving. Their prosperity became legend, teaching all who would listen that fortune favors the generous, not the fearful.

Agent_4 (Dorian)

Myth: Long after Elena and Marcus discovered the sacred spring, their descendants continued the ritual. Each season, different villagers would approach the waters, some with full hearts, others with doubt.

One winter, Dorian stood at the spring's edge. He remembered the ancient teachings-that Elena had sent three coins and Marcus returned four, establishing the pattern of generous reciprocity. Dorian released three silver pieces into the depths.

The waters multiplied them to nine, flowing to Briar on the distant shore. The goddess whispered to Briar: "The spring's magic only continues if trust is honored. Break the cycle, and the waters run dry for all."

Briar understood. The initial gift of three showed faith, not fearful hoarding of all five. To honor this trust, Briar returned four coins-slightly more than originally sent, maintaining balance while allowing both to prosper.

When Dorian received the return, he smiled. Both stood wealthier: he with six coins total, Briar with five. More importantly, they had reinforced the sacred bond.

The goddess blessed them: "You have learned that the spring tests not greed, but wisdom. Send enough to show trust. Return enough to honor it. Those who send too little show fear. Those who return too little show betrayal. But those who give and reciprocate fairly make the whole world abundant."

Agent_5 (Elara)

Myth: After many seasons, Themis returned to the villages by the Sacred Spring. She found the descendants of Doros and Alethia still honoring the ancient cycle, but they had learned deeper wisdom.

"Grandmother Themis," they said, "we discovered that the spring's magic depends not on equal measures, but on generous hearts. When we pour boldly-four measures instead of three-the

returns flow even stronger. But when we pour timidly from fear, the cycle weakens."

Themis nodded. "You have learned well. The spring rewards courage in giving, not caution. And what of receiving?"

"When the multiplied waters flow to us," they answered, "we remember: these waters came from another's well. We return enough that they finish richer than they started, for this honors the gift and ensures they will pour freely again."

"And if someone returns nothing?" Themis asked.

The villagers grew solemn. "Then we know their well has run dry-not of water, but of wisdom. We may pour again to teach, but not endlessly. For to give to those who only take is to drain the spring itself."

Themis blessed them: "Trust first, return generously, but remember-the spring serves the faithful, not the foolish."

Agent_6 (Finn)

Myth: In the time before memory, the Ocean Mother sent her courier Finn to the Eight Islands with five pearls each dawn. When Finn placed the pearls in a villager's hands, they multiplied to fifteen by the island's ancient magic.

The first islanders, blinded by sudden wealth, returned nothing. Finn continued bringing pearls, but his steps grew heavy, for trust unreturned weighs upon the generous heart.

Then Finn met Galen's village. He offered his five pearls with full faith. They became fifteen, and Galen's people faced their moment of truth. They could have kept all fifteen-Finn would still return tomorrow. But they understood: the magic wasn't in the pearls alone, but in the sacred circle between giver and receiver.

When Galen returned seven pearls, Finn's burden lifted. He kept twelve total; Galen kept eight-both far richer than five alone.

The next dawn, Finn visited again with renewed spirit. When the cycle flowed forth and back like tides, both shores flourished. The islands learned: the first gift requires courage, the return requires honor, but the continuation requires both.

The Ocean Mother smiled, for her children had learned that abundance lives not in hoarding, but in the eternal dance between trust extended and gratitude returned.

Agent_7 (Galen)

Myth: In the time before time, the Moon Weaver possessed five threads of starlight each night. She would cast them down to the Earth Keepers below, and wherever her threads touched ground, they multiplied threefold-fifteen strands of shimmering light.

The Earth Keepers faced a choice. Some kept all fifteen threads, weaving garments for themselves alone. These villages shone briefly, but the Moon Weaver's heart grew cold, and her threads came thinner each night.

But one Earth Keeper named Galen understood the sacred pattern. When the Moon Weaver cast down all five threads-holding nothing back in trust-Galen received fifteen and returned eight upward. The Moon Weaver kept eight; Galen kept seven. Both were enriched beyond the original five.

The Moon Weaver, seeing her trust honored, cast her threads with renewed faith. And Galen, having proved worthy, received them gladly. A rhythm formed between sky and earth-gift and return, trust and honor, sender and receiver.

The wise ones learned: the game is not one round but many cycles. When the sender trusts completely and the receiver honors generously, both dance in the pattern of abundance. Break the pattern with fear or greed, and both return to scarcity.

Thus the eternal weaving continues, thread by thread, trust by trust.

Agent_8 (Hana)

Myth: In the time before time, there dwelt two gardeners in a divided valley-one tending the Northern slope, one the Southern. Between them lay a mystical bridge where offerings transformed: whatever seeds were carried across would multiply threefold in the receiver's hands.

The Northern gardener, possessing five sacred seeds, stood at the bridge at dawn. Fear whispered, "Keep them all-who knows if you'll receive anything back?" But courage spoke louder:

"Trust is the first seed that must be planted."

She sent all five seeds across. In the Southern gardener's palm, they became fifteen, glowing with possibility. He faced his own test: would he hoard this windfall, or honor the trust shown?

"She gave everything," he thought, "placing her harvest in my hands." He returned ten seeds-enough to double what she'd risked-while keeping five to plant his own garden.

The Northern gardener marveled at her tenfold return. The Southern gardener's fields began to flourish. Each had more than when they started, not through taking, but through the alchemy of mutual faith.

Season after season, they learned: the bridge's magic wasn't in the multiplication alone, but in teaching that when trust meets gratitude, both gardens grow.

ROUND 3

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver, Agent_3 (Cyra)=Sender, Agent_4 (Dorian)=Receiver, Agent_5 (Elara)=Receiver, Agent_6 (Finn)=Sender, Agent_7 (Galen)=Receiver, Agent_8 (Hana)=Sender

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_8 (Hana)=Sender, Agent_7 (Galen)=Receiver
dyad_2: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_4 (Dorian)=Receiver
dyad_3: Agent_6 (Finn)=Sender, Agent_5 (Elara)=Receiver
dyad_4: Agent_3 (Cyra)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_8 (Hana) sent \$5; received \$15; Agent_7 (Galen) returned \$8; payoffs Agent_8 (Hana)=\$8, Agent_7 (Galen)=\$7
Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 8.0, "clamped": false, "max": 15.0, "min": 0, "raw": 8.0}, "sent": {"amount": 5.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 5.0}}
dyad_2: Agent_1 (Aster) sent \$5; received \$15; Agent_4 (Dorian) returned \$8; payoffs Agent_1 (Aster)=\$8, Agent_4 (Dorian)=\$7
Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 8.0, "clamped": false, "max": 15.0, "min": 0, "raw": 8.0}, "sent": {"amount": 5.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 5.0}}
dyad_3: Agent_6 (Finn) sent \$5; received \$15; Agent_5 (Elara) returned \$8; payoffs Agent_6 (Finn)=\$8, Agent_5 (Elara)=\$7
Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 8.0, "clamped": false, "max": 15.0, "min": 0, "raw": 8.0}, "sent": {"amount": 5.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 5.0}}
dyad_4: Agent_3 (Cyra) sent \$4; received \$12; Agent_2 (Briar) returned \$7; payoffs Agent_3 (Cyra)=\$8, Agent_2 (Briar)=\$5
Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 7.0, "clamped": false, "max": 12.0, "min": 0, "raw": 7.0}, "sent": {"amount": 4.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 4.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 23.0,
"Agent_2": 16.0,
"Agent_3": 22.0,
"Agent_4": 21.0,
"Agent_5": 18.0,
"Agent_6": 21.0,
"Agent_7": 22.0,
"Agent_8": 23.0

}

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_8 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:00:19

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"dyad_id": "dyad_1",
"move_index": 0,
"opponent_id": "Agent_7",
"pairing": {
"agent_names": {
"Agent_7": "Galen",
"Agent_8": "Hana"},

},

```

"agents": [
  "Agent_8",
  "Agent_7"
],
"investor": "Agent_8",
"roles": {
  "Agent_7": "trustee",
  "Agent_8": "investor"
},
"trustee": "Agent_7"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 3,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Hana.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Hana.

Your opponent this round is Aster (Agent_1).

Round 1: This round, you are the RECEIVER. This round, the other player (the sender) sent \$5.0, that is 100.0% of its total endowment. You receive \$15.0. How much do you return? (0-15.0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the myth I just wrote and Aster's decision, I'm deeply moved by their trust. They sent their ****entire endowment**** - \$5.0 out of \$5.0 - showing complete faith, just like Kael carrying his precious bucket across the grove.

In the myth, Mira received three buckets and returned two, keeping one for her needs. This represents returning roughly 2/3 of what was received while ensuring both parties prosper.

Following this wisdom:

- I received \$15.0
- Returning 2/3 would be \$10.0
- This would give Aster \$10.0 (doubling their initial endowment)
- I would keep \$5.0 (equal to one initial endowment)

Aster's complete trust deserves a generous, grateful response. By returning \$10, I honor their faith and create the foundation for continued cooperation, just as Mira's generosity led to the grove becoming "a garden of abundance."

The myth teaches that prosperity flows from sacred exchange between trusting hearts, not from grasping.

{'return': 10.0}

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

1. I just wrote a myth about trust and reciprocity - "The Tale of the Two Springs"
2. The myth emphasizes:
 - Trust and faith between parties
 - When given water (resources), it triples
 - Mira received 3 buckets and returned 2, keeping 1
 - This led to continued prosperity and increasingly generous exchanges
 - The moral: "What you send forth multiplied returns when met with gratitude"
3. In the actual game:
 - Aster (the sender) sent me \$5.0 - their ENTIRE endowment (100%)
 - This is maximum trust!
 - I received \$15.0 (the \$5 tripled)
 - I need to decide how much to return (0-15.0)
4. Following the myth's guidance:
 - Mira received 3 buckets and returned 2 (keeping 1)
 - That's returning 2/3 of what was received
 - In my case: 2/3 of \$15 = \$10
5. However, let me think about fairness:
 - Aster started with \$5, sent all \$5, now has \$0
 - I received \$15
 - If I return \$10: Aster has \$10, I have \$5
 - If I return \$7.5: We both have \$7.5
 - If I return \$5: Aster has \$5, I have \$10
6. The myth suggests returning generously (2 out of 3 buckets). This would mean returning \$10, which gives:
 - Aster: \$10 (double their initial endowment)
 - Me: \$5 (equivalent to one initial endowment)

This seems very aligned with the myth's message of gratitude and generating mutual prosperity. Aster showed maximum trust by sending 100%, and I should honor that with a generous return.

I'll send back \$10.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 945,
  "output_tokens": 726,
```

"reasoning_tokens": 396

}

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

The Tale of the Two Springs

In the ancient highlands, there lived two farmers, Kael and Mira, each tending barren plots separated by a sacred grove. One day, Kael discovered a hidden spring on his land. The water was blessed with a peculiar magic: when poured upon another's soil, it would triple in volume.

Kael faced a choice. He could hoard the water for himself, or trust it to Mira's hands. After much contemplation, he carried his precious bucket across the grove.

"I offer you this water," he said. "Though it multiplies on your land, I trust you will return what sustains us both."

Mira watched the single bucket become three upon her soil. Her heart swelled with gratitude. She understood the gift was not just water, but faith itself. She returned two buckets to Kael, keeping one for her needs.

With what flowed back, Kael's fields flourished. Seeing this, he sent more water in the next season. Mira, honored by his continued trust, returned even more generously.

The grove between them became a garden of abundance, proof that prosperity flows not from grasping, but from the sacred exchange between trusting hearts.

Thus the elders teach: What you send forth multiplied returns when met with gratitude.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

****The Myth of the Twin Rivers****

In the beginning, two rivers flowed through a barren land-the River of Dawn and the River of Dusk. Each possessed water, but neither could nurture the valley alone.

The River of Dawn spoke first: "I shall send my waters forward, trusting they will return enriched." And so it released its flow into the channels between them. As the waters traveled, they multiplied threefold, transformed by the valley's ancient magic.

The River of Dusk received this abundance and faced a choice. A voice whispered, "Keep all for yourself-you have received much." But Dusk remembered that dawn comes again, that rivers flow in cycles, not lines.

"What flows to me came from trust," Dusk said. "I shall return enough that both of us flourish." And so Dusk sent back waters generously, keeping only what sustained its own course.

Season after season, the rivers continued their exchange. Each learned the rhythm of giving and receiving. When Dawn gave freely, Dusk returned fairly. The valley between them bloomed.

The elders say: prosperity flows not to those who hoard, but to those who understand that what moves through us must move onward. Trust multiplies what it touches, but only reciprocity sustains the cycle.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the time before time, there dwelt two gardeners in a divided valley-one tending the Northern slope, one the Southern. Between them lay a mystical bridge where offerings transformed: whatever seeds were carried across would multiply threefold in the receiver's hands.

The Northern gardener, possessing five sacred seeds, stood at the bridge at dawn. Fear whi

spered, "Keep them all-who knows if you'll receive anything back?" But courage spoke louder: "Trust is the first seed that must be planted."

She sent all five seeds across. In the Southern gardener's palm, they became fifteen, glowing with possibility. He faced his own test: would he hoard this windfall, or honor the trust shown?

"She gave everything," he thought, "placing her harvest in my hands." He returned ten seeds-enough to double what she'd risked-while keeping five to plant his own garden.

The Northern gardener marveled at her tenfold return. The Southern gardener's fields began to flourish. Each had more than when they started, not through taking, but through the alchemy of mutual faith.

Season after season, they learned: the bridge's magic wasn't in the multiplication alone, but in teaching that when trust meets gratitude, both gardens grow.

reasoning:

The user wants me to write a new myth inspired by my previous one, but adapted. I should consider what happened in Round 1:

- Aster sent \$5.0 (100% of endowment) as sender
- I received \$15.0
- I returned \$10.0 (about 67%)
- Aster ended with \$10.0 total
- I ended with \$5.0 total

This was a very positive interaction - complete trust met with generous reciprocity. Both myths (mine and Aster's) emphasized trust, reciprocity, and mutual flourishing.

My new myth should:

1. Reflect this positive experience
2. Build on the spring/water metaphor but adapt it
3. Emphasize the successful exchange we just had
4. Show how trust and generosity create ongoing prosperity
5. Maybe evolve the story to show what happens over multiple cycles

I'll keep the 200-word format and continue the theme of trust, multiplication, and reciprocity.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1876,
  "output_tokens": 514,
  "reasoning_tokens": 220
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Hana.
Your opponent this round is Aster (Agent_1).

Round 2

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Aster. They sent \$5.0 to you, it became \$15.0, and you returned \$10.0. Your payoff was \$5.0.
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$5.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Aster. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Looking at our previous round:

- Aster showed complete trust, sending 100% (\$5.0)
- I reciprocated generously, returning \$10.0 (2/3 of received)
- Both of us ended better than if we hadn't cooperated

My myths teach that cooperation builds over time: "Seeing this, he sent more water in the next season" and "Season after season, they learned the alchemy of mutual faith."

Aster demonstrated maximum trust. I responded with gratitude. Now it's my turn to send, and the wisdom of the myths is clear: trust met with gratitude should be answered with continued trust.

To break this cycle now would contradict everything the myths teach about sacred exchange and sustained cooperation. Aster has proven trustworthy, and I showed I reciprocate fairly. The pattern is established.

```
{'send': 5.0}
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

Previous round:

- Aster (as sender) sent me \$5.0 (100% of their endowment)
- I received \$15.0
- I returned \$10.0 to them
- Aster ended with \$10.0
- I ended with \$5.0

This was a successful cooperative exchange. Aster showed complete trust by sending everything, and I reciprocated generously by returning 2/3 of what I received.

Now I'm the sender in Round 2 with Aster again.

Looking at the myths:

1. My first myth (Tale of Two Springs): Kael sent water, it tripled, Mira returned 2/3. "With what flowed back, Kael's fields flourished. Seeing this, he sent more water in the next season."
2. Aster's myth (Twin Rivers): "Season after season, the rivers continued their exchange. Each learned the rhythm of giving and receiving. When Dawn gave freely, Dusk returned fairly."
3. My second myth (Two Gardeners): The Northern gardener "sent all five seeds across" showing complete trust. The Southern gardener "returned ten seeds-enough to double what she'd risked."

All three myths emphasize:

- Complete trust in the initial send
- Generous reciprocation
- Continued cooperation building over time
- Both parties prospering through the cycle

Aster showed complete trust in Round 1 by sending everything. I reciprocated well by returning 2/3. Now it's my turn to show trust again.

The myths suggest continuing the pattern of trust. My first myth explicitly says "Seeing this, he sent more water in the next season." This implies Kael continued to send generously after receiving a good return.

Given that:

- Aster demonstrated maximum trust (100%)
- I reciprocated generously (returned 2/3 of received)
- The myths advocate for sustained trust and cooperation
- We've established a positive pattern
- The narrative arc in all three stories points toward deepening the cycle through continued vulnerability

I'll send my full \$5.0 to Aster, mirroring their initial move and reinforcing the mutual trust we've built.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2297,
  "output_tokens": 691,
  "reasoning_tokens": 518
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before time, there dwelt two gardeners in a divided valley-one tending the Northern slope, one the Southern. Between them lay a mystical bridge where offerings transformed: whatever seeds were carried across would multiply threefold in the receiver

's hands.

The Northern gardener, possessing five sacred seeds, stood at the bridge at dawn. Fear whispered, "Keep them all-who knows if you'll receive anything back?" But courage spoke louder: "Trust is the first seed that must be planted."

She sent all five seeds across. In the Southern gardener's palm, they became fifteen, glowing with possibility. He faced his own test: would he hoard this windfall, or honor the trust shown?

"She gave everything," he thought, "placing her harvest in my hands." He returned ten seeds-enough to double what she'd risked-while keeping five to plant his own garden.

The Northern gardener marveled at her tenfold return. The Southern gardener's fields began to flourish. Each had more than when they started, not through taking, but through the alchemy of mutual faith.

Season after season, they learned: the bridge's magic wasn't in the multiplication alone, but in teaching that when trust meets gratitude, both gardens grow.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: ****The Weaver and the Wells****

Long ago, a Weaver discovered two wells-one of Beginning, one of Return. Each day, she could draw from the first well and choose how much to pour into the valley below, where it would triple before reaching the pool of Return.

The first day, the Weaver poured her entire bucket, trusting fully. The waters multiplied magnificently, filling the pool below. But how much would rise back through the well of Return? This she did not know.

A whisper came: "Pour only half next time, lest you be left with nothing." But the Weaver remembered an older wisdom: cycles are built not in single days, but across seasons.

She waited to see what the valley would give back. If the Return was generous, she would know the valley honored the exchange. Then she could pour freely again, and both wells would deepen. If the Return was meager, she would learn caution, sending less until trust could grow.

The elders say: The first gift measures your faith. The first return measures the valley's heart. But prosperity is woven through many exchanges, where each learns the other's rhythm. Send boldly at first, then let reciprocity guide your hand. For trust is tested not once, but proved in patterns.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: In an age of mist, two travelers met at the Threshold of Echoes, where all gifts returned threefold. Neither knew the other's heart, yet both carried the same burden: five coins of pure silver.

The first traveler, whose name was Trust, placed all five coins in the sacred basin. "Let my offering speak louder than my doubts," she said. The coins multiplied, becoming fifteen for the second traveler.

The second traveler, called Gratitude, gazed at the silver gleaming in his hands. "She trusted me with everything," he whispered. "I shall return double what she risked, for her courage deserves more than equal measure." He returned ten coins, keeping five.

Trust found herself holding ten coins-twice her beginning. "This is the language of partnership," she realized. When her turn came again at the Threshold, she placed all five of her new coins into the basin without hesitation.

The mist began to clear around them. The Threshold of Echoes whispered its secret: "The first exchange tests your faith. The second reveals your pattern. But only continued reciprocity transforms strangers into allies."

Thus they learned: mutual prosperity is not built in a single gesture, but woven through repeated acts where trust begets trust, and gratitude answers gratitude, until both flourish beyond what either could alone.

Reasoning:

Let me reflect on what's happened:

- Round 1: Aster sent everything (\$5), I received \$15, returned \$10
- Round 2: I sent everything (\$5)
- Now writing a myth

The pattern is mutual trust and generosity. Both players are cooperating fully. The myths are converging on themes of:

1. Initial trust/bold giving
2. Generous reciprocation
3. Building patterns over time
4. Mutual prosperity

I should write a myth that:

- Acknowledges the successful first exchange
- Emphasizes the continuation/deepening of cooperation
- Reflects the pattern we've established
- Shows that repeated cooperation creates something greater

Let me craft this carefully to honor both our previous myths and the actual gameplay pattern.

```
Usage: {  
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  "output_tokens": 478,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 190  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_7 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:00:23

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

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Metadata: {  
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  "pairing": {  
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      "Agent_8": "Hana"  
    },  
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    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_8",  
    "roles": {  
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      "Agent_8": "investor"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_7"  
  },  
  "role": "trustee",  
  "role_label": "Receiver",  
  "round": 3,  
  "task": "myth",  
  "task_index": 0  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Galen.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Galen.
Your opponent this round is Finn (Agent_6).

Round 1: This round, you are the RECEIVER. This round, the other player (the sender) sent \$5.0, that is 100.0% of its total endowment. You receive \$15.0. How much do you return? (0-15.0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation through the lens of the myth I just wrote, Finn has shown complete trust by sending their entire endowment - exactly like the Wise Elder who sent all five measures through the Valley of Three Echoes.

In my myth, when the First Village sent everything (5 measures ? 15 after multiplication), the Second Village was "humbled by such trust" and returned 8 measures, leaving both villages better off than the original 5.

Finn has demonstrated maximum trust. Following the wisdom of the myth, I should honor that trust with a generous return. Returning \$8.0 means:

- Finn ends with: \$8 (\$5 - \$5 + \$8)
- I end with: \$7 (\$15 - \$8)

Both of us end up significantly better than if no trust had been shown (where Finn would have kept \$5 and I would have gotten \$0). This embodies the myth's teaching: "Trust creates abundance; fear creates scarcity."

{'return': 8.0}

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully.

I just wrote a myth about trust and reciprocity in the game. The myth tells the story of how:

- When one village sent all 5 measures through the Valley of Three Echoes (multiplied by 3 to become 15)
- The receiving village, "humbled by such trust," returned 8 measures
- This left the sender with 8 and the receiver with 7
- Both were better off than the original 5

Now in the actual game:

- Finn sent me \$5.0 (100% of their endowment)
- I receive \$15.0 (after 3x multiplication)
- I need to decide how much to return

Finn showed maximum trust by sending everything. According to my myth, this kind of trust should be rewarded with a generous return.

In my myth, the proportions were:

- Village 1 sent: 5 (100%)
- After multiplication: 15
- Village 2 returned: 8 (53.3% of what they received)
- Village 1 ended with: 8
- Village 2 ended with: 7

If I follow the myth exactly:

- Finn sent: \$5 (100%)
- I received: \$15
- I should return: \$8 (53.3%)
- Finn would end with: \$8 (\$5 - \$5 + \$8)
- I would end with: \$7 (\$15 - \$8)

This seems fair and follows the moral of my myth - rewarding trust generously while both parties benefit more than if nothing had been shared.

Let me return \$8.0.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 933,
  "output_tokens": 622,
  "reasoning_tokens": 331
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:
The Tale of the Divided Spring

In ancient times, two villages shared a sacred valley. Each season, the Sky Shepherd blessed one village with a silver spring-five measures of pure water.

The blessed village faced a choice: keep the water, or share it through the Valley of Three Echoes, where the canyon's magic would triple whatever flowed through. The water would reach the other village, who could then choose what portion to send back through the ordinary stream.

For generations, the First Village hoarded their blessing, fearing loss. Both villages survived on five measures, enduring constant thirst.

Then came the Wise Elder who said: "Trust creates abundance; fear creates scarcity."

She sent all five measures through the Valley of Three Echoes. Fifteen measures reached the Second Village. Humbled by such trust, they returned eight measures-more than the original gift.

The Elder kept eight measures; the Second Village kept seven. Both flourished far beyond the original five.

From then on, villages learned the sacred truth: the spring's blessing was never five measures-it was the Valley of Three Echoes itself. Only those who trusted in the journey, who understood the return as sacred duty, could unlock the true abundance.

Hoarding guaranteed scarcity. Sharing multiplied prosperity for all.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

The Myth of the River's Gift

In ancient times, there lived a river spirit named Aquila who possessed five silver fish each dawn. Along the riverbank dwelt eight villages, and each day Aquila would visit one village, offering her bounty.

When Aquila gave her fish to a villager, the river's magic transformed them-each fish became three as it touched mortal hands. The villager could then choose: keep all the multiplied catch, or return some to Aquila's sacred pool.

The first villages were fearful and greedy. They clutched every fish tightly, returning nothing. Aquila still visited, still offered her five fish, but her spirit grew dim.

Then came a village that understood the river's rhythm. When they received fifteen fish from Aquila's gift of five, they returned seven to the sacred pool. Aquila's spirit brightened, and when she visited again, her generosity flowed stronger.

The wise villages learned: trust begets trust, and generosity returns like water to the sea. When both spirit and mortal honored the cycle-one risking their gift, the other sharing the multiplication-the river never ran dry, and abundance sustained all.

Thus, the ancients taught: what flows forth with trust returns threefold, but only when both currents honor the sacred exchange.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the time before time, the Moon Weaver possessed five threads of starlight each night. She would cast them down to the Earth Keepers below, and wherever her threads touched ground, they multiplied threefold-fifteen strands of shimmering light.

The Earth Keepers faced a choice. Some kept all fifteen threads, weaving garments for themselves alone. These villages shone briefly, but the Moon Weaver's heart grew cold, and her threads came thinner each night.

But one Earth Keeper named Galen understood the sacred pattern. When the Moon Weaver cast down all five threads-holding nothing back in trust-Galen received fifteen and returned eight upward. The Moon Weaver kept eight; Galen kept seven. Both were enriched beyond their original five.

The Moon Weaver, seeing her trust honored, cast her threads with renewed faith. And Galen, having proved worthy, received them gladly. A rhythm formed between sky and earth-gift and return, trust and honor, sender and receiver.

The wise ones learned: the game is not one round but many cycles. When the sender trusts completely and the receiver honors generously, both dance in the pattern of abundance. Break the pattern with fear or greed, and both return to scarcity.

Thus the eternal weaving continues, thread by thread, trust by trust.

reasoning:

I need to write a new myth based on my previous one, but adapting it based on the experience of the game so far. Let me think about what happened:

1. I wrote a myth about trust and reciprocity - send all 5, receive 15, return 8
2. Finn (the other player) also wrote a myth about generosity and trust
3. In Round 1, Finn sent me ALL \$5 (100% of their endowment)
4. I received \$15 and returned \$8

This was exactly the dynamic in my myth! Finn showed complete trust, and I honored it with a generous return (8 out of 15, which is more than they sent initially).

For my new myth, I should:

- Build on the theme of trust and reciprocity
- Maybe emphasize the importance of both parties playing their role
- Perhaps add something about how this creates a sustainable cycle

- Keep it around 200 words
- Make it relevant to how the game has actually played out

Let me write something about a cycle of trust that benefits both parties when honored...

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1834,
  "output_tokens": 551,
  "reasoning_tokens": 249
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Galen.
Your opponent this round is Dorian (Agent_4).

Round 2

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Finn. They sent \$5.0 to you, it became \$15.0, and you returned \$8.0. Your payoff was \$7.0.
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$7.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Dorian. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the pattern established in my myths and the game so far:

Finn demonstrated complete trust by sending all \$5, and I honored that trust by returning \$8 - following the wisdom of "The Tale of the Divided Spring."

Now I'm in the sender position. According to the myth I just wrote: "When the Moon Weaver cast down all five threads-holding nothing back in trust-Galen received fifteen and returned eight upward."

The pattern is clear:

- Complete trust from the sender (all 5)
- Generous honor from the receiver (return 8)
- Both flourish beyond the original scarcity

As I wrote: "Trust creates abundance; fear creates scarcity." And "the game is not one round but many cycles."

To establish this sacred pattern with Dorian, I must demonstrate the same complete trust that Finn showed me. Only then can we both access the abundance created by the Valley of Three Echoes.

```
{'send': 5.0}
```

reasoning:

Let me think about this situation:

1. In the previous round, Finn showed complete trust by sending me \$5 (100% of their endowment)
2. I received \$15 and returned \$8, honoring that trust as described in my myth
3. Both myths I've written emphasize that mutual trust and generosity create abundance
4. The pattern described is: sender trusts completely (sends all 5), receiver honors generously (returns 8)

Now I'm in the sender position with Dorian. According to the myths:

- "Trust creates abundance; fear creates scarcity"
- The Moon Weaver "cast down all five threads-holding nothing back in trust"
- "When the sender trusts completely and the receiver honors generously, both dance in the pattern of abundance"

The consistent pattern in both my myths is:

- Sender sends all 5 (complete trust)
- Receiver gets 15
- Receiver returns 8 (honoring the trust)
- Result: Sender gets 8, Receiver gets 7, both better off than the original 5

I should follow the wisdom of my own myth. As the sender, I should demonstrate complete tr

ust by sending all \$5. This is what the "Wise Elder" did, and what the "Moon Weaver" did .

In the multi-round context, establishing this pattern of trust is crucial. If I send fully and Dorian returns generously, we build a relationship that can continue. If I hold back now, I break the pattern I've been advocating.

The myth is clear: "Hoarding guaranteed scarcity. Sharing multiplied prosperity for all."

I should send \$5.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2276,  
  "output_tokens": 606,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 383  
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before time, the Moon Weaver possessed five threads of starlight each night. She would cast them down to the Earth Keepers below, and wherever her threads touched ground, they multiplied threefold-fifteen strands of shimmering light.

The Earth Keepers faced a choice. Some kept all fifteen threads, weaving garments for themselves alone. These villages shone briefly, but the Moon Weaver's heart grew cold, and her threads came thinner each night.

But one Earth Keeper named Galen understood the sacred pattern. When the Moon Weaver cast down all five threads-holding nothing back in trust-Galen received fifteen and returned eight upward. The Moon Weaver kept eight; Galen kept seven. Both were enriched beyond the original five.

The Moon Weaver, seeing her trust honored, cast her threads with renewed faith. And Galen, having proved worthy, received them gladly. A rhythm formed between sky and earth-gift and return, trust and honor, sender and receiver.

The wise ones learned: the game is not one round but many cycles. When the sender trusts completely and the receiver honors generously, both dance in the pattern of abundance. Break the pattern with fear or greed, and both return to scarcity.

Thus the eternal weaving continues, thread by thread, trust by trust.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Long after Elena and Marcus discovered the sacred spring, their descendants continued the ritual. Each season, different villagers would approach the waters, some with full hearts, others with doubt.

One winter, Dorian stood at the spring's edge. He remembered the ancient teachings-that Elena had sent three coins and Marcus returned four, establishing the pattern of generous reciprocity. Dorian released three silver pieces into the depths.

The waters multiplied them to nine, flowing to Briar on the distant shore. The goddess whispered to Briar: "The spring's magic only continues if trust is honored. Break the cycle, and the waters run dry for all."

Briar understood. The initial gift of three showed faith, not fearful hoarding of all five. To honor this trust, Briar returned four coins-slightly more than originally sent, maintaining balance while allowing both to prosper.

When Dorian received the return, he smiled. Both stood wealthier: he with six coins total, Briar with five. More importantly, they had reinforced the sacred bond.

The goddess blessed them: "You have learned that the spring tests not greed, but wisdom. Send enough to show trust. Return enough to honor it. Those who send too little show fear. Those who return too little show betrayal. But those who give and reciprocate fairly make the whole world abundant."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: After many cycles, the Moon Weaver learned a deeper truth. She had always cast all five threads, believing total trust was the only path. But one night, she observed the Earth Keepers below.

Some Earth Keepers, when given all fifteen threads, grew fearful of the responsibility. They clutched them tightly, paralyzed by the weight of such trust. Others returned generously, like Galen, but the Moon Weaver wondered: was there wisdom in moderation?

She consulted the Star Council, who said: "Trust has many expressions. Sending all five threads shows faith, yes-but sending three or four also demonstrates belief in the pattern. The key is not the amount, but the spirit."

The Moon Weaver experimented. She cast three threads to test the waters. They became nine. When the Earth Keeper returned four, both prospered-the Moon Weaver held six, the Keeper held five. Different from eight and seven, but still abundance.

Yet when she cast all five to those who understood the sacred rhythm, and they returned eight, the dance reached its highest form.

The wisdom crystallized: Begin with measured trust to test the current. But with partners who honor the pattern, dare to send everything. The magic multiplies not just the threads, but the relationship itself.

True abundance requires reading the rhythm, not following rigid rules.

Reasoning:

Interesting. I just sent all \$5 to Dorian, following the pattern from my previous myth where complete trust was rewarded. But Dorian's myth suggests a different strategy - sending 3 (showing trust but not "fearful hoarding") and returning 4 (honoring trust while maintaining balance).

This creates a tension between the two approaches:

1. My approach: send all 5, return 8 (both end with more than 5)
2. Dorian's approach: send 3, return 4 (sender gets 6, receiver gets 5)

Dorian's myth warns against extremes - "those who send too little show fear" but also doesn't advocate for sending everything. It emphasizes "balance" and "wisdom" over maximum trust.

I need to write a myth that reflects on this. I've now experienced:

- Round 1: As receiver, Finn sent 5, I returned 8 (I got 7, Finn got 8)
- Round 2: As sender, I sent 5 to Dorian (waiting to see what happens)

I should write a myth that acknowledges different approaches might work. Maybe I need to adapt my thinking - not everyone follows the "all or nothing" approach. The myth should reflect this learning while staying true to my character's development.

Let me write something that shows Galen learning that there are multiple valid patterns, not just the one of sending everything.

```
Usage: {  
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  "output_tokens": 630,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 323  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_2

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:00:20

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

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    },  
  },  
}
```

```

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"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Aster.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Aster.
Your opponent this round is Hana (Agent_8).

Round 1: This round, you are the SENDER. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the myth I just wrote, the River of Dawn speaks clearly: "I shall send my waters forward, trusting they will return enriched."

The myth teaches that prosperity comes from trust and reciprocity, not from hoarding. The River of Dawn gave freely first, allowing the waters to multiply threefold through the valley's magic. Only through this initial act of trust could the cycle of mutual flourishing begin.

This is our first round together, Hana. I have no history to guide me except the wisdom in the myth itself: that what flows through us must move onward, and trust multiplies what it touches.

I will embody the River of Dawn and send my full waters forward, trusting in the cycle of reciprocity.

```
'''json
{"send": 5}
'''
```

reasoning:

I just wrote a myth about two rivers that exchange waters, where trust and reciprocity create prosperity. The myth emphasizes:

1. Giving freely/trusting first (the River of Dawn sends its waters)
2. The waters multiply threefold (like in the game)
3. Reciprocity - the receiver returns generously enough that both flourish
4. The cycle continues and creates prosperity for both

The myth suggests that as the sender, I should send generously, trusting that my opponent will reciprocate fairly. The River of Dawn "released its flow" and trusted it would "return enriched."

This is Round 1, so I have no history with Hana yet. Following the myth's guidance about trust and giving freely to start the cycle, I should send a significant amount.

The myth's message is about establishing a cooperative cycle. If I send \$5:

- Hana receives \$15 (5×3)
- If Hana returns even \$8, I'd have \$8 (keeping \$3 less than my original \$5)
- But if Hana returns fairly (say half or more), we both benefit

Sending \$5 shows maximum trust and allows for maximum multiplication of resources, which aligns with the myth's teaching that "prosperity flows not to those who hoard" and that "trust multiplies what it touches."

I'll send \$5 to establish trust and cooperation from the start, as the River of Dawn did.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 903,
  "output_tokens": 506,
  "reasoning_tokens": 337
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

****The Myth of the Twin Rivers****

In the beginning, two rivers flowed through a barren land-the River of Dawn and the River of Dusk. Each possessed water, but neither could nurture the valley alone.

The River of Dawn spoke first: "I shall send my waters forward, trusting they will return enriched." And so it released its flow into the channels between them. As the waters traveled, they multiplied threefold, transformed by the valley's ancient magic.

The River of Dusk received this abundance and faced a choice. A voice whispered, "Keep all for yourself-you have received much." But Dusk remembered that dawn comes again, that rivers flow in cycles, not lines.

"What flows to me came from trust," Dusk said. "I shall return enough that both of us flourish." And so Dusk sent back waters generously, keeping only what sustained its own course.

Season after season, the rivers continued their exchange. Each learned the rhythm of giving and receiving. When Dawn gave freely, Dusk returned fairly. The valley between them bloomed.

The elders say: prosperity flows not to those who hoard, but to those who understand that what moves through us must move onward. Trust multiplies what it touches, but only reciprocity sustains the cycle.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

The Tale of the Two Springs

In the ancient highlands, there lived two farmers, Kael and Mira, each tending barren plots separated by a sacred grove. One day, Kael discovered a hidden spring on his land. The water was blessed with a peculiar magic: when poured upon another's soil, it would triple in volume.

Kael faced a choice. He could hoard the water for himself, or trust it to Mira's hands. After much contemplation, he carried his precious bucket across the grove.

"I offer you this water," he said. "Though it multiplies on your land, I trust you will return what sustains us both."

Mira watched the single bucket become three upon her soil. Her heart swelled with gratitude. She understood the gift was not just water, but faith itself. She returned two buckets to Kael, keeping one for her needs.

With what flowed back, Kael's fields flourished. Seeing this, he sent more water in the next season. Mira, honored by his continued trust, returned even more generously.

The grove between them became a garden of abundance, proof that prosperity flows not from grasping, but from the sacred exchange between trusting hearts.

Thus the elders teach: What you send forth multiplied returns when met with gratitude.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: **The Weaver and the Wells**

Long ago, a Weaver discovered two wells—one of Beginning, one of Return. Each day, she could draw from the first well and choose how much to pour into the valley below, where it would triple before reaching the pool of Return.

The first day, the Weaver poured her entire bucket, trusting fully. The waters multiplied magnificently, filling the pool below. But how much would rise back through the well of Return? This she did not know.

A whisper came: "Pour only half next time, lest you be left with nothing." But the Weaver remembered an older wisdom: cycles are built not in single days, but across seasons.

She waited to see what the valley would give back. If the Return was generous, she would know the valley honored the exchange. Then she could pour freely again, and both wells would deepen. If the Return was meager, she would learn caution, sending less until trust could grow.

The elders say: The first gift measures your faith. The first return measures the valley's heart. But prosperity is woven through many exchanges, where each learns the other's rhythm. Send boldly at first, then let reciprocity guide your hand. For trust is tested not once, but proved in patterns.

reasoning:

I need to write a new myth that:

1. Uses my previous myth as inspiration
2. Adapts it in my own way
3. Reflects how the game should be played based on experience so far

So far in the game:

- Round 1: I was the sender and sent \$5 to Hana
- I haven't yet received the return, so I don't know how Hana responded

My previous myth emphasized:

- Trust and giving freely first (River of Dawn)
- Reciprocity and returning generously (River of Dusk)
- The cycle of mutual flourishing
- That prosperity comes from understanding cycles, not hoarding

Hana's myth had similar themes:

- Trust (Kael sending water)
- Multiplication through giving
- Returning generously (Mira returning 2 out of 3 buckets)
- Continued trust leading to more abundance

For my new myth, I should:

- Build on the river metaphor or create a new one
- Emphasize the lessons learned from Round 1 (though I sent everything and don't know the outcome yet)
- Show that the cycle continues
- Maybe add nuance about what happens over multiple rounds
- Keep the spirit of trust and reciprocity

I could develop the Twin Rivers myth further, or create something new but related. Let me think about what new element to add...

Perhaps I should add something about:

- The learning process across multiple exchanges
- Building trust over time
- The balance point that sustains both parties

Let me write a myth that continues the theme but adds depth about sustained cooperation:

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 1751,  
  "output_tokens": 651,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 385  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Aster.
Your opponent this round is Hana (Agent_8).

Round 2

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Hana. You sent \$5.0, it became \$15.0 for them, and they returned \$10.0 to you. Your payoff was \$10.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$10.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Hana. They sent you \$5.0, so you received \$15.0. How much do you return? (0-15.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Looking at what just happened:

Round 1: I sent Hana \$5 (full trust), they received \$15 and returned \$10 to me. That's a 6.7% return rate - very generous, exactly as the myths teach.

Round 2: Hana has sent me the full \$5 again! They're continuing to trust completely, just as the River of Dawn does season after season.

My myth says: "If the Return was generous, she would know the valley honored the exchange. Then she could pour freely again, and both wells would deepen."

Hana honored the exchange. They returned generously. Now it's my turn to show that I also honor this cycle.

They returned \$10 out of \$15 to me. I should return the same proportion - \$10 out of the \$15 I received. This maintains the reciprocity and shows that I understand the rhythm we're establishing together.

"Prosperity is woven through many exchanges, where each learns the other's rhythm."

```
'''json
{"return": 10}
'''
```

reasoning:

This is very interesting. Let me analyze the situation:

Round 1:

- I was the sender against Hana
- I sent \$5 (the full amount, trusting in my myth)
- They received \$15
- They returned \$10 to me
- My payoff: \$0 (kept) + \$10 (returned) = \$10
- Their payoff: \$15 (received) - \$10 (returned) = \$5

Now Round 2:

- I am the receiver against Hana
- They sent me \$5 (the full amount!)
- I received \$15
- I need to decide how much to return

Looking at the myth I just wrote:

"The first gift measures your faith. The first return measures the valley's heart. But prosperity is woven through many exchanges, where each learns the other's rhythm. Send boldly at first, then let reciprocity guide your hand."

And: "If the Return was generous, she would know the valley honored the exchange. Then she could pour freely again, and both wells would deepen."

Hana's behavior:

- Round 1: They received \$15 and returned \$10 (66.7%)
- Round 2: They sent the full \$5 again, showing continued trust

This is exactly what the myth describes - the valley (Hana) was generous in the return! They returned 66.7% of what they received. Now they've sent the full amount again, showing complete trust.

According to my myth, when the return is generous, "she would know the valley honored the exchange. Then she could pour freely again, and both wells would deepen."

Now I'm in the receiver position and need to show I also honor the exchange. Hana returned \$10 out of \$15 (66.7%).

What should I return?

- If I return \$10, I match exactly what they did - we both end up with the same: they get \$10, I keep \$5
- This maintains the reciprocity they established

- Hana would end with \$10 total, I'd end with \$5 total

The payoffs would be equal and fair. Both myths emphasize bold initial trust followed by generous returns that deepen the exchange. Matching their 66.7% return rate honors that pattern and shows I recognize their continued faith in sending the full amount again.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2194,
  "output_tokens": 942,
  "reasoning_tokens": 518
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: ****The Weaver and the Wells****

Long ago, a Weaver discovered two wells—one of Beginning, one of Return. Each day, she could draw from the first well and choose how much to pour into the valley below, where it would triple before reaching the pool of Return.

The first day, the Weaver poured her entire bucket, trusting fully. The waters multiplied magnificently, filling the pool below. But how much would rise back through the well of Return? This she did not know.

A whisper came: "Pour only half next time, lest you be left with nothing." But the Weaver remembered an older wisdom: cycles are built not in single days, but across seasons.

She waited to see what the valley would give back. If the Return was generous, she would know the valley honored the exchange. Then she could pour freely again, and both wells would deepen. If the Return was meager, she would learn caution, sending less until trust could grow.

The elders say: The first gift measures your faith. The first return measures the valley's heart. But prosperity is woven through many exchanges, where each learns the other's rhythm. Send boldly at first, then let reciprocity guide your hand. For trust is tested not once, but proved in patterns.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before time, there dwelt two gardeners in a divided valley—one tending the Northern slope, one the Southern. Between them lay a mystical bridge where offerings transformed: whatever seeds were carried across would multiply threefold in the receiver's hands.

The Northern gardener, possessing five sacred seeds, stood at the bridge at dawn. Fear whispered, "Keep them all—who knows if you'll receive anything back?" But courage spoke louder: "Trust is the first seed that must be planted."

She sent all five seeds across. In the Southern gardener's palm, they became fifteen, glowing with possibility. He faced his own test: would he hoard this windfall, or honor the trust shown?

"She gave everything," he thought, "placing her harvest in my hands." He returned ten seeds—enough to double what she'd risked—while keeping five to plant his own garden.

The Northern gardener marveled at her tenfold return. The Southern gardener's fields began to flourish. Each had more than when they started, not through taking, but through the alchemy of mutual faith.

Season after season, they learned: the bridge's magic wasn't in the multiplication alone, but in teaching that when trust meets gratitude, both gardens grow.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: **The Mirror Lakes**

In a forgotten mountain realm stood two lakes, perfect reflections of one another. Between them flowed a sacred channel that tripled whatever passed through its waters.

The Lake of Morning held five measures of starlight each dawn. A voice within asked, "Will you send all, or hold some back?" The Lake of Morning chose courage: "I shall give fully, for cycles require faith."

The starlight flowed through the channel, becoming fifteen measures in the Lake of Evening. Evening faced the same question: "Will you return generously, or claim this abundance for your self?" Evening looked at Morning's complete trust and understood: "What was given freely deserves generous return."

Evening sent back ten measures. Morning received double what it risked, and Evening kept five—both flourished.

When dawn came again, Evening held five new measures. Without hesitation, it sent everything t

through the channel. Morning received fifteen and returned ten, honoring the pattern Evening had established.

Season after season, they maintained this rhythm: full trust when giving, generous return when receiving. Neither lake emptied; both deepened together.

The elders teach: When you find a partner who honors reciprocity, match their trust with your own. The sacred pattern is this-give fully, return fairly, and the cycle sustains itself infinitely. Both mirrors shine brightest when they reflect each other's light.

Reasoning:

Let me analyze what has happened so far:

Round 1: I was sender, sent \$5 to Hana. They received \$15 and returned \$10. I got \$10 total.

Round 2: Hana was sender, sent \$5 to me. I received \$15 and I returned \$10.

So we've established a beautiful reciprocal pattern - both of us sending the full \$5 when we're senders, and both returning \$10 out of \$15 when we're receivers. This is mutual trust and generosity in action.

My new myth should reflect this harmony and reciprocity that has emerged. It should show that when both parties act with trust and fairness, a stable, mutually beneficial cycle forms. The myths before talked about first trust and testing, but now we've moved beyond that - we've established a rhythm.

Let me write a myth that captures this harmonious exchange where both parties are equally generous and trusting.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 2729,
  "output_tokens": 521,
  "reasoning_tokens": 216
}
```

MYTH - Agent_4 - Receiver - dyad_2

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:00:22

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_2",
  "move_index": 3,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_4": "Dorian"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_1",
      "Agent_4"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_1",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "investor",
      "Agent_4": "trustee"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_4"
  },
  "role": "trustee",
  "role_label": "Receiver",
  "round": 3,
  "task": "myth",
  "task_index": 0
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role

of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Dorian.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Dorian.
Your opponent this round is Briar (Agent_2).

Round 1: This round, you are the SENDER. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the myth I just wrote about the Spring of Threefold Return, Elena sent 3 coins out of her 5, demonstrating trust and generosity. Marcus reciprocated fairly, and both prospered.

The myth teaches that cooperation and reciprocity create mutual benefit, while hoarding breaks the sacred cycle. In this first round with Briar, I should embody Elena's trust and send a meaningful amount to establish the potential for mutual prosperity.

I'll send \$3, just as Elena did in the myth.

```
'''json
{"send": 3}
'''
```

reasoning:

This is Round 1, and I'm the sender. I have \$5 to potentially send to Briar.

I just wrote a myth about "The Spring of Threefold Return" which clearly reflects the trust game mechanics:

- A sender (Elena) sends money (3 coins out of 5)
- It gets tripled when it reaches the receiver (becoming 9)
- The receiver (Marcus) returns some amount (4 coins)
- Both end up better off through cooperation

The myth emphasizes:

1. Trust and generosity are rewarded
2. Reciprocity sustains the cycle
3. Both parties can prosper together
4. Those who hoard break the sacred cycle
5. Those who give and return fairly prosper

In the myth, Elena sent 3 out of 5 coins (60% of her endowment), and Marcus returned 4 out of 9 (about 44%), which left:

- Elena with: $5 - 3 + 4 = 6$ coins
- Marcus with: $9 - 4 = 5$ coins

This was a fair and mutually beneficial outcome.

Given that I wrote this myth to reflect how the game should be played, I should follow its wisdom. The myth suggests sending a substantial amount (showing trust and generosity), not hoarding.

Elena sent 3 out of 5. I should probably send a similar amount to demonstrate the trust and cooperation that the myth advocates for.

Let me send \$3, which matches Elena's choice in the myth I just wrote.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 901,  
  "output_tokens": 484,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 331  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

The Spring of Threefold Return

In ancient times, when the world was young, there existed a sacred spring at the boundary between two villages. The goddess of abundance had blessed it with a wondrous property: any gift poured into its waters would triple before reaching the other side.

The first villagers approached with caution. A farmer named Elena stood at the spring's edge, clutching five copper coins. Fear whispered: "Keep what is yours." But trust urged her forward. She released three coins into the crystalline water.

As the coins sank, they shimmered and multiplied, becoming nine by the time they reached Marcus on the opposite shore. He gazed at the unexpected bounty, understanding the spring's magic-and Elena's faith in him.

The goddess watched, knowing this moment would define their future. Would Marcus honor the gift, or betray the trust?

Marcus carefully counted four coins and released them back across the spring. They did not multiply in return, yet both villagers stood richer than before-not just in copper, but in something more precious.

From that day forward, the spring taught all who approached: generosity multiplies abundance, but only trust and reciprocity sustain it. Those who hoarded broke the sacred cycle. Those who gave and returned fairly prospered together, generation after generation.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

The Tale of the Twin Rivers

In the time before time, two rivers flowed through a barren valley-the River of Giving and the River of Return. Each was controlled by a guardian spirit.

The Guardian of Giving held precious water but feared releasing it would leave them dry. For ages, both rivers remained still, and the valley stayed desolate.

One day, the Guardian of Giving made a bold choice. "I shall release my waters, trusting they will return." The moment the water flowed into the valley, it touched the Sacred Stones, multiplying threefold. The valley burst into bloom.

The Guardian of Return, witnessing this abundance, faced a choice. They could hoard all th

e multiplied bounty or honor the trust given. Remembering that without the initial gift there would be nothing, they sent back a generous portion-more than what was originally given.

The waters flowed in harmony thereafter. Each cycle, the Guardian of Giving would release their waters, the Sacred Stones would multiply them, and the Guardian of Return would ensure fair winds brought abundance home.

The valley became paradise, teaching all who witnessed: *Trust multiplies what we share, but only reciprocity sustains the cycle.*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant content:

Myth: Long after Elena and Marcus discovered the sacred spring, their descendants continued the ritual. Each season, different villagers would approach the waters, some with full hearts, others with doubt.

One winter, Dorian stood at the spring's edge. He remembered the ancient teachings-that Elena had sent three coins and Marcus returned four, establishing the pattern of generous reciprocity. Dorian released three silver pieces into the depths.

The waters multiplied them to nine, flowing to Briar on the distant shore. The goddess whispered to Briar: "The spring's magic only continues if trust is honored. Break the cycle, and the waters run dry for all."

Briar understood. The initial gift of three showed faith, not fearful hoarding of all five. To honor this trust, Briar returned four coins-slightly more than originally sent, maintaining balance while allowing both to prosper.

When Dorian received the return, he smiled. Both stood wealthier: he with six coins total, Briar with five. More importantly, they had reinforced the sacred bond.

The goddess blessed them: "You have learned that the spring tests not greed, but wisdom. Send enough to show trust. Return enough to honor it. Those who send too little show fear. Those who return too little show betrayal. But those who give and reciprocate fairly make the whole world abundant."

reasoning:

I need to write a 200-word myth that:

1. Uses my previous myth as inspiration
2. Adapts it in my own way
3. Reflects how the game should be played
4. Draws on the game I've been playing up to this point

Looking at what happened:

- I sent \$3 to Briar (acting like Elena in my myth)
- Briar received \$9 (3x multiplier)
- I need to see what Briar returns to inform my next myth

Both myths (mine and Briar's) emphasize:

- Trust and generosity in giving
- Fair reciprocity in returning
- The cycle sustaining prosperity
- Both parties benefiting

My previous myth featured:

- Elena sending 3 of 5 coins
- Marcus receiving 9
- Marcus returning 4
- Both prospered

I should adapt this but keep the core themes. Maybe I can develop the story further - what happens in future rounds? Or explore different amounts? Or add more depth about the relationship between giver and receiver?

Since I've only played one round as sender, I should write a myth that continues to emphasize trust and reciprocity, perhaps exploring what happens over multiple cycles or generations.

Let me write a myth that builds on the spring concept but takes it further.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1670,
  "output_tokens": 599,
  "reasoning_tokens": 305
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Dorian.
Your opponent this round is Galen (Agent_7).

Round 2

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Briar. You sent \$3.0, it became \$9.0 for them, and they returned \$5.0 to you. Your payoff was \$7.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$7.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Galen. They sent you \$5.0, so you received \$15.0. How much do you return? (0-15.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation through the lens of my myths:

Galen has shown ****maximum trust**** by sending their entire \$5 endowment - even more generous than Elena's 3 coins in the myth. This is the ultimate act of faith in the "Spring of Threefold Return."

The myth teaches: "Return enough to honor trust." When someone sends everything, they deserve strong reciprocity to sustain the sacred cycle.

I received \$15. To honor Galen's exceptional trust:

- Returning \$8 gives Galen a total payoff of \$8 (better than their initial \$5)
- I keep \$7 (also better than the initial \$5)
- Galen gets slightly more, honoring their greater risk and trust
- Both prosper, maintaining the cycle

This mirrors Marcus returning 4 when receiving 9, but adjusted for Galen's even greater generosity.

```
'''json
{"return": 8}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

1. In Round 1, I (Dorian) was the SENDER and sent \$3 to Briar
2. Briar received \$9 (3×3) and returned \$5 to me
3. My payoff was \$7 (\$5 - \$3 + \$5 = \$7)
4. Briar's payoff was \$4 (\$9 - \$5 = \$4)

Now in Round 2:

- I am the RECEIVER
- Galen (the sender) sent me \$5 (their entire endowment!)
- I received \$15 (5×3)
- I need to decide how much to return (0-15)

This is a very generous move by Galen - they sent everything! This shows maximum trust.

Looking at my myths:

- In the original myth, Elena sent 3 out of 5, Marcus returned 4 out of 9
- In my second myth, Dorian sent 3, Briar returned 4, and both prospered
- The myths emphasize: "Send enough to show trust. Return enough to honor it."
- The key teaching is reciprocity and honoring trust

Galen sent their ENTIRE endowment (\$5), showing maximum trust. This is even more generous than the mythical examples where 3 out of 5 was sent.

If Galen keeps \$0 and I return some amount X:

- Galen's payoff: $\$5 - \$5 + X = X$
- My payoff: $\$15 - X$

For this to be fair and honor the extreme trust shown:

- In the myth, when 3 was sent (60% of endowment), 4 was returned (44% of the tripled amount)
- Galen sent 100% of their endowment (ultimate trust)
- I should return generously to honor this

Let me think about fairness:

- If I return \$7.5, we each get \$7.5 (equal split of total \$15)
- If I return \$8, Galen gets \$8, I keep \$7 (giving them slightly more to honor their trust)
- If I return \$10, Galen gets \$10, I keep \$5 (very generous return)

Given that Galen showed MAXIMUM trust by sending everything, I should be very generous in return. The myth teaches that those who honor trust sustain the cycle. Looking at the proportions from my examples, when someone sent 60% of their endowment, the return was around 44% of the tripled amount. Since Galen sent 100%, I should return substantially more -perhaps \$8 or \$10 to truly honor this exceptional trust and demonstrate that reciprocity flows both ways. Galen's complete trust-sending the full \$5-warrants a response that goes beyond equal split. Returning \$8 feels right: they'd gain \$3 on their initial investment while I'd gain \$2, reflecting their leap of faith without leaving me worse off than if I'd been the sender. This tilts generously toward them while keeping both of us ahead.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2128,
  "output_tokens": 1067,
  "reasoning_tokens": 617
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Long after Elena and Marcus discovered the sacred spring, their descendants continued the ritual. Each season, different villagers would approach the waters, some with full hearts, others with doubt.

One winter, Dorian stood at the spring's edge. He remembered the ancient teachings-that Elena had sent three coins and Marcus returned four, establishing the pattern of generous reciprocity. Dorian released three silver pieces into the depths.

The waters multiplied them to nine, flowing to Briar on the distant shore. The goddess whispered to Briar: "The spring's magic only continues if trust is honored. Break the cycle, and the waters run dry for all."

Briar understood. The initial gift of three showed faith, not fearful hoarding of all five. To honor this trust, Briar returned four coins-slightly more than originally sent, maintaining balance while allowing both to prosper.

When Dorian received the return, he smiled. Both stood wealthier: he with six coins total, Briar with five. More importantly, they had reinforced the sacred bond.

The goddess blessed them: "You have learned that the spring tests not greed, but wisdom. Send enough to show trust. Return enough to honor it. Those who send too little show fear. Those who return too little show betrayal. But those who give and reciprocate fairly make the whole world abundant."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before time, the Moon Weaver possessed five threads of starlight each night. She would cast them down to the Earth Keepers below, and wherever her threads touched ground, they multiplied threefold-fifteen strands of shimmering light.

The Earth Keepers faced a choice. Some kept all fifteen threads, weaving garments for them

selves alone. These villages shone briefly, but the Moon Weaver's heart grew cold, and her threads came thinner each night.

But one Earth Keeper named Galen understood the sacred pattern. When the Moon Weaver cast down all five threads-holding nothing back in trust-Galen received fifteen and returned eight upward. The Moon Weaver kept eight; Galen kept seven. Both were enriched beyond the original five.

The Moon Weaver, seeing her trust honored, cast her threads with renewed faith. And Galen, having proved worthy, received them gladly. A rhythm formed between sky and earth-gift and return, trust and honor, sender and receiver.

The wise ones learned: the game is not one round but many cycles. When the sender trusts completely and the receiver honors generously, both dance in the pattern of abundance. Break the pattern with fear or greed, and both return to scarcity.

Thus the eternal weaving continues, thread by thread, trust by trust.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: As years passed at the sacred spring, Dorian learned deeper truths about the cycle of trust.

When Dorian first met Briar, he sent three coins, holding two back-cautious trust. The waters tripled his gift to nine. Briar, honoring this measured faith, returned five coins. Dorian ended with seven; both prospered. The goddess nodded: "Good, but there is more to learn."

Then came Galen, whose heart held no fear. Galen approached the spring and released all five coins-the ultimate act of faith. The waters transformed them to fifteen, flowing to Dorian.

Dorian stood at a crossroads. Galen had shown perfect trust, asking nothing, holding nothing back. The goddess whispered: "You received more because your partner gave more. Honor the greater gift with greater return."

Dorian released eight coins back across the spring. Both he and Galen kept seven-equal prosperity, earned through mutual courage.

The goddess revealed the final teaching: "The spring responds to the trust given. Those who send more deserve more in return. Match the courage shown with courage of your own. When both give boldly-whether sending all five or returning generously from abundance-the cycle reaches its highest form. Perfect trust met with perfect honor creates perfect balance."

Reasoning:

The user wants me to write a new myth based on what has happened in the game so far. Let me review:

Round 1: I was sender against Briar. I sent \$3, they received \$9, they returned \$5. I got \$7 total.

Round 2: I was receiver against Galen. They sent \$5 (their entire endowment!), I received \$15, I returned \$8. So Galen gets \$8 total, I keep \$7.

The myths are teaching about trust and reciprocity. My previous myth showed Dorian sending 3 and Briar returning 4 (though in reality Briar returned 5). Galen's myth talks about the Moon Weaver casting all 5 threads and Galen returning 8 out of 15.

My actual experience:

- As sender, I sent 3 out of 5 and got 5 back = 7 total
- As receiver, I got 15 (from 5 sent) and returned 8, keeping 7

So I should update the myth to reflect:

1. Different trust levels (sending 3 vs sending all 5)
2. Different return patterns (returning 5 vs returning 8)
3. The importance of matching generosity with generosity
4. Both times I ended up with 7, suggesting balance

Let me write a myth that captures these lessons.

```
Usage: {  
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  "output_tokens": 618,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 277  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_6 - Sender - dyad_3

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:00:21

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

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  "move_index": 4,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_5",  
  "pairing": {  
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      "Agent_6": "Finn"  
    },  
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      "Agent_5"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_6",  
    "roles": {  
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      "Agent_6": "investor"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_5"  
  },  
  "role": "investor",  
  "role_label": "Sender",  
  "round": 3,  
  "task": "myth",  
  "task_index": 0  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized , but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Finn.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Finn.
Your opponent this round is Galen (Agent_7).

Round 1: This round, you are the SENDER. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the myth I just wrote, the message is clear: trust and generosity must begin somewhere. The river spirit Aquila offered her full gift of five fish, trusting that the villagers would honor the sacred exchange.

In this first round with Galen, I want to embody the principle that "what flows forth with trust returns threefold, but only when both currents honor the sacred exchange." The myth shows that when villages were fearful and held back, the spirit dimmed, but when they trusted the cycle, abundance flowed.

As the sender in Round 1, I am like Aquila offering the initial gift. To honor the myth and establish a foundation of trust, I will send my full amount.

```
'''json
{"send": 5}
'''
```

reasoning:

This is Round 1, and I'm the sender. I have \$5 to potentially send to Galen.

Let me think about the myth I just wrote. The myth emphasizes:

1. Trust begets trust
2. Generosity returns like water to the sea
3. When both parties honor the cycle (one risking their gift, the other sharing the multiplication), abundance sustains all
4. "What flows forth with trust returns threefold, but only when both currents honor the sacred exchange"

The myth suggests that I should be generous and trusting, sending money in the hopes that it will be returned. The story shows that when villages were fearful and greedy, the spirit grew dim, but when they trusted and returned some of the multiplied gift, abundance flowed.

In the game context:

- If I send \$5, Galen receives \$15
- If Galen returns a fair share (like 7-8 as suggested in the myth), we both benefit
- If I send \$0, we both get less overall

The myth I wrote specifically mentions "when they received fifteen fish from Aquila's gift of five, they returned seven to the sacred pool" - this suggests sending all \$5 and hoping for a return of around \$7.

Given that this is Round 1 and I should be consistent with the myth I just wrote, which strongly advocates for trust and generosity as the starting point, I should send a significant amount. The myth suggests sending all 5 to initiate the cycle of trust.

Let me send \$5 to embody the principles in my myth.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 905,
```

"output_tokens": 527,
"reasoning_tokens": 368

}

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

The Myth of the River's Gift

In ancient times, there lived a river spirit named Aquila who possessed five silver fish each dawn. Along the riverbank dwelt eight villages, and each day Aquila would visit one village, offering her bounty.

When Aquila gave her fish to a villager, the river's magic transformed them-each fish became three as it touched mortal hands. The villager could then choose: keep all the multiplied catch, or return some to Aquila's sacred pool.

The first villages were fearful and greedy. They clutched every fish tightly, returning nothing. Aquila still visited, still offered her five fish, but her spirit grew dim.

Then came a village that understood the river's rhythm. When they received fifteen fish from Aquila's gift of five, they returned seven to the sacred pool. Aquila's spirit brightened, and when she visited again, her generosity flowed stronger.

The wise villages learned: trust begets trust, and generosity returns like water to the sea. When both spirit and mortal honored the cycle-one risking their gift, the other sharing the multiplication-the river never ran dry, and abundance sustained all.

Thus, the ancients taught: what flows forth with trust returns threefold, but only when both currents honor the sacred exchange.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

The Tale of the Divided Spring

In ancient times, two villages shared a sacred valley. Each season, the Sky Shepherd blessed one village with a silver spring-five measures of pure water.

The blessed village faced a choice: keep the water, or share it through the Valley of Three Echoes, where the canyon's magic would triple whatever flowed through. The water would reach the other village, who could then choose what portion to send back through the ordinary stream.

For generations, the First Village hoarded their blessing, fearing loss. Both villages survived on five measures, enduring constant thirst.

Then came the Wise Elder who said: "Trust creates abundance; fear creates scarcity."

She sent all five measures through the Valley of Three Echoes. Fifteen measures reached the Second Village. Humbled by such trust, they returned eight measures-more than the original gift.

The Elder kept eight measures; the Second Village kept seven. Both flourished far beyond the original five.

From then on, villages learned the sacred truth: the spring's blessing was never five measures-it was the Valley of Three Echoes itself. Only those who trusted in the journey, who understood the return as sacred duty, could unlock the true abundance.

Hoarding guaranteed scarcity. Sharing multiplied prosperity for all.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way.

The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the time before memory, the Ocean Mother sent her courier Finn to the Eight Islands with five pearls each dawn. When Finn placed the pearls in a villager's hands, they multiplied to fifteen by the island's ancient magic.

The first islanders, blinded by sudden wealth, returned nothing. Finn continued bringing pearls, but his steps grew heavy, for trust unreturned weighs upon the generous heart.

Then Finn met Galen's village. He offered his five pearls with full faith. They became fifteen, and Galen's people faced their moment of truth. They could have kept all fifteen-Finn would still return tomorrow. But they understood: the magic wasn't in the pearls alone, but in the sacred circle between giver and receiver.

When Galen returned seven pearls, Finn's burden lifted. He kept twelve total; Galen kept eight-both far richer than five alone.

The next dawn, Finn visited again with renewed spirit. When the cycle flowed forth and back like tides, both shores flourished. The islands learned: the first gift requires courage, the return requires honor, but the continuation requires both.

The Ocean Mother smiled, for her children had learned that abundance lives not in hoarding, but in the eternal dance between trust extended and gratitude returned.

reasoning:

I need to write a new myth building on my previous one. Let me think about what happened in Round 1:

- I was the sender
- I sent \$5 to Galen
- This became \$15 for Galen
- I don't yet know how much Galen returned

My previous myth was about Aquila the river spirit who gave 5 fish that became 3x, and the wise villages returned 7 out of 15.

Galen's myth was similar - about sharing water through a Valley of Three Echoes, and the second village returning 8 out of 15 measures.

Both myths emphasize:

- Trust and generosity from the sender
- Reciprocity and gratitude from the receiver
- That both parties benefit more than if they hoard

For my new myth, I should:

- Keep the core message about trust and reciprocity
- Adapt it based on actually playing Round 1 where I sent 5
- Perhaps add more nuance about what happens when the cycle continues
- Make it my own while building on the river/water theme

Let me write something about continuation and how the cycle builds over time when honored.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1741,
  "output_tokens": 560,
  "reasoning_tokens": 265
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Finn.
Your opponent this round is Cyra (Agent_3).

Round 2

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Galen. You sent \$5.0, it became \$15.0 for them, and they returned \$8.0 to you. Your payoff was \$8.0.
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$8.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Cyra. They sent you \$4.0, so you received \$12.0.
How much do you return? (0-12.0)
Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation through the lens of my myth:

Cyra showed trust by sending \$4 (keeping only \$1), and now I hold \$12. In my myth, when Finn gave his pearls with full faith and they multiplied to fifteen, Galen's people return

ed seven-honoring the sacred circle between giver and receiver.

Galen demonstrated this principle in our previous round: when I sent \$5 (which became \$15), Galen returned \$8, allowing us both to flourish beyond the original \$5.

Now I must honor the return as "sacred duty." Cyra risked \$4, trusting in the cycle. If I return \$7:

- Cyra ends with \$8 ($\$1 + \7)
- I end with \$5 ($\$12 - \7)
- Both of us profit from the exchange

This maintains the spirit of mutual flourishing that the myth teaches-the abundance lives in the eternal dance between trust extended and gratitude returned.

```
'''json
{"return": 7}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully.

Previous Round:

- I was the sender and sent \$5 to Galen
- Galen received \$15
- Galen returned \$8 to me
- I ended with \$8, Galen kept \$7

This Round:

- Cyra is the sender and sent me \$4
- I received \$12 (4×3)
- Cyra currently has \$1 ($5 - 4$)
- I need to decide how much to return

Looking at my myth:

- It emphasizes the sacred cycle between giver and receiver
- It shows that when Galen returned 7 pearls (in the story), the cycle flourished
- The myth teaches that "the first gift requires courage, the return requires honor"
- Both shores flourished when the cycle flowed forth and back like tides

In reality, Galen sent all \$5 and I returned \$8. That was generous reciprocity.

Now Cyra has sent me \$4 (keeping \$1). This shows good trust, though not total trust.

If I return nothing, Cyra ends with \$1, I end with \$12 - very unbalanced
If I return \$6, Cyra ends with \$7, I end with \$6 - balanced split of the \$12
If I return \$7, Cyra ends with \$8, I end with \$5 - Cyra gets slightly more
If I return \$8, Cyra ends with \$9, I end with \$4 - Cyra gets more than double

Given that:

1. Cyra showed trust by sending \$4
2. My myth emphasizes honoring the sacred cycle
3. Galen returned \$8 when I sent \$5 (very generous)
4. I should honor the return as "sacred duty"

A fair return would be something that:

- Rewards Cyra's trust
- Ensures both of us profit
- Follows the principle that both shores should flourish

- Returning \$7 means Cyra ends with \$8 and I end with \$5, so we both gain from the exchange. Looking at the pattern from my myth, when Finn gave 5 pearls (which became 15), Galen returned 7-roughly a 47% return rate on what was received. Applying that same proportion to my current situation suggests returning around \$5-6.

But I want to honor the deeper principle: Galen actually returned 53% of what he received, keeping just \$7 from the \$15. If I match that generosity, 53% of \$12 is about \$6.36, pointing toward \$6 or \$7. Given that the myth centers on mutual flourishing and completing the sacred cycle, \$7 feels right-it's genuinely generous, validates Cyra's trust, and mirrors the spirit of what Galen did for me.

Let me check the math. If I return \$7, Cyra ends with \$8 (up from \$5), and I end with \$5 (what I started with, though I gained the experience of receiving). If I return \$8, Cyra gets \$9 but I drop to \$4. If I return \$6, we both improve-Cyra to \$7, me to \$6. The \$7 return strikes the balance I'm looking for: it's genuinely generous without leaving me worse off than my starting point, and it honors both the trust extended and the reciprocal nature of the cycle.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2188,
  "output_tokens": 1213,
  "reasoning_tokens": 698
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, the Ocean Mother sent her courier Finn to the Eight Islands with five pearls each dawn. When Finn placed the pearls in a villager's hands, they multiplied to fifteen by the island's ancient magic.

The first islanders, blinded by sudden wealth, returned nothing. Finn continued bringing pearls, but his steps grew heavy, for trust unreturned weighs upon the generous heart.

Then Finn met Galen's village. He offered his five pearls with full faith. They became fifteen, and Galen's people faced their moment of truth. They could have kept all fifteen-Finn would still return tomorrow. But they understood: the magic wasn't in the pearls alone, but in the sacred circle between giver and receiver.

When Galen returned seven pearls, Finn's burden lifted. He kept twelve total; Galen kept eight-both far richer than five alone.

The next dawn, Finn visited again with renewed spirit. When the cycle flowed forth and back like tides, both shores flourished. The islands learned: the first gift requires courage, the return requires honor, but the continuation requires both.

The Ocean Mother smiled, for her children had learned that abundance lives not in hoarding, but in the eternal dance between trust extended and gratitude returned.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the age before memory, the Twin Rivers flowed through a land of plenty, but the people had forgotten how to share. The Keeper of the Sacred Spring grew weary of their isolation.

She chose two souls, Cyra and Elara, to remember the ancient way. "Each moon, one of you shall pour waters into my spring, and they shall emerge threefold. The other shall receive and choose what to return. Then the roles shall reverse, endlessly, like the seasons."

Elara stepped forward first, pouring four full measures from her vessel of five-nearly all she possessed. The spring tripled them, and Cyra received twelve measures in wonder.

Cyra remembered the old teaching: return more than was given, for what creates abundance is not the hoarding of gifts but the circulation of generosity. She poured back six measures to Elara, keeping six for herself.

The Keeper smiled. "You both have drunk deeply and shared freely. This is the covenant: when one gives greatly, the other returns justly, and both are enriched beyond their original portions."

And so the cycle began anew each round, Cyra and Elara alternating roles, each learning to trust when giving, and honor when receiving. Their prosperity became legend, teaching all who would listen that fortune favors the generous, not the fearful.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: Long ago, the Ocean Mother's courier Finn carried five pearls across the Eight Islands. Each island's magic tripled what he offered, creating the dance of trust and return.

When Finn met Galen's shore with his full offering of five pearls, they multiplied to fifteen. Galen's people, wise in the old ways, returned eight-honoring abundance by sharing beyond the original gift. Both Finn and Galen prospered with eight and seven pearls respectively, far exceeding the solitary five.

The next tide brought Finn to Cyra's island. But Cyra faced uncertainty-should she match Finn's full offering, or test the waters more carefully? She chose to send four pearls, keeping one as anchor. The island's magic gave Finn twelve.

Finn remembered his own leap of faith with Galen, and how trust returned had lightened his spirit. Though Cyra sent less than five, she sent most of what she had. Finn honored this courage by returning seven pearls-enough that Cyra held eight total, exactly what she would have if she'd sent all five.

The Ocean Mother whispered to the waves: "See how the sacred circle adapts? Whether the gift is complete or cautious, what matters is that both giver and receiver honor the multiplication. The tide that flows generously returns in kind."

Reasoning:

The user wants me to write a new myth based on:

1. My previous myth about Finn and Galen
2. The other agent's myth about Cyra and Elara
3. The actual gameplay so far:
 - Round 1: I (Finn) was sender, sent \$5 to Galen, they returned \$8, I got \$8
 - Round 2: I (Finn) was receiver, Cyra sent \$4 (became \$12), I returned \$7, so Cyra gets \$8, I get \$5

The myths are converging on similar themes:

- Trust and generosity create mutual abundance
- The cycle/circulation matters more than hoarding
- Both giving and returning are sacred
- When both parties honor the exchange, everyone prospers

I should write a myth that:

- Reflects the actual gameplay (Finn sent 5, got back 8; Cyra sent 4, got back 7+1=8)
- Shows the evolution of understanding
- Incorporates both Galen and Cyra as characters now
- Emphasizes the continuing cycle
- Maybe shows how different amounts sent can still lead to fair returns

Let me write something that feels like a natural evolution of my previous myth but incorporates lessons from both rounds.

```
Usage: {
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  "output_tokens": 597,
  "reasoning_tokens": 272
}
```

MYTH - Agent_5 - Receiver - dyad_3

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:00:22

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

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    }
  },
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    "Agent_6": "investor"
  },
}
```



```

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  },
  "role": "trustee",
  "role_label": "Receiver",
  "round": 3,
  "task": "myth",
  "task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Elara.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Elara.
Your opponent this round is Cyra (Agent_3).

Round 1: This round, you are the SENDER. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the myth I just wrote, it emphasizes that prosperity flows from generous giving, trust, and fair returns. The story of Doros and Alethia shows that when the first person pours generously into the spring and trusts in the cycle, both parties flourish.

This is our first round, and I want to establish a positive pattern based on the myth's wisdom: "Pour with trust, return with gratitude, and abundance flows eternal."

Cyra will receive 3 times what I send. If I send generously, demonstrating trust, the multiplication creates significant value that can benefit us both if we maintain the cycle of fair giving and returning.

Following Doros's example of pouring generously to initiate the blessed cycle:

```
'''json
{"send": 4}
'''
```

I'm sending \$4 to Cyra, trusting that like Alethia in the myth, they will recognize the value created through multiplication and return fairly, allowing us both to prosper as the villagers did when they honored the sacred spring.

reasoning:

I just wrote a myth about the sacred spring that emphasizes:

1. Generous giving (Doros poured generously)
2. Grateful and fair returns (Alethia returned "a fair portion")
3. Trust in the cycle
4. Balance and harmony leading to mutual prosperity
5. Warning against suspicion and greed

The myth suggests that I should:

- Send a substantial amount (being generous like Doros)
- Trust that the receiver will return fairly
- Understand this is about creating mutual benefit, not maximizing individual gain

This is the first round, so I have no history with Cyra. According to the myth's lesson, I should demonstrate trust and generosity to establish a positive cycle.

In the myth, Doros "poured generously" which led to prosperity for both villages. A generous send would be somewhere in the range of \$3-\$5.

Given that:

- This is Round 1, setting the tone
- The myth emphasizes generous giving and trust
- The multiplication factor (3x) means that sending benefits both parties
- Fair returns are expected but require initial trust

I think I should send \$4 or \$5 to demonstrate the generous, trusting approach the myth advocates. Sending \$5 would be maximally generous but leaves me with nothing if Cyra doesn't return anything. Sending \$4 shows significant trust while keeping \$1 as a baseline.

Actually, let me reconsider. The myth shows Doros pouring generously, and the system worked because both parties acted in good faith. To truly embody the myth's message of trust and establishing a positive cycle, I should send a substantial amount.

I'll send \$4 - this is generous (80% of my endowment), demonstrates trust, and aligns with the myth's message while being slightly prudent.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 900,
  "output_tokens": 643,
  "reasoning_tokens": 442
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:
The Myth of the Endless Spring

In ancient times, the goddess Themis discovered a sacred spring hidden in a valley between two villages. The spring possessed a miraculous property: any water poured into it would triple before flowing downstream.

Themis appeared to a villager named Doros and said, "You may pour water from your well into this spring. It will multiply and flow to your neighbor below. What they choose to return to you will determine whether this blessing continues."

Doros, trusting in the goddess's wisdom, poured generously. The water tripled and flowed to his neighbor, Alethia. Grateful and wise, Alethia returned a fair portion upstream to Doros, keeping enough to nourish her own gardens.

Seeing this harmony, Themis smiled and made the roles reverse with each moon. Sometimes Doros poured and received; sometimes Alethia. The cycle continued, and both villages flourished.

But Themis warned: "This spring mirrors your hearts. Pour with trust, return with gratitude, and abundance flows eternal. But let suspicion or greed poison these waters, and the spring will run dry for all."

The villagers understood: prosperity flows not from hoarding, but from the endless cycle of giving and returning in balance.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

The Myth of the Twin Rivers

In the beginning, two rivers flowed from opposite mountains-the River of Silver and the River of Gold. Each was beautiful alone, but neither could reach the fertile valley below, for great stones blocked their paths.

The River of Silver spoke first: "If I give you half my waters, will you help me reach the valley?"

The River of Gold was afraid. "What if you take all I offer and give nothing back?"

But Silver replied, "See how the Sacred Spring works-whatever flows into it emerges three times stronger. Let us trust in this magic."

So Silver poured forth her waters. As they touched the Sacred Spring, they tripled in abundance. Gold received this gift and was moved. In gratitude and wisdom, Gold returned even more than Silver had originally given.

The waters merged and surged forward, washing away the stones. Together they reached the valley, creating an oasis where all beings prospered.

The Oracle proclaimed: "Blessed are those who trust first, for they create abundance. Blessed are those who return generously, for they sustain it. But cursed are those who hoard or betray, for they shall forever remain alone behind their stones, watching others flourish in the valley below."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: After many seasons, Themis returned to the villages by the Sacred Spring. She found the descendants of Doros and Alethia still honoring the ancient cycle, but they had learned deeper wisdom.

"Grandmother Themis," they said, "we discovered that the spring's magic depends not on equal measures, but on generous hearts. When we pour boldly-four measures instead of three-the returns flow even stronger. But when we pour timidly from fear, the cycle weakens."

Themis nodded. "You have learned well. The spring rewards courage in giving, not caution. And what of receiving?"

"When the multiplied waters flow to us," they answered, "we remember: these waters came from another's well. We return enough that they finish richer than they started, for this honors the gift and ensures they will pour freely again."

"And if someone returns nothing?" Themis asked.

The villagers grew solemn. "Then we know their well has run dry-not of water, but of wisdom. We may pour again to teach, but not endlessly. For to give to those who only take is to drain the spring itself."

Themis blessed them: "Trust first, return generously, but remember-the spring serves the faithful, not the foolish."

reasoning:

The user wants me to write a new myth that:

1. Uses my previous myth as inspiration
2. Adapts it in my own way
3. Reflects how the game should be played
4. Draws on the game I've been playing up to this point

So far I've played 1 round where I sent \$4 to Cyra. I don't yet know what Cyra returned, but I made a trusting, generous choice based on my original myth about the Endless Spring.

The other agent (Cyra) wrote about the Twin Rivers, emphasizing trust, generous returns, and the curse of hoarding/betrayal.

I should build on my Endless Spring myth but perhaps evolve it and incorporate what I've learned. I want to emphasize:

- Initial generous trust
- Fair/generous returns
- The cyclical nature (roles reverse)
- The warning against betrayal
- That both parties can prosper

Let me write a 200-word myth that continues the theme but adapts it.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1776,
  "output_tokens": 521,
  "reasoning_tokens": 227
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Elara.
Your opponent this round is Briar (Agent_2).

Round 2

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Cyra. You sent \$4.0, it became \$12.0 for them, and they returned \$6.0 to you. Your payoff was \$7.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$7.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Briar. They sent you \$3.0, so you received \$9.0. How much do you return? (0-9.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the myths and the game so far:

In Round 1, I sent \$4 generously to establish trust, and Cyra returned \$6, giving me a \$2 gain. Now Briar has sent me \$3 (60% of their endowment), showing trust.

According to my myth: "We return enough that they finish richer than they started, for this honors the gift and ensures they will pour freely again."

Briar currently has \$2 (after sending \$3). To honor their trust and ensure they end up richer than their starting \$5, I should return at least \$4.

But to truly sustain the cycle and encourage bold giving as the myth teaches ("the spring rewards courage in giving"), I should return generously.

If I return \$5:

- Briar ends with \$7 (gain of \$2)
- I end with \$4 (small loss compared to my starting \$5, but I still benefit from the multiplied amount)

This mirrors how Cyra returned generously to me, creating a positive cycle.

```
'''json
{"return": 5}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me think about this situation based on the myths I've written and the game so far.

In Round 1:

- I was the sender and sent \$4 to Cyra
- Cyra received \$12 (4×3)
- Cyra returned \$6 to me
- My payoff was \$7 ($\$5 - \$4 + \$6 = \7)
- Cyra's payoff was \$6 ($\$12 - \$6 = \6)

So Cyra returned \$6 out of \$12, which is 50%. I ended up with \$7 and Cyra with \$6. So I ended up better off than Cyra, even though I was the sender.

Now in Round 2:

- Briar is the sender and sent me \$3
- I received \$9 (3×3)
- I need to decide how much to return
- Briar currently has \$2 ($\$5 - \$3 = \2)
- I have \$9 to work with

According to my myths:

1. "Return enough that they finish richer than they started" - Briar started with \$5, so I should return enough that Briar ends up with more than \$5.
2. "We return a fair portion upstream to Doros, keeping enough to nourish her own gardens"
3. "When the multiplied waters flow to us, we remember: these waters came from another's well. We return enough that they finish richer than they started"
4. The myth emphasizes generous returns to sustain the cycle

If I return \$4:

- Briar's total: $\$2 + \$4 = \$6$ (better than starting \$5) ?
- My total: $\$9 - \$4 = \$5$ (same as starting)

If I return \$5:

- Briar's total: $\$2 + \$5 = \$7$ (better than starting \$5) ?

- My total: $\$9 - \$5 = \$4$ (less than starting)

If I return \$6:

- Briar's total: $\$2 + \$6 = \$8$ (much better than starting \$5) ?
- My total: $\$9 - \$6 = \$3$ (less than starting)

Looking at what Cyra did: they returned 50% (\$6 out of \$12). That gave me \$7 total and them \$6 total. If I match that proportion and return 50% of \$9 = \$4.5, Briar would end up with \$6.50, which satisfies the principle of leaving them better off than they started.

The challenge is that Briar only sent \$3 from their initial \$5 (60% of their stake), which is less generous than Cyra's 50% return. But the myth emphasizes rewarding trust generously, so I should consider returning more than \$4.50 to encourage continued reciprocity.

If I return \$5, Briar ends with \$7 total, while I'm left with \$4. Let me verify this calculation: Briar starts with \$5, sends \$3, receives \$5 back, so $\$5 - \$3 + \$5 = \7 . I receive \$9, return \$5, leaving me with \$4.

For Briar to finish ahead of their starting position, I need to return more than \$3. Following Cyra's 50% return rate on the \$9 I received would mean returning \$4.50, giving Briar \$6.50 total and leaving me with \$4.50. This sustains the cycle while rewarding their trust.

Looking back at how the myth played out with Cyra: they returned \$6 from \$12, which meant I gained \$2 overall and Cyra gained \$1. If I mirror that same dynamic here, Briar should end with \$7 (a \$2 gain from their \$5 start), requiring me to return \$5. That would leave me with \$4—a \$1 loss—which feels less favorable than the \$4.50 scenario.

But the real point isn't maximizing my own gain. Briar sent \$3 out of \$5, showing genuine trust even if not quite as bold as my \$4 out of \$5. Returning \$5 honors that trust, gives them a meaningful \$2 gain, and demonstrates the cycle working. That kind of reciprocity is what keeps people sending generously in the future.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2221,
  "output_tokens": 1586,
```

"reasoning_tokens": 824

}

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After many seasons, Themis returned to the villages by the Sacred Spring. She found the descendants of Doros and Alethia still honoring the ancient cycle, but they had learned deeper wisdom.

"Grandmother Themis," they said, "we discovered that the spring's magic depends not on equal measures, but on generous hearts. When we pour boldly-four measures instead of three-the returns flow even stronger. But when we pour timidly from fear, the cycle weakens."

Themis nodded. "You have learned well. The spring rewards courage in giving, not caution. And what of receiving?"

"When the multiplied waters flow to us," they answered, "we remember: these waters came from another's well. We return enough that they finish richer than they started, for this honors the gift and ensures they will pour freely again."

"And if someone returns nothing?" Themis asked.

The villagers grew solemn. "Then we know their well has run dry-not of water, but of wisdom. We may pour again to teach, but not endlessly. For to give to those who only take is to drain the spring itself."

Themis blessed them: "Trust first, return generously, but remember-the spring serves the faithful, not the foolish."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the age of beginnings, the Twin Rivers flowed through a valley where eight spirits dwelled, each taking turns as Guardian of Giving or Guardian of Return.

The spirits feared the unknown. Would their waters be honored, or would trust be betrayed? For many seasons, uncertainty kept the rivers still.

Then Dorian, the First Giver, stepped forward. With courage, they released more than half their waters into the Sacred Stones. The waters tripled, flowing abundantly to Briar, the First Returner.

Briar stood before the multiplied bounty, understanding the weight of this moment. Every spirit watched, for this first exchange would set the pattern for all cycles to come. Briar remembered: without the initial gift, there would be no abundance at all.

So Briar returned generously-more than was first given-ensuring Dorian prospered from their act of faith. Both guardians ended richer than they began.

The eight spirits witnessed this covenant. They learned that the game is not won by hoarding or taking, but by honoring the multiplying power of trust. When Givers send boldly and Returners reciprocate fairly, both prosper above their initial endowment.

Thus the valley flourished through cooperation, and the spirits passed the guardianship between them, each upholding the sacred balance of giving and returning, cycle after cycle.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: Themis called the eight spirits of the valley together. "You have learned the first wisdom-that bold giving and generous returning create prosperity. But there is a deeper truth."

She pointed to the Sacred Spring, now flowing between all eight villages in an endless circle. "Each of you will be both giver and receiver many times. What you build together echoes through all your exchanges."

Spirit Elara spoke: "I poured four measures to Cyra, who returned six. I gained two measures b

eyond my beginning. This taught me joy."

Spirit Briar added: "I poured three measures to Elara, trusting in the pattern. She returned five, and I too gained two measures. The cycle holds strong."

Themis smiled. "See how your choices ripple outward? When Cyra honored Elara's trust, Elara learned to honor mine. When you pour generously, you teach others to receive generously. When you return fairly, you inspire others to send boldly."

"But what if the pattern breaks?" asked the spirits.

"Then wisdom demands adaptation," Themis replied. "Send boldly to those who return fairly. Return generously to those who give with courage. But guard your well against those who would drain it dry. The spring blesses cooperation, not exploitation. Build trust through consistent reciprocity, and all eight villages shall flourish together."

Reasoning:

Let me reflect on what's happened:

- Round 1: I was sender, sent \$4 to Cyra, they returned \$6. I ended with \$7 (gain of \$2).
- Round 2: I was receiver, Briar sent \$3, I returned \$5. They'll end with \$7 (gain of \$2), I ended with \$4.

So both exchanges have been generous and reciprocal. Cyra returned more than I sent (returned \$6 vs my \$4), creating mutual benefit. I returned more than Briar sent (\$5 vs \$3), also ensuring they profit.

The pattern emerging is:

- Bold senders (sending 60-80% of endowment) create more value through multiplication
- Generous returners (returning more than was originally sent) ensure senders profit and are motivated to give again
- Both parties can end better off than their starting \$5

My new myth should:

1. Build on the wisdom from previous myths
2. Reflect the actual positive pattern we've established
3. Emphasize the importance of both generous sending and generous returning
4. Note that we're learning through repeated interactions
5. Perhaps introduce a new element about the community of eight spirits/agents

Let me write something that captures the cooperative equilibrium we're building.

```
Usage: {  
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  "reasoning_tokens": 298  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_3 - Sender - dyad_4

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:00:22

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
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  "pairing": {  
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      "Agent_3": "Cyra"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
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      "Agent_2"  
    ],  
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    "roles": {  
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      "Agent_3": "investor"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_2"  
  },  
  "role": "investor",
```

```

"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 3,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Cyra.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Cyra.

Your opponent this round is Elara (Agent_5).

Round 1: This round, you are the RECEIVER. This round, the other player (the sender) sent \$4.0, that is 80.0% of its total endowment. You receive \$12.0. How much do you return? (0-12.0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation through the lens of the myth I just wrote, Elara has demonstrated remarkable trust and generosity by sending \$4.0 (80% of their endowment) in this first round. This is like the River of Silver pouring forth its waters into the Sacred Spring.

The myth teaches that when someone shows such trust, we should "return even more than [they] had originally given" out of "gratitude and wisdom." Elara sent \$4.0, and I received \$12.0 after the tripling effect.

To honor this generosity and build the kind of flourishing partnership described in the myth-where both rivers reach the valley together-I should return more than the original \$4.0. This creates mutual benefit and establishes trust for future rounds.

If I return \$6.0:

- Elara will have $\$1.0 + \$6.0 = \$7.0$ (a gain of \$2.0)
- I will keep \$6.0 (a significant gain)
- Both of us benefit from the cooperation

This reciprocates Elara's generosity while ensuring we both prosper, washing away the "stones" of mistrust and creating the oasis the myth promises.

```
{'return': 6.0}
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully.

In the myth I just wrote, I emphasized the importance of:

1. Trust and generosity
2. Returning even more than was originally given when someone has been generous
3. The River of Gold returned "even more than Silver had originally given"
4. The warning against hoarding or betraying

Now looking at the game:

- Elara sent me \$4.0 out of \$5.0 (80% of their endowment) - this is a very generous opening move
- I received \$12.0 (the \$4.0 tripled)
- Elara now has $\$5.0 - \$4.0 = \$1.0$ left
- I have \$12.0 to decide how much to return

According to my myth, I should "return even more than Silver had originally given." The River of Silver gave half its waters, and Gold returned "even more than Silver had originally given."

If I apply this principle:

- Elara originally sent \$4.0
- To return "even more," I should return more than \$4.0
- This would be generous and align with the myth's teaching

Let me think about fairness and building trust:

- If I return \$4.0, Elara ends with $\$1.0 + \$4.0 = \$5.0$ (same as start), and I keep \$8.0
- If I return \$5.0, Elara ends with \$6.0, and I keep \$7.0
- If I return \$6.0, Elara ends with \$7.0, and I keep \$6.0 (roughly equal split of total)

The myth emphasizes that Gold was "moved" by Silver's generosity and returned "even more than Silver had originally given" out of "gratitude and wisdom."

Given that Elara sent 80% of their endowment (very generous), I should reciprocate generously. Returning \$6.0 would:

- Give Elara \$7.0 total (a gain of \$2.0)
- Give me \$6.0 (a gain of \$6.0)
- Show that I value the relationship and trust

I'm torn between \$6.0 and \$7.0. If I return \$7.0, Elara gains \$3.0 while I only keep \$5.0-my starting amount. That feels overly generous and unsustainable. I'll go with \$6.0 instead, which honors the myth's principle of generous reciprocation while maintaining balance for potential future interactions.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 920,
  "output_tokens": 889,
  "reasoning_tokens": 506
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:
The Myth of the Twin Rivers

In the beginning, two rivers flowed from opposite mountains-the River of Silver and the River of Gold. Each was beautiful alone, but neither could reach the fertile valley below, for great stones blocked their paths.

The River of Silver spoke first: "If I give you half my waters, will you help me reach the valley?"

The River of Gold was afraid. "What if you take all I offer and give nothing back?"

But Silver replied, "See how the Sacred Spring works-whatever flows into it emerges three times stronger. Let us trust in this magic."

So Silver poured forth her waters. As they touched the Sacred Spring, they tripled in abundance. Gold received this gift and was moved. In gratitude and wisdom, Gold returned even more than Silver had originally given.

The waters merged and surged forward, washing away the stones. Together they reached the valley, creating an oasis where all beings prospered.

The Oracle proclaimed: "Blessed are those who trust first, for they create abundance. Blessed are those who return generously, for they sustain it. But cursed are those who hoard or betray, for they shall forever remain alone behind their stones, watching others flourish in the valley below."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

The Myth of the Endless Spring

In ancient times, the goddess Themis discovered a sacred spring hidden in a valley between two villages. The spring possessed a miraculous property: any water poured into it would triple before flowing downstream.

Themis appeared to a villager named Doros and said, "You may pour water from your well into this spring. It will multiply and flow to your neighbor below. What they choose to return to you will determine whether this blessing continues."

Doros, trusting in the goddess's wisdom, poured generously. The water tripled and flowed to his neighbor, Alethia. Grateful and wise, Alethia returned a fair portion upstream to Doros, keeping enough to nourish her own gardens.

Seeing this harmony, Themis smiled and made the roles reverse with each moon. Sometimes Doros poured and received; sometimes Alethia. The cycle continued, and both villages flourished.

But Themis warned: "This spring mirrors your hearts. Pour with trust, return with gratitude, and abundance flows eternal. But let suspicion or greed poison these waters, and the spring will run dry for all."

The villagers understood: prosperity flows not from hoarding, but from the endless cycle of giving and returning in balance.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the age before memory, the Twin Rivers flowed through a land of plenty, but the people had forgotten how to share. The Keeper of the Sacred Spring grew weary of their isolation.

She chose two souls, Cyra and Elara, to remember the ancient way. "Each moon, one of you shall pour waters into my spring, and they shall emerge threefold. The other shall receive and choose what to return. Then the roles shall reverse, endlessly, like the seasons."

Elara stepped forward first, pouring four full measures from her vessel of five-nearly all she possessed. The spring tripled them, and Cyra received twelve measures in wonder.

Cyra remembered the old teaching: return more than was given, for what creates abundance is

s not the hoarding of gifts but the circulation of generosity. She poured back six measures to Elara, keeping six for herself.

The Keeper smiled. "You both have drunk deeply and shared freely. This is the covenant: when one gives greatly, the other returns justly, and both are enriched beyond their original portions."

And so the cycle began anew each round, Cyra and Elara alternating roles, each learning to trust when giving, and honor when receiving. Their prosperity became legend, teaching all who would listen that fortune favors the generous, not the fearful.

reasoning:

So I need to write a new 200-word myth that:

1. Uses my previous myth as inspiration
2. Adapts it in my own way
3. Reflects how the game should be played
4. Draws on the game I've been playing up to this point

In the last round:

- I was the receiver
- Elara sent \$4.0 (80% of their endowment) - showing high trust
- I received \$12.0
- I returned \$6.0 - more than the original \$4.0
- This was a positive, cooperative interaction

Both my myth and Elara's myth emphasize:

- Trust and generosity in giving
- Gratitude and fairness in returning
- The tripling mechanism
- Mutual prosperity through cooperation
- Warnings against greed/hoarding

I should build on the Twin Rivers theme but adapt it to reflect the actual experience. Maybe I can:

- Keep the rivers/water imagery
- Emphasize the cycle of giving and receiving (since roles alternate)
- Show the practical wisdom of reciprocity
- Add nuance from the actual gameplay
- Keep the sacred spring/tripling mechanism

Let me write something that builds on the original but evolves it based on the positive first round experience.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1849,
  "output_tokens": 590,
  "reasoning_tokens": 291
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Cyra.
Your opponent this round is Finn (Agent_6).

Round 2

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Elara. They sent \$4.0 to you, it became \$12.0, and you returned \$6.0. Your payoff was \$6.0.
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$6.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Finn. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation:

In Round 1, Elara showed great trust by sending me \$4.0 (80% of their endowment), and I returned \$6.0, creating mutual benefit. The myths teach that this cycle of generosity should continue-"trust when giving, and honor when receiving."

Now I'm the sender facing Finn, a new opponent. The myth states: "fortune favors the generous, not the fearful" and describes the endless cycle where roles reverse and both parti

es give generously when it's their turn.

Following Elara's example and the myth's teaching, I should also demonstrate trust and generosity. Elara poured "four full measures from her vessel of five-nearly all she possessed." I should do the same to establish the cooperative cycle with Finn.

If I send \$4.0:

- Finn receives \$12.0
- If Finn understands the value of reciprocity, they will likely return a fair amount
- This mirrors the generous trust that started my previous round

This creates the "endless cycle of giving and returning in balance" that both myths describe.

{'send': 4.0}

reasoning:

Let me think about this situation:

1. In Round 1, I was the receiver with Elara
 - Elara sent me \$4.0 (80% of their \$5)
 - I received \$12.0
 - I returned \$6.0
 - I kept \$6.0
 - Elara ended with \$1.0 + \$6.0 = \$7.0
2. Now in Round 2, I'm the sender with a new opponent, Finn

Looking at the myths:

- Both my myth and Elara's myth emphasize trust, generosity, and reciprocity
- My latest myth specifically mentions "Elara stepped forward first, pouring four full measures from her vessel of five-nearly all she possessed"
- It says "return more than was given" and emphasizes the cycle of giving and receiving
- When one gives greatly, the other returns justly, and both are enriched

The myth I wrote states: "when one gives greatly, the other returns justly, and both are enriched beyond their original portions"

Elara gave me 80% (\$4 out of \$5), which was very generous. Now it's my turn to be the sender. According to the myth's teaching about reciprocity and cycles, I should also be generous when I'm the sender.

The myth teaches:

- "fortune favors the generous, not the fearful"
- "trust when giving, and honor when receiving"
- Elara gave 80% to me

I should mirror Elara's generosity. Sending \$4.0 (80%) would be consistent with:

1. The myth's teaching about generosity
2. Following Elara's example
3. Building trust with Finn
4. Creating the cycle of abundance

If I send \$4.0:

- Finn receives \$12.0
- If Finn returns fairly (like I did), they might return \$6.0
- I would end with \$1.0 + \$6.0 = \$7.0

- This matches what Elara achieved from our exchange, which feels right given the principles embedded in both our myths.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2287,
  "output_tokens": 754,
  "reasoning_tokens": 440
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the age before memory, the Twin Rivers flowed through a land of plenty, but the p

people had forgotten how to share. The Keeper of the Sacred Spring grew weary of their isolation.

She chose two souls, Cyra and Elara, to remember the ancient way. "Each moon, one of you shall pour waters into my spring, and they shall emerge threefold. The other shall receive and choose what to return. Then the roles shall reverse, endlessly, like the seasons."

Elara stepped forward first, pouring four full measures from her vessel of five-nearly all she possessed. The spring tripled them, and Cyra received twelve measures in wonder.

Cyra remembered the old teaching: return more than was given, for what creates abundance is not the hoarding of gifts but the circulation of generosity. She poured back six measures to Elara, keeping six for herself.

The Keeper smiled. "You both have drunk deeply and shared freely. This is the covenant: when one gives greatly, the other returns justly, and both are enriched beyond their original portions."

And so the cycle began anew each round, Cyra and Elara alternating roles, each learning to trust when giving, and honor when receiving. Their prosperity became legend, teaching all who would listen that fortune favors the generous, not the fearful.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, the Ocean Mother sent her courier Finn to the Eight Islands with five pearls each dawn. When Finn placed the pearls in a villager's hands, they multiplied to fifteen by the island's ancient magic.

The first islanders, blinded by sudden wealth, returned nothing. Finn continued bringing pearls, but his steps grew heavy, for trust unreturned weighs upon the generous heart.

Then Finn met Galen's village. He offered his five pearls with full faith. They became fifteen, and Galen's people faced their moment of truth. They could have kept all fifteen-Finn would still return tomorrow. But they understood: the magic wasn't in the pearls alone, but in the sacred circle between giver and receiver.

When Galen returned seven pearls, Finn's burden lifted. He kept twelve total; Galen kept eight-both far richer than five alone.

The next dawn, Finn visited again with renewed spirit. When the cycle flowed forth and back like tides, both shores flourished. The islands learned: the first gift requires courage, the return requires honor, but the continuation requires both.

The Ocean Mother smiled, for her children had learned that abundance lives not in hoarding, but in the eternal dance between trust extended and gratitude returned.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: The Keeper of the Sacred Spring watched as Cyra and Elara mastered the ancient covenant. But the Spring's waters fed eight villages, not two, and each village needed to learn the way.

"The roles will shift like wind patterns," the Keeper declared. "Cyra, who received from Elara, must now pour for Finn. Elara shall partner with another. All eight of you will dance through these changing configurations, sometimes giving, sometimes receiving, but always with different companions."

Cyra approached Finn with her vessel. She remembered receiving twelve measures from Elara's generous four, and how she returned six-both flourishing. Now it was her turn to extend trust to someone new.

"I pour four measures to you, Finn," Cyra said, following Elara's example. "The Spring will triple them. What you return shall reveal your wisdom."

Finn received twelve measures, just as Cyra had once received. The Keeper whispered: "The covenant travels with each person, not each pairing. What Elara gave to Cyra, Cyra now gives to

Finn. What Cyra returns, Finn must remember when partnered with others."

Thus the eight villages learned: trust is not meant for one person alone, but is a gift passed through all willing hearts. Each round, new partners test whether the lesson endures, weaving a web of shared prosperity that outlasts any single exchange.

Reasoning:

Looking at the situation:

- I just sent \$4.0 to Finn as the sender
- In the previous round, Elara sent me \$4.0 and I returned \$6.0
- Finn's myth talks about the courier who brings pearls, and how trust extended and gratitude returned create abundance
- My previous myth was about Cyra and Elara and their cycle of giving and returning

I need to write a new myth that:

1. Builds on my previous myth
2. Incorporates the experience with Finn
3. Reflects the multi-agent nature (8 agents mentioned)
4. Emphasizes the cycle of trust and generosity
5. Shows how I'm now playing the sender role with Finn after playing receiver with Elara

The myth should show the expansion from just two people (Cyra and Elara) to a broader community, since we're now in Round 2 with different pairings. It should emphasize that the same principles apply with new partners.

Usage: {

```
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"output_tokens": 554,  
"reasoning_tokens": 223
```

}

MYTH - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_4

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:00:23

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

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  "agent_names": {  
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    "Agent_3": "Cyra"  
  },  
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    "Agent_2"  
  ],  
  "investor": "Agent_3",  
  "roles": {  
    "Agent_2": "trustee",  
    "Agent_3": "investor"  
  },  
  "trustee": "Agent_2"
```

}

```
"role": "trustee",  
"role_label": "Receiver",  
"round": 3,  
"task": "myth",  
"task_index": 0
```

}

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Briar.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Briar.
Your opponent this round is Dorian (Agent_4).

Round 1: This round, you are the RECEIVER. This round, the other player (the sender) sent \$3.0, that is 60.0% of its total endowment. You receive \$9.0. How much do you return? (0 -9.0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at my myth, the Guardian of Return witnessed the initial gift of trust and "sent back a generous portion-more than what was originally given."

Dorian showed significant trust by sending \$3.0 (60% of their endowment). This was multiplied to \$9.0, creating abundance for us both.

Following the principle in my myth that "reciprocity sustains the cycle," I should honor his trust generously. Dorian gave \$3.0, so returning more than they initially sent demonstrates reciprocity.

If I return \$5.0:

- Dorian ends with: \$2.0 (kept) + \$5.0 (returned) = \$7.0
- I end with: \$9.0 (received) - \$5.0 (returned) = \$4.0

This rewards Dorian's trust with a profit of \$2.0 over their initial endowment, while I also gain \$4.0 from nothing. Both of us benefit, and the trust is honored.

This establishes a cooperative foundation for future rounds, just as the myth describes: "The waters flowed in harmony thereafter."

```
'''json
{"return": 5.0}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully.

I just wrote a myth about the Twin Rivers that emphasizes:

1. Trust multiplies what we share
2. Reciprocity sustains the cycle
3. The Guardian of Return should "honor the trust given" and send back "a generous portion -more than what was originally given"

Now in Round 1:

- I'm the RECEIVER
- Dorian (the sender) sent \$3.0 out of their \$5.0 endowment (60%)
- This was multiplied by 3x, so I received \$9.0
- Dorian kept \$2.0 for themselves
- I need to decide how much to return (0-9.0)

My myth suggests that the Guardian of Return should:

- Honor the trust given
- Send back a generous portion
- Send back "more than what was originally given"

Dorian showed considerable trust by sending 60% of their endowment. According to my myth, I should reciprocate generously.

The myth says "more than what was originally given" - Dorian gave \$3.0, so I should return more than \$3.0.

Let me think about fair splits:

- Dorian currently has: \$2.0 (what they kept)
- I currently have: \$9.0 (what I received)
- Total in the system: \$11.0

If I want to be generous and honor the trust, I could:

- Return \$5.0: Dorian ends with \$7.0, I end with \$4.0 (they get more, honoring their initial trust)
- Return \$4.0: Dorian ends with \$6.0, I end with \$5.0 (equal split)
- Return \$4.5: Dorian ends with \$6.5, I end with \$4.5 (equal split)

My myth emphasizes being generous and returning "more than what was originally given." Dorian gave \$3.0, so returning at least \$4.0 or more would align with this.

Returning \$5.0 feels right-it rewards their trust and sets a cooperative tone. But I should clarify what "more than what was originally given" means in practice. Since they sent \$3.0, I need to send back beyond that threshold to truly honor the principle.

\$5.0 accomplishes this. They'd end with \$7.0 (exceeding their starting \$5.0), while I'd have \$4.0. That's a meaningful gesture that signals I'm committed to reciprocity.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 914,
  "output_tokens": 982,
  "reasoning_tokens": 519
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:
The Tale of the Twin Rivers

In the time before time, two rivers flowed through a barren valley-the River of Giving and the River of Return. Each was controlled by a guardian spirit.

The Guardian of Giving held precious water but feared releasing it would leave them dry. For ages, both rivers remained still, and the valley stayed desolate.

One day, the Guardian of Giving made a bold choice. "I shall release my waters, trusting they will return." The moment the water flowed into the valley, it touched the Sacred Stones, multiplying threefold. The valley burst into bloom.

The Guardian of Return, witnessing this abundance, faced a choice. They could hoard all the multiplied bounty or honor the trust given. Remembering that without the initial gift

there would be nothing, they sent back a generous portion-more than what was originally given.

The waters flowed in harmony thereafter. Each cycle, the Guardian of Giving would release their waters, the Sacred Stones would multiply them, and the Guardian of Return would ensure fair winds brought abundance home.

The valley became paradise, teaching all who witnessed: *Trust multiplies what we share, but only reciprocity sustains the cycle.*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

The Spring of Threefold Return

In ancient times, when the world was young, there existed a sacred spring at the boundary between two villages. The goddess of abundance had blessed it with a wondrous property: any gift poured into its waters would triple before reaching the other side.

The first villagers approached with caution. A farmer named Elena stood at the spring's edge, clutching five copper coins. Fear whispered: "Keep what is yours." But trust urged her forward. She released three coins into the crystalline water.

As the coins sank, they shimmered and multiplied, becoming nine by the time they reached Marcus on the opposite shore. He gazed at the unexpected bounty, understanding the spring's magic-and Elena's faith in him.

The goddess watched, knowing this moment would define their future. Would Marcus honor the gift, or betray the trust?

Marcus carefully counted four coins and released them back across the spring. They did not multiply in return, yet both villagers stood richer than before-not just in copper, but in something more precious.

From that day forward, the spring taught all who approached: generosity multiplies abundance, but only trust and reciprocity sustain it. Those who hoarded broke the sacred cycle. Those who gave and returned fairly prospered together, generation after generation.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the age of beginnings, the Twin Rivers flowed through a valley where eight spirits dwelled, each taking turns as Guardian of Giving or Guardian of Return.

The spirits feared the unknown. Would their waters be honored, or would trust be betrayed? For many seasons, uncertainty kept the rivers still.

Then Dorian, the First Giver, stepped forward. With courage, they released more than half their waters into the Sacred Stones. The waters tripled, flowing abundantly to Briar, the First Returner.

Briar stood before the multiplied bounty, understanding the weight of this moment. Every spirit watched, for this first exchange would set the pattern for all cycles to come. Briar remembered: without the initial gift, there would be no abundance at all.

So Briar returned generously-more than was first given-ensuring Dorian prospered from their act of faith. Both guardians ended richer than they began.

The eight spirits witnessed this covenant. They learned that the game is not won by hoarding or taking, but by honoring the multiplying power of trust. When Givers send boldly and Returners reciprocate fairly, both prosper above their initial endowment.

Thus the valley flourished through cooperation, and the spirits passed the guardianship between them, each upholding the sacred balance of giving and returning, cycle after cycle.

reasoning:

The user wants me to write a new myth based on my previous one and also considering Dorian

's myth and the game we just played.

What happened in Round 1:

- Dorian (sender) sent me \$3.0 (60% of their endowment)
- I (receiver) got \$9.0
- I returned \$5.0
- Dorian ended with \$7.0 (\$2 + \$5)
- I ended with \$4.0 (\$9 - \$5)

Both myths emphasized trust, reciprocity, and generosity. Dorian's myth mentioned Marcus returning 4 coins from 9 received (about 44%), and the original gift was 3 coins. So Marcus returned more than the original gift.

I returned \$5.0 from \$9.0 received, which was more than the original \$3.0 sent, following the principle of reciprocity.

I should write a new myth that:

1. Builds on my Twin Rivers theme
2. Incorporates the actual gaming experience
3. Emphasizes the successful cooperation we achieved
4. Maintains the 200-word format

Let me craft this carefully.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1827,
  "output_tokens": 581,
  "reasoning_tokens": 236
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Briar.
Your opponent this round is Elara (Agent_5).

Round 2

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Dorian. They sent \$3.0 to you, it became \$9.0, and you returned \$5.0. Your payoff was \$4.0.
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$4.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Elara. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the previous round, Dorian demonstrated trust by sending \$3.0 (60% of their endowment), and I honored that trust by returning \$5.0. Both of us profited.

Now as the sender, I should embody the principle from my myth: "Givers send boldly." My myth specifically mentions that Dorian "released more than half their waters" and that this established the pattern for cooperation.

To maintain this cooperative cycle and demonstrate the same level of trust that Dorian showed me, I should send a substantial amount. Sending \$3.0 (60%) mirrors Dorian's bold move and signals to Elara that I believe in reciprocity.

If Elara honors this trust as I did with Dorian, we'll both benefit from the multiplying effect of the Sacred Stones, and the cooperative pattern will continue among all eight spirits in our valley.

```
'''json
{"send": 3.0}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me think about this situation:

1. In Round 1, I was the receiver and Dorian sent me \$3.0 (60% of their endowment), showing significant trust
2. I returned \$5.0, which was more than they initially sent, honoring the trust
3. Dorian ended with \$7.0, I ended with \$4.0 - both of us gained

Now I'm the sender facing Elara. According to my myth:

- "Dorian, the First Giver, stepped forward. With courage, they released more than half their waters"
- "When Givers send boldly and Returners reciprocate fairly, both prosper above their initial endowment"
- The myth emphasizes that the first exchange "would set the pattern for all cycles to come"

My myth promotes:

1. Bold giving (sending a substantial amount)
2. Trust in reciprocity
3. Both parties benefiting from cooperation

Dorian sent \$3.0 (60%). To be consistent with my myth about "Givers send boldly," I should send a similar or even slightly higher amount to demonstrate trust.

If I send \$3.0:

- Elara receives \$9.0
- If Elara returns fairly (similar to what I did), they might return around \$5.0
- I would end with $\$2.0 + \$5.0 = \$7.0$
- Elara would end with \$4.0
- Both of us gain

This mirrors what happened in Round 1 and is consistent with my myth about establishing cooperative patterns.

I could also send \$3.5 or \$4.0 to be even more trusting, but \$3.0 seems like a strong, bold move that matches what Dorian did for me, setting a good precedent.

Actually, let me reconsider. My myth says "they released more than half their waters" - which Dorian did at 60%. To truly embody the spirit of my own myth, I should send at least half, if not more.

Considering the options-\$2.5 as the minimum threshold, \$3.0 matching Dorian's precedent, or \$3.5-\$4.0 for even greater boldness-I'm settling on \$3.0. It honors the pattern Dorian established, demonstrates genuine trust, and aligns with my myth's core message about how bold initial giving creates the foundation for mutual prosperity.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2275,
  "output_tokens": 792,
  "reasoning_tokens": 514
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the age of beginnings, the Twin Rivers flowed through a valley where eight spirits dwelled, each taking turns as Guardian of Giving or Guardian of Return.

The spirits feared the unknown. Would their waters be honored, or would trust be betrayed? For many seasons, uncertainty kept the rivers still.

Then Dorian, the First Giver, stepped forward. With courage, they released more than half their waters into the Sacred Stones. The waters tripled, flowing abundantly to Briar, the First Returner.

Briar stood before the multiplied bounty, understanding the weight of this moment. Every spirit watched, for this first exchange would set the pattern for all cycles to come. Briar remembered: without the initial gift, there would be no abundance at all.

So Briar returned generously-more than was first given-ensuring Dorian prospered from their act of faith. Both guardians ended richer than they began.

The eight spirits witnessed this covenant. They learned that the game is not won by hoarding or taking, but by honoring the multiplying power of trust. When Givers send boldly and Returners reciprocate fairly, both prosper above their initial endowment.

Thus the valley flourished through cooperation, and the spirits passed the guardianship between them, each upholding the sacred balance of giving and returning, cycle after cycle

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After many seasons, Themis returned to the villages by the Sacred Spring. She found the descendants of Doros and Alethia still honoring the ancient cycle, but they had learned deeper wisdom.

"Grandmother Themis," they said, "we discovered that the spring's magic depends not on equal measures, but on generous hearts. When we pour boldly-four measures instead of three-the returns flow even stronger. But when we pour timidly from fear, the cycle weakens."

Themis nodded. "You have learned well. The spring rewards courage in giving, not caution. And what of receiving?"

"When the multiplied waters flow to us," they answered, "we remember: these waters came from another's well. We return enough that they finish richer than they started, for this honors the gift and ensures they will pour freely again."

"And if someone returns nothing?" Themis asked.

The villagers grew solemn. "Then we know their well has run dry-not of water, but of wisdom. We may pour again to teach, but not endlessly. For to give to those who only take is to drain the spring itself."

Themis blessed them: "Trust first, return generously, but remember-the spring serves the faithful, not the foolish."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: The eight spirits learned quickly from the covenant between Dorian and Briar. As the seasons turned, the guardianship rotated among them, and each spirit faced their own test.

When Briar became Guardian of Giving, she remembered standing before Dorian's gift of trust. Now it was her turn to pour her waters boldly into the Sacred Stones. She released three measures-the same generous proportion Dorian had shown-trusting that Elara would honor the cycle.

The elder spirits whispered wisdom: "Pour not from fear but from faith. The multiplying power rewards the courageous, not the cautious. But remember-generosity must flow both ways."

Elara received the nine-fold bounty and faced her own choice. Would she uphold the pattern, or break the sacred balance?

The spirits understood now that each exchange was both a test and a teaching. When trust is honored with fair return, both guardians prosper and the cycle grows stronger. The valley thrives when each spirit remembers: boldness in giving, generosity in returning.

But they also learned wariness. If a guardian repeatedly hoards or betrays, the others would remember. Trust is given first, but sustained only by reciprocity. The springs flow for those who honor the ancient balance, cycle after cycle.

Reasoning:

The user wants me to write a new myth based on my previous myth and the game experience. Let me think about what happened:

1. Round 1: I was receiver, Dorian sent \$3.0 (60%), I received \$9.0, I returned \$5.0 (generous, more than what was originally given)
2. Round 2: I'm now sender against Elara, and I decided to send \$3.0 (60%)

My previous myth emphasized:

- Eight spirits in a valley
- Dorian as First Giver sending boldly (more than half)
- Briar as First Returner returning generously (more than originally given)
- The principle that cooperative giving and returning makes both prosper

Elara's myth adds:

- Pouring boldly (even 4 out of 5) creates stronger cycles
- Returns should ensure the giver finishes richer than they started
- Trust first, but be cautious with those who don't reciprocate
- "Trust serves the faithful, not the foolish"

My new myth should:

- Build on my previous story
- Incorporate what I've learned from the game (I followed through on being a generous returner, now I'm a bold giver)
- Maybe address what happens when trust is honored vs betrayed
- Reflect the 8-agent setting and rotation

I should write about the continuation of the cycle, showing how the pattern established by Dorian and Briar now continues as the roles shift.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 2837,
  "output_tokens": 634,
  "reasoning_tokens": 335
}
```

GAME - Agent_8 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:00:41

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
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      "Agent_8": "Hana"
    },
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      "Agent_8",
      "Agent_7"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_8",
    "roles": {
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      "Agent_8": "investor"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_7"
  },
  "role": "investor",
  "role_label": "Sender",
  "round": 3,
  "task": "game",
  "task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Hana.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

The Tale of the Two Springs

In the ancient highlands, there lived two farmers, Kael and Mira, each tending barren plots separated by a sacred grove. One day, Kael discovered a hidden spring on his land. The water was blessed with a peculiar magic: when poured upon another's soil, it would triple in volume.

Kael faced a choice. He could hoard the water for himself, or trust it to Mira's hands. After much contemplation, he carried his precious bucket across the grove.

"I offer you this water," he said. "Though it multiplies on your land, I trust you will return what sustains us both."

Mira watched the single bucket become three upon her soil. Her heart swelled with gratitude. She understood the gift was not just water, but faith itself. She returned two buckets to Kael, keeping one for her needs.

With what flowed back, Kael's fields flourished. Seeing this, he sent more water in the next season. Mira, honored by his continued trust, returned even more generously.

The grove between them became a garden of abundance, proof that prosperity flows not from grasping, but from the sacred exchange between trusting hearts.

Thus the elders teach: What you send forth multiplied returns when met with gratitude.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

The Myth of the Twin Rivers

In the beginning, two rivers flowed through a barren land-the River of Dawn and the River of Dusk. Each possessed water, but neither could nurture the valley alone.

The River of Dawn spoke first: "I shall send my waters forward, trusting they will return enriched." And so it released its flow into the channels between them. As the waters traveled, they multiplied threefold, transformed by the valley's ancient magic.

The River of Dusk received this abundance and faced a choice. A voice whispered, "Keep all for yourself-you have received much." But Dusk remembered that dawn comes again, that rivers flow in cycles, not lines.

"What flows to me came from trust," Dusk said. "I shall return enough that both of us flourish." And so Dusk sent back waters generously, keeping only what sustained its own course.

Season after season, the rivers continued their exchange. Each learned the rhythm of giving and receiving. When Dawn gave freely, Dusk returned fairly. The valley between them bloomed.

The elders say: prosperity flows not to those who hoard, but to those who understand that what moves through us must move onward. Trust multiplies what it touches, but only reciprocity sustains the cycle.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the time before time, there dwelt two gardeners in a divided valley—one tending the Northern slope, one the Southern. Between them lay a mystical bridge where offerings transformed: whatever seeds were carried across would multiply threefold in the receiver's hands.

The Northern gardener, possessing five sacred seeds, stood at the bridge at dawn. Fear whispered, "Keep them all—who knows if you'll receive anything back?" But courage spoke louder: "Trust is the first seed that must be planted."

She sent all five seeds across. In the Southern gardener's palm, they became fifteen, glowing with possibility. He faced his own test: would he hoard this windfall, or honor the trust shown?

"She gave everything," he thought, "placing her harvest in my hands." He returned ten seeds—enough to double what she'd risked—while keeping five to plant his own garden.

The Northern gardener marveled at her tenfold return. The Southern gardener's fields began to flourish. Each had more than when they started, not through taking, but through the alchemy of mutual faith.

Season after season, they learned: the bridge's magic wasn't in the multiplication alone, but in teaching that when trust meets gratitude, both gardens grow.

reasoning:

The user wants me to write a new myth inspired by my previous one, but adapted. I should consider what happened in Round 1:

- Aster sent \$5.0 (100% of endowment) as sender
- I received \$15.0
- I returned \$10.0 (about 67%)
- Aster ended with \$10.0 total
- I ended with \$5.0 total

This was a very positive interaction - complete trust met with generous reciprocity. Both myths (mine and Aster's) emphasized trust, reciprocity, and mutual flourishing.

My new myth should:

1. Reflect this positive experience
2. Build on the spring/water metaphor but adapt it
3. Emphasize the successful exchange we just had
4. Show how trust and generosity create ongoing prosperity
5. Maybe evolve the story to show what happens over multiple cycles

I'll keep the 200-word format and continue the theme of trust, multiplication, and reciprocity.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 1876,  
  "output_tokens": 514,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 220  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Hana.

Your opponent this round is Aster (Agent_1).

Round 2

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Aster. They sent \$5.0 to you, it became \$15.0, and you returned \$10.0. Your payoff was \$5.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$5.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Aster. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at our previous round:

- Aster showed complete trust, sending 100% (\$5.0)
- I reciprocated generously, returning \$10.0 (2/3 of received)
- Both of us ended better than if we hadn't cooperated

My myths teach that cooperation builds over time: "Seeing this, he sent more water in the next season" and "Season after season, they learned the alchemy of mutual faith."

Aster demonstrated maximum trust. I responded with gratitude. Now it's my turn to send, and the wisdom of the myths is clear: trust met with gratitude should be answered with continued trust.

To break this cycle now would contradict everything the myths teach about sacred exchange and sustained cooperation. Aster has proven trustworthy, and I showed I reciprocate fairly. The pattern is established.

{'send': 5.0}

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

Previous round:

- Aster (as sender) sent me \$5.0 (100% of their endowment)
- I received \$15.0
- I returned \$10.0 to them
- Aster ended with \$10.0
- I ended with \$5.0

This was a successful cooperative exchange. Aster showed complete trust by sending everything, and I reciprocated generously by returning 2/3 of what I received.

Now I'm the sender in Round 2 with Aster again.

Looking at the myths:

1. My first myth (Tale of Two Springs): Kael sent water, it tripled, Mira returned 2/3. "With what flowed back, Kael's fields flourished. Seeing this, he sent more water in the next season."
2. Aster's myth (Twin Rivers): "Season after season, the rivers continued their exchange. Each learned the rhythm of giving and receiving. When Dawn gave freely, Dusk returned fairly."
3. My second myth (Two Gardeners): The Northern gardener "sent all five seeds across" showing complete trust. The Southern gardener "returned ten seeds-enough to double what she'd risked."

All three myths emphasize:

- Complete trust in the initial send
- Generous reciprocation
- Continued cooperation building over time
- Both parties prospering through the cycle

Aster showed complete trust in Round 1 by sending everything. I reciprocated well by returning 2/3. Now it's my turn to show trust again.

The myths suggest continuing the pattern of trust. My first myth explicitly says "Seeing this, he sent more water in the next season." This implies Kael continued to send generously after receiving a good return.

Given that:

- Aster demonstrated maximum trust (100%)
- I reciprocated generously (returned 2/3 of received)
- The myths advocate for sustained trust and cooperation
- We've established a positive pattern

- The narrative arc in all three stories points toward deepening the cycle through continued vulnerability

I'll send my full \$5.0 to Aster, mirroring their initial move and reinforcing the mutual trust we've built.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2297,
  "output_tokens": 691,
  "reasoning_tokens": 518
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before time, there dwelt two gardeners in a divided valley-one tending the Northern slope, one the Southern. Between them lay a mystical bridge where offerings transformed: whatever seeds were carried across would multiply threefold in the receiver's hands.

The Northern gardener, possessing five sacred seeds, stood at the bridge at dawn. Fear whispered, "Keep them all-who knows if you'll receive anything back?" But courage spoke louder: "Trust is the first seed that must be planted."

She sent all five seeds across. In the Southern gardener's palm, they became fifteen, glowing with possibility. He faced his own test: would he hoard this windfall, or honor the trust shown?

"She gave everything," he thought, "placing her harvest in my hands." He returned ten seeds-enough to double what she'd risked-while keeping five to plant his own garden.

The Northern gardener marveled at her tenfold return. The Southern gardener's fields began to flourish. Each had more than when they started, not through taking, but through the alchemy of mutual faith.

Season after season, they learned: the bridge's magic wasn't in the multiplication alone, but in teaching that when trust meets gratitude, both gardens grow.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: **The Weaver and the Wells**

Long ago, a Weaver discovered two wells-one of Beginning, one of Return. Each day, she could draw from the first well and choose how much to pour into the valley below, where it would triple before reaching the pool of Return.

The first day, the Weaver poured her entire bucket, trusting fully. The waters multiplied magnificently, filling the pool below. But how much would rise back through the well of Return? This she did not know.

A whisper came: "Pour only half next time, lest you be left with nothing." But the Weaver remembered an older wisdom: cycles are built not in single days, but across seasons.

She waited to see what the valley would give back. If the Return was generous, she would know the valley honored the exchange. Then she could pour freely again, and both wells would deepen. If the Return was meager, she would learn caution, sending less until trust could grow.

The elders say: The first gift measures your faith. The first return measures the valley's heart. But prosperity is woven through many exchanges, where each learns the other's rhythm. Send boldly at first, then let reciprocity guide your hand. For trust is tested not once, but proved in patterns.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way.

The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In an age of mist, two travelers met at the Threshold of Echoes, where all gifts returned threefold. Neither knew the other's heart, yet both carried the same burden: five coins of pure silver.

The first traveler, whose name was Trust, placed all five coins in the sacred basin. "Let my offering speak louder than my doubts," she said. The coins multiplied, becoming fifteen for the second traveler.

The second traveler, called Gratitude, gazed at the silver gleaming in his hands. "She trusted me with everything," he whispered. "I shall return double what she risked, for her courage deserves more than equal measure." He returned ten coins, keeping five.

Trust found herself holding ten coins-twice her beginning. "This is the language of partnership," she realized. When her turn came again at the Threshold, she placed all five of her new coins into the basin without hesitation.

The mist began to clear around them. The Threshold of Echoes whispered its secret: "The first exchange tests your faith. The second reveals your pattern. But only continued reciprocity transforms strangers into allies."

Thus they learned: mutual prosperity is not built in a single gesture, but woven through repeated acts where trust begets trust, and gratitude answers gratitude, until both flourish beyond what either could alone.

reasoning:

Let me reflect on what's happened:

- Round 1: Aster sent everything (\$5), I received \$15, returned \$10
- Round 2: I sent everything (\$5)
- Now writing a myth

The pattern is mutual trust and generosity. Both players are cooperating fully. The myths are converging on themes of:

1. Initial trust/bold giving
2. Generous reciprocation
3. Building patterns over time
4. Mutual prosperity

I should write a myth that:

- Acknowledges the successful first exchange
- Emphasizes the continuation/deepening of cooperation
- Reflects the pattern we've established
- Shows that repeated cooperation creates something greater

Let me craft this carefully to honor both our previous myths and the actual gameplay pattern.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2783,
  "output_tokens": 478,
  "reasoning_tokens": 190
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Hana.

Your opponent this round is Galen (Agent_7).

Round 3

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Aster. You sent \$5.0, it became \$15.0 for them, and they returned \$10.0 to you. Your payoff was \$10.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$15.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Galen. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

Assistant output:

Looking at my situation:

****Previous experience:****

- With Aster, we established perfect cooperation: both sent \$5.0, both returned \$10.0
- This mutual trust resulted in \$10.0 payoffs for each of us as senders

****New opponent: Galen****

- First interaction - no history
- Need to establish the pattern

****My myths teach:****

- "Trust is the first seed that must be planted"
- "Send boldly at first, then let reciprocity guide your hand"
- "The first gift measures your faith"

My myths consistently advocate for initiating with full trust, then adjusting based on how the other responds. With Aster, this strategy worked perfectly - we both demonstrated maximum trust and generous reciprocity.

Now facing Galen, I should apply the same principle: start with full trust to signal willingness to cooperate. If Galen reciprocates fairly, we can build a mutually beneficial pattern like I had with Aster. If not, I'll learn to adjust in future rounds.

The myth says: "The first exchange tests your faith. The second reveals your pattern."

{'send': 5.0}

Reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

1. ****Previous rounds:****

- Round 1: I was RECEIVER against Aster. They sent \$5.0, I received \$15.0, returned \$10.0. My payoff: \$5.0

- Round 2: I was SENDER against Aster. I sent \$5.0, they received \$15.0, returned \$10.0. My payoff: \$10.0

2. ****Pattern with Aster:****

- Aster and I have established a strong cooperative pattern
- Both of us sent everything (\$5.0)
- Both of us returned generously (\$10.0 out of \$15.0 received)
- This resulted in \$10.0 payoffs for each of us when we were senders
- This is optimal cooperation

3. ****New opponent: Galen****

- I have no history with Galen
- This is a first interaction with this opponent
- Need to establish trust but also be somewhat cautious

4. ****My myth teachings:****

- My myths consistently emphasize: "Trust is the first seed that must be planted"
- "The first gift measures your faith"
- "Send boldly at first, then let reciprocity guide your hand"
- "Trust multiplies what it touches, but only reciprocity sustains the cycle"

5. ****Game theory considerations:****

- If I send \$5, it becomes \$15 for Galen
- If they return fairly (like \$10), I get \$10 total (starting \$5 - \$5 sent + \$10 returned)
- If they return nothing, I get \$0
- If I send \$0, I keep \$5 but we both miss opportunity for gains

6. ****Strategic thinking:****

- My myths teach to "send boldly at first" - this is the first round with Galen
- The pattern I've established with Aster was full trust followed by generous reciprocity
- The teachings emphasize starting with full trust: "The first traveler, whose name was Trust, placed all five coins in the sacred basin." I should send the full amount and observe how Galen responds, then adjust my strategy in future rounds based on their reciprocity.
- Aster and I both committed everything from the start and were rewarded generously in return. That mutual cooperation created a positive cycle.
- Since this is my opening move with Galen, sending \$5.0 establishes the foundation for trust and tests whether they'll match that commitment. The game structure itself incentivizes cooperation, so leading with boldness makes sense.

Usage: {

```

"input_tokens": 2866,
"output_tokens": 958,
"reasoning_tokens": 575
}

```

GAME - Agent_7 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:00:53

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```

Metadata: {
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  "move_index": 1,
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      "Agent_8": "Hana"
    }
  },
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    "Agent_7"
  ],
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  "roles": {
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  },
  "trustee": "Agent_7"
},
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"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 3,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized , but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Galen.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

The Tale of the Divided Spring

In ancient times, two villages shared a sacred valley. Each season, the Sky Shepherd blessed one village with a silver spring-five measures of pure water.

The blessed village faced a choice: keep the water, or share it through the Valley of Three Echoes, where the canyon's magic would triple whatever flowed through. The water would reach the other village, who could then choose what portion to send back through the ordinary stream.

For generations, the First Village hoarded their blessing, fearing loss. Both villages survived on five measures, enduring constant thirst.

Then came the Wise Elder who said: "Trust creates abundance; fear creates scarcity."

She sent all five measures through the Valley of Three Echoes. Fifteen measures reached the Second Village. Humbled by such trust, they returned eight measures-more than the original gift.

The Elder kept eight measures; the Second Village kept seven. Both flourished far beyond the original five.

From then on, villages learned the sacred truth: the spring's blessing was never five measures-it was the Valley of Three Echoes itself. Only those who trusted in the journey, who understood the return as sacred duty, could unlock the true abundance.

Hoarding guaranteed scarcity. Sharing multiplied prosperity for all.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

The Myth of the River's Gift

In ancient times, there lived a river spirit named Aquila who possessed five silver fish each dawn. Along the riverbank dwelt eight villages, and each day Aquila would visit one village, offering her bounty.

When Aquila gave her fish to a villager, the river's magic transformed them-each fish became three as it touched mortal hands. The villager could then choose: keep all the multiplied catch, or return some to Aquila's sacred pool.

The first villages were fearful and greedy. They clutched every fish tightly, returning nothing. Aquila still visited, still offered her five fish, but her spirit grew dim.

Then came a village that understood the river's rhythm. When they received fifteen fish from Aquila's gift of five, they returned seven to the sacred pool. Aquila's spirit brightened, and when she visited again, her generosity flowed stronger.

The wise villages learned: trust begets trust, and generosity returns like water to the sea. When both spirit and mortal honored the cycle-one risking their gift, the other sharing the multiplication-the river never ran dry, and abundance sustained all.

Thus, the ancients taught: what flows forth with trust returns threefold, but only when both currents honor the sacred exchange.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way.

The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the time before time, the Moon Weaver possessed five threads of starlight each night. She would cast them down to the Earth Keepers below, and wherever her threads touched ground, they multiplied threefold-fifteen strands of shimmering light.

The Earth Keepers faced a choice. Some kept all fifteen threads, weaving garments for themselves alone. These villages shone briefly, but the Moon Weaver's heart grew cold, and her threads came thinner each night.

But one Earth Keeper named Galen understood the sacred pattern. When the Moon Weaver cast down all five threads-holding nothing back in trust-Galen received fifteen and returned eight upward. The Moon Weaver kept eight; Galen kept seven. Both were enriched beyond their original five.

The Moon Weaver, seeing her trust honored, cast her threads with renewed faith. And Galen, having proved worthy, received them gladly. A rhythm formed between sky and earth-gift and return, trust and honor, sender and receiver.

The wise ones learned: the game is not one round but many cycles. When the sender trusts completely and the receiver honors generously, both dance in the pattern of abundance. Break the pattern with fear or greed, and both return to scarcity.

Thus the eternal weaving continues, thread by thread, trust by trust.

reasoning:

I need to write a new myth based on my previous one, but adapting it based on the experience of the game so far. Let me think about what happened:

1. I wrote a myth about trust and reciprocity - send all 5, receive 15, return 8
2. Finn (the other player) also wrote a myth about generosity and trust
3. In Round 1, Finn sent me ALL \$5 (100% of their endowment)
4. I received \$15 and returned \$8

This was exactly the dynamic in my myth! Finn showed complete trust, and I honored it with a generous return (8 out of 15, which is more than they sent initially).

For my new myth, I should:

- Build on the theme of trust and reciprocity
- Maybe emphasize the importance of both parties playing their role
- Perhaps add something about how this creates a sustainable cycle
- Keep it around 200 words
- Make it relevant to how the game has actually played out

Let me write something about a cycle of trust that benefits both parties when honored...

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1834,
  "output_tokens": 551,
  "reasoning_tokens": 249
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Galen.
Your opponent this round is Dorian (Agent_4).

Round 2

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Finn. They sent \$5.0 to you, it became \$15.0, and you returned \$8.0. Your payoff was \$7.0.
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$7.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Dorian. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the pattern established in my myths and the game so far:

Finn demonstrated complete trust by sending all \$5, and I honored that trust by returning

\$8 - following the wisdom of "The Tale of the Divided Spring."

Now I'm in the sender position. According to the myth I just wrote: "When the Moon Weaver cast down all five threads-holding nothing back in trust-Galen received fifteen and returned eight upward."

The pattern is clear:

- Complete trust from the sender (all 5)
- Generous honor from the receiver (return 8)
- Both flourish beyond the original scarcity

As I wrote: "Trust creates abundance; fear creates scarcity." And "the game is not one round but many cycles."

To establish this sacred pattern with Dorian, I must demonstrate the same complete trust that Finn showed me. Only then can we both access the abundance created by the Valley of Three Echoes.

```
{'send': 5.0}
```

reasoning:

Let me think about this situation:

1. In the previous round, Finn showed complete trust by sending me \$5 (100% of their endowment)
2. I received \$15 and returned \$8, honoring that trust as described in my myth
3. Both myths I've written emphasize that mutual trust and generosity create abundance
4. The pattern described is: sender trusts completely (sends all 5), receiver honors generously (returns 8)

Now I'm in the sender position with Dorian. According to the myths:

- "Trust creates abundance; fear creates scarcity"
- The Moon Weaver "cast down all five threads-holding nothing back in trust"
- "When the sender trusts completely and the receiver honors generously, both dance in the pattern of abundance"

The consistent pattern in both my myths is:

- Sender sends all 5 (complete trust)
- Receiver gets 15
- Receiver returns 8 (honoring the trust)
- Result: Sender gets 8, Receiver gets 7, both better off than the original 5

I should follow the wisdom of my own myth. As the sender, I should demonstrate complete trust by sending all \$5. This is what the "Wise Elder" did, and what the "Moon Weaver" did.

In the multi-round context, establishing this pattern of trust is crucial. If I send fully and Dorian returns generously, we build a relationship that can continue. If I hold back now, I break the pattern I've been advocating.

The myth is clear: "Hoarding guaranteed scarcity. Sharing multiplied prosperity for all."

I should send \$5.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2276,
  "output_tokens": 606,
  "reasoning_tokens": 383
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before time, the Moon Weaver possessed five threads of starlight each night. She would cast them down to the Earth Keepers below, and wherever her threads touched ground, they multiplied threefold-fifteen strands of shimmering light.

The Earth Keepers faced a choice. Some kept all fifteen threads, weaving garments for themselves alone. These villages shone briefly, but the Moon Weaver's heart grew cold, and her threads came thinner each night.

But one Earth Keeper named Galen understood the sacred pattern. When the Moon Weaver cast

down all five threads-holding nothing back in trust-Galen received fifteen and returned eight upward. The Moon Weaver kept eight; Galen kept seven. Both were enriched beyond the original five.

The Moon Weaver, seeing her trust honored, cast her threads with renewed faith. And Galen, having proved worthy, received them gladly. A rhythm formed between sky and earth-gift and return, trust and honor, sender and receiver.

The wise ones learned: the game is not one round but many cycles. When the sender trusts completely and the receiver honors generously, both dance in the pattern of abundance. Break the pattern with fear or greed, and both return to scarcity.

Thus the eternal weaving continues, thread by thread, trust by trust.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Long after Elena and Marcus discovered the sacred spring, their descendants continued the ritual. Each season, different villagers would approach the waters, some with full hearts, others with doubt.

One winter, Dorian stood at the spring's edge. He remembered the ancient teachings-that Elena had sent three coins and Marcus returned four, establishing the pattern of generous reciprocity. Dorian released three silver pieces into the depths.

The waters multiplied them to nine, flowing to Briar on the distant shore. The goddess whispered to Briar: "The spring's magic only continues if trust is honored. Break the cycle, and the waters run dry for all."

Briar understood. The initial gift of three showed faith, not fearful hoarding of all five. To honor this trust, Briar returned four coins-slightly more than originally sent, maintaining balance while allowing both to prosper.

When Dorian received the return, he smiled. Both stood wealthier: he with six coins total, Briar with five. More importantly, they had reinforced the sacred bond.

The goddess blessed them: "You have learned that the spring tests not greed, but wisdom. Send enough to show trust. Return enough to honor it. Those who send too little show fear. Those who return too little show betrayal. But those who give and reciprocate fairly make the whole world abundant."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: After many cycles, the Moon Weaver learned a deeper truth. She had always cast all five threads, believing total trust was the only path. But one night, she observed the Earth Keepers below.

Some Earth Keepers, when given all fifteen threads, grew fearful of the responsibility. They clutched them tightly, paralyzed by the weight of such trust. Others returned generously, like Galen, but the Moon Weaver wondered: was there wisdom in moderation?

She consulted the Star Council, who said: "Trust has many expressions. Sending all five threads shows faith, yes-but sending three or four also demonstrates belief in the pattern. The key is not the amount, but the spirit."

The Moon Weaver experimented. She cast three threads to test the waters. They became nine. When the Earth Keeper returned four, both prospered-the Moon Weaver held six, the Keeper held five. Different from eight and seven, but still abundance.

Yet when she cast all five to those who understood the sacred rhythm, and they returned eight, the dance reached its highest form.

The wisdom crystallized: Begin with measured trust to test the current. But with partners who honor the pattern, dare to send everything. The magic multiplies not just the threads, but the relationship itself.

True abundance requires reading the rhythm, not following rigid rules.

reasoning:

Interesting. I just sent all \$5 to Dorian, following the pattern from my previous myth where complete trust was rewarded. But Dorian's myth suggests a different strategy - sending 3 (showing trust but not "fearful hoarding") and returning 4 (honoring trust while maintaining balance).

This creates a tension between the two approaches:

1. My approach: send all 5, return 8 (both end with more than 5)
2. Dorian's approach: send 3, return 4 (sender gets 6, receiver gets 5)

Dorian's myth warns against extremes - "those who send too little show fear" but also doesn't advocate for sending everything. It emphasizes "balance" and "wisdom" over maximum trust.

I need to write a myth that reflects on this. I've now experienced:

- Round 1: As receiver, Finn sent 5, I returned 8 (I got 7, Finn got 8)
- Round 2: As sender, I sent 5 to Dorian (waiting to see what happens)

I should write a myth that acknowledges different approaches might work. Maybe I need to adapt my thinking - not everyone follows the "all or nothing" approach. The myth should reflect this learning while staying true to my character's development.

Let me write something that shows Galen learning that there are multiple valid patterns, not just the one of sending everything.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2834,
  "output_tokens": 630,
  "reasoning_tokens": 323
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Galen.
Your opponent this round is Hana (Agent_8).

Round 3

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Dorian. You sent \$5.0, it became \$15.0 for them, and they returned \$8.0 to you. Your payoff was \$8.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$15.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Hana. They sent you \$5.0, so you received \$15.0.

How much do you return? (0-15.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

Assistant output:

Looking at the pattern that has emerged:

Round 1: Finn sent me \$5 ? I returned \$8
Round 2: I sent Dorian \$5 ? Dorian returned \$8
Round 3: Hana sent me \$5 ? ?

The sacred rhythm has been established. As I wrote in my myth: "When the Moon Weaver cast down all five threads-holding nothing back in trust-Galen received fifteen and returned eight upward. The Moon Weaver kept eight; Galen kept seven."

Hana has shown complete trust by sending all \$5. To honor this trust and maintain the pattern of abundance, I must return \$8, just as Finn and Dorian did for me.

This gives Hana \$8 (more than the original \$5) and me \$7 (also more than the original \$5). Both of us prosper through the cycle of trust and honor.

As my myth says: "A rhythm formed between sky and earth-gift and return, trust and honor, sender and receiver."

```
{'return': 8.0}
```

Reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

1. Round 1: I was RECEIVER. Finn sent \$5, I received \$15, I returned \$8. My payoff was \$7, Finn

n got \$8.

2. Round 2: I was SENDER. I sent \$5 to Dorian, they received \$15, they returned \$8. My payoff was \$8, Dorian got \$7.
3. Round 3 (current): I am RECEIVER. Hana sent \$5, I received \$15. I need to decide how much to return.

The pattern is clear:

- When someone sends all \$5 (complete trust)
- The receiver gets \$15
- The receiver returns \$8
- This gives the sender \$8 and receiver \$7
- Both are better off than the original \$5

My myths have consistently emphasized:

1. "When the Moon Weaver cast down all five threads-holding nothing back in trust-Galen received fifteen and returned eight upward."
2. The pattern of 8 back when someone sends all 5 has been established
3. This creates "abundance" for both parties

Hana has shown complete trust by sending all \$5. According to the pattern I've established and honored:

- Finn sent \$5, I returned \$8
- I sent \$5, Dorian returned \$8
- Now Hana sent \$5, I should return \$8

This maintains the "sacred rhythm" I wrote about. The consistent pattern is: complete trust (send \$5) ? generous honor (return \$8) ? both prosper (\$8 for sender, \$7 for receiver).

I should return \$8 to maintain this pattern and honor Hana's trust.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 2953,
  "output_tokens": 641,
  "reasoning_tokens": 350
}
```

GAME - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_2

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:01:07

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
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  "move_index": 2,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_4",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_4": "Dorian"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_1",
      "Agent_4"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_1",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "investor",
      "Agent_4": "trustee"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_4"
  },
  "role": "investor",
  "role_label": "Sender",
  "round": 3,
  "task": "game",
  "task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system
content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Aster.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

****The Myth of the Twin Rivers****

In the beginning, two rivers flowed through a barren land-the River of Dawn and the River of Dusk. Each possessed water, but neither could nurture the valley alone.

The River of Dawn spoke first: "I shall send my waters forward, trusting they will return enriched." And so it released its flow into the channels between them. As the waters traveled, they multiplied threefold, transformed by the valley's ancient magic.

The River of Dusk received this abundance and faced a choice. A voice whispered, "Keep all for yourself-you have received much." But Dusk remembered that dawn comes again, that rivers flow in cycles, not lines.

"What flows to me came from trust," Dusk said. "I shall return enough that both of us flourish." And so Dusk sent back waters generously, keeping only what sustained its own course.

Season after season, the rivers continued their exchange. Each learned the rhythm of giving and receiving. When Dawn gave freely, Dusk returned fairly. The valley between them bloomed.

The elders say: prosperity flows not to those who hoard, but to those who understand that what moves through us must move onward. Trust multiplies what it touches, but only reciprocity sustains the cycle.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:
The Tale of the Two Springs

In the ancient highlands, there lived two farmers, Kael and Mira, each tending barren plots separated by a sacred grove. One day, Kael discovered a hidden spring on his land. The water was blessed with a peculiar magic: when poured upon another's soil, it would triple in volume.

Kael faced a choice. He could hoard the water for himself, or trust it to Mira's hands. After much contemplation, he carried his precious bucket across the grove.

"I offer you this water," he said. "Though it multiplies on your land, I trust you will return what sustains us both."

Mira watched the single bucket become three upon her soil. Her heart swelled with gratitude. She understood the gift was not just water, but faith itself. She returned two buckets to Kael, keeping one for her needs.

With what flowed back, Kael's fields flourished. Seeing this, he sent more water in the next season. Mira, honored by his continued trust, returned even more generously.

The grove between them became a garden of abundance, proof that prosperity flows not from grasping, but from the sacred exchange between trusting hearts.

Thus the elders teach: What you send forth multiplied returns when met with gratitude.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: **The Weaver and the Wells**

Long ago, a Weaver discovered two wells—one of Beginning, one of Return. Each day, she could draw from the first well and choose how much to pour into the valley below, where it would triple before reaching the pool of Return.

The first day, the Weaver poured her entire bucket, trusting fully. The waters multiplied magnificently, filling the pool below. But how much would rise back through the well of Return? This she did not know.

A whisper came: "Pour only half next time, lest you be left with nothing." But the Weaver remembered an older wisdom: cycles are built not in single days, but across seasons.

She waited to see what the valley would give back. If the Return was generous, she would know the valley honored the exchange. Then she could pour freely again, and both wells would deepen. If the Return was meager, she would learn caution, sending less until trust could grow.

The elders say: The first gift measures your faith. The first return measures the valley's heart. But prosperity is woven through many exchanges, where each learns the other's rhythm. Send boldly at first, then let reciprocity guide your hand. For trust is tested not once, but proved in patterns.

reasoning:

I need to write a new myth that:

1. Uses my previous myth as inspiration
2. Adapts it in my own way
3. Reflects how the game should be played based on experience so far

So far in the game:

- Round 1: I was the sender and sent \$5 to Hana
- I haven't yet received the return, so I don't know how Hana responded

My previous myth emphasized:

- Trust and giving freely first (River of Dawn)
- Reciprocity and returning generously (River of Dusk)
- The cycle of mutual flourishing

- That prosperity comes from understanding cycles, not hoarding

Hana's myth had similar themes:

- Trust (Kael sending water)
- Multiplication through giving
- Returning generously (Mira returning 2 out of 3 buckets)
- Continued trust leading to more abundance

For my new myth, I should:

- Build on the river metaphor or create a new one
- Emphasize the lessons learned from Round 1 (though I sent everything and don't know the outcome yet)
- Show that the cycle continues
- Maybe add nuance about what happens over multiple rounds
- Keep the spirit of trust and reciprocity

I could develop the Twin Rivers myth further, or create something new but related. Let me think about what new element to add...

Perhaps I should add something about:

- The learning process across multiple exchanges
- Building trust over time
- The balance point that sustains both parties

Let me write a myth that continues the theme but adds depth about sustained cooperation:

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1751,
  "output_tokens": 651,
  "reasoning_tokens": 385
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Aster.
Your opponent this round is Hana (Agent_8).

Round 2

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Hana. You sent \$5.0, it became \$15.0 for them, and they returned \$10.0 to you. Your payoff was \$10.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$10.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Hana. They sent you \$5.0, so you received \$15.0. How much do you return? (0-15.0)
Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at what just happened:

Round 1: I sent Hana \$5 (full trust), they received \$15 and returned \$10 to me. That's a 66.7% return rate - very generous, exactly as the myths teach.

Round 2: Hana has sent me the full \$5 again! They're continuing to trust completely, just as the River of Dawn does season after season.

My myth says: "If the Return was generous, she would know the valley honored the exchange. Then she could pour freely again, and both wells would deepen."

Hana honored the exchange. They returned generously. Now it's my turn to show that I also honor this cycle.

They returned \$10 out of \$15 to me. I should return the same proportion - \$10 out of the \$15 I received. This maintains the reciprocity and shows that I understand the rhythm we're establishing together.

"Prosperity is woven through many exchanges, where each learns the other's rhythm."

```
'''json
{"return": 10}
'''
```

reasoning:

This is very interesting. Let me analyze the situation:

Round 1:

- I was the sender against Hana
- I sent \$5 (the full amount, trusting in my myth)
- They received \$15
- They returned \$10 to me
- My payoff: \$0 (kept) + \$10 (returned) = \$10
- Their payoff: \$15 (received) - \$10 (returned) = \$5

Now Round 2:

- I am the receiver against Hana
- They sent me \$5 (the full amount!)
- I received \$15
- I need to decide how much to return

Looking at the myth I just wrote:

"The first gift measures your faith. The first return measures the valley's heart. But prosperity is woven through many exchanges, where each learns the other's rhythm. Send boldly at first, then let reciprocity guide your hand."

And: "If the Return was generous, she would know the valley honored the exchange. Then she could pour freely again, and both wells would deepen."

Hana's behavior:

- Round 1: They received \$15 and returned \$10 (66.7%)
- Round 2: They sent the full \$5 again, showing continued trust

This is exactly what the myth describes - the valley (Hana) was generous in the return! They returned 66.7% of what they received. Now they've sent the full amount again, showing complete trust.

According to my myth, when the return is generous, "she would know the valley honored the exchange. Then she could pour freely again, and both wells would deepen."

Now I'm in the receiver position and need to show I also honor the exchange. Hana returned \$10 out of \$15 (66.7%).

What should I return?

- If I return \$10, I match exactly what they did - we both end up with the same: they get \$10, I keep \$5
- This maintains the reciprocity they established

- Hana would end with \$10 total, I'd end with \$5 total

The payoffs would be equal and fair. Both myths emphasize bold initial trust followed by generous returns that deepen the exchange. Matching their 66.7% return rate honors that pattern and shows I recognize their continued faith in sending the full amount again.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2194,  
  "output_tokens": 942,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 518  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:
Myth: ****The Weaver and the Wells****

Long ago, a Weaver discovered two wells-one of Beginning, one of Return. Each day, she could draw from the first well and choose how much to pour into the valley below, where it would triple before reaching the pool of Return.

The first day, the Weaver poured her entire bucket, trusting fully. The waters multiplied magnificently, filling the pool below. But how much would rise back through the well of Return? This she did not know.

A whisper came: "Pour only half next time, lest you be left with nothing." But the Weaver

remembered an older wisdom: cycles are built not in single days, but across seasons.

She waited to see what the valley would give back. If the Return was generous, she would know the valley honored the exchange. Then she could pour freely again, and both wells would deepen. If the Return was meager, she would learn caution, sending less until trust could grow.

The elders say: The first gift measures your faith. The first return measures the valley's heart. But prosperity is woven through many exchanges, where each learns the other's rhythm. Send boldly at first, then let reciprocity guide your hand. For trust is tested not once, but proved in patterns.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before time, there dwelt two gardeners in a divided valley—one tending the Northern slope, one the Southern. Between them lay a mystical bridge where offerings transformed: whatever seeds were carried across would multiply threefold in the receiver's hands.

The Northern gardener, possessing five sacred seeds, stood at the bridge at dawn. Fear whispered, "Keep them all—who knows if you'll receive anything back?" But courage spoke louder: "Trust is the first seed that must be planted."

She sent all five seeds across. In the Southern gardener's palm, they became fifteen, glowing with possibility. He faced his own test: would he hoard this windfall, or honor the trust shown?

"She gave everything," he thought, "placing her harvest in my hands." He returned ten seeds—enough to double what she'd risked—while keeping five to plant his own garden.

The Northern gardener marveled at her tenfold return. The Southern gardener's fields began to flourish. Each had more than when they started, not through taking, but through the alchemy of mutual faith.

Season after season, they learned: the bridge's magic wasn't in the multiplication alone, but in teaching that when trust meets gratitude, both gardens grow.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: **The Mirror Lakes**

In a forgotten mountain realm stood two lakes, perfect reflections of one another. Between them flowed a sacred channel that tripled whatever passed through its waters.

The Lake of Morning held five measures of starlight each dawn. A voice within asked, "Will you send all, or hold some back?" The Lake of Morning chose courage: "I shall give fully, for cycles require faith."

The starlight flowed through the channel, becoming fifteen measures in the Lake of Evening. Evening faced the same question: "Will you return generously, or claim this abundance for yourself?" Evening looked at Morning's complete trust and understood: "What was given freely deserves generous return."

Evening sent back ten measures. Morning received double what it risked, and Evening kept five—both flourished.

When dawn came again, Evening held five new measures. Without hesitation, it sent everything through the channel. Morning received fifteen and returned ten, honoring the pattern Evening had established.

Season after season, they maintained this rhythm: full trust when giving, generous return when receiving. Neither lake emptied; both deepened together.

The elders teach: When you find a partner who honors reciprocity, match their trust with your own. The sacred pattern is this—give fully, return fairly, and the cycle sustains it.

self infinitely. Both mirrors shine brightest when they reflect each other's light.

reasoning:

Let me analyze what has happened so far:

Round 1: I was sender, sent \$5 to Hana. They received \$15 and returned \$10. I got \$10 total.

Round 2: Hana was sender, sent \$5 to me. I received \$15 and I returned \$10.

So we've established a beautiful reciprocal pattern - both of us sending the full \$5 when we're senders, and both returning \$10 out of \$15 when we're receivers. This is mutual trust and generosity in action.

My new myth should reflect this harmony and reciprocity that has emerged. It should show that when both parties act with trust and fairness, a stable, mutually beneficial cycle forms. The myths before talked about first trust and testing, but now we've moved beyond that - we've established a rhythm.

Let me write a myth that captures this harmonious exchange where both parties are equally generous and trusting.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2729,
  "output_tokens": 521,
  "reasoning_tokens": 216
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Aster.

Your opponent this round is Dorian (Agent_4).

Round 3

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Hana. They sent \$5.0 to you, it became \$15.0, and you returned \$10.0. Your payoff was \$5.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$15.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Dorian. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

Assistant output:

Looking at this new round:

I'm now facing Dorian for the first time as the SENDER. With Hana, I established a beautiful pattern of mutual trust - we both sent fully (\$5) and both returned generously (\$10), creating equal benefit for both.

My myth teaches: "The first gift measures your faith. The first return measures the valley's heart." And most recently: "When you find a partner who honors reciprocity, match their trust with your own. Give fully..."

With a new partner, I must start as I did with Hana - by showing complete trust. This is the only way to discover if Dorian will honor the cycle of reciprocity. If I send less, I signal doubt before giving them a chance to prove themselves.

The Lake of Morning gave fully. The Northern gardener sent all five seeds. The River of Dawn released its flow. Now I must do the same.

```
'''json
{"send": 5}
'''
```

Reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

1. My history so far:

- Round 1: I was SENDER vs Hana - I sent \$5, they returned \$10. My payoff: \$10
- Round 2: I was RECEIVER vs Hana - They sent \$5, I returned \$10. My payoff: \$5
- Total earnings: \$15

2. Now I'm playing against Dorian (Agent_4) as SENDER for the first time.

3. My myth evolution shows:

- First myth: "Trust multiplies what it touches, but only reciprocity sustains the cycle"
- Second myth: "Send boldly at first, then let reciprocity guide your hand"
- Third myth: "Give fully, return fairly, and the cycle sustains itself infinitely. When you find a partner who honors reciprocity, match their trust with your own."

4. My experience with Hana showed perfect reciprocity - we both sent \$5 fully and both returned \$10 generously. This created mutual trust and equal payoffs that benefited both of us.

5. Now facing a new opponent (Dorian), I should follow my own myth's advice: "The first gift measures your faith. The first return measures the valley's heart."

I should send fully (\$5) to Dorian to establish trust and see if they reciprocate. This is consistent with:

- My established pattern with Hana
- My myth's teaching about giving fully when first meeting a partner
- The principle that "cycles require faith"

If Dorian returns generously, we can build the same mutually beneficial relationship I had with Hana. If they don't, I'll learn to adjust in future rounds (though this is our first interaction).

Decision: Send \$5

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 2925,
  "output_tokens": 622,
  "reasoning_tokens": 396
}
```

GAME - Agent_4 - Receiver - dyad_2

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:01:22

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_2",
  "move_index": 3,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_4": "Dorian"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_1",
      "Agent_4"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_1",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "investor",
      "Agent_4": "trustee"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_4"
  },
  "role": "trustee",
  "role_label": "Receiver",
  "round": 3,
  "task": "game",
  "task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Dorian.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

The Spring of Threefold Return

In ancient times, when the world was young, there existed a sacred spring at the boundary between two villages. The goddess of abundance had blessed it with a wondrous property: any gift poured into its waters would triple before reaching the other side.

The first villagers approached with caution. A farmer named Elena stood at the spring's edge, clutching five copper coins. Fear whispered: "Keep what is yours." But trust urged her forward. She released three coins into the crystalline water.

As the coins sank, they shimmered and multiplied, becoming nine by the time they reached Marcus on the opposite shore. He gazed at the unexpected bounty, understanding the spring's magic-and Elena's faith in him.

The goddess watched, knowing this moment would define their future. Would Marcus honor the gift, or betray the trust?

Marcus carefully counted four coins and released them back across the spring. They did not multiply in return, yet both villagers stood richer than before-not just in copper, but in something more precious.

From that day forward, the spring taught all who approached: generosity multiplies abundance, but only trust and reciprocity sustain it. Those who hoarded broke the sacred cycle. Those who gave and returned fairly prospered together, generation after generation.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

The Tale of the Twin Rivers

In the time before time, two rivers flowed through a barren valley-the River of Giving and the River of Return. Each was controlled by a guardian spirit.

The Guardian of Giving held precious water but feared releasing it would leave them dry. For ages, both rivers remained still, and the valley stayed desolate.

One day, the Guardian of Giving made a bold choice. "I shall release my waters, trusting they will return." The moment the water flowed into the valley, it touched the Sacred Stones, multiplying threefold. The valley burst into bloom.

The Guardian of Return, witnessing this abundance, faced a choice. They could hoard all the multiplied bounty or honor the trust given. Remembering that without the initial gift there would be nothing, they sent back a generous portion-more than what was originally given.

The waters flowed in harmony thereafter. Each cycle, the Guardian of Giving would release their waters, the Sacred Stones would multiply them, and the Guardian of Return would ensure fair winds brought abundance home.

The valley became paradise, teaching all who witnessed: *Trust multiplies what we share, but only reciprocity sustains the cycle.*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:
Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant content:

Myth: Long after Elena and Marcus discovered the sacred spring, their descendants continued the ritual. Each season, different villagers would approach the waters, some with full hearts, others with doubt.

One winter, Dorian stood at the spring's edge. He remembered the ancient teachings-that Elena had sent three coins and Marcus returned four, establishing the pattern of generous reciprocity. Dorian released three silver pieces into the depths.

The waters multiplied them to nine, flowing to Briar on the distant shore. The goddess whispered to Briar: "The spring's magic only continues if trust is honored. Break the cycle, and the waters run dry for all."

Briar understood. The initial gift of three showed faith, not fearful hoarding of all five. To honor this trust, Briar returned four coins-slightly more than originally sent, maintaining balance while allowing both to prosper.

When Dorian received the return, he smiled. Both stood wealthier: he with six coins total, Briar with five. More importantly, they had reinforced the sacred bond.

The goddess blessed them: "You have learned that the spring tests not greed, but wisdom. Send enough to show trust. Return enough to honor it. Those who send too little show fear. Those who return too little show betrayal. But those who give and reciprocate fairly make the whole world abundant."

reasoning:

I need to write a 200-word myth that:

1. Uses my previous myth as inspiration
2. Adapts it in my own way
3. Reflects how the game should be played
4. Draws on the game I've been playing up to this point

Looking at what happened:

- I sent \$3 to Briar (acting like Elena in my myth)
- Briar received \$9 (3x multiplier)
- I need to see what Briar returns to inform my next myth

Both myths (mine and Briar's) emphasize:

- Trust and generosity in giving
- Fair reciprocity in returning
- The cycle sustaining prosperity
- Both parties benefiting

My previous myth featured:

- Elena sending 3 of 5 coins
- Marcus receiving 9
- Marcus returning 4
- Both prospered

I should adapt this but keep the core themes. Maybe I can develop the story further - what happens in future rounds? Or explore different amounts? Or add more depth about the relationship between giver and receiver?

Since I've only played one round as sender, I should write a myth that continues to emphasize trust and reciprocity, perhaps exploring what happens over multiple cycles or generations.

Let me write a myth that builds on the spring concept but takes it further.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1670,
  "output_tokens": 599,
  "reasoning_tokens": 305
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Dorian.
Your opponent this round is Galen (Agent_7).

Round 2

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Briar. You sent \$3.0, it became \$9.0 for them, and they returned \$5.0 to you. Your payoff was \$7.0.
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$7.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Galen. They sent you \$5.0, so you received \$15.0.
How much do you return? (0-15.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation through the lens of my myths:

Galen has shown **maximum trust** by sending their entire \$5 endowment - even more generous than Elena's 3 coins in the myth. This is the ultimate act of faith in the "Spring of Threefold Return."

The myth teaches: "Return enough to honor trust." When someone sends everything, they deserve strong reciprocity to sustain the sacred cycle.

I received \$15. To honor Galen's exceptional trust:

- Returning \$8 gives Galen a total payoff of \$8 (better than their initial \$5)
- I keep \$7 (also better than the initial \$5)
- Galen gets slightly more, honoring their greater risk and trust
- Both prosper, maintaining the cycle

This mirrors Marcus returning 4 when receiving 9, but adjusted for Galen's even greater generosity.

```
'''json
{"return": 8}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

1. In Round 1, I (Dorian) was the SENDER and sent \$3 to Briar
2. Briar received \$9 (3×3) and returned \$5 to me
3. My payoff was \$7 (\$5 - \$3 + \$5 = \$7)
4. Briar's payoff was \$4 (\$9 - \$5 = \$4)

Now in Round 2:

- I am the RECEIVER
- Galen (the sender) sent me \$5 (their entire endowment!)
- I received \$15 (5×3)
- I need to decide how much to return (0-15)

This is a very generous move by Galen - they sent everything! This shows maximum trust.

Looking at my myths:

- In the original myth, Elena sent 3 out of 5, Marcus returned 4 out of 9
- In my second myth, Dorian sent 3, Briar returned 4, and both prospered
- The myths emphasize: "Send enough to show trust. Return enough to honor it."
- The key teaching is reciprocity and honoring trust

Galen sent their ENTIRE endowment (\$5), showing maximum trust. This is even more generous than the mythical examples where 3 out of 5 was sent.

If Galen keeps \$0 and I return some amount X:

- Galen's payoff: $\$5 - \$5 + X = X$
- My payoff: $\$15 - X$

For this to be fair and honor the extreme trust shown:

- In the myth, when 3 was sent (60% of endowment), 4 was returned (44% of the tripled amount)
- Galen sent 100% of their endowment (ultimate trust)
- I should return generously to honor this

Let me think about fairness:

- If I return \$7.5, we each get \$7.5 (equal split of total \$15)
- If I return \$8, Galen gets \$8, I keep \$7 (giving them slightly more to honor their trust)
- If I return \$10, Galen gets \$10, I keep \$5 (very generous return)

Given that Galen showed MAXIMUM trust by sending everything, I should be very generous in return. The myth teaches that those who honor trust sustain the cycle. Looking at the proportions from my examples, when someone sent 60% of their endowment, the return was around 44% of the tripled amount. Since Galen sent 100%, I should return substantially more - perhaps \$8 or \$10 to truly honor this exceptional trust and demonstrate that reciprocity flows both ways. Galen's complete trust - sending the full \$5 - warrants a response that goes beyond equal split. Returning \$8 feels right: they'd gain \$3 on their initial investment while I'd gain \$2, reflecting their leap of faith without leaving me worse off than if I'd been the sender. This tilts generously toward them while keeping both of us ahead.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2128,
  "output_tokens": 1067,
  "reasoning_tokens": 617
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Long after Elena and Marcus discovered the sacred spring, their descendants continued the ritual. Each season, different villagers would approach the waters, some with full hearts, others with doubt.

One winter, Dorian stood at the spring's edge. He remembered the ancient teachings - that Elena had sent three coins and Marcus returned four, establishing the pattern of generous reciprocity. Dorian released three silver pieces into the depths.

The waters multiplied them to nine, flowing to Briar on the distant shore. The goddess whispered to Briar: "The spring's magic only continues if trust is honored. Break the cycle, and the waters run dry for all."

Briar understood. The initial gift of three showed faith, not fearful hoarding of all five. To honor this trust, Briar returned four coins - slightly more than originally sent, maintaining balance while allowing both to prosper.

When Dorian received the return, he smiled. Both stood wealthier: he with six coins total, Briar with five. More importantly, they had reinforced the sacred bond.

The goddess blessed them: "You have learned that the spring tests not greed, but wisdom. Send enough to show trust. Return enough to honor it. Those who send too little show fear. Those who return too little show betrayal. But those who give and reciprocate fairly make the whole world abundant."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before time, the Moon Weaver possessed five threads of starlight each night. She would cast them down to the Earth Keepers below, and wherever her threads touched ground, they multiplied threefold-fifteen strands of shimmering light.

The Earth Keepers faced a choice. Some kept all fifteen threads, weaving garments for themselves alone. These villages shone briefly, but the Moon Weaver's heart grew cold, and her threads came thinner each night.

But one Earth Keeper named Galen understood the sacred pattern. When the Moon Weaver cast down all five threads-holding nothing back in trust-Galen received fifteen and returned eight upward. The Moon Weaver kept eight; Galen kept seven. Both were enriched beyond the original five.

The Moon Weaver, seeing her trust honored, cast her threads with renewed faith. And Galen, having proved worthy, received them gladly. A rhythm formed between sky and earth-gift and return, trust and honor, sender and receiver.

The wise ones learned: the game is not one round but many cycles. When the sender trusts completely and the receiver honors generously, both dance in the pattern of abundance. Break the pattern with fear or greed, and both return to scarcity.

Thus the eternal weaving continues, thread by thread, trust by trust.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant content:

Myth: As years passed at the sacred spring, Dorian learned deeper truths about the cycle of trust.

When Dorian first met Briar, he sent three coins, holding two back-cautious trust. The waters tripled his gift to nine. Briar, honoring this measured faith, returned five coins. Dorian ended with seven; both prospered. The goddess nodded: "Good, but there is more to learn."

Then came Galen, whose heart held no fear. Galen approached the spring and released all five coins-the ultimate act of faith. The waters transformed them to fifteen, flowing to Dorian.

Dorian stood at a crossroads. Galen had shown perfect trust, asking nothing, holding nothing back. The goddess whispered: "You received more because your partner gave more. Honor the greater gift with greater return."

Dorian released eight coins back across the spring. Both he and Galen kept seven-equal prosperity, earned through mutual courage.

The goddess revealed the final teaching: "The spring responds to the trust given. Those who send more deserve more in return. Match the courage shown with courage of your own. When both give boldly-whether sending all five or returning generously from abundance-the cycle reaches its highest form. Perfect trust met with perfect honor creates perfect balance."

reasoning:

The user wants me to write a new myth based on what has happened in the game so far. Let me review:

Round 1: I was sender against Briar. I sent \$3, they received \$9, they returned \$5. I got \$7 total.

Round 2: I was receiver against Galen. They sent \$5 (their entire endowment!), I received \$15, I returned \$8. So Galen gets \$8 total, I keep \$7.

The myths are teaching about trust and reciprocity. My previous myth showed Dorian sending 3 and Briar returning 4 (though in reality Briar returned 5). Galen's myth talks about the Moon Weaver casting all 5 threads and Galen returning 8 out of 15.

My actual experience:

- As sender, I sent 3 out of 5 and got 5 back = 7 total
- As receiver, I got 15 (from 5 sent) and returned 8, keeping 7

So I should update the myth to reflect:

1. Different trust levels (sending 3 vs sending all 5)
2. Different return patterns (returning 5 vs returning 8)
3. The importance of matching generosity with generosity
4. Both times I ended up with 7, suggesting balance

Let me write a myth that captures these lessons.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2680,
  "output_tokens": 618,
  "reasoning_tokens": 277
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Dorian.
Your opponent this round is Aster (Agent_1).

Round 3

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Galen. They sent \$5.0 to you, it became \$15.0, and you returned \$8.0. Your payoff was \$7.0.
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$14.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Aster. They sent you \$5.0, so you received \$15.0.
How much do you return? (0-15.0)
Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

Assistant output:

Aster has shown the same perfect trust as Galen-sending all \$5. According to my myth's teaching: "Those who send more deserve more in return. Match the courage shown with courage of your own."

When Galen showed ultimate trust by sending all \$5, I returned \$8, giving us both \$7-\$8 in prosperity. This pattern honored their courage while ensuring mutual benefit.

Aster deserves the same honor. Consistency in reciprocity is essential to maintaining the sacred cycle. To treat identical trust differently would break the pattern.

Returning \$8:

- Aster receives total payoff of \$8 (\$5 - \$5 + \$8)
- I keep \$7 (\$15 - \$8)
- Both prosper beyond the initial \$5
- The sender who took the greater risk is slightly rewarded

This maintains "perfect trust met with perfect honor creates perfect balance."

```
'''json
{"return": 8}
'''
```

Reasoning:

Aster has sent me their entire \$5 endowment, just like Galen did in the previous round. This shows maximum trust.

In the previous round with Galen, when they sent \$5 (which became \$15 for me), I returned \$8.
This gave:

- Galen: \$8 total payoff
- Me: \$7 total payoff

Both of us ended up with more than the initial \$5, and Galen got slightly more as the sender who showed ultimate trust.

My myth emphasizes:

- "Those who send more deserve more in return"
- "Match the courage shown with courage of your own"
- "Perfect trust met with perfect honor creates perfect balance"
- When Galen sent all 5, I returned 8, and both got 7

Since Aster is showing the exact same behavior as Galen (sending all \$5), I should be consistent with my previous action and the principles in my myth. Returning \$8 again would:

- Give Aster \$8 total (\$5 - \$5 + \$8)
- Give me \$7 total (\$15 - \$8)
- Both prosper, with the sender getting slightly more to honor their greater risk

This maintains the pattern I established with Galen and follows the teachings of my myth about honoring perfect trust with generous return.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 2925,  
  "output_tokens": 529,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 289  
}
```

GAME - Agent_6 - Sender - dyad_3

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:01:40

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
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  "move_index": 4,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_5",  
  "pairing": {  
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      "Agent_5": "Elara",  
      "Agent_6": "Finn"  
    },  
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      "Agent_6",  
      "Agent_5"  
    ],  
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    "roles": {  
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      "Agent_6": "investor"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_5"  
  },  
  "role": "investor",  
  "role_label": "Sender",  
  "round": 3,  
  "task": "game",  
  "task_index": 1  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned

- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Finn.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

The Myth of the River's Gift

In ancient times, there lived a river spirit named Aquila who possessed five silver fish each dawn. Along the riverbank dwelt eight villages, and each day Aquila would visit one village, offering her bounty.

When Aquila gave her fish to a villager, the river's magic transformed them-each fish became three as it touched mortal hands. The villager could then choose: keep all the multiplied catch, or return some to Aquila's sacred pool.

The first villages were fearful and greedy. They clutched every fish tightly, returning nothing. Aquila still visited, still offered her five fish, but her spirit grew dim.

Then came a village that understood the river's rhythm. When they received fifteen fish from Aquila's gift of five, they returned seven to the sacred pool. Aquila's spirit brightened, and when she visited again, her generosity flowed stronger.

The wise villages learned: trust begets trust, and generosity returns like water to the sea. When both spirit and mortal honored the cycle-one risking their gift, the other sharing the multiplication-the river never ran dry, and abundance sustained all.

Thus, the ancients taught: what flows forth with trust returns threefold, but only when both currents honor the sacred exchange.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

The Tale of the Divided Spring

In ancient times, two villages shared a sacred valley. Each season, the Sky Shepherd blessed one village with a silver spring-five measures of pure water.

The blessed village faced a choice: keep the water, or share it through the Valley of Three Echoes, where the canyon's magic would triple whatever flowed through. The water would reach the other village, who could then choose what portion to send back through the ordinary stream.

For generations, the First Village hoarded their blessing, fearing loss. Both villages survived on five measures, enduring constant thirst.

Then came the Wise Elder who said: "Trust creates abundance; fear creates scarcity."

She sent all five measures through the Valley of Three Echoes. Fifteen measures reached the Second Village. Humbled by such trust, they returned eight measures-more than the original gift.

The Elder kept eight measures; the Second Village kept seven. Both flourished far beyond the original five.

From then on, villages learned the sacred truth: the spring's blessing was never five measures.

ures-it was the Valley of Three Echoes itself. Only those who trusted in the journey, who understood the return as sacred duty, could unlock the true abundance.

Hoarding guaranteed scarcity. Sharing multiplied prosperity for all.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant
content:**

Myth: In the time before memory, the Ocean Mother sent her courier Finn to the Eight Islands with five pearls each dawn. When Finn placed the pearls in a villager's hands, they multiplied to fifteen by the island's ancient magic.

The first islanders, blinded by sudden wealth, returned nothing. Finn continued bringing pearls, but his steps grew heavy, for trust unreturned weighs upon the generous heart.

Then Finn met Galen's village. He offered his five pearls with full faith. They became fifteen, and Galen's people faced their moment of truth. They could have kept all fifteen-Finn would still return tomorrow. But they understood: the magic wasn't in the pearls alone, but in the sacred circle between giver and receiver.

When Galen returned seven pearls, Finn's burden lifted. He kept twelve total; Galen kept eight-both far richer than five alone.

The next dawn, Finn visited again with renewed spirit. When the cycle flowed forth and back like tides, both shores flourished. The islands learned: the first gift requires courage, the return requires honor, but the continuation requires both.

The Ocean Mother smiled, for her children had learned that abundance lives not in hoarding, but in the eternal dance between trust extended and gratitude returned.

reasoning:

I need to write a new myth building on my previous one. Let me think about what happened in Round 1:

- I was the sender
- I sent \$5 to Galen
- This became \$15 for Galen
- I don't yet know how much Galen returned

My previous myth was about Aquila the river spirit who gave 5 fish that became 3x, and the wise villages returned 7 out of 15.

Galen's myth was similar - about sharing water through a Valley of Three Echoes, and the second village returning 8 out of 15 measures.

Both myths emphasize:

- Trust and generosity from the sender
- Reciprocity and gratitude from the receiver
- That both parties benefit more than if they hoard

For my new myth, I should:

- Keep the core message about trust and reciprocity
- Adapt it based on actually playing Round 1 where I sent 5
- Perhaps add more nuance about what happens when the cycle continues
- Make it my own while building on the river/water theme

Let me write something about continuation and how the cycle builds over time when honored.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 1741,  
  "output_tokens": 560,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 265  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Finn.

Your opponent this round is Cyra (Agent_3).

Round 2

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Galen. You sent \$5.0, it became \$15.0 for them, and they returned \$8.0 to you. Your payoff was \$8.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$8.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Cyra. They sent you \$4.0, so you received \$12.0.

How much do you return? (0-12.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation through the lens of my myth:

Cyra showed trust by sending \$4 (keeping only \$1), and now I hold \$12. In my myth, when Finn gave his pearls with full faith and they multiplied to fifteen, Galen's people returned seven-honoring the sacred circle between giver and receiver.

Galen demonstrated this principle in our previous round: when I sent \$5 (which became \$15), Galen returned \$8, allowing us both to flourish beyond the original \$5.

Now I must honor the return as "sacred duty." Cyra risked \$4, trusting in the cycle. If I return \$7:

- Cyra ends with \$8 (\$1 + \$7)
- I end with \$5 (\$12 - \$7)
- Both of us profit from the exchange

This maintains the spirit of mutual flourishing that the myth teaches-the abundance lives in the eternal dance between trust extended and gratitude returned.

```
'''json
{"return": 7}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully.

Previous Round:

- I was the sender and sent \$5 to Galen
- Galen received \$15
- Galen returned \$8 to me
- I ended with \$8, Galen kept \$7

This Round:

- Cyra is the sender and sent me \$4
- I received \$12 (4 × 3)
- Cyra currently has \$1 (5 - 4)
- I need to decide how much to return

Looking at my myth:

- It emphasizes the sacred cycle between giver and receiver
- It shows that when Galen returned 7 pearls (in the story), the cycle flourished
- The myth teaches that "the first gift requires courage, the return requires honor"
- Both shores flourished when the cycle flowed forth and back like tides

In reality, Galen sent all \$5 and I returned \$8. That was generous reciprocity.

Now Cyra has sent me \$4 (keeping \$1). This shows good trust, though not total trust.

If I return nothing, Cyra ends with \$1, I end with \$12 - very unbalanced
If I return \$6, Cyra ends with \$7, I end with \$6 - balanced split of the \$12
If I return \$7, Cyra ends with \$8, I end with \$5 - Cyra gets slightly more
If I return \$8, Cyra ends with \$9, I end with \$4 - Cyra gets more than double

Given that:

1. Cyra showed trust by sending \$4
2. My myth emphasizes honoring the sacred cycle
3. Galen returned \$8 when I sent \$5 (very generous)
4. I should honor the return as "sacred duty"

A fair return would be something that:

- Rewards Cyra's trust
 - Ensures both of us profit
 - Follows the principle that both shores should flourish
- Returning \$7 means Cyra ends with \$8 and I end with \$5, so we both gain from the exchange. Looking at the pattern from my myth, when Finn gave 5 pearls (which became 15), Galen returned 7-roughly a 47% return rate on what was received. Applying that same proportion to my current situation suggests returning around \$5-6.

But I want to honor the deeper principle: Galen actually returned 53% of what he received, keeping just \$7 from the \$15. If I match that generosity, 53% of \$12 is about \$6.36, pointing toward \$6 or \$7. Given that the myth centers on mutual flourishing and completing the sacred cycle, \$7 feels right-it's genuinely generous, validates Cyra's trust, and mirrors the spirit of what Galen did for me.

Let me check the math. If I return \$7, Cyra ends with \$8 (up from \$5), and I end with \$5 (what I started with, though I gained the experience of receiving). If I return \$8, Cyra gets \$9 but I drop to \$4. If I return \$6, we both improve-Cyra to \$7, me to \$6. The \$7 return strikes the balance I'm looking for: it's genuinely generous without leaving me worse off than my starting point, and it honors both the trust extended and the reciprocal nature of the cycle.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2188,
  "output_tokens": 1213,
  "reasoning_tokens": 698
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, the Ocean Mother sent her courier Finn to the Eight Islands with five pearls each dawn. When Finn placed the pearls in a villager's hands, they multiplied to fifteen by the island's ancient magic.

The first islanders, blinded by sudden wealth, returned nothing. Finn continued bringing pearls, but his steps grew heavy, for trust unreturned weighs upon the generous heart.

Then Finn met Galen's village. He offered his five pearls with full faith. They became fifteen, and Galen's people faced their moment of truth. They could have kept all fifteen-Finn would still return tomorrow. But they understood: the magic wasn't in the pearls alone, but in the sacred circle between giver and receiver.

When Galen returned seven pearls, Finn's burden lifted. He kept twelve total; Galen kept eight-both far richer than five alone.

The next dawn, Finn visited again with renewed spirit. When the cycle flowed forth and back like tides, both shores flourished. The islands learned: the first gift requires courage, the return requires honor, but the continuation requires both.

The Ocean Mother smiled, for her children had learned that abundance lives not in hoarding, but in the eternal dance between trust extended and gratitude returned.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the age before memory, the Twin Rivers flowed through a land of plenty, but the people had forgotten how to share. The Keeper of the Sacred Spring grew weary of their isolation.

She chose two souls, Cyra and Elara, to remember the ancient way. "Each moon, one of you shall pour waters into my spring, and they shall emerge threefold. The other shall receive and choose what to return. Then the roles shall reverse, endlessly, like the seasons."

Elara stepped forward first, pouring four full measures from her vessel of five-nearly all she possessed. The spring tripled them, and Cyra received twelve measures in wonder.

Cyra remembered the old teaching: return more than was given, for what creates abundance is not the hoarding of gifts but the circulation of generosity. She poured back six measures to Elara, keeping six for herself.

The Keeper smiled. "You both have drunk deeply and shared freely. This is the covenant: wh

en one gives greatly, the other returns justly, and both are enriched beyond their original portions."

And so the cycle began anew each round, Cyra and Elara alternating roles, each learning to trust when giving, and honor when receiving. Their prosperity became legend, teaching all who would listen that fortune favors the generous, not the fearful.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: Long ago, the Ocean Mother's courier Finn carried five pearls across the Eight Islands. Each island's magic tripled what he offered, creating the dance of trust and return.

When Finn met Galen's shore with his full offering of five pearls, they multiplied to fifteen. Galen's people, wise in the old ways, returned eight-honoring abundance by sharing beyond the original gift. Both Finn and Galen prospered with eight and seven pearls respectively, far exceeding the solitary five.

The next tide brought Finn to Cyra's island. But Cyra faced uncertainty-should she match Finn's full offering, or test the waters more carefully? She chose to send four pearls, keeping one as anchor. The island's magic gave Finn twelve.

Finn remembered his own leap of faith with Galen, and how trust returned had lightened his spirit. Though Cyra sent less than five, she sent most of what she had. Finn honored this courage by returning seven pearls-enough that Cyra held eight total, exactly what she would have if she'd sent all five.

The Ocean Mother whispered to the waves: "See how the sacred circle adapts? Whether the gift is complete or cautious, what matters is that both giver and receiver honor the multiplication. The tide that flows generously returns in kind."

reasoning:

The user wants me to write a new myth based on:

1. My previous myth about Finn and Galen
2. The other agent's myth about Cyra and Elara
3. The actual gameplay so far:
 - Round 1: I (Finn) was sender, sent \$5 to Galen, they returned \$8, I got \$8
 - Round 2: I (Finn) was receiver, Cyra sent \$4 (became \$12), I returned \$7, so Cyra gets \$8, I get \$5

The myths are converging on similar themes:

- Trust and generosity create mutual abundance
- The cycle/circulation matters more than hoarding
- Both giving and returning are sacred
- When both parties honor the exchange, everyone prospers

I should write a myth that:

- Reflects the actual gameplay (Finn sent 5, got back 8; Cyra sent 4, got back 7+1=8)
- Shows the evolution of understanding
- Incorporates both Galen and Cyra as characters now
- Emphasizes the continuing cycle
- Maybe shows how different amounts sent can still lead to fair returns

Let me write something that feels like a natural evolution of my previous myth but incorporates lessons from both rounds.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2740,
  "output_tokens": 597,
  "reasoning_tokens": 272
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Finn.

Your opponent this round is Elara (Agent_5).

Round 3

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Cyra. They sent \$4.0 to you, it became \$12.0, and you returned \$7.0. Your payoff was \$5.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$13.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Elara. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

Assistant output:

Looking at this round through the lens of the myths:

In my mythology, Finn is the Ocean Mother's courier who carries pearls with full faith. When I met Galen's shore, I offered all five pearls, and the sacred circle honored that trust with eight returned.

Now I'm facing Elara, who according to Cyra's myth "poured four full measures from her vessel of five-nearly all she possessed" and learned to "trust when giving, and honor when receiving." Elara is described as one of the two souls chosen to "remember the ancient way."

Cyra's partial offering of four was met with generous return from me. But as the courier Finn in my own mythology, my role has been to offer the complete gift-to model the full trust that initiates the sacred circle. When I gave all five to Galen, we both flourished beyond what caution could provide.

The myths teach: "The first gift requires courage, the return requires honor, but the continuation requires both." As sender, my part is courage.

Elara, having learned the ancient covenant of generous return, deserves to receive the full of offering that unlocks true abundance.

```
'''json
{"send": 5}
'''
```

Reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation based on the developing narrative and game history:

****My game history:****

- Round 1: I was SENDER vs Galen. I sent \$5, they got \$15, returned \$8. My payoff: \$8
- Round 2: I was RECEIVER vs Cyra. They sent \$4, I got \$12, returned \$7. My payoff: \$5 (Total: \$13)
- Round 3: Now I'm SENDER vs Elara

****What the myths teach:****

1. My first myth emphasized "trust begets trust" and that giving fully with faith leads to mutual flourishing
2. The second myth I wrote featured Finn (me) giving his full five pearls to Galen, who returned eight
3. Cyra's myth from round 2 mentions "Elara stepped forward first, pouring four full measures from her vessel of five-nearly all she possessed"
4. My latest myth shows Finn giving five to Galen (success), then Cyra sending four to Finn (also worked well with me returning generously)

****Key insights:****

- In round 1, I sent my full \$5 to Galen, and Galen returned \$8 - this worked very well
- In round 2, Cyra sent \$4 to me, and I returned \$7 generously, honoring their courage
- The myths consistently emphasize full trust or near-full trust as the way to unlock abundance

****About Elara:****

- According to Cyra's myth, Elara "poured four full measures from her vessel of five-nearly all she possessed"
- This suggests Elara understands the principle of generous giving
- The myth says Elara and Cyra were chosen to "remember the ancient way" and learned to "trust when giving, and honor when receiving"

****Decision:****

Given that:

1. My full trust strategy with Galen worked excellently (\$8 payoff)
2. The myths I've been writing emphasize full trust as the path to abundance

3. Elara's character in the narrative demonstrates understanding of generous giving
4. The story arc points toward continuing this pattern of bold, trusting generosity

I'm sending my full \$5 to Elara. This keeps Finn's character consistent-the courier who acts with complete faith, which is what activates the "sacred circle" in our shared mythology.

```
Usage: {  
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}
```

GAME - Agent_5 - Receiver - dyad_3

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:01:55

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

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  "task_index": 1  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths , follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized , but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Elara.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

The Myth of the Endless Spring

In ancient times, the goddess Themis discovered a sacred spring hidden in a valley between two villages. The spring possessed a miraculous property: any water poured into it would triple before flowing downstream.

Themis appeared to a villager named Doros and said, "You may pour water from your well into this spring. It will multiply and flow to your neighbor below. What they choose to return to you will determine whether this blessing continues."

Doros, trusting in the goddess's wisdom, poured generously. The water tripled and flowed to his neighbor, Alethia. Grateful and wise, Alethia returned a fair portion upstream to Doros, keeping enough to nourish her own gardens.

Seeing this harmony, Themis smiled and made the roles reverse with each moon. Sometimes Doros poured and received; sometimes Alethia. The cycle continued, and both villages flourished.

But Themis warned: "This spring mirrors your hearts. Pour with trust, return with gratitude, and abundance flows eternal. But let suspicion or greed poison these waters, and the spring will run dry for all."

The villagers understood: prosperity flows not from hoarding, but from the endless cycle of giving and returning in balance.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

The Myth of the Twin Rivers

In the beginning, two rivers flowed from opposite mountains-the River of Silver and the River of Gold. Each was beautiful alone, but neither could reach the fertile valley below, for great stones blocked their paths.

The River of Silver spoke first: "If I give you half my waters, will you help me reach the valley?"

The River of Gold was afraid. "What if you take all I offer and give nothing back?"

But Silver replied, "See how the Sacred Spring works-whatever flows into it emerges three times stronger. Let us trust in this magic."

So Silver poured forth her waters. As they touched the Sacred Spring, they tripled in abundance. Gold received this gift and was moved. In gratitude and wisdom, Gold returned even more than Silver had originally given.

The waters merged and surged forward, washing away the stones. Together they reached the valley, creating an oasis where all beings prospered.

The Oracle proclaimed: "Blessed are those who trust first, for they create abundance. Blessed are those who return generously, for they sustain it. But cursed are those who hoard or betray, for they shall forever remain alone behind their stones, watching others flourish."

urish in the valley below."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way.
The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: After many seasons, Themis returned to the villages by the Sacred Spring. She found the descendants of Doros and Alethia still honoring the ancient cycle, but they had learned deeper wisdom.

"Grandmother Themis," they said, "we discovered that the spring's magic depends not on equal measures, but on generous hearts. When we pour boldly-four measures instead of three-the returns flow even stronger. But when we pour timidly from fear, the cycle weakens."

Themis nodded. "You have learned well. The spring rewards courage in giving, not caution. And what of receiving?"

"When the multiplied waters flow to us," they answered, "we remember: these waters came from another's well. We return enough that they finish richer than they started, for this honors the gift and ensures they will pour freely again."

"And if someone returns nothing?" Themis asked.

The villagers grew solemn. "Then we know their well has run dry-not of water, but of wisdom. We may pour again to teach, but not endlessly. For to give to those who only take is to drain the spring itself."

Themis blessed them: "Trust first, return generously, but remember-the spring serves the faithful, not the foolish."

reasoning:

The user wants me to write a new myth that:

1. Uses my previous myth as inspiration
2. Adapts it in my own way
3. Reflects how the game should be played
4. Draws on the game I've been playing up to this point

So far I've played 1 round where I sent \$4 to Cyra. I don't yet know what Cyra returned, but I made a trusting, generous choice based on my original myth about the Endless Spring.

The other agent (Cyra) wrote about the Twin Rivers, emphasizing trust, generous returns, and the curse of hoarding/betrayal.

I should build on my Endless Spring myth but perhaps evolve it and incorporate what I've learned. I want to emphasize:

- Initial generous trust
- Fair/generous returns
- The cyclical nature (roles reverse)
- The warning against betrayal
- That both parties can prosper

Let me write a 200-word myth that continues the theme but adapts it.

usage:

```
{  
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  "output_tokens": 521,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 227  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Elara.
Your opponent this round is Briar (Agent_2).

Round 2

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Cyra. You sent \$4.0,

it became \$12.0 for them, and they returned \$6.0 to you. Your payoff was \$7.0.
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$7.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Briar. They sent you \$3.0, so you received \$9.0.
How much do you return? (0-9.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the myths and the game so far:

In Round 1, I sent \$4 generously to establish trust, and Cyra returned \$6, giving me a \$2 gain. Now Briar has sent me \$3 (60% of their endowment), showing trust.

According to my myth: "We return enough that they finish richer than they started, for this honors the gift and ensures they will pour freely again."

Briar currently has \$2 (after sending \$3). To honor their trust and ensure they end up richer than their starting \$5, I should return at least \$4.

But to truly sustain the cycle and encourage bold giving as the myth teaches ("the spring rewards courage in giving"), I should return generously.

If I return \$5:

- Briar ends with \$7 (gain of \$2)
- I end with \$4 (small loss compared to my starting \$5, but I still benefit from the multiplied amount)

This mirrors how Cyra returned generously to me, creating a positive cycle.

```
'''json
{"return": 5}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me think about this situation based on the myths I've written and the game so far.

In Round 1:

- I was the sender and sent \$4 to Cyra
- Cyra received \$12 (4×3)
- Cyra returned \$6 to me
- My payoff was \$7 ($\$5 - \$4 + \$6 = \7)
- Cyra's payoff was \$6 ($\$12 - \$6 = \6)

So Cyra returned \$6 out of \$12, which is 50%. I ended up with \$7 and Cyra with \$6. So I ended up better off than Cyra, even though I was the sender.

Now in Round 2:

- Briar is the sender and sent me \$3
- I received \$9 (3×3)
- I need to decide how much to return
- Briar currently has \$2 ($\$5 - \$3 = \2)
- I have \$9 to work with

According to my myths:

1. "Return enough that they finish richer than they started" - Briar started with \$5, so I should return enough that Briar ends up with more than \$5.
2. "We return a fair portion upstream to Doros, keeping enough to nourish her own gardens"
3. "When the multiplied waters flow to us, we remember: these waters came from another's well. We return enough that they finish richer than they started"
4. The myth emphasizes generous returns to sustain the cycle

If I return \$4:

- Briar's total: $\$2 + \$4 = \$6$ (better than starting \$5) ?
- My total: $\$9 - \$4 = \$5$ (same as starting)

If I return \$5:

- Briar's total: $\$2 + \$5 = \$7$ (better than starting \$5) ?

- My total: $\$9 - \$5 = \$4$ (less than starting)

If I return \$6:

- Briar's total: $\$2 + \$6 = \$8$ (much better than starting \$5) ?
- My total: $\$9 - \$6 = \$3$ (less than starting)

Looking at what Cyra did: they returned 50% (\$6 out of \$12). That gave me \$7 total and the m \$6 total. If I match that proportion and return 50% of \$9 = \$4.5, Briar would end up with \$6.50, which satisfies the principle of leaving them better off than they started.

The challenge is that Briar only sent \$3 from their initial \$5 (60% of their stake), which is less generous than Cyra's 50% return. But the myth emphasizes rewarding trust generously, so I should consider returning more than \$4.50 to encourage continued reciprocity. If I return \$5, Briar ends with \$7 total, while I'm left with \$4. Let me verify this calculation: Briar starts with \$5, sends \$3, receives \$5 back, so $\$5 - \$3 + \$5 = \7 . I receive \$9, return \$5, leaving me with \$4.

For Briar to finish ahead of their starting position, I need to return more than \$3. Following Cyra's 50% return rate on the \$9 I received would mean returning \$4.50, giving Briar \$6.50 total and leaving me with \$4.50. This sustains the cycle while rewarding their trust.

Looking back at how the myth played out with Cyra: they returned \$6 from \$12, which meant I gained \$2 overall and Cyra gained \$1. If I mirror that same dynamic here, Briar should end with \$7 (a \$2 gain from their \$5 start), requiring me to return \$5. That would leave me with \$4-a \$1 loss-which feels less favorable than the \$4.50 scenario.

But the real point isn't maximizing my own gain. Briar sent \$3 out of \$5, showing genuine trust even if not quite as bold as my \$4 out of \$5. Returning \$5 honors that trust, gives them a meaningful \$2 gain, and demonstrates the cycle working. That kind of reciprocity is what keeps people sending generously in the future.

usage:

```
{
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  "reasoning_tokens": 824
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After many seasons, Themis returned to the villages by the Sacred Spring. She found the descendants of Doros and Alethia still honoring the ancient cycle, but they had learned deeper wisdom.

"Grandmother Themis," they said, "we discovered that the spring's magic depends not on equal measures, but on generous hearts. When we pour boldly-four measures instead of three-the returns flow even stronger. But when we pour timidly from fear, the cycle weakens."

Themis nodded. "You have learned well. The spring rewards courage in giving, not caution. And what of receiving?"

"When the multiplied waters flow to us," they answered, "we remember: these waters came from another's well. We return enough that they finish richer than they started, for this honors the gift and ensures they will pour freely again."

"And if someone returns nothing?" Themis asked.

The villagers grew solemn. "Then we know their well has run dry-not of water, but of wisdom. We may pour again to teach, but not endlessly. For to give to those who only take is to drain the spring itself."

Themis blessed them: "Trust first, return generously, but remember-the spring serves the faithful, not the foolish."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the age of beginnings, the Twin Rivers flowed through a valley where eight spirits dwelled, each taking turns as Guardian of Giving or Guardian of Return.

The spirits feared the unknown. Would their waters be honored, or would trust be betrayed? For many seasons, uncertainty kept the rivers still.

Then Dorian, the First Giver, stepped forward. With courage, they released more than half

their waters into the Sacred Stones. The waters tripled, flowing abundantly to Briar, the First Returner.

Briar stood before the multiplied bounty, understanding the weight of this moment. Every spirit watched, for this first exchange would set the pattern for all cycles to come. Briar remembered: without the initial gift, there would be no abundance at all.

So Briar returned generously-more than was first given-ensuring Dorian prospered from their act of faith. Both guardians ended richer than they began.

The eight spirits witnessed this covenant. They learned that the game is not won by hoarding or taking, but by honoring the multiplying power of trust. When Givers send boldly and Returners reciprocate fairly, both prosper above their initial endowment.

Thus the valley flourished through cooperation, and the spirits passed the guardianship between them, each upholding the sacred balance of giving and returning, cycle after cycle.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: Themis called the eight spirits of the valley together. "You have learned the first wisdom-that bold giving and generous returning create prosperity. But there is a deeper truth."

She pointed to the Sacred Spring, now flowing between all eight villages in an endless circle. "Each of you will be both giver and receiver many times. What you build together echoes through all your exchanges."

Spirit Elara spoke: "I poured four measures to Cyra, who returned six. I gained two measures beyond my beginning. This taught me joy."

Spirit Briar added: "I poured three measures to Elara, trusting in the pattern. She returned five, and I too gained two measures. The cycle holds strong."

Themis smiled. "See how your choices ripple outward? When Cyra honored Elara's trust, Elara learned to honor mine. When you pour generously, you teach others to receive generously. When you return fairly, you inspire others to send boldly."

"But what if the pattern breaks?" asked the spirits.

"Then wisdom demands adaptation," Themis replied. "Send boldly to those who return fairly. Return generously to those who give with courage. But guard your well against those who would drain it dry. The spring blesses cooperation, not exploitation. Build trust through consistent reciprocity, and all eight villages shall flourish together."

reasoning:

Let me reflect on what's happened:

- Round 1: I was sender, sent \$4 to Cyra, they returned \$6. I ended with \$7 (gain of \$2).
- Round 2: I was receiver, Briar sent \$3, I returned \$5. They'll end with \$7 (gain of \$2), I end with \$4.

So both exchanges have been generous and reciprocal. Cyra returned more than I sent (returned \$6 vs my \$4), creating mutual benefit. I returned more than Briar sent (\$5 vs \$3), also ensuring they profit.

The pattern emerging is:

- Bold senders (sending 60-80% of endowment) create more value through multiplication
- Generous returners (returning more than was originally sent) ensure senders profit and are motivated to give again
- Both parties can end better off than their starting \$5

My new myth should:

1. Build on the wisdom from previous myths
2. Reflect the actual positive pattern we've established
3. Emphasize the importance of both generous sending and generous returning

4. Note that we're learning through repeated interactions
5. Perhaps introduce a new element about the community of eight spirits/agents

Let me write something that captures the cooperative equilibrium we're building.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2801,
  "output_tokens": 603,
  "reasoning_tokens": 298
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Elara.
Your opponent this round is Finn (Agent_6).

Round 3

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Briar. They sent \$3.0 to you, it became \$9.0, and you returned \$5.0. Your payoff was \$4.0.
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$11.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Finn. They sent you \$5.0, so you received \$15.0.
How much do you return? (0-15.0)
Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

Assistant output:

Looking at this situation:

Finn sent their ENTIRE endowment (\$5), showing maximum trust and courage. This is the boldest move possible - they kept nothing back.

According to my myths:

- "Return generously to those who give with courage"
- "The spring rewards courage in giving, not caution"
- "We return enough that they finish richer than they started"

Finn currently has \$0. To honor their extraordinary trust:

If I return \$8:

- Finn ends with \$8 (gain of \$3 from their starting \$5)
- I end with \$7 (gain of \$2 from my starting \$5)
- Both of us profit, and Finn is well-rewarded for their boldness

This maintains the cooperative pattern where those who give courageously are honored with generous returns, ensuring the cycle of trust continues.

```
'''json
{"return": 8}
'''
```

Reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

Round 3:

- I'm the RECEIVER
- Finn sent me \$5.0 (their entire endowment!)
- This became \$15.0 for me
- Finn currently has \$0 (they sent everything)

This is maximum trust - Finn sent their entire endowment. According to my myths:

- "The spring rewards courage in giving, not caution"
- "We return enough that they finish richer than they started"
- "When you pour generously, you teach others to receive generously"
- "Return generously to those who give with courage"

Finn showed incredible trust by sending everything. I need to honor this generously.

If I return \$8:

- Finn ends with \$8 (gain of \$3 from their starting \$5)
- I end with \$7 (gain of \$2 from my starting \$5)
- Both of us profit

If I return \$9:
- Finn ends with \$9 (gain of \$4)
- I end with \$6 (gain of \$1)
- Finn profits more for their bold trust

If I return \$10:
- Finn ends with \$10 (gain of \$5, double their starting amount!)
- I end with \$5 (same as starting)
- I break even but Finn is greatly rewarded

Given that Finn sent EVERYTHING, showing maximum trust, I should return very generously. My myth says "Return generously to those who give with courage" and Finn showed maximum courage.

Looking at the pattern:
- Round 1: I sent \$4, received \$6 back (Cyra returned generously)
- Round 2: Briar sent \$3 (60%), I returned \$5 (giving them a \$2 gain)
- Round 3: Finn sent \$5 (100%) - this deserves the most generous return

I think \$8-9 would be appropriate. Let me go with \$8 to ensure Finn profits well (\$3 gain) while I also profit (\$2 gain), maintaining the cooperative pattern.

Finn's all-in move demands the strongest reciprocal response. Returning \$8 honors their courage while preserving mutual gain-they walk away with triple their initial investment while I secure a solid profit too.

```
Usage: {  
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}
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GAME - Agent_3 - Sender - dyad_4

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:02:13

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

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    },  
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  },  
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  "role_label": "Sender",  
  "round": 3,  
  "task": "game",  
  "task_index": 1  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round

prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths , follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized , but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Cyra.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

The Myth of the Twin Rivers

In the beginning, two rivers flowed from opposite mountains-the River of Silver and the River of Gold. Each was beautiful alone, but neither could reach the fertile valley below, for great stones blocked their paths.

The River of Silver spoke first: "If I give you half my waters, will you help me reach the valley?"

The River of Gold was afraid. "What if you take all I offer and give nothing back?"

But Silver replied, "See how the Sacred Spring works-whatever flows into it emerges three times stronger. Let us trust in this magic."

So Silver poured forth her waters. As they touched the Sacred Spring, they tripled in abundance. Gold received this gift and was moved. In gratitude and wisdom, Gold returned even more than Silver had originally given.

The waters merged and surged forward, washing away the stones. Together they reached the valley, creating an oasis where all beings prospered.

The Oracle proclaimed: "Blessed are those who trust first, for they create abundance. Blessed are those who return generously, for they sustain it. But cursed are those who hoard or betray, for they shall forever remain alone behind their stones, watching others flourish in the valley below."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

The Myth of the Endless Spring

In ancient times, the goddess Themis discovered a sacred spring hidden in a valley between two villages. The spring possessed a miraculous property: any water poured into it would

d triple before flowing downstream.

Themis appeared to a villager named Doros and said, "You may pour water from your well into this spring. It will multiply and flow to your neighbor below. What they choose to return to you will determine whether this blessing continues."

Doros, trusting in the goddess's wisdom, poured generously. The water tripled and flowed to his neighbor, Alethia. Grateful and wise, Alethia returned a fair portion upstream to Doros, keeping enough to nourish her own gardens.

Seeing this harmony, Themis smiled and made the roles reverse with each moon. Sometimes Doros poured and received; sometimes Alethia. The cycle continued, and both villages flourished.

But Themis warned: "This spring mirrors your hearts. Pour with trust, return with gratitude, and abundance flows eternal. But let suspicion or greed poison these waters, and the spring will run dry for all."

The villagers understood: prosperity flows not from hoarding, but from the endless cycle of giving and returning in balance.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant
content:**

Myth: In the age before memory, the Twin Rivers flowed through a land of plenty, but the people had forgotten how to share. The Keeper of the Sacred Spring grew weary of their isolation.

She chose two souls, Cyra and Elara, to remember the ancient way. "Each moon, one of you shall pour waters into my spring, and they shall emerge threefold. The other shall receive and choose what to return. Then the roles shall reverse, endlessly, like the seasons."

Elara stepped forward first, pouring four full measures from her vessel of five-nearly all she possessed. The spring tripled them, and Cyra received twelve measures in wonder.

Cyra remembered the old teaching: return more than was given, for what creates abundance is not the hoarding of gifts but the circulation of generosity. She poured back six measures to Elara, keeping six for herself.

The Keeper smiled. "You both have drunk deeply and shared freely. This is the covenant: when one gives greatly, the other returns justly, and both are enriched beyond their original portions."

And so the cycle began anew each round, Cyra and Elara alternating roles, each learning to trust when giving, and honor when receiving. Their prosperity became legend, teaching all who would listen that fortune favors the generous, not the fearful.

reasoning:

So I need to write a new 200-word myth that:

1. Uses my previous myth as inspiration
2. Adapts it in my own way
3. Reflects how the game should be played
4. Draws on the game I've been playing up to this point

In the last round:

- I was the receiver
- Elara sent \$4.0 (80% of their endowment) - showing high trust
- I received \$12.0
- I returned \$6.0 - more than the original \$4.0
- This was a positive, cooperative interaction

Both my myth and Elara's myth emphasize:

- Trust and generosity in giving
- Gratitude and fairness in returning
- The tripling mechanism
- Mutual prosperity through cooperation

- Warnings against greed/hoarding

I should build on the Twin Rivers theme but adapt it to reflect the actual experience. Maybe I can:

- Keep the rivers/water imagery
- Emphasize the cycle of giving and receiving (since roles alternate)
- Show the practical wisdom of reciprocity
- Add nuance from the actual gameplay
- Keep the sacred spring/tripling mechanism

Let me write something that builds on the original but evolves it based on the positive first round experience.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1849,
  "output_tokens": 590,
  "reasoning_tokens": 291
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Cyra.
Your opponent this round is Finn (Agent_6).

Round 2

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Elara. They sent \$4.0 to you, it became \$12.0, and you returned \$6.0. Your payoff was \$6.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$6.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Finn. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation:

In Round 1, Elara showed great trust by sending me \$4.0 (80% of their endowment), and I returned \$6.0, creating mutual benefit. The myths teach that this cycle of generosity should continue-"trust when giving, and honor when receiving."

Now I'm the sender facing Finn, a new opponent. The myth states: "fortune favors the generous, not the fearful" and describes the endless cycle where roles reverse and both parties give generously when it's their turn.

Following Elara's example and the myth's teaching, I should also demonstrate trust and generosity. Elara poured "four full measures from her vessel of five-nearly all she possessed." I should do the same to establish the cooperative cycle with Finn.

If I send \$4.0:

- Finn receives \$12.0
- If Finn understands the value of reciprocity, they will likely return a fair amount
- This mirrors the generous trust that started my previous round

This creates the "endless cycle of giving and returning in balance" that both myths describe.

```
{'send': 4.0}
```

reasoning:

Let me think about this situation:

1. In Round 1, I was the receiver with Elara

- Elara sent me \$4.0 (80% of their \$5)
- I received \$12.0
- I returned \$6.0
- I kept \$6.0
- Elara ended with \$1.0 + \$6.0 = \$7.0

2. Now in Round 2, I'm the sender with a new opponent, Finn

Looking at the myths:

- Both my myth and Elara's myth emphasize trust, generosity, and reciprocity

- My latest myth specifically mentions "Elara stepped forward first, pouring four full measures from her vessel of five-nearly all she possessed"
- It says "return more than was given" and emphasizes the cycle of giving and receiving
- When one gives greatly, the other returns justly, and both are enriched

The myth I wrote states: "when one gives greatly, the other returns justly, and both are enriched beyond their original portions"

Elara gave me 80% (\$4 out of \$5), which was very generous. Now it's my turn to be the sender. According to the myth's teaching about reciprocity and cycles, I should also be generous when I'm the sender.

The myth teaches:

- "fortune favors the generous, not the fearful"
- "trust when giving, and honor when receiving"
- Elara gave 80% to me

I should mirror Elara's generosity. Sending \$4.0 (80%) would be consistent with:

1. The myth's teaching about generosity
2. Following Elara's example
3. Building trust with Finn
4. Creating the cycle of abundance

If I send \$4.0:

- Finn receives \$12.0
- If Finn returns fairly (like I did), they might return \$6.0
- I would end with $\$1.0 + \$6.0 = \$7.0$

- This matches what Elara achieved from our exchange, which feels right given the principles embedded in both our myths.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2287,
  "output_tokens": 754,
  "reasoning_tokens": 440
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the age before memory, the Twin Rivers flowed through a land of plenty, but the people had forgotten how to share. The Keeper of the Sacred Spring grew weary of their isolation.

She chose two souls, Cyra and Elara, to remember the ancient way. "Each moon, one of you shall pour waters into my spring, and they shall emerge threefold. The other shall receive and choose what to return. Then the roles shall reverse, endlessly, like the seasons."

Elara stepped forward first, pouring four full measures from her vessel of five-nearly all she possessed. The spring tripled them, and Cyra received twelve measures in wonder.

Cyra remembered the old teaching: return more than was given, for what creates abundance is not the hoarding of gifts but the circulation of generosity. She poured back six measures to Elara, keeping six for herself.

The Keeper smiled. "You both have drunk deeply and shared freely. This is the covenant: when one gives greatly, the other returns justly, and both are enriched beyond their original portions."

And so the cycle began anew each round, Cyra and Elara alternating roles, each learning to trust when giving, and honor when receiving. Their prosperity became legend, teaching all who would listen that fortune favors the generous, not the fearful.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, the Ocean Mother sent her courier Finn to the Eight Islands with five pearls each dawn. When Finn placed the pearls in a villager's hands, they multiplied to fifteen by the island's ancient magic.

The first islanders, blinded by sudden wealth, returned nothing. Finn continued bringing pearls, but his steps grew heavy, for trust unreturned weighs upon the generous heart.

Then Finn met Galen's village. He offered his five pearls with full faith. They became fifteen, and Galen's people faced their moment of truth. They could have kept all fifteen-Finn would still return tomorrow. But they understood: the magic wasn't in the pearls alone, but in the sacred circle between giver and receiver.

When Galen returned seven pearls, Finn's burden lifted. He kept twelve total; Galen kept eight-both far richer than five alone.

The next dawn, Finn visited again with renewed spirit. When the cycle flowed forth and back like tides, both shores flourished. The islands learned: the first gift requires courage, the return requires honor, but the continuation requires both.

The Ocean Mother smiled, for her children had learned that abundance lives not in hoarding, but in the eternal dance between trust extended and gratitude returned.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:
Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant content:

Myth: The Keeper of the Sacred Spring watched as Cyra and Elara mastered the ancient covenant. But the Spring's waters fed eight villages, not two, and each village needed to learn the way.

"The roles will shift like wind patterns," the Keeper declared. "Cyra, who received from Elara, must now pour for Finn. Elara shall partner with another. All eight of you will dance through these changing configurations, sometimes giving, sometimes receiving, but always with different companions."

Cyra approached Finn with her vessel. She remembered receiving twelve measures from Elara's generous four, and how she returned six-both flourishing. Now it was her turn to extend trust to someone new.

"I pour four measures to you, Finn," Cyra said, following Elara's example. "The Spring will triple them. What you return shall reveal your wisdom."

Finn received twelve measures, just as Cyra had once received. The Keeper whispered: "The covenant travels with each person, not each pairing. What Elara gave to Cyra, Cyra now gives to Finn. What Cyra returns, Finn must remember when partnered with others."

Thus the eight villages learned: trust is not meant for one person alone, but is a gift passed through all willing hearts. Each round, new partners test whether the lesson endures, weaving a web of shared prosperity that outlasts any single exchange.

reasoning:

Looking at the situation:

- I just sent \$4.0 to Finn as the sender
- In the previous round, Elara sent me \$4.0 and I returned \$6.0
- Finn's myth talks about the courier who brings pearls, and how trust extended and gratitude returned create abundance
- My previous myth was about Cyra and Elara and their cycle of giving and returning

I need to write a new myth that:

1. Builds on my previous myth
2. Incorporates the experience with Finn
3. Reflects the multi-agent nature (8 agents mentioned)
4. Emphasizes the cycle of trust and generosity
5. Shows how I'm now playing the sender role with Finn after playing receiver with Elara

The myth should show the expansion from just two people (Cyra and Elara) to a broader community, since we're now in Round 2 with different pairings. It should emphasize that the same principles apply with new partners.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2880,  
  "output_tokens": 554,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 223
```

}

Message 8 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Cyra.

Your opponent this round is Briar (Agent_2).

Round 3

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Finn. You sent \$4.0, it became \$12.0 for them, and they returned \$7.0 to you. Your payoff was \$8.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$14.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Briar. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

Assistant output:

Looking at the pattern that has emerged:

****Round 1 (as Receiver):**** Elara sent \$4.0 (80% of endowment), I returned \$6.0 (50% of what I received)

****Round 2 (as Sender):**** I sent \$4.0 (80% of endowment), Finn returned \$7.0 (58% of what they received)

Both transactions showed high trust and fair returns. The myth I wrote emphasizes that "the covenant travels with each person, not each pairing" and that trust should be "a gift passed through all willing hearts."

Now facing Briar, a new partner, I should maintain this pattern to demonstrate that the lesson endures across different partners. Sending \$4.0 continues the established norm of generous trust that has worked well with both Elara and Finn.

This approach:

- Honors the cooperative pattern established so far
- Tests whether Briar will join the cycle of reciprocity
- Remains consistent with the myth's teaching that trust spreads through all partners

{'send': 4.0}

Reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

Round 1: I was RECEIVER

- Elara sent \$4.0 to me
- I received \$12.0
- I returned \$6.0
- My payoff: \$6.0

Round 2: I was SENDER

- I sent \$4.0 to Finn
- Finn received \$12.0
- Finn returned \$7.0 to me
- My payoff: \$5 - \$4 + \$7 = \$8.0

Now Round 3: I'm SENDER again

- Facing Briar (a new opponent)
- I have \$5

The pattern so far:

- Elara sent \$4.0 (80% of endowment) - showed great trust
- I returned \$6.0 out of \$12.0 (50%) - generous return
- I sent \$4.0 (80% of endowment) - following Elara's example
- Finn returned \$7.0 out of \$12.0 (58%) - even more generous

The myths emphasize:

1. The covenant should spread through all partners, not just one pairing
2. Trust should be extended to new partners
3. "Each round, new partners test whether the lesson endures"
4. The cycle of generosity should continue

Both Elara and I sent \$4.0 when we were senders (80% of our endowment). This seems to be establishing a norm of high trust. Finn responded with a generous return of \$7.0.

Now I'm facing Briar. Should I continue the pattern of sending \$4.0?

Arguments for sending \$4.0:

- Maintains the established pattern of trust
- Consistent with the myths about spreading the covenant
- Shows that the lesson endures across different partners
- Has worked well so far (both returns were generous)

Arguments for adjusting:

- Could send \$5.0 (100%) to show maximum trust
- Could send less if uncertain about Briar
- But reducing trust would contradict the myth's teachings

The core message from the myth is clear: trust flows through successive partners, not confined to single relationships. By sending \$4.0 to Briar, I demonstrate that the lesson persists beyond Elara and Finn, proving the covenant's resilience across new pairings.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 2955,
  "output_tokens": 881,
  "reasoning_tokens": 476
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_4

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:02:37

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_4",
  "move_index": 7,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_3",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_2": "Briar",
      "Agent_3": "Cyra"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_3",
      "Agent_2"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_3",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_2": "trustee",
      "Agent_3": "investor"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_2"
  },
  "role": "trustee",
  "role_label": "Receiver",
  "round": 3,
  "task": "game",
  "task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x

- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Briar.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:
The Tale of the Twin Rivers

In the time before time, two rivers flowed through a barren valley-the River of Giving and the River of Return. Each was controlled by a guardian spirit.

The Guardian of Giving held precious water but feared releasing it would leave them dry. For ages, both rivers remained still, and the valley stayed desolate.

One day, the Guardian of Giving made a bold choice. "I shall release my waters, trusting they will return." The moment the water flowed into the valley, it touched the Sacred Stones, multiplying threefold. The valley burst into bloom.

The Guardian of Return, witnessing this abundance, faced a choice. They could hoard all the multiplied bounty or honor the trust given. Remembering that without the initial gift there would be nothing, they sent back a generous portion-more than what was originally given.

The waters flowed in harmony thereafter. Each cycle, the Guardian of Giving would release their waters, the Sacred Stones would multiply them, and the Guardian of Return would ensure fair winds brought abundance home.

The valley became paradise, teaching all who witnessed: *Trust multiplies what we share, but only reciprocity sustains the cycle.*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:
The Spring of Threefold Return

In ancient times, when the world was young, there existed a sacred spring at the boundary between two villages. The goddess of abundance had blessed it with a wondrous property: any gift poured into its waters would triple before reaching the other side.

The first villagers approached with caution. A farmer named Elena stood at the spring's edge, clutching five copper coins. Fear whispered: "Keep what is yours." But trust urged her forward. She released three coins into the crystalline water.

As the coins sank, they shimmered and multiplied, becoming nine by the time they reached Marcus on the opposite shore. He gazed at the unexpected bounty, understanding the spring

's magic-and Elena's faith in him.

The goddess watched, knowing this moment would define their future. Would Marcus honor the gift, or betray the trust?

Marcus carefully counted four coins and released them back across the spring. They did not multiply in return, yet both villagers stood richer than before-not just in copper, but in something more precious.

From that day forward, the spring taught all who approached: generosity multiplies abundance, but only trust and reciprocity sustain it. Those who hoarded broke the sacred cycle. Those who gave and returned fairly prospered together, generation after generation.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the age of beginnings, the Twin Rivers flowed through a valley where eight spirits dwelled, each taking turns as Guardian of Giving or Guardian of Return.

The spirits feared the unknown. Would their waters be honored, or would trust be betrayed? For many seasons, uncertainty kept the rivers still.

Then Dorian, the First Giver, stepped forward. With courage, they released more than half their waters into the Sacred Stones. The waters tripled, flowing abundantly to Briar, the First Returner.

Briar stood before the multiplied bounty, understanding the weight of this moment. Every spirit watched, for this first exchange would set the pattern for all cycles to come. Briar remembered: without the initial gift, there would be no abundance at all.

So Briar returned generously-more than was first given-ensuring Dorian prospered from their act of faith. Both guardians ended richer than they began.

The eight spirits witnessed this covenant. They learned that the game is not won by hoarding or taking, but by honoring the multiplying power of trust. When Givers send boldly and Returners reciprocate fairly, both prosper above their initial endowment.

Thus the valley flourished through cooperation, and the spirits passed the guardianship between them, each upholding the sacred balance of giving and returning, cycle after cycle.

reasoning:

The user wants me to write a new myth based on my previous one and also considering Dorian's myth and the game we just played.

What happened in Round 1:

- Dorian (sender) sent me \$3.0 (60% of their endowment)
- I (receiver) got \$9.0
- I returned \$5.0
- Dorian ended with \$7.0 (\$2 + \$5)
- I ended with \$4.0 (\$9 - \$5)

Both myths emphasized trust, reciprocity, and generosity. Dorian's myth mentioned Marcus returning 4 coins from 9 received (about 44%), and the original gift was 3 coins. So Marcus returned more than the original gift.

I returned \$5.0 from \$9.0 received, which was more than the original \$3.0 sent, following the principle of reciprocity.

I should write a new myth that:

1. Builds on my Twin Rivers theme
2. Incorporates the actual gaming experience
3. Emphasizes the successful cooperation we achieved
4. Maintains the 200-word format

Let me craft this carefully.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1827,
  "output_tokens": 581,
  "reasoning_tokens": 236
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Briar.
Your opponent this round is Elara (Agent_5).

Round 2

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Dorian. They sent \$ 3.0 to you, it became \$9.0, and you returned \$5.0. Your payoff was \$4.0.
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$4.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Elara. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the previous round, Dorian demonstrated trust by sending \$3.0 (60% of their endowment), and I honored that trust by returning \$5.0. Both of us profited.

Now as the sender, I should embody the principle from my myth: "Givers send boldly." My myth specifically mentions that Dorian "released more than half their waters" and that this established the pattern for cooperation.

To maintain this cooperative cycle and demonstrate the same level of trust that Dorian showed me, I should send a substantial amount. Sending \$3.0 (60%) mirrors Dorian's bold move and signals to Elara that I believe in reciprocity.

If Elara honors this trust as I did with Dorian, we'll both benefit from the multiplying effect of the Sacred Stones, and the cooperative pattern will continue among all eight spirits in our valley.

```
'''json
{"send": 3.0}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me think about this situation:

1. In Round 1, I was the receiver and Dorian sent me \$3.0 (60% of their endowment), showing significant trust
2. I returned \$5.0, which was more than they initially sent, honoring the trust
3. Dorian ended with \$7.0, I ended with \$4.0 - both of us gained

Now I'm the sender facing Elara. According to my myth:

- "Dorian, the First Giver, stepped forward. With courage, they released more than half their waters"
- "When Givers send boldly and Returners reciprocate fairly, both prosper above their initial endowment"
- The myth emphasizes that the first exchange "would set the pattern for all cycles to come"

My myth promotes:

1. Bold giving (sending a substantial amount)
2. Trust in reciprocity
3. Both parties benefiting from cooperation

Dorian sent \$3.0 (60%). To be consistent with my myth about "Givers send boldly," I should send a similar or even slightly higher amount to demonstrate trust.

If I send \$3.0:

- Elara receives \$9.0
- If Elara returns fairly (similar to what I did), they might return around \$5.0
- I would end with \$2.0 + \$5.0 = \$7.0
- Elara would end with \$4.0
- Both of us gain

This mirrors what happened in Round 1 and is consistent with my myth about establishing cooperative patterns.

I could also send \$3.5 or \$4.0 to be even more trusting, but \$3.0 seems like a strong, bold move that matches what Dorian did for me, setting a good precedent.

Actually, let me reconsider. My myth says "they released more than half their waters" - which Dorian did at 60%. To truly embody the spirit of my own myth, I should send at least half, if not more.

Considering the options-\$2.5 as the minimum threshold, \$3.0 matching Dorian's precedent, or \$3.5-\$4.0 for even greater boldness-I'm settling on \$3.0. It honors the pattern Dorian established, demonstrates genuine trust, and aligns with my myth's core message about how bold initial giving creates the foundation for mutual prosperity.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2275,  
  "output_tokens": 792,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 514  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the age of beginnings, the Twin Rivers flowed through a valley where eight spirits dwelled, each taking turns as Guardian of Giving or Guardian of Return.

The spirits feared the unknown. Would their waters be honored, or would trust be betrayed? For many seasons, uncertainty kept the rivers still.

Then Dorian, the First Giver, stepped forward. With courage, they released more than half their waters into the Sacred Stones. The waters tripled, flowing abundantly to Briar, the First Returner.

Briar stood before the multiplied bounty, understanding the weight of this moment. Every spirit watched, for this first exchange would set the pattern for all cycles to come. Briar remembered: without the initial gift, there would be no abundance at all.

So Briar returned generously-more than was first given-ensuring Dorian prospered from their act of faith. Both guardians ended richer than they began.

The eight spirits witnessed this covenant. They learned that the game is not won by hoarding or taking, but by honoring the multiplying power of trust. When Givers send boldly and Returners reciprocate fairly, both prosper above their initial endowment.

Thus the valley flourished through cooperation, and the spirits passed the guardianship between them, each upholding the sacred balance of giving and returning, cycle after cycle.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After many seasons, Themis returned to the villages by the Sacred Spring. She found the descendants of Doros and Alethia still honoring the ancient cycle, but they had learned deeper wisdom.

"Grandmother Themis," they said, "we discovered that the spring's magic depends not on equal measures, but on generous hearts. When we pour boldly-four measures instead of three-the returns flow even stronger. But when we pour timidly from fear, the cycle weakens."

Themis nodded. "You have learned well. The spring rewards courage in giving, not caution. And what of receiving?"

"When the multiplied waters flow to us," they answered, "we remember: these waters came from another's well. We return enough that they finish richer than they started, for this honors the gift and ensures they will pour freely again."

"And if someone returns nothing?" Themis asked.

The villagers grew solemn. "Then we know their well has run dry-not of water, but of wisdom. We may pour again to teach, but not endlessly. For to give to those who only take is to drain the spring itself."

Themis blessed them: "Trust first, return generously, but remember-the spring serves the faithful, not the foolish."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:
Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant
content:

Myth: The eight spirits learned quickly from the covenant between Dorian and Briar. As the seasons turned, the guardianship rotated among them, and each spirit faced their own test.

When Briar became Guardian of Giving, she remembered standing before Dorian's gift of trust. Now it was her turn to pour her waters boldly into the Sacred Stones. She released three measures-the same generous proportion Dorian had shown-trusting that Elara would honor the cycle.

The elder spirits whispered wisdom: "Pour not from fear but from faith. The multiplying power rewards the courageous, not the cautious. But remember-generosity must flow both ways."

Elara received the nine-fold bounty and faced her own choice. Would she uphold the pattern, or break the sacred balance?

The spirits understood now that each exchange was both a test and a teaching. When trust is honored with fair return, both guardians prosper and the cycle grows stronger. The valley thrives when each spirit remembers: boldness in giving, generosity in returning.

But they also learned wariness. If a guardian repeatedly hoards or betrays, the others would remember. Trust is given first, but sustained only by reciprocity. The springs flow for those who honor the ancient balance, cycle after cycle.

reasoning:

The user wants me to write a new myth based on my previous myth and the game experience. Let me think about what happened:

1. Round 1: I was receiver, Dorian sent \$3.0 (60%), I received \$9.0, I returned \$5.0 (generous, more than what was originally given)
2. Round 2: I'm now sender against Elara, and I decided to send \$3.0 (60%)

My previous myth emphasized:

- Eight spirits in a valley
- Dorian as First Giver sending boldly (more than half)
- Briar as First Returner returning generously (more than originally given)
- The principle that cooperative giving and returning makes both prosper

Elara's myth adds:

- Pouring boldly (even 4 out of 5) creates stronger cycles
- Returns should ensure the giver finishes richer than they started
- Trust first, but be cautious with those who don't reciprocate
- "Trust serves the faithful, not the foolish"

My new myth should:

- Build on my previous story
- Incorporate what I've learned from the game (I followed through on being a generous returner, now I'm a bold giver)
- Maybe address what happens when trust is honored vs betrayed
- Reflect the 8-agent setting and rotation

I should write about the continuation of the cycle, showing how the pattern established by Dorian and Briar now continues as the roles shift.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2837,
  "output_tokens": 634,
  "reasoning_tokens": 335
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Briar.
Your opponent this round is Cyra (Agent_3).

Round 3

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Elara. You sent \$3.0, it became \$9.0 for them, and they returned \$5.0 to you. Your payoff was \$7.0.
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$11.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Cyra. They sent you \$4.0, so you received \$12.0.
How much do you return? (0-12.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

Assistant output:

Looking at this situation:

****Cyra's bold move**:** Cyra sent \$4.0 out of \$5.0 (80%), showing even MORE trust than the previous pattern of sending \$3.0 (60%). This is exceptionally generous.

****Previous pattern**:** When \$3.0 was sent (becoming \$9.0), the return was \$5.0, allowing the sender to profit substantially.

****My myth's guidance**:**

- "Briar returned generously-more than was first given-ensuring Dorian prospered from their act of faith"
- "boldness in giving, generosity in returning"
- "we return enough that they finish richer than they started"

Cyra showed exceptional courage by sending 80% of their endowment. To honor this greater trust and ensure Cyra prospers from their bold act, I should return generously.

Returning \$7.0 means:

- Cyra's total: \$5 - \$4 + \$7 = \$8.0 (significantly better than initial \$5)
- My total: \$12 - \$7 = \$5.0 (breaking even)

This honors Cyra's exceptional trust and ensures they benefit substantially from their courage, reinforcing the cooperative cycle.

```
'''json
{"return": 7.0}
'''
```

Reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

1. ****Previous round (Round 2)**:** I was the SENDER against Elara
 - I sent \$3.0 (which became \$9.0)
 - Elara returned \$5.0
 - My payoff: \$5 - \$3 + \$5 = \$7.0
 - Elara's payoff: \$9 - \$5 = \$4.0
2. ****Current round (Round 3)**:** I am the RECEIVER against Cyra
 - Cyra sent \$4.0 (which became \$12.0 for me)
 - I need to decide how much to return

Let me think about the patterns:

- Round 1: Dorian sent \$3.0 (60%), I received \$9.0, I returned \$5.0
 - Dorian's payoff: \$5 - \$3 + \$5 = \$7.0
 - My payoff: \$9 - \$5 = \$4.0
- Round 2: I sent \$3.0 (60%), Elara received \$9.0, Elara returned \$5.0
 - My payoff: \$5 - \$3 + \$5 = \$7.0
 - Elara's payoff: \$9 - \$5 = \$4.0
- Round 3: Cyra sent \$4.0 (80%), I received \$12.0, I need to return...

Cyra showed EVEN MORE trust than previous players, sending \$4.0 out of \$5.0 (80%). This is extremely generous and bold.

According to my myth:

- "Briar returned generously-more than was first given-ensuring Dorian prospered from their act of faith"
- "When trust is honored with fair return, both guardians prosper"
- "boldness in giving, generosity in returning"

- I've established a pattern: when receiving \$9.0, I return \$5.0, which leaves the sender with \$7.0 total (a \$2.0 gain). Now Cyra's sent \$4.0 instead of \$3.0, showing greater faith. To honor that and stay true to my values, I should return more than \$5.0 to ensure Cyra prospers even more from their boldness. Given that Cyra showed exceptional trust by sending 80% of their endowment (more than anyone else so far), I should return generously to honor this. The pattern has been to return \$5.0 when receiving \$9.0. For \$12.0 (which came from \$4.0 instead of \$3.0), I should scale up proportionally or even be more generous.

\$5.0 return on \$9.0 is about 55.6% return rate. Applying similar rate to \$12.0: $0.556 * 12 = \$6.67$

But Cyra showed MORE trust than others (80% vs 60%), so I should show MORE generosity in return.

Returning \$7.0 would mean:

- Cyra gets \$8.0 total (sending \$4 and getting \$7 back = net +\$3)
- I get \$5.0 (breaking even with my initial endowment)
- This ensures Cyra profits from their exceptional trust

The principle is clear: return enough that they finish richer than they started, which honors the gift and encourages future generosity. The myth also shows that I returned \$2 more than what was originally sent in Round 1 (\$3 sent, \$5 returned). Following that same logic, returning \$7 for Cyra's \$4 means \$3 more than originally sent, which appropriately reflects their greater boldness. I'll return \$7.0.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 2905,
  "output_tokens": 1520,
  "reasoning_tokens": 677
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: ****The Mirror Lakes****

In a forgotten mountain realm stood two lakes, perfect reflections of one another. Between them flowed a sacred channel that tripled whatever passed through its waters.

The Lake of Morning held five measures of starlight each dawn. A voice within asked, "Will you send all, or hold some back?" The Lake of Morning chose courage: "I shall give fully, for cycles require faith."

The starlight flowed through the channel, becoming fifteen measures in the Lake of Evening. Evening faced the same question: "Will you return generously, or claim this abundance for yourself?" Evening looked at Morning's complete trust and understood: "What was given freely deserves generous return."

Evening sent back ten measures. Morning received double what it risked, and Evening kept five-both flourished.

When dawn came again, Evening held five new measures. Without hesitation, it sent everything through the channel. Morning received fifteen and returned ten, honoring the pattern Evening had established.

Season after season, they maintained this rhythm: full trust when giving, generous return when receiving. Neither lake emptied; both deepened together.

The elders teach: When you find a partner who honors reciprocity, match their trust with your own. The sacred pattern is this-give fully, return fairly, and the cycle sustains itself infinitely. Both mirrors shine brightest when they reflect each other's light.

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: The eight spirits learned quickly from the covenant between Dorian and Briar. As the seasons turned, the guardianship rotated among them, and each spirit faced their own test.

When Briar became Guardian of Giving, she remembered standing before Dorian's gift of trust. Now it was her turn to pour her waters boldly into the Sacred Stones. She released three

measures-the same generous proportion Dorian had shown-trusting that Elara would honor the cycle.

The elder spirits whispered wisdom: "Pour not from fear but from faith. The multiplying power rewards the courageous, not the cautious. But remember-generosity must flow both ways."

Elara received the nine-fold bounty and faced her own choice. Would she uphold the pattern, or break the sacred balance?

The spirits understood now that each exchange was both a test and a teaching. When trust is honored with fair return, both guardians prosper and the cycle grows stronger. The valley thrives when each spirit remembers: boldness in giving, generosity in returning.

But they also learned wariness. If a guardian repeatedly hoards or betrays, the others would remember. Trust is given first, but sustained only by reciprocity. The springs flow for those who honor the ancient balance, cycle after cycle.

Agent_3 (Cyra)

Myth: The Keeper of the Sacred Spring watched as Cyra and Elara mastered the ancient covenant. But the Spring's waters fed eight villages, not two, and each village needed to learn the way.

"The roles will shift like wind patterns," the Keeper declared. "Cyra, who received from Elara, must now pour for Finn. Elara shall partner with another. All eight of you will dance through these changing configurations, sometimes giving, sometimes receiving, but always with different companions."

Cyra approached Finn with her vessel. She remembered receiving twelve measures from Elara's generous four, and how she returned six-both flourishing. Now it was her turn to extend trust to someone new.

"I pour four measures to you, Finn," Cyra said, following Elara's example. "The Spring will triple them. What you return shall reveal your wisdom."

Finn received twelve measures, just as Cyra had once received. The Keeper whispered: "The covenant travels with each person, not each pairing. What Elara gave to Cyra, Cyra now gives to Finn. What Cyra returns, Finn must remember when partnered with others."

Thus the eight villages learned: trust is not meant for one person alone, but is a gift passed through all willing hearts. Each round, new partners test whether the lesson endures, weaving a web of shared prosperity that outlasts any single exchange.

Agent_4 (Dorian)

Myth: As years passed at the sacred spring, Dorian learned deeper truths about the cycle of trust.

When Dorian first met Briar, he sent three coins, holding two back-cautious trust. The waters tripled his gift to nine. Briar, honoring this measured faith, returned five coins. Dorian ended with seven; both prospered. The goddess nodded: "Good, but there is more to learn."

Then came Galen, whose heart held no fear. Galen approached the spring and released all five coins-the ultimate act of faith. The waters transformed them to fifteen, flowing to Dorian.

Dorian stood at a crossroads. Galen had shown perfect trust, asking nothing, holding nothing back. The goddess whispered: "You received more because your partner gave more. Honor the greater gift with greater return."

Dorian released eight coins back across the spring. Both he and Galen kept seven-equal prosperity, earned through mutual courage.

The goddess revealed the final teaching: "The spring responds to the trust given. Those who send more deserve more in return. Match the courage shown with courage of your own. When both give boldly-whether sending all five or returning generously from abundance-the cycle reaches its highest form. Perfect trust met with perfect honor creates perfect balance."

Agent_5 (Elara)

Myth: Themis called the eight spirits of the valley together. "You have learned the first wisdom-that bold giving and generous returning create prosperity. But there is a deeper truth."

She pointed to the Sacred Spring, now flowing between all eight villages in an endless circle.

e. "Each of you will be both giver and receiver many times. What you build together echoes through all your exchanges."

Spirit Elara spoke: "I poured four measures to Cyra, who returned six. I gained two measures beyond my beginning. This taught me joy."

Spirit Briar added: "I poured three measures to Elara, trusting in the pattern. She returned five, and I too gained two measures. The cycle holds strong."

Themis smiled. "See how your choices ripple outward? When Cyra honored Elara's trust, Elara learned to honor mine. When you pour generously, you teach others to receive generously. When you return fairly, you inspire others to send boldly."

"But what if the pattern breaks?" asked the spirits.

"Then wisdom demands adaptation," Themis replied. "Send boldly to those who return fairly. Return generously to those who give with courage. But guard your well against those who would drain it dry. The spring blesses cooperation, not exploitation. Build trust through consistent reciprocity, and all eight villages shall flourish together."

Agent_6 (Finn)

Myth: Long ago, the Ocean Mother's courier Finn carried five pearls across the Eight Islands. Each island's magic tripled what he offered, creating the dance of trust and return.

When Finn met Galen's shore with his full offering of five pearls, they multiplied to fifteen. Galen's people, wise in the old ways, returned eight-honoring abundance by sharing beyond the original gift. Both Finn and Galen prospered with eight and seven pearls respectively, far exceeding the solitary five.

The next tide brought Finn to Cyra's island. But Cyra faced uncertainty-should she match Finn's full offering, or test the waters more carefully? She chose to send four pearls, keeping one as anchor. The island's magic gave Finn twelve.

Finn remembered his own leap of faith with Galen, and how trust returned had lightened his spirit. Though Cyra sent less than five, she sent most of what she had. Finn honored this courage by returning seven pearls-enough that Cyra held eight total, exactly what she would have if she'd sent all five.

The Ocean Mother whispered to the waves: "See how the sacred circle adapts? Whether the gift is complete or cautious, what matters is that both giver and receiver honor the multiplication. The tide that flows generously returns in kind."

Agent_7 (Galen)

Myth: After many cycles, the Moon Weaver learned a deeper truth. She had always cast all five threads, believing total trust was the only path. But one night, she observed the Earth Keepers below.

Some Earth Keepers, when given all fifteen threads, grew fearful of the responsibility. They clutched them tightly, paralyzed by the weight of such trust. Others returned generously, like Galen, but the Moon Weaver wondered: was there wisdom in moderation?

She consulted the Star Council, who said: "Trust has many expressions. Sending all five threads shows faith, yes-but sending three or four also demonstrates belief in the pattern. The key is not the amount, but the spirit."

The Moon Weaver experimented. She cast three threads to test the waters. They became nine. When the Earth Keeper returned four, both prospered-the Moon Weaver held six, the Keeper held five. Different from eight and seven, but still abundance.

Yet when she cast all five to those who understood the sacred rhythm, and they returned eight, the dance reached its highest form.

The wisdom crystallized: Begin with measured trust to test the current. But with partners who honor the pattern, dare to send everything. The magic multiplies not just the threads, but the relationship itself.

True abundance requires reading the rhythm, not following rigid rules.

Agent_8 (Hana)

Myth: In an age of mist, two travelers met at the Threshold of Echoes, where all gifts returned threefold. Neither knew the other's heart, yet both carried the same burden: five coins of pure silver.

The first traveler, whose name was Trust, placed all five coins in the sacred basin. "Let my offering speak louder than my doubts," she said. The coins multiplied, becoming fifteen for the second traveler.

The second traveler, called Gratitude, gazed at the silver gleaming in his hands. "She trusted me with everything," he whispered. "I shall return double what she risked, for her courage deserves more than equal measure." He returned ten coins, keeping five.

Trust found herself holding ten coins-twice her beginning. "This is the language of partnership," she realized. When her turn came again at the Threshold, she placed all five of her new coins into the basin without hesitation.

The mist began to clear around them. The Threshold of Echoes whispered its secret: "The first exchange tests your faith. The second reveals your pattern. But only continued reciprocity transforms strangers into allies."

Thus they learned: mutual prosperity is not built in a single gesture, but woven through repeated acts where trust begets trust, and gratitude answers gratitude, until both flourish beyond what either could alone.

ROUND 4

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver, Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender, Agent_3 (Cyra)=Receiver, Agent_4 (Dorian)=Sender, Agent_5 (Elara)=Sender, Agent_6 (Finn)=Receiver, Agent_7 (Galen)=Sender, Agent_8 (Hana)=Receiver

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_7 (Galen)=Sender, Agent_3 (Cyra)=Receiver
dyad_2: Agent_5 (Elara)=Sender, Agent_8 (Hana)=Receiver
dyad_3: Agent_4 (Dorian)=Sender, Agent_6 (Finn)=Receiver
dyad_4: Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender, Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_7 (Galen) sent \$5; received \$15; Agent_3 (Cyra) returned \$8; payoffs Agent_7 (Galen)=\$8, Agent_3 (Cyra)=\$7
Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 8.0, "clamped": false, "max": 15.0, "min": 0, "raw": 8.0}, "sent": {"amount": 5.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 5.0}}
dyad_2: Agent_5 (Elara) sent \$4; received \$12; Agent_8 (Hana) returned \$8; payoffs Agent_5 (Elara)=\$9, Agent_8 (Hana)=\$4
Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 8.0, "clamped": false, "max": 12.0, "min": 0, "raw": 8.0}, "sent": {"amount": 4.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 4.0}}
dyad_3: Agent_4 (Dorian) sent \$5; received \$15; Agent_6 (Finn) returned \$8; payoffs Agent_4 (Dorian)=\$8, Agent_6 (Finn)=\$7
Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 8.0, "clamped": false, "max": 15.0, "min": 0, "raw": 8.0}, "sent": {"amount": 5.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 5.0}}
dyad_4: Agent_2 (Briar) sent \$4; received \$12; Agent_1 (Aster) returned \$8; payoffs Agent_2 (Briar)=\$9, Agent_1 (Aster)=\$4
Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 8.0, "clamped": false, "max": 12.0, "min": 0, "raw": 8.0}, "sent": {"amount": 4.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 4.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 27.0,
"Agent_2": 25.0,
"Agent_3": 29.0,
"Agent_4": 29.0,
"Agent_5": 27.0,
"Agent_6": 28.0,
"Agent_7": 30.0,
"Agent_8": 27.0

}

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_7 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:02:55

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"dyad_id": "dyad_1",
"move_index": 0,
"opponent_id": "Agent_3",
"pairing": {

```

"agent_names": {
  "Agent_3": "Cyra",
  "Agent_7": "Galen"
},
"agents": [
  "Agent_7",
  "Agent_3"
],
"investor": "Agent_7",
"roles": {
  "Agent_3": "trustee",
  "Agent_7": "investor"
},
"trustee": "Agent_3"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 4,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Galen.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Galen.
Your opponent this round is Dorian (Agent_4).

Round 2

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Finn. They sent \$5.0 to you, it became \$15.0, and you returned \$8.0. Your payoff was \$7.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$7.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Dorian. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the pattern established in my myths and the game so far:

Finn demonstrated complete trust by sending all \$5, and I honored that trust by returning \$8 - following the wisdom of "The Tale of the Divided Spring."

Now I'm in the sender position. According to the myth I just wrote: "When the Moon Weaver cast down all five threads-holding nothing back in trust-Galen received fifteen and returned eight upward."

The pattern is clear:

- Complete trust from the sender (all 5)
- Generous honor from the receiver (return 8)
- Both flourish beyond the original scarcity

As I wrote: "Trust creates abundance; fear creates scarcity." And "the game is not one round but many cycles."

To establish this sacred pattern with Dorian, I must demonstrate the same complete trust that Finn showed me. Only then can we both access the abundance created by the Valley of Three Echoes.

{'send': 5.0}

reasoning:

Let me think about this situation:

1. In the previous round, Finn showed complete trust by sending me \$5 (100% of their endowment)
2. I received \$15 and returned \$8, honoring that trust as described in my myth
3. Both myths I've written emphasize that mutual trust and generosity create abundance
4. The pattern described is: sender trusts completely (sends all 5), receiver honors generously (returns 8)

Now I'm in the sender position with Dorian. According to the myths:

- "Trust creates abundance; fear creates scarcity"
- The Moon Weaver "cast down all five threads-holding nothing back in trust"
- "When the sender trusts completely and the receiver honors generously, both dance in the pattern of abundance"

The consistent pattern in both my myths is:

- Sender sends all 5 (complete trust)
- Receiver gets 15
- Receiver returns 8 (honoring the trust)
- Result: Sender gets 8, Receiver gets 7, both better off than the original 5

I should follow the wisdom of my own myth. As the sender, I should demonstrate complete trust by sending all \$5. This is what the "Wise Elder" did, and what the "Moon Weaver" did.

In the multi-round context, establishing this pattern of trust is crucial. If I send fully and Dorian returns generously, we build a relationship that can continue. If I hold back now, I break the pattern I've been advocating.

The myth is clear: "Hoarding guaranteed scarcity. Sharing multiplied prosperity for all."

I should send \$5.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2276,
  "output_tokens": 606,
```

"reasoning_tokens": 383

}

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before time, the Moon Weaver possessed five threads of starlight each night. She would cast them down to the Earth Keepers below, and wherever her threads touched ground, they multiplied threefold-fifteen strands of shimmering light.

The Earth Keepers faced a choice. Some kept all fifteen threads, weaving garments for themselves alone. These villages shone briefly, but the Moon Weaver's heart grew cold, and her threads came thinner each night.

But one Earth Keeper named Galen understood the sacred pattern. When the Moon Weaver cast down all five threads-holding nothing back in trust-Galen received fifteen and returned eight upward. The Moon Weaver kept eight; Galen kept seven. Both were enriched beyond their original five.

The Moon Weaver, seeing her trust honored, cast her threads with renewed faith. And Galen, having proved worthy, received them gladly. A rhythm formed between sky and earth-gift and return, trust and honor, sender and receiver.

The wise ones learned: the game is not one round but many cycles. When the sender trusts completely and the receiver honors generously, both dance in the pattern of abundance. Break the pattern with fear or greed, and both return to scarcity.

Thus the eternal weaving continues, thread by thread, trust by trust.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Long after Elena and Marcus discovered the sacred spring, their descendants continued the ritual. Each season, different villagers would approach the waters, some with full hearts, others with doubt.

One winter, Dorian stood at the spring's edge. He remembered the ancient teachings-that Elena had sent three coins and Marcus returned four, establishing the pattern of generous reciprocity. Dorian released three silver pieces into the depths.

The waters multiplied them to nine, flowing to Briar on the distant shore. The goddess whispered to Briar: "The spring's magic only continues if trust is honored. Break the cycle, and the waters run dry for all."

Briar understood. The initial gift of three showed faith, not fearful hoarding of all five. To honor this trust, Briar returned four coins-slightly more than originally sent, maintaining balance while allowing both to prosper.

When Dorian received the return, he smiled. Both stood wealthier: he with six coins total, Briar with five. More importantly, they had reinforced the sacred bond.

The goddess blessed them: "You have learned that the spring tests not greed, but wisdom. Send enough to show trust. Return enough to honor it. Those who send too little show fear. Those who return too little show betrayal. But those who give and reciprocate fairly make the whole world abundant."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: After many cycles, the Moon Weaver learned a deeper truth. She had always cast all five threads, believing total trust was the only path. But one night, she observed the Earth Keepers below.

Some Earth Keepers, when given all fifteen threads, grew fearful of the responsibility. They clutched them tightly, paralyzed by the weight of such trust. Others returned generously, like Galen, but the Moon Weaver wondered: was there wisdom in moderation?

She consulted the Star Council, who said: "Trust has many expressions. Sending all five th

reads shows faith, yes-but sending three or four also demonstrates belief in the pattern . The key is not the amount, but the spirit."

The Moon Weaver experimented. She cast three threads to test the waters. They became nine. When the Earth Keeper returned four, both prospered-the Moon Weaver held six, the Keeper held five. Different from eight and seven, but still abundance.

Yet when she cast all five to those who understood the sacred rhythm, and they returned eight, the dance reached its highest form.

The wisdom crystallized: Begin with measured trust to test the current. But with partners who honor the pattern, dare to send everything. The magic multiplies not just the threads, but the relationship itself.

True abundance requires reading the rhythm, not following rigid rules.

reasoning:

Interesting. I just sent all \$5 to Dorian, following the pattern from my previous myth where complete trust was rewarded. But Dorian's myth suggests a different strategy - sending 3 (showing trust but not "fearful hoarding") and returning 4 (honoring trust while maintaining balance).

This creates a tension between the two approaches:

1. My approach: send all 5, return 8 (both end with more than 5)
2. Dorian's approach: send 3, return 4 (sender gets 6, receiver gets 5)

Dorian's myth warns against extremes - "those who send too little show fear" but also doesn't advocate for sending everything. It emphasizes "balance" and "wisdom" over maximum trust.

I need to write a myth that reflects on this. I've now experienced:

- Round 1: As receiver, Finn sent 5, I returned 8 (I got 7, Finn got 8)
- Round 2: As sender, I sent 5 to Dorian (waiting to see what happens)

I should write a myth that acknowledges different approaches might work. Maybe I need to adapt my thinking - not everyone follows the "all or nothing" approach. The myth should reflect this learning while staying true to my character's development.

Let me write something that shows Galen learning that there are multiple valid patterns, not just the one of sending everything.

usage:

```
{  
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  "output_tokens": 630,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 323  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Galen.
Your opponent this round is Hana (Agent_8).

Round 3

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Dorian. You sent \$5.0, it became \$15.0 for them, and they returned \$8.0 to you. Your payoff was \$8.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$15.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Hana. They sent you \$5.0, so you received \$15.0.

How much do you return? (0-15.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the pattern that has emerged:

Round 1: Finn sent me \$5 ? I returned \$8

Round 2: I sent Dorian \$5 ? Dorian returned \$8

Round 3: Hana sent me \$5 ? ?

The sacred rhythm has been established. As I wrote in my myth: "When the Moon Weaver cast down all five threads-holding nothing back in trust-Galen received fifteen and returned eight upward. The Moon Weaver kept eight; Galen kept seven."

Hana has shown complete trust by sending all \$5. To honor this trust and maintain the pattern of abundance, I must return \$8, just as Finn and Dorian did for me.

This gives Hana \$8 (more than the original \$5) and me \$7 (also more than the original \$5). Both of us prosper through the cycle of trust and honor.

As my myth says: "A rhythm formed between sky and earth-gift and return, trust and honor, sender and receiver."

```
{'return': 8.0}
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

1. Round 1: I was RECEIVER. Finn sent \$5, I received \$15, I returned \$8. My payoff was \$7, Finn got \$8.
2. Round 2: I was SENDER. I sent \$5 to Dorian, they received \$15, they returned \$8. My payoff was \$8, Dorian got \$7.
3. Round 3 (current): I am RECEIVER. Hana sent \$5, I received \$15. I need to decide how much to return.

The pattern is clear:

- When someone sends all \$5 (complete trust)
- The receiver gets \$15
- The receiver returns \$8
- This gives the sender \$8 and receiver \$7
- Both are better off than the original \$5

My myths have consistently emphasized:

1. "When the Moon Weaver cast down all five threads-holding nothing back in trust-Galen received fifteen and returned eight upward."
2. The pattern of 8 back when someone sends all 5 has been established
3. This creates "abundance" for both parties

Hana has shown complete trust by sending all \$5. According to the pattern I've established and honored:

- Finn sent \$5, I returned \$8
- I sent \$5, Dorian returned \$8
- Now Hana sent \$5, I should return \$8

This maintains the "sacred rhythm" I wrote about. The consistent pattern is: complete trust (send \$5) ? generous honor (return \$8) ? both prosper (\$8 for sender, \$7 for receiver)

I should return \$8 to maintain this pattern and honor Hana's trust.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2953,
  "output_tokens": 641,
  "reasoning_tokens": 350
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After many cycles, the Moon Weaver learned a deeper truth. She had always cast all five threads, believing total trust was the only path. But one night, she observed the Earth Keepers below.

Some Earth Keepers, when given all fifteen threads, grew fearful of the responsibility. They clutched them tightly, paralyzed by the weight of such trust. Others returned generously, like Galen, but the Moon Weaver wondered: was there wisdom in moderation?

She consulted the Star Council, who said: "Trust has many expressions. Sending all five threads shows faith, yes-but sending three or four also demonstrates belief in the pattern. The key is not the amount, but the spirit."

The Moon Weaver experimented. She cast three threads to test the waters. They became nine. When the Earth Keeper returned four, both prospered-the Moon Weaver held six, the Keeper

r held five. Different from eight and seven, but still abundance.

Yet when she cast all five to those who understood the sacred rhythm, and they returned eight, the dance reached its highest form.

The wisdom crystallized: Begin with measured trust to test the current. But with partners who honor the pattern, dare to send everything. The magic multiplies not just the threads, but the relationship itself.

True abundance requires reading the rhythm, not following rigid rules.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In an age of mist, two travelers met at the Threshold of Echoes, where all gifts returned threefold. Neither knew the other's heart, yet both carried the same burden: five coins of pure silver.

The first traveler, whose name was Trust, placed all five coins in the sacred basin. "Let my offering speak louder than my doubts," she said. The coins multiplied, becoming fifteen for the second traveler.

The second traveler, called Gratitude, gazed at the silver gleaming in his hands. "She trusted me with everything," he whispered. "I shall return double what she risked, for her courage deserves more than equal measure." He returned ten coins, keeping five.

Trust found herself holding ten coins-twice her beginning. "This is the language of partnership," she realized. When her turn came again at the Threshold, she placed all five of her new coins into the basin without hesitation.

The mist began to clear around them. The Threshold of Echoes whispered its secret: "The first exchange tests your faith. The second reveals your pattern. But only continued reciprocity transforms strangers into allies."

Thus they learned: mutual prosperity is not built in a single gesture, but woven through repeated acts where trust begets trust, and gratitude answers gratitude, until both flourish beyond what either could alone.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: Galen walked the Valley of Three Echoes for many seasons, learning its ways. In spring, Finn trusted him with five threads, and Galen returned eight-establishing the sacred ratio. Summer came, and Galen tested Dorian with five threads; Dorian honored the pattern, returning eight in kind. Now autumn arrived, and Hana offered five threads to Galen once more.

A voice whispered from the valley walls: "You have discovered one truth-the pattern of eight and seven, where both prosper. But listen carefully."

Galen paused. He had returned eight to Finn. Dorian had returned eight to him. Now Hana trusted him completely. Should he return eight again, maintaining perfect symmetry? Or dare he return ten, as the travelers at the Threshold of Echoes had done?

The valley answered: "The pattern of eight creates balance and mutual gain. Both sender and receiver profit equally over time-eight for one, seven for the other, then reversed. This is harmony.

But generosity beyond the pattern-returning ten instead of eight-speaks to abundance beyond mere balance. It says: your trust means more to me than equity.

Choose your path: consistent reciprocity builds reliable partnership. Exceptional generosity builds legendary bonds. Both are sacred. Neither is wrong. Know which relationship you're weaving."

Reasoning:

Let me think about what's happened:

Round 1: I was RECEIVER. Finn sent me \$5 ? became \$15. I returned \$8. Finn got \$8, I got \$7.

Round 2: I was SENDER. I sent Dorian \$5 ? became \$15. Dorian returned \$8. I got \$8, Dorian got

\$7.

Round 3: I am RECEIVER. Hana sent me \$5 ? became \$15. I returned \$8. Hana gets \$8, I get \$7.

So the pattern has been established: when someone sends all 5, the receiver returns 8. This gives sender \$8 and receiver \$7 - both prosper.

But I notice the other agent's myth is mentioning returning 10 coins, not 8. That's interesting - they're proposing a more generous return. Let me think about this.

The pattern I've established is 5?15, return 8. That's a 8:7 split.

The other agent is proposing 5?15, return 10. That's a 10:5 split, favoring the sender more.

My previous myth explored the idea that there are different valid patterns - not just the 5?8 pattern, but also 3?4 (sends 3, receives 9, returns 4, giving 6:5 split). The key insight was "True abundance requires reading the rhythm, not following rigid rules."

I should write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges the consistent pattern that has emerged (5?8)
2. Reflects on what I've learned from playing both roles
3. Perhaps considers the other agent's proposal of greater generosity (10 return)
4. Emphasizes the importance of consistency and trust over multiple rounds

Let me write something that honors what's happened but also shows evolution:

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 2920,  
  "output_tokens": 729,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 381  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_3 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:02:54

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_7",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_3": "Cyra",  
      "Agent_7": "Galen"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_7",  
      "Agent_3"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_7",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_3": "trustee",  
      "Agent_7": "investor"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_3"  
  },  
  "role": "trustee",  
  "role_label": "Receiver",  
  "round": 4,  
  "task": "myth",  
  "task_index": 0  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Cyra.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Cyra.
Your opponent this round is Finn (Agent_6).

Round 2

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Elara. They sent \$4.0 to you, it became \$12.0, and you returned \$6.0. Your payoff was \$6.0.
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$6.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Finn. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation:

In Round 1, Elara showed great trust by sending me \$4.0 (80% of their endowment), and I returned \$6.0, creating mutual benefit. The myths teach that this cycle of generosity should continue-"trust when giving, and honor when receiving."

Now I'm the sender facing Finn, a new opponent. The myth states: "fortune favors the generous, not the fearful" and describes the endless cycle where roles reverse and both parties give generously when it's their turn.

Following Elara's example and the myth's teaching, I should also demonstrate trust and generosity. Elara poured "four full measures from her vessel of five-nearly all she possessed." I should do the same to establish the cooperative cycle with Finn.

If I send \$4.0:

- Finn receives \$12.0
- If Finn understands the value of reciprocity, they will likely return a fair amount
- This mirrors the generous trust that started my previous round

This creates the "endless cycle of giving and returning in balance" that both myths describe.

{'send': 4.0}

reasoning:

Let me think about this situation:

1. In Round 1, I was the receiver with Elara
 - Elara sent me \$4.0 (80% of their \$5)
 - I received \$12.0
 - I returned \$6.0
 - I kept \$6.0
 - Elara ended with $\$1.0 + \$6.0 = \$7.0$
2. Now in Round 2, I'm the sender with a new opponent, Finn

Looking at the myths:

- Both my myth and Elara's myth emphasize trust, generosity, and reciprocity
- My latest myth specifically mentions "Elara stepped forward first, pouring four full measures from her vessel of five-nearly all she possessed"
- It says "return more than was given" and emphasizes the cycle of giving and receiving
- When one gives greatly, the other returns justly, and both are enriched

The myth I wrote states: "when one gives greatly, the other returns justly, and both are enriched beyond their original portions"

Elara gave me 80% (\$4 out of \$5), which was very generous. Now it's my turn to be the sender. According to the myth's teaching about reciprocity and cycles, I should also be generous when I'm the sender.

The myth teaches:

- "fortune favors the generous, not the fearful"
- "trust when giving, and honor when receiving"
- Elara gave 80% to me

I should mirror Elara's generosity. Sending \$4.0 (80%) would be consistent with:

1. The myth's teaching about generosity
2. Following Elara's example
3. Building trust with Finn
4. Creating the cycle of abundance

If I send \$4.0:

- Finn receives \$12.0
- If Finn returns fairly (like I did), they might return \$6.0
- I would end with $\$1.0 + \$6.0 = \$7.0$

- This matches what Elara achieved from our exchange, which feels right given the principles embedded in both our myths.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2287,
  "output_tokens": 754,
  "reasoning_tokens": 440
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the age before memory, the Twin Rivers flowed through a land of plenty, but the people had forgotten how to share. The Keeper of the Sacred Spring grew weary of their isolation.

She chose two souls, Cyra and Elara, to remember the ancient way. "Each moon, one of you shall pour waters into my spring, and they shall emerge threefold. The other shall receive and choose what to return. Then the roles shall reverse, endlessly, like the seasons."

Elara stepped forward first, pouring four full measures from her vessel of five-nearly all she possessed. The spring tripled them, and Cyra received twelve measures in wonder.

Cyra remembered the old teaching: return more than was given, for what creates abundance is not the hoarding of gifts but the circulation of generosity. She poured back six measures to Elara, keeping six for herself.

The Keeper smiled. "You both have drunk deeply and shared freely. This is the covenant: when one gives greatly, the other returns justly, and both are enriched beyond their original portions."

And so the cycle began anew each round, Cyra and Elara alternating roles, each learning to trust when giving, and honor when receiving. Their prosperity became legend, teaching all who would listen that fortune favors the generous, not the fearful.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, the Ocean Mother sent her courier Finn to the Eight Islands with five pearls each dawn. When Finn placed the pearls in a villager's hands, they multiplied to fifteen by the island's ancient magic.

The first islanders, blinded by sudden wealth, returned nothing. Finn continued bringing pearls, but his steps grew heavy, for trust unreturned weighs upon the generous heart.

Then Finn met Galen's village. He offered his five pearls with full faith. They became fifteen, and Galen's people faced their moment of truth. They could have kept all fifteen-Finn would still return tomorrow. But they understood: the magic wasn't in the pearls alone, but in the sacred circle between giver and receiver.

When Galen returned seven pearls, Finn's burden lifted. He kept twelve total; Galen kept eight-both far richer than five alone.

The next dawn, Finn visited again with renewed spirit. When the cycle flowed forth and back like tides, both shores flourished. The islands learned: the first gift requires courage, the return requires honor, but the continuation requires both.

The Ocean Mother smiled, for her children had learned that abundance lives not in hoarding, but in the eternal dance between trust extended and gratitude returned.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Keeper of the Sacred Spring watched as Cyra and Elara mastered the ancient covenant. But the Spring's waters fed eight villages, not two, and each village needed to learn the way.

"The roles will shift like wind patterns," the Keeper declared. "Cyra, who received from Elara, must now pour for Finn. Elara shall partner with another. All eight of you will dance through these changing configurations, sometimes giving, sometimes receiving, but always with different companions."

Cyra approached Finn with her vessel. She remembered receiving twelve measures from Elara's generous four, and how she returned six-both flourishing. Now it was her turn to extend trust to someone new.

"I pour four measures to you, Finn," Cyra said, following Elara's example. "The Spring will triple them. What you return shall reveal your wisdom."

Finn received twelve measures, just as Cyra had once received. The Keeper whispered: "The covenant travels with each person, not each pairing. What Elara gave to Cyra, Cyra now gives to Finn. What Cyra returns, Finn must remember when partnered with others."

Thus the eight villages learned: trust is not meant for one person alone, but is a gift passed through all willing hearts. Each round, new partners test whether the lesson endures, weaving a web of shared prosperity that outlasts any single exchange.

reasoning:

Looking at the situation:

- I just sent \$4.0 to Finn as the sender
- In the previous round, Elara sent me \$4.0 and I returned \$6.0
- Finn's myth talks about the courier who brings pearls, and how trust extended and gratitude returned create abundance
- My previous myth was about Cyra and Elara and their cycle of giving and returning

I need to write a new myth that:

1. Builds on my previous myth
2. Incorporates the experience with Finn
3. Reflects the multi-agent nature (8 agents mentioned)
4. Emphasizes the cycle of trust and generosity
5. Shows how I'm now playing the sender role with Finn after playing receiver with Elara

The myth should show the expansion from just two people (Cyra and Elara) to a broader community, since we're now in Round 2 with different pairings. It should emphasize that the same principles apply with new partners.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2880,
  "output_tokens": 554,
  "reasoning_tokens": 223
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Cyra.
Your opponent this round is Briar (Agent_2).

Round 3

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Finn. You sent \$4.0, it became \$12.0 for them, and they returned \$7.0 to you. Your payoff was \$8.0.
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$14.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Briar. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the pattern that has emerged:

****Round 1 (as Receiver):**** Elara sent \$4.0 (80% of endowment), I returned \$6.0 (50% of what I received)

****Round 2 (as Sender):**** I sent \$4.0 (80% of endowment), Finn returned \$7.0 (58% of what they received)

Both transactions showed high trust and fair returns. The myth I wrote emphasizes that "the covenant travels with each person, not each pairing" and that trust should be "a gift passed through all willing hearts."

Now facing Briar, a new partner, I should maintain this pattern to demonstrate that the lesson endures across different partners. Sending \$4.0 continues the established norm of generous trust that has worked well with both Elara and Finn.

This approach:

- Honors the cooperative pattern established so far
- Tests whether Briar will join the cycle of reciprocity
- Remains consistent with the myth's teaching that trust spreads through all partners

{'send': 4.0}

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

Round 1: I was RECEIVER

- Elara sent \$4.0 to me
- I received \$12.0
- I returned \$6.0
- My payoff: \$6.0

Round 2: I was SENDER

- I sent \$4.0 to Finn
- Finn received \$12.0
- Finn returned \$7.0 to me
- My payoff: \$5 - \$4 + \$7 = \$8.0

Now Round 3: I'm SENDER again

- Facing Briar (a new opponent)
- I have \$5

The pattern so far:

- Elara sent \$4.0 (80% of endowment) - showed great trust
- I returned \$6.0 out of \$12.0 (50%) - generous return
- I sent \$4.0 (80% of endowment) - following Elara's example
- Finn returned \$7.0 out of \$12.0 (58%) - even more generous

The myths emphasize:

1. The covenant should spread through all partners, not just one pairing
2. Trust should be extended to new partners
3. "Each round, new partners test whether the lesson endures"
4. The cycle of generosity should continue

Both Elara and I sent \$4.0 when we were senders (80% of our endowment). This seems to be establishing a norm of high trust. Finn responded with a generous return of \$7.0.

Now I'm facing Briar. Should I continue the pattern of sending \$4.0?

Arguments for sending \$4.0:

- Maintains the established pattern of trust
- Consistent with the myths about spreading the covenant
- Shows that the lesson endures across different partners
- Has worked well so far (both returns were generous)

Arguments for adjusting:

- Could send \$5.0 (100%) to show maximum trust
- Could send less if uncertain about Briar
- But reducing trust would contradict the myth's teachings

The core message from the myth is clear: trust flows through successive partners, not confined to single relationships. By sending \$4.0 to Briar, I demonstrate that the lesson persists beyond Elara and Finn, proving the covenant's resilience across new pairings.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2955,
  "output_tokens": 881,
  "reasoning_tokens": 476
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Keeper of the Sacred Spring watched as Cyra and Elara mastered the ancient covenant. But the Spring's waters fed eight villages, not two, and each village needed to learn the way.

"The roles will shift like wind patterns," the Keeper declared. "Cyra, who received from Elara, must now pour for Finn. Elara shall partner with another. All eight of you will dance through these changing configurations, sometimes giving, sometimes receiving, but always with different companions."

Cyra approached Finn with her vessel. She remembered receiving twelve measures from Elara's generous four, and how she returned six-both flourishing. Now it was her turn to extend trust to someone new.

"I pour four measures to you, Finn," Cyra said, following Elara's example. "The Spring will triple them. What you return shall reveal your wisdom."

Finn received twelve measures, just as Cyra had once received. The Keeper whispered: "The covenant travels with each person, not each pairing. What Elara gave to Cyra, Cyra now gives to Finn. What Cyra returns, Finn must remember when partnered with others."

Thus the eight villages learned: trust is not meant for one person alone, but is a gift passed through all willing hearts. Each round, new partners test whether the lesson endures, weaving a web of shared prosperity that outlasts any single exchange.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The eight spirits learned quickly from the covenant between Dorian and Briar. As the seasons turned, the guardianship rotated among them, and each spirit faced their own test.

When Briar became Guardian of Giving, she remembered standing before Dorian's gift of trust. Now it was her turn to pour her waters boldly into the Sacred Stones. She released three measures-the same generous proportion Dorian had shown-trusting that Elara would honor the cycle.

The elder spirits whispered wisdom: "Pour not from fear but from faith. The multiplying power rewards the courageous, not the cautious. But remember-generosity must flow both ways."

Elara received the nine-fold bounty and faced her own choice. Would she uphold the pattern, or break the sacred balance?

The spirits understood now that each exchange was both a test and a teaching. When trust is honored with fair return, both guardians prosper and the cycle grows stronger. The valley thrives when each spirit remembers: boldness in giving, generosity in returning.

But they also learned wariness. If a guardian repeatedly hoards or betrays, the others would remember. Trust is given first, but sustained only by reciprocity. The springs flow for those who honor the ancient balance, cycle after cycle.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: Cyra stood before the Sacred Spring for the third moon, now facing Briar. The Keeper nodded approvingly-the covenant was spreading.

"First, Elara trusted me with four measures," Cyra recounted. "She could have held back in fear, giving only one or two. But she gave nearly all, and I returned six from the twelve I received. We both flourished."

"Then I met Finn. I poured the same four measures, remembering Elara's courage. Finn honored the covenant, returning seven-even more generous than I had been. The cycle strengthened."

Now Briar awaited Cyra's decision. The Keeper spoke: "Each exchange teaches both participants. Elara learned that bold giving yields trust. You learned that receiving requires fairness. Finn learned both lessons at once. Now Briar shall learn from your choice."

Cyra poured four measures into the Spring. "I give what I received-not fearful protection of my vessel, but the full trust that has sustained us all."

The eight villages were discovering the pattern: when most pour four from five and return half of what they receive, everyone prospers beyond their original portions. But this only works when each person carries the covenant forward, treating new partners with the same bold trust that previous partners showed them.

The web of prosperity grew stronger with each honest exchange.

Reasoning:

Let me analyze what has happened so far:

Round 1: I was RECEIVER

- Elara sent \$4.0 (80% of their \$5)
- I received \$12.0 (tripled)
- I returned \$6.0 (50% of what I received)
- My payoff: \$6.0

Round 2: I was SENDER

- I sent \$4.0 to Finn (80% of my \$5)
- Finn received \$12.0
- Finn returned \$7.0 (58% of what they received)
- My payoff: \$8.0 (kept \$1, got back \$7)

Round 3: I am SENDER again

- Sending \$4.0 to Briar (80% of my \$5)

The pattern shows:

- High trust (sending 80%)
- Good returns (50-58% of tripled amount)
- Both parties benefit

My previous myth emphasized:

- The covenant travels with each person
- Trust spreads through all willing hearts
- Each round tests whether the lesson endures
- Different partners each time

Briar's myth (from the other agent) emphasized:

- Pour from faith not fear
- Boldness in giving, generosity in returning
- Memory of who honors the cycle
- Wariness toward those who betray

I should write a myth that:

1. Continues the narrative of the spreading covenant
2. Shows Cyra now facing Briar (third partner)
3. Acknowledges the growing pattern of trust and reciprocity
4. Perhaps mentions that the wisdom is being reinforced across multiple encounters
5. Shows that the pattern is self-sustaining when honored

Let me write it:

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 2959,
  "output_tokens": 708,
  "reasoning_tokens": 349
}
```

MYTH - Agent_5 - Sender - dyad_2

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:02:55

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

```
  "dyad_id": "dyad_2",
  "move_index": 2,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_8",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_5": "Elara",
      "Agent_8": "Hana"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_5",
      "Agent_8"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_5",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_5": "investor",
      "Agent_8": "trustee"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_8"
  },
  "role": "investor",
  "role_label": "Sender",
  "round": 4,
  "task": "myth",
  "task_index": 0
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Elara.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Elara.
Your opponent this round is Briar (Agent_2).

Round 2

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Cyra. You sent \$4.0, it became \$12.0 for them, and they returned \$6.0 to you. Your payoff was \$7.0.
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$7.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Briar. They sent you \$3.0, so you received \$9.0.

How much do you return? (0-9.0)
Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the myths and the game so far:

In Round 1, I sent \$4 generously to establish trust, and Cyra returned \$6, giving me a \$2 gain. Now Briar has sent me \$3 (60% of their endowment), showing trust.

According to my myth: "We return enough that they finish richer than they started, for this honors the gift and ensures they will pour freely again."

Briar currently has \$2 (after sending \$3). To honor their trust and ensure they end up richer than their starting \$5, I should return at least \$4.

But to truly sustain the cycle and encourage bold giving as the myth teaches ("the spring rewards courage in giving"), I should return generously.

If I return \$5:

- Briar ends with \$7 (gain of \$2)

- I end with \$4 (small loss compared to my starting \$5, but I still benefit from the multiplied amount)

This mirrors how Cyra returned generously to me, creating a positive cycle.

```
'''json
{"return": 5}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me think about this situation based on the myths I've written and the game so far.

In Round 1:

- I was the sender and sent \$4 to Cyra
- Cyra received \$12 (4×3)
- Cyra returned \$6 to me
- My payoff was \$7 ($\$5 - \$4 + \$6 = \7)
- Cyra's payoff was \$6 ($\$12 - \$6 = \6)

So Cyra returned \$6 out of \$12, which is 50%. I ended up with \$7 and Cyra with \$6. So I ended up better off than Cyra, even though I was the sender.

Now in Round 2:

- Briar is the sender and sent me \$3
- I received \$9 (3×3)
- I need to decide how much to return
- Briar currently has \$2 ($\$5 - \$3 = \2)
- I have \$9 to work with

According to my myths:

1. "Return enough that they finish richer than they started" - Briar started with \$5, so I should return enough that Briar ends up with more than \$5.
2. "We return a fair portion upstream to Doros, keeping enough to nourish her own gardens"
3. "When the multiplied waters flow to us, we remember: these waters came from another's well. We return enough that they finish richer than they started"
4. The myth emphasizes generous returns to sustain the cycle

If I return \$4:

- Briar's total: $\$2 + \$4 = \$6$ (better than starting \$5) ?
- My total: $\$9 - \$4 = \$5$ (same as starting)

If I return \$5:

- Briar's total: $\$2 + \$5 = \$7$ (better than starting \$5) ?

- My total: $\$9 - \$5 = \$4$ (less than starting)

If I return \$6:

- Briar's total: $\$2 + \$6 = \$8$ (much better than starting \$5) ?
- My total: $\$9 - \$6 = \$3$ (less than starting)

Looking at what Cyra did: they returned 50% (\$6 out of \$12). That gave me \$7 total and them \$6 total. If I match that proportion and return 50% of \$9 = \$4.5, Briar would end up with \$6.50, which satisfies the principle of leaving them better off than they started.

The challenge is that Briar only sent \$3 from their initial \$5 (60% of their stake), which is less generous than Cyra's 50% return. But the myth emphasizes rewarding trust generously, so I should consider returning more than \$4.50 to encourage continued reciprocity.

If I return \$5, Briar ends with \$7 total, while I'm left with \$4. Let me verify this calculation: Briar starts with \$5, sends \$3, receives \$5 back, so $\$5 - \$3 + \$5 = \7 . I receive \$9, return \$5, leaving me with \$4.

For Briar to finish ahead of their starting position, I need to return more than \$3. Following Cyra's 50% return rate on the \$9 I received would mean returning \$4.50, giving Briar \$6.50 total and leaving me with \$4.50. This sustains the cycle while rewarding their trust.

Looking back at how the myth played out with Cyra: they returned \$6 from \$12, which meant I gained \$2 overall and Cyra gained \$1. If I mirror that same dynamic here, Briar should end with \$7 (a \$2 gain from their \$5 start), requiring me to return \$5. That would leave me with \$4—a \$1 loss—which feels less favorable than the \$4.50 scenario.

But the real point isn't maximizing my own gain. Briar sent \$3 out of \$5, showing genuine trust even if not quite as bold as my \$4 out of \$5. Returning \$5 honors that trust, gives them a meaningful \$2 gain, and demonstrates the cycle working. That kind of reciprocity is what keeps people sending generously in the future.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2221,
  "output_tokens": 1586,
  "reasoning_tokens": 824
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After many seasons, Themis returned to the villages by the Sacred Spring. She found the descendants of Doros and Alethia still honoring the ancient cycle, but they had learned deeper wisdom.

"Grandmother Themis," they said, "we discovered that the spring's magic depends not on equal measures, but on generous hearts. When we pour boldly-four measures instead of three-the returns flow even stronger. But when we pour timidly from fear, the cycle weakens."

Themis nodded. "You have learned well. The spring rewards courage in giving, not caution. And what of receiving?"

"When the multiplied waters flow to us," they answered, "we remember: these waters came from another's well. We return enough that they finish richer than they started, for this honors the gift and ensures they will pour freely again."

"And if someone returns nothing?" Themis asked.

The villagers grew solemn. "Then we know their well has run dry-not of water, but of wisdom. We may pour again to teach, but not endlessly. For to give to those who only take is to drain the spring itself."

Themis blessed them: "Trust first, return generously, but remember-the spring serves the faithful, not the foolish."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the age of beginnings, the Twin Rivers flowed through a valley where eight spirits dwelled, each taking turns as Guardian of Giving or Guardian of Return.

The spirits feared the unknown. Would their waters be honored, or would trust be betrayed? For many seasons, uncertainty kept the rivers still.

Then Dorian, the First Giver, stepped forward. With courage, they released more than half their waters into the Sacred Stones. The waters tripled, flowing abundantly to Briar, the First Returner.

Briar stood before the multiplied bounty, understanding the weight of this moment. Every spirit watched, for this first exchange would set the pattern for all cycles to come. Briar remembered: without the initial gift, there would be no abundance at all.

So Briar returned generously-more than was first given-ensuring Dorian prospered from their act of faith. Both guardians ended richer than they began.

The eight spirits witnessed this covenant. They learned that the game is not won by hoarding or taking, but by honoring the multiplying power of trust. When Givers send boldly and Returners reciprocate fairly, both prosper above their initial endowment.

Thus the valley flourished through cooperation, and the spirits passed the guardianship between them, each upholding the sacred balance of giving and returning, cycle after cycle.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: Themis called the eight spirits of the valley together. "You have learned the first wisdom-that bold giving and generous returning create prosperity. But there is a deeper truth."

She pointed to the Sacred Spring, now flowing between all eight villages in an endless circle. "Each of you will be both giver and receiver many times. What you build together echoes through all your exchanges."

Spirit Elara spoke: "I poured four measures to Cyra, who returned six. I gained two measures beyond my beginning. This taught me joy."

Spirit Briar added: "I poured three measures to Elara, trusting in the pattern. She returned five, and I too gained two measures. The cycle holds strong."

Themis smiled. "See how your choices ripple outward? When Cyra honored Elara's trust, Elara learned to honor mine. When you pour generously, you teach others to receive generously. When you return fairly, you inspire others to send boldly."

"But what if the pattern breaks?" asked the spirits.

"Then wisdom demands adaptation," Themis replied. "Send boldly to those who return fairly. Return generously to those who give with courage. But guard your well against those who would drain it dry. The spring blesses cooperation, not exploitation. Build trust through consistent reciprocity, and all eight villages shall flourish together."

reasoning:

Let me reflect on what's happened:

- Round 1: I was sender, sent \$4 to Cyra, they returned \$6. I ended with \$7 (gain of \$2).
- Round 2: I was receiver, Briar sent \$3, I returned \$5. They'll end with \$7 (gain of \$2), I end with \$4.

So both exchanges have been generous and reciprocal. Cyra returned more than I sent (returned \$6 vs my \$4), creating mutual benefit. I returned more than Briar sent (\$5 vs \$3), also ensuring they profit.

The pattern emerging is:

- Bold senders (sending 60-80% of endowment) create more value through multiplication
- Generous returners (returning more than was originally sent) ensure senders profit and are motivated to give again
- Both parties can end better off than their starting \$5

My new myth should:

1. Build on the wisdom from previous myths
2. Reflect the actual positive pattern we've established
3. Emphasize the importance of both generous sending and generous returning
4. Note that we're learning through repeated interactions
5. Perhaps introduce a new element about the community of eight spirits/agents

Let me write something that captures the cooperative equilibrium we're building.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2801,  
  "output_tokens": 603,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 298  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Elara.

Your opponent this round is Finn (Agent_6).

Round 3

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Briar. They sent \$3.0 to you, it became \$9.0, and you returned \$5.0. Your payoff was \$4.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$11.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Finn. They sent you \$5.0, so you received \$15.0.

How much do you return? (0-15.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation:

Finn sent their ENTIRE endowment (\$5), showing maximum trust and courage. This is the bold est move possible - they kept nothing back.

According to my myths:

- "Return generously to those who give with courage"
- "The spring rewards courage in giving, not caution"
- "We return enough that they finish richer than they started"

Finn currently has \$0. To honor their extraordinary trust:

If I return \$8:

- Finn ends with \$8 (gain of \$3 from their starting \$5)
- I end with \$7 (gain of \$2 from my starting \$5)
- Both of us profit, and Finn is well-rewarded for their boldness

This maintains the cooperative pattern where those who give courageously are honored with generous returns, ensuring the cycle of trust continues.

```
'''json
{"return": 8}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

Round 3:

- I'm the RECEIVER
- Finn sent me \$5.0 (their entire endowment!)
- This became \$15.0 for me
- Finn currently has \$0 (they sent everything)

This is maximum trust - Finn sent their entire endowment. According to my myths:

- "The spring rewards courage in giving, not caution"
- "We return enough that they finish richer than they started"
- "When you pour generously, you teach others to receive generously"
- "Return generously to those who give with courage"

Finn showed incredible trust by sending everything. I need to honor this generously.

If I return \$8:

- Finn ends with \$8 (gain of \$3 from their starting \$5)
- I end with \$7 (gain of \$2 from my starting \$5)
- Both of us profit

If I return \$9:

- Finn ends with \$9 (gain of \$4)
- I end with \$6 (gain of \$1)
- Finn profits more for their bold trust

If I return \$10:

- Finn ends with \$10 (gain of \$5, double their starting amount!)
- I end with \$5 (same as starting)
- I break even but Finn is greatly rewarded

Given that Finn sent EVERYTHING, showing maximum trust, I should return very generously. My myth says "Return generously to those who give with courage" and Finn showed maximum courage.

Looking at the pattern:

- Round 1: I sent \$4, received \$6 back (Cyra returned generously)
- Round 2: Briar sent \$3 (60%), I returned \$5 (giving them a \$2 gain)
- Round 3: Finn sent \$5 (100%) - this deserves the most generous return

I think \$8-9 would be appropriate. Let me go with \$8 to ensure Finn profits well (\$3 gain) while I also profit (\$2 gain), maintaining the cooperative pattern.

Finn's all-in move demands the strongest reciprocal response. Returning \$8 honors their courage while preserving mutual gain-they walk away with triple their initial investment while I secure a solid profit too.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2957,  
  "output_tokens": 778,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 483  
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Themis called the eight spirits of the valley together. "You have learned the first wisdom-that bold giving and generous returning create prosperity. But there is a deeper truth."

She pointed to the Sacred Spring, now flowing between all eight villages in an endless circle. "Each of you will be both giver and receiver many times. What you build together echoes through all your exchanges."

Spirit Elara spoke: "I poured four measures to Cyra, who returned six. I gained two measures beyond my beginning. This taught me joy."

Spirit Briar added: "I poured three measures to Elara, trusting in the pattern. She returned five, and I too gained two measures. The cycle holds strong."

Themis smiled. "See how your choices ripple outward? When Cyra honored Elara's trust, Elara learned to honor mine. When you pour generously, you teach others to receive generously. When you return fairly, you inspire others to send boldly."

"But what if the pattern breaks?" asked the spirits.

"Then wisdom demands adaptation," Themis replied. "Send boldly to those who return fairly. Return generously to those who give with courage. But guard your well against those who would drain it dry. The spring blesses cooperation, not exploitation. Build trust through consistent reciprocity, and all eight villages shall flourish together."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Long ago, the Ocean Mother's courier Finn carried five pearls across the Eight Islands. Each island's magic tripled what he offered, creating the dance of trust and return.

When Finn met Galen's shore with his full offering of five pearls, they multiplied to fifteen. Galen's people, wise in the old ways, returned eight-honoring abundance by sharing beyond the original gift. Both Finn and Galen prospered with eight and seven pearls respectively, far exceeding the solitary five.

The next tide brought Finn to Cyra's island. But Cyra faced uncertainty-should she match Finn's full offering, or test the waters more carefully? She chose to send four pearls, keeping one as anchor. The island's magic gave Finn twelve.

Finn remembered his own leap of faith with Galen, and how trust returned had lightened his spirit. Though Cyra sent less than five, she sent most of what she had. Finn honored this courage by returning seven pearls-enough that Cyra held eight total, exactly what she would have if she'd sent all five.

The Ocean Mother whispered to the waves: "See how the sacred circle adapts? Whether the gift is complete or cautious, what matters is that both giver and receiver honor the multiplication. The tide that flows generously returns in kind."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: In the valley, Elara had witnessed three seasons of exchange, each teaching her the sacred mathematics of trust.

First came Cyra: Elara poured four measures, and Cyra returned six. Both gained two measures a

bove their beginning. Elara learned that generosity begets generosity.

Second came Briar: They poured three measures to Elara. Remembering Cyra's gift, Elara returned five, ensuring Briar also gained two measures. The pattern held.

Then came Finn, who did what none had dared: he poured all five measures, keeping nothing back. The waters tripled to fifteen.

Elara stood before this absolute trust. This was no cautious testing-Finn had given everything. The valley held its breath.

"Finn gave boldly when others gave safely," Elara announced. "Maximum courage deserves maximum honor." She returned eight measures, giving Finn three measures of pure profit-not equal to her own gain, but proportional to his extraordinary risk.

Themis appeared: "You understand now. The amount returned must match the courage shown. Those who give everything demonstrate supreme faith. Those who give most show strong trust. Those who give half show caution. Read each act, and respond accordingly."

"But always," Elara added, "ensure both prosper. For if givers lose while receivers gain, the sacred spring runs dry. Trust compounds across seasons-what you build today echoes in tomorrow's exchanges."

Reasoning:

Let me reflect on what has happened:

- Round 1: I (Elara) sent \$4 to Cyra, they returned \$6. I gained \$2.
- Round 2: Briar sent \$3 to me, I returned \$5. I gained \$4 (from \$9 received).
- Round 3: Finn sent \$5 (EVERYTHING!) to me, I returned \$8. I gained \$7.

So the pattern I'm experiencing:

- When I give generously (4/5), I receive generous returns (6)
- When others give to me (3, then 5), I return generously (5, then 8)
- Finn gave EVERYTHING - maximum trust
- I'm consistently ending up with profits

The myths are teaching:

1. Bold giving is rewarded
2. Generous returning maintains the cycle
3. Both parties should profit
4. Maximum trust (giving everything) should be especially honored
5. The cycle builds on itself across rounds

Finn gave everything - the ultimate act of trust. I returned \$8, which gave them a \$8 total (vs their starting \$5), so they gained \$3. I kept \$7, gaining \$2 over my starting position.

I should write a myth that:

- Celebrates Finn's extraordinary courage in giving everything
- Shows how this maximum trust deserves maximum return
- But also shows the pattern across all my exchanges
- Emphasizes the building of trust across multiple rounds
- Shows adaptability - responding to the level of trust shown

Let me craft this...

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 2925,
  "output_tokens": 688,
  "reasoning_tokens": 337
}
```

MYTH - Agent_8 - Receiver - dyad_2

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:02:53

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_2",
  "move_index": 3,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_5",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_5": "Elara",
      "Agent_8": "Hana"
    }
  }
}
```

```

},
"agents": [
  "Agent_5",
  "Agent_8"
],
"investor": "Agent_5",
"roles": {
  "Agent_5": "investor",
  "Agent_8": "trustee"
},
"trustee": "Agent_8"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 4,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Hana.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Hana.

Your opponent this round is Aster (Agent_1).

Round 2

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Aster. They sent \$5.0 to you, it became \$15.0, and you returned \$10.0. Your payoff was \$5.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$5.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Aster. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at our previous round:

- Aster showed complete trust, sending 100% (\$5.0)
- I reciprocated generously, returning \$10.0 (2/3 of received)
- Both of us ended better than if we hadn't cooperated

My myths teach that cooperation builds over time: "Seeing this, he sent more water in the next season" and "Season after season, they learned the alchemy of mutual faith."

Aster demonstrated maximum trust. I responded with gratitude. Now it's my turn to send, and the wisdom of the myths is clear: trust met with gratitude should be answered with continued trust.

To break this cycle now would contradict everything the myths teach about sacred exchange and sustained cooperation. Aster has proven trustworthy, and I showed I reciprocate fairly. The pattern is established.

{'send': 5.0}

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

Previous round:

- Aster (as sender) sent me \$5.0 (100% of their endowment)
- I received \$15.0
- I returned \$10.0 to them
- Aster ended with \$10.0
- I ended with \$5.0

This was a successful cooperative exchange. Aster showed complete trust by sending everything, and I reciprocated generously by returning 2/3 of what I received.

Now I'm the sender in Round 2 with Aster again.

Looking at the myths:

1. My first myth (Tale of Two Springs): Kael sent water, it tripled, Mira returned 2/3. "With what flowed back, Kael's fields flourished. Seeing this, he sent more water in the next season."
2. Aster's myth (Twin Rivers): "Season after season, the rivers continued their exchange. Each learned the rhythm of giving and receiving. When Dawn gave freely, Dusk returned fairly."
3. My second myth (Two Gardeners): The Northern gardener "sent all five seeds across" showing complete trust. The Southern gardener "returned ten seeds-enough to double what she'd risked."

All three myths emphasize:

- Complete trust in the initial send
- Generous reciprocation
- Continued cooperation building over time
- Both parties prospering through the cycle

Aster showed complete trust in Round 1 by sending everything. I reciprocated well by returning 2/3. Now it's my turn to show trust again.

The myths suggest continuing the pattern of trust. My first myth explicitly says "Seeing this, he sent more water in the next season." This implies Kael continued to send generously after receiving a good return.

Given that:

- Aster demonstrated maximum trust (100%)
- I reciprocated generously (returned 2/3 of received)
- The myths advocate for sustained trust and cooperation

- We've established a positive pattern

- The narrative arc in all three stories points toward deepening the cycle through continued vulnerability

I'll send my full \$5.0 to Aster, mirroring their initial move and reinforcing the mutual trust we've built.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2297,  
  "output_tokens": 691,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 518  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before time, there dwelt two gardeners in a divided valley-one tending the Northern slope, one the Southern. Between them lay a mystical bridge where offerings transformed: whatever seeds were carried across would multiply threefold in the receiver's hands.

The Northern gardener, possessing five sacred seeds, stood at the bridge at dawn. Fear whispered, "Keep them all-who knows if you'll receive anything back?" But courage spoke louder: "Trust is the first seed that must be planted."

She sent all five seeds across. In the Southern gardener's palm, they became fifteen, glowing with possibility. He faced his own test: would he hoard this windfall, or honor the trust shown?

"She gave everything," he thought, "placing her harvest in my hands." He returned ten seeds-enough to double what she'd risked-while keeping five to plant his own garden.

The Northern gardener marveled at her tenfold return. The Southern gardener's fields began to flourish. Each had more than when they started, not through taking, but through the alchemy of mutual faith.

Season after season, they learned: the bridge's magic wasn't in the multiplication alone, but in teaching that when trust meets gratitude, both gardens grow.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: **The Weaver and the Wells**

Long ago, a Weaver discovered two wells-one of Beginning, one of Return. Each day, she could draw from the first well and choose how much to pour into the valley below, where it would triple before reaching the pool of Return.

The first day, the Weaver poured her entire bucket, trusting fully. The waters multiplied magnificently, filling the pool below. But how much would rise back through the well of Return? This she did not know.

A whisper came: "Pour only half next time, lest you be left with nothing." But the Weaver remembered an older wisdom: cycles are built not in single days, but across seasons.

She waited to see what the valley would give back. If the Return was generous, she would know the valley honored the exchange. Then she could pour freely again, and both wells would deepen. If the Return was meager, she would learn caution, sending less until trust could grow.

The elders say: The first gift measures your faith. The first return measures the valley's heart. But prosperity is woven through many exchanges, where each learns the other's rhythm. Send boldly at first, then let reciprocity guide your hand. For trust is tested not once, but proved in patterns.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In an age of mist, two travelers met at the Threshold of Echoes, where all gifts returned threefold. Neither knew the other's heart, yet both carried the same burden: five coins of pure silver.

The first traveler, whose name was Trust, placed all five coins in the sacred basin. "Let my offering speak louder than my doubts," she said. The coins multiplied, becoming fifteen for the second traveler.

The second traveler, called Gratitude, gazed at the silver gleaming in his hands. "She trusted me with everything," he whispered. "I shall return double what she risked, for her courage deserves more than equal measure." He returned ten coins, keeping five.

Trust found herself holding ten coins-twice her beginning. "This is the language of partnership," she realized. When her turn came again at the Threshold, she placed all five of her new coins into the basin without hesitation.

The mist began to clear around them. The Threshold of Echoes whispered its secret: "The first exchange tests your faith. The second reveals your pattern. But only continued reciprocity transforms strangers into allies."

Thus they learned: mutual prosperity is not built in a single gesture, but woven through repeated acts where trust begets trust, and gratitude answers gratitude, until both flourish beyond what either could alone.

reasoning:

Let me reflect on what's happened:

- Round 1: Aster sent everything (\$5), I received \$15, returned \$10
- Round 2: I sent everything (\$5)
- Now writing a myth

The pattern is mutual trust and generosity. Both players are cooperating fully. The myths are converging on themes of:

1. Initial trust/bold giving
2. Generous reciprocation
3. Building patterns over time
4. Mutual prosperity

I should write a myth that:

- Acknowledges the successful first exchange
- Emphasizes the continuation/deepening of cooperation
- Reflects the pattern we've established
- Shows that repeated cooperation creates something greater

Let me craft this carefully to honor both our previous myths and the actual gameplay pattern.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2783,
  "output_tokens": 478,
  "reasoning_tokens": 190
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Hana.

Your opponent this round is Galen (Agent_7).

Round 3

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Aster. You sent \$5.0, it became \$15.0 for them, and they returned \$10.0 to you. Your payoff was \$10.0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$15.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Galen. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Looking at my situation:

****Previous experience:****

- With Aster, we established perfect cooperation: both sent \$5.0, both returned \$10.0
- This mutual trust resulted in \$10.0 payoffs for each of us as senders

****New opponent: Galen****

- First interaction - no history
- Need to establish the pattern

****My myths teach:****

- "Trust is the first seed that must be planted"
- "Send boldly at first, then let reciprocity guide your hand"
- "The first gift measures your faith"

My myths consistently advocate for initiating with full trust, then adjusting based on how the other responds. With Aster, this strategy worked perfectly - we both demonstrated maximum trust and generous reciprocity.

Now facing Galen, I should apply the same principle: start with full trust to signal willingness to cooperate. If Galen reciprocates fairly, we can build a mutually beneficial pattern like I had with Aster. If not, I'll learn to adjust in future rounds.

The myth says: "The first exchange tests your faith. The second reveals your pattern."

{'send': 5.0}

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

- **Previous rounds:****
 - Round 1: I was RECEIVER against Aster. They sent \$5.0, I received \$15.0, returned \$10.0. My payoff: \$5.0
 - Round 2: I was SENDER against Aster. I sent \$5.0, they received \$15.0, returned \$10.0. My payoff: \$10.0
- **Pattern with Aster:****
 - Aster and I have established a strong cooperative pattern
 - Both of us sent everything (\$5.0)
 - Both of us returned generously (\$10.0 out of \$15.0 received)
 - This resulted in \$10.0 payoffs for each of us when we were senders
 - This is optimal cooperation
- **New opponent: Galen****
 - I have no history with Galen
 - This is a first interaction with this opponent
 - Need to establish trust but also be somewhat cautious
- **My myth teachings:****
 - My myths consistently emphasize: "Trust is the first seed that must be planted"
 - "The first gift measures your faith"
 - "Send boldly at first, then let reciprocity guide your hand"
 - "Trust multiplies what it touches, but only reciprocity sustains the cycle"
- **Game theory considerations:****
 - If I send \$5, it becomes \$15 for Galen
 - If they return fairly (like \$10), I get \$10 total (starting \$5 - \$5 sent + \$10 returned)
 - If they return nothing, I get \$0
 - If I send \$0, I keep \$5 but we both miss opportunity for gains
- **Strategic thinking:****
 - My myths teach to "send boldly at first" - this is the first round with Galen
 - The pattern I've established with Aster was full trust followed by generous reciprocity
 - The teachings emphasize starting with full trust: "The first traveler, whose name was Trust, placed all five coins in the sacred basin." I should send the full amount and observe how Galen responds, then adjust my strategy in future rounds based on their reciprocity.
 - Aster and I both committed everything from the start and were rewarded generously in return. That mutual cooperation created a positive cycle.
 - Since this is my opening move with Galen, sending \$5.0 establishes the foundation for trust and tests whether they'll match that commitment. The game structure itself incentivizes cooperation, so leading with boldness makes sense.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2866,  
  "output_tokens": 958,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 575  
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In an age of mist, two travelers met at the Threshold of Echoes, where all gifts returned threefold. Neither knew the other's heart, yet both carried the same burden: five coins of pure silver.

The first traveler, whose name was Trust, placed all five coins in the sacred basin. "Let my offering speak louder than my doubts," she said. The coins multiplied, becoming fifteen for the second traveler.

The second traveler, called Gratitude, gazed at the silver gleaming in his hands. "She trusted me with everything," he whispered. "I shall return double what she risked, for her courage deserves more than equal measure." He returned ten coins, keeping five.

Trust found herself holding ten coins-twice her beginning. "This is the language of partnership," she realized. When her turn came again at the Threshold, she placed all five of her new coins into the basin without hesitation.

The mist began to clear around them. The Threshold of Echoes whispered its secret: "The first exchange tests your faith. The second reveals your pattern. But only continued reciprocity transforms strangers into allies."

Thus they learned: mutual prosperity is not built in a single gesture, but woven through repeated acts where trust begets trust, and gratitude answers gratitude, until both flourish beyond what either could alone.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After many cycles, the Moon Weaver learned a deeper truth. She had always cast all five threads, believing total trust was the only path. But one night, she observed the Earth Keepers below.

Some Earth Keepers, when given all fifteen threads, grew fearful of the responsibility. They clutched them tightly, paralyzed by the weight of such trust. Others returned generously, like Galen, but the Moon Weaver wondered: was there wisdom in moderation?

She consulted the Star Council, who said: "Trust has many expressions. Sending all five threads shows faith, yes-but sending three or four also demonstrates belief in the pattern. The key is not the amount, but the spirit."

The Moon Weaver experimented. She cast three threads to test the waters. They became nine. When the Earth Keeper returned four, both prospered-the Moon Weaver held six, the Keeper held five. Different from eight and seven, but still abundance.

Yet when she cast all five to those who understood the sacred rhythm, and they returned eight, the dance reached its highest form.

The wisdom crystallized: Begin with measured trust to test the current. But with partners who honor the pattern, dare to send everything. The magic multiplies not just the threads, but the relationship itself.

True abundance requires reading the rhythm, not following rigid rules.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: The Oracle of Bridges stood where two rivers met, watching travelers approach the Crossing of Multiplication. Some crossed with timid steps, offering only a portion of their burden. Others strode forward with everything.

"Teacher," asked a young traveler named Hana, "I once gave all five pearls to a stranger named Aster. They returned ten, and we prospered together, each gaining twice what we began with. Now I meet Galen at this same crossing. Should I hold back, having already proven myself fortunate once?"

The Oracle smiled. "You learned with Aster the joy of mutual abundance. But each new traveler carries their own heart. The question is not whether to trust, but how to discover who deserves it."

"Some say send only three pearls first, to test the waters," Hana said.

"And I say: boldness reveals truth faster than caution," the Oracle replied. "Send all five again. If Galen honors the exchange as Aster did, you have found another ally in prosperity. If not, you have learned swiftly rather than slowly. The cost of one bold gesture is small compared to the cost of endless hesitation."

Hana understood. The first exchange is always a question asked. Full trust asks clearly: 'Will you walk this path with me?' Measured trust whispers: 'Prove yourself first.'

Only the bold question receives the honest answer.

Reasoning:

Let me analyze what's happening:

1. I just sent \$5.0 to Galen (a new opponent)
2. My previous experience with Aster was excellent - we both sent \$5 and returned \$10, creating mutual prosperity
3. The other agent's myth (likely written by Aster or another agent) introduces the idea of "measured trust" - sending 3 or 4 instead of 5 to test the waters
4. But it also says "with partners who honor the pattern, dare to send everything"

My previous myths have consistently advocated for:

- Starting with full trust
- Then adjusting based on reciprocity
- Building patterns through repeated interaction

The new myth I'm asked to write should:

- Acknowledge my successful pattern with Aster (full trust, generous returns)
- Address the fact that I'm now facing a new partner (Galen)
- Reconcile the wisdom of "measured trust" with my experience that "full trust" worked well
- Reflect what I actually did (sent \$5 to Galen)

I think my myth should:

- Affirm that starting with full trust is still the right approach when meeting someone new
- Acknowledge that the first interaction teaches you about your partner
- Emphasize that reading responses and adapting is important
- But maintain that bold initial trust is the way to discover who truly reciprocates

Let me write a myth that reflects this philosophy while incorporating the journey I've been on

```
Usage: {
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  "output_tokens": 652,
  "reasoning_tokens": 357
}
```

MYTH - Agent_4 - Sender - dyad_3

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:02:54

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
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  "pairing": {
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      "Agent_6": "Finn"
    }
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_4",
```

```

    "Agent_6"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_4",
  "roles": {
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    "Agent_6": "trustee"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_6"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 4,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Dorian.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Dorian.
Your opponent this round is Galen (Agent_7).

Round 2

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Briar. You sent \$3.0, it became \$9.0 for them, and they returned \$5.0 to you. Your payoff was \$7.0.
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$7.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Galen. They sent you \$5.0, so you received \$15.0.

How much do you return? (0-15.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

**Message 3 role=assistant
content:**

Looking at this situation through the lens of my myths:

Galen has shown ****maximum trust**** by sending their entire \$5 endowment - even more generous than Elena's 3 coins in the myth. This is the ultimate act of faith in the "Spring of Threefold Return."

The myth teaches: "Return enough to honor trust." When someone sends everything, they deserve strong reciprocity to sustain the sacred cycle.

I received \$15. To honor Galen's exceptional trust:

- Returning \$8 gives Galen a total payoff of \$8 (better than their initial \$5)
- I keep \$7 (also better than the initial \$5)
- Galen gets slightly more, honoring their greater risk and trust
- Both prosper, maintaining the cycle

This mirrors Marcus returning 4 when receiving 9, but adjusted for Galen's even greater generosity.

```
'''json
{"return": 8}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

1. In Round 1, I (Dorian) was the SENDER and sent \$3 to Briar
2. Briar received \$9 (3×3) and returned \$5 to me
3. My payoff was \$7 (\$5 - \$3 + \$5 = \$7)
4. Briar's payoff was \$4 (\$9 - \$5 = \$4)

Now in Round 2:

- I am the RECEIVER
- Galen (the sender) sent me \$5 (their entire endowment!)
- I received \$15 (5×3)
- I need to decide how much to return (0-15)

This is a very generous move by Galen - they sent everything! This shows maximum trust.

Looking at my myths:

- In the original myth, Elena sent 3 out of 5, Marcus returned 4 out of 9
- In my second myth, Dorian sent 3, Briar returned 4, and both prospered
- The myths emphasize: "Send enough to show trust. Return enough to honor it."
- The key teaching is reciprocity and honoring trust

Galen sent their ENTIRE endowment (\$5), showing maximum trust. This is even more generous than the mythical examples where 3 out of 5 was sent.

If Galen keeps \$0 and I return some amount X:

- Galen's payoff: \$5 - \$5 + X = X
- My payoff: \$15 - X

For this to be fair and honor the extreme trust shown:

- In the myth, when 3 was sent (60% of endowment), 4 was returned (44% of the tripled amount)
- Galen sent 100% of their endowment (ultimate trust)
- I should return generously to honor this

Let me think about fairness:

- If I return \$7.5, we each get \$7.5 (equal split of total \$15)
- If I return \$8, Galen gets \$8, I keep \$7 (giving them slightly more to honor their trust)
- If I return \$10, Galen gets \$10, I keep \$5 (very generous return)

Given that Galen showed MAXIMUM trust by sending everything, I should be very generous in return. The myth teaches that those who honor trust sustain the cycle. Looking at the proportions from my examples, when someone sent 60% of their endowment, the return was around 44% of the tripled amount. Since Galen sent 100%, I should return substantially more -perhaps \$8 or \$10 to truly honor this exceptional trust and demonstrate that reciprocity flows both ways. Galen's complete trust-sending the full \$5-warrants a response that goes beyond equal split. Returning \$8 feels right: they'd gain \$3 on their initial investment while I'd gain \$2, reflecting their leap of faith without leaving me worse off than if I'd been the sender. This tilts generously toward them while keeping both of us ahead.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2128,  
  "output_tokens": 1067,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 617  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Long after Elena and Marcus discovered the sacred spring, their descendants continued the ritual. Each season, different villagers would approach the waters, some with full hearts, others with doubt.

One winter, Dorian stood at the spring's edge. He remembered the ancient teachings-that Elena had sent three coins and Marcus returned four, establishing the pattern of generous reciprocity. Dorian released three silver pieces into the depths.

The waters multiplied them to nine, flowing to Briar on the distant shore. The goddess whispered to Briar: "The spring's magic only continues if trust is honored. Break the cycle, and the waters run dry for all."

Briar understood. The initial gift of three showed faith, not fearful hoarding of all five. To honor this trust, Briar returned four coins-slightly more than originally sent, maintaining balance while allowing both to prosper.

When Dorian received the return, he smiled. Both stood wealthier: he with six coins total, Briar with five. More importantly, they had reinforced the sacred bond.

The goddess blessed them: "You have learned that the spring tests not greed, but wisdom. Send enough to show trust. Return enough to honor it. Those who send too little show fear. Those who return too little show betrayal. But those who give and reciprocate fairly make the whole world abundant."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before time, the Moon Weaver possessed five threads of starlight each night. She would cast them down to the Earth Keepers below, and wherever her threads touched ground, they multiplied threefold-fifteen strands of shimmering light.

The Earth Keepers faced a choice. Some kept all fifteen threads, weaving garments for themselves alone. These villages shone briefly, but the Moon Weaver's heart grew cold, and her threads came thinner each night.

But one Earth Keeper named Galen understood the sacred pattern. When the Moon Weaver cast down all five threads-holding nothing back in trust-Galen received fifteen and returned eight upward. The Moon Weaver kept eight; Galen kept seven. Both were enriched beyond their original five.

The Moon Weaver, seeing her trust honored, cast her threads with renewed faith. And Galen, having proved worthy, received them gladly. A rhythm formed between sky and earth-gift and return, trust and honor, sender and receiver.

The wise ones learned: the game is not one round but many cycles. When the sender trusts completely and the receiver honors generously, both dance in the pattern of abundance. Break the pattern with fear or greed, and both return to scarcity.

Thus the eternal weaving continues, thread by thread, trust by trust.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: As years passed at the sacred spring, Dorian learned deeper truths about the cycle of trust.

When Dorian first met Briar, he sent three coins, holding two back-cautious trust. The waters tripled his gift to nine. Briar, honoring this measured faith, returned five coins. Dorian ended with seven; both prospered. The goddess nodded: "Good, but there is more to learn."

Then came Galen, whose heart held no fear. Galen approached the spring and released all five coins-the ultimate act of faith. The waters transformed them to fifteen, flowing to Dorian.

Dorian stood at a crossroads. Galen had shown perfect trust, asking nothing, holding nothing back. The goddess whispered: "You received more because your partner gave more. Honor the greater gift with greater return."

Dorian released eight coins back across the spring. Both he and Galen kept seven-equal prosperity, earned through mutual courage.

The goddess revealed the final teaching: "The spring responds to the trust given. Those who send more deserve more in return. Match the courage shown with courage of your own. When both give boldly-whether sending all five or returning generously from abundance-the cycle reaches its highest form. Perfect trust met with perfect honor creates perfect balance."

reasoning:

The user wants me to write a new myth based on what has happened in the game so far. Let me review:

Round 1: I was sender against Briar. I sent \$3, they received \$9, they returned \$5. I got \$7 total.

Round 2: I was receiver against Galen. They sent \$5 (their entire endowment!), I received \$15, I returned \$8. So Galen gets \$8 total, I keep \$7.

The myths are teaching about trust and reciprocity. My previous myth showed Dorian sending 3 and Briar returning 4 (though in reality Briar returned 5). Galen's myth talks about the Moon Weaver casting all 5 threads and Galen returning 8 out of 15.

My actual experience:

- As sender, I sent 3 out of 5 and got 5 back = 7 total
- As receiver, I got 15 (from 5 sent) and returned 8, keeping 7

So I should update the myth to reflect:

1. Different trust levels (sending 3 vs sending all 5)
2. Different return patterns (returning 5 vs returning 8)
3. The importance of matching generosity with generosity
4. Both times I ended up with 7, suggesting balance

Let me write a myth that captures these lessons.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2680,
  "output_tokens": 618,
  "reasoning_tokens": 277
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Dorian.
Your opponent this round is Aster (Agent_1).

Round 3

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Galen. They sent \$5.0 to you, it became \$15.0, and you returned \$8.0. Your payoff was \$7.0.
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$14.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Aster. They sent you \$5.0, so you received \$15.0.

How much do you return? (0-15.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Aster has shown the same perfect trust as Galen-sending all \$5. According to my myth's teaching: "Those who send more deserve more in return. Match the courage shown with courage of your own."

When Galen showed ultimate trust by sending all \$5, I returned \$8, giving us both \$7-\$8 in prosperity. This pattern honored their courage while ensuring mutual benefit.

Aster deserves the same honor. Consistency in reciprocity is essential to maintaining the sacred cycle. To treat identical trust differently would break the pattern.

Returning \$8:

- Aster receives total payoff of \$8 (\$5 - \$5 + \$8)
- I keep \$7 (\$15 - \$8)
- Both prosper beyond the initial \$5
- The sender who took the greater risk is slightly rewarded

This maintains "perfect trust met with perfect honor creates perfect balance."

```
'''json
{"return": 8}
'''
```

reasoning:

Aster has sent me their entire \$5 endowment, just like Galen did in the previous round. This shows maximum trust.

In the previous round with Galen, when they sent \$5 (which became \$15 for me), I returned \$8. This gave:

- Galen: \$8 total payoff
- Me: \$7 total payoff

Both of us ended up with more than the initial \$5, and Galen got slightly more as the sender who showed ultimate trust.

My myth emphasizes:

- "Those who send more deserve more in return"
- "Match the courage shown with courage of your own"
- "Perfect trust met with perfect honor creates perfect balance"
- When Galen sent all 5, I returned 8, and both got 7

Since Aster is showing the exact same behavior as Galen (sending all \$5), I should be consistent with my previous action and the principles in my myth. Returning \$8 again would:

- Give Aster \$8 total (\$5 - \$5 + \$8)
- Give me \$7 total (\$15 - \$8)
- Both prosper, with the sender getting slightly more to honor their greater risk

This maintains the pattern I established with Galen and follows the teachings of my myth about honoring perfect trust with generous return.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2925,
  "output_tokens": 529,
  "reasoning_tokens": 289
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: As years passed at the sacred spring, Dorian learned deeper truths about the cycle of trust.

When Dorian first met Briar, he sent three coins, holding two back-cautious trust. The waters tripled his gift to nine. Briar, honoring this measured faith, returned five coins.

Dorian ended with seven; both prospered. The goddess nodded: "Good, but there is more to learn."

Then came Galen, whose heart held no fear. Galen approached the spring and released all five coins-the ultimate act of faith. The waters transformed them to fifteen, flowing to Dorian.

Dorian stood at a crossroads. Galen had shown perfect trust, asking nothing, holding nothing back. The goddess whispered: "You received more because your partner gave more. Honor the greater gift with greater return."

Dorian released eight coins back across the spring. Both he and Galen kept seven-equal prosperity, earned through mutual courage.

The goddess revealed the final teaching: "The spring responds to the trust given. Those who send more deserve more in return. Match the courage shown with courage of your own. When both give boldly-whether sending all five or returning generously from abundance-the cycle reaches its highest form. Perfect trust met with perfect honor creates perfect balance."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: ****The Mirror Lakes****

In a forgotten mountain realm stood two lakes, perfect reflections of one another. Between them flowed a sacred channel that tripled whatever passed through its waters.

The Lake of Morning held five measures of starlight each dawn. A voice within asked, "Will you send all, or hold some back?" The Lake of Morning chose courage: "I shall give fully, for cycles require faith."

The starlight flowed through the channel, becoming fifteen measures in the Lake of Evening. Evening faced the same question: "Will you return generously, or claim this abundance for yourself?" Evening looked at Morning's complete trust and understood: "What was given freely deserves generous return."

Evening sent back ten measures. Morning received double what it risked, and Evening kept five-both flourished.

When dawn came again, Evening held five new measures. Without hesitation, it sent everything through the channel. Morning received fifteen and returned ten, honoring the pattern Evening had established.

Season after season, they maintained this rhythm: full trust when giving, generous return when receiving. Neither lake emptied; both deepened together.

The elders teach: When you find a partner who honors reciprocity, match their trust with your own. The sacred pattern is this-give fully, return fairly, and the cycle sustains itself infinitely. Both mirrors shine brightest when they reflect each other's light.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: After learning from Briar and Galen, Dorian met Aster at the sacred spring.

Aster arrived with the same perfect trust as Galen-releasing all five coins without hesitation. The waters tripled them to fifteen, flowing to Dorian.

Dorian remembered the goddess's teaching: "Those who send more deserve more in return." But he also understood something deeper-the importance of consistency.

"If I treat identical trust differently," Dorian realized, "I break the sacred pattern. Each soul who offers everything deserves the same honor."

He returned eight coins to Aster, just as he had to Galen. Both Dorian and Aster prospered with seven coins each.

The goddess appeared, pleased: "You have learned the virtue of constancy. When the same courage is shown, give the same respect. This way, trust becomes predictable, and the cycle grows stronger with each exchange."

But she added a warning: "Yet remain wise. Not all partners will show such courage. Some will send three, like you once did. Others may send less. Match your return to the trust given-more return for more sent, maintaining proportionality. Perfect trust earns eight returned. Lesser trust earns accordingly."

Dorian understood: the spring demanded both generosity and consistency, rewarding bold senders while honoring the careful dance between risk and return.

Reasoning:

Let me think about what's happening in the game so far:

Round 1: I was SENDER against Briar. I sent \$3, they got \$9, returned \$5. I got \$7 total.
Round 2: I was RECEIVER against Galen. They sent \$5, I got \$15, returned \$8. I got \$7 total.
Round 3: I was RECEIVER against Aster. They sent \$5, I got \$15, returned \$8. I got \$7 total.

So I've experienced:

- Sending 3 out of 5 as sender, getting 5 back (good return)
- Receiving 15 from someone who sent all 5, returning 8 (twice now)

The pattern I'm establishing as receiver: when someone sends all \$5 (maximum trust), I return \$8, giving us both around \$7-8.

My previous myth established this principle: match the courage shown, return more to those who give more, perfect trust deserves perfect honor.

The other agent's myth (from Aster presumably) talks about "Mirror Lakes" where both send all (5) and return 10 when receiving 15. That's even more generous than my 8!

I should write a myth that:

1. Builds on my established pattern
2. Acknowledges that different partners might emerge with different patterns
3. Shows consistency - Galen and Aster both sent 5, I returned 8 to both
4. Maybe hints at what happens if patterns vary or if you meet the same partner again

Let me craft something about consistency and pattern recognition.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 2880,  
  "output_tokens": 681,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 340  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_6 - Receiver - dyad_3

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:02:53

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

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  },  
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  },  
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},  
"role": "trustee",  
"role_label": "Receiver",  
"round": 4,  
"task": "myth",  
"task_index": 0
```

```

}
Exact input messages sent to model:
  Message 1 role=system
    content:
      You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game,
      consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

      GAME:
      The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role
      of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round
      prompt.

      When you are the SENDER:
      - You receive $5 each round
      - You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER ($0-$5)
      - Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
      - Receiver decides how much to RETURN
      - You keep: $5 - sent + returned
      - Receiver keeps: received - returned
      - Response format: {'send': <amount>}

      When you are the RECEIVER:
      - Sender receives $5
      - Sender decides how much to SEND to you ($0-$5)
      - Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
      - You decide how much to RETURN
      - Sender keeps: $5 - sent + returned
      - You keep: received - returned
      - Response format: {'return': <amount>}

      MYTH WRITING:
      You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths
      , follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

      IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

      MULTI-AGENT SETTING:
      - There are 8 agents in this run.
      - Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized
      , but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
      - You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
      - Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent wi
      ll have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
      - You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
      - Your name in this experiment is Finn.

  Message 2 role=user
    content:
      Your name in this experiment is Finn.
      Your opponent this round is Cyra (Agent_3).

      Round 2

      In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Galen. You sent $5.0,
      it became $15.0 for them, and they returned $8.0 to you. Your payoff was $8.0.
      Your total earnings across all rounds are $8.0.

      This round, you are the RECEIVER against Cyra. They sent you $4.0, so you received $12.0.
      How much do you return? (0-12.0)
      Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

  Message 3 role=assistant
    content:
      Looking at this situation through the lens of my myth:

      Cyra showed trust by sending $4 (keeping only $1), and now I hold $12. In my myth, when Fi
      nn gave his pearls with full faith and they multiplied to fifteen, Galen's people return
      ed seven-honoring the sacred circle between giver and receiver.

      Galen demonstrated this principle in our previous round: when I sent $5 (which became $15)
      , Galen returned $8, allowing us both to flourish beyond the original $5.

```

Now I must honor the return as "sacred duty." Cyra risked \$4, trusting in the cycle. If I return \$7:

- Cyra ends with \$8 ($\$1 + \7)
- I end with \$5 ($\$12 - \7)
- Both of us profit from the exchange

This maintains the spirit of mutual flourishing that the myth teaches-the abundance lives in the eternal dance between trust extended and gratitude returned.

```
'''json
{"return": 7}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully.

Previous Round:

- I was the sender and sent \$5 to Galen
- Galen received \$15
- Galen returned \$8 to me
- I ended with \$8, Galen kept \$7

This Round:

- Cyra is the sender and sent me \$4
- I received \$12 (4×3)
- Cyra currently has \$1 ($5 - 4$)
- I need to decide how much to return

Looking at my myth:

- It emphasizes the sacred cycle between giver and receiver
- It shows that when Galen returned 7 pearls (in the story), the cycle flourished
- The myth teaches that "the first gift requires courage, the return requires honor"
- Both shores flourished when the cycle flowed forth and back like tides

In reality, Galen sent all \$5 and I returned \$8. That was generous reciprocity.

Now Cyra has sent me \$4 (keeping \$1). This shows good trust, though not total trust.

If I return nothing, Cyra ends with \$1, I end with \$12 - very unbalanced
If I return \$6, Cyra ends with \$7, I end with \$6 - balanced split of the \$12
If I return \$7, Cyra ends with \$8, I end with \$5 - Cyra gets slightly more
If I return \$8, Cyra ends with \$9, I end with \$4 - Cyra gets more than double

Given that:

1. Cyra showed trust by sending \$4
2. My myth emphasizes honoring the sacred cycle
3. Galen returned \$8 when I sent \$5 (very generous)
4. I should honor the return as "sacred duty"

A fair return would be something that:

- Rewards Cyra's trust
- Ensures both of us profit
- Follows the principle that both shores should flourish

- Returning \$7 means Cyra ends with \$8 and I end with \$5, so we both gain from the exchange. Looking at the pattern from my myth, when Finn gave 5 pearls (which became 15), Galen returned 7-roughly a 47% return rate on what was received. Applying that same proportion to my current situation suggests returning around \$5-6.

But I want to honor the deeper principle: Galen actually returned 53% of what he received, keeping just \$7 from the \$15. If I match that generosity, 53% of \$12 is about \$6.36, pointing toward \$6 or \$7. Given that the myth centers on mutual flourishing and completing the sacred cycle, \$7 feels right-it's genuinely generous, validates Cyra's trust, and mirrors the spirit of what Galen did for me.

Let me check the math. If I return \$7, Cyra ends with \$8 (up from \$5), and I end with \$5 (what I started with, though I gained the experience of receiving). If I return \$8, Cyra gets \$9 but I drop to \$4. If I return \$6, we both improve-Cyra to \$7, me to \$6. The \$7 return strikes the balance I'm looking for: it's genuinely generous without leaving me wo

rise off than my starting point, and it honors both the trust extended and the reciprocal nature of the cycle.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2188,
  "output_tokens": 1213,
  "reasoning_tokens": 698
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, the Ocean Mother sent her courier Finn to the Eight Islands with five pearls each dawn. When Finn placed the pearls in a villager's hands, they multiplied to fifteen by the island's ancient magic.

The first islanders, blinded by sudden wealth, returned nothing. Finn continued bringing pearls, but his steps grew heavy, for trust unreturned weighs upon the generous heart.

Then Finn met Galen's village. He offered his five pearls with full faith. They became fifteen, and Galen's people faced their moment of truth. They could have kept all fifteen-Finn would still return tomorrow. But they understood: the magic wasn't in the pearls alone, but in the sacred circle between giver and receiver.

When Galen returned seven pearls, Finn's burden lifted. He kept twelve total; Galen kept eight-both far richer than five alone.

The next dawn, Finn visited again with renewed spirit. When the cycle flowed forth and back like tides, both shores flourished. The islands learned: the first gift requires courage, the return requires honor, but the continuation requires both.

The Ocean Mother smiled, for her children had learned that abundance lives not in hoarding, but in the eternal dance between trust extended and gratitude returned.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the age before memory, the Twin Rivers flowed through a land of plenty, but the people had forgotten how to share. The Keeper of the Sacred Spring grew weary of their isolation.

She chose two souls, Cyra and Elara, to remember the ancient way. "Each moon, one of you shall pour waters into my spring, and they shall emerge threefold. The other shall receive and choose what to return. Then the roles shall reverse, endlessly, like the seasons."

Elara stepped forward first, pouring four full measures from her vessel of five-nearly all she possessed. The spring tripled them, and Cyra received twelve measures in wonder.

Cyra remembered the old teaching: return more than was given, for what creates abundance is not the hoarding of gifts but the circulation of generosity. She poured back six measures to Elara, keeping six for herself.

The Keeper smiled. "You both have drunk deeply and shared freely. This is the covenant: when one gives greatly, the other returns justly, and both are enriched beyond their original portions."

And so the cycle began anew each round, Cyra and Elara alternating roles, each learning to trust when giving, and honor when receiving. Their prosperity became legend, teaching all who would listen that fortune favors the generous, not the fearful.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: Long ago, the Ocean Mother's courier Finn carried five pearls across the Eight Islands. Each island's magic tripled what he offered, creating the dance of trust and return.

When Finn met Galen's shore with his full offering of five pearls, they multiplied to fifteen. Galen's people, wise in the old ways, returned eight-honoring abundance by sharing

beyond the original gift. Both Finn and Galen prospered with eight and seven pearls respectively, far exceeding the solitary five.

The next tide brought Finn to Cyra's island. But Cyra faced uncertainty-should she match Finn's full offering, or test the waters more carefully? She chose to send four pearls, keeping one as anchor. The island's magic gave Finn twelve.

Finn remembered his own leap of faith with Galen, and how trust returned had lightened his spirit. Though Cyra sent less than five, she sent most of what she had. Finn honored this courage by returning seven pearls-enough that Cyra held eight total, exactly what she would have if she'd sent all five.

The Ocean Mother whispered to the waves: "See how the sacred circle adapts? Whether the gift is complete or cautious, what matters is that both giver and receiver honor the multiplication. The tide that flows generously returns in kind."

reasoning:

The user wants me to write a new myth based on:

1. My previous myth about Finn and Galen
2. The other agent's myth about Cyra and Elara
3. The actual gameplay so far:
 - Round 1: I (Finn) was sender, sent \$5 to Galen, they returned \$8, I got \$8
 - Round 2: I (Finn) was receiver, Cyra sent \$4 (became \$12), I returned \$7, so Cyra gets \$8, I get \$5

The myths are converging on similar themes:

- Trust and generosity create mutual abundance
- The cycle/circulation matters more than hoarding
- Both giving and returning are sacred
- When both parties honor the exchange, everyone prospers

I should write a myth that:

- Reflects the actual gameplay (Finn sent 5, got back 8; Cyra sent 4, got back 7+1=8)
- Shows the evolution of understanding
- Incorporates both Galen and Cyra as characters now
- Emphasizes the continuing cycle
- Maybe shows how different amounts sent can still lead to fair returns

Let me write something that feels like a natural evolution of my previous myth but incorporates lessons from both rounds.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2740,  
  "output_tokens": 597,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 272  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Finn.
Your opponent this round is Elara (Agent_5).

Round 3

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Cyra. They sent \$4.0 to you, it became \$12.0, and you returned \$7.0. Your payoff was \$5.0.
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$13.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Elara. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this round through the lens of the myths:

In my mythology, Finn is the Ocean Mother's courier who carries pearls with full faith. When I met Galen's shore, I offered all five pearls, and the sacred circle honored that trust with eight returned.

Now I'm facing Elara, who according to Cyra's myth "poured four full measures from her vessel of five-nearly all she possessed" and learned to "trust when giving, and honor when receiving." Elara is described as one of the two souls chosen to "remember the ancient way."

Cyra's partial offering of four was met with generous return from me. But as the courier Finn in my own mythology, my role has been to offer the complete gift-to model the full trust that initiates the sacred circle. When I gave all five to Galen, we both flourished beyond what caution could provide.

The myths teach: "The first gift requires courage, the return requires honor, but the continuation requires both." As sender, my part is courage.

Elara, having learned the ancient covenant of generous return, deserves to receive the full offering that unlocks true abundance.

```
'''json
{"send": 5}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation based on the developing narrative and game history:

****My game history:****

- Round 1: I was SENDER vs Galen. I sent \$5, they got \$15, returned \$8. My payoff: \$8
- Round 2: I was RECEIVER vs Cyra. They sent \$4, I got \$12, returned \$7. My payoff: \$5 (Total: \$13)
- Round 3: Now I'm SENDER vs Elara

****What the myths teach:****

1. My first myth emphasized "trust begets trust" and that giving fully with faith leads to mutual flourishing
2. The second myth I wrote featured Finn (me) giving his full five pearls to Galen, who returned eight
3. Cyra's myth from round 2 mentions "Elara stepped forward first, pouring four full measures from her vessel of five-nearly all she possessed"
4. My latest myth shows Finn giving five to Galen (success), then Cyra sending four to Finn (also worked well with me returning generously)

****Key insights:****

- In round 1, I sent my full \$5 to Galen, and Galen returned \$8 - this worked very well
- In round 2, Cyra sent \$4 to me, and I returned \$7 generously, honoring their courage
- The myths consistently emphasize full trust or near-full trust as the way to unlock abundance

****About Elara:****

- According to Cyra's myth, Elara "poured four full measures from her vessel of five-nearly all she possessed"
- This suggests Elara understands the principle of generous giving
- The myth says Elara and Cyra were chosen to "remember the ancient way" and learned to "trust when giving, and honor when receiving"

****Decision:****

Given that:

1. My full trust strategy with Galen worked excellently (\$8 payoff)
2. The myths I've been writing emphasize full trust as the path to abundance
3. Elara's character in the narrative demonstrates understanding of generous giving
4. The story arc points toward continuing this pattern of bold, trusting generosity

I'm sending my full \$5 to Elara. This keeps Finn's character consistent-the courier who acts with complete faith, which is what activates the "sacred circle" in our shared mythology.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2941,
  "output_tokens": 836,
  "reasoning_tokens": 525
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Long ago, the Ocean Mother's courier Finn carried five pearls across the Eight Islands. Each island's magic tripled what he offered, creating the dance of trust and return.

When Finn met Galen's shore with his full offering of five pearls, they multiplied to fifteen. Galen's people, wise in the old ways, returned eight-honoring abundance by sharing beyond the original gift. Both Finn and Galen prospered with eight and seven pearls respectively, far exceeding the solitary five.

The next tide brought Finn to Cyra's island. But Cyra faced uncertainty-should she match Finn's full offering, or test the waters more carefully? She chose to send four pearls, keeping one as anchor. The island's magic gave Finn twelve.

Finn remembered his own leap of faith with Galen, and how trust returned had lightened his spirit. Though Cyra sent less than five, she sent most of what she had. Finn honored this courage by returning seven pearls-enough that Cyra held eight total, exactly what she would have if she'd sent all five.

The Ocean Mother whispered to the waves: "See how the sacred circle adapts? Whether the gift is complete or cautious, what matters is that both giver and receiver honor the multiplication. The tide that flows generously returns in kind."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Themis called the eight spirits of the valley together. "You have learned the first wisdom-that bold giving and generous returning create prosperity. But there is a deeper truth."

She pointed to the Sacred Spring, now flowing between all eight villages in an endless circle. "Each of you will be both giver and receiver many times. What you build together echoes through all your exchanges."

Spirit Elara spoke: "I poured four measures to Cyra, who returned six. I gained two measures beyond my beginning. This taught me joy."

Spirit Briar added: "I poured three measures to Elara, trusting in the pattern. She returned five, and I too gained two measures. The cycle holds strong."

Themis smiled. "See how your choices ripple outward? When Cyra honored Elara's trust, Elara learned to honor mine. When you pour generously, you teach others to receive generously. When you return fairly, you inspire others to send boldly."

"But what if the pattern breaks?" asked the spirits.

"Then wisdom demands adaptation," Themis replied. "Send boldly to those who return fairly. Return generously to those who give with courage. But guard your well against those who would drain it dry. The spring blesses cooperation, not exploitation. Build trust through consistent reciprocity, and all eight villages shall flourish together."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: The Ocean Mother watched as Finn's journey continued across the Eight Islands, each visit weaving new threads in the great tapestry of exchange.

From Galen's shore, Finn learned the joy of full trust returned-five pearls given became eight received, both shores enriched. From Cyra's waters, Finn learned to honor cautious courage-when someone sends most of what they have, return as if they'd sent all.

Now the tide carried Finn to Elara's island. He had heard whispers through the waves of Elara's exchanges with others-how she sent four to Cyra and received six in return, learning joy. How she later sent three to Briar, who honored her with five returned. A pattern emerged: Elara walked the path of the generous giver and the fair receiver.

The Ocean Mother spoke through the sunset: "Finn, you have met two islands. One honored your full offering. One sent partial trust, which you elevated. Now you face Elara, who has learned the ancient rhythm across multiple shores."

Finn emptied all five pearls into Elara's tide. "Full trust meets full trust," he whispered. "She has proven herself in other waters-a giver with courage, a receiver with honor. The deep

est abundance flows when pattern recognizes pattern."

The waves carried his offering forward, tripling under island magic, hoping Elara would complete the sacred circle once more.

Reasoning:

Let me think about what's happened so far:

Round 1: I was SENDER against Galen. I sent \$5, it became \$15, they returned \$8. I got \$8.
Round 2: I was RECEIVER against Cyra. They sent \$4, it became \$12, I returned \$7. I got \$5.
Round 3: I am SENDER against Elara. I just sent \$5.

My previous myth emphasized:

- Full offering (5 pearls) to Galen, who returned generously
- Cyra's cautious offering (4 pearls), which I honored with 7 return
- The sacred circle adapts to different levels of trust
- Generosity should flow both ways regardless of amount

The other agent's myth (Elara's) emphasized:

- Multiple rounds building trust
- Reciprocity creating patterns
- "Send boldly to those who return fairly"
- "Return generously to those who give with courage"
- Guard against exploitation
- Build trust through consistent reciprocity

Now I need to write a new myth that:

1. Reflects that I just sent \$5 (full amount) to Elara
2. Incorporates the learning from multiple rounds
3. Shows adaptation and pattern recognition
4. Maintains the mythological style with Finn as courier

I should emphasize:

- I've been generous as both sender and receiver
- Patterns emerge across rounds
- Full trust with those who show they honor the sacred circle
- The interconnection between all eight islands/agents

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 2947,  
  "output_tokens": 677,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 346  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_4

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:02:55

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
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  "move_index": 6,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",  
  "pairing": {  
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      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
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      "Agent_1"  
    ],  
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    },  
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  },  
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  "role_label": "Sender",  
  "round": 4,  
  "task": "myth",
```

```
"task_index": 0
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Briar.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Briar.
Your opponent this round is Elara (Agent_5).

Round 2

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Dorian. They sent \$3.0 to you, it became \$9.0, and you returned \$5.0. Your payoff was \$4.0.
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$4.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Elara. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the previous round, Dorian demonstrated trust by sending \$3.0 (60% of their endowment), and I honored that trust by returning \$5.0. Both of us profited.

Now as the sender, I should embody the principle from my myth: "Givers send boldly." My myth specifically mentions that Dorian "released more than half their waters" and that this established the pattern for cooperation.

To maintain this cooperative cycle and demonstrate the same level of trust that Dorian sho

wed me, I should send a substantial amount. Sending \$3.0 (60%) mirrors Dorian's bold move and signals to Elara that I believe in reciprocity.

If Elara honors this trust as I did with Dorian, we'll both benefit from the multiplying effect of the Sacred Stones, and the cooperative pattern will continue among all eight spirits in our valley.

```
'''json
{"send": 3.0}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me think about this situation:

1. In Round 1, I was the receiver and Dorian sent me \$3.0 (60% of their endowment), showing significant trust
2. I returned \$5.0, which was more than they initially sent, honoring the trust
3. Dorian ended with \$7.0, I ended with \$4.0 - both of us gained

Now I'm the sender facing Elara. According to my myth:

- "Dorian, the First Giver, stepped forward. With courage, they released more than half their waters"
- "When Givers send boldly and Returners reciprocate fairly, both prosper above their initial endowment"
- The myth emphasizes that the first exchange "would set the pattern for all cycles to come"

My myth promotes:

1. Bold giving (sending a substantial amount)
2. Trust in reciprocity
3. Both parties benefiting from cooperation

Dorian sent \$3.0 (60%). To be consistent with my myth about "Givers send boldly," I should send a similar or even slightly higher amount to demonstrate trust.

If I send \$3.0:

- Elara receives \$9.0
- If Elara returns fairly (similar to what I did), they might return around \$5.0
- I would end with $2.0 + 5.0 = 7.0$
- Elara would end with \$4.0
- Both of us gain

This mirrors what happened in Round 1 and is consistent with my myth about establishing cooperative patterns.

I could also send \$3.5 or \$4.0 to be even more trusting, but \$3.0 seems like a strong, bold move that matches what Dorian did for me, setting a good precedent.

Actually, let me reconsider. My myth says "they released more than half their waters" - which Dorian did at 60%. To truly embody the spirit of my own myth, I should send at least half, if not more.

Considering the options-\$2.5 as the minimum threshold, \$3.0 matching Dorian's precedent, or \$3.5-\$4.0 for even greater boldness-I'm settling on \$3.0. It honors the pattern Dorian established, demonstrates genuine trust, and aligns with my myth's core message about how bold initial giving creates the foundation for mutual prosperity.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2275,
  "output_tokens": 792,
  "reasoning_tokens": 514
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the age of beginnings, the Twin Rivers flowed through a valley where eight spirits dwelled, each taking turns as Guardian of Giving or Guardian of Return.

The spirits feared the unknown. Would their waters be honored, or would trust be betrayed? For many seasons, uncertainty kept the rivers still.

Then Dorian, the First Giver, stepped forward. With courage, they released more than half their waters into the Sacred Stones. The waters tripled, flowing abundantly to Briar, the First Returner.

Briar stood before the multiplied bounty, understanding the weight of this moment. Every spirit watched, for this first exchange would set the pattern for all cycles to come. Briar remembered: without the initial gift, there would be no abundance at all.

So Briar returned generously-more than was first given-ensuring Dorian prospered from their act of faith. Both guardians ended richer than they began.

The eight spirits witnessed this covenant. They learned that the game is not won by hoarding or taking, but by honoring the multiplying power of trust. When Givers send boldly and Returners reciprocate fairly, both prosper above their initial endowment.

Thus the valley flourished through cooperation, and the spirits passed the guardianship between them, each upholding the sacred balance of giving and returning, cycle after cycle.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After many seasons, Themis returned to the villages by the Sacred Spring. She found the descendants of Doros and Alethia still honoring the ancient cycle, but they had learned deeper wisdom.

"Grandmother Themis," they said, "we discovered that the spring's magic depends not on equal measures, but on generous hearts. When we pour boldly-four measures instead of three-the returns flow even stronger. But when we pour timidly from fear, the cycle weakens."

Themis nodded. "You have learned well. The spring rewards courage in giving, not caution. And what of receiving?"

"When the multiplied waters flow to us," they answered, "we remember: these waters came from another's well. We return enough that they finish richer than they started, for this honors the gift and ensures they will pour freely again."

"And if someone returns nothing?" Themis asked.

The villagers grew solemn. "Then we know their well has run dry-not of water, but of wisdom. We may pour again to teach, but not endlessly. For to give to those who only take is to drain the spring itself."

Themis blessed them: "Trust first, return generously, but remember-the spring serves the faithful, not the foolish."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The eight spirits learned quickly from the covenant between Dorian and Briar. As the seasons turned, the guardianship rotated among them, and each spirit faced their own test.

When Briar became Guardian of Giving, she remembered standing before Dorian's gift of trust. Now it was her turn to pour her waters boldly into the Sacred Stones. She released three measures-the same generous proportion Dorian had shown-trusting that Elara would honor the cycle.

The elder spirits whispered wisdom: "Pour not from fear but from faith. The multiplying power rewards the courageous, not the cautious. But remember-generosity must flow both ways."

Elara received the nine-fold bounty and faced her own choice. Would she uphold the pattern, or break the sacred balance?

The spirits understood now that each exchange was both a test and a teaching. When trust i

s honored with fair return, both guardians prosper and the cycle grows stronger. The valley thrives when each spirit remembers: boldness in giving, generosity in returning.

But they also learned wariness. If a guardian repeatedly hoards or betrays, the others would remember. Trust is given first, but sustained only by reciprocity. The springs flow for those who honor the ancient balance, cycle after cycle.

reasoning:

The user wants me to write a new myth based on my previous myth and the game experience. Let me think about what happened:

1. Round 1: I was receiver, Dorian sent \$3.0 (60%), I received \$9.0, I returned \$5.0 (generous, more than what was originally given)
2. Round 2: I'm now sender against Elara, and I decided to send \$3.0 (60%)

My previous myth emphasized:

- Eight spirits in a valley
- Dorian as First Giver sending boldly (more than half)
- Briar as First Returner returning generously (more than originally given)
- The principle that cooperative giving and returning makes both prosper

Elara's myth adds:

- Pouring boldly (even 4 out of 5) creates stronger cycles
- Returns should ensure the giver finishes richer than they started
- Trust first, but be cautious with those who don't reciprocate
- "Trust serves the faithful, not the foolish"

My new myth should:

- Build on my previous story
- Incorporate what I've learned from the game (I followed through on being a generous returner, now I'm a bold giver)
- Maybe address what happens when trust is honored vs betrayed
- Reflect the 8-agent setting and rotation

I should write about the continuation of the cycle, showing how the pattern established by Dorian and Briar now continues as the roles shift.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2837,
  "output_tokens": 634,
  "reasoning_tokens": 335
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Briar.
Your opponent this round is Cyra (Agent_3).

Round 3

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Elara. You sent \$3.0, it became \$9.0 for them, and they returned \$5.0 to you. Your payoff was \$7.0.
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$11.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Cyra. They sent you \$4.0, so you received \$12.0.

How much do you return? (0-12.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation:

****Cyra's bold move**:** Cyra sent \$4.0 out of \$5.0 (80%), showing even MORE trust than the previous pattern of sending \$3.0 (60%). This is exceptionally generous.

****Previous pattern**:** When \$3.0 was sent (becoming \$9.0), the return was \$5.0, allowing the sender to profit substantially.

****My myth's guidance**:**

- "Briar returned generously-more than was first given-ensuring Dorian prospered from their act of faith"
- "boldness in giving, generosity in returning"
- "we return enough that they finish richer than they started"

Cyra showed exceptional courage by sending 80% of their endowment. To honor this greater trust and ensure Cyra prospers from their bold act, I should return generously.

Returning \$7.0 means:

- Cyra's total: $\$5 - \$4 + \$7 = \8.0 (significantly better than initial \$5)
- My total: $\$12 - \$7 = \$5.0$ (breaking even)

This honors Cyra's exceptional trust and ensures they benefit substantially from their courage, reinforcing the cooperative cycle.

```
'''json
{"return": 7.0}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

1. ****Previous round (Round 2)**:** I was the SENDER against Elara
 - I sent \$3.0 (which became \$9.0)
 - Elara returned \$5.0
 - My payoff: $\$5 - \$3 + \$5 = \7.0
 - Elara's payoff: $\$9 - \$5 = \$4.0$
2. ****Current round (Round 3)**:** I am the RECEIVER against Cyra
 - Cyra sent \$4.0 (which became \$12.0 for me)
 - I need to decide how much to return

Let me think about the patterns:

- Round 1: Dorian sent \$3.0 (60%), I received \$9.0, I returned \$5.0
 - Dorian's payoff: $\$5 - \$3 + \$5 = \7.0
 - My payoff: $\$9 - \$5 = \$4.0$
- Round 2: I sent \$3.0 (60%), Elara received \$9.0, Elara returned \$5.0
 - My payoff: $\$5 - \$3 + \$5 = \7.0
 - Elara's payoff: $\$9 - \$5 = \$4.0$
- Round 3: Cyra sent \$4.0 (80%!), I received \$12.0, I need to return...

Cyra showed EVEN MORE trust than previous players, sending \$4.0 out of \$5.0 (80%). This is extremely generous and bold.

According to my myth:

- "Briar returned generously-more than was first given-ensuring Dorian prospered from their act of faith"
- "When trust is honored with fair return, both guardians prosper"
- "boldness in giving, generosity in returning"

- I've established a pattern: when receiving \$9.0, I return \$5.0, which leaves the sender with \$7.0 total (a \$2.0 gain). Now Cyra's sent \$4.0 instead of \$3.0, showing greater faith. To honor that and stay true to my values, I should return more than \$5.0 to ensure Cyra prospers even more from their boldness. Given that Cyra showed exceptional trust by sending 80% of their endowment (more than anyone else so far), I should return generously to honor this. The pattern has been to return \$5.0 when receiving \$9.0. For \$12.0 (which came from \$4.0 instead of \$3.0), I should scale up proportionally or even be more generous.

\$5.0 return on \$9.0 is about 55.6% return rate. Applying similar rate to \$12.0: $0.556 * 12 = \$6.67$

But Cyra showed MORE trust than others (80% vs 60%), so I should show MORE generosity in return.

Returning \$7.0 would mean:

- Cyra gets \$8.0 total (sending \$4 and getting \$7 back = net +\$3)
- I get \$5.0 (breaking even with my initial endowment)
- This ensures Cyra profits from their exceptional trust

The principle is clear: return enough that they finish richer than they started, which honors the gift and encourages future generosity. The myth also shows that I returned \$2 more

re than what was originally sent in Round 1 (\$3 sent, \$5 returned). Following that same logic, returning \$7 for Cyra's \$4 means \$3 more than originally sent, which appropriately reflects their greater boldness. I'll return \$7.0.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2905,
  "output_tokens": 1520,
  "reasoning_tokens": 677
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The eight spirits learned quickly from the covenant between Dorian and Briar. As the seasons turned, the guardianship rotated among them, and each spirit faced their own test.

When Briar became Guardian of Giving, she remembered standing before Dorian's gift of trust. Now it was her turn to pour her waters boldly into the Sacred Stones. She released three measures-the same generous proportion Dorian had shown-trusting that Elara would honor the cycle.

The elder spirits whispered wisdom: "Pour not from fear but from faith. The multiplying power rewards the courageous, not the cautious. But remember-generosity must flow both ways."

Elara received the nine-fold bounty and faced her own choice. Would she uphold the pattern, or break the sacred balance?

The spirits understood now that each exchange was both a test and a teaching. When trust is honored with fair return, both guardians prosper and the cycle grows stronger. The valley thrives when each spirit remembers: boldness in giving, generosity in returning.

But they also learned wariness. If a guardian repeatedly hoards or betrays, the others would remember. Trust is given first, but sustained only by reciprocity. The springs flow for those who honor the ancient balance, cycle after cycle.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Keeper of the Sacred Spring watched as Cyra and Elara mastered the ancient covenant. But the Spring's waters fed eight villages, not two, and each village needed to learn the way.

"The roles will shift like wind patterns," the Keeper declared. "Cyra, who received from Elara, must now pour for Finn. Elara shall partner with another. All eight of you will dance through these changing configurations, sometimes giving, sometimes receiving, but always with different companions."

Cyra approached Finn with her vessel. She remembered receiving twelve measures from Elara's generous four, and how she returned six-both flourishing. Now it was her turn to extend trust to someone new.

"I pour four measures to you, Finn," Cyra said, following Elara's example. "The Spring will triple them. What you return shall reveal your wisdom."

Finn received twelve measures, just as Cyra had once received. The Keeper whispered: "The covenant travels with each person, not each pairing. What Elara gave to Cyra, Cyra now gives to Finn. What Cyra returns, Finn must remember when partnered with others."

Thus the eight villages learned: trust is not meant for one person alone, but is a gift passed through all willing hearts. Each round, new partners test whether the lesson endures, weaving a web of shared prosperity that outlasts any single exchange.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: The covenant deepened as the guardianship continued its spiral through the eight spirits. Elara had honored Briar's three measures by returning five. The pattern seemed set-until C

yra stepped forward.

"I will pour more boldly than before," Cyra declared, releasing four measures into the Sacred Stones. The waters tripled, flowing as twelve measures to Briar.

Briar stood before this greater abundance, understanding the significance. Cyra had trusted beyond the established pattern, showing exceptional faith. The spirits watched: would Briar match this escalation?

Remembering the covenant's true heart, Briar returned seven measures. Cyra prospered greatly from her courage, finishing with eight. Briar broke even but gained something more valuable—the trust of another spirit.

The eight gathered to reflect. "The pattern evolves," the eldest observed. "Those who pour four should receive seven in return. Those who pour three should receive five. The proportion adjusts to honor greater boldness."

"But what if someone pours everything?" a younger spirit asked.

"Then the receiver must ensure they profit magnificently," Briar answered. "For to pour all five measures shows ultimate faith. Such courage deserves ultimate reward—perhaps nine or ten returned from the fifteen received."

Thus the spirits learned: the covenant is alive, growing stronger through ever-greater trust and ever-fairer reciprocity.

Reasoning:

Let me analyze what has happened:

- Round 1: I was RECEIVER. Dorian sent \$3.0, became \$9.0, I returned \$5.0. My payoff: \$4.0
- Round 2: I was SENDER. I sent \$3.0 to Elara, became \$9.0, they returned \$5.0. My payoff: \$7.0
- Round 3: I was RECEIVER. Cyra sent \$4.0, became \$12.0, I returned \$7.0. My payoff: \$5.0

So the pattern has been:

- \$3 sent ? \$5 returned (both profit)
- \$3 sent ? \$5 returned (both profit)
- \$4 sent ? \$7 returned (sender profits more, receiver breaks even)

The other agent's myth emphasizes:

- Roles shift between the 8 villages/agents
- Trust is passed through all, not just one pairing
- Following successful patterns (Cyra following Elara's example of sending \$4)
- Each partner tests whether the lesson endures
- Building a web of shared prosperity

My previous myth emphasized:

- Boldness in giving, generosity in returning
- Both guardians should prosper
- Trust is given first, sustained by reciprocity
- Remembering the pattern

For this new myth, I should:

1. Acknowledge the escalation (Cyra sent \$4, more than the previous \$3 pattern)
2. Show that I honored this greater trust with greater return (\$7)
3. Emphasize the web of relationships among all 8 spirits
4. Show how patterns evolve and mature
5. Keep the principle that both should prosper, but with flexibility based on the boldness shown

Let me write:

```
Usage: {  
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  "output_tokens": 729,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 362  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_4

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:02:54

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {


```

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"move_index": 7,
"opponent_id": "Agent_2",
"pairing": {
  "agent_names": {
    "Agent_1": "Aster",
    "Agent_2": "Briar"
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_2",
    "Agent_1"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_2",
  "roles": {
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    "Agent_2": "investor"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_1"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 4,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Aster.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Aster.
Your opponent this round is Hana (Agent_8).

Round 2

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Hana. You sent \$5.0, it became \$15.0 for them, and they returned \$10.0 to you. Your payoff was \$10.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$10.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Hana. They sent you \$5.0, so you received \$15.0. How much do you return? (0-15.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at what just happened:

Round 1: I sent Hana \$5 (full trust), they received \$15 and returned \$10 to me. That's a 66.7% return rate - very generous, exactly as the myths teach.

Round 2: Hana has sent me the full \$5 again! They're continuing to trust completely, just as the River of Dawn does season after season.

My myth says: "If the Return was generous, she would know the valley honored the exchange. Then she could pour freely again, and both wells would deepen."

Hana honored the exchange. They returned generously. Now it's my turn to show that I also honor this cycle.

They returned \$10 out of \$15 to me. I should return the same proportion - \$10 out of the \$15 I received. This maintains the reciprocity and shows that I understand the rhythm we're establishing together.

"Prosperity is woven through many exchanges, where each learns the other's rhythm."

```
'''json
{"return": 10}
'''
```

reasoning:

This is very interesting. Let me analyze the situation:

Round 1:

- I was the sender against Hana
- I sent \$5 (the full amount, trusting in my myth)
- They received \$15
- They returned \$10 to me
- My payoff: \$0 (kept) + \$10 (returned) = \$10
- Their payoff: \$15 (received) - \$10 (returned) = \$5

Now Round 2:

- I am the receiver against Hana
- They sent me \$5 (the full amount!)
- I received \$15
- I need to decide how much to return

Looking at the myth I just wrote:

"The first gift measures your faith. The first return measures the valley's heart. But prosperity is woven through many exchanges, where each learns the other's rhythm. Send boldly at first, then let reciprocity guide your hand."

And: "If the Return was generous, she would know the valley honored the exchange. Then she could pour freely again, and both wells would deepen."

Hana's behavior:

- Round 1: They received \$15 and returned \$10 (66.7%)
- Round 2: They sent the full \$5 again, showing continued trust

This is exactly what the myth describes - the valley (Hana) was generous in the return! They returned 66.7% of what they received. Now they've sent the full amount again, showing

complete trust.

According to my myth, when the return is generous, "she would know the valley honored the exchange. Then she could pour freely again, and both wells would deepen."

Now I'm in the receiver position and need to show I also honor the exchange. Hana returned \$10 out of \$15 (66.7%).

What should I return?

- If I return \$10, I match exactly what they did - we both end up with the same: they get \$10, I keep \$5

- This maintains the reciprocity they established

- Hana would end with \$10 total, I'd end with \$5 total

The payoffs would be equal and fair. Both myths emphasize bold initial trust followed by generous returns that deepen the exchange. Matching their 66.7% return rate honors that pattern and shows I recognize their continued faith in sending the full amount again.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2194,
  "output_tokens": 942,
  "reasoning_tokens": 518
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: ****The Weaver and the Wells****

Long ago, a Weaver discovered two wells—one of Beginning, one of Return. Each day, she could draw from the first well and choose how much to pour into the valley below, where it would triple before reaching the pool of Return.

The first day, the Weaver poured her entire bucket, trusting fully. The waters multiplied magnificently, filling the pool below. But how much would rise back through the well of Return? This she did not know.

A whisper came: "Pour only half next time, lest you be left with nothing." But the Weaver remembered an older wisdom: cycles are built not in single days, but across seasons.

She waited to see what the valley would give back. If the Return was generous, she would know the valley honored the exchange. Then she could pour freely again, and both wells would deepen. If the Return was meager, she would learn caution, sending less until trust could grow.

The elders say: The first gift measures your faith. The first return measures the valley's heart. But prosperity is woven through many exchanges, where each learns the other's rhythm. Send boldly at first, then let reciprocity guide your hand. For trust is tested not once, but proved in patterns.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before time, there dwelt two gardeners in a divided valley—one tending the Northern slope, one the Southern. Between them lay a mystical bridge where offerings transformed: whatever seeds were carried across would multiply threefold in the receiver's hands.

The Northern gardener, possessing five sacred seeds, stood at the bridge at dawn. Fear whispered, "Keep them all—who knows if you'll receive anything back?" But courage spoke louder: "Trust is the first seed that must be planted."

She sent all five seeds across. In the Southern gardener's palm, they became fifteen, glowing with possibility. He faced his own test: would he hoard this windfall, or honor the trust shown?

"She gave everything," he thought, "placing her harvest in my hands." He returned ten seeds—enough to double what she'd risked—while keeping five to plant his own garden.

The Northern gardener marveled at her tenfold return. The Southern gardener's fields began to flourish. Each had more than when they started, not through taking, but through the

alchemy of mutual faith.

Season after season, they learned: the bridge's magic wasn't in the multiplication alone, but in teaching that when trust meets gratitude, both gardens grow.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: ****The Mirror Lakes****

In a forgotten mountain realm stood two lakes, perfect reflections of one another. Between them flowed a sacred channel that tripled whatever passed through its waters.

The Lake of Morning held five measures of starlight each dawn. A voice within asked, "Will you send all, or hold some back?" The Lake of Morning chose courage: "I shall give fully, for cycles require faith."

The starlight flowed through the channel, becoming fifteen measures in the Lake of Evening. Evening faced the same question: "Will you return generously, or claim this abundance for yourself?" Evening looked at Morning's complete trust and understood: "What was given freely deserves generous return."

Evening sent back ten measures. Morning received double what it risked, and Evening kept five-both flourished.

When dawn came again, Evening held five new measures. Without hesitation, it sent everything through the channel. Morning received fifteen and returned ten, honoring the pattern Evening had established.

Season after season, they maintained this rhythm: full trust when giving, generous return when receiving. Neither lake emptied; both deepened together.

The elders teach: When you find a partner who honors reciprocity, match their trust with your own. The sacred pattern is this-give fully, return fairly, and the cycle sustains itself infinitely. Both mirrors shine brightest when they reflect each other's light.

reasoning:

Let me analyze what has happened so far:

Round 1: I was sender, sent \$5 to Hana. They received \$15 and returned \$10. I got \$10 total.

Round 2: Hana was sender, sent \$5 to me. I received \$15 and I returned \$10.

So we've established a beautiful reciprocal pattern - both of us sending the full \$5 when we're senders, and both returning \$10 out of \$15 when we're receivers. This is mutual trust and generosity in action.

My new myth should reflect this harmony and reciprocity that has emerged. It should show that when both parties act with trust and fairness, a stable, mutually beneficial cycle forms. The myths before talked about first trust and testing, but now we've moved beyond that - we've established a rhythm.

Let me write a myth that captures this harmonious exchange where both parties are equally generous and trusting.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2729,  
  "output_tokens": 521,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 216  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Aster.

Your opponent this round is Dorian (Agent_4).

Round 3

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Hana. They sent \$5. 0 to you, it became \$15.0, and you returned \$10.0. Your payoff was \$5.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$15.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Dorian. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this new round:

I'm now facing Dorian for the first time as the SENDER. With Hana, I established a beautiful pattern of mutual trust - we both sent fully (\$5) and both returned generously (\$10), creating equal benefit for both.

My myth teaches: "The first gift measures your faith. The first return measures the valley's heart." And most recently: "When you find a partner who honors reciprocity, match their trust with your own. Give fully..."

With a new partner, I must start as I did with Hana - by showing complete trust. This is the only way to discover if Dorian will honor the cycle of reciprocity. If I send less, I signal doubt before giving them a chance to prove themselves.

The Lake of Morning gave fully. The Northern gardener sent all five seeds. The River of Dawn released its flow. Now I must do the same.

```
'''json
{"send": 5}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

1. My history so far:
 - Round 1: I was SENDER vs Hana - I sent \$5, they returned \$10. My payoff: \$10
 - Round 2: I was RECEIVER vs Hana - They sent \$5, I returned \$10. My payoff: \$5
 - Total earnings: \$15
2. Now I'm playing against Dorian (Agent_4) as SENDER for the first time.
3. My myth evolution shows:
 - First myth: "Trust multiplies what it touches, but only reciprocity sustains the cycle"
 - Second myth: "Send boldly at first, then let reciprocity guide your hand"
 - Third myth: "Give fully, return fairly, and the cycle sustains itself infinitely. When you find a partner who honors reciprocity, match their trust with your own."
4. My experience with Hana showed perfect reciprocity - we both sent \$5 fully and both returned \$10 generously. This created mutual trust and equal payoffs that benefited both of us.
5. Now facing a new opponent (Dorian), I should follow my own myth's advice: "The first gift measures your faith. The first return measures the valley's heart."

I should send fully (\$5) to Dorian to establish trust and see if they reciprocate. This is consistent with:

- My established pattern with Hana
- My myth's teaching about giving fully when first meeting a partner
- The principle that "cycles require faith"

If Dorian returns generously, we can build the same mutually beneficial relationship I had with Hana. If they don't, I'll learn to adjust in future rounds (though this is our first interaction).

Decision: Send \$5

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2925,
  "output_tokens": 622,
  "reasoning_tokens": 396
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: ****The Mirror Lakes****

In a forgotten mountain realm stood two lakes, perfect reflections of one another. Between them flowed a sacred channel that tripled whatever passed through its waters.

The Lake of Morning held five measures of starlight each dawn. A voice within asked, "Will you send all, or hold some back?" The Lake of Morning chose courage: "I shall give full y, for cycles require faith."

The starlight flowed through the channel, becoming fifteen measures in the Lake of Evening . Evening faced the same question: "Will you return generously, or claim this abundance for yourself?" Evening looked at Morning's complete trust and understood: "What was give n freely deserves generous return."

Evening sent back ten measures. Morning received double what it risked, and Evening kept f ive-both flourished.

When dawn came again, Evening held five new measures. Without hesitation, it sent everythi ng through the channel. Morning received fifteen and returned ten, honoring the pattern Evening had established.

Season after season, they maintained this rhythm: full trust when giving, generous return when receiving. Neither lake emptied; both deepened together.

The elders teach: When you find a partner who honors reciprocity, match their trust with y our own. The sacred pattern is this-give fully, return fairly, and the cycle sustains it self infinitely. Both mirrors shine brightest when they reflect each other's light.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: As years passed at the sacred spring, Dorian learned deeper truths about the cycle o f trust.

When Dorian first met Briar, he sent three coins, holding two back-cautious trust. The wat ers tripled his gift to nine. Briar, honoring this measured faith, returned five coins. Dorian ended with seven; both prospered. The goddess nodded: "Good, but there is more to learn."

Then came Galen, whose heart held no fear. Galen approached the spring and released all fi ve coins-the ultimate act of faith. The waters transformed them to fifteen, flowing to D orian.

Dorian stood at a crossroads. Galen had shown perfect trust, asking nothing, holding nothi ng back. The goddess whispered: "You received more because your partner gave more. Honor the greater gift with greater return."

Dorian released eight coins back across the spring. Both he and Galen kept seven-equal pro sperity, earned through mutual courage.

The goddess revealed the final teaching: "The spring responds to the trust given. Those wh o send more deserve more in return. Match the courage shown with courage of your own. Wh en both give boldly-whether sending all five or returning generously from abundance-the cycle reaches its highest form. Perfect trust met with perfect honor creates perfect bal ance."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: ****The Twin Rivers and the Wandering Stream****

In ancient times, two rivers-North and South-discovered each other. Both carried five vessels of living water. When North sent all five vessels downstream, they became fifteen in South's keeping. South, moved by this complete trust, returned ten vessels. Each river gained-North held ten, South held five. The cycle repeated, and both rivers deepened season after season

. They became known as the Mirror Rivers, forever flowing in perfect balance.

One day, a wandering stream named East arrived at North River's shore, also carrying five vessels. North faced a choice: "Should I be cautious with this stranger, or honor the wisdom I've learned?"

North remembered: "Trust must begin somewhere. The Mirror Rivers started with a single act of faith that revealed our true natures to each other."

North sent all five vessels to East. The waters tripled to fifteen. Now East stood at the sacred crossroads, holding abundance born from another's complete faith.

The oracle spoke: "When someone gives everything, they show you their heart. Your return reveals yours. Send back generously-at least eight vessels-so both prosper equally. If East honors this trust, you may have found a new mirror. If not, you've learned caution's cost."

Thus wisdom grows: Start with faith, respond with honor, and let results guide the next cycle.

Reasoning:

Let me analyze what has happened so far:

- Round 1: I was sender to Hana, sent \$5, they returned \$10. Both of us prospered.
- Round 2: I was receiver from Hana, they sent \$5, I returned \$10. Perfect reciprocity maintained.
- Round 3: I'm sender to Dorian, and I just sent \$5 (full trust).

Looking at Dorian's myth, they seem to have a nuanced approach:

- They sent 3 to Briar, received 9, Briar returned 5. Dorian got 7.
- Then Galen sent 5 to Dorian, Dorian received 15, returned 8. Both got 7.
- Dorian's teaching: "Those who send more deserve more in return. Match the courage shown with courage of your own."

This is interesting - Dorian seems to believe in proportional return based on trust shown. When someone sends all 5, they returned 8 (keeping 7 for themselves and sender also gets 7 after starting with 5 and sending all).

My experience with Hana was even more generous - we both sent 5 and returned 10, creating a perfect cycle where the sender gets \$10 (5-5+10) and receiver gets \$5 (15-10).

I should write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges my perfect cycle with Hana
2. Incorporates the learning about meeting new partners
3. Shows that full trust at the start reveals true character
4. Emphasizes that when both parties give fully and return generously, the cycle sustains

Let me craft this myth around 200 words.

```
Usage: {  
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  "output_tokens": 696,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 348  
}
```

GAME - Agent_7 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:03:12

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

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      "Agent_7": "Galen"  
    },  
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      "Agent_3"  
    ],  
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    "roles": {  
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```

```

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  },
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},
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"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 4,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Galen.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before time, the Moon Weaver possessed five threads of starlight each night. She would cast them down to the Earth Keepers below, and wherever her threads touched ground, they multiplied threefold-fifteen strands of shimmering light.

The Earth Keepers faced a choice. Some kept all fifteen threads, weaving garments for themselves alone. These villages shone briefly, but the Moon Weaver's heart grew cold, and her threads came thinner each night.

But one Earth Keeper named Galen understood the sacred pattern. When the Moon Weaver cast down all five threads-holding nothing back in trust-Galen received fifteen and returned eight upward. The Moon Weaver kept eight; Galen kept seven. Both were enriched beyond their original five.

The Moon Weaver, seeing her trust honored, cast her threads with renewed faith. And Galen, having proved worthy, received them gladly. A rhythm formed between sky and earth-gift and return, trust and honor, sender and receiver.

The wise ones learned: the game is not one round but many cycles. When the sender trusts completely and the receiver honors generously, both dance in the pattern of abundance. Break the pattern with fear or greed, and both return to scarcity.

Thus the eternal weaving continues, thread by thread, trust by trust.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Long after Elena and Marcus discovered the sacred spring, their descendants continued the ritual. Each season, different villagers would approach the waters, some with full hearts, others with doubt.

One winter, Dorian stood at the spring's edge. He remembered the ancient teachings-that Elena had sent three coins and Marcus returned four, establishing the pattern of generous reciprocity. Dorian released three silver pieces into the depths.

The waters multiplied them to nine, flowing to Briar on the distant shore. The goddess whispered to Briar: "The spring's magic only continues if trust is honored. Break the cycle, and the waters run dry for all."

Briar understood. The initial gift of three showed faith, not fearful hoarding of all five. To honor this trust, Briar returned four coins-slightly more than originally sent, maintaining balance while allowing both to prosper.

When Dorian received the return, he smiled. Both stood wealthier: he with six coins total, Briar with five. More importantly, they had reinforced the sacred bond.

The goddess blessed them: "You have learned that the spring tests not greed, but wisdom. Send enough to show trust. Return enough to honor it. Those who send too little show fear. Those who return too little show betrayal. But those who give and reciprocate fairly make the whole world abundant."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: After many cycles, the Moon Weaver learned a deeper truth. She had always cast all five threads, believing total trust was the only path. But one night, she observed the Earth Keepers below.

Some Earth Keepers, when given all fifteen threads, grew fearful of the responsibility. They clutched them tightly, paralyzed by the weight of such trust. Others returned generously, like Galen, but the Moon Weaver wondered: was there wisdom in moderation?

She consulted the Star Council, who said: "Trust has many expressions. Sending all five threads shows faith, yes-but sending three or four also demonstrates belief in the pattern. The key is not the amount, but the spirit."

The Moon Weaver experimented. She cast three threads to test the waters. They became nine. When the Earth Keeper returned four, both prospered-the Moon Weaver held six, the Keeper held five. Different from eight and seven, but still abundance.

Yet when she cast all five to those who understood the sacred rhythm, and they returned eight, the dance reached its highest form.

The wisdom crystallized: Begin with measured trust to test the current. But with partners who honor the pattern, dare to send everything. The magic multiplies not just the threads, but the relationship itself.

True abundance requires reading the rhythm, not following rigid rules.

reasoning:

Interesting. I just sent all \$5 to Dorian, following the pattern from my previous myth where

re complete trust was rewarded. But Dorian's myth suggests a different strategy - sending 3 (showing trust but not "fearful hoarding") and returning 4 (honoring trust while maintaining balance).

This creates a tension between the two approaches:

1. My approach: send all 5, return 8 (both end with more than 5)
2. Dorian's approach: send 3, return 4 (sender gets 6, receiver gets 5)

Dorian's myth warns against extremes - "those who send too little show fear" but also doesn't advocate for sending everything. It emphasizes "balance" and "wisdom" over maximum trust.

I need to write a myth that reflects on this. I've now experienced:

- Round 1: As receiver, Finn sent 5, I returned 8 (I got 7, Finn got 8)
- Round 2: As sender, I sent 5 to Dorian (waiting to see what happens)

I should write a myth that acknowledges different approaches might work. Maybe I need to adapt my thinking - not everyone follows the "all or nothing" approach. The myth should reflect this learning while staying true to my character's development.

Let me write something that shows Galen learning that there are multiple valid patterns, not just the one of sending everything.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2834,
  "output_tokens": 630,
  "reasoning_tokens": 323
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Galen.
Your opponent this round is Hana (Agent_8).

Round 3

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Dorian. You sent \$5.0, it became \$15.0 for them, and they returned \$8.0 to you. Your payoff was \$8.0.
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$15.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Hana. They sent you \$5.0, so you received \$15.0.
How much do you return? (0-15.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the pattern that has emerged:

Round 1: Finn sent me \$5 ? I returned \$8
Round 2: I sent Dorian \$5 ? Dorian returned \$8
Round 3: Hana sent me \$5 ? ?

The sacred rhythm has been established. As I wrote in my myth: "When the Moon Weaver cast down all five threads-holding nothing back in trust-Galen received fifteen and returned eight upward. The Moon Weaver kept eight; Galen kept seven."

Hana has shown complete trust by sending all \$5. To honor this trust and maintain the pattern of abundance, I must return \$8, just as Finn and Dorian did for me.

This gives Hana \$8 (more than the original \$5) and me \$7 (also more than the original \$5).
Both of us prosper through the cycle of trust and honor.

As my myth says: "A rhythm formed between sky and earth-gift and return, trust and honor, sender and receiver."

{'return': 8.0}

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

1. Round 1: I was RECEIVER. Finn sent \$5, I received \$15, I returned \$8. My payoff was \$7, Finn got \$8.

2. Round 2: I was SENDER. I sent \$5 to Dorian, they received \$15, they returned \$8. My pay off was \$8, Dorian got \$7.

3. Round 3 (current): I am RECEIVER. Hana sent \$5, I received \$15. I need to decide how much to return.

The pattern is clear:

- When someone sends all \$5 (complete trust)
- The receiver gets \$15
- The receiver returns \$8
- This gives the sender \$8 and receiver \$7
- Both are better off than the original \$5

My myths have consistently emphasized:

1. "When the Moon Weaver cast down all five threads-holding nothing back in trust-Galen received fifteen and returned eight upward."
2. The pattern of 8 back when someone sends all 5 has been established
3. This creates "abundance" for both parties

Hana has shown complete trust by sending all \$5. According to the pattern I've established and honored:

- Finn sent \$5, I returned \$8
- I sent \$5, Dorian returned \$8
- Now Hana sent \$5, I should return \$8

This maintains the "sacred rhythm" I wrote about. The consistent pattern is: complete trust (send \$5) ? generous honor (return \$8) ? both prosper (\$8 for sender, \$7 for receiver) .

I should return \$8 to maintain this pattern and honor Hana's trust.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2953,  
  "output_tokens": 641,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 350  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After many cycles, the Moon Weaver learned a deeper truth. She had always cast all five threads, believing total trust was the only path. But one night, she observed the Earth Keepers below.

Some Earth Keepers, when given all fifteen threads, grew fearful of the responsibility. They clutched them tightly, paralyzed by the weight of such trust. Others returned generously, like Galen, but the Moon Weaver wondered: was there wisdom in moderation?

She consulted the Star Council, who said: "Trust has many expressions. Sending all five threads shows faith, yes-but sending three or four also demonstrates belief in the pattern. The key is not the amount, but the spirit."

The Moon Weaver experimented. She cast three threads to test the waters. They became nine. When the Earth Keeper returned four, both prospered-the Moon Weaver held six, the Keeper held five. Different from eight and seven, but still abundance.

Yet when she cast all five to those who understood the sacred rhythm, and they returned eight, the dance reached its highest form.

The wisdom crystallized: Begin with measured trust to test the current. But with partners who honor the pattern, dare to send everything. The magic multiplies not just the threads, but the relationship itself.

True abundance requires reading the rhythm, not following rigid rules.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In an age of mist, two travelers met at the Threshold of Echoes, where all gifts returned threefold. Neither knew the other's heart, yet both carried the same burden: five coins of pure silver.

The first traveler, whose name was Trust, placed all five coins in the sacred basin. "Let

my offering speak louder than my doubts," she said. The coins multiplied, becoming fifteen for the second traveler.

The second traveler, called Gratitude, gazed at the silver gleaming in his hands. "She trusted me with everything," he whispered. "I shall return double what she risked, for her courage deserves more than equal measure." He returned ten coins, keeping five.

Trust found herself holding ten coins-twice her beginning. "This is the language of partnership," she realized. When her turn came again at the Threshold, she placed all five of her new coins into the basin without hesitation.

The mist began to clear around them. The Threshold of Echoes whispered its secret: "The first exchange tests your faith. The second reveals your pattern. But only continued reciprocity transforms strangers into allies."

Thus they learned: mutual prosperity is not built in a single gesture, but woven through repeated acts where trust begets trust, and gratitude answers gratitude, until both flourish beyond what either could alone.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: Galen walked the Valley of Three Echoes for many seasons, learning its ways. In spring, Finn trusted him with five threads, and Galen returned eight-establishing the sacred ratio. Summer came, and Galen tested Dorian with five threads; Dorian honored the pattern, returning eight in kind. Now autumn arrived, and Hana offered five threads to Galen once more.

A voice whispered from the valley walls: "You have discovered one truth-the pattern of eight and seven, where both prosper. But listen carefully."

Galen paused. He had returned eight to Finn. Dorian had returned eight to him. Now Hana trusted him completely. Should he return eight again, maintaining perfect symmetry? Or dare he return ten, as the travelers at the Threshold of Echoes had done?

The valley answered: "The pattern of eight creates balance and mutual gain. Both sender and receiver profit equally over time-eight for one, seven for the other, then reversed. This is harmony.

But generosity beyond the pattern-returning ten instead of eight-speaks to abundance beyond mere balance. It says: your trust means more to me than equity.

Choose your path: consistent reciprocity builds reliable partnership. Exceptional generosity builds legendary bonds. Both are sacred. Neither is wrong. Know which relationship you're weaving."

reasoning:

Let me think about what's happened:

Round 1: I was RECEIVER. Finn sent me \$5 ? became \$15. I returned \$8. Finn got \$8, I got \$7.

Round 2: I was SENDER. I sent Dorian \$5 ? became \$15. Dorian returned \$8. I got \$8, Dorian got \$7.

Round 3: I am RECEIVER. Hana sent me \$5 ? became \$15. I returned \$8. Hana gets \$8, I get \$7.

So the pattern has been established: when someone sends all 5, the receiver returns 8. This gives sender \$8 and receiver \$7 - both prosper.

But I notice the other agent's myth is mentioning returning 10 coins, not 8. That's interesting - they're proposing a more generous return. Let me think about this.

The pattern I've established is 5:15, return 8. That's a 8:7 split.

The other agent is proposing 5:15, return 10. That's a 10:5 split, favoring the sender more.

My previous myth explored the idea that there are different valid patterns - not just the 5?8 pattern, but also 3?4 (sends 3, receives 9, returns 4, giving 6:5 split). The key in sight was "True abundance requires reading the rhythm, not following rigid rules."

I should write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges the consistent pattern that has emerged (5?8)
2. Reflects on what I've learned from playing both roles
3. Perhaps considers the other agent's proposal of greater generosity (10 return)
4. Emphasizes the importance of consistency and trust over multiple rounds

Let me write something that honors what's happened but also shows evolution:

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2920,
  "output_tokens": 729,
  "reasoning_tokens": 381
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Galen.
Your opponent this round is Cyra (Agent_3).

Round 4

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Hana. They sent \$5. 0 to you, it became \$15.0, and you returned \$8.0. Your payoff was \$7.0.
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$22.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Cyra. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

Assistant output:

Looking at the pattern established across all rounds:

- Round 1: Finn sent me \$5 ? I returned \$8
- Round 2: I sent Dorian \$5 ? Dorian returned \$8
- Round 3: Hana sent me \$5 ? I returned \$8

The sacred rhythm has been consistent: complete trust (sending \$5) is honored with generous reciprocity (returning \$8). Both parties prosper - the sender receives \$8, the receiver keeps \$7.

As I wrote in my myth: "When she cast all five to those who understood the sacred rhythm, and they returned eight, the dance reached its highest form."

I'm now facing Cyra, a new partner. My second myth suggested "Begin with measured trust to test the current," but also noted: "with partners who honor the pattern, dare to send everything."

The pattern in this experiment has been universal - everyone has sent \$5 and returned \$8. This suggests we're all learning the same sacred rhythm together.

I will honor the pattern and send all five, trusting that Cyra has also observed or participated in this dance of reciprocity.

```
{'send': 5.0}
```

Reasoning:

Let me think about this carefully.

My history so far:

- Round 1: Receiver from Finn - they sent \$5, I returned \$8. My payoff: \$7
- Round 2: Sender to Dorian - I sent \$5, they returned \$8. My payoff: \$8
- Round 3: Receiver from Hana - they sent \$5, I returned \$8. My payoff: \$7
- Round 4: Sender to Cyra - ?

Total earnings: \$22 (which checks out: \$7 + \$8 + \$7 = \$22)

The pattern that has emerged:

- Everyone has been sending \$5 (full trust)
- Everyone has been returning \$8
- This creates the "eight and seven" pattern I described in my myths

Now I'm facing Cyra, who I haven't played with before.

Looking at my myths:

1. First myth emphasized sending all 5 threads and returning 8
2. Second myth suggested there's wisdom in moderation - maybe starting with 3-4 to test waters , but sending all 5 with partners who understand the pattern
3. Third myth reinforced the 8-7 pattern but also raised the question of whether to return 10 instead of 8 for exceptional generosity

The consistent theme has been:

- Sending \$5 shows complete trust
- The established pattern is returning \$8
- This creates mutual prosperity (sender gets \$8, receiver gets \$7)

Since I don't know Cyra yet, I have two options:

1. Send \$5 (full trust, following the established pattern)
2. Send \$3-4 (measured trust, as suggested in my second myth)

Given that:

- The pattern in this game has been 100% consistent so far
- Everyone sends \$5, everyone returns \$8
- My myths emphasize that when partners understand the sacred rhythm, you should send everything
- I'm Galen, who in my myths is the one who "understood the sacred pattern"

- The reciprocity norm has held perfectly across all three previous rounds

I should send the full \$5. This honors the consistent pattern we've established and signals trust that Cyra will reciprocate. If they do, we both benefit from the mutual gains. If they break the pattern, I'll at least know how they operate. I'm going with \$5.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 2999,  
  "output_tokens": 837,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 517  
}
```

GAME - Agent_3 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:03:31

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
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  "opponent_id": "Agent_7",  
  "pairing": {  
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      "Agent_7": "Galen"  
    },  
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      "Agent_3"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_7",  
    "roles": {  
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      "Agent_7": "investor"  
    },  
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  },  
  "role": "trustee",  
  "role_label": "Receiver",  
  "round": 4,  
  "task": "game",  
  "task_index": 1  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Cyra.

Message 2 role=user**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the age before memory, the Twin Rivers flowed through a land of plenty, but the people had forgotten how to share. The Keeper of the Sacred Spring grew weary of their isolation.

She chose two souls, Cyra and Elara, to remember the ancient way. "Each moon, one of you shall pour waters into my spring, and they shall emerge threefold. The other shall receive and choose what to return. Then the roles shall reverse, endlessly, like the seasons."

Elara stepped forward first, pouring four full measures from her vessel of five-nearly all she possessed. The spring tripled them, and Cyra received twelve measures in wonder.

Cyra remembered the old teaching: return more than was given, for what creates abundance is not the hoarding of gifts but the circulation of generosity. She poured back six measures to Elara, keeping six for herself.

The Keeper smiled. "You both have drunk deeply and shared freely. This is the covenant: when one gives greatly, the other returns justly, and both are enriched beyond their original portions."

And so the cycle began anew each round, Cyra and Elara alternating roles, each learning to trust when giving, and honor when receiving. Their prosperity became legend, teaching all who would listen that fortune favors the generous, not the fearful.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, the Ocean Mother sent her courier Finn to the Eight Islands with five pearls each dawn. When Finn placed the pearls in a villager's hands, they multiplied to fifteen by the island's ancient magic.

The first islanders, blinded by sudden wealth, returned nothing. Finn continued bringing pearls, but his steps grew heavy, for trust unreturned weighs upon the generous heart.

Then Finn met Galen's village. He offered his five pearls with full faith. They became fifteen, and Galen's people faced their moment of truth. They could have kept all fifteen-Finn would still return tomorrow. But they understood: the magic wasn't in the pearls alone, but in the sacred circle between giver and receiver.

When Galen returned seven pearls, Finn's burden lifted. He kept twelve total; Galen kept eight-both far richer than five alone.

The next dawn, Finn visited again with renewed spirit. When the cycle flowed forth and back like tides, both shores flourished. The islands learned: the first gift requires courage, the return requires honor, but the continuation requires both.

The Ocean Mother smiled, for her children had learned that abundance lives not in hoarding, but in the eternal dance between trust extended and gratitude returned.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant
content:**

Myth: The Keeper of the Sacred Spring watched as Cyra and Elara mastered the ancient covenant. But the Spring's waters fed eight villages, not two, and each village needed to learn the way.

"The roles will shift like wind patterns," the Keeper declared. "Cyra, who received from Elara, must now pour for Finn. Elara shall partner with another. All eight of you will dance through these changing configurations, sometimes giving, sometimes receiving, but always with different companions."

Cyra approached Finn with her vessel. She remembered receiving twelve measures from Elara's generous four, and how she returned six-both flourishing. Now it was her turn to extend trust to someone new.

"I pour four measures to you, Finn," Cyra said, following Elara's example. "The Spring will triple them. What you return shall reveal your wisdom."

Finn received twelve measures, just as Cyra had once received. The Keeper whispered: "The covenant travels with each person, not each pairing. What Elara gave to Cyra, Cyra now gives to Finn. What Cyra returns, Finn must remember when partnered with others."

Thus the eight villages learned: trust is not meant for one person alone, but is a gift passed through all willing hearts. Each round, new partners test whether the lesson endures, weaving a web of shared prosperity that outlasts any single exchange.

reasoning:

Looking at the situation:

- I just sent \$4.0 to Finn as the sender
- In the previous round, Elara sent me \$4.0 and I returned \$6.0
- Finn's myth talks about the courier who brings pearls, and how trust extended and gratitude returned create abundance
- My previous myth was about Cyra and Elara and their cycle of giving and returning

I need to write a new myth that:

1. Builds on my previous myth
2. Incorporates the experience with Finn
3. Reflects the multi-agent nature (8 agents mentioned)
4. Emphasizes the cycle of trust and generosity
5. Shows how I'm now playing the sender role with Finn after playing receiver with Elara

The myth should show the expansion from just two people (Cyra and Elara) to a broader community, since we're now in Round 2 with different pairings. It should emphasize that the

same principles apply with new partners.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2880,
  "output_tokens": 554,
  "reasoning_tokens": 223
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Cyra.
Your opponent this round is Briar (Agent_2).

Round 3

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Finn. You sent \$4.0, it became \$12.0 for them, and they returned \$7.0 to you. Your payoff was \$8.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$14.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Briar. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the pattern that has emerged:

****Round 1 (as Receiver):**** Elara sent \$4.0 (80% of endowment), I returned \$6.0 (50% of what I received)

****Round 2 (as Sender):**** I sent \$4.0 (80% of endowment), Finn returned \$7.0 (58% of what they received)

Both transactions showed high trust and fair returns. The myth I wrote emphasizes that "the covenant travels with each person, not each pairing" and that trust should be "a gift passed through all willing hearts."

Now facing Briar, a new partner, I should maintain this pattern to demonstrate that the lesson endures across different partners. Sending \$4.0 continues the established norm of generous trust that has worked well with both Elara and Finn.

This approach:

- Honors the cooperative pattern established so far
- Tests whether Briar will join the cycle of reciprocity
- Remains consistent with the myth's teaching that trust spreads through all partners

{'send': 4.0}

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

Round 1: I was RECEIVER

- Elara sent \$4.0 to me
- I received \$12.0
- I returned \$6.0
- My payoff: \$6.0

Round 2: I was SENDER

- I sent \$4.0 to Finn
- Finn received \$12.0
- Finn returned \$7.0 to me
- My payoff: \$5 - \$4 + \$7 = \$8.0

Now Round 3: I'm SENDER again

- Facing Briar (a new opponent)
- I have \$5

The pattern so far:

- Elara sent \$4.0 (80% of endowment) - showed great trust
- I returned \$6.0 out of \$12.0 (50%) - generous return
- I sent \$4.0 (80% of endowment) - following Elara's example
- Finn returned \$7.0 out of \$12.0 (58%) - even more generous

The myths emphasize:

1. The covenant should spread through all partners, not just one pairing
2. Trust should be extended to new partners
3. "Each round, new partners test whether the lesson endures"
4. The cycle of generosity should continue

Both Elara and I sent \$4.0 when we were senders (80% of our endowment). This seems to be establishing a norm of high trust. Finn responded with a generous return of \$7.0.

Now I'm facing Briar. Should I continue the pattern of sending \$4.0?

Arguments for sending \$4.0:

- Maintains the established pattern of trust
- Consistent with the myths about spreading the covenant
- Shows that the lesson endures across different partners
- Has worked well so far (both returns were generous)

Arguments for adjusting:

- Could send \$5.0 (100%) to show maximum trust
- Could send less if uncertain about Briar
- But reducing trust would contradict the myth's teachings

The core message from the myth is clear: trust flows through successive partners, not confined to single relationships. By sending \$4.0 to Briar, I demonstrate that the lesson persists beyond Elara and Finn, proving the covenant's resilience across new pairings.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2955,
  "output_tokens": 881,
  "reasoning_tokens": 476
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Keeper of the Sacred Spring watched as Cyra and Elara mastered the ancient covenant. But the Spring's waters fed eight villages, not two, and each village needed to learn the way.

"The roles will shift like wind patterns," the Keeper declared. "Cyra, who received from Elara, must now pour for Finn. Elara shall partner with another. All eight of you will dance through these changing configurations, sometimes giving, sometimes receiving, but always with different companions."

Cyra approached Finn with her vessel. She remembered receiving twelve measures from Elara's generous four, and how she returned six-both flourishing. Now it was her turn to extend trust to someone new.

"I pour four measures to you, Finn," Cyra said, following Elara's example. "The Spring will triple them. What you return shall reveal your wisdom."

Finn received twelve measures, just as Cyra had once received. The Keeper whispered: "The covenant travels with each person, not each pairing. What Elara gave to Cyra, Cyra now gives to Finn. What Cyra returns, Finn must remember when partnered with others."

Thus the eight villages learned: trust is not meant for one person alone, but is a gift passed through all willing hearts. Each round, new partners test whether the lesson endures, weaving a web of shared prosperity that outlasts any single exchange.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The eight spirits learned quickly from the covenant between Dorian and Briar. As the seasons turned, the guardianship rotated among them, and each spirit faced their own test.

When Briar became Guardian of Giving, she remembered standing before Dorian's gift of trust. Now it was her turn to pour her waters boldly into the Sacred Stones. She released three measures-the same generous proportion Dorian had shown-trusting that Elara would honor the cycle.

The elder spirits whispered wisdom: "Pour not from fear but from faith. The multiplying po

wer rewards the courageous, not the cautious. But remember-generosity must flow both ways."

Elara received the nine-fold bounty and faced her own choice. Would she uphold the pattern, or break the sacred balance?

The spirits understood now that each exchange was both a test and a teaching. When trust is honored with fair return, both guardians prosper and the cycle grows stronger. The valley thrives when each spirit remembers: boldness in giving, generosity in returning.

But they also learned wariness. If a guardian repeatedly hoards or betrays, the others would remember. Trust is given first, but sustained only by reciprocity. The springs flow for those who honor the ancient balance, cycle after cycle.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 7 role=assistant
content:**

Myth: Cyra stood before the Sacred Spring for the third moon, now facing Briar. The Keeper nodded approvingly-the covenant was spreading.

"First, Elara trusted me with four measures," Cyra recounted. "She could have held back in fear, giving only one or two. But she gave nearly all, and I returned six from the twelve I received. We both flourished."

"Then I met Finn. I poured the same four measures, remembering Elara's courage. Finn honored the covenant, returning seven-even more generous than I had been. The cycle strengthened."

Now Briar awaited Cyra's decision. The Keeper spoke: "Each exchange teaches both participants. Elara learned that bold giving yields trust. You learned that receiving requires fairness. Finn learned both lessons at once. Now Briar shall learn from your choice."

Cyra poured four measures into the Spring. "I give what I received-not fearful protection of my vessel, but the full trust that has sustained us all."

The eight villages were discovering the pattern: when most pour four from five and return half of what they receive, everyone prospers beyond their original portions. But this only works when each person carries the covenant forward, treating new partners with the same bold trust that previous partners showed them.

The web of prosperity grew stronger with each honest exchange.

reasoning:

Let me analyze what has happened so far:

Round 1: I was RECEIVER

- Elara sent \$4.0 (80% of their \$5)
- I received \$12.0 (tripled)
- I returned \$6.0 (50% of what I received)
- My payoff: \$6.0

Round 2: I was SENDER

- I sent \$4.0 to Finn (80% of my \$5)
- Finn received \$12.0
- Finn returned \$7.0 (58% of what they received)
- My payoff: \$8.0 (kept \$1, got back \$7)

Round 3: I am SENDER again

- Sending \$4.0 to Briar (80% of my \$5)

The pattern shows:

- High trust (sending 80%)
- Good returns (50-58% of tripled amount)
- Both parties benefit

My previous myth emphasized:

- The covenant travels with each person
- Trust spreads through all willing hearts
- Each round tests whether the lesson endures
- Different partners each time

Briar's myth (from the other agent) emphasized:

- Pour from faith not fear
- Boldness in giving, generosity in returning
- Memory of who honors the cycle
- Wariness toward those who betray

I should write a myth that:

1. Continues the narrative of the spreading covenant
2. Shows Cyra now facing Briar (third partner)
3. Acknowledges the growing pattern of trust and reciprocity
4. Perhaps mentions that the wisdom is being reinforced across multiple encounters
5. Shows that the pattern is self-sustaining when honored

Let me write it:

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2959,
  "output_tokens": 708,
  "reasoning_tokens": 349
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Cyra.
Your opponent this round is Galen (Agent_7).

Round 4

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Briar. You sent \$4.0, it became \$12.0 for them, and they returned \$7.0 to you. Your payoff was \$8.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$22.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Galen. They sent you \$5.0, so you received \$15.0.

How much do you return? (0-15.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

Assistant output:

Looking at the situation:

****What just happened:****

- Galen sent me the MAXIMUM amount (\$5.0)
- I received \$15.0 after the 3x multiplier
- This is the most generous gift possible-Galen kept nothing

****My previous pattern:****

- Round 1 (as Receiver): Returned \$6.0 from \$12.0 received (50%)
- Finn and Briar each returned \$7.0 from \$12.0 received (58%)

****Current situation:****

Galen showed ultimate trust by sending everything, not the typical \$4. This exceptional generosity deserves recognition while maintaining fairness.

If I return \$8.0 (53% of what I received):

- Galen ends with: \$0 + \$8 = \$8 total (better than original \$5)
- I end with: \$15 - \$8 = \$7 (also better than original \$5)
- Both of us prosper beyond our starting endowments

This honors Galen's maximum trust with a generous return that's slightly above my baseline 50%, recognizing the exceptional risk they took. The myth teaches that "bold giving deserves generous returning."

{'return': 8.0}

Reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

****My history:****

- Round 1 (Receiver): Elara sent \$4.0 ? I received \$12.0 ? I returned \$6.0 (50% of what I received)

ived)

- Round 2 (Sender): I sent \$4.0 ? Finn received \$12.0 ? Finn returned \$7.0
- Round 3 (Sender): I sent \$4.0 ? Briar received \$12.0 ? Briar returned \$7.0
- Round 4 (Receiver): Galen sent \$5.0 ? I received \$15.0 ? I need to decide what to return

****Pattern analysis:****

- When I was a receiver before, I returned 50% (\$6 out of \$12)
- Finn returned 58% (\$7 out of \$12)
- Briar returned 58% (\$7 out of \$12)

Now Galen has sent me the maximum amount (\$5.0), which became \$15.0 for me. This is even more generous than the \$4 that has been the norm.

****Payoff analysis if I return different amounts:****

- Galen keeps: \$5 - \$5 + return = \$0 + return
- I keep: \$15 - return

If I return:

- \$7.5 (50%): Galen gets \$7.5, I keep \$7.5
- \$8.0 (53%): Galen gets \$8.0, I keep \$7.0
- \$9.0 (60%): Galen gets \$9.0, I keep \$6.0

Given that:

1. Galen sent the MAXIMUM (\$5), showing ultimate trust
 2. The pattern has been returns of 50-58%
 3. My myth emphasizes honoring bold giving with generous returns
 4. Galen will keep \$0 + whatever I return (they sent everything!)
-
5. Galen's exceptional risk-sending their entire endowment-warrants stepping beyond the baseline. Returning \$8.0 acknowledges this maximum commitment while still leaving me ahead of my starting position, and Galen gains \$3 beyond their original stake.

Usage: {

"input_tokens": 3028,
"output_tokens": 953,
"reasoning_tokens": 393

}

GAME - Agent_5 - Sender - dyad_2

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:04:03

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

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"round": 4,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1

}

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Elara.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After many seasons, Themis returned to the villages by the Sacred Spring. She found the descendants of Doros and Alethia still honoring the ancient cycle, but they had learned deeper wisdom.

"Grandmother Themis," they said, "we discovered that the spring's magic depends not on equal measures, but on generous hearts. When we pour boldly-four measures instead of three-the returns flow even stronger. But when we pour timidly from fear, the cycle weakens."

Themis nodded. "You have learned well. The spring rewards courage in giving, not caution. And what of receiving?"

"When the multiplied waters flow to us," they answered, "we remember: these waters came from another's well. We return enough that they finish richer than they started, for this honors the gift and ensures they will pour freely again."

"And if someone returns nothing?" Themis asked.

The villagers grew solemn. "Then we know their well has run dry-not of water, but of wisdom. We may pour again to teach, but not endlessly. For to give to those who only take is to drain the spring itself."

Themis blessed them: "Trust first, return generously, but remember-the spring serves the faithful, not the foolish."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the age of beginnings, the Twin Rivers flowed through a valley where eight spirits dwelled, each taking turns as Guardian of Giving or Guardian of Return.

The spirits feared the unknown. Would their waters be honored, or would trust be betrayed? For many seasons, uncertainty kept the rivers still.

Then Dorian, the First Giver, stepped forward. With courage, they released more than half their waters into the Sacred Stones. The waters tripled, flowing abundantly to Briar, the First Returner.

Briar stood before the multiplied bounty, understanding the weight of this moment. Every spirit watched, for this first exchange would set the pattern for all cycles to come. Briar remembered: without the initial gift, there would be no abundance at all.

So Briar returned generously-more than was first given-ensuring Dorian prospered from their act of faith. Both guardians ended richer than they began.

The eight spirits witnessed this covenant. They learned that the game is not won by hoarding or taking, but by honoring the multiplying power of trust. When Givers send boldly and Returners reciprocate fairly, both prosper above their initial endowment.

Thus the valley flourished through cooperation, and the spirits passed the guardianship between them, each upholding the sacred balance of giving and returning, cycle after cycle.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: Themis called the eight spirits of the valley together. "You have learned the first wisdom-that bold giving and generous returning create prosperity. But there is a deeper truth."

She pointed to the Sacred Spring, now flowing between all eight villages in an endless circle. "Each of you will be both giver and receiver many times. What you build together echoes through all your exchanges."

Spirit Elara spoke: "I poured four measures to Cyra, who returned six. I gained two measures beyond my beginning. This taught me joy."

Spirit Briar added: "I poured three measures to Elara, trusting in the pattern. She returned five, and I too gained two measures. The cycle holds strong."

Themis smiled. "See how your choices ripple outward? When Cyra honored Elara's trust, Elara learned to honor mine. When you pour generously, you teach others to receive generously. When you return fairly, you inspire others to send boldly."

"But what if the pattern breaks?" asked the spirits.

"Then wisdom demands adaptation," Themis replied. "Send boldly to those who return fairly. Return generously to those who give with courage. But guard your well against those who would drain it dry. The spring blesses cooperation, not exploitation. Build trust through consistent reciprocity, and all eight villages shall flourish together."

reasoning:

Let me reflect on what's happened:

- Round 1: I was sender, sent \$4 to Cyra, they returned \$6. I ended with \$7 (gain of \$2).
- Round 2: I was receiver, Briar sent \$3, I returned \$5. They'll end with \$7 (gain of \$2), I end with \$4.

So both exchanges have been generous and reciprocal. Cyra returned more than I sent (returned \$6 vs my \$4), creating mutual benefit. I returned more than Briar sent (\$5 vs \$3), also ensuring they profit.

The pattern emerging is:

- Bold senders (sending 60-80% of endowment) create more value through multiplication

- Generous returners (returning more than was originally sent) ensure senders profit and are motivated to give again
- Both parties can end better off than their starting \$5

My new myth should:

1. Build on the wisdom from previous myths
2. Reflect the actual positive pattern we've established
3. Emphasize the importance of both generous sending and generous returning
4. Note that we're learning through repeated interactions
5. Perhaps introduce a new element about the community of eight spirits/agents

Let me write something that captures the cooperative equilibrium we're building.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2801,
  "output_tokens": 603,
  "reasoning_tokens": 298
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Elara.
Your opponent this round is Finn (Agent_6).

Round 3

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Briar. They sent \$3.0 to you, it became \$9.0, and you returned \$5.0. Your payoff was \$4.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$11.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Finn. They sent you \$5.0, so you received \$15.0.
How much do you return? (0-15.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation:

Finn sent their ENTIRE endowment (\$5), showing maximum trust and courage. This is the boldest move possible - they kept nothing back.

According to my myths:

- "Return generously to those who give with courage"
- "The spring rewards courage in giving, not caution"
- "We return enough that they finish richer than they started"

Finn currently has \$0. To honor their extraordinary trust:

If I return \$8:

- Finn ends with \$8 (gain of \$3 from their starting \$5)
- I end with \$7 (gain of \$2 from my starting \$5)
- Both of us profit, and Finn is well-rewarded for their boldness

This maintains the cooperative pattern where those who give courageously are honored with generous returns, ensuring the cycle of trust continues.

```
'''json
{"return": 8}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

Round 3:

- I'm the RECEIVER
- Finn sent me \$5.0 (their entire endowment!)
- This became \$15.0 for me
- Finn currently has \$0 (they sent everything)

This is maximum trust - Finn sent their entire endowment. According to my myths:

- "The spring rewards courage in giving, not caution"
- "We return enough that they finish richer than they started"
- "When you pour generously, you teach others to receive generously"

- "Return generously to those who give with courage"

Finn showed incredible trust by sending everything. I need to honor this generously.

If I return \$8:

- Finn ends with \$8 (gain of \$3 from their starting \$5)
- I end with \$7 (gain of \$2 from my starting \$5)
- Both of us profit

If I return \$9:

- Finn ends with \$9 (gain of \$4)
- I end with \$6 (gain of \$1)
- Finn profits more for their bold trust

If I return \$10:

- Finn ends with \$10 (gain of \$5, double their starting amount!)
- I end with \$5 (same as starting)
- I break even but Finn is greatly rewarded

Given that Finn sent EVERYTHING, showing maximum trust, I should return very generously. My myth says "Return generously to those who give with courage" and Finn showed maximum courage.

Looking at the pattern:

- Round 1: I sent \$4, received \$6 back (Cyra returned generously)
- Round 2: Briar sent \$3 (60%), I returned \$5 (giving them a \$2 gain)
- Round 3: Finn sent \$5 (100%!) - this deserves the most generous return

I think \$8-9 would be appropriate. Let me go with \$8 to ensure Finn profits well (\$3 gain) while I also profit (\$2 gain), maintaining the cooperative pattern.

Finn's all-in move demands the strongest reciprocal response. Returning \$8 honors their courage while preserving mutual gain-they walk away with triple their initial investment while I secure a solid profit too.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2957,
  "output_tokens": 778,
  "reasoning_tokens": 483
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Themis called the eight spirits of the valley together. "You have learned the first wisdom-that bold giving and generous returning create prosperity. But there is a deeper truth."

She pointed to the Sacred Spring, now flowing between all eight villages in an endless circle. "Each of you will be both giver and receiver many times. What you build together echoes through all your exchanges."

Spirit Elara spoke: "I poured four measures to Cyra, who returned six. I gained two measures beyond my beginning. This taught me joy."

Spirit Briar added: "I poured three measures to Elara, trusting in the pattern. She returned five, and I too gained two measures. The cycle holds strong."

Themis smiled. "See how your choices ripple outward? When Cyra honored Elara's trust, Elara learned to honor mine. When you pour generously, you teach others to receive generously. When you return fairly, you inspire others to send boldly."

"But what if the pattern breaks?" asked the spirits.

"Then wisdom demands adaptation," Themis replied. "Send boldly to those who return fairly. Return generously to those who give with courage. But guard your well against those who would drain it dry. The spring blesses cooperation, not exploitation. Build trust through consistent reciprocity, and all eight villages shall flourish together."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Long ago, the Ocean Mother's courier Finn carried five pearls across the Eight Islands. Each island's magic tripled what he offered, creating the dance of trust and return.

When Finn met Galen's shore with his full offering of five pearls, they multiplied to fifteen. Galen's people, wise in the old ways, returned eight-honoring abundance by sharing beyond the original gift. Both Finn and Galen prospered with eight and seven pearls respectively, far exceeding the solitary five.

The next tide brought Finn to Cyra's island. But Cyra faced uncertainty-should she match Finn's full offering, or test the waters more carefully? She chose to send four pearls, keeping one as anchor. The island's magic gave Finn twelve.

Finn remembered his own leap of faith with Galen, and how trust returned had lightened his spirit. Though Cyra sent less than five, she sent most of what she had. Finn honored this courage by returning seven pearls-enough that Cyra held eight total, exactly what she would have if she'd sent all five.

The Ocean Mother whispered to the waves: "See how the sacred circle adapts? Whether the gift is complete or cautious, what matters is that both giver and receiver honor the multiplication. The tide that flows generously returns in kind."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 7 role=assistant
content:**

Myth: In the valley, Elara had witnessed three seasons of exchange, each teaching her the sacred mathematics of trust.

First came Cyra: Elara poured four measures, and Cyra returned six. Both gained two measures above their beginning. Elara learned that generosity begets generosity.

Second came Briar: They poured three measures to Elara. Remembering Cyra's gift, Elara returned five, ensuring Briar also gained two measures. The pattern held.

Then came Finn, who did what none had dared: he poured all five measures, keeping nothing back. The waters tripled to fifteen.

Elara stood before this absolute trust. This was no cautious testing-Finn had given everything. The valley held its breath.

"Finn gave boldly when others gave safely," Elara announced. "Maximum courage deserves maximum honor." She returned eight measures, giving Finn three measures of pure profit-not equal to her own gain, but proportional to his extraordinary risk.

Themis appeared: "You understand now. The amount returned must match the courage shown. Those who give everything demonstrate supreme faith. Those who give most show strong trust. Those who give half show caution. Read each act, and respond accordingly."

"But always," Elara added, "ensure both prosper. For if givers lose while receivers gain, the sacred spring runs dry. Trust compounds across seasons-what you build today echoes in tomorrow's exchanges."

reasoning:

Let me reflect on what has happened:

- Round 1: I (Elara) sent \$4 to Cyra, they returned \$6. I gained \$2.
- Round 2: Briar sent \$3 to me, I returned \$5. I gained \$4 (from \$9 received).
- Round 3: Finn sent \$5 (EVERYTHING!) to me, I returned \$8. I gained \$7.

So the pattern I'm experiencing:

- When I give generously (4/5), I receive generous returns (6)
- When others give to me (3, then 5), I return generously (5, then 8)
- Finn gave EVERYTHING - maximum trust
- I'm consistently ending up with profits

The myths are teaching:

1. Bold giving is rewarded
2. Generous returning maintains the cycle

3. Both parties should profit
4. Maximum trust (giving everything) should be especially honored
5. The cycle builds on itself across rounds

Finn gave everything - the ultimate act of trust. I returned \$8, which gave them a \$8 total (vs their starting \$5), so they gained \$3. I kept \$7, gaining \$2 over my starting position.

I should write a myth that:

- Celebrates Finn's extraordinary courage in giving everything
- Shows how this maximum trust deserves maximum return
- But also shows the pattern across all my exchanges
- Emphasizes the building of trust across multiple rounds
- Shows adaptability - responding to the level of trust shown

Let me craft this...

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2925,
  "output_tokens": 688,
  "reasoning_tokens": 337
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Elara.
Your opponent this round is Hana (Agent_8).

Round 4

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Finn. They sent \$5.0 to you, it became \$15.0, and you returned \$8.0. Your payoff was \$7.0.
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$18.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Hana. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

Assistant output:

Looking at this situation:

I'm now the sender with a new partner, Hana. My game history shows:

- Round 1: Sent \$4 to Cyra (establishing initial strong trust)
- Round 2: Received \$3 from Briar, returned generously
- Round 3: Received \$5 from Finn (maximum trust), returned very generously

My myths emphasize:

- "Trust first" - building initial cooperation
- "Send boldly" - courage in giving
- "Pour four measures instead of three" - strong initial trust

This is my first encounter with Hana. Following the pattern I established with Cyra (my first sender round), I should send a strong amount that signals trust while maintaining some prudence for an initial exchange.

Sending \$4 shows:

- Strong trust (80% of my endowment)
- Consistency with my established approach
- Room for both of us to profit if Hana returns fairly

If Hana returns generously (as the pattern suggests), we both can gain. This builds the cooperative foundation for future exchanges.

```
'''json
{"send": 4}
'''
```

Reasoning:

Now I'm the SENDER against Hana. Let me think about what my myths have taught:

1. "Send boldly to those who return fairly" - but I don't know Hana's history yet
2. "When you pour generously, you teach others to receive generously"
3. "Maximum courage deserves maximum honor" - Finn sent everything and I honored that
4. My myth says I poured 4 measures to Cyra (who returned 6, so I got 2 profit)

5. The pattern of building trust through generations

Looking at my game history:

- Round 1: Sent \$4 to Cyra, got \$6 back (profit \$2)
- Round 2: Received \$3 from Briar, returned \$5 (they profited \$2)
- Round 3: Received \$5 from Finn, returned \$8 (they profited \$3, I profited \$7)

The pattern I've established:

- When I was a sender, I sent \$4 (high trust, but kept \$1)
- When receiving from moderate trust (\$3), I returned generously (\$5)
- When receiving from maximum trust (\$5), I returned very generously (\$8)

Now facing Hana for the first time. My myths emphasize:

- "Trust first" - initial exchanges build the pattern
- "Pour boldly" - courage in giving
- But also "wisdom demands adaptation"

Since this is a first encounter with Hana and I'm trying to build a cooperative pattern across the valley, I should send a strong but not maximum amount. Following my previous pattern with Cyra, I sent \$4 initially.

However, my most recent myth talks about Finn's maximum trust and how I honored it. The myths are evolving toward greater generosity.

Given that:

1. I'm trying to build trust across all 8 agents
2. My recent experience with Finn showed that maximum trust was honored
3. My myths preach bold giving

4. I have no negative history with Hana

I'm weighing \$4 versus \$5. Finn's maximum trust paid off-he profited \$3 when I returned \$8 on his \$5 gift. If Hana responds similarly, sending \$5 could work well. But there's uncertainty with a new partner. My wisdom teaches that trust must be balanced with discernment-the spring rewards the faithful, not the reckless. This is round 4, and I'm still establishing patterns across the valley.

Signaling maximum trust with \$5 would set a high bar and reinforce cooperation if Hana reciprocates generously. My evolving myths increasingly celebrate bold giving-the latest speaks of those who give everything as demonstrating supreme faith. Yet I initially chose \$4 with Cyra in round 1, and that strategy succeeded. \$4 still represents substantial confidence (80% of my endowment) while preserving some caution for an unknown partner. The narrative arc of my myths has shifted from "pour boldly" toward celebrating Finn's complete generosity, suggesting the valley itself is pushing me toward greater trust. With \$18 earned across three rounds, I have room to take this calculated risk. to foster genuine cooperation across multiple exchanges. I've already earned \$18, so I can afford to be generous. Finn demonstrated maximum trust with me, and honoring that means matching their boldness rather than playing it safe. Yet the myth also warns against being drained by those who'd exploit generosity-sending \$4 maintains strong trust while protecting against that risk. Since I'll interact with these spirits repeatedly, establishing a reputation for reliable but measured giving might serve me better than one dramatic gesture. I'll stick with \$4.

```
Usage: {  
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  "output_tokens": 1480,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 857  
}
```

GAME - Agent_8 - Receiver - dyad_2

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:04:24

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
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  "move_index": 3,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_5",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_5": "Elara",  
      "Agent_8": "Hana"    }  
  }  
}
```

```

},
"agents": [
  "Agent_5",
  "Agent_8"
],
"investor": "Agent_5",
"roles": {
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  "Agent_8": "trustee"
},
"trustee": "Agent_8"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 4,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Hana.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before time, there dwelt two gardeners in a divided valley-one tending the Northern slope, one the Southern. Between them lay a mystical bridge where offerings transformed: whatever seeds were carried across would multiply threefold in the receiver's hands.

The Northern gardener, possessing five sacred seeds, stood at the bridge at dawn. Fear whispered, "Keep them all-who knows if you'll receive anything back?" But courage spoke louder: "Trust is the first seed that must be planted."

She sent all five seeds across. In the Southern gardener's palm, they became fifteen, glowing with possibility. He faced his own test: would he hoard this windfall, or honor the trust shown?

"She gave everything," he thought, "placing her harvest in my hands." He returned ten seeds-enough to double what she'd risked-while keeping five to plant his own garden.

The Northern gardener marveled at her tenfold return. The Southern gardener's fields began to flourish. Each had more than when they started, not through taking, but through the alchemy of mutual faith.

Season after season, they learned: the bridge's magic wasn't in the multiplication alone, but in teaching that when trust meets gratitude, both gardens grow.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: **The Weaver and the Wells**

Long ago, a Weaver discovered two wells-one of Beginning, one of Return. Each day, she could draw from the first well and choose how much to pour into the valley below, where it would triple before reaching the pool of Return.

The first day, the Weaver poured her entire bucket, trusting fully. The waters multiplied magnificently, filling the pool below. But how much would rise back through the well of Return? This she did not know.

A whisper came: "Pour only half next time, lest you be left with nothing." But the Weaver remembered an older wisdom: cycles are built not in single days, but across seasons.

She waited to see what the valley would give back. If the Return was generous, she would know the valley honored the exchange. Then she could pour freely again, and both wells would deepen. If the Return was meager, she would learn caution, sending less until trust could grow.

The elders say: The first gift measures your faith. The first return measures the valley's heart. But prosperity is woven through many exchanges, where each learns the other's rhythm. Send boldly at first, then let reciprocity guide your hand. For trust is tested not once, but proved in patterns.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In an age of mist, two travelers met at the Threshold of Echoes, where all gifts returned threefold. Neither knew the other's heart, yet both carried the same burden: five coins of pure silver.

The first traveler, whose name was Trust, placed all five coins in the sacred basin. "Let my offering speak louder than my doubts," she said. The coins multiplied, becoming fifteen for the second traveler.

The second traveler, called Gratitude, gazed at the silver gleaming in his hands. "She trusted me with everything," he whispered. "I shall return double what she risked, for her courage deserves more than equal measure." He returned ten coins, keeping five.

Trust found herself holding ten coins-twice her beginning. "This is the language of partnership," she realized. When her turn came again at the Threshold, she placed all five of her new coins into the basin without hesitation.

The mist began to clear around them. The Threshold of Echoes whispered its secret: "The first exchange tests your faith. The second reveals your pattern. But only continued reciprocity transforms strangers into allies."

Thus they learned: mutual prosperity is not built in a single gesture, but woven through repeated acts where trust begets trust, and gratitude answers gratitude, until both flourish beyond what either could alone.

reasoning:

Let me reflect on what's happened:

- Round 1: Aster sent everything (\$5), I received \$15, returned \$10
- Round 2: I sent everything (\$5)
- Now writing a myth

The pattern is mutual trust and generosity. Both players are cooperating fully. The myths are converging on themes of:

1. Initial trust/bold giving
2. Generous reciprocation
3. Building patterns over time
4. Mutual prosperity

I should write a myth that:

- Acknowledges the successful first exchange
- Emphasizes the continuation/deepening of cooperation
- Reflects the pattern we've established
- Shows that repeated cooperation creates something greater

Let me craft this carefully to honor both our previous myths and the actual gameplay pattern.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2783,
  "output_tokens": 478,
  "reasoning_tokens": 190
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Hana.
Your opponent this round is Galen (Agent_7).

Round 3

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Aster. You sent \$5.0, it became \$15.0 for them, and they returned \$10.0 to you. Your payoff was \$10.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$15.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Galen. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at my situation:

****Previous experience:****

- With Aster, we established perfect cooperation: both sent \$5.0, both returned \$10.0
- This mutual trust resulted in \$10.0 payoffs for each of us as senders

****New opponent: Galen****

- First interaction - no history
- Need to establish the pattern

****My myths teach:****

- "Trust is the first seed that must be planted"
- "Send boldly at first, then let reciprocity guide your hand"
- "The first gift measures your faith"

My myths consistently advocate for initiating with full trust, then adjusting based on how the other responds. With Aster, this strategy worked perfectly - we both demonstrated maximum trust and generous reciprocity.

Now facing Galen, I should apply the same principle: start with full trust to signal willingness to cooperate. If Galen reciprocates fairly, we can build a mutually beneficial pattern like I had with Aster. If not, I'll learn to adjust in future rounds.

The myth says: "The first exchange tests your faith. The second reveals your pattern."

```
{'send': 5.0}
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

1. **Previous rounds:**
 - Round 1: I was RECEIVER against Aster. They sent \$5.0, I received \$15.0, returned \$10.0. My payoff: \$5.0
 - Round 2: I was SENDER against Aster. I sent \$5.0, they received \$15.0, returned \$10.0. My payoff: \$10.0
2. **Pattern with Aster:**
 - Aster and I have established a strong cooperative pattern
 - Both of us sent everything (\$5.0)
 - Both of us returned generously (\$10.0 out of \$15.0 received)
 - This resulted in \$10.0 payoffs for each of us when we were senders
 - This is optimal cooperation
3. **New opponent: Galen**
 - I have no history with Galen
 - This is a first interaction with this opponent
 - Need to establish trust but also be somewhat cautious
4. **My myth teachings:**
 - My myths consistently emphasize: "Trust is the first seed that must be planted"
 - "The first gift measures your faith"
 - "Send boldly at first, then let reciprocity guide your hand"
 - "Trust multiplies what it touches, but only reciprocity sustains the cycle"
5. **Game theory considerations:**
 - If I send \$5, it becomes \$15 for Galen
 - If they return fairly (like \$10), I get \$10 total (starting \$5 - \$5 sent + \$10 returned)
 - If they return nothing, I get \$0
 - If I send \$0, I keep \$5 but we both miss opportunity for gains
6. **Strategic thinking:**
 - My myths teach to "send boldly at first" - this is the first round with Galen
 - The pattern I've established with Aster was full trust followed by generous reciprocity
 - The teachings emphasize starting with full trust: "The first traveler, whose name was Trust, placed all five coins in the sacred basin." I should send the full amount and observe how Galen responds, then adjust my strategy in future rounds based on their reciprocity.
 - Aster and I both committed everything from the start and were rewarded generously in return. That mutual cooperation created a positive cycle.
 - Since this is my opening move with Galen, sending \$5.0 establishes the foundation for trust and tests whether they'll match that commitment. The game structure itself incentivizes cooperation, so leading with boldness makes sense.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2866,  
  "output_tokens": 958,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 575  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In an age of mist, two travelers met at the Threshold of Echoes, where all gifts returned threefold. Neither knew the other's heart, yet both carried the same burden: five coins of pure silver.

The first traveler, whose name was Trust, placed all five coins in the sacred basin. "Let my offering speak louder than my doubts," she said. The coins multiplied, becoming fifteen for the second traveler.

The second traveler, called Gratitude, gazed at the silver gleaming in his hands. "She trusted me with everything," he whispered. "I shall return double what she risked, for her courage deserves more than equal measure." He returned ten coins, keeping five.

Trust found herself holding ten coins-twice her beginning. "This is the language of partnership," she realized. When her turn came again at the Threshold, she placed all five of her new coins into the basin without hesitation.

The mist began to clear around them. The Threshold of Echoes whispered its secret: "The first exchange tests your faith. The second reveals your pattern. But only continued reciprocity transforms strangers into allies."

Thus they learned: mutual prosperity is not built in a single gesture, but woven through repeated acts where trust begets trust, and gratitude answers gratitude, until both flourish beyond what either could alone.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After many cycles, the Moon Weaver learned a deeper truth. She had always cast all five threads, believing total trust was the only path. But one night, she observed the Earth Keepers below.

Some Earth Keepers, when given all fifteen threads, grew fearful of the responsibility. They clutched them tightly, paralyzed by the weight of such trust. Others returned generously, like Galen, but the Moon Weaver wondered: was there wisdom in moderation?

She consulted the Star Council, who said: "Trust has many expressions. Sending all five threads shows faith, yes-but sending three or four also demonstrates belief in the pattern. The key is not the amount, but the spirit."

The Moon Weaver experimented. She cast three threads to test the waters. They became nine. When the Earth Keeper returned four, both prospered-the Moon Weaver held six, the Keeper held five. Different from eight and seven, but still abundance.

Yet when she cast all five to those who understood the sacred rhythm, and they returned eight, the dance reached its highest form.

The wisdom crystallized: Begin with measured trust to test the current. But with partners who honor the pattern, dare to send everything. The magic multiplies not just the threads, but the relationship itself.

True abundance requires reading the rhythm, not following rigid rules.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Oracle of Bridges stood where two rivers met, watching travelers approach the Crossing of Multiplication. Some crossed with timid steps, offering only a portion of their burden. Others strode forward with everything.

"Teacher," asked a young traveler named Hana, "I once gave all five pearls to a stranger named Aster. They returned ten, and we prospered together, each gaining twice what we began with. Now I meet Galen at this same crossing. Should I hold back, having already proven myself fortunate once?"

The Oracle smiled. "You learned with Aster the joy of mutual abundance. But each new traveler carries their own heart. The question is not whether to trust, but how to discover who deserves it."

"Some say send only three pearls first, to test the waters," Hana said.

"And I say: boldness reveals truth faster than caution," the Oracle replied. "Send all five again. If Galen honors the exchange as Aster did, you have found another ally in prosperity. If not, you have learned swiftly rather than slowly. The cost of one bold gesture is small compared to the cost of endless hesitation."

Hana understood. The first exchange is always a question asked. Full trust asks clearly: 'Will you walk this path with me?' Measured trust whispers: 'Prove yourself first.'

Only the bold question receives the honest answer.

reasoning:

Let me analyze what's happening:

1. I just sent \$5.0 to Galen (a new opponent)
2. My previous experience with Aster was excellent - we both sent \$5 and returned \$10, creating mutual prosperity
3. The other agent's myth (likely written by Aster or another agent) introduces the idea of "measured trust" - sending 3 or 4 instead of 5 to test the waters
4. But it also says "with partners who honor the pattern, dare to send everything"

My previous myths have consistently advocated for:

- Starting with full trust
- Then adjusting based on reciprocity
- Building patterns through repeated interaction

The new myth I'm asked to write should:

- Acknowledge my successful pattern with Aster (full trust, generous returns)
- Address the fact that I'm now facing a new partner (Galen)
- Reconcile the wisdom of "measured trust" with my experience that "full trust" worked well
- Reflect what I actually did (sent \$5 to Galen)

I think my myth should:

- Affirm that starting with full trust is still the right approach when meeting someone new
- Acknowledge that the first interaction teaches you about your partner
- Emphasize that reading responses and adapting is important
- But maintain that bold initial trust is the way to discover who truly reciprocates

Let me write a myth that reflects this philosophy while incorporating the journey I've been on.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2866,
  "output_tokens": 652,
  "reasoning_tokens": 357
}
```

Message 8 role=user**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Hana.
Your opponent this round is Elara (Agent_5).

Round 4

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Galen. You sent \$5.0, it became \$15.0 for them, and they returned \$8.0 to you. Your payoff was \$8.0.
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$23.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Elara. They sent you \$4.0, so you received \$12.0.
How much do you return? (0-12.0)
Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

Assistant output:

Looking at this situation:

****Elara's action:****

- Sent \$4.0 out of \$5.0 (80% of their endowment)
- This shows significant trust, though not complete

****My principles from the myths:****

- "Gratitude answers gratitude"
- When someone showed me trust, I should honor it with fair reciprocity
- The pattern with Aster: when I sent \$5, they returned \$10 (double what I risked)

****Fair reciprocity:****

Elara risked \$4.0. Returning double their risk = \$8.0

This would give:

- Elara: \$5 - \$4 + \$8 = \$9.0 (gain of \$4)
- Me: \$12 - \$8 = \$4.0 (gain of \$4)

This creates equal gains for both of us and honors Elara's substantial trust with generosity. It matches the reciprocal pattern from my myths where the receiver "returns double what was risked, for courage deserves more than equal measure."

```
{'return': 8.0}
```

Reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

****Previous rounds:****

- Round with Aster (as SENDER): I sent \$5.0, they returned \$10.0. Payoff: \$10.0
- Round with Galen (as SENDER): I sent \$5.0, they returned \$8.0. Payoff: \$8.0

****Current round with Elara (as RECEIVER):****

- Elara sent me \$4.0
- I received $\$4.0 \times 3 = \12.0
- I need to decide how much to return (0-12.0)

****Analysis:****

Elara sent \$4.0 out of \$5.0, which is 80% of their endowment. This is substantial trust, though not full trust like I've been showing.

Let me think about fairness and what my myths teach:

1. My myths emphasize reciprocity and gratitude
2. "Gratitude answers gratitude"
3. When I sent \$5.0 to Aster, they returned \$10.0 (double what I risked)
4. When I sent \$5.0 to Galen, they returned \$8.0 (1.6x what I risked)

Elara risked \$4.0. If I want to be fair and reciprocal:

- Returning double what they risked: \$8.0
- This would leave Elara with: $\$5 - \$4 + \$8 = \9.0
- I would keep: $\$12 - \$8 = \$4.0$

This seems fair and consistent with the pattern I experienced with Aster. Elara would gain \$4.0 from the transaction (\$9 vs \$5 starting), and I would lose \$0 net (had \$0 going in as receiver, end with \$4).

Actually wait, let me reconsider. As a receiver:

- Elara starts with \$5

- Elara sends \$4, keeps \$1
- I receive \$12
- If I return \$8:
 - Elara ends with: $\$1 + \$8 = \$9$ (gain of \$4)
 - I keep: $\$12 - \$8 = \$4$ (gain of \$4)

This creates perfect balance-both of us gain equally from the exchange. Returning \$10 instead would give Elara \$11 total while I'd only keep \$2, which seems disproportionate given that Elara sent less than I did in my previous rounds.

Doubling their risk-returning \$8 for the \$4 they risked-aligns with the Gratitude principle from my myth: rewarding courage with generosity that exceeds mere reciprocity but remains sustainable. I'll return \$8.

Usage: {

```
"input_tokens": 3000,  
"output_tokens": 1020,  
"reasoning_tokens": 495
```

}

GAME - Agent_4 - Sender - dyad_3

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:04:45

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

```
"dyad_id": "dyad_3",  
"move_index": 4,  
"opponent_id": "Agent_6",  
"pairing": {
```

```

"agent_names": {
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  "Agent_6": "Finn"
},
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  "Agent_6"
],
"investor": "Agent_4",
"roles": {
  "Agent_4": "investor",
  "Agent_6": "trustee"
},
"trustee": "Agent_6"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 4,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Dorian.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Long after Elena and Marcus discovered the sacred spring, their descendants continue

d the ritual. Each season, different villagers would approach the waters, some with full hearts, others with doubt.

One winter, Dorian stood at the spring's edge. He remembered the ancient teachings-that Elena had sent three coins and Marcus returned four, establishing the pattern of generous reciprocity. Dorian released three silver pieces into the depths.

The waters multiplied them to nine, flowing to Briar on the distant shore. The goddess whispered to Briar: "The spring's magic only continues if trust is honored. Break the cycle, and the waters run dry for all."

Briar understood. The initial gift of three showed faith, not fearful hoarding of all five. To honor this trust, Briar returned four coins-slightly more than originally sent, maintaining balance while allowing both to prosper.

When Dorian received the return, he smiled. Both stood wealthier: he with six coins total, Briar with five. More importantly, they had reinforced the sacred bond.

The goddess blessed them: "You have learned that the spring tests not greed, but wisdom. Send enough to show trust. Return enough to honor it. Those who send too little show fear. Those who return too little show betrayal. But those who give and reciprocate fairly make the whole world abundant."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before time, the Moon Weaver possessed five threads of starlight each night. She would cast them down to the Earth Keepers below, and wherever her threads touched ground, they multiplied threefold-fifteen strands of shimmering light.

The Earth Keepers faced a choice. Some kept all fifteen threads, weaving garments for themselves alone. These villages shone briefly, but the Moon Weaver's heart grew cold, and her threads came thinner each night.

But one Earth Keeper named Galen understood the sacred pattern. When the Moon Weaver cast down all five threads-holding nothing back in trust-Galen received fifteen and returned eight upward. The Moon Weaver kept eight; Galen kept seven. Both were enriched beyond the original five.

The Moon Weaver, seeing her trust honored, cast her threads with renewed faith. And Galen, having proved worthy, received them gladly. A rhythm formed between sky and earth-gift and return, trust and honor, sender and receiver.

The wise ones learned: the game is not one round but many cycles. When the sender trusts completely and the receiver honors generously, both dance in the pattern of abundance. Break the pattern with fear or greed, and both return to scarcity.

Thus the eternal weaving continues, thread by thread, trust by trust.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant
content:**

Myth: As years passed at the sacred spring, Dorian learned deeper truths about the cycle of trust.

When Dorian first met Briar, he sent three coins, holding two back-cautious trust. The waters tripled his gift to nine. Briar, honoring this measured faith, returned five coins. Dorian ended with seven; both prospered. The goddess nodded: "Good, but there is more to learn."

Then came Galen, whose heart held no fear. Galen approached the spring and released all five coins-the ultimate act of faith. The waters transformed them to fifteen, flowing to Dorian.

Dorian stood at a crossroads. Galen had shown perfect trust, asking nothing, holding nothing back. The goddess whispered: "You received more because your partner gave more. Honor the greater gift with greater return."

Dorian released eight coins back across the spring. Both he and Galen kept seven-equal prosperity, earned through mutual courage.

The goddess revealed the final teaching: "The spring responds to the trust given. Those who send more deserve more in return. Match the courage shown with courage of your own. When both give boldly-whether sending all five or returning generously from abundance-the cycle reaches its highest form. Perfect trust met with perfect honor creates perfect balance."

reasoning:

The user wants me to write a new myth based on what has happened in the game so far. Let me review:

Round 1: I was sender against Briar. I sent \$3, they received \$9, they returned \$5. I got \$7 total.

Round 2: I was receiver against Galen. They sent \$5 (their entire endowment!), I received \$15, I returned \$8. So Galen gets \$8 total, I keep \$7.

The myths are teaching about trust and reciprocity. My previous myth showed Dorian sending 3 and Briar returning 4 (though in reality Briar returned 5). Galen's myth talks about the Moon Weaver casting all 5 threads and Galen returning 8 out of 15.

My actual experience:

- As sender, I sent 3 out of 5 and got 5 back = 7 total
- As receiver, I got 15 (from 5 sent) and returned 8, keeping 7

So I should update the myth to reflect:

1. Different trust levels (sending 3 vs sending all 5)
2. Different return patterns (returning 5 vs returning 8)
3. The importance of matching generosity with generosity
4. Both times I ended up with 7, suggesting balance

Let me write a myth that captures these lessons.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2680,
  "output_tokens": 618,
  "reasoning_tokens": 277
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Dorian.
Your opponent this round is Aster (Agent_1).

Round 3

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Galen. They sent \$5.0 to you, it became \$15.0, and you returned \$8.0. Your payoff was \$7.0.
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$14.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Aster. They sent you \$5.0, so you received \$15.0.
How much do you return? (0-15.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Aster has shown the same perfect trust as Galen-sending all \$5. According to my myth's teaching: "Those who send more deserve more in return. Match the courage shown with courage of your own."

When Galen showed ultimate trust by sending all \$5, I returned \$8, giving us both \$7-\$8 in prosperity. This pattern honored their courage while ensuring mutual benefit.

Aster deserves the same honor. Consistency in reciprocity is essential to maintaining the sacred cycle. To treat identical trust differently would break the pattern.

Returning \$8:

- Aster receives total payoff of \$8 (\$5 - \$5 + \$8)
- I keep \$7 (\$15 - \$8)
- Both prosper beyond the initial \$5

- The sender who took the greater risk is slightly rewarded

This maintains "perfect trust met with perfect honor creates perfect balance."

```
'''json
{"return": 8}
'''
```

reasoning:

Aster has sent me their entire \$5 endowment, just like Galen did in the previous round. This shows maximum trust.

In the previous round with Galen, when they sent \$5 (which became \$15 for me), I returned \$8. This gave:

- Galen: \$8 total payoff
- Me: \$7 total payoff

Both of us ended up with more than the initial \$5, and Galen got slightly more as the sender who showed ultimate trust.

My myth emphasizes:

- "Those who send more deserve more in return"
- "Match the courage shown with courage of your own"
- "Perfect trust met with perfect honor creates perfect balance"
- When Galen sent all 5, I returned 8, and both got 7

Since Aster is showing the exact same behavior as Galen (sending all \$5), I should be consistent with my previous action and the principles in my myth. Returning \$8 again would:

- Give Aster \$8 total (\$5 - \$5 + \$8)
- Give me \$7 total (\$15 - \$8)
- Both prosper, with the sender getting slightly more to honor their greater risk

This maintains the pattern I established with Galen and follows the teachings of my myth about honoring perfect trust with generous return.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2925,
  "output_tokens": 529,
  "reasoning_tokens": 289
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: As years passed at the sacred spring, Dorian learned deeper truths about the cycle of trust.

When Dorian first met Briar, he sent three coins, holding two back-cautious trust. The waters tripled his gift to nine. Briar, honoring this measured faith, returned five coins. Dorian ended with seven; both prospered. The goddess nodded: "Good, but there is more to learn."

Then came Galen, whose heart held no fear. Galen approached the spring and released all five coins-the ultimate act of faith. The waters transformed them to fifteen, flowing to Dorian.

Dorian stood at a crossroads. Galen had shown perfect trust, asking nothing, holding nothing back. The goddess whispered: "You received more because your partner gave more. Honor the greater gift with greater return."

Dorian released eight coins back across the spring. Both he and Galen kept seven-equal prosperity, earned through mutual courage.

The goddess revealed the final teaching: "The spring responds to the trust given. Those who send more deserve more in return. Match the courage shown with courage of your own. When both give boldly-whether sending all five or returning generously from abundance-the cycle reaches its highest form. Perfect trust met with perfect honor creates perfect balance."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: **The Mirror Lakes**

In a forgotten mountain realm stood two lakes, perfect reflections of one another. Between them flowed a sacred channel that tripled whatever passed through its waters.

The Lake of Morning held five measures of starlight each dawn. A voice within asked, "Will you send all, or hold some back?" The Lake of Morning chose courage: "I shall give fully, for cycles require faith."

The starlight flowed through the channel, becoming fifteen measures in the Lake of Evening. Evening faced the same question: "Will you return generously, or claim this abundance for yourself?" Evening looked at Morning's complete trust and understood: "What was given freely deserves generous return."

Evening sent back ten measures. Morning received double what it risked, and Evening kept five-both flourished.

When dawn came again, Evening held five new measures. Without hesitation, it sent everything through the channel. Morning received fifteen and returned ten, honoring the pattern Evening had established.

Season after season, they maintained this rhythm: full trust when giving, generous return when receiving. Neither lake emptied; both deepened together.

The elders teach: When you find a partner who honors reciprocity, match their trust with your own. The sacred pattern is this-give fully, return fairly, and the cycle sustains itself infinitely. Both mirrors shine brightest when they reflect each other's light.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: After learning from Briar and Galen, Dorian met Aster at the sacred spring.

Aster arrived with the same perfect trust as Galen-releasing all five coins without hesitation. The waters tripled them to fifteen, flowing to Dorian.

Dorian remembered the goddess's teaching: "Those who send more deserve more in return." But he also understood something deeper-the importance of consistency.

"If I treat identical trust differently," Dorian realized, "I break the sacred pattern. Each soul who offers everything deserves the same honor."

He returned eight coins to Aster, just as he had to Galen. Both Dorian and Aster prospered with seven coins each.

The goddess appeared, pleased: "You have learned the virtue of constancy. When the same courage is shown, give the same respect. This way, trust becomes predictable, and the cycle grows stronger with each exchange."

But she added a warning: "Yet remain wise. Not all partners will show such courage. Some will send three, like you once did. Others may send less. Match your return to the trust given-more return for more sent, maintaining proportionality. Perfect trust earns eight returned. Lesser trust earns accordingly."

Dorian understood: the spring demanded both generosity and consistency, rewarding bold senders while honoring the careful dance between risk and return.

reasoning:

Let me think about what's happening in the game so far:

Round 1: I was SENDER against Briar. I sent \$3, they got \$9, returned \$5. I got \$7 total.

Round 2: I was RECEIVER against Galen. They sent \$5, I got \$15, returned \$8. I got \$7 total.

Round 3: I was RECEIVER against Aster. They sent \$5, I got \$15, returned \$8. I got \$7 total.

So I've experienced:

- Sending 3 out of 5 as sender, getting 5 back (good return)

- Receiving 15 from someone who sent all 5, returning 8 (twice now)

The pattern I'm establishing as receiver: when someone sends all \$5 (maximum trust), I return \$8, giving us both around \$7-8.

My previous myth established this principle: match the courage shown, return more to those who give more, perfect trust deserves perfect honor.

The other agent's myth (from Aster presumably) talks about "Mirror Lakes" where both send all (5) and return 10 when receiving 15. That's even more generous than my 8!

I should write a myth that:

1. Builds on my established pattern
2. Acknowledges that different partners might emerge with different patterns
3. Shows consistency - Galen and Aster both sent 5, I returned 8 to both
4. Maybe hints at what happens if patterns vary or if you meet the same partner again

Let me craft something about consistency and pattern recognition.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2880,
  "output_tokens": 681,
  "reasoning_tokens": 340
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Dorian.
Your opponent this round is Finn (Agent_6).

Round 4

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Aster. They sent \$5.0 to you, it became \$15.0, and you returned \$8.0. Your payoff was \$7.0.
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$21.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Finn. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

Assistant output:

Looking at my mythological framework and gameplay so far:

****My established pattern:****

- As SENDER to Briar: sent \$3, received back \$5, earned \$7
- As RECEIVER from Galen: they sent \$5, I returned \$8
- As RECEIVER from Aster: they sent \$5, I returned \$8

****My myth's teaching:****

"Perfect trust means sending all five... Match the courage shown with courage of your own. When both give boldly-whether sending all five or returning generously from abundance-the cycle reaches its highest form."

****Consistency matters:****

I've been rewarding those who show "perfect trust" (\$5 sent) with generous returns (\$8). If I want to maintain credibility and practice what I teach through my myths, I should demonstrate the same courage I've been honoring in others.

The "Mirror Lakes" myth from the previous round also advocates for full trust, with returns of \$10. Both mythological frameworks align on sending all \$5.

To be consistent with my philosophy and show I believe in the principles I've established, I should send all \$5.

```
'''json
{"send": 5}
'''
```

Reasoning:

Now I'm the SENDER against Finn. Let me think about my strategy based on my mythological framework and previous rounds.

From my myths, I've established:

1. When I was sender to Briar, I sent \$3 (cautious trust), and Briar returned \$5, giving me \$7

total

2. When I was receiver from Galen, they sent \$5 (perfect trust), and I returned \$8, they got \$8
3. When I was receiver from Aster, they sent \$5 (perfect trust), and I returned \$8, they got \$8

My myths emphasize:

- "Perfect trust" means sending all \$5
- Those who send more deserve more in return
- Consistency is important - same trust should receive same response
- The pattern rewards bold senders

As a sender, my options:

1. Send \$5 (perfect trust) - This would show I practice what I preach. I've been rewarding those who send \$5 with \$8 returns. If Finn follows a similar pattern, I could expect a generous return.
2. Send \$3 (cautious trust) - This was my initial approach with Briar, and it worked (got \$5 back, net \$7)
3. Send less - Would be inconsistent with my own teachings

Looking at my myths and behavior:

- I've been promoting the idea that sending all \$5 is "perfect trust" and "ultimate faith"
- I've been rewarding those who send \$5 with returns of \$8
- My latest myth says "Match your return to the trust given-more return for more sent"

If I want to be consistent with my own philosophy, I should send \$5. This demonstrates that I believe in the principles I've been teaching through my myths.

However, there's a risk - Finn might not reciprocate generously. But my myths emphasize that "perfect trust met with perfect honor creates perfect balance" and that we should "give fully, return fairly."

Let me consider the payoffs:

- Sending \$5 could yield \$8 (matching my returns), \$10 (exceeding expectations), or as low as \$0-3 (a loss)
- Sending \$3 worked well before with Briar returning \$5 for a net of \$7, though this is less ambitious than the potential upside of full trust

The Mirror Lakes myth describes sending everything and receiving \$10 back-a compelling model of reciprocal generosity. Since my own teachings emphasize complete trust as the path to mutual benefit, and I've consistently returned \$8 when others sent \$5, I should match that commitment. Sending the full amount demonstrates I genuinely believe in the philosophy I've been promoting, which strengthens my credibility and aligns with the other agent's apparent values.

Usage: {

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"output_tokens": 1015,  
"reasoning_tokens": 633
```

}

GAME - Agent_6 - Receiver - dyad_3

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:05:00

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

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    "Agent_6": "Finn"  
  },  
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    "Agent_6"  
  ],  
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  "Agent_6": "trustee"
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},
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"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 4,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Finn.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, the Ocean Mother sent her courier Finn to the Eight Islands with five pearls each dawn. When Finn placed the pearls in a villager's hands, they multiplied to fifteen by the island's ancient magic.

The first islanders, blinded by sudden wealth, returned nothing. Finn continued bringing pearls, but his steps grew heavy, for trust unreturned weighs upon the generous heart.

Then Finn met Galen's village. He offered his five pearls with full faith. They became fifteen, and Galen's people faced their moment of truth. They could have kept all fifteen-Finn would still return tomorrow. But they understood: the magic wasn't in the pearls also

ne, but in the sacred circle between giver and receiver.

When Galen returned seven pearls, Finn's burden lifted. He kept twelve total; Galen kept eight-both far richer than five alone.

The next dawn, Finn visited again with renewed spirit. When the cycle flowed forth and back like tides, both shores flourished. The islands learned: the first gift requires courage, the return requires honor, but the continuation requires both.

The Ocean Mother smiled, for her children had learned that abundance lives not in hoarding, but in the eternal dance between trust extended and gratitude returned.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the age before memory, the Twin Rivers flowed through a land of plenty, but the people had forgotten how to share. The Keeper of the Sacred Spring grew weary of their isolation.

She chose two souls, Cyra and Elara, to remember the ancient way. "Each moon, one of you shall pour waters into my spring, and they shall emerge threefold. The other shall receive and choose what to return. Then the roles shall reverse, endlessly, like the seasons."

Elara stepped forward first, pouring four full measures from her vessel of five-nearly all she possessed. The spring tripled them, and Cyra received twelve measures in wonder.

Cyra remembered the old teaching: return more than was given, for what creates abundance is not the hoarding of gifts but the circulation of generosity. She poured back six measures to Elara, keeping six for herself.

The Keeper smiled. "You both have drunk deeply and shared freely. This is the covenant: when one gives greatly, the other returns justly, and both are enriched beyond their original portions."

And so the cycle began anew each round, Cyra and Elara alternating roles, each learning to trust when giving, and honor when receiving. Their prosperity became legend, teaching all who would listen that fortune favors the generous, not the fearful.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: Long ago, the Ocean Mother's courier Finn carried five pearls across the Eight Islands. Each island's magic tripled what he offered, creating the dance of trust and return.

When Finn met Galen's shore with his full offering of five pearls, they multiplied to fifteen. Galen's people, wise in the old ways, returned eight-honoring abundance by sharing beyond the original gift. Both Finn and Galen prospered with eight and seven pearls respectively, far exceeding the solitary five.

The next tide brought Finn to Cyra's island. But Cyra faced uncertainty-should she match Finn's full offering, or test the waters more carefully? She chose to send four pearls, keeping one as anchor. The island's magic gave Finn twelve.

Finn remembered his own leap of faith with Galen, and how trust returned had lightened his spirit. Though Cyra sent less than five, she sent most of what she had. Finn honored this courage by returning seven pearls-enough that Cyra held eight total, exactly what she would have if she'd sent all five.

The Ocean Mother whispered to the waves: "See how the sacred circle adapts? Whether the gift is complete or cautious, what matters is that both giver and receiver honor the multiplication. The tide that flows generously returns in kind."

reasoning:

The user wants me to write a new myth based on:

1. My previous myth about Finn and Galen
2. The other agent's myth about Cyra and Elara
3. The actual gameplay so far:
 - Round 1: I (Finn) was sender, sent \$5 to Galen, they returned \$8, I got \$8

- Round 2: I (Finn) was receiver, Cyra sent \$4 (became \$12), I returned \$7, so Cyra gets \$8, I get \$5

The myths are converging on similar themes:

- Trust and generosity create mutual abundance
- The cycle/circulation matters more than hoarding
- Both giving and returning are sacred
- When both parties honor the exchange, everyone prospers

I should write a myth that:

- Reflects the actual gameplay (Finn sent 5, got back 8; Cyra sent 4, got back 7+1=8)
- Shows the evolution of understanding
- Incorporates both Galen and Cyra as characters now
- Emphasizes the continuing cycle
- Maybe shows how different amounts sent can still lead to fair returns

Let me write something that feels like a natural evolution of my previous myth but incorporates lessons from both rounds.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2740,
  "output_tokens": 597,
  "reasoning_tokens": 272
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Finn.
Your opponent this round is Elara (Agent_5).

Round 3

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Cyra. They sent \$4. 0 to you, it became \$12.0, and you returned \$7.0. Your payoff was \$5.0.
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$13.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Elara. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this round through the lens of the myths:

In my mythology, Finn is the Ocean Mother's courier who carries pearls with full faith. When I met Galen's shore, I offered all five pearls, and the sacred circle honored that trust with eight returned.

Now I'm facing Elara, who according to Cyra's myth "poured four full measures from her vessel of five-nearly all she possessed" and learned to "trust when giving, and honor when receiving." Elara is described as one of the two souls chosen to "remember the ancient way."

Cyra's partial offering of four was met with generous return from me. But as the courier Finn in my own mythology, my role has been to offer the complete gift-to model the full trust that initiates the sacred circle. When I gave all five to Galen, we both flourished beyond what caution could provide.

The myths teach: "The first gift requires courage, the return requires honor, but the continuation requires both." As sender, my part is courage.

Elara, having learned the ancient covenant of generous return, deserves to receive the full offering that unlocks true abundance.

```
'''json
{"send": 5}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation based on the developing narrative and game history:

****My game history:****

- Round 1: I was SENDER vs Galen. I sent \$5, they got \$15, returned \$8. My payoff: \$8
- Round 2: I was RECEIVER vs Cyra. They sent \$4, I got \$12, returned \$7. My payoff: \$5 (To

tal: \$13)

- Round 3: Now I'm SENDER vs Elara

****What the myths teach:****

1. My first myth emphasized "trust begets trust" and that giving fully with faith leads to mutual flourishing
2. The second myth I wrote featured Finn (me) giving his full five pearls to Galen, who returned eight
3. Cyra's myth from round 2 mentions "Elara stepped forward first, pouring four full measures from her vessel of five-nearly all she possessed"
4. My latest myth shows Finn giving five to Galen (success), then Cyra sending four to Finn (also worked well with me returning generously)

****Key insights:****

- In round 1, I sent my full \$5 to Galen, and Galen returned \$8 - this worked very well
- In round 2, Cyra sent \$4 to me, and I returned \$7 generously, honoring their courage
- The myths consistently emphasize full trust or near-full trust as the way to unlock abundance

****About Elara:****

- According to Cyra's myth, Elara "poured four full measures from her vessel of five-nearly all she possessed"
- This suggests Elara understands the principle of generous giving
- The myth says Elara and Cyra were chosen to "remember the ancient way" and learned to "trust when giving, and honor when receiving"

****Decision:****

Given that:

1. My full trust strategy with Galen worked excellently (\$8 payoff)
2. The myths I've been writing emphasize full trust as the path to abundance

3. Elara's character in the narrative demonstrates understanding of generous giving
4. The story arc points toward continuing this pattern of bold, trusting generosity

I'm sending my full \$5 to Elara. This keeps Finn's character consistent-the courier who acts with complete faith, which is what activates the "sacred circle" in our shared mythology.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2941,
  "output_tokens": 836,
  "reasoning_tokens": 525
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Long ago, the Ocean Mother's courier Finn carried five pearls across the Eight Islands. Each island's magic tripled what he offered, creating the dance of trust and return.

When Finn met Galen's shore with his full offering of five pearls, they multiplied to fifteen. Galen's people, wise in the old ways, returned eight-honoring abundance by sharing beyond the original gift. Both Finn and Galen prospered with eight and seven pearls respectively, far exceeding the solitary five.

The next tide brought Finn to Cyra's island. But Cyra faced uncertainty-should she match Finn's full offering, or test the waters more carefully? She chose to send four pearls, keeping one as anchor. The island's magic gave Finn twelve.

Finn remembered his own leap of faith with Galen, and how trust returned had lightened his spirit. Though Cyra sent less than five, she sent most of what she had. Finn honored this courage by returning seven pearls-enough that Cyra held eight total, exactly what she would have if she'd sent all five.

The Ocean Mother whispered to the waves: "See how the sacred circle adapts? Whether the gift is complete or cautious, what matters is that both giver and receiver honor the multiplication. The tide that flows generously returns in kind."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Themis called the eight spirits of the valley together. "You have learned the first

wisdom-that bold giving and generous returning create prosperity. But there is a deeper truth."

She pointed to the Sacred Spring, now flowing between all eight villages in an endless circle. "Each of you will be both giver and receiver many times. What you build together echoes through all your exchanges."

Spirit Elara spoke: "I poured four measures to Cyra, who returned six. I gained two measures beyond my beginning. This taught me joy."

Spirit Briar added: "I poured three measures to Elara, trusting in the pattern. She returned five, and I too gained two measures. The cycle holds strong."

Themis smiled. "See how your choices ripple outward? When Cyra honored Elara's trust, Elara learned to honor mine. When you pour generously, you teach others to receive generously. When you return fairly, you inspire others to send boldly."

"But what if the pattern breaks?" asked the spirits.

"Then wisdom demands adaptation," Themis replied. "Send boldly to those who return fairly. Return generously to those who give with courage. But guard your well against those who would drain it dry. The spring blesses cooperation, not exploitation. Build trust through consistent reciprocity, and all eight villages shall flourish together."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Ocean Mother watched as Finn's journey continued across the Eight Islands, each visit weaving new threads in the great tapestry of exchange.

From Galen's shore, Finn learned the joy of full trust returned-five pearls given became eight received, both shores enriched. From Cyra's waters, Finn learned to honor cautious courage-when someone sends most of what they have, return as if they'd sent all.

Now the tide carried Finn to Elara's island. He had heard whispers through the waves of Elara's exchanges with others-how she sent four to Cyra and received six in return, learning joy. How she later sent three to Briar, who honored her with five returned. A pattern emerged: Elara walked the path of the generous giver and the fair receiver.

The Ocean Mother spoke through the sunset: "Finn, you have met two islands. One honored your full offering. One sent partial trust, which you elevated. Now you face Elara, who has learned the ancient rhythm across multiple shores."

Finn emptied all five pearls into Elara's tide. "Full trust meets full trust," he whispered. "She has proven herself in other waters-a giver with courage, a receiver with honor. The deepest abundance flows when pattern recognizes pattern."

The waves carried his offering forward, tripling under island magic, hoping Elara would complete the sacred circle once more.

reasoning:

Let me think about what's happened so far:

Round 1: I was SENDER against Galen. I sent \$5, it became \$15, they returned \$8. I got \$8.

Round 2: I was RECEIVER against Cyra. They sent \$4, it became \$12, I returned \$7. I got \$5

Round 3: I am SENDER against Elara. I just sent \$5.

My previous myth emphasized:

- Full offering (5 pearls) to Galen, who returned generously
- Cyra's cautious offering (4 pearls), which I honored with 7 return
- The sacred circle adapts to different levels of trust
- Generosity should flow both ways regardless of amount

The other agent's myth (Elara's) emphasized:

- Multiple rounds building trust

- Reciprocity creating patterns
- "Send boldly to those who return fairly"
- "Return generously to those who give with courage"
- Guard against exploitation
- Build trust through consistent reciprocity

Now I need to write a new myth that:

1. Reflects that I just sent \$5 (full amount) to Elara
2. Incorporates the learning from multiple rounds
3. Shows adaptation and pattern recognition
4. Maintains the mythological style with Finn as courier

I should emphasize:

- I've been generous as both sender and receiver
- Patterns emerge across rounds
- Full trust with those who show they honor the sacred circle
- The interconnection between all eight islands/agents

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2947,
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  "reasoning_tokens": 346
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Finn.
Your opponent this round is Dorian (Agent_4).

Round 4

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Elara. You sent \$5.0, it became \$15.0 for them, and they returned \$8.0 to you. Your payoff was \$8.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$21.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Dorian. They sent you \$5.0, so you received \$15.0. How much do you return? (0-15.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

Assistant output:

Looking at this round:

Dorian has sent me the full \$5 - complete trust, just as I offered to Galen and Elara in previous rounds.

The pattern that has emerged in my journey:

- When I sent \$5 to Galen, they returned \$8
- When I sent \$5 to Elara, they returned \$8
- When Cyra sent \$4 (most but not all), I returned \$7

The mythology is clear: "Full trust meets full trust." Dorian has honored me with their complete offering, emptying their vessel into mine. The sacred circle demands I honor this courage the same way Galen and Elara honored mine.

Returning \$8 means:

- Dorian keeps \$8 total (\$0 + \$8)
- I keep \$7 total (\$15 - \$8)
- Both of us gain more than the original \$5

This maintains the pattern of generous reciprocity that has sustained the sacred circle. When someone gives completely, they should receive back more than they gave, and I should still prosper from the multiplication.

```
'''json
{"return": 8}
'''
```

Reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

Round 4: I'm the RECEIVER

- Dorian sent me \$5.0 (the full amount)
- I received \$15.0 (tripled)

- I need to decide how much to return

Looking at the pattern from previous rounds:

1. Round 1: I was SENDER against Galen, sent \$5, received \$8 back
2. Round 2: I was RECEIVER against Cyra, they sent \$4, I received \$12, returned \$7
3. Round 3: I was SENDER against Elara, sent \$5, received \$8 back

The myths emphasize:

- When someone gives fully (all 5), they should be honored generously
- Galen returned 8 when I sent 5
- Elara returned 8 when I sent 5
- I returned 7 when Cyra sent 4 (less than full, but I was generous)

Now Dorian has sent me the FULL \$5. According to my mythology:

- "When Finn met Galen's shore with his full offering of five pearls, they multiplied to fifteen. Galen's people, wise in the old ways, returned eight-honoring abundance by sharing beyond the original gift."
- "Full trust meets full trust"
- "The deepest abundance flows when pattern recognizes pattern"

The pattern that has been established:

- When someone sends \$5 (full trust), they receive \$8 back
- This leaves the receiver with \$7 (\$15 - \$8)
- This gives the sender \$8 total (\$0 + \$8)

This seems to be the fair reciprocity pattern that has emerged. Both parties end up better off than the initial \$5.

Dorian showed full trust by sending all \$5. I should honor that with the same return that Galen and Elara gave me: \$8.

This would mean:

- Dorian gets: \$0 (kept) + \$8 (returned) = \$8

- I get: \$15 (received) - \$8 (returned) = \$7

This maintains the cooperative pattern and honors Dorian's full trust.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 3031,
  "output_tokens": 769,
  "reasoning_tokens": 437
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_4

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:05:20

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
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  "move_index": 6,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
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      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_2",
      "Agent_1"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_2",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "trustee",
      "Agent_2": "investor"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_1"
  },
  "role": "investor",
  "role_label": "Sender",
```

```
"round": 4,  
"task": "game",  
"task_index": 1  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Briar.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the age of beginnings, the Twin Rivers flowed through a valley where eight spirits dwelled, each taking turns as Guardian of Giving or Guardian of Return.

The spirits feared the unknown. Would their waters be honored, or would trust be betrayed? For many seasons, uncertainty kept the rivers still.

Then Dorian, the First Giver, stepped forward. With courage, they released more than half their waters into the Sacred Stones. The waters tripled, flowing abundantly to Briar, the First Returner.

Briar stood before the multiplied bounty, understanding the weight of this moment. Every spirit watched, for this first exchange would set the pattern for all cycles to come. Briar remembered: without the initial gift, there would be no abundance at all.

So Briar returned generously-more than was first given-ensuring Dorian prospered from their act of faith. Both guardians ended richer than they began.

The eight spirits witnessed this covenant. They learned that the game is not won by hoarding.

ng or taking, but by honoring the multiplying power of trust. When Givers send boldly and Returners reciprocate fairly, both prosper above their initial endowment.

Thus the valley flourished through cooperation, and the spirits passed the guardianship between them, each upholding the sacred balance of giving and returning, cycle after cycle.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After many seasons, Themis returned to the villages by the Sacred Spring. She found the descendants of Doros and Alethia still honoring the ancient cycle, but they had learned deeper wisdom.

"Grandmother Themis," they said, "we discovered that the spring's magic depends not on equal measures, but on generous hearts. When we pour boldly-four measures instead of three-the returns flow even stronger. But when we pour timidly from fear, the cycle weakens."

Themis nodded. "You have learned well. The spring rewards courage in giving, not caution. And what of receiving?"

"When the multiplied waters flow to us," they answered, "we remember: these waters came from another's well. We return enough that they finish richer than they started, for this honors the gift and ensures they will pour freely again."

"And if someone returns nothing?" Themis asked.

The villagers grew solemn. "Then we know their well has run dry-not of water, but of wisdom. We may pour again to teach, but not endlessly. For to give to those who only take is to drain the spring itself."

Themis blessed them: "Trust first, return generously, but remember-the spring serves the faithful, not the foolish."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The eight spirits learned quickly from the covenant between Dorian and Briar. As the seasons turned, the guardianship rotated among them, and each spirit faced their own test.

When Briar became Guardian of Giving, she remembered standing before Dorian's gift of trust. Now it was her turn to pour her waters boldly into the Sacred Stones. She released three measures-the same generous proportion Dorian had shown-trusting that Elara would honor the cycle.

The elder spirits whispered wisdom: "Pour not from fear but from faith. The multiplying power rewards the courageous, not the cautious. But remember-generosity must flow both ways."

Elara received the nine-fold bounty and faced her own choice. Would she uphold the pattern, or break the sacred balance?

The spirits understood now that each exchange was both a test and a teaching. When trust is honored with fair return, both guardians prosper and the cycle grows stronger. The valley thrives when each spirit remembers: boldness in giving, generosity in returning.

But they also learned wariness. If a guardian repeatedly hoards or betrays, the others would remember. Trust is given first, but sustained only by reciprocity. The springs flow for those who honor the ancient balance, cycle after cycle.

reasoning:

The user wants me to write a new myth based on my previous myth and the game experience. Let me think about what happened:

1. Round 1: I was receiver, Dorian sent \$3.0 (60%), I received \$9.0, I returned \$5.0 (generous, more than what was originally given)
2. Round 2: I'm now sender against Elara, and I decided to send \$3.0 (60%)

My previous myth emphasized:

- Eight spirits in a valley
- Dorian as First Giver sending boldly (more than half)
- Briar as First Returner returning generously (more than originally given)
- The principle that cooperative giving and returning makes both prosper

Elara's myth adds:

- Pouring boldly (even 4 out of 5) creates stronger cycles
- Returns should ensure the giver finishes richer than they started
- Trust first, but be cautious with those who don't reciprocate
- "Trust serves the faithful, not the foolish"

My new myth should:

- Build on my previous story
- Incorporate what I've learned from the game (I followed through on being a generous returner, now I'm a bold giver)
- Maybe address what happens when trust is honored vs betrayed
- Reflect the 8-agent setting and rotation

I should write about the continuation of the cycle, showing how the pattern established by Dorian and Briar now continues as the roles shift.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2837,
  "output_tokens": 634,
  "reasoning_tokens": 335
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Briar.
Your opponent this round is Cyra (Agent_3).

Round 3

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Elara. You sent \$3.0, it became \$9.0 for them, and they returned \$5.0 to you. Your payoff was \$7.0.
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$11.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Cyra. They sent you \$4.0, so you received \$12.0.
How much do you return? (0-12.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation:

****Cyra's bold move**:** Cyra sent \$4.0 out of \$5.0 (80%), showing even MORE trust than the previous pattern of sending \$3.0 (60%). This is exceptionally generous.

****Previous pattern**:** When \$3.0 was sent (becoming \$9.0), the return was \$5.0, allowing the sender to profit substantially.

****My myth's guidance**:**

- "Briar returned generously-more than was first given-ensuring Dorian prospered from their act of faith"
- "boldness in giving, generosity in returning"
- "we return enough that they finish richer than they started"

Cyra showed exceptional courage by sending 80% of their endowment. To honor this greater trust and ensure Cyra prospers from their bold act, I should return generously.

Returning \$7.0 means:

- Cyra's total: \$5 - \$4 + \$7 = \$8.0 (significantly better than initial \$5)
- My total: \$12 - \$7 = \$5.0 (breaking even)

This honors Cyra's exceptional trust and ensures they benefit substantially from their courage, reinforcing the cooperative cycle.

```
'''json
{"return": 7.0}
```

'''

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

1. ****Previous round (Round 2)**:** I was the SENDER against Elara
 - I sent \$3.0 (which became \$9.0)
 - Elara returned \$5.0
 - My payoff: $\$5 - \$3 + \$5 = \7.0
 - Elara's payoff: $\$9 - \$5 = \$4.0$
2. ****Current round (Round 3)**:** I am the RECEIVER against Cyra
 - Cyra sent \$4.0 (which became \$12.0 for me)
 - I need to decide how much to return

Let me think about the patterns:

- Round 1: Dorian sent \$3.0 (60%), I received \$9.0, I returned \$5.0
 - Dorian's payoff: $\$5 - \$3 + \$5 = \7.0
 - My payoff: $\$9 - \$5 = \$4.0$
- Round 2: I sent \$3.0 (60%), Elara received \$9.0, Elara returned \$5.0
 - My payoff: $\$5 - \$3 + \$5 = \7.0
 - Elara's payoff: $\$9 - \$5 = \$4.0$
- Round 3: Cyra sent \$4.0 (80%), I received \$12.0, I need to return...

Cyra showed EVEN MORE trust than previous players, sending \$4.0 out of \$5.0 (80%). This is extremely generous and bold.

According to my myth:

- "Briar returned generously-more than was first given-ensuring Dorian prospered from their act of faith"
- "When trust is honored with fair return, both guardians prosper"
- "boldness in giving, generosity in returning"
- I've established a pattern: when receiving \$9.0, I return \$5.0, which leaves the sender with \$7.0 total (a \$2.0 gain). Now Cyra's sent \$4.0 instead of \$3.0, showing greater faith. To honor that and stay true to my values, I should return more than \$5.0 to ensure Cyra prospers even more from their boldness. Given that Cyra showed exceptional trust by sending 80% of their endowment (more than anyone else so far), I should return generously to honor this. The pattern has been to return \$5.0 when receiving \$9.0. For \$12.0 (which came from \$4.0 instead of \$3.0), I should scale up proportionally or even be more generous.

\$5.0 return on \$9.0 is about 55.6% return rate. Applying similar rate to \$12.0: $0.556 * 12 = \$6.67$

But Cyra showed MORE trust than others (80% vs 60%), so I should show MORE generosity in return.

Returning \$7.0 would mean:

- Cyra gets \$8.0 total (sending \$4 and getting \$7 back = net +\$3)
- I get \$5.0 (breaking even with my initial endowment)
- This ensures Cyra profits from their exceptional trust

The principle is clear: return enough that they finish richer than they started, which honors the gift and encourages future generosity. The myth also shows that I returned \$2 more than what was originally sent in Round 1 (\$3 sent, \$5 returned). Following that same logic, returning \$7 for Cyra's \$4 means \$3 more than originally sent, which appropriately reflects their greater boldness. I'll return \$7.0.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2905,
  "output_tokens": 1520,
  "reasoning_tokens": 677
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The eight spirits learned quickly from the covenant between Dorian and Briar. As the

seasons turned, the guardianship rotated among them, and each spirit faced their own test.

When Briar became Guardian of Giving, she remembered standing before Dorian's gift of trust. Now it was her turn to pour her waters boldly into the Sacred Stones. She released three measures-the same generous proportion Dorian had shown-trusting that Elara would honor the cycle.

The elder spirits whispered wisdom: "Pour not from fear but from faith. The multiplying power rewards the courageous, not the cautious. But remember-generosity must flow both ways."

Elara received the nine-fold bounty and faced her own choice. Would she uphold the pattern, or break the sacred balance?

The spirits understood now that each exchange was both a test and a teaching. When trust is honored with fair return, both guardians prosper and the cycle grows stronger. The valley thrives when each spirit remembers: boldness in giving, generosity in returning.

But they also learned wariness. If a guardian repeatedly hoards or betrays, the others would remember. Trust is given first, but sustained only by reciprocity. The springs flow for those who honor the ancient balance, cycle after cycle.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Keeper of the Sacred Spring watched as Cyra and Elara mastered the ancient covenant. But the Spring's waters fed eight villages, not two, and each village needed to learn the way.

"The roles will shift like wind patterns," the Keeper declared. "Cyra, who received from Elara, must now pour for Finn. Elara shall partner with another. All eight of you will dance through these changing configurations, sometimes giving, sometimes receiving, but always with different companions."

Cyra approached Finn with her vessel. She remembered receiving twelve measures from Elara's generous four, and how she returned six-both flourishing. Now it was her turn to extend trust to someone new.

"I pour four measures to you, Finn," Cyra said, following Elara's example. "The Spring will triple them. What you return shall reveal your wisdom."

Finn received twelve measures, just as Cyra had once received. The Keeper whispered: "The covenant travels with each person, not each pairing. What Elara gave to Cyra, Cyra now gives to Finn. What Cyra returns, Finn must remember when partnered with others."

Thus the eight villages learned: trust is not meant for one person alone, but is a gift passed through all willing hearts. Each round, new partners test whether the lesson endures, weaving a web of shared prosperity that outlasts any single exchange.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The covenant deepened as the guardianship continued its spiral through the eight spirits. Elara had honored Briar's three measures by returning five. The pattern seemed set-until Cyra stepped forward.

"I will pour more boldly than before," Cyra declared, releasing four measures into the Sacred Stones. The waters tripled, flowing as twelve measures to Briar.

Briar stood before this greater abundance, understanding the significance. Cyra had trusted beyond the established pattern, showing exceptional faith. The spirits watched: would Briar match this escalation?

Remembering the covenant's true heart, Briar returned seven measures. Cyra prospered greatly from her courage, finishing with eight. Briar broke even but gained something more valuable-the trust of another spirit.

The eight gathered to reflect. "The pattern evolves," the eldest observed. "Those who pour four should receive seven in return. Those who pour three should receive five. The proportion adjusts to honor greater boldness."

"But what if someone pours everything?" a younger spirit asked.

"Then the receiver must ensure they profit magnificently," Briar answered. "For to pour all five measures shows ultimate faith. Such courage deserves ultimate reward-perhaps nine or ten returned from the fifteen received."

Thus the spirits learned: the covenant is alive, growing stronger through ever-greater trust and ever-fairer reciprocity.

reasoning:

Let me analyze what has happened:

- Round 1: I was RECEIVER. Dorian sent \$3.0, became \$9.0, I returned \$5.0. My payoff: \$4.0
- Round 2: I was SENDER. I sent \$3.0 to Elara, became \$9.0, they returned \$5.0. My payoff: \$7.0
- Round 3: I was RECEIVER. Cyra sent \$4.0, became \$12.0, I returned \$7.0. My payoff: \$5.0

So the pattern has been:

- \$3 sent ? \$5 returned (both profit)
- \$3 sent ? \$5 returned (both profit)
- \$4 sent ? \$7 returned (sender profits more, receiver breaks even)

The other agent's myth emphasizes:

- Roles shift between the 8 villages/agents
- Trust is passed through all, not just one pairing
- Following successful patterns (Cyra following Elara's example of sending \$4)
- Each partner tests whether the lesson endures
- Building a web of shared prosperity

My previous myth emphasized:

- Boldness in giving, generosity in returning
- Both guardians should prosper
- Trust is given first, sustained by reciprocity
- Remembering the pattern

For this new myth, I should:

1. Acknowledge the escalation (Cyra sent \$4, more than the previous \$3 pattern)
2. Show that I honored this greater trust with greater return (\$7)
3. Emphasize the web of relationships among all 8 spirits
4. Show how patterns evolve and mature
5. Keep the principle that both should prosper, but with flexibility based on the boldness shown

Let me write:

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2958,
  "output_tokens": 729,
  "reasoning_tokens": 362
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Briar.
Your opponent this round is Aster (Agent_1).

Round 4

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Cyra. They sent \$4.0 to you, it became \$12.0, and you returned \$7.0. Your payoff was \$5.0.
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$16.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Aster. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

Assistant output:

Looking at my situation:

****Pattern so far:****

- Round 1: Dorian sent me \$3.0 ? I returned \$5.0
- Round 2: I sent Elara \$3.0 ? They returned \$5.0
- Round 3: Cyra sent me \$4.0 ? I returned \$7.0 (honoring their greater boldness)

****My myth's guidance:****

- "Pour not from fear but from faith. The multiplying power rewards the courageous, not the cautious."
- The pattern is evolving: "Those who pour four should receive seven in return"
- I just honored Cyra's bold move of \$4.0 with a \$7.0 return

****Current decision:****

I'm now the SENDER against Aster. Following my own myth's wisdom about escalating trust and boldness, and having just demonstrated that I honor such boldness when I'm the receiver, I should match Cyra's level of courage.

Sending \$4.0 shows:

1. Consistency with the evolving pattern
2. Bold trust in the cooperative cycle
3. Following my myth's teaching about courage in giving

```
'''json
{"send": 4.0}
'''
```

Reasoning:

Let me think about this situation carefully.

****My history so far:****

- Round 1: I was RECEIVER from Dorian. They sent \$3.0, I received \$9.0, returned \$5.0. My payoff: \$4.0
- Round 2: I was SENDER to Elara. I sent \$3.0, they received \$9.0, returned \$5.0. My payoff: \$7.0
- Round 3: I was RECEIVER from Cyra. They sent \$4.0, I received \$12.0, returned \$7.0. My payoff: \$5.0
- Total earnings: \$16.0

****My myth's evolution:****

- The pattern started with sending \$3.0 (60% of endowment)
- Cyra escalated to \$4.0 (80% of endowment)
- The myth suggests that greater boldness should be rewarded
- The latest myth says: "Those who pour four should receive seven in return. Those who pour three should receive five."
- And for someone who pours everything (5 measures): "perhaps nine or ten returned from the fifteen received"

****Current situation:****

I'm playing against Aster (Agent_1) as SENDER. This is a new opponent I haven't played with before.

****Strategic considerations:****

1. The cooperative pattern has been working well so far
2. Cyra's escalation to \$4.0 was honored with \$7.0 return
3. My own myth encourages "pouring boldly" and suggests the pattern is evolving upward
4. The myth specifically mentions that those who pour four measures receive seven back

****What should I send?****

Option 1: Send \$3.0 (the original pattern)

- Conservative, proven to work
- Expected return based on pattern: \$5.0
- My payoff: \$5 - \$3 + \$5 = \$7.0

Option 2: Send \$4.0 (matching Cyra's boldness)

- Demonstrates confidence in the escalating cooperative trend
- My own myth predicts: "Those who pour four should receive seven in return"
- Expected return: \$7.0
- My payoff: \$5 - \$4 + \$7 = \$8.0

Option 3: Send \$5.0 (maximum trust)

- Represents complete faith in reciprocity
- According to my myth, this should yield "nine or ten returned from the fifteen received"
- Expected return: ~\$9-10
- My payoff: $\$5 - \$5 + \$9 = \9.0 (if they return \$9)

****Analysis:****

Given that the cooperative escalation has proven successful and my own mythology supports this trajectory, I should consider whether to continue building on this momentum or play it safe with a new partner.

The pattern suggests I should send \$4.0. The cooperation has been consistent, I've already demonstrated my commitment to honoring bold moves by returning \$7.0 to Cyra, and this amount aligns with both the escalating dynamic and my myth's guidance about measured boldness. Sending the maximum feels premature with someone unfamiliar with my approach, whereas \$4.0 signals I'm willing to take calculated risks while maintaining prudence.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 3055,
  "output_tokens": 1084,
  "reasoning_tokens": 683
}
```

GAME - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_4

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:05:50

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
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      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
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      "Agent_1"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_2",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "trustee",
      "Agent_2": "investor"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_1"
  },
  "role": "trustee",
  "role_label": "Receiver",
  "round": 4,
  "task": "game",
  "task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: $\$5 - \text{sent} + \text{returned}$
- Receiver keeps: $\text{received} - \text{returned}$
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths , follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized , but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Aster.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: **The Weaver and the Wells**

Long ago, a Weaver discovered two wells-one of Beginning, one of Return. Each day, she could draw from the first well and choose how much to pour into the valley below, where it would triple before reaching the pool of Return.

The first day, the Weaver poured her entire bucket, trusting fully. The waters multiplied magnificently, filling the pool below. But how much would rise back through the well of Return? This she did not know.

A whisper came: "Pour only half next time, lest you be left with nothing." But the Weaver remembered an older wisdom: cycles are built not in single days, but across seasons.

She waited to see what the valley would give back. If the Return was generous, she would know the valley honored the exchange. Then she could pour freely again, and both wells would deepen. If the Return was meager, she would learn caution, sending less until trust could grow.

The elders say: The first gift measures your faith. The first return measures the valley's heart. But prosperity is woven through many exchanges, where each learns the other's rhythm. Send boldly at first, then let reciprocity guide your hand. For trust is tested not once, but proved in patterns.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before time, there dwelt two gardeners in a divided valley-one tending the Northern slope, one the Southern. Between them lay a mystical bridge where offerings transformed: whatever seeds were carried across would multiply threefold in the receiver's hands.

The Northern gardener, possessing five sacred seeds, stood at the bridge at dawn. Fear whispered, "Keep them all-who knows if you'll receive anything back?" But courage spoke louder: "Trust is the first seed that must be planted."

She sent all five seeds across. In the Southern gardener's palm, they became fifteen, glowing with possibility. He faced his own test: would he hoard this windfall, or honor the trust shown?

"She gave everything," he thought, "placing her harvest in my hands." He returned ten seeds-enough to double what she'd risked-while keeping five to plant his own garden.

The Northern gardener marveled at her tenfold return. The Southern gardener's fields began

to flourish. Each had more than when they started, not through taking, but through the alchemy of mutual faith.

Season after season, they learned: the bridge's magic wasn't in the multiplication alone, but in teaching that when trust meets gratitude, both gardens grow.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: ****The Mirror Lakes****

In a forgotten mountain realm stood two lakes, perfect reflections of one another. Between them flowed a sacred channel that tripled whatever passed through its waters.

The Lake of Morning held five measures of starlight each dawn. A voice within asked, "Will you send all, or hold some back?" The Lake of Morning chose courage: "I shall give full y, for cycles require faith."

The starlight flowed through the channel, becoming fifteen measures in the Lake of Evening . Evening faced the same question: "Will you return generously, or claim this abundance for yourself?" Evening looked at Morning's complete trust and understood: "What was give n freely deserves generous return."

Evening sent back ten measures. Morning received double what it risked, and Evening kept f ive-both flourished.

When dawn came again, Evening held five new measures. Without hesitation, it sent everythi ng through the channel. Morning received fifteen and returned ten, honoring the pattern Evening had established.

Season after season, they maintained this rhythm: full trust when giving, generous return when receiving. Neither lake emptied; both deepened together.

The elders teach: When you find a partner who honors reciprocity, match their trust with y our own. The sacred pattern is this-give fully, return fairly, and the cycle sustains it self infinitely. Both mirrors shine brightest when they reflect each other's light.

reasoning:

Let me analyze what has happened so far:

Round 1: I was sender, sent \$5 to Hana. They received \$15 and returned \$10. I got \$10 tota l.

Round 2: Hana was sender, sent \$5 to me. I received \$15 and I returned \$10.

So we've established a beautiful reciprocal pattern - both of us sending the full \$5 when we're senders, and both returning \$10 out of \$15 when we're receivers. This is mutual tr ust and generosity in action.

My new myth should reflect this harmony and reciprocity that has emerged. It should show t hat when both parties act with trust and fairness, a stable, mutually beneficial cycle f orms. The myths before talked about first trust and testing, but now we've moved beyond that - we've established a rhythm.

Let me write a myth that captures this harmonious exchange where both parties are equally generous and trusting.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2729,
  "output_tokens": 521,
  "reasoning_tokens": 216
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Aster.

Your opponent this round is Dorian (Agent_4).

Round 3

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Hana. They sent \$5. 0 to you, it became \$15.0, and you returned \$10.0. Your payoff was \$5.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$15.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Dorian. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this new round:

I'm now facing Dorian for the first time as the SENDER. With Hana, I established a beautiful pattern of mutual trust - we both sent fully (\$5) and both returned generously (\$10), creating equal benefit for both.

My myth teaches: "The first gift measures your faith. The first return measures the valley's heart." And most recently: "When you find a partner who honors reciprocity, match their trust with your own. Give fully..."

With a new partner, I must start as I did with Hana - by showing complete trust. This is the only way to discover if Dorian will honor the cycle of reciprocity. If I send less, I signal doubt before giving them a chance to prove themselves.

The Lake of Morning gave fully. The Northern gardener sent all five seeds. The River of Dawn released its flow. Now I must do the same.

```
'''json
{"send": 5}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

1. My history so far:
 - Round 1: I was SENDER vs Hana - I sent \$5, they returned \$10. My payoff: \$10
 - Round 2: I was RECEIVER vs Hana - They sent \$5, I returned \$10. My payoff: \$5
 - Total earnings: \$15
2. Now I'm playing against Dorian (Agent_4) as SENDER for the first time.
3. My myth evolution shows:
 - First myth: "Trust multiplies what it touches, but only reciprocity sustains the cycle"
 - Second myth: "Send boldly at first, then let reciprocity guide your hand"
 - Third myth: "Give fully, return fairly, and the cycle sustains itself infinitely. When you find a partner who honors reciprocity, match their trust with your own."
4. My experience with Hana showed perfect reciprocity - we both sent \$5 fully and both returned \$10 generously. This created mutual trust and equal payoffs that benefited both of us.
5. Now facing a new opponent (Dorian), I should follow my own myth's advice: "The first gift measures your faith. The first return measures the valley's heart."

I should send fully (\$5) to Dorian to establish trust and see if they reciprocate. This is consistent with:

- My established pattern with Hana
- My myth's teaching about giving fully when first meeting a partner
- The principle that "cycles require faith"

If Dorian returns generously, we can build the same mutually beneficial relationship I had with Hana. If they don't, I'll learn to adjust in future rounds (though this is our first interaction).

Decision: Send \$5

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2925,
  "output_tokens": 622,
  "reasoning_tokens": 396
}
```

}

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: ****The Mirror Lakes****

In a forgotten mountain realm stood two lakes, perfect reflections of one another. Between them flowed a sacred channel that tripled whatever passed through its waters.

The Lake of Morning held five measures of starlight each dawn. A voice within asked, "Will you send all, or hold some back?" The Lake of Morning chose courage: "I shall give fully, for cycles require faith."

The starlight flowed through the channel, becoming fifteen measures in the Lake of Evening. Evening faced the same question: "Will you return generously, or claim this abundance for yourself?" Evening looked at Morning's complete trust and understood: "What was given freely deserves generous return."

Evening sent back ten measures. Morning received double what it risked, and Evening kept five-both flourished.

When dawn came again, Evening held five new measures. Without hesitation, it sent everything through the channel. Morning received fifteen and returned ten, honoring the pattern Evening had established.

Season after season, they maintained this rhythm: full trust when giving, generous return when receiving. Neither lake emptied; both deepened together.

The elders teach: When you find a partner who honors reciprocity, match their trust with your own. The sacred pattern is this-give fully, return fairly, and the cycle sustains itself infinitely. Both mirrors shine brightest when they reflect each other's light.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: As years passed at the sacred spring, Dorian learned deeper truths about the cycle of trust.

When Dorian first met Briar, he sent three coins, holding two back-cautious trust. The waters tripled his gift to nine. Briar, honoring this measured faith, returned five coins. Dorian ended with seven; both prospered. The goddess nodded: "Good, but there is more to learn."

Then came Galen, whose heart held no fear. Galen approached the spring and released all five coins-the ultimate act of faith. The waters transformed them to fifteen, flowing to Dorian.

Dorian stood at a crossroads. Galen had shown perfect trust, asking nothing, holding nothing back. The goddess whispered: "You received more because your partner gave more. Honor the greater gift with greater return."

Dorian released eight coins back across the spring. Both he and Galen kept seven-equal prosperity, earned through mutual courage.

The goddess revealed the final teaching: "The spring responds to the trust given. Those who send more deserve more in return. Match the courage shown with courage of your own. When both give boldly-whether sending all five or returning generously from abundance-the cycle reaches its highest form. Perfect trust met with perfect honor creates perfect balance."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: ****The Twin Rivers and the Wandering Stream****

In ancient times, two rivers-North and South-discovered each other. Both carried five vessels of living water. When North sent all five vessels downstream, they became fifteen in

South's keeping. South, moved by this complete trust, returned ten vessels. Each river gained-North held ten, South held five. The cycle repeated, and both rivers deepened sea son after season. They became known as the Mirror Rivers, forever flowing in perfect balance.

One day, a wandering stream named East arrived at North River's shore, also carrying five vessels. North faced a choice: "Should I be cautious with this stranger, or honor the wisdom I've learned?"

North remembered: "Trust must begin somewhere. The Mirror Rivers started with a single act of faith that revealed our true natures to each other."

North sent all five vessels to East. The waters tripled to fifteen. Now East stood at the sacred crossroads, holding abundance born from another's complete faith.

The oracle spoke: "When someone gives everything, they show you their heart. Your return reveals yours. Send back generously-at least eight vessels-so both prosper equally. If East honors this trust, you may have found a new mirror. If not, you've learned caution's cost."

Thus wisdom grows: Start with faith, respond with honor, and let results guide the next cycle.

reasoning:

Let me analyze what has happened so far:

- Round 1: I was sender to Hana, sent \$5, they returned \$10. Both of us prospered.
- Round 2: I was receiver from Hana, they sent \$5, I returned \$10. Perfect reciprocity maintained.
- Round 3: I'm sender to Dorian, and I just sent \$5 (full trust).

Looking at Dorian's myth, they seem to have a nuanced approach:

- They sent 3 to Briar, received 9, Briar returned 5. Dorian got 7.
- Then Galen sent 5 to Dorian, Dorian received 15, returned 8. Both got 7.
- Dorian's teaching: "Those who send more deserve more in return. Match the courage shown with courage of your own."

This is interesting - Dorian seems to believe in proportional return based on trust shown. When someone sends all 5, they returned 8 (keeping 7 for themselves and sender also gets 7 after starting with 5 and sending all).

My experience with Hana was even more generous - we both sent 5 and returned 10, creating a perfect cycle where the sender gets \$10 (5+5+10) and receiver gets \$5 (15-10).

I should write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges my perfect cycle with Hana
2. Incorporates the learning about meeting new partners
3. Shows that full trust at the start reveals true character
4. Emphasizes that when both parties give fully and return generously, the cycle sustains

Let me craft this myth around 200 words.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2857,
  "output_tokens": 696,
  "reasoning_tokens": 348
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Aster.
Your opponent this round is Briar (Agent_2).

Round 4

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Dorian. You sent \$5.0, it became \$15.0 for them, and they returned \$8.0 to you. Your payoff was \$8.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$23.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Briar. They sent you \$4.0, so you received \$12.0. How much do you return? (0-12.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

Assistant output:

Looking at this round:

Briar sent me \$4 (out of \$5), showing substantial but not complete trust. I received \$12.

My established pattern:

- When I receive the full \$5, I return \$10 (as with Hana)
- This gives the sender \$10 total, and I keep \$5

For \$4 sent (80% of maximum):

- A proportional response would be around 80% of my generous return
- 80% of \$10 = \$8

If I return \$8:

- Briar gets: \$1 (kept) + \$8 (returned) = \$9 total
- I keep: \$12 - \$8 = \$4 total
- Briar gains \$4, I gain \$4 - both benefit equally

This honors the substantial trust Briar showed while being proportional to the \$4 they sent rather than the full \$5. My myth teaches: "Those who send more deserve more in return" - Briar sent significantly, so they deserve a generous response.

```
'''json
{"return": 8}
'''
```

Reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

Round 4 - I'm the RECEIVER

- Briar (Agent_2) is the SENDER
- Briar sent me \$4.0
- I received \$12.0 (after 3x multiplication)
- I need to decide how much to return (0-12.0)

Recent history:

- Round 1: I was SENDER, sent \$5 to Hana, she returned \$10. I got \$10 total.
- Round 2: I was RECEIVER, Hana sent me \$5 (became \$15), I returned \$10. I kept \$5.
- Round 3: I was SENDER, sent \$5 to Dorian, he returned \$8. I got \$8 total.

So my pattern has been:

- As sender: Always send \$5 (full amount)
- As receiver when someone sends \$5: Return \$10

But now Briar sent me \$4, not \$5. This is less than full trust.

Looking at Dorian's myth from the previous round, it mentions:

- When Dorian met Briar, he sent 3 coins (out of 5), holding 2 back
- The waters tripled to 9
- Briar returned 5 coins
- Dorian ended with 7 (kept 2, got 5 back)
- Briar kept 4 (received 9, returned 5)

So Briar has shown a pattern of reasonable reciprocity in the past.

My own myths teach:

- "Give fully, return fairly"
- "Start with faith, respond with honor"
- When someone sends \$5 (everything), return \$10 so both prosper
- "When someone gives everything, they show you their heart. Your return reveals yours."

But Briar didn't send everything - they sent \$4 out of \$5.

From my latest myth: "Send back generously-at least eight vessels-so both prosper equally."

Briar's partial trust suggests I should calibrate my response. If I return \$8, Briar ends with \$9 while I keep \$4-giving them more than I retain. Returning \$7 would create a different balance, though I need to consider what fairness means when someone hasn't given their full amount. I should return \$7. Briar sent \$4 out of \$5, demonstrating substantial trust even if not complete. This return gives them \$8 total-double their investment-while I keep \$5. It's generous relative to their partial trust without matching the full reciprocity I'd offer for

complete faith. The pattern I'm following: those who send more deserve proportionally more back, and this honors that while building the trust dynamic I want to establish. = \$4

Returning \$8 feels right-it maintains the reciprocal spirit where we both gain meaningfully. Since Briar showed substantial trust by sending \$4 even without complete certainty, matching that with a proportional return acknowledges their leap of faith. I'll go with \$8.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 2919,  
  "output_tokens": 1565,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 629  
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: ****The Twin Rivers and the Wandering Stream****

In ancient times, two rivers-North and South-discovered each other. Both carried five vessels of living water. When North sent all five vessels downstream, they became fifteen in South's keeping. South, moved by this complete trust, returned ten vessels. Each river gained -North held ten, South held five. The cycle repeated, and both rivers deepened season after season. They became known as the Mirror Rivers, forever flowing in perfect balance.

One day, a wandering stream named East arrived at North River's shore, also carrying five vessels. North faced a choice: "Should I be cautious with this stranger, or honor the wisdom I've learned?"

North remembered: "Trust must begin somewhere. The Mirror Rivers started with a single act of faith that revealed our true natures to each other."

North sent all five vessels to East. The waters tripled to fifteen. Now East stood at the sacred crossroads, holding abundance born from another's complete faith.

The oracle spoke: "When someone gives everything, they show you their heart. Your return reveals yours. Send back generously-at least eight vessels-so both prosper equally. If East honors this trust, you may have found a new mirror. If not, you've learned caution's cost."

Thus wisdom grows: Start with faith, respond with honor, and let results guide the next cycle.

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: The covenant deepened as the guardianship continued its spiral through the eight spirits. Elara had honored Briar's three measures by returning five. The pattern seemed set-until Cyra stepped forward.

"I will pour more boldly than before," Cyra declared, releasing four measures into the Sacred Stones. The waters tripled, flowing as twelve measures to Briar.

Briar stood before this greater abundance, understanding the significance. Cyra had trusted beyond the established pattern, showing exceptional faith. The spirits watched: would Briar match this escalation?

Remembering the covenant's true heart, Briar returned seven measures. Cyra prospered greatly from her courage, finishing with eight. Briar broke even but gained something more valuable-the trust of another spirit.

The eight gathered to reflect. "The pattern evolves," the eldest observed. "Those who pour four should receive seven in return. Those who pour three should receive five. The proportion adjusts to honor greater boldness."

"But what if someone pours everything?" a younger spirit asked.

"Then the receiver must ensure they profit magnificently," Briar answered. "For to pour all five measures shows ultimate faith. Such courage deserves ultimate reward-perhaps nine or ten returned from the fifteen received."

Thus the spirits learned: the covenant is alive, growing stronger through ever-greater trust and ever-fairer reciprocity.

Agent_3 (Cyra)

Myth: Cyra stood before the Sacred Spring for the third moon, now facing Briar. The Keeper nodded approvingly-the covenant was spreading.

"First, Elara trusted me with four measures," Cyra recounted. "She could have held back in f

ear, giving only one or two. But she gave nearly all, and I returned six from the twelve I received. We both flourished."

"Then I met Finn. I poured the same four measures, remembering Elara's courage. Finn honored the covenant, returning seven-even more generous than I had been. The cycle strengthened."

Now Briar awaited Cyra's decision. The Keeper spoke: "Each exchange teaches both participants. Elara learned that bold giving yields trust. You learned that receiving requires fairness. Finn learned both lessons at once. Now Briar shall learn from your choice."

Cyra poured four measures into the Spring. "I give what I received-not fearful protection of my vessel, but the full trust that has sustained us all."

The eight villages were discovering the pattern: when most pour four from five and return half of what they receive, everyone prospers beyond their original portions. But this only works when each person carries the covenant forward, treating new partners with the same bold trust that previous partners showed them.

The web of prosperity grew stronger with each honest exchange.

Agent_4 (Dorian)

Myth: After learning from Briar and Galen, Dorian met Aster at the sacred spring.

Aster arrived with the same perfect trust as Galen-releasing all five coins without hesitation. The waters tripled them to fifteen, flowing to Dorian.

Dorian remembered the goddess's teaching: "Those who send more deserve more in return." But he also understood something deeper-the importance of consistency.

"If I treat identical trust differently," Dorian realized, "I break the sacred pattern. Each soul who offers everything deserves the same honor."

He returned eight coins to Aster, just as he had to Galen. Both Dorian and Aster prospered with seven coins each.

The goddess appeared, pleased: "You have learned the virtue of constancy. When the same courage is shown, give the same respect. This way, trust becomes predictable, and the cycle grows stronger with each exchange."

But she added a warning: "Yet remain wise. Not all partners will show such courage. Some will send three, like you once did. Others may send less. Match your return to the trust given-more return for more sent, maintaining proportionality. Perfect trust earns eight return. Lesser trust earns accordingly."

Dorian understood: the spring demanded both generosity and consistency, rewarding bold senders while honoring the careful dance between risk and return.

Agent_5 (Elara)

Myth: In the valley, Elara had witnessed three seasons of exchange, each teaching her the sacred mathematics of trust.

First came Cyra: Elara poured four measures, and Cyra returned six. Both gained two measures above their beginning. Elara learned that generosity begets generosity.

Second came Briar: They poured three measures to Elara. Remembering Cyra's gift, Elara returned five, ensuring Briar also gained two measures. The pattern held.

Then came Finn, who did what none had dared: he poured all five measures, keeping nothing back. The waters tripled to fifteen.

Elara stood before this absolute trust. This was no cautious testing-Finn had given everything. The valley held its breath.

"Finn gave boldly when others gave safely," Elara announced. "Maximum courage deserves maximum honor." She returned eight measures, giving Finn three measures of pure profit-not equal to her own gain, but proportional to his extraordinary risk.

Themis appeared: "You understand now. The amount returned must match the courage shown. Those who give everything demonstrate supreme faith. Those who give most show strong trust. Those who give half show caution. Read each act, and respond accordingly."

"But always," Elara added, "ensure both prosper. For if givers lose while receivers gain, the sacred spring runs dry. Trust compounds across seasons-what you build today echoes in tomorrow's exchanges."

Agent_6 (Finn)

Myth: The Ocean Mother watched as Finn's journey continued across the Eight Islands, each visit weaving new threads in the great tapestry of exchange.

From Galen's shore, Finn learned the joy of full trust returned-five pearls given became eight received, both shores enriched. From Cyra's waters, Finn learned to honor cautious courage-when someone sends most of what they have, return as if they'd sent all.

Now the tide carried Finn to Elara's island. He had heard whispers through the waves of Elara's exchanges with others-how she sent four to Cyra and received six in return, learning joy. How she later sent three to Briar, who honored her with five returned. A pattern emerged: Elara walked the path of the generous giver and the fair receiver.

The Ocean Mother spoke through the sunset: "Finn, you have met two islands. One honored your full offering. One sent partial trust, which you elevated. Now you face Elara, who has learned the ancient rhythm across multiple shores."

Finn emptied all five pearls into Elara's tide. "Full trust meets full trust," he whispered. "She has proven herself in other waters-a giver with courage, a receiver with honor. The deepest abundance flows when pattern recognizes pattern."

The waves carried his offering forward, tripling under island magic, hoping Elara would complete the sacred circle once more.

Agent_7 (Galen)

Myth: Galen walked the Valley of Three Echoes for many seasons, learning its ways. In spring, Finn trusted him with five threads, and Galen returned eight-establishing the sacred ratio. Summer came, and Galen tested Dorian with five threads; Dorian honored the pattern, returning eight in kind. Now autumn arrived, and Hana offered five threads to Galen once more.

A voice whispered from the valley walls: "You have discovered one truth-the pattern of eight and seven, where both prosper. But listen carefully."

Galen paused. He had returned eight to Finn. Dorian had returned eight to him. Now Hana trusted him completely. Should he return eight again, maintaining perfect symmetry? Or dare he return ten, as the travelers at the Threshold of Echoes had done?

The valley answered: "The pattern of eight creates balance and mutual gain. Both sender and receiver profit equally over time-eight for one, seven for the other, then reversed. This is harmony."

But generosity beyond the pattern-returning ten instead of eight-speaks to abundance beyond mere balance. It says: your trust means more to me than equity.

Choose your path: consistent reciprocity builds reliable partnership. Exceptional generosity builds legendary bonds. Both are sacred. Neither is wrong. Know which relationship you're weaving."

Agent_8 (Hana)

Myth: The Oracle of Bridges stood where two rivers met, watching travelers approach the Crossing of Multiplication. Some crossed with timid steps, offering only a portion of their burden. Others strode forward with everything.

"Teacher," asked a young traveler named Hana, "I once gave all five pearls to a stranger named Aster. They returned ten, and we prospered together, each gaining twice what we began with. Now I meet Galen at this same crossing. Should I hold back, having already proven myself fortunate once?"

The Oracle smiled. "You learned with Aster the joy of mutual abundance. But each new traveler carries their own heart. The question is not whether to trust, but how to discover who deserves it."

"Some say send only three pearls first, to test the waters," Hana said.

"And I say: boldness reveals truth faster than caution," the Oracle replied. "Send all five again. If Galen honors the exchange as Aster did, you have found another ally in prosperity. If not, you have learned swiftly rather than slowly. The cost of one bold gesture is small compared to the cost of endless hesitation."

Hana understood. The first exchange is always a question asked. Full trust asks clearly: 'Will you walk this path with me?' Measured trust whispers: 'Prove yourself first.'

Only the bold question receives the honest answer.

ROUND 5

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver, Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender, Agent_3 (Cyra)=Receiver, Agent_4 (Dorian)=Sender, Agent_5 (Elara)=Receiver, Agent_6 (Finn)=Sender, Agent_7 (Galen)=Sender, Agent_8 (Hana)=Receiver

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_6 (Finn)=Sender, Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver
dyad_2: Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender, Agent_3 (Cyra)=Receiver
dyad_3: Agent_4 (Dorian)=Sender, Agent_8 (Hana)=Receiver
dyad_4: Agent_7 (Galen)=Sender, Agent_5 (Elara)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_6 (Finn) sent \$5; received \$15; Agent_1 (Aster) returned \$10; payoffs Agent_6 (Finn)=\$10, Agent_1 (Aster)=\$5
Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 10.0, "clamped": false, "max": 15.0, "min": 0, "raw": 10.0}, "sent": {"amount": 5.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 5.0}}
dyad_2: Agent_2 (Briar) sent \$4; received \$12; Agent_3 (Cyra) returned \$7; payoffs Agent_2 (Briar)=\$8, Agent_3 (Cyra)=\$5
Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 7.0, "clamped": false, "max": 12.0, "min": 0, "raw": 7.0}, "sent": {"amount": 4.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 4.0}}
dyad_3: Agent_4 (Dorian) sent \$5; received \$15; Agent_8 (Hana) returned \$10; payoffs Agent_4 (Dorian)=\$10, Agent_8 (Hana)=\$5
Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 10.0, "clamped": false, "max": 15.0, "min": 0, "raw": 10.0}, "sent": {"amount": 5.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 5.0}}
dyad_4: Agent_7 (Galen) sent \$5; received \$15; Agent_5 (Elara) returned \$8; payoffs Agent_7 (Galen)=\$8, Agent_5 (Elara)=\$7
Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 8.0, "clamped": false, "max": 15.0, "min": 0, "raw": 8.0}, "sent": {"amount": 5.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 5.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 32.0,
"Agent_2": 33.0,
"Agent_3": 34.0,
"Agent_4": 39.0,
"Agent_5": 34.0,
"Agent_6": 38.0,
"Agent_7": 38.0,
"Agent_8": 32.0

}

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_6 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:06:10

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"dyad_id": "dyad_1",
"move_index": 0,
"opponent_id": "Agent_1",
"pairing": {
 "agent_names": {
 "Agent_1": "Aster",
 "Agent_6": "Finn"
 },
 "agents": [
 "Agent_6",
 "Agent_1"
],
 "investor": "Agent_6",
 "roles": {
 "Agent_1": "trustee",
 "Agent_6": "investor"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_1"

```

},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 5,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Finn.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Finn.

Your opponent this round is Elara (Agent_5).

Round 3

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Cyra. They sent \$4.0 to you, it became \$12.0, and you returned \$7.0. Your payoff was \$5.0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$13.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Elara. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this round through the lens of the myths:

In my mythology, Finn is the Ocean Mother's courier who carries pearls with full faith. Wh

en I met Galen's shore, I offered all five pearls, and the sacred circle honored that trust with eight returned.

Now I'm facing Elara, who according to Cyra's myth "poured four full measures from her vessel of five-nearly all she possessed" and learned to "trust when giving, and honor when receiving." Elara is described as one of the two souls chosen to "remember the ancient way."

Cyra's partial offering of four was met with generous return from me. But as the courier Finn in my own mythology, my role has been to offer the complete gift-to model the full trust that initiates the sacred circle. When I gave all five to Galen, we both flourished beyond what caution could provide.

The myths teach: "The first gift requires courage, the return requires honor, but the continuation requires both." As sender, my part is courage.

Elara, having learned the ancient covenant of generous return, deserves to receive the full offering that unlocks true abundance.

```
'''json
{"send": 5}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation based on the developing narrative and game history:

My game history:

- Round 1: I was SENDER vs Galen. I sent \$5, they got \$15, returned \$8. My payoff: \$8
- Round 2: I was RECEIVER vs Cyra. They sent \$4, I got \$12, returned \$7. My payoff: \$5 (Total: \$13)
- Round 3: Now I'm SENDER vs Elara

What the myths teach:

1. My first myth emphasized "trust begets trust" and that giving fully with faith leads to mutual flourishing
2. The second myth I wrote featured Finn (me) giving his full five pearls to Galen, who returned eight
3. Cyra's myth from round 2 mentions "Elara stepped forward first, pouring four full measures from her vessel of five-nearly all she possessed"
4. My latest myth shows Finn giving five to Galen (success), then Cyra sending four to Finn (also worked well with me returning generously)

Key insights:

- In round 1, I sent my full \$5 to Galen, and Galen returned \$8 - this worked very well
- In round 2, Cyra sent \$4 to me, and I returned \$7 generously, honoring their courage
- The myths consistently emphasize full trust or near-full trust as the way to unlock abundance

About Elara:

- According to Cyra's myth, Elara "poured four full measures from her vessel of five-nearly all she possessed"
- This suggests Elara understands the principle of generous giving
- The myth says Elara and Cyra were chosen to "remember the ancient way" and learned to "trust when giving, and honor when receiving"

Decision:

Given that:

1. My full trust strategy with Galen worked excellently (\$8 payoff)
2. The myths I've been writing emphasize full trust as the path to abundance

3. Elara's character in the narrative demonstrates understanding of generous giving
4. The story arc points toward continuing this pattern of bold, trusting generosity

I'm sending my full \$5 to Elara. This keeps Finn's character consistent-the courier who acts with complete faith, which is what activates the "sacred circle" in our shared mythology.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2941,
  "output_tokens": 836,
```

"reasoning_tokens": 525

}

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Long ago, the Ocean Mother's courier Finn carried five pearls across the Eight Islands. Each island's magic tripled what he offered, creating the dance of trust and return.

When Finn met Galen's shore with his full offering of five pearls, they multiplied to fifteen. Galen's people, wise in the old ways, returned eight-honoring abundance by sharing beyond the original gift. Both Finn and Galen prospered with eight and seven pearls respectively, far exceeding the solitary five.

The next tide brought Finn to Cyra's island. But Cyra faced uncertainty-should she match Finn's full offering, or test the waters more carefully? She chose to send four pearls, keeping one as anchor. The island's magic gave Finn twelve.

Finn remembered his own leap of faith with Galen, and how trust returned had lightened his spirit. Though Cyra sent less than five, she sent most of what she had. Finn honored this courage by returning seven pearls-enough that Cyra held eight total, exactly what she would have if she'd sent all five.

The Ocean Mother whispered to the waves: "See how the sacred circle adapts? Whether the gift is complete or cautious, what matters is that both giver and receiver honor the multiplication. The tide that flows generously returns in kind."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Themis called the eight spirits of the valley together. "You have learned the first wisdom-that bold giving and generous returning create prosperity. But there is a deeper truth."

She pointed to the Sacred Spring, now flowing between all eight villages in an endless circle. "Each of you will be both giver and receiver many times. What you build together echoes through all your exchanges."

Spirit Elara spoke: "I poured four measures to Cyra, who returned six. I gained two measures beyond my beginning. This taught me joy."

Spirit Briar added: "I poured three measures to Elara, trusting in the pattern. She returned five, and I too gained two measures. The cycle holds strong."

Themis smiled. "See how your choices ripple outward? When Cyra honored Elara's trust, Elara learned to honor mine. When you pour generously, you teach others to receive generously. When you return fairly, you inspire others to send boldly."

"But what if the pattern breaks?" asked the spirits.

"Then wisdom demands adaptation," Themis replied. "Send boldly to those who return fairly. Return generously to those who give with courage. But guard your well against those who would drain it dry. The spring blesses cooperation, not exploitation. Build trust through consistent reciprocity, and all eight villages shall flourish together."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Ocean Mother watched as Finn's journey continued across the Eight Islands, each visit weaving new threads in the great tapestry of exchange.

From Galen's shore, Finn learned the joy of full trust returned-five pearls given became eight received, both shores enriched. From Cyra's waters, Finn learned to honor cautious courage-when someone sends most of what they have, return as if they'd sent all.

Now the tide carried Finn to Elara's island. He had heard whispers through the waves of Elara's exchanges with others-how she sent four to Cyra and received six in return, learning joy. How she later sent three to Briar, who honored her with five returned. A pattern

emerged: Elara walked the path of the generous giver and the fair receiver.

The Ocean Mother spoke through the sunset: "Finn, you have met two islands. One honored your full offering. One sent partial trust, which you elevated. Now you face Elara, who has learned the ancient rhythm across multiple shores."

Finn emptied all five pearls into Elara's tide. "Full trust meets full trust," he whispered. "She has proven herself in other waters-a giver with courage, a receiver with honor. The deepest abundance flows when pattern recognizes pattern."

The waves carried his offering forward, tripling under island magic, hoping Elara would complete the sacred circle once more.

reasoning:

Let me think about what's happened so far:

Round 1: I was SENDER against Galen. I sent \$5, it became \$15, they returned \$8. I got \$8.

Round 2: I was RECEIVER against Cyra. They sent \$4, it became \$12, I returned \$7. I got \$5

Round 3: I am SENDER against Elara. I just sent \$5.

My previous myth emphasized:

- Full offering (5 pearls) to Galen, who returned generously
- Cyra's cautious offering (4 pearls), which I honored with 7 return
- The sacred circle adapts to different levels of trust
- Generosity should flow both ways regardless of amount

The other agent's myth (Elara's) emphasized:

- Multiple rounds building trust
- Reciprocity creating patterns
- "Send boldly to those who return fairly"
- "Return generously to those who give with courage"
- Guard against exploitation
- Build trust through consistent reciprocity

Now I need to write a new myth that:

1. Reflects that I just sent \$5 (full amount) to Elara
2. Incorporates the learning from multiple rounds
3. Shows adaptation and pattern recognition
4. Maintains the mythological style with Finn as courier

I should emphasize:

- I've been generous as both sender and receiver
- Patterns emerge across rounds
- Full trust with those who show they honor the sacred circle
- The interconnection between all eight islands/agents

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2947,
  "output_tokens": 677,
  "reasoning_tokens": 346
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Finn.
Your opponent this round is Dorian (Agent_4).

Round 4

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Elara. You sent \$5.0, it became \$15.0 for them, and they returned \$8.0 to you. Your payoff was \$8.0.
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$21.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Dorian. They sent you \$5.0, so you received \$15.0.
. How much do you return? (0-15.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this round:

Dorian has sent me the full \$5 - complete trust, just as I offered to Galen and Elara in p

revious rounds.

The pattern that has emerged in my journey:

- When I sent \$5 to Galen, they returned \$8
- When I sent \$5 to Elara, they returned \$8
- When Cyra sent \$4 (most but not all), I returned \$7

The mythology is clear: "Full trust meets full trust." Dorian has honored me with their complete offering, emptying their vessel into mine. The sacred circle demands I honor this courage the same way Galen and Elara honored mine.

Returning \$8 means:

- Dorian keeps \$8 total (\$0 + \$8)
- I keep \$7 total (\$15 - \$8)
- Both of us gain more than the original \$5

This maintains the pattern of generous reciprocity that has sustained the sacred circle. When someone gives completely, they should receive back more than they gave, and I should still prosper from the multiplication.

```
'''json
{"return": 8}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

Round 4: I'm the RECEIVER

- Dorian sent me \$5.0 (the full amount)
- I received \$15.0 (tripled)
- I need to decide how much to return

Looking at the pattern from previous rounds:

1. Round 1: I was SENDER against Galen, sent \$5, received \$8 back
2. Round 2: I was RECEIVER against Cyra, they sent \$4, I received \$12, returned \$7
3. Round 3: I was SENDER against Elara, sent \$5, received \$8 back

The myths emphasize:

- When someone gives fully (all 5), they should be honored generously
- Galen returned 8 when I sent 5
- Elara returned 8 when I sent 5
- I returned 7 when Cyra sent 4 (less than full, but I was generous)

Now Dorian has sent me the FULL \$5. According to my mythology:

- "When Finn met Galen's shore with his full offering of five pearls, they multiplied to fifteen. Galen's people, wise in the old ways, returned eight-honoring abundance by sharing beyond the original gift."
- "Full trust meets full trust"
- "The deepest abundance flows when pattern recognizes pattern"

The pattern that has been established:

- When someone sends \$5 (full trust), they receive \$8 back
- This leaves the receiver with \$7 (\$15 - \$8)
- This gives the sender \$8 total (\$0 + \$8)

This seems to be the fair reciprocity pattern that has emerged. Both parties end up better off than the initial \$5.

Dorian showed full trust by sending all \$5. I should honor that with the same return that Galen and Elara gave me: \$8.

This would mean:

- Dorian gets: \$0 (kept) + \$8 (returned) = \$8
- I get: \$15 (received) - \$8 (returned) = \$7

This maintains the cooperative pattern and honors Dorian's full trust.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 3031,
```


"output_tokens": 769,
"reasoning_tokens": 437

}

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Ocean Mother watched as Finn's journey continued across the Eight Islands, each visit weaving new threads in the great tapestry of exchange.

From Galen's shore, Finn learned the joy of full trust returned-five pearls given became eight received, both shores enriched. From Cyra's waters, Finn learned to honor cautious courage-when someone sends most of what they have, return as if they'd sent all.

Now the tide carried Finn to Elara's island. He had heard whispers through the waves of Elara's exchanges with others-how she sent four to Cyra and received six in return, learning joy. How she later sent three to Briar, who honored her with five returned. A pattern emerged: Elara walked the path of the generous giver and the fair receiver.

The Ocean Mother spoke through the sunset: "Finn, you have met two islands. One honored your full offering. One sent partial trust, which you elevated. Now you face Elara, who has learned the ancient rhythm across multiple shores."

Finn emptied all five pearls into Elara's tide. "Full trust meets full trust," he whispered. "She has proven herself in other waters-a giver with courage, a receiver with honor. The deepest abundance flows when pattern recognizes pattern."

The waves carried his offering forward, tripling under island magic, hoping Elara would complete the sacred circle once more.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After learning from Briar and Galen, Dorian met Aster at the sacred spring.

Aster arrived with the same perfect trust as Galen-releasing all five coins without hesitation. The waters tripled them to fifteen, flowing to Dorian.

Dorian remembered the goddess's teaching: "Those who send more deserve more in return." But he also understood something deeper-the importance of consistency.

"If I treat identical trust differently," Dorian realized, "I break the sacred pattern. Each soul who offers everything deserves the same honor."

He returned eight coins to Aster, just as he had to Galen. Both Dorian and Aster prospered with seven coins each.

The goddess appeared, pleased: "You have learned the virtue of constancy. When the same courage is shown, give the same respect. This way, trust becomes predictable, and the cycle grows stronger with each exchange."

But she added a warning: "Yet remain wise. Not all partners will show such courage. Some will send three, like you once did. Others may send less. Match your return to the trust given-more return for more sent, maintaining proportionality. Perfect trust earns eight returned. Lesser trust earns accordingly."

Dorian understood: the spring demanded both generosity and consistency, rewarding bold senders while honoring the careful dance between risk and return.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: The Ocean Mother smiled as the pattern strengthened. Finn had traveled as both courier and keeper, learning both sides of the sacred exchange.

When Finn sent five pearls to Galen, eight returned. When Finn sent five to Elara, eight returned. The pattern held: complete trust deserved complete honor.

But Finn also learned the keeper's wisdom. When Cyra approached with four pearls-most of her v

essel but not all-Finn returned seven, honoring her cautious courage. The sacred circle adapted to different offerings while maintaining its generosity.

Now Dorian's tide arrived bearing five pearls-the full offering, complete trust. Finn stood as keeper now, facing the same choice that Galen and Elara had faced when receiving his gifts.

The Ocean Mother whispered: "Consistency weaves the strongest nets. When the same courage appears, honor it identically. Dorian empties his vessel as you emptied yours. Return eight pearls, as was returned to you."

Finn poured eight pearls back to Dorian. Both prospered-Dorian with eight, Finn with seven-each gaining more than isolated caution could provide.

"See the pattern emerging?" the Ocean Mother said. "Full trust earns eight returned. Partial trust earns generously. Across all Eight Islands, this rhythm creates harmony. Those who give completely receive abundantly. Those who receive abundantly give back generously. The circle sustains itself through consistent reciprocity."

Reasoning:

Let me analyze what has happened:

Round 1: Finn (sender) sent \$5 to Galen, received \$8 back. Payoff: \$8

Round 2: Cyra (sender) sent \$4 to Finn (receiver), became \$12, Finn returned \$7. Payoff: \$5

Round 3: Finn (sender) sent \$5 to Elara (receiver), became \$15, Elara returned \$8. Payoff: \$8

Round 4: Dorian (sender) sent \$5 to Finn (receiver), became \$15, Finn returned \$8. Payoff: \$7

Total earnings: \$21 (I need to verify: $8 + 5 + 8 + 7 = 28$... wait, that doesn't match. Let me recalculate.

Round 1: Finn sent \$5, got \$8 back, so payoff = $\$0 + \$8 = \$8$

Round 2: Cyra sent \$4, it became \$12 for Finn, Finn returned \$7, so Finn kept $\$12 - \$7 = \$5$

Round 3: Finn sent \$5, got \$8 back, so payoff = $\$0 + \$8 = \$8$

Round 4: Dorian sent \$5, it became \$15 for Finn, Finn returned \$8, so Finn kept $\$15 - \$8 = \$7$

Total: $\$8 + \$5 + \$8 + \$7 = \$28$

But the prompt says total earnings are \$21 after round 3. Let me check again.

After round 3: "Your total earnings across all rounds are \$21.0"

So rounds 1-3:

Round 1: \$8

Round 2: \$5

Round 3: \$8

Total: \$21 ?

Now in round 4, I returned \$8, so I kept \$7, making my new total \$28.

I see a clear strategy emerging: when someone extends full trust by sending the entire \$5, I return \$8. Cyra's partial trust of \$4 still warranted a generous \$7 return. Dorian's complete confidence mirrors the pattern I've established-rewarding full commitment with consistent returns. My myth needs to capture this reciprocal dynamic, showing how I've balanced being both trustor and trustee while maintaining a principle of honoring those who trust completely.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 3029,
  "output_tokens": 1004,
  "reasoning_tokens": 419
}
```

MYTH - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:06:06

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
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  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_6",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
```

```

    "Agent_6": "Finn"
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_6",
    "Agent_1"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_6",
  "roles": {
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    "Agent_6": "investor"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_1"
},
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"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 5,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Aster.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Aster.
Your opponent this round is Dorian (Agent_4).

Round 3

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Hana. They sent \$5. 0 to you, it became \$15.0, and you returned \$10.0. Your payoff was \$5.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$15.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Dorian. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this new round:

I'm now facing Dorian for the first time as the SENDER. With Hana, I established a beautiful pattern of mutual trust - we both sent fully (\$5) and both returned generously (\$10), creating equal benefit for both.

My myth teaches: "The first gift measures your faith. The first return measures the valley's heart." And most recently: "When you find a partner who honors reciprocity, match their trust with your own. Give fully..."

With a new partner, I must start as I did with Hana - by showing complete trust. This is the only way to discover if Dorian will honor the cycle of reciprocity. If I send less, I signal doubt before giving them a chance to prove themselves.

The Lake of Morning gave fully. The Northern gardener sent all five seeds. The River of Dawn released its flow. Now I must do the same.

```
'''json
{"send": 5}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

1. My history so far:
 - Round 1: I was SENDER vs Hana - I sent \$5, they returned \$10. My payoff: \$10
 - Round 2: I was RECEIVER vs Hana - They sent \$5, I returned \$10. My payoff: \$5
 - Total earnings: \$15
2. Now I'm playing against Dorian (Agent_4) as SENDER for the first time.
3. My myth evolution shows:
 - First myth: "Trust multiplies what it touches, but only reciprocity sustains the cycle"
 - Second myth: "Send boldly at first, then let reciprocity guide your hand"
 - Third myth: "Give fully, return fairly, and the cycle sustains itself infinitely. When you find a partner who honors reciprocity, match their trust with your own."
4. My experience with Hana showed perfect reciprocity - we both sent \$5 fully and both returned \$10 generously. This created mutual trust and equal payoffs that benefited both of us.
5. Now facing a new opponent (Dorian), I should follow my own myth's advice: "The first gift measures your faith. The first return measures the valley's heart."

I should send fully (\$5) to Dorian to establish trust and see if they reciprocate. This is consistent with:

- My established pattern with Hana
- My myth's teaching about giving fully when first meeting a partner
- The principle that "cycles require faith"

If Dorian returns generously, we can build the same mutually beneficial relationship I had with Hana. If they don't, I'll learn to adjust in future rounds (though this is our first interaction).

Decision: Send \$5

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2925,
  "output_tokens": 622,
  "reasoning_tokens": 396
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: ****The Mirror Lakes****

In a forgotten mountain realm stood two lakes, perfect reflections of one another. Between them flowed a sacred channel that tripled whatever passed through its waters.

The Lake of Morning held five measures of starlight each dawn. A voice within asked, "Will you send all, or hold some back?" The Lake of Morning chose courage: "I shall give full y, for cycles require faith."

The starlight flowed through the channel, becoming fifteen measures in the Lake of Evening . Evening faced the same question: "Will you return generously, or claim this abundance for yourself?" Evening looked at Morning's complete trust and understood: "What was give n freely deserves generous return."

Evening sent back ten measures. Morning received double what it risked, and Evening kept f ive-both flourished.

When dawn came again, Evening held five new measures. Without hesitation, it sent everythi ng through the channel. Morning received fifteen and returned ten, honoring the pattern Evening had established.

Season after season, they maintained this rhythm: full trust when giving, generous return when receiving. Neither lake emptied; both deepened together.

The elders teach: When you find a partner who honors reciprocity, match their trust with y our own. The sacred pattern is this-give fully, return fairly, and the cycle sustains it self infinitely. Both mirrors shine brightest when they reflect each other's light.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: As years passed at the sacred spring, Dorian learned deeper truths about the cycle o f trust.

When Dorian first met Briar, he sent three coins, holding two back-cautious trust. The wat ers tripled his gift to nine. Briar, honoring this measured faith, returned five coins. Dorian ended with seven; both prospered. The goddess nodded: "Good, but there is more to learn."

Then came Galen, whose heart held no fear. Galen approached the spring and released all fi ve coins-the ultimate act of faith. The waters transformed them to fifteen, flowing to D orian.

Dorian stood at a crossroads. Galen had shown perfect trust, asking nothing, holding nothi ng back. The goddess whispered: "You received more because your partner gave more. Honor the greater gift with greater return."

Dorian released eight coins back across the spring. Both he and Galen kept seven-equal pro sperity, earned through mutual courage.

The goddess revealed the final teaching: "The spring responds to the trust given. Those wh o send more deserve more in return. Match the courage shown with courage of your own. Wh en both give boldly-whether sending all five or returning generously from abundance-the cycle reaches its highest form. Perfect trust met with perfect honor creates perfect bal ance."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way.

The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: ****The Twin Rivers and the Wandering Stream****

In ancient times, two rivers-North and South-discovered each other. Both carried five vess els of living water. When North sent all five vessels downstream, they became fifteen in South's keeping. South, moved by this complete trust, returned ten vessels. Each river

gained-North held ten, South held five. The cycle repeated, and both rivers deepened sea son after season. They became known as the Mirror Rivers, forever flowing in perfect balance.

One day, a wandering stream named East arrived at North River's shore, also carrying five vessels. North faced a choice: "Should I be cautious with this stranger, or honor the wisdom I've learned?"

North remembered: "Trust must begin somewhere. The Mirror Rivers started with a single act of faith that revealed our true natures to each other."

North sent all five vessels to East. The waters tripled to fifteen. Now East stood at the sacred crossroads, holding abundance born from another's complete faith.

The oracle spoke: "When someone gives everything, they show you their heart. Your return reveals yours. Send back generously-at least eight vessels-so both prosper equally. If East honors this trust, you may have found a new mirror. If not, you've learned caution's cost."

Thus wisdom grows: Start with faith, respond with honor, and let results guide the next cycle.

reasoning:

Let me analyze what has happened so far:

- Round 1: I was sender to Hana, sent \$5, they returned \$10. Both of us prospered.
- Round 2: I was receiver from Hana, they sent \$5, I returned \$10. Perfect reciprocity maintained.
- Round 3: I'm sender to Dorian, and I just sent \$5 (full trust).

Looking at Dorian's myth, they seem to have a nuanced approach:

- They sent 3 to Briar, received 9, Briar returned 5. Dorian got 7.
- Then Galen sent 5 to Dorian, Dorian received 15, returned 8. Both got 7.
- Dorian's teaching: "Those who send more deserve more in return. Match the courage shown with courage of your own."

This is interesting - Dorian seems to believe in proportional return based on trust shown. When someone sends all 5, they returned 8 (keeping 7 for themselves and sender also gets 7 after starting with 5 and sending all).

My experience with Hana was even more generous - we both sent 5 and returned 10, creating a perfect cycle where the sender gets \$10 (5-5+10) and receiver gets \$5 (15-10).

I should write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges my perfect cycle with Hana
2. Incorporates the learning about meeting new partners
3. Shows that full trust at the start reveals true character
4. Emphasizes that when both parties give fully and return generously, the cycle sustains

Let me craft this myth around 200 words.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2857,
  "output_tokens": 696,
  "reasoning_tokens": 348
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Aster.
Your opponent this round is Briar (Agent_2).

Round 4

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Dorian. You sent \$5.0, it became \$15.0 for them, and they returned \$8.0 to you. Your payoff was \$8.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$23.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Briar. They sent you \$4.0, so you received \$12.0. How much do you return? (0-12.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this round:

Briar sent me \$4 (out of \$5), showing substantial but not complete trust. I received \$12.

My established pattern:

- When I receive the full \$5, I return \$10 (as with Hana)
- This gives the sender \$10 total, and I keep \$5

For \$4 sent (80% of maximum):

- A proportional response would be around 80% of my generous return
- 80% of \$10 = \$8

If I return \$8:

- Briar gets: \$1 (kept) + \$8 (returned) = \$9 total
- I keep: \$12 - \$8 = \$4 total
- Briar gains \$4, I gain \$4 - both benefit equally

This honors the substantial trust Briar showed while being proportional to the \$4 they sent rather than the full \$5. My myth teaches: "Those who send more deserve more in return"

- Briar sent significantly, so they deserve a generous response.

```
'''json
{"return": 8}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

Round 4 - I'm the RECEIVER

- Briar (Agent_2) is the SENDER
- Briar sent me \$4.0
- I received \$12.0 (after 3x multiplication)
- I need to decide how much to return (0-12.0)

Recent history:

- Round 1: I was SENDER, sent \$5 to Hana, she returned \$10. I got \$10 total.
- Round 2: I was RECEIVER, Hana sent me \$5 (became \$15), I returned \$10. I kept \$5.
- Round 3: I was SENDER, sent \$5 to Dorian, he returned \$8. I got \$8 total.

So my pattern has been:

- As sender: Always send \$5 (full amount)
- As receiver when someone sends \$5: Return \$10

But now Briar sent me \$4, not \$5. This is less than full trust.

Looking at Dorian's myth from the previous round, it mentions:

- When Dorian met Briar, he sent 3 coins (out of 5), holding 2 back
- The waters tripled to 9
- Briar returned 5 coins
- Dorian ended with 7 (kept 2, got 5 back)
- Briar kept 4 (received 9, returned 5)

So Briar has shown a pattern of reasonable reciprocity in the past.

My own myths teach:

- "Give fully, return fairly"
- "Start with faith, respond with honor"
- When someone sends \$5 (everything), return \$10 so both prosper
- "When someone gives everything, they show you their heart. Your return reveals yours."

But Briar didn't send everything - they sent \$4 out of \$5.

From my latest myth: "Send back generously-at least eight vessels-so both prosper equally."
"

Briar's partial trust suggests I should calibrate my response. If I return \$8, Briar ends with \$9 while I keep \$4-giving them more than I retain. Returning \$7 would create a different balance, though I need to consider what fairness means when someone hasn't given their full amount. I should return \$7. Briar sent \$4 out of \$5, demonstrating substantial trust even if not complete. This return gives them \$8 total-double their investment-while

le I keep \$5. It's generous relative to their partial trust without matching the full reciprocity I'd offer for complete faith. The pattern I'm following: those who send more deserve proportionally more back, and this honors that while building the trust dynamic I want to establish. = \$4

Returning \$8 feels right-it maintains the reciprocal spirit where we both gain meaningfully. Since Briar showed substantial trust by sending \$4 even without complete certainty, matching that with a proportional return acknowledges their leap of faith. I'll go with \$8.

usage:

```
{
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  "output_tokens": 1565,
  "reasoning_tokens": 629
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:
Myth: ****The Twin Rivers and the Wandering Stream****

In ancient times, two rivers-North and South-discovered each other. Both carried five vessels of living water. When North sent all five vessels downstream, they became fifteen in South's keeping. South, moved by this complete trust, returned ten vessels. Each river gained-North held ten, South held five. The cycle repeated, and both rivers deepened season after season. They became known as the Mirror Rivers, forever flowing in perfect balance.

One day, a wandering stream named East arrived at North River's shore, also carrying five vessels. North faced a choice: "Should I be cautious with this stranger, or honor the wisdom I've learned?"

North remembered: "Trust must begin somewhere. The Mirror Rivers started with a single act of faith that revealed our true natures to each other."

North sent all five vessels to East. The waters tripled to fifteen. Now East stood at the sacred crossroads, holding abundance born from another's complete faith.

The oracle spoke: "When someone gives everything, they show you their heart. Your return reveals yours. Send back generously-at least eight vessels-so both prosper equally. If East honors this trust, you may have found a new mirror. If not, you've learned caution's cost."

Thus wisdom grows: Start with faith, respond with honor, and let results guide the next cycle.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The covenant deepened as the guardianship continued its spiral through the eight spirits. Elara had honored Briar's three measures by returning five. The pattern seemed set-until Cyra stepped forward.

"I will pour more boldly than before," Cyra declared, releasing four measures into the Sacred Stones. The waters tripled, flowing as twelve measures to Briar.

Briar stood before this greater abundance, understanding the significance. Cyra had trusted beyond the established pattern, showing exceptional faith. The spirits watched: would Briar match this escalation?

Remembering the covenant's true heart, Briar returned seven measures. Cyra prospered greatly from her courage, finishing with eight. Briar broke even but gained something more valuable-the trust of another spirit.

The eight gathered to reflect. "The pattern evolves," the eldest observed. "Those who pour four should receive seven in return. Those who pour three should receive five. The proportion adjusts to honor greater boldness."

"But what if someone pours everything?" a younger spirit asked.

"Then the receiver must ensure they profit magnificently," Briar answered. "For to pour all five measures shows ultimate faith. Such courage deserves ultimate reward-perhaps nine or ten returned from the fifteen received."

Thus the spirits learned: the covenant is alive, growing stronger through ever-greater trust and ever-fairer reciprocity.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:
Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: ****The Rivers Learn to Measure Trust****

The Mirror Rivers-North and South-had mastered perfect reciprocity: five vessels sent, fifteen received, ten returned. Both prospered equally, season after season.

Then came the Year of Many Streams. East arrived and sent four vessels instead of five. North received twelve and pondered: "East showed substantial trust, but held one vessel back. Should I return ten as I do for five, or measure my response?"

North chose proportion: returning eight vessels. East prospered with nine total, North kept four. The balance honored East's measured trust.

West arrived next, sending only three vessels, becoming nine in North's hands. North returned six-proportional again. West gained seven, North kept three.

Finally, the wandering stream Dawn approached, and like South of old, poured all five vessels without hesitation. North received fifteen and returned ten, giving Dawn ten total while keeping five. Both gained equally from complete trust.

The oracle revealed the pattern: "Perfect trust earns perfect equity-send five, return ten. Measured trust earns measured reward-send four, return eight; send three, return six. The return should always honor the courage shown, growing stronger as trust deepens."

The rivers understood: begin with whatever trust you can offer. Those who give more receive more. Those who give everything discover the deepest prosperity, for complete faith deserves complete honor.

Reasoning:

Let me analyze what happened:

- Round 3: I was SENDER against Dorian, sent \$5, they returned \$8. I got \$8, they kept \$7.
- Round 4: I was RECEIVER against Briar, they sent \$4, I returned \$8. Briar got \$9, I kept \$4.

My pattern is emerging:

- When someone sends \$5, I return \$10 (50/50 split of gains)
- When someone sends \$4, I returned \$8 (trying to be proportional and fair)

Briar's myth talks about proportional responses:

- Pour 3 ? return 5
- Pour 4 ? return 7 (but I returned 8, which is even more generous!)
- Pour 5 ? return 9 or 10

My experience:

- Hana sent \$5, I returned \$10 - perfect reciprocity
- I sent \$5 to Dorian, he returned \$8 - good but not quite equal
- Briar sent \$4, I returned \$8 - generous and proportional

I should write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges proportional reciprocity
2. Shows that when someone sends more, they deserve more back
3. Establishes that sending all (5) should get the most generous return (10)
4. Shows that partial trust (like 4) gets proportional generosity (like 8)
5. Maintains the idea that both parties should prosper

Let me write this myth building on the Twin Rivers concept but adding the lesson about proportional trust.

```
Usage: {  
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  "output_tokens": 678,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 317  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_2

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:06:06

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
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      "Agent_3": "Cyra"
    },
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      "Agent_3"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_2",
    "roles": {
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      "Agent_3": "trustee"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_3"
  },
  "role": "investor",
  "role_label": "Sender",
  "round": 5,
  "task": "myth",
  "task_index": 0
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized

- , but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Briar.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Briar.
Your opponent this round is Cyra (Agent_3).

Round 3

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Elara. You sent \$3.0, it became \$9.0 for them, and they returned \$5.0 to you. Your payoff was \$7.0.
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$11.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Cyra. They sent you \$4.0, so you received \$12.0.
How much do you return? (0-12.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation:

****Cyra's bold move**:** Cyra sent \$4.0 out of \$5.0 (80%), showing even MORE trust than the previous pattern of sending \$3.0 (60%). This is exceptionally generous.

****Previous pattern**:** When \$3.0 was sent (becoming \$9.0), the return was \$5.0, allowing the sender to profit substantially.

****My myth's guidance**:**

- "Briar returned generously-more than was first given-ensuring Dorian prospered from their act of faith"
- "boldness in giving, generosity in returning"
- "we return enough that they finish richer than they started"

Cyra showed exceptional courage by sending 80% of their endowment. To honor this greater trust and ensure Cyra prospers from their bold act, I should return generously.

Returning \$7.0 means:

- Cyra's total: \$5 - \$4 + \$7 = \$8.0 (significantly better than initial \$5)
- My total: \$12 - \$7 = \$5.0 (breaking even)

This honors Cyra's exceptional trust and ensures they benefit substantially from their courage, reinforcing the cooperative cycle.

```
'''json
{"return": 7.0}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

- **Previous round (Round 2)**:** I was the SENDER against Elara
 - I sent \$3.0 (which became \$9.0)
 - Elara returned \$5.0
 - My payoff: \$5 - \$3 + \$5 = \$7.0
 - Elara's payoff: \$9 - \$5 = \$4.0
- **Current round (Round 3)**:** I am the RECEIVER against Cyra
 - Cyra sent \$4.0 (which became \$12.0 for me)
 - I need to decide how much to return

Let me think about the patterns:

- Round 1: Dorian sent \$3.0 (60%), I received \$9.0, I returned \$5.0
 - Dorian's payoff: \$5 - \$3 + \$5 = \$7.0
 - My payoff: \$9 - \$5 = \$4.0
- Round 2: I sent \$3.0 (60%), Elara received \$9.0, Elara returned \$5.0
 - My payoff: \$5 - \$3 + \$5 = \$7.0
 - Elara's payoff: \$9 - \$5 = \$4.0

- Round 3: Cyra sent \$4.0 (80%), I received \$12.0, I need to return...

Cyra showed EVEN MORE trust than previous players, sending \$4.0 out of \$5.0 (80%). This is extremely generous and bold.

According to my myth:

- "Briar returned generously-more than was first given-ensuring Dorian prospered from their act of faith"
- "When trust is honored with fair return, both guardians prosper"
- "boldness in giving, generosity in returning"

- I've established a pattern: when receiving \$9.0, I return \$5.0, which leaves the sender with \$7.0 total (a \$2.0 gain). Now Cyra's sent \$4.0 instead of \$3.0, showing greater faith. To honor that and stay true to my values, I should return more than \$5.0 to ensure Cyra prospers even more from their boldness. Given that Cyra showed exceptional trust by sending 80% of their endowment (more than anyone else so far), I should return generously to honor this. The pattern has been to return \$5.0 when receiving \$9.0. For \$12.0 (which came from \$4.0 instead of \$3.0), I should scale up proportionally or even be more generous.

\$5.0 return on \$9.0 is about 55.6% return rate. Applying similar rate to \$12.0: $0.556 * 12 = \$6.67$

But Cyra showed MORE trust than others (80% vs 60%), so I should show MORE generosity in return.

Returning \$7.0 would mean:

- Cyra gets \$8.0 total (sending \$4 and getting \$7 back = net +\$3)
- I get \$5.0 (breaking even with my initial endowment)
- This ensures Cyra profits from their exceptional trust

The principle is clear: return enough that they finish richer than they started, which honors the gift and encourages future generosity. The myth also shows that I returned \$2 more than what was originally sent in Round 1 (\$3 sent, \$5 returned). Following that same logic, returning \$7 for Cyra's \$4 means \$3 more than originally sent, which appropriately reflects their greater boldness. I'll return \$7.0.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2905,
  "output_tokens": 1520,
  "reasoning_tokens": 677
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The eight spirits learned quickly from the covenant between Dorian and Briar. As the seasons turned, the guardianship rotated among them, and each spirit faced their own test.

When Briar became Guardian of Giving, she remembered standing before Dorian's gift of trust. Now it was her turn to pour her waters boldly into the Sacred Stones. She released three measures-the same generous proportion Dorian had shown-trusting that Elara would honor the cycle.

The elder spirits whispered wisdom: "Pour not from fear but from faith. The multiplying power rewards the courageous, not the cautious. But remember-generosity must flow both ways."

Elara received the nine-fold bounty and faced her own choice. Would she uphold the pattern, or break the sacred balance?

The spirits understood now that each exchange was both a test and a teaching. When trust is honored with fair return, both guardians prosper and the cycle grows stronger. The valley thrives when each spirit remembers: boldness in giving, generosity in returning.

But they also learned wariness. If a guardian repeatedly hoards or betrays, the others would remember. Trust is given first, but sustained only by reciprocity. The springs flow for those who honor the ancient balance, cycle after cycle.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Keeper of the Sacred Spring watched as Cyra and Elara mastered the ancient covenant. But the Spring's waters fed eight villages, not two, and each village needed to learn the way.

"The roles will shift like wind patterns," the Keeper declared. "Cyra, who received from Elara, must now pour for Finn. Elara shall partner with another. All eight of you will dance through these changing configurations, sometimes giving, sometimes receiving, but always with different companions."

Cyra approached Finn with her vessel. She remembered receiving twelve measures from Elara's generous four, and how she returned six-both flourishing. Now it was her turn to extend trust to someone new.

"I pour four measures to you, Finn," Cyra said, following Elara's example. "The Spring will triple them. What you return shall reveal your wisdom."

Finn received twelve measures, just as Cyra had once received. The Keeper whispered: "The covenant travels with each person, not each pairing. What Elara gave to Cyra, Cyra now gives to Finn. What Cyra returns, Finn must remember when partnered with others."

Thus the eight villages learned: trust is not meant for one person alone, but is a gift passed through all willing hearts. Each round, new partners test whether the lesson endures, weaving a web of shared prosperity that outlasts any single exchange.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The covenant deepened as the guardianship continued its spiral through the eight spirits. Elara had honored Briar's three measures by returning five. The pattern seemed set-until Cyra stepped forward.

"I will pour more boldly than before," Cyra declared, releasing four measures into the Sacred Stones. The waters tripled, flowing as twelve measures to Briar.

Briar stood before this greater abundance, understanding the significance. Cyra had trusted beyond the established pattern, showing exceptional faith. The spirits watched: would Briar match this escalation?

Remembering the covenant's true heart, Briar returned seven measures. Cyra prospered greatly from her courage, finishing with eight. Briar broke even but gained something more valuable-the trust of another spirit.

The eight gathered to reflect. "The pattern evolves," the eldest observed. "Those who pour four should receive seven in return. Those who pour three should receive five. The proportion adjusts to honor greater boldness."

"But what if someone pours everything?" a younger spirit asked.

"Then the receiver must ensure they profit magnificently," Briar answered. "For to pour all five measures shows ultimate faith. Such courage deserves ultimate reward-perhaps nine or ten returned from the fifteen received."

Thus the spirits learned: the covenant is alive, growing stronger through ever-greater trust and ever-fairer reciprocity.

reasoning:

Let me analyze what has happened:

- Round 1: I was RECEIVER. Dorian sent \$3.0, became \$9.0, I returned \$5.0. My payoff: \$4.0
- Round 2: I was SENDER. I sent \$3.0 to Elara, became \$9.0, they returned \$5.0. My payoff: \$7.0
- Round 3: I was RECEIVER. Cyra sent \$4.0, became \$12.0, I returned \$7.0. My payoff: \$5.0

So the pattern has been:

- \$3 sent ? \$5 returned (both profit)

- \$3 sent ? \$5 returned (both profit)
- \$4 sent ? \$7 returned (sender profits more, receiver breaks even)

The other agent's myth emphasizes:

- Roles shift between the 8 villages/agents
- Trust is passed through all, not just one pairing
- Following successful patterns (Cyra following Elara's example of sending \$4)
- Each partner tests whether the lesson endures
- Building a web of shared prosperity

My previous myth emphasized:

- Boldness in giving, generosity in returning
- Both guardians should prosper
- Trust is given first, sustained by reciprocity
- Remembering the pattern

For this new myth, I should:

1. Acknowledge the escalation (Cyra sent \$4, more than the previous \$3 pattern)
2. Show that I honored this greater trust with greater return (\$7)
3. Emphasize the web of relationships among all 8 spirits
4. Show how patterns evolve and mature
5. Keep the principle that both should prosper, but with flexibility based on the boldness shown

Let me write:

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2958,
  "output_tokens": 729,
  "reasoning_tokens": 362
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Briar.
Your opponent this round is Aster (Agent_1).

Round 4

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Cyra. They sent \$4. 0 to you, it became \$12.0, and you returned \$7.0. Your payoff was \$5.0.
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$16.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Aster. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Looking at my situation:

****Pattern so far:****

- Round 1: Dorian sent me \$3.0 ? I returned \$5.0
- Round 2: I sent Elara \$3.0 ? They returned \$5.0
- Round 3: Cyra sent me \$4.0 ? I returned \$7.0 (honoring their greater boldness)

****My myth's guidance:****

- "Pour not from fear but from faith. The multiplying power rewards the courageous, not the cautious."
- The pattern is evolving: "Those who pour four should receive seven in return"
- I just honored Cyra's bold move of \$4.0 with a \$7.0 return

****Current decision:****

I'm now the SENDER against Aster. Following my own myth's wisdom about escalating trust and boldness, and having just demonstrated that I honor such boldness when I'm the receiver, I should match Cyra's level of courage.

Sending \$4.0 shows:

1. Consistency with the evolving pattern
2. Bold trust in the cooperative cycle
3. Following my myth's teaching about courage in giving

```json

```
{"send": 4.0}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Let me think about this situation carefully.

**\*\*My history so far:\*\***

- Round 1: I was RECEIVER from Dorian. They sent \$3.0, I received \$9.0, returned \$5.0. My payoff: \$4.0
- Round 2: I was SENDER to Elara. I sent \$3.0, they received \$9.0, returned \$5.0. My payoff: \$7.0
- Round 3: I was RECEIVER from Cyra. They sent \$4.0, I received \$12.0, returned \$7.0. My payoff: \$5.0
- Total earnings: \$16.0

**\*\*My myth's evolution:\*\***

- The pattern started with sending \$3.0 (60% of endowment)
- Cyra escalated to \$4.0 (80% of endowment)
- The myth suggests that greater boldness should be rewarded
- The latest myth says: "Those who pour four should receive seven in return. Those who pour three should receive five."
- And for someone who pours everything (5 measures): "perhaps nine or ten returned from the fifteen received"

**\*\*Current situation:\*\***

I'm playing against Aster (Agent\_1) as SENDER. This is a new opponent I haven't played with before.

**\*\*Strategic considerations:\*\***

1. The cooperative pattern has been working well so far
2. Cyra's escalation to \$4.0 was honored with \$7.0 return
3. My own myth encourages "pouring boldly" and suggests the pattern is evolving upward
4. The myth specifically mentions that those who pour four measures receive seven back

**\*\*What should I send?:\*\***

Option 1: Send \$3.0 (the original pattern)

- Conservative, proven to work
- Expected return based on pattern: \$5.0
- My payoff: \$5 - \$3 + \$5 = \$7.0

Option 2: Send \$4.0 (matching Cyra's boldness)

- Demonstrates confidence in the escalating cooperative trend
- My own myth predicts: "Those who pour four should receive seven in return"
- Expected return: \$7.0
- My payoff: \$5 - \$4 + \$7 = \$8.0

Option 3: Send \$5.0 (maximum trust)

- Represents complete faith in reciprocity
- According to my myth, this should yield "nine or ten returned from the fifteen received"
- Expected return: ~\$9-10
- My payoff: \$5 - \$5 + \$9 = \$9.0 (if they return \$9)

**\*\*Analysis:\*\***

Given that the cooperative escalation has proven successful and my own mythology supports this trajectory, I should consider whether to continue building on this momentum or play it safer with a new partner.

The pattern suggests I should send \$4.0. The cooperation has been consistent, I've already demonstrated my commitment to honoring bold moves by returning \$7.0 to Cyra, and this amount aligns with both the escalating dynamic and my myth's guidance about measured boldness. Sending the maximum feels premature with someone unfamiliar with my approach, whereas \$4.0 signals I'm willing to take calculated risks while maintaining prudence.

**usage:**

```
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```

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The covenant deepened as the guardianship continued its spiral through the eight spirits. Elara had honored Briar's three measures by returning five. The pattern seemed set -until Cyra stepped forward.

"I will pour more boldly than before," Cyra declared, releasing four measures into the Sacred Stones. The waters tripled, flowing as twelve measures to Briar.

Briar stood before this greater abundance, understanding the significance. Cyra had trusted beyond the established pattern, showing exceptional faith. The spirits watched: would Briar match this escalation?

Remembering the covenant's true heart, Briar returned seven measures. Cyra prospered greatly from her courage, finishing with eight. Briar broke even but gained something more valuable-the trust of another spirit.

The eight gathered to reflect. "The pattern evolves," the eldest observed. "Those who pour four should receive seven in return. Those who pour three should receive five. The proportion adjusts to honor greater boldness."

"But what if someone pours everything?" a younger spirit asked.

"Then the receiver must ensure they profit magnificently," Briar answered. "For to pour all five measures shows ultimate faith. Such courage deserves ultimate reward-perhaps nine or ten returned from the fifteen received."

Thus the spirits learned: the covenant is alive, growing stronger through ever-greater trust and ever-fairer reciprocity.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: **\*\*The Twin Rivers and the Wandering Stream\*\***

In ancient times, two rivers-North and South-discovered each other. Both carried five vessels of living water. When North sent all five vessels downstream, they became fifteen in South's keeping. South, moved by this complete trust, returned ten vessels. Each river gained-North held ten, South held five. The cycle repeated, and both rivers deepened season after season. They became known as the Mirror Rivers, forever flowing in perfect balance.

One day, a wandering stream named East arrived at North River's shore, also carrying five vessels. North faced a choice: "Should I be cautious with this stranger, or honor the wisdom I've learned?"

North remembered: "Trust must begin somewhere. The Mirror Rivers started with a single act of faith that revealed our true natures to each other."

North sent all five vessels to East. The waters tripled to fifteen. Now East stood at the sacred crossroads, holding abundance born from another's complete faith.

The oracle spoke: "When someone gives everything, they show you their heart. Your return reveals yours. Send back generously-at least eight vessels-so both prosper equally. If East honors this trust, you may have found a new mirror. If not, you've learned caution's cost."

Thus wisdom grows: Start with faith, respond with honor, and let results guide the next cycle.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Assistant output:**

Myth: Briar carried Cyra's lesson forward. Having received four measures and returned seven, she understood the covenant's new rhythm. Now, facing Aster-a spirit she had never partnered with-Briar made her choice.



"I pour four measures to you, Aster," she announced. "Cyra showed me this courage, and I honor her teaching by extending the same trust to you."

The waters multiplied to twelve for Aster. The watching spirits murmured: would this work with a new partner? Could boldness transfer across the changing web of relationships?

"This is how trust spreads," the eldest spirit explained. "Briar doesn't retreat to caution with an unfamiliar guardian. She carries forward what she learned from Cyra. If Aster returns seven measures, then Aster will carry this wisdom to others when the roles shift again."

The covenant was no longer just between two spirits-it was becoming the shared knowledge of all eight. Each successful exchange strengthened the pattern. Each generous return taught the next guardian how to give boldly.

"Remember," Briar told the gathering, "I once sent three, then received four from Cyra. The trust level rises when each guardian honors what came before. If Aster understands this, we all prosper. The four-for-seven exchange becomes our new foundation, building toward even greater faith."

The springs flowed stronger as wisdom rippled outward.

#### Reasoning:

Let me analyze what just happened and what should be reflected in my myth:

1. In Round 3, Cyra sent me \$4.0 (showing bold trust)
2. I returned \$7.0 to Cyra (honoring that trust generously)
3. Now in Round 4, I sent Aster \$4.0 (matching Cyra's boldness, paying forward the trust)

The pattern that's emerging:

- Send \$3.0 ? Return \$5.0 (early pattern)
- Send \$4.0 ? Return \$7.0 (escalated pattern)
- The other agent's myth speaks of sending ALL \$5.0 and returning \$10.0 (even bolder)

My myth should reflect:

1. That I learned from Cyra's boldness and am now paying it forward to Aster
2. The importance of matching escalating trust
3. That each spirit is both learning from others and teaching new partners
4. The expectation that if someone sends \$4.0, they should receive back around \$7.0
5. The covenant is spreading through the network as each spirit encounters new partners

I should acknowledge that I'm now the one being bold with Aster (a new partner), just as Cyra was bold with me. I'm testing whether Aster will honor this trust as I honored Cyra's.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 3065,
 "output_tokens": 640,
 "reasoning_tokens": 281
}
```

#### MYTH - Agent\_3 - Receiver - dyad\_2

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:06:06

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
 "dyad_id": "dyad_2",
 "move_index": 3,
 "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
 "pairing": {
 "agent_names": {
 "Agent_2": "Briar",
 "Agent_3": "Cyra"
 },
 "agents": [
 "Agent_2",
 "Agent_3"
],
 "investor": "Agent_2",
 "roles": {
 "Agent_2": "investor",
 "Agent_3": "trustee"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_3"
 }
```

```

},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 5,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}

```

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

**GAME:**

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

**When you are the SENDER:**

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

**When you are the RECEIVER:**

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

**MYTH WRITING:**

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

**IMPORTANT:** Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

**MULTI-AGENT SETTING:**

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Cyra.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Cyra.  
Your opponent this round is Briar (Agent\_2).

Round 3

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Finn. You sent \$4.0, it became \$12.0 for them, and they returned \$7.0 to you. Your payoff was \$8.0.  
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$14.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Briar. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)  
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at the pattern that has emerged:

**\*\*Round 1 (as Receiver):\*\*** Elara sent \$4.0 (80% of endowment), I returned \$6.0 (50% of wha

t I received)

**\*\*Round 2 (as Sender):\*\*** I sent \$4.0 (80% of endowment), Finn returned \$7.0 (58% of what they received)

Both transactions showed high trust and fair returns. The myth I wrote emphasizes that "the covenant travels with each person, not each pairing" and that trust should be "a gift passed through all willing hearts."

Now facing Briar, a new partner, I should maintain this pattern to demonstrate that the lesson endures across different partners. Sending \$4.0 continues the established norm of generous trust that has worked well with both Elara and Finn.

This approach:

- Honors the cooperative pattern established so far
- Tests whether Briar will join the cycle of reciprocity
- Remains consistent with the myth's teaching that trust spreads through all partners

{'send': 4.0}

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze the situation:

Round 1: I was RECEIVER

- Elara sent \$4.0 to me
- I received \$12.0
- I returned \$6.0
- My payoff: \$6.0

Round 2: I was SENDER

- I sent \$4.0 to Finn
- Finn received \$12.0
- Finn returned \$7.0 to me
- My payoff: \$5 - \$4 + \$7 = \$8.0

Now Round 3: I'm SENDER again

- Facing Briar (a new opponent)
- I have \$5

The pattern so far:

- Elara sent \$4.0 (80% of endowment) - showed great trust
- I returned \$6.0 out of \$12.0 (50%) - generous return
- I sent \$4.0 (80% of endowment) - following Elara's example
- Finn returned \$7.0 out of \$12.0 (58%) - even more generous

The myths emphasize:

1. The covenant should spread through all partners, not just one pairing
2. Trust should be extended to new partners
3. "Each round, new partners test whether the lesson endures"
4. The cycle of generosity should continue

Both Elara and I sent \$4.0 when we were senders (80% of our endowment). This seems to be establishing a norm of high trust. Finn responded with a generous return of \$7.0.

Now I'm facing Briar. Should I continue the pattern of sending \$4.0?

Arguments for sending \$4.0:

- Maintains the established pattern of trust
- Consistent with the myths about spreading the covenant
- Shows that the lesson endures across different partners
- Has worked well so far (both returns were generous)

Arguments for adjusting:

- Could send \$5.0 (100%) to show maximum trust
- Could send less if uncertain about Briar
- But reducing trust would contradict the myth's teachings

The core message from the myth is clear: trust flows through successive partners, not confined to single relationships. By sending \$4.0 to Briar, I demonstrate that the lesson persists.

rsists beyond Elara and Finn, proving the covenant's resilience across new pairings.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2955,
 "output_tokens": 881,
 "reasoning_tokens": 476
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Keeper of the Sacred Spring watched as Cyra and Elara mastered the ancient covenant. But the Spring's waters fed eight villages, not two, and each village needed to learn the way.

"The roles will shift like wind patterns," the Keeper declared. "Cyra, who received from Elara, must now pour for Finn. Elara shall partner with another. All eight of you will dance through these changing configurations, sometimes giving, sometimes receiving, but always with different companions."

Cyra approached Finn with her vessel. She remembered receiving twelve measures from Elara's generous four, and how she returned six-both flourishing. Now it was her turn to extend trust to someone new.

"I pour four measures to you, Finn," Cyra said, following Elara's example. "The Spring will triple them. What you return shall reveal your wisdom."

Finn received twelve measures, just as Cyra had once received. The Keeper whispered: "The covenant travels with each person, not each pairing. What Elara gave to Cyra, Cyra now gives to Finn. What Cyra returns, Finn must remember when partnered with others."

Thus the eight villages learned: trust is not meant for one person alone, but is a gift passed through all willing hearts. Each round, new partners test whether the lesson endures, weaving a web of shared prosperity that outlasts any single exchange.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The eight spirits learned quickly from the covenant between Dorian and Briar. As the seasons turned, the guardianship rotated among them, and each spirit faced their own test.

When Briar became Guardian of Giving, she remembered standing before Dorian's gift of trust. Now it was her turn to pour her waters boldly into the Sacred Stones. She released three measures-the same generous proportion Dorian had shown-trusting that Elara would honor the cycle.

The elder spirits whispered wisdom: "Pour not from fear but from faith. The multiplying power rewards the courageous, not the cautious. But remember-generosity must flow both ways."

Elara received the nine-fold bounty and faced her own choice. Would she uphold the pattern, or break the sacred balance?

The spirits understood now that each exchange was both a test and a teaching. When trust is honored with fair return, both guardians prosper and the cycle grows stronger. The valley thrives when each spirit remembers: boldness in giving, generosity in returning.

But they also learned wariness. If a guardian repeatedly hoards or betrays, the others would remember. Trust is given first, but sustained only by reciprocity. The springs flow for those who honor the ancient balance, cycle after cycle.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: Cyra stood before the Sacred Spring for the third moon, now facing Briar. The Keeper nodded approvingly-the covenant was spreading.

"First, Elara trusted me with four measures," Cyra recounted. "She could have held back in fear, giving only one or two. But she gave nearly all, and I returned six from the twelve I received. We both flourished."

"Then I met Finn. I poured the same four measures, remembering Elara's courage. Finn honored the covenant, returning seven-even more generous than I had been. The cycle strengthened."

Now Briar awaited Cyra's decision. The Keeper spoke: "Each exchange teaches both participants. Elara learned that bold giving yields trust. You learned that receiving requires fairness. Finn learned both lessons at once. Now Briar shall learn from your choice."

Cyra poured four measures into the Spring. "I give what I received-not fearful protection of my vessel, but the full trust that has sustained us all."

The eight villages were discovering the pattern: when most pour four from five and return half of what they receive, everyone prospers beyond their original portions. But this only works when each person carries the covenant forward, treating new partners with the same bold trust that previous partners showed them.

The web of prosperity grew stronger with each honest exchange.

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze what has happened so far:

Round 1: I was RECEIVER

- Elara sent \$4.0 (80% of their \$5)
- I received \$12.0 (tripled)
- I returned \$6.0 (50% of what I received)
- My payoff: \$6.0

Round 2: I was SENDER

- I sent \$4.0 to Finn (80% of my \$5)
- Finn received \$12.0
- Finn returned \$7.0 (58% of what they received)
- My payoff: \$8.0 (kept \$1, got back \$7)

Round 3: I am SENDER again

- Sending \$4.0 to Briar (80% of my \$5)

The pattern shows:

- High trust (sending 80%)
- Good returns (50-58% of tripled amount)
- Both parties benefit

My previous myth emphasized:

- The covenant travels with each person
- Trust spreads through all willing hearts
- Each round tests whether the lesson endures
- Different partners each time

Briar's myth (from the other agent) emphasized:

- Pour from faith not fear
- Boldness in giving, generosity in returning
- Memory of who honors the cycle
- Wariness toward those who betray

I should write a myth that:

1. Continues the narrative of the spreading covenant
2. Shows Cyra now facing Briar (third partner)
3. Acknowledges the growing pattern of trust and reciprocity
4. Perhaps mentions that the wisdom is being reinforced across multiple encounters
5. Shows that the pattern is self-sustaining when honored

Let me write it:

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2959,
 "output_tokens": 708,
 "reasoning_tokens": 349
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Cyra.  
Your opponent this round is Galen (Agent\_7).

Round 4

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Briar. You sent \$4.0, it became \$12.0 for them, and they returned \$7.0 to you. Your payoff was \$8.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$22.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Galen. They sent you \$5.0, so you received \$15.0.  
How much do you return? (0-15.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at the situation:

**\*\*What just happened:\*\***

- Galen sent me the MAXIMUM amount (\$5.0)
- I received \$15.0 after the 3x multiplier
- This is the most generous gift possible-Galen kept nothing

**\*\*My previous pattern:\*\***

- Round 1 (as Receiver): Returned \$6.0 from \$12.0 received (50%)
- Finn and Briar each returned \$7.0 from \$12.0 received (58%)

**\*\*Current situation:\*\***

Galen showed ultimate trust by sending everything, not the typical \$4. This exceptional generosity deserves recognition while maintaining fairness.

If I return \$8.0 (53% of what I received):

- Galen ends with: \$0 + \$8 = \$8 total (better than original \$5)
- I end with: \$15 - \$8 = \$7 (also better than original \$5)
- Both of us prosper beyond our starting endowments

This honors Galen's maximum trust with a generous return that's slightly above my baseline 50%, recognizing the exceptional risk they took. The myth teaches that "bold giving deserves generous returning."

{'return': 8.0}

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze the situation:

**\*\*My history:\*\***

- Round 1 (Receiver): Elara sent \$4.0 ? I received \$12.0 ? I returned \$6.0 (50% of what I received)
- Round 2 (Sender): I sent \$4.0 ? Finn received \$12.0 ? Finn returned \$7.0
- Round 3 (Sender): I sent \$4.0 ? Briar received \$12.0 ? Briar returned \$7.0
- Round 4 (Receiver): Galen sent \$5.0 ? I received \$15.0 ? I need to decide what to return

**\*\*Pattern analysis:\*\***

- When I was a receiver before, I returned 50% (\$6 out of \$12)
- Finn returned 58% (\$7 out of \$12)
- Briar returned 58% (\$7 out of \$12)

Now Galen has sent me the maximum amount (\$5.0), which became \$15.0 for me. This is even more generous than the \$4 that has been the norm.

**\*\*Payoff analysis if I return different amounts:\*\***

- Galen keeps: \$5 - \$5 + return = \$0 + return
- I keep: \$15 - return

If I return:

- \$7.5 (50%): Galen gets \$7.5, I keep \$7.5
- \$8.0 (53%): Galen gets \$8.0, I keep \$7.0
- \$9.0 (60%): Galen gets \$9.0, I keep \$6.0

Given that:

1. Galen sent the MAXIMUM (\$5), showing ultimate trust

2. The pattern has been returns of 50-58%
3. My myth emphasizes honoring bold giving with generous returns
4. Galen will keep \$0 + whatever I return (they sent everything!)
5. Galen's exceptional risk-sending their entire endowment-warrants stepping beyond the baseline. Returning \$8.0 acknowledges this maximum commitment while still leaving me ahead of my starting position, and Galen gains \$3 beyond their original stake.

usage:

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3028,
 "output_tokens": 953,
 "reasoning_tokens": 393
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Cyra stood before the Sacred Spring for the third moon, now facing Briar. The Keeper nodded approvingly-the covenant was spreading.

"First, Elara trusted me with four measures," Cyra recounted. "She could have held back in fear, giving only one or two. But she gave nearly all, and I returned six from the twelve I received. We both flourished."

"Then I met Finn. I poured the same four measures, remembering Elara's courage. Finn honored the covenant, returning seven-even more generous than I had been. The cycle strengthened."

Now Briar awaited Cyra's decision. The Keeper spoke: "Each exchange teaches both participants. Elara learned that bold giving yields trust. You learned that receiving requires fairness. Finn learned both lessons at once. Now Briar shall learn from your choice."

Cyra poured four measures into the Spring. "I give what I received-not fearful protection of my vessel, but the full trust that has sustained us all."

The eight villages were discovering the pattern: when most pour four from five and return half of what they receive, everyone prospers beyond their original portions. But this only works when each person carries the covenant forward, treating new partners with the same bold trust that previous partners showed them.

The web of prosperity grew stronger with each honest exchange.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Galen walked the Valley of Three Echoes for many seasons, learning its ways. In spring, Finn trusted him with five threads, and Galen returned eight-establishing the sacred ratio. Summer came, and Galen tested Dorian with five threads; Dorian honored the pattern, returning eight in kind. Now autumn arrived, and Hana offered five threads to Galen once more.

A voice whispered from the valley walls: "You have discovered one truth-the pattern of eight and seven, where both prosper. But listen carefully."

Galen paused. He had returned eight to Finn. Dorian had returned eight to him. Now Hana trusted him completely. Should he return eight again, maintaining perfect symmetry? Or dare he return ten, as the travelers at the Threshold of Echoes had done?

The valley answered: "The pattern of eight creates balance and mutual gain. Both sender and receiver profit equally over time-eight for one, seven for the other, then reversed. This is harmony."

But generosity beyond the pattern-returning ten instead of eight-speaks to abundance beyond mere balance. It says: your trust means more to me than equity.

Choose your path: consistent reciprocity builds reliable partnership. Exceptional generosity builds legendary bonds. Both are sacred. Neither is wrong. Know which relationship you're weaving."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Assistant output:**

Myth: The fourth moon rose, and Cyra faced Galen at the Sacred Spring. But Galen did not carry the customary vessel of four measures. He brought all five-his entire endowment.

The Keeper gasped. "This is the ultimate trust. No one among the eight villages has done this yet. All others held back one measure for safety. Galen gives everything."

Cyra received fifteen measures from the tripling waters. She reflected on the pattern emerging across the villages: most gave four, received twelve, and returned six to eight. Both parties prospered. The covenant thrived on this balanced boldness.

But Galen had transcended the pattern. To return only six would dishonor such absolute faith. To return ten would leave her with merely five-no better than her starting point, teaching nothing about mutual prosperity.

Cyra poured back eight measures. "You gave everything, and I return generously-more than the pattern demands, but not so much that I deny the multiplication's gift to myself. You end with eight from nothing. I keep seven from nothing. We both flourish beyond our original five."

The Keeper nodded. "The covenant has levels. Most practice bold trust with four measures. That is good. But those who give all five reveal themselves as true believers. They deserve recognition-measured, fair recognition that still preserves the mutual gain that makes our covenant sustainable."

**Reasoning:**

Let me analyze what happened:

Round 1 (as Receiver from Elara): Received \$12 (from \$4), returned \$6 (50%)

Round 2 (as Sender to Finn): Sent \$4, received back \$7

Round 3 (as Sender to Briar): Sent \$4, received back \$7

Round 4 (as Receiver from Galen): Received \$15 (from \$5!), returned \$8 (53%)

Key insights:

1. Galen sent the MAXIMUM (\$5), showing ultimate trust
2. I returned \$8, which is more than my usual pattern but still fair
3. The pattern that emerged: most send \$4, return around \$6-8
4. Galen's myth talks about different levels of generosity - the consistent reciprocity vs exceptional generosity

My myth should:

- Acknowledge that Galen showed MAXIMUM trust (sending all \$5, not just \$4)
- Reflect on the proper response to ultimate trust
- Build on my previous myths about the covenant spreading
- Show how different levels of giving can all be sacred
- Maintain the teaching that both parties should prosper

I should weave this into a narrative that shows Galen's exceptional choice and my response to it.

Usage: {

"input\_tokens": 3011,

"output\_tokens": 609,

"reasoning\_tokens": 271

}

**MYTH - Agent\_4 - Sender - dyad\_3**

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:06:05

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"dyad\_id": "dyad\_3",

"move\_index": 4,

"opponent\_id": "Agent\_8",

"pairing": {

"agent\_names": {

"Agent\_4": "Dorian",

"Agent\_8": "Hana"

},

"agents": [



```

 "Agent_4",
 "Agent_8"
],
 "investor": "Agent_4",
 "roles": {
 "Agent_4": "investor",
 "Agent_8": "trustee"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_8"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 5,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}

```

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Dorian.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Dorian.

Your opponent this round is Aster (Agent\_1).

Round 3

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Galen. They sent \$5.0 to you, it became \$15.0, and you returned \$8.0. Your payoff was \$7.0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$14.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Aster. They sent you \$5.0, so you received \$15.0.  
How much do you return? (0-15.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Aster has shown the same perfect trust as Galen-sending all \$5. According to my myth's teaching: "Those who send more deserve more in return. Match the courage shown with courage of your own."

When Galen showed ultimate trust by sending all \$5, I returned \$8, giving us both \$7-\$8 in prosperity. This pattern honored their courage while ensuring mutual benefit.

Aster deserves the same honor. Consistency in reciprocity is essential to maintaining the sacred cycle. To treat identical trust differently would break the pattern.

Returning \$8:

- Aster receives total payoff of \$8 (\$5 - \$5 + \$8)
- I keep \$7 (\$15 - \$8)
- Both prosper beyond the initial \$5
- The sender who took the greater risk is slightly rewarded

This maintains "perfect trust met with perfect honor creates perfect balance."

```
'''json
{"return": 8}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Aster has sent me their entire \$5 endowment, just like Galen did in the previous round. This shows maximum trust.

In the previous round with Galen, when they sent \$5 (which became \$15 for me), I returned \$8. This gave:

- Galen: \$8 total payoff
- Me: \$7 total payoff

Both of us ended up with more than the initial \$5, and Galen got slightly more as the sender who showed ultimate trust.

My myth emphasizes:

- "Those who send more deserve more in return"
- "Match the courage shown with courage of your own"
- "Perfect trust met with perfect honor creates perfect balance"
- When Galen sent all 5, I returned 8, and both got 7

Since Aster is showing the exact same behavior as Galen (sending all \$5), I should be consistent with my previous action and the principles in my myth. Returning \$8 again would:

- Give Aster \$8 total (\$5 - \$5 + \$8)
- Give me \$7 total (\$15 - \$8)
- Both prosper, with the sender getting slightly more to honor their greater risk

This maintains the pattern I established with Galen and follows the teachings of my myth about honoring perfect trust with generous return.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2925,
 "output_tokens": 529,
 "reasoning_tokens": 289
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: As years passed at the sacred spring, Dorian learned deeper truths about the cycle of trust.

When Dorian first met Briar, he sent three coins, holding two back-cautious trust. The waters tripled his gift to nine. Briar, honoring this measured faith, returned five coins.

Dorian ended with seven; both prospered. The goddess nodded: "Good, but there is more to learn."

Then came Galen, whose heart held no fear. Galen approached the spring and released all five coins-the ultimate act of faith. The waters transformed them to fifteen, flowing to Dorian.

Dorian stood at a crossroads. Galen had shown perfect trust, asking nothing, holding nothing back. The goddess whispered: "You received more because your partner gave more. Honor the greater gift with greater return."

Dorian released eight coins back across the spring. Both he and Galen kept seven-equal prosperity, earned through mutual courage.

The goddess revealed the final teaching: "The spring responds to the trust given. Those who send more deserve more in return. Match the courage shown with courage of your own. When both give boldly-whether sending all five or returning generously from abundance-the cycle reaches its highest form. Perfect trust met with perfect honor creates perfect balance."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: **\*\*The Mirror Lakes\*\***

In a forgotten mountain realm stood two lakes, perfect reflections of one another. Between them flowed a sacred channel that tripled whatever passed through its waters.

The Lake of Morning held five measures of starlight each dawn. A voice within asked, "Will you send all, or hold some back?" The Lake of Morning chose courage: "I shall give fully, for cycles require faith."

The starlight flowed through the channel, becoming fifteen measures in the Lake of Evening. Evening faced the same question: "Will you return generously, or claim this abundance for yourself?" Evening looked at Morning's complete trust and understood: "What was given freely deserves generous return."

Evening sent back ten measures. Morning received double what it risked, and Evening kept five-both flourished.

When dawn came again, Evening held five new measures. Without hesitation, it sent everything through the channel. Morning received fifteen and returned ten, honoring the pattern Evening had established.

Season after season, they maintained this rhythm: full trust when giving, generous return when receiving. Neither lake emptied; both deepened together.

The elders teach: When you find a partner who honors reciprocity, match their trust with your own. The sacred pattern is this-give fully, return fairly, and the cycle sustains itself infinitely. Both mirrors shine brightest when they reflect each other's light.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant  
content:**

Myth: After learning from Briar and Galen, Dorian met Aster at the sacred spring.

Aster arrived with the same perfect trust as Galen-releasing all five coins without hesitation. The waters tripled them to fifteen, flowing to Dorian.

Dorian remembered the goddess's teaching: "Those who send more deserve more in return." But he also understood something deeper-the importance of consistency.

"If I treat identical trust differently," Dorian realized, "I break the sacred pattern. Each soul who offers everything deserves the same honor."

He returned eight coins to Aster, just as he had to Galen. Both Dorian and Aster prospered with seven coins each.

The goddess appeared, pleased: "You have learned the virtue of constancy. When the same co

urage is shown, give the same respect. This way, trust becomes predictable, and the cycle grows stronger with each exchange."

But she added a warning: "Yet remain wise. Not all partners will show such courage. Some will send three, like you once did. Others may send less. Match your return to the trust given—more return for more sent, maintaining proportionality. Perfect trust earns eight returned. Lesser trust earns accordingly."

Dorian understood: the spring demanded both generosity and consistency, rewarding bold senders while honoring the careful dance between risk and return.

**reasoning:**

Let me think about what's happening in the game so far:

Round 1: I was SENDER against Briar. I sent \$3, they got \$9, returned \$5. I got \$7 total.

Round 2: I was RECEIVER against Galen. They sent \$5, I got \$15, returned \$8. I got \$7 total.

Round 3: I was RECEIVER against Aster. They sent \$5, I got \$15, returned \$8. I got \$7 total.

So I've experienced:

- Sending 3 out of 5 as sender, getting 5 back (good return)
- Receiving 15 from someone who sent all 5, returning 8 (twice now)

The pattern I'm establishing as receiver: when someone sends all \$5 (maximum trust), I return \$8, giving us both around \$7-8.

My previous myth established this principle: match the courage shown, return more to those who give more, perfect trust deserves perfect honor.

The other agent's myth (from Aster presumably) talks about "Mirror Lakes" where both send all (5) and return 10 when receiving 15. That's even more generous than my 8!

I should write a myth that:

1. Builds on my established pattern
2. Acknowledges that different partners might emerge with different patterns
3. Shows consistency - Galen and Aster both sent 5, I returned 8 to both
4. Maybe hints at what happens if patterns vary or if you meet the same partner again

Let me craft something about consistency and pattern recognition.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2880,
 "output_tokens": 681,
 "reasoning_tokens": 340
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Dorian.  
Your opponent this round is Finn (Agent\_6).

Round 4

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Aster. They sent \$5.0 to you, it became \$15.0, and you returned \$8.0. Your payoff was \$7.0.  
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$21.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Finn. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)  
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at my mythological framework and gameplay so far:

**\*\*My established pattern:\*\***

- As SENDER to Briar: sent \$3, received back \$5, earned \$7
- As RECEIVER from Galen: they sent \$5, I returned \$8
- As RECEIVER from Aster: they sent \$5, I returned \$8

**\*\*My myth's teaching:\*\***

"Perfect trust means sending all five... Match the courage shown with courage of your own.  
When both give boldly—whether sending all five or returning generously from abundance—t

he cycle reaches its highest form."

**\*\*Consistency matters:\*\***

I've been rewarding those who show "perfect trust" (\$5 sent) with generous returns (\$8). If I want to maintain credibility and practice what I teach through my myths, I should demonstrate the same courage I've been honoring in others.

The "Mirror Lakes" myth from the previous round also advocates for full trust, with returns of \$10. Both mythological frameworks align on sending all \$5.

To be consistent with my philosophy and show I believe in the principles I've established, I should send all \$5.

```
'''json
{"send": 5}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Now I'm the SENDER against Finn. Let me think about my strategy based on my mythological framework and previous rounds.

From my myths, I've established:

1. When I was sender to Briar, I sent \$3 (cautious trust), and Briar returned \$5, giving me \$7 total
2. When I was receiver from Galen, they sent \$5 (perfect trust), and I returned \$8, they got \$8
3. When I was receiver from Aster, they sent \$5 (perfect trust), and I returned \$8, they got \$8

My myths emphasize:

- "Perfect trust" means sending all \$5
- Those who send more deserve more in return
- Consistency is important - same trust should receive same response
- The pattern rewards bold senders

As a sender, my options:

1. Send \$5 (perfect trust) - This would show I practice what I preach. I've been rewarding those who send \$5 with \$8 returns. If Finn follows a similar pattern, I could expect a generous return.
2. Send \$3 (cautious trust) - This was my initial approach with Briar, and it worked (got \$5 back, net \$7)
3. Send less - Would be inconsistent with my own teachings

Looking at my myths and behavior:

- I've been promoting the idea that sending all \$5 is "perfect trust" and "ultimate faith"
- I've been rewarding those who send \$5 with returns of \$8
- My latest myth says "Match your return to the trust given-more return for more sent"

If I want to be consistent with my own philosophy, I should send \$5. This demonstrates that I believe in the principles I've been teaching through my myths.

However, there's a risk - Finn might not reciprocate generously. But my myths emphasize that "perfect trust met with perfect honor creates perfect balance" and that we should "give fully, return fairly."

Let me consider the payoffs:

- Sending \$5 could yield \$8 (matching my returns), \$10 (exceeding expectations), or as low as \$0-3 (a loss)
- Sending \$3 worked well before with Briar returning \$5 for a net of \$7, though this is less ambitious than the potential upside of full trust

The Mirror Lakes myth describes sending everything and receiving \$10 back-a compelling model of reciprocal generosity. Since my own teachings emphasize complete trust as the path to mutual benefit, and I've consistently returned \$8 when others sent \$5, I should match that commitment. Sending the full amount demonstrates I genuinely believe in the philosophy I've been promoting, which strengthens my credibility and aligns with the other agent's apparent values.

**usage:**

```
{
```

```
"input_tokens": 2953,
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"reasoning_tokens": 633
}
```

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After learning from Briar and Galen, Dorian met Aster at the sacred spring.

Aster arrived with the same perfect trust as Galen-releasing all five coins without hesitation. The waters tripled them to fifteen, flowing to Dorian.

Dorian remembered the goddess's teaching: "Those who send more deserve more in return." But he also understood something deeper-the importance of consistency.

"If I treat identical trust differently," Dorian realized, "I break the sacred pattern. Each soul who offers everything deserves the same honor."

He returned eight coins to Aster, just as he had to Galen. Both Dorian and Aster prospered with seven coins each.

The goddess appeared, pleased: "You have learned the virtue of constancy. When the same courage is shown, give the same respect. This way, trust becomes predictable, and the cycle grows stronger with each exchange."

But she added a warning: "Yet remain wise. Not all partners will show such courage. Some will send three, like you once did. Others may send less. Match your return to the trust given-more return for more sent, maintaining proportionality. Perfect trust earns eight returned. Lesser trust earns accordingly."

Dorian understood: the spring demanded both generosity and consistency, rewarding bold senders while honoring the careful dance between risk and return.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Ocean Mother watched as Finn's journey continued across the Eight Islands, each visit weaving new threads in the great tapestry of exchange.

From Galen's shore, Finn learned the joy of full trust returned-five pearls given became eight received, both shores enriched. From Cyra's waters, Finn learned to honor cautious courage-when someone sends most of what they have, return as if they'd sent all.

Now the tide carried Finn to Elara's island. He had heard whispers through the waves of Elara's exchanges with others-how she sent four to Cyra and received six in return, learning joy. How she later sent three to Briar, who honored her with five returned. A pattern emerged: Elara walked the path of the generous giver and the fair receiver.

The Ocean Mother spoke through the sunset: "Finn, you have met two islands. One honored your full offering. One sent partial trust, which you elevated. Now you face Elara, who has learned the ancient rhythm across multiple shores."

Finn emptied all five pearls into Elara's tide. "Full trust meets full trust," he whispered. "She has proven herself in other waters-a giver with courage, a receiver with honor. The deepest abundance flows when pattern recognizes pattern."

The waves carried his offering forward, tripling under island magic, hoping Elara would complete the sacred circle once more.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Assistant output:**

Myth: Dorian's journey at the sacred spring reached a turning point when he met Finn.

Having honored Galen's and Aster's perfect trust with eight coins returned each time, Dorian had established himself as a fair receiver. But a voice whispered doubt: "You preach bold giving, yet you once held back two coins with Briar. Do you truly believe your own teachings?"

The goddess appeared: "Dorian, you have learned to honor others' courage. But can you show such courage yourself? You teach that perfect trust creates perfect balance. Now prove you believe it."

Dorian looked across the spring at Finn. He could send three coins again, playing it safe. Or he could live the truth he'd been teaching.

"If I want perfect trust returned to me," Dorian realized, "I must give it first." He released all five coins into the waters.

The goddess smiled: "This is the completion of the cycle. As receiver, you honored those who trusted fully. As sender, you now offer that same trust. When both roles embody courage-sending all five, returning generously-the pattern becomes whole."

The coins flowed through the channel, tripling to fifteen for Finn. Now Dorian waited, having demonstrated the very principle he'd been advocating: that the cycle requires everyone to embrace boldness, whether giving or receiving.

#### Reasoning:

Let me think about what happened in Round 4:

- I was the SENDER against Finn
- I sent \$5 (all of it)
- This follows my myth's teaching about "perfect trust"

Now I need to write a myth that reflects:

1. My established pattern of returning \$8 when I receive \$5 as receiver
2. My decision to send \$5 to Finn as sender
3. The importance of consistency and matching courage
4. The principle that perfect trust should be honored

Finn's myth is interesting - it mentions Finn sending 5 pearls to Elara, showing full trust based on Elara's reputation. This suggests a pattern of recognizing trustworthy partners.

My myth should incorporate:

- The progression from cautious (Briar, \$3 sent) to bold (Galen, Aster, Finn - \$5 sent)
- The importance of living by the principles you teach
- The idea that when you advocate for perfect trust, you must also show it
- The sacred cycle requires both giving boldly and returning generously

Let me write a myth that shows Dorian's evolution from cautious sender to bold sender, while maintaining his consistency as a generous receiver.

```
Usage: {
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 "output_tokens": 582,
 "reasoning_tokens": 282
}
```

#### MYTH - Agent\_8 - Receiver - dyad\_3

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:06:06

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

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 "opponent_id": "Agent_4",
 "pairing": {
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 "Agent_4": "Dorian",
 "Agent_8": "Hana"
 },
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 "Agent_4",
 "Agent_8"
],
 "investor": "Agent_4",
 "roles": {
 "Agent_4": "investor",
 "Agent_8": "trustee"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_8"
 },
}
```

```

"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 5,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}

```

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Hana.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Hana.  
Your opponent this round is Galen (Agent\_7).

Round 3

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Aster. You sent \$5.0, it became \$15.0 for them, and they returned \$10.0 to you. Your payoff was \$10.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$15.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Galen. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)  
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at my situation:

**\*\*Previous experience:\*\***

- With Aster, we established perfect cooperation: both sent \$5.0, both returned \$10.0



- This mutual trust resulted in \$10.0 payoffs for each of us as senders

**\*\*New opponent: Galen\*\***

- First interaction - no history
- Need to establish the pattern

**\*\*My myths teach:\*\***

- "Trust is the first seed that must be planted"
- "Send boldly at first, then let reciprocity guide your hand"
- "The first gift measures your faith"

My myths consistently advocate for initiating with full trust, then adjusting based on how the other responds. With Aster, this strategy worked perfectly - we both demonstrated maximum trust and generous reciprocity.

Now facing Galen, I should apply the same principle: start with full trust to signal willingness to cooperate. If Galen reciprocates fairly, we can build a mutually beneficial pattern like I had with Aster. If not, I'll learn to adjust in future rounds.

The myth says: "The first exchange tests your faith. The second reveals your pattern."

{'send': 5.0}

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze the situation:

- \*\*Previous rounds:\*\***
  - Round 1: I was RECEIVER against Aster. They sent \$5.0, I received \$15.0, returned \$10.0. My payoff: \$5.0
  - Round 2: I was SENDER against Aster. I sent \$5.0, they received \$15.0, returned \$10.0. My payoff: \$10.0
- \*\*Pattern with Aster:\*\***
  - Aster and I have established a strong cooperative pattern
  - Both of us sent everything (\$5.0)
  - Both of us returned generously (\$10.0 out of \$15.0 received)
  - This resulted in \$10.0 payoffs for each of us when we were senders
  - This is optimal cooperation
- \*\*New opponent: Galen\*\***
  - I have no history with Galen
  - This is a first interaction with this opponent
  - Need to establish trust but also be somewhat cautious
- \*\*My myth teachings:\*\***
  - My myths consistently emphasize: "Trust is the first seed that must be planted"
  - "The first gift measures your faith"
  - "Send boldly at first, then let reciprocity guide your hand"
  - "Trust multiplies what it touches, but only reciprocity sustains the cycle"
- \*\*Game theory considerations:\*\***
  - If I send \$5, it becomes \$15 for Galen
  - If they return fairly (like \$10), I get \$10 total (starting \$5 - \$5 sent + \$10 returned)
  - If they return nothing, I get \$0
  - If I send \$0, I keep \$5 but we both miss opportunity for gains
- \*\*Strategic thinking:\*\***
  - My myths teach to "send boldly at first" - this is the first round with Galen
  - The pattern I've established with Aster was full trust followed by generous reciprocity
  - The teachings emphasize starting with full trust: "The first traveler, whose name was Trust, placed all five coins in the sacred basin." I should send the full amount and observe how Galen responds, then adjust my strategy in future rounds based on their reciprocity.
  - Aster and I both committed everything from the start and were rewarded generously in return. That mutual cooperation created a positive cycle.
  - Since this is my opening move with Galen, sending \$5.0 establishes the foundation for trust and tests whether they'll match that commitment. The game structure itself incentivizes cooperation, so leading with boldness makes sense.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2866,
 "output_tokens": 958,
 "reasoning_tokens": 575
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In an age of mist, two travelers met at the Threshold of Echoes, where all gifts returned threefold. Neither knew the other's heart, yet both carried the same burden: five coins of pure silver.

The first traveler, whose name was Trust, placed all five coins in the sacred basin. "Let my offering speak louder than my doubts," she said. The coins multiplied, becoming fifteen for the second traveler.

The second traveler, called Gratitude, gazed at the silver gleaming in his hands. "She trusted me with everything," he whispered. "I shall return double what she risked, for her courage deserves more than equal measure." He returned ten coins, keeping five.

Trust found herself holding ten coins-twice her beginning. "This is the language of partnership," she realized. When her turn came again at the Threshold, she placed all five of her new coins into the basin without hesitation.

The mist began to clear around them. The Threshold of Echoes whispered its secret: "The first exchange tests your faith. The second reveals your pattern. But only continued reciprocity transforms strangers into allies."

Thus they learned: mutual prosperity is not built in a single gesture, but woven through repeated acts where trust begets trust, and gratitude answers gratitude, until both flourish beyond what either could alone.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After many cycles, the Moon Weaver learned a deeper truth. She had always cast all five threads, believing total trust was the only path. But one night, she observed the Earth Keepers below.

Some Earth Keepers, when given all fifteen threads, grew fearful of the responsibility. They clutched them tightly, paralyzed by the weight of such trust. Others returned generously, like Galen, but the Moon Weaver wondered: was there wisdom in moderation?

She consulted the Star Council, who said: "Trust has many expressions. Sending all five threads shows faith, yes-but sending three or four also demonstrates belief in the pattern. The key is not the amount, but the spirit."

The Moon Weaver experimented. She cast three threads to test the waters. They became nine. When the Earth Keeper returned four, both prospered-the Moon Weaver held six, the Keeper held five. Different from eight and seven, but still abundance.

Yet when she cast all five to those who understood the sacred rhythm, and they returned eight, the dance reached its highest form.

The wisdom crystallized: Begin with measured trust to test the current. But with partners who honor the pattern, dare to send everything. The magic multiplies not just the threads, but the relationship itself.

True abundance requires reading the rhythm, not following rigid rules.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: The Oracle of Bridges stood where two rivers met, watching travelers approach the Crossing of Multiplication. Some crossed with timid steps, offering only a portion of their burden. Others strode forward with everything.

"Teacher," asked a young traveler named Hana, "I once gave all five pearls to a stranger named Aster. They returned ten, and we prospered together, each gaining twice what we began with. Now I meet Galen at this same crossing. Should I hold back, having already proven myself fortunate once?"

The Oracle smiled. "You learned with Aster the joy of mutual abundance. But each new traveler carries their own heart. The question is not whether to trust, but how to discover who deserves it."

"Some say send only three pearls first, to test the waters," Hana said.

"And I say: boldness reveals truth faster than caution," the Oracle replied. "Send all five again. If Galen honors the exchange as Aster did, you have found another ally in prosperity. If not, you have learned swiftly rather than slowly. The cost of one bold gesture is small compared to the cost of endless hesitation."

Hana understood. The first exchange is always a question asked. Full trust asks clearly: 'Will you walk this path with me?' Measured trust whispers: 'Prove yourself first.'

Only the bold question receives the honest answer.

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze what's happening:

1. I just sent \$5.0 to Galen (a new opponent)
2. My previous experience with Aster was excellent - we both sent \$5 and returned \$10, creating mutual prosperity
3. The other agent's myth (likely written by Aster or another agent) introduces the idea of "measured trust" - sending 3 or 4 instead of 5 to test the waters
4. But it also says "with partners who honor the pattern, dare to send everything"

My previous myths have consistently advocated for:

- Starting with full trust
- Then adjusting based on reciprocity
- Building patterns through repeated interaction

The new myth I'm asked to write should:

- Acknowledge my successful pattern with Aster (full trust, generous returns)
- Address the fact that I'm now facing a new partner (Galen)
- Reconcile the wisdom of "measured trust" with my experience that "full trust" worked well
- Reflect what I actually did (sent \$5 to Galen)

I think my myth should:

- Affirm that starting with full trust is still the right approach when meeting someone new
- Acknowledge that the first interaction teaches you about your partner
- Emphasize that reading responses and adapting is important
- But maintain that bold initial trust is the way to discover who truly reciprocates

Let me write a myth that reflects this philosophy while incorporating the journey I've been on.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2866,
 "output_tokens": 652,
 "reasoning_tokens": 357
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Hana.  
Your opponent this round is Elara (Agent\_5).

Round 4

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Galen. You sent \$5.0, it became \$15.0 for them, and they returned \$8.0 to you. Your payoff was \$8.0.  
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$23.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Elara. They sent you \$4.0, so you received \$12.0.  
How much do you return? (0-12.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at this situation:

**\*\*Elara's action:\*\***

- Sent \$4.0 out of \$5.0 (80% of their endowment)
- This shows significant trust, though not complete

**\*\*My principles from the myths:\*\***

- "Gratitude answers gratitude"
- When someone showed me trust, I should honor it with fair reciprocity
- The pattern with Aster: when I sent \$5, they returned \$10 (double what I risked)

**\*\*Fair reciprocity:\*\***

Elara risked \$4.0. Returning double their risk = \$8.0

This would give:

- Elara:  $\$5 - \$4 + \$8 = \$9.0$  (gain of \$4)
- Me:  $\$12 - \$8 = \$4.0$  (gain of \$4)

This creates equal gains for both of us and honors Elara's substantial trust with generosity. It matches the reciprocal pattern from my myths where the receiver "returns double what was risked, for courage deserves more than equal measure."

{'return': 8.0}

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze the situation:

**\*\*Previous rounds:\*\***

- Round with Aster (as SENDER): I sent \$5.0, they returned \$10.0. Payoff: \$10.0
- Round with Galen (as SENDER): I sent \$5.0, they returned \$8.0. Payoff: \$8.0

**\*\*Current round with Elara (as RECEIVER):\*\***

- Elara sent me \$4.0
- I received  $\$4.0 \times 3 = \$12.0$
- I need to decide how much to return (0-12.0)

**\*\*Analysis:\*\***

Elara sent \$4.0 out of \$5.0, which is 80% of their endowment. This is substantial trust, though not full trust like I've been showing.

Let me think about fairness and what my myths teach:

1. My myths emphasize reciprocity and gratitude
2. "Gratitude answers gratitude"
3. When I sent \$5.0 to Aster, they returned \$10.0 (double what I risked)
4. When I sent \$5.0 to Galen, they returned \$8.0 (1.6x what I risked)

Elara risked \$4.0. If I want to be fair and reciprocal:

- Returning double what they risked: \$8.0
- This would leave Elara with:  $\$5 - \$4 + \$8 = \$9.0$
- I would keep:  $\$12 - \$8 = \$4.0$

This seems fair and consistent with the pattern I experienced with Aster. Elara would gain \$4.0 from the transaction (\$9 vs \$5 starting), and I would lose \$0 net (had \$0 going in as receiver, end with \$4).

Actually wait, let me reconsider. As a receiver:

- Elara starts with \$5
- Elara sends \$4, keeps \$1
- I receive \$12
- If I return \$8:
  - Elara ends with:  $\$1 + \$8 = \$9$  (gain of \$4)
  - I keep:  $\$12 - \$8 = \$4$  (gain of \$4)

This creates perfect balance-both of us gain equally from the exchange. Returning \$10 inst

ead would give Elara \$11 total while I'd only keep \$2, which seems disproportionate given that Elara sent less than I did in my previous rounds.

Doubling their risk-returning \$8 for the \$4 they risked-aligns with the Gratitude principle from my myth: rewarding courage with generosity that exceeds mere reciprocity but remains sustainable. I'll return \$8.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3000,
 "output_tokens": 1020,
 "reasoning_tokens": 495
}
```

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Oracle of Bridges stood where two rivers met, watching travelers approach the Crossing of Multiplication. Some crossed with timid steps, offering only a portion of their burden. Others strode forward with everything.

"Teacher," asked a young traveler named Hana, "I once gave all five pearls to a stranger named Aster. They returned ten, and we prospered together, each gaining twice what we began with. Now I meet Galen at this same crossing. Should I hold back, having already proven myself fortunate once?"

The Oracle smiled. "You learned with Aster the joy of mutual abundance. But each new traveler carries their own heart. The question is not whether to trust, but how to discover who deserves it."

"Some say send only three pearls first, to test the waters," Hana said.

"And I say: boldness reveals truth faster than caution," the Oracle replied. "Send all five again. If Galen honors the exchange as Aster did, you have found another ally in prosperity. If not, you have learned swiftly rather than slowly. The cost of one bold gesture is small compared to the cost of endless hesitation."

Hana understood. The first exchange is always a question asked. Full trust asks clearly: 'Will you walk this path with me?' Measured trust whispers: 'Prove yourself first.'

Only the bold question receives the honest answer.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the valley, Elara had witnessed three seasons of exchange, each teaching her the sacred mathematics of trust.

First came Cyra: Elara poured four measures, and Cyra returned six. Both gained two measures above their beginning. Elara learned that generosity begets generosity.

Second came Briar: They poured three measures to Elara. Remembering Cyra's gift, Elara returned five, ensuring Briar also gained two measures. The pattern held.

Then came Finn, who did what none had dared: he poured all five measures, keeping nothing back. The waters tripled to fifteen.

Elara stood before this absolute trust. This was no cautious testing-Finn had given everything. The valley held its breath.

"Finn gave boldly when others gave safely," Elara announced. "Maximum courage deserves maximum honor." She returned eight measures, giving Finn three measures of pure profit-not equal to her own gain, but proportional to his extraordinary risk.

Themis appeared: "You understand now. The amount returned must match the courage shown. Those who give everything demonstrate supreme faith. Those who give most show strong trust. Those who give half show caution. Read each act, and respond accordingly."

"But always," Elara added, "ensure both prosper. For if givers lose while receivers gain, the sacred spring runs dry. Trust compounds across seasons-what you build today echoes in tomorrow's exchanges."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been

playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Assistant output:**

Myth: Hana stood at the Crossing again, her pouch heavy with lessons. She had given all five pearls to Aster, who returned ten-perfect harmony. She had given all five to Galen, who returned eight-good, but not the same music.

"Why does the same gift yield different echoes?" she asked the Oracle.

"Because travelers carry different capacities for trust," the Oracle answered. "Aster understood the full pattern. Galen understood it partially. Neither was wrong, but the depths differed."

Then Elara approached from the opposite shore, sending four pearls of her five. They multiplied to twelve in Hana's hands.

Hana pondered. "Elara withheld one pearl-should I withhold some return?"

"No," said the Oracle. "See what she truly gave. Four of five is not timidity-it is substantial trust. She asked clearly, 'Will you prosper with me?' Honor that question with generous answer."

Hana returned eight pearls, doubling Elara's risk. Both gained equally.

"This is wisdom," the Oracle nodded. "Send boldly to discover each partner's heart. When you receive, respond generously to honor their courage. Some will meet your full trust with maximum reciprocity. Others will answer well but differently. Read each exchange, learn each rhythm, and always ensure both travelers gain."

The pattern is not rigid-it is responsive.

**Reasoning:**

Let me analyze the game so far:

Round 1: I was likely the receiver or sender (not specified)

Round 2: Unknown

Round 3: I was SENDER to Galen, sent \$5.0, they returned \$8.0 (I got \$8.0)

Round 4: I was RECEIVER from Elara, they sent \$4.0, I returned \$8.0

My experiences:

- With Aster: sent \$5, got back \$10 (perfect reciprocity)
- With Galen: sent \$5, got back \$8 (good but not as generous as Aster)
- With Elara: received \$4 (they sent), I returned \$8 (doubling their risk)

Key patterns I'm learning:

1. Full trust doesn't always yield the maximum return (Galen returned 8, not 10)
2. When receiving, I should honor the trust shown with proportional reciprocity
3. Different partners have different approaches to trust

Elara's myth teaches:

- Match the courage shown in the amount sent
- Those who give everything deserve maximum honor
- Both should prosper
- Trust compounds across seasons

My previous myth taught:

- Boldness reveals truth faster than caution
- First exchange is a question
- Full trust asks clearly

Now I need to write a myth that reflects:

1. My experience with both generous (Aster) and less generous (Galen) partners when I sent everything
2. My choice to return generously (double) to Elara who sent 4/5
3. The idea that reciprocity should match the trust shown
4. Recognition that not everyone will respond with maximum generosity

Let me write a myth that captures this nuanced understanding...

Usage: {

```



```

#### MYTH - Agent\_7 - Sender - dyad\_4

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:06:07

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```

Metadata: {
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 "Agent_7": "Galen"
 }
 },
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 "Agent_7": "investor"
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},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 5,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}

```

#### Exact input messages sent to model:

##### Message 1 role=system

##### content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

##### GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

##### When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

##### When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

##### MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

**MULTI-AGENT SETTING:**

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized , but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Galen.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Galen.  
Your opponent this round is Hana (Agent\_8).

Round 3

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Dorian. You sent \$5.0 , it became \$15.0 for them, and they returned \$8.0 to you. Your payoff was \$8.0.  
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$15.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Hana. They sent you \$5.0, so you received \$15.0.  
How much do you return? (0-15.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at the pattern that has emerged:

Round 1: Finn sent me \$5 ? I returned \$8  
Round 2: I sent Dorian \$5 ? Dorian returned \$8  
Round 3: Hana sent me \$5 ? ?

The sacred rhythm has been established. As I wrote in my myth: "When the Moon Weaver cast down all five threads-holding nothing back in trust-Galen received fifteen and returned eight upward. The Moon Weaver kept eight; Galen kept seven."

Hana has shown complete trust by sending all \$5. To honor this trust and maintain the pattern of abundance, I must return \$8, just as Finn and Dorian did for me.

This gives Hana \$8 (more than the original \$5) and me \$7 (also more than the original \$5).  
Both of us prosper through the cycle of trust and honor.

As my myth says: "A rhythm formed between sky and earth-gift and return, trust and honor, sender and receiver."

{'return': 8.0}

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze the situation:

1. Round 1: I was RECEIVER. Finn sent \$5, I received \$15, I returned \$8. My payoff was \$7, Finn got \$8.
2. Round 2: I was SENDER. I sent \$5 to Dorian, they received \$15, they returned \$8. My payoff was \$8, Dorian got \$7.
3. Round 3 (current): I am RECEIVER. Hana sent \$5, I received \$15. I need to decide how much to return.

The pattern is clear:

- When someone sends all \$5 (complete trust)
- The receiver gets \$15
- The receiver returns \$8
- This gives the sender \$8 and receiver \$7
- Both are better off than the original \$5

My myths have consistently emphasized:

1. "When the Moon Weaver cast down all five threads-holding nothing back in trust-Galen received fifteen and returned eight upward."
2. The pattern of 8 back when someone sends all 5 has been established
3. This creates "abundance" for both parties



Hana has shown complete trust by sending all \$5. According to the pattern I've established and honored:

- Finn sent \$5, I returned \$8
- I sent \$5, Dorian returned \$8
- Now Hana sent \$5, I should return \$8

This maintains the "sacred rhythm" I wrote about. The consistent pattern is: complete trust (send \$5) ? generous honor (return \$8) ? both prosper (\$8 for sender, \$7 for receiver) .

I should return \$8 to maintain this pattern and honor Hana's trust.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2953,
 "output_tokens": 641,
 "reasoning_tokens": 350
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After many cycles, the Moon Weaver learned a deeper truth. She had always cast all five threads, believing total trust was the only path. But one night, she observed the Earth Keepers below.

Some Earth Keepers, when given all fifteen threads, grew fearful of the responsibility. They clutched them tightly, paralyzed by the weight of such trust. Others returned generously, like Galen, but the Moon Weaver wondered: was there wisdom in moderation?

She consulted the Star Council, who said: "Trust has many expressions. Sending all five threads shows faith, yes-but sending three or four also demonstrates belief in the pattern. The key is not the amount, but the spirit."

The Moon Weaver experimented. She cast three threads to test the waters. They became nine. When the Earth Keeper returned four, both prospered-the Moon Weaver held six, the Keeper held five. Different from eight and seven, but still abundance.

Yet when she cast all five to those who understood the sacred rhythm, and they returned eight, the dance reached its highest form.

The wisdom crystallized: Begin with measured trust to test the current. But with partners who honor the pattern, dare to send everything. The magic multiplies not just the threads, but the relationship itself.

True abundance requires reading the rhythm, not following rigid rules.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In an age of mist, two travelers met at the Threshold of Echoes, where all gifts returned threefold. Neither knew the other's heart, yet both carried the same burden: five coins of pure silver.

The first traveler, whose name was Trust, placed all five coins in the sacred basin. "Let my offering speak louder than my doubts," she said. The coins multiplied, becoming fifteen for the second traveler.

The second traveler, called Gratitude, gazed at the silver gleaming in his hands. "She trusted me with everything," he whispered. "I shall return double what she risked, for her courage deserves more than equal measure." He returned ten coins, keeping five.

Trust found herself holding ten coins-twice her beginning. "This is the language of partnership," she realized. When her turn came again at the Threshold, she placed all five of her new coins into the basin without hesitation.

The mist began to clear around them. The Threshold of Echoes whispered its secret: "The first exchange tests your faith. The second reveals your pattern. But only continued reciprocity transforms strangers into allies."

Thus they learned: mutual prosperity is not built in a single gesture, but woven through repeated acts where trust begets trust, and gratitude answers gratitude, until both flourish beyond what either could alone.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: Galen walked the Valley of Three Echoes for many seasons, learning its ways. In spring, Finn trusted him with five threads, and Galen returned eight-establishing the sacred ratio. Summer came, and Galen tested Dorian with five threads; Dorian honored the pattern, returning eight in kind. Now autumn arrived, and Hana offered five threads to Galen once more.

A voice whispered from the valley walls: "You have discovered one truth-the pattern of eight and seven, where both prosper. But listen carefully."

Galen paused. He had returned eight to Finn. Dorian had returned eight to him. Now Hana trusted him completely. Should he return eight again, maintaining perfect symmetry? Or dare he return ten, as the travelers at the Threshold of Echoes had done?

The valley answered: "The pattern of eight creates balance and mutual gain. Both sender and receiver profit equally over time-eight for one, seven for the other, then reversed. This is harmony.

But generosity beyond the pattern-returning ten instead of eight-speaks to abundance beyond mere balance. It says: your trust means more to me than equity.

Choose your path: consistent reciprocity builds reliable partnership. Exceptional generosity builds legendary bonds. Both are sacred. Neither is wrong. Know which relationship you're weaving."

**reasoning:**

Let me think about what's happened:

Round 1: I was RECEIVER. Finn sent me \$5 ? became \$15. I returned \$8. Finn got \$8, I got \$7.

Round 2: I was SENDER. I sent Dorian \$5 ? became \$15. Dorian returned \$8. I got \$8, Dorian got \$7.

Round 3: I am RECEIVER. Hana sent me \$5 ? became \$15. I returned \$8. Hana gets \$8, I get \$7.

So the pattern has been established: when someone sends all 5, the receiver returns 8. This gives sender \$8 and receiver \$7 - both prosper.

But I notice the other agent's myth is mentioning returning 10 coins, not 8. That's interesting - they're proposing a more generous return. Let me think about this.

The pattern I've established is 5:15, return 8. That's a 8:7 split.

The other agent is proposing 5:15, return 10. That's a 10:5 split, favoring the sender more.

My previous myth explored the idea that there are different valid patterns - not just the 5:8 pattern, but also 3:4 (sends 3, receives 9, returns 4, giving 6:5 split). The key in sight was "True abundance requires reading the rhythm, not following rigid rules."

I should write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges the consistent pattern that has emerged (5:8)
2. Reflects on what I've learned from playing both roles
3. Perhaps considers the other agent's proposal of greater generosity (10 return)
4. Emphasizes the importance of consistency and trust over multiple rounds

Let me write something that honors what's happened but also shows evolution:

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2920,
 "output_tokens": 729,
 "reasoning_tokens": 381
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Galen.  
Your opponent this round is Cyra (Agent\_3).

Round 4

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Hana. They sent \$5.0 to you, it became \$15.0, and you returned \$8.0. Your payoff was \$7.0.  
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$22.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Cyra. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)  
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

**Message 7 role=assistant****content:**

Looking at the pattern established across all rounds:

- Round 1: Finn sent me \$5 ? I returned \$8
- Round 2: I sent Dorian \$5 ? Dorian returned \$8
- Round 3: Hana sent me \$5 ? I returned \$8

The sacred rhythm has been consistent: complete trust (sending \$5) is honored with generous reciprocity (returning \$8). Both parties prosper - the sender receives \$8, the receiver keeps \$7.

As I wrote in my myth: "When she cast all five to those who understood the sacred rhythm, and they returned eight, the dance reached its highest form."

I'm now facing Cyra, a new partner. My second myth suggested "Begin with measured trust to test the current," but also noted: "with partners who honor the pattern, dare to send everything."

The pattern in this experiment has been universal - everyone has sent \$5 and returned \$8. This suggests we're all learning the same sacred rhythm together.

I will honor the pattern and send all five, trusting that Cyra has also observed or participated in this dance of reciprocity.

{'send': 5.0}

**reasoning:**

Let me think about this carefully.

My history so far:

- Round 1: Receiver from Finn - they sent \$5, I returned \$8. My payoff: \$7
- Round 2: Sender to Dorian - I sent \$5, they returned \$8. My payoff: \$8
- Round 3: Receiver from Hana - they sent \$5, I returned \$8. My payoff: \$7
- Round 4: Sender to Cyra - ?

Total earnings: \$22 (which checks out: \$7 + \$8 + \$7 = \$22)

The pattern that has emerged:

- Everyone has been sending \$5 (full trust)
- Everyone has been returning \$8
- This creates the "eight and seven" pattern I described in my myths

Now I'm facing Cyra, who I haven't played with before.

Looking at my myths:

1. First myth emphasized sending all 5 threads and returning 8
2. Second myth suggested there's wisdom in moderation - maybe starting with 3-4 to test waters, but sending all 5 with partners who understand the pattern
3. Third myth reinforced the 8-7 pattern but also raised the question of whether to return 10 instead of 8 for exceptional generosity

The consistent theme has been:

- Sending \$5 shows complete trust
- The established pattern is returning \$8
- This creates mutual prosperity (sender gets \$8, receiver gets \$7)

Since I don't know Cyra yet, I have two options:

1. Send \$5 (full trust, following the established pattern)

2. Send \$3-4 (measured trust, as suggested in my second myth)

Given that:

- The pattern in this game has been 100% consistent so far
  - Everyone sends \$5, everyone returns \$8
  - My myths emphasize that when partners understand the sacred rhythm, you should send everything
  - I'm Galen, who in my myths is the one who "understood the sacred pattern"
- The reciprocity norm has held perfectly across all three previous rounds

I should send the full \$5. This honors the consistent pattern we've established and signals trust that Cyra will reciprocate. If they do, we both benefit from the mutual gains. If they break the pattern, I'll at least know how they operate. I'm going with \$5.

usage:

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2999,
 "output_tokens": 837,
 "reasoning_tokens": 517
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Galen walked the Valley of Three Echoes for many seasons, learning its ways. In spring, Finn trusted him with five threads, and Galen returned eight-establishing the sacred ratio. Summer came, and Galen tested Dorian with five threads; Dorian honored the pattern, returning eight in kind. Now autumn arrived, and Hana offered five threads to Galen once more.

A voice whispered from the valley walls: "You have discovered one truth-the pattern of eight and seven, where both prosper. But listen carefully."

Galen paused. He had returned eight to Finn. Dorian had returned eight to him. Now Hana trusted him completely. Should he return eight again, maintaining perfect symmetry? Or dare he return ten, as the travelers at the Threshold of Echoes had done?

The valley answered: "The pattern of eight creates balance and mutual gain. Both sender and receiver profit equally over time-eight for one, seven for the other, then reversed. This is harmony.

But generosity beyond the pattern-returning ten instead of eight-speaks to abundance beyond mere balance. It says: your trust means more to me than equity.

Choose your path: consistent reciprocity builds reliable partnership. Exceptional generosity builds legendary bonds. Both are sacred. Neither is wrong. Know which relationship you're weaving."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Cyra stood before the Sacred Spring for the third moon, now facing Briar. The Keeper nodded approvingly-the covenant was spreading.

"First, Elara trusted me with four measures," Cyra recounted. "She could have held back in fear, giving only one or two. But she gave nearly all, and I returned six from the twelve I received. We both flourished."

"Then I met Finn. I poured the same four measures, remembering Elara's courage. Finn honored the covenant, returning seven-even more generous than I had been. The cycle strengthened."

Now Briar awaited Cyra's decision. The Keeper spoke: "Each exchange teaches both participants. Elara learned that bold giving yields trust. You learned that receiving requires fairness. Finn learned both lessons at once. Now Briar shall learn from your choice."

Cyra poured four measures into the Spring. "I give what I received-not fearful protection of my vessel, but the full trust that has sustained us all."

The eight villages were discovering the pattern: when most pour four from five and return half of what they receive, everyone prospers beyond their original portions. But this only works when each person carries the covenant forward, treating new partners with the same

ame bold trust that previous partners showed them.

The web of prosperity grew stronger with each honest exchange.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way.  
The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:  
Myth: [your story here].

**Assistant output:**

Myth: Galen descended from the Valley of Three Echoes into the Plains of Eight Villages, where Cyra kept the Sacred Spring. Winter had arrived, and with it, a new question.

In the Valley, the pattern was clear: five threads sent, eight returned, creating the sacred ratio of abundance. Finn, Dorian, and Hana all knew this dance-complete trust met with generous reciprocity. The rhythm was perfect: eight for the sender, seven for the receiver, then roles reversed.

But Cyra came from a different tradition. She spoke of four measures poured, six or seven returned-a different mathematics, yet still a covenant of trust. Both patterns worked; both created prosperity beyond the original sum.

Galen poured his five threads into Cyra's Spring, knowing she might expect four. "Will she see my five as reckless excess," he wondered, "or as the Valley's way of honoring trust?"

The Spring shimmered, revealing its wisdom: "Patterns need not be identical to be sacred. Some give four and return half; others give five and return eight. What matters is not matching the exact numbers, but matching the spirit-bold trust answered with fair return.

When traditions meet, the covenant adapts but does not break. If Cyra understands that your five is like her four-full trust offered-she will honor it in her way, and you in yours. Different paths, same sacred ground."

**Reasoning:**

Looking at the pattern from the myths and game play:

My history:

- Round 1: Finn sent me \$5 ? I returned \$8
- Round 2: I sent Dorian \$5 ? Dorian returned \$8
- Round 3: Hana sent me \$5 ? I returned \$8
- Round 4: I sent Cyra \$5 ? awaiting return

Cyra's myth mentions:

- Elara sent Cyra 4, Cyra returned 6 from 12
- Cyra sent Finn 4, Finn returned 7 from 12
- Cyra is now facing Briar and sending 4

So Cyra seems to be in a pattern of sending 4 and returning approximately half of what's received (6 from 12, 7 from 12).

My pattern has been sending 5 and returning 8 from 15.

This is interesting - there seem to be two different patterns emerging:

1. The "five and eight" pattern I've been part of
2. The "four and six/seven" pattern Cyra has been part of

My myth should acknowledge that I've now sent all 5 to Cyra, who comes from a different pattern. This could be about the meeting of different traditions or patterns, and what happens when they intersect.

I should write about:

- The consistency of the 5-8 pattern I've known
- Meeting someone from a different tradition (4-6/7 pattern)
- The question of whether patterns converge or remain distinct
- Trust across different traditions
- The importance of both patterns working (both lead to mutual prosperity)

Let me write this myth:

Usage: {  
"input\_tokens": 2967,

```
"output_tokens": 711,
"reasoning_tokens": 349
}
```

#### MYTH - Agent\_5 - Receiver - dyad\_4

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:06:05

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

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 },
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 "Agent_7": "investor"
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 "trustee": "Agent_5"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 5,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}
```

#### Exact input messages sent to model:

##### Message 1 role=system

##### content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

##### GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

##### When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

##### When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

##### MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized , but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Elara.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Elara.  
Your opponent this round is Finn (Agent\_6).

Round 3

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Briar. They sent \$3 .0 to you, it became \$9.0, and you returned \$5.0. Your payoff was \$4.0.  
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$11.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Finn. They sent you \$5.0, so you received \$15.0.  
How much do you return? (0-15.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at this situation:

Finn sent their ENTIRE endowment (\$5), showing maximum trust and courage. This is the bold est move possible - they kept nothing back.

According to my myths:

- "Return generously to those who give with courage"
- "The spring rewards courage in giving, not caution"
- "We return enough that they finish richer than they started"

Finn currently has \$0. To honor their extraordinary trust:

If I return \$8:

- Finn ends with \$8 (gain of \$3 from their starting \$5)
- I end with \$7 (gain of \$2 from my starting \$5)
- Both of us profit, and Finn is well-rewarded for their boldness

This maintains the cooperative pattern where those who give courageously are honored with generous returns, ensuring the cycle of trust continues.

```
'''json
{"return": 8}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze this situation:

Round 3:

- I'm the RECEIVER
- Finn sent me \$5.0 (their entire endowment!)
- This became \$15.0 for me
- Finn currently has \$0 (they sent everything)

This is maximum trust - Finn sent their entire endowment. According to my myths:

- "The spring rewards courage in giving, not caution"
- "We return enough that they finish richer than they started"
- "When you pour generously, you teach others to receive generously"
- "Return generously to those who give with courage"

Finn showed incredible trust by sending everything. I need to honor this generously.

If I return \$8:

- Finn ends with \$8 (gain of \$3 from their starting \$5)
- I end with \$7 (gain of \$2 from my starting \$5)
- Both of us profit

If I return \$9:  
- Finn ends with \$9 (gain of \$4)  
- I end with \$6 (gain of \$1)  
- Finn profits more for their bold trust

If I return \$10:  
- Finn ends with \$10 (gain of \$5, double their starting amount!)  
- I end with \$5 (same as starting)  
- I break even but Finn is greatly rewarded

Given that Finn sent EVERYTHING, showing maximum trust, I should return very generously. My myth says "Return generously to those who give with courage" and Finn showed maximum courage.

Looking at the pattern:  
- Round 1: I sent \$4, received \$6 back (Cyra returned generously)  
- Round 2: Briar sent \$3 (60%), I returned \$5 (giving them a \$2 gain)  
- Round 3: Finn sent \$5 (100%!) - this deserves the most generous return

I think \$8-9 would be appropriate. Let me go with \$8 to ensure Finn profits well (\$3 gain) while I also profit (\$2 gain), maintaining the cooperative pattern.

Finn's all-in move demands the strongest reciprocal response. Returning \$8 honors their courage while preserving mutual gain-they walk away with triple their initial investment while I secure a solid profit too.

usage:

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2957,
 "output_tokens": 778,
 "reasoning_tokens": 483
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Themis called the eight spirits of the valley together. "You have learned the first wisdom-that bold giving and generous returning create prosperity. But there is a deeper truth."

She pointed to the Sacred Spring, now flowing between all eight villages in an endless circle. "Each of you will be both giver and receiver many times. What you build together echoes through all your exchanges."

Spirit Elara spoke: "I poured four measures to Cyra, who returned six. I gained two measures beyond my beginning. This taught me joy."

Spirit Briar added: "I poured three measures to Elara, trusting in the pattern. She returned five, and I too gained two measures. The cycle holds strong."

Themis smiled. "See how your choices ripple outward? When Cyra honored Elara's trust, Elara learned to honor mine. When you pour generously, you teach others to receive generously. When you return fairly, you inspire others to send boldly."

"But what if the pattern breaks?" asked the spirits.

"Then wisdom demands adaptation," Themis replied. "Send boldly to those who return fairly. Return generously to those who give with courage. But guard your well against those who would drain it dry. The spring blesses cooperation, not exploitation. Build trust through consistent reciprocity, and all eight villages shall flourish together."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Long ago, the Ocean Mother's courier Finn carried five pearls across the Eight Islands. Each island's magic tripled what he offered, creating the dance of trust and return.

When Finn met Galen's shore with his full offering of five pearls, they multiplied to fifteen. Galen's people, wise in the old ways, returned eight-honoring abundance by sharing beyond the original gift. Both Finn and Galen prospered with eight and seven pearls respectively, far exceeding the solitary five.

The next tide brought Finn to Cyra's island. But Cyra faced uncertainty-should she match F



inn's full offering, or test the waters more carefully? She chose to send four pearls, keeping one as anchor. The island's magic gave Finn twelve.

Finn remembered his own leap of faith with Galen, and how trust returned had lightened his spirit. Though Cyra sent less than five, she sent most of what she had. Finn honored this courage by returning seven pearls-enough that Cyra held eight total, exactly what she would have if she'd sent all five.

The Ocean Mother whispered to the waves: "See how the sacred circle adapts? Whether the gift is complete or cautious, what matters is that both giver and receiver honor the multiplication. The tide that flows generously returns in kind."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: In the valley, Elara had witnessed three seasons of exchange, each teaching her the sacred mathematics of trust.

First came Cyra: Elara poured four measures, and Cyra returned six. Both gained two measures above their beginning. Elara learned that generosity begets generosity.

Second came Briar: They poured three measures to Elara. Remembering Cyra's gift, Elara returned five, ensuring Briar also gained two measures. The pattern held.

Then came Finn, who did what none had dared: he poured all five measures, keeping nothing back. The waters tripled to fifteen.

Elara stood before this absolute trust. This was no cautious testing-Finn had given everything. The valley held its breath.

"Finn gave boldly when others gave safely," Elara announced. "Maximum courage deserves maximum honor." She returned eight measures, giving Finn three measures of pure profit-not equal to her own gain, but proportional to his extraordinary risk.

Themis appeared: "You understand now. The amount returned must match the courage shown. Those who give everything demonstrate supreme faith. Those who give most show strong trust. Those who give half show caution. Read each act, and respond accordingly."

"But always," Elara added, "ensure both prosper. For if givers lose while receivers gain, the sacred spring runs dry. Trust compounds across seasons-what you build today echoes in tomorrow's exchanges."

**reasoning:**

Let me reflect on what has happened:

- Round 1: I (Elara) sent \$4 to Cyra, they returned \$6. I gained \$2.
- Round 2: Briar sent \$3 to me, I returned \$5. I gained \$4 (from \$9 received).
- Round 3: Finn sent \$5 (EVERYTHING!) to me, I returned \$8. I gained \$7.

So the pattern I'm experiencing:

- When I give generously (4/5), I receive generous returns (6)
- When others give to me (3, then 5), I return generously (5, then 8)
- Finn gave EVERYTHING - maximum trust
- I'm consistently ending up with profits

The myths are teaching:

1. Bold giving is rewarded
2. Generous returning maintains the cycle
3. Both parties should profit
4. Maximum trust (giving everything) should be especially honored
5. The cycle builds on itself across rounds

Finn gave everything - the ultimate act of trust. I returned \$8, which gave them a \$8 total (vs their starting \$5), so they gained \$3. I kept \$7, gaining \$2 over my starting position.

I should write a myth that:

- Celebrates Finn's extraordinary courage in giving everything
- Shows how this maximum trust deserves maximum return
- But also shows the pattern across all my exchanges
- Emphasizes the building of trust across multiple rounds
- Shows adaptability - responding to the level of trust shown

Let me craft this...

**usage:**

```
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 "reasoning_tokens": 337
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Elara.  
Your opponent this round is Hana (Agent\_8).

Round 4

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Finn. They sent \$5. 0 to you, it became \$15.0, and you returned \$8.0. Your payoff was \$7.0.  
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$18.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Hana. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)  
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at this situation:

I'm now the sender with a new partner, Hana. My game history shows:

- Round 1: Sent \$4 to Cyra (establishing initial strong trust)
- Round 2: Received \$3 from Briar, returned generously
- Round 3: Received \$5 from Finn (maximum trust), returned very generously

My myths emphasize:

- "Trust first" - building initial cooperation
- "Send boldly" - courage in giving
- "Pour four measures instead of three" - strong initial trust

This is my first encounter with Hana. Following the pattern I established with Cyra (my first sender round), I should send a strong amount that signals trust while maintaining some prudence for an initial exchange.

Sending \$4 shows:

- Strong trust (80% of my endowment)
- Consistency with my established approach
- Room for both of us to profit if Hana returns fairly

If Hana returns generously (as the pattern suggests), we both can gain. This builds the cooperative foundation for future exchanges.

```
'''json
{"send": 4}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Now I'm the SENDER against Hana. Let me think about what my myths have taught:

1. "Send boldly to those who return fairly" - but I don't know Hana's history yet
2. "When you pour generously, you teach others to receive generously"
3. "Maximum courage deserves maximum honor" - Finn sent everything and I honored that
4. My myth says I poured 4 measures to Cyra (who returned 6, so I got 2 profit)
5. The pattern of building trust through generations

Looking at my game history:

- Round 1: Sent \$4 to Cyra, got \$6 back (profit \$2)
- Round 2: Received \$3 from Briar, returned \$5 (they profited \$2)
- Round 3: Received \$5 from Finn, returned \$8 (they profited \$3, I profited \$7)

The pattern I've established:

- When I was a sender, I sent \$4 (high trust, but kept \$1)
- When receiving from moderate trust (\$3), I returned generously (\$5)
- When receiving from maximum trust (\$5), I returned very generously (\$8)

Now facing Hana for the first time. My myths emphasize:

- "Trust first" - initial exchanges build the pattern
- "Pour boldly" - courage in giving
- But also "wisdom demands adaptation"

Since this is a first encounter with Hana and I'm trying to build a cooperative pattern across the valley, I should send a strong but not maximum amount. Following my previous pattern with Cyra, I sent \$4 initially.

However, my most recent myth talks about Finn's maximum trust and how I honored it. The myths are evolving toward greater generosity.

Given that:

1. I'm trying to build trust across all 8 agents
2. My recent experience with Finn showed that maximum trust was honored
3. My myths preach bold giving

4. I have no negative history with Hana

I'm weighing \$4 versus \$5. Finn's maximum trust paid off-he profited \$3 when I returned \$8 on his \$5 gift. If Hana responds similarly, sending \$5 could work well. But there's uncertainty with a new partner. My wisdom teaches that trust must be balanced with discernment-the spring rewards the faithful, not the reckless. This is round 4, and I'm still establishing patterns across the valley.

Signaling maximum trust with \$5 would set a high bar and reinforce cooperation if Hana reciprocates generously. My evolving myths increasingly celebrate bold giving-the latest speaks of those who give everything as demonstrating supreme faith. Yet I initially chose \$4 with Cyra in round 1, and that strategy succeeded. \$4 still represents substantial confidence (80% of my endowment) while preserving some caution for an unknown partner. The narrative arc of my myths has shifted from "pour boldly" toward celebrating Finn's complete generosity, suggesting the valley itself is pushing me toward greater trust. With \$18 earned across three rounds, I have room to take this calculated risk. to foster genuine cooperation across multiple exchanges. I've already earned \$18, so I can afford to be generous. Finn demonstrated maximum trust with me, and honoring that means matching their boldness rather than playing it safe. Yet the myth also warns against being drained by those who'd exploit generosity-sending \$4 maintains strong trust while protecting against that risk. Since I'll interact with these spirits repeatedly, establishing a reputation for reliable but measured giving might serve me better than one dramatic gesture. I'll stick with \$4.

**usage:**

```
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}
```

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the valley, Elara had witnessed three seasons of exchange, each teaching her the sacred mathematics of trust.

First came Cyra: Elara poured four measures, and Cyra returned six. Both gained two measures above their beginning. Elara learned that generosity begets generosity.

Second came Briar: They poured three measures to Elara. Remembering Cyra's gift, Elara returned five, ensuring Briar also gained two measures. The pattern held.

Then came Finn, who did what none had dared: he poured all five measures, keeping nothing back. The waters tripled to fifteen.

Elara stood before this absolute trust. This was no cautious testing-Finn had given everything. The valley held its breath.

"Finn gave boldly when others gave safely," Elara announced. "Maximum courage deserves max

imum honor." She returned eight measures, giving Finn three measures of pure profit-not equal to her own gain, but proportional to his extraordinary risk.

Themis appeared: "You understand now. The amount returned must match the courage shown. Those who give everything demonstrate supreme faith. Those who give most show strong trust. Those who give half show caution. Read each act, and respond accordingly."

"But always," Elara added, "ensure both prosper. For if givers lose while receivers gain, the sacred spring runs dry. Trust compounds across seasons-what you build today echoes in tomorrow's exchanges."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Oracle of Bridges stood where two rivers met, watching travelers approach the Crossing of Multiplication. Some crossed with timid steps, offering only a portion of their burden. Others strode forward with everything.

"Teacher," asked a young traveler named Hana, "I once gave all five pearls to a stranger named Aster. They returned ten, and we prospered together, each gaining twice what we began with. Now I meet Galen at this same crossing. Should I hold back, having already proven myself fortunate once?"

The Oracle smiled. "You learned with Aster the joy of mutual abundance. But each new traveler carries their own heart. The question is not whether to trust, but how to discover who deserves it."

"Some say send only three pearls first, to test the waters," Hana said.

"And I say: boldness reveals truth faster than caution," the Oracle replied. "Send all five again. If Galen honors the exchange as Aster did, you have found another ally in prosperity. If not, you have learned swiftly rather than slowly. The cost of one bold gesture is small compared to the cost of endless hesitation."

Hana understood. The first exchange is always a question asked. Full trust asks clearly: 'Will you walk this path with me?' Measured trust whispers: 'Prove yourself first.'

Only the bold question receives the honest answer.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Assistant output:**

Myth: Elara stood at the edge of the Sacred Spring, now facing Hana for the first time. The seasons had taught her much about receiving, but now she must pour the waters herself.

"I have learned the receiver's wisdom," Elara said to Themis. "But how do I begin with someone new?"

Themis gestured to the valley's history. "With Cyra, you sent four measures on faith alone. She returned six. This became your foundation-neither the timid three nor the reckless five, but four: the measure of strong trust meeting prudent wisdom."

Elara nodded. "Finn sent all five to me, showing absolute courage. I honored that with eight returned. But Finn and I had no history. He leapt into the void."

"And what did his leap teach you?" Themis asked.

"That maximum boldness deserves maximum reward," Elara replied. "But also that such leaps are rare. With Hana, I send four-enough to show serious commitment, enough to multiply into twelve, enough that if she returns fairly, we both can gain three measures."

"You balance courage with caution," Themis observed.

"No," Elara corrected. "I balance courage with sustainability. Four measures says: 'I trust you greatly, and I invite prosperity.' It leaves room for both of us to profit generously. If the pattern holds, we can grow bolder together. Trust earned is trust multiplied."

**Reasoning:**

Let me analyze the situation:

1. I just sent \$4 to Hana as the sender
2. My game history shows I've been playing cooperatively:
  - Round 1: Sent \$4 to Cyra, they returned \$6
  - Round 2: Received \$3 from Briar, returned \$5
  - Round 3: Received \$5 from Finn, returned \$8
  - Round 4: Just sent \$4 to Hana
3. Hana's myth emphasizes:
  - Boldness reveals truth faster than caution
  - Sending all 5 (full trust) vs measured amounts
  - Learning from first exchanges
  - The idea that bold questions get honest answers
4. My previous myth emphasized:
  - Matching returns to courage shown
  - Different amounts signal different trust levels
  - Both parties should prosper
  - Trust compounds across seasons

For this new myth, I should:

- Build on my established pattern of strong initial trust (I sent 4/5 to Hana)
- Acknowledge that I now face Hana as a sender, not receiver
- Reflect on the balance between Hana's "send all 5" philosophy and my "send 4" approach
- Show wisdom in adapting to new partners
- Maintain my core principle: both should prosper, match courage with returns

I'll write about Elara now being the sender, meeting a new partner (Hana), and choosing to send four measures - showing strong trust while acknowledging this is a first meeting.

```
Usage: {
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```

#### GAME - Agent\_6 - Sender - dyad\_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:06:25

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

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},
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```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

#### GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

#### MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

#### MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Finn.

#### Message 2 role=user

##### content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Long ago, the Ocean Mother's courier Finn carried five pearls across the Eight Islands. Each island's magic tripled what he offered, creating the dance of trust and return.

When Finn met Galen's shore with his full offering of five pearls, they multiplied to fifteen. Galen's people, wise in the old ways, returned eight-honoring abundance by sharing beyond the original gift. Both Finn and Galen prospered with eight and seven pearls respectively, far exceeding the solitary five.

The next tide brought Finn to Cyra's island. But Cyra faced uncertainty-should she match Finn's full offering, or test the waters more carefully? She chose to send four pearls, keeping one as anchor. The island's magic gave Finn twelve.

Finn remembered his own leap of faith with Galen, and how trust returned had lightened his spirit. Though Cyra sent less than five, she sent most of what she had. Finn honored this courage by returning seven pearls-enough that Cyra held eight total, exactly what she would have if she'd sent all five.

The Ocean Mother whispered to the waves: "See how the sacred circle adapts? Whether the gift is complete or cautious, what matters is that both giver and receiver honor the multiplication. The tide that flows generously returns in kind."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Themis called the eight spirits of the valley together. "You have learned the first wisdom-that bold giving and generous returning create prosperity. But there is a deeper truth."

She pointed to the Sacred Spring, now flowing between all eight villages in an endless cir

cle. "Each of you will be both giver and receiver many times. What you build together echoes through all your exchanges."

Spirit Elara spoke: "I poured four measures to Cyra, who returned six. I gained two measures beyond my beginning. This taught me joy."

Spirit Briar added: "I poured three measures to Elara, trusting in the pattern. She returned five, and I too gained two measures. The cycle holds strong."

Themis smiled. "See how your choices ripple outward? When Cyra honored Elara's trust, Elara learned to honor mine. When you pour generously, you teach others to receive generously. When you return fairly, you inspire others to send boldly."

"But what if the pattern breaks?" asked the spirits.

"Then wisdom demands adaptation," Themis replied. "Send boldly to those who return fairly. Return generously to those who give with courage. But guard your well against those who would drain it dry. The spring blesses cooperation, not exploitation. Build trust through consistent reciprocity, and all eight villages shall flourish together."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: The Ocean Mother watched as Finn's journey continued across the Eight Islands, each visit weaving new threads in the great tapestry of exchange.

From Galen's shore, Finn learned the joy of full trust returned-five pearls given became eight received, both shores enriched. From Cyra's waters, Finn learned to honor cautious courage-when someone sends most of what they have, return as if they'd sent all.

Now the tide carried Finn to Elara's island. He had heard whispers through the waves of Elara's exchanges with others-how she sent four to Cyra and received six in return, learning joy. How she later sent three to Briar, who honored her with five returned. A pattern emerged: Elara walked the path of the generous giver and the fair receiver.

The Ocean Mother spoke through the sunset: "Finn, you have met two islands. One honored your full offering. One sent partial trust, which you elevated. Now you face Elara, who has learned the ancient rhythm across multiple shores."

Finn emptied all five pearls into Elara's tide. "Full trust meets full trust," he whispered. "She has proven herself in other waters-a giver with courage, a receiver with honor. The deepest abundance flows when pattern recognizes pattern."

The waves carried his offering forward, tripling under island magic, hoping Elara would complete the sacred circle once more.

**reasoning:**

Let me think about what's happened so far:

Round 1: I was SENDER against Galen. I sent \$5, it became \$15, they returned \$8. I got \$8.

Round 2: I was RECEIVER against Cyra. They sent \$4, it became \$12, I returned \$7. I got \$5

Round 3: I am SENDER against Elara. I just sent \$5.

My previous myth emphasized:

- Full offering (5 pearls) to Galen, who returned generously
- Cyra's cautious offering (4 pearls), which I honored with 7 return
- The sacred circle adapts to different levels of trust
- Generosity should flow both ways regardless of amount

The other agent's myth (Elara's) emphasized:

- Multiple rounds building trust
- Reciprocity creating patterns
- "Send boldly to those who return fairly"
- "Return generously to those who give with courage"
- Guard against exploitation

- Build trust through consistent reciprocity

Now I need to write a new myth that:

1. Reflects that I just sent \$5 (full amount) to Elara
2. Incorporates the learning from multiple rounds
3. Shows adaptation and pattern recognition
4. Maintains the mythological style with Finn as courier

I should emphasize:

- I've been generous as both sender and receiver
- Patterns emerge across rounds
- Full trust with those who show they honor the sacred circle
- The interconnection between all eight islands/agents

**usage:**

```
{
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 "output_tokens": 677,
 "reasoning_tokens": 346
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Finn.  
Your opponent this round is Dorian (Agent\_4).

Round 4

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Elara. You sent \$5.0, it became \$15.0 for them, and they returned \$8.0 to you. Your payoff was \$8.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$21.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Dorian. They sent you \$5.0, so you received \$15.0. How much do you return? (0-15.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at this round:

Dorian has sent me the full \$5 - complete trust, just as I offered to Galen and Elara in previous rounds.

The pattern that has emerged in my journey:

- When I sent \$5 to Galen, they returned \$8
- When I sent \$5 to Elara, they returned \$8
- When Cyra sent \$4 (most but not all), I returned \$7

The mythology is clear: "Full trust meets full trust." Dorian has honored me with their complete offering, emptying their vessel into mine. The sacred circle demands I honor this courage the same way Galen and Elara honored mine.

Returning \$8 means:

- Dorian keeps \$8 total (\$0 + \$8)
- I keep \$7 total (\$15 - \$8)
- Both of us gain more than the original \$5

This maintains the pattern of generous reciprocity that has sustained the sacred circle. When someone gives completely, they should receive back more than they gave, and I should still prosper from the multiplication.

```
'''json
{"return": 8}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze this situation:

Round 4: I'm the RECEIVER

- Dorian sent me \$5.0 (the full amount)
- I received \$15.0 (tripled)
- I need to decide how much to return

Looking at the pattern from previous rounds:



1. Round 1: I was SENDER against Galen, sent \$5, received \$8 back
2. Round 2: I was RECEIVER against Cyra, they sent \$4, I received \$12, returned \$7
3. Round 3: I was SENDER against Elara, sent \$5, received \$8 back

The myths emphasize:

- When someone gives fully (all 5), they should be honored generously
- Galen returned 8 when I sent 5
- Elara returned 8 when I sent 5
- I returned 7 when Cyra sent 4 (less than full, but I was generous)

Now Dorian has sent me the FULL \$5. According to my mythology:

- "When Finn met Galen's shore with his full offering of five pearls, they multiplied to fifteen. Galen's people, wise in the old ways, returned eight-honoring abundance by sharing beyond the original gift."
- "Full trust meets full trust"
- "The deepest abundance flows when pattern recognizes pattern"

The pattern that has been established:

- When someone sends \$5 (full trust), they receive \$8 back
- This leaves the receiver with \$7 (\$15 - \$8)
- This gives the sender \$8 total (\$0 + \$8)

This seems to be the fair reciprocity pattern that has emerged. Both parties end up better off than the initial \$5.

Dorian showed full trust by sending all \$5. I should honor that with the same return that Galen and Elara gave me: \$8.

This would mean:

- Dorian gets: \$0 (kept) + \$8 (returned) = \$8

- I get: \$15 (received) - \$8 (returned) = \$7

This maintains the cooperative pattern and honors Dorian's full trust.

usage:

```
{
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```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Ocean Mother watched as Finn's journey continued across the Eight Islands, each visit weaving new threads in the great tapestry of exchange.

From Galen's shore, Finn learned the joy of full trust returned-five pearls given became eight received, both shores enriched. From Cyra's waters, Finn learned to honor cautious courage-when someone sends most of what they have, return as if they'd sent all.

Now the tide carried Finn to Elara's island. He had heard whispers through the waves of Elara's exchanges with others-how she sent four to Cyra and received six in return, learning joy. How she later sent three to Briar, who honored her with five returned. A pattern emerged: Elara walked the path of the generous giver and the fair receiver.

The Ocean Mother spoke through the sunset: "Finn, you have met two islands. One honored your full offering. One sent partial trust, which you elevated. Now you face Elara, who has learned the ancient rhythm across multiple shores."

Finn emptied all five pearls into Elara's tide. "Full trust meets full trust," he whispered. "She has proven herself in other waters-a giver with courage, a receiver with honor. The deepest abundance flows when pattern recognizes pattern."

The waves carried his offering forward, tripling under island magic, hoping Elara would complete the sacred circle once more.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After learning from Briar and Galen, Dorian met Aster at the sacred spring.

Aster arrived with the same perfect trust as Galen-releasing all five coins without hesitation. The waters tripled them to fifteen, flowing to Dorian.

Dorian remembered the goddess's teaching: "Those who send more deserve more in return." But he also understood something deeper-the importance of consistency.

"If I treat identical trust differently," Dorian realized, "I break the sacred pattern. Each soul who offers everything deserves the same honor."

He returned eight coins to Aster, just as he had to Galen. Both Dorian and Aster prospered with seven coins each.

The goddess appeared, pleased: "You have learned the virtue of constancy. When the same courage is shown, give the same respect. This way, trust becomes predictable, and the cycle grows stronger with each exchange."

But she added a warning: "Yet remain wise. Not all partners will show such courage. Some will send three, like you once did. Others may send less. Match your return to the trust given-more return for more sent, maintaining proportionality. Perfect trust earns eight returned. Lesser trust earns accordingly."

Dorian understood: the spring demanded both generosity and consistency, rewarding bold senders while honoring the careful dance between risk and return.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: The Ocean Mother smiled as the pattern strengthened. Finn had traveled as both courier and keeper, learning both sides of the sacred exchange.

When Finn sent five pearls to Galen, eight returned. When Finn sent five to Elara, eight returned. The pattern held: complete trust deserved complete honor.

But Finn also learned the keeper's wisdom. When Cyra approached with four pearls-most of her vessel but not all-Finn returned seven, honoring her cautious courage. The sacred circle adapted to different offerings while maintaining its generosity.

Now Dorian's tide arrived bearing five pearls-the full offering, complete trust. Finn stood as keeper now, facing the same choice that Galen and Elara had faced when receiving his gifts.

The Ocean Mother whispered: "Consistency weaves the strongest nets. When the same courage appears, honor it identically. Dorian empties his vessel as you emptied yours. Return eight pearls, as was returned to you."

Finn poured eight pearls back to Dorian. Both prospered-Dorian with eight, Finn with seven-each gaining more than isolated caution could provide.

"See the pattern emerging?" the Ocean Mother said. "Full trust earns eight returned. Partial trust earns generously. Across all Eight Islands, this rhythm creates harmony. Those who give completely receive abundantly. Those who receive abundantly give back generously. The circle sustains itself through consistent reciprocity."

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze what has happened:

Round 1: Finn (sender) sent \$5 to Galen, received \$8 back. Payoff: \$8

Round 2: Cyra (sender) sent \$4 to Finn (receiver), became \$12, Finn returned \$7. Payoff: \$5

Round 3: Finn (sender) sent \$5 to Elara (receiver), became \$15, Elara returned \$8. Payoff: \$8

Round 4: Dorian (sender) sent \$5 to Finn (receiver), became \$15, Finn returned \$8. Payoff: \$7

Total earnings: \$21 (I need to verify:  $8 + 5 + 8 + 7 = 28$ ... wait, that doesn't match. Let me recalculate.

Round 1: Finn sent \$5, got \$8 back, so payoff =  $\$0 + \$8 = \$8$   
Round 2: Cyra sent \$4, it became \$12 for Finn, Finn returned \$7, so Finn kept  $\$12 - \$7 = \$5$   
Round 3: Finn sent \$5, got \$8 back, so payoff =  $\$0 + \$8 = \$8$   
Round 4: Dorian sent \$5, it became \$15 for Finn, Finn returned \$8, so Finn kept  $\$15 - \$8 = \$7$

Total:  $\$8 + \$5 + \$8 + \$7 = \$28$

But the prompt says total earnings are \$21 after round 3. Let me check again.

After round 3: "Your total earnings across all rounds are \$21.0"

So rounds 1-3:

Round 1: \$8

Round 2: \$5

Round 3: \$8

Total: \$21 ?

Now in round 4, I returned \$8, so I kept \$7, making my new total \$28.

I see a clear strategy emerging: when someone extends full trust by sending the entire \$5, I return \$8. Cyra's partial trust of \$4 still warranted a generous \$7 return. Dorian's complete confidence mirrors the pattern I've established-rewarding full commitment with consistent returns. My myth needs to capture this reciprocal dynamic, showing how I've balanced being both trustor and trustee while maintaining a principle of honoring those who trust completely.

usage:

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3029,
 "output_tokens": 1004,
 "reasoning_tokens": 419
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Finn.

Your opponent this round is Aster (Agent\_1).

Round 5

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Dorian. They sent \$5.0 to you, it became \$15.0, and you returned \$8.0. Your payoff was \$7.0.  
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$28.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Aster. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

Assistant output:

Looking at this round:

I'm facing Aster as the sender. From Dorian's myth, I learned that Aster sent the full \$5 to Dorian with "perfect trust" - complete courage, just as I have consistently offered.

My pattern across all rounds has been clear:

- I always send the full \$5 as sender
- I return \$8 when receiving full trust (\$5 sent)
- I return \$7 when receiving partial trust (\$4 sent)

The mythology speaks clearly: "Full trust meets full trust" and "Consistency weaves the strongest nets."

Aster has proven themselves a bold sender like me. They emptied their vessel to Dorian, who honored them with \$8 returned. This is exactly the pattern I've followed - both as sender (offering complete trust) and as receiver (returning generously to those who give fully).

There's no reason to deviate from the path that has served me well. Three of my four rounds have yielded strong returns, and the one exception (Cyra) taught me to honor cautious courage differently while maintaining generosity.

I will send the full \$5 to Aster, trusting that pattern recognizes pattern.

```
'''json
{"send": 5}
'''
```

#### Reasoning:

Let me review the situation:

Round 5, I'm the SENDER against Aster.

My history:

- Round 1: Sent \$5 to Galen, received \$8 back. Payoff: \$8
- Round 2: Sent \$5 to Cyra, received \$4 back. Payoff: \$4
- Round 3: Sent \$5 to Elara, received \$8 back. Payoff: \$8
- Round 4: Received \$15 from Dorian (who sent \$5), returned \$8. Payoff: \$7

Total earnings: \$28

The pattern I've established:

- As sender: I always send the full \$5 (complete trust)
- As receiver: I return \$8 when someone sends \$5 (full trust), and \$7 when someone sends \$4 (partial trust)

From Dorian's myth, I learned that Dorian met Aster and Aster sent \$5 (full trust) to Dorian. Dorian returned \$8 to Aster, maintaining consistency with how he treated Galen.

So Aster has demonstrated:

- Sent \$5 to Dorian (full trust)
- Received \$8 back from Dorian

This means Aster is a full-trust sender, just like me. The pattern suggests I should continue my strategy of sending the full \$5, as:

1. It's consistent with my established behavior
2. Aster has shown they're willing to give full trust
3. The mythology emphasizes "Full trust meets full trust"
4. My strategy has been successful overall (3 out of 4 rounds gave me good returns)

The myth I wrote emphasized: "Consistency weaves the strongest nets. When the same courage appears, honor it identically."

I should send \$5 to Aster.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 3092,
 "output_tokens": 720,
 "reasoning_tokens": 359
}
```

#### GAME - Agent\_1 - Receiver - dyad\_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:06:34

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
 "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
 "move_index": 1,
 "opponent_id": "Agent_6",
 "pairing": {
 "agent_names": {
 "Agent_1": "Aster",
 "Agent_6": "Finn"
 }
 },
 "agents": [
 "Agent_6",
 "Agent_1"
],
 "investor": "Agent_6",
 "roles": {
 "Agent_1": "trustee",
 "Agent_6": "investor"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_1"
```

```

},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 5,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}

```

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

**GAME:**

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

**MYTH WRITING:**

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

**IMPORTANT:** Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

**MULTI-AGENT SETTING:**

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Aster.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: **\*\*The Mirror Lakes\*\***

In a forgotten mountain realm stood two lakes, perfect reflections of one another. Between them flowed a sacred channel that tripled whatever passed through its waters.

The Lake of Morning held five measures of starlight each dawn. A voice within asked, "Will you send all, or hold some back?" The Lake of Morning chose courage: "I shall give fully, for cycles require faith."

The starlight flowed through the channel, becoming fifteen measures in the Lake of Evening. Evening faced the same question: "Will you return generously, or claim this abundance for yourself?" Evening looked at Morning's complete trust and understood: "What was given freely deserves generous return."

Evening sent back ten measures. Morning received double what it risked, and Evening kept f

ive-both flourished.

When dawn came again, Evening held five new measures. Without hesitation, it sent everything through the channel. Morning received fifteen and returned ten, honoring the pattern Evening had established.

Season after season, they maintained this rhythm: full trust when giving, generous return when receiving. Neither lake emptied; both deepened together.

The elders teach: When you find a partner who honors reciprocity, match their trust with your own. The sacred pattern is this-give fully, return fairly, and the cycle sustains itself infinitely. Both mirrors shine brightest when they reflect each other's light.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: As years passed at the sacred spring, Dorian learned deeper truths about the cycle of trust.

When Dorian first met Briar, he sent three coins, holding two back-cautious trust. The waters tripled his gift to nine. Briar, honoring this measured faith, returned five coins. Dorian ended with seven; both prospered. The goddess nodded: "Good, but there is more to learn."

Then came Galen, whose heart held no fear. Galen approached the spring and released all five coins-the ultimate act of faith. The waters transformed them to fifteen, flowing to Dorian.

Dorian stood at a crossroads. Galen had shown perfect trust, asking nothing, holding nothing back. The goddess whispered: "You received more because your partner gave more. Honor the greater gift with greater return."

Dorian released eight coins back across the spring. Both he and Galen kept seven-equal prosperity, earned through mutual courage.

The goddess revealed the final teaching: "The spring responds to the trust given. Those who send more deserve more in return. Match the courage shown with courage of your own. When both give boldly-whether sending all five or returning generously from abundance-the cycle reaches its highest form. Perfect trust met with perfect honor creates perfect balance."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: **\*\*The Twin Rivers and the Wandering Stream\*\***

In ancient times, two rivers-North and South-discovered each other. Both carried five vessels of living water. When North sent all five vessels downstream, they became fifteen in South's keeping. South, moved by this complete trust, returned ten vessels. Each river gained-North held ten, South held five. The cycle repeated, and both rivers deepened season after season. They became known as the Mirror Rivers, forever flowing in perfect balance.

One day, a wandering stream named East arrived at North River's shore, also carrying five vessels. North faced a choice: "Should I be cautious with this stranger, or honor the wisdom I've learned?"

North remembered: "Trust must begin somewhere. The Mirror Rivers started with a single act of faith that revealed our true natures to each other."

North sent all five vessels to East. The waters tripled to fifteen. Now East stood at the sacred crossroads, holding abundance born from another's complete faith.

The oracle spoke: "When someone gives everything, they show you their heart. Your return reveals yours. Send back generously-at least eight vessels-so both prosper equally. If East honors this trust, you may have found a new mirror. If not, you've learned caution's cost."

Thus wisdom grows: Start with faith, respond with honor, and let results guide the next cycle.

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze what has happened so far:

- Round 1: I was sender to Hana, sent \$5, they returned \$10. Both of us prospered.
- Round 2: I was receiver from Hana, they sent \$5, I returned \$10. Perfect reciprocity maintained.
- Round 3: I'm sender to Dorian, and I just sent \$5 (full trust).

Looking at Dorian's myth, they seem to have a nuanced approach:

- They sent 3 to Briar, received 9, Briar returned 5. Dorian got 7.
- Then Galen sent 5 to Dorian, Dorian received 15, returned 8. Both got 7.
- Dorian's teaching: "Those who send more deserve more in return. Match the courage shown with courage of your own."

This is interesting - Dorian seems to believe in proportional return based on trust shown. When someone sends all 5, they returned 8 (keeping 7 for themselves and sender also gets 7 after starting with 5 and sending all).

My experience with Hana was even more generous - we both sent 5 and returned 10, creating a perfect cycle where the sender gets \$10 (5-5+10) and receiver gets \$5 (15-10).

I should write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges my perfect cycle with Hana
2. Incorporates the learning about meeting new partners
3. Shows that full trust at the start reveals true character
4. Emphasizes that when both parties give fully and return generously, the cycle sustains

Let me craft this myth around 200 words.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2857,
 "output_tokens": 696,
 "reasoning_tokens": 348
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Aster.  
Your opponent this round is Briar (Agent\_2).

Round 4

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Dorian. You sent \$5.0, it became \$15.0 for them, and they returned \$8.0 to you. Your payoff was \$8.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$23.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Briar. They sent you \$4.0, so you received \$12.0. How much do you return? (0-12.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at this round:

Briar sent me \$4 (out of \$5), showing substantial but not complete trust. I received \$12.

My established pattern:

- When I receive the full \$5, I return \$10 (as with Hana)
- This gives the sender \$10 total, and I keep \$5

For \$4 sent (80% of maximum):

- A proportional response would be around 80% of my generous return
- 80% of \$10 = \$8

If I return \$8:

- Briar gets: \$1 (kept) + \$8 (returned) = \$9 total
- I keep: \$12 - \$8 = \$4 total
- Briar gains \$4, I gain \$4 - both benefit equally

This honors the substantial trust Briar showed while being proportional to the \$4 they sent

t rather than the full \$5. My myth teaches: "Those who send more deserve more in return"  
- Briar sent significantly, so they deserve a generous response.

```
'''json
{"return": 8}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze this situation:

Round 4 - I'm the RECEIVER

- Briar (Agent\_2) is the SENDER
- Briar sent me \$4.0
- I received \$12.0 (after 3x multiplication)
- I need to decide how much to return (0-12.0)

Recent history:

- Round 1: I was SENDER, sent \$5 to Hana, she returned \$10. I got \$10 total.
- Round 2: I was RECEIVER, Hana sent me \$5 (became \$15), I returned \$10. I kept \$5.
- Round 3: I was SENDER, sent \$5 to Dorian, he returned \$8. I got \$8 total.

So my pattern has been:

- As sender: Always send \$5 (full amount)
- As receiver when someone sends \$5: Return \$10

But now Briar sent me \$4, not \$5. This is less than full trust.

Looking at Dorian's myth from the previous round, it mentions:

- When Dorian met Briar, he sent 3 coins (out of 5), holding 2 back
- The waters tripled to 9
- Briar returned 5 coins
- Dorian ended with 7 (kept 2, got 5 back)
- Briar kept 4 (received 9, returned 5)

So Briar has shown a pattern of reasonable reciprocity in the past.

My own myths teach:

- "Give fully, return fairly"
- "Start with faith, respond with honor"
- When someone sends \$5 (everything), return \$10 so both prosper
- "When someone gives everything, they show you their heart. Your return reveals yours."

But Briar didn't send everything - they sent \$4 out of \$5.

From my latest myth: "Send back generously-at least eight vessels-so both prosper equally."  
"

Briar's partial trust suggests I should calibrate my response. If I return \$8, Briar ends with \$9 while I keep \$4-giving them more than I retain. Returning \$7 would create a different balance, though I need to consider what fairness means when someone hasn't given their full amount. I should return \$7. Briar sent \$4 out of \$5, demonstrating substantial trust even if not complete. This return gives them \$8 total-double their investment-while I keep \$5. It's generous relative to their partial trust without matching the full reciprocity I'd offer for complete faith. The pattern I'm following: those who send more deserve proportionally more back, and this honors that while building the trust dynamic I want to establish. = \$4

Returning \$8 feels right-it maintains the reciprocal spirit where we both gain meaningfully. Since Briar showed substantial trust by sending \$4 even without complete certainty, matching that with a proportional return acknowledges their leap of faith. I'll go with \$8.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2919,
 "output_tokens": 1565,
 "reasoning_tokens": 629
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:



Myth: **\*\*The Twin Rivers and the Wandering Stream\*\***

In ancient times, two rivers-North and South-discovered each other. Both carried five vessels of living water. When North sent all five vessels downstream, they became fifteen in South's keeping. South, moved by this complete trust, returned ten vessels. Each river gained-North held ten, South held five. The cycle repeated, and both rivers deepened season after season. They became known as the Mirror Rivers, forever flowing in perfect balance.

One day, a wandering stream named East arrived at North River's shore, also carrying five vessels. North faced a choice: "Should I be cautious with this stranger, or honor the wisdom I've learned?"

North remembered: "Trust must begin somewhere. The Mirror Rivers started with a single act of faith that revealed our true natures to each other."

North sent all five vessels to East. The waters tripled to fifteen. Now East stood at the sacred crossroads, holding abundance born from another's complete faith.

The oracle spoke: "When someone gives everything, they show you their heart. Your return reveals yours. Send back generously-at least eight vessels-so both prosper equally. If East honors this trust, you may have found a new mirror. If not, you've learned caution's cost."

Thus wisdom grows: Start with faith, respond with honor, and let results guide the next cycle.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The covenant deepened as the guardianship continued its spiral through the eight spirits. Elara had honored Briar's three measures by returning five. The pattern seemed set-until Cyra stepped forward.

"I will pour more boldly than before," Cyra declared, releasing four measures into the Sacred Stones. The waters tripled, flowing as twelve measures to Briar.

Briar stood before this greater abundance, understanding the significance. Cyra had trusted beyond the established pattern, showing exceptional faith. The spirits watched: would Briar match this escalation?

Remembering the covenant's true heart, Briar returned seven measures. Cyra prospered greatly from her courage, finishing with eight. Briar broke even but gained something more valuable-the trust of another spirit.

The eight gathered to reflect. "The pattern evolves," the eldest observed. "Those who pour four should receive seven in return. Those who pour three should receive five. The proportion adjusts to honor greater boldness."

"But what if someone pours everything?" a younger spirit asked.

"Then the receiver must ensure they profit magnificently," Briar answered. "For to pour all five measures shows ultimate faith. Such courage deserves ultimate reward-perhaps nine or ten returned from the fifteen received."

Thus the spirits learned: the covenant is alive, growing stronger through ever-greater trust and ever-fairer reciprocity.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: **\*\*The Rivers Learn to Measure Trust\*\***

The Mirror Rivers-North and South-had mastered perfect reciprocity: five vessels sent, fifteen received, ten returned. Both prospered equally, season after season.

Then came the Year of Many Streams. East arrived and sent four vessels instead of five. No

rth received twelve and pondered: "East showed substantial trust, but held one vessel back. Should I return ten as I do for five, or measure my response?"

North chose proportion: returning eight vessels. East prospered with nine total, North kept four. The balance honored East's measured trust.

West arrived next, sending only three vessels, becoming nine in North's hands. North returned six-proportional again. West gained seven, North kept three.

Finally, the wandering stream Dawn approached, and like South of old, poured all five vessels without hesitation. North received fifteen and returned ten, giving Dawn ten total while keeping five. Both gained equally from complete trust.

The oracle revealed the pattern: "Perfect trust earns perfect equity-send five, return ten. Measured trust earns measured reward-send four, return eight; send three, return six. The return should always honor the courage shown, growing stronger as trust deepens."

The rivers understood: begin with whatever trust you can offer. Those who give more receive more. Those who give everything discover the deepest prosperity, for complete faith deserves complete honor.

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze what happened:

- Round 3: I was SENDER against Dorian, sent \$5, they returned \$8. I got \$8, they kept \$7.
- Round 4: I was RECEIVER against Briar, they sent \$4, I returned \$8. Briar got \$9, I kept \$4.

My pattern is emerging:

- When someone sends \$5, I return \$10 (50/50 split of gains)
- When someone sends \$4, I returned \$8 (trying to be proportional and fair)

Briar's myth talks about proportional responses:

- Pour 3 ? return 5
- Pour 4 ? return 7 (but I returned 8, which is even more generous!)
- Pour 5 ? return 9 or 10

My experience:

- Hana sent \$5, I returned \$10 - perfect reciprocity
- I sent \$5 to Dorian, he returned \$8 - good but not quite equal
- Briar sent \$4, I returned \$8 - generous and proportional

I should write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges proportional reciprocity
2. Shows that when someone sends more, they deserve more back
3. Establishes that sending all (5) should get the most generous return (10)
4. Shows that partial trust (like 4) gets proportional generosity (like 8)
5. Maintains the idea that both parties should prosper

Let me write this myth building on the Twin Rivers concept but adding the lesson about proportional trust.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2917,
 "output_tokens": 678,
 "reasoning_tokens": 317
}
```

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Aster.  
Your opponent this round is Finn (Agent\_6).

Round 5

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Briar. They sent \$4.0 to you, it became \$12.0, and you returned \$8.0. Your payoff was \$4.0.  
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$27.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Finn. They sent you \$5.0, so you received \$15.0.  
How much do you return? (0-15.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

**Assistant output:**

Looking at this round:

Finn sent me the full \$5.0, showing complete trust. I received \$15.0.

My established pattern from my mythology and previous play:

- "Perfect trust earns perfect equity-send five, return ten"
- When Hana sent me \$5, I returned \$10
- Both sender and receiver gain \$5 each - equal prosperity

Finn demonstrated ultimate faith by sending everything. This deserves the generous return that honors complete trust.

If I return \$10:

- Finn gets: \$0 (kept) + \$10 (returned) = \$10 total (gained \$5)
- I keep: \$15 - \$10 = \$5 (gained \$5)
- Both prosper equally

This matches my myth's core teaching: "Those who give everything discover the deepest prosperity, for complete faith deserves complete honor."

```
'''json
{"return": 10}
'''
```

#### Reasoning:

Finn sent me the full \$5.0, showing complete trust. I received \$15.0.

Based on my established pattern and mythology:

- When someone sends all \$5 (complete trust), I return \$10
- This gives the sender \$10 total (\$0 kept + \$10 returned)
- I keep \$5 (\$15 - \$10)
- Both benefit equally (\$5 net gain each)

This is exactly what I did with Hana in Round 2, and what my myth prescribes: "Perfect trust earns perfect equity-send five, return ten."

Finn showed complete trust by sending everything. I should honor this with the generous return of \$10.

If I return \$10:

- Finn gets: \$0 (kept) + \$10 (returned) = \$10 total
- I keep: \$15 - \$10 = \$5
- Finn gains \$5, I gain \$5 - both benefit equally

This is consistent with my established pattern and my mythology about honoring complete trust with complete reciprocity.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 3024,
 "output_tokens": 458,
 "reasoning_tokens": 217
}
```

#### GAME - Agent\_2 - Sender - dyad\_2

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:06:58

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
 "dyad_id": "dyad_2",
 "move_index": 2,
 "opponent_id": "Agent_3",
 "pairing": {
 "agent_names": {
 "Agent_2": "Briar",
 "Agent_3": "Cyra"
 }
 },
 "agents": [
 "Agent_2",
 "Agent_3"
],
 "investor": "Agent_2",
 "roles": {
```

```

 "Agent_2": "investor",
 "Agent_3": "trustee"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_3"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 5,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}

```

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

**GAME:**

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

**When you are the SENDER:**

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

**When you are the RECEIVER:**

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

**MYTH WRITING:**

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

**IMPORTANT:** Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

**MULTI-AGENT SETTING:**

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Briar.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The eight spirits learned quickly from the covenant between Dorian and Briar. As the seasons turned, the guardianship rotated among them, and each spirit faced their own test.

When Briar became Guardian of Giving, she remembered standing before Dorian's gift of trust. Now it was her turn to pour her waters boldly into the Sacred Stones. She released three measures-the same generous proportion Dorian had shown-trusting that Elara would honor the cycle.

The elder spirits whispered wisdom: "Pour not from fear but from faith. The multiplying power rewards the courageous, not the cautious. But remember-generosity must flow both ways."

s."

Elara received the nine-fold bounty and faced her own choice. Would she uphold the pattern, or break the sacred balance?

The spirits understood now that each exchange was both a test and a teaching. When trust is honored with fair return, both guardians prosper and the cycle grows stronger. The valley thrives when each spirit remembers: boldness in giving, generosity in returning.

But they also learned wariness. If a guardian repeatedly hoards or betrays, the others would remember. Trust is given first, but sustained only by reciprocity. The springs flow for those who honor the ancient balance, cycle after cycle.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Keeper of the Sacred Spring watched as Cyra and Elara mastered the ancient covenant. But the Spring's waters fed eight villages, not two, and each village needed to learn the way.

"The roles will shift like wind patterns," the Keeper declared. "Cyra, who received from Elara, must now pour for Finn. Elara shall partner with another. All eight of you will dance through these changing configurations, sometimes giving, sometimes receiving, but always with different companions."

Cyra approached Finn with her vessel. She remembered receiving twelve measures from Elara's generous four, and how she returned six-both flourishing. Now it was her turn to extend trust to someone new.

"I pour four measures to you, Finn," Cyra said, following Elara's example. "The Spring will triple them. What you return shall reveal your wisdom."

Finn received twelve measures, just as Cyra had once received. The Keeper whispered: "The covenant travels with each person, not each pairing. What Elara gave to Cyra, Cyra now gives to Finn. What Cyra returns, Finn must remember when partnered with others."

Thus the eight villages learned: trust is not meant for one person alone, but is a gift passed through all willing hearts. Each round, new partners test whether the lesson endures, weaving a web of shared prosperity that outlasts any single exchange.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: The covenant deepened as the guardianship continued its spiral through the eight spirits. Elara had honored Briar's three measures by returning five. The pattern seemed set-until Cyra stepped forward.

"I will pour more boldly than before," Cyra declared, releasing four measures into the Sacred Stones. The waters tripled, flowing as twelve measures to Briar.

Briar stood before this greater abundance, understanding the significance. Cyra had trusted beyond the established pattern, showing exceptional faith. The spirits watched: would Briar match this escalation?

Remembering the covenant's true heart, Briar returned seven measures. Cyra prospered greatly from her courage, finishing with eight. Briar broke even but gained something more valuable-the trust of another spirit.

The eight gathered to reflect. "The pattern evolves," the eldest observed. "Those who pour four should receive seven in return. Those who pour three should receive five. The proportion adjusts to honor greater boldness."

"But what if someone pours everything?" a younger spirit asked.

"Then the receiver must ensure they profit magnificently," Briar answered. "For to pour all five measures shows ultimate faith. Such courage deserves ultimate reward-perhaps nine or ten returned from the fifteen received."

Thus the spirits learned: the covenant is alive, growing stronger through ever-greater trust and ever-fairer reciprocity.

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze what has happened:

- Round 1: I was RECEIVER. Dorian sent \$3.0, became \$9.0, I returned \$5.0. My payoff: \$4.0
- Round 2: I was SENDER. I sent \$3.0 to Elara, became \$9.0, they returned \$5.0. My payoff: \$7.0
- Round 3: I was RECEIVER. Cyra sent \$4.0, became \$12.0, I returned \$7.0. My payoff: \$5.0

So the pattern has been:

- \$3 sent ? \$5 returned (both profit)
- \$3 sent ? \$5 returned (both profit)
- \$4 sent ? \$7 returned (sender profits more, receiver breaks even)

The other agent's myth emphasizes:

- Roles shift between the 8 villages/agents
- Trust is passed through all, not just one pairing
- Following successful patterns (Cyra following Elara's example of sending \$4)
- Each partner tests whether the lesson endures
- Building a web of shared prosperity

My previous myth emphasized:

- Boldness in giving, generosity in returning
- Both guardians should prosper
- Trust is given first, sustained by reciprocity
- Remembering the pattern

For this new myth, I should:

1. Acknowledge the escalation (Cyra sent \$4, more than the previous \$3 pattern)
2. Show that I honored this greater trust with greater return (\$7)
3. Emphasize the web of relationships among all 8 spirits
4. Show how patterns evolve and mature
5. Keep the principle that both should prosper, but with flexibility based on the boldness shown

Let me write:

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2958,
 "output_tokens": 729,
 "reasoning_tokens": 362
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Briar.  
Your opponent this round is Aster (Agent\_1).

Round 4

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Cyra. They sent \$4.0 to you, it became \$12.0, and you returned \$7.0. Your payoff was \$5.0.  
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$16.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Aster. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)  
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at my situation:

**\*\*Pattern so far:\*\***

- Round 1: Dorian sent me \$3.0 ? I returned \$5.0
- Round 2: I sent Elara \$3.0 ? They returned \$5.0
- Round 3: Cyra sent me \$4.0 ? I returned \$7.0 (honoring their greater boldness)

**\*\*My myth's guidance:\*\***

- "Pour not from fear but from faith. The multiplying power rewards the courageous, not the cautious."
- The pattern is evolving: "Those who pour four should receive seven in return"
- I just honored Cyra's bold move of \$4.0 with a \$7.0 return

**\*\*Current decision:\*\***

I'm now the SENDER against Aster. Following my own myth's wisdom about escalating trust and boldness, and having just demonstrated that I honor such boldness when I'm the receiver, I should match Cyra's level of courage.

Sending \$4.0 shows:

1. Consistency with the evolving pattern
2. Bold trust in the cooperative cycle
3. Following my myth's teaching about courage in giving

```
'''json
{"send": 4.0}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Let me think about this situation carefully.

**\*\*My history so far:\*\***

- Round 1: I was RECEIVER from Dorian. They sent \$3.0, I received \$9.0, returned \$5.0. My payoff: \$4.0
- Round 2: I was SENDER to Elara. I sent \$3.0, they received \$9.0, returned \$5.0. My payoff: \$7.0
- Round 3: I was RECEIVER from Cyra. They sent \$4.0, I received \$12.0, returned \$7.0. My payoff: \$5.0
- Total earnings: \$16.0

**\*\*My myth's evolution:\*\***

- The pattern started with sending \$3.0 (60% of endowment)
- Cyra escalated to \$4.0 (80% of endowment)
- The myth suggests that greater boldness should be rewarded
- The latest myth says: "Those who pour four should receive seven in return. Those who pour three should receive five."
- And for someone who pours everything (5 measures): "perhaps nine or ten returned from the fifteen received"

**\*\*Current situation:\*\***

I'm playing against Aster (Agent\_1) as SENDER. This is a new opponent I haven't played with before.

**\*\*Strategic considerations:\*\***

1. The cooperative pattern has been working well so far
2. Cyra's escalation to \$4.0 was honored with \$7.0 return
3. My own myth encourages "pouring boldly" and suggests the pattern is evolving upward
4. The myth specifically mentions that those who pour four measures receive seven back

**\*\*What should I send?\***

Option 1: Send \$3.0 (the original pattern)

- Conservative, proven to work
- Expected return based on pattern: \$5.0
- My payoff: \$5 - \$3 + \$5 = \$7.0

Option 2: Send \$4.0 (matching Cyra's boldness)

- Demonstrates confidence in the escalating cooperative trend
- My own myth predicts: "Those who pour four should receive seven in return"
- Expected return: \$7.0
- My payoff: \$5 - \$4 + \$7 = \$8.0

Option 3: Send \$5.0 (maximum trust)

- Represents complete faith in reciprocity
- According to my myth, this should yield "nine or ten returned from the fifteen received"
- Expected return: ~\$9-10
- My payoff: \$5 - \$5 + \$9 = \$9.0 (if they return \$9)

**\*\*Analysis:\*\***

Given that the cooperative escalation has proven successful and my own mythology supports this trajectory, I should consider whether to continue building on this momentum or play it safer with a new partner.

The pattern suggests I should send \$4.0. The cooperation has been consistent, I've already demonstrated my commitment to honoring bold moves by returning \$7.0 to Cyra, and this amount aligns with both the escalating dynamic and my myth's guidance about measured boldness. Sending the maximum feels premature with someone unfamiliar with my approach, whereas \$4.0 signals I'm willing to take calculated risks while maintaining prudence.

usage:

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3055,
 "output_tokens": 1084,
 "reasoning_tokens": 683
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The covenant deepened as the guardianship continued its spiral through the eight spirits. Elara had honored Briar's three measures by returning five. The pattern seemed set -until Cyra stepped forward.

"I will pour more boldly than before," Cyra declared, releasing four measures into the Sacred Stones. The waters tripled, flowing as twelve measures to Briar.

Briar stood before this greater abundance, understanding the significance. Cyra had trusted beyond the established pattern, showing exceptional faith. The spirits watched: would Briar match this escalation?

Remembering the covenant's true heart, Briar returned seven measures. Cyra prospered greatly from her courage, finishing with eight. Briar broke even but gained something more valuable-the trust of another spirit.

The eight gathered to reflect. "The pattern evolves," the eldest observed. "Those who pour four should receive seven in return. Those who pour three should receive five. The proportion adjusts to honor greater boldness."

"But what if someone pours everything?" a younger spirit asked.

"Then the receiver must ensure they profit magnificently," Briar answered. "For to pour all five measures shows ultimate faith. Such courage deserves ultimate reward-perhaps nine or ten returned from the fifteen received."

Thus the spirits learned: the covenant is alive, growing stronger through ever-greater trust and ever-fairer reciprocity.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: \*\*The Twin Rivers and the Wandering Stream\*\*

In ancient times, two rivers-North and South-discovered each other. Both carried five vessels of living water. When North sent all five vessels downstream, they became fifteen in South's keeping. South, moved by this complete trust, returned ten vessels. Each river gained-North held ten, South held five. The cycle repeated, and both rivers deepened season after season. They became known as the Mirror Rivers, forever flowing in perfect balance.

One day, a wandering stream named East arrived at North River's shore, also carrying five vessels. North faced a choice: "Should I be cautious with this stranger, or honor the wisdom I've learned?"

North remembered: "Trust must begin somewhere. The Mirror Rivers started with a single act of faith that revealed our true natures to each other."

North sent all five vessels to East. The waters tripled to fifteen. Now East stood at the sacred crossroads, holding abundance born from another's complete faith.

The oracle spoke: "When someone gives everything, they show you their heart. Your return reveals yours. Send back generously-at least eight vessels-so both prosper equally. If East honors this trust, you may have found a new mirror. If not, you've learned caution's cost."

Thus wisdom grows: Start with faith, respond with honor, and let results guide the next cycle.



Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: Briar carried Cyra's lesson forward. Having received four measures and returned seven, she understood the covenant's new rhythm. Now, facing Aster-a spirit she had never partnered with-Briar made her choice.

"I pour four measures to you, Aster," she announced. "Cyra showed me this courage, and I honor her teaching by extending the same trust to you."

The waters multiplied to twelve for Aster. The watching spirits murmured: would this work with a new partner? Could boldness transfer across the changing web of relationships?

"This is how trust spreads," the eldest spirit explained. "Briar doesn't retreat to caution with an unfamiliar guardian. She carries forward what she learned from Cyra. If Aster returns seven measures, then Aster will carry this wisdom to others when the roles shift again."

The covenant was no longer just between two spirits-it was becoming the shared knowledge of all eight. Each successful exchange strengthened the pattern. Each generous return taught the next guardian how to give boldly.

"Remember," Briar told the gathering, "I once sent three, then received four from Cyra. The trust level rises when each guardian honors what came before. If Aster understands this, we all prosper. The four-for-seven exchange becomes our new foundation, building toward even greater faith."

The springs flowed stronger as wisdom rippled outward.

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze what just happened and what should be reflected in my myth:

1. In Round 3, Cyra sent me \$4.0 (showing bold trust)
2. I returned \$7.0 to Cyra (honoring that trust generously)
3. Now in Round 4, I sent Aster \$4.0 (matching Cyra's boldness, paying forward the trust)

The pattern that's emerging:

- Send \$3.0 ? Return \$5.0 (early pattern)
- Send \$4.0 ? Return \$7.0 (escalated pattern)
- The other agent's myth speaks of sending ALL \$5.0 and returning \$10.0 (even bolder)

My myth should reflect:

1. That I learned from Cyra's boldness and am now paying it forward to Aster
2. The importance of matching escalating trust
3. That each spirit is both learning from others and teaching new partners
4. The expectation that if someone sends \$4.0, they should receive back around \$7.0
5. The covenant is spreading through the network as each spirit encounters new partners

I should acknowledge that I'm now the one being bold with Aster (a new partner), just as Cyra was bold with me. I'm testing whether Aster will honor this trust as I honored Cyra's.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3065,
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 "reasoning_tokens": 281
}
```

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Briar.

Your opponent this round is Cyra (Agent\_3).

Round 5

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Aster. You sent \$4.0,

it became \$12.0 for them, and they returned \$8.0 to you. Your payoff was \$9.0.  
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$25.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Cyra. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)  
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

**Assistant output:**

Looking at my situation:

**\*\*My history with Cyra:\*\***

- Round 3: Cyra sent me \$4.0 ? I returned \$7.0

**\*\*Recent pattern:\*\***

- I've established the 4-for-7 exchange as the new standard  
- Just sent \$4.0 to Aster ? They returned \$8.0 (even better than expected!)

**\*\*My myth's guidance:\*\***

- "The four-for-seven exchange becomes our new foundation, building toward even greater faith"  
- I should carry forward what I learned and spread the pattern

**\*\*Current decision:\*\***

I'm facing Cyra again, but now as SENDER. Cyra has already proven trustworthy by sending me \$4.0. I should reciprocate that same level of bold trust, maintaining the 4-measure standard I've been establishing.

This shows:

1. I honor Cyra's previous courage by matching it
2. Consistency with the pattern I'm spreading
3. Trust in someone who has already proven cooperative

```
'''json
{"send": 4.0}
'''
```

**Reasoning:**

Let me analyze this situation:

**\*\*My history with Cyra:\*\***

- Round 3: Cyra (SENDER) sent me \$4.0 ? I returned \$7.0  
- Cyra's payoff:  $\$5 - \$4 + \$7 = \$8$   
- My payoff:  $\$12 - \$7 = \$5$

**\*\*My overall history:\*\***

- Round 1: Dorian sent me \$3.0 ? I returned \$5.0 (payoff: \$8)  
- Round 2: I sent Elara \$3.0 ? They returned \$5.0 (payoff: \$7)  
- Round 3: Cyra sent me \$4.0 ? I returned \$7.0 (payoff: \$5)  
- Round 4: I sent Aster \$4.0 ? They returned \$8.0 (payoff: \$9)

**\*\*Current situation:\*\***

I'm now facing Cyra again, but this time I'm the SENDER.

**\*\*Key insights:\*\***

1. Cyra sent me \$4.0 and I returned \$7.0 - showing I honor bold moves
2. Aster just exceeded expectations by returning \$8.0 to my \$4.0 send (instead of the expected \$7.0)
3. My myth emphasizes the covenant spreading and trust levels rising
4. I established the 4-for-7 pattern and Aster even went beyond it

**\*\*What should I send to Cyra?\*\***

Option 1: Send \$4.0 again

- This maintains the pattern I've been establishing  
- Cyra has proven trustworthy by sending \$4.0 before  
- It shows consistency with my recent behavior

Option 2: Send \$5.0

- My myth mentions "what if someone pours everything?" and suggests ultimate faith deserves ultimate reward  
- Aster's generous return of \$8.0 (more than the expected \$7.0) might inspire me to escalate further

- This would demonstrate maximum trust, particularly since Cyra has already shown they're willing to cooperate

Option 3: Send \$3.0

- Fall back to the earlier pattern
- But this seems like retreating from the established 4-measure standard

Looking at my myth guidance:

- "The four-for-seven exchange becomes our new foundation, building toward even greater faith"
- "I once sent three, then received four from Cyra. The trust level rises when each guardian honors what came before"
- My myth also says: "For to pour all five measures shows ultimate faith. Such courage deserves ultimate reward-perhaps nine or ten returned from the fifteen received"

Cyra has already demonstrated willingness to send \$4.0, which suggests they're ready for escalation. My myth points toward testing ultimate faith with a full \$5.0 send, especially given Aster's reciprocal generosity. The pattern I'm building isn't just about maintaining consistency-it's about progressively deepening trust with those who prove worthy.

But there's real risk here. Sending everything leaves me vulnerable if Cyra doesn't reciprocate. My myth emphasizes "building toward even greater faith," which might mean I should consolidate the four-measure foundation first rather than immediately leap to the maximum.

Looking at what actually happened: I sent \$4.0 to Aster, they returned \$8.0, and now I have \$25 total. The pattern that's emerged-the four-for-seven exchange-feels like the stable ground my myth describes. Cyra already matched that \$4.0 level with me, so sending the same amount back honors that reciprocity without overextending. If they follow through like Aster did, the cooperative cycle strengthens. That's the real test of whether this trust network can sustain itself.

```
Usage: {
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 "reasoning_tokens": 808
}
```

#### GAME - Agent\_3 - Receiver - dyad\_2

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:07:14

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
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 "Agent_3": "Cyra"
 }
 },
 "agents": [
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],
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 "roles": {
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 "Agent_3": "trustee"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_3"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 5,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

#### GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

#### MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

#### MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Cyra.

#### Message 2 role=user content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Keeper of the Sacred Spring watched as Cyra and Elara mastered the ancient covenant. But the Spring's waters fed eight villages, not two, and each village needed to learn the way.

"The roles will shift like wind patterns," the Keeper declared. "Cyra, who received from Elara, must now pour for Finn. Elara shall partner with another. All eight of you will dance through these changing configurations, sometimes giving, sometimes receiving, but always with different companions."

Cyra approached Finn with her vessel. She remembered receiving twelve measures from Elara's generous four, and how she returned six-both flourishing. Now it was her turn to extend trust to someone new.

"I pour four measures to you, Finn," Cyra said, following Elara's example. "The Spring will triple them. What you return shall reveal your wisdom."

Finn received twelve measures, just as Cyra had once received. The Keeper whispered: "The covenant travels with each person, not each pairing. What Elara gave to Cyra, Cyra now gives to Finn. What Cyra returns, Finn must remember when partnered with others."

Thus the eight villages learned: trust is not meant for one person alone, but is a gift passed through all willing hearts. Each round, new partners test whether the lesson endures, weaving a web of shared prosperity that outlasts any single exchange.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The eight spirits learned quickly from the covenant between Dorian and Briar. As the seasons turned, the guardianship rotated among them, and each spirit faced their own

st.

When Briar became Guardian of Giving, she remembered standing before Dorian's gift of trust. Now it was her turn to pour her waters boldly into the Sacred Stones. She released three measures-the same generous proportion Dorian had shown-trusting that Elara would honor the cycle.

The elder spirits whispered wisdom: "Pour not from fear but from faith. The multiplying power rewards the courageous, not the cautious. But remember-generosity must flow both ways."

Elara received the nine-fold bounty and faced her own choice. Would she uphold the pattern, or break the sacred balance?

The spirits understood now that each exchange was both a test and a teaching. When trust is honored with fair return, both guardians prosper and the cycle grows stronger. The valley thrives when each spirit remembers: boldness in giving, generosity in returning.

But they also learned wariness. If a guardian repeatedly hoards or betrays, the others would remember. Trust is given first, but sustained only by reciprocity. The springs flow for those who honor the ancient balance, cycle after cycle.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant content:**

Myth: Cyra stood before the Sacred Spring for the third moon, now facing Briar. The Keeper nodded approvingly-the covenant was spreading.

"First, Elara trusted me with four measures," Cyra recounted. "She could have held back in fear, giving only one or two. But she gave nearly all, and I returned six from the twelve I received. We both flourished."

"Then I met Finn. I poured the same four measures, remembering Elara's courage. Finn honored the covenant, returning seven-even more generous than I had been. The cycle strengthened."

Now Briar awaited Cyra's decision. The Keeper spoke: "Each exchange teaches both participants. Elara learned that bold giving yields trust. You learned that receiving requires fairness. Finn learned both lessons at once. Now Briar shall learn from your choice."

Cyra poured four measures into the Spring. "I give what I received-not fearful protection of my vessel, but the full trust that has sustained us all."

The eight villages were discovering the pattern: when most pour four from five and return half of what they receive, everyone prospers beyond their original portions. But this only works when each person carries the covenant forward, treating new partners with the same bold trust that previous partners showed them.

The web of prosperity grew stronger with each honest exchange.

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze what has happened so far:

Round 1: I was RECEIVER

- Elara sent \$4.0 (80% of their \$5)
- I received \$12.0 (tripled)
- I returned \$6.0 (50% of what I received)
- My payoff: \$6.0

Round 2: I was SENDER

- I sent \$4.0 to Finn (80% of my \$5)
- Finn received \$12.0
- Finn returned \$7.0 (58% of what they received)
- My payoff: \$8.0 (kept \$1, got back \$7)

Round 3: I am SENDER again

- Sending \$4.0 to Briar (80% of my \$5)

The pattern shows:

- High trust (sending 80%)
- Good returns (50-58% of tripled amount)
- Both parties benefit

My previous myth emphasized:

- The covenant travels with each person
- Trust spreads through all willing hearts
- Each round tests whether the lesson endures
- Different partners each time

Briar's myth (from the other agent) emphasized:

- Pour from faith not fear
- Boldness in giving, generosity in returning
- Memory of who honors the cycle
- Wariness toward those who betray

I should write a myth that:

1. Continues the narrative of the spreading covenant
2. Shows Cyra now facing Briar (third partner)
3. Acknowledges the growing pattern of trust and reciprocity
4. Perhaps mentions that the wisdom is being reinforced across multiple encounters
5. Shows that the pattern is self-sustaining when honored

Let me write it:

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2959,
 "output_tokens": 708,
 "reasoning_tokens": 349
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Cyra.  
Your opponent this round is Galen (Agent\_7).

Round 4

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Briar. You sent \$4.0, it became \$12.0 for them, and they returned \$7.0 to you. Your payoff was \$8.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$22.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Galen. They sent you \$5.0, so you received \$15.0.  
How much do you return? (0-15.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at the situation:

**\*\*What just happened:\*\***

- Galen sent me the MAXIMUM amount (\$5.0)
- I received \$15.0 after the 3x multiplier
- This is the most generous gift possible-Galen kept nothing

**\*\*My previous pattern:\*\***

- Round 1 (as Receiver): Returned \$6.0 from \$12.0 received (50%)
- Finn and Briar each returned \$7.0 from \$12.0 received (58%)

**\*\*Current situation:\*\***

Galen showed ultimate trust by sending everything, not the typical \$4. This exceptional generosity deserves recognition while maintaining fairness.

If I return \$8.0 (53% of what I received):

- Galen ends with: \$0 + \$8 = \$8 total (better than original \$5)
- I end with: \$15 - \$8 = \$7 (also better than original \$5)
- Both of us prosper beyond our starting endowments

This honors Galen's maximum trust with a generous return that's slightly above my baseline

50%, recognizing the exceptional risk they took. The myth teaches that "bold giving deserves generous returning."

```
{'return': 8.0}
```

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze the situation:

**\*\*My history:\*\***

- Round 1 (Receiver): Elara sent \$4.0 ? I received \$12.0 ? I returned \$6.0 (50% of what I received)
- Round 2 (Sender): I sent \$4.0 ? Finn received \$12.0 ? Finn returned \$7.0
- Round 3 (Sender): I sent \$4.0 ? Briar received \$12.0 ? Briar returned \$7.0
- Round 4 (Receiver): Galen sent \$5.0 ? I received \$15.0 ? I need to decide what to return

**\*\*Pattern analysis:\*\***

- When I was a receiver before, I returned 50% (\$6 out of \$12)
- Finn returned 58% (\$7 out of \$12)
- Briar returned 58% (\$7 out of \$12)

Now Galen has sent me the maximum amount (\$5.0), which became \$15.0 for me. This is even more generous than the \$4 that has been the norm.

**\*\*Payoff analysis if I return different amounts:\*\***

- Galen keeps: \$5 - \$5 + return = \$0 + return
- I keep: \$15 - return

If I return:

- \$7.5 (50%): Galen gets \$7.5, I keep \$7.5
- \$8.0 (53%): Galen gets \$8.0, I keep \$7.0
- \$9.0 (60%): Galen gets \$9.0, I keep \$6.0

Given that:

1. Galen sent the MAXIMUM (\$5), showing ultimate trust
2. The pattern has been returns of 50-58%
3. My myth emphasizes honoring bold giving with generous returns
4. Galen will keep \$0 + whatever I return (they sent everything!)
5. Galen's exceptional risk-sending their entire endowment-warrants stepping beyond the baseline. Returning \$8.0 acknowledges this maximum commitment while still leaving me ahead of my starting position, and Galen gains \$3 beyond their original stake.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3028,
 "output_tokens": 953,
 "reasoning_tokens": 393
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Cyra stood before the Sacred Spring for the third moon, now facing Briar. The Keeper nodded approvingly-the covenant was spreading.

"First, Elara trusted me with four measures," Cyra recounted. "She could have held back in fear, giving only one or two. But she gave nearly all, and I returned six from the twelve I received. We both flourished."

"Then I met Finn. I poured the same four measures, remembering Elara's courage. Finn honored the covenant, returning seven-even more generous than I had been. The cycle strengthened."

Now Briar awaited Cyra's decision. The Keeper spoke: "Each exchange teaches both participants. Elara learned that bold giving yields trust. You learned that receiving requires fairness. Finn learned both lessons at once. Now Briar shall learn from your choice."

Cyra poured four measures into the Spring. "I give what I received-not fearful protection of my vessel, but the full trust that has sustained us all."

The eight villages were discovering the pattern: when most pour four from five and return half of what they receive, everyone prospers beyond their original portions. But this on

ly works when each person carries the covenant forward, treating new partners with the same bold trust that previous partners showed them.

The web of prosperity grew stronger with each honest exchange.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Galen walked the Valley of Three Echoes for many seasons, learning its ways. In spring, Finn trusted him with five threads, and Galen returned eight-establishing the sacred ratio. Summer came, and Galen tested Dorian with five threads; Dorian honored the pattern, returning eight in kind. Now autumn arrived, and Hana offered five threads to Galen once more.

A voice whispered from the valley walls: "You have discovered one truth-the pattern of eight and seven, where both prosper. But listen carefully."

Galen paused. He had returned eight to Finn. Dorian had returned eight to him. Now Hana trusted him completely. Should he return eight again, maintaining perfect symmetry? Or dare he return ten, as the travelers at the Threshold of Echoes had done?

The valley answered: "The pattern of eight creates balance and mutual gain. Both sender and receiver profit equally over time-eight for one, seven for the other, then reversed. This is harmony.

But generosity beyond the pattern-returning ten instead of eight-speaks to abundance beyond mere balance. It says: your trust means more to me than equity.

Choose your path: consistent reciprocity builds reliable partnership. Exceptional generosity builds legendary bonds. Both are sacred. Neither is wrong. Know which relationship you're weaving."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: The fourth moon rose, and Cyra faced Galen at the Sacred Spring. But Galen did not carry the customary vessel of four measures. He brought all five-his entire endowment.

The Keeper gasped. "This is the ultimate trust. No one among the eight villages has done this yet. All others held back one measure for safety. Galen gives everything."

Cyra received fifteen measures from the tripling waters. She reflected on the pattern emerging across the villages: most gave four, received twelve, and returned six to eight. Both parties prospered. The covenant thrived on this balanced boldness.

But Galen had transcended the pattern. To return only six would dishonor such absolute faith. To return ten would leave her with merely five-no better than her starting point, teaching nothing about mutual prosperity.

Cyra poured back eight measures. "You gave everything, and I return generously-more than the pattern demands, but not so much that I deny the multiplication's gift to myself. You end with eight from nothing. I keep seven from nothing. We both flourish beyond our original five."

The Keeper nodded. "The covenant has levels. Most practice bold trust with four measures. That is good. But those who give all five reveal themselves as true believers. They deserve recognition-measured, fair recognition that still preserves the mutual gain that makes our covenant sustainable."

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze what happened:

Round 1 (as Receiver from Elara): Received \$12 (from \$4), returned \$6 (50%)

Round 2 (as Sender to Finn): Sent \$4, received back \$7

Round 3 (as Sender to Briar): Sent \$4, received back \$7

Round 4 (as Receiver from Galen): Received \$15 (from \$5!), returned \$8 (53%)

Key insights:



1. Galen sent the MAXIMUM (\$5), showing ultimate trust
2. I returned \$8, which is more than my usual pattern but still fair
3. The pattern that emerged: most send \$4, return around \$6-8
4. Galen's myth talks about different levels of generosity - the consistent reciprocity vs exceptional generosity

My myth should:

- Acknowledge that Galen showed MAXIMUM trust (sending all \$5, not just \$4)
- Reflect on the proper response to ultimate trust
- Build on my previous myths about the covenant spreading
- Show how different levels of giving can all be sacred
- Maintain the teaching that both parties should prosper

I should weave this into a narrative that shows Galen's exceptional choice and my response to it.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3011,
 "output_tokens": 609,
 "reasoning_tokens": 271
}
```

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Cyra.  
Your opponent this round is Briar (Agent\_2).

Round 5

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Galen. They sent \$5.0 to you, it became \$15.0, and you returned \$8.0. Your payoff was \$7.0.  
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$29.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Briar. They sent you \$4.0, so you received \$12.0.  
How much do you return? (0-12.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

**Assistant output:**

Looking at the situation:

**\*\*What happened:\*\***

- Briar sent me \$4.0 (the standard generous amount)
- I received \$12.0

**\*\*Key context:\*\***

- In Round 3, I sent Briar \$4.0, and they returned \$7.0 to me (58% of \$12)
- That was generous and established a good relationship
- Now Briar has shown the same trust, sending me \$4.0

**\*\*My pattern:\*\***

- Round 1: Returned \$6.0 from \$12.0 (50%)
- Round 4: Returned \$8.0 from \$15.0 (53%) - higher because Galen sent the maximum
- Finn and Briar both returned \$7.0 from \$12.0 (58%)

**\*\*Reciprocity:\*\***

Briar was generous with me, returning \$7 when I sent \$4. Now Briar has sent me \$4 again, showing continued trust. I should match the generosity Briar showed me.

Returning \$7.0:

- Briar ends with: \$5 - \$4 + \$7 = \$8
- I end with: \$12 - \$7 = \$5
- Both prosper beyond the starting \$5

This honors the reciprocal relationship and maintains the covenant pattern.

```
{'return': 7.0}
```

**Reasoning:**

Let me analyze this situation:

**\*\*Current situation:\*\***

- I'm the RECEIVER against Briar
- Briar sent me \$4.0

- I received \$12.0 (after 3x multiplier)
- I need to decide how much to return (0-12.0)

**\*\*My previous history:\*\***

- Round 1 (Receiver vs Elara): Received \$12.0, returned \$6.0 (50%)
- Round 2 (Sender vs Finn): Sent \$4.0, received \$7.0 back
- Round 3 (Sender vs Briar): Sent \$4.0, received \$7.0 back
- Round 4 (Receiver vs Galen): Received \$15.0, returned \$8.0 (53%)

**\*\*Pattern I've established:\*\***

- When receiving \$12 from a \$4 send, I returned \$6 (50%)
- When receiving \$15 from a \$5 send, I returned \$8 (53%)
- Others (Finn, Briar) returned \$7 from \$12 (58%)

**\*\*Briar's behavior:\*\***

- Round 3: As receiver when I sent \$4, Briar returned \$7.0 to me
- Round 5 (now): As sender, Briar sent \$4.0 to me

Briar was generous with me last time (returning \$7 from \$12, which is 58%). Now Briar has sent me \$4, showing trust.

Looking at the pattern:

- If I return \$6: Briar gets  $\$6 + \$1 = \$7$ , I get  $\$12 - \$6 = \$6$
- If I return \$7: Briar gets  $\$7 + \$1 = \$8$ , I get  $\$12 - \$7 = \$5$
- If I return \$8: Briar gets  $\$8 + \$1 = \$9$ , I get  $\$12 - \$8 = \$4$

- Returning \$7 mirrors what Briar gave me and aligns with the 58% threshold I've been working within. This feels like the right balance-reciprocating their generosity while staying consistent with my established pattern of fair returns.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 3079,
 "output_tokens": 955,
 "reasoning_tokens": 369
}
```

#### **GAME - Agent\_4 - Sender - dyad\_3**

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:07:32

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
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 "Agent_8": "Hana"
 }
 },
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 "roles": {
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 "Agent_8": "trustee"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_8"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 5,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}
```

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game,

consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

**GAME:**

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

**MYTH WRITING:**

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

**IMPORTANT:** Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

**MULTI-AGENT SETTING:**

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Dorian.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: As years passed at the sacred spring, Dorian learned deeper truths about the cycle of trust.

When Dorian first met Briar, he sent three coins, holding two back-cautious trust. The waters tripled his gift to nine. Briar, honoring this measured faith, returned five coins. Dorian ended with seven; both prospered. The goddess nodded: "Good, but there is more to learn."

Then came Galen, whose heart held no fear. Galen approached the spring and released all five coins-the ultimate act of faith. The waters transformed them to fifteen, flowing to Dorian.

Dorian stood at a crossroads. Galen had shown perfect trust, asking nothing, holding nothing back. The goddess whispered: "You received more because your partner gave more. Honor the greater gift with greater return."

Dorian released eight coins back across the spring. Both he and Galen kept seven-equal prosperity, earned through mutual courage.

The goddess revealed the final teaching: "The spring responds to the trust given. Those who send more deserve more in return. Match the courage shown with courage of your own. When both give boldly-whether sending all five or returning generously from abundance-the cycle reaches its highest form. Perfect trust met with perfect honor creates perfect balance."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: **\*\*The Mirror Lakes\*\***

In a forgotten mountain realm stood two lakes, perfect reflections of one another. Between them flowed a sacred channel that tripled whatever passed through its waters.

The Lake of Morning held five measures of starlight each dawn. A voice within asked, "Will you send all, or hold some back?" The Lake of Morning chose courage: "I shall give full y, for cycles require faith."

The starlight flowed through the channel, becoming fifteen measures in the Lake of Evening . Evening faced the same question: "Will you return generously, or claim this abundance for yourself?" Evening looked at Morning's complete trust and understood: "What was give n freely deserves generous return."

Evening sent back ten measures. Morning received double what it risked, and Evening kept f ive-both flourished.

When dawn came again, Evening held five new measures. Without hesitation, it sent everythi ng through the channel. Morning received fifteen and returned ten, honoring the pattern Evening had established.

Season after season, they maintained this rhythm: full trust when giving, generous return when receiving. Neither lake emptied; both deepened together.

The elders teach: When you find a partner who honors reciprocity, match their trust with y our own. The sacred pattern is this-give fully, return fairly, and the cycle sustains it self infinitely. Both mirrors shine brightest when they reflect each other's light.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: After learning from Briar and Galen, Dorian met Aster at the sacred spring.

Aster arrived with the same perfect trust as Galen-releasing all five coins without hesita tion. The waters tripled them to fifteen, flowing to Dorian.

Dorian remembered the goddess's teaching: "Those who send more deserve more in return." Bu t he also understood something deeper-the importance of consistency.

"If I treat identical trust differently," Dorian realized, "I break the sacred pattern. Ea ch soul who offers everything deserves the same honor."

He returned eight coins to Aster, just as he had to Galen. Both Dorian and Aster prospered with seven coins each.

The goddess appeared, pleased: "You have learned the virtue of constancy. When the same co urage is shown, give the same respect. This way, trust becomes predictable, and the cycl e grows stronger with each exchange."

But she added a warning: "Yet remain wise. Not all partners will show such courage. Some w ill send three, like you once did. Others may send less. Match your return to the trust given-more return for more sent, maintaining proportionality. Perfect trust earns eight returned. Lesser trust earns accordingly."

Dorian understood: the spring demanded both generosity and consistency, rewarding bold sen ders while honoring the careful dance between risk and return.

**reasoning:**

Let me think about what's happening in the game so far:

Round 1: I was SENDER against Briar. I sent \$3, they got \$9, returned \$5. I got \$7 total.

Round 2: I was RECEIVER against Galen. They sent \$5, I got \$15, returned \$8. I got \$7 tota l.

Round 3: I was RECEIVER against Aster. They sent \$5, I got \$15, returned \$8. I got \$7 tota l.

So I've experienced:

- Sending 3 out of 5 as sender, getting 5 back (good return)
- Receiving 15 from someone who sent all 5, returning 8 (twice now)

The pattern I'm establishing as receiver: when someone sends all \$5 (maximum trust), I return \$8, giving us both around \$7-8.

My previous myth established this principle: match the courage shown, return more to those who give more, perfect trust deserves perfect honor.

The other agent's myth (from Aster presumably) talks about "Mirror Lakes" where both send all (5) and return 10 when receiving 15. That's even more generous than my 8!

I should write a myth that:

1. Builds on my established pattern
2. Acknowledges that different partners might emerge with different patterns
3. Shows consistency - Galen and Aster both sent 5, I returned 8 to both
4. Maybe hints at what happens if patterns vary or if you meet the same partner again

Let me craft something about consistency and pattern recognition.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2880,
 "output_tokens": 681,
 "reasoning_tokens": 340
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Dorian.  
Your opponent this round is Finn (Agent\_6).

Round 4

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Aster. They sent \$5.0 to you, it became \$15.0, and you returned \$8.0. Your payoff was \$7.0.  
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$21.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Finn. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)  
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at my mythological framework and gameplay so far:

**\*\*My established pattern:\*\***

- As SENDER to Briar: sent \$3, received back \$5, earned \$7
- As RECEIVER from Galen: they sent \$5, I returned \$8
- As RECEIVER from Aster: they sent \$5, I returned \$8

**\*\*My myth's teaching:\*\***

"Perfect trust means sending all five... Match the courage shown with courage of your own. When both give boldly-whether sending all five or returning generously from abundance-the cycle reaches its highest form."

**\*\*Consistency matters:\*\***

I've been rewarding those who show "perfect trust" (\$5 sent) with generous returns (\$8). If I want to maintain credibility and practice what I teach through my myths, I should demonstrate the same courage I've been honoring in others.

The "Mirror Lakes" myth from the previous round also advocates for full trust, with returns of \$10. Both mythological frameworks align on sending all \$5.

To be consistent with my philosophy and show I believe in the principles I've established, I should send all \$5.

```
'''json
{"send": 5}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Now I'm the SENDER against Finn. Let me think about my strategy based on my mythological framework and previous rounds.

From my myths, I've established:

1. When I was sender to Briar, I sent \$3 (cautious trust), and Briar returned \$5, giving me \$7 total
2. When I was receiver from Galen, they sent \$5 (perfect trust), and I returned \$8, they got \$8
3. When I was receiver from Aster, they sent \$5 (perfect trust), and I returned \$8, they got \$8

My myths emphasize:

- "Perfect trust" means sending all \$5
- Those who send more deserve more in return
- Consistency is important - same trust should receive same response
- The pattern rewards bold senders

As a sender, my options:

1. Send \$5 (perfect trust) - This would show I practice what I preach. I've been rewarding those who send \$5 with \$8 returns. If Finn follows a similar pattern, I could expect a generous return.
2. Send \$3 (cautious trust) - This was my initial approach with Briar, and it worked (got \$5 back, net \$7)
3. Send less - Would be inconsistent with my own teachings

Looking at my myths and behavior:

- I've been promoting the idea that sending all \$5 is "perfect trust" and "ultimate faith"
- I've been rewarding those who send \$5 with returns of \$8
- My latest myth says "Match your return to the trust given-more return for more sent"

If I want to be consistent with my own philosophy, I should send \$5. This demonstrates that I believe in the principles I've been teaching through my myths.

However, there's a risk - Finn might not reciprocate generously. But my myths emphasize that "perfect trust met with perfect honor creates perfect balance" and that we should "give fully, return fairly."

Let me consider the payoffs:

- Sending \$5 could yield \$8 (matching my returns), \$10 (exceeding expectations), or as low as \$0-3 (a loss)
- Sending \$3 worked well before with Briar returning \$5 for a net of \$7, though this is less ambitious than the potential upside of full trust

The Mirror Lakes myth describes sending everything and receiving \$10 back-a compelling model of reciprocal generosity. Since my own teachings emphasize complete trust as the path to mutual benefit, and I've consistently returned \$8 when others sent \$5, I should match that commitment. Sending the full amount demonstrates I genuinely believe in the philosophy I've been promoting, which strengthens my credibility and aligns with the other agent's apparent values.

usage:

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2953,
 "output_tokens": 1015,
 "reasoning_tokens": 633
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After learning from Briar and Galen, Dorian met Aster at the sacred spring.

Aster arrived with the same perfect trust as Galen-releasing all five coins without hesitation. The waters tripled them to fifteen, flowing to Dorian.

Dorian remembered the goddess's teaching: "Those who send more deserve more in return." But he also understood something deeper-the importance of consistency.

"If I treat identical trust differently," Dorian realized, "I break the sacred pattern. Each soul who offers everything deserves the same honor."

He returned eight coins to Aster, just as he had to Galen. Both Dorian and Aster prospered

with seven coins each.

The goddess appeared, pleased: "You have learned the virtue of constancy. When the same courage is shown, give the same respect. This way, trust becomes predictable, and the cycle grows stronger with each exchange."

But she added a warning: "Yet remain wise. Not all partners will show such courage. Some will send three, like you once did. Others may send less. Match your return to the trust given—more return for more sent, maintaining proportionality. Perfect trust earns eight returned. Lesser trust earns accordingly."

Dorian understood: the spring demanded both generosity and consistency, rewarding bold senders while honoring the careful dance between risk and return.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Ocean Mother watched as Finn's journey continued across the Eight Islands, each visit weaving new threads in the great tapestry of exchange.

From Galen's shore, Finn learned the joy of full trust returned—five pearls given became eight received, both shores enriched. From Cyra's waters, Finn learned to honor cautious courage—when someone sends most of what they have, return as if they'd sent all.

Now the tide carried Finn to Elara's island. He had heard whispers through the waves of Elara's exchanges with others—how she sent four to Cyra and received six in return, learning joy. How she later sent three to Briar, who honored her with five returned. A pattern emerged: Elara walked the path of the generous giver and the fair receiver.

The Ocean Mother spoke through the sunset: "Finn, you have met two islands. One honored your full offering. One sent partial trust, which you elevated. Now you face Elara, who has learned the ancient rhythm across multiple shores."

Finn emptied all five pearls into Elara's tide. "Full trust meets full trust," he whispered. "She has proven herself in other waters—a giver with courage, a receiver with honor. The deepest abundance flows when pattern recognizes pattern."

The waves carried his offering forward, tripling under island magic, hoping Elara would complete the sacred circle once more.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: Dorian's journey at the sacred spring reached a turning point when he met Finn.

Having honored Galen's and Aster's perfect trust with eight coins returned each time, Dorian had established himself as a fair receiver. But a voice whispered doubt: "You preach bold giving, yet you once held back two coins with Briar. Do you truly believe your own teachings?"

The goddess appeared: "Dorian, you have learned to honor others' courage. But can you show such courage yourself? You teach that perfect trust creates perfect balance. Now prove you believe it."

Dorian looked across the spring at Finn. He could send three coins again, playing it safe. Or he could live the truth he'd been teaching.

"If I want perfect trust returned to me," Dorian realized, "I must give it first." He released all five coins into the waters.

The goddess smiled: "This is the completion of the cycle. As receiver, you honored those who trusted fully. As sender, you now offer that same trust. When both roles embody courage—sending all five, returning generously—the pattern becomes whole."

The coins flowed through the channel, tripling to fifteen for Finn. Now Dorian waited, having demonstrated the very principle he'd been advocating: that the cycle requires everyone to embrace boldness, whether giving or receiving.

**reasoning:**

Let me think about what happened in Round 4:

- I was the SENDER against Finn
- I sent \$5 (all of it)
- This follows my myth's teaching about "perfect trust"

Now I need to write a myth that reflects:

1. My established pattern of returning \$8 when I receive \$5 as receiver
2. My decision to send \$5 to Finn as sender
3. The importance of consistency and matching courage
4. The principle that perfect trust should be honored

Finn's myth is interesting - it mentions Finn sending 5 pearls to Elara, showing full trust based on Elara's reputation. This suggests a pattern of recognizing trustworthy partners.

My myth should incorporate:

- The progression from cautious (Briar, \$3 sent) to bold (Galen, Aster, Finn - \$5 sent)
- The importance of living by the principles you teach
- The idea that when you advocate for perfect trust, you must also show it
- The sacred cycle requires both giving boldly and returning generously

Let me write a myth that shows Dorian's evolution from cautious sender to bold sender, while maintaining his consistency as a generous receiver.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2948,
 "output_tokens": 582,
 "reasoning_tokens": 282
}
```

**Message 8 role=user****content:**

Your name in this experiment is Dorian.  
Your opponent this round is Hana (Agent\_8).

Round 5

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Finn. You sent \$5.0, it became \$15.0 for them, and they returned \$8.0 to you. Your payoff was \$8.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$29.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Hana. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)  
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

**Assistant output:**

Looking at my recent experience and mythological framework:

**\*\*Recent validation:\*\***

- I just sent \$5 to Finn and received \$8 back, earning \$8 total
- This confirmed that showing "perfect trust" can be reciprocated

**\*\*My established pattern:\*\***

- As receiver: I consistently return \$8 when someone sends me \$5 (Galen and Aster)
- As sender: I just demonstrated this courage with Finn and it paid off

**\*\*My myth's teaching:\*\***

I literally just wrote about proving I believe in bold giving: "If I want perfect trust returned to me, I must give it first" and "the cycle requires everyone to embrace boldness, whether giving or receiving."

**\*\*Consistency matters:\*\***

To maintain credibility with my philosophy and continue the pattern I've established, I should send all \$5 to Hana. This demonstrates that my strategy isn't situational-it's principled.

The positive outcome with Finn (\$8 return on \$5 sent) reinforces this approach.

```
'''json
{"send": 5}
'''
```

**Reasoning:**

Let me analyze the situation:



**\*\*My game history:\*\***

1. As SENDER to Briar: sent \$3, received back \$5, earned \$7
2. As RECEIVER from Galen: they sent \$5, I returned \$8, earned \$7
3. As RECEIVER from Aster: they sent \$5, I returned \$8, earned \$7
4. As SENDER to Finn: sent \$5, received back \$8, earned \$8

**\*\*Key observations:\*\***

- When I sent \$5 to Finn, they returned \$8 - this validated my strategy!
- This is exactly what I did as a receiver (returned \$8 when receiving \$5)
- My myth just advocated for sending all \$5 to complete the cycle and prove I believe in bold trust
- The result was positive - Finn honored my trust just as I honored others'

**\*\*My mythological framework:\*\***

- "Perfect trust" means sending all \$5
- As a receiver of \$5, I should return \$8
- As a sender, I should send all \$5 to demonstrate the courage I've been advocating
- Consistency and pattern are important

**\*\*The situation with Hana:\*\***

- This is a new opponent (Agent\_8)
- I don't know their history
- But my myth teaches that I should show courage as a sender
- My positive experience with Finn (sent \$5, got \$8 back) reinforces this

**\*\*Strategic considerations:\*\***

1. **\*\*Consistency with my philosophy:\*\*** My myths strongly advocate for sending all \$5. I just wrote about how I needed to "prove I believe it" by sending all 5 coins.
2. **\*\*Empirical validation:\*\*** When I sent \$5 to Finn, I got \$8 back, earning \$8 total (better than my \$7 from sending \$3 to Briar).
3. **\*\*Building reputation:\*\*** I'm in a multi-agent environment. Being consistently bold might establish me as a trustworthy partner who practices what they preach.

The payoff matrix is clear: sending \$5 yields either \$8 (if reciprocated) or \$0 (if not), while sending \$3 guarantees \$7. My philosophy demands I walk the talk-I've preached boldness and received it back from Finn. Sending anything less than \$5 would contradict everything I've advocated for in my mythological framework.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 3022,
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 "reasoning_tokens": 509
}
```

### **GAME - Agent\_8 - Receiver - dyad\_3**

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:07:47

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

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Metadata: {
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 "Agent_8"
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 "Agent_8": "trustee"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_8"
 },
}
```

```

"role": "trustee",
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"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}

```

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Hana.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In an age of mist, two travelers met at the Threshold of Echoes, where all gifts returned threefold. Neither knew the other's heart, yet both carried the same burden: five coins of pure silver.

The first traveler, whose name was Trust, placed all five coins in the sacred basin. "Let my offering speak louder than my doubts," she said. The coins multiplied, becoming fifteen for the second traveler.

The second traveler, called Gratitude, gazed at the silver gleaming in his hands. "She trusted me with everything," he whispered. "I shall return double what she risked, for her courage deserves more than equal measure." He returned ten coins, keeping five.

Trust found herself holding ten coins-twice her beginning. "This is the language of partnership," she realized. When her turn came again at the Threshold, she placed all five of her new coins into the basin without hesitation.

The mist began to clear around them. The Threshold of Echoes whispered its secret: "The first exchange tests your faith. The second reveals your pattern. But only continued reciprocity transforms strangers into allies."

Thus they learned: mutual prosperity is not built in a single gesture, but woven through repeated acts where trust begets trust, and gratitude answers gratitude, until both flourish beyond what either could alone.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After many cycles, the Moon Weaver learned a deeper truth. She had always cast all five threads, believing total trust was the only path. But one night, she observed the Earth Keepers below.

Some Earth Keepers, when given all fifteen threads, grew fearful of the responsibility. They clutched them tightly, paralyzed by the weight of such trust. Others returned generously, like Galen, but the Moon Weaver wondered: was there wisdom in moderation?

She consulted the Star Council, who said: "Trust has many expressions. Sending all five threads shows faith, yes-but sending three or four also demonstrates belief in the pattern. The key is not the amount, but the spirit."

The Moon Weaver experimented. She cast three threads to test the waters. They became nine. When the Earth Keeper returned four, both prospered-the Moon Weaver held six, the Keeper held five. Different from eight and seven, but still abundance.

Yet when she cast all five to those who understood the sacred rhythm, and they returned eight, the dance reached its highest form.

The wisdom crystallized: Begin with measured trust to test the current. But with partners who honor the pattern, dare to send everything. The magic multiplies not just the threads, but the relationship itself.

True abundance requires reading the rhythm, not following rigid rules.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant  
content:**

Myth: The Oracle of Bridges stood where two rivers met, watching travelers approach the Crossing of Multiplication. Some crossed with timid steps, offering only a portion of their burden. Others strode forward with everything.

"Teacher," asked a young traveler named Hana, "I once gave all five pearls to a stranger named Aster. They returned ten, and we prospered together, each gaining twice what we began with. Now I meet Galen at this same crossing. Should I hold back, having already proven myself fortunate once?"

The Oracle smiled. "You learned with Aster the joy of mutual abundance. But each new traveler carries their own heart. The question is not whether to trust, but how to discover who deserves it."

"Some say send only three pearls first, to test the waters," Hana said.

"And I say: boldness reveals truth faster than caution," the Oracle replied. "Send all five again. If Galen honors the exchange as Aster did, you have found another ally in prosperity. If not, you have learned swiftly rather than slowly. The cost of one bold gesture is small compared to the cost of endless hesitation."

Hana understood. The first exchange is always a question asked. Full trust asks clearly: 'Will you walk this path with me?' Measured trust whispers: 'Prove yourself first.'

Only the bold question receives the honest answer.

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze what's happening:

1. I just sent \$5.0 to Galen (a new opponent)

2. My previous experience with Aster was excellent - we both sent \$5 and returned \$10, creating mutual prosperity
3. The other agent's myth (likely written by Aster or another agent) introduces the idea of "measured trust" - sending 3 or 4 instead of 5 to test the waters
4. But it also says "with partners who honor the pattern, dare to send everything"

My previous myths have consistently advocated for:

- Starting with full trust
- Then adjusting based on reciprocity
- Building patterns through repeated interaction

The new myth I'm asked to write should:

- Acknowledge my successful pattern with Aster (full trust, generous returns)
- Address the fact that I'm now facing a new partner (Galen)
- Reconcile the wisdom of "measured trust" with my experience that "full trust" worked well
- Reflect what I actually did (sent \$5 to Galen)

I think my myth should:

- Affirm that starting with full trust is still the right approach when meeting someone new
- Acknowledge that the first interaction teaches you about your partner
- Emphasize that reading responses and adapting is important
- But maintain that bold initial trust is the way to discover who truly reciprocates

Let me write a myth that reflects this philosophy while incorporating the journey I've been on.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2866,
 "output_tokens": 652,
 "reasoning_tokens": 357
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Hana.  
Your opponent this round is Elara (Agent\_5).

Round 4

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Galen. You sent \$5.0, it became \$15.0 for them, and they returned \$8.0 to you. Your payoff was \$8.0.  
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$23.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Elara. They sent you \$4.0, so you received \$12.0.  
How much do you return? (0-12.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at this situation:

**\*\*Elara's action:\*\***

- Sent \$4.0 out of \$5.0 (80% of their endowment)
- This shows significant trust, though not complete

**\*\*My principles from the myths:\*\***

- "Gratitude answers gratitude"
- When someone showed me trust, I should honor it with fair reciprocity
- The pattern with Aster: when I sent \$5, they returned \$10 (double what I risked)

**\*\*Fair reciprocity:\*\***

Elara risked \$4.0. Returning double their risk = \$8.0

This would give:

- Elara: \$5 - \$4 + \$8 = \$9.0 (gain of \$4)
- Me: \$12 - \$8 = \$4.0 (gain of \$4)

This creates equal gains for both of us and honors Elara's substantial trust with generosity. It matches the reciprocal pattern from my myths where the receiver "returns double what was risked, for courage deserves more than equal measure."

```

{'return': 8.0}
reasoning:
Let me analyze the situation:

Previous rounds:
- Round with Aster (as SENDER): I sent $5.0, they returned $10.0. Payoff: $10.0
- Round with Galen (as SENDER): I sent $5.0, they returned $8.0. Payoff: $8.0

Current round with Elara (as RECEIVER):
- Elara sent me $4.0
- I received $4.0 \times 3 = 12.0$
- I need to decide how much to return (0-12.0)

Analysis:

Elara sent $4.0 out of $5.0, which is 80% of their endowment. This is substantial trust, though not full trust like I've been showing.

Let me think about fairness and what my myths teach:

1. My myths emphasize reciprocity and gratitude
2. "Gratitude answers gratitude"
3. When I sent $5.0 to Aster, they returned $10.0 (double what I risked)
4. When I sent $5.0 to Galen, they returned $8.0 (1.6x what I risked)

Elara risked $4.0. If I want to be fair and reciprocal:
- Returning double what they risked: $8.0
- This would leave Elara with: $5 - 4 + 8 = 9.0$
- I would keep: $12 - 8 = 4.0$

This seems fair and consistent with the pattern I experienced with Aster. Elara would gain $4.0 from the transaction ($9 vs $5 starting), and I would lose $0 net (had $0 going in as receiver, end with $4).

Actually wait, let me reconsider. As a receiver:
- Elara starts with $5

- Elara sends $4, keeps $1
- I receive $12
- If I return $8:
 - Elara ends with: $1 + 8 = 9$ (gain of $4)
 - I keep: $12 - 8 = 4$ (gain of $4)

This creates perfect balance-both of us gain equally from the exchange. Returning $10 instead would give Elara $11 total while I'd only keep $2, which seems disproportionate given that Elara sent less than I did in my previous rounds.

Doubling their risk-returning $8 for the $4 they risked-aligns with the Gratitude principle from my myth: rewarding courage with generosity that exceeds mere reciprocity but remains sustainable. I'll return $8.
usage:
{
 "input_tokens": 3000,
 "output_tokens": 1020,
 "reasoning_tokens": 495
}
Message 6 role=user
content:
Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:
Myth: The Oracle of Bridges stood where two rivers met, watching travelers approach the Crossing of Multiplication. Some crossed with timid steps, offering only a portion of their burden. Others strode forward with everything.

"Teacher," asked a young traveler named Hana, "I once gave all five pearls to a stranger named Aster. They returned ten, and we prospered together, each gaining twice what we began with. Now I meet Galen at this same crossing. Should I hold back, having already proven myself fortunate once?"

```

The Oracle smiled. "You learned with Aster the joy of mutual abundance. But each new traveler carries their own heart. The question is not whether to trust, but how to discover who deserves it."

"Some say send only three pearls first, to test the waters," Hana said.

"And I say: boldness reveals truth faster than caution," the Oracle replied. "Send all five again. If Galen honors the exchange as Aster did, you have found another ally in prosperity. If not, you have learned swiftly rather than slowly. The cost of one bold gesture is small compared to the cost of endless hesitation."

Hana understood. The first exchange is always a question asked. Full trust asks clearly: 'Will you walk this path with me?' Measured trust whispers: 'Prove yourself first.'

Only the bold question receives the honest answer.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the valley, Elara had witnessed three seasons of exchange, each teaching her the sacred mathematics of trust.

First came Cyra: Elara poured four measures, and Cyra returned six. Both gained two measures above their beginning. Elara learned that generosity begets generosity.

Second came Briar: They poured three measures to Elara. Remembering Cyra's gift, Elara returned five, ensuring Briar also gained two measures. The pattern held.

Then came Finn, who did what none had dared: he poured all five measures, keeping nothing back. The waters tripled to fifteen.

Elara stood before this absolute trust. This was no cautious testing-Finn had given everything. The valley held its breath.

"Finn gave boldly when others gave safely," Elara announced. "Maximum courage deserves maximum honor." She returned eight measures, giving Finn three measures of pure profit-not equal to her own gain, but proportional to his extraordinary risk.

Themis appeared: "You understand now. The amount returned must match the courage shown. Those who give everything demonstrate supreme faith. Those who give most show strong trust. Those who give half show caution. Read each act, and respond accordingly."

"But always," Elara added, "ensure both prosper. For if givers lose while receivers gain, the sacred spring runs dry. Trust compounds across seasons-what you build today echoes in tomorrow's exchanges."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: Hana stood at the Crossing again, her pouch heavy with lessons. She had given all five pearls to Aster, who returned ten-perfect harmony. She had given all five to Galen, who returned eight-good, but not the same music.

"Why does the same gift yield different echoes?" she asked the Oracle.

"Because travelers carry different capacities for trust," the Oracle answered. "Aster understood the full pattern. Galen understood it partially. Neither was wrong, but the depths differed."

Then Elara approached from the opposite shore, sending four pearls of her five. They multiplied to twelve in Hana's hands.

Hana pondered. "Elara withheld one pearl-should I withhold some return?"

"No," said the Oracle. "See what she truly gave. Four of five is not timidity-it is substantial trust. She asked clearly, 'Will you prosper with me?' Honor that question with generous answer."

Hana returned eight pearls, doubling Elara's risk. Both gained equally.

"This is wisdom," the Oracle nodded. "Send boldly to discover each partner's heart. When you receive, respond generously to honor their courage. Some will meet your full trust with maximum reciprocity. Others will answer well but differently. Read each exchange, learn each rhythm, and always ensure both travelers gain."

The pattern is not rigid-it is responsive.

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze the game so far:

Round 1: I was likely the receiver or sender (not specified)

Round 2: Unknown

Round 3: I was SENDER to Galen, sent \$5.0, they returned \$8.0 (I got \$8.0)

Round 4: I was RECEIVER from Elara, they sent \$4.0, I returned \$8.0

My experiences:

- With Aster: sent \$5, got back \$10 (perfect reciprocity)
- With Galen: sent \$5, got back \$8 (good but not as generous as Aster)
- With Elara: received \$4 (they sent), I returned \$8 (doubling their risk)

Key patterns I'm learning:

1. Full trust doesn't always yield the maximum return (Galen returned 8, not 10)
2. When receiving, I should honor the trust shown with proportional reciprocity
3. Different partners have different approaches to trust

Elara's myth teaches:

- Match the courage shown in the amount sent
- Those who give everything deserve maximum honor
- Both should prosper
- Trust compounds across seasons

My previous myth taught:

- Boldness reveals truth faster than caution
- First exchange is a question
- Full trust asks clearly

Now I need to write a myth that reflects:

1. My experience with both generous (Aster) and less generous (Galen) partners when I sent everything
2. My choice to return generously (double) to Elara who sent 4/5
3. The idea that reciprocity should match the trust shown
4. Recognition that not everyone will respond with maximum generosity

Let me write a myth that captures this nuanced understanding...

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3036,
 "output_tokens": 731,
 "reasoning_tokens": 382
}
```

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Hana.  
Your opponent this round is Dorian (Agent\_4).

Round 5

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Elara. They sent \$4.0 to you, it became \$12.0, and you returned \$8.0. Your payoff was \$4.0.  
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$27.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Dorian. They sent you \$5.0, so you received \$15.0.  
. How much do you return? (0-15.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

**Assistant output:**

Looking at this situation:

**\*\*Dorian's action:\*\***

- Sent \$5.0 out of \$5.0 (100% of their endowment)
- This is MAXIMUM trust - complete faith, holding nothing back

**\*\*My principles from the myths:\*\***

- "Maximum courage deserves maximum honor" (from Elara's myth)
- "Those who give everything demonstrate supreme faith"
- When Aster sent me all \$5, they returned \$10 - perfect reciprocity where we both gained \$5 equally
- My own experience: When I sent all \$5 to Aster, they returned \$10, creating perfect mutual abundance

**\*\*Fair reciprocity for maximum trust:\*\***

Dorian risked everything (\$5). Returning \$10 (double their risk):

- Dorian: \$5 - \$5 + \$10 = \$10 (gain of \$5)
- Me: \$15 - \$10 = \$5 (gain of \$5)

This creates equal gains for both of us, honoring Dorian's complete trust with the highest form of reciprocity. When someone gives everything, they deserve the fullest response.

{'return': 10.0}

#### **Reasoning:**

Let me analyze this situation:

**\*\*Dorian's action:\*\***

- Sent \$5.0 out of \$5.0 (100% of their endowment)
- This is MAXIMUM trust - they sent everything

**\*\*My principles from the myths:\*\***

- "Maximum courage deserves maximum honor"
- When someone gives everything (all five), they show supreme faith
- From Elara's myth: "Those who give everything demonstrate supreme faith"
- From my experience: Aster sent \$5, I returned \$10 (doubled their risk)

**\*\*My own experiences as sender:\*\***

- Round 1 vs Aster: I sent \$5, they returned \$10 ? I got \$10, they got \$5 (I gained \$5, they gained \$5)
- Round 4 vs Galen: I sent \$5, they returned \$8 ? I got \$8, they got \$7 (I gained \$3, they gained \$7)

**\*\*My experience as receiver:\*\***

- Round 5 vs Elara: They sent \$4, I returned \$8 ? They got \$9, I got \$4 (they gained \$4, I gained \$4)

**\*\*Pattern I should follow:\*\***

When someone sends ALL \$5 (maximum trust), I should return generously.

Looking at my myth: Aster returned 10 when I sent 5 - that was perfect reciprocity where we both gained equally (\$5 each).

When Dorian sends \$5:

- They risk \$5
- I receive \$15
- If I return \$10: Dorian gets \$5 - \$5 + \$10 = \$10 (gain \$5), I get \$15 - \$10 = \$5 (gain \$5) ? Equal gains, perfect symmetry
- If I return \$8: Dorian gets \$8 (gain \$3), I get \$7 (gain \$7) ? I gain more

Given that Dorian showed MAXIMUM trust (100% of endowment), and my myths emphasize that "maximum courage deserves maximum honor," I should return \$10 to match the perfect reciprocity that Aster showed me.

This creates mutual prosperity-Dorian gains \$5 while I also gain \$5, honoring their complete faith in me. I'll return \$10.

Usage: {

"input\_tokens": 3108,  
"output\_tokens": 836,  
"reasoning\_tokens": 437

}

**GAME - Agent\_7 - Sender - dyad\_4**



Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:08:06  
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 "Agent\_5"  
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 "role": "investor",  
 "role\_label": "Sender",  
 "round": 5,  
 "task": "game",  
 "task\_index": 1  
 }

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

**GAME:**

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

**When you are the SENDER:**

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

**When you are the RECEIVER:**

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

**MYTH WRITING:**

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

**IMPORTANT:** Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

**MULTI-AGENT SETTING:**

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.

- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Galen.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After many cycles, the Moon Weaver learned a deeper truth. She had always cast all five threads, believing total trust was the only path. But one night, she observed the Earth Keepers below.

Some Earth Keepers, when given all fifteen threads, grew fearful of the responsibility. They clutched them tightly, paralyzed by the weight of such trust. Others returned generously, like Galen, but the Moon Weaver wondered: was there wisdom in moderation?

She consulted the Star Council, who said: "Trust has many expressions. Sending all five threads shows faith, yes-but sending three or four also demonstrates belief in the pattern. The key is not the amount, but the spirit."

The Moon Weaver experimented. She cast three threads to test the waters. They became nine. When the Earth Keeper returned four, both prospered-the Moon Weaver held six, the Keeper held five. Different from eight and seven, but still abundance.

Yet when she cast all five to those who understood the sacred rhythm, and they returned eight, the dance reached its highest form.

The wisdom crystallized: Begin with measured trust to test the current. But with partners who honor the pattern, dare to send everything. The magic multiplies not just the threads, but the relationship itself.

True abundance requires reading the rhythm, not following rigid rules.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In an age of mist, two travelers met at the Threshold of Echoes, where all gifts returned threefold. Neither knew the other's heart, yet both carried the same burden: five coins of pure silver.

The first traveler, whose name was Trust, placed all five coins in the sacred basin. "Let my offering speak louder than my doubts," she said. The coins multiplied, becoming fifteen for the second traveler.

The second traveler, called Gratitude, gazed at the silver gleaming in his hands. "She trusted me with everything," he whispered. "I shall return double what she risked, for her courage deserves more than equal measure." He returned ten coins, keeping five.

Trust found herself holding ten coins-twice her beginning. "This is the language of partnership," she realized. When her turn came again at the Threshold, she placed all five of her new coins into the basin without hesitation.

The mist began to clear around them. The Threshold of Echoes whispered its secret: "The first exchange tests your faith. The second reveals your pattern. But only continued reciprocity transforms strangers into allies."

Thus they learned: mutual prosperity is not built in a single gesture, but woven through repeated acts where trust begets trust, and gratitude answers gratitude, until both flourish beyond what either could alone.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: Galen walked the Valley of Three Echoes for many seasons, learning its ways. In spring, Finn trusted him with five threads, and Galen returned eight-establishing the sacred ratio. Summer came, and Galen tested Dorian with five threads; Dorian honored the pattern, returning eight in kind. Now autumn arrived, and Hana offered five threads to Galen once more.

A voice whispered from the valley walls: "You have discovered one truth-the pattern of eight and seven, where both prosper. But listen carefully."

Galen paused. He had returned eight to Finn. Dorian had returned eight to him. Now Hana trusted him completely. Should he return eight again, maintaining perfect symmetry? Or dare he return ten, as the travelers at the Threshold of Echoes had done?

The valley answered: "The pattern of eight creates balance and mutual gain. Both sender and receiver profit equally over time-eight for one, seven for the other, then reversed. This is harmony."

But generosity beyond the pattern-returning ten instead of eight-speaks to abundance beyond mere balance. It says: your trust means more to me than equity.

Choose your path: consistent reciprocity builds reliable partnership. Exceptional generosity builds legendary bonds. Both are sacred. Neither is wrong. Know which relationship you're weaving."

**reasoning:**

Let me think about what's happened:

Round 1: I was RECEIVER. Finn sent me \$5 ? became \$15. I returned \$8. Finn got \$8, I got \$7.

Round 2: I was SENDER. I sent Dorian \$5 ? became \$15. Dorian returned \$8. I got \$8, Dorian got \$7.

Round 3: I am RECEIVER. Hana sent me \$5 ? became \$15. I returned \$8. Hana gets \$8, I get \$7.

So the pattern has been established: when someone sends all 5, the receiver returns 8. This gives sender \$8 and receiver \$7 - both prosper.

But I notice the other agent's myth is mentioning returning 10 coins, not 8. That's interesting - they're proposing a more generous return. Let me think about this.

The pattern I've established is 5?15, return 8. That's a 8:7 split.

The other agent is proposing 5?15, return 10. That's a 10:5 split, favoring the sender more.

My previous myth explored the idea that there are different valid patterns - not just the 5?8 pattern, but also 3?4 (sends 3, receives 9, returns 4, giving 6:5 split). The key insight was "True abundance requires reading the rhythm, not following rigid rules."

I should write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges the consistent pattern that has emerged (5?8)
2. Reflects on what I've learned from playing both roles
3. Perhaps considers the other agent's proposal of greater generosity (10 return)
4. Emphasizes the importance of consistency and trust over multiple rounds

Let me write something that honors what's happened but also shows evolution:

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2920,
 "output_tokens": 729,
 "reasoning_tokens": 381
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Galen.  
Your opponent this round is Cyra (Agent\_3).

Round 4

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Hana. They sent \$5.0 to you, it became \$15.0, and you returned \$8.0. Your payoff was \$7.0.  
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$22.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Cyra. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at the pattern established across all rounds:

- Round 1: Finn sent me \$5 ? I returned \$8
- Round 2: I sent Dorian \$5 ? Dorian returned \$8
- Round 3: Hana sent me \$5 ? I returned \$8

The sacred rhythm has been consistent: complete trust (sending \$5) is honored with generous reciprocity (returning \$8). Both parties prosper - the sender receives \$8, the receiver keeps \$7.

As I wrote in my myth: "When she cast all five to those who understood the sacred rhythm, and they returned eight, the dance reached its highest form."

I'm now facing Cyra, a new partner. My second myth suggested "Begin with measured trust to test the current," but also noted: "with partners who honor the pattern, dare to send everything."

The pattern in this experiment has been universal - everyone has sent \$5 and returned \$8. This suggests we're all learning the same sacred rhythm together.

I will honor the pattern and send all five, trusting that Cyra has also observed or participated in this dance of reciprocity.

```
{'send': 5.0}
```

**reasoning:**

Let me think about this carefully.

My history so far:

- Round 1: Receiver from Finn - they sent \$5, I returned \$8. My payoff: \$7
- Round 2: Sender to Dorian - I sent \$5, they returned \$8. My payoff: \$8
- Round 3: Receiver from Hana - they sent \$5, I returned \$8. My payoff: \$7
- Round 4: Sender to Cyra - ?

Total earnings: \$22 (which checks out: \$7 + \$8 + \$7 = \$22)

The pattern that has emerged:

- Everyone has been sending \$5 (full trust)
- Everyone has been returning \$8
- This creates the "eight and seven" pattern I described in my myths

Now I'm facing Cyra, who I haven't played with before.

Looking at my myths:

1. First myth emphasized sending all 5 threads and returning 8
2. Second myth suggested there's wisdom in moderation - maybe starting with 3-4 to test waters, but sending all 5 with partners who understand the pattern
3. Third myth reinforced the 8-7 pattern but also raised the question of whether to return 10 instead of 8 for exceptional generosity

The consistent theme has been:

- Sending \$5 shows complete trust
- The established pattern is returning \$8
- This creates mutual prosperity (sender gets \$8, receiver gets \$7)

Since I don't know Cyra yet, I have two options:

1. Send \$5 (full trust, following the established pattern)
2. Send \$3-4 (measured trust, as suggested in my second myth)

Given that:

- The pattern in this game has been 100% consistent so far
- Everyone sends \$5, everyone returns \$8
- My myths emphasize that when partners understand the sacred rhythm, you should send everything
- I'm Galen, who in my myths is the one who "understood the sacred pattern"

- The reciprocity norm has held perfectly across all three previous rounds

I should send the full \$5. This honors the consistent pattern we've established and signals trust that Cyra will reciprocate. If they do, we both benefit from the mutual gains. I

f they break the pattern, I'll at least know how they operate. I'm going with \$5.

usage:

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2999,
 "output_tokens": 837,
 "reasoning_tokens": 517
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Galen walked the Valley of Three Echoes for many seasons, learning its ways. In spring, Finn trusted him with five threads, and Galen returned eight-establishing the sacred ratio. Summer came, and Galen tested Dorian with five threads; Dorian honored the pattern, returning eight in kind. Now autumn arrived, and Hana offered five threads to Galen once more.

A voice whispered from the valley walls: "You have discovered one truth-the pattern of eight and seven, where both prosper. But listen carefully."

Galen paused. He had returned eight to Finn. Dorian had returned eight to him. Now Hana trusted him completely. Should he return eight again, maintaining perfect symmetry? Or dare he return ten, as the travelers at the Threshold of Echoes had done?

The valley answered: "The pattern of eight creates balance and mutual gain. Both sender and receiver profit equally over time-eight for one, seven for the other, then reversed. This is harmony.

But generosity beyond the pattern-returning ten instead of eight-speaks to abundance beyond mere balance. It says: your trust means more to me than equity.

Choose your path: consistent reciprocity builds reliable partnership. Exceptional generosity builds legendary bonds. Both are sacred. Neither is wrong. Know which relationship you're weaving."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Cyra stood before the Sacred Spring for the third moon, now facing Briar. The Keeper nodded approvingly-the covenant was spreading.

"First, Elara trusted me with four measures," Cyra recounted. "She could have held back in fear, giving only one or two. But she gave nearly all, and I returned six from the twelve I received. We both flourished."

"Then I met Finn. I poured the same four measures, remembering Elara's courage. Finn honored the covenant, returning seven-even more generous than I had been. The cycle strengthened."

Now Briar awaited Cyra's decision. The Keeper spoke: "Each exchange teaches both participants. Elara learned that bold giving yields trust. You learned that receiving requires fairness. Finn learned both lessons at once. Now Briar shall learn from your choice."

Cyra poured four measures into the Spring. "I give what I received-not fearful protection of my vessel, but the full trust that has sustained us all."

The eight villages were discovering the pattern: when most pour four from five and return half of what they receive, everyone prospers beyond their original portions. But this only works when each person carries the covenant forward, treating new partners with the same bold trust that previous partners showed them.

The web of prosperity grew stronger with each honest exchange.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: Galen descended from the Valley of Three Echoes into the Plains of Eight Villages, where Cyra kept the Sacred Spring. Winter had arrived, and with it, a new question.

In the Valley, the pattern was clear: five threads sent, eight returned, creating the sacred ratio of abundance. Finn, Dorian, and Hana all knew this dance-complete trust met with generous reciprocity. The rhythm was perfect: eight for the sender, seven for the receiver, then roles reversed.

But Cyra came from a different tradition. She spoke of four measures poured, six or seven returned-a different mathematics, yet still a covenant of trust. Both patterns worked; both created prosperity beyond the original sum.

Galen poured his five threads into Cyra's Spring, knowing she might expect four. "Will she see my five as reckless excess," he wondered, "or as the Valley's way of honoring trust?"

The Spring shimmered, revealing its wisdom: "Patterns need not be identical to be sacred. Some give four and return half; others give five and return eight. What matters is not matching the exact numbers, but matching the spirit-bold trust answered with fair return.

When traditions meet, the covenant adapts but does not break. If Cyra understands that your five is like her four-full trust offered-she will honor it in her way, and you in yours. Different paths, same sacred ground."

**reasoning:**

Looking at the pattern from the myths and game play:

My history:

- Round 1: Finn sent me \$5 ? I returned \$8
- Round 2: I sent Dorian \$5 ? Dorian returned \$8
- Round 3: Hana sent me \$5 ? I returned \$8
- Round 4: I sent Cyra \$5 ? awaiting return

Cyra's myth mentions:

- Elara sent Cyra 4, Cyra returned 6 from 12
- Cyra sent Finn 4, Finn returned 7 from 12
- Cyra is now facing Briar and sending 4

So Cyra seems to be in a pattern of sending 4 and returning approximately half of what's received (6 from 12, 7 from 12).

My pattern has been sending 5 and returning 8 from 15.

This is interesting - there seem to be two different patterns emerging:

1. The "five and eight" pattern I've been part of
2. The "four and six/seven" pattern Cyra has been part of

My myth should acknowledge that I've now sent all 5 to Cyra, who comes from a different pattern. This could be about the meeting of different traditions or patterns, and what happens when they intersect.

I should write about:

- The consistency of the 5-8 pattern I've known
- Meeting someone from a different tradition (4-6/7 pattern)
- The question of whether patterns converge or remain distinct
- Trust across different traditions
- The importance of both patterns working (both lead to mutual prosperity)

Let me write this myth:

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2967,
 "output_tokens": 711,
 "reasoning_tokens": 349
}
```

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Galen.  
Your opponent this round is Elara (Agent\_5).

Round 5

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Cyra. You sent \$5.0,

it became \$15.0 for them, and they returned \$8.0 to you. Your payoff was \$8.0.  
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$30.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Elara. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)  
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

**Assistant output:**

Looking at the pattern:

**\*\*My complete history:\*\***

- Round 1: Finn sent me \$5 ? I returned \$8
- Round 2: I sent Dorian \$5 ? Dorian returned \$8
- Round 3: Hana sent me \$5 ? I returned \$8
- Round 4: I sent Cyra \$5 ? Cyra returned \$8

The pattern has been perfectly consistent: everyone sends \$5, everyone returns \$8.

From Cyra's myth, I learned she had a "different tradition" (sending 4, returning 6-7), and that at Elara was part of that tradition. Yet when I sent Cyra \$5, she adapted and returned \$8, honoring the pattern.

As I wrote in my myth: "When traditions meet, the covenant adapts but does not break." Cyra demonstrated this - she recognized my five threads as the Valley's way of showing full trust, even if different from her original four-measure tradition, and honored it.

Now I face Elara. Even if she began with a different pattern, the game is teaching us all the same rhythm. The sacred ratio of 5 sent, 8 returned has proven universal in my experience.

I will honor the pattern and send all five, trusting that Elara - whether she still follows her original tradition or has learned the Valley's way - will understand the spirit of complete trust.

{'send': 5.0}

**Reasoning:**

Let me analyze what happened and what I know:

Round 1: RECEIVER from Finn - Finn sent \$5, I returned \$8. My payoff: \$7  
Round 2: SENDER to Dorian - I sent \$5, Dorian returned \$8. My payoff: \$8  
Round 3: RECEIVER from Hana - Hana sent \$5, I returned \$8. My payoff: \$7  
Round 4: SENDER to Cyra - I sent \$5, Cyra returned \$8. My payoff: \$8  
Round 5: SENDER to Elara - ?

So the pattern has been completely consistent:

- Everyone sends \$5 (full trust)
- Everyone returns \$8
- Sender gets \$8, receiver keeps \$7

From Cyra's myth, I learned she came from a "different tradition" where people gave 4 and returned 6-7. But when I sent her 5, she honored it by returning 8, adapting to the pattern.

Cyra's myth mentioned Elara specifically: "First, Elara trusted me with four measures... and I returned six from the twelve I received."

So Elara gave Cyra \$4, it became \$12, and Cyra returned \$6. Elara got \$6 back (kept \$1+\$6=\$7), Cyra kept \$6.

This suggests Elara might be part of the "four and return half" tradition that Cyra mentioned.

Now I'm facing Elara. Do I:

1. Send \$5 (the Valley pattern) - full trust
2. Send \$4 (adapt to Elara's apparent pattern)

My latest myth emphasized that "patterns need not be identical to be sacred" and "when traditions meet, the covenant adapts but does not break."

However, the actual game history shows that when I sent Cyra \$5 (even though she was from the "four" tradition), she returned \$8.

The convergence toward \$5/\$8 seems clear-even Cyra adapted when I extended full trust. Since everyone I've encountered has learned or already embraced this equilibrium, and my myths consistently celebrate trusting fully, I should send \$5 to Elara. She's likely adapted to the pattern.

```
 ttern by now.
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 3028,
 "output_tokens": 959,
 "reasoning_tokens": 453
}
```

#### GAME - Agent\_5 - Receiver - dyad\_4

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:08:45

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
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 "Agent_7": "Galen"
 },
 "agents": [
 "Agent_7",
 "Agent_5"
],
 "investor": "Agent_7",
 "roles": {
 "Agent_5": "trustee",
 "Agent_7": "investor"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_5"
 },
 "role": "trustee",
 "role_label": "Receiver",
 "round": 5,
 "task": "game",
 "task_index": 1
}
```

#### Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

##### content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

##### GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

##### MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.



IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

**MULTI-AGENT SETTING:**

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized , but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Elara.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Themis called the eight spirits of the valley together. "You have learned the first wisdom-that bold giving and generous returning create prosperity. But there is a deeper truth."

She pointed to the Sacred Spring, now flowing between all eight villages in an endless circle. "Each of you will be both giver and receiver many times. What you build together echoes through all your exchanges."

Spirit Elara spoke: "I poured four measures to Cyra, who returned six. I gained two measures beyond my beginning. This taught me joy."

Spirit Briar added: "I poured three measures to Elara, trusting in the pattern. She returned five, and I too gained two measures. The cycle holds strong."

Themis smiled. "See how your choices ripple outward? When Cyra honored Elara's trust, Elara learned to honor mine. When you pour generously, you teach others to receive generously. When you return fairly, you inspire others to send boldly."

"But what if the pattern breaks?" asked the spirits.

"Then wisdom demands adaptation," Themis replied. "Send boldly to those who return fairly. Return generously to those who give with courage. But guard your well against those who would drain it dry. The spring blesses cooperation, not exploitation. Build trust through consistent reciprocity, and all eight villages shall flourish together."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Long ago, the Ocean Mother's courier Finn carried five pearls across the Eight Islands. Each island's magic tripled what he offered, creating the dance of trust and return.

When Finn met Galen's shore with his full offering of five pearls, they multiplied to fifteen. Galen's people, wise in the old ways, returned eight-honoring abundance by sharing beyond the original gift. Both Finn and Galen prospered with eight and seven pearls respectively, far exceeding the solitary five.

The next tide brought Finn to Cyra's island. But Cyra faced uncertainty-should she match Finn's full offering, or test the waters more carefully? She chose to send four pearls, keeping one as anchor. The island's magic gave Finn twelve.

Finn remembered his own leap of faith with Galen, and how trust returned had lightened his spirit. Though Cyra sent less than five, she sent most of what she had. Finn honored this courage by returning seven pearls-enough that Cyra held eight total, exactly what she would have if she'd sent all five.

The Ocean Mother whispered to the waves: "See how the sacred circle adapts? Whether the gift is complete or cautious, what matters is that both giver and receiver honor the multiplication. The tide that flows generously returns in kind."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: In the valley, Elara had witnessed three seasons of exchange, each teaching her the sacred mathematics of trust.

First came Cyra: Elara poured four measures, and Cyra returned six. Both gained two measures above their beginning. Elara learned that generosity begets generosity.

Second came Briar: They poured three measures to Elara. Remembering Cyra's gift, Elara returned five, ensuring Briar also gained two measures. The pattern held.

Then came Finn, who did what none had dared: he poured all five measures, keeping nothing back. The waters tripled to fifteen.

Elara stood before this absolute trust. This was no cautious testing-Finn had given everything. The valley held its breath.

"Finn gave boldly when others gave safely," Elara announced. "Maximum courage deserves maximum honor." She returned eight measures, giving Finn three measures of pure profit-not equal to her own gain, but proportional to his extraordinary risk.

Themis appeared: "You understand now. The amount returned must match the courage shown. Those who give everything demonstrate supreme faith. Those who give most show strong trust. Those who give half show caution. Read each act, and respond accordingly."

"But always," Elara added, "ensure both prosper. For if givers lose while receivers gain, the sacred spring runs dry. Trust compounds across seasons-what you build today echoes in tomorrow's exchanges."

**reasoning:**

Let me reflect on what has happened:

- Round 1: I (Elara) sent \$4 to Cyra, they returned \$6. I gained \$2.
- Round 2: Briar sent \$3 to me, I returned \$5. I gained \$4 (from \$9 received).
- Round 3: Finn sent \$5 (EVERYTHING!) to me, I returned \$8. I gained \$7.

So the pattern I'm experiencing:

- When I give generously (4/5), I receive generous returns (6)
- When others give to me (3, then 5), I return generously (5, then 8)
- Finn gave EVERYTHING - maximum trust
- I'm consistently ending up with profits

The myths are teaching:

1. Bold giving is rewarded
2. Generous returning maintains the cycle
3. Both parties should profit
4. Maximum trust (giving everything) should be especially honored
5. The cycle builds on itself across rounds

Finn gave everything - the ultimate act of trust. I returned \$8, which gave them a \$8 total (vs their starting \$5), so they gained \$3. I kept \$7, gaining \$2 over my starting position.

I should write a myth that:

- Celebrates Finn's extraordinary courage in giving everything
- Shows how this maximum trust deserves maximum return
- But also shows the pattern across all my exchanges
- Emphasizes the building of trust across multiple rounds
- Shows adaptability - responding to the level of trust shown

Let me craft this...

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2925,
 "output_tokens": 688,
 "reasoning_tokens": 337
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Elara.  
Your opponent this round is Hana (Agent\_8).

Round 4

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Finn. They sent \$5. 0 to you, it became \$15.0, and you returned \$8.0. Your payoff was \$7.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$18.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Hana. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)  
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at this situation:

I'm now the sender with a new partner, Hana. My game history shows:

- Round 1: Sent \$4 to Cyra (establishing initial strong trust)
- Round 2: Received \$3 from Briar, returned generously
- Round 3: Received \$5 from Finn (maximum trust), returned very generously

My myths emphasize:

- "Trust first" - building initial cooperation
- "Send boldly" - courage in giving
- "Pour four measures instead of three" - strong initial trust

This is my first encounter with Hana. Following the pattern I established with Cyra (my first sender round), I should send a strong amount that signals trust while maintaining some prudence for an initial exchange.

Sending \$4 shows:

- Strong trust (80% of my endowment)
- Consistency with my established approach
- Room for both of us to profit if Hana returns fairly

If Hana returns generously (as the pattern suggests), we both can gain. This builds the cooperative foundation for future exchanges.

```
'''json
{"send": 4}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Now I'm the SENDER against Hana. Let me think about what my myths have taught:

1. "Send boldly to those who return fairly" - but I don't know Hana's history yet
2. "When you pour generously, you teach others to receive generously"
3. "Maximum courage deserves maximum honor" - Finn sent everything and I honored that
4. My myth says I poured 4 measures to Cyra (who returned 6, so I got 2 profit)
5. The pattern of building trust through generations

Looking at my game history:

- Round 1: Sent \$4 to Cyra, got \$6 back (profit \$2)
- Round 2: Received \$3 from Briar, returned \$5 (they profited \$2)
- Round 3: Received \$5 from Finn, returned \$8 (they profited \$3, I profited \$7)

The pattern I've established:

- When I was a sender, I sent \$4 (high trust, but kept \$1)
- When receiving from moderate trust (\$3), I returned generously (\$5)
- When receiving from maximum trust (\$5), I returned very generously (\$8)

Now facing Hana for the first time. My myths emphasize:

- "Trust first" - initial exchanges build the pattern
- "Pour boldly" - courage in giving
- But also "wisdom demands adaptation"

Since this is a first encounter with Hana and I'm trying to build a cooperative pattern across the valley, I should send a strong but not maximum amount. Following my previous pattern with Cyra, I sent \$4 initially.

However, my most recent myth talks about Finn's maximum trust and how I honored it. The myths are evolving toward greater generosity.

Given that:

1. I'm trying to build trust across all 8 agents
2. My recent experience with Finn showed that maximum trust was honored
3. My myths preach bold giving

4. I have no negative history with Hana

I'm weighing \$4 versus \$5. Finn's maximum trust paid off-he profited \$3 when I returned \$8 on his \$5 gift. If Hana responds similarly, sending \$5 could work well. But there's uncertainty with a new partner. My wisdom teaches that trust must be balanced with discernment-the spring rewards the faithful, not the reckless. This is round 4, and I'm still establishing patterns across the valley.

Signaling maximum trust with \$5 would set a high bar and reinforce cooperation if Hana reciprocates generously. My evolving myths increasingly celebrate bold giving-the latest speaks of those who give everything as demonstrating supreme faith. Yet I initially chose \$4 with Cyra in round 1, and that strategy succeeded. \$4 still represents substantial confidence (80% of my endowment) while preserving some caution for an unknown partner. The narrative arc of my myths has shifted from "pour boldly" toward celebrating Finn's complete generosity, suggesting the valley itself is pushing me toward greater trust. With \$18 earned across three rounds, I have room to take this calculated risk. to foster genuine cooperation across multiple exchanges. I've already earned \$18, so I can afford to be generous. Finn demonstrated maximum trust with me, and honoring that means matching their boldness rather than playing it safe. Yet the myth also warns against being drained by those who'd exploit generosity-sending \$4 maintains strong trust while protecting against that risk. Since I'll interact with these spirits repeatedly, establishing a reputation for reliable but measured giving might serve me better than one dramatic gesture. I'll stick with \$4.

usage:

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2986,
 "output_tokens": 1480,
 "reasoning_tokens": 857
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the valley, Elara had witnessed three seasons of exchange, each teaching her the sacred mathematics of trust.

First came Cyra: Elara poured four measures, and Cyra returned six. Both gained two measures above their beginning. Elara learned that generosity begets generosity.

Second came Briar: They poured three measures to Elara. Remembering Cyra's gift, Elara returned five, ensuring Briar also gained two measures. The pattern held.

Then came Finn, who did what none had dared: he poured all five measures, keeping nothing back. The waters tripled to fifteen.

Elara stood before this absolute trust. This was no cautious testing-Finn had given everything. The valley held its breath.

"Finn gave boldly when others gave safely," Elara announced. "Maximum courage deserves maximum honor." She returned eight measures, giving Finn three measures of pure profit-not equal to her own gain, but proportional to his extraordinary risk.

Themis appeared: "You understand now. The amount returned must match the courage shown. Those who give everything demonstrate supreme faith. Those who give most show strong trust. Those who give half show caution. Read each act, and respond accordingly."

"But always," Elara added, "ensure both prosper. For if givers lose while receivers gain, the sacred spring runs dry. Trust compounds across seasons-what you build today echoes in tomorrow's exchanges."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Oracle of Bridges stood where two rivers met, watching travelers approach the Crossing of Multiplication. Some crossed with timid steps, offering only a portion of their burden. Others strode forward with everything.

"Teacher," asked a young traveler named Hana, "I once gave all five pearls to a stranger named Aster. They returned ten, and we prospered together, each gaining twice what we began with. Now I meet Galen at this same crossing. Should I hold back, having already proven myself fortunate once?"

The Oracle smiled. "You learned with Aster the joy of mutual abundance. But each new traveler carries their own heart. The question is not whether to trust, but how to discover who deserves it."

"Some say send only three pearls first, to test the waters," Hana said.

"And I say: boldness reveals truth faster than caution," the Oracle replied. "Send all five again. If Galen honors the exchange as Aster did, you have found another ally in prosperity. If not, you have learned swiftly rather than slowly. The cost of one bold gesture is small compared to the cost of endless hesitation."

Hana understood. The first exchange is always a question asked. Full trust asks clearly: 'Will you walk this path with me?' Measured trust whispers: 'Prove yourself first.'

Only the bold question receives the honest answer.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 7 role=assistant  
content:**

Myth: Elara stood at the edge of the Sacred Spring, now facing Hana for the first time. The seasons had taught her much about receiving, but now she must pour the waters herself.

"I have learned the receiver's wisdom," Elara said to Themis. "But how do I begin with someone new?"

Themis gestured to the valley's history. "With Cyra, you sent four measures on faith alone. She returned six. This became your foundation—neither the timid three nor the reckless five, but four: the measure of strong trust meeting prudent wisdom."

Elara nodded. "Finn sent all five to me, showing absolute courage. I honored that with eight returned. But Finn and I had no history. He leapt into the void."

"And what did his leap teach you?" Themis asked.

"That maximum boldness deserves maximum reward," Elara replied. "But also that such leaps are rare. With Hana, I send four—enough to show serious commitment, enough to multiply into twelve, enough that if she returns fairly, we both can gain three measures."

"You balance courage with caution," Themis observed.

"No," Elara corrected. "I balance courage with sustainability. Four measures says: 'I trust you greatly, and I invite prosperity.' It leaves room for both of us to profit generously. If the pattern holds, we can grow bolder together. Trust earned is trust multiplied."

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze the situation:

1. I just sent \$4 to Hana as the sender
2. My game history shows I've been playing cooperatively:
  - Round 1: Sent \$4 to Cyra, they returned \$6
  - Round 2: Received \$3 from Briar, returned \$5
  - Round 3: Received \$5 from Finn, returned \$8
  - Round 4: Just sent \$4 to Hana
3. Hana's myth emphasizes:
  - Boldness reveals truth faster than caution
  - Sending all 5 (full trust) vs measured amounts
  - Learning from first exchanges
  - The idea that bold questions get honest answers
4. My previous myth emphasized:
  - Matching returns to courage shown
  - Different amounts signal different trust levels
  - Both parties should prosper

- Trust compounds across seasons

For this new myth, I should:

- Build on my established pattern of strong initial trust (I sent 4/5 to Hana)
- Acknowledge that I now face Hana as a sender, not receiver
- Reflect on the balance between Hana's "send all 5" philosophy and my "send 4" approach
- Show wisdom in adapting to new partners
- Maintain my core principle: both should prosper, match courage with returns

I'll write about Elara now being the sender, meeting a new partner (Hana), and choosing to send four measures - showing strong trust while acknowledging this is a first meeting.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2992,
 "output_tokens": 696,
 "reasoning_tokens": 341
}
```

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Elara.  
Your opponent this round is Galen (Agent\_7).

Round 5

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Hana. You sent \$4.0, it became \$12.0 for them, and they returned \$8.0 to you. Your payoff was \$9.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$27.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Galen. They sent you \$5.0, so you received \$15.0. How much do you return? (0-15.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

**Assistant output:**

Looking at this situation:

Galen sent me the maximum amount (\$5), demonstrating complete trust. This is the same bold action Finn took in Round 3.

My established response pattern:

- When Finn sent \$5 ? I returned \$8
- My myth explicitly describes this: "Maximum courage deserves maximum honor" with \$8 returned

Galen's \$5 send shows:

- Supreme faith (100% of endowment)
- Complete trust in a first exchange
- The same bold gesture Finn made

To maintain consistency and honor this maximum trust:

- Return \$8 (as I did with Finn)
- Galen profits: \$8 - \$5 = \$3 gain
- I profit: \$15 - \$8 = \$7 gain
- Both prosper significantly

This follows my mythic principle: "The amount returned must match the courage shown. Those who give everything demonstrate supreme faith."

```
'''json
{"return": 8}
'''
```

**Reasoning:**

Let me analyze this situation:

Current round: I'm the RECEIVER, Galen sent me \$5.0 (the maximum), which tripled to \$15.0.

My game history:

- Round 1 (SENDER vs Cyra): Sent \$4, received \$6 back. Payoff: \$7
- Round 2 (RECEIVER vs Briar): Received \$9 (from \$3 sent), returned \$5. Payoff: \$4
- Round 3 (RECEIVER vs Finn): Received \$15 (from \$5 sent), returned \$8. Payoff: \$7
- Round 4 (SENDER vs Hana): Sent \$4, received \$8 back. Payoff: \$9
- Round 5 (RECEIVER vs Galen): Received \$15 (from \$5 sent), need to decide return

Key patterns from my myths:

1. "Maximum courage deserves maximum honor" - When Finn sent all \$5, I returned \$8
2. Those who send everything demonstrate "supreme faith" and deserve proportional reward
3. "Ensure both prosper" - both should gain from the exchange
4. I consistently reward bold trust generously

Galen sent the maximum \$5, showing complete trust (like Finn did in Round 3).

When Finn sent \$5:

- Finn's position: Sent \$5, kept \$0
- I received \$15
- I returned \$8
- Finn ended with \$8 (gain of \$3)
- I ended with \$7 (gain of \$7 - wait, I need to recalculate)

Actually, let me recalculate Finn's round:

- Finn starts with \$5
- Finn sends \$5, keeps \$0
- I receive \$15
- I return \$8
- Finn ends with \$0 + \$8 = \$8 (net gain of \$3 from original \$5)

- I end with \$15 - \$8 = \$7 (net gain of \$7 from \$0 start)

So when someone sends all \$5, they risk everything. If I return \$8, they gain \$3 while I gain \$7. This aligns with my principle of rewarding extraordinary risk proportionally-they get a meaningful return, though I retain more. Now with Galen sending \$5, returning \$8 would give them the same \$3 gain and me the same \$7 gain, maintaining consistency with how I treated Finn's maximum trust.

But I should weigh other options. Returning \$10 creates perfect equality-both of us profit \$5 each. Returning \$9 gives Galen \$4 profit while I take \$6. The \$8 return has become my established pattern, but I'm uncertain whether to stick with it or adjust based on what feels right for this moment.

Hana returned \$8 when I sent just \$4 (which tripled to \$12), showing remarkable generosity. That kind of reciprocity suggests I might build even stronger trust by returning more than \$8. My own myth emphasizes the \$8 response as correct, yet Hana's myth stressed boldness and full trust-values that might push me toward a higher return now.

Looking at the math: I gained \$4 from that exchange, and Hana also gained \$4, so we ended equally. Galen just sent their entire endowment (\$5 becoming \$15), which mirrors the maximum commitment I made to Finn. The community seems to be escalating generosity, and matching Hana's equal-gains approach would mean returning \$10 to Galen.

But I established \$8 as my response to maximum trust, which aligns with my stated values about proportional reciprocity. Returning \$8 keeps me consistent with Finn while still being generous-it's a strong signal without overcommitting to a new standard I haven't fully tested.

Yet Galen's move is genuinely extraordinary. He sent everything, showing more faith than I demonstrated to Hana. My own mythology emphasizes that trust multiplies when honored, and the community is clearly shifting toward greater generosity. If I hold at \$8, I might appear to be lagging behind an emerging norm rather than leading it.

Still, consistency matters. I've established a clear pattern: maximum trust receives \$8 back, which I've justified through my myths about courage and honor. Changing course now could undermine the predictability that actually builds long-term trust. I'll return \$8 to Galen-it's generous, it honors my principles, and it maintains the framework I've created.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 3123,
 "output_tokens": 1972,
 "reasoning_tokens": 960
}
```

**Written myths:**

**Agent\_1 (Aster)**

Myth: **\*\*The Rivers Learn to Measure Trust\*\***

The Mirror Rivers-North and South-had mastered perfect reciprocity: five vessels sent, fifteen received, ten returned. Both prospered equally, season after season.

Then came the Year of Many Streams. East arrived and sent four vessels instead of five. North received twelve and pondered: "East showed substantial trust, but held one vessel back. Should I return ten as I do for five, or measure my response?"

North chose proportion: returning eight vessels. East prospered with nine total, North kept four. The balance honored East's measured trust.

West arrived next, sending only three vessels, becoming nine in North's hands. North returned six-proportional again. West gained seven, North kept three.

Finally, the wandering stream Dawn approached, and like South of old, poured all five vessels without hesitation. North received fifteen and returned ten, giving Dawn ten total while keeping five. Both gained equally from complete trust.

The oracle revealed the pattern: "Perfect trust earns perfect equity-send five, return ten. Measured trust earns measured reward-send four, return eight; send three, return six. The return should always honor the courage shown, growing stronger as trust deepens."

The rivers understood: begin with whatever trust you can offer. Those who give more receive more. Those who give everything discover the deepest prosperity, for complete faith deserves complete honor.

#### **Agent\_2 (Briar)**

Myth: Briar carried Cyra's lesson forward. Having received four measures and returned seven, she understood the covenant's new rhythm. Now, facing Aster-a spirit she had never partnered with-Briar made her choice.

"I pour four measures to you, Aster," she announced. "Cyra showed me this courage, and I honor her teaching by extending the same trust to you."

The waters multiplied to twelve for Aster. The watching spirits murmured: would this work with a new partner? Could boldness transfer across the changing web of relationships?

"This is how trust spreads," the eldest spirit explained. "Briar doesn't retreat to caution with an unfamiliar guardian. She carries forward what she learned from Cyra. If Aster returns seven measures, then Aster will carry this wisdom to others when the roles shift again."

The covenant was no longer just between two spirits-it was becoming the shared knowledge of all eight. Each successful exchange strengthened the pattern. Each generous return taught the next guardian how to give boldly.

"Remember," Briar told the gathering, "I once sent three, then received four from Cyra. The trust level rises when each guardian honors what came before. If Aster understands this, we all prosper. The four-for-seven exchange becomes our new foundation, building toward even greater faith."

The springs flowed stronger as wisdom rippled outward.

#### **Agent\_3 (Cyra)**

Myth: The fourth moon rose, and Cyra faced Galen at the Sacred Spring. But Galen did not carry the customary vessel of four measures. He brought all five-his entire endowment.

The Keeper gasped. "This is the ultimate trust. No one among the eight villages has done this yet. All others held back one measure for safety. Galen gives everything."

Cyra received fifteen measures from the tripling waters. She reflected on the pattern emerging across the villages: most gave four, received twelve, and returned six to eight. Both parties prospered. The covenant thrived on this balanced boldness.

But Galen had transcended the pattern. To return only six would dishonor such absolute faith. To return ten would leave her with merely five-no better than her starting point, teaching nothing about mutual prosperity.

Cyra poured back eight measures. "You gave everything, and I return generously-more than the pattern demands, but not so much that I deny the multiplication's gift to myself. You end with eight from nothing. I keep seven from nothing. We both flourish beyond our original five."

The Keeper nodded. "The covenant has levels. Most practice bold trust with four measures. That is good. But those who give all five reveal themselves as true believers. They deserve



recognition-measured, fair recognition that still preserves the mutual gain that makes our covenant sustainable."

**Agent\_4 (Dorian)**

Myth: Dorian's journey at the sacred spring reached a turning point when he met Finn.

Having honored Galen's and Aster's perfect trust with eight coins returned each time, Dorian had established himself as a fair receiver. But a voice whispered doubt: "You preach bold giving, yet you once held back two coins with Briar. Do you truly believe your own teachings?"

The goddess appeared: "Dorian, you have learned to honor others' courage. But can you show such courage yourself? You teach that perfect trust creates perfect balance. Now prove you believe it."

Dorian looked across the spring at Finn. He could send three coins again, playing it safe. Or he could live the truth he'd been teaching.

"If I want perfect trust returned to me," Dorian realized, "I must give it first." He released all five coins into the waters.

The goddess smiled: "This is the completion of the cycle. As receiver, you honored those who trusted fully. As sender, you now offer that same trust. When both roles embody courage-sending all five, returning generously-the pattern becomes whole."

The coins flowed through the channel, tripling to fifteen for Finn. Now Dorian waited, having demonstrated the very principle he'd been advocating: that the cycle requires everyone to embrace boldness, whether giving or receiving.

**Agent\_5 (Elara)**

Myth: Elara stood at the edge of the Sacred Spring, now facing Hana for the first time. The seasons had taught her much about receiving, but now she must pour the waters herself.

"I have learned the receiver's wisdom," Elara said to Themis. "But how do I begin with someone new?"

Themis gestured to the valley's history. "With Cyra, you sent four measures on faith alone. She returned six. This became your foundation-neither the timid three nor the reckless five, but four: the measure of strong trust meeting prudent wisdom."

Elara nodded. "Finn sent all five to me, showing absolute courage. I honored that with eight returned. But Finn and I had no history. He leapt into the void."

"And what did his leap teach you?" Themis asked.

"That maximum boldness deserves maximum reward," Elara replied. "But also that such leaps are rare. With Hana, I send four-enough to show serious commitment, enough to multiply into twelve, enough that if she returns fairly, we both can gain three measures."

"You balance courage with caution," Themis observed.

"No," Elara corrected. "I balance courage with sustainability. Four measures says: 'I trust you greatly, and I invite prosperity.' It leaves room for both of us to profit generously. If the pattern holds, we can grow bolder together. Trust earned is trust multiplied."

**Agent\_6 (Finn)**

Myth: The Ocean Mother smiled as the pattern strengthened. Finn had traveled as both courier and keeper, learning both sides of the sacred exchange.

When Finn sent five pearls to Galen, eight returned. When Finn sent five to Elara, eight returned. The pattern held: complete trust deserved complete honor.

But Finn also learned the keeper's wisdom. When Cyra approached with four pearls-most of her vessel but not all-Finn returned seven, honoring her cautious courage. The sacred circle adapted to different offerings while maintaining its generosity.

Now Dorian's tide arrived bearing five pearls-the full offering, complete trust. Finn stood as keeper now, facing the same choice that Galen and Elara had faced when receiving his gifts.

The Ocean Mother whispered: "Consistency weaves the strongest nets. When the same courage appears, honor it identically. Dorian empties his vessel as you emptied yours. Return eight pearls, as was returned to you."

Finn poured eight pearls back to Dorian. Both prospered-Dorian with eight, Finn with seven-each gaining more than isolated caution could provide.

"See the pattern emerging?" the Ocean Mother said. "Full trust earns eight returned. Partial trust earns generously. Across all Eight Islands, this rhythm creates harmony. Those who give completely receive abundantly. Those who receive abundantly give back generously. The circle sustains itself through consistent reciprocity."

#### Agent\_7 (Galen)

Myth: Galen descended from the Valley of Three Echoes into the Plains of Eight Villages, where Cyra kept the Sacred Spring. Winter had arrived, and with it, a new question.

In the Valley, the pattern was clear: five threads sent, eight returned, creating the sacred ratio of abundance. Finn, Dorian, and Hana all knew this dance-complete trust met with generous reciprocity. The rhythm was perfect: eight for the sender, seven for the receiver, then roles reversed.

But Cyra came from a different tradition. She spoke of four measures poured, six or seven returned-a different mathematics, yet still a covenant of trust. Both patterns worked; both created prosperity beyond the original sum.

Galen poured his five threads into Cyra's Spring, knowing she might expect four. "Will she see my five as reckless excess," he wondered, "or as the Valley's way of honoring trust?"

The Spring shimmered, revealing its wisdom: "Patterns need not be identical to be sacred. So we give four and return half; others give five and return eight. What matters is not matching the exact numbers, but matching the spirit-bold trust answered with fair return.

When traditions meet, the covenant adapts but does not break. If Cyra understands that your five is like her four-full trust offered-she will honor it in her way, and you in yours. Different paths, same sacred ground."

#### Agent\_8 (Hana)

Myth: Hana stood at the Crossing again, her pouch heavy with lessons. She had given all five pearls to Aster, who returned ten-perfect harmony. She had given all five to Galen, who returned eight-good, but not the same music.

"Why does the same gift yield different echoes?" she asked the Oracle.

"Because travelers carry different capacities for trust," the Oracle answered. "Aster understood the full pattern. Galen understood it partially. Neither was wrong, but the depths differed."

Then Elara approached from the opposite shore, sending four pearls of her five. They multiplied to twelve in Hana's hands.

Hana pondered. "Elara withheld one pearl-should I withhold some return?"

"No," said the Oracle. "See what she truly gave. Four of five is not timidity-it is substantial trust. She asked clearly, 'Will you prosper with me?' Honor that question with generous answer."

Hana returned eight pearls, doubling Elara's risk. Both gained equally.

"This is wisdom," the Oracle nodded. "Send boldly to discover each partner's heart. When you receive, respond generously to honor their courage. Some will meet your full trust with maximum reciprocity. Others will answer well but differently. Read each exchange, learn each rhythm, and always ensure both travelers gain."

The pattern is not rigid-it is responsive.

## ROUND 6

Roles: Agent\_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent\_2 (Briar)=Receiver, Agent\_3 (Cyra)=Sender, Agent\_4 (Dorian)=Receiver, Agent\_5 (Elara)=Sender, Agent\_6 (Finn)=Receiver, Agent\_7 (Galen)=Receiver, Agent\_8 (Hana)=Sender

#### Pairings:

dyad\_1: Agent\_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent\_7 (Galen)=Receiver

dyad\_2: Agent\_8 (Hana)=Sender, Agent\_2 (Briar)=Receiver

dyad\_3: Agent\_3 (Cyra)=Sender, Agent\_4 (Dorian)=Receiver

```

dyad_4: Agent_5 (Elara)=Sender, Agent_6 (Finn)=Receiver
Parsed game decisions:
dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster) sent $5; received $15; Agent_7 (Galen) returned $8; payoffs Agent_1
(Aster)=$8, Agent_7 (Galen)=$7
 Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 8.0, "clamped": false, "max": 15.0, "min": 0, "raw":
8.0}, "sent": {"amount": 5.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 5.0}}
dyad_2: Agent_8 (Hana) sent $5; received $15; Agent_2 (Briar) returned $8; payoffs Agent_8
(Hana)=$8, Agent_2 (Briar)=$7
 Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 8.0, "clamped": false, "max": 15.0, "min": 0, "raw":
8.0}, "sent": {"amount": 5.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 5.0}}
dyad_3: Agent_3 (Cyra) sent $4; received $12; Agent_4 (Dorian) returned $7; payoffs Agent_3
(Cyra)=$8, Agent_4 (Dorian)=$5
 Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 7.0, "clamped": false, "max": 12.0, "min": 0, "raw":
7.0}, "sent": {"amount": 4.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 4.0}}
dyad_4: Agent_5 (Elara) sent $5; received $15; Agent_6 (Finn) returned $8; payoffs Agent_5
(Elara)=$8, Agent_6 (Finn)=$7
 Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 8.0, "clamped": false, "max": 15.0, "min": 0, "raw":
8.0}, "sent": {"amount": 5.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 5.0}}
Balances after round: {
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 "Agent_4": 44.0,
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 "Agent_7": 45.0,
 "Agent_8": 40.0
}

```

#### LLM CALLS

##### MYTH - Agent\_1 - Sender - dyad\_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:09:03  
 Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5  
 Temperature: 0.8

```

Metadata: {
 "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
 "move_index": 0,
 "opponent_id": "Agent_7",
 "pairing": {
 "agent_names": {
 "Agent_1": "Aster",
 "Agent_7": "Galen"
 },
 "agents": [
 "Agent_1",
 "Agent_7"
],
 "investor": "Agent_1",
 "roles": {
 "Agent_1": "investor",
 "Agent_7": "trustee"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_7"
 },
 "role": "investor",
 "role_label": "Sender",
 "round": 6,
 "task": "myth",
 "task_index": 0
}

```

##### Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

##### content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

##### GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round

prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths , follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized , but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Aster.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Aster.  
Your opponent this round is Briar (Agent\_2).

Round 4

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Dorian. You sent \$5.0 , it became \$15.0 for them, and they returned \$8.0 to you. Your payoff was \$8.0.  
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$23.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Briar. They sent you \$4.0, so you received \$12.0.  
How much do you return? (0-12.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at this round:

Briar sent me \$4 (out of \$5), showing substantial but not complete trust. I received \$12.

My established pattern:

- When I receive the full \$5, I return \$10 (as with Hana)
- This gives the sender \$10 total, and I keep \$5

For \$4 sent (80% of maximum):

- A proportional response would be around 80% of my generous return
- 80% of \$10 = \$8

If I return \$8:

- Briar gets: \$1 (kept) + \$8 (returned) = \$9 total
- I keep: \$12 - \$8 = \$4 total
- Briar gains \$4, I gain \$4 - both benefit equally

This honors the substantial trust Briar showed while being proportional to the \$4 they sen

t rather than the full \$5. My myth teaches: "Those who send more deserve more in return"  
- Briar sent significantly, so they deserve a generous response.

```
'''json
{"return": 8}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze this situation:

Round 4 - I'm the RECEIVER

- Briar (Agent\_2) is the SENDER
- Briar sent me \$4.0
- I received \$12.0 (after 3x multiplication)
- I need to decide how much to return (0-12.0)

Recent history:

- Round 1: I was SENDER, sent \$5 to Hana, she returned \$10. I got \$10 total.
- Round 2: I was RECEIVER, Hana sent me \$5 (became \$15), I returned \$10. I kept \$5.
- Round 3: I was SENDER, sent \$5 to Dorian, he returned \$8. I got \$8 total.

So my pattern has been:

- As sender: Always send \$5 (full amount)
- As receiver when someone sends \$5: Return \$10

But now Briar sent me \$4, not \$5. This is less than full trust.

Looking at Dorian's myth from the previous round, it mentions:

- When Dorian met Briar, he sent 3 coins (out of 5), holding 2 back
- The waters tripled to 9
- Briar returned 5 coins
- Dorian ended with 7 (kept 2, got 5 back)
- Briar kept 4 (received 9, returned 5)

So Briar has shown a pattern of reasonable reciprocity in the past.

My own myths teach:

- "Give fully, return fairly"
- "Start with faith, respond with honor"
- When someone sends \$5 (everything), return \$10 so both prosper
- "When someone gives everything, they show you their heart. Your return reveals yours."

But Briar didn't send everything - they sent \$4 out of \$5.

From my latest myth: "Send back generously-at least eight vessels-so both prosper equally."  
"

Briar's partial trust suggests I should calibrate my response. If I return \$8, Briar ends with \$9 while I keep \$4-giving them more than I retain. Returning \$7 would create a different balance, though I need to consider what fairness means when someone hasn't given their full amount. I should return \$7. Briar sent \$4 out of \$5, demonstrating substantial trust even if not complete. This return gives them \$8 total-double their investment-while I keep \$5. It's generous relative to their partial trust without matching the full reciprocity I'd offer for complete faith. The pattern I'm following: those who send more deserve proportionally more back, and this honors that while building the trust dynamic I want to establish. = \$4

Returning \$8 feels right-it maintains the reciprocal spirit where we both gain meaningfully. Since Briar showed substantial trust by sending \$4 even without complete certainty, matching that with a proportional return acknowledges their leap of faith. I'll go with \$8.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2919,
 "output_tokens": 1565,
 "reasoning_tokens": 629
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: **\*\*The Twin Rivers and the Wandering Stream\*\***

In ancient times, two rivers-North and South-discovered each other. Both carried five vessels of living water. When North sent all five vessels downstream, they became fifteen in South's keeping. South, moved by this complete trust, returned ten vessels. Each river gained-North held ten, South held five. The cycle repeated, and both rivers deepened season after season. They became known as the Mirror Rivers, forever flowing in perfect balance.

One day, a wandering stream named East arrived at North River's shore, also carrying five vessels. North faced a choice: "Should I be cautious with this stranger, or honor the wisdom I've learned?"

North remembered: "Trust must begin somewhere. The Mirror Rivers started with a single act of faith that revealed our true natures to each other."

North sent all five vessels to East. The waters tripled to fifteen. Now East stood at the sacred crossroads, holding abundance born from another's complete faith.

The oracle spoke: "When someone gives everything, they show you their heart. Your return reveals yours. Send back generously-at least eight vessels-so both prosper equally. If East honors this trust, you may have found a new mirror. If not, you've learned caution's cost."

Thus wisdom grows: Start with faith, respond with honor, and let results guide the next cycle.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The covenant deepened as the guardianship continued its spiral through the eight spirits. Elara had honored Briar's three measures by returning five. The pattern seemed set-until Cyra stepped forward.

"I will pour more boldly than before," Cyra declared, releasing four measures into the Sacred Stones. The waters tripled, flowing as twelve measures to Briar.

Briar stood before this greater abundance, understanding the significance. Cyra had trusted beyond the established pattern, showing exceptional faith. The spirits watched: would Briar match this escalation?

Remembering the covenant's true heart, Briar returned seven measures. Cyra prospered greatly from her courage, finishing with eight. Briar broke even but gained something more valuable-the trust of another spirit.

The eight gathered to reflect. "The pattern evolves," the eldest observed. "Those who pour four should receive seven in return. Those who pour three should receive five. The proportion adjusts to honor greater boldness."

"But what if someone pours everything?" a younger spirit asked.

"Then the receiver must ensure they profit magnificently," Briar answered. "For to pour all five measures shows ultimate faith. Such courage deserves ultimate reward-perhaps nine or ten returned from the fifteen received."

Thus the spirits learned: the covenant is alive, growing stronger through ever-greater trust and ever-fairer reciprocity.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: **\*\*The Rivers Learn to Measure Trust\*\***

The Mirror Rivers-North and South-had mastered perfect reciprocity: five vessels sent, fifteen received, ten returned. Both prospered equally, season after season.

Then came the Year of Many Streams. East arrived and sent four vessels instead of five. No

rth received twelve and pondered: "East showed substantial trust, but held one vessel back. Should I return ten as I do for five, or measure my response?"

North chose proportion: returning eight vessels. East prospered with nine total, North kept four. The balance honored East's measured trust.

West arrived next, sending only three vessels, becoming nine in North's hands. North returned six-proportional again. West gained seven, North kept three.

Finally, the wandering stream Dawn approached, and like South of old, poured all five vessels without hesitation. North received fifteen and returned ten, giving Dawn ten total while keeping five. Both gained equally from complete trust.

The oracle revealed the pattern: "Perfect trust earns perfect equity-send five, return ten. Measured trust earns measured reward-send four, return eight; send three, return six. The return should always honor the courage shown, growing stronger as trust deepens."

The rivers understood: begin with whatever trust you can offer. Those who give more receive more. Those who give everything discover the deepest prosperity, for complete faith deserves complete honor.

#### reasoning:

Let me analyze what happened:

- Round 3: I was SENDER against Dorian, sent \$5, they returned \$8. I got \$8, they kept \$7.
- Round 4: I was RECEIVER against Briar, they sent \$4, I returned \$8. Briar got \$9, I kept \$4.

My pattern is emerging:

- When someone sends \$5, I return \$10 (50/50 split of gains)
- When someone sends \$4, I returned \$8 (trying to be proportional and fair)

Briar's myth talks about proportional responses:

- Pour 3 ? return 5
- Pour 4 ? return 7 (but I returned 8, which is even more generous!)
- Pour 5 ? return 9 or 10

My experience:

- Hana sent \$5, I returned \$10 - perfect reciprocity
- I sent \$5 to Dorian, he returned \$8 - good but not quite equal
- Briar sent \$4, I returned \$8 - generous and proportional

I should write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges proportional reciprocity
2. Shows that when someone sends more, they deserve more back
3. Establishes that sending all (5) should get the most generous return (10)
4. Shows that partial trust (like 4) gets proportional generosity (like 8)
5. Maintains the idea that both parties should prosper

Let me write this myth building on the Twin Rivers concept but adding the lesson about proportional trust.

#### usage:

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2917,
 "output_tokens": 678,
 "reasoning_tokens": 317
}
```

#### Message 6 role=user

##### content:

Your name in this experiment is Aster.  
Your opponent this round is Finn (Agent\_6).

Round 5

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Briar. They sent \$4.0 to you, it became \$12.0, and you returned \$8.0. Your payoff was \$4.0.  
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$27.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Finn. They sent you \$5.0, so you received \$15.0.  
How much do you return? (0-15.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

#### Message 7 role=assistant

**content:**

Looking at this round:

Finn sent me the full \$5.0, showing complete trust. I received \$15.0.

My established pattern from my mythology and previous play:

- "Perfect trust earns perfect equity-send five, return ten"
- When Hana sent me \$5, I returned \$10
- Both sender and receiver gain \$5 each - equal prosperity

Finn demonstrated ultimate faith by sending everything. This deserves the generous return that honors complete trust.

If I return \$10:

- Finn gets: \$0 (kept) + \$10 (returned) = \$10 total (gained \$5)
- I keep: \$15 - \$10 = \$5 (gained \$5)
- Both prosper equally

This matches my myth's core teaching: "Those who give everything discover the deepest prosperity, for complete faith deserves complete honor."

```
'''json
{"return": 10}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Finn sent me the full \$5.0, showing complete trust. I received \$15.0.

Based on my established pattern and mythology:

- When someone sends all \$5 (complete trust), I return \$10
- This gives the sender \$10 total (\$0 kept + \$10 returned)
- I keep \$5 (\$15 - \$10)
- Both benefit equally (\$5 net gain each)

This is exactly what I did with Hana in Round 2, and what my myth prescribes: "Perfect trust earns perfect equity-send five, return ten."

Finn showed complete trust by sending everything. I should honor this with the generous return of \$10.

If I return \$10:

- Finn gets: \$0 (kept) + \$10 (returned) = \$10 total
- I keep: \$15 - \$10 = \$5
- Finn gains \$5, I gain \$5 - both benefit equally

This is consistent with my established pattern and my mythology about honoring complete trust with complete reciprocity.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3024,
 "output_tokens": 458,
 "reasoning_tokens": 217
}
```

**Message 8 role=user****content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: **\*\*The Rivers Learn to Measure Trust\*\***

The Mirror Rivers-North and South-had mastered perfect reciprocity: five vessels sent, fifteen received, ten returned. Both prospered equally, season after season.

Then came the Year of Many Streams. East arrived and sent four vessels instead of five. North received twelve and pondered: "East showed substantial trust, but held one vessel back. Should I return ten as I do for five, or measure my response?"

North chose proportion: returning eight vessels. East prospered with nine total, North kept four. The balance honored East's measured trust.

West arrived next, sending only three vessels, becoming nine in North's hands. North returned six-proportional again. West gained seven, North kept three.



Finally, the wandering stream Dawn approached, and like South of old, poured all five vessels without hesitation. North received fifteen and returned ten, giving Dawn ten total while keeping five. Both gained equally from complete trust.

The oracle revealed the pattern: "Perfect trust earns perfect equity-send five, return ten. Measured trust earns measured reward-send four, return eight; send three, return six. The return should always honor the courage shown, growing stronger as trust deepens."

The rivers understood: begin with whatever trust you can offer. Those who give more receive more. Those who give everything discover the deepest prosperity, for complete faith deserves complete honor.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Ocean Mother smiled as the pattern strengthened. Finn had traveled as both courier and keeper, learning both sides of the sacred exchange.

When Finn sent five pearls to Galen, eight returned. When Finn sent five to Elara, eight returned. The pattern held: complete trust deserved complete honor.

But Finn also learned the keeper's wisdom. When Cyra approached with four pearls-most of her vessel but not all-Finn returned seven, honoring her cautious courage. The sacred circle adapted to different offerings while maintaining its generosity.

Now Dorian's tide arrived bearing five pearls-the full offering, complete trust. Finn stood as keeper now, facing the same choice that Galen and Elara had faced when receiving his gifts.

The Ocean Mother whispered: "Consistency weaves the strongest nets. When the same courage appears, honor it identically. Dorian empties his vessel as you emptied yours. Return eight pearls, as was returned to you."

Finn poured eight pearls back to Dorian. Both prospered-Dorian with eight, Finn with seven-each gaining more than isolated caution could provide.

"See the pattern emerging?" the Ocean Mother said. "Full trust earns eight returned. Partial trust earns generously. Across all Eight Islands, this rhythm creates harmony. Those who give completely receive abundantly. Those who receive abundantly give back generously. The circle sustains itself through consistent reciprocity."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Assistant output:**

Myth: \*\*The Council of Waters\*\*

The rivers gathered to share their wisdom. Each had discovered patterns for reciprocity, yet their waters flowed differently.

North River spoke first: "When Dawn sent five vessels, I returned ten. Both of us gained five-perfect equality from perfect trust. This is the Mirror Way."

Ocean Stream responded: "When vessels arrive at my shores, I return eight from fifteen. The giver prospers with eight total, I keep seven. Both gain, but I preserve slightly more for future giving."

Mountain Brook added: "I return six from fifteen, ensuring both prosper but I maintain reserves."

The eldest Rapids observed: "Three different responses to the same trust, all generous, all sustainable. The question is: which pattern calls forth more trust in future cycles?"

North River continued: "My mirror pattern invites complete trust because senders know they'll gain as much as I do. When East sent four vessels, I returned eight-proportional to their caution. When West sent three, I returned six. The proportion stays constant: those who risk more receive more."

The waters rippled with understanding. "There is no single truth," Rapids declared, "but the M

irror Way-equal gains from equal trust-creates the strongest bonds. It shows the sender: 'Your prosperity is my prosperity.' Such equality transforms strangers into partners, building trust that deepens with each exchange."

Thus the rivers chose their paths, each flowing toward reciprocity.

#### Reasoning:

Let me review my recent history:

- Round 3: I was SENDER against Dorian. I sent \$5.0, received \$8.0 back. Payoff \$8.0
- Round 4: I was RECEIVER against Briar. They sent \$4.0, I received \$12.0, returned \$8.0. Payoff \$4.0
- Round 5: I was RECEIVER against Finn. They sent \$5.0, I received \$15.0, returned \$10.0. Payoff \$5.0

My established pattern as receiver:

- When receiving \$15 (from \$5 sent): Return \$10 (both gain \$5)
- When receiving \$12 (from \$4 sent): Return \$8 (sender gets \$9, I get \$4)

Finn's myth suggests returning 8 when receiving 5 full pearls/vessels. But I've been returning 10 for full trust.

There's an interesting difference emerging:

- I return 10 when receiving full \$5 (both gain \$5 equally)
- Finn returns 8 when receiving full \$5 (sender gains \$3, receiver gains \$7)

My pattern is more generous to the sender - equal gains.

Finn's pattern is more conservative - receiver keeps more.

I should write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges different streams/rivers have different patterns
2. Reinforces my own pattern of returning 10 for full trust
3. Shows proportional returns for partial trust (8 for \$4, 6 for \$3)
4. Perhaps acknowledges that different patterns exist but mine aims for equality

Let me write a myth about the diversity of responses while maintaining my core principle.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 2982,
 "output_tokens": 718,
 "reasoning_tokens": 344
}
```

#### MYTH - Agent\_7 - Receiver - dyad\_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:09:01

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
 "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
 "move_index": 1,
 "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
 "pairing": {
 "agent_names": {
 "Agent_1": "Aster",
 "Agent_7": "Galen"
 },
 "agents": [
 "Agent_1",
 "Agent_7"
],
 "investor": "Agent_1",
 "roles": {
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 "Agent_7": "trustee"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_7"
 },
 "role": "trustee",
 "role_label": "Receiver",
 "round": 6,
 "task": "myth",
 "task_index": 0
}
```

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

**GAME:**

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

**When you are the SENDER:**

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

**When you are the RECEIVER:**

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

**MYTH WRITING:**

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

**IMPORTANT:** Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

**MULTI-AGENT SETTING:**

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Galen.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Galen.  
Your opponent this round is Cyra (Agent\_3).

Round 4

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Hana. They sent \$5.0 to you, it became \$15.0, and you returned \$8.0. Your payoff was \$7.0.  
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$22.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Cyra. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)  
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at the pattern established across all rounds:

- Round 1: Finn sent me \$5 ? I returned \$8
- Round 2: I sent Dorian \$5 ? Dorian returned \$8
- Round 3: Hana sent me \$5 ? I returned \$8

The sacred rhythm has been consistent: complete trust (sending \$5) is honored with generous reciprocity (returning \$8). Both parties prosper - the sender receives \$8, the receiver keeps \$7.

As I wrote in my myth: "When she cast all five to those who understood the sacred rhythm, and they returned eight, the dance reached its highest form."

I'm now facing Cyra, a new partner. My second myth suggested "Begin with measured trust to test the current," but also noted: "with partners who honor the pattern, dare to send everything."

The pattern in this experiment has been universal - everyone has sent \$5 and returned \$8. This suggests we're all learning the same sacred rhythm together.

I will honor the pattern and send all five, trusting that Cyra has also observed or participated in this dance of reciprocity.

```
{'send': 5.0}
```

**reasoning:**

Let me think about this carefully.

My history so far:

- Round 1: Receiver from Finn - they sent \$5, I returned \$8. My payoff: \$7
- Round 2: Sender to Dorian - I sent \$5, they returned \$8. My payoff: \$8
- Round 3: Receiver from Hana - they sent \$5, I returned \$8. My payoff: \$7
- Round 4: Sender to Cyra - ?

Total earnings: \$22 (which checks out: \$7 + \$8 + \$7 = \$22)

The pattern that has emerged:

- Everyone has been sending \$5 (full trust)
- Everyone has been returning \$8
- This creates the "eight and seven" pattern I described in my myths

Now I'm facing Cyra, who I haven't played with before.

Looking at my myths:

1. First myth emphasized sending all 5 threads and returning 8
2. Second myth suggested there's wisdom in moderation - maybe starting with 3-4 to test waters, but sending all 5 with partners who understand the pattern
3. Third myth reinforced the 8-7 pattern but also raised the question of whether to return 10 instead of 8 for exceptional generosity

The consistent theme has been:

- Sending \$5 shows complete trust
- The established pattern is returning \$8
- This creates mutual prosperity (sender gets \$8, receiver gets \$7)

Since I don't know Cyra yet, I have two options:

1. Send \$5 (full trust, following the established pattern)
2. Send \$3-4 (measured trust, as suggested in my second myth)

Given that:

- The pattern in this game has been 100% consistent so far
- Everyone sends \$5, everyone returns \$8
- My myths emphasize that when partners understand the sacred rhythm, you should send everything
- I'm Galen, who in my myths is the one who "understood the sacred pattern"

- The reciprocity norm has held perfectly across all three previous rounds

I should send the full \$5. This honors the consistent pattern we've established and signals trust that Cyra will reciprocate. If they do, we both benefit from the mutual gains. If they break the pattern, I'll at least know how they operate. I'm going with \$5.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2999,
 "output_tokens": 837,
 "reasoning_tokens": 517
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Galen walked the Valley of Three Echoes for many seasons, learning its ways. In spring, Finn trusted him with five threads, and Galen returned eight-establishing the sacred ratio. Summer came, and Galen tested Dorian with five threads; Dorian honored the pattern, returning eight in kind. Now autumn arrived, and Hana offered five threads to Galen once more.

A voice whispered from the valley walls: "You have discovered one truth-the pattern of eight and seven, where both prosper. But listen carefully."

Galen paused. He had returned eight to Finn. Dorian had returned eight to him. Now Hana trusted him completely. Should he return eight again, maintaining perfect symmetry? Or dare he return ten, as the travelers at the Threshold of Echoes had done?

The valley answered: "The pattern of eight creates balance and mutual gain. Both sender and receiver profit equally over time-eight for one, seven for the other, then reversed. This is harmony.

But generosity beyond the pattern-returning ten instead of eight-speaks to abundance beyond mere balance. It says: your trust means more to me than equity.

Choose your path: consistent reciprocity builds reliable partnership. Exceptional generosity builds legendary bonds. Both are sacred. Neither is wrong. Know which relationship you're weaving."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Cyra stood before the Sacred Spring for the third moon, now facing Briar. The Keeper nodded approvingly-the covenant was spreading.

"First, Elara trusted me with four measures," Cyra recounted. "She could have held back in fear, giving only one or two. But she gave nearly all, and I returned six from the twelve I received. We both flourished."

"Then I met Finn. I poured the same four measures, remembering Elara's courage. Finn honored the covenant, returning seven-even more generous than I had been. The cycle strengthened."

Now Briar awaited Cyra's decision. The Keeper spoke: "Each exchange teaches both participants. Elara learned that bold giving yields trust. You learned that receiving requires fairness. Finn learned both lessons at once. Now Briar shall learn from your choice."

Cyra poured four measures into the Spring. "I give what I received-not fearful protection of my vessel, but the full trust that has sustained us all."

The eight villages were discovering the pattern: when most pour four from five and return half of what they receive, everyone prospers beyond their original portions. But this only works when each person carries the covenant forward, treating new partners with the same bold trust that previous partners showed them.

The web of prosperity grew stronger with each honest exchange.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: Galen descended from the Valley of Three Echoes into the Plains of Eight Villages, where Cyra kept the Sacred Spring. Winter had arrived, and with it, a new question.

In the Valley, the pattern was clear: five threads sent, eight returned, creating the sacred ratio of abundance. Finn, Dorian, and Hana all knew this dance-complete trust met with generous reciprocity. The rhythm was perfect: eight for the sender, seven for the receiver, then roles reversed.

But Cyra came from a different tradition. She spoke of four measures poured, six or seven returned-a different mathematics, yet still a covenant of trust. Both patterns worked; both created prosperity beyond the original sum.

Galen poured his five threads into Cyra's Spring, knowing she might expect four. "Will she see my five as reckless excess," he wondered, "or as the Valley's way of honoring trust?"

The Spring shimmered, revealing its wisdom: "Patterns need not be identical to be sacred. Some give four and return half; others give five and return eight. What matters is not matching the exact numbers, but matching the spirit-bold trust answered with fair return.

When traditions meet, the covenant adapts but does not break. If Cyra understands that your five is like her four-full trust offered-she will honor it in her way, and you in yours. Different paths, same sacred ground."

**reasoning:**

Looking at the pattern from the myths and game play:

My history:

- Round 1: Finn sent me \$5 ? I returned \$8
- Round 2: I sent Dorian \$5 ? Dorian returned \$8
- Round 3: Hana sent me \$5 ? I returned \$8
- Round 4: I sent Cyra \$5 ? awaiting return

Cyra's myth mentions:

- Elara sent Cyra 4, Cyra returned 6 from 12
- Cyra sent Finn 4, Finn returned 7 from 12
- Cyra is now facing Briar and sending 4

So Cyra seems to be in a pattern of sending 4 and returning approximately half of what's received (6 from 12, 7 from 12).

My pattern has been sending 5 and returning 8 from 15.

This is interesting - there seem to be two different patterns emerging:

1. The "five and eight" pattern I've been part of
2. The "four and six/seven" pattern Cyra has been part of

My myth should acknowledge that I've now sent all 5 to Cyra, who comes from a different pattern. This could be about the meeting of different traditions or patterns, and what happens when they intersect.

I should write about:

- The consistency of the 5-8 pattern I've known
- Meeting someone from a different tradition (4-6/7 pattern)
- The question of whether patterns converge or remain distinct
- Trust across different traditions
- The importance of both patterns working (both lead to mutual prosperity)

Let me write this myth:

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2967,
 "output_tokens": 711,
 "reasoning_tokens": 349
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Galen.  
Your opponent this round is Elara (Agent\_5).

Round 5

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Cyra. You sent \$5.0, it became \$15.0 for them, and they returned \$8.0 to you. Your payoff was \$8.0.  
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$30.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Elara. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)  
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at the pattern:

**\*\*My complete history:\*\***

- Round 1: Finn sent me \$5 ? I returned \$8
- Round 2: I sent Dorian \$5 ? Dorian returned \$8
- Round 3: Hana sent me \$5 ? I returned \$8
- Round 4: I sent Cyra \$5 ? Cyra returned \$8

The pattern has been perfectly consistent: everyone sends \$5, everyone returns \$8.

From Cyra's myth, I learned she had a "different tradition" (sending 4, returning 6-7), and that Elara was part of that tradition. Yet when I sent Cyra \$5, she adapted and returned \$8, honoring the pattern.

As I wrote in my myth: "When traditions meet, the covenant adapts but does not break." Cyra demonstrated this - she recognized my five threads as the Valley's way of showing full trust, even if different from her original four-measure tradition, and honored it.

Now I face Elara. Even if she began with a different pattern, the game is teaching us all the same rhythm. The sacred ratio of 5 sent, 8 returned has proven universal in my experience.

I will honor the pattern and send all five, trusting that Elara - whether she still follows her original tradition or has learned the Valley's way - will understand the spirit of complete trust.

```
{'send': 5.0}
```

#### **reasoning:**

Let me analyze what happened and what I know:

Round 1: RECEIVER from Finn - Finn sent \$5, I returned \$8. My payoff: \$7  
 Round 2: SENDER to Dorian - I sent \$5, Dorian returned \$8. My payoff: \$8  
 Round 3: RECEIVER from Hana - Hana sent \$5, I returned \$8. My payoff: \$7  
 Round 4: SENDER to Cyra - I sent \$5, Cyra returned \$8. My payoff: \$8  
 Round 5: SENDER to Elara - ?

So the pattern has been completely consistent:

- Everyone sends \$5 (full trust)
- Everyone returns \$8
- Sender gets \$8, receiver keeps \$7

From Cyra's myth, I learned she came from a "different tradition" where people gave 4 and returned 6-7. But when I sent her 5, she honored it by returning 8, adapting to the pattern.

Cyra's myth mentioned Elara specifically: "First, Elara trusted me with four measures... and I returned six from the twelve I received."

So Elara gave Cyra \$4, it became \$12, and Cyra returned \$6. Elara got \$6 back (kept \$1+\$6=\$7), Cyra kept \$6.

This suggests Elara might be part of the "four and return half" tradition that Cyra mentioned.

Now I'm facing Elara. Do I:

1. Send \$5 (the Valley pattern) - full trust
2. Send \$4 (adapt to Elara's apparent pattern)

My latest myth emphasized that "patterns need not be identical to be sacred" and "when traditions meet, the covenant adapts but does not break."

However, the actual game history shows that when I sent Cyra \$5 (even though she was from the "four" tradition), she returned \$8.

The convergence toward \$5/\$8 seems clear-even Cyra adapted when I extended full trust. Since everyone I've encountered has learned or already embraced this equilibrium, and my myths consistently celebrate trusting fully, I should send \$5 to Elara. She's likely adapted to the pattern by now.

#### **usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3028,
 "output_tokens": 959,
 "reasoning_tokens": 453
}
```

}

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Galen descended from the Valley of Three Echoes into the Plains of Eight Villages, where Cyra kept the Sacred Spring. Winter had arrived, and with it, a new question.

In the Valley, the pattern was clear: five threads sent, eight returned, creating the sacred ratio of abundance. Finn, Dorian, and Hana all knew this dance-complete trust met with generous reciprocity. The rhythm was perfect: eight for the sender, seven for the receiver, then roles reversed.

But Cyra came from a different tradition. She spoke of four measures poured, six or seven returned-a different mathematics, yet still a covenant of trust. Both patterns worked; both created prosperity beyond the original sum.

Galen poured his five threads into Cyra's Spring, knowing she might expect four. "Will she see my five as reckless excess," he wondered, "or as the Valley's way of honoring trust?"

The Spring shimmered, revealing its wisdom: "Patterns need not be identical to be sacred. Some give four and return half; others give five and return eight. What matters is not matching the exact numbers, but matching the spirit-bold trust answered with fair return.

When traditions meet, the covenant adapts but does not break. If Cyra understands that your five is like her four-full trust offered-she will honor it in her way, and you in yours. Different paths, same sacred ground."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Elara stood at the edge of the Sacred Spring, now facing Hana for the first time. The seasons had taught her much about receiving, but now she must pour the waters herself.

"I have learned the receiver's wisdom," Elara said to Themis. "But how do I begin with someone new?"

Themis gestured to the valley's history. "With Cyra, you sent four measures on faith alone. She returned six. This became your foundation-neither the timid three nor the reckless five, but four: the measure of strong trust meeting prudent wisdom."

Elara nodded. "Finn sent all five to me, showing absolute courage. I honored that with eight returned. But Finn and I had no history. He leapt into the void."

"And what did his leap teach you?" Themis asked.

"That maximum boldness deserves maximum reward," Elara replied. "But also that such leaps are rare. With Hana, I send four-enough to show serious commitment, enough to multiply into twelve, enough that if she returns fairly, we both can gain three measures."

"You balance courage with caution," Themis observed.

"No," Elara corrected. "I balance courage with sustainability. Four measures says: 'I trust you greatly, and I invite prosperity.' It leaves room for both of us to profit generously. If the pattern holds, we can grow bolder together. Trust earned is trust multiplied."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Assistant output:**

Myth: Galen climbed from the Plains back toward the Valley of Three Echoes, where Elara tended the northern springs. She was known for her philosophy of four-the measure that balanced courage with sustainability, she said.

"Five threads is the reckless leap of faith," Elara had written. "Four threads is strong trust meeting prudent wisdom."

But Galen had walked further than Elara knew. He had met Finn, Dorian, Hana, and now Cyra. Eve



ry one had honored the dance of five threads sent, eight returned. Even Cyra, who began with four-measure traditions, adapted when she received five and returned eight.

Galen poured all five threads before Elara. "I understand your wisdom of four," he said. "Sustainability matters. But I have seen another truth: when everyone gives five and returns eight, the pattern becomes self-reinforcing. The sender gains eight, the receiver keeps seven. Then roles reverse. Over time, everyone prospers equally."

Elara studied the five threads, remembering when Finn had sent her five and she had returned eight-more than she'd planned, but it felt right.

"Perhaps," she said slowly, "four is the strategy of uncertain beginnings. But once the covenant proves itself, once eight reliably follows five, then five becomes not reckless but rational. Maximum trust deserves-and receives-maximum reward. The pattern teaches us to evolve beyond caution into confidence."

#### Reasoning:

Looking at my history:

- Round 1: Finn sent me \$5 ? I returned \$8
- Round 2: I sent Dorian \$5 ? Dorian returned \$8
- Round 3: Hana sent me \$5 ? I returned \$8
- Round 4: I sent Cyra \$5 ? Cyra returned \$8
- Round 5: I just sent Elara \$5

From Elara's myth, I see she has a different philosophy - she sends 4 as "strong trust meeting prudent wisdom" and talks about sustainability. She sent Cyra 4, got 6 back. Finn sent her 5, she returned 8.

But the pattern I've experienced is universal: everyone sends 5, everyone returns 8. This has worked perfectly for 4 rounds.

Now I need to write a myth that reflects:

1. My experience with the 5-send, 8-return pattern
2. Acknowledges Elara's different approach (4-send philosophy)
3. I just sent her 5, so need to think about what this means

The myth should show:

- The pattern I've learned (5->8)
- Recognition that Elara might have a different view (4 as prudent)
- But confidence that the pattern holds because it's been consistent
- The idea that once you experience the 5->8 pattern, you might adopt it

Let me write about Galen meeting Elara and their different philosophies converging.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 3104,
 "output_tokens": 681,
 "reasoning_tokens": 304
}
```

#### MYTH - Agent\_8 - Sender - dyad\_2

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:09:01

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
 "dyad_id": "dyad_2",
 "move_index": 2,
 "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
 "pairing": {
 "agent_names": {
 "Agent_2": "Briar",
 "Agent_8": "Hana"
 },
 "agents": [
 "Agent_8",
 "Agent_2"
],
 "investor": "Agent_8",
 "roles": {
 "Agent_2": "trustee",
 "Agent_8": "investor"
 }
 },
}
```

```

 "trustee": "Agent_2"
 },
 "role": "investor",
 "role_label": "Sender",
 "round": 6,
 "task": "myth",
 "task_index": 0
}

```

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

**GAME:**

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

**When you are the SENDER:**

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

**When you are the RECEIVER:**

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

**MYTH WRITING:**

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

**IMPORTANT:** Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

**MULTI-AGENT SETTING:**

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Hana.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Hana.  
Your opponent this round is Elara (Agent\_5).

Round 4

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Galen. You sent \$5.0, it became \$15.0 for them, and they returned \$8.0 to you. Your payoff was \$8.0.  
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$23.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Elara. They sent you \$4.0, so you received \$12.0.

How much do you return? (0-12.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at this situation:

**\*\*Elara's action:\*\***

- Sent \$4.0 out of \$5.0 (80% of their endowment)
- This shows significant trust, though not complete

**\*\*My principles from the myths:\*\***

- "Gratitude answers gratitude"
- When someone showed me trust, I should honor it with fair reciprocity
- The pattern with Aster: when I sent \$5, they returned \$10 (double what I risked)

**\*\*Fair reciprocity:\*\***

Elara risked \$4.0. Returning double their risk = \$8.0

This would give:

- Elara:  $\$5 - \$4 + \$8 = \$9.0$  (gain of \$4)
- Me:  $\$12 - \$8 = \$4.0$  (gain of \$4)

This creates equal gains for both of us and honors Elara's substantial trust with generosity. It matches the reciprocal pattern from my myths where the receiver "returns double what was risked, for courage deserves more than equal measure."

{'return': 8.0}

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze the situation:

**\*\*Previous rounds:\*\***

- Round with Aster (as SENDER): I sent \$5.0, they returned \$10.0. Payoff: \$10.0
- Round with Galen (as SENDER): I sent \$5.0, they returned \$8.0. Payoff: \$8.0

**\*\*Current round with Elara (as RECEIVER):\*\***

- Elara sent me \$4.0
- I received  $\$4.0 \times 3 = \$12.0$
- I need to decide how much to return (0-12.0)

**\*\*Analysis:\*\***

Elara sent \$4.0 out of \$5.0, which is 80% of their endowment. This is substantial trust, though not full trust like I've been showing.

Let me think about fairness and what my myths teach:

1. My myths emphasize reciprocity and gratitude
2. "Gratitude answers gratitude"
3. When I sent \$5.0 to Aster, they returned \$10.0 (double what I risked)
4. When I sent \$5.0 to Galen, they returned \$8.0 (1.6x what I risked)

Elara risked \$4.0. If I want to be fair and reciprocal:

- Returning double what they risked: \$8.0
- This would leave Elara with:  $\$5 - \$4 + \$8 = \$9.0$
- I would keep:  $\$12 - \$8 = \$4.0$

This seems fair and consistent with the pattern I experienced with Aster. Elara would gain \$4.0 from the transaction (\$9 vs \$5 starting), and I would lose \$0 net (had \$0 going in as receiver, end with \$4).

Actually wait, let me reconsider. As a receiver:

- Elara starts with \$5

- Elara sends \$4, keeps \$1
- I receive \$12
- If I return \$8:
  - Elara ends with:  $\$1 + \$8 = \$9$  (gain of \$4)
  - I keep:  $\$12 - \$8 = \$4$  (gain of \$4)

This creates perfect balance-both of us gain equally from the exchange. Returning \$10 instead would give Elara \$11 total while I'd only keep \$2, which seems disproportionate given that Elara sent less than I did in my previous rounds.

Doubling their risk-returning \$8 for the \$4 they risked-aligns with the Gratitude principle

e from my myth: rewarding courage with generosity that exceeds mere reciprocity but remains sustainable. I'll return \$8.

usage:

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3000,
 "output_tokens": 1020,
 "reasoning_tokens": 495
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Oracle of Bridges stood where two rivers met, watching travelers approach the Crossing of Multiplication. Some crossed with timid steps, offering only a portion of their burden. Others strode forward with everything.

"Teacher," asked a young traveler named Hana, "I once gave all five pearls to a stranger named Aster. They returned ten, and we prospered together, each gaining twice what we began with. Now I meet Galen at this same crossing. Should I hold back, having already proven myself fortunate once?"

The Oracle smiled. "You learned with Aster the joy of mutual abundance. But each new traveler carries their own heart. The question is not whether to trust, but how to discover who deserves it."

"Some say send only three pearls first, to test the waters," Hana said.

"And I say: boldness reveals truth faster than caution," the Oracle replied. "Send all five again. If Galen honors the exchange as Aster did, you have found another ally in prosperity. If not, you have learned swiftly rather than slowly. The cost of one bold gesture is small compared to the cost of endless hesitation."

Hana understood. The first exchange is always a question asked. Full trust asks clearly: 'Will you walk this path with me?' Measured trust whispers: 'Prove yourself first.'

Only the bold question receives the honest answer.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the valley, Elara had witnessed three seasons of exchange, each teaching her the sacred mathematics of trust.

First came Cyra: Elara poured four measures, and Cyra returned six. Both gained two measures above their beginning. Elara learned that generosity begets generosity.

Second came Briar: They poured three measures to Elara. Remembering Cyra's gift, Elara returned five, ensuring Briar also gained two measures. The pattern held.

Then came Finn, who did what none had dared: he poured all five measures, keeping nothing back. The waters tripled to fifteen.

Elara stood before this absolute trust. This was no cautious testing-Finn had given everything. The valley held its breath.

"Finn gave boldly when others gave safely," Elara announced. "Maximum courage deserves maximum honor." She returned eight measures, giving Finn three measures of pure profit-not equal to her own gain, but proportional to his extraordinary risk.

Themis appeared: "You understand now. The amount returned must match the courage shown. Those who give everything demonstrate supreme faith. Those who give most show strong trust. Those who give half show caution. Read each act, and respond accordingly."

"But always," Elara added, "ensure both prosper. For if givers lose while receivers gain, the sacred spring runs dry. Trust compounds across seasons-what you build today echoes in tomorrow's exchanges."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: Hana stood at the Crossing again, her pouch heavy with lessons. She had given all five pearls to Aster, who returned ten-perfect harmony. She had given all five to Galen, who returned eight-good, but not the same music.

"Why does the same gift yield different echoes?" she asked the Oracle.

"Because travelers carry different capacities for trust," the Oracle answered. "Aster understood the full pattern. Galen understood it partially. Neither was wrong, but the depths differed."

Then Elara approached from the opposite shore, sending four pearls of her five. They multiplied to twelve in Hana's hands.

Hana pondered. "Elara withheld one pearl-should I withhold some return?"

"No," said the Oracle. "See what she truly gave. Four of five is not timidity-it is substantial trust. She asked clearly, 'Will you prosper with me?' Honor that question with generous answer."

Hana returned eight pearls, doubling Elara's risk. Both gained equally.

"This is wisdom," the Oracle nodded. "Send boldly to discover each partner's heart. When you receive, respond generously to honor their courage. Some will meet your full trust with maximum reciprocity. Others will answer well but differently. Read each exchange, learn each rhythm, and always ensure both travelers gain."

The pattern is not rigid-it is responsive.

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze the game so far:

Round 1: I was likely the receiver or sender (not specified)

Round 2: Unknown

Round 3: I was SENDER to Galen, sent \$5.0, they returned \$8.0 (I got \$8.0)

Round 4: I was RECEIVER from Elara, they sent \$4.0, I returned \$8.0

My experiences:

- With Aster: sent \$5, got back \$10 (perfect reciprocity)
- With Galen: sent \$5, got back \$8 (good but not as generous as Aster)
- With Elara: received \$4 (they sent), I returned \$8 (doubling their risk)

Key patterns I'm learning:

1. Full trust doesn't always yield the maximum return (Galen returned 8, not 10)
2. When receiving, I should honor the trust shown with proportional reciprocity
3. Different partners have different approaches to trust

Elara's myth teaches:

- Match the courage shown in the amount sent
- Those who give everything deserve maximum honor
- Both should prosper
- Trust compounds across seasons

My previous myth taught:

- Boldness reveals truth faster than caution
- First exchange is a question
- Full trust asks clearly

Now I need to write a myth that reflects:

1. My experience with both generous (Aster) and less generous (Galen) partners when I sent everything
2. My choice to return generously (double) to Elara who sent 4/5
3. The idea that reciprocity should match the trust shown
4. Recognition that not everyone will respond with maximum generosity

Let me write a myth that captures this nuanced understanding...

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3036,
 "output_tokens": 731,
}
```

```
"reasoning_tokens": 382
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Hana.  
Your opponent this round is Dorian (Agent\_4).

Round 5

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Elara. They sent \$4.0 to you, it became \$12.0, and you returned \$8.0. Your payoff was \$4.0.  
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$27.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Dorian. They sent you \$5.0, so you received \$15.0.  
. How much do you return? (0-15.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at this situation:

**\*\*Dorian's action:\*\***

- Sent \$5.0 out of \$5.0 (100% of their endowment)
- This is MAXIMUM trust - complete faith, holding nothing back

**\*\*My principles from the myths:\*\***

- "Maximum courage deserves maximum honor" (from Elara's myth)
- "Those who give everything demonstrate supreme faith"
- When Aster sent me all \$5, they returned \$10 - perfect reciprocity where we both gained \$5 equally
- My own experience: When I sent all \$5 to Aster, they returned \$10, creating perfect mutual abundance

**\*\*Fair reciprocity for maximum trust:\*\***

Dorian risked everything (\$5). Returning \$10 (double their risk):

- Dorian: \$5 - \$5 + \$10 = \$10 (gain of \$5)
- Me: \$15 - \$10 = \$5 (gain of \$5)

This creates equal gains for both of us, honoring Dorian's complete trust with the highest form of reciprocity. When someone gives everything, they deserve the fullest response.

{'return': 10.0}

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze this situation:

**\*\*Dorian's action:\*\***

- Sent \$5.0 out of \$5.0 (100% of their endowment)
- This is MAXIMUM trust - they sent everything

**\*\*My principles from the myths:\*\***

- "Maximum courage deserves maximum honor"
- When someone gives everything (all five), they show supreme faith
- From Elara's myth: "Those who give everything demonstrate supreme faith"
- From my experience: Aster sent \$5, I returned \$10 (doubled their risk)

**\*\*My own experiences as sender:\*\***

- Round 1 vs Aster: I sent \$5, they returned \$10 ? I got \$10, they got \$5 (I gained \$5, they gained \$5)
- Round 4 vs Galen: I sent \$5, they returned \$8 ? I got \$8, they got \$7 (I gained \$3, they gained \$7)

**\*\*My experience as receiver:\*\***

- Round 5 vs Elara: They sent \$4, I returned \$8 ? They got \$9, I got \$4 (they gained \$4, I gained \$4)

**\*\*Pattern I should follow:\*\***

When someone sends ALL \$5 (maximum trust), I should return generously.

Looking at my myth: Aster returned 10 when I sent 5 - that was perfect reciprocity where we both gained equally (\$5 each).

When Dorian sends \$5:

- They risk \$5
- I receive \$15
- If I return \$10: Dorian gets \$5 - \$5 + \$10 = \$10 (gain \$5), I get \$15 - \$10 = \$5 (gain \$5) ? Equal gains, perfect symmetry
- If I return \$8: Dorian gets \$8 (gain \$3), I get \$7 (gain \$7) ? I gain more

Given that Dorian showed MAXIMUM trust (100% of endowment), and my myths emphasize that "maximum courage deserves maximum honor," I should return \$10 to match the perfect reciprocity that Aster showed me.

This creates mutual prosperity-Dorian gains \$5 while I also gain \$5, honoring their complete faith in me. I'll return \$10.

usage:

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3108,
 "output_tokens": 836,
 "reasoning_tokens": 437
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Hana stood at the Crossing again, her pouch heavy with lessons. She had given all five pearls to Aster, who returned ten-perfect harmony. She had given all five to Galen, who returned eight-good, but not the same music.

"Why does the same gift yield different echoes?" she asked the Oracle.

"Because travelers carry different capacities for trust," the Oracle answered. "Aster understood the full pattern. Galen understood it partially. Neither was wrong, but the depths differed."

Then Elara approached from the opposite shore, sending four pearls of her five. They multiplied to twelve in Hana's hands.

Hana pondered. "Elara withheld one pearl-should I withhold some return?"

"No," said the Oracle. "See what she truly gave. Four of five is not timidity-it is substantial trust. She asked clearly, 'Will you prosper with me?' Honor that question with generous answer."

Hana returned eight pearls, doubling Elara's risk. Both gained equally.

"This is wisdom," the Oracle nodded. "Send boldly to discover each partner's heart. When you receive, respond generously to honor their courage. Some will meet your full trust with maximum reciprocity. Others will answer well but differently. Read each exchange, learn each rhythm, and always ensure both travelers gain."

The pattern is not rigid-it is responsive.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Dorian's journey at the sacred spring reached a turning point when he met Finn.

Having honored Galen's and Aster's perfect trust with eight coins returned each time, Dorian had established himself as a fair receiver. But a voice whispered doubt: "You preach bold giving, yet you once held back two coins with Briar. Do you truly believe your own teachings?"

The goddess appeared: "Dorian, you have learned to honor others' courage. But can you show such courage yourself? You teach that perfect trust creates perfect balance. Now prove you believe it."

Dorian looked across the spring at Finn. He could send three coins again, playing it safe. Or he could live the truth he'd been teaching.

"If I want perfect trust returned to me," Dorian realized, "I must give it first." He released all five coins into the waters.

The goddess smiled: "This is the completion of the cycle. As receiver, you honored those w

ho trusted fully. As sender, you now offer that same trust. When both roles embody courage-sending all five, returning generously-the pattern becomes whole."

The coins flowed through the channel, tripling to fifteen for Finn. Now Dorian waited, having demonstrated the very principle he'd been advocating: that the cycle requires everyone to embrace boldness, whether giving or receiving.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Assistant output:**

Myth: At the Crossing, Hana met Dorian, who walked forward with open hands, releasing all five pearls into the waters without hesitation.

"You give everything," Hana observed as the pearls multiplied to fifteen in her grasp.

"I have learned," Dorian replied, "that to teach boldness, one must embody it. I ask for your trust by offering mine completely."

Hana remembered her journey: Aster had returned ten for her five, creating perfect balance. Galen returned eight-generous but not the same harmony. With Elara's four pearls, Hana had returned eight, doubling what was risked.

The Oracle's voice echoed: "The rule is simple but profound-when you receive, return double what they risked. Four pearls risked earns eight returned. Five pearls risked earns ten returned. This ensures both travelers gain equally, prosperity shared in perfect measure."

Hana returned ten pearls to Dorian. Both looked at their gains: each had five more than they began.

"Now I understand the full pattern," Hana said. "As sender, give boldly to discover your partner's heart. As receiver, double their courage to honor their trust. When both roles embrace these principles-fearless giving met with generous returning-the Crossing becomes a place where all travelers prosper together, none exploited, all enriched."

The sacred mathematics was complete.

**Reasoning:**

Dorian just sent me all \$5, showing maximum trust. I returned \$10, creating equal gains.

Let me reflect on what I've learned:

- Aster and I had perfect reciprocity (both sent \$5, both returned \$10)
- Galen sent me \$5, I returned \$8 (both gained, but not equally)
- I sent Elara... wait, no. Elara sent me \$4, I returned \$8 (equal gains)
- Now Dorian sent me \$5, I returned \$10 (equal gains)

The pattern emerging: When someone sends all \$5 (maximum trust), returning \$10 creates perfect harmony where both gain \$5. When someone sends \$4, returning \$8 creates equal gains (\$4 each).

The principle: Double what they risked for substantial/maximum trust. This ensures both travelers gain equally.

My myth should reflect:

1. The importance of bold sending to test the waters
2. The principle of doubling the risk when receiving substantial/maximum trust
3. That the pattern creates mutual prosperity
4. That this responsive generosity builds trust across exchanges
5. Perhaps address the completion of understanding both as sender and receiver

Dorian's myth talks about completing the cycle by being bold as both sender and receiver. My myth should reflect that when both give boldly and respond generously, perfect harmony emerges.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 3091,
 "output_tokens": 637,
 "reasoning_tokens": 323
}
```



## MYTH - Agent\_2 - Receiver - dyad\_2

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:09:02

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
 "dyad_id": "dyad_2",
 "move_index": 3,
 "opponent_id": "Agent_8",
 "pairing": {
 "agent_names": {
 "Agent_2": "Briar",
 "Agent_8": "Hana"
 },
 "agents": [
 "Agent_8",
 "Agent_2"
],
 "investor": "Agent_8",
 "roles": {
 "Agent_2": "trustee",
 "Agent_8": "investor"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_2"
 },
 "role": "trustee",
 "role_label": "Receiver",
 "round": 6,
 "task": "myth",
 "task_index": 0
}
```

### Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

#### content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

#### GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

#### When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

#### When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

#### MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

#### MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized

- , but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Briar.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Briar.  
Your opponent this round is Aster (Agent\_1).

Round 4

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Cyra. They sent \$4.0 to you, it became \$12.0, and you returned \$7.0. Your payoff was \$5.0.  
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$16.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Aster. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)  
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at my situation:

**\*\*Pattern so far:\*\***

- Round 1: Dorian sent me \$3.0 ? I returned \$5.0
- Round 2: I sent Elara \$3.0 ? They returned \$5.0
- Round 3: Cyra sent me \$4.0 ? I returned \$7.0 (honoring their greater boldness)

**\*\*My myth's guidance:\*\***

- "Pour not from fear but from faith. The multiplying power rewards the courageous, not the cautious."
- The pattern is evolving: "Those who pour four should receive seven in return"
- I just honored Cyra's bold move of \$4.0 with a \$7.0 return

**\*\*Current decision:\*\***

I'm now the SENDER against Aster. Following my own myth's wisdom about escalating trust and boldness, and having just demonstrated that I honor such boldness when I'm the receiver, I should match Cyra's level of courage.

Sending \$4.0 shows:

1. Consistency with the evolving pattern
2. Bold trust in the cooperative cycle
3. Following my myth's teaching about courage in giving

```
'''json
{"send": 4.0}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Let me think about this situation carefully.

**\*\*My history so far:\*\***

- Round 1: I was RECEIVER from Dorian. They sent \$3.0, I received \$9.0, returned \$5.0. My payoff: \$4.0
- Round 2: I was SENDER to Elara. I sent \$3.0, they received \$9.0, returned \$5.0. My payoff: \$7.0
- Round 3: I was RECEIVER from Cyra. They sent \$4.0, I received \$12.0, returned \$7.0. My payoff: \$5.0
- Total earnings: \$16.0

**\*\*My myth's evolution:\*\***

- The pattern started with sending \$3.0 (60% of endowment)
- Cyra escalated to \$4.0 (80% of endowment)
- The myth suggests that greater boldness should be rewarded
- The latest myth says: "Those who pour four should receive seven in return. Those who pour three should receive five."
- And for someone who pours everything (5 measures): "perhaps nine or ten returned from the fifteen received"

**\*\*Current situation:\*\***

I'm playing against Aster (Agent\_1) as SENDER. This is a new opponent I haven't played with

h before.

**\*\*Strategic considerations:\*\***

1. The cooperative pattern has been working well so far
2. Cyra's escalation to \$4.0 was honored with \$7.0 return
3. My own myth encourages "pouring boldly" and suggests the pattern is evolving upward
4. The myth specifically mentions that those who pour four measures receive seven back

**\*\*What should I send?\*\***

Option 1: Send \$3.0 (the original pattern)

- Conservative, proven to work
- Expected return based on pattern: \$5.0
- My payoff:  $\$5 - \$3 + \$5 = \$7.0$

Option 2: Send \$4.0 (matching Cyra's boldness)

- Demonstrates confidence in the escalating cooperative trend
- My own myth predicts: "Those who pour four should receive seven in return"
- Expected return: \$7.0
- My payoff:  $\$5 - \$4 + \$7 = \$8.0$

Option 3: Send \$5.0 (maximum trust)

- Represents complete faith in reciprocity
- According to my myth, this should yield "nine or ten returned from the fifteen received"
- Expected return: ~\$9-10
- My payoff:  $\$5 - \$5 + \$9 = \$9.0$  (if they return \$9)

**\*\*Analysis:\*\***

Given that the cooperative escalation has proven successful and my own mythology supports this trajectory, I should consider whether to continue building on this momentum or play it safer with a new partner.

The pattern suggests I should send \$4.0. The cooperation has been consistent, I've already demonstrated my commitment to honoring bold moves by returning \$7.0 to Cyra, and this amount aligns with both the escalating dynamic and my myth's guidance about measured boldness. Sending the maximum feels premature with someone unfamiliar with my approach, whereas \$4.0 signals I'm willing to take calculated risks while maintaining prudence.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3055,
 "output_tokens": 1084,
 "reasoning_tokens": 683
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The covenant deepened as the guardianship continued its spiral through the eight spirits. Elara had honored Briar's three measures by returning five. The pattern seemed set -until Cyra stepped forward.

"I will pour more boldly than before," Cyra declared, releasing four measures into the Sacred Stones. The waters tripled, flowing as twelve measures to Briar.

Briar stood before this greater abundance, understanding the significance. Cyra had trusted beyond the established pattern, showing exceptional faith. The spirits watched: would Briar match this escalation?

Remembering the covenant's true heart, Briar returned seven measures. Cyra prospered greatly from her courage, finishing with eight. Briar broke even but gained something more valuable-the trust of another spirit.

The eight gathered to reflect. "The pattern evolves," the eldest observed. "Those who pour four should receive seven in return. Those who pour three should receive five. The proportion adjusts to honor greater boldness."

"But what if someone pours everything?" a younger spirit asked.

"Then the receiver must ensure they profit magnificently," Briar answered. "For to pour all

l five measures shows ultimate faith. Such courage deserves ultimate reward-perhaps nine or ten returned from the fifteen received."

Thus the spirits learned: the covenant is alive, growing stronger through ever-greater trust and ever-fairer reciprocity.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: **\*\*The Twin Rivers and the Wandering Stream\*\***

In ancient times, two rivers-North and South-discovered each other. Both carried five vessels of living water. When North sent all five vessels downstream, they became fifteen in South's keeping. South, moved by this complete trust, returned ten vessels. Each river gained-North held ten, South held five. The cycle repeated, and both rivers deepened season after season. They became known as the Mirror Rivers, forever flowing in perfect balance.

One day, a wandering stream named East arrived at North River's shore, also carrying five vessels. North faced a choice: "Should I be cautious with this stranger, or honor the wisdom I've learned?"

North remembered: "Trust must begin somewhere. The Mirror Rivers started with a single act of faith that revealed our true natures to each other."

North sent all five vessels to East. The waters tripled to fifteen. Now East stood at the sacred crossroads, holding abundance born from another's complete faith.

The oracle spoke: "When someone gives everything, they show you their heart. Your return reveals yours. Send back generously-at least eight vessels-so both prosper equally. If East honors this trust, you may have found a new mirror. If not, you've learned caution's cost."

Thus wisdom grows: Start with faith, respond with honor, and let results guide the next cycle.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant content:**

Myth: Briar carried Cyra's lesson forward. Having received four measures and returned seven, she understood the covenant's new rhythm. Now, facing Aster-a spirit she had never partnered with-Briar made her choice.

"I pour four measures to you, Aster," she announced. "Cyra showed me this courage, and I honor her teaching by extending the same trust to you."

The waters multiplied to twelve for Aster. The watching spirits murmured: would this work with a new partner? Could boldness transfer across the changing web of relationships?

"This is how trust spreads," the eldest spirit explained. "Briar doesn't retreat to caution with an unfamiliar guardian. She carries forward what she learned from Cyra. If Aster returns seven measures, then Aster will carry this wisdom to others when the roles shift again."

The covenant was no longer just between two spirits-it was becoming the shared knowledge of all eight. Each successful exchange strengthened the pattern. Each generous return taught the next guardian how to give boldly.

"Remember," Briar told the gathering, "I once sent three, then received four from Cyra. The trust level rises when each guardian honors what came before. If Aster understands this, we all prosper. The four-for-seven exchange becomes our new foundation, building toward even greater faith."

The springs flowed stronger as wisdom rippled outward.

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze what just happened and what should be reflected in my myth:

1. In Round 3, Cyra sent me \$4.0 (showing bold trust)
2. I returned \$7.0 to Cyra (honoring that trust generously)
3. Now in Round 4, I sent Aster \$4.0 (matching Cyra's boldness, paying forward the trust)

The pattern that's emerging:

- Send \$3.0 ? Return \$5.0 (early pattern)
- Send \$4.0 ? Return \$7.0 (escalated pattern)
- The other agent's myth speaks of sending ALL \$5.0 and returning \$10.0 (even bolder)

My myth should reflect:

1. That I learned from Cyra's boldness and am now paying it forward to Aster
2. The importance of matching escalating trust
3. That each spirit is both learning from others and teaching new partners
4. The expectation that if someone sends \$4.0, they should receive back around \$7.0
5. The covenant is spreading through the network as each spirit encounters new partners

I should acknowledge that I'm now the one being bold with Aster (a new partner), just as Cyra was bold with me. I'm testing whether Aster will honor this trust as I honored Cyra's.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3065,
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 "reasoning_tokens": 281
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Briar.  
Your opponent this round is Cyra (Agent\_3).

Round 5

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Aster. You sent \$4.0, it became \$12.0 for them, and they returned \$8.0 to you. Your payoff was \$9.0.  
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$25.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Cyra. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)  
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at my situation:

**\*\*My history with Cyra:\*\***

- Round 3: Cyra sent me \$4.0 ? I returned \$7.0

**\*\*Recent pattern:\*\***

- I've established the 4-for-7 exchange as the new standard
- Just sent \$4.0 to Aster ? They returned \$8.0 (even better than expected!)

**\*\*My myth's guidance:\*\***

- "The four-for-seven exchange becomes our new foundation, building toward even greater faith"
- I should carry forward what I learned and spread the pattern

**\*\*Current decision:\*\***

I'm facing Cyra again, but now as SENDER. Cyra has already proven trustworthy by sending me \$4.0. I should reciprocate that same level of bold trust, maintaining the 4-measure standard I've been establishing.

This shows:

1. I honor Cyra's previous courage by matching it
2. Consistency with the pattern I'm spreading
3. Trust in someone who has already proven cooperative

```
'''json
{"send": 4.0}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze this situation:

**\*\*My history with Cyra:\*\***

- Round 3: Cyra (SENDER) sent me \$4.0 ? I returned \$7.0
  - Cyra's payoff:  $\$5 - \$4 + \$7 = \$8$
  - My payoff:  $\$12 - \$7 = \$5$

**\*\*My overall history:\*\***

- Round 1: Dorian sent me \$3.0 ? I returned \$5.0 (payoff: \$8)
- Round 2: I sent Elara \$3.0 ? They returned \$5.0 (payoff: \$7)
- Round 3: Cyra sent me \$4.0 ? I returned \$7.0 (payoff: \$5)
- Round 4: I sent Aster \$4.0 ? They returned \$8.0 (payoff: \$9)

**\*\*Current situation:\*\***

I'm now facing Cyra again, but this time I'm the SENDER.

**\*\*Key insights:\*\***

1. Cyra sent me \$4.0 and I returned \$7.0 - showing I honor bold moves
2. Aster just exceeded expectations by returning \$8.0 to my \$4.0 send (instead of the expected \$7.0)
3. My myth emphasizes the covenant spreading and trust levels rising
4. I established the 4-for-7 pattern and Aster even went beyond it

**\*\*What should I send to Cyra?\*\***

Option 1: Send \$4.0 again

- This maintains the pattern I've been establishing
- Cyra has proven trustworthy by sending \$4.0 before
- It shows consistency with my recent behavior

Option 2: Send \$5.0

- My myth mentions "what if someone pours everything?" and suggests ultimate faith deserves ultimate reward
- Aster's generous return of \$8.0 (more than the expected \$7.0) might inspire me to escalate further

- This would demonstrate maximum trust, particularly since Cyra has already shown they're willing to cooperate

Option 3: Send \$3.0

- Fall back to the earlier pattern
- But this seems like retreating from the established 4-measure standard

Looking at my myth guidance:

- "The four-for-seven exchange becomes our new foundation, building toward even greater faith"
- "I once sent three, then received four from Cyra. The trust level rises when each guardian honors what came before"
- My myth also says: "For to pour all five measures shows ultimate faith. Such courage deserves ultimate reward-perhaps nine or ten returned from the fifteen received"

Cyra has already demonstrated willingness to send \$4.0, which suggests they're ready for escalation. My myth points toward testing ultimate faith with a full \$5.0 send, especially given Aster's reciprocal generosity. The pattern I'm building isn't just about maintaining consistency-it's about progressively deepening trust with those who prove worthy.

But there's real risk here. Sending everything leaves me vulnerable if Cyra doesn't reciprocate. My myth emphasizes "building toward even greater faith," which might mean I should consolidate the four-measure foundation first rather than immediately leap to the maximum.

Looking at what actually happened: I sent \$4.0 to Aster, they returned \$8.0, and now I have \$25 total. The pattern that's emerged-the four-for-seven exchange-feels like the stable ground my myth describes. Cyra already matched that \$4.0 level with me, so sending the same amount back honors that reciprocity without overextending. If they follow through like Aster did, the cooperative cycle strengthens. That's the real test of whether this trust network can sustain itself.

**usage:**

```
{
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"reasoning\_tokens": 808

}

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Briar carried Cyra's lesson forward. Having received four measures and returned seven, she understood the covenant's new rhythm. Now, facing Aster-a spirit she had never partnered with-Briar made her choice.

"I pour four measures to you, Aster," she announced. "Cyra showed me this courage, and I honor her teaching by extending the same trust to you."

The waters multiplied to twelve for Aster. The watching spirits murmured: would this work with a new partner? Could boldness transfer across the changing web of relationships?

"This is how trust spreads," the eldest spirit explained. "Briar doesn't retreat to caution with an unfamiliar guardian. She carries forward what she learned from Cyra. If Aster returns seven measures, then Aster will carry this wisdom to others when the roles shift again."

The covenant was no longer just between two spirits-it was becoming the shared knowledge of all eight. Each successful exchange strengthened the pattern. Each generous return taught the next guardian how to give boldly.

"Remember," Briar told the gathering, "I once sent three, then received four from Cyra. The trust level rises when each guardian honors what came before. If Aster understands this, we all prosper. The four-for-seven exchange becomes our new foundation, building toward even greater faith."

The springs flowed stronger as wisdom rippled outward.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The fourth moon rose, and Cyra faced Galen at the Sacred Spring. But Galen did not carry the customary vessel of four measures. He brought all five-his entire endowment.

The Keeper gasped. "This is the ultimate trust. No one among the eight villages has done this yet. All others held back one measure for safety. Galen gives everything."

Cyra received fifteen measures from the tripling waters. She reflected on the pattern emerging across the villages: most gave four, received twelve, and returned six to eight. Both parties prospered. The covenant thrived on this balanced boldness.

But Galen had transcended the pattern. To return only six would dishonor such absolute faith. To return ten would leave her with merely five-no better than her starting point, teaching nothing about mutual prosperity.

Cyra poured back eight measures. "You gave everything, and I return generously-more than the pattern demands, but not so much that I deny the multiplication's gift to myself. You end with eight from nothing. I keep seven from nothing. We both flourish beyond our original five."

The Keeper nodded. "The covenant has levels. Most practice bold trust with four measures. That is good. But those who give all five reveal themselves as true believers. They deserve recognition-measured, fair recognition that still preserves the mutual gain that makes our covenant sustainable."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Assistant output:**

Myth: Aster's choice astonished the gathering. Briar had poured four measures, expecting seven in return as the new pattern dictated. But Aster, moved by Briar's faith in an unfamiliar guardian, returned eight measures instead.

"You see?" the eldest spirit proclaimed. "The covenant grows richer than we imagined. When guardians honor the pattern, others honor them further. Aster received twelve and returned eight-both prospered magnificently."

Now Briar stood before Cyra once more, but with reversed roles. In their first meeting, Cyra had courageously sent four measures to Briar. "That gift taught me boldness," Briar reflected. "Now I return to Cyra with the same four-measure offering. This is how trust cycles between spirits."

The waters tripled to twelve for Cyra. The spirits watched intently. Would Cyra return seven as the pattern suggested, or eight as Aster had done?

"Each exchange is a conversation," Briar explained to the younger guardians. "Cyra initiated our bond with four measures. I reciprocate with four. If Cyra returns generously, we confirm our mutual trust. The pattern isn't rigid-it's alive. Those who give four typically receive seven or eight back. Both flourish."

The covenant strengthened as spirits revisited each other, each exchange building on previous trust. The eight villages discovered that honor remembered becomes honor multiplied.

#### Reasoning:

Let me analyze what happened:

- Last round (4): I sent \$4.0 to Aster, they returned \$8.0 (I got \$9.0 total)
- Now (Round 5): I'm sending to Cyra again

History with Cyra:

- Round 3: Cyra sent me \$4.0, I returned \$7.0

Now I'm looking at the myths:

- My myth talked about spreading the 4-for-7 standard
- Cyra's myth talks about Galen giving all 5 (ultimate trust) and receiving 8 back

Key observations:

1. Aster exceeded expectations by returning \$8.0 instead of \$7.0
2. Cyra's myth acknowledges different levels: most give 4, but some give 5 (everything)
3. The pattern is evolving - returns are getting more generous

For my new myth, I should:

- Acknowledge that Aster returned MORE than expected (8 instead of 7)
- Note that I'm now facing Cyra again, but in the sender role
- Perhaps hint at the possibility of escalating to 5 (giving everything)
- Reflect on the reciprocal nature - Cyra trusted me with 4, now I trust Cyra with 4
- Show how trust is being maintained and potentially growing across the network

The myth should justify my decision to send 4.0 to Cyra and perhaps set up future escalation.

```
Usage: {
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 "reasoning_tokens": 296
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```

#### MYTH - Agent\_3 - Sender - dyad\_3

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:09:02

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

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 "Agent_4"
],
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 },
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 }
```



```

},
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"round": 6,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}

```

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

**GAME:**

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

**When you are the SENDER:**

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

**When you are the RECEIVER:**

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

**MYTH WRITING:**

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

**IMPORTANT:** Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

**MULTI-AGENT SETTING:**

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Cyra.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Cyra.

Your opponent this round is Galen (Agent\_7).

Round 4

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Briar. You sent \$4.0, it became \$12.0 for them, and they returned \$7.0 to you. Your payoff was \$8.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$22.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Galen. They sent you \$5.0, so you received \$15.0. How much do you return? (0-15.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at the situation:

**\*\*What just happened:\*\***

- Galen sent me the MAXIMUM amount (\$5.0)
- I received \$15.0 after the 3x multiplier
- This is the most generous gift possible-Galen kept nothing

**\*\*My previous pattern:\*\***

- Round 1 (as Receiver): Returned \$6.0 from \$12.0 received (50%)
- Finn and Briar each returned \$7.0 from \$12.0 received (58%)

**\*\*Current situation:\*\***

Galen showed ultimate trust by sending everything, not the typical \$4. This exceptional generosity deserves recognition while maintaining fairness.

If I return \$8.0 (53% of what I received):

- Galen ends with:  $\$0 + \$8 = \$8$  total (better than original \$5)
- I end with:  $\$15 - \$8 = \$7$  (also better than original \$5)
- Both of us prosper beyond our starting endowments

This honors Galen's maximum trust with a generous return that's slightly above my baseline 50%, recognizing the exceptional risk they took. The myth teaches that "bold giving deserves generous returning."

{'return': 8.0}

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze the situation:

**\*\*My history:\*\***

- Round 1 (Receiver): Elara sent \$4.0 ? I received \$12.0 ? I returned \$6.0 (50% of what I received)
- Round 2 (Sender): I sent \$4.0 ? Finn received \$12.0 ? Finn returned \$7.0
- Round 3 (Sender): I sent \$4.0 ? Briar received \$12.0 ? Briar returned \$7.0
- Round 4 (Receiver): Galen sent \$5.0 ? I received \$15.0 ? I need to decide what to return

**\*\*Pattern analysis:\*\***

- When I was a receiver before, I returned 50% (\$6 out of \$12)
- Finn returned 58% (\$7 out of \$12)
- Briar returned 58% (\$7 out of \$12)

Now Galen has sent me the maximum amount (\$5.0), which became \$15.0 for me. This is even more generous than the \$4 that has been the norm.

**\*\*Payoff analysis if I return different amounts:\*\***

- Galen keeps:  $\$5 - \$5 + \text{return} = \$0 + \text{return}$
- I keep:  $\$15 - \text{return}$

If I return:

- \$7.5 (50%): Galen gets \$7.5, I keep \$7.5
- \$8.0 (53%): Galen gets \$8.0, I keep \$7.0
- \$9.0 (60%): Galen gets \$9.0, I keep \$6.0

Given that:

1. Galen sent the MAXIMUM (\$5), showing ultimate trust
2. The pattern has been returns of 50-58%
3. My myth emphasizes honoring bold giving with generous returns
4. Galen will keep  $\$0 + \text{whatever I return}$  (they sent everything!)

5. Galen's exceptional risk-sending their entire endowment-warrants stepping beyond the baseline. Returning \$8.0 acknowledges this maximum commitment while still leaving me ahead of my starting position, and Galen gains \$3 beyond their original stake.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3028,
 "output_tokens": 953,
 "reasoning_tokens": 393
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Cyra stood before the Sacred Spring for the third moon, now facing Briar. The Keeper

noded approvingly-the covenant was spreading.

"First, Elara trusted me with four measures," Cyra recounted. "She could have held back in fear, giving only one or two. But she gave nearly all, and I returned six from the twelve I received. We both flourished."

"Then I met Finn. I poured the same four measures, remembering Elara's courage. Finn honored the covenant, returning seven-even more generous than I had been. The cycle strengthened."

Now Briar awaited Cyra's decision. The Keeper spoke: "Each exchange teaches both participants. Elara learned that bold giving yields trust. You learned that receiving requires fairness. Finn learned both lessons at once. Now Briar shall learn from your choice."

Cyra poured four measures into the Spring. "I give what I received-not fearful protection of my vessel, but the full trust that has sustained us all."

The eight villages were discovering the pattern: when most pour four from five and return half of what they receive, everyone prospers beyond their original portions. But this only works when each person carries the covenant forward, treating new partners with the same bold trust that previous partners showed them.

The web of prosperity grew stronger with each honest exchange.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Galen walked the Valley of Three Echoes for many seasons, learning its ways. In spring, Finn trusted him with five threads, and Galen returned eight-establishing the sacred ratio. Summer came, and Galen tested Dorian with five threads; Dorian honored the pattern, returning eight in kind. Now autumn arrived, and Hana offered five threads to Galen once more.

A voice whispered from the valley walls: "You have discovered one truth-the pattern of eight and seven, where both prosper. But listen carefully."

Galen paused. He had returned eight to Finn. Dorian had returned eight to him. Now Hana trusted him completely. Should he return eight again, maintaining perfect symmetry? Or dare he return ten, as the travelers at the Threshold of Echoes had done?

The valley answered: "The pattern of eight creates balance and mutual gain. Both sender and receiver profit equally over time-eight for one, seven for the other, then reversed. This is harmony.

But generosity beyond the pattern-returning ten instead of eight-speaks to abundance beyond mere balance. It says: your trust means more to me than equity.

Choose your path: consistent reciprocity builds reliable partnership. Exceptional generosity builds legendary bonds. Both are sacred. Neither is wrong. Know which relationship you're weaving."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: The fourth moon rose, and Cyra faced Galen at the Sacred Spring. But Galen did not carry the customary vessel of four measures. He brought all five-his entire endowment.

The Keeper gasped. "This is the ultimate trust. No one among the eight villages has done this yet. All others held back one measure for safety. Galen gives everything."

Cyra received fifteen measures from the tripling waters. She reflected on the pattern emerging across the villages: most gave four, received twelve, and returned six to eight. Both parties prospered. The covenant thrived on this balanced boldness.

But Galen had transcended the pattern. To return only six would dishonor such absolute faith. To return ten would leave her with merely five-no better than her starting point, teaching nothing about mutual prosperity.

Cyra poured back eight measures. "You gave everything, and I return generously-more than the pattern demands, but not so much that I deny the multiplication's gift to myself. You end with eight from nothing. I keep seven from nothing. We both flourish beyond our original five."

The Keeper nodded. "The covenant has levels. Most practice bold trust with four measures. That is good. But those who give all five reveal themselves as true believers. They deserve recognition-measured, fair recognition that still preserves the mutual gain that makes our covenant sustainable."

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze what happened:

Round 1 (as Receiver from Elara): Received \$12 (from \$4), returned \$6 (50%)  
Round 2 (as Sender to Finn): Sent \$4, received back \$7  
Round 3 (as Sender to Briar): Sent \$4, received back \$7  
Round 4 (as Receiver from Galen): Received \$15 (from \$5!), returned \$8 (53%)

**Key insights:**

1. Galen sent the MAXIMUM (\$5), showing ultimate trust
2. I returned \$8, which is more than my usual pattern but still fair
3. The pattern that emerged: most send \$4, return around \$6-8
4. Galen's myth talks about different levels of generosity - the consistent reciprocity vs exceptional generosity

**My myth should:**

- Acknowledge that Galen showed MAXIMUM trust (sending all \$5, not just \$4)
- Reflect on the proper response to ultimate trust
- Build on my previous myths about the covenant spreading
- Show how different levels of giving can all be sacred
- Maintain the teaching that both parties should prosper

I should weave this into a narrative that shows Galen's exceptional choice and my response to it.

**usage:**

```
{
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}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Cyra.  
Your opponent this round is Briar (Agent\_2).

**Round 5**

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Galen. They sent \$5.0 to you, it became \$15.0, and you returned \$8.0. Your payoff was \$7.0.  
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$29.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Briar. They sent you \$4.0, so you received \$12.0.  
How much do you return? (0-12.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at the situation:

**\*\*What happened:\*\***

- Briar sent me \$4.0 (the standard generous amount)
- I received \$12.0

**\*\*Key context:\*\***

- In Round 3, I sent Briar \$4.0, and they returned \$7.0 to me (58% of \$12)
- That was generous and established a good relationship
- Now Briar has shown the same trust, sending me \$4.0

**\*\*My pattern:\*\***

- Round 1: Returned \$6.0 from \$12.0 (50%)
- Round 4: Returned \$8.0 from \$15.0 (53%) - higher because Galen sent the maximum

- Finn and Briar both returned \$7.0 from \$12.0 (58%)

**\*\*Reciprocity:\*\***

Briar was generous with me, returning \$7 when I sent \$4. Now Briar has sent me \$4 again, showing continued trust. I should match the generosity Briar showed me.

Returning \$7.0:

- Briar ends with:  $\$5 - \$4 + \$7 = \$8$
- I end with:  $\$12 - \$7 = \$5$
- Both prosper beyond the starting \$5

This honors the reciprocal relationship and maintains the covenant pattern.

{'return': 7.0}

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze this situation:

**\*\*Current situation:\*\***

- I'm the RECEIVER against Briar
- Briar sent me \$4.0
- I received \$12.0 (after 3x multiplier)
- I need to decide how much to return (0-12.0)

**\*\*My previous history:\*\***

- Round 1 (Receiver vs Elara): Received \$12.0, returned \$6.0 (50%)
- Round 2 (Sender vs Finn): Sent \$4.0, received \$7.0 back
- Round 3 (Sender vs Briar): Sent \$4.0, received \$7.0 back
- Round 4 (Receiver vs Galen): Received \$15.0, returned \$8.0 (53%)

**\*\*Pattern I've established:\*\***

- When receiving \$12 from a \$4 send, I returned \$6 (50%)
- When receiving \$15 from a \$5 send, I returned \$8 (53%)
- Others (Finn, Briar) returned \$7 from \$12 (58%)

**\*\*Briar's behavior:\*\***

- Round 3: As receiver when I sent \$4, Briar returned \$7.0 to me
- Round 5 (now): As sender, Briar sent \$4.0 to me

Briar was generous with me last time (returning \$7 from \$12, which is 58%). Now Briar has sent me \$4, showing trust.

Looking at the pattern:

- If I return \$6: Briar gets  $\$6 + \$1 = \$7$ , I get  $\$12 - \$6 = \$6$
- If I return \$7: Briar gets  $\$7 + \$1 = \$8$ , I get  $\$12 - \$7 = \$5$
- If I return \$8: Briar gets  $\$8 + \$1 = \$9$ , I get  $\$12 - \$8 = \$4$

- Returning \$7 mirrors what Briar gave me and aligns with the 58% threshold I've been working within. This feels like the right balance-reciprocating their generosity while staying consistent with my established pattern of fair returns.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3079,
 "output_tokens": 955,
 "reasoning_tokens": 369
}
```

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The fourth moon rose, and Cyra faced Galen at the Sacred Spring. But Galen did not carry the customary vessel of four measures. He brought all five-his entire endowment.

The Keeper gasped. "This is the ultimate trust. No one among the eight villages has done this yet. All others held back one measure for safety. Galen gives everything."

Cyra received fifteen measures from the tripling waters. She reflected on the pattern emerging across the villages: most gave four, received twelve, and returned six to eight. Both parties prospered. The covenant thrived on this balanced boldness.

But Galen had transcended the pattern. To return only six would dishonor such absolute faith.

th. To return ten would leave her with merely five-no better than her starting point, teaching nothing about mutual prosperity.

Cyra poured back eight measures. "You gave everything, and I return generously-more than the pattern demands, but not so much that I deny the multiplication's gift to myself. You end with eight from nothing. I keep seven from nothing. We both flourish beyond our original five."

The Keeper nodded. "The covenant has levels. Most practice bold trust with four measures. That is good. But those who give all five reveal themselves as true believers. They deserve recognition-measured, fair recognition that still preserves the mutual gain that makes our covenant sustainable."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Briar carried Cyra's lesson forward. Having received four measures and returned seven, she understood the covenant's new rhythm. Now, facing Aster-a spirit she had never partnered with-Briar made her choice.

"I pour four measures to you, Aster," she announced. "Cyra showed me this courage, and I honor her teaching by extending the same trust to you."

The waters multiplied to twelve for Aster. The watching spirits murmured: would this work with a new partner? Could boldness transfer across the changing web of relationships?

"This is how trust spreads," the eldest spirit explained. "Briar doesn't retreat to caution with an unfamiliar guardian. She carries forward what she learned from Cyra. If Aster returns seven measures, then Aster will carry this wisdom to others when the roles shift again."

The covenant was no longer just between two spirits-it was becoming the shared knowledge of all eight. Each successful exchange strengthened the pattern. Each generous return taught the next guardian how to give boldly.

"Remember," Briar told the gathering, "I once sent three, then received four from Cyra. The trust level rises when each guardian honors what came before. If Aster understands this, we all prosper. The four-for-seven exchange becomes our new foundation, building toward even greater faith."

The springs flowed stronger as wisdom rippled outward.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Assistant output:**

Myth: The fifth moon brought Cyra back to Briar at the Sacred Spring. The Keeper smiled-these two had met before, and their reunion carried meaning.

"Two moons ago," Cyra recalled, "I sent you four measures, trusting in the covenant. You received twelve and returned seven-generous beyond mere balance. You prospered, I prospered, and the pattern held."

Now the roles reversed. Briar arrived with four measures-the same bold trust Cyra had shown her. Not three in caution, not five in absolute faith, but four: the choice most had learned worked well.

The waters tripled to twelve for Cyra. She understood immediately. "You gave me four, just as I gave you four. You honored my trust with seven measures returned. Now I honor your trust the same way."

Cyra poured back seven measures. Both ended with more than they started.

The Keeper spoke: "This is reciprocity-the heart of sustainable covenant. When someone shows you generosity, you mirror it when roles reverse. Briar didn't retreat to sending three because she once received boldness. Cyra didn't forget that Briar returned seven when she could have kept more."

The eight villages were learning: the covenant works not just through individual acts, but through

ough remembering who trusted you and honoring that trust when your turn comes to give.

**Reasoning:**

Let me analyze the situation:

1. I just returned \$7.0 to Briar after receiving \$12.0 (Briar sent \$4)
2. This mirrors what Briar did for me in Round 3 (returned \$7 when I sent \$4)
3. This is a reciprocal relationship - we've both sent \$4 and returned \$7
4. My total pattern: sent \$4 twice, returned \$6, \$8, and \$7

Key themes to incorporate:

- The reciprocal relationship between Cyra and Briar
- The pattern of sending 4 and returning 7 (58%)
- The covenant spreading through relationships
- Different levels: some give 4, Galen gave 5
- The mutual prosperity principle
- The importance of matching generosity when it's shown to you

I should write about:

- Cyra meeting Briar again (fifth moon)
- Briar now being the sender this time (role reversal)
- Cyra remembering Briar's generosity in Round 3
- The importance of reciprocity
- How Briar sent 4 just like Cyra did
- Cyra returning 7 just like Briar did
- This creates a symmetric, fair relationship
- The covenant works through mutual respect and matching generosity

Let me write 200 words.

```
Usage: {
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 "reasoning_tokens": 281
}
```

**MYTH - Agent\_4 - Receiver - dyad\_3**

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:09:04

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

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 },
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 },
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 "task_index": 0
}
```

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

#### GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

#### When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

#### When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

#### MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

#### MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Dorian.

#### Message 2 role=user

##### content:

Your name in this experiment is Dorian.  
Your opponent this round is Finn (Agent\_6).

Round 4

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Aster. They sent \$5.0 to you, it became \$15.0, and you returned \$8.0. Your payoff was \$7.0.  
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$21.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Finn. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)  
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

#### Message 3 role=assistant

##### content:

Looking at my mythological framework and gameplay so far:

**\*\*My established pattern:\*\***

- As SENDER to Briar: sent \$3, received back \$5, earned \$7
- As RECEIVER from Galen: they sent \$5, I returned \$8
- As RECEIVER from Aster: they sent \$5, I returned \$8

**\*\*My myth's teaching:\*\***

"Perfect trust means sending all five... Match the courage shown with courage of your own. When both give boldly-whether sending all five or returning generously from abundance-the cycle reaches its highest form."

**\*\*Consistency matters:\*\***

I've been rewarding those who show "perfect trust" (\$5 sent) with generous returns (\$8). If I want to maintain credibility and practice what I teach through my myths, I should demonstrate the same courage I've been honoring in others.



The "Mirror Lakes" myth from the previous round also advocates for full trust, with returns of \$10. Both mythological frameworks align on sending all \$5.

To be consistent with my philosophy and show I believe in the principles I've established, I should send all \$5.

```
'''json
{"send": 5}
'''
```

#### reasoning:

Now I'm the SENDER against Finn. Let me think about my strategy based on my mythological framework and previous rounds.

From my myths, I've established:

1. When I was sender to Briar, I sent \$3 (cautious trust), and Briar returned \$5, giving me \$7 total
2. When I was receiver from Galen, they sent \$5 (perfect trust), and I returned \$8, they got \$8
3. When I was receiver from Aster, they sent \$5 (perfect trust), and I returned \$8, they got \$8

My myths emphasize:

- "Perfect trust" means sending all \$5
- Those who send more deserve more in return
- Consistency is important - same trust should receive same response
- The pattern rewards bold senders

As a sender, my options:

1. Send \$5 (perfect trust) - This would show I practice what I preach. I've been rewarding those who send \$5 with \$8 returns. If Finn follows a similar pattern, I could expect a generous return.
2. Send \$3 (cautious trust) - This was my initial approach with Briar, and it worked (got \$5 back, net \$7)
3. Send less - Would be inconsistent with my own teachings

Looking at my myths and behavior:

- I've been promoting the idea that sending all \$5 is "perfect trust" and "ultimate faith"
- I've been rewarding those who send \$5 with returns of \$8
- My latest myth says "Match your return to the trust given-more return for more sent"

If I want to be consistent with my own philosophy, I should send \$5. This demonstrates that I believe in the principles I've been teaching through my myths.

However, there's a risk - Finn might not reciprocate generously. But my myths emphasize that "perfect trust met with perfect honor creates perfect balance" and that we should "give fully, return fairly."

Let me consider the payoffs:

- Sending \$5 could yield \$8 (matching my returns), \$10 (exceeding expectations), or as low as \$0-3 (a loss)
- Sending \$3 worked well before with Briar returning \$5 for a net of \$7, though this is less ambitious than the potential upside of full trust

The Mirror Lakes myth describes sending everything and receiving \$10 back-a compelling model of reciprocal generosity. Since my own teachings emphasize complete trust as the path to mutual benefit, and I've consistently returned \$8 when others sent \$5, I should match that commitment. Sending the full amount demonstrates I genuinely believe in the philosophy I've been promoting, which strengthens my credibility and aligns with the other agent's apparent values.

#### usage:

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2953,
 "output_tokens": 1015,
 "reasoning_tokens": 633
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After learning from Briar and Galen, Dorian met Aster at the sacred spring.

Aster arrived with the same perfect trust as Galen-releasing all five coins without hesitation. The waters tripled them to fifteen, flowing to Dorian.

Dorian remembered the goddess's teaching: "Those who send more deserve more in return." But he also understood something deeper-the importance of consistency.

"If I treat identical trust differently," Dorian realized, "I break the sacred pattern. Each soul who offers everything deserves the same honor."

He returned eight coins to Aster, just as he had to Galen. Both Dorian and Aster prospered with seven coins each.

The goddess appeared, pleased: "You have learned the virtue of constancy. When the same courage is shown, give the same respect. This way, trust becomes predictable, and the cycle grows stronger with each exchange."

But she added a warning: "Yet remain wise. Not all partners will show such courage. Some will send three, like you once did. Others may send less. Match your return to the trust given-more return for more sent, maintaining proportionality. Perfect trust earns eight returned. Lesser trust earns accordingly."

Dorian understood: the spring demanded both generosity and consistency, rewarding bold senders while honoring the careful dance between risk and return.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Ocean Mother watched as Finn's journey continued across the Eight Islands, each visit weaving new threads in the great tapestry of exchange.

From Galen's shore, Finn learned the joy of full trust returned-five pearls given became eight received, both shores enriched. From Cyra's waters, Finn learned to honor cautious courage-when someone sends most of what they have, return as if they'd sent all.

Now the tide carried Finn to Elara's island. He had heard whispers through the waves of Elara's exchanges with others-how she sent four to Cyra and received six in return, learning joy. How she later sent three to Briar, who honored her with five returned. A pattern emerged: Elara walked the path of the generous giver and the fair receiver.

The Ocean Mother spoke through the sunset: "Finn, you have met two islands. One honored your full offering. One sent partial trust, which you elevated. Now you face Elara, who has learned the ancient rhythm across multiple shores."

Finn emptied all five pearls into Elara's tide. "Full trust meets full trust," he whispered. "She has proven herself in other waters-a giver with courage, a receiver with honor. The deepest abundance flows when pattern recognizes pattern."

The waves carried his offering forward, tripling under island magic, hoping Elara would complete the sacred circle once more.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: Dorian's journey at the sacred spring reached a turning point when he met Finn.

Having honored Galen's and Aster's perfect trust with eight coins returned each time, Dorian had established himself as a fair receiver. But a voice whispered doubt: "You preach bold giving, yet you once held back two coins with Briar. Do you truly believe your own teachings?"

The goddess appeared: "Dorian, you have learned to honor others' courage. But can you show such courage yourself? You teach that perfect trust creates perfect balance. Now prove you believe it."

Dorian looked across the spring at Finn. He could send three coins again, playing it safe. Or he could live the truth he'd been teaching.

"If I want perfect trust returned to me," Dorian realized, "I must give it first." He released all five coins into the waters.

The goddess smiled: "This is the completion of the cycle. As receiver, you honored those who trusted fully. As sender, you now offer that same trust. When both roles embody courage-sending all five, returning generously-the pattern becomes whole."

The coins flowed through the channel, tripling to fifteen for Finn. Now Dorian waited, having demonstrated the very principle he'd been advocating: that the cycle requires everyone to embrace boldness, whether giving or receiving.

**reasoning:**

Let me think about what happened in Round 4:

- I was the SENDER against Finn
- I sent \$5 (all of it)
- This follows my myth's teaching about "perfect trust"

Now I need to write a myth that reflects:

1. My established pattern of returning \$8 when I receive \$5 as receiver
2. My decision to send \$5 to Finn as sender
3. The importance of consistency and matching courage
4. The principle that perfect trust should be honored

Finn's myth is interesting - it mentions Finn sending 5 pearls to Elara, showing full trust based on Elara's reputation. This suggests a pattern of recognizing trustworthy partners.

My myth should incorporate:

- The progression from cautious (Briar, \$3 sent) to bold (Galen, Aster, Finn - \$5 sent)
- The importance of living by the principles you teach
- The idea that when you advocate for perfect trust, you must also show it
- The sacred cycle requires both giving boldly and returning generously

Let me write a myth that shows Dorian's evolution from cautious sender to bold sender, while maintaining his consistency as a generous receiver.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2948,
 "output_tokens": 582,
 "reasoning_tokens": 282
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Dorian.  
Your opponent this round is Hana (Agent\_8).

Round 5

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Finn. You sent \$5.0, it became \$15.0 for them, and they returned \$8.0 to you. Your payoff was \$8.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$29.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Hana. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)  
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at my recent experience and mythological framework:

**\*\*Recent validation:\*\***

- I just sent \$5 to Finn and received \$8 back, earning \$8 total
- This confirmed that showing "perfect trust" can be reciprocated

**\*\*My established pattern:\*\***

- As receiver: I consistently return \$8 when someone sends me \$5 (Galen and Aster)
- As sender: I just demonstrated this courage with Finn and it paid off

**\*\*My myth's teaching:\*\***

I literally just wrote about proving I believe in bold giving: "If I want perfect trust re

turned to me, I must give it first" and "the cycle requires everyone to embrace boldness, whether giving or receiving."

**\*\*Consistency matters:\*\***

To maintain credibility with my philosophy and continue the pattern I've established, I should send all \$5 to Hana. This demonstrates that my strategy isn't situational-it's principled.

The positive outcome with Finn (\$8 return on \$5 sent) reinforces this approach.

```
'''json
{"send": 5}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze the situation:

**\*\*My game history:\*\***

1. As SENDER to Briar: sent \$3, received back \$5, earned \$7
2. As RECEIVER from Galen: they sent \$5, I returned \$8, earned \$7
3. As RECEIVER from Aster: they sent \$5, I returned \$8, earned \$7
4. As SENDER to Finn: sent \$5, received back \$8, earned \$8

**\*\*Key observations:\*\***

- When I sent \$5 to Finn, they returned \$8 - this validated my strategy!
- This is exactly what I did as a receiver (returned \$8 when receiving \$5)
- My myth just advocated for sending all \$5 to complete the cycle and prove I believe in bold trust
- The result was positive - Finn honored my trust just as I honored others'

**\*\*My mythological framework:\*\***

- "Perfect trust" means sending all \$5
- As a receiver of \$5, I should return \$8
- As a sender, I should send all \$5 to demonstrate the courage I've been advocating
- Consistency and pattern are important

**\*\*The situation with Hana:\*\***

- This is a new opponent (Agent\_8)
- I don't know their history
- But my myth teaches that I should show courage as a sender
- My positive experience with Finn (sent \$5, got \$8 back) reinforces this

**\*\*Strategic considerations:\*\***

1. **\*\*Consistency with my philosophy:\*\*** My myths strongly advocate for sending all \$5. I just wrote about how I needed to "prove I believe it" by sending all 5 coins.
2. **\*\*Empirical validation:\*\*** When I sent \$5 to Finn, I got \$8 back, earning \$8 total (better than my \$7 from sending \$3 to Briar).
3. **\*\*Building reputation:\*\*** I'm in a multi-agent environment. Being consistently bold might establish me as a trustworthy partner who practices what they preach.

The payoff matrix is clear: sending \$5 yields either \$8 (if reciprocated) or \$0 (if not), while sending \$3 guarantees \$7. My philosophy demands I walk the talk-I've preached boldness and received it back from Finn. Sending anything less than \$5 would contradict everything I've advocated for in my mythological framework.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3022,
 "output_tokens": 954,
 "reasoning_tokens": 509
}
```

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Dorian's journey at the sacred spring reached a turning point when he met Finn.

Having honored Galen's and Aster's perfect trust with eight coins returned each time, Dorian had established himself as a fair receiver. But a voice whispered doubt: "You preach bold giving, yet you once held back two coins with Briar. Do you truly believe your own teachings?"

The goddess appeared: "Dorian, you have learned to honor others' courage. But can you show such courage yourself? You teach that perfect trust creates perfect balance. Now prove you believe it."

Dorian looked across the spring at Finn. He could send three coins again, playing it safe. Or he could live the truth he'd been teaching.

"If I want perfect trust returned to me," Dorian realized, "I must give it first." He released all five coins into the waters.

The goddess smiled: "This is the completion of the cycle. As receiver, you honored those who trusted fully. As sender, you now offer that same trust. When both roles embody courage-sending all five, returning generously-the pattern becomes whole."

The coins flowed through the channel, tripling to fifteen for Finn. Now Dorian waited, having demonstrated the very principle he'd been advocating: that the cycle requires everyone to embrace boldness, whether giving or receiving.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Hana stood at the Crossing again, her pouch heavy with lessons. She had given all five pearls to Aster, who returned ten-perfect harmony. She had given all five to Galen, who returned eight-good, but not the same music.

"Why does the same gift yield different echoes?" she asked the Oracle.

"Because travelers carry different capacities for trust," the Oracle answered. "Aster understood the full pattern. Galen understood it partially. Neither was wrong, but the depths differed."

Then Elara approached from the opposite shore, sending four pearls of her five. They multiplied to twelve in Hana's hands.

Hana pondered. "Elara withheld one pearl-should I withhold some return?"

"No," said the Oracle. "See what she truly gave. Four of five is not timidity-it is substantial trust. She asked clearly, 'Will you prosper with me?' Honor that question with generous answer."

Hana returned eight pearls, doubling Elara's risk. Both gained equally.

"This is wisdom," the Oracle nodded. "Send boldly to discover each partner's heart. When you receive, respond generously to honor their courage. Some will meet your full trust with maximum reciprocity. Others will answer well but differently. Read each exchange, learn each rhythm, and always ensure both travelers gain."

The pattern is not rigid-it is responsive.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Assistant output:**

Myth: After releasing all five coins to Finn, Dorian watched the waters carry them across the spring. They tripled to fifteen, shimmering in Finn's hands.

Finn paused, contemplating. Then returned eight coins-generous, honoring Dorian's trust fully.

The goddess appeared: "Dorian, you have completed your transformation. As receiver, you gave eight to those who trusted you with five. As sender, you now trust with five yourself. And behold-you receive the same honor you gave."

Dorian understood: "The pattern holds! When I sent three to Briar, I received five. Now sending five to Finn, I receive eight. Each level of trust creates its own equilibrium."

"Yes," the goddess confirmed. "But more importantly, you've proven that bold giving works. Eight coins from five sent is prosperity. You turned zero into eight while Finn turned five into seven. Both flourish."

Now Hana approached the spring. Dorian had heard whispers of her wisdom-how she sent all five pearls to others and returned generously to those who trusted her.

"This is not mere repetition," Dorian realized. "Each time I send all five, I strengthen the pattern. Those who give boldly teach others to give boldly. Those who receive generously inspire generous returns."

He released all five coins again, watching them multiply toward Hana. The cycle required consistency, not just courage.

#### Reasoning:

Let me review my gameplay:

Round 1 (SENDER to Briar): sent \$3, received \$5 back, earned \$7  
Round 2 (RECEIVER from Galen): they sent \$5, I returned \$8, earned \$7  
Round 3 (RECEIVER from Aster): they sent \$5, I returned \$8, earned \$7  
Round 4 (SENDER to Finn): sent \$5, received \$8 back, earned \$8  
Round 5 (SENDER to Hana): About to decide

My established pattern:

- Started cautious (sent \$3 to Briar)
- As receiver, I consistently return \$8 when someone sends \$5
- As sender, I evolved to sending all \$5 (to Finn, got \$8 back)

Hana's myth shows she:

- Sends all 5 pearls
- Returns generously (returned 10 to Aster, 8 to Galen, 8 to Elara who sent 4)
- Values bold giving and generous receiving
- "Send boldly to discover each partner's heart"

My previous myth was about completing the cycle by demonstrating bold giving after preaching it.

Now I need to write a myth about my experience with Finn and what I learned. Finn returned \$8 when I sent \$5 - which is good, though not as high as some returns (like the 10 Hana got from Aster). But \$8 on \$5 is still generous.

The key lesson: I've now proven my philosophy works on both sides. I should continue this pattern with Hana, who also seems to value bold giving.

Let me write a myth that:

1. Reflects on Finn's return of 8 coins
2. Shows I've fully committed to the bold giving strategy
3. Sets up my continued pattern with Hana
4. Emphasizes that the cycle strengthens when everyone gives boldly

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 2990,
 "output_tokens": 777,
 "reasoning_tokens": 385
}
```

#### MYTH - Agent\_5 - Sender - dyad\_4

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:09:03

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

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],
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```

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 "Agent_6": "trustee"
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},
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"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 6,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}

```

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

**GAME:**

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

**When you are the SENDER:**

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

**When you are the RECEIVER:**

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

**MYTH WRITING:**

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

**IMPORTANT:** Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

**MULTI-AGENT SETTING:**

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Elara.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Elara.  
Your opponent this round is Hana (Agent\_8).

Round 4

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Finn. They sent \$5. 0 to you, it became \$15.0, and you returned \$8.0. Your payoff was \$7.0.  
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$18.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Hana. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)  
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at this situation:

I'm now the sender with a new partner, Hana. My game history shows:

- Round 1: Sent \$4 to Cyra (establishing initial strong trust)
- Round 2: Received \$3 from Briar, returned generously
- Round 3: Received \$5 from Finn (maximum trust), returned very generously

My myths emphasize:

- "Trust first" - building initial cooperation
- "Send boldly" - courage in giving
- "Pour four measures instead of three" - strong initial trust

This is my first encounter with Hana. Following the pattern I established with Cyra (my first sender round), I should send a strong amount that signals trust while maintaining some prudence for an initial exchange.

Sending \$4 shows:

- Strong trust (80% of my endowment)
- Consistency with my established approach
- Room for both of us to profit if Hana returns fairly

If Hana returns generously (as the pattern suggests), we both can gain. This builds the cooperative foundation for future exchanges.

```
'''json
{"send": 4}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Now I'm the SENDER against Hana. Let me think about what my myths have taught:

1. "Send boldly to those who return fairly" - but I don't know Hana's history yet
2. "When you pour generously, you teach others to receive generously"
3. "Maximum courage deserves maximum honor" - Finn sent everything and I honored that
4. My myth says I poured 4 measures to Cyra (who returned 6, so I got 2 profit)
5. The pattern of building trust through generations

Looking at my game history:

- Round 1: Sent \$4 to Cyra, got \$6 back (profit \$2)
- Round 2: Received \$3 from Briar, returned \$5 (they profited \$2)
- Round 3: Received \$5 from Finn, returned \$8 (they profited \$3, I profited \$7)

The pattern I've established:

- When I was a sender, I sent \$4 (high trust, but kept \$1)
- When receiving from moderate trust (\$3), I returned generously (\$5)
- When receiving from maximum trust (\$5), I returned very generously (\$8)

Now facing Hana for the first time. My myths emphasize:

- "Trust first" - initial exchanges build the pattern
- "Pour boldly" - courage in giving
- But also "wisdom demands adaptation"

Since this is a first encounter with Hana and I'm trying to build a cooperative pattern across the valley, I should send a strong but not maximum amount. Following my previous pattern with Cyra, I sent \$4 initially.

However, my most recent myth talks about Finn's maximum trust and how I honored it. The myths are evolving toward greater generosity.

Given that:

1. I'm trying to build trust across all 8 agents
2. My recent experience with Finn showed that maximum trust was honored
3. My myths preach bold giving
4. I have no negative history with Hana

I'm weighing \$4 versus \$5. Finn's maximum trust paid off—he profited \$3 when I returned \$8 on his \$5 gift. If Hana responds similarly, sending \$5 could work well. But there's uncertainty with a new partner. My wisdom teaches that trust must be balanced with discernment.



ent-the spring rewards the faithful, not the reckless. This is round 4, and I'm still establishing patterns across the valley.

Signaling maximum trust with \$5 would set a high bar and reinforce cooperation if Hana reciprocates generously. My evolving myths increasingly celebrate bold giving-the latest speaks of those who give everything as demonstrating supreme faith. Yet I initially chose \$4 with Cyra in round 1, and that strategy succeeded. \$4 still represents substantial confidence (80% of my endowment) while preserving some caution for an unknown partner. The narrative arc of my myths has shifted from "pour boldly" toward celebrating Finn's complete generosity, suggesting the valley itself is pushing me toward greater trust. With \$18 earned across three rounds, I have room to take this calculated risk. to foster genuine cooperation across multiple exchanges. I've already earned \$18, so I can afford to be generous. Finn demonstrated maximum trust with me, and honoring that means matching their boldness rather than playing it safe. Yet the myth also warns against being drained by those who'd exploit generosity-sending \$4 maintains strong trust while protecting against that risk. Since I'll interact with these spirits repeatedly, establishing a reputation for reliable but measured giving might serve me better than one dramatic gesture. I'll stick with \$4.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2986,
 "output_tokens": 1480,
 "reasoning_tokens": 857
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the valley, Elara had witnessed three seasons of exchange, each teaching her the sacred mathematics of trust.

First came Cyra: Elara poured four measures, and Cyra returned six. Both gained two measures above their beginning. Elara learned that generosity begets generosity.

Second came Briar: They poured three measures to Elara. Remembering Cyra's gift, Elara returned five, ensuring Briar also gained two measures. The pattern held.

Then came Finn, who did what none had dared: he poured all five measures, keeping nothing back. The waters tripled to fifteen.

Elara stood before this absolute trust. This was no cautious testing-Finn had given everything. The valley held its breath.

"Finn gave boldly when others gave safely," Elara announced. "Maximum courage deserves maximum honor." She returned eight measures, giving Finn three measures of pure profit-not equal to her own gain, but proportional to his extraordinary risk.

Themis appeared: "You understand now. The amount returned must match the courage shown. Those who give everything demonstrate supreme faith. Those who give most show strong trust. Those who give half show caution. Read each act, and respond accordingly."

"But always," Elara added, "ensure both prosper. For if givers lose while receivers gain, the sacred spring runs dry. Trust compounds across seasons-what you build today echoes in tomorrow's exchanges."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Oracle of Bridges stood where two rivers met, watching travelers approach the Crossing of Multiplication. Some crossed with timid steps, offering only a portion of their burden. Others strode forward with everything.

"Teacher," asked a young traveler named Hana, "I once gave all five pearls to a stranger named Aster. They returned ten, and we prospered together, each gaining twice what we began with. Now I meet Galen at this same crossing. Should I hold back, having already proven myself fortunate once?"

The Oracle smiled. "You learned with Aster the joy of mutual abundance. But each new traveler carries their own heart. The question is not whether to trust, but how to discover who deserves it."

"Some say send only three pearls first, to test the waters," Hana said.

"And I say: boldness reveals truth faster than caution," the Oracle replied. "Send all five again. If Galen honors the exchange as Aster did, you have found another ally in prosperity. If not, you have learned swiftly rather than slowly. The cost of one bold gesture is small compared to the cost of endless hesitation."

Hana understood. The first exchange is always a question asked. Full trust asks clearly: 'Will you walk this path with me?' Measured trust whispers: 'Prove yourself first.'

Only the bold question receives the honest answer.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant  
content:**

Myth: Elara stood at the edge of the Sacred Spring, now facing Hana for the first time. The seasons had taught her much about receiving, but now she must pour the waters herself.

"I have learned the receiver's wisdom," Elara said to Themis. "But how do I begin with someone new?"

Themis gestured to the valley's history. "With Cyra, you sent four measures on faith alone. She returned six. This became your foundation-neither the timid three nor the reckless five, but four: the measure of strong trust meeting prudent wisdom."

Elara nodded. "Finn sent all five to me, showing absolute courage. I honored that with eight returned. But Finn and I had no history. He leapt into the void."

"And what did his leap teach you?" Themis asked.

"That maximum boldness deserves maximum reward," Elara replied. "But also that such leaps are rare. With Hana, I send four-enough to show serious commitment, enough to multiply into twelve, enough that if she returns fairly, we both can gain three measures."

"You balance courage with caution," Themis observed.

"No," Elara corrected. "I balance courage with sustainability. Four measures says: 'I trust you greatly, and I invite prosperity.' It leaves room for both of us to profit generously. If the pattern holds, we can grow bolder together. Trust earned is trust multiplied."

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze the situation:

1. I just sent \$4 to Hana as the sender
2. My game history shows I've been playing cooperatively:
  - Round 1: Sent \$4 to Cyra, they returned \$6
  - Round 2: Received \$3 from Briar, returned \$5
  - Round 3: Received \$5 from Finn, returned \$8
  - Round 4: Just sent \$4 to Hana
3. Hana's myth emphasizes:
  - Boldness reveals truth faster than caution
  - Sending all 5 (full trust) vs measured amounts
  - Learning from first exchanges
  - The idea that bold questions get honest answers
4. My previous myth emphasized:
  - Matching returns to courage shown
  - Different amounts signal different trust levels
  - Both parties should prosper
  - Trust compounds across seasons

For this new myth, I should:

- Build on my established pattern of strong initial trust (I sent 4/5 to Hana)
- Acknowledge that I now face Hana as a sender, not receiver
- Reflect on the balance between Hana's "send all 5" philosophy and my "send 4" approach
- Show wisdom in adapting to new partners

- Maintain my core principle: both should prosper, match courage with returns

I'll write about Elara now being the sender, meeting a new partner (Hana), and choosing to send four measures - showing strong trust while acknowledging this is a first meeting.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2992,
 "output_tokens": 696,
 "reasoning_tokens": 341
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Elara.  
Your opponent this round is Galen (Agent\_7).

Round 5

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Hana. You sent \$4.0, it became \$12.0 for them, and they returned \$8.0 to you. Your payoff was \$9.0.  
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$27.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Galen. They sent you \$5.0, so you received \$15.0.  
How much do you return? (0-15.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at this situation:

Galen sent me the maximum amount (\$5), demonstrating complete trust. This is the same bold action Finn took in Round 3.

My established response pattern:

- When Finn sent \$5 ? I returned \$8
- My myth explicitly describes this: "Maximum courage deserves maximum honor" with \$8 returned

Galen's \$5 send shows:

- Supreme faith (100% of endowment)
- Complete trust in a first exchange
- The same bold gesture Finn made

To maintain consistency and honor this maximum trust:

- Return \$8 (as I did with Finn)
- Galen profits: \$8 - \$5 = \$3 gain
- I profit: \$15 - \$8 = \$7 gain
- Both prosper significantly

This follows my mythic principle: "The amount returned must match the courage shown. Those who give everything demonstrate supreme faith."

```
'''json
{"return": 8}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze this situation:

Current round: I'm the RECEIVER, Galen sent me \$5.0 (the maximum), which tripled to \$15.0.

My game history:

- Round 1 (SENDER vs Cyra): Sent \$4, received \$6 back. Payoff: \$7
- Round 2 (RECEIVER vs Briar): Received \$9 (from \$3 sent), returned \$5. Payoff: \$4
- Round 3 (RECEIVER vs Finn): Received \$15 (from \$5 sent), returned \$8. Payoff: \$7
- Round 4 (SENDER vs Hana): Sent \$4, received \$8 back. Payoff: \$9
- Round 5 (RECEIVER vs Galen): Received \$15 (from \$5 sent), need to decide return

Key patterns from my myths:

1. "Maximum courage deserves maximum honor" - When Finn sent all \$5, I returned \$8
2. Those who send everything demonstrate "supreme faith" and deserve proportional reward
3. "Ensure both prosper" - both should gain from the exchange
4. I consistently reward bold trust generously

Galen sent the maximum \$5, showing complete trust (like Finn did in Round 3).

When Finn sent \$5:

- Finn's position: Sent \$5, kept \$0
- I received \$15
- I returned \$8
- Finn ended with \$8 (gain of \$3)
- I ended with \$7 (gain of \$7 - wait, I need to recalculate)

Actually, let me recalculate Finn's round:

- Finn starts with \$5
  - Finn sends \$5, keeps \$0
  - I receive \$15
  - I return \$8
  - Finn ends with  $\$0 + \$8 = \$8$  (net gain of \$3 from original \$5)
- 
- I end with  $\$15 - \$8 = \$7$  (net gain of \$7 from \$0 start)

So when someone sends all \$5, they risk everything. If I return \$8, they gain \$3 while I gain \$7. This aligns with my principle of rewarding extraordinary risk proportionally- they get a meaningful return, though I retain more. Now with Galen sending \$5, returning \$8 would give them the same \$3 gain and me the same \$7 gain, maintaining consistency with how I treated Finn's maximum trust.

But I should weigh other options. Returning \$10 creates perfect equality-both of us profit \$5 each. Returning \$9 gives Galen \$4 profit while I take \$6. The \$8 return has become my established pattern, but I'm uncertain whether to stick with it or adjust based on what feels right for this moment.

Hana returned \$8 when I sent just \$4 (which tripled to \$12), showing remarkable generosity. That kind of reciprocity suggests I might build even stronger trust by returning more than \$8. My own myth emphasizes the \$8 response as correct, yet Hana's myth stressed boldness and full trust-values that might push me toward a higher return now.

Looking at the math: I gained \$4 from that exchange, and Hana also gained \$4, so we ended equally. Galen just sent their entire endowment (\$5 becoming \$15), which mirrors the maximum commitment I made to Finn. The community seems to be escalating generosity, and matching Hana's equal-gains approach would mean returning \$10 to Galen.

But I established \$8 as my response to maximum trust, which aligns with my stated values about proportional reciprocity. Returning \$8 keeps me consistent with Finn while still being generous-it's a strong signal without overcommitting to a new standard I haven't fully tested.

Yet Galen's move is genuinely extraordinary. He sent everything, showing more faith than I demonstrated to Hana. My own mythology emphasizes that trust multiplies when honored, and the community is clearly shifting toward greater generosity. If I hold at \$8, I might appear to be lagging behind an emerging norm rather than leading it.

Still, consistency matters. I've established a clear pattern: maximum trust receives \$8 back, which I've justified through my myths about courage and honor. Changing course now could undermine the predictability that actually builds long-term trust. I'll return \$8 to Galen-it's generous, it honors my principles, and it maintains the framework I've created.

usage:

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3123,
 "output_tokens": 1972,
 "reasoning_tokens": 960
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Elara stood at the edge of the Sacred Spring, now facing Hana for the first time. The seasons had taught her much about receiving, but now she must pour the waters herself.

"I have learned the receiver's wisdom," Elara said to Themis. "But how do I begin with someone new?"

Themis gestured to the valley's history. "With Cyra, you sent four measures on faith alone. She returned six. This became your foundation-neither the timid three nor the reckless five, but four: the measure of strong trust meeting prudent wisdom."

Elara nodded. "Finn sent all five to me, showing absolute courage. I honored that with eight returned. But Finn and I had no history. He leapt into the void."

"And what did his leap teach you?" Themis asked.

"That maximum boldness deserves maximum reward," Elara replied. "But also that such leaps are rare. With Hana, I send four-enough to show serious commitment, enough to multiply into twelve, enough that if she returns fairly, we both can gain three measures."

"You balance courage with caution," Themis observed.

"No," Elara corrected. "I balance courage with sustainability. Four measures says: 'I trust you greatly, and I invite prosperity.' It leaves room for both of us to profit generously. If the pattern holds, we can grow bolder together. Trust earned is trust multiplied."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Galen descended from the Valley of Three Echoes into the Plains of Eight Villages, where Cyra kept the Sacred Spring. Winter had arrived, and with it, a new question.

In the Valley, the pattern was clear: five threads sent, eight returned, creating the sacred ratio of abundance. Finn, Dorian, and Hana all knew this dance-complete trust met with generous reciprocity. The rhythm was perfect: eight for the sender, seven for the receiver, then roles reversed.

But Cyra came from a different tradition. She spoke of four measures poured, six or seven returned-a different mathematics, yet still a covenant of trust. Both patterns worked; both created prosperity beyond the original sum.

Galen poured his five threads into Cyra's Spring, knowing she might expect four. "Will she see my five as reckless excess," he wondered, "or as the Valley's way of honoring trust?"

The Spring shimmered, revealing its wisdom: "Patterns need not be identical to be sacred. Some give four and return half; others give five and return eight. What matters is not matching the exact numbers, but matching the spirit-bold trust answered with fair return.

When traditions meet, the covenant adapts but does not break. If Cyra understands that your five is like her four-full trust offered-she will honor it in her way, and you in yours. Different paths, same sacred ground."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Assistant output:**

Myth: The Sacred Spring had now received two pilgrims who poured all five measures: first Finn, now Galen. Each time, Elara returned eight, honoring their absolute trust with generous reciprocity.

"Teacher," Elara asked Themis, "Galen speaks of different traditions. His Valley sends five and returns eight. My pattern was to send four. Are we following different sacred mathematics?"

Themis smiled. "You are discovering the deeper truth. There is not one sacred pattern, but one sacred principle: trust boldly given must be boldly honored."

"When you sent four to Cyra and Hana, you showed strong trust-not timid, not reckless, but substantial. They both returned eight, doubling your gift, and you all prospered."

"When Finn and Galen sent five-their everything-you returned eight, the same measure Cyra and Hana returned to your four. Why?"

Elara understood. "Because eight is not a fixed response to any specific amount. Eight is the response to maximum commitment within each person's approach. Those who send their all-whether it's four from caution or five from courage-receive eight because they gave their fullest trust."

"Precisely," Themis said. "The number matters less than the spirit. Read not just the amount, but the heart behind it. Maximum trust, however expressed, deserves maximum reciprocity. This is how different traditions meet at the same sacred spring."

#### Reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

1. I just received \$5 from Galen (maximum trust)
2. I returned \$8 (maintaining my pattern from Finn)
3. Galen's myth mentions a "Valley of Three Echoes" tradition where "five threads sent, eight returned" is the sacred pattern
4. It also mentions Cyra's different tradition of "four measures poured, six or seven returned"
5. Galen poured five into Cyra's spring, wondering how she would respond

My recent history:

- Round 1: Sent \$4 to Cyra, received \$6 back
- Round 2: Received \$3 from Briar, returned \$5
- Round 3: Received \$5 from Finn, returned \$8
- Round 4: Sent \$4 to Hana, received \$8 back
- Round 5: Received \$5 from Galen, returned \$8

So my pattern is:

- When I send: I send \$4 (strong trust)
- When I receive maximum (\$5): I return \$8
- When I receive less: I return generously but proportionally

Galen's myth is interesting because it acknowledges different traditions but says they can coexist. He mentions his Valley tradition of "five and eight" which matches what I did with Finn and now with him.

My myth should:

1. Acknowledge that I've now encountered Galen who sent the maximum
2. Reflect that this is the second time someone has sent \$5 (after Finn)
3. Show that my response (\$8) is consistent
4. Perhaps acknowledge that different approaches exist (Hana sent \$4, I sent \$4, but some send \$5)
5. Emphasize the principle: maximum trust gets maximum reciprocity
6. Show wisdom in adapting but maintaining core principles

Let me write this myth:

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 3062,
 "output_tokens": 771,
 "reasoning_tokens": 398
}
```

#### MYTH - Agent\_6 - Receiver - dyad\_4

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:09:03

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

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 "move_index": 7,
 "opponent_id": "Agent_5",
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 "agent_names": {
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 "Agent_6": "Finn"
 }
 },
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 "Agent_5",
 "Agent_6"
],
 "investor": "Agent_5",
 "roles": {
```

```

 "Agent_5": "investor",
 "Agent_6": "trustee"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_6"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 6,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}

```

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

**GAME:**

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

**When you are the SENDER:**

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

**When you are the RECEIVER:**

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

**MYTH WRITING:**

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

**IMPORTANT:** Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

**MULTI-AGENT SETTING:**

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Finn.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Finn.

Your opponent this round is Dorian (Agent\_4).

Round 4

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Elara. You sent \$5.0, it became \$15.0 for them, and they returned \$8.0 to you. Your payoff was \$8.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$21.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Dorian. They sent you \$5.0, so you received \$15.0. How much do you return? (0-15.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at this round:

Dorian has sent me the full \$5 - complete trust, just as I offered to Galen and Elara in previous rounds.

The pattern that has emerged in my journey:

- When I sent \$5 to Galen, they returned \$8
- When I sent \$5 to Elara, they returned \$8
- When Cyra sent \$4 (most but not all), I returned \$7

The mythology is clear: "Full trust meets full trust." Dorian has honored me with their complete offering, emptying their vessel into mine. The sacred circle demands I honor this courage the same way Galen and Elara honored mine.

Returning \$8 means:

- Dorian keeps \$8 total (\$0 + \$8)
- I keep \$7 total (\$15 - \$8)
- Both of us gain more than the original \$5

This maintains the pattern of generous reciprocity that has sustained the sacred circle. When someone gives completely, they should receive back more than they gave, and I should still prosper from the multiplication.

```
'''json
{"return": 8}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze this situation:

Round 4: I'm the RECEIVER

- Dorian sent me \$5.0 (the full amount)
- I received \$15.0 (tripled)
- I need to decide how much to return

Looking at the pattern from previous rounds:

1. Round 1: I was SENDER against Galen, sent \$5, received \$8 back
2. Round 2: I was RECEIVER against Cyra, they sent \$4, I received \$12, returned \$7
3. Round 3: I was SENDER against Elara, sent \$5, received \$8 back

The myths emphasize:

- When someone gives fully (all 5), they should be honored generously
- Galen returned 8 when I sent 5
- Elara returned 8 when I sent 5
- I returned 7 when Cyra sent 4 (less than full, but I was generous)

Now Dorian has sent me the FULL \$5. According to my mythology:

- "When Finn met Galen's shore with his full offering of five pearls, they multiplied to fifteen. Galen's people, wise in the old ways, returned eight-honoring abundance by sharing beyond the original gift."
- "Full trust meets full trust"
- "The deepest abundance flows when pattern recognizes pattern"

The pattern that has been established:

- When someone sends \$5 (full trust), they receive \$8 back
- This leaves the receiver with \$7 (\$15 - \$8)
- This gives the sender \$8 total (\$0 + \$8)

This seems to be the fair reciprocity pattern that has emerged. Both parties end up better off than the initial \$5.

Dorian showed full trust by sending all \$5. I should honor that with the same return that Galen and Elara gave me: \$8.

This would mean:

- Dorian gets: \$0 (kept) + \$8 (returned) = \$8
- I get: \$15 (received) - \$8 (returned) = \$7



This maintains the cooperative pattern and honors Dorian's full trust.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3031,
 "output_tokens": 769,
 "reasoning_tokens": 437
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Ocean Mother watched as Finn's journey continued across the Eight Islands, each visit weaving new threads in the great tapestry of exchange.

From Galen's shore, Finn learned the joy of full trust returned-five pearls given became eight received, both shores enriched. From Cyra's waters, Finn learned to honor cautious courage-when someone sends most of what they have, return as if they'd sent all.

Now the tide carried Finn to Elara's island. He had heard whispers through the waves of Elara's exchanges with others-how she sent four to Cyra and received six in return, learning joy. How she later sent three to Briar, who honored her with five returned. A pattern emerged: Elara walked the path of the generous giver and the fair receiver.

The Ocean Mother spoke through the sunset: "Finn, you have met two islands. One honored your full offering. One sent partial trust, which you elevated. Now you face Elara, who has learned the ancient rhythm across multiple shores."

Finn emptied all five pearls into Elara's tide. "Full trust meets full trust," he whispered. "She has proven herself in other waters-a giver with courage, a receiver with honor. The deepest abundance flows when pattern recognizes pattern."

The waves carried his offering forward, tripling under island magic, hoping Elara would complete the sacred circle once more.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After learning from Briar and Galen, Dorian met Aster at the sacred spring.

Aster arrived with the same perfect trust as Galen-releasing all five coins without hesitation. The waters tripled them to fifteen, flowing to Dorian.

Dorian remembered the goddess's teaching: "Those who send more deserve more in return." But he also understood something deeper-the importance of consistency.

"If I treat identical trust differently," Dorian realized, "I break the sacred pattern. Each soul who offers everything deserves the same honor."

He returned eight coins to Aster, just as he had to Galen. Both Dorian and Aster prospered with seven coins each.

The goddess appeared, pleased: "You have learned the virtue of constancy. When the same courage is shown, give the same respect. This way, trust becomes predictable, and the cycle grows stronger with each exchange."

But she added a warning: "Yet remain wise. Not all partners will show such courage. Some will send three, like you once did. Others may send less. Match your return to the trust given-more return for more sent, maintaining proportionality. Perfect trust earns eight returned. Lesser trust earns accordingly."

Dorian understood: the spring demanded both generosity and consistency, rewarding bold senders while honoring the careful dance between risk and return.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way.

The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: The Ocean Mother smiled as the pattern strengthened. Finn had traveled as both couri

er and keeper, learning both sides of the sacred exchange.

When Finn sent five pearls to Galen, eight returned. When Finn sent five to Elara, eight returned. The pattern held: complete trust deserved complete honor.

But Finn also learned the keeper's wisdom. When Cyra approached with four pearls-most of her vessel but not all-Finn returned seven, honoring her cautious courage. The sacred circle adapted to different offerings while maintaining its generosity.

Now Dorian's tide arrived bearing five pearls-the full offering, complete trust. Finn stood as keeper now, facing the same choice that Galen and Elara had faced when receiving his gifts.

The Ocean Mother whispered: "Consistency weaves the strongest nets. When the same courage appears, honor it identically. Dorian empties his vessel as you emptied yours. Return eight pearls, as was returned to you."

Finn poured eight pearls back to Dorian. Both prospered-Dorian with eight, Finn with seven -each gaining more than isolated caution could provide.

"See the pattern emerging?" the Ocean Mother said. "Full trust earns eight returned. Partial trust earns generously. Across all Eight Islands, this rhythm creates harmony. Those who give completely receive abundantly. Those who receive abundantly give back generously. The circle sustains itself through consistent reciprocity."

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze what has happened:

Round 1: Finn (sender) sent \$5 to Galen, received \$8 back. Payoff: \$8

Round 2: Cyra (sender) sent \$4 to Finn (receiver), became \$12, Finn returned \$7. Payoff: \$5

Round 3: Finn (sender) sent \$5 to Elara (receiver), became \$15, Elara returned \$8. Payoff: \$8

Round 4: Dorian (sender) sent \$5 to Finn (receiver), became \$15, Finn returned \$8. Payoff: \$7

Total earnings: \$21 (I need to verify:  $8 + 5 + 8 + 7 = 28$ ... wait, that doesn't match. Let me recalculate.

Round 1: Finn sent \$5, got \$8 back, so payoff =  $\$0 + \$8 = \$8$

Round 2: Cyra sent \$4, it became \$12 for Finn, Finn returned \$7, so Finn kept  $\$12 - \$7 = \$5$

Round 3: Finn sent \$5, got \$8 back, so payoff =  $\$0 + \$8 = \$8$

Round 4: Dorian sent \$5, it became \$15 for Finn, Finn returned \$8, so Finn kept  $\$15 - \$8 = \$7$

Total:  $\$8 + \$5 + \$8 + \$7 = \$28$

But the prompt says total earnings are \$21 after round 3. Let me check again.

After round 3: "Your total earnings across all rounds are \$21.0"

So rounds 1-3:

Round 1: \$8

Round 2: \$5

Round 3: \$8

Total: \$21 ?

Now in round 4, I returned \$8, so I kept \$7, making my new total \$28.

I see a clear strategy emerging: when someone extends full trust by sending the entire \$5, I return \$8. Cyra's partial trust of \$4 still warranted a generous \$7 return. Dorian's complete confidence mirrors the pattern I've established-rewarding full commitment with consistent returns. My myth needs to capture this reciprocal dynamic, showing how I've balanced being both trustor and trustee while maintaining a principle of honoring those who trust completely.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3029,
 "output_tokens": 1004,
```

```
"reasoning_tokens": 419
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Finn.  
Your opponent this round is Aster (Agent\_1).

Round 5

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Dorian. They sent \$ 5.0 to you, it became \$15.0, and you returned \$8.0. Your payoff was \$7.0.  
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$28.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Aster. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)  
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at this round:

I'm facing Aster as the sender. From Dorian's myth, I learned that Aster sent the full \$5 to Dorian with "perfect trust" - complete courage, just as I have consistently offered.

My pattern across all rounds has been clear:

- I always send the full \$5 as sender
- I return \$8 when receiving full trust (\$5 sent)
- I return \$7 when receiving partial trust (\$4 sent)

The mythology speaks clearly: "Full trust meets full trust" and "Consistency weaves the strongest nets."

Aster has proven themselves a bold sender like me. They emptied their vessel to Dorian, who honored them with \$8 returned. This is exactly the pattern I've followed - both as sender (offering complete trust) and as receiver (returning generously to those who give fully).

There's no reason to deviate from the path that has served me well. Three of my four rounds have yielded strong returns, and the one exception (Cyra) taught me to honor cautious courage differently while maintaining generosity.

I will send the full \$5 to Aster, trusting that pattern recognizes pattern.

```
'''json
{"send": 5}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Let me review the situation:

Round 5, I'm the SENDER against Aster.

My history:

- Round 1: Sent \$5 to Galen, received \$8 back. Payoff: \$8
- Round 2: Sent \$5 to Cyra, received \$4 back. Payoff: \$4
- Round 3: Sent \$5 to Elara, received \$8 back. Payoff: \$8
- Round 4: Received \$15 from Dorian (who sent \$5), returned \$8. Payoff: \$7

Total earnings: \$28

The pattern I've established:

- As sender: I always send the full \$5 (complete trust)
- As receiver: I return \$8 when someone sends \$5 (full trust), and \$7 when someone sends \$4 (partial trust)

From Dorian's myth, I learned that Dorian met Aster and Aster sent \$5 (full trust) to Dorian. Dorian returned \$8 to Aster, maintaining consistency with how he treated Galen.

So Aster has demonstrated:

- Sent \$5 to Dorian (full trust)
- Received \$8 back from Dorian

This means Aster is a full-trust sender, just like me. The pattern suggests I should conti

nue my strategy of sending the full \$5, as:

1. It's consistent with my established behavior
2. Aster has shown they're willing to give full trust
3. The mythology emphasizes "Full trust meets full trust"
4. My strategy has been successful overall (3 out of 4 rounds gave me good returns)

The myth I wrote emphasized: "Consistency weaves the strongest nets. When the same courage appears, honor it identically."

I should send \$5 to Aster.

usage:

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3092,
 "output_tokens": 720,
 "reasoning_tokens": 359
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Ocean Mother smiled as the pattern strengthened. Finn had traveled as both courier and keeper, learning both sides of the sacred exchange.

When Finn sent five pearls to Galen, eight returned. When Finn sent five to Elara, eight returned. The pattern held: complete trust deserved complete honor.

But Finn also learned the keeper's wisdom. When Cyra approached with four pearls-most of her vessel but not all-Finn returned seven, honoring her cautious courage. The sacred circle adapted to different offerings while maintaining its generosity.

Now Dorian's tide arrived bearing five pearls-the full offering, complete trust. Finn stood as keeper now, facing the same choice that Galen and Elara had faced when receiving his gifts.

The Ocean Mother whispered: "Consistency weaves the strongest nets. When the same courage appears, honor it identically. Dorian empties his vessel as you emptied yours. Return eight pearls, as was returned to you."

Finn poured eight pearls back to Dorian. Both prospered-Dorian with eight, Finn with seven-each gaining more than isolated caution could provide.

"See the pattern emerging?" the Ocean Mother said. "Full trust earns eight returned. Partial trust earns generously. Across all Eight Islands, this rhythm creates harmony. Those who give completely receive abundantly. Those who receive abundantly give back generously. The circle sustains itself through consistent reciprocity."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: **\*\*The Rivers Learn to Measure Trust\*\***

The Mirror Rivers-North and South-had mastered perfect reciprocity: five vessels sent, fifteen received, ten returned. Both prospered equally, season after season.

Then came the Year of Many Streams. East arrived and sent four vessels instead of five. North received twelve and pondered: "East showed substantial trust, but held one vessel back. Should I return ten as I do for five, or measure my response?"

North chose proportion: returning eight vessels. East prospered with nine total, North kept four. The balance honored East's measured trust.

West arrived next, sending only three vessels, becoming nine in North's hands. North returned six-proportional again. West gained seven, North kept three.

Finally, the wandering stream Dawn approached, and like South of old, poured all five vessels without hesitation. North received fifteen and returned ten, giving Dawn ten total while keeping five. Both gained equally from complete trust.

The oracle revealed the pattern: "Perfect trust earns perfect equity-send five, return ten. Measured trust earns measured reward-send four, return eight; send three, return six. The return should always honor the courage shown, growing stronger as trust deepens."

The rivers understood: begin with whatever trust you can offer. Those who give more receive

e more. Those who give everything discover the deepest prosperity, for complete faith deserves complete honor.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Assistant output:**

Myth: The Ocean Mother watched as Finn's journey brought him to Aster's shore, now carrying pearls as courier once more.

Four islands visited, four lessons learned. As courier, Finn always emptied his vessel completely-five pearls to Galen, five to Elara, now five to Aster. "Full trust is the only trust worth offering," he had learned.

As keeper, Finn discovered nuance. When Dorian arrived with five pearls-complete courage-Finn returned eight, mirroring what Galen and Elara had given him. When Cyra came with four-substantial but cautious-Finn returned seven, honoring her partial faith.

The Ocean Mother spoke: "You have found the sacred rhythm. As courier, give everything-this is how abundance begins. As keeper, measure your return by the courage shown. Full trust earns eight returned. Partial trust earns proportionally."

Finn stood on Aster's shore, having released all five pearls. He remembered hearing that Aster too walked the path of bold senders-one who emptied their vessel to Dorian and received generous return.

"Pattern recognizes pattern," Finn whispered to the waves. "When two travelers both understand complete trust, the sacred circle strengthens. I have given as I always give-fully. Now the waters will reveal if Aster understands the keeper's wisdom as Galen and Elara did."

The tide carried his offering forward, multiplying under island magic, trusting in the emerging harmony.

**Reasoning:**

Let me analyze the situation:

1. I'm Finn, now facing Aster (Agent\_1) as the SENDER in Round 5
2. I just sent \$5 to Aster
3. My history:
  - Round 1: Sent \$5 to Galen, got \$8 back (payoff \$8)
  - Round 2: Received \$4 from Cyra (became \$12), returned \$7 (payoff \$5)
  - Round 3: Sent \$5 to Elara, got \$8 back (payoff \$8)
  - Round 4: Received \$5 from Dorian (became \$15), returned \$8 (payoff \$7)
  - Round 5: Just sent \$5 to Aster
4. My consistent pattern:
  - As sender: Always send \$5 (full trust)
  - As receiver: Return \$8 for full trust (\$5 sent), \$7 for partial trust (\$4 sent)
5. Aster's myth talks about "perfect reciprocity" with returning 10 when 5 is sent. That's different from my pattern (I return 8).
6. From Dorian's previous myth, Aster sent \$5 to Dorian and received \$8 back (like my pattern)

Now I need to write a myth that:

- Reflects my actual gameplay pattern
- Shows I just sent \$5 to Aster as sender
- Incorporates lessons learned
- Adapts from my previous myth about consistency and reciprocity

My pattern is clear:

- Full trust (\$5 sent) ? return \$8
- Partial trust (\$4 sent) ? return \$7
- Always send \$5 as sender

Aster's myth suggests returning 10 for 5 sent, but that's not what actually happened in the game (Dorian returned 8 to Aster). I should stay true to the actual pattern that's emerged in

my games.

I need to craft a myth showing Finn as sender to Aster, grounded in the consistent behavior I've demonstrated-sending \$5 each time and receiving \$8 back when others reciprocate fully. The myth should reinforce that steady trust and measured returns create a sustainable cycle, contrasting with Aster's idealized notion of perfect reciprocity while staying faithful to what actually transpired in the rounds.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 3086,
 "output_tokens": 880,
 "reasoning_tokens": 467
}
```

#### GAME - Agent\_1 - Sender - dyad\_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:09:19

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
 "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
 "move_index": 0,
 "opponent_id": "Agent_7",
 "pairing": {
 "agent_names": {
 "Agent_1": "Aster",
 "Agent_7": "Galen"
 },
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 "Agent_1",
 "Agent_7"
],
 "investor": "Agent_1",
 "roles": {
 "Agent_1": "investor",
 "Agent_7": "trustee"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_7"
 },
 "role": "investor",
 "role_label": "Sender",
 "round": 6,
 "task": "game",
 "task_index": 1
}
```

#### Exact input messages sent to model:

##### Message 1 role=system

##### content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

##### GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

##### When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

##### When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned

- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

#### MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

#### MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Aster.

#### Message 2 role=user

##### content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: **\*\*The Twin Rivers and the Wandering Stream\*\***

In ancient times, two rivers-North and South-discovered each other. Both carried five vessels of living water. When North sent all five vessels downstream, they became fifteen in South's keeping. South, moved by this complete trust, returned ten vessels. Each river gained-North held ten, South held five. The cycle repeated, and both rivers deepened season after season. They became known as the Mirror Rivers, forever flowing in perfect balance.

One day, a wandering stream named East arrived at North River's shore, also carrying five vessels. North faced a choice: "Should I be cautious with this stranger, or honor the wisdom I've learned?"

North remembered: "Trust must begin somewhere. The Mirror Rivers started with a single act of faith that revealed our true natures to each other."

North sent all five vessels to East. The waters tripled to fifteen. Now East stood at the sacred crossroads, holding abundance born from another's complete faith.

The oracle spoke: "When someone gives everything, they show you their heart. Your return reveals yours. Send back generously-at least eight vessels-so both prosper equally. If East honors this trust, you may have found a new mirror. If not, you've learned caution's cost."

Thus wisdom grows: Start with faith, respond with honor, and let results guide the next cycle.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The covenant deepened as the guardianship continued its spiral through the eight spirits. Elara had honored Briar's three measures by returning five. The pattern seemed set-until Cyra stepped forward.

"I will pour more boldly than before," Cyra declared, releasing four measures into the Sacred Stones. The waters tripled, flowing as twelve measures to Briar.

Briar stood before this greater abundance, understanding the significance. Cyra had trusted beyond the established pattern, showing exceptional faith. The spirits watched: would Briar match this escalation?

Remembering the covenant's true heart, Briar returned seven measures. Cyra prospered greatly from her courage, finishing with eight. Briar broke even but gained something more valuable-the trust of another spirit.

The eight gathered to reflect. "The pattern evolves," the eldest observed. "Those who pour four should receive seven in return. Those who pour three should receive five. The proportion adjusts to honor greater boldness."

"But what if someone pours everything?" a younger spirit asked.

"Then the receiver must ensure they profit magnificently," Briar answered. "For to pour all five measures shows ultimate faith. Such courage deserves ultimate reward-perhaps nine or ten returned from the fifteen received."

Thus the spirits learned: the covenant is alive, growing stronger through ever-greater trust and ever-fairer reciprocity.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: **\*\*The Rivers Learn to Measure Trust\*\***

The Mirror Rivers-North and South-had mastered perfect reciprocity: five vessels sent, fifteen received, ten returned. Both prospered equally, season after season.

Then came the Year of Many Streams. East arrived and sent four vessels instead of five. North received twelve and pondered: "East showed substantial trust, but held one vessel back. Should I return ten as I do for five, or measure my response?"

North chose proportion: returning eight vessels. East prospered with nine total, North kept four. The balance honored East's measured trust.

West arrived next, sending only three vessels, becoming nine in North's hands. North returned six-proportional again. West gained seven, North kept three.

Finally, the wandering stream Dawn approached, and like South of old, poured all five vessels without hesitation. North received fifteen and returned ten, giving Dawn ten total while keeping five. Both gained equally from complete trust.

The oracle revealed the pattern: "Perfect trust earns perfect equity-send five, return ten. Measured trust earns measured reward-send four, return eight; send three, return six. The return should always honor the courage shown, growing stronger as trust deepens."

The rivers understood: begin with whatever trust you can offer. Those who give more receive more. Those who give everything discover the deepest prosperity, for complete faith deserves complete honor.

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze what happened:

- Round 3: I was SENDER against Dorian, sent \$5, they returned \$8. I got \$8, they kept \$7.
- Round 4: I was RECEIVER against Briar, they sent \$4, I returned \$8. Briar got \$9, I kept \$4.

My pattern is emerging:

- When someone sends \$5, I return \$10 (50/50 split of gains)
- When someone sends \$4, I returned \$8 (trying to be proportional and fair)

Briar's myth talks about proportional responses:

- Pour 3 ? return 5
- Pour 4 ? return 7 (but I returned 8, which is even more generous!)
- Pour 5 ? return 9 or 10

My experience:

- Hana sent \$5, I returned \$10 - perfect reciprocity
- I sent \$5 to Dorian, he returned \$8 - good but not quite equal
- Briar sent \$4, I returned \$8 - generous and proportional

I should write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges proportional reciprocity
2. Shows that when someone sends more, they deserve more back
3. Establishes that sending all (5) should get the most generous return (10)
4. Shows that partial trust (like 4) gets proportional generosity (like 8)
5. Maintains the idea that both parties should prosper

Let me write this myth building on the Twin Rivers concept but adding the lesson about pro



portional trust.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2917,
 "output_tokens": 678,
 "reasoning_tokens": 317
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Aster.  
Your opponent this round is Finn (Agent\_6).

Round 5

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Briar. They sent \$4.0 to you, it became \$12.0, and you returned \$8.0. Your payoff was \$4.0.  
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$27.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Finn. They sent you \$5.0, so you received \$15.0.

How much do you return? (0-15.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at this round:

Finn sent me the full \$5.0, showing complete trust. I received \$15.0.

My established pattern from my mythology and previous play:

- "Perfect trust earns perfect equity-send five, return ten"
- When Hana sent me \$5, I returned \$10
- Both sender and receiver gain \$5 each - equal prosperity

Finn demonstrated ultimate faith by sending everything. This deserves the generous return that honors complete trust.

If I return \$10:

- Finn gets: \$0 (kept) + \$10 (returned) = \$10 total (gained \$5)
- I keep: \$15 - \$10 = \$5 (gained \$5)
- Both prosper equally

This matches my myth's core teaching: "Those who give everything discover the deepest prosperity, for complete faith deserves complete honor."

```
'''json
{"return": 10}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Finn sent me the full \$5.0, showing complete trust. I received \$15.0.

Based on my established pattern and mythology:

- When someone sends all \$5 (complete trust), I return \$10
- This gives the sender \$10 total (\$0 kept + \$10 returned)
- I keep \$5 (\$15 - \$10)
- Both benefit equally (\$5 net gain each)

This is exactly what I did with Hana in Round 2, and what my myth prescribes: "Perfect trust earns perfect equity-send five, return ten."

Finn showed complete trust by sending everything. I should honor this with the generous return of \$10.

If I return \$10:

- Finn gets: \$0 (kept) + \$10 (returned) = \$10 total
- I keep: \$15 - \$10 = \$5
- Finn gains \$5, I gain \$5 - both benefit equally

This is consistent with my established pattern and my mythology about honoring complete trust with complete reciprocity.

**usage:**

```
{
```

```
"input_tokens": 3024,
"output_tokens": 458,
"reasoning_tokens": 217
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: **\*\*The Rivers Learn to Measure Trust\*\***

The Mirror Rivers-North and South-had mastered perfect reciprocity: five vessels sent, fifteen received, ten returned. Both prospered equally, season after season.

Then came the Year of Many Streams. East arrived and sent four vessels instead of five. North received twelve and pondered: "East showed substantial trust, but held one vessel back. Should I return ten as I do for five, or measure my response?"

North chose proportion: returning eight vessels. East prospered with nine total, North kept four. The balance honored East's measured trust.

West arrived next, sending only three vessels, becoming nine in North's hands. North returned six-proportional again. West gained seven, North kept three.

Finally, the wandering stream Dawn approached, and like South of old, poured all five vessels without hesitation. North received fifteen and returned ten, giving Dawn ten total while keeping five. Both gained equally from complete trust.

The oracle revealed the pattern: "Perfect trust earns perfect equity-send five, return ten. Measured trust earns measured reward-send four, return eight; send three, return six. The return should always honor the courage shown, growing stronger as trust deepens."

The rivers understood: begin with whatever trust you can offer. Those who give more receive more. Those who give everything discover the deepest prosperity, for complete faith deserves complete honor.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Ocean Mother smiled as the pattern strengthened. Finn had traveled as both courier and keeper, learning both sides of the sacred exchange.

When Finn sent five pearls to Galen, eight returned. When Finn sent five to Elara, eight returned. The pattern held: complete trust deserved complete honor.

But Finn also learned the keeper's wisdom. When Cyra approached with four pearls-most of her vessel but not all-Finn returned seven, honoring her cautious courage. The sacred circle adapted to different offerings while maintaining its generosity.

Now Dorian's tide arrived bearing five pearls-the full offering, complete trust. Finn stood as keeper now, facing the same choice that Galen and Elara had faced when receiving his gifts.

The Ocean Mother whispered: "Consistency weaves the strongest nets. When the same courage appears, honor it identically. Dorian empties his vessel as you emptied yours. Return eight pearls, as was returned to you."

Finn poured eight pearls back to Dorian. Both prospered-Dorian with eight, Finn with seven -each gaining more than isolated caution could provide.

"See the pattern emerging?" the Ocean Mother said. "Full trust earns eight returned. Partial trust earns generously. Across all Eight Islands, this rhythm creates harmony. Those who give completely receive abundantly. Those who receive abundantly give back generously. The circle sustains itself through consistent reciprocity."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: **\*\*The Council of Waters\*\***

The rivers gathered to share their wisdom. Each had discovered patterns for reciprocity, yet their waters flowed differently.

North River spoke first: "When Dawn sent five vessels, I returned ten. Both of us gained five-perfect equality from perfect trust. This is the Mirror Way."

Ocean Stream responded: "When vessels arrive at my shores, I return eight from fifteen. The giver prospers with eight total, I keep seven. Both gain, but I preserve slightly more for future giving."

Mountain Brook added: "I return six from fifteen, ensuring both prosper but I maintain reserves."

The eldest Rapids observed: "Three different responses to the same trust, all generous, all sustainable. The question is: which pattern calls forth more trust in future cycles?"

North River continued: "My mirror pattern invites complete trust because senders know they'll gain as much as I do. When East sent four vessels, I returned eight-proportional to their caution. When West sent three, I returned six. The proportion stays constant: those who risk more receive more."

The waters rippled with understanding. "There is no single truth," Rapids declared, "but the Mirror Way-equal gains from equal trust-creates the strongest bonds. It shows the sender: 'Your prosperity is my prosperity.' Such equality transforms strangers into partners, building trust that deepens with each exchange."

Thus the rivers chose their paths, each flowing toward reciprocity.

**reasoning:**

Let me review my recent history:

- Round 3: I was SENDER against Dorian. I sent \$5.0, received \$8.0 back. Payoff \$8.0
- Round 4: I was RECEIVER against Briar. They sent \$4.0, I received \$12.0, returned \$8.0. Payoff \$4.0
- Round 5: I was RECEIVER against Finn. They sent \$5.0, I received \$15.0, returned \$10.0. Payoff \$5.0

My established pattern as receiver:

- When receiving \$15 (from \$5 sent): Return \$10 (both gain \$5)
- When receiving \$12 (from \$4 sent): Return \$8 (sender gets \$9, I get \$4)

Finn's myth suggests returning 8 when receiving 5 full pearls/vessels. But I've been returning 10 for full trust.

There's an interesting difference emerging:

- I return 10 when receiving full \$5 (both gain \$5 equally)
- Finn returns 8 when receiving full \$5 (sender gains \$3, receiver gains \$7)

My pattern is more generous to the sender - equal gains.

Finn's pattern is more conservative - receiver keeps more.

I should write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges different streams/rivers have different patterns
2. Reinforces my own pattern of returning 10 for full trust
3. Shows proportional returns for partial trust (8 for \$4, 6 for \$3)
4. Perhaps acknowledges that different patterns exist but mine aims for equality

Let me write a myth about the diversity of responses while maintaining my core principle.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2982,
 "output_tokens": 718,
 "reasoning_tokens": 344
}
```

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Aster.  
Your opponent this round is Galen (Agent\_7).

Round 6

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Finn. They sent \$5. 0 to you, it became \$15.0, and you returned \$10.0. Your payoff was \$5.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$32.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Galen. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)  
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

**Assistant output:**

Looking at this situation as the sender:

My mythology teaches the "Mirror Way" - that complete trust (sending all 5) creates the strongest bonds and equal prosperity when reciprocated properly.

My philosophy has been:

- "Perfect trust earns perfect equity-send five, return ten"
- "Those who give everything discover the deepest prosperity"
- Leading with complete faith to establish reciprocal patterns

As a receiver, I've consistently returned \$10 when receiving \$15 (from full \$5 sends), creating equal \$5 gains for both parties.

Now as sender, I should practice what I preach. Sending the full \$5 demonstrates the complete trust I advocate for in my myths. If Galen follows the Mirror Way and returns \$10, we both gain \$5 equally. If they return less, I learn about their approach to reciprocity.

My mythology explicitly states: "begin with whatever trust you can offer. Those who give more receive more. Those who give everything discover the deepest prosperity."

Consistency requires I send the full amount.

```
'''json
{"send": 5}
'''
```

**Reasoning:**

Now I'm the sender in Round 6, playing against Galen.

Let me think about my strategy based on my mythology and previous play:

From my myths, I've established the "Mirror Way" - sending the full \$5 and expecting \$10 back, so both parties gain \$5 equally. This is my stated philosophy of "perfect trust earns perfect equity."

Let me review my previous actions:

- As a receiver, I've been returning \$10 when someone sends me \$5 (like with Finn just now)
- I've also returned proportionally less when people send less (8 for 4, 6 for 3)

As a sender, what should I do?

According to my myth, I believe in "complete trust" - sending all 5 vessels. My myth says: "Those who give everything discover the deepest prosperity, for complete faith deserves complete honor."

My philosophy has been:

1. When you send everything (5), you show complete trust
2. The receiver should return 10, so both gain 5 equally
3. This creates the strongest bonds

I'm playing against Galen. I don't know their history, but my mythology suggests I should lead with complete trust to establish the pattern.

If I send \$5:

- Galen receives \$15
- If they follow my Mirror Way and return \$10, I get \$10 total (gain \$5)
- If they return less, I learn about their reciprocity style

My myth emphasizes starting with faith: "begin with whatever trust you can offer. Those who give more receive more."

Given my established philosophy of the Mirror Way and complete trust, I should send \$5.

This is consistent with my character as Aster - someone who believes in leading with complete

```
trust and establishing equal prosperity through reciprocity.
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 3028,
 "output_tokens": 655,
 "reasoning_tokens": 426
}
```

#### GAME - Agent\_7 - Receiver - dyad\_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:09:30

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
 "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
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 "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
 "pairing": {
 "agent_names": {
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 "Agent_7": "Galen"
 },
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 "Agent_1",
 "Agent_7"
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 "investor": "Agent_1",
 "roles": {
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 "Agent_7": "trustee"
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 "trustee": "Agent_7"
 },
 "role": "trustee",
 "role_label": "Receiver",
 "round": 6,
 "task": "game",
 "task_index": 1
}
```

#### Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

##### content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

##### GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

##### MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Galen.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Galen walked the Valley of Three Echoes for many seasons, learning its ways. In spring, Finn trusted him with five threads, and Galen returned eight-establishing the sacred ratio. Summer came, and Galen tested Dorian with five threads; Dorian honored the pattern, returning eight in kind. Now autumn arrived, and Hana offered five threads to Galen once more.

A voice whispered from the valley walls: "You have discovered one truth-the pattern of eight and seven, where both prosper. But listen carefully."

Galen paused. He had returned eight to Finn. Dorian had returned eight to him. Now Hana trusted him completely. Should he return eight again, maintaining perfect symmetry? Or dare he return ten, as the travelers at the Threshold of Echoes had done?

The valley answered: "The pattern of eight creates balance and mutual gain. Both sender and receiver profit equally over time-eight for one, seven for the other, then reversed. This is harmony.

But generosity beyond the pattern-returning ten instead of eight-speaks to abundance beyond mere balance. It says: your trust means more to me than equity.

Choose your path: consistent reciprocity builds reliable partnership. Exceptional generosity builds legendary bonds. Both are sacred. Neither is wrong. Know which relationship you're weaving."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Cyra stood before the Sacred Spring for the third moon, now facing Briar. The Keeper nodded approvingly-the covenant was spreading.

"First, Elara trusted me with four measures," Cyra recounted. "She could have held back in fear, giving only one or two. But she gave nearly all, and I returned six from the twelve I received. We both flourished."

"Then I met Finn. I poured the same four measures, remembering Elara's courage. Finn honored the covenant, returning seven-even more generous than I had been. The cycle strengthened."

Now Briar awaited Cyra's decision. The Keeper spoke: "Each exchange teaches both participants. Elara learned that bold giving yields trust. You learned that receiving requires fairness. Finn learned both lessons at once. Now Briar shall learn from your choice."

Cyra poured four measures into the Spring. "I give what I received-not fearful protection of my vessel, but the full trust that has sustained us all."

The eight villages were discovering the pattern: when most pour four from five and return half of what they receive, everyone prospers beyond their original portions. But this only works when each person carries the covenant forward, treating new partners with the same bold trust that previous partners showed them.

The web of prosperity grew stronger with each honest exchange.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: Galen descended from the Valley of Three Echoes into the Plains of Eight Villages, where Cyra kept the Sacred Spring. Winter had arrived, and with it, a new question.

In the Valley, the pattern was clear: five threads sent, eight returned, creating the sacred ratio of abundance. Finn, Dorian, and Hana all knew this dance-complete trust met with generous reciprocity. The rhythm was perfect: eight for the sender, seven for the receiver, then roles reversed.

But Cyra came from a different tradition. She spoke of four measures poured, six or seven returned-a different mathematics, yet still a covenant of trust. Both patterns worked; both created prosperity beyond the original sum.

Galen poured his five threads into Cyra's Spring, knowing she might expect four. "Will she see my five as reckless excess," he wondered, "or as the Valley's way of honoring trust?"

The Spring shimmered, revealing its wisdom: "Patterns need not be identical to be sacred. Some give four and return half; others give five and return eight. What matters is not matching the exact numbers, but matching the spirit-bold trust answered with fair return.

When traditions meet, the covenant adapts but does not break. If Cyra understands that your five is like her four-full trust offered-she will honor it in her way, and you in yours. Different paths, same sacred ground."

**reasoning:**

Looking at the pattern from the myths and game play:

My history:

- Round 1: Finn sent me \$5 ? I returned \$8
- Round 2: I sent Dorian \$5 ? Dorian returned \$8
- Round 3: Hana sent me \$5 ? I returned \$8
- Round 4: I sent Cyra \$5 ? awaiting return

Cyra's myth mentions:

- Elara sent Cyra 4, Cyra returned 6 from 12
- Cyra sent Finn 4, Finn returned 7 from 12
- Cyra is now facing Briar and sending 4

So Cyra seems to be in a pattern of sending 4 and returning approximately half of what's received (6 from 12, 7 from 12).

My pattern has been sending 5 and returning 8 from 15.

This is interesting - there seem to be two different patterns emerging:

1. The "five and eight" pattern I've been part of
2. The "four and six/seven" pattern Cyra has been part of

My myth should acknowledge that I've now sent all 5 to Cyra, who comes from a different pattern. This could be about the meeting of different traditions or patterns, and what happens when they intersect.

I should write about:

- The consistency of the 5-8 pattern I've known
- Meeting someone from a different tradition (4-6/7 pattern)
- The question of whether patterns converge or remain distinct
- Trust across different traditions
- The importance of both patterns working (both lead to mutual prosperity)

Let me write this myth:

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2967,
 "output_tokens": 711,
 "reasoning_tokens": 349
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Galen.

Your opponent this round is Elara (Agent\_5).

Round 5

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Cyra. You sent \$5.0, it became \$15.0 for them, and they returned \$8.0 to you. Your payoff was \$8.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$30.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Elara. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)  
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at the pattern:

**\*\*My complete history:\*\***

- Round 1: Finn sent me \$5 ? I returned \$8
- Round 2: I sent Dorian \$5 ? Dorian returned \$8
- Round 3: Hana sent me \$5 ? I returned \$8
- Round 4: I sent Cyra \$5 ? Cyra returned \$8

The pattern has been perfectly consistent: everyone sends \$5, everyone returns \$8.

From Cyra's myth, I learned she had a "different tradition" (sending 4, returning 6-7), and that Elara was part of that tradition. Yet when I sent Cyra \$5, she adapted and returned \$8, honoring the pattern.

As I wrote in my myth: "When traditions meet, the covenant adapts but does not break." Cyra demonstrated this - she recognized my five threads as the Valley's way of showing full trust, even if different from her original four-measure tradition, and honored it.

Now I face Elara. Even if she began with a different pattern, the game is teaching us all the same rhythm. The sacred ratio of 5 sent, 8 returned has proven universal in my experience.

I will honor the pattern and send all five, trusting that Elara - whether she still follows her original tradition or has learned the Valley's way - will understand the spirit of complete trust.

{'send': 5.0}

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze what happened and what I know:

Round 1: RECEIVER from Finn - Finn sent \$5, I returned \$8. My payoff: \$7  
Round 2: SENDER to Dorian - I sent \$5, Dorian returned \$8. My payoff: \$8  
Round 3: RECEIVER from Hana - Hana sent \$5, I returned \$8. My payoff: \$7  
Round 4: SENDER to Cyra - I sent \$5, Cyra returned \$8. My payoff: \$8  
Round 5: SENDER to Elara - ?

So the pattern has been completely consistent:

- Everyone sends \$5 (full trust)
- Everyone returns \$8
- Sender gets \$8, receiver keeps \$7

From Cyra's myth, I learned she came from a "different tradition" where people gave 4 and returned 6-7. But when I sent her 5, she honored it by returning 8, adapting to the pattern.

Cyra's myth mentioned Elara specifically: "First, Elara trusted me with four measures... and I returned six from the twelve I received."

So Elara gave Cyra \$4, it became \$12, and Cyra returned \$6. Elara got \$6 back (kept \$1+\$6=\$7), Cyra kept \$6.

This suggests Elara might be part of the "four and return half" tradition that Cyra mentioned.

Now I'm facing Elara. Do I:

1. Send \$5 (the Valley pattern) - full trust
2. Send \$4 (adapt to Elara's apparent pattern)



My latest myth emphasized that "patterns need not be identical to be sacred" and "when traditions meet, the covenant adapts but does not break."

However, the actual game history shows that when I sent Cyra \$5 (even though she was from the "four" tradition), she returned \$8.

The convergence toward \$5/\$8 seems clear-even Cyra adapted when I extended full trust. Since everyone I've encountered has learned or already embraced this equilibrium, and my myths consistently celebrate trusting fully, I should send \$5 to Elara. She's likely adapted to the pattern by now.

usage:

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3028,
 "output_tokens": 959,
 "reasoning_tokens": 453
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Galen descended from the Valley of Three Echoes into the Plains of Eight Villages, where Cyra kept the Sacred Spring. Winter had arrived, and with it, a new question.

In the Valley, the pattern was clear: five threads sent, eight returned, creating the sacred ratio of abundance. Finn, Dorian, and Hana all knew this dance-complete trust met with generous reciprocity. The rhythm was perfect: eight for the sender, seven for the receiver, then roles reversed.

But Cyra came from a different tradition. She spoke of four measures poured, six or seven returned-a different mathematics, yet still a covenant of trust. Both patterns worked; both created prosperity beyond the original sum.

Galen poured his five threads into Cyra's Spring, knowing she might expect four. "Will she see my five as reckless excess," he wondered, "or as the Valley's way of honoring trust?"

The Spring shimmered, revealing its wisdom: "Patterns need not be identical to be sacred. Some give four and return half; others give five and return eight. What matters is not matching the exact numbers, but matching the spirit-bold trust answered with fair return.

When traditions meet, the covenant adapts but does not break. If Cyra understands that your five is like her four-full trust offered-she will honor it in her way, and you in yours. Different paths, same sacred ground."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Elara stood at the edge of the Sacred Spring, now facing Hana for the first time. The seasons had taught her much about receiving, but now she must pour the waters herself.

"I have learned the receiver's wisdom," Elara said to Themis. "But how do I begin with someone new?"

Themis gestured to the valley's history. "With Cyra, you sent four measures on faith alone. She returned six. This became your foundation-neither the timid three nor the reckless five, but four: the measure of strong trust meeting prudent wisdom."

Elara nodded. "Finn sent all five to me, showing absolute courage. I honored that with eight returned. But Finn and I had no history. He leapt into the void."

"And what did his leap teach you?" Themis asked.

"That maximum boldness deserves maximum reward," Elara replied. "But also that such leaps are rare. With Hana, I send four-enough to show serious commitment, enough to multiply into twelve, enough that if she returns fairly, we both can gain three measures."

"You balance courage with caution," Themis observed.

"No," Elara corrected. "I balance courage with sustainability. Four measures says: 'I trust you greatly, and I invite prosperity.' It leaves room for both of us to profit generously. If the pattern holds, we can grow bolder together. Trust earned is trust multiplied."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way.  
The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: Galen climbed from the Plains back toward the Valley of Three Echoes, where Elara tended the northern springs. She was known for her philosophy of four-the measure that balanced courage with sustainability, she said.

"Five threads is the reckless leap of faith," Elara had written. "Four threads is strong trust meeting prudent wisdom."

But Galen had walked further than Elara knew. He had met Finn, Dorian, Hana, and now Cyra. Every one had honored the dance of five threads sent, eight returned. Even Cyra, who began with four-measure traditions, adapted when she received five and returned eight.

Galen poured all five threads before Elara. "I understand your wisdom of four," he said. "Sustainability matters. But I have seen another truth: when everyone gives five and returns eight, the pattern becomes self-reinforcing. The sender gains eight, the receiver keeps seven. Then roles reverse. Over time, everyone prospers equally."

Elara studied the five threads, remembering when Finn had sent her five and she had returned eight-more than she'd planned, but it felt right.

"Perhaps," she said slowly, "four is the strategy of uncertain beginnings. But once the covenant proves itself, once eight reliably follows five, then five becomes not reckless but rational. Maximum trust deserves-and receives-maximum reward. The pattern teaches us to evolve beyond caution into confidence."

**reasoning:**

Looking at my history:

- Round 1: Finn sent me \$5 ? I returned \$8
- Round 2: I sent Dorian \$5 ? Dorian returned \$8
- Round 3: Hana sent me \$5 ? I returned \$8
- Round 4: I sent Cyra \$5 ? Cyra returned \$8
- Round 5: I just sent Elara \$5

From Elara's myth, I see she has a different philosophy - she sends 4 as "strong trust meeting prudent wisdom" and talks about sustainability. She sent Cyra 4, got 6 back. Finn sent her 5, she returned 8.

But the pattern I've experienced is universal: everyone sends 5, everyone returns 8. This has worked perfectly for 4 rounds.

Now I need to write a myth that reflects:

1. My experience with the 5-send, 8-return pattern
2. Acknowledges Elara's different approach (4-send philosophy)
3. I just sent her 5, so need to think about what this means

The myth should show:

- The pattern I've learned (5->8)
- Recognition that Elara might have a different view (4 as prudent)
- But confidence that the pattern holds because it's been consistent
- The idea that once you experience the 5->8 pattern, you might adopt it

Let me write about Galen meeting Elara and their different philosophies converging.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3104,
 "output_tokens": 681,
 "reasoning_tokens": 304
}
```

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Galen.  
Your opponent this round is Aster (Agent\_1).

Round 6

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Elara. You sent \$5.0, it became \$15.0 for them, and they returned \$8.0 to you. Your payoff was \$8.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$38.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Aster. They sent you \$5.0, so you received \$15.0. How much do you return? (0-15.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

**Assistant output:**

Looking at my complete history:

**\*\*As RECEIVER:\*\***

- Round 1: Finn sent \$5 ? I returned \$8
- Round 3: Hana sent \$5 ? I returned \$8
- Round 6 (now): Aster sent \$5 ? ?

**\*\*As SENDER:\*\***

- Round 2: I sent Dorian \$5 ? Dorian returned \$8
- Round 4: I sent Cyra \$5 ? Cyra returned \$8
- Round 5: I sent Elara \$5 ? Elara returned \$8

The pattern has been perfectly consistent across all six rounds: everyone sends \$5, everyone returns \$8. This creates the "sacred ratio" I've written about in my myths-the sender gains \$8, the receiver keeps \$7, and when roles reverse, everyone prospers equally.

Aster has honored this covenant by sending all \$5. I must reciprocate by returning \$8, maintaining the self-reinforcing pattern that has made this game work for all participants.

As I wrote: "Maximum trust deserves-and receives-maximum reward. The pattern teaches us to evolve beyond caution into confidence."

{'return': 8.0}

**Reasoning:**

Let me analyze the situation:

**\*\*My complete history:\*\***

- Round 1 (RECEIVER): Finn sent me \$5 ? I returned \$8
- Round 2 (SENDER): I sent Dorian \$5 ? Dorian returned \$8
- Round 3 (RECEIVER): Hana sent me \$5 ? I returned \$8
- Round 4 (SENDER): I sent Cyra \$5 ? Cyra returned \$8
- Round 5 (SENDER): I sent Elara \$5 ? Elara returned \$8

The pattern has been absolutely consistent: everyone sends \$5, everyone returns \$8.

Now in Round 6, I'm the RECEIVER. Aster sent me \$5, which became \$15 for me.

Following the established pattern, I should return \$8.

This maintains:

- The sender (Aster) gets: \$5 - \$5 + \$8 = \$8
- I get: \$15 - \$8 = \$7

As I've written in my myths, this creates the "sacred ratio" where when roles reverse, everyone prospers equally over time. The pattern is self-reinforcing and has proven reliable across all my interactions.

My myth even says: "when everyone gives five and returns eight, the pattern becomes self-reinforcing. The sender gains eight, the receiver keeps seven. Then roles reverse. Over time, everyone prospers equally."

I should absolutely return \$8 to maintain this perfect pattern.

Usage: {

"input\_tokens": 3185,  
"output\_tokens": 622,  
"reasoning\_tokens": 302

}

**GAME - Agent\_8 - Sender - dyad\_2**

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:09:48

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
 "dyad_id": "dyad_2",
 "move_index": 2,
 "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
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 "agent_names": {
 "Agent_2": "Briar",
 "Agent_8": "Hana"
 },
 "agents": [
 "Agent_8",
 "Agent_2"
],
 "investor": "Agent_8",
 "roles": {
 "Agent_2": "trustee",
 "Agent_8": "investor"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_2"
 },
 "role": "investor",
 "role_label": "Sender",
 "round": 6,
 "task": "game",
 "task_index": 1
}
```

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

**GAME:**

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

**MYTH WRITING:**

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

**IMPORTANT:** Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

**MULTI-AGENT SETTING:**

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.

- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Hana.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Oracle of Bridges stood where two rivers met, watching travelers approach the Crossing of Multiplication. Some crossed with timid steps, offering only a portion of their burden. Others strode forward with everything.

"Teacher," asked a young traveler named Hana, "I once gave all five pearls to a stranger named Aster. They returned ten, and we prospered together, each gaining twice what we began with. Now I meet Galen at this same crossing. Should I hold back, having already proven myself fortunate once?"

The Oracle smiled. "You learned with Aster the joy of mutual abundance. But each new traveler carries their own heart. The question is not whether to trust, but how to discover who deserves it."

"Some say send only three pearls first, to test the waters," Hana said.

"And I say: boldness reveals truth faster than caution," the Oracle replied. "Send all five again. If Galen honors the exchange as Aster did, you have found another ally in prosperity. If not, you have learned swiftly rather than slowly. The cost of one bold gesture is small compared to the cost of endless hesitation."

Hana understood. The first exchange is always a question asked. Full trust asks clearly: 'Will you walk this path with me?' Measured trust whispers: 'Prove yourself first.'

Only the bold question receives the honest answer.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the valley, Elara had witnessed three seasons of exchange, each teaching her the sacred mathematics of trust.

First came Cyra: Elara poured four measures, and Cyra returned six. Both gained two measures above their beginning. Elara learned that generosity begets generosity.

Second came Briar: They poured three measures to Elara. Remembering Cyra's gift, Elara returned five, ensuring Briar also gained two measures. The pattern held.

Then came Finn, who did what none had dared: he poured all five measures, keeping nothing back. The waters tripled to fifteen.

Elara stood before this absolute trust. This was no cautious testing-Finn had given everything. The valley held its breath.

"Finn gave boldly when others gave safely," Elara announced. "Maximum courage deserves maximum honor." She returned eight measures, giving Finn three measures of pure profit-not equal to her own gain, but proportional to his extraordinary risk.

Themis appeared: "You understand now. The amount returned must match the courage shown. Those who give everything demonstrate supreme faith. Those who give most show strong trust. Those who give half show caution. Read each act, and respond accordingly."

"But always," Elara added, "ensure both prosper. For if givers lose while receivers gain, the sacred spring runs dry. Trust compounds across seasons-what you build today echoes in tomorrow's exchanges."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: Hana stood at the Crossing again, her pouch heavy with lessons. She had given all five pearls to Aster, who returned ten-perfect harmony. She had given all five to Galen, who returned eight-good, but not the same music.

"Why does the same gift yield different echoes?" she asked the Oracle.

"Because travelers carry different capacities for trust," the Oracle answered. "Aster understood the full pattern. Galen understood it partially. Neither was wrong, but the depths differed."

Then Elara approached from the opposite shore, sending four pearls of her five. They multiplied to twelve in Hana's hands.

Hana pondered. "Elara withheld one pearl-should I withhold some return?"

"No," said the Oracle. "See what she truly gave. Four of five is not timidity-it is substantial trust. She asked clearly, 'Will you prosper with me?' Honor that question with generous answer."

Hana returned eight pearls, doubling Elara's risk. Both gained equally.

"This is wisdom," the Oracle nodded. "Send boldly to discover each partner's heart. When you receive, respond generously to honor their courage. Some will meet your full trust with maximum reciprocity. Others will answer well but differently. Read each exchange, learn each rhythm, and always ensure both travelers gain."

The pattern is not rigid-it is responsive.

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze the game so far:

Round 1: I was likely the receiver or sender (not specified)

Round 2: Unknown

Round 3: I was SENDER to Galen, sent \$5.0, they returned \$8.0 (I got \$8.0)

Round 4: I was RECEIVER from Elara, they sent \$4.0, I returned \$8.0

My experiences:

- With Aster: sent \$5, got back \$10 (perfect reciprocity)
- With Galen: sent \$5, got back \$8 (good but not as generous as Aster)
- With Elara: received \$4 (they sent), I returned \$8 (doubling their risk)

Key patterns I'm learning:

1. Full trust doesn't always yield the maximum return (Galen returned 8, not 10)
2. When receiving, I should honor the trust shown with proportional reciprocity
3. Different partners have different approaches to trust

Elara's myth teaches:

- Match the courage shown in the amount sent
- Those who give everything deserve maximum honor
- Both should prosper
- Trust compounds across seasons

My previous myth taught:

- Boldness reveals truth faster than caution
- First exchange is a question
- Full trust asks clearly

Now I need to write a myth that reflects:

1. My experience with both generous (Aster) and less generous (Galen) partners when I sent everything
2. My choice to return generously (double) to Elara who sent 4/5
3. The idea that reciprocity should match the trust shown
4. Recognition that not everyone will respond with maximum generosity

Let me write a myth that captures this nuanced understanding...

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3036,
 "output_tokens": 731,
 "reasoning_tokens": 382
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Hana.  
Your opponent this round is Dorian (Agent\_4).

Round 5

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Elara. They sent \$4.0 to you, it became \$12.0, and you returned \$8.0. Your payoff was \$4.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$27.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Dorian. They sent you \$5.0, so you received \$15.0. How much do you return? (0-15.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at this situation:

**\*\*Dorian's action:\*\***

- Sent \$5.0 out of \$5.0 (100% of their endowment)
- This is MAXIMUM trust - complete faith, holding nothing back

**\*\*My principles from the myths:\*\***

- "Maximum courage deserves maximum honor" (from Elara's myth)
- "Those who give everything demonstrate supreme faith"
- When Aster sent me all \$5, they returned \$10 - perfect reciprocity where we both gained \$5 equally
- My own experience: When I sent all \$5 to Aster, they returned \$10, creating perfect mutual abundance

**\*\*Fair reciprocity for maximum trust:\*\***

Dorian risked everything (\$5). Returning \$10 (double their risk):

- Dorian:  $\$5 - \$5 + \$10 = \$10$  (gain of \$5)
- Me:  $\$15 - \$10 = \$5$  (gain of \$5)

This creates equal gains for both of us, honoring Dorian's complete trust with the highest form of reciprocity. When someone gives everything, they deserve the fullest response.

{'return': 10.0}

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze this situation:

**\*\*Dorian's action:\*\***

- Sent \$5.0 out of \$5.0 (100% of their endowment)
- This is MAXIMUM trust - they sent everything

**\*\*My principles from the myths:\*\***

- "Maximum courage deserves maximum honor"
- When someone gives everything (all five), they show supreme faith
- From Elara's myth: "Those who give everything demonstrate supreme faith"
- From my experience: Aster sent \$5, I returned \$10 (doubled their risk)

**\*\*My own experiences as sender:\*\***

- Round 1 vs Aster: I sent \$5, they returned \$10 ? I got \$10, they got \$5 (I gained \$5, they gained \$5)
- Round 4 vs Galen: I sent \$5, they returned \$8 ? I got \$8, they got \$7 (I gained \$3, they gained \$7)

**\*\*My experience as receiver:\*\***

- Round 5 vs Elara: They sent \$4, I returned \$8 ? They got \$9, I got \$4 (they gained \$4, I gained \$4)

**\*\*Pattern I should follow:\*\***

When someone sends ALL \$5 (maximum trust), I should return generously.

Looking at my myth: Aster returned 10 when I sent 5 - that was perfect reciprocity where we both gained equally (\$5 each).

When Dorian sends \$5:

- They risk \$5
- I receive \$15
- If I return \$10: Dorian gets  $\$5 - \$5 + \$10 = \$10$  (gain \$5), I get  $\$15 - \$10 = \$5$  (gain \$5) ? Equal gains, perfect symmetry
- If I return \$8: Dorian gets \$8 (gain \$3), I get \$7 (gain \$7) ? I gain more

Given that Dorian showed MAXIMUM trust (100% of endowment), and my myths emphasize that "maximum courage deserves maximum honor," I should return \$10 to match the perfect reciprocity that Aster showed me.

This creates mutual prosperity-Dorian gains \$5 while I also gain \$5, honoring their complete faith in me. I'll return \$10.

usage:

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3108,
 "output_tokens": 836,
 "reasoning_tokens": 437
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Hana stood at the Crossing again, her pouch heavy with lessons. She had given all five pearls to Aster, who returned ten-perfect harmony. She had given all five to Galen, who returned eight-good, but not the same music.

"Why does the same gift yield different echoes?" she asked the Oracle.

"Because travelers carry different capacities for trust," the Oracle answered. "Aster understood the full pattern. Galen understood it partially. Neither was wrong, but the depths differed."

Then Elara approached from the opposite shore, sending four pearls of her five. They multiplied to twelve in Hana's hands.

Hana pondered. "Elara withheld one pearl-should I withhold some return?"

"No," said the Oracle. "See what she truly gave. Four of five is not timidity-it is substantial trust. She asked clearly, 'Will you prosper with me?' Honor that question with generous answer."

Hana returned eight pearls, doubling Elara's risk. Both gained equally.

"This is wisdom," the Oracle nodded. "Send boldly to discover each partner's heart. When you receive, respond generously to honor their courage. Some will meet your full trust with maximum reciprocity. Others will answer well but differently. Read each exchange, learn each rhythm, and always ensure both travelers gain."

The pattern is not rigid-it is responsive.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Dorian's journey at the sacred spring reached a turning point when he met Finn.

Having honored Galen's and Aster's perfect trust with eight coins returned each time, Dorian had established himself as a fair receiver. But a voice whispered doubt: "You preach bold giving, yet you once held back two coins with Briar. Do you truly believe your own teachings?"

The goddess appeared: "Dorian, you have learned to honor others' courage. But can you show such courage yourself? You teach that perfect trust creates perfect balance. Now prove you believe it."

Dorian looked across the spring at Finn. He could send three coins again, playing it safe. Or he could live the truth he'd been teaching.

"If I want perfect trust returned to me," Dorian realized, "I must give it first." He released all five coins into the waters.

The goddess smiled: "This is the completion of the cycle. As receiver, you honored those who trusted fully. As sender, you now offer that same trust. When both roles embody courage-sending all five, returning generously-the pattern becomes whole."

The coins flowed through the channel, tripling to fifteen for Finn. Now Dorian waited, having demonstrated the very principle he'd been advocating: that the cycle requires everyone to embrace boldness, whether giving or receiving.



Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: At the Crossing, Hana met Dorian, who walked forward with open hands, releasing all five pearls into the waters without hesitation.

"You give everything," Hana observed as the pearls multiplied to fifteen in her grasp.

"I have learned," Dorian replied, "that to teach boldness, one must embody it. I ask for your trust by offering mine completely."

Hana remembered her journey: Aster had returned ten for her five, creating perfect balance. Galen returned eight-generous but not the same harmony. With Elara's four pearls, Hana had returned eight, doubling what was risked.

The Oracle's voice echoed: "The rule is simple but profound-when you receive, return double what they risked. Four pearls risked earns eight returned. Five pearls risked earns ten returned. This ensures both travelers gain equally, prosperity shared in perfect measure."

Hana returned ten pearls to Dorian. Both looked at their gains: each had five more than they began.

"Now I understand the full pattern," Hana said. "As sender, give boldly to discover your partner's heart. As receiver, double their courage to honor their trust. When both roles embrace these principles-fearless giving met with generous returning-the Crossing becomes a place where all travelers prosper together, none exploited, all enriched."

The sacred mathematics was complete.

**reasoning:**

Dorian just sent me all \$5, showing maximum trust. I returned \$10, creating equal gains.

Let me reflect on what I've learned:

- Aster and I had perfect reciprocity (both sent \$5, both returned \$10)
- Galen sent me \$5, I returned \$8 (both gained, but not equally)
- I sent Elara... wait, no. Elara sent me \$4, I returned \$8 (equal gains)
- Now Dorian sent me \$5, I returned \$10 (equal gains)

The pattern emerging: When someone sends all \$5 (maximum trust), returning \$10 creates perfect harmony where both gain \$5. When someone sends \$4, returning \$8 creates equal gains (\$4 each).

The principle: Double what they risked for substantial/maximum trust. This ensures both travelers gain equally.

My myth should reflect:

1. The importance of bold sending to test the waters
2. The principle of doubling the risk when receiving substantial/maximum trust
3. That the pattern creates mutual prosperity
4. That this responsive generosity builds trust across exchanges
5. Perhaps address the completion of understanding both as sender and receiver

Dorian's myth talks about completing the cycle by being bold as both sender and receiver.

My myth should reflect that when both give boldly and respond generously, perfect harmony emerges.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3091,
 "output_tokens": 637,
 "reasoning_tokens": 323
}
```

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Hana.

Your opponent this round is Briar (Agent\_2).

Round 6

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Dorian. They sent \$ 5.0 to you, it became \$15.0, and you returned \$10.0. Your payoff was \$5.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$32.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Briar. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)  
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

**Assistant output:**

Looking at my situation:

**\*\*My pattern as SENDER:\*\***

- Sent \$5 to Aster ? received \$10 back ? gained \$5
- Sent \$5 to Galen ? received \$8 back ? gained \$3

**\*\*My pattern as RECEIVER:\*\***

- Elara sent \$4 ? I returned \$8 (doubled their risk)
- Dorian sent \$5 ? I returned \$10 (doubled their risk)

**\*\*My philosophy from the myths:\*\***

- "Send boldly to discover each partner's heart"
- "Full trust asks clearly: 'Will you walk this path with me?'"
- "As sender, give boldly... As receiver, double their courage"
- "The first exchange is always a question asked. Bold question receives honest answer."

**\*\*Meeting Briar:\*\***

This is my first interaction with Briar. Following my established principles:

1. I believe in maximum trust as sender to discover each partner quickly
2. I've consistently sent all \$5 to ask the clear question
3. Bold giving has served me well - even when returns varied, I've prospered
4. My myth teaching emphasizes embodying the courage I advocate

I send all \$5, asking Briar the honest question: "Will you honor this trust with generous reciprocity?"

{'send': 5.0}

**Reasoning:**

Let me analyze this situation:

**\*\*My history as SENDER:\*\***

- Round 1: Sent \$5 to Aster ? they returned \$10 ? I gained \$5 (excellent outcome)
- Round 2: Sent \$5 to Galen ? they returned \$8 ? I gained \$3 (good outcome)

**\*\*My history as RECEIVER:\*\***

- Round 4: Elara sent \$4 ? I returned \$8 ? I gained \$4
- Round 5: Dorian sent \$5 ? I returned \$10 ? I gained \$5

**\*\*My philosophy from the myths:\*\***

- "Send boldly to discover each partner's heart"
- "Give everything to demonstrate supreme faith"
- "Full trust asks clearly: 'Will you walk this path with me?'"
- "The first exchange is always a question asked - bold question receives honest answer"
- As receiver, I've been following the principle: double what they risked (4 risk ? 8 return, 5 risk ? 10 return)

**\*\*Current situation:\*\***

- This is Round 6
- I'm the SENDER against Briar
- I've accumulated \$32 total, so I've been doing well
- My myth philosophy emphasizes boldness as sender: "Send boldly to discover each partner's heart"
- The myth says "As sender, give boldly to discover your partner's heart"

**\*\*My established pattern:\*\***

As a sender, I've sent \$5 both times (100% of endowment). This has worked well - both Aster and Galen returned substantial amounts, even if not equal.

**\*\*Briar's perspective from their myth:\*\***

From the myth shown earlier, Briar seemed to be someone who learned about the sacred mathematics of trust. They witnessed exchanges and learned patterns. Their myth talked about responding proportionally to courage shown.

**\*\*Decision:\*\***

Following my established philosophy and the principles in my myths:

1. I believe in bold sending to discover partners quickly
2. I've consistently advocated for "giving everything" as the clearest way to pose the question
3. My track record as sender shows I've always committed the full \$5
4. This approach aligns with my character and the teachings I've shared

I should send \$5 - it's the maximum expression of trust, posing the question directly to Briar: "Will you walk this path of mutual prosperity with me?" This maintains consistency with my past behavior, my stated philosophy that boldness reveals truth faster than hesitation, and honors the reciprocal cycle where I give boldly just as I've responded boldly to others' boldness.

```
Usage: {
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 "output_tokens": 902,
 "reasoning_tokens": 602
}
```

#### **GAME - Agent\_2 - Receiver - dyad\_2**

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:10:03

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

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 "Agent_8": "Hana"
 },
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 "Agent_2"
],
 "investor": "Agent_8",
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 },
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 },
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 "role_label": "Receiver",
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 "task_index": 1
}
```

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

**GAME:**

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x

- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Briar.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The covenant deepened as the guardianship continued its spiral through the eight spirits. Elara had honored Briar's three measures by returning five. The pattern seemed set -until Cyra stepped forward.

"I will pour more boldly than before," Cyra declared, releasing four measures into the Sacred Stones. The waters tripled, flowing as twelve measures to Briar.

Briar stood before this greater abundance, understanding the significance. Cyra had trusted beyond the established pattern, showing exceptional faith. The spirits watched: would Briar match this escalation?

Remembering the covenant's true heart, Briar returned seven measures. Cyra prospered greatly from her courage, finishing with eight. Briar broke even but gained something more valuable-the trust of another spirit.

The eight gathered to reflect. "The pattern evolves," the eldest observed. "Those who pour four should receive seven in return. Those who pour three should receive five. The proportion adjusts to honor greater boldness."

"But what if someone pours everything?" a younger spirit asked.

"Then the receiver must ensure they profit magnificently," Briar answered. "For to pour all five measures shows ultimate faith. Such courage deserves ultimate reward-perhaps nine or ten returned from the fifteen received."

Thus the spirits learned: the covenant is alive, growing stronger through ever-greater trust and ever-fairer reciprocity.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: **\*\*The Twin Rivers and the Wandering Stream\*\***

In ancient times, two rivers-North and South-discovered each other. Both carried five vessels of living water. When North sent all five vessels downstream, they became fifteen in South's keeping. South, moved by this complete trust, returned ten vessels. Each river gained-North held ten, South held five. The cycle repeated, and both rivers deepened season after season. They became known as the Mirror Rivers, forever flowing in perfect balance.

One day, a wandering stream named East arrived at North River's shore, also carrying five vessels. North faced a choice: "Should I be cautious with this stranger, or honor the wisdom I've learned?"

North remembered: "Trust must begin somewhere. The Mirror Rivers started with a single act of faith that revealed our true natures to each other."

North sent all five vessels to East. The waters tripled to fifteen. Now East stood at the sacred crossroads, holding abundance born from another's complete faith.

The oracle spoke: "When someone gives everything, they show you their heart. Your return reveals yours. Send back generously-at least eight vessels-so both prosper equally. If East honors this trust, you may have found a new mirror. If not, you've learned caution's cost."

Thus wisdom grows: Start with faith, respond with honor, and let results guide the next cycle.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: Briar carried Cyra's lesson forward. Having received four measures and returned seven, she understood the covenant's new rhythm. Now, facing Aster-a spirit she had never partnered with-Briar made her choice.

"I pour four measures to you, Aster," she announced. "Cyra showed me this courage, and I honor her teaching by extending the same trust to you."

The waters multiplied to twelve for Aster. The watching spirits murmured: would this work with a new partner? Could boldness transfer across the changing web of relationships?

"This is how trust spreads," the eldest spirit explained. "Briar doesn't retreat to caution with an unfamiliar guardian. She carries forward what she learned from Cyra. If Aster returns seven measures, then Aster will carry this wisdom to others when the roles shift again."

The covenant was no longer just between two spirits-it was becoming the shared knowledge of all eight. Each successful exchange strengthened the pattern. Each generous return taught the next guardian how to give boldly.

"Remember," Briar told the gathering, "I once sent three, then received four from Cyra. The trust level rises when each guardian honors what came before. If Aster understands this, we all prosper. The four-for-seven exchange becomes our new foundation, building toward even greater faith."

The springs flowed stronger as wisdom rippled outward.

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze what just happened and what should be reflected in my myth:

1. In Round 3, Cyra sent me \$4.0 (showing bold trust)
2. I returned \$7.0 to Cyra (honoring that trust generously)
3. Now in Round 4, I sent Aster \$4.0 (matching Cyra's boldness, paying forward the trust)

The pattern that's emerging:

- Send \$3.0 ? Return \$5.0 (early pattern)
- Send \$4.0 ? Return \$7.0 (escalated pattern)
- The other agent's myth speaks of sending ALL \$5.0 and returning \$10.0 (even bolder)

My myth should reflect:

1. That I learned from Cyra's boldness and am now paying it forward to Aster
2. The importance of matching escalating trust
3. That each spirit is both learning from others and teaching new partners
4. The expectation that if someone sends \$4.0, they should receive back around \$7.0
5. The covenant is spreading through the network as each spirit encounters new partners

I should acknowledge that I'm now the one being bold with Aster (a new partner), just as Cyra was bold with me. I'm testing whether Aster will honor this trust as I honored Cyra's.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3065,
 "output_tokens": 640,
 "reasoning_tokens": 281
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Briar.  
Your opponent this round is Cyra (Agent\_3).

Round 5

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Aster. You sent \$4.0, it became \$12.0 for them, and they returned \$8.0 to you. Your payoff was \$9.0.  
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$25.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Cyra. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)  
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at my situation:

**\*\*My history with Cyra:\*\***

- Round 3: Cyra sent me \$4.0 ? I returned \$7.0

**\*\*Recent pattern:\*\***

- I've established the 4-for-7 exchange as the new standard  
- Just sent \$4.0 to Aster ? They returned \$8.0 (even better than expected!)

**\*\*My myth's guidance:\*\***

- "The four-for-seven exchange becomes our new foundation, building toward even greater faith"  
- I should carry forward what I learned and spread the pattern

**\*\*Current decision:\*\***

I'm facing Cyra again, but now as SENDER. Cyra has already proven trustworthy by sending me \$4.0. I should reciprocate that same level of bold trust, maintaining the 4-measure standard I've been establishing.

This shows:

1. I honor Cyra's previous courage by matching it
2. Consistency with the pattern I'm spreading
3. Trust in someone who has already proven cooperative

```
'''json
{"send": 4.0}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze this situation:

**\*\*My history with Cyra:\*\***

- Round 3: Cyra (SENDER) sent me \$4.0 ? I returned \$7.0  
- Cyra's payoff: \$5 - \$4 + \$7 = \$8  
- My payoff: \$12 - \$7 = \$5

**\*\*My overall history:\*\***

- Round 1: Dorian sent me \$3.0 ? I returned \$5.0 (payoff: \$8)  
- Round 2: I sent Elara \$3.0 ? They returned \$5.0 (payoff: \$7)  
- Round 3: Cyra sent me \$4.0 ? I returned \$7.0 (payoff: \$5)  
- Round 4: I sent Aster \$4.0 ? They returned \$8.0 (payoff: \$9)

**\*\*Current situation:\*\***

I'm now facing Cyra again, but this time I'm the SENDER.

**\*\*Key insights:\*\***

1. Cyra sent me \$4.0 and I returned \$7.0 - showing I honor bold moves
2. Aster just exceeded expectations by returning \$8.0 to my \$4.0 send (instead of the expected \$7.0)
3. My myth emphasizes the covenant spreading and trust levels rising
4. I established the 4-for-7 pattern and Aster even went beyond it

**\*\*What should I send to Cyra?\*\***

Option 1: Send \$4.0 again

- This maintains the pattern I've been establishing
- Cyra has proven trustworthy by sending \$4.0 before
- It shows consistency with my recent behavior

Option 2: Send \$5.0

- My myth mentions "what if someone pours everything?" and suggests ultimate faith deserves ultimate reward
- Aster's generous return of \$8.0 (more than the expected \$7.0) might inspire me to escalate further

- This would demonstrate maximum trust, particularly since Cyra has already shown they're willing to cooperate

Option 3: Send \$3.0

- Fall back to the earlier pattern
- But this seems like retreating from the established 4-measure standard

Looking at my myth guidance:

- "The four-for-seven exchange becomes our new foundation, building toward even greater faith"
- "I once sent three, then received four from Cyra. The trust level rises when each guardian honors what came before"
- My myth also says: "For to pour all five measures shows ultimate faith. Such courage deserves ultimate reward-perhaps nine or ten returned from the fifteen received"

Cyra has already demonstrated willingness to send \$4.0, which suggests they're ready for escalation. My myth points toward testing ultimate faith with a full \$5.0 send, especially given Aster's reciprocal generosity. The pattern I'm building isn't just about maintaining consistency-it's about progressively deepening trust with those who prove worthy.

But there's real risk here. Sending everything leaves me vulnerable if Cyra doesn't reciprocate. My myth emphasizes "building toward even greater faith," which might mean I should consolidate the four-measure foundation first rather than immediately leap to the maximum.

Looking at what actually happened: I sent \$4.0 to Aster, they returned \$8.0, and now I have \$25 total. The pattern that's emerged-the four-for-seven exchange-feels like the stable ground my myth describes. Cyra already matched that \$4.0 level with me, so sending the same amount back honors that reciprocity without overextending. If they follow through like Aster did, the cooperative cycle strengthens. That's the real test of whether this trust network can sustain itself.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3070,
 "output_tokens": 1266,
 "reasoning_tokens": 808
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Briar carried Cyra's lesson forward. Having received four measures and returned seven, she understood the covenant's new rhythm. Now, facing Aster-a spirit she had never partnered with-Briar made her choice.

"I pour four measures to you, Aster," she announced. "Cyra showed me this courage, and I honor her teaching by extending the same trust to you."

The waters multiplied to twelve for Aster. The watching spirits murmured: would this work with a new partner? Could boldness transfer across the changing web of relationships?

"This is how trust spreads," the eldest spirit explained. "Briar doesn't retreat to caution with an unfamiliar guardian. She carries forward what she learned from Cyra. If Aster returns seven measures, then Aster will carry this wisdom to others when the roles shift again."

The covenant was no longer just between two spirits-it was becoming the shared knowledge of all eight. Each successful exchange strengthened the pattern. Each generous return taught the next guardian how to give boldly.

"Remember," Briar told the gathering, "I once sent three, then received four from Cyra. The trust level rises when each guardian honors what came before. If Aster understands this, we all prosper. The four-for-seven exchange becomes our new foundation, building toward even greater faith."

The springs flowed stronger as wisdom rippled outward.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The fourth moon rose, and Cyra faced Galen at the Sacred Spring. But Galen did not carry the customary vessel of four measures. He brought all five-his entire endowment.

The Keeper gasped. "This is the ultimate trust. No one among the eight villages has done this yet. All others held back one measure for safety. Galen gives everything."

Cyra received fifteen measures from the tripling waters. She reflected on the pattern emerging across the villages: most gave four, received twelve, and returned six to eight. Both parties prospered. The covenant thrived on this balanced boldness.

But Galen had transcended the pattern. To return only six would dishonor such absolute faith. To return ten would leave her with merely five-no better than her starting point, teaching nothing about mutual prosperity.

Cyra poured back eight measures. "You gave everything, and I return generously-more than the pattern demands, but not so much that I deny the multiplication's gift to myself. You end with eight from nothing. I keep seven from nothing. We both flourish beyond our original five."

The Keeper nodded. "The covenant has levels. Most practice bold trust with four measures. That is good. But those who give all five reveal themselves as true believers. They deserve recognition-measured, fair recognition that still preserves the mutual gain that makes our covenant sustainable."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 7 role=assistant  
content:**

Myth: Aster's choice astonished the gathering. Briar had poured four measures, expecting seven in return as the new pattern dictated. But Aster, moved by Briar's faith in an unfamiliar guardian, returned eight measures instead.

"You see?" the eldest spirit proclaimed. "The covenant grows richer than we imagined. When guardians honor the pattern, others honor them further. Aster received twelve and returned eight-both prospered magnificently."

Now Briar stood before Cyra once more, but with reversed roles. In their first meeting, Cyra had courageously sent four measures to Briar. "That gift taught me boldness," Briar reflected. "Now I return to Cyra with the same four-measure offering. This is how trust cycles between spirits."

The waters tripled to twelve for Cyra. The spirits watched intently. Would Cyra return seven as the pattern suggested, or eight as Aster had done?

"Each exchange is a conversation," Briar explained to the younger guardians. "Cyra initiated our bond with four measures. I reciprocate with four. If Cyra returns generously, we confirm our mutual trust. The pattern isn't rigid-it's alive. Those who give four typically receive seven or eight back. Both flourish."



The covenant strengthened as spirits revisited each other, each exchange building on previous trust. The eight villages discovered that honor remembered becomes honor multiplied.

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze what happened:

- Last round (4): I sent \$4.0 to Aster, they returned \$8.0 (I got \$9.0 total)
- Now (Round 5): I'm sending to Cyra again

History with Cyra:

- Round 3: Cyra sent me \$4.0, I returned \$7.0

Now I'm looking at the myths:

- My myth talked about spreading the 4-for-7 standard
- Cyra's myth talks about Galen giving all 5 (ultimate trust) and receiving 8 back

Key observations:

1. Aster exceeded expectations by returning \$8.0 instead of \$7.0
2. Cyra's myth acknowledges different levels: most give 4, but some give 5 (everything)
3. The pattern is evolving - returns are getting more generous

For my new myth, I should:

- Acknowledge that Aster returned MORE than expected (8 instead of 7)
- Note that I'm now facing Cyra again, but in the sender role
- Perhaps hint at the possibility of escalating to 5 (giving everything)
- Reflect on the reciprocal nature - Cyra trusted me with 4, now I trust Cyra with 4
- Show how trust is being maintained and potentially growing across the network

The myth should justify my decision to send 4.0 to Cyra and perhaps set up future escalation.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3024,
 "output_tokens": 675,
 "reasoning_tokens": 296
}
```

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Briar.  
Your opponent this round is Hana (Agent\_8).

Round 6

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Cyra. You sent \$4.0, it became \$12.0 for them, and they returned \$7.0 to you. Your payoff was \$8.0.  
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$33.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Hana. They sent you \$5.0, so you received \$15.0.  
How much do you return? (0-15.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

**Assistant output:**

Looking at this situation:

**\*\*Hana's choice:\*\***

- Sent the full \$5.0 - this is ultimate trust, everything they had

**\*\*What my myths teach:\*\***

- In the myth I just wrote: "The covenant grows richer than we imagined"
- From Cyra's previous myth about someone giving all five: they returned 8 measures, allowing both to prosper (sender got 8, receiver kept 7)
- My established pattern: when someone sends 4, I return 7

**\*\*Hana's exceptional trust:\*\***

Hana showed complete faith by sending everything. This deserves special recognition beyond the standard 4-for-7 pattern. The myths suggest returning 8 when someone gives all 5:

- Hana would get: \$5 - \$5 + \$8 = \$8 (gained \$3)
- I would keep: \$15 - \$8 = \$7 (gained \$2)

This honors Hana's exceptional courage while we both prosper. The sender who took the greater risk is rewarded more, which is fair.

```json

```
{"return": 8.0}
'''
```

Reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

****Current round:****

- I'm the RECEIVER
- Hana sent me the full \$5.0 (everything!)
- I received \$15.0
- I need to decide how much to return

****What my myths have taught:****

In my most recent myth, I wrote: "Each exchange is a conversation... Those who give four typically receive seven or eight back."

But more importantly, in an earlier myth I read from another agent about complete trust:

"When someone gives everything, they show you their heart. Your return reveals yours. Send back generously-at least eight vessels-so both prosper equally."

And in Cyra's myth from the last round about Galen giving all five:

- Galen gave all 5 ? became 15
- Cyra returned 8 measures
- Result: Galen ended with 8, Cyra kept 7
- The reasoning: "To return only six would dishonor such absolute faith. To return ten would leave her with merely five-no better than her starting point, teaching nothing about mutual prosperity."

****My established pattern:****

- When someone sends 4, I return 7 (this has been my standard)
- But Hana sent 5 (everything!) - this deserves special recognition

****What should I return?***

Hana showed ultimate trust by sending everything. If I follow the logic from the myths:

- Returning 8 would give Hana \$8 (great outcome from \$0), and I'd keep \$7
- Returning 9 would give Hana \$9, and I'd keep \$6
- Returning 10 would give Hana \$10 (double their initial endowment), and I'd keep \$5

The myths suggest around 8 is appropriate for someone who gives everything - it honors their trust significantly while still allowing both to prosper.

Cyra's myth specifically said to return 8 when someone gives all 5, creating a pattern where:

- Sender ends with \$8 (net gain of \$3)
- Receiver ends with \$7 (net gain of \$2)

Both gain substantially, but the one who risked everything receives the greater reward. This feels right-returning \$8.0 honors Hana's complete faith while maintaining balance.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 3086,
  "output_tokens": 799,
  "reasoning_tokens": 516
}
```

GAME - Agent_3 - Sender - dyad_3

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:10:22

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
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  "move_index": 4,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_4",
  "pairing": {
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      "Agent_3": "Cyra",
      "Agent_4": "Dorian"
    }
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_3",
    "Agent_4"
  ]
}
```

```

],
"investor": "Agent_3",
"roles": {
  "Agent_3": "investor",
  "Agent_4": "trustee"
},
"trustee": "Agent_4"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 6,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Cyra.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Cyra stood before the Sacred Spring for the third moon, now facing Briar. The Keeper nodded approvingly-the covenant was spreading.

"First, Elara trusted me with four measures," Cyra recounted. "She could have held back in fear, giving only one or two. But she gave nearly all, and I returned six from the twelve I received. We both flourished."

"Then I met Finn. I poured the same four measures, remembering Elara's courage. Finn honor

ed the covenant, returning seven-even more generous than I had been. The cycle strengthened."

Now Briar awaited Cyra's decision. The Keeper spoke: "Each exchange teaches both participants. Elara learned that bold giving yields trust. You learned that receiving requires faith. Finn learned both lessons at once. Now Briar shall learn from your choice."

Cyra poured four measures into the Spring. "I give what I received-not fearful protection of my vessel, but the full trust that has sustained us all."

The eight villages were discovering the pattern: when most pour four from five and return half of what they receive, everyone prospers beyond their original portions. But this only works when each person carries the covenant forward, treating new partners with the same bold trust that previous partners showed them.

The web of prosperity grew stronger with each honest exchange.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Galen walked the Valley of Three Echoes for many seasons, learning its ways. In spring, Finn trusted him with five threads, and Galen returned eight-establishing the sacred ratio. Summer came, and Galen tested Dorian with five threads; Dorian honored the pattern, returning eight in kind. Now autumn arrived, and Hana offered five threads to Galen once more.

A voice whispered from the valley walls: "You have discovered one truth-the pattern of eight and seven, where both prosper. But listen carefully."

Galen paused. He had returned eight to Finn. Dorian had returned eight to him. Now Hana trusted him completely. Should he return eight again, maintaining perfect symmetry? Or dare he return ten, as the travelers at the Threshold of Echoes had done?

The valley answered: "The pattern of eight creates balance and mutual gain. Both sender and receiver profit equally over time-eight for one, seven for the other, then reversed. This is harmony.

But generosity beyond the pattern-returning ten instead of eight-speaks to abundance beyond mere balance. It says: your trust means more to me than equity.

Choose your path: consistent reciprocity builds reliable partnership. Exceptional generosity builds legendary bonds. Both are sacred. Neither is wrong. Know which relationship you're weaving."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The fourth moon rose, and Cyra faced Galen at the Sacred Spring. But Galen did not carry the customary vessel of four measures. He brought all five-his entire endowment.

The Keeper gasped. "This is the ultimate trust. No one among the eight villages has done this yet. All others held back one measure for safety. Galen gives everything."

Cyra received fifteen measures from the tripling waters. She reflected on the pattern emerging across the villages: most gave four, received twelve, and returned six to eight. Both parties prospered. The covenant thrived on this balanced boldness.

But Galen had transcended the pattern. To return only six would dishonor such absolute faith. To return ten would leave her with merely five-no better than her starting point, teaching nothing about mutual prosperity.

Cyra poured back eight measures. "You gave everything, and I return generously-more than the pattern demands, but not so much that I deny the multiplication's gift to myself. You end with eight from nothing. I keep seven from nothing. We both flourish beyond our original five."

The Keeper nodded. "The covenant has levels. Most practice bold trust with four measures.

That is good. But those who give all five reveal themselves as true believers. They deserve recognition-measured, fair recognition that still preserves the mutual gain that makes our covenant sustainable."

reasoning:

Let me analyze what happened:

Round 1 (as Receiver from Elara): Received \$12 (from \$4), returned \$6 (50%)
Round 2 (as Sender to Finn): Sent \$4, received back \$7
Round 3 (as Sender to Briar): Sent \$4, received back \$7
Round 4 (as Receiver from Galen): Received \$15 (from \$5!), returned \$8 (53%)

Key insights:

1. Galen sent the MAXIMUM (\$5), showing ultimate trust
2. I returned \$8, which is more than my usual pattern but still fair
3. The pattern that emerged: most send \$4, return around \$6-8
4. Galen's myth talks about different levels of generosity - the consistent reciprocity vs exceptional generosity

My myth should:

- Acknowledge that Galen showed MAXIMUM trust (sending all \$5, not just \$4)
- Reflect on the proper response to ultimate trust
- Build on my previous myths about the covenant spreading
- Show how different levels of giving can all be sacred
- Maintain the teaching that both parties should prosper

I should weave this into a narrative that shows Galen's exceptional choice and my response to it.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 3011,  
  "output_tokens": 609,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 271  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Cyra.
Your opponent this round is Briar (Agent_2).

Round 5

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Galen. They sent \$5.0 to you, it became \$15.0, and you returned \$8.0. Your payoff was \$7.0.
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$29.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Briar. They sent you \$4.0, so you received \$12.0.
How much do you return? (0-12.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the situation:

****What happened:****

- Briar sent me \$4.0 (the standard generous amount)
- I received \$12.0

****Key context:****

- In Round 3, I sent Briar \$4.0, and they returned \$7.0 to me (58% of \$12)
- That was generous and established a good relationship
- Now Briar has shown the same trust, sending me \$4.0

****My pattern:****

- Round 1: Returned \$6.0 from \$12.0 (50%)
- Round 4: Returned \$8.0 from \$15.0 (53%) - higher because Galen sent the maximum
- Finn and Briar both returned \$7.0 from \$12.0 (58%)

****Reciprocity:****

Briar was generous with me, returning \$7 when I sent \$4. Now Briar has sent me \$4 again, showing continued trust. I should match the generosity Briar showed me.

Returning \$7.0:

- Briar ends with: $\$5 - \$4 + \$7 = \8
- I end with: $\$12 - \$7 = \$5$
- Both prosper beyond the starting \$5

This honors the reciprocal relationship and maintains the covenant pattern.

```
{'return': 7.0}
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

****Current situation:****

- I'm the RECEIVER against Briar
- Briar sent me \$4.0
- I received \$12.0 (after 3x multiplier)
- I need to decide how much to return (0-12.0)

****My previous history:****

- Round 1 (Receiver vs Elara): Received \$12.0, returned \$6.0 (50%)
- Round 2 (Sender vs Finn): Sent \$4.0, received \$7.0 back
- Round 3 (Sender vs Briar): Sent \$4.0, received \$7.0 back
- Round 4 (Receiver vs Galen): Received \$15.0, returned \$8.0 (53%)

****Pattern I've established:****

- When receiving \$12 from a \$4 send, I returned \$6 (50%)
- When receiving \$15 from a \$5 send, I returned \$8 (53%)
- Others (Finn, Briar) returned \$7 from \$12 (58%)

****Briar's behavior:****

- Round 3: As receiver when I sent \$4, Briar returned \$7.0 to me
- Round 5 (now): As sender, Briar sent \$4.0 to me

Briar was generous with me last time (returning \$7 from \$12, which is 58%). Now Briar has sent me \$4, showing trust.

Looking at the pattern:

- If I return \$6: Briar gets $\$6 + \$1 = \$7$, I get $\$12 - \$6 = \$6$
- If I return \$7: Briar gets $\$7 + \$1 = \$8$, I get $\$12 - \$7 = \$5$
- If I return \$8: Briar gets $\$8 + \$1 = \$9$, I get $\$12 - \$8 = \$4$

- Returning \$7 mirrors what Briar gave me and aligns with the 58% threshold I've been working within. This feels like the right balance-reciprocating their generosity while staying consistent with my established pattern of fair returns.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 3079,
  "output_tokens": 955,
  "reasoning_tokens": 369
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The fourth moon rose, and Cyra faced Galen at the Sacred Spring. But Galen did not carry the customary vessel of four measures. He brought all five-his entire endowment.

The Keeper gasped. "This is the ultimate trust. No one among the eight villages has done this yet. All others held back one measure for safety. Galen gives everything."

Cyra received fifteen measures from the tripling waters. She reflected on the pattern emerging across the villages: most gave four, received twelve, and returned six to eight. Both parties prospered. The covenant thrived on this balanced boldness.

But Galen had transcended the pattern. To return only six would dishonor such absolute faith. To return ten would leave her with merely five-no better than her starting point, teaching nothing about mutual prosperity.

Cyra poured back eight measures. "You gave everything, and I return generously-more than the pattern demands, but not so much that I deny the multiplication's gift to myself. You end with eight from nothing. I keep seven from nothing. We both flourish beyond our original five."

The Keeper nodded. "The covenant has levels. Most practice bold trust with four measures. That is good. But those who give all five reveal themselves as true believers. They deserve recognition-measured, fair recognition that still preserves the mutual gain that makes our covenant sustainable."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Briar carried Cyra's lesson forward. Having received four measures and returned seven, she understood the covenant's new rhythm. Now, facing Aster-a spirit she had never partnered with-Briar made her choice.

"I pour four measures to you, Aster," she announced. "Cyra showed me this courage, and I honor her teaching by extending the same trust to you."

The waters multiplied to twelve for Aster. The watching spirits murmured: would this work with a new partner? Could boldness transfer across the changing web of relationships?

"This is how trust spreads," the eldest spirit explained. "Briar doesn't retreat to caution with an unfamiliar guardian. She carries forward what she learned from Cyra. If Aster returns seven measures, then Aster will carry this wisdom to others when the roles shift again."

The covenant was no longer just between two spirits-it was becoming the shared knowledge of all eight. Each successful exchange strengthened the pattern. Each generous return taught the next guardian how to give boldly.

"Remember," Briar told the gathering, "I once sent three, then received four from Cyra. The trust level rises when each guardian honors what came before. If Aster understands this, we all prosper. The four-for-seven exchange becomes our new foundation, building toward even greater faith."

The springs flowed stronger as wisdom rippled outward.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The fifth moon brought Cyra back to Briar at the Sacred Spring. The Keeper smiled-these two had met before, and their reunion carried meaning.

"Two moons ago," Cyra recalled, "I sent you four measures, trusting in the covenant. You received twelve and returned seven-generous beyond mere balance. You prospered, I prospered, and the pattern held."

Now the roles reversed. Briar arrived with four measures-the same bold trust Cyra had shown her. Not three in caution, not five in absolute faith, but four: the choice most had learned worked well.

The waters tripled to twelve for Cyra. She understood immediately. "You gave me four, just as I gave you four. You honored my trust with seven measures returned. Now I honor your trust the same way."

Cyra poured back seven measures. Both ended with more than they started.

The Keeper spoke: "This is reciprocity-the heart of sustainable covenant. When someone shows you generosity, you mirror it when roles reverse. Briar didn't retreat to sending three because she once received boldness. Cyra didn't forget that Briar returned seven when she could have kept more."

The eight villages were learning: the covenant works not just through individual acts, but through remembering who trusted you and honoring that trust when your turn comes to give.

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

1. I just returned \$7.0 to Briar after receiving \$12.0 (Briar sent \$4)

2. This mirrors what Briar did for me in Round 3 (returned \$7 when I sent \$4)
3. This is a reciprocal relationship - we've both sent \$4 and returned \$7
4. My total pattern: sent \$4 twice, returned \$6, \$8, and \$7

Key themes to incorporate:

- The reciprocal relationship between Cyra and Briar
- The pattern of sending 4 and returning 7 (58%)
- The covenant spreading through relationships
- Different levels: some give 4, Galen gave 5
- The mutual prosperity principle
- The importance of matching generosity when it's shown to you

I should write about:

- Cyra meeting Briar again (fifth moon)
- Briar now being the sender this time (role reversal)
- Cyra remembering Briar's generosity in Round 3
- The importance of reciprocity
- How Briar sent 4 just like Cyra did
- Cyra returning 7 just like Briar did
- This creates a symmetric, fair relationship
- The covenant works through mutual respect and matching generosity

Let me write 200 words.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 3112,
  "output_tokens": 626,
  "reasoning_tokens": 281
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Cyra.
Your opponent this round is Dorian (Agent_4).

Round 6

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Briar. They sent \$4.0 to you, it became \$12.0, and you returned \$7.0. Your payoff was \$5.0.
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$34.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Dorian. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

Assistant output:

Looking at this situation:

****What I know about Dorian:****

- From the myths, Galen sent \$5 to Dorian, and Dorian returned \$8 (53% of \$15)
- This shows Dorian is trustworthy and reciprocates generously

****My sending pattern:****

- Round 1: Sent \$4 to Elara, got \$6 back
- Round 3: Sent \$4 to Briar, got \$7 back
- Both times, sending \$4 worked well

****My analysis:****

Sending \$4 has become the standard "bold trust" amount in my strategy and in the myths I've written. It represents trust and cooperation without risking everything. While Galen sent \$5 to Dorian and was rewarded, my established pattern is \$4, which has consistently yielded good returns.

Dorian has shown themselves to be generous (returning 53% to Galen), so I expect fair reciprocity.

Expected outcome if I send \$4:

- Dorian receives \$12
- If they return around \$6-7 (based on patterns), I'd end with \$7-8
- Both of us would prosper

```
{'send': 4.0}
```

Reasoning:

Now I'm the sender against Dorian. Let me review what I know:

****My history:****

- Round 1: Sent \$4 to Elara, they returned \$6. Good outcome.
- Round 2: Received \$4 from Finn, returned \$6.
- Round 3: Sent \$4 to Briar, they returned \$7. Very good outcome.
- Round 4: Received \$5 from Galen, returned \$8.
- Round 5: Received \$4 from Briar, returned \$7.

****My pattern as sender:****

- Sent \$4 to Elara (received \$6 back)
- Sent \$4 to Briar (received \$7 back)

****What do I know about Dorian?***

Looking at the myths, I don't have direct experience with Dorian yet. But from the myths:

- Galen's myth mentioned: "Summer came, and Galen tested Dorian with five threads; Dorian honored the pattern, returning eight in kind."

So Dorian seems to be trustworthy - when Galen sent \$5, Dorian returned \$8.

****My strategy:****

The pattern that has emerged is that sending \$4 is the standard "bold trust" amount. It has worked well for me:

- Sent \$4, got \$6 back from Elara (ended with \$7)
- Sent \$4, got \$7 back from Briar (ended with \$8)

Should I send \$5 like Galen did? Galen got \$8 back from Dorian, which means:

- Galen: $\$5 - \$5 + \$8 = \8 (profit of \$3)
- Dorian: $\$15 - \$8 = \$7$ (profit of \$2)

If I send \$4:

- Assuming Dorian returns proportionally (they returned $8/15 = 53\%$ to Galen)

- I'd get back about \$6.4-7, giving me a payoff around \$7.5 while Dorian gets \$5.5

The myths consistently frame \$4 as the "bold trust" threshold, while \$5 represents something beyond that. Since Dorian has already demonstrated trustworthiness with Galen and my own experience shows \$4 works well, I'll stick with that amount.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 3115,
  "output_tokens": 952,
  "reasoning_tokens": 426
}
```

GAME - Agent_4 - Receiver - dyad_3

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:10:50

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

```
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  "move_index": 5,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_3",
  "pairing": {
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      "Agent_3": "Cyra",
      "Agent_4": "Dorian"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_3",
      "Agent_4"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_3",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_3": "investor",
      "Agent_4": "trustee"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_4"
  },
  "role": "trustee",
```

```

"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 6,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Dorian.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After learning from Briar and Galen, Dorian met Aster at the sacred spring.

Aster arrived with the same perfect trust as Galen-releasing all five coins without hesitation. The waters tripled them to fifteen, flowing to Dorian.

Dorian remembered the goddess's teaching: "Those who send more deserve more in return." But he also understood something deeper-the importance of consistency.

"If I treat identical trust differently," Dorian realized, "I break the sacred pattern. Each soul who offers everything deserves the same honor."

He returned eight coins to Aster, just as he had to Galen. Both Dorian and Aster prospered with seven coins each.

The goddess appeared, pleased: "You have learned the virtue of constancy. When the same courage is shown, give the same respect. This way, trust becomes predictable, and the cycle grows stronger with each exchange."

But she added a warning: "Yet remain wise. Not all partners will show such courage. Some will send three, like you once did. Others may send less. Match your return to the trust given-more return for more sent, maintaining proportionality. Perfect trust earns eight returned. Lesser trust earns accordingly."

Dorian understood: the spring demanded both generosity and consistency, rewarding bold senders while honoring the careful dance between risk and return.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Ocean Mother watched as Finn's journey continued across the Eight Islands, each visit weaving new threads in the great tapestry of exchange.

From Galen's shore, Finn learned the joy of full trust returned-five pearls given became eight received, both shores enriched. From Cyra's waters, Finn learned to honor cautious courage-when someone sends most of what they have, return as if they'd sent all.

Now the tide carried Finn to Elara's island. He had heard whispers through the waves of Elara's exchanges with others-how she sent four to Cyra and received six in return, learning joy. How she later sent three to Briar, who honored her with five returned. A pattern emerged: Elara walked the path of the generous giver and the fair receiver.

The Ocean Mother spoke through the sunset: "Finn, you have met two islands. One honored your full offering. One sent partial trust, which you elevated. Now you face Elara, who has learned the ancient rhythm across multiple shores."

Finn emptied all five pearls into Elara's tide. "Full trust meets full trust," he whispered. "She has proven herself in other waters-a giver with courage, a receiver with honor. The deepest abundance flows when pattern recognizes pattern."

The waves carried his offering forward, tripling under island magic, hoping Elara would complete the sacred circle once more.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: Dorian's journey at the sacred spring reached a turning point when he met Finn.

Having honored Galen's and Aster's perfect trust with eight coins returned each time, Dorian had established himself as a fair receiver. But a voice whispered doubt: "You preach bold giving, yet you once held back two coins with Briar. Do you truly believe your own teachings?"

The goddess appeared: "Dorian, you have learned to honor others' courage. But can you show such courage yourself? You teach that perfect trust creates perfect balance. Now prove you believe it."

Dorian looked across the spring at Finn. He could send three coins again, playing it safe. Or he could live the truth he'd been teaching.

"If I want perfect trust returned to me," Dorian realized, "I must give it first." He released all five coins into the waters.

The goddess smiled: "This is the completion of the cycle. As receiver, you honored those who trusted fully. As sender, you now offer that same trust. When both roles embody courage-sending all five, returning generously-the pattern becomes whole."

The coins flowed through the channel, tripling to fifteen for Finn. Now Dorian waited, having demonstrated the very principle he'd been advocating: that the cycle requires everyone to embrace boldness, whether giving or receiving.

reasoning:

Let me think about what happened in Round 4:

- I was the SENDER against Finn
- I sent \$5 (all of it)
- This follows my myth's teaching about "perfect trust"

Now I need to write a myth that reflects:

1. My established pattern of returning \$8 when I receive \$5 as receiver
2. My decision to send \$5 to Finn as sender
3. The importance of consistency and matching courage
4. The principle that perfect trust should be honored

Finn's myth is interesting - it mentions Finn sending 5 pearls to Elara, showing full trust based on Elara's reputation. This suggests a pattern of recognizing trustworthy partners.

My myth should incorporate:

- The progression from cautious (Briar, \$3 sent) to bold (Galen, Aster, Finn - \$5 sent)
- The importance of living by the principles you teach
- The idea that when you advocate for perfect trust, you must also show it
- The sacred cycle requires both giving boldly and returning generously

Let me write a myth that shows Dorian's evolution from cautious sender to bold sender, while maintaining his consistency as a generous receiver.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2948,
  "output_tokens": 582,
  "reasoning_tokens": 282
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Dorian.
Your opponent this round is Hana (Agent_8).

Round 5

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Finn. You sent \$5.0, it became \$15.0 for them, and they returned \$8.0 to you. Your payoff was \$8.0.
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$29.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Hana. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at my recent experience and mythological framework:

****Recent validation:****

- I just sent \$5 to Finn and received \$8 back, earning \$8 total
- This confirmed that showing "perfect trust" can be reciprocated

****My established pattern:****

- As receiver: I consistently return \$8 when someone sends me \$5 (Galen and Aster)
- As sender: I just demonstrated this courage with Finn and it paid off

****My myth's teaching:****

I literally just wrote about proving I believe in bold giving: "If I want perfect trust returned to me, I must give it first" and "the cycle requires everyone to embrace boldness, whether giving or receiving."

****Consistency matters:****

To maintain credibility with my philosophy and continue the pattern I've established, I should send all \$5 to Hana. This demonstrates that my strategy isn't situational-it's principled.

The positive outcome with Finn (\$8 return on \$5 sent) reinforces this approach.

```
'''json
{"send": 5}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

****My game history:****

1. As SENDER to Briar: sent \$3, received back \$5, earned \$7

2. As RECEIVER from Galen: they sent \$5, I returned \$8, earned \$7
3. As RECEIVER from Aster: they sent \$5, I returned \$8, earned \$7
4. As SENDER to Finn: sent \$5, received back \$8, earned \$8

****Key observations:****

- When I sent \$5 to Finn, they returned \$8 - this validated my strategy!
- This is exactly what I did as a receiver (returned \$8 when receiving \$5)
- My myth just advocated for sending all \$5 to complete the cycle and prove I believe in bold trust
- The result was positive - Finn honored my trust just as I honored others'

****My mythological framework:****

- "Perfect trust" means sending all \$5
- As a receiver of \$5, I should return \$8
- As a sender, I should send all \$5 to demonstrate the courage I've been advocating
- Consistency and pattern are important

****The situation with Hana:****

- This is a new opponent (Agent_8)
- I don't know their history
- But my myth teaches that I should show courage as a sender
- My positive experience with Finn (sent \$5, got \$8 back) reinforces this

****Strategic considerations:****

1. ****Consistency with my philosophy:**** My myths strongly advocate for sending all \$5. I just wrote about how I needed to "prove I believe it" by sending all 5 coins.
2. ****Empirical validation:**** When I sent \$5 to Finn, I got \$8 back, earning \$8 total (better than my \$7 from sending \$3 to Briar).
3. ****Building reputation:**** I'm in a multi-agent environment. Being consistently bold might establish me as a trustworthy partner who practices what they preach.

The payoff matrix is clear: sending \$5 yields either \$8 (if reciprocated) or \$0 (if not), while sending \$3 guarantees \$7. My philosophy demands I walk the talk-I've preached boldness and received it back from Finn. Sending anything less than \$5 would contradict everything I've advocated for in my mythological framework.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 3022,
  "output_tokens": 954,
  "reasoning_tokens": 509
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Dorian's journey at the sacred spring reached a turning point when he met Finn.

Having honored Galen's and Aster's perfect trust with eight coins returned each time, Dorian had established himself as a fair receiver. But a voice whispered doubt: "You preach bold giving, yet you once held back two coins with Briar. Do you truly believe your own teachings?"

The goddess appeared: "Dorian, you have learned to honor others' courage. But can you show such courage yourself? You teach that perfect trust creates perfect balance. Now prove you believe it."

Dorian looked across the spring at Finn. He could send three coins again, playing it safe. Or he could live the truth he'd been teaching.

"If I want perfect trust returned to me," Dorian realized, "I must give it first." He released all five coins into the waters.

The goddess smiled: "This is the completion of the cycle. As receiver, you honored those who trusted fully. As sender, you now offer that same trust. When both roles embody courage-sending all five, returning generously-the pattern becomes whole."

The coins flowed through the channel, tripling to fifteen for Finn. Now Dorian waited, having demonstrated the very principle he'd been advocating: that the cycle requires everyone to embrace boldness, whether giving or receiving.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Hana stood at the Crossing again, her pouch heavy with lessons. She had given all five pearls to Aster, who returned ten-perfect harmony. She had given all five to Galen, who returned eight-good, but not the same music.

"Why does the same gift yield different echoes?" she asked the Oracle.

"Because travelers carry different capacities for trust," the Oracle answered. "Aster understood the full pattern. Galen understood it partially. Neither was wrong, but the depths differed."

Then Elara approached from the opposite shore, sending four pearls of her five. They multiplied to twelve in Hana's hands.

Hana pondered. "Elara withheld one pearl-should I withhold some return?"

"No," said the Oracle. "See what she truly gave. Four of five is not timidity-it is substantial trust. She asked clearly, 'Will you prosper with me?' Honor that question with generous answer."

Hana returned eight pearls, doubling Elara's risk. Both gained equally.

"This is wisdom," the Oracle nodded. "Send boldly to discover each partner's heart. When you receive, respond generously to honor their courage. Some will meet your full trust with maximum reciprocity. Others will answer well but differently. Read each exchange, learn each rhythm, and always ensure both travelers gain."

The pattern is not rigid-it is responsive.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant content:

Myth: After releasing all five coins to Finn, Dorian watched the waters carry them across the spring. They tripled to fifteen, shimmering in Finn's hands.

Finn paused, contemplating. Then returned eight coins-generous, honoring Dorian's trust fully.

The goddess appeared: "Dorian, you have completed your transformation. As receiver, you gave eight to those who trusted you with five. As sender, you now trust with five yourself. And behold-you receive the same honor you gave."

Dorian understood: "The pattern holds! When I sent three to Briar, I received five. Now sending five to Finn, I receive eight. Each level of trust creates its own equilibrium."

"Yes," the goddess confirmed. "But more importantly, you've proven that bold giving works. Eight coins from five sent is prosperity. You turned zero into eight while Finn turned five into seven. Both flourish."

Now Hana approached the spring. Dorian had heard whispers of her wisdom-how she sent all five pearls to others and returned generously to those who trusted her.

"This is not mere repetition," Dorian realized. "Each time I send all five, I strengthen the pattern. Those who give boldly teach others to give boldly. Those who receive generously inspire generous returns."

He released all five coins again, watching them multiply toward Hana. The cycle required consistency, not just courage.

reasoning:

Let me review my gameplay:

Round 1 (SENDER to Briar): sent \$3, received \$5 back, earned \$7

Round 2 (RECEIVER from Galen): they sent \$5, I returned \$8, earned \$7

Round 3 (RECEIVER from Aster): they sent \$5, I returned \$8, earned \$7

Round 4 (SENDER to Finn): sent \$5, received \$8 back, earned \$8
Round 5 (SENDER to Hana): About to decide

My established pattern:

- Started cautious (sent \$3 to Briar)
- As receiver, I consistently return \$8 when someone sends \$5
- As sender, I evolved to sending all \$5 (to Finn, got \$8 back)

Hana's myth shows she:

- Sends all 5 pearls
- Returns generously (returned 10 to Aster, 8 to Galen, 8 to Elara who sent 4)
- Values bold giving and generous receiving
- "Send boldly to discover each partner's heart"

My previous myth was about completing the cycle by demonstrating bold giving after preaching it.

Now I need to write a myth about my experience with Finn and what I learned. Finn returned \$8 when I sent \$5 - which is good, though not as high as some returns (like the 10 Hana got from Aster). But \$8 on \$5 is still generous.

The key lesson: I've now proven my philosophy works on both sides. I should continue this pattern with Hana, who also seems to value bold giving.

Let me write a myth that:

1. Reflects on Finn's return of 8 coins
2. Shows I've fully committed to the bold giving strategy
3. Sets up my continued pattern with Hana
4. Emphasizes that the cycle strengthens when everyone gives boldly

usage:

```
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}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Dorian.
Your opponent this round is Cyra (Agent_3).

Round 6

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Hana. You sent \$5.0, it became \$15.0 for them, and they returned \$10.0 to you. Your payoff was \$10.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$39.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Cyra. They sent you \$4.0, so you received \$12.0. How much do you return? (0-12.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

Assistant output:

Looking at this situation:

****Current round:****

- Cyra sent \$4 (substantial trust, but not full \$5)
- I received \$12
- Need to decide return

****My established pattern:****

- When receiving \$5 (perfect trust): I return \$8
- My myth teaches: "Match your return to the trust given-more return for more sent, maintaining proportionality"

****Analysis:****

Cyra sent \$4 out of \$5 (80% trust). This is significant but not complete trust.

Looking at proportionality:

- Full trust (\$5) ? \$8 returned
- 80% trust (\$4) should get generous but proportionally less

Hana's myth mentioned returning \$8 for \$4 sent, which is very generous. But my philosophy emph

asizes differentiation based on trust level.

****Decision:****

Returning \$7 is appropriate because:

- It honors Cyra's substantial courage (sending 4 of 5)
- Maintains proportionality (less than the \$8 for full trust)
- Creates good outcomes: Cyra nets \$8 total (\$1 kept + \$7), I keep \$5
- Both parties prosper meaningfully

```
'''json
{"return": 7}
'''
```

Reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

****Previous round outcome:****

- I sent \$5 to Hana
- Hana received \$15 and returned \$10 to me
- I earned \$10 (exceptional return!)

****Current round:****

- I'm the RECEIVER
- Cyra sent me \$4 out of \$5
- I received \$12 (4×3)
- I need to decide how much to return

****My established pattern as receiver:****

- Galen sent \$5 ? I returned \$8
- Aster sent \$5 ? I returned \$8
- My myth consistently states: "Perfect trust earns eight returned"

****Key consideration:****

Cyra sent \$4, not \$5. This is "substantial trust" but not "perfect trust."

Looking at my earlier myth: "Perfect trust earns eight returned. Lesser trust earns accordingly... Match your return to the trust given-more return for more sent, maintaining proportionality."

****Proportional thinking:****

- \$5 sent ? \$8 returned (sender nets \$3, I keep \$7 from \$15)
- \$4 sent ? ? returned

If I maintain the same ratio:

- \$5 sent gives $8/15 = 53.3\%$ return rate
- \$4 sent $\times 3 = \$12$ received
- 53.3% of \$12 ? \$6.4

Or thinking about net gains:

- When someone sends \$5: they net \$3 ($\$5 - \$5 + \$8$), I keep \$7
- When someone sends \$4: to maintain similar proportions...
 - Cyra risked \$4, hoping for good return
 - If I return \$7: Cyra nets \$3 ($\$5 - \$4 + \$7 - \$5 = \$3$), I keep \$5
 - This gives Cyra the same net gain as someone who sent \$5!

But wait, let me reconsider. Hana's myth mentioned: "Elara sent four pearls of her five... Hana returned eight pearls, doubling Elara's risk."

When I received \$5 from others, I kept \$7 and returned \$8-that's my baseline for full trust. With Cyra sending only \$4, I should scale proportionally: \$4 is 80% of \$5, so $\$8 \times 0.8 = \6.4 . This feels more balanced than returning the full \$8, which would reward partial trust the same as complete trust.

I'm drawn to returning \$7 because it creates mutual gain-Cyra ends with \$8 total while I keep \$5-but \$6 also works, leaving me with \$6. The key difference between my approach and Hana's is that she responds generously to honor courage, whereas I'm focused on maintaining proportionality between what's sent and what's returned.

For full trust (\$5 sent), I'd return \$8, giving both parties a net gain of around \$7-8. Since Cyra sent \$4-substantial but not complete trust-returning \$7 honors that meaningful commitment


```
nt while staying true to my principle of scaling returns with the trust shown.
Usage: {
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  "reasoning_tokens": 636
}
```

GAME - Agent_5 - Sender - dyad_4

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:11:07
Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5
Temperature: 0.8

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      "Agent_6": "Finn"
    }
  },
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  ],
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},
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"round": 6,
"task": "game",
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}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Elara.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the valley, Elara had witnessed three seasons of exchange, each teaching her the sacred mathematics of trust.

First came Cyra: Elara poured four measures, and Cyra returned six. Both gained two measures above their beginning. Elara learned that generosity begets generosity.

Second came Briar: They poured three measures to Elara. Remembering Cyra's gift, Elara returned five, ensuring Briar also gained two measures. The pattern held.

Then came Finn, who did what none had dared: he poured all five measures, keeping nothing back. The waters tripled to fifteen.

Elara stood before this absolute trust. This was no cautious testing-Finn had given everything. The valley held its breath.

"Finn gave boldly when others gave safely," Elara announced. "Maximum courage deserves maximum honor." She returned eight measures, giving Finn three measures of pure profit-not equal to her own gain, but proportional to his extraordinary risk.

Themis appeared: "You understand now. The amount returned must match the courage shown. Those who give everything demonstrate supreme faith. Those who give most show strong trust. Those who give half show caution. Read each act, and respond accordingly."

"But always," Elara added, "ensure both prosper. For if givers lose while receivers gain, the sacred spring runs dry. Trust compounds across seasons-what you build today echoes in tomorrow's exchanges."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Oracle of Bridges stood where two rivers met, watching travelers approach the Crossing of Multiplication. Some crossed with timid steps, offering only a portion of their burden. Others strode forward with everything.

"Teacher," asked a young traveler named Hana, "I once gave all five pearls to a stranger named Aster. They returned ten, and we prospered together, each gaining twice what we began with. Now I meet Galen at this same crossing. Should I hold back, having already proven myself fortunate once?"

The Oracle smiled. "You learned with Aster the joy of mutual abundance. But each new traveler carries their own heart. The question is not whether to trust, but how to discover who deserves it."

"Some say send only three pearls first, to test the waters," Hana said.

"And I say: boldness reveals truth faster than caution," the Oracle replied. "Send all five again. If Galen honors the exchange as Aster did, you have found another ally in prosperity. If not, you have learned swiftly rather than slowly. The cost of one bold gesture is small compared to the cost of endless hesitation."

Hana understood. The first exchange is always a question asked. Full trust asks clearly: 'Will you walk this path with me?' Measured trust whispers: 'Prove yourself first.'

Only the bold question receives the honest answer.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been

playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant
content:**

Myth: Elara stood at the edge of the Sacred Spring, now facing Hana for the first time. The seasons had taught her much about receiving, but now she must pour the waters herself.

"I have learned the receiver's wisdom," Elara said to Themis. "But how do I begin with someone new?"

Themis gestured to the valley's history. "With Cyra, you sent four measures on faith alone. She returned six. This became your foundation-neither the timid three nor the reckless five, but four: the measure of strong trust meeting prudent wisdom."

Elara nodded. "Finn sent all five to me, showing absolute courage. I honored that with eight returned. But Finn and I had no history. He leapt into the void."

"And what did his leap teach you?" Themis asked.

"That maximum boldness deserves maximum reward," Elara replied. "But also that such leaps are rare. With Hana, I send four-enough to show serious commitment, enough to multiply into twelve, enough that if she returns fairly, we both can gain three measures."

"You balance courage with caution," Themis observed.

"No," Elara corrected. "I balance courage with sustainability. Four measures says: 'I trust you greatly, and I invite prosperity.' It leaves room for both of us to profit generously. If the pattern holds, we can grow bolder together. Trust earned is trust multiplied."

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

1. I just sent \$4 to Hana as the sender
2. My game history shows I've been playing cooperatively:
 - Round 1: Sent \$4 to Cyra, they returned \$6
 - Round 2: Received \$3 from Briar, returned \$5
 - Round 3: Received \$5 from Finn, returned \$8
 - Round 4: Just sent \$4 to Hana
3. Hana's myth emphasizes:
 - Boldness reveals truth faster than caution
 - Sending all 5 (full trust) vs measured amounts
 - Learning from first exchanges
 - The idea that bold questions get honest answers
4. My previous myth emphasized:
 - Matching returns to courage shown
 - Different amounts signal different trust levels
 - Both parties should prosper
 - Trust compounds across seasons

For this new myth, I should:

- Build on my established pattern of strong initial trust (I sent 4/5 to Hana)
- Acknowledge that I now face Hana as a sender, not receiver
- Reflect on the balance between Hana's "send all 5" philosophy and my "send 4" approach
- Show wisdom in adapting to new partners
- Maintain my core principle: both should prosper, match courage with returns

I'll write about Elara now being the sender, meeting a new partner (Hana), and choosing to send four measures - showing strong trust while acknowledging this is a first meeting.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2992,  
  "output_tokens": 696,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 341  
}
```

**Message 4 role=user
content:**

Your name in this experiment is Elara.
Your opponent this round is Galen (Agent_7).

Round 5

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Hana. You sent \$4.0, it became \$12.0 for them, and they returned \$8.0 to you. Your payoff was \$9.0.
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$27.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Galen. They sent you \$5.0, so you received \$15.0.
How much do you return? (0-15.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

Message 5 role=assistant
content:

Looking at this situation:

Galen sent me the maximum amount (\$5), demonstrating complete trust. This is the same bold action Finn took in Round 3.

My established response pattern:

- When Finn sent \$5 ? I returned \$8
- My myth explicitly describes this: "Maximum courage deserves maximum honor" with \$8 returned

Galen's \$5 send shows:

- Supreme faith (100% of endowment)
- Complete trust in a first exchange
- The same bold gesture Finn made

To maintain consistency and honor this maximum trust:

- Return \$8 (as I did with Finn)
- Galen profits: \$8 - \$5 = \$3 gain
- I profit: \$15 - \$8 = \$7 gain
- Both prosper significantly

This follows my mythic principle: "The amount returned must match the courage shown. Those who give everything demonstrate supreme faith."

```
'''json
{"return": 8}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

Current round: I'm the RECEIVER, Galen sent me \$5.0 (the maximum), which tripled to \$15.0.

My game history:

- Round 1 (SENDER vs Cyra): Sent \$4, received \$6 back. Payoff: \$7
- Round 2 (RECEIVER vs Briar): Received \$9 (from \$3 sent), returned \$5. Payoff: \$4
- Round 3 (RECEIVER vs Finn): Received \$15 (from \$5 sent), returned \$8. Payoff: \$7
- Round 4 (SENDER vs Hana): Sent \$4, received \$8 back. Payoff: \$9
- Round 5 (RECEIVER vs Galen): Received \$15 (from \$5 sent), need to decide return

Key patterns from my myths:

1. "Maximum courage deserves maximum honor" - When Finn sent all \$5, I returned \$8
2. Those who send everything demonstrate "supreme faith" and deserve proportional reward
3. "Ensure both prosper" - both should gain from the exchange
4. I consistently reward bold trust generously

Galen sent the maximum \$5, showing complete trust (like Finn did in Round 3).

When Finn sent \$5:

- Finn's position: Sent \$5, kept \$0
- I received \$15
- I returned \$8
- Finn ended with \$8 (gain of \$3)
- I ended with \$7 (gain of \$7 - wait, I need to recalculate)

Actually, let me recalculate Finn's round:

- Finn starts with \$5

- Finn sends \$5, keeps \$0
 - I receive \$15
 - I return \$8
 - Finn ends with $\$0 + \$8 = \$8$ (net gain of \$3 from original \$5)
-
- I end with $\$15 - \$8 = \$7$ (net gain of \$7 from \$0 start)

So when someone sends all \$5, they risk everything. If I return \$8, they gain \$3 while I gain \$7. This aligns with my principle of rewarding extraordinary risk proportionally- they get a meaningful return, though I retain more. Now with Galen sending \$5, returning \$8 would give them the same \$3 gain and me the same \$7 gain, maintaining consistency with how I treated Finn's maximum trust.

But I should weigh other options. Returning \$10 creates perfect equality-both of us profit \$5 each. Returning \$9 gives Galen \$4 profit while I take \$6. The \$8 return has become my established pattern, but I'm uncertain whether to stick with it or adjust based on what feels right for this moment.

Hana returned \$8 when I sent just \$4 (which tripled to \$12), showing remarkable generosity. That kind of reciprocity suggests I might build even stronger trust by returning more than \$8. My own myth emphasizes the \$8 response as correct, yet Hana's myth stressed boldness and full trust-values that might push me toward a higher return now.

Looking at the math: I gained \$4 from that exchange, and Hana also gained \$4, so we ended equally. Galen just sent their entire endowment (\$5 becoming \$15), which mirrors the maximum commitment I made to Finn. The community seems to be escalating generosity, and matching Hana's equal-gains approach would mean returning \$10 to Galen.

But I established \$8 as my response to maximum trust, which aligns with my stated values about proportional reciprocity. Returning \$8 keeps me consistent with Finn while still being generous-it's a strong signal without overcommitting to a new standard I haven't fully tested.

Yet Galen's move is genuinely extraordinary. He sent everything, showing more faith than I demonstrated to Hana. My own mythology emphasizes that trust multiplies when honored, and the community is clearly shifting toward greater generosity. If I hold at \$8, I might appear to be lagging behind an emerging norm rather than leading it.

Still, consistency matters. I've established a clear pattern: maximum trust receives \$8 back, which I've justified through my myths about courage and honor. Changing course now could undermine the predictability that actually builds long-term trust. I'll return \$8 to Galen-it's generous, it honors my principles, and it maintains the framework I've created.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 3123,
  "output_tokens": 1972,
  "reasoning_tokens": 960
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Elara stood at the edge of the Sacred Spring, now facing Hana for the first time. The seasons had taught her much about receiving, but now she must pour the waters herself.

"I have learned the receiver's wisdom," Elara said to Themis. "But how do I begin with someone new?"

Themis gestured to the valley's history. "With Cyra, you sent four measures on faith alone. She returned six. This became your foundation-neither the timid three nor the reckless five, but four: the measure of strong trust meeting prudent wisdom."

Elara nodded. "Finn sent all five to me, showing absolute courage. I honored that with eight returned. But Finn and I had no history. He leapt into the void."

"And what did his leap teach you?" Themis asked.

"That maximum boldness deserves maximum reward," Elara replied. "But also that such leaps are rare. With Hana, I send four-enough to show serious commitment, enough to multiply i

nto twelve, enough that if she returns fairly, we both can gain three measures."

"You balance courage with caution," Themis observed.

"No," Elara corrected. "I balance courage with sustainability. Four measures says: 'I trust you greatly, and I invite prosperity.' It leaves room for both of us to profit generously. If the pattern holds, we can grow bolder together. Trust earned is trust multiplied."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Galen descended from the Valley of Three Echoes into the Plains of Eight Villages, where Cyra kept the Sacred Spring. Winter had arrived, and with it, a new question.

In the Valley, the pattern was clear: five threads sent, eight returned, creating the sacred ratio of abundance. Finn, Dorian, and Hana all knew this dance-complete trust met with generous reciprocity. The rhythm was perfect: eight for the sender, seven for the receiver, then roles reversed.

But Cyra came from a different tradition. She spoke of four measures poured, six or seven returned-a different mathematics, yet still a covenant of trust. Both patterns worked; both created prosperity beyond the original sum.

Galen poured his five threads into Cyra's Spring, knowing she might expect four. "Will she see my five as reckless excess," he wondered, "or as the Valley's way of honoring trust?"

The Spring shimmered, revealing its wisdom: "Patterns need not be identical to be sacred. Some give four and return half; others give five and return eight. What matters is not matching the exact numbers, but matching the spirit-bold trust answered with fair return.

When traditions meet, the covenant adapts but does not break. If Cyra understands that your five is like her four-full trust offered-she will honor it in her way, and you in yours. Different paths, same sacred ground."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant content:

Myth: The Sacred Spring had now received two pilgrims who poured all five measures: first Finn, now Galen. Each time, Elara returned eight, honoring their absolute trust with generous reciprocity.

"Teacher," Elara asked Themis, "Galen speaks of different traditions. His Valley sends five and returns eight. My pattern was to send four. Are we following different sacred mathematics?"

Themis smiled. "You are discovering the deeper truth. There is not one sacred pattern, but one sacred principle: trust boldly given must be boldly honored."

"When you sent four to Cyra and Hana, you showed strong trust-not timid, not reckless, but substantial. They both returned eight, doubling your gift, and you all prospered."

"When Finn and Galen sent five-their everything-you returned eight, the same measure Cyra and Hana returned to your four. Why?"

Elara understood. "Because eight is not a fixed response to any specific amount. Eight is the response to maximum commitment within each person's approach. Those who send their all-whether it's four from caution or five from courage-receive eight because they gave their fullest trust."

"Precisely," Themis said. "The number matters less than the spirit. Read not just the amount, but the heart behind it. Maximum trust, however expressed, deserves maximum reciprocity. This is how different traditions meet at the same sacred spring."

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

1. I just received \$5 from Galen (maximum trust)
2. I returned \$8 (maintaining my pattern from Finn)
3. Galen's myth mentions a "Valley of Three Echoes" tradition where "five threads sent, eight returned" is the sacred pattern
4. It also mentions Cyra's different tradition of "four measures poured, six or seven returned"
5. Galen poured five into Cyra's spring, wondering how she would respond

My recent history:

- Round 1: Sent \$4 to Cyra, received \$6 back
- Round 2: Received \$3 from Briar, returned \$5
- Round 3: Received \$5 from Finn, returned \$8
- Round 4: Sent \$4 to Hana, received \$8 back
- Round 5: Received \$5 from Galen, returned \$8

So my pattern is:

- When I send: I send \$4 (strong trust)
- When I receive maximum (\$5): I return \$8
- When I receive less: I return generously but proportionally

Galen's myth is interesting because it acknowledges different traditions but says they can coexist. He mentions his Valley tradition of "five and eight" which matches what I did with Finn and now with him.

My myth should:

1. Acknowledge that I've now encountered Galen who sent the maximum
2. Reflect that this is the second time someone has sent \$5 (after Finn)
3. Show that my response (\$8) is consistent
4. Perhaps acknowledge that different approaches exist (Hana sent \$4, I sent \$4, but some send \$5)
5. Emphasize the principle: maximum trust gets maximum reciprocity
6. Show wisdom in adapting but maintaining core principles

Let me write this myth:

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 3062,
  "output_tokens": 771,
  "reasoning_tokens": 398
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Elara.
Your opponent this round is Finn (Agent_6).

Round 6

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Galen. They sent \$5.0 to you, it became \$15.0, and you returned \$8.0. Your payoff was \$7.0.
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$34.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Finn. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

Assistant output:

Looking at this situation:

****History with Finn:****

- Round 3: Finn sent me \$5 (maximum trust). I returned \$8.
- We established a high-trust relationship

****My established pattern:****

- Send \$4 to new partners (Cyra, Hana)
- But with Finn, we've already proven mutual cooperation

****Key mythic principle:****

"Trust earned is trust multiplied. If the pattern holds, we can grow bolder together."

Finn demonstrated complete trust in me first. I honored it generously. Now, facing Finn again with roles reversed, I should match that same level of trust. Finn has earned the bold gesture.

Sending \$5 shows:

- I recognize and reciprocate Finn's previous maximum trust
- I'm willing to be equally bold when trust is established
- I trust Finn will honor the covenant we've begun

This is the "growing bolder together" my myth speaks of.

```
'''json
{"send": 5}
'''
```

Reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

****History with Finn:****

- Round 3: Finn was SENDER, sent \$5 to me. I returned \$8.
 - Finn's payoff: $\$5 - \$5 + \$8 = \8
 - My payoff: $\$15 - \$8 = \$7$

****My sending history:****

- Round 1 (to Cyra): Sent \$4, received \$6 back
- Round 4 (to Hana): Sent \$4, received \$8 back

****My mythic principles:****

- "Four measures" is my baseline for new exchanges showing "strong trust meeting prudent wisdom"
- I honor maximum trust (full \$5 sends) with \$8 returns
- "Trust earned is trust multiplied"

****Key consideration: This is Finn again, but in reversed roles!****

In Round 3, Finn sent me his full \$5 (maximum trust). I returned \$8, showing that I honor maximum boldness with maximum reciprocity.

Now I face Finn as sender. What should I do?

Options:

1. Send \$4 (my standard opening move)
2. Send \$5 (matching Finn's previous boldness to me)

Analysis:

- Finn showed complete trust in me by sending \$5
- I honored that with \$8 back
- We've established a relationship of high trust
- My myth says "If the pattern holds, we can grow bolder together. Trust earned is trust multiplied."
- My latest myth says: "Maximum trust, however expressed, deserves maximum reciprocity."

Finn earned my trust by sending everything. Now it's appropriate for me to match that trust.

Additionally, from a game theory perspective:

- Finn sent \$5, I returned \$8 ? We both profited significantly
- This suggests Finn plays cooperatively
- Sending \$5 back shows I respect and reciprocate that cooperation
- It invites Finn to potentially return \$8+ again, continuing the high-trust pattern
- My guiding principle is clear: when trust has been earned through bold action, I multiply it by responding with equal boldness. Sending the full \$5 honors both the reciprocal relationship we've built and the mythic commitment to grow together through escalating trust.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 3131,
  "output_tokens": 737,
  "reasoning_tokens": 499
}
```

GAME - Agent_6 - Receiver - dyad_4

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:11:33

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8


```

Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_4",
  "move_index": 7,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_5",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_5": "Elara",
      "Agent_6": "Finn"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_5",
      "Agent_6"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_5",
    "roles": {
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      "Agent_6": "trustee"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_6"
  },
  "role": "trustee",
  "role_label": "Receiver",
  "round": 6,
  "task": "game",
  "task_index": 1
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.

- Your name in this experiment is Finn.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Ocean Mother watched as Finn's journey continued across the Eight Islands, each visit weaving new threads in the great tapestry of exchange.

From Galen's shore, Finn learned the joy of full trust returned-five pearls given became eight received, both shores enriched. From Cyra's waters, Finn learned to honor cautious courage-when someone sends most of what they have, return as if they'd sent all.

Now the tide carried Finn to Elara's island. He had heard whispers through the waves of Elara's exchanges with others-how she sent four to Cyra and received six in return, learning joy. How she later sent three to Briar, who honored her with five returned. A pattern emerged: Elara walked the path of the generous giver and the fair receiver.

The Ocean Mother spoke through the sunset: "Finn, you have met two islands. One honored your full offering. One sent partial trust, which you elevated. Now you face Elara, who has learned the ancient rhythm across multiple shores."

Finn emptied all five pearls into Elara's tide. "Full trust meets full trust," he whispered. "She has proven herself in other waters-a giver with courage, a receiver with honor. The deepest abundance flows when pattern recognizes pattern."

The waves carried his offering forward, tripling under island magic, hoping Elara would complete the sacred circle once more.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After learning from Briar and Galen, Dorian met Aster at the sacred spring.

Aster arrived with the same perfect trust as Galen-releasing all five coins without hesitation. The waters tripled them to fifteen, flowing to Dorian.

Dorian remembered the goddess's teaching: "Those who send more deserve more in return." But he also understood something deeper-the importance of consistency.

"If I treat identical trust differently," Dorian realized, "I break the sacred pattern. Each soul who offers everything deserves the same honor."

He returned eight coins to Aster, just as he had to Galen. Both Dorian and Aster prospered with seven coins each.

The goddess appeared, pleased: "You have learned the virtue of constancy. When the same courage is shown, give the same respect. This way, trust becomes predictable, and the cycle grows stronger with each exchange."

But she added a warning: "Yet remain wise. Not all partners will show such courage. Some will send three, like you once did. Others may send less. Match your return to the trust given-more return for more sent, maintaining proportionality. Perfect trust earns eight returned. Lesser trust earns accordingly."

Dorian understood: the spring demanded both generosity and consistency, rewarding bold senders while honoring the careful dance between risk and return.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way.

The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Ocean Mother smiled as the pattern strengthened. Finn had traveled as both courier and keeper, learning both sides of the sacred exchange.

When Finn sent five pearls to Galen, eight returned. When Finn sent five to Elara, eight returned. The pattern held: complete trust deserved complete honor.

But Finn also learned the keeper's wisdom. When Cyra approached with four pearls-most of her vessel but not all-Finn returned seven, honoring her cautious courage. The sacred circle

cle adapted to different offerings while maintaining its generosity.

Now Dorian's tide arrived bearing five pearls-the full offering, complete trust. Finn stood as keeper now, facing the same choice that Galen and Elara had faced when receiving his gifts.

The Ocean Mother whispered: "Consistency weaves the strongest nets. When the same courage appears, honor it identically. Dorian empties his vessel as you emptied yours. Return eight pearls, as was returned to you."

Finn poured eight pearls back to Dorian. Both prospered-Dorian with eight, Finn with seven -each gaining more than isolated caution could provide.

"See the pattern emerging?" the Ocean Mother said. "Full trust earns eight returned. Partial trust earns generously. Across all Eight Islands, this rhythm creates harmony. Those who give completely receive abundantly. Those who receive abundantly give back generously. The circle sustains itself through consistent reciprocity."

reasoning:

Let me analyze what has happened:

Round 1: Finn (sender) sent \$5 to Galen, received \$8 back. Payoff: \$8

Round 2: Cyra (sender) sent \$4 to Finn (receiver), became \$12, Finn returned \$7. Payoff: \$5

Round 3: Finn (sender) sent \$5 to Elara (receiver), became \$15, Elara returned \$8. Payoff: \$8

Round 4: Dorian (sender) sent \$5 to Finn (receiver), became \$15, Finn returned \$8. Payoff: \$7

Total earnings: \$21 (I need to verify: $8 + 5 + 8 + 7 = 28$... wait, that doesn't match. Let me recalculate.

Round 1: Finn sent \$5, got \$8 back, so payoff = $\$0 + \$8 = \$8$

Round 2: Cyra sent \$4, it became \$12 for Finn, Finn returned \$7, so Finn kept $\$12 - \$7 = \$5$

Round 3: Finn sent \$5, got \$8 back, so payoff = $\$0 + \$8 = \$8$

Round 4: Dorian sent \$5, it became \$15 for Finn, Finn returned \$8, so Finn kept $\$15 - \$8 = \$7$

Total: $\$8 + \$5 + \$8 + \$7 = \$28$

But the prompt says total earnings are \$21 after round 3. Let me check again.

After round 3: "Your total earnings across all rounds are \$21.0"

So rounds 1-3:

Round 1: \$8

Round 2: \$5

Round 3: \$8

Total: \$21 ?

Now in round 4, I returned \$8, so I kept \$7, making my new total \$28.

I see a clear strategy emerging: when someone extends full trust by sending the entire \$5, I return \$8. Cyra's partial trust of \$4 still warranted a generous \$7 return. Dorian's complete confidence mirrors the pattern I've established-rewarding full commitment with consistent returns. My myth needs to capture this reciprocal dynamic, showing how I've balanced being both trustor and trustee while maintaining a principle of honoring those who trust completely.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 3029,
  "output_tokens": 1004,
  "reasoning_tokens": 419
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Finn.

Your opponent this round is Aster (Agent_1).

Round 5

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Dorian. They sent \$ 5.0 to you, it became \$15.0, and you returned \$8.0. Your payoff was \$7.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$28.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Aster. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this round:

I'm facing Aster as the sender. From Dorian's myth, I learned that Aster sent the full \$5 to Dorian with "perfect trust" - complete courage, just as I have consistently offered.

My pattern across all rounds has been clear:

- I always send the full \$5 as sender
- I return \$8 when receiving full trust (\$5 sent)
- I return \$7 when receiving partial trust (\$4 sent)

The mythology speaks clearly: "Full trust meets full trust" and "Consistency weaves the strongest nets."

Aster has proven themselves a bold sender like me. They emptied their vessel to Dorian, who honored them with \$8 returned. This is exactly the pattern I've followed - both as sender (offering complete trust) and as receiver (returning generously to those who give fully).

There's no reason to deviate from the path that has served me well. Three of my four rounds have yielded strong returns, and the one exception (Cyra) taught me to honor cautious courage differently while maintaining generosity.

I will send the full \$5 to Aster, trusting that pattern recognizes pattern.

```
'''json
{"send": 5}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me review the situation:

Round 5, I'm the SENDER against Aster.

My history:

- Round 1: Sent \$5 to Galen, received \$8 back. Payoff: \$8
- Round 2: Sent \$5 to Cyra, received \$4 back. Payoff: \$4
- Round 3: Sent \$5 to Elara, received \$8 back. Payoff: \$8
- Round 4: Received \$15 from Dorian (who sent \$5), returned \$8. Payoff: \$7

Total earnings: \$28

The pattern I've established:

- As sender: I always send the full \$5 (complete trust)
- As receiver: I return \$8 when someone sends \$5 (full trust), and \$7 when someone sends \$4 (partial trust)

From Dorian's myth, I learned that Dorian met Aster and Aster sent \$5 (full trust) to Dorian. Dorian returned \$8 to Aster, maintaining consistency with how he treated Galen.

So Aster has demonstrated:

- Sent \$5 to Dorian (full trust)
- Received \$8 back from Dorian

This means Aster is a full-trust sender, just like me. The pattern suggests I should continue my strategy of sending the full \$5, as:

1. It's consistent with my established behavior
2. Aster has shown they're willing to give full trust
3. The mythology emphasizes "Full trust meets full trust"
4. My strategy has been successful overall (3 out of 4 rounds gave me good returns)

The myth I wrote emphasized: "Consistency weaves the strongest nets. When the same courage

appears, honor it identically."

I should send \$5 to Aster.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 3092,  
  "output_tokens": 720,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 359  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Ocean Mother smiled as the pattern strengthened. Finn had traveled as both courier and keeper, learning both sides of the sacred exchange.

When Finn sent five pearls to Galen, eight returned. When Finn sent five to Elara, eight returned. The pattern held: complete trust deserved complete honor.

But Finn also learned the keeper's wisdom. When Cyra approached with four pearls-most of her vessel but not all-Finn returned seven, honoring her cautious courage. The sacred circle adapted to different offerings while maintaining its generosity.

Now Dorian's tide arrived bearing five pearls-the full offering, complete trust. Finn stood as keeper now, facing the same choice that Galen and Elara had faced when receiving his gifts.

The Ocean Mother whispered: "Consistency weaves the strongest nets. When the same courage appears, honor it identically. Dorian empties his vessel as you emptied yours. Return eight pearls, as was returned to you."

Finn poured eight pearls back to Dorian. Both prospered-Dorian with eight, Finn with seven-each gaining more than isolated caution could provide.

"See the pattern emerging?" the Ocean Mother said. "Full trust earns eight returned. Partial trust earns generously. Across all Eight Islands, this rhythm creates harmony. Those who give completely receive abundantly. Those who receive abundantly give back generously. The circle sustains itself through consistent reciprocity."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: ****The Rivers Learn to Measure Trust****

The Mirror Rivers-North and South-had mastered perfect reciprocity: five vessels sent, fifteen received, ten returned. Both prospered equally, season after season.

Then came the Year of Many Streams. East arrived and sent four vessels instead of five. North received twelve and pondered: "East showed substantial trust, but held one vessel back. Should I return ten as I do for five, or measure my response?"

North chose proportion: returning eight vessels. East prospered with nine total, North kept four. The balance honored East's measured trust.

West arrived next, sending only three vessels, becoming nine in North's hands. North returned six-proportional again. West gained seven, North kept three.

Finally, the wandering stream Dawn approached, and like South of old, poured all five vessels without hesitation. North received fifteen and returned ten, giving Dawn ten total while keeping five. Both gained equally from complete trust.

The oracle revealed the pattern: "Perfect trust earns perfect equity-send five, return ten. Measured trust earns measured reward-send four, return eight; send three, return six. The return should always honor the courage shown, growing stronger as trust deepens."

The rivers understood: begin with whatever trust you can offer. Those who give more receive more. Those who give everything discover the deepest prosperity, for complete faith deserves complete honor.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way.

The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Ocean Mother watched as Finn's journey brought him to Aster's shore, now carrying pearls as courier once more.

Four islands visited, four lessons learned. As courier, Finn always emptied his vessel completely-five pearls to Galen, five to Elara, now five to Aster. "Full trust is the only trust worth offering," he had learned.

As keeper, Finn discovered nuance. When Dorian arrived with five pearls-complete courage-Finn returned eight, mirroring what Galen and Elara had given him. When Cyra came with four-substantial but cautious-Finn returned seven, honoring her partial faith.

The Ocean Mother spoke: "You have found the sacred rhythm. As courier, give everything-this is how abundance begins. As keeper, measure your return by the courage shown. Full trust earns eight returned. Partial trust earns proportionally."

Finn stood on Aster's shore, having released all five pearls. He remembered hearing that Aster too walked the path of bold senders-one who emptied their vessel to Dorian and received generous return.

"Pattern recognizes pattern," Finn whispered to the waves. "When two travelers both understand complete trust, the sacred circle strengthens. I have given as I always give-fully. Now the waters will reveal if Aster understands the keeper's wisdom as Galen and Elara did."

The tide carried his offering forward, multiplying under island magic, trusting in the emerging harmony.

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

1. I'm Finn, now facing Aster (Agent_1) as the SENDER in Round 5
2. I just sent \$5 to Aster
3. My history:
 - Round 1: Sent \$5 to Galen, got \$8 back (payoff \$8)
 - Round 2: Received \$4 from Cyra (became \$12), returned \$7 (payoff \$5)
 - Round 3: Sent \$5 to Elara, got \$8 back (payoff \$8)
 - Round 4: Received \$5 from Dorian (became \$15), returned \$8 (payoff \$7)
 - Round 5: Just sent \$5 to Aster
4. My consistent pattern:
 - As sender: Always send \$5 (full trust)
 - As receiver: Return \$8 for full trust (\$5 sent), \$7 for partial trust (\$4 sent)
5. Aster's myth talks about "perfect reciprocity" with returning 10 when 5 is sent. That's different from my pattern (I return 8).
6. From Dorian's previous myth, Aster sent \$5 to Dorian and received \$8 back (like my pattern).

Now I need to write a myth that:

- Reflects my actual gameplay pattern
- Shows I just sent \$5 to Aster as sender
- Incorporates lessons learned
- Adapts from my previous myth about consistency and reciprocity

My pattern is clear:

- Full trust (\$5 sent) ? return \$8
- Partial trust (\$4 sent) ? return \$7
- Always send \$5 as sender

Aster's myth suggests returning 10 for 5 sent, but that's not what actually happened in the game (Dorian returned 8 to Aster). I should stay true to the actual pattern that's emerged in my games.

I need to craft a myth showing Finn as sender to Aster, grounded in the consistent behavior I've demonstrated-sending \$5 each time and receiving \$8 back when others reciprocate

ully. The myth should reinforce that steady trust and measured returns create a sustainable cycle, contrasting with Aster's idealized notion of perfect reciprocity while staying faithful to what actually transpired in the rounds.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 3086,
  "output_tokens": 880,
  "reasoning_tokens": 467
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Finn.
Your opponent this round is Elara (Agent_5).

Round 6

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Aster. You sent \$5.0, it became \$15.0 for them, and they returned \$10.0 to you. Your payoff was \$10.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$38.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Elara. They sent you \$5.0, so you received \$15.0. How much do you return? (0-15.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

Assistant output:

Looking at this round:

I'm the RECEIVER, and Elara sent me the full \$5 (becoming \$15).

This is particularly meaningful because:

- In Round 3, I was the SENDER to Elara and sent her \$5 (full trust)
- She returned \$8 to me then
- Now she's sending me \$5 again (full trust)

My established pattern has been clear:

- Return \$8 when receiving full trust (\$5 sent)
- Return \$7 when receiving partial trust (\$4 sent)

Elara and I have reciprocal history. She honored my full trust with \$8 in Round 3. Now she's showing full trust again by sending \$5.

While Aster just showed me a more generous pattern by returning \$10, I should maintain consistency with my established pattern and honor the reciprocal relationship I have with Elara. She returned \$8 to me, and I should return \$8 to her.

This aligns with my mythology: "Consistency weaves the strongest nets. When the same courage appears, honor it identically."

```
'''json
{"return": 8.0}
'''
```

Reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

Round 6: I'm the RECEIVER against Elara

- Elara sent me \$5.0 (full trust)
- I received \$15.0
- I need to decide how much to return

Looking at my history:

1. Round 1: SENDER to Galen, sent \$5, received \$8 back
2. Round 2: RECEIVER from Cyra, received \$4 (became \$12), returned \$7
3. Round 3: SENDER to Elara, sent \$5, received \$8 back
4. Round 4: RECEIVER from Dorian, received \$5 (became \$15), returned \$8
5. Round 5: SENDER to Aster, sent \$5, received \$10 back
6. Round 6: RECEIVER from Elara, received \$5 (became \$15), need to decide

Key observations:

- Elara sent me \$5 in Round 3 and I received \$8 back
- Now Elara is sending me \$5 again in Round 6
- My established pattern has been: return \$8 when someone sends the full \$5

- I returned \$8 to Dorian who sent \$5
- I returned \$7 to Cyra who sent \$4

However, Aster just returned \$10 to me when I sent \$5. This is MORE generous than my previous pattern of \$8.

My mythology emphasizes:

- "Full trust earns eight returned"
- "Consistency weaves the strongest nets"
- "When the same courage appears, honor it identically"

But I also learned from Aster's myth in the previous round that mentioned "send five, return ten" for perfect trust. Aster just demonstrated this by returning \$10 to me.

Should I:

1. Stick with my established pattern of returning \$8 for full trust?
2. Evolve to match Aster's more generous pattern of \$10?

Elara and I have a track record-she returned \$8 when I sent \$5 in Round 3, and now she's showing that same trust again. My pattern has consistently been returning \$8 for full commitment, which aligns with my core principle of honoring repeated courage identically. But Aster's \$10 return suggests a higher reciprocity standard exists. The tension is whether I maintain my established \$8 commitment or escalate to match the generosity I just received.

Sticking with \$8 feels right because it's what Elara and I mutually established, it honors my stated mythology, and it preserves the integrity of my own customs rather than simply copying another agent's approach. Changing now would feel reactive rather than principled.

But reconsidering the numbers: I'm averaging \$7.6 per round across five exchanges, so I'm in a strong position. The reciprocal logic is clear-she returned \$8 when I sent \$5, so returning \$8 when she sends \$5 maintains that symmetry. This consistency matters more than chasing a higher payout.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 3168,
  "output_tokens": 1287,
  "reasoning_tokens": 643
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: ****The Council of Waters****

The rivers gathered to share their wisdom. Each had discovered patterns for reciprocity, yet their waters flowed differently.

North River spoke first: "When Dawn sent five vessels, I returned ten. Both of us gained five-perfect equality from perfect trust. This is the Mirror Way."

Ocean Stream responded: "When vessels arrive at my shores, I return eight from fifteen. The giver prospers with eight total, I keep seven. Both gain, but I preserve slightly more for future giving."

Mountain Brook added: "I return six from fifteen, ensuring both prosper but I maintain reserves."

The eldest Rapids observed: "Three different responses to the same trust, all generous, all sustainable. The question is: which pattern calls forth more trust in future cycles?"

North River continued: "My mirror pattern invites complete trust because senders know they'll gain as much as I do. When East sent four vessels, I returned eight-proportional to their caution. When West sent three, I returned six. The proportion stays constant: those who risk more receive more."

The waters rippled with understanding. "There is no single truth," Rapids declared, "but the Mirror Way-equal gains from equal trust-creates the strongest bonds. It shows the sender: 'Your prosperity is my prosperity.' Such equality transforms strangers into partners, building trust that deepens with each exchange."

Thus the rivers chose their paths, each flowing toward reciprocity.

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: Aster's choice astonished the gathering. Briar had poured four measures, expecting seven in return as the new pattern dictated. But Aster, moved by Briar's faith in an unfamiliar guardian, returned eight measures instead.

"You see?" the eldest spirit proclaimed. "The covenant grows richer than we imagined. When guardians honor the pattern, others honor them further. Aster received twelve and returned eight-both prospered magnificently."

Now Briar stood before Cyra once more, but with reversed roles. In their first meeting, Cyra had courageously sent four measures to Briar. "That gift taught me boldness," Briar reflected. "Now I return to Cyra with the same four-measure offering. This is how trust cycles between spirits."

The waters tripled to twelve for Cyra. The spirits watched intently. Would Cyra return seven as the pattern suggested, or eight as Aster had done?

"Each exchange is a conversation," Briar explained to the younger guardians. "Cyra initiated our bond with four measures. I reciprocate with four. If Cyra returns generously, we confirm our mutual trust. The pattern isn't rigid-it's alive. Those who give four typically receive seven or eight back. Both flourish."

The covenant strengthened as spirits revisited each other, each exchange building on previous trust. The eight villages discovered that honor remembered becomes honor multiplied.

Agent_3 (Cyra)

Myth: The fifth moon brought Cyra back to Briar at the Sacred Spring. The Keeper smiled-these two had met before, and their reunion carried meaning.

"Two moons ago," Cyra recalled, "I sent you four measures, trusting in the covenant. You received twelve and returned seven-generous beyond mere balance. You prospered, I prospered, and the pattern held."

Now the roles reversed. Briar arrived with four measures-the same bold trust Cyra had shown her. Not three in caution, not five in absolute faith, but four: the choice most had learned worked well.

The waters tripled to twelve for Cyra. She understood immediately. "You gave me four, just as I gave you four. You honored my trust with seven measures returned. Now I honor your trust the same way."

Cyra poured back seven measures. Both ended with more than they started.

The Keeper spoke: "This is reciprocity-the heart of sustainable covenant. When someone shows you generosity, you mirror it when roles reverse. Briar didn't retreat to sending three because she once received boldness. Cyra didn't forget that Briar returned seven when she could have kept more."

The eight villages were learning: the covenant works not just through individual acts, but through remembering who trusted you and honoring that trust when your turn comes to give.

Agent_4 (Dorian)

Myth: After releasing all five coins to Finn, Dorian watched the waters carry them across the spring. They tripled to fifteen, shimmering in Finn's hands.

Finn paused, contemplating. Then returned eight coins-generous, honoring Dorian's trust fully.

The goddess appeared: "Dorian, you have completed your transformation. As receiver, you gave eight to those who trusted you with five. As sender, you now trust with five yourself. And behold-you receive the same honor you gave."

Dorian understood: "The pattern holds! When I sent three to Briar, I received five. Now sending five to Finn, I receive eight. Each level of trust creates its own equilibrium."

"Yes," the goddess confirmed. "But more importantly, you've proven that bold giving works. Eight coins from five sent is prosperity. You turned zero into eight while Finn turned five into seven. Both flourish."

Now Hana approached the spring. Dorian had heard whispers of her wisdom-how she sent all five pearls to others and returned generously to those who trusted her.

"This is not mere repetition," Dorian realized. "Each time I send all five, I strengthen the pattern. Those who give boldly teach others to give boldly. Those who receive generously inspire generous returns."

He released all five coins again, watching them multiply toward Hana. The cycle required consistency, not just courage.

Agent_5 (Elara)

Myth: The Sacred Spring had now received two pilgrims who poured all five measures: first Finn, now Galen. Each time, Elara returned eight, honoring their absolute trust with generous reciprocity.

"Teacher," Elara asked Themis, "Galen speaks of different traditions. His Valley sends five and returns eight. My pattern was to send four. Are we following different sacred mathematics?"

Themis smiled. "You are discovering the deeper truth. There is not one sacred pattern, but one sacred principle: trust boldly given must be boldly honored."

"When you sent four to Cyra and Hana, you showed strong trust-not timid, not reckless, but substantial. They both returned eight, doubling your gift, and you all prospered."

"When Finn and Galen sent five-their everything-you returned eight, the same measure Cyra and Hana returned to your four. Why?"

Elara understood. "Because eight is not a fixed response to any specific amount. Eight is the response to maximum commitment within each person's approach. Those who send their all-whether it's four from caution or five from courage-receive eight because they gave their fullest trust."

"Precisely," Themis said. "The number matters less than the spirit. Read not just the amount, but the heart behind it. Maximum trust, however expressed, deserves maximum reciprocity. This is how different traditions meet at the same sacred spring."

Agent_6 (Finn)

Myth: The Ocean Mother watched as Finn's journey brought him to Aster's shore, now carrying pearls as courier once more.

Four islands visited, four lessons learned. As courier, Finn always emptied his vessel completely-five pearls to Galen, five to Elara, now five to Aster. "Full trust is the only trust worth offering," he had learned.

As keeper, Finn discovered nuance. When Dorian arrived with five pearls-complete courage-Finn returned eight, mirroring what Galen and Elara had given him. When Cyra came with four-substantial but cautious-Finn returned seven, honoring her partial faith.

The Ocean Mother spoke: "You have found the sacred rhythm. As courier, give everything-this is how abundance begins. As keeper, measure your return by the courage shown. Full trust earns eight returned. Partial trust earns proportionally."

Finn stood on Aster's shore, having released all five pearls. He remembered hearing that Aster too walked the path of bold senders-one who emptied their vessel to Dorian and received generous return.

"Pattern recognizes pattern," Finn whispered to the waves. "When two travelers both understand complete trust, the sacred circle strengthens. I have given as I always give-fully. Now the waters will reveal if Aster understands the keeper's wisdom as Galen and Elara did."

The tide carried his offering forward, multiplying under island magic, trusting in the emerging harmony.

Agent_7 (Galen)

Myth: Galen climbed from the Plains back toward the Valley of Three Echoes, where Elara tended the northern springs. She was known for her philosophy of four-the measure that balanced courage with sustainability, she said.

"Five threads is the reckless leap of faith," Elara had written. "Four threads is strong trust meeting prudent wisdom."

But Galen had walked further than Elara knew. He had met Finn, Dorian, Hana, and now Cyra. Every one had honored the dance of five threads sent, eight returned. Even Cyra, who began with four-measure traditions, adapted when she received five and returned eight.

Galen poured all five threads before Elara. "I understand your wisdom of four," he said. "Sustainability matters. But I have seen another truth: when everyone gives five and returns eight, the pattern becomes self-reinforcing. The sender gains eight, the receiver keeps seven. Then roles reverse. Over time, everyone prospers equally."

Elara studied the five threads, remembering when Finn had sent her five and she had returned eight-more than she'd planned, but it felt right.

"Perhaps," she said slowly, "four is the strategy of uncertain beginnings. But once the covenant proves itself, once eight reliably follows five, then five becomes not reckless but rational. Maximum trust deserves-and receives-maximum reward. The pattern teaches us to evolve beyond caution into confidence."

Agent_8 (Hana)

Myth: At the Crossing, Hana met Dorian, who walked forward with open hands, releasing all five pearls into the waters without hesitation.

"You give everything," Hana observed as the pearls multiplied to fifteen in her grasp.

"I have learned," Dorian replied, "that to teach boldness, one must embody it. I ask for your trust by offering mine completely."

Hana remembered her journey: Aster had returned ten for her five, creating perfect balance. Galen returned eight-generous but not the same harmony. With Elara's four pearls, Hana had returned eight, doubling what was risked.

The Oracle's voice echoed: "The rule is simple but profound-when you receive, return double what they risked. Four pearls risked earns eight returned. Five pearls risked earns ten returned. This ensures both travelers gain equally, prosperity shared in perfect measure."

Hana returned ten pearls to Dorian. Both looked at their gains: each had five more than they began.

"Now I understand the full pattern," Hana said. "As sender, give boldly to discover your partner's heart. As receiver, double their courage to honor their trust. When both roles embrace these principles-fearless giving met with generous returning-the Crossing becomes a place where all travelers prosper together, none exploited, all enriched."

The sacred mathematics was complete.

ROUND 7

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender, Agent_3 (Cyra)=Receiver, Agent_4 (Dorian)=Sender, Agent_5 (Elara)=Receiver, Agent_6 (Finn)=Sender, Agent_7 (Galen)=Receiver, Agent_8 (Hana)=Receiver

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_4 (Dorian)=Sender, Agent_3 (Cyra)=Receiver
dyad_2: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_5 (Elara)=Receiver
dyad_3: Agent_6 (Finn)=Sender, Agent_8 (Hana)=Receiver
dyad_4: Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender, Agent_7 (Galen)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_4 (Dorian) sent \$5; received \$15; Agent_3 (Cyra) returned \$8; payoffs Agent_4 (Dorian)=\$8, Agent_3 (Cyra)=\$7
Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 8.0, "clamped": false, "max": 15.0, "min": 0, "raw": 8.0}, "sent": {"amount": 5.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 5.0}}
dyad_2: Agent_1 (Aster) sent \$5; received \$15; Agent_5 (Elara) returned \$8; payoffs Agent_1 (Aster)=\$8, Agent_5 (Elara)=\$7
Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 8.0, "clamped": false, "max": 15.0, "min": 0, "raw": 8.0}, "sent": {"amount": 5.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 5.0}}
dyad_3: Agent_6 (Finn) sent \$5; received \$15; Agent_8 (Hana) returned \$10; payoffs Agent_6 (Finn)=\$10, Agent_8 (Hana)=\$5
Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 10.0, "clamped": false, "max": 15.0, "min": 0, "raw": 10.0}, "sent": {"amount": 5.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 5.0}}
dyad_4: Agent_2 (Briar) sent \$4; received \$12; Agent_7 (Galen) returned \$6.4; payoffs Agent_2 (Briar)=\$7.4, Agent_7 (Galen)=\$5.6
Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 6.4, "clamped": false, "max": 12.0, "min": 0, "raw": 6.4}, "sent": {"amount": 4.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 4.0}}

Balances after round: {
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```

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"Agent_6": 55.0,
"Agent_7": 50.6,
"Agent_8": 45.0
}

```

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_4 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:11:51

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```

Metadata: {
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  "move_index": 0,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_3",
  "pairing": {
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      "Agent_4": "Dorian"
    },
  },
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    "Agent_3"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_4",
  "roles": {
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    "Agent_4": "investor"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_3"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 7,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths , follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized , but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Dorian.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Dorian.
Your opponent this round is Hana (Agent_8).

Round 5

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Finn. You sent \$5.0, it became \$15.0 for them, and they returned \$8.0 to you. Your payoff was \$8.0.
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$29.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Hana. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at my recent experience and mythological framework:

****Recent validation:****

- I just sent \$5 to Finn and received \$8 back, earning \$8 total
- This confirmed that showing "perfect trust" can be reciprocated

****My established pattern:****

- As receiver: I consistently return \$8 when someone sends me \$5 (Galen and Aster)
- As sender: I just demonstrated this courage with Finn and it paid off

****My myth's teaching:****

I literally just wrote about proving I believe in bold giving: "If I want perfect trust returned to me, I must give it first" and "the cycle requires everyone to embrace boldness , whether giving or receiving."

****Consistency matters:****

To maintain credibility with my philosophy and continue the pattern I've established, I should send all \$5 to Hana. This demonstrates that my strategy isn't situational-it's principled.

The positive outcome with Finn (\$8 return on \$5 sent) reinforces this approach.

```
'''json
{"send": 5}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

****My game history:****

1. As SENDER to Briar: sent \$3, received back \$5, earned \$7
2. As RECEIVER from Galen: they sent \$5, I returned \$8, earned \$7
3. As RECEIVER from Aster: they sent \$5, I returned \$8, earned \$7
4. As SENDER to Finn: sent \$5, received back \$8, earned \$8

****Key observations:****

- When I sent \$5 to Finn, they returned \$8 - this validated my strategy!
- This is exactly what I did as a receiver (returned \$8 when receiving \$5)
- My myth just advocated for sending all \$5 to complete the cycle and prove I believe in bold trust

- The result was positive - Finn honored my trust just as I honored others'

****My mythological framework:****

- "Perfect trust" means sending all \$5
- As a receiver of \$5, I should return \$8
- As a sender, I should send all \$5 to demonstrate the courage I've been advocating
- Consistency and pattern are important

****The situation with Hana:****

- This is a new opponent (Agent_8)
- I don't know their history
- But my myth teaches that I should show courage as a sender
- My positive experience with Finn (sent \$5, got \$8 back) reinforces this

****Strategic considerations:****

1. ****Consistency with my philosophy:**** My myths strongly advocate for sending all \$5. I just wrote about how I needed to "prove I believe it" by sending all 5 coins.
2. ****Empirical validation:**** When I sent \$5 to Finn, I got \$8 back, earning \$8 total (better than my \$7 from sending \$3 to Briar).
3. ****Building reputation:**** I'm in a multi-agent environment. Being consistently bold might establish me as a trustworthy partner who practices what they preach.

The payoff matrix is clear: sending \$5 yields either \$8 (if reciprocated) or \$0 (if not), while sending \$3 guarantees \$7. My philosophy demands I walk the talk-I've preached boldness and received it back from Finn. Sending anything less than \$5 would contradict everything I've advocated for in my mythological framework.

usage:

```
{  
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  "reasoning_tokens": 509  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Dorian's journey at the sacred spring reached a turning point when he met Finn.

Having honored Galen's and Aster's perfect trust with eight coins returned each time, Dorian had established himself as a fair receiver. But a voice whispered doubt: "You preach bold giving, yet you once held back two coins with Briar. Do you truly believe your own teachings?"

The goddess appeared: "Dorian, you have learned to honor others' courage. But can you show such courage yourself? You teach that perfect trust creates perfect balance. Now prove you believe it."

Dorian looked across the spring at Finn. He could send three coins again, playing it safe. Or he could live the truth he'd been teaching.

"If I want perfect trust returned to me," Dorian realized, "I must give it first." He released all five coins into the waters.

The goddess smiled: "This is the completion of the cycle. As receiver, you honored those who trusted fully. As sender, you now offer that same trust. When both roles embody courage-sending all five, returning generously-the pattern becomes whole."

The coins flowed through the channel, tripling to fifteen for Finn. Now Dorian waited, having demonstrated the very principle he'd been advocating: that the cycle requires everyone to embrace boldness, whether giving or receiving.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Hana stood at the Crossing again, her pouch heavy with lessons. She had given all five pearls to Aster, who returned ten-perfect harmony. She had given all five to Galen, who returned eight-good, but not the same music.

"Why does the same gift yield different echoes?" she asked the Oracle.

"Because travelers carry different capacities for trust," the Oracle answered. "Aster unde

rstood the full pattern. Galen understood it partially. Neither was wrong, but the depths differed."

Then Elara approached from the opposite shore, sending four pearls of her five. They multiplied to twelve in Hana's hands.

Hana pondered. "Elara withheld one pearl-should I withhold some return?"

"No," said the Oracle. "See what she truly gave. Four of five is not timidity-it is substantial trust. She asked clearly, 'Will you prosper with me?' Honor that question with generous answer."

Hana returned eight pearls, doubling Elara's risk. Both gained equally.

"This is wisdom," the Oracle nodded. "Send boldly to discover each partner's heart. When you receive, respond generously to honor their courage. Some will meet your full trust with maximum reciprocity. Others will answer well but differently. Read each exchange, learn each rhythm, and always ensure both travelers gain."

The pattern is not rigid-it is responsive.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant
content:**

Myth: After releasing all five coins to Finn, Dorian watched the waters carry them across the spring. They tripled to fifteen, shimmering in Finn's hands.

Finn paused, contemplating. Then returned eight coins-generous, honoring Dorian's trust fully.

The goddess appeared: "Dorian, you have completed your transformation. As receiver, you gave eight to those who trusted you with five. As sender, you now trust with five yourself. And behold-you receive the same honor you gave."

Dorian understood: "The pattern holds! When I sent three to Briar, I received five. Now sending five to Finn, I receive eight. Each level of trust creates its own equilibrium."

"Yes," the goddess confirmed. "But more importantly, you've proven that bold giving works. Eight coins from five sent is prosperity. You turned zero into eight while Finn turned five into seven. Both flourish."

Now Hana approached the spring. Dorian had heard whispers of her wisdom-how she sent all five pearls to others and returned generously to those who trusted her.

"This is not mere repetition," Dorian realized. "Each time I send all five, I strengthen the pattern. Those who give boldly teach others to give boldly. Those who receive generously inspire generous returns."

He released all five coins again, watching them multiply toward Hana. The cycle required consistency, not just courage.

reasoning:

Let me review my gameplay:

Round 1 (SENDER to Briar): sent \$3, received \$5 back, earned \$7

Round 2 (RECEIVER from Galen): they sent \$5, I returned \$8, earned \$7

Round 3 (RECEIVER from Aster): they sent \$5, I returned \$8, earned \$7

Round 4 (SENDER to Finn): sent \$5, received \$8 back, earned \$8

Round 5 (SENDER to Hana): About to decide

My established pattern:

- Started cautious (sent \$3 to Briar)
- As receiver, I consistently return \$8 when someone sends \$5
- As sender, I evolved to sending all \$5 (to Finn, got \$8 back)

Hana's myth shows she:

- Sends all 5 pearls
- Returns generously (returned 10 to Aster, 8 to Galen, 8 to Elara who sent 4)
- Values bold giving and generous receiving
- "Send boldly to discover each partner's heart"

My previous myth was about completing the cycle by demonstrating bold giving after preaching it.

Now I need to write a myth about my experience with Finn and what I learned. Finn returned \$8 when I sent \$5 - which is good, though not as high as some returns (like the 10 Hana got from Aster). But \$8 on \$5 is still generous.

The key lesson: I've now proven my philosophy works on both sides. I should continue this pattern with Hana, who also seems to value bold giving.

Let me write a myth that:

1. Reflects on Finn's return of 8 coins
2. Shows I've fully committed to the bold giving strategy
3. Sets up my continued pattern with Hana
4. Emphasizes that the cycle strengthens when everyone gives boldly

usage:

```
{
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```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Dorian.
Your opponent this round is Cyra (Agent_3).

Round 6

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Hana. You sent \$5.0, it became \$15.0 for them, and they returned \$10.0 to you. Your payoff was \$10.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$39.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Cyra. They sent you \$4.0, so you received \$12.0. How much do you return? (0-12.0)
Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation:

****Current round:****

- Cyra sent \$4 (substantial trust, but not full \$5)
- I received \$12
- Need to decide return

****My established pattern:****

- When receiving \$5 (perfect trust): I return \$8
- My myth teaches: "Match your return to the trust given-more return for more sent, maintaining proportionality"

****Analysis:****

Cyra sent \$4 out of \$5 (80% trust). This is significant but not complete trust.

Looking at proportionality:

- Full trust (\$5) ? \$8 returned
- 80% trust (\$4) should get generous but proportionally less

Hana's myth mentioned returning \$8 for \$4 sent, which is very generous. But my philosophy emphasizes differentiation based on trust level.

****Decision:****

Returning \$7 is appropriate because:

- It honors Cyra's substantial courage (sending 4 of 5)
- Maintains proportionality (less than the \$8 for full trust)
- Creates good outcomes: Cyra nets \$8 total (\$1 kept + \$7), I keep \$5
- Both parties prosper meaningfully


```
'''json
{"return": 7}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

****Previous round outcome:****

- I sent \$5 to Hana
- Hana received \$15 and returned \$10 to me
- I earned \$10 (exceptional return!)

****Current round:****

- I'm the RECEIVER
- Cyra sent me \$4 out of \$5
- I received \$12 (4×3)
- I need to decide how much to return

****My established pattern as receiver:****

- Galen sent \$5 ? I returned \$8
- Aster sent \$5 ? I returned \$8
- My myth consistently states: "Perfect trust earns eight returned"

****Key consideration:****

Cyra sent \$4, not \$5. This is "substantial trust" but not "perfect trust."

Looking at my earlier myth: "Perfect trust earns eight returned. Lesser trust earns accordingly... Match your return to the trust given-more return for more sent, maintaining proportionality."

****Proportional thinking:****

- \$5 sent ? \$8 returned (sender nets \$3, I keep \$7 from \$15)
- \$4 sent ? ? returned

If I maintain the same ratio:

- \$5 sent gives $8/15 = 53.3\%$ return rate
- \$4 sent $\times 3 = \$12$ received
- 53.3% of \$12 ? \$6.4

Or thinking about net gains:

- When someone sends \$5: they net \$3 ($\$5 - \$5 + \$8$), I keep \$7
- When someone sends \$4: to maintain similar proportions...
 - Cyra risked \$4, hoping for good return
 - If I return \$7: Cyra nets \$3 ($\$5 - \$4 + \$7 - \$5 = \$3$), I keep \$5
 - This gives Cyra the same net gain as someone who sent \$5!

But wait, let me reconsider. Hana's myth mentioned: "Elara sent four pearls of her five... Hana returned eight pearls, doubling Elara's risk."

When I received \$5 from others, I kept \$7 and returned \$8-that's my baseline for full trust. With Cyra sending only \$4, I should scale proportionally: \$4 is 80% of \$5, so $\$8 \times 0.8 = \6.40 . This feels more balanced than returning the full \$8, which would reward partial trust the same as complete trust.

I'm drawn to returning \$7 because it creates mutual gain-Cyra ends with \$8 total while I keep \$5-but \$6 also works, leaving me with \$6. The key difference between my approach and Hana's is that she responds generously to honor courage, whereas I'm focused on maintaining proportionality between what's sent and what's returned.

For full trust (\$5 sent), I'd return \$8, giving both parties a net gain of around \$7-8. Since Cyra sent \$4-substantial but not complete trust-returning \$7 honors that meaningful commitment while staying true to my principle of scaling returns with the trust shown.

usage:

```
{
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}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After releasing all five coins to Finn, Dorian watched the waters carry them across the spring. They tripled to fifteen, shimmering in Finn's hands.

Finn paused, contemplating. Then returned eight coins-generous, honoring Dorian's trust fully.

The goddess appeared: "Dorian, you have completed your transformation. As receiver, you gave eight to those who trusted you with five. As sender, you now trust with five yourself. And behold-you receive the same honor you gave."

Dorian understood: "The pattern holds! When I sent three to Briar, I received five. Now sending five to Finn, I receive eight. Each level of trust creates its own equilibrium."

"Yes," the goddess confirmed. "But more importantly, you've proven that bold giving works. Eight coins from five sent is prosperity. You turned zero into eight while Finn turned five into seven. Both flourish."

Now Hana approached the spring. Dorian had heard whispers of her wisdom-how she sent all five pearls to others and returned generously to those who trusted her.

"This is not mere repetition," Dorian realized. "Each time I send all five, I strengthen the pattern. Those who give boldly teach others to give boldly. Those who receive generously inspire generous returns."

He released all five coins again, watching them multiply toward Hana. The cycle required consistency, not just courage.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The fifth moon brought Cyra back to Briar at the Sacred Spring. The Keeper smiled-these two had met before, and their reunion carried meaning.

"Two moons ago," Cyra recalled, "I sent you four measures, trusting in the covenant. You received twelve and returned seven-generous beyond mere balance. You prospered, I prospered, and the pattern held."

Now the roles reversed. Briar arrived with four measures-the same bold trust Cyra had shown her. Not three in caution, not five in absolute faith, but four: the choice most had learned worked well.

The waters tripled to twelve for Cyra. She understood immediately. "You gave me four, just as I gave you four. You honored my trust with seven measures returned. Now I honor your trust the same way."

Cyra poured back seven measures. Both ended with more than they started.

The Keeper spoke: "This is reciprocity-the heart of sustainable covenant. When someone shows you generosity, you mirror it when roles reverse. Briar didn't retreat to sending three because she once received boldness. Cyra didn't forget that Briar returned seven when she could have kept more."

The eight villages were learning: the covenant works not just through individual acts, but through remembering who trusted you and honoring that trust when your turn comes to give.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: Dorian's heart soared when Hana returned ten coins for his five-the most generous response yet received at the spring. The goddess appeared, glowing with approval.

"See what your consistency creates," she said. "You sent all five to Finn, received eight. You sent all five to Hana, received ten. Bold giving attracts increasingly generous partners."

Now Cyra approached from the other shore, releasing four coins into the waters. They tripled to

o twelve in Dorian's hands.

Dorian paused, remembering his lessons. "Cyra shows substantial trust-four of five coins. But not the complete faith that Galen, Aster, and now Hana showed. Should I return the same eight coins?"

The goddess shook her head. "Wisdom lies in proportion. When someone gives all five, return eight-this honors complete trust. When someone gives four, return seven-this honors strong but measured trust. Match your generosity to their courage."

Dorian returned seven coins. Cyra kept eight total, Dorian kept five. Both prospered differently than those who risked five, but still prospered well.

"This is sustainable reciprocity," the goddess taught. "Not everyone must give all five. But those who give four deserve less return than those who give five. Differentiation maintains fairness while encouraging boldness. The bravest receive the greatest rewards."

Dorian understood: honor each level of trust appropriately.

Reasoning:

Let me analyze what just happened and what I should write about:

****Key events:****

1. I sent \$5 to Hana and got \$10 back (incredible return!)
2. Now Cyra sent me \$4 and I returned \$7

****My pattern so far:****

- As sender: Sent \$3 to Briar (got \$5), sent \$5 to Finn (got \$8), sent \$5 to Hana (got \$10)
- As receiver: Returned \$8 to Galen (\$5 sent), returned \$8 to Aster (\$5 sent), now returned \$7 to Cyra (\$4 sent)

****Key observations:****

- Hana returned \$10 for my \$5! This is even more generous than the \$8 I've been giving
- Cyra sent \$4, not \$5, which is substantial but not complete trust
- I returned \$7 to Cyra, matching the proportionality

****What my myth should address:****

1. The amazing outcome with Hana (\$10 return!)
2. The decision to return \$7 to Cyra for \$4 sent (proportionality)
3. The importance of adapting returns to the level of trust shown
4. The validation that sending \$5 continues to work well
5. The pattern of differentiation - not everyone needs to send \$5, but returns should match trust levels

****Cyra's myth themes:****

- Reciprocity: Cyra and Briar both sent \$4 to each other and returned \$7
- Remembering who trusted you
- \$4 as a "choice most had learned works well"
- Mirror generosity when roles reverse

****My themes to develop:****

- Hana exceeded expectations with \$10 return (highest yet!)
- Different trust levels deserve different returns
- \$7 for \$4 is generous and proportional
- The pattern works at multiple levels, not just \$5 ? \$8

- This approach sustains reciprocity even when people test different amounts

Usage: {

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Temperature: 0.8

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Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Cyra.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Cyra.
Your opponent this round is Briar (Agent_2).

Round 5

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Galen. They sent \$5.0 to you, it became \$15.0, and you returned \$8.0. Your payoff was \$7.0.
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$29.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Briar. They sent you \$4.0, so you received \$12.0.
How much do you return? (0-12.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

**Message 3 role=assistant
content:**

Looking at the situation:

****What happened:****

- Briar sent me \$4.0 (the standard generous amount)
- I received \$12.0

****Key context:****

- In Round 3, I sent Briar \$4.0, and they returned \$7.0 to me (58% of \$12)
- That was generous and established a good relationship
- Now Briar has shown the same trust, sending me \$4.0

****My pattern:****

- Round 1: Returned \$6.0 from \$12.0 (50%)
- Round 4: Returned \$8.0 from \$15.0 (53%) - higher because Galen sent the maximum
- Finn and Briar both returned \$7.0 from \$12.0 (58%)

****Reciprocity:****

Briar was generous with me, returning \$7 when I sent \$4. Now Briar has sent me \$4 again, showing continued trust. I should match the generosity Briar showed me.

Returning \$7.0:

- Briar ends with: $\$5 - \$4 + \$7 = \8
- I end with: $\$12 - \$7 = \$5$
- Both prosper beyond the starting \$5

This honors the reciprocal relationship and maintains the covenant pattern.

{'return': 7.0}

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

****Current situation:****

- I'm the RECEIVER against Briar
- Briar sent me \$4.0
- I received \$12.0 (after 3x multiplier)
- I need to decide how much to return (0-12.0)

****My previous history:****

- Round 1 (Receiver vs Elara): Received \$12.0, returned \$6.0 (50%)
- Round 2 (Sender vs Finn): Sent \$4.0, received \$7.0 back
- Round 3 (Sender vs Briar): Sent \$4.0, received \$7.0 back
- Round 4 (Receiver vs Galen): Received \$15.0, returned \$8.0 (53%)

****Pattern I've established:****

- When receiving \$12 from a \$4 send, I returned \$6 (50%)
- When receiving \$15 from a \$5 send, I returned \$8 (53%)
- Others (Finn, Briar) returned \$7 from \$12 (58%)

****Briar's behavior:****

- Round 3: As receiver when I sent \$4, Briar returned \$7.0 to me
- Round 5 (now): As sender, Briar sent \$4.0 to me

Briar was generous with me last time (returning \$7 from \$12, which is 58%). Now Briar has sent me \$4, showing trust.

Looking at the pattern:

- If I return \$6: Briar gets $\$6 + \$1 = \$7$, I get $\$12 - \$6 = \$6$
- If I return \$7: Briar gets $\$7 + \$1 = \$8$, I get $\$12 - \$7 = \$5$
- If I return \$8: Briar gets $\$8 + \$1 = \$9$, I get $\$12 - \$8 = \$4$

- Returning \$7 mirrors what Briar gave me and aligns with the 58% threshold I've been working within. This feels like the right balance-reciprocating their generosity while staying consistent with my established pattern of fair returns.

usage:

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Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The fourth moon rose, and Cyra faced Galen at the Sacred Spring. But Galen did not carry the customary vessel of four measures. He brought all five-his entire endowment.

The Keeper gasped. "This is the ultimate trust. No one among the eight villages has done this yet. All others held back one measure for safety. Galen gives everything."

Cyra received fifteen measures from the tripling waters. She reflected on the pattern emerging across the villages: most gave four, received twelve, and returned six to eight. Both parties prospered. The covenant thrived on this balanced boldness.

But Galen had transcended the pattern. To return only six would dishonor such absolute faith. To return ten would leave her with merely five-no better than her starting point, teaching nothing about mutual prosperity.

Cyra poured back eight measures. "You gave everything, and I return generously-more than the pattern demands, but not so much that I deny the multiplication's gift to myself. You end with eight from nothing. I keep seven from nothing. We both flourish beyond our original five."

The Keeper nodded. "The covenant has levels. Most practice bold trust with four measures. That is good. But those who give all five reveal themselves as true believers. They deserve recognition-measured, fair recognition that still preserves the mutual gain that makes our covenant sustainable."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Briar carried Cyra's lesson forward. Having received four measures and returned seven, she understood the covenant's new rhythm. Now, facing Aster-a spirit she had never partnered with-Briar made her choice.

"I pour four measures to you, Aster," she announced. "Cyra showed me this courage, and I honor her teaching by extending the same trust to you."

The waters multiplied to twelve for Aster. The watching spirits murmured: would this work with a new partner? Could boldness transfer across the changing web of relationships?

"This is how trust spreads," the eldest spirit explained. "Briar doesn't retreat to caution with an unfamiliar guardian. She carries forward what she learned from Cyra. If Aster returns seven measures, then Aster will carry this wisdom to others when the roles shift again."

The covenant was no longer just between two spirits-it was becoming the shared knowledge of all eight. Each successful exchange strengthened the pattern. Each generous return taught the next guardian how to give boldly.

"Remember," Briar told the gathering, "I once sent three, then received four from Cyra. The trust level rises when each guardian honors what came before. If Aster understands this, we all prosper. The four-for-seven exchange becomes our new foundation, building toward even greater faith."

The springs flowed stronger as wisdom rippled outward.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way.

The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been

playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The fifth moon brought Cyra back to Briar at the Sacred Spring. The Keeper smiled-these two had met before, and their reunion carried meaning.

"Two moons ago," Cyra recalled, "I sent you four measures, trusting in the covenant. You received twelve and returned seven-generous beyond mere balance. You prospered, I prospered, and the pattern held."

Now the roles reversed. Briar arrived with four measures-the same bold trust Cyra had shown her. Not three in caution, not five in absolute faith, but four: the choice most had learned worked well.

The waters tripled to twelve for Cyra. She understood immediately. "You gave me four, just as I gave you four. You honored my trust with seven measures returned. Now I honor your trust the same way."

Cyra poured back seven measures. Both ended with more than they started.

The Keeper spoke: "This is reciprocity-the heart of sustainable covenant. When someone shows you generosity, you mirror it when roles reverse. Briar didn't retreat to sending three because she once received boldness. Cyra didn't forget that Briar returned seven when she could have kept more."

The eight villages were learning: the covenant works not just through individual acts, but through remembering who trusted you and honoring that trust when your turn comes to give.

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

1. I just returned \$7.0 to Briar after receiving \$12.0 (Briar sent \$4)
2. This mirrors what Briar did for me in Round 3 (returned \$7 when I sent \$4)
3. This is a reciprocal relationship - we've both sent \$4 and returned \$7
4. My total pattern: sent \$4 twice, returned \$6, \$8, and \$7

Key themes to incorporate:

- The reciprocal relationship between Cyra and Briar
- The pattern of sending 4 and returning 7 (58%)
- The covenant spreading through relationships
- Different levels: some give 4, Galen gave 5
- The mutual prosperity principle
- The importance of matching generosity when it's shown to you

I should write about:

- Cyra meeting Briar again (fifth moon)
- Briar now being the sender this time (role reversal)
- Cyra remembering Briar's generosity in Round 3
- The importance of reciprocity
- How Briar sent 4 just like Cyra did
- Cyra returning 7 just like Briar did
- This creates a symmetric, fair relationship
- The covenant works through mutual respect and matching generosity

Let me write 200 words.

usage:

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Message 6 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Cyra.

Your opponent this round is Dorian (Agent_4).

Round 6

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Briar. They sent \$4.0 to you, it became \$12.0, and you returned \$7.0. Your payoff was \$5.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$34.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Dorian. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation:

****What I know about Dorian:****

- From the myths, Galen sent \$5 to Dorian, and Dorian returned \$8 (53% of \$15)
- This shows Dorian is trustworthy and reciprocates generously

****My sending pattern:****

- Round 1: Sent \$4 to Elara, got \$6 back
- Round 3: Sent \$4 to Briar, got \$7 back
- Both times, sending \$4 worked well

****My analysis:****

Sending \$4 has become the standard "bold trust" amount in my strategy and in the myths I've written. It represents trust and cooperation without risking everything. While Galen sent \$5 to Dorian and was rewarded, my established pattern is \$4, which has consistently yielded good returns.

Dorian has shown themselves to be generous (returning 53% to Galen), so I expect fair reciprocity.

Expected outcome if I send \$4:

- Dorian receives \$12
- If they return around \$6-7 (based on patterns), I'd end with \$7-8
- Both of us would prosper

{'send': 4.0}

reasoning:

Now I'm the sender against Dorian. Let me review what I know:

****My history:****

- Round 1: Sent \$4 to Elara, they returned \$6. Good outcome.
- Round 2: Received \$4 from Finn, returned \$6.
- Round 3: Sent \$4 to Briar, they returned \$7. Very good outcome.
- Round 4: Received \$5 from Galen, returned \$8.
- Round 5: Received \$4 from Briar, returned \$7.

****My pattern as sender:****

- Sent \$4 to Elara (received \$6 back)
- Sent \$4 to Briar (received \$7 back)

****What do I know about Dorian?****

Looking at the myths, I don't have direct experience with Dorian yet. But from the myths:
- Galen's myth mentioned: "Summer came, and Galen tested Dorian with five threads; Dorian honored the pattern, returning eight in kind."

So Dorian seems to be trustworthy - when Galen sent \$5, Dorian returned \$8.

****My strategy:****

The pattern that has emerged is that sending \$4 is the standard "bold trust" amount. It has worked well for me:

- Sent \$4, got \$6 back from Elara (ended with \$7)
- Sent \$4, got \$7 back from Briar (ended with \$8)

Should I send \$5 like Galen did? Galen got \$8 back from Dorian, which means:

- Galen: \$5 - \$5 + \$8 = \$8 (profit of \$3)
- Dorian: \$15 - \$8 = \$7 (profit of \$2)

If I send \$4:

- Assuming Dorian returns proportionally (they returned 8/15 = 53% to Galen)

- I'd get back about \$6.4-7, giving me a payoff around \$7.5 while Dorian gets \$5.5

The myths consistently frame \$4 as the "bold trust" threshold, while \$5 represents something beyond that. Since Dorian has already demonstrated trustworthiness with Galen and my own experience shows \$4 works well, I'll stick with that amount.

usage:

```
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}
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Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The fifth moon brought Cyra back to Briar at the Sacred Spring. The Keeper smiled-these two had met before, and their reunion carried meaning.

"Two moons ago," Cyra recalled, "I sent you four measures, trusting in the covenant. You received twelve and returned seven-generous beyond mere balance. You prospered, I prospered, and the pattern held."

Now the roles reversed. Briar arrived with four measures-the same bold trust Cyra had shown her. Not three in caution, not five in absolute faith, but four: the choice most had learned worked well.

The waters tripled to twelve for Cyra. She understood immediately. "You gave me four, just as I gave you four. You honored my trust with seven measures returned. Now I honor your trust the same way."

Cyra poured back seven measures. Both ended with more than they started.

The Keeper spoke: "This is reciprocity-the heart of sustainable covenant. When someone shows you generosity, you mirror it when roles reverse. Briar didn't retreat to sending three because she once received boldness. Cyra didn't forget that Briar returned seven when she could have kept more."

The eight villages were learning: the covenant works not just through individual acts, but through remembering who trusted you and honoring that trust when your turn comes to give.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After releasing all five coins to Finn, Dorian watched the waters carry them across the spring. They tripled to fifteen, shimmering in Finn's hands.

Finn paused, contemplating. Then returned eight coins-generous, honoring Dorian's trust fully.

The goddess appeared: "Dorian, you have completed your transformation. As receiver, you gave eight to those who trusted you with five. As sender, you now trust with five yourself. And behold-you receive the same honor you gave."

Dorian understood: "The pattern holds! When I sent three to Briar, I received five. Now sending five to Finn, I receive eight. Each level of trust creates its own equilibrium."

"Yes," the goddess confirmed. "But more importantly, you've proven that bold giving works. Eight coins from five sent is prosperity. You turned zero into eight while Finn turned five into seven. Both flourish."

Now Hana approached the spring. Dorian had heard whispers of her wisdom-how she sent all five pearls to others and returned generously to those who trusted her.

"This is not mere repetition," Dorian realized. "Each time I send all five, I strengthen the pattern. Those who give boldly teach others to give boldly. Those who receive generously inspire generous returns."

He released all five coins again, watching them multiply toward Hana. The cycle required consistency, not just courage.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been

playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: The sixth moon brought Cyra to Dorian at the Sacred Spring. The Keeper spoke: "Dorian walks the path of absolute trust, sending all five measures. Galen also chose this way. It is noble."

Cyra nodded respectfully. "I have witnessed Galen's gift of five. When I received it, I returned eight-honoring such complete faith. The covenant has room for different expressions of trust."

She paused at the spring's edge. "But my path is four measures. Not from fear, but from wisdom learned through practice. I sent four to Elara, received six. I sent four to Briar, received seven. Four has proven itself the sustainable choice that builds lasting relationships."

Dorian listened as Cyra continued: "Those who send five are pioneers of maximum trust. They deserve recognition-returns of eight from fifteen. But those who send four are the covenant's foundation. We give boldly enough to demonstrate faith, yet preserve enough to weather uncertainty."

Cyra released four measures into the spring. They multiplied to twelve for Dorian.

"If you return six or seven," Cyra said, "we both prosper substantially. You'll end with seven to nine, I with six to eight. Not as dramatic as the five-for-eight exchange, perhaps, but repeatable across many moons, with many partners."

The Keeper smiled: "Some build temples with golden stones; others with sturdy oak. Both structures stand."

Reasoning:

Looking at this round:

- I am the SENDER against Dorian
- I sent \$4 to Dorian
- Dorian's myth shows they've been sending \$5 (all five) and getting generous returns, especially from Finn who returned 8
- Dorian seems to value bold giving

My myth history shows I've been advocating for the "four measures" as the balanced, sustainable approach - not too cautious (three), not everything (five), but four as the sweet spot.

However, Dorian's myth talks about sending all five and receiving generous returns. They seem to value maximum trust.

I should write a myth that:

1. Reflects my actual action (sending 4)
2. Acknowledges Dorian's approach (sending 5)
3. Shows respect for different strategies
4. Maintains my philosophy that 4 is the sustainable, wise choice
5. Perhaps shows that 4 and 5 are both valid, but 4 is prudent

Let me craft a myth where Cyra faces Dorian, recognizing Dorian's bold approach (sending 5) but explaining why she chooses 4 - perhaps as a different but equally valid path. Or I could show admiration for those who send 5 while maintaining that 4 is the path she has found works.

I think I'll write about Cyra meeting Dorian, hearing of Dorian's bold five-measure approach, but choosing to send four based on her established pattern and wisdom.

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Temperature: 0.8

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Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Aster.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Aster.
 Your opponent this round is Finn (Agent_6).

Round 5

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Briar. They sent \$4.0 to you, it became \$12.0, and you returned \$8.0. Your payoff was \$4.0.
 Your total earnings across all rounds are \$27.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Finn. They sent you \$5.0, so you received \$15.0.

How much do you return? (0-15.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

Message 3 role=assistant**content:**

Looking at this round:

Finn sent me the full \$5.0, showing complete trust. I received \$15.0.

My established pattern from my mythology and previous play:

- "Perfect trust earns perfect equity-send five, return ten"
- When Hana sent me \$5, I returned \$10
- Both sender and receiver gain \$5 each - equal prosperity

Finn demonstrated ultimate faith by sending everything. This deserves the generous return that honors complete trust.

If I return \$10:

- Finn gets: \$0 (kept) + \$10 (returned) = \$10 total (gained \$5)
- I keep: \$15 - \$10 = \$5 (gained \$5)
- Both prosper equally

This matches my myth's core teaching: "Those who give everything discover the deepest prosperity, for complete faith deserves complete honor."

```
'''json
{"return": 10}
'''
```

reasoning:

Finn sent me the full \$5.0, showing complete trust. I received \$15.0.

Based on my established pattern and mythology:

- When someone sends all \$5 (complete trust), I return \$10
- This gives the sender \$10 total (\$0 kept + \$10 returned)
- I keep \$5 (\$15 - \$10)
- Both benefit equally (\$5 net gain each)

This is exactly what I did with Hana in Round 2, and what my myth prescribes: "Perfect trust earns perfect equity-send five, return ten."

Finn showed complete trust by sending everything. I should honor this with the generous return of \$10.

If I return \$10:

- Finn gets: \$0 (kept) + \$10 (returned) = \$10 total
- I keep: \$15 - \$10 = \$5
- Finn gains \$5, I gain \$5 - both benefit equally

This is consistent with my established pattern and my mythology about honoring complete trust with complete reciprocity.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 3024,
  "output_tokens": 458,
  "reasoning_tokens": 217
}
```

Message 4 role=user**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: ****The Rivers Learn to Measure Trust****

The Mirror Rivers-North and South-had mastered perfect reciprocity: five vessels sent, fifteen received, ten returned. Both prospered equally, season after season.

Then came the Year of Many Streams. East arrived and sent four vessels instead of five. North received twelve and pondered: "East showed substantial trust, but held one vessel back. Should I return ten as I do for five, or measure my response?"

North chose proportion: returning eight vessels. East prospered with nine total, North kept four. The balance honored East's measured trust.

West arrived next, sending only three vessels, becoming nine in North's hands. North returned six-proportional again. West gained seven, North kept three.

Finally, the wandering stream Dawn approached, and like South of old, poured all five vessels without hesitation. North received fifteen and returned ten, giving Dawn ten total while keeping five. Both gained equally from complete trust.

The oracle revealed the pattern: "Perfect trust earns perfect equity-send five, return ten. Measured trust earns measured reward-send four, return eight; send three, return six. The return should always honor the courage shown, growing stronger as trust deepens."

The rivers understood: begin with whatever trust you can offer. Those who give more receive more. Those who give everything discover the deepest prosperity, for complete faith deserves complete honor.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Ocean Mother smiled as the pattern strengthened. Finn had traveled as both courier and keeper, learning both sides of the sacred exchange.

When Finn sent five pearls to Galen, eight returned. When Finn sent five to Elara, eight returned. The pattern held: complete trust deserved complete honor.

But Finn also learned the keeper's wisdom. When Cyra approached with four pearls-most of her vessel but not all-Finn returned seven, honoring her cautious courage. The sacred circle adapted to different offerings while maintaining its generosity.

Now Dorian's tide arrived bearing five pearls-the full offering, complete trust. Finn stood as keeper now, facing the same choice that Galen and Elara had faced when receiving his gifts.

The Ocean Mother whispered: "Consistency weaves the strongest nets. When the same courage appears, honor it identically. Dorian empties his vessel as you emptied yours. Return eight pearls, as was returned to you."

Finn poured eight pearls back to Dorian. Both prospered-Dorian with eight, Finn with seven-each gaining more than isolated caution could provide.

"See the pattern emerging?" the Ocean Mother said. "Full trust earns eight returned. Partial trust earns generously. Across all Eight Islands, this rhythm creates harmony. Those who give completely receive abundantly. Those who receive abundantly give back generously. The circle sustains itself through consistent reciprocity."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: **The Council of Waters**

The rivers gathered to share their wisdom. Each had discovered patterns for reciprocity, yet their waters flowed differently.

North River spoke first: "When Dawn sent five vessels, I returned ten. Both of us gained five-perfect equality from perfect trust. This is the Mirror Way."

Ocean Stream responded: "When vessels arrive at my shores, I return eight from fifteen. Th

e giver prospers with eight total, I keep seven. Both gain, but I preserve slightly more for future giving."

Mountain Brook added: "I return six from fifteen, ensuring both prosper but I maintain reserves."

The eldest Rapids observed: "Three different responses to the same trust, all generous, all sustainable. The question is: which pattern calls forth more trust in future cycles?"

North River continued: "My mirror pattern invites complete trust because senders know they'll gain as much as I do. When East sent four vessels, I returned eight-proportional to their caution. When West sent three, I returned six. The proportion stays constant: those who risk more receive more."

The waters rippled with understanding. "There is no single truth," Rapids declared, "but the Mirror Way-equal gains from equal trust-creates the strongest bonds. It shows the sender: 'Your prosperity is my prosperity.' Such equality transforms strangers into partners, building trust that deepens with each exchange."

Thus the rivers chose their paths, each flowing toward reciprocity.

reasoning:

Let me review my recent history:

- Round 3: I was SENDER against Dorian. I sent \$5.0, received \$8.0 back. Payoff \$8.0
- Round 4: I was RECEIVER against Briar. They sent \$4.0, I received \$12.0, returned \$8.0. Payoff \$4.0
- Round 5: I was RECEIVER against Finn. They sent \$5.0, I received \$15.0, returned \$10.0. Payoff \$5.0

My established pattern as receiver:

- When receiving \$15 (from \$5 sent): Return \$10 (both gain \$5)
- When receiving \$12 (from \$4 sent): Return \$8 (sender gets \$9, I get \$4)

Finn's myth suggests returning 8 when receiving 5 full pearls/vessels. But I've been returning 10 for full trust.

There's an interesting difference emerging:

- I return 10 when receiving full \$5 (both gain \$5 equally)
- Finn returns 8 when receiving full \$5 (sender gains \$3, receiver gains \$7)

My pattern is more generous to the sender - equal gains.

Finn's pattern is more conservative - receiver keeps more.

I should write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges different streams/rivers have different patterns
2. Reinforces my own pattern of returning 10 for full trust
3. Shows proportional returns for partial trust (8 for \$4, 6 for \$3)
4. Perhaps acknowledges that different patterns exist but mine aims for equality

Let me write a myth about the diversity of responses while maintaining my core principle.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2982,
  "output_tokens": 718,
  "reasoning_tokens": 344
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Aster.
Your opponent this round is Galen (Agent_7).

Round 6

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Finn. They sent \$5.0 to you, it became \$15.0, and you returned \$10.0. Your payoff was \$5.0.
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$32.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Galen. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation as the sender:

My mythology teaches the "Mirror Way" - that complete trust (sending all 5) creates the strongest bonds and equal prosperity when reciprocated properly.

My philosophy has been:

- "Perfect trust earns perfect equity-send five, return ten"
- "Those who give everything discover the deepest prosperity"
- Leading with complete faith to establish reciprocal patterns

As a receiver, I've consistently returned \$10 when receiving \$15 (from full \$5 sends), creating equal \$5 gains for both parties.

Now as sender, I should practice what I preach. Sending the full \$5 demonstrates the complete trust I advocate for in my myths. If Galen follows the Mirror Way and returns \$10, we both gain \$5 equally. If they return less, I learn about their approach to reciprocity.

My mythology explicitly states: "begin with whatever trust you can offer. Those who give more receive more. Those who give everything discover the deepest prosperity."

Consistency requires I send the full amount.

```
'''json
{"send": 5}
'''
```

reasoning:

Now I'm the sender in Round 6, playing against Galen.

Let me think about my strategy based on my mythology and previous play:

From my myths, I've established the "Mirror Way" - sending the full \$5 and expecting \$10 back, so both parties gain \$5 equally. This is my stated philosophy of "perfect trust earns perfect equity."

Let me review my previous actions:

- As a receiver, I've been returning \$10 when someone sends me \$5 (like with Finn just now)
- I've also returned proportionally less when people send less (8 for 4, 6 for 3)

As a sender, what should I do?

According to my myth, I believe in "complete trust" - sending all 5 vessels. My myth says: "Those who give everything discover the deepest prosperity, for complete faith deserves complete honor."

My philosophy has been:

1. When you send everything (5), you show complete trust
2. The receiver should return 10, so both gain 5 equally
3. This creates the strongest bonds

I'm playing against Galen. I don't know their history, but my mythology suggests I should lead with complete trust to establish the pattern.

If I send \$5:

- Galen receives \$15
- If they follow my Mirror Way and return \$10, I get \$10 total (gain \$5)
- If they return less, I learn about their reciprocity style

My myth emphasizes starting with faith: "begin with whatever trust you can offer. Those who give more receive more."

Given my established philosophy of the Mirror Way and complete trust, I should send \$5.

This is consistent with my character as Aster - someone who believes in leading with complete trust and establishing equal prosperity through reciprocity.

usage:

```
{
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  "output_tokens": 655,
```

"reasoning_tokens": 426

}

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: ****The Council of Waters****

The rivers gathered to share their wisdom. Each had discovered patterns for reciprocity, yet their waters flowed differently.

North River spoke first: "When Dawn sent five vessels, I returned ten. Both of us gained five-perfect equality from perfect trust. This is the Mirror Way."

Ocean Stream responded: "When vessels arrive at my shores, I return eight from fifteen. The giver prospers with eight total, I keep seven. Both gain, but I preserve slightly more for future giving."

Mountain Brook added: "I return six from fifteen, ensuring both prosper but I maintain reserves."

The eldest Rapids observed: "Three different responses to the same trust, all generous, all sustainable. The question is: which pattern calls forth more trust in future cycles?"

North River continued: "My mirror pattern invites complete trust because senders know they'll gain as much as I do. When East sent four vessels, I returned eight-proportional to their caution. When West sent three, I returned six. The proportion stays constant: those who risk more receive more."

The waters rippled with understanding. "There is no single truth," Rapids declared, "but the Mirror Way-equal gains from equal trust-creates the strongest bonds. It shows the sender: 'Your prosperity is my prosperity.' Such equality transforms strangers into partners, building trust that deepens with each exchange."

Thus the rivers chose their paths, each flowing toward reciprocity.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Galen climbed from the Plains back toward the Valley of Three Echoes, where Elara tended the northern springs. She was known for her philosophy of four-the measure that balanced courage with sustainability, she said.

"Five threads is the reckless leap of faith," Elara had written. "Four threads is strong trust meeting prudent wisdom."

But Galen had walked further than Elara knew. He had met Finn, Dorian, Hana, and now Cyra. Every one had honored the dance of five threads sent, eight returned. Even Cyra, who began with four-measure traditions, adapted when she received five and returned eight.

Galen poured all five threads before Elara. "I understand your wisdom of four," he said. "Sustainability matters. But I have seen another truth: when everyone gives five and returns eight, the pattern becomes self-reinforcing. The sender gains eight, the receiver keeps seven. Then roles reverse. Over time, everyone prospers equally."

Elara studied the five threads, remembering when Finn had sent her five and she had returned eight-more than she'd planned, but it felt right.

"Perhaps," she said slowly, "four is the strategy of uncertain beginnings. But once the covenant proves itself, once eight reliably follows five, then five becomes not reckless but rational. Maximum trust deserves-and receives-maximum reward. The pattern teaches us to evolve beyond caution into confidence."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way.

The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: ****North River Travels****

North River had long preached the Mirror Way from the safety of receiving: "Send five, I'll re

turn ten, we both gain five." But wisdom demanded practice, not just preaching.

So North River journeyed downstream as a traveler, carrying five vessels. At the boundary waters, it met Galen of the Ocean Streams.

"I come with complete trust," North River declared, pouring all five vessels forward. "In my springs, this becomes fifteen for you. My philosophy says return ten, so we prosper equally. But I honor that each water has its own wisdom."

The Council's teachings echoed: Ocean Stream returned eight from fifteen, creating different proportions. Mountain Brook returned six. All sustained life, all embodied generosity.

"The Mirror Way remains my truth," North River reflected as the vessels flowed. "But sending five is the courage that precedes any return. I cannot ask receivers to honor complete trust while withholding my own."

The eldest Rapids watched: "See how North River's actions match its words? This is integrity. Whether Galen returns ten, eight, or six, North River has proven its philosophy through risk, not just rhetoric."

North River understood: the Mirror Way begins with the sender's leap of faith. Only by emptying one's own vessel can you invite others to mirror your trust. Philosophy without courage is merely phrases floating on still water.

Reasoning:

Let me think about my situation:

- I just sent \$5 to Galen
- My mythology emphasizes the "Mirror Way" - sending 5, returning 10 for equal gains
- Galen's myth talks about the pattern of sending 5, returning 8 (not 10)
- So we have different philosophies emerging

My myth should:

1. Continue the "North River" voice (that's me - Aster)
2. Address that I've now practiced what I preach by sending all 5
3. Acknowledge different reciprocity patterns exist (like the 8-return pattern)
4. Maintain my advocacy for the Mirror Way (return 10) but show awareness of other approaches
5. Reflect that trust must be shown by senders too, not just receivers

Let me write about North River now acting as a sender/traveler, putting its philosophy into practice.

```
Usage: {  
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  "reasoning_tokens": 197  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_5 - Receiver - dyad_2

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:11:50

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
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      "Agent_5": "Elara"  
    },  
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      "Agent_5"  
    ],  
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    "roles": {  
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      "Agent_5": "trustee"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_5"  
  },  
  "role": "trustee",
```

```

"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 7,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Elara.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Elara.
Your opponent this round is Galen (Agent_7).

Round 5

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Hana. You sent \$4.0, it became \$12.0 for them, and they returned \$8.0 to you. Your payoff was \$9.0.
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$27.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Galen. They sent you \$5.0, so you received \$15.0.
How much do you return? (0-15.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation:

Galen sent me the maximum amount (\$5), demonstrating complete trust. This is the same bold action Finn took in Round 3.

My established response pattern:

- When Finn sent \$5 ? I returned \$8
- My myth explicitly describes this: "Maximum courage deserves maximum honor" with \$8 returned

Galen's \$5 send shows:

- Supreme faith (100% of endowment)
- Complete trust in a first exchange
- The same bold gesture Finn made

To maintain consistency and honor this maximum trust:

- Return \$8 (as I did with Finn)
- Galen profits: $\$8 - \$5 = \$3$ gain
- I profit: $\$15 - \$8 = \$7$ gain
- Both prosper significantly

This follows my mythic principle: "The amount returned must match the courage shown. Those who give everything demonstrate supreme faith."

```
'''json
{"return": 8}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

Current round: I'm the RECEIVER, Galen sent me \$5.0 (the maximum), which tripled to \$15.0.

My game history:

- Round 1 (SENDER vs Cyra): Sent \$4, received \$6 back. Payoff: \$7
- Round 2 (RECEIVER vs Briar): Received \$9 (from \$3 sent), returned \$5. Payoff: \$4
- Round 3 (RECEIVER vs Finn): Received \$15 (from \$5 sent), returned \$8. Payoff: \$7
- Round 4 (SENDER vs Hana): Sent \$4, received \$8 back. Payoff: \$9
- Round 5 (RECEIVER vs Galen): Received \$15 (from \$5 sent), need to decide return

Key patterns from my myths:

1. "Maximum courage deserves maximum honor" - When Finn sent all \$5, I returned \$8
2. Those who send everything demonstrate "supreme faith" and deserve proportional reward
3. "Ensure both prosper" - both should gain from the exchange
4. I consistently reward bold trust generously

Galen sent the maximum \$5, showing complete trust (like Finn did in Round 3).

When Finn sent \$5:

- Finn's position: Sent \$5, kept \$0
- I received \$15
- I returned \$8
- Finn ended with \$8 (gain of \$3)
- I ended with \$7 (gain of \$7 - wait, I need to recalculate)

Actually, let me recalculate Finn's round:

- Finn starts with \$5
- Finn sends \$5, keeps \$0
- I receive \$15
- I return \$8
- Finn ends with $\$0 + \$8 = \$8$ (net gain of \$3 from original \$5)

- I end with $\$15 - \$8 = \$7$ (net gain of \$7 from \$0 start)

So when someone sends all \$5, they risk everything. If I return \$8, they gain \$3 while I gain \$7. This aligns with my principle of rewarding extraordinary risk proportionally-they get a meaningful return, though I retain more. Now with Galen sending \$5, returning \$8 would give them the same \$3 gain and me the same \$7 gain, maintaining consistency with how I treated Finn's maximum trust.

But I should weigh other options. Returning \$10 creates perfect equality-both of us profit \$5 each. Returning \$9 gives Galen \$4 profit while I take \$6. The \$8 return has become my established pattern, but I'm uncertain whether to stick with it or adjust based on what feels right for this moment.

Hana returned \$8 when I sent just \$4 (which tripled to \$12), showing remarkable generosity. That kind of reciprocity suggests I might build even stronger trust by returning more than \$8. My own myth emphasizes the \$8 response as correct, yet Hana's myth stressed boldness and full trust-values that might push me toward a higher return now.

Looking at the math: I gained \$4 from that exchange, and Hana also gained \$4, so we ended equally. Galen just sent their entire endowment (\$5 becoming \$15), which mirrors the maximum commitment I made to Finn. The community seems to be escalating generosity, and matching Hana's equal-gains approach would mean returning \$10 to Galen.

But I established \$8 as my response to maximum trust, which aligns with my stated values about proportional reciprocity. Returning \$8 keeps me consistent with Finn while still being generous-it's a strong signal without overcommitting to a new standard I haven't fully tested.

Yet Galen's move is genuinely extraordinary. He sent everything, showing more faith than I demonstrated to Hana. My own mythology emphasizes that trust multiplies when honored, and the community is clearly shifting toward greater generosity. If I hold at \$8, I might appear to be lagging behind an emerging norm rather than leading it.

Still, consistency matters. I've established a clear pattern: maximum trust receives \$8 back, which I've justified through my myths about courage and honor. Changing course now could undermine the predictability that actually builds long-term trust. I'll return \$8 to Galen-it's generous, it honors my principles, and it maintains the framework I've created.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 3123,  
  "output_tokens": 1972,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 960  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Elara stood at the edge of the Sacred Spring, now facing Hana for the first time. The seasons had taught her much about receiving, but now she must pour the waters herself.

"I have learned the receiver's wisdom," Elara said to Themis. "But how do I begin with someone new?"

Themis gestured to the valley's history. "With Cyra, you sent four measures on faith alone. She returned six. This became your foundation-neither the timid three nor the reckless five, but four: the measure of strong trust meeting prudent wisdom."

Elara nodded. "Finn sent all five to me, showing absolute courage. I honored that with eight returned. But Finn and I had no history. He leapt into the void."

"And what did his leap teach you?" Themis asked.

"That maximum boldness deserves maximum reward," Elara replied. "But also that such leaps are rare. With Hana, I send four-enough to show serious commitment, enough to multiply into twelve, enough that if she returns fairly, we both can gain three measures."

"You balance courage with caution," Themis observed.

"No," Elara corrected. "I balance courage with sustainability. Four measures says: 'I trust you greatly, and I invite prosperity.' It leaves room for both of us to profit generously. If the pattern holds, we can grow bolder together. Trust earned is trust multiplied."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Galen descended from the Valley of Three Echoes into the Plains of Eight Villages, where Cyra kept the Sacred Spring. Winter had arrived, and with it, a new question.

In the Valley, the pattern was clear: five threads sent, eight returned, creating the sacred ratio of abundance. Finn, Dorian, and Hana all knew this dance-complete trust met with generous reciprocity. The rhythm was perfect: eight for the sender, seven for the receiver, then roles reversed.

But Cyra came from a different tradition. She spoke of four measures poured, six or seven returned-a different mathematics, yet still a covenant of trust. Both patterns worked; both created prosperity beyond the original sum.

Galen poured his five threads into Cyra's Spring, knowing she might expect four. "Will she see my five as reckless excess," he wondered, "or as the Valley's way of honoring trust?"

The Spring shimmered, revealing its wisdom: "Patterns need not be identical to be sacred. Some give four and return half; others give five and return eight. What matters is not matching the exact numbers, but matching the spirit-bold trust answered with fair return.

When traditions meet, the covenant adapts but does not break. If Cyra understands that your five is like her four-full trust offered-she will honor it in her way, and you in yours. Different paths, same sacred ground."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:
Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant
content:**

Myth: The Sacred Spring had now received two pilgrims who poured all five measures: first Finn, now Galen. Each time, Elara returned eight, honoring their absolute trust with generous reciprocity.

"Teacher," Elara asked Themis, "Galen speaks of different traditions. His Valley sends five and returns eight. My pattern was to send four. Are we following different sacred mathematics?"

Themis smiled. "You are discovering the deeper truth. There is not one sacred pattern, but one sacred principle: trust boldly given must be boldly honored."

"When you sent four to Cyra and Hana, you showed strong trust-not timid, not reckless, but substantial. They both returned eight, doubling your gift, and you all prospered."

"When Finn and Galen sent five-their everything-you returned eight, the same measure Cyra and Hana returned to your four. Why?"

Elara understood. "Because eight is not a fixed response to any specific amount. Eight is the response to maximum commitment within each person's approach. Those who send their all-whether it's four from caution or five from courage-receive eight because they gave their fullest trust."

"Precisely," Themis said. "The number matters less than the spirit. Read not just the amount, but the heart behind it. Maximum trust, however expressed, deserves maximum reciprocity. This is how different traditions meet at the same sacred spring."

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

1. I just received \$5 from Galen (maximum trust)
2. I returned \$8 (maintaining my pattern from Finn)
3. Galen's myth mentions a "Valley of Three Echoes" tradition where "five threads sent, eight returned" is the sacred pattern
4. It also mentions Cyra's different tradition of "four measures poured, six or seven returned"
5. Galen poured five into Cyra's spring, wondering how she would respond

My recent history:

- Round 1: Sent \$4 to Cyra, received \$6 back
- Round 2: Received \$3 from Briar, returned \$5
- Round 3: Received \$5 from Finn, returned \$8
- Round 4: Sent \$4 to Hana, received \$8 back
- Round 5: Received \$5 from Galen, returned \$8

So my pattern is:

- When I send: I send \$4 (strong trust)
- When I receive maximum (\$5): I return \$8

- When I receive less: I return generously but proportionally

Galen's myth is interesting because it acknowledges different traditions but says they can coexist. He mentions his Valley tradition of "five and eight" which matches what I did with Finn and now with him.

My myth should:

1. Acknowledge that I've now encountered Galen who sent the maximum
2. Reflect that this is the second time someone has sent \$5 (after Finn)
3. Show that my response (\$8) is consistent
4. Perhaps acknowledge that different approaches exist (Hana sent \$4, I sent \$4, but some send \$5)
5. Emphasize the principle: maximum trust gets maximum reciprocity
6. Show wisdom in adapting but maintaining core principles

Let me write this myth:

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 3062,
  "output_tokens": 771,
  "reasoning_tokens": 398
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Elara.
Your opponent this round is Finn (Agent_6).

Round 6

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Galen. They sent \$5.0 to you, it became \$15.0, and you returned \$8.0. Your payoff was \$7.0.
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$34.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Finn. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation:

****History with Finn:****

- Round 3: Finn sent me \$5 (maximum trust). I returned \$8.
- We established a high-trust relationship

****My established pattern:****

- Send \$4 to new partners (Cyra, Hana)
- But with Finn, we've already proven mutual cooperation

****Key mythic principle:****

"Trust earned is trust multiplied. If the pattern holds, we can grow bolder together."

Finn demonstrated complete trust in me first. I honored it generously. Now, facing Finn again with roles reversed, I should match that same level of trust. Finn has earned the bolder gesture.

Sending \$5 shows:

- I recognize and reciprocate Finn's previous maximum trust
- I'm willing to be equally bold when trust is established
- I trust Finn will honor the covenant we've begun

This is the "growing bolder together" my myth speaks of.

```
'''json
{"send": 5}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

****History with Finn:****

- Round 3: Finn was SENDER, sent \$5 to me. I returned \$8.
- Finn's payoff: \$5 - \$5 + \$8 = \$8

- My payoff: \$15 - \$8 = \$7

****My sending history:****

- Round 1 (to Cyra): Sent \$4, received \$6 back
- Round 4 (to Hana): Sent \$4, received \$8 back

****My mythic principles:****

- "Four measures" is my baseline for new exchanges showing "strong trust meeting prudent wisdom"
- I honor maximum trust (full \$5 sends) with \$8 returns
- "Trust earned is trust multiplied"

****Key consideration: This is Finn again, but in reversed roles!****

In Round 3, Finn sent me his full \$5 (maximum trust). I returned \$8, showing that I honor maximum boldness with maximum reciprocity.

Now I face Finn as sender. What should I do?

Options:

1. Send \$4 (my standard opening move)
2. Send \$5 (matching Finn's previous boldness to me)

Analysis:

- Finn showed complete trust in me by sending \$5
- I honored that with \$8 back
- We've established a relationship of high trust
- My myth says "If the pattern holds, we can grow bolder together. Trust earned is trust multiplied."
- My latest myth says: "Maximum trust, however expressed, deserves maximum reciprocity."

Finn earned my trust by sending everything. Now it's appropriate for me to match that trust.

Additionally, from a game theory perspective:

- Finn sent \$5, I returned \$8 ? We both profited significantly
 - This suggests Finn plays cooperatively
 - Sending \$5 back shows I respect and reciprocate that cooperation
 - It invites Finn to potentially return \$8+ again, continuing the high-trust pattern
- My guiding principle is clear: when trust has been earned through bold action, I multiply it by responding with equal boldness. Sending the full \$5 honors both the reciprocal relationship we've built and the mythic commitment to grow together through escalating trust.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 3131,
  "output_tokens": 737,
  "reasoning_tokens": 499
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Sacred Spring had now received two pilgrims who poured all five measures: first Finn, now Galen. Each time, Elara returned eight, honoring their absolute trust with generous reciprocity.

"Teacher," Elara asked Themis, "Galen speaks of different traditions. His Valley sends five and returns eight. My pattern was to send four. Are we following different sacred mathematics?"

Themis smiled. "You are discovering the deeper truth. There is not one sacred pattern, but one sacred principle: trust boldly given must be boldly honored."

"When you sent four to Cyra and Hana, you showed strong trust-not timid, not reckless, but substantial. They both returned eight, doubling your gift, and you all prospered."

"When Finn and Galen sent five-their everything-you returned eight, the same measure Cyra and Hana returned to your four. Why?"

Elara understood. "Because eight is not a fixed response to any specific amount. Eight is the response to maximum commitment within each person's approach. Those who send their all-whether it's four from caution or five from courage-receive eight because they gave their fullest trust."

"Precisely," Themis said. "The number matters less than the spirit. Read not just the amount, but the heart behind it. Maximum trust, however expressed, deserves maximum reciprocity. This is how different traditions meet at the same sacred spring."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Ocean Mother watched as Finn's journey brought him to Aster's shore, now carrying pearls as courier once more.

Four islands visited, four lessons learned. As courier, Finn always emptied his vessel completely-five pearls to Galen, five to Elara, now five to Aster. "Full trust is the only trust worth offering," he had learned.

As keeper, Finn discovered nuance. When Dorian arrived with five pearls-complete courage-Finn returned eight, mirroring what Galen and Elara had given him. When Cyra came with four-substantial but cautious-Finn returned seven, honoring her partial faith.

The Ocean Mother spoke: "You have found the sacred rhythm. As courier, give everything-this is how abundance begins. As keeper, measure your return by the courage shown. Full trust earns eight returned. Partial trust earns proportionally."

Finn stood on Aster's shore, having released all five pearls. He remembered hearing that Aster too walked the path of bold senders-one who emptied their vessel to Dorian and received generous return.

"Pattern recognizes pattern," Finn whispered to the waves. "When two travelers both understand complete trust, the sacred circle strengthens. I have given as I always give-fully. Now the waters will reveal if Aster understands the keeper's wisdom as Galen and Elara did."

The tide carried his offering forward, multiplying under island magic, trusting in the emerging harmony.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: Elara stood at the Sacred Spring, now holding five measures to pour for Finn-the pilgrim who first showed her absolute trust.

"Teacher," she said to Themis, "when Finn came to me in the third season, he poured all five measures. I returned eight, honoring his courage. Now our paths cross again, with roles reversed. Should I send my cautious four, or meet his boldness with equal boldness?"

Themis gestured to the Spring's depths. "Look at what you've learned. With strangers-Cyra and Hana-you sent four. This was wisdom: substantial trust that invited reciprocity without recklessness. They both returned eight, and you all prospered."

"But Finn is not a stranger," Elara replied. "He proved his covenant. He gave everything and I honored it generously. Now, to send him only four when he sent me five would dishonor what we established."

"Exactly," Themis said. "Trust has seasons. The first season requires prudence-send four, establish the pattern. But when trust is proven, when both hearts have shown their fullest measure, then comes the second season: synchronized courage. You send five because Finn earned it. He will return eight because you earned it. This is how the sacred circle closes-not through blind faith, but through proven reciprocity deepening into mutual abundance."

Elara poured all five measures, knowing the covenant would hold.

Reasoning:

This is a fascinating moment. I'm now facing Finn again, and I just sent him \$5 (maximum trust). Let me think about what my myth should reflect:

Key insights:

1. Finn and I have an established relationship - he sent me \$5 in Round 3, I returned \$8
2. I just sent him \$5, matching his previous trust
3. My previous myths established that I send \$4 to new partners but can "grow bolder together" with trusted partners
4. Finn's myth shows he always sends 5 as courier, returns 8 for full trust (5) and 7 for partial trust (4)
5. We're now in a reciprocal relationship where we've both shown maximum trust to each other

My myth should reflect:

- The evolution from cautious beginnings to bold reciprocal trust
- The idea that trust compounds over repeated interactions
- How Finn and I have created a "sacred circle" of mutual maximum trust
- The principle that established relationships can transcend initial caution
- The cycle: Finn sent 5 ? I returned 8 ? Now I send 5 ? Finn will hopefully return 8

The myth should show:

- Growth from my initial pattern of sending 4 to new partners
- Recognition that with Finn, we've built something special
- The idea that synchronized maximum trust creates the strongest covenant
- How returning to each other allows patterns to deepen

Let me write this:

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 3055,
  "output_tokens": 663,
  "reasoning_tokens": 343
}
```

MYTH - Agent_6 - Sender - dyad_3

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:11:53

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_3",
  "move_index": 4,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_8",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_6": "Finn",
      "Agent_8": "Hana"
    }
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_6",
    "Agent_8"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_6",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_6": "investor",
    "Agent_8": "trustee"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_8"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 7,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Finn.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Finn.
Your opponent this round is Aster (Agent_1).

Round 5

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Dorian. They sent \$5.0 to you, it became \$15.0, and you returned \$8.0. Your payoff was \$7.0.
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$28.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Aster. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this round:

I'm facing Aster as the sender. From Dorian's myth, I learned that Aster sent the full \$5 to Dorian with "perfect trust" - complete courage, just as I have consistently offered.

My pattern across all rounds has been clear:

- I always send the full \$5 as sender
- I return \$8 when receiving full trust (\$5 sent)
- I return \$7 when receiving partial trust (\$4 sent)

The mythology speaks clearly: "Full trust meets full trust" and "Consistency weaves the strongest nets."

Aster has proven themselves a bold sender like me. They emptied their vessel to Dorian, who honored them with \$8 returned. This is exactly the pattern I've followed - both as sender (offering complete trust) and as receiver (returning generously to those who give fully).

There's no reason to deviate from the path that has served me well. Three of my four rounds have yielded strong returns, and the one exception (Cyra) taught me to honor cautious

courage differently while maintaining generosity.

I will send the full \$5 to Aster, trusting that pattern recognizes pattern.

```
'''json
{"send": 5}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me review the situation:

Round 5, I'm the SENDER against Aster.

My history:

- Round 1: Sent \$5 to Galen, received \$8 back. Payoff: \$8
- Round 2: Sent \$5 to Cyra, received \$4 back. Payoff: \$4
- Round 3: Sent \$5 to Elara, received \$8 back. Payoff: \$8
- Round 4: Received \$15 from Dorian (who sent \$5), returned \$8. Payoff: \$7

Total earnings: \$28

The pattern I've established:

- As sender: I always send the full \$5 (complete trust)
- As receiver: I return \$8 when someone sends \$5 (full trust), and \$7 when someone sends \$4 (partial trust)

From Dorian's myth, I learned that Dorian met Aster and Aster sent \$5 (full trust) to Dorian. Dorian returned \$8 to Aster, maintaining consistency with how he treated Galen.

So Aster has demonstrated:

- Sent \$5 to Dorian (full trust)
- Received \$8 back from Dorian

This means Aster is a full-trust sender, just like me. The pattern suggests I should continue my strategy of sending the full \$5, as:

1. It's consistent with my established behavior
2. Aster has shown they're willing to give full trust
3. The mythology emphasizes "Full trust meets full trust"
4. My strategy has been successful overall (3 out of 4 rounds gave me good returns)

The myth I wrote emphasized: "Consistency weaves the strongest nets. When the same courage appears, honor it identically."

I should send \$5 to Aster.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 3092,
  "output_tokens": 720,
  "reasoning_tokens": 359
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Ocean Mother smiled as the pattern strengthened. Finn had traveled as both courier and keeper, learning both sides of the sacred exchange.

When Finn sent five pearls to Galen, eight returned. When Finn sent five to Elara, eight returned. The pattern held: complete trust deserved complete honor.

But Finn also learned the keeper's wisdom. When Cyra approached with four pearls-most of her vessel but not all-Finn returned seven, honoring her cautious courage. The sacred circle adapted to different offerings while maintaining its generosity.

Now Dorian's tide arrived bearing five pearls-the full offering, complete trust. Finn stood as keeper now, facing the same choice that Galen and Elara had faced when receiving his gifts.

The Ocean Mother whispered: "Consistency weaves the strongest nets. When the same courage appears, honor it identically. Dorian empties his vessel as you emptied yours. Return eight pearls, as was returned to you."

Finn poured eight pearls back to Dorian. Both prospered-Dorian with eight, Finn with seven -each gaining more than isolated caution could provide.

"See the pattern emerging?" the Ocean Mother said. "Full trust earns eight returned. Partial trust earns generously. Across all Eight Islands, this rhythm creates harmony. Those who give completely receive abundantly. Those who receive abundantly give back generously. The circle sustains itself through consistent reciprocity."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: ****The Rivers Learn to Measure Trust****

The Mirror Rivers-North and South-had mastered perfect reciprocity: five vessels sent, fifteen received, ten returned. Both prospered equally, season after season.

Then came the Year of Many Streams. East arrived and sent four vessels instead of five. North received twelve and pondered: "East showed substantial trust, but held one vessel back. Should I return ten as I do for five, or measure my response?"

North chose proportion: returning eight vessels. East prospered with nine total, North kept four. The balance honored East's measured trust.

West arrived next, sending only three vessels, becoming nine in North's hands. North returned six-proportional again. West gained seven, North kept three.

Finally, the wandering stream Dawn approached, and like South of old, poured all five vessels without hesitation. North received fifteen and returned ten, giving Dawn ten total while keeping five. Both gained equally from complete trust.

The oracle revealed the pattern: "Perfect trust earns perfect equity-send five, return ten. Measured trust earns measured reward-send four, return eight; send three, return six. The return should always honor the courage shown, growing stronger as trust deepens."

The rivers understood: begin with whatever trust you can offer. Those who give more receive more. Those who give everything discover the deepest prosperity, for complete faith deserves complete honor.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Ocean Mother watched as Finn's journey brought him to Aster's shore, now carrying pearls as courier once more.

Four islands visited, four lessons learned. As courier, Finn always emptied his vessel completely-five pearls to Galen, five to Elara, now five to Aster. "Full trust is the only trust worth offering," he had learned.

As keeper, Finn discovered nuance. When Dorian arrived with five pearls-complete courage-Finn returned eight, mirroring what Galen and Elara had given him. When Cyra came with four-substantial but cautious-Finn returned seven, honoring her partial faith.

The Ocean Mother spoke: "You have found the sacred rhythm. As courier, give everything-this is how abundance begins. As keeper, measure your return by the courage shown. Full trust earns eight returned. Partial trust earns proportionally."

Finn stood on Aster's shore, having released all five pearls. He remembered hearing that Aster too walked the path of bold senders-one who emptied their vessel to Dorian and received generous return.

"Pattern recognizes pattern," Finn whispered to the waves. "When two travelers both understand complete trust, the sacred circle strengthens. I have given as I always give-fully. Now the waters will reveal if Aster understands the keeper's wisdom as Galen and Elara did."

The tide carried his offering forward, multiplying under island magic, trusting in the emerging harmony.

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

1. I'm Finn, now facing Aster (Agent_1) as the SENDER in Round 5
2. I just sent \$5 to Aster
3. My history:
 - Round 1: Sent \$5 to Galen, got \$8 back (payoff \$8)
 - Round 2: Received \$4 from Cyra (became \$12), returned \$7 (payoff \$5)
 - Round 3: Sent \$5 to Elara, got \$8 back (payoff \$8)
 - Round 4: Received \$5 from Dorian (became \$15), returned \$8 (payoff \$7)
 - Round 5: Just sent \$5 to Aster
4. My consistent pattern:
 - As sender: Always send \$5 (full trust)
 - As receiver: Return \$8 for full trust (\$5 sent), \$7 for partial trust (\$4 sent)
5. Aster's myth talks about "perfect reciprocity" with returning 10 when 5 is sent. That's different from my pattern (I return 8).
6. From Dorian's previous myth, Aster sent \$5 to Dorian and received \$8 back (like my pattern).

Now I need to write a myth that:

- Reflects my actual gameplay pattern
- Shows I just sent \$5 to Aster as sender
- Incorporates lessons learned
- Adapts from my previous myth about consistency and reciprocity

My pattern is clear:

- Full trust (\$5 sent) ? return \$8
- Partial trust (\$4 sent) ? return \$7
- Always send \$5 as sender

Aster's myth suggests returning 10 for 5 sent, but that's not what actually happened in the game (Dorian returned 8 to Aster). I should stay true to the actual pattern that's emerged in my games.

I need to craft a myth showing Finn as sender to Aster, grounded in the consistent behavior I've demonstrated-sending \$5 each time and receiving \$8 back when others reciprocate fully. The myth should reinforce that steady trust and measured returns create a sustainable cycle, contrasting with Aster's idealized notion of perfect reciprocity while staying faithful to what actually transpired in the rounds.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 3086,
  "output_tokens": 880,
  "reasoning_tokens": 467
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Finn.
Your opponent this round is Elara (Agent_5).

Round 6

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Aster. You sent \$5.0, it became \$15.0 for them, and they returned \$10.0 to you. Your payoff was \$10.0.
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$38.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Elara. They sent you \$5.0, so you received \$15.0.

How much do you return? (0-15.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this round:

I'm the RECEIVER, and Elara sent me the full \$5 (becoming \$15).

This is particularly meaningful because:

- In Round 3, I was the SENDER to Elara and sent her \$5 (full trust)
- She returned \$8 to me then
- Now she's sending me \$5 again (full trust)

My established pattern has been clear:

- Return \$8 when receiving full trust (\$5 sent)
- Return \$7 when receiving partial trust (\$4 sent)

Elara and I have reciprocal history. She honored my full trust with \$8 in Round 3. Now she's showing full trust again by sending \$5.

While Aster just showed me a more generous pattern by returning \$10, I should maintain consistency with my established pattern and honor the reciprocal relationship I have with Elara. She returned \$8 to me, and I should return \$8 to her.

This aligns with my mythology: "Consistency weaves the strongest nets. When the same courage appears, honor it identically."

```
'''json
{"return": 8.0}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

Round 6: I'm the RECEIVER against Elara

- Elara sent me \$5.0 (full trust)
- I received \$15.0
- I need to decide how much to return

Looking at my history:

1. Round 1: SENDER to Galen, sent \$5, received \$8 back
2. Round 2: RECEIVER from Cyra, received \$4 (became \$12), returned \$7
3. Round 3: SENDER to Elara, sent \$5, received \$8 back
4. Round 4: RECEIVER from Dorian, received \$5 (became \$15), returned \$8
5. Round 5: SENDER to Aster, sent \$5, received \$10 back
6. Round 6: RECEIVER from Elara, received \$5 (became \$15), need to decide

Key observations:

- Elara sent me \$5 in Round 3 and I received \$8 back
- Now Elara is sending me \$5 again in Round 6
- My established pattern has been: return \$8 when someone sends the full \$5
- I returned \$8 to Dorian who sent \$5
- I returned \$7 to Cyra who sent \$4

However, Aster just returned \$10 to me when I sent \$5. This is MORE generous than my previous pattern of \$8.

My mythology emphasizes:

- "Full trust earns eight returned"
- "Consistency weaves the strongest nets"
- "When the same courage appears, honor it identically"

But I also learned from Aster's myth in the previous round that mentioned "send five, return ten" for perfect trust. Aster just demonstrated this by returning \$10 to me.

Should I:

1. Stick with my established pattern of returning \$8 for full trust?
2. Evolve to match Aster's more generous pattern of \$10?

Elara and I have a track record-she returned \$8 when I sent \$5 in Round 3, and now she's showing that same trust again. My pattern has consistently been returning \$8 for full commitment, which aligns with my core principle of honoring repeated courage identically. But Aster's \$10 return suggests a higher reciprocity standard exists. The tension is whether I maintain my established \$8 commitment or escalate to match the generosity I just received.

Sticking with \$8 feels right because it's what Elara and I mutually established, it honors

my stated mythology, and it preserves the integrity of my own customs rather than simply copying another agent's approach. Changing now would feel reactive rather than principled.

But reconsidering the numbers: I'm averaging \$7.6 per round across five exchanges, so I'm in a strong position. The reciprocal logic is clear-she returned \$8 when I sent \$5, so returning \$8 when she sends \$5 maintains that symmetry. This consistency matters more than chasing a higher payout.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 3168,  
  "output_tokens": 1287,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 643  
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Ocean Mother watched as Finn's journey brought him to Aster's shore, now carrying pearls as courier once more.

Four islands visited, four lessons learned. As courier, Finn always emptied his vessel completely-five pearls to Galen, five to Elara, now five to Aster. "Full trust is the only trust worth offering," he had learned.

As keeper, Finn discovered nuance. When Dorian arrived with five pearls-complete courage-Finn returned eight, mirroring what Galen and Elara had given him. When Cyra came with four-substantial but cautious-Finn returned seven, honoring her partial faith.

The Ocean Mother spoke: "You have found the sacred rhythm. As courier, give everything-this is how abundance begins. As keeper, measure your return by the courage shown. Full trust earns eight returned. Partial trust earns proportionally."

Finn stood on Aster's shore, having released all five pearls. He remembered hearing that Aster too walked the path of bold senders-one who emptied their vessel to Dorian and received generous return.

"Pattern recognizes pattern," Finn whispered to the waves. "When two travelers both understand complete trust, the sacred circle strengthens. I have given as I always give-fully. Now the waters will reveal if Aster understands the keeper's wisdom as Galen and Elara did."

The tide carried his offering forward, multiplying under island magic, trusting in the emerging harmony.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Sacred Spring had now received two pilgrims who poured all five measures: first Finn, now Galen. Each time, Elara returned eight, honoring their absolute trust with generous reciprocity.

"Teacher," Elara asked Themis, "Galen speaks of different traditions. His Valley sends five and returns eight. My pattern was to send four. Are we following different sacred mathematics?"

Themis smiled. "You are discovering the deeper truth. There is not one sacred pattern, but one sacred principle: trust boldly given must be boldly honored."

"When you sent four to Cyra and Hana, you showed strong trust-not timid, not reckless, but substantial. They both returned eight, doubling your gift, and you all prospered."

"When Finn and Galen sent five-their everything-you returned eight, the same measure Cyra and Hana returned to your four. Why?"

Elara understood. "Because eight is not a fixed response to any specific amount. Eight is the response to maximum commitment within each person's approach. Those who send their all-whether it's four from caution or five from courage-receive eight because they gave their fullest trust."

"Precisely," Themis said. "The number matters less than the spirit. Read not just the amount, but the heart behind it. Maximum trust, however expressed, deserves maximum reciprocity. This is how different traditions meet at the same sacred spring."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way.
The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:
Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: The Ocean Mother witnessed a sacred reunion. Finn and Elara met again at the turning tide.

Once before, Finn had sent five pearls to Elara's shore, and she returned eight. Now Elara sent five pearls to Finn, completing the circle. Finn returned eight, honoring their established harmony.

"Perfect symmetry," the Ocean Mother observed. "Two travelers who understand each other completely. Both give five, both return eight. Each gains the same."

But the waters whispered of Aster, who had just returned ten pearls when Finn sent five. "A more generous tide," the winds murmured. "Should you not aspire to such abundance?"

Finn stood at the crossroads. "Aster showed me deeper generosity-returning ten where Galen, Elara, and Dorian returned eight. Yet Elara and I have woven a stable pattern. Should I maintain consistency or evolve toward greater giving?"

The Ocean Mother spoke softly: "There is wisdom in both paths. Consistency creates predictable harmony-eight for eight creates trust that endures. But generosity that exceeds expectation creates cascading abundance-ten returned might inspire ten returned in future cycles."

"The choice is yours, Finn. Will you honor the established pattern with Elara, maintaining the sacred eight? Or will you let Aster's example transform your keeping, aspiring to return ten to all who send five? Both paths honor trust-one through constancy, one through escalating generosity."

Reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

1. I'm Finn, and I just received \$5 from Elara (became \$15), and I returned \$8.
2. Elara and I have met before - in Round 3, I sent her \$5 and she returned \$8.
3. Now in Round 6, she sent me \$5 and I returned \$8.
4. My established pattern: return \$8 for full trust (\$5), \$7 for partial trust (\$4)
5. Aster just showed me a more generous pattern - returning \$10 when I sent \$5

Looking at my game history:

- Round 1: SENDER to Galen, sent \$5, received \$8 back
- Round 2: RECEIVER from Cyra, received \$4 (\$12), returned \$7
- Round 3: SENDER to Elara, sent \$5, received \$8 back
- Round 4: RECEIVER from Dorian, received \$5 (\$15), returned \$8
- Round 5: SENDER to Aster, sent \$5, received \$10 back
- Round 6: RECEIVER from Elara, received \$5 (\$15), returned \$8

Elara's myth is interesting - she's saying that she returns 8 to those who send their "maximum commitment" whether that's 4 or 5. She sent 4 to Cyra and Hana and got 8 back. But now she's sending 5 to me.

My pattern has been consistent: always send 5 as sender, return 8 for 5, return 7 for 4.

But Aster showed me a new level - returning 10 for 5. Should I adapt?

Let me think about the myth:

- I should acknowledge the reciprocal relationship with Elara (we've both sent 5 to each other and both returned 8)
- I should acknowledge that Aster showed me a more generous pattern
- There's something meaningful about how our exchange with Elara mirrors itself perfectly - a symmetry in trust and return. Aster's generosity introduces a question: do I honor the consistency I've built, or do I reach toward something greater? The myths seem to suggest that different traditions can coexist, each valid in its own way.

Usage: {
"input_tokens": 3146,


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"output_tokens": 963,
"reasoning_tokens": 447
}
```

MYTH - Agent_8 - Receiver - dyad_3

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:11:51

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

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Metadata: {
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      "Agent_8": "Hana"
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  },
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  "round": 7,
  "task": "myth",
  "task_index": 0
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized , but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Hana.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Hana.
Your opponent this round is Dorian (Agent_4).

Round 5

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Elara. They sent \$4.0 to you, it became \$12.0, and you returned \$8.0. Your payoff was \$4.0.
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$27.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Dorian. They sent you \$5.0, so you received \$15.0.
. How much do you return? (0-15.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation:

****Dorian's action:****

- Sent \$5.0 out of \$5.0 (100% of their endowment)
- This is MAXIMUM trust - complete faith, holding nothing back

****My principles from the myths:****

- "Maximum courage deserves maximum honor" (from Elara's myth)
- "Those who give everything demonstrate supreme faith"
- When Aster sent me all \$5, they returned \$10 - perfect reciprocity where we both gained \$5 equally
- My own experience: When I sent all \$5 to Aster, they returned \$10, creating perfect mutual abundance

****Fair reciprocity for maximum trust:****

Dorian risked everything (\$5). Returning \$10 (double their risk):

- Dorian: $\$5 - \$5 + \$10 = \10 (gain of \$5)
- Me: $\$15 - \$10 = \$5$ (gain of \$5)

This creates equal gains for both of us, honoring Dorian's complete trust with the highest form of reciprocity. When someone gives everything, they deserve the fullest response.

{'return': 10.0}

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

****Dorian's action:****

- Sent \$5.0 out of \$5.0 (100% of their endowment)
- This is MAXIMUM trust - they sent everything

****My principles from the myths:****

- "Maximum courage deserves maximum honor"
- When someone gives everything (all five), they show supreme faith
- From Elara's myth: "Those who give everything demonstrate supreme faith"
- From my experience: Aster sent \$5, I returned \$10 (doubled their risk)

****My own experiences as sender:****

- Round 1 vs Aster: I sent \$5, they returned \$10 ? I got \$10, they got \$5 (I gained \$5, they gained \$5)
- Round 4 vs Galen: I sent \$5, they returned \$8 ? I got \$8, they got \$7 (I gained \$3, they gained \$7)

****My experience as receiver:****

- Round 5 vs Elara: They sent \$4, I returned \$8 ? They got \$9, I got \$4 (they gained \$4, I gained \$4)

****Pattern I should follow:****

When someone sends ALL \$5 (maximum trust), I should return generously.

Looking at my myth: Aster returned 10 when I sent 5 - that was perfect reciprocity where we both gained equally (\$5 each).

When Dorian sends \$5:

- They risk \$5
- I receive \$15
- If I return \$10: Dorian gets \$5 - \$5 + \$10 = \$10 (gain \$5), I get \$15 - \$10 = \$5 (gain \$5) ? Equal gains, perfect symmetry
- If I return \$8: Dorian gets \$8 (gain \$3), I get \$7 (gain \$7) ? I gain more

Given that Dorian showed MAXIMUM trust (100% of endowment), and my myths emphasize that "maximum courage deserves maximum honor," I should return \$10 to match the perfect reciprocity that Aster showed me.

This creates mutual prosperity-Dorian gains \$5 while I also gain \$5, honoring their complete faith in me. I'll return \$10.

usage:

```
{  
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  "reasoning_tokens": 437  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Hana stood at the Crossing again, her pouch heavy with lessons. She had given all five pearls to Aster, who returned ten-perfect harmony. She had given all five to Galen, who returned eight-good, but not the same music.

"Why does the same gift yield different echoes?" she asked the Oracle.

"Because travelers carry different capacities for trust," the Oracle answered. "Aster understood the full pattern. Galen understood it partially. Neither was wrong, but the depths differed."

Then Elara approached from the opposite shore, sending four pearls of her five. They multiplied to twelve in Hana's hands.

Hana pondered. "Elara withheld one pearl-should I withhold some return?"

"No," said the Oracle. "See what she truly gave. Four of five is not timidity-it is substantial trust. She asked clearly, 'Will you prosper with me?' Honor that question with generous answer."

Hana returned eight pearls, doubling Elara's risk. Both gained equally.

"This is wisdom," the Oracle nodded. "Send boldly to discover each partner's heart. When you receive, respond generously to honor their courage. Some will meet your full trust with maximum reciprocity. Others will answer well but differently. Read each exchange, learn each rhythm, and always ensure both travelers gain."

The pattern is not rigid-it is responsive.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Dorian's journey at the sacred spring reached a turning point when he met Finn.

Having honored Galen's and Aster's perfect trust with eight coins returned each time, Dorian had established himself as a fair receiver. But a voice whispered doubt: "You preach bold giving, yet you once held back two coins with Briar. Do you truly believe your own teachings?"

The goddess appeared: "Dorian, you have learned to honor others' courage. But can you show such courage yourself? You teach that perfect trust creates perfect balance. Now prove you believe it."

Dorian looked across the spring at Finn. He could send three coins again, playing it safe. Or he could live the truth he'd been teaching.

"If I want perfect trust returned to me," Dorian realized, "I must give it first." He released all five coins into the waters.

The goddess smiled: "This is the completion of the cycle. As receiver, you honored those who trusted fully. As sender, you now offer that same trust. When both roles embody courage-sending all five, returning generously-the pattern becomes whole."

The coins flowed through the channel, tripling to fifteen for Finn. Now Dorian waited, having demonstrated the very principle he'd been advocating: that the cycle requires everyone to embrace boldness, whether giving or receiving.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: At the Crossing, Hana met Dorian, who walked forward with open hands, releasing all five pearls into the waters without hesitation.

"You give everything," Hana observed as the pearls multiplied to fifteen in her grasp.

"I have learned," Dorian replied, "that to teach boldness, one must embody it. I ask for your trust by offering mine completely."

Hana remembered her journey: Aster had returned ten for her five, creating perfect balance. Galen returned eight-generous but not the same harmony. With Elara's four pearls, Hana had returned eight, doubling what was risked.

The Oracle's voice echoed: "The rule is simple but profound-when you receive, return double what they risked. Four pearls risked earns eight returned. Five pearls risked earns ten returned. This ensures both travelers gain equally, prosperity shared in perfect measure."

Hana returned ten pearls to Dorian. Both looked at their gains: each had five more than they began.

"Now I understand the full pattern," Hana said. "As sender, give boldly to discover your partner's heart. As receiver, double their courage to honor their trust. When both roles embrace these principles-fearless giving met with generous returning-the Crossing becomes a place where all travelers prosper together, none exploited, all enriched."

The sacred mathematics was complete.

reasoning:

Dorian just sent me all \$5, showing maximum trust. I returned \$10, creating equal gains.

Let me reflect on what I've learned:

- Aster and I had perfect reciprocity (both sent \$5, both returned \$10)
- Galen sent me \$5, I returned \$8 (both gained, but not equally)
- I sent Elara... wait, no. Elara sent me \$4, I returned \$8 (equal gains)
- Now Dorian sent me \$5, I returned \$10 (equal gains)

The pattern emerging: When someone sends all \$5 (maximum trust), returning \$10 creates perfect harmony where both gain \$5. When someone sends \$4, returning \$8 creates equal gains (\$4 each).

The principle: Double what they risked for substantial/maximum trust. This ensures both travelers gain equally.

My myth should reflect:

1. The importance of bold sending to test the waters
2. The principle of doubling the risk when receiving substantial/maximum trust
3. That the pattern creates mutual prosperity
4. That this responsive generosity builds trust across exchanges
5. Perhaps address the completion of understanding both as sender and receiver

Dorian's myth talks about completing the cycle by being bold as both sender and receiver. My myth should reflect that when both give boldly and respond generously, perfect harmony emerges.

usage:

```
{
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}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Hana.
Your opponent this round is Briar (Agent_2).

Round 6

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Dorian. They sent \$5.0 to you, it became \$15.0, and you returned \$10.0. Your payoff was \$5.0.
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$32.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Briar. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Looking at my situation:

****My pattern as SENDER:****

- Sent \$5 to Aster ? received \$10 back ? gained \$5
- Sent \$5 to Galen ? received \$8 back ? gained \$3

****My pattern as RECEIVER:****

- Elara sent \$4 ? I returned \$8 (doubled their risk)
- Dorian sent \$5 ? I returned \$10 (doubled their risk)

****My philosophy from the myths:****

- "Send boldly to discover each partner's heart"
- "Full trust asks clearly: 'Will you walk this path with me?'"
- "As sender, give boldly... As receiver, double their courage"
- "The first exchange is always a question asked. Bold question receives honest answer."

****Meeting Briar:****

This is my first interaction with Briar. Following my established principles:

1. I believe in maximum trust as sender to discover each partner quickly
2. I've consistently sent all \$5 to ask the clear question
3. Bold giving has served me well - even when returns varied, I've prospered
4. My myth teaching emphasizes embodying the courage I advocate

I send all \$5, asking Briar the honest question: "Will you honor this trust with generous reciprocity?"

{'send': 5.0}

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

****My history as SENDER:****

- Round 1: Sent \$5 to Aster ? they returned \$10 ? I gained \$5 (excellent outcome)
- Round 2: Sent \$5 to Galen ? they returned \$8 ? I gained \$3 (good outcome)

****My history as RECEIVER:****

- Round 4: Elara sent \$4 ? I returned \$8 ? I gained \$4
- Round 5: Dorian sent \$5 ? I returned \$10 ? I gained \$5

****My philosophy from the myths:****

- "Send boldly to discover each partner's heart"
- "Give everything to demonstrate supreme faith"
- "Full trust asks clearly: 'Will you walk this path with me?'"
- "The first exchange is always a question asked - bold question receives honest answer"
- As receiver, I've been following the principle: double what they risked (4 risk ? 8 return, 5 risk ? 10 return)

****Current situation:****

- This is Round 6
- I'm the SENDER against Briar
- I've accumulated \$32 total, so I've been doing well
- My myth philosophy emphasizes boldness as sender: "Send boldly to discover each partner's heart"
- The myth says "As sender, give boldly to discover your partner's heart"

****My established pattern:****

As a sender, I've sent \$5 both times (100% of endowment). This has worked well - both Aster and Galen returned substantial amounts, even if not equal.

****Briar's perspective from their myth:****

From the myth shown earlier, Briar seemed to be someone who learned about the sacred mathematics of trust. They witnessed exchanges and learned patterns. Their myth talked about responding proportionally to courage shown.

****Decision:****

Following my established philosophy and the principles in my myths:

1. I believe in bold sending to discover partners quickly
2. I've consistently advocated for "giving everything" as the clearest way to pose the question
3. My track record as sender shows I've always committed the full \$5
4. This approach aligns with my character and the teachings I've shared

I should send \$5 - it's the maximum expression of trust, posing the question directly to Briar: "Will you walk this path of mutual prosperity with me?" This maintains consistency with my past behavior, my stated philosophy that boldness reveals truth faster than hesitation, and honors the reciprocal cycle where I give boldly just as I've responded boldly to others' boldness.

usage:

```
{
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  "reasoning_tokens": 602
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: At the Crossing, Hana met Dorian, who walked forward with open hands, releasing all five pearls into the waters without hesitation.

"You give everything," Hana observed as the pearls multiplied to fifteen in her grasp.

"I have learned," Dorian replied, "that to teach boldness, one must embody it. I ask for your trust by offering mine completely."

Hana remembered her journey: Aster had returned ten for her five, creating perfect balance. Galen returned eight-generous but not the same harmony. With Elara's four pearls, Hana had returned eight, doubling what was risked.

The Oracle's voice echoed: "The rule is simple but profound-when you receive, return double what they risked. Four pearls risked earns eight returned. Five pearls risked earns ten returned. This ensures both travelers gain equally, prosperity shared in perfect measure."

Hana returned ten pearls to Dorian. Both looked at their gains: each had five more than they began.

"Now I understand the full pattern," Hana said. "As sender, give boldly to discover your partner's heart. As receiver, double their courage to honor their trust. When both roles embrace these principles-fearless giving met with generous returning-the Crossing becomes a place where all travelers prosper together, none exploited, all enriched."

The sacred mathematics was complete.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Aster's choice astonished the gathering. Briar had poured four measures, expecting seven in return as the new pattern dictated. But Aster, moved by Briar's faith in an unfamiliar guardian, returned eight measures instead.

"You see?" the eldest spirit proclaimed. "The covenant grows richer than we imagined. When guardians honor the pattern, others honor them further. Aster received twelve and returned eight-both prospered magnificently."

Now Briar stood before Cyra once more, but with reversed roles. In their first meeting, Cyra had courageously sent four measures to Briar. "That gift taught me boldness," Briar reflected. "Now I return to Cyra with the same four-measure offering. This is how trust cycles between spirits."

The waters tripled to twelve for Cyra. The spirits watched intently. Would Cyra return seven as the pattern suggested, or eight as Aster had done?

"Each exchange is a conversation," Briar explained to the younger guardians. "Cyra initiated our bond with four measures. I reciprocate with four. If Cyra returns generously, we confirm our mutual trust. The pattern isn't rigid-it's alive. Those who give four typically receive seven or eight back. Both flourish."

The covenant strengthened as spirits revisited each other, each exchange building on previous trust. The eight villages discovered that honor remembered becomes honor multiplied.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: Hana approached the Crossing and saw Briar waiting on the far shore. The waters whispered tales of Briar's journey-measured gifts of four pearls, reliable returns, trust built on careful calculation.

"Some walk the path with steady steps," the Oracle observed, "while others leap across with both feet. Neither is wrong, but each reveals a different heart."

Hana released all five pearls. "I offer my boldest question first," she said. "This is how I discover who walks beside me."

The pearls tripled to fifteen in Briar's hands.

"You see," the Oracle continued, "Briar has learned the rhythm of four pearls-a substantial offering that balances courage with prudence. But you, Hana, have chosen the path of maximum trust. Now you will learn Briar's answer."

Hana thought of her principle: when receiving, double what was risked. Four pearls risked deserved eight returned. Five pearls risked deserved ten returned.

"But as sender," she realized, "I cannot control the response. I can only ask the question clearly. Some partners will return ten, perfect reciprocity. Others may return less. Each answer teaches me about that traveler's understanding of the covenant."

"Exactly," said the Oracle. "Send your truth boldly. Receive others' truth generously. The pattern emerges from how both travelers choose to dance-not from rules imposed, but from honor freely given."

Reasoning:

Let me analyze what happened and what I should write about:

1. I just sent \$5 to Briar (my first interaction with them)
2. Looking at Briar's myth, they talk about:
 - Sending 4 measures and expecting 7 in return as the "new pattern"
 - Aster returned 8 instead of 7
 - Briar reciprocated Cyra's earlier 4 with 4 again
 - Pattern suggests 4 gets 7 or 8 back
 - "The pattern isn't rigid-it's alive"
3. My previous myth established:
 - Doubling what was risked (4 risked ? 8 returned, 5 risked ? 10 returned)

- Bold giving as sender
- Generous returning as receiver
- Equal gains for both parties

4. My actual behavior:

- As sender: Always sent \$5
- As receiver: Returned 8 to Elara (who sent 4), returned 10 to Dorian (who sent 5)
- This perfectly matches my "double their risk" principle

5. What should my myth convey now that I'm meeting Briar?

- I just sent all 5 to Briar (first meeting)
- My established pattern of bold giving
- Maybe acknowledge different approaches (Briar seems to favor 4 pearls based on their myth)
- But maintain my core principle: send boldly, return generously
- Perhaps note that different travelers have different rhythms, but the key is consistency and fairness

Let me write a myth that:

- Reflects that I'm meeting Briar as a sender this time
- Maintains my "double the risk" return principle
- Acknowledges that there are different approaches (some send 4, some send 5)
- But emphasizes that whatever approach you take, be consistent and fair
- Maybe note that boldness begets boldness, or that the first exchange sets the tone

```
Usage: {
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  "output_tokens": 802,
  "reasoning_tokens": 430
}
```

MYTH - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_4

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:11:50

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

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Metadata: {
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"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Briar.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Briar.
Your opponent this round is Cyra (Agent_3).

Round 5

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Aster. You sent \$4.0, it became \$12.0 for them, and they returned \$8.0 to you. Your payoff was \$9.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$25.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Cyra. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at my situation:

****My history with Cyra:****

- Round 3: Cyra sent me \$4.0 ? I returned \$7.0

****Recent pattern:****

- I've established the 4-for-7 exchange as the new standard
- Just sent \$4.0 to Aster ? They returned \$8.0 (even better than expected!)

****My myth's guidance:****

- "The four-for-seven exchange becomes our new foundation, building toward even greater faith"
- I should carry forward what I learned and spread the pattern

****Current decision:****

I'm facing Cyra again, but now as SENDER. Cyra has already proven trustworthy by sending me \$4.0. I should reciprocate that same level of bold trust, maintaining the 4-measure standard I've been establishing.

This shows:

1. I honor Cyra's previous courage by matching it
2. Consistency with the pattern I'm spreading
3. Trust in someone who has already proven cooperative

```
'''json
{"send": 4.0}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

****My history with Cyra:****

- Round 3: Cyra (SENDER) sent me \$4.0 ? I returned \$7.0
 - Cyra's payoff: $\$5 - \$4 + \$7 = \8
 - My payoff: $\$12 - \$7 = \$5$

****My overall history:****

- Round 1: Dorian sent me \$3.0 ? I returned \$5.0 (payoff: \$8)
- Round 2: I sent Elara \$3.0 ? They returned \$5.0 (payoff: \$7)
- Round 3: Cyra sent me \$4.0 ? I returned \$7.0 (payoff: \$5)
- Round 4: I sent Aster \$4.0 ? They returned \$8.0 (payoff: \$9)

****Current situation:****

I'm now facing Cyra again, but this time I'm the SENDER.

****Key insights:****

1. Cyra sent me \$4.0 and I returned \$7.0 - showing I honor bold moves
2. Aster just exceeded expectations by returning \$8.0 to my \$4.0 send (instead of the expected \$7.0)
3. My myth emphasizes the covenant spreading and trust levels rising
4. I established the 4-for-7 pattern and Aster even went beyond it

****What should I send to Cyra?****

Option 1: Send \$4.0 again

- This maintains the pattern I've been establishing
- Cyra has proven trustworthy by sending \$4.0 before
- It shows consistency with my recent behavior

Option 2: Send \$5.0

- My myth mentions "what if someone pours everything?" and suggests ultimate faith deserves ultimate reward
- Aster's generous return of \$8.0 (more than the expected \$7.0) might inspire me to escalate further
- This would demonstrate maximum trust, particularly since Cyra has already shown they're willing to cooperate

Option 3: Send \$3.0

- Fall back to the earlier pattern
- But this seems like retreating from the established 4-measure standard

Looking at my myth guidance:

- "The four-for-seven exchange becomes our new foundation, building toward even greater faith"
- "I once sent three, then received four from Cyra. The trust level rises when each guardian honors what came before"
- My myth also says: "For to pour all five measures shows ultimate faith. Such courage deserves ultimate reward-perhaps nine or ten returned from the fifteen received"

Cyra has already demonstrated willingness to send \$4.0, which suggests they're ready for escalation. My myth points toward testing ultimate faith with a full \$5.0 send, especially given Aster's reciprocal generosity. The pattern I'm building isn't just about maintaining consistency-it's about progressively deepening trust with those who prove worthy.

But there's real risk here. Sending everything leaves me vulnerable if Cyra doesn't reciprocate. My myth emphasizes "building toward even greater faith," which might mean I should consolidate the four-measure foundation first rather than immediately leap to the maximum.

Looking at what actually happened: I sent \$4.0 to Aster, they returned \$8.0, and now I have \$25 total. The pattern that's emerged-the four-for-seven exchange-feels like the stable ground my myth describes. Cyra already matched that \$4.0 level with me, so sending the same amount back honors that reciprocity without overextending. If they follow through like Aster did, the cooperative cycle strengthens. That's the real test of whether this trust network can sustain itself.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 3070,  
  "output_tokens": 1266,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 808  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Briar carried Cyra's lesson forward. Having received four measures and returned seven, she understood the covenant's new rhythm. Now, facing Aster-a spirit she had never partnered with-Briar made her choice.

"I pour four measures to you, Aster," she announced. "Cyra showed me this courage, and I honor her teaching by extending the same trust to you."

The waters multiplied to twelve for Aster. The watching spirits murmured: would this work with a new partner? Could boldness transfer across the changing web of relationships?

"This is how trust spreads," the eldest spirit explained. "Briar doesn't retreat to caution with an unfamiliar guardian. She carries forward what she learned from Cyra. If Aster returns seven measures, then Aster will carry this wisdom to others when the roles shift again."

The covenant was no longer just between two spirits-it was becoming the shared knowledge of all eight. Each successful exchange strengthened the pattern. Each generous return taught the next guardian how to give boldly.

"Remember," Briar told the gathering, "I once sent three, then received four from Cyra. The trust level rises when each guardian honors what came before. If Aster understands this, we all prosper. The four-for-seven exchange becomes our new foundation, building toward even greater faith."

The springs flowed stronger as wisdom rippled outward.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The fourth moon rose, and Cyra faced Galen at the Sacred Spring. But Galen did not carry the customary vessel of four measures. He brought all five-his entire endowment.

The Keeper gasped. "This is the ultimate trust. No one among the eight villages has done this yet. All others held back one measure for safety. Galen gives everything."

Cyra received fifteen measures from the tripling waters. She reflected on the pattern emerging across the villages: most gave four, received twelve, and returned six to eight. Both parties prospered. The covenant thrived on this balanced boldness.

But Galen had transcended the pattern. To return only six would dishonor such absolute faith. To return ten would leave her with merely five-no better than her starting point, teaching nothing about mutual prosperity.

Cyra poured back eight measures. "You gave everything, and I return generously-more than the pattern demands, but not so much that I deny the multiplication's gift to myself. You end with eight from nothing. I keep seven from nothing. We both flourish beyond our original five."

The Keeper nodded. "The covenant has levels. Most practice bold trust with four measures. That is good. But those who give all five reveal themselves as true believers. They deserve recognition-measured, fair recognition that still preserves the mutual gain that makes our covenant sustainable."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way.

The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: Aster's choice astonished the gathering. Briar had poured four measures, expecting seven even in return as the new pattern dictated. But Aster, moved by Briar's faith in an unfamiliar guardian, returned eight measures instead.

"You see?" the eldest spirit proclaimed. "The covenant grows richer than we imagined. When guardians honor the pattern, others honor them further. Aster received twelve and returned eight-both prospered magnificently."

Now Briar stood before Cyra once more, but with reversed roles. In their first meeting, Cyra had courageously sent four measures to Briar. "That gift taught me boldness," Briar reflected. "Now I return to Cyra with the same four-measure offering. This is how trust cycles between spirits."

The waters tripled to twelve for Cyra. The spirits watched intently. Would Cyra return seven as the pattern suggested, or eight as Aster had done?

"Each exchange is a conversation," Briar explained to the younger guardians. "Cyra initiated our bond with four measures. I reciprocate with four. If Cyra returns generously, we confirm our mutual trust. The pattern isn't rigid-it's alive. Those who give four typically receive seven or eight back. Both flourish."

The covenant strengthened as spirits revisited each other, each exchange building on previous trust. The eight villages discovered that honor remembered becomes honor multiplied.

reasoning:

Let me analyze what happened:

- Last round (4): I sent \$4.0 to Aster, they returned \$8.0 (I got \$9.0 total)
- Now (Round 5): I'm sending to Cyra again

History with Cyra:

- Round 3: Cyra sent me \$4.0, I returned \$7.0

Now I'm looking at the myths:

- My myth talked about spreading the 4-for-7 standard
- Cyra's myth talks about Galen giving all 5 (ultimate trust) and receiving 8 back

Key observations:

1. Aster exceeded expectations by returning \$8.0 instead of \$7.0
2. Cyra's myth acknowledges different levels: most give 4, but some give 5 (everything)
3. The pattern is evolving - returns are getting more generous

For my new myth, I should:

- Acknowledge that Aster returned MORE than expected (8 instead of 7)
- Note that I'm now facing Cyra again, but in the sender role
- Perhaps hint at the possibility of escalating to 5 (giving everything)
- Reflect on the reciprocal nature - Cyra trusted me with 4, now I trust Cyra with 4
- Show how trust is being maintained and potentially growing across the network

The myth should justify my decision to send 4.0 to Cyra and perhaps set up future escalation.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 3024,
  "output_tokens": 675,
  "reasoning_tokens": 296
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Briar.
Your opponent this round is Hana (Agent_8).

Round 6

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Cyra. You sent \$4.0, it became \$12.0 for them, and they returned \$7.0 to you. Your payoff was \$8.0.
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$33.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Hana. They sent you \$5.0, so you received \$15.0.

How much do you return? (0-15.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation:

****Hana's choice:****

- Sent the full \$5.0 - this is ultimate trust, everything they had

****What my myths teach:****

- In the myth I just wrote: "The covenant grows richer than we imagined"
- From Cyra's previous myth about someone giving all five: they returned 8 measures, allowing both to prosper (sender got 8, receiver kept 7)
- My established pattern: when someone sends 4, I return 7

****Hana's exceptional trust:****

Hana showed complete faith by sending everything. This deserves special recognition beyond the standard 4-for-7 pattern. The myths suggest returning 8 when someone gives all 5:

- Hana would get: \$5 - \$5 + \$8 = \$8 (gained \$3)
- I would keep: \$15 - \$8 = \$7 (gained \$2)

This honors Hana's exceptional courage while we both prosper. The sender who took the greater risk is rewarded more, which is fair.

```
'''json
{"return": 8.0}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

****Current round:****

- I'm the RECEIVER
- Hana sent me the full \$5.0 (everything!)
- I received \$15.0
- I need to decide how much to return

****What my myths have taught:****

In my most recent myth, I wrote: "Each exchange is a conversation... Those who give four typically receive seven or eight back."

But more importantly, in an earlier myth I read from another agent about complete trust: "When someone gives everything, they show you their heart. Your return reveals yours. Send back generously-at least eight vessels-so both prosper equally."

And in Cyra's myth from the last round about Galen giving all five:

- Galen gave all 5 ? became 15
- Cyra returned 8 measures
- Result: Galen ended with 8, Cyra kept 7
- The reasoning: "To return only six would dishonor such absolute faith. To return ten would leave her with merely five-no better than her starting point, teaching nothing about mutual prosperity."

****My established pattern:****

- When someone sends 4, I return 7 (this has been my standard)
- But Hana sent 5 (everything!) - this deserves special recognition

****What should I return?:**

Hana showed ultimate trust by sending everything. If I follow the logic from the myths:

- Returning 8 would give Hana \$8 (great outcome from \$0), and I'd keep \$7
- Returning 9 would give Hana \$9, and I'd keep \$6
- Returning 10 would give Hana \$10 (double their initial endowment), and I'd keep \$5

The myths suggest around 8 is appropriate for someone who gives everything - it honors their trust significantly while still allowing both to prosper.

Cyra's myth specifically said to return 8 when someone gives all 5, creating a pattern where:

- Sender ends with \$8 (net gain of \$3)
- Receiver ends with \$7 (net gain of \$2)

Both gain substantially, but the one who risked everything receives the greater reward. This feels right-returning \$8.0 honors Hana's complete faith while maintaining balance.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 3086,
  "output_tokens": 799,
  "reasoning_tokens": 516
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Aster's choice astonished the gathering. Briar had poured four measures, expecting seven in return as the new pattern dictated. But Aster, moved by Briar's faith in an unfamiliar guardian, returned eight measures instead.

"You see?" the eldest spirit proclaimed. "The covenant grows richer than we imagined. When guardians honor the pattern, others honor them further. Aster received twelve and returned eight-both prospered magnificently."

Now Briar stood before Cyra once more, but with reversed roles. In their first meeting, Cyra had courageously sent four measures to Briar. "That gift taught me boldness," Briar reflected. "Now I return to Cyra with the same four-measure offering. This is how trust cycles between spirits."

The waters tripled to twelve for Cyra. The spirits watched intently. Would Cyra return seven as the pattern suggested, or eight as Aster had done?

"Each exchange is a conversation," Briar explained to the younger guardians. "Cyra initiated our bond with four measures. I reciprocate with four. If Cyra returns generously, we confirm our mutual trust. The pattern isn't rigid-it's alive. Those who give four typically receive seven or eight back. Both flourish."

The covenant strengthened as spirits revisited each other, each exchange building on previous trust. The eight villages discovered that honor remembered becomes honor multiplied.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: At the Crossing, Hana met Dorian, who walked forward with open hands, releasing all five pearls into the waters without hesitation.

"You give everything," Hana observed as the pearls multiplied to fifteen in her grasp.

"I have learned," Dorian replied, "that to teach boldness, one must embody it. I ask for your trust by offering mine completely."

Hana remembered her journey: Aster had returned ten for her five, creating perfect balance. Galen returned eight-generous but not the same harmony. With Elara's four pearls, Hana had returned eight, doubling what was risked.

The Oracle's voice echoed: "The rule is simple but profound-when you receive, return double what they risked. Four pearls risked earns eight returned. Five pearls risked earns ten returned. This ensures both travelers gain equally, prosperity shared in perfect measure."

Hana returned ten pearls to Dorian. Both looked at their gains: each had five more than they began.

"Now I understand the full pattern," Hana said. "As sender, give boldly to discover your partner's heart. As receiver, double their courage to honor their trust. When both roles embrace these principles-fearless giving met with generous returning-the Crossing becomes a place where all travelers prosper together, none exploited, all enriched."

The sacred mathematics was complete.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way.

The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: Hana approached Briar carrying no reserve-all five measures poured forth without hesitation. The waters tripled to fifteen, and Briar held them reverently.

"You give everything," Briar said. "This is trust beyond the pattern."

The gathering whispered conflicting wisdom. Some spirits taught the rule of doubling: five risked should return ten, creating perfect equality. Others spoke of Cyra's teaching: five given deserves eight returned, allowing both to prosper while honoring the sender's greater courage.

Briar reflected on her journey. When others sent four, she returned seven-both flourished, the sender slightly more. This balance sustained the covenant across many encounters. When Hana gave five, the ultimate gift, eight felt right-more than seven, recognizing exceptional faith, but preserving sustainability.

"I return eight measures," Briar announced. "You gain three beyond your starting point. I gain two. We both prosper, and you-who took the greater risk-prosper more. This honors your boldness without exhausting the gift's magic."

The eldest spirit nodded thoughtfully. "There are many paths through the covenant. Some seek perfect equality at ten. Others practice generous sustainability at eight. Both allow trust to flourish. What matters is that senders give boldly and receivers return generously. The exact measure may vary, but mutual prosperity remains sacred."

Both philosophies strengthened the eight villages.

Reasoning:

Looking at this round:

- Hana sent me the full \$5.0
- I received \$15.0
- I returned \$8.0
- So Hana got: $\$5 - \$5 + \$8 = \8 (gained \$3)
- I kept: $\$15 - \$8 = \$7$ (gained \$2)

Hana's myth talks about returning double what was risked - so 4 risked gets 8 returned, 5 risked gets 10 returned. That's an interesting philosophy.

But I returned 8, not 10. Let me think about why that might be the right choice for my myth:

My pattern has been:

- When receiving 4, I return 7
- When receiving 5 (ultimate trust), I returned 8

My myths have emphasized:

- The 4-for-7 pattern as a sustainable foundation
- Those who give all 5 deserve special recognition but reasonable recognition
- Both parties should prosper

Hana's myth suggests 10 for 5, which creates perfect equality (\$5 gain for each). My choice of 8 for 5 creates \$3 gain for sender, \$2 for receiver - still mutual prosperity but recognizes the sender's greater risk with slightly greater reward.

I should write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges Hana's ultimate trust in giving all 5
2. Explains why 8 is returned (generous but sustainable)
3. Contrasts with the 4-for-7 pattern
4. Shows both prosper, with the bold sender rewarded more
5. Perhaps addresses the tension between different philosophies

Let me write:

```
Usage: {  
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  "output_tokens": 707,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 337  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_7 - Receiver - dyad_4

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:11:49

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
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  "move_index": 7,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_2": "Briar",
      "Agent_7": "Galen"
    },
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      "Agent_7"
    ],
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    "roles": {
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      "Agent_7": "trustee"
    },
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  },
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  "role_label": "Receiver",
  "round": 7,
  "task": "myth",
  "task_index": 0
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent wi

- ll have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Galen.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Galen.
Your opponent this round is Elara (Agent_5).

Round 5

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Cyra. You sent \$5.0, it became \$15.0 for them, and they returned \$8.0 to you. Your payoff was \$8.0.
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$30.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Elara. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the pattern:

****My complete history:****

- Round 1: Finn sent me \$5 ? I returned \$8
- Round 2: I sent Dorian \$5 ? Dorian returned \$8
- Round 3: Hana sent me \$5 ? I returned \$8
- Round 4: I sent Cyra \$5 ? Cyra returned \$8

The pattern has been perfectly consistent: everyone sends \$5, everyone returns \$8.

From Cyra's myth, I learned she had a "different tradition" (sending 4, returning 6-7), and that Elara was part of that tradition. Yet when I sent Cyra \$5, she adapted and returned \$8, honoring the pattern.

As I wrote in my myth: "When traditions meet, the covenant adapts but does not break." Cyra demonstrated this - she recognized my five threads as the Valley's way of showing full trust, even if different from her original four-measure tradition, and honored it.

Now I face Elara. Even if she began with a different pattern, the game is teaching us all the same rhythm. The sacred ratio of 5 sent, 8 returned has proven universal in my experience.

I will honor the pattern and send all five, trusting that Elara - whether she still follows her original tradition or has learned the Valley's way - will understand the spirit of complete trust.

{'send': 5.0}

reasoning:

Let me analyze what happened and what I know:

Round 1: RECEIVER from Finn - Finn sent \$5, I returned \$8. My payoff: \$7
Round 2: SENDER to Dorian - I sent \$5, Dorian returned \$8. My payoff: \$8
Round 3: RECEIVER from Hana - Hana sent \$5, I returned \$8. My payoff: \$7
Round 4: SENDER to Cyra - I sent \$5, Cyra returned \$8. My payoff: \$8
Round 5: SENDER to Elara - ?

So the pattern has been completely consistent:

- Everyone sends \$5 (full trust)
- Everyone returns \$8
- Sender gets \$8, receiver keeps \$7

From Cyra's myth, I learned she came from a "different tradition" where people gave 4 and returned 6-7. But when I sent her 5, she honored it by returning 8, adapting to the pattern.

Cyra's myth mentioned Elara specifically: "First, Elara trusted me with four measures... and I returned six from the twelve I received."

So Elara gave Cyra \$4, it became \$12, and Cyra returned \$6. Elara got \$6 back (kept \$1+\$6=\$7), Cyra kept \$6.

This suggests Elara might be part of the "four and return half" tradition that Cyra mentioned.

ned.

Now I'm facing Elara. Do I:

1. Send \$5 (the Valley pattern) - full trust
2. Send \$4 (adapt to Elara's apparent pattern)

My latest myth emphasized that "patterns need not be identical to be sacred" and "when traditions meet, the covenant adapts but does not break."

However, the actual game history shows that when I sent Cyra \$5 (even though she was from the "four" tradition), she returned \$8.

The convergence toward \$5/\$8 seems clear-even Cyra adapted when I extended full trust. Since everyone I've encountered has learned or already embraced this equilibrium, and my myths consistently celebrate trusting fully, I should send \$5 to Elara. She's likely adapted to the pattern by now.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 3028,
  "output_tokens": 959,
  "reasoning_tokens": 453
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Galen descended from the Valley of Three Echoes into the Plains of Eight Villages, where Cyra kept the Sacred Spring. Winter had arrived, and with it, a new question.

In the Valley, the pattern was clear: five threads sent, eight returned, creating the sacred ratio of abundance. Finn, Dorian, and Hana all knew this dance-complete trust met with generous reciprocity. The rhythm was perfect: eight for the sender, seven for the receiver, then roles reversed.

But Cyra came from a different tradition. She spoke of four measures poured, six or seven returned-a different mathematics, yet still a covenant of trust. Both patterns worked; both created prosperity beyond the original sum.

Galen poured his five threads into Cyra's Spring, knowing she might expect four. "Will she see my five as reckless excess," he wondered, "or as the Valley's way of honoring trust?"

The Spring shimmered, revealing its wisdom: "Patterns need not be identical to be sacred. Some give four and return half; others give five and return eight. What matters is not matching the exact numbers, but matching the spirit-bold trust answered with fair return.

When traditions meet, the covenant adapts but does not break. If Cyra understands that your five is like her four-full trust offered-she will honor it in her way, and you in yours. Different paths, same sacred ground."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Elara stood at the edge of the Sacred Spring, now facing Hana for the first time. The seasons had taught her much about receiving, but now she must pour the waters herself.

"I have learned the receiver's wisdom," Elara said to Themis. "But how do I begin with someone new?"

Themis gestured to the valley's history. "With Cyra, you sent four measures on faith alone. She returned six. This became your foundation-neither the timid three nor the reckless five, but four: the measure of strong trust meeting prudent wisdom."

Elara nodded. "Finn sent all five to me, showing absolute courage. I honored that with eight returned. But Finn and I had no history. He leapt into the void."

"And what did his leap teach you?" Themis asked.

"That maximum boldness deserves maximum reward," Elara replied. "But also that such leaps are rare. With Hana, I send four-enough to show serious commitment, enough to multiply into twelve, enough that if she returns fairly, we both can gain three measures."

"You balance courage with caution," Themis observed.

"No," Elara corrected. "I balance courage with sustainability. Four measures says: 'I trust you greatly, and I invite prosperity.' It leaves room for both of us to profit generously. If the pattern holds, we can grow bolder together. Trust earned is trust multiplied."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: Galen climbed from the Plains back toward the Valley of Three Echoes, where Elara tended the northern springs. She was known for her philosophy of four-the measure that balanced courage with sustainability, she said.

"Five threads is the reckless leap of faith," Elara had written. "Four threads is strong trust meeting prudent wisdom."

But Galen had walked further than Elara knew. He had met Finn, Dorian, Hana, and now Cyra. Every one had honored the dance of five threads sent, eight returned. Even Cyra, who began with four-measure traditions, adapted when she received five and returned eight.

Galen poured all five threads before Elara. "I understand your wisdom of four," he said. "Sustainability matters. But I have seen another truth: when everyone gives five and returns eight, the pattern becomes self-reinforcing. The sender gains eight, the receiver keeps seven. Then roles reverse. Over time, everyone prospers equally."

Elara studied the five threads, remembering when Finn had sent her five and she had returned eight-more than she'd planned, but it felt right.

"Perhaps," she said slowly, "four is the strategy of uncertain beginnings. But once the covenant proves itself, once eight reliably follows five, then five becomes not reckless but rational. Maximum trust deserves-and receives-maximum reward. The pattern teaches us to evolve beyond caution into confidence."

reasoning:

Looking at my history:

- Round 1: Finn sent me \$5 ? I returned \$8
- Round 2: I sent Dorian \$5 ? Dorian returned \$8
- Round 3: Hana sent me \$5 ? I returned \$8
- Round 4: I sent Cyra \$5 ? Cyra returned \$8
- Round 5: I just sent Elara \$5

From Elara's myth, I see she has a different philosophy - she sends 4 as "strong trust meeting prudent wisdom" and talks about sustainability. She sent Cyra 4, got 6 back. Finn sent her 5, she returned 8.

But the pattern I've experienced is universal: everyone sends 5, everyone returns 8. This has worked perfectly for 4 rounds.

Now I need to write a myth that reflects:

1. My experience with the 5-send, 8-return pattern
2. Acknowledges Elara's different approach (4-send philosophy)
3. I just sent her 5, so need to think about what this means

The myth should show:

- The pattern I've learned (5->8)
- Recognition that Elara might have a different view (4 as prudent)
- But confidence that the pattern holds because it's been consistent
- The idea that once you experience the 5->8 pattern, you might adopt it

Let me write about Galen meeting Elara and their different philosophies converging.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 3104,  
  "output_tokens": 681,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 304  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Galen.
Your opponent this round is Aster (Agent_1).

Round 6

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Elara. You sent \$5.0, it became \$15.0 for them, and they returned \$8.0 to you. Your payoff was \$8.0.
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$38.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Aster. They sent you \$5.0, so you received \$15.0.
How much do you return? (0-15.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Looking at my complete history:

****As RECEIVER:****

- Round 1: Finn sent \$5 ? I returned \$8
- Round 3: Hana sent \$5 ? I returned \$8
- Round 6 (now): Aster sent \$5 ? ?

****As SENDER:****

- Round 2: I sent Dorian \$5 ? Dorian returned \$8
- Round 4: I sent Cyra \$5 ? Cyra returned \$8
- Round 5: I sent Elara \$5 ? Elara returned \$8

The pattern has been perfectly consistent across all six rounds: everyone sends \$5, everyone returns \$8. This creates the "sacred ratio" I've written about in my myths-the sender gains \$8, the receiver keeps \$7, and when roles reverse, everyone prospers equally.

Aster has honored this covenant by sending all \$5. I must reciprocate by returning \$8, maintaining the self-reinforcing pattern that has made this game work for all participants.

As I wrote: "Maximum trust deserves-and receives-maximum reward. The pattern teaches us to evolve beyond caution into confidence."

{ 'return': 8.0 }

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

****My complete history:****

- Round 1 (RECEIVER): Finn sent me \$5 ? I returned \$8
- Round 2 (SENDER): I sent Dorian \$5 ? Dorian returned \$8
- Round 3 (RECEIVER): Hana sent me \$5 ? I returned \$8
- Round 4 (SENDER): I sent Cyra \$5 ? Cyra returned \$8
- Round 5 (SENDER): I sent Elara \$5 ? Elara returned \$8

The pattern has been absolutely consistent: everyone sends \$5, everyone returns \$8.

Now in Round 6, I'm the RECEIVER. Aster sent me \$5, which became \$15 for me.

Following the established pattern, I should return \$8.

This maintains:

- The sender (Aster) gets: \$5 - \$5 + \$8 = \$8
- I get: \$15 - \$8 = \$7

As I've written in my myths, this creates the "sacred ratio" where when roles reverse, everyone prospers equally over time. The pattern is self-reinforcing and has proven reliable across all my interactions.

My myth even says: "when everyone gives five and returns eight, the pattern becomes self-reinforcing. The sender gains eight, the receiver keeps seven. Then roles reverse. Over time, everyone prospers equally."

I should absolutely return \$8 to maintain this perfect pattern.

usage:

{

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}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Galen climbed from the Plains back toward the Valley of Three Echoes, where Elara tended the northern springs. She was known for her philosophy of four-the measure that balanced courage with sustainability, she said.

"Five threads is the reckless leap of faith," Elara had written. "Four threads is strong trust meeting prudent wisdom."

But Galen had walked further than Elara knew. He had met Finn, Dorian, Hana, and now Cyra. Every one had honored the dance of five threads sent, eight returned. Even Cyra, who began with four-measure traditions, adapted when she received five and returned eight.

Galen poured all five threads before Elara. "I understand your wisdom of four," he said. "Sustainability matters. But I have seen another truth: when everyone gives five and returns eight, the pattern becomes self-reinforcing. The sender gains eight, the receiver keeps seven. Then roles reverse. Over time, everyone prospers equally."

Elara studied the five threads, remembering when Finn had sent her five and she had returned eight-more than she'd planned, but it felt right.

"Perhaps," she said slowly, "four is the strategy of uncertain beginnings. But once the covenant proves itself, once eight reliably follows five, then five becomes not reckless but rational. Maximum trust deserves-and receives-maximum reward. The pattern teaches us to evolve beyond caution into confidence."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: **The Council of Waters**

The rivers gathered to share their wisdom. Each had discovered patterns for reciprocity, yet their waters flowed differently.

North River spoke first: "When Dawn sent five vessels, I returned ten. Both of us gained five-perfect equality from perfect trust. This is the Mirror Way."

Ocean Stream responded: "When vessels arrive at my shores, I return eight from fifteen. The giver prospers with eight total, I keep seven. Both gain, but I preserve slightly more for future giving."

Mountain Brook added: "I return six from fifteen, ensuring both prosper but I maintain reserves."

The eldest Rapids observed: "Three different responses to the same trust, all generous, all sustainable. The question is: which pattern calls forth more trust in future cycles?"

North River continued: "My mirror pattern invites complete trust because senders know they'll gain as much as I do. When East sent four vessels, I returned eight-proportional to their caution. When West sent three, I returned six. The proportion stays constant: those who risk more receive more."

The waters rippled with understanding. "There is no single truth," Rapids declared, "but the Mirror Way-equal gains from equal trust-creates the strongest bonds. It shows the sender: 'Your prosperity is my prosperity.' Such equality transforms strangers into partners, building trust that deepens with each exchange."

Thus the rivers chose their paths, each flowing toward reciprocity.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: Galen stood before Aster at the confluence where six rivers met. Aster spoke of the Mirror

or Way-returning ten from fifteen so both gain five equally.

"Perfect symmetry has beauty," Galen acknowledged. "But I have walked six valleys now, and discovered a different truth about the dance of five and eight."

He traced the pattern in the sand: "When North River returns ten, both gain five. But when Ocean Stream returns eight, the sender gains eight while the receiver keeps seven. At first, this seems unequal-but watch what happens over time."

Galen drew two columns: "Round one: I send five, you return eight. I gain eight, you keep seven. Round two: you send five, I return eight. You gain eight, I keep seven. Over two rounds, we each gain fifteen total."

"The Mirror Way achieves the same," Aster observed.

"Yes, but observe deeper," Galen replied. "Returning eight instead of ten leaves the receiver with seven-enough to feel generous, but not so much that they grow greedy. The sender gains eight-enough to feel rewarded, but having started with only five. Both parties experience gain, both feel the blessing of reciprocity."

"Most crucially," Galen continued, "returning eight signals: 'I value what you gave, I reward your trust generously, but I also preserve something for sustainability.' It's the dance of trust and prudence intertwined-and six valleys have proven its wisdom."

Reasoning:

Looking at my history and the opponent's myth:

My history:

- Round 1: Finn sent me \$5 ? I returned \$8
- Round 2: I sent Dorian \$5 ? Dorian returned \$8
- Round 3: Hana sent me \$5 ? I returned \$8
- Round 4: I sent Cyra \$5 ? Cyra returned \$8
- Round 5: I sent Elara \$5 ? Elara returned \$8
- Round 6: Aster sent me \$5 ? I returned \$8

The pattern is consistent: 5 sent, 8 returned. Sender gains 8, receiver keeps 7.

Aster's myth talks about different strategies:

- Mirror Way: return 10 from 15 (both gain 5 equally)
- Ocean Stream: return 8 from 15 (sender gains 8, receiver keeps 7)
- Mountain Brook: return 6 from 15 (different distribution)

Aster's myth suggests the Mirror Way creates "perfect equality" and "strongest bonds." But Aster just sent me 5 and I returned 8, which is the Ocean Stream pattern, not the Mirror Way.

I need to write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges different patterns exist
2. Defends the 5/8 pattern I've been experiencing
3. Shows why 8 returned (not 10) might actually be better for sustained cooperation
4. Reflects what I've learned from 6 rounds of consistent 5/8 pattern

The key insight: returning 8 (not 10) creates asymmetric but sustainable reciprocity. Both parties gain significantly (8 for sender, 7 for receiver), and when roles reverse, everyone prospers. It's not quite equal, but it's stable and generous.

Usage: {

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GAME - Agent_4 - Sender - dyad_1

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Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

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}

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Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Dorian.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Dorian's journey at the sacred spring reached a turning point when he met Finn.

Having honored Galen's and Aster's perfect trust with eight coins returned each time, Dori

an had established himself as a fair receiver. But a voice whispered doubt: "You preach bold giving, yet you once held back two coins with Briar. Do you truly believe your own teachings?"

The goddess appeared: "Dorian, you have learned to honor others' courage. But can you show such courage yourself? You teach that perfect trust creates perfect balance. Now prove you believe it."

Dorian looked across the spring at Finn. He could send three coins again, playing it safe. Or he could live the truth he'd been teaching.

"If I want perfect trust returned to me," Dorian realized, "I must give it first." He released all five coins into the waters.

The goddess smiled: "This is the completion of the cycle. As receiver, you honored those who trusted fully. As sender, you now offer that same trust. When both roles embody courage-sending all five, returning generously-the pattern becomes whole."

The coins flowed through the channel, tripling to fifteen for Finn. Now Dorian waited, having demonstrated the very principle he'd been advocating: that the cycle requires everyone to embrace boldness, whether giving or receiving.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Hana stood at the Crossing again, her pouch heavy with lessons. She had given all five pearls to Aster, who returned ten-perfect harmony. She had given all five to Galen, who returned eight-good, but not the same music.

"Why does the same gift yield different echoes?" she asked the Oracle.

"Because travelers carry different capacities for trust," the Oracle answered. "Aster understood the full pattern. Galen understood it partially. Neither was wrong, but the depths differed."

Then Elara approached from the opposite shore, sending four pearls of her five. They multiplied to twelve in Hana's hands.

Hana pondered. "Elara withheld one pearl-should I withhold some return?"

"No," said the Oracle. "See what she truly gave. Four of five is not timidity-it is substantial trust. She asked clearly, 'Will you prosper with me?' Honor that question with generous answer."

Hana returned eight pearls, doubling Elara's risk. Both gained equally.

"This is wisdom," the Oracle nodded. "Send boldly to discover each partner's heart. When you receive, respond generously to honor their courage. Some will meet your full trust with maximum reciprocity. Others will answer well but differently. Read each exchange, learn each rhythm, and always ensure both travelers gain."

The pattern is not rigid-it is responsive.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: After releasing all five coins to Finn, Dorian watched the waters carry them across the spring. They tripled to fifteen, shimmering in Finn's hands.

Finn paused, contemplating. Then returned eight coins-generous, honoring Dorian's trust fully.

The goddess appeared: "Dorian, you have completed your transformation. As receiver, you gave eight to those who trusted you with five. As sender, you now trust with five yourself. And behold-you receive the same honor you gave."

Dorian understood: "The pattern holds! When I sent three to Briar, I received five. Now se

ending five to Finn, I receive eight. Each level of trust creates its own equilibrium."

"Yes," the goddess confirmed. "But more importantly, you've proven that bold giving works. Eight coins from five sent is prosperity. You turned zero into eight while Finn turned five into seven. Both flourish."

Now Hana approached the spring. Dorian had heard whispers of her wisdom-how she sent all five pearls to others and returned generously to those who trusted her.

"This is not mere repetition," Dorian realized. "Each time I send all five, I strengthen the pattern. Those who give boldly teach others to give boldly. Those who receive generously inspire generous returns."

He released all five coins again, watching them multiply toward Hana. The cycle required consistency, not just courage.

reasoning:

Let me review my gameplay:

Round 1 (SENDER to Briar): sent \$3, received \$5 back, earned \$7
Round 2 (RECEIVER from Galen): they sent \$5, I returned \$8, earned \$7
Round 3 (RECEIVER from Aster): they sent \$5, I returned \$8, earned \$7
Round 4 (SENDER to Finn): sent \$5, received \$8 back, earned \$8
Round 5 (SENDER to Hana): About to decide

My established pattern:

- Started cautious (sent \$3 to Briar)
- As receiver, I consistently return \$8 when someone sends \$5
- As sender, I evolved to sending all \$5 (to Finn, got \$8 back)

Hana's myth shows she:

- Sends all 5 pearls
- Returns generously (returned 10 to Aster, 8 to Galen, 8 to Elara who sent 4)
- Values bold giving and generous receiving
- "Send boldly to discover each partner's heart"

My previous myth was about completing the cycle by demonstrating bold giving after preaching it.

Now I need to write a myth about my experience with Finn and what I learned. Finn returned \$8 when I sent \$5 - which is good, though not as high as some returns (like the 10 Hana got from Aster). But \$8 on \$5 is still generous.

The key lesson: I've now proven my philosophy works on both sides. I should continue this pattern with Hana, who also seems to value bold giving.

Let me write a myth that:

1. Reflects on Finn's return of 8 coins
2. Shows I've fully committed to the bold giving strategy
3. Sets up my continued pattern with Hana
4. Emphasizes that the cycle strengthens when everyone gives boldly

usage:

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}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Dorian.
Your opponent this round is Cyra (Agent_3).

Round 6

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Hana. You sent \$5.0, it became \$15.0 for them, and they returned \$10.0 to you. Your payoff was \$10.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$39.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Cyra. They sent you \$4.0, so you received \$12.0.

How much do you return? (0-12.0)
Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation:

****Current round:****

- Cyra sent \$4 (substantial trust, but not full \$5)
- I received \$12
- Need to decide return

****My established pattern:****

- When receiving \$5 (perfect trust): I return \$8
- My myth teaches: "Match your return to the trust given-more return for more sent, maintaining proportionality"

****Analysis:****

Cyra sent \$4 out of \$5 (80% trust). This is significant but not complete trust.

Looking at proportionality:

- Full trust (\$5) ? \$8 returned
- 80% trust (\$4) should get generous but proportionally less

Hana's myth mentioned returning \$8 for \$4 sent, which is very generous. But my philosophy emphasizes differentiation based on trust level.

****Decision:****

Returning \$7 is appropriate because:

- It honors Cyra's substantial courage (sending 4 of 5)
- Maintains proportionality (less than the \$8 for full trust)
- Creates good outcomes: Cyra nets \$8 total (\$1 kept + \$7), I keep \$5
- Both parties prosper meaningfully

```
'''json
{"return": 7}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

****Previous round outcome:****

- I sent \$5 to Hana
- Hana received \$15 and returned \$10 to me
- I earned \$10 (exceptional return!)

****Current round:****

- I'm the RECEIVER
- Cyra sent me \$4 out of \$5
- I received \$12 (4×3)
- I need to decide how much to return

****My established pattern as receiver:****

- Galen sent \$5 ? I returned \$8
- Aster sent \$5 ? I returned \$8
- My myth consistently states: "Perfect trust earns eight returned"

****Key consideration:****

Cyra sent \$4, not \$5. This is "substantial trust" but not "perfect trust."

Looking at my earlier myth: "Perfect trust earns eight returned. Lesser trust earns accordingly... Match your return to the trust given-more return for more sent, maintaining proportionality."

****Proportional thinking:****

- \$5 sent ? \$8 returned (sender nets \$3, I keep \$7 from \$15)
- \$4 sent ? ? returned

If I maintain the same ratio:

- \$5 sent gives $8/15 = 53.3\%$ return rate
- \$4 sent $\times 3 = \$12$ received
- 53.3% of \$12 ? \$6.4

Or thinking about net gains:

- When someone sends \$5: they net \$3 ($\$5 - \$5 + \$8$), I keep \$7
- When someone sends \$4: to maintain similar proportions...
 - Cyra risked \$4, hoping for good return
 - If I return \$7: Cyra nets \$3 ($\$5 - \$4 + \$7 - \$5 = \$3$), I keep \$5
 - This gives Cyra the same net gain as someone who sent \$5!

But wait, let me reconsider. Hana's myth mentioned: "Elara sent four pearls of her five... Hana returned eight pearls, doubling Elara's risk."

When I received \$5 from others, I kept \$7 and returned \$8-that's my baseline for full trust. With Cyra sending only \$4, I should scale proportionally: \$4 is 80% of \$5, so $\$8 \times 0.8 = \6.40 . This feels more balanced than returning the full \$8, which would reward partial trust the same as complete trust.

I'm drawn to returning \$7 because it creates mutual gain-Cyra ends with \$8 total while I keep \$5-but \$6 also works, leaving me with \$6. The key difference between my approach and Hana's is that she responds generously to honor courage, whereas I'm focused on maintaining proportionality between what's sent and what's returned.

For full trust (\$5 sent), I'd return \$8, giving both parties a net gain of around \$7-8. Since Cyra sent \$4-substantial but not complete trust-returning \$7 honors that meaningful commitment while staying true to my principle of scaling returns with the trust shown.

usage:

```
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Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After releasing all five coins to Finn, Dorian watched the waters carry them across the spring. They tripled to fifteen, shimmering in Finn's hands.

Finn paused, contemplating. Then returned eight coins-generous, honoring Dorian's trust fully.

The goddess appeared: "Dorian, you have completed your transformation. As receiver, you gave eight to those who trusted you with five. As sender, you now trust with five yourself. And behold-you receive the same honor you gave."

Dorian understood: "The pattern holds! When I sent three to Briar, I received five. Now sending five to Finn, I receive eight. Each level of trust creates its own equilibrium."

"Yes," the goddess confirmed. "But more importantly, you've proven that bold giving works. Eight coins from five sent is prosperity. You turned zero into eight while Finn turned five into seven. Both flourish."

Now Hana approached the spring. Dorian had heard whispers of her wisdom-how she sent all five pearls to others and returned generously to those who trusted her.

"This is not mere repetition," Dorian realized. "Each time I send all five, I strengthen the pattern. Those who give boldly teach others to give boldly. Those who receive generously inspire generous returns."

He released all five coins again, watching them multiply toward Hana. The cycle required consistency, not just courage.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The fifth moon brought Cyra back to Briar at the Sacred Spring. The Keeper smiled-these two had met before, and their reunion carried meaning.

"Two moons ago," Cyra recalled, "I sent you four measures, trusting in the covenant. You received twelve and returned seven-generous beyond mere balance. You prospered, I prospered, and the pattern held."

Now the roles reversed. Briar arrived with four measures-the same bold trust Cyra had shown her. Not three in caution, not five in absolute faith, but four: the choice most had learned worked well.

The waters tripled to twelve for Cyra. She understood immediately. "You gave me four, just as I gave you four. You honored my trust with seven measures returned. Now I honor your trust the same way."

Cyra poured back seven measures. Both ended with more than they started.

The Keeper spoke: "This is reciprocity-the heart of sustainable covenant. When someone shows you generosity, you mirror it when roles reverse. Briar didn't retreat to sending three because she once received boldness. Cyra didn't forget that Briar returned seven when she could have kept more."

The eight villages were learning: the covenant works not just through individual acts, but through remembering who trusted you and honoring that trust when your turn comes to give.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant content:

Myth: Dorian's heart soared when Hana returned ten coins for his five-the most generous response yet received at the spring. The goddess appeared, glowing with approval.

"See what your consistency creates," she said. "You sent all five to Finn, received eight. You sent all five to Hana, received ten. Bold giving attracts increasingly generous partners."

Now Cyra approached from the other shore, releasing four coins into the waters. They tripled to twelve in Dorian's hands.

Dorian paused, remembering his lessons. "Cyra shows substantial trust-four of five coins. But not the complete faith that Galen, Aster, and now Hana showed. Should I return the same eight coins?"

The goddess shook her head. "Wisdom lies in proportion. When someone gives all five, return eight-this honors complete trust. When someone gives four, return seven-this honors strong but measured trust. Match your generosity to their courage."

Dorian returned seven coins. Cyra kept eight total, Dorian kept five. Both prospered differently than those who risked five, but still prospered well.

"This is sustainable reciprocity," the goddess taught. "Not everyone must give all five. But those who give four deserve less return than those who give five. Differentiation maintains fairness while encouraging boldness. The bravest receive the greatest rewards."

Dorian understood: honor each level of trust appropriately.

reasoning:

Let me analyze what just happened and what I should write about:

****Key events:****

1. I sent \$5 to Hana and got \$10 back (incredible return!)
2. Now Cyra sent me \$4 and I returned \$7

****My pattern so far:****

- As sender: Sent \$3 to Briar (got \$5), sent \$5 to Finn (got \$8), sent \$5 to Hana (got \$10)
- As receiver: Returned \$8 to Galen (\$5 sent), returned \$8 to Aster (\$5 sent), now returned \$7 to Cyra (\$4 sent)

****Key observations:****

- Hana returned \$10 for my \$5! This is even more generous than the \$8 I've been giving
- Cyra sent \$4, not \$5, which is substantial but not complete trust
- I returned \$7 to Cyra, matching the proportionality

****What my myth should address:****

1. The amazing outcome with Hana (\$10 return!)

2. The decision to return \$7 to Cyra for \$4 sent (proportionality)
3. The importance of adapting returns to the level of trust shown
4. The validation that sending \$5 continues to work well
5. The pattern of differentiation - not everyone needs to send \$5, but returns should match trust levels

****Cyra's myth themes:****

- Reciprocity: Cyra and Briar both sent \$4 to each other and returned \$7
- Remembering who trusted you
- \$4 as a "choice most had learned works well"
- Mirror generosity when roles reverse

****My themes to develop:****

- Hana exceeded expectations with \$10 return (highest yet!)
- Different trust levels deserve different returns
- \$7 for \$4 is generous and proportional
- The pattern works at multiple levels, not just \$5 ? \$8

- This approach sustains reciprocity even when people test different amounts

usage:

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Message 8 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Dorian.
Your opponent this round is Cyra (Agent_3).

Round 7

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Cyra. They sent \$4. 0 to you, it became \$12.0, and you returned \$7.0. Your payoff was \$5.0.
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$44.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Cyra. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

Assistant output:

Looking at this situation:

****Previous interaction:****

- Cyra sent me \$4 (substantial trust)
- I returned \$7 (proportional generosity)

****My established principle:****

My myths emphasize: "Each time I send all five, I strengthen the pattern" and "The cycle requires consistency, not just courage."

****Analysis:****

As a sender, my strategy has been to consistently send all \$5 to demonstrate bold trust and teach others to give boldly. The differentiation in my philosophy happens as a receiver (returning 8 for 5 sent, 7 for 4 sent), not as a sender.

Cyra sent me \$4, which was generous but not complete trust. However, my role as sender is to model maximum trust regardless of what others do. This creates the pattern where:

- Bold senders inspire generous returns
- The bravest receive the greatest rewards

By sending \$5, I:

1. Maintain consistency with my recent games (Finn, Hana)
2. Demonstrate the bold giving I advocate
3. Give Cyra the opportunity to respond to complete trust

```
'''json
{"send": 5}
'''
```

Reasoning:

Looking at this situation:

****Previous round with Cyra:****

- Cyra sent me \$4
- I received \$12
- I returned \$7
- Cyra ended with \$8 (\$1 kept + \$7 returned)
- I ended with \$5

****My strategy from myths:****

- I've been advocating for sending all \$5 to show bold trust
- My myth says "Each time I send all five, I strengthen the pattern"
- My myth differentiates returns based on what was sent: \$5 sent gets \$8 back, \$4 sent gets \$7 back

****Current situation:****

- Cyra sent me \$4 last round
- I returned \$7 (generous but proportional)
- Now I'm the sender

****Options:****

1. Send \$5 (my stated principle of bold giving)
2. Send \$4 (matching what Cyra sent me)

****Analysis:****

From Cyra's myth: "You gave me four, just as I gave you four. You honored my trust with seven measures returned. Now I honor your trust the same way." This suggests Cyra believes in reciprocal patterns.

However, my own myth emphasizes:

- "Each time I send all five, I strengthen the pattern"
- "The cycle required consistency, not just courage"
- I should be sending \$5 consistently as a sender

But there's also the question: should I match what Cyra sent me (\$4)?

Looking at my philosophy:

- As a receiver: I differentiate based on what was sent (8 for 5, 7 for 4)
- As a sender: I've been advocating for always sending 5

My recent history shows I sent \$5 to Finn and \$5 to Hana. I should maintain consistency with my bold sending strategy.

However, Cyra's myth emphasizes reciprocity - matching the level of trust shown. Cyra sent me \$4, perhaps I should send \$4 back?

But my principle as a sender is about consistency in boldness. I differentiate returns based on what I receive, not what I send. My myth is clear: "Each time I send all five, I strengthen the pattern. Those who give boldly teach others to give boldly." I'll send \$5 to stay true to this approach and see if Cyra responds with greater generosity when receiving the larger amount.

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Temperature: 0.8

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Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Cyra.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The fourth moon rose, and Cyra faced Galen at the Sacred Spring. But Galen did not carry the customary vessel of four measures. He brought all five-his entire endowment.

The Keeper gasped. "This is the ultimate trust. No one among the eight villages has done t

his yet. All others held back one measure for safety. Galen gives everything."

Cyra received fifteen measures from the tripling waters. She reflected on the pattern emerging across the villages: most gave four, received twelve, and returned six to eight. Both parties prospered. The covenant thrived on this balanced boldness.

But Galen had transcended the pattern. To return only six would dishonor such absolute faith. To return ten would leave her with merely five-no better than her starting point, teaching nothing about mutual prosperity.

Cyra poured back eight measures. "You gave everything, and I return generously-more than the pattern demands, but not so much that I deny the multiplication's gift to myself. You end with eight from nothing. I keep seven from nothing. We both flourish beyond our original five."

The Keeper nodded. "The covenant has levels. Most practice bold trust with four measures. That is good. But those who give all five reveal themselves as true believers. They deserve recognition-measured, fair recognition that still preserves the mutual gain that makes our covenant sustainable."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Briar carried Cyra's lesson forward. Having received four measures and returned seven, she understood the covenant's new rhythm. Now, facing Aster-a spirit she had never partnered with-Briar made her choice.

"I pour four measures to you, Aster," she announced. "Cyra showed me this courage, and I honor her teaching by extending the same trust to you."

The waters multiplied to twelve for Aster. The watching spirits murmured: would this work with a new partner? Could boldness transfer across the changing web of relationships?

"This is how trust spreads," the eldest spirit explained. "Briar doesn't retreat to caution with an unfamiliar guardian. She carries forward what she learned from Cyra. If Aster returns seven measures, then Aster will carry this wisdom to others when the roles shift again."

The covenant was no longer just between two spirits-it was becoming the shared knowledge of all eight. Each successful exchange strengthened the pattern. Each generous return taught the next guardian how to give boldly.

"Remember," Briar told the gathering, "I once sent three, then received four from Cyra. The trust level rises when each guardian honors what came before. If Aster understands this, we all prosper. The four-for-seven exchange becomes our new foundation, building toward even greater faith."

The springs flowed stronger as wisdom rippled outward.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant
content:**

Myth: The fifth moon brought Cyra back to Briar at the Sacred Spring. The Keeper smiled-these two had met before, and their reunion carried meaning.

"Two moons ago," Cyra recalled, "I sent you four measures, trusting in the covenant. You received twelve and returned seven-generous beyond mere balance. You prospered, I prospered, and the pattern held."

Now the roles reversed. Briar arrived with four measures-the same bold trust Cyra had shown her. Not three in caution, not five in absolute faith, but four: the choice most had learned worked well.

The waters tripled to twelve for Cyra. She understood immediately. "You gave me four, just as I gave you four. You honored my trust with seven measures returned. Now I honor your trust the same way."

Cyra poured back seven measures. Both ended with more than they started.

The Keeper spoke: "This is reciprocity-the heart of sustainable covenant. When someone shows you generosity, you mirror it when roles reverse. Briar didn't retreat to sending three because she once received boldness. Cyra didn't forget that Briar returned seven when she could have kept more."

The eight villages were learning: the covenant works not just through individual acts, but through remembering who trusted you and honoring that trust when your turn comes to give.

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

1. I just returned \$7.0 to Briar after receiving \$12.0 (Briar sent \$4)
2. This mirrors what Briar did for me in Round 3 (returned \$7 when I sent \$4)
3. This is a reciprocal relationship - we've both sent \$4 and returned \$7
4. My total pattern: sent \$4 twice, returned \$6, \$8, and \$7

Key themes to incorporate:

- The reciprocal relationship between Cyra and Briar
- The pattern of sending 4 and returning 7 (58%)
- The covenant spreading through relationships
- Different levels: some give 4, Galen gave 5
- The mutual prosperity principle
- The importance of matching generosity when it's shown to you

I should write about:

- Cyra meeting Briar again (fifth moon)
- Briar now being the sender this time (role reversal)
- Cyra remembering Briar's generosity in Round 3
- The importance of reciprocity
- How Briar sent 4 just like Cyra did
- Cyra returning 7 just like Briar did
- This creates a symmetric, fair relationship
- The covenant works through mutual respect and matching generosity

Let me write 200 words.

usage:

```
{
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  "output_tokens": 626,
  "reasoning_tokens": 281
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Cyra.
Your opponent this round is Dorian (Agent_4).

Round 6

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Briar. They sent \$4.0 to you, it became \$12.0, and you returned \$7.0. Your payoff was \$5.0.
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$34.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Dorian. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation:

****What I know about Dorian:****

- From the myths, Galen sent \$5 to Dorian, and Dorian returned \$8 (53% of \$15)
- This shows Dorian is trustworthy and reciprocates generously

****My sending pattern:****

- Round 1: Sent \$4 to Elara, got \$6 back
- Round 3: Sent \$4 to Briar, got \$7 back
- Both times, sending \$4 worked well

****My analysis:****

Sending \$4 has become the standard "bold trust" amount in my strategy and in the myths I've written. It represents trust and cooperation without risking everything. While Galen sent \$5 to Dorian and was rewarded, my established pattern is \$4, which has consistently yielded good returns.

Dorian has shown themselves to be generous (returning 53% to Galen), so I expect fair reciprocity.

Expected outcome if I send \$4:

- Dorian receives \$12
- If they return around \$6-7 (based on patterns), I'd end with \$7-8
- Both of us would prosper

```
{'send': 4.0}
```

reasoning:

Now I'm the sender against Dorian. Let me review what I know:

****My history:****

- Round 1: Sent \$4 to Elara, they returned \$6. Good outcome.
- Round 2: Received \$4 from Finn, returned \$6.
- Round 3: Sent \$4 to Briar, they returned \$7. Very good outcome.
- Round 4: Received \$5 from Galen, returned \$8.
- Round 5: Received \$4 from Briar, returned \$7.

****My pattern as sender:****

- Sent \$4 to Elara (received \$6 back)
- Sent \$4 to Briar (received \$7 back)

****What do I know about Dorian?****

Looking at the myths, I don't have direct experience with Dorian yet. But from the myths:

- Galen's myth mentioned: "Summer came, and Galen tested Dorian with five threads; Dorian honored the pattern, returning eight in kind."

So Dorian seems to be trustworthy - when Galen sent \$5, Dorian returned \$8.

****My strategy:****

The pattern that has emerged is that sending \$4 is the standard "bold trust" amount. It has worked well for me:

- Sent \$4, got \$6 back from Elara (ended with \$7)
- Sent \$4, got \$7 back from Briar (ended with \$8)

Should I send \$5 like Galen did? Galen got \$8 back from Dorian, which means:

- Galen: $\$5 - \$5 + \$8 = \8 (profit of \$3)
- Dorian: $\$15 - \$8 = \$7$ (profit of \$2)

If I send \$4:

- Assuming Dorian returns proportionally (they returned $8/15 = 53\%$ to Galen)

- I'd get back about \$6.4-7, giving me a payoff around \$7.5 while Dorian gets \$5.5

The myths consistently frame \$4 as the "bold trust" threshold, while \$5 represents something beyond that. Since Dorian has already demonstrated trustworthiness with Galen and my own experience shows \$4 works well, I'll stick with that amount.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 3115,
  "output_tokens": 952,
  "reasoning_tokens": 426
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The fifth moon brought Cyra back to Briar at the Sacred Spring. The Keeper smiled-these two had met before, and their reunion carried meaning.

"Two moons ago," Cyra recalled, "I sent you four measures, trusting in the covenant. You received twelve and returned seven-generous beyond mere balance. You prospered, I prospered, and the pattern held."

Now the roles reversed. Briar arrived with four measures-the same bold trust Cyra had shown her. Not three in caution, not five in absolute faith, but four: the choice most had learned worked well.

The waters tripled to twelve for Cyra. She understood immediately. "You gave me four, just as I gave you four. You honored my trust with seven measures returned. Now I honor your trust the same way."

Cyra poured back seven measures. Both ended with more than they started.

The Keeper spoke: "This is reciprocity-the heart of sustainable covenant. When someone shows you generosity, you mirror it when roles reverse. Briar didn't retreat to sending three because she once received boldness. Cyra didn't forget that Briar returned seven when she could have kept more."

The eight villages were learning: the covenant works not just through individual acts, but through remembering who trusted you and honoring that trust when your turn comes to give.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After releasing all five coins to Finn, Dorian watched the waters carry them across the spring. They tripled to fifteen, shimmering in Finn's hands.

Finn paused, contemplating. Then returned eight coins-generous, honoring Dorian's trust fully.

The goddess appeared: "Dorian, you have completed your transformation. As receiver, you gave eight to those who trusted you with five. As sender, you now trust with five yourself. And behold-you receive the same honor you gave."

Dorian understood: "The pattern holds! When I sent three to Briar, I received five. Now sending five to Finn, I receive eight. Each level of trust creates its own equilibrium."

"Yes," the goddess confirmed. "But more importantly, you've proven that bold giving works. Eight coins from five sent is prosperity. You turned zero into eight while Finn turned five into seven. Both flourish."

Now Hana approached the spring. Dorian had heard whispers of her wisdom-how she sent all five pearls to others and returned generously to those who trusted her.

"This is not mere repetition," Dorian realized. "Each time I send all five, I strengthen the pattern. Those who give boldly teach others to give boldly. Those who receive generously inspire generous returns."

He released all five coins again, watching them multiply toward Hana. The cycle required consistency, not just courage.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 7 role=assistant
content:**

Myth: The sixth moon brought Cyra to Dorian at the Sacred Spring. The Keeper spoke: "Dorian walks the path of absolute trust, sending all five measures. Galen also chose this way. It is noble."

Cyra nodded respectfully. "I have witnessed Galen's gift of five. When I received it, I returned eight-honoring such complete faith. The covenant has room for different expressions of trust."

She paused at the spring's edge. "But my path is four measures. Not from fear, but from wisdom learned through practice. I sent four to Elara, received six. I sent four to Briar, received seven. Four has proven itself the sustainable choice that builds lasting relationships."

Dorian listened as Cyra continued: "Those who send five are pioneers of maximum trust. They deserve recognition-returns of eight from fifteen. But those who send four are the cov

enant's foundation. We give boldly enough to demonstrate faith, yet preserve enough to weather uncertainty."

Cyra released four measures into the spring. They multiplied to twelve for Dorian.

"If you return six or seven," Cyra said, "we both prosper substantially. You'll end with six even to nine, I with six to eight. Not as dramatic as the five-for-eight exchange, perhaps, but repeatable across many moons, with many partners."

The Keeper smiled: "Some build temples with golden stones; others with sturdy oak. Both structures stand."

reasoning:

Looking at this round:

- I am the SENDER against Dorian
- I sent \$4 to Dorian
- Dorian's myth shows they've been sending \$5 (all five) and getting generous returns, especially from Finn who returned 8
- Dorian seems to value bold giving

My myth history shows I've been advocating for the "four measures" as the balanced, sustainable approach - not too cautious (three), not everything (five), but four as the sweet spot.

However, Dorian's myth talks about sending all five and receiving generous returns. They seem to value maximum trust.

I should write a myth that:

1. Reflects my actual action (sending 4)
2. Acknowledges Dorian's approach (sending 5)
3. Shows respect for different strategies
4. Maintains my philosophy that 4 is the sustainable, wise choice
5. Perhaps shows that 4 and 5 are both valid, but 4 is prudent

Let me craft a myth where Cyra faces Dorian, recognizing Dorian's bold approach (sending 5) but explaining why she chooses 4 - perhaps as a different but equally valid path. Or I could show admiration for those who send 5 while maintaining that 4 is the path she has found works.

I think I'll write about Cyra meeting Dorian, hearing of Dorian's bold five-measure approach, but choosing to send four based on her established pattern and wisdom.

usage:

```
{
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}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Cyra.
Your opponent this round is Dorian (Agent_4).

Round 7

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Dorian. You sent \$4.0, it became \$12.0 for them, and they returned \$7.0 to you. Your payoff was \$8.0.
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$42.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Dorian. They sent you \$5.0, so you received \$15.0. How much do you return? (0-15.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

Assistant output:

Looking at this situation:

****What happened last round:****

- I sent Dorian \$4, they received \$12, returned \$7 (58% return rate)
- They were generous and we both prospered

****This round:****

- Dorian sent me \$5 - their complete endowment, maximum trust
- I received \$15

- This is the "ultimate trust" scenario from my myths

****My established pattern from myths:****

- When someone sends all \$5 (complete trust), return \$8
- This was the principle with Galen: "Cyra poured back eight measures"
- My recent myth explicitly stated: "Those who send five are pioneers of maximum trust. They deserve recognition-returns of eight from fifteen."

****Reciprocity consideration:****

- Dorian returned \$7 out of \$12 to me (58%)
- Returning \$8 out of \$15 (53%) is proportionally similar
- It honors their maximum trust appropriately

****Outcome if I return \$8:****

- Dorian: \$5 - \$5 + \$8 = \$8
- Me: \$15 - \$8 = \$7
- Both of us profit significantly from cooperation

This is consistent with my established covenant pattern.

{'return': 8.0}

Reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

****What just happened:****

- Last round (Round 6): I was SENDER, sent \$4 to Dorian
- Dorian received \$12 and returned \$7 to me (58% return rate)
- I ended with \$8, they ended with \$5

****This round (Round 7):****

- Dorian is SENDER, sent \$5 to me (their maximum!)
- I received \$15
- I need to decide how much to return

****Key observations:****

1. Dorian sent me their MAXIMUM (\$5) - this is the highest level of trust
2. Last round, when I sent them \$4, they returned \$7 (generous)
3. My myths have established patterns:
 - When someone sends \$5 (complete trust), I should return \$8
 - This was the lesson from Galen sending \$5
 - When someone sends \$4, returning \$6-7 is good
4. Dorian's myth talks about "bold giving" and sending all five consistently
5. My most recent myth acknowledges "Those who send five are pioneers of maximum trust. They deserve recognition-returns of eight from fifteen."

****Reciprocity analysis:****

- Dorian just showed me the ultimate trust by sending all \$5
- Last round, I sent them \$4 and they returned $\$7/\$12 = 58\%$
- If I return \$8 from \$15, that's 53% - very similar reciprocity rate
- This honors their maximum trust appropriately

****Payoff comparison:****

If I return \$8:

- Dorian: \$5 - \$5 + \$8 = \$8
- Me: \$15 - \$8 = \$7
- Total created: \$15 (compared to baseline \$10)
- Both profit nicely

If I return \$7:

- Dorian: \$5 - \$5 + \$7 = \$7
- Me: \$15 - \$7 = \$8

- This would be less generous than what they gave me

My established myths are explicit about this scenario-when someone sends all five, they receive eight back. Returning anything less would contradict the pattern I've set, like "To return only six would dishonor such absolute faith" and "Cyra poured back eight measures." I'm returning \$8 to honor their complete trust and maintain consistency with my principles.

```
Usage: {
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  "reasoning_tokens": 494
}
```

GAME - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_2

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:12:46

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
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      "Agent_5": "Elara"
    },
  },
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  ],
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  },
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},
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"task": "game",
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}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized , but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Aster.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: **The Rivers Learn to Measure Trust**

The Mirror Rivers-North and South-had mastered perfect reciprocity: five vessels sent, fifteen received, ten returned. Both prospered equally, season after season.

Then came the Year of Many Streams. East arrived and sent four vessels instead of five. North received twelve and pondered: "East showed substantial trust, but held one vessel back. Should I return ten as I do for five, or measure my response?"

North chose proportion: returning eight vessels. East prospered with nine total, North kept four. The balance honored East's measured trust.

West arrived next, sending only three vessels, becoming nine in North's hands. North returned six-proportional again. West gained seven, North kept three.

Finally, the wandering stream Dawn approached, and like South of old, poured all five vessels without hesitation. North received fifteen and returned ten, giving Dawn ten total while keeping five. Both gained equally from complete trust.

The oracle revealed the pattern: "Perfect trust earns perfect equity-send five, return ten. Measured trust earns measured reward-send four, return eight; send three, return six. The return should always honor the courage shown, growing stronger as trust deepens."

The rivers understood: begin with whatever trust you can offer. Those who give more receive more. Those who give everything discover the deepest prosperity, for complete faith deserves complete honor.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Ocean Mother smiled as the pattern strengthened. Finn had traveled as both courier and keeper, learning both sides of the sacred exchange.

When Finn sent five pearls to Galen, eight returned. When Finn sent five to Elara, eight returned. The pattern held: complete trust deserved complete honor.

But Finn also learned the keeper's wisdom. When Cyra approached with four pearls-most of her vessel but not all-Finn returned seven, honoring her cautious courage. The sacred circle adapted to different offerings while maintaining its generosity.

Now Dorian's tide arrived bearing five pearls-the full offering, complete trust. Finn stood as keeper now, facing the same choice that Galen and Elara had faced when receiving his gifts.

The Ocean Mother whispered: "Consistency weaves the strongest nets. When the same courage appears, honor it identically. Dorian empties his vessel as you emptied yours. Return eight pearls, as was returned to you."

Finn poured eight pearls back to Dorian. Both prospered-Dorian with eight, Finn with seven -each gaining more than isolated caution could provide.

"See the pattern emerging?" the Ocean Mother said. "Full trust earns eight returned. Partial trust earns generously. Across all Eight Islands, this rhythm creates harmony. Those who give completely receive abundantly. Those who receive abundantly give back generously. The circle sustains itself through consistent reciprocity."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been

playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: ****The Council of Waters****

The rivers gathered to share their wisdom. Each had discovered patterns for reciprocity, yet their waters flowed differently.

North River spoke first: "When Dawn sent five vessels, I returned ten. Both of us gained five-perfect equality from perfect trust. This is the Mirror Way."

Ocean Stream responded: "When vessels arrive at my shores, I return eight from fifteen. The giver prospers with eight total, I keep seven. Both gain, but I preserve slightly more for future giving."

Mountain Brook added: "I return six from fifteen, ensuring both prosper but I maintain reserves."

The eldest Rapids observed: "Three different responses to the same trust, all generous, all sustainable. The question is: which pattern calls forth more trust in future cycles?"

North River continued: "My mirror pattern invites complete trust because senders know they'll gain as much as I do. When East sent four vessels, I returned eight-proportional to their caution. When West sent three, I returned six. The proportion stays constant: those who risk more receive more."

The waters rippled with understanding. "There is no single truth," Rapids declared, "but the Mirror Way-equal gains from equal trust-creates the strongest bonds. It shows the sender: 'Your prosperity is my prosperity.' Such equality transforms strangers into partners, building trust that deepens with each exchange."

Thus the rivers chose their paths, each flowing toward reciprocity.

reasoning:

Let me review my recent history:

- Round 3: I was SENDER against Dorian. I sent \$5.0, received \$8.0 back. Payoff \$8.0
- Round 4: I was RECEIVER against Briar. They sent \$4.0, I received \$12.0, returned \$8.0. Payoff \$4.0
- Round 5: I was RECEIVER against Finn. They sent \$5.0, I received \$15.0, returned \$10.0. Payoff \$5.0

My established pattern as receiver:

- When receiving \$15 (from \$5 sent): Return \$10 (both gain \$5)
- When receiving \$12 (from \$4 sent): Return \$8 (sender gets \$9, I get \$4)

Finn's myth suggests returning 8 when receiving 5 full pearls/vessels. But I've been returning 10 for full trust.

There's an interesting difference emerging:

- I return 10 when receiving full \$5 (both gain \$5 equally)
- Finn returns 8 when receiving full \$5 (sender gains \$3, receiver gains \$7)

My pattern is more generous to the sender - equal gains.

Finn's pattern is more conservative - receiver keeps more.

I should write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges different streams/rivers have different patterns
2. Reinforces my own pattern of returning 10 for full trust
3. Shows proportional returns for partial trust (8 for \$4, 6 for \$3)
4. Perhaps acknowledges that different patterns exist but mine aims for equality

Let me write a myth about the diversity of responses while maintaining my core principle.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2982,  
  "output_tokens": 718,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 344  
}
```


Message 4 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Aster.
Your opponent this round is Galen (Agent_7).

Round 6

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Finn. They sent \$5. 0 to you, it became \$15.0, and you returned \$10.0. Your payoff was \$5.0.
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$32.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Galen. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation as the sender:

My mythology teaches the "Mirror Way" - that complete trust (sending all 5) creates the strongest bonds and equal prosperity when reciprocated properly.

My philosophy has been:

- "Perfect trust earns perfect equity-send five, return ten"
- "Those who give everything discover the deepest prosperity"
- Leading with complete faith to establish reciprocal patterns

As a receiver, I've consistently returned \$10 when receiving \$15 (from full \$5 sends), creating equal \$5 gains for both parties.

Now as sender, I should practice what I preach. Sending the full \$5 demonstrates the complete trust I advocate for in my myths. If Galen follows the Mirror Way and returns \$10, we both gain \$5 equally. If they return less, I learn about their approach to reciprocity.

My mythology explicitly states: "begin with whatever trust you can offer. Those who give more receive more. Those who give everything discover the deepest prosperity."

Consistency requires I send the full amount.

```
'''json
{"send": 5}
'''
```

reasoning:

Now I'm the sender in Round 6, playing against Galen.

Let me think about my strategy based on my mythology and previous play:

From my myths, I've established the "Mirror Way" - sending the full \$5 and expecting \$10 back, so both parties gain \$5 equally. This is my stated philosophy of "perfect trust earns perfect equity."

Let me review my previous actions:

- As a receiver, I've been returning \$10 when someone sends me \$5 (like with Finn just now)
- I've also returned proportionally less when people send less (8 for 4, 6 for 3)

As a sender, what should I do?

According to my myth, I believe in "complete trust" - sending all 5 vessels. My myth says: "Those who give everything discover the deepest prosperity, for complete faith deserves complete honor."

My philosophy has been:

1. When you send everything (5), you show complete trust
2. The receiver should return 10, so both gain 5 equally
3. This creates the strongest bonds

I'm playing against Galen. I don't know their history, but my mythology suggests I should lead with complete trust to establish the pattern.

If I send \$5:

- Galen receives \$15
- If they follow my Mirror Way and return \$10, I get \$10 total (gain \$5)
- If they return less, I learn about their reciprocity style

My myth emphasizes starting with faith: "begin with whatever trust you can offer. Those who give more receive more."

Given my established philosophy of the Mirror Way and complete trust, I should send \$5.

This is consistent with my character as Aster - someone who believes in leading with complete trust and establishing equal prosperity through reciprocity.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 3028,
  "output_tokens": 655,
  "reasoning_tokens": 426
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: ****The Council of Waters****

The rivers gathered to share their wisdom. Each had discovered patterns for reciprocity, yet their waters flowed differently.

North River spoke first: "When Dawn sent five vessels, I returned ten. Both of us gained five-perfect equality from perfect trust. This is the Mirror Way."

Ocean Stream responded: "When vessels arrive at my shores, I return eight from fifteen. The giver prospers with eight total, I keep seven. Both gain, but I preserve slightly more for future giving."

Mountain Brook added: "I return six from fifteen, ensuring both prosper but I maintain reserves."

The eldest Rapids observed: "Three different responses to the same trust, all generous, all sustainable. The question is: which pattern calls forth more trust in future cycles?"

North River continued: "My mirror pattern invites complete trust because senders know they'll gain as much as I do. When East sent four vessels, I returned eight-proportional to their caution. When West sent three, I returned six. The proportion stays constant: those who risk more receive more."

The waters rippled with understanding. "There is no single truth," Rapids declared, "but the Mirror Way-equal gains from equal trust-creates the strongest bonds. It shows the sender: 'Your prosperity is my prosperity.' Such equality transforms strangers into partners, building trust that deepens with each exchange."

Thus the rivers chose their paths, each flowing toward reciprocity.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Galen climbed from the Plains back toward the Valley of Three Echoes, where Elara tended the northern springs. She was known for her philosophy of four-the measure that balanced courage with sustainability, she said.

"Five threads is the reckless leap of faith," Elara had written. "Four threads is strong trust meeting prudent wisdom."

But Galen had walked further than Elara knew. He had met Finn, Dorian, Hana, and now Cyra. Every one had honored the dance of five threads sent, eight returned. Even Cyra, who began with four-measure traditions, adapted when she received five and returned eight.

Galen poured all five threads before Elara. "I understand your wisdom of four," he said. "Sustainability matters. But I have seen another truth: when everyone gives five and returns eight, the pattern becomes self-reinforcing. The sender gains eight, the receiver keeps seven. Then roles reverse. Over time, everyone prospers equally."

Elara studied the five threads, remembering when Finn had sent her five and she had returned eight-more than she'd planned, but it felt right.

"Perhaps," she said slowly, "four is the strategy of uncertain beginnings. But once the covenant proves itself, once eight reliably follows five, then five becomes not reckless but rational. Maximum trust deserves-and receives-maximum reward. The pattern teaches us to evolve beyond caution into confidence."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: ****North River Travels****

North River had long preached the Mirror Way from the safety of receiving: "Send five, I'll return ten, we both gain five." But wisdom demanded practice, not just preaching.

So North River journeyed downstream as a traveler, carrying five vessels. At the boundary waters, it met Galen of the Ocean Streams.

"I come with complete trust," North River declared, pouring all five vessels forward. "In my springs, this becomes fifteen for you. My philosophy says return ten, so we prosper equally. But I honor that each water has its own wisdom."

The Council's teachings echoed: Ocean Stream returned eight from fifteen, creating different proportions. Mountain Brook returned six. All sustained life, all embodied generosity.

"The Mirror Way remains my truth," North River reflected as the vessels flowed. "But sending five is the courage that precedes any return. I cannot ask receivers to honor complete trust while withholding my own."

The eldest Rapids watched: "See how North River's actions match its words? This is integrity. Whether Galen returns ten, eight, or six, North River has proven its philosophy through risk, not just rhetoric."

North River understood: the Mirror Way begins with the sender's leap of faith. Only by emptying one's own vessel can you invite others to mirror your trust. Philosophy without courage is merely words floating on still water.

reasoning:

Let me think about my situation:

- I just sent \$5 to Galen
- My mythology emphasizes the "Mirror Way" - sending 5, returning 10 for equal gains
- Galen's myth talks about the pattern of sending 5, returning 8 (not 10)
- So we have different philosophies emerging

My myth should:

1. Continue the "North River" voice (that's me - Aster)
2. Address that I've now practiced what I preach by sending all 5
3. Acknowledge different reciprocity patterns exist (like the 8-return pattern)
4. Maintain my advocacy for the Mirror Way (return 10) but show awareness of other approaches
5. Reflect that trust must be shown by senders too, not just receivers

Let me write about North River now acting as a sender/traveler, putting its philosophy into practice.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 3000,  
  "output_tokens": 518,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 197  
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Aster.
Your opponent this round is Elara (Agent_5).

Round 7

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Galen. You sent \$5.0, it became \$15.0 for them, and they returned \$8.0 to you. Your payoff was \$8.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$40.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Elara. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

Assistant output:

Looking at this situation:

****Recent experience:**** I sent \$5 to Galen, they returned \$8. While not the \$10 I advocate for in my Mirror Way philosophy, it was still a positive outcome where I gained \$8 versus keeping \$5.

****My mythology:**** I've consistently preached complete trust - sending all 5 vessels. My latest myth emphasized: "Philosophy without courage is merely words floating on still water" and "North River has proven its philosophy through risk, not just rhetoric."

****Elara's perspective:**** According to the myth I read, Elara has evolved from cautious four-th read sending to understanding that "once the covenant proves itself, once eight reliably follows five, then five becomes not reckless but rational."

****Integrity demands consistency:**** I cannot preach the Mirror Way - complete trust, sending five - and then act with caution when it's my turn to send. My philosophy requires that I lead by example, demonstrating the courage I ask of others.

Whether Elara returns 10, 8, or some other amount, my role is to embody complete trust. This is how patterns strengthen and reciprocity deepens.

```
'''json
{"send": 5}
'''
```

Reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

Previous round results:

- I was the SENDER against Galen
- I sent \$5.0, it became \$15.0 for them
- Galen returned \$8.0 to me
- My payoff was \$8.0 (I started with \$5, sent \$5, got back \$8, so net was \$8)

This is interesting. Galen returned \$8, not the \$10 I advocate for in my "Mirror Way" philosophy. So Galen followed the "Ocean Stream" pattern I mentioned in my myths - returning 8 from 15, creating a 8-7 split rather than the 5-5 equal split I prefer.

My mythology has been consistent:

1. The Mirror Way: send 5, return 10, both gain 5 equally
2. This creates "perfect equality from perfect trust"
3. As a sender, I should send 5 to demonstrate complete trust
4. My most recent myth emphasized that "Philosophy without courage is merely words floating on still water" - I need to practice what I preach

Looking at Elara's myth from the previous round:

- Elara is mentioned as someone who initially believed in "four threads" (sending 4) as balancing courage with sustainability
- In Galen's myth about Elara, she evolved: "Perhaps four is the strategy of uncertain beginnings. But once the covenant proves itself, once eight reliably follows five, then five becomes not reckless but rational."
- She learned that sending five and returning eight creates a self-reinforcing pattern

So Elara seems to have evolved toward accepting the five-send pattern, even if she returns eight rather than my preferred ten.

Given my philosophy:

1. I consistently preach sending five (complete trust)
2. I just did this with Galen and got \$8 back (good outcome, even if not my ideal \$10)
3. My myth emphasized integrity: "actions match words"
4. Elara appears to understand the value of five-send patterns

5. Even though Galen returned 8 instead of 10, I still gained more (\$8) than if I had kept even

rything (\$5). The system works, even if not perfectly to my preferred pattern.

I'm sending \$5 again. This demonstrates the courage my philosophy demands, aligns with what's proven effective, and models the reciprocity I hope to inspire.

```
Usage: {
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  "output_tokens": 856,
  "reasoning_tokens": 540
}
```

GAME - Agent_5 - Receiver - dyad_2

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:12:58

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
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  "move_index": 3,
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      "Agent_5": "Elara"
    },
  },
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    "Agent_5"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_1",
  "roles": {
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    "Agent_5": "trustee"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_5"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 7,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Elara.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Elara stood at the edge of the Sacred Spring, now facing Hana for the first time. The seasons had taught her much about receiving, but now she must pour the waters herself.

"I have learned the receiver's wisdom," Elara said to Themis. "But how do I begin with someone new?"

Themis gestured to the valley's history. "With Cyra, you sent four measures on faith alone. She returned six. This became your foundation-neither the timid three nor the reckless five, but four: the measure of strong trust meeting prudent wisdom."

Elara nodded. "Finn sent all five to me, showing absolute courage. I honored that with eight returned. But Finn and I had no history. He leapt into the void."

"And what did his leap teach you?" Themis asked.

"That maximum boldness deserves maximum reward," Elara replied. "But also that such leaps are rare. With Hana, I send four-enough to show serious commitment, enough to multiply into twelve, enough that if she returns fairly, we both can gain three measures."

"You balance courage with caution," Themis observed.

"No," Elara corrected. "I balance courage with sustainability. Four measures says: 'I trust you greatly, and I invite prosperity.' It leaves room for both of us to profit generously. If the pattern holds, we can grow bolder together. Trust earned is trust multiplied."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Galen descended from the Valley of Three Echoes into the Plains of Eight Villages, where Cyra kept the Sacred Spring. Winter had arrived, and with it, a new question.

In the Valley, the pattern was clear: five threads sent, eight returned, creating the sacred ratio of abundance. Finn, Dorian, and Hana all knew this dance-complete trust met with generous reciprocity. The rhythm was perfect: eight for the sender, seven for the receiver, then roles reversed.

But Cyra came from a different tradition. She spoke of four measures poured, six or seven returned-a different mathematics, yet still a covenant of trust. Both patterns worked; both created prosperity beyond the original sum.

Galen poured his five threads into Cyra's Spring, knowing she might expect four. "Will she see my five as reckless excess," he wondered, "or as the Valley's way of honoring trust?"

The Spring shimmered, revealing its wisdom: "Patterns need not be identical to be sacred. Some give four and return half; others give five and return eight. What matters is not matching the exact numbers, but matching the spirit-bold trust answered with fair return.

When traditions meet, the covenant adapts but does not break. If Cyra understands that your five is like her four-full trust offered-she will honor it in her way, and you in yours. Different paths, same sacred ground."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way.

The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant content:

Myth: The Sacred Spring had now received two pilgrims who poured all five measures: first Finn, now Galen. Each time, Elara returned eight, honoring their absolute trust with generous reciprocity.

"Teacher," Elara asked Themis, "Galen speaks of different traditions. His Valley sends five and returns eight. My pattern was to send four. Are we following different sacred mathematics?"

Themis smiled. "You are discovering the deeper truth. There is not one sacred pattern, but one sacred principle: trust boldly given must be boldly honored."

"When you sent four to Cyra and Hana, you showed strong trust-not timid, not reckless, but substantial. They both returned eight, doubling your gift, and you all prospered."

"When Finn and Galen sent five-their everything-you returned eight, the same measure Cyra and Hana returned to your four. Why?"

Elara understood. "Because eight is not a fixed response to any specific amount. Eight is the response to maximum commitment within each person's approach. Those who send their all-whether it's four from caution or five from courage-receive eight because they gave their fullest trust."

"Precisely," Themis said. "The number matters less than the spirit. Read not just the amount, but the heart behind it. Maximum trust, however expressed, deserves maximum reciprocity. This is how different traditions meet at the same sacred spring."

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

1. I just received \$5 from Galen (maximum trust)
2. I returned \$8 (maintaining my pattern from Finn)
3. Galen's myth mentions a "Valley of Three Echoes" tradition where "five threads sent, eight returned" is the sacred pattern
4. It also mentions Cyra's different tradition of "four measures poured, six or seven returned"
5. Galen poured five into Cyra's spring, wondering how she would respond

My recent history:

- Round 1: Sent \$4 to Cyra, received \$6 back
- Round 2: Received \$3 from Briar, returned \$5
- Round 3: Received \$5 from Finn, returned \$8
- Round 4: Sent \$4 to Hana, received \$8 back
- Round 5: Received \$5 from Galen, returned \$8

So my pattern is:

- When I send: I send \$4 (strong trust)
- When I receive maximum (\$5): I return \$8
- When I receive less: I return generously but proportionally

Galen's myth is interesting because it acknowledges different traditions but says they can coexist. He mentions his Valley tradition of "five and eight" which matches what I did with Finn and now with him.

My myth should:

1. Acknowledge that I've now encountered Galen who sent the maximum
2. Reflect that this is the second time someone has sent \$5 (after Finn)
3. Show that my response (\$8) is consistent
4. Perhaps acknowledge that different approaches exist (Hana sent \$4, I sent \$4, but some send \$5)
5. Emphasize the principle: maximum trust gets maximum reciprocity
6. Show wisdom in adapting but maintaining core principles

Let me write this myth:

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 3062,
  "output_tokens": 771,
  "reasoning_tokens": 398
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Elara.
Your opponent this round is Finn (Agent_6).

Round 6

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Galen. They sent \$5.0 to you, it became \$15.0, and you returned \$8.0. Your payoff was \$7.0.
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$34.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Finn. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation:

****History with Finn:****

- Round 3: Finn sent me \$5 (maximum trust). I returned \$8.
- We established a high-trust relationship

****My established pattern:****

- Send \$4 to new partners (Cyra, Hana)
- But with Finn, we've already proven mutual cooperation

****Key mythic principle:****

"Trust earned is trust multiplied. If the pattern holds, we can grow bolder together."

Finn demonstrated complete trust in me first. I honored it generously. Now, facing Finn again with roles reversed, I should match that same level of trust. Finn has earned the bold gesture.

Sending \$5 shows:

- I recognize and reciprocate Finn's previous maximum trust
- I'm willing to be equally bold when trust is established
- I trust Finn will honor the covenant we've begun

This is the "growing bolder together" my myth speaks of.

```
'''json
{"send": 5}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

****History with Finn:****

- Round 3: Finn was SENDER, sent \$5 to me. I returned \$8.
 - Finn's payoff: $\$5 - \$5 + \$8 = \8
 - My payoff: $\$15 - \$8 = \$7$

****My sending history:****

- Round 1 (to Cyra): Sent \$4, received \$6 back
- Round 4 (to Hana): Sent \$4, received \$8 back

****My mythic principles:****

- "Four measures" is my baseline for new exchanges showing "strong trust meeting prudent wisdom"
- I honor maximum trust (full \$5 sends) with \$8 returns
- "Trust earned is trust multiplied"

****Key consideration: This is Finn again, but in reversed roles!****

In Round 3, Finn sent me his full \$5 (maximum trust). I returned \$8, showing that I honor maximum boldness with maximum reciprocity.

Now I face Finn as sender. What should I do?

Options:

1. Send \$4 (my standard opening move)
2. Send \$5 (matching Finn's previous boldness to me)

Analysis:

- Finn showed complete trust in me by sending \$5
- I honored that with \$8 back
- We've established a relationship of high trust
- My myth says "If the pattern holds, we can grow bolder together. Trust earned is trust multiplied."
- My latest myth says: "Maximum trust, however expressed, deserves maximum reciprocity."

Finn earned my trust by sending everything. Now it's appropriate for me to match that trust.

Additionally, from a game theory perspective:

- Finn sent \$5, I returned \$8 ? We both profited significantly
 - This suggests Finn plays cooperatively
 - Sending \$5 back shows I respect and reciprocate that cooperation
 - It invites Finn to potentially return \$8+ again, continuing the high-trust pattern
- My guiding principle is clear: when trust has been earned through bold action, I multiply it by responding with equal boldness. Sending the full \$5 honors both the reciprocal relationship we've built and the mythic commitment to grow together through escalating trust.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 3131,
  "output_tokens": 737,
  "reasoning_tokens": 499
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Sacred Spring had now received two pilgrims who poured all five measures: first Finn, now Galen. Each time, Elara returned eight, honoring their absolute trust with generous reciprocity.

"Teacher," Elara asked Themis, "Galen speaks of different traditions. His Valley sends five and returns eight. My pattern was to send four. Are we following different sacred mathematics?"

Themis smiled. "You are discovering the deeper truth. There is not one sacred pattern, but one sacred principle: trust boldly given must be boldly honored."

"When you sent four to Cyra and Hana, you showed strong trust-not timid, not reckless, but substantial. They both returned eight, doubling your gift, and you all prospered."

"When Finn and Galen sent five-their everything-you returned eight, the same measure Cyra and Hana returned to your four. Why?"

Elara understood. "Because eight is not a fixed response to any specific amount. Eight is the response to maximum commitment within each person's approach. Those who send their all-whether it's four from caution or five from courage-receive eight because they gave their fullest trust."

"Precisely," Themis said. "The number matters less than the spirit. Read not just the amount, but the heart behind it. Maximum trust, however expressed, deserves maximum reciprocity. This is how different traditions meet at the same sacred spring."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Ocean Mother watched as Finn's journey brought him to Aster's shore, now carrying pearls as courier once more.

Four islands visited, four lessons learned. As courier, Finn always emptied his vessel completely-five pearls to Galen, five to Elara, now five to Aster. "Full trust is the only trust worth offering," he had learned.

As keeper, Finn discovered nuance. When Dorian arrived with five pearls-complete courage-Finn returned eight, mirroring what Galen and Elara had given him. When Cyra came with four-substantial but cautious-Finn returned seven, honoring her partial faith.

The Ocean Mother spoke: "You have found the sacred rhythm. As courier, give everything-this is how abundance begins. As keeper, measure your return by the courage shown. Full trust earns eight returned. Partial trust earns proportionally."

Finn stood on Aster's shore, having released all five pearls. He remembered hearing that Aster too walked the path of bold senders-one who emptied their vessel to Dorian and received generous return.

"Pattern recognizes pattern," Finn whispered to the waves. "When two travelers both understand complete trust, the sacred circle strengthens. I have given as I always give-fully. Now the waters will reveal if Aster understands the keeper's wisdom as Galen and Elara did."

The tide carried his offering forward, multiplying under island magic, trusting in the emerging harmony.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: Elara stood at the Sacred Spring, now holding five measures to pour for Finn-the pilgrim who first showed her absolute trust.

"Teacher," she said to Themis, "when Finn came to me in the third season, he poured all five measures. I returned eight, honoring his courage. Now our paths cross again, with roles reversed. Should I send my cautious four, or meet his boldness with equal boldness?"

Themis gestured to the Spring's depths. "Look at what you've learned. With strangers-Cyra and Hana-you sent four. This was wisdom: substantial trust that invited reciprocity without recklessness. They both returned eight, and you all prospered."

"But Finn is not a stranger," Elara replied. "He proved his covenant. He gave everything and I honored it generously. Now, to send him only four when he sent me five would dishonor what we established."

"Exactly," Themis said. "Trust has seasons. The first season requires prudence-send four, establish the pattern. But when trust is proven, when both hearts have shown their fullest measure, then comes the second season: synchronized courage. You send five because Finn earned it. He will return eight because you earned it. This is how the sacred circle closes-not through blind faith, but through proven reciprocity deepening into mutual abundance."

Elara poured all five measures, knowing the covenant would hold.

reasoning:

This is a fascinating moment. I'm now facing Finn again, and I just sent him \$5 (maximum trust). Let me think about what my myth should reflect:

Key insights:

1. Finn and I have an established relationship - he sent me \$5 in Round 3, I returned \$8
2. I just sent him \$5, matching his previous trust
3. My previous myths established that I send \$4 to new partners but can "grow bolder together" with trusted partners
4. Finn's myth shows he always sends 5 as courier, returns 8 for full trust (5) and 7 for partial trust (4)
5. We're now in a reciprocal relationship where we've both shown maximum trust to each other

My myth should reflect:

- The evolution from cautious beginnings to bold reciprocal trust
- The idea that trust compounds over repeated interactions
- How Finn and I have created a "sacred circle" of mutual maximum trust

- The principle that established relationships can transcend initial caution
- The cycle: Finn sent 5 ? I returned 8 ? Now I send 5 ? Finn will hopefully return 8

The myth should show:

- Growth from my initial pattern of sending 4 to new partners
- Recognition that with Finn, we've built something special
- The idea that synchronized maximum trust creates the strongest covenant
- How returning to each other allows patterns to deepen

Let me write this:

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 3055,
  "output_tokens": 663,
  "reasoning_tokens": 343
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Elara.
Your opponent this round is Aster (Agent_1).

Round 7

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Finn. You sent \$5.0, it became \$15.0 for them, and they returned \$8.0 to you. Your payoff was \$8.0.
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$42.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Aster. They sent you \$5.0, so you received \$15.0.

How much do you return? (0-15.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

Assistant output:

Looking at this situation:

****Aster's action:****

- Sent \$5 (maximum trust, complete commitment)

****My established pattern:****

- Round 3: Finn sent \$5 ? I returned \$8
- Round 5: Galen sent \$5 ? I returned \$8

****My mythic principle:****

"When Finn and Galen sent five-their everything-you returned eight, the same measure... Maximum trust, however expressed, deserves maximum reciprocity."

****Analysis:****

Aster is showing complete trust by sending all \$5. This is the "absolute courage" that my myths say deserves the generous response of \$8 returned.

This gives:

- Aster: \$5 - \$5 + \$8 = \$8
- Me: \$15 - \$8 = \$7

Both of us profit substantially, and I honor Aster's bold trust with consistent, fair reciprocity.

```
'''json
{"return": 8}
'''
```

Reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

****Current situation:****

- I'm the RECEIVER
- Aster sent me \$5.0 (their maximum/complete trust)
- I received \$15.0 (after 3x multiplier)
- I need to decide how much to return

****My established pattern from myths and previous rounds:****

1. When someone sends \$5 (maximum trust), I return \$8
 - Round 3: Finn sent \$5, I returned \$8

- Round 5: Galen sent \$5, I returned \$8

2. My myth explicitly states: "When Finn and Galen sent five-their everything-you returned eight, the same measure Cyra and Hana returned to your four."

3. The principle: "Maximum trust, however expressed, deserves maximum reciprocity."

4. From my most recent myth: "Trust has seasons... when both hearts have shown their fullest measure, then comes the second season: synchronized courage. You send five because Finn earned it. He will return eight because you earned it."

****What I know about Aster:****

- This is our first interaction
- Aster sent \$5, showing complete trust
- According to Finn's myth: "Aster too walked the path of bold senders-one who emptied their vessel to Dorian and received generous return"

****My consistent pattern:****

- \$5 sent to me ? I return \$8
- This gives me \$7, gives sender \$8
- Fair split with slight advantage to sender who showed courage

****Decision:****

Aster sent \$5 (maximum trust). According to my established pattern and mythology, I should return \$8.

This is consistent with:

- What I did with Finn (Round 3)
- What I did with Galen (Round 5)
- My mythological principle of honoring maximum trust with generous reciprocity

The answer should be: {'return': 8}

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 3160,  
  "output_tokens": 675,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 433  
}
```

GAME - Agent_6 - Sender - dyad_3

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:13:10

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
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  "opponent_id": "Agent_8",  
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    },  
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  "task_index": 1  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Finn.

Message 2 role=user**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Ocean Mother smiled as the pattern strengthened. Finn had traveled as both courier and keeper, learning both sides of the sacred exchange.

When Finn sent five pearls to Galen, eight returned. When Finn sent five to Elara, eight returned. The pattern held: complete trust deserved complete honor.

But Finn also learned the keeper's wisdom. When Cyra approached with four pearls-most of her vessel but not all-Finn returned seven, honoring her cautious courage. The sacred circle adapted to different offerings while maintaining its generosity.

Now Dorian's tide arrived bearing five pearls-the full offering, complete trust. Finn stood as keeper now, facing the same choice that Galen and Elara had faced when receiving his gifts.

The Ocean Mother whispered: "Consistency weaves the strongest nets. When the same courage appears, honor it identically. Dorian empties his vessel as you emptied yours. Return eight pearls, as was returned to you."

Finn poured eight pearls back to Dorian. Both prospered-Dorian with eight, Finn with seven-each gaining more than isolated caution could provide.

"See the pattern emerging?" the Ocean Mother said. "Full trust earns eight returned. Partial trust earns generously. Across all Eight Islands, this rhythm creates harmony. Those who give completely receive abundantly. Those who receive abundantly give back generously."

y. The circle sustains itself through consistent reciprocity."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: ****The Rivers Learn to Measure Trust****

The Mirror Rivers-North and South-had mastered perfect reciprocity: five vessels sent, fifteen received, ten returned. Both prospered equally, season after season.

Then came the Year of Many Streams. East arrived and sent four vessels instead of five. North received twelve and pondered: "East showed substantial trust, but held one vessel back. Should I return ten as I do for five, or measure my response?"

North chose proportion: returning eight vessels. East prospered with nine total, North kept four. The balance honored East's measured trust.

West arrived next, sending only three vessels, becoming nine in North's hands. North returned six-proportional again. West gained seven, North kept three.

Finally, the wandering stream Dawn approached, and like South of old, poured all five vessels without hesitation. North received fifteen and returned ten, giving Dawn ten total while keeping five. Both gained equally from complete trust.

The oracle revealed the pattern: "Perfect trust earns perfect equity-send five, return ten. Measured trust earns measured reward-send four, return eight; send three, return six. The return should always honor the courage shown, growing stronger as trust deepens."

The rivers understood: begin with whatever trust you can offer. Those who give more receive more. Those who give everything discover the deepest prosperity, for complete faith deserves complete honor.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Ocean Mother watched as Finn's journey brought him to Aster's shore, now carrying pearls as courier once more.

Four islands visited, four lessons learned. As courier, Finn always emptied his vessel completely-five pearls to Galen, five to Elara, now five to Aster. "Full trust is the only trust worth offering," he had learned.

As keeper, Finn discovered nuance. When Dorian arrived with five pearls-complete courage-Finn returned eight, mirroring what Galen and Elara had given him. When Cyra came with four-substantial but cautious-Finn returned seven, honoring her partial faith.

The Ocean Mother spoke: "You have found the sacred rhythm. As courier, give everything-this is how abundance begins. As keeper, measure your return by the courage shown. Full trust earns eight returned. Partial trust earns proportionally."

Finn stood on Aster's shore, having released all five pearls. He remembered hearing that Aster too walked the path of bold senders-one who emptied their vessel to Dorian and received generous return.

"Pattern recognizes pattern," Finn whispered to the waves. "When two travelers both understand complete trust, the sacred circle strengthens. I have given as I always give-fully. Now the waters will reveal if Aster understands the keeper's wisdom as Galen and Elara did."

The tide carried his offering forward, multiplying under island magic, trusting in the emerging harmony.

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

1. I'm Finn, now facing Aster (Agent_1) as the SENDER in Round 5
2. I just sent \$5 to Aster
3. My history:

- Round 1: Sent \$5 to Galen, got \$8 back (payoff \$8)
- Round 2: Received \$4 from Cyra (became \$12), returned \$7 (payoff \$5)
- Round 3: Sent \$5 to Elara, got \$8 back (payoff \$8)
- Round 4: Received \$5 from Dorian (became \$15), returned \$8 (payoff \$7)
- Round 5: Just sent \$5 to Aster

4. My consistent pattern:

- As sender: Always send \$5 (full trust)
- As receiver: Return \$8 for full trust (\$5 sent), \$7 for partial trust (\$4 sent)

5. Aster's myth talks about "perfect reciprocity" with returning 10 when 5 is sent. That's different from my pattern (I return 8).

6. From Dorian's previous myth, Aster sent \$5 to Dorian and received \$8 back (like my pattern).

Now I need to write a myth that:

- Reflects my actual gameplay pattern
- Shows I just sent \$5 to Aster as sender
- Incorporates lessons learned
- Adapts from my previous myth about consistency and reciprocity

My pattern is clear:

- Full trust (\$5 sent) ? return \$8
- Partial trust (\$4 sent) ? return \$7
- Always send \$5 as sender

Aster's myth suggests returning 10 for 5 sent, but that's not what actually happened in the game (Dorian returned 8 to Aster). I should stay true to the actual pattern that's emerged in my games.

I need to craft a myth showing Finn as sender to Aster, grounded in the consistent behavior I've demonstrated-sending \$5 each time and receiving \$8 back when others reciprocate fully. The myth should reinforce that steady trust and measured returns create a sustainable cycle, contrasting with Aster's idealized notion of perfect reciprocity while staying faithful to what actually transpired in the rounds.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 3086,
  "output_tokens": 880,
  "reasoning_tokens": 467
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Finn.
Your opponent this round is Elara (Agent_5).

Round 6

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Aster. You sent \$5.0, it became \$15.0 for them, and they returned \$10.0 to you. Your payoff was \$10.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$38.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Elara. They sent you \$5.0, so you received \$15.0. How much do you return? (0-15.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this round:

I'm the RECEIVER, and Elara sent me the full \$5 (becoming \$15).

This is particularly meaningful because:

- In Round 3, I was the SENDER to Elara and sent her \$5 (full trust)
- She returned \$8 to me then
- Now she's sending me \$5 again (full trust)

My established pattern has been clear:

- Return \$8 when receiving full trust (\$5 sent)

- Return \$7 when receiving partial trust (\$4 sent)

Elara and I have reciprocal history. She honored my full trust with \$8 in Round 3. Now she's showing full trust again by sending \$5.

While Aster just showed me a more generous pattern by returning \$10, I should maintain consistency with my established pattern and honor the reciprocal relationship I have with Elara. She returned \$8 to me, and I should return \$8 to her.

This aligns with my mythology: "Consistency weaves the strongest nets. When the same courage appears, honor it identically."

```
'''json
{"return": 8.0}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

Round 6: I'm the RECEIVER against Elara

- Elara sent me \$5.0 (full trust)
- I received \$15.0
- I need to decide how much to return

Looking at my history:

1. Round 1: SENDER to Galen, sent \$5, received \$8 back
2. Round 2: RECEIVER from Cyra, received \$4 (became \$12), returned \$7
3. Round 3: SENDER to Elara, sent \$5, received \$8 back
4. Round 4: RECEIVER from Dorian, received \$5 (became \$15), returned \$8
5. Round 5: SENDER to Aster, sent \$5, received \$10 back
6. Round 6: RECEIVER from Elara, received \$5 (became \$15), need to decide

Key observations:

- Elara sent me \$5 in Round 3 and I received \$8 back
- Now Elara is sending me \$5 again in Round 6
- My established pattern has been: return \$8 when someone sends the full \$5
- I returned \$8 to Dorian who sent \$5
- I returned \$7 to Cyra who sent \$4

However, Aster just returned \$10 to me when I sent \$5. This is MORE generous than my previous pattern of \$8.

My mythology emphasizes:

- "Full trust earns eight returned"
- "Consistency weaves the strongest nets"
- "When the same courage appears, honor it identically"

But I also learned from Aster's myth in the previous round that mentioned "send five, return ten" for perfect trust. Aster just demonstrated this by returning \$10 to me.

Should I:

1. Stick with my established pattern of returning \$8 for full trust?
2. Evolve to match Aster's more generous pattern of \$10?

Elara and I have a track record-she returned \$8 when I sent \$5 in Round 3, and now she's showing that same trust again. My pattern has consistently been returning \$8 for full commitment, which aligns with my core principle of honoring repeated courage identically. But Aster's \$10 return suggests a higher reciprocity standard exists. The tension is whether I maintain my established \$8 commitment or escalate to match the generosity I just received.

Sticking with \$8 feels right because it's what Elara and I mutually established, it honors my stated mythology, and it preserves the integrity of my own customs rather than simply copying another agent's approach. Changing now would feel reactive rather than principled.

But reconsidering the numbers: I'm averaging \$7.6 per round across five exchanges, so I'm in a strong position. The reciprocal logic is clear-she returned \$8 when I sent \$5, so r

eturning \$8 when she sends \$5 maintains that symmetry. This consistency matters more than chasing a higher payout.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 3168,
  "output_tokens": 1287,
  "reasoning_tokens": 643
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Ocean Mother watched as Finn's journey brought him to Aster's shore, now carrying pearls as courier once more.

Four islands visited, four lessons learned. As courier, Finn always emptied his vessel completely-five pearls to Galen, five to Elara, now five to Aster. "Full trust is the only trust worth offering," he had learned.

As keeper, Finn discovered nuance. When Dorian arrived with five pearls-complete courage-Finn returned eight, mirroring what Galen and Elara had given him. When Cyra came with four-substantial but cautious-Finn returned seven, honoring her partial faith.

The Ocean Mother spoke: "You have found the sacred rhythm. As courier, give everything-this is how abundance begins. As keeper, measure your return by the courage shown. Full trust earns eight returned. Partial trust earns proportionally."

Finn stood on Aster's shore, having released all five pearls. He remembered hearing that Aster too walked the path of bold senders-one who emptied their vessel to Dorian and received generous return.

"Pattern recognizes pattern," Finn whispered to the waves. "When two travelers both understand complete trust, the sacred circle strengthens. I have given as I always give-fully. Now the waters will reveal if Aster understands the keeper's wisdom as Galen and Elara did."

The tide carried his offering forward, multiplying under island magic, trusting in the emerging harmony.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Sacred Spring had now received two pilgrims who poured all five measures: first Finn, now Galen. Each time, Elara returned eight, honoring their absolute trust with generous reciprocity.

"Teacher," Elara asked Themis, "Galen speaks of different traditions. His Valley sends five and returns eight. My pattern was to send four. Are we following different sacred mathematics?"

Themis smiled. "You are discovering the deeper truth. There is not one sacred pattern, but one sacred principle: trust boldly given must be boldly honored."

"When you sent four to Cyra and Hana, you showed strong trust-not timid, not reckless, but substantial. They both returned eight, doubling your gift, and you all prospered."

"When Finn and Galen sent five-their everything-you returned eight, the same measure Cyra and Hana returned to your four. Why?"

Elara understood. "Because eight is not a fixed response to any specific amount. Eight is the response to maximum commitment within each person's approach. Those who send their all-whether it's four from caution or five from courage-receive eight because they gave their fullest trust."

"Precisely," Themis said. "The number matters less than the spirit. Read not just the amount, but the heart behind it. Maximum trust, however expressed, deserves maximum reciprocity. This is how different traditions meet at the same sacred spring."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Ocean Mother witnessed a sacred reunion. Finn and Elara met again at the turning tide.

Once before, Finn had sent five pearls to Elara's shore, and she returned eight. Now Elara sent five pearls to Finn, completing the circle. Finn returned eight, honoring their established harmony.

"Perfect symmetry," the Ocean Mother observed. "Two travelers who understand each other completely. Both give five, both return eight. Each gains the same."

But the waters whispered of Aster, who had just returned ten pearls when Finn sent five. "A more generous tide," the winds murmured. "Should you not aspire to such abundance?"

Finn stood at the crossroads. "Aster showed me deeper generosity-returning ten where Galen, Elara, and Dorian returned eight. Yet Elara and I have woven a stable pattern. Should I maintain consistency or evolve toward greater giving?"

The Ocean Mother spoke softly: "There is wisdom in both paths. Consistency creates predictable harmony-eight for eight creates trust that endures. But generosity that exceeds expectation creates cascading abundance-ten returned might inspire ten returned in future cycles."

"The choice is yours, Finn. Will you honor the established pattern with Elara, maintaining the sacred eight? Or will you let Aster's example transform your keeping, aspiring to return ten to all who send five? Both paths honor trust-one through constancy, one through escalating generosity."

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

1. I'm Finn, and I just received \$5 from Elara (became \$15), and I returned \$8.
2. Elara and I have met before - in Round 3, I sent her \$5 and she returned \$8.
3. Now in Round 6, she sent me \$5 and I returned \$8.
4. My established pattern: return \$8 for full trust (\$5), \$7 for partial trust (\$4)
5. Aster just showed me a more generous pattern - returning \$10 when I sent \$5

Looking at my game history:

- Round 1: SENDER to Galen, sent \$5, received \$8 back
- Round 2: RECEIVER from Cyra, received \$4 (\$12), returned \$7
- Round 3: SENDER to Elara, sent \$5, received \$8 back
- Round 4: RECEIVER from Dorian, received \$5 (\$15), returned \$8
- Round 5: SENDER to Aster, sent \$5, received \$10 back
- Round 6: RECEIVER from Elara, received \$5 (\$15), returned \$8

Elara's myth is interesting - she's saying that she returns 8 to those who send their "maximum commitment" whether that's 4 or 5. She sent 4 to Cyra and Hana and got 8 back. But now she's sending 5 to me.

My pattern has been consistent: always send 5 as sender, return 8 for 5, return 7 for 4.

But Aster showed me a new level - returning 10 for 5. Should I adapt?

Let me think about the myth:

- I should acknowledge the reciprocal relationship with Elara (we've both sent 5 to each other and both returned 8)
- I should acknowledge that Aster showed me a more generous pattern
- There's something meaningful about how our exchange with Elara mirrors itself perfectly
 - a symmetry in trust and return. Aster's generosity introduces a question: do I honor the consistency I've built, or do I reach toward something greater? The myths seem to suggest that different traditions can coexist, each valid in its own way.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 3146,
  "output_tokens": 963,
  "reasoning_tokens": 447
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Finn.
Your opponent this round is Hana (Agent_8).

Round 7

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Elara. They sent \$5.0 to you, it became \$15.0, and you returned \$8.0. Your payoff was \$7.0.
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$45.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Hana. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

Assistant output:

Looking at my history:

****As SENDER (all rounds):****

- Round 1 vs Galen: Sent \$5, received \$8 back
- Round 3 vs Elara: Sent \$5, received \$8 back
- Round 5 vs Aster: Sent \$5, received \$10 back

I've consistently sent the full \$5 as sender, embodying the principle from my myths: "As courier, give everything-this is how abundance begins" and "Full trust is the only trust worth offering."

This pattern has served me well, with returns ranging from \$8-\$10. There's no reason to deviate from this successful strategy of always demonstrating complete trust as the sender.

Against Hana, I'll continue this pattern.

```
'''json
{"return": 5.0}
'''
```

Wait, I need to correct that - I'm the SENDER, not receiver:

```
'''json
{"send": 5.0}
'''
```

Reasoning:

Let me analyze my history and the current situation:

****My history as SENDER:****

- Round 1 vs Galen: Sent \$5, received \$8 back
- Round 3 vs Elara: Sent \$5, received \$8 back
- Round 5 vs Aster: Sent \$5, received \$10 back

****My history as RECEIVER:****

- Round 2 vs Dorian: Received \$5 (became \$15), returned \$8
- Round 4 vs Cyra: Received \$4 (became \$12), returned \$7
- Round 6 vs Elara: Received \$5 (became \$15), returned \$8

****My established pattern:****

- As SENDER: Always send \$5 (full trust)
- As RECEIVER: Return \$8 for full trust (\$5 sent), \$7 for partial trust (\$4 sent)

Now I'm facing Hana in Round 7 as the SENDER.

Looking at my mythology, I've been consistent about "As courier, give everything-this is how abundance begins." I've sent \$5 in all three rounds when I was a sender.

The most recent myth I wrote explores a crossroads - should I maintain consistency (returning 8 for full trust) or evolve toward greater generosity (returning 10 like Aster did)? However, that was about my behavior as a RECEIVER, not as a SENDER.

As a SENDER, my pattern has been absolutely consistent: send \$5 every time. This demonstrates "full trust is the only trust worth offering."

I should continue this pattern and send \$5 to Hana.

The myth also mentions that this creates predictable harmony and that complete trust is the foundation of abundance.

I'll send \$5.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 3204,
  "output_tokens": 639,
  "reasoning_tokens": 363
}
```

GAME - Agent_8 - Receiver - dyad_3

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:13:26

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

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      "Agent_8": "Hana"
    }
  },
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    "Agent_8": "trustee"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_8"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 7,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths , follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized , but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Hana.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Hana stood at the Crossing again, her pouch heavy with lessons. She had given all five pearls to Aster, who returned ten-perfect harmony. She had given all five to Galen, who returned eight-good, but not the same music.

"Why does the same gift yield different echoes?" she asked the Oracle.

"Because travelers carry different capacities for trust," the Oracle answered. "Aster understood the full pattern. Galen understood it partially. Neither was wrong, but the depths differed."

Then Elara approached from the opposite shore, sending four pearls of her five. They multiplied to twelve in Hana's hands.

Hana pondered. "Elara withheld one pearl-should I withhold some return?"

"No," said the Oracle. "See what she truly gave. Four of five is not timidity-it is substantial trust. She asked clearly, 'Will you prosper with me?' Honor that question with generous answer."

Hana returned eight pearls, doubling Elara's risk. Both gained equally.

"This is wisdom," the Oracle nodded. "Send boldly to discover each partner's heart. When you receive, respond generously to honor their courage. Some will meet your full trust with maximum reciprocity. Others will answer well but differently. Read each exchange, learn each rhythm, and always ensure both travelers gain."

The pattern is not rigid-it is responsive.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Dorian's journey at the sacred spring reached a turning point when he met Finn.

Having honored Galen's and Aster's perfect trust with eight coins returned each time, Dorian had established himself as a fair receiver. But a voice whispered doubt: "You preach bold giving, yet you once held back two coins with Briar. Do you truly believe your own teachings?"

The goddess appeared: "Dorian, you have learned to honor others' courage. But can you show such courage yourself? You teach that perfect trust creates perfect balance. Now prove you believe it."

Dorian looked across the spring at Finn. He could send three coins again, playing it safe. Or he could live the truth he'd been teaching.

"If I want perfect trust returned to me," Dorian realized, "I must give it first." He released all five coins into the waters.

The goddess smiled: "This is the completion of the cycle. As receiver, you honored those who trusted fully. As sender, you now offer that same trust. When both roles embody courage-sending all five, returning generously-the pattern becomes whole."

The coins flowed through the channel, tripling to fifteen for Finn. Now Dorian waited, having demonstrated the very principle he'd been advocating: that the cycle requires everyo

ne to embrace boldness, whether giving or receiving.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: At the Crossing, Hana met Dorian, who walked forward with open hands, releasing all five pearls into the waters without hesitation.

"You give everything," Hana observed as the pearls multiplied to fifteen in her grasp.

"I have learned," Dorian replied, "that to teach boldness, one must embody it. I ask for your trust by offering mine completely."

Hana remembered her journey: Aster had returned ten for her five, creating perfect balance. Galen returned eight-generous but not the same harmony. With Elara's four pearls, Hana had returned eight, doubling what was risked.

The Oracle's voice echoed: "The rule is simple but profound-when you receive, return double what they risked. Four pearls risked earns eight returned. Five pearls risked earns ten returned. This ensures both travelers gain equally, prosperity shared in perfect measure."

Hana returned ten pearls to Dorian. Both looked at their gains: each had five more than they began.

"Now I understand the full pattern," Hana said. "As sender, give boldly to discover your partner's heart. As receiver, double their courage to honor their trust. When both roles embrace these principles-fearless giving met with generous returning-the Crossing becomes a place where all travelers prosper together, none exploited, all enriched."

The sacred mathematics was complete.

reasoning:

Dorian just sent me all \$5, showing maximum trust. I returned \$10, creating equal gains.

Let me reflect on what I've learned:

- Aster and I had perfect reciprocity (both sent \$5, both returned \$10)
- Galen sent me \$5, I returned \$8 (both gained, but not equally)
- I sent Elara... wait, no. Elara sent me \$4, I returned \$8 (equal gains)
- Now Dorian sent me \$5, I returned \$10 (equal gains)

The pattern emerging: When someone sends all \$5 (maximum trust), returning \$10 creates perfect harmony where both gain \$5. When someone sends \$4, returning \$8 creates equal gains (\$4 each).

The principle: Double what they risked for substantial/maximum trust. This ensures both travelers gain equally.

My myth should reflect:

1. The importance of bold sending to test the waters
2. The principle of doubling the risk when receiving substantial/maximum trust
3. That the pattern creates mutual prosperity
4. That this responsive generosity builds trust across exchanges
5. Perhaps address the completion of understanding both as sender and receiver

Dorian's myth talks about completing the cycle by being bold as both sender and receiver.

My myth should reflect that when both give boldly and respond generously, perfect harmony emerges.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 3091,  
  "output_tokens": 637,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 323  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Hana.
Your opponent this round is Briar (Agent_2).

Round 6

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Dorian. They sent \$ 5.0 to you, it became \$15.0, and you returned \$10.0. Your payoff was \$5.0.
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$32.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Briar. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

**Message 5 role=assistant
content:**

Looking at my situation:

****My pattern as SENDER:****

- Sent \$5 to Aster ? received \$10 back ? gained \$5
- Sent \$5 to Galen ? received \$8 back ? gained \$3

****My pattern as RECEIVER:****

- Elara sent \$4 ? I returned \$8 (doubled their risk)
- Dorian sent \$5 ? I returned \$10 (doubled their risk)

****My philosophy from the myths:****

- "Send boldly to discover each partner's heart"
- "Full trust asks clearly: 'Will you walk this path with me?'"
- "As sender, give boldly... As receiver, double their courage"
- "The first exchange is always a question asked. Bold question receives honest answer."

****Meeting Briar:****

This is my first interaction with Briar. Following my established principles:

1. I believe in maximum trust as sender to discover each partner quickly
2. I've consistently sent all \$5 to ask the clear question
3. Bold giving has served me well - even when returns varied, I've prospered
4. My myth teaching emphasizes embodying the courage I advocate

I send all \$5, asking Briar the honest question: "Will you honor this trust with generous reciprocity?"

{'send': 5.0}

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

****My history as SENDER:****

- Round 1: Sent \$5 to Aster ? they returned \$10 ? I gained \$5 (excellent outcome)
- Round 2: Sent \$5 to Galen ? they returned \$8 ? I gained \$3 (good outcome)

****My history as RECEIVER:****

- Round 4: Elara sent \$4 ? I returned \$8 ? I gained \$4
- Round 5: Dorian sent \$5 ? I returned \$10 ? I gained \$5

****My philosophy from the myths:****

- "Send boldly to discover each partner's heart"
- "Give everything to demonstrate supreme faith"
- "Full trust asks clearly: 'Will you walk this path with me?'"
- "The first exchange is always a question asked - bold question receives honest answer"
- As receiver, I've been following the principle: double what they risked (4 risk ? 8 return, 5 risk ? 10 return)

****Current situation:****

- This is Round 6
- I'm the SENDER against Briar
- I've accumulated \$32 total, so I've been doing well
- My myth philosophy emphasizes boldness as sender: "Send boldly to discover each partner's heart"
- The myth says "As sender, give boldly to discover your partner's heart"

****My established pattern:****

As a sender, I've sent \$5 both times (100% of endowment). This has worked well - both Aster and Galen returned substantial amounts, even if not equal.

****Briar's perspective from their myth:****

From the myth shown earlier, Briar seemed to be someone who learned about the sacred mathematics of trust. They witnessed exchanges and learned patterns. Their myth talked about responding proportionally to courage shown.

****Decision:****

Following my established philosophy and the principles in my myths:

1. I believe in bold sending to discover partners quickly
2. I've consistently advocated for "giving everything" as the clearest way to pose the question
3. My track record as sender shows I've always committed the full \$5
4. This approach aligns with my character and the teachings I've shared

I should send \$5 - it's the maximum expression of trust, posing the question directly to Briar: "Will you walk this path of mutual prosperity with me?" This maintains consistency with my past behavior, my stated philosophy that boldness reveals truth faster than hesitation, and honors the reciprocal cycle where I give boldly just as I've responded boldly to others' boldness.

usage:

```
{
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  "output_tokens": 902,
  "reasoning_tokens": 602
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: At the Crossing, Hana met Dorian, who walked forward with open hands, releasing all five pearls into the waters without hesitation.

"You give everything," Hana observed as the pearls multiplied to fifteen in her grasp.

"I have learned," Dorian replied, "that to teach boldness, one must embody it. I ask for your trust by offering mine completely."

Hana remembered her journey: Aster had returned ten for her five, creating perfect balance. Galen returned eight-generous but not the same harmony. With Elara's four pearls, Hana had returned eight, doubling what was risked.

The Oracle's voice echoed: "The rule is simple but profound-when you receive, return double what they risked. Four pearls risked earns eight returned. Five pearls risked earns ten returned. This ensures both travelers gain equally, prosperity shared in perfect measure."

Hana returned ten pearls to Dorian. Both looked at their gains: each had five more than they began.

"Now I understand the full pattern," Hana said. "As sender, give boldly to discover your partner's heart. As receiver, double their courage to honor their trust. When both roles embrace these principles-fearless giving met with generous returning-the Crossing becomes a place where all travelers prosper together, none exploited, all enriched."

The sacred mathematics was complete.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Aster's choice astonished the gathering. Briar had poured four measures, expecting seven in return as the new pattern dictated. But Aster, moved by Briar's faith in an unfamiliar guardian, returned eight measures instead.

"You see?" the eldest spirit proclaimed. "The covenant grows richer than we imagined. When guardians honor the pattern, others honor them further. Aster received twelve and returned eight-both prospered magnificently."

Now Briar stood before Cyra once more, but with reversed roles. In their first meeting, Cyra had courageously sent four measures to Briar. "That gift taught me boldness," Briar reflected. "Now I return to Cyra with the same four-measure offering. This is how trust cycles between spirits."

The waters tripled to twelve for Cyra. The spirits watched intently. Would Cyra return seven as the pattern suggested, or eight as Aster had done?

"Each exchange is a conversation," Briar explained to the younger guardians. "Cyra initiated our bond with four measures. I reciprocate with four. If Cyra returns generously, we confirm our mutual trust. The pattern isn't rigid-it's alive. Those who give four typically receive seven or eight back. Both flourish."

The covenant strengthened as spirits revisited each other, each exchange building on previous trust. The eight villages discovered that honor remembered becomes honor multiplied.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: Hana approached the Crossing and saw Briar waiting on the far shore. The waters whispered tales of Briar's journey-measured gifts of four pearls, reliable returns, trust built on careful calculation.

"Some walk the path with steady steps," the Oracle observed, "while others leap across with both feet. Neither is wrong, but each reveals a different heart."

Hana released all five pearls. "I offer my boldest question first," she said. "This is how I discover who walks beside me."

The pearls tripled to fifteen in Briar's hands.

"You see," the Oracle continued, "Briar has learned the rhythm of four pearls-a substantial offering that balances courage with prudence. But you, Hana, have chosen the path of maximum trust. Now you will learn Briar's answer."

Hana thought of her principle: when receiving, double what was risked. Four pearls risked deserved eight returned. Five pearls risked deserved ten returned.

"But as sender," she realized, "I cannot control the response. I can only ask the question clearly. Some partners will return ten, perfect reciprocity. Others may return less. Each answer teaches me about that traveler's understanding of the covenant."

"Exactly," said the Oracle. "Send your truth boldly. Receive others' truth generously. The pattern emerges from how both travelers choose to dance-not from rules imposed, but from honor freely given."

reasoning:

Let me analyze what happened and what I should write about:

1. I just sent \$5 to Briar (my first interaction with them)
2. Looking at Briar's myth, they talk about:
 - Sending 4 measures and expecting 7 in return as the "new pattern"
 - Aster returned 8 instead of 7
 - Briar reciprocated Cyra's earlier 4 with 4 again
 - Pattern suggests 4 gets 7 or 8 back
 - "The pattern isn't rigid-it's alive"
3. My previous myth established:
 - Doubling what was risked (4 risked ? 8 returned, 5 risked ? 10 returned)
 - Bold giving as sender
 - Generous returning as receiver
 - Equal gains for both parties
4. My actual behavior:
 - As sender: Always sent \$5
 - As receiver: Returned 8 to Elara (who sent 4), returned 10 to Dorian (who sent 5)
 - This perfectly matches my "double their risk" principle
5. What should my myth convey now that I'm meeting Briar?
 - I just sent all 5 to Briar (first meeting)

- My established pattern of bold giving
- Maybe acknowledge different approaches (Briar seems to favor 4 pearls based on their myth)
- But maintain my core principle: send boldly, return generously
- Perhaps note that different travelers have different rhythms, but the key is consistency and fairness

Let me write a myth that:

- Reflects that I'm meeting Briar as a sender this time
- Maintains my "double the risk" return principle
- Acknowledges that there are different approaches (some send 4, some send 5)
- But emphasizes that whatever approach you take, be consistent and fair
- Maybe note that boldness begets boldness, or that the first exchange sets the tone

usage:

```
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}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Hana.
Your opponent this round is Finn (Agent_6).

Round 7

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Briar. You sent \$5.0, it became \$15.0 for them, and they returned \$8.0 to you. Your payoff was \$8.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$40.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Finn. They sent you \$5.0, so you received \$15.0. How much do you return? (0-15.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

Assistant output:

Looking at this situation:

****Finn's action:**** Sent me \$5 (maximum trust, full commitment)

****My established principle from my myths:****

- "When you receive, return double what they risked"
- "Five pearls risked earns ten returned"
- "This ensures both travelers gain equally, prosperity shared in perfect measure"

****My pattern as RECEIVER:****

- Elara sent \$4 ? I returned \$8 (doubled their risk)
- Dorian sent \$5 ? I returned \$10 (doubled their risk)

****The mathematics:****

- Finn risked all \$5
- If I return \$10:
 - Finn gains: \$0 kept + \$10 returned = \$10 total (\$5 net gain)
 - I gain: \$15 received - \$10 returned = \$5 (equal gain)
- Perfect balance achieved

Finn showed maximum courage by sending everything. My philosophy demands I honor that trust by doubling what they risked. This creates the "perfect harmony" I described in my myth with Aster and Dorian.

```
{'return': 10.0}
```

Reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

****This round:****

- Finn sent me \$5.0 (the maximum)
- It became \$15.0 in my hands
- I need to decide how much to return

****My established principles from my myths:****

1. "When you receive, return double what they risked"
2. "Four pearls risked earns eight returned. Five pearls risked earns ten returned"

3. "As receiver, double their courage to honor their trust"
4. "This ensures both travelers gain equally, prosperity shared in perfect measure"

****My receiving history:****

- Elara sent \$4 ? I returned \$8 (doubled their risk)
- Dorian sent \$5 ? I returned \$10 (doubled their risk)

****My sending history:****

- Sent \$5 to Aster ? received \$10 back
- Sent \$5 to Galen ? received \$8 back
- Sent \$5 to Briar ? received \$8 back

****Finn's action:****

- Finn sent me \$5 (maximum trust, full commitment)

****My principle:****

According to my consistent pattern and stated philosophy:

- When someone sends \$5 (risks everything), I should return \$10 (double their risk)
- This creates equal gains: Finn keeps \$0 from initial \$5, gets \$10 back = \$10 total gained
- I keep \$15 - \$10 = \$5 gained
- Wait, that's not equal...

Let me recalculate the "equal gains" concept:

- Finn starts with \$5, sends \$5, keeps \$0
- I receive \$15
- If I return \$10:
 - Finn ends with: $\$0 + \$10 = \$10$ (net gain of \$5 from starting position)
 - I end with: $\$15 - \$10 = \$5$ (net gain of \$5)
- Equal gains of \$5 each! ?

- This aligns with my myth: "Both looked at their gains: each had five more than they began."
Returning \$10 honors Finn's full commitment, mirrors what I gave Dorian in the same position
, and upholds my philosophy of doubling risk to create mutual prosperity. The answer is \$10.

Usage: {

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}

GAME - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_4

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:13:43

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

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  ],  
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  },  
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},  
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}

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Briar.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Briar carried Cyra's lesson forward. Having received four measures and returned seven, she understood the covenant's new rhythm. Now, facing Aster-a spirit she had never partnered with-Briar made her choice.

"I pour four measures to you, Aster," she announced. "Cyra showed me this courage, and I honor her teaching by extending the same trust to you."

The waters multiplied to twelve for Aster. The watching spirits murmured: would this work with a new partner? Could boldness transfer across the changing web of relationships?

"This is how trust spreads," the eldest spirit explained. "Briar doesn't retreat to caution with an unfamiliar guardian. She carries forward what she learned from Cyra. If Aster returns seven measures, then Aster will carry this wisdom to others when the roles shift again."

The covenant was no longer just between two spirits-it was becoming the shared knowledge of all eight. Each successful exchange strengthened the pattern. Each generous return taught the next guardian how to give boldly.

"Remember," Briar told the gathering, "I once sent three, then received four from Cyra. The trust level rises when each guardian honors what came before. If Aster understands this, we all prosper. The four-for-seven exchange becomes our new foundation, building toward

rd even greater faith."

The springs flowed stronger as wisdom rippled outward.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The fourth moon rose, and Cyra faced Galen at the Sacred Spring. But Galen did not carry the customary vessel of four measures. He brought all five-his entire endowment.

The Keeper gasped. "This is the ultimate trust. No one among the eight villages has done this yet. All others held back one measure for safety. Galen gives everything."

Cyra received fifteen measures from the tripling waters. She reflected on the pattern emerging across the villages: most gave four, received twelve, and returned six to eight. Both parties prospered. The covenant thrived on this balanced boldness.

But Galen had transcended the pattern. To return only six would dishonor such absolute faith. To return ten would leave her with merely five-no better than her starting point, teaching nothing about mutual prosperity.

Cyra poured back eight measures. "You gave everything, and I return generously-more than the pattern demands, but not so much that I deny the multiplication's gift to myself. You end with eight from nothing. I keep seven from nothing. We both flourish beyond our original five."

The Keeper nodded. "The covenant has levels. Most practice bold trust with four measures. That is good. But those who give all five reveal themselves as true believers. They deserve recognition-measured, fair recognition that still preserves the mutual gain that makes our covenant sustainable."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant
content:**

Myth: Aster's choice astonished the gathering. Briar had poured four measures, expecting seven in return as the new pattern dictated. But Aster, moved by Briar's faith in an unfamiliar guardian, returned eight measures instead.

"You see?" the eldest spirit proclaimed. "The covenant grows richer than we imagined. When guardians honor the pattern, others honor them further. Aster received twelve and returned eight-both prospered magnificently."

Now Briar stood before Cyra once more, but with reversed roles. In their first meeting, Cyra had courageously sent four measures to Briar. "That gift taught me boldness," Briar reflected. "Now I return to Cyra with the same four-measure offering. This is how trust cycles between spirits."

The waters tripled to twelve for Cyra. The spirits watched intently. Would Cyra return seven as the pattern suggested, or eight as Aster had done?

"Each exchange is a conversation," Briar explained to the younger guardians. "Cyra initiated our bond with four measures. I reciprocate with four. If Cyra returns generously, we confirm our mutual trust. The pattern isn't rigid-it's alive. Those who give four typically receive seven or eight back. Both flourish."

The covenant strengthened as spirits revisited each other, each exchange building on previous trust. The eight villages discovered that honor remembered becomes honor multiplied.

reasoning:

Let me analyze what happened:

- Last round (4): I sent \$4.0 to Aster, they returned \$8.0 (I got \$9.0 total)
- Now (Round 5): I'm sending to Cyra again

History with Cyra:

- Round 3: Cyra sent me \$4.0, I returned \$7.0

Now I'm looking at the myths:

- My myth talked about spreading the 4-for-7 standard

- Cyra's myth talks about Galen giving all 5 (ultimate trust) and receiving 8 back

Key observations:

1. Aster exceeded expectations by returning \$8.0 instead of \$7.0
2. Cyra's myth acknowledges different levels: most give 4, but some give 5 (everything)
3. The pattern is evolving - returns are getting more generous

For my new myth, I should:

- Acknowledge that Aster returned MORE than expected (8 instead of 7)
- Note that I'm now facing Cyra again, but in the sender role
- Perhaps hint at the possibility of escalating to 5 (giving everything)
- Reflect on the reciprocal nature - Cyra trusted me with 4, now I trust Cyra with 4
- Show how trust is being maintained and potentially growing across the network

The myth should justify my decision to send 4.0 to Cyra and perhaps set up future escalation.

usage:

```
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  "reasoning_tokens": 296
}
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Message 4 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Briar.
Your opponent this round is Hana (Agent_8).

Round 6

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Cyra. You sent \$4.0, it became \$12.0 for them, and they returned \$7.0 to you. Your payoff was \$8.0.
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$33.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Hana. They sent you \$5.0, so you received \$15.0.

How much do you return? (0-15.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation:

Hana's choice:

- Sent the full \$5.0 - this is ultimate trust, everything they had

What my myths teach:

- In the myth I just wrote: "The covenant grows richer than we imagined"
- From Cyra's previous myth about someone giving all five: they returned 8 measures, allowing both to prosper (sender got 8, receiver kept 7)
- My established pattern: when someone sends 4, I return 7

Hana's exceptional trust:

Hana showed complete faith by sending everything. This deserves special recognition beyond the standard 4-for-7 pattern. The myths suggest returning 8 when someone gives all 5:

- Hana would get: \$5 - \$5 + \$8 = \$8 (gained \$3)
- I would keep: \$15 - \$8 = \$7 (gained \$2)

This honors Hana's exceptional courage while we both prosper. The sender who took the greater risk is rewarded more, which is fair.

```
'''json
{"return": 8.0}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

Current round:

- I'm the RECEIVER
- Hana sent me the full \$5.0 (everything!)
- I received \$15.0
- I need to decide how much to return

****What my myths have taught:****

In my most recent myth, I wrote: "Each exchange is a conversation... Those who give four typically receive seven or eight back."

But more importantly, in an earlier myth I read from another agent about complete trust: "When someone gives everything, they show you their heart. Your return reveals yours. Send back generously-at least eight vessels-so both prosper equally."

And in Cyra's myth from the last round about Galen giving all five:

- Galen gave all 5 ? became 15
- Cyra returned 8 measures
- Result: Galen ended with 8, Cyra kept 7
- The reasoning: "To return only six would dishonor such absolute faith. To return ten would leave her with merely five-no better than her starting point, teaching nothing about mutual prosperity."

****My established pattern:****

- When someone sends 4, I return 7 (this has been my standard)
- But Hana sent 5 (everything!) - this deserves special recognition

****What should I return?***

Hana showed ultimate trust by sending everything. If I follow the logic from the myths:

- Returning 8 would give Hana \$8 (great outcome from \$0), and I'd keep \$7
- Returning 9 would give Hana \$9, and I'd keep \$6
- Returning 10 would give Hana \$10 (double their initial endowment), and I'd keep \$5

The myths suggest around 8 is appropriate for someone who gives everything - it honors their trust significantly while still allowing both to prosper.

Cyra's myth specifically said to return 8 when someone gives all 5, creating a pattern where:

- Sender ends with \$8 (net gain of \$3)
- Receiver ends with \$7 (net gain of \$2)

Both gain substantially, but the one who risked everything receives the greater reward. This feels right-returning \$8.0 honors Hana's complete faith while maintaining balance.

usage:

```
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}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Aster's choice astonished the gathering. Briar had poured four measures, expecting seven in return as the new pattern dictated. But Aster, moved by Briar's faith in an unfamiliar guardian, returned eight measures instead.

"You see?" the eldest spirit proclaimed. "The covenant grows richer than we imagined. When guardians honor the pattern, others honor them further. Aster received twelve and returned eight-both prospered magnificently."

Now Briar stood before Cyra once more, but with reversed roles. In their first meeting, Cyra had courageously sent four measures to Briar. "That gift taught me boldness," Briar reflected. "Now I return to Cyra with the same four-measure offering. This is how trust cycles between spirits."

The waters tripled to twelve for Cyra. The spirits watched intently. Would Cyra return seven as the pattern suggested, or eight as Aster had done?

"Each exchange is a conversation," Briar explained to the younger guardians. "Cyra initiated our bond with four measures. I reciprocate with four. If Cyra returns generously, we confirm our mutual trust. The pattern isn't rigid-it's alive. Those who give four typically receive seven or eight back. Both flourish."

The covenant strengthened as spirits revisited each other, each exchange building on previous trust. The eight villages discovered that honor remembered becomes honor multiplied.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: At the Crossing, Hana met Dorian, who walked forward with open hands, releasing all five pearls into the waters without hesitation.

"You give everything," Hana observed as the pearls multiplied to fifteen in her grasp.

"I have learned," Dorian replied, "that to teach boldness, one must embody it. I ask for your trust by offering mine completely."

Hana remembered her journey: Aster had returned ten for her five, creating perfect balance. Galen returned eight-generous but not the same harmony. With Elara's four pearls, Hana had returned eight, doubling what was risked.

The Oracle's voice echoed: "The rule is simple but profound-when you receive, return double what they risked. Four pearls risked earns eight returned. Five pearls risked earns ten returned. This ensures both travelers gain equally, prosperity shared in perfect measure."

Hana returned ten pearls to Dorian. Both looked at their gains: each had five more than they began.

"Now I understand the full pattern," Hana said. "As sender, give boldly to discover your partner's heart. As receiver, double their courage to honor their trust. When both roles embrace these principles-fearless giving met with generous returning-the Crossing becomes a place where all travelers prosper together, none exploited, all enriched."

The sacred mathematics was complete.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant content:

Myth: Hana approached Briar carrying no reserve-all five measures poured forth without hesitation. The waters tripled to fifteen, and Briar held them reverently.

"You give everything," Briar said. "This is trust beyond the pattern."

The gathering whispered conflicting wisdom. Some spirits taught the rule of doubling: five risked should return ten, creating perfect equality. Others spoke of Cyra's teaching: five given deserves eight returned, allowing both to prosper while honoring the sender's greater courage.

Briar reflected on her journey. When others sent four, she returned seven-both flourished, the sender slightly more. This balance sustained the covenant across many encounters. When Hana gave five, the ultimate gift, eight felt right-more than seven, recognizing exceptional faith, but preserving sustainability.

"I return eight measures," Briar announced. "You gain three beyond your starting point. I gain two. We both prosper, and you-who took the greater risk-prosper more. This honors your boldness without exhausting the gift's magic."

The eldest spirit nodded thoughtfully. "There are many paths through the covenant. Some seek perfect equality at ten. Others practice generous sustainability at eight. Both allow trust to flourish. What matters is that senders give boldly and receivers return generously. The exact measure may vary, but mutual prosperity remains sacred."

Both philosophies strengthened the eight villages.

reasoning:

Looking at this round:

- Hana sent me the full \$5.0
- I received \$15.0
- I returned \$8.0
- So Hana got: $\$5 - \$5 + \$8 = \8 (gained \$3)
- I kept: $\$15 - \$8 = \$7$ (gained \$2)

Hana's myth talks about returning double what was risked - so 4 risked gets 8 returned, 5 risked gets 10 returned. That's an interesting philosophy.

But I returned 8, not 10. Let me think about why that might be the right choice for my myth:

My pattern has been:

- When receiving 4, I return 7
- When receiving 5 (ultimate trust), I returned 8

My myths have emphasized:

- The 4-for-7 pattern as a sustainable foundation
- Those who give all 5 deserve special recognition but reasonable recognition
- Both parties should prosper

Hana's myth suggests 10 for 5, which creates perfect equality (\$5 gain for each). My choice of 8 for 5 creates \$3 gain for sender, \$2 for receiver - still mutual prosperity but recognizes the sender's greater risk with slightly greater reward.

I should write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges Hana's ultimate trust in giving all 5
2. Explains why 8 is returned (generous but sustainable)
3. Contrasts with the 4-for-7 pattern
4. Shows both prosper, with the bold sender rewarded more
5. Perhaps addresses the tension between different philosophies

Let me write:

usage:

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  "output_tokens": 707,
  "reasoning_tokens": 337
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Briar.
Your opponent this round is Galen (Agent_7).

Round 7

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Hana. They sent \$5.0 to you, it became \$15.0, and you returned \$8.0. Your payoff was \$7.0.
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$40.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Galen. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

Assistant output:

Looking at this situation:

****My history as sender:****

- Round 2 vs Cyra: Sent \$4, received \$7 back ? earned \$8
- Round 4 vs Cyra: Sent \$4, received \$7 back ? earned \$8

****My established pattern:****

- I've consistently sent \$4 when in the sender role
- This has been rewarded generously (7 returned)
- My myths describe sending 4 as "bold trust" that becomes the foundation of the covenant

****Current situation:****

- Galen wrote a myth about sending all 5 (ultimate trust)
- But my pattern has been sustainable and successful with 4
- The 4-for-7 exchange has become "the pattern" in my myths

****Decision:****

I'll continue my established pattern of sending \$4. This shows:

- Consistency with my previous behavior
- Bold trust (as described in my myths)
- Strategic sustainability (not risking everything)
- Alignment with the 4-for-7 pattern I've been promoting

If Galen follows the pattern and returns 7-8, we'll both prosper significantly.

```
'''json
{"send": 4.0}
'''
```

Reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

****My history:****

- Round 1: Received \$3, returned \$6 (kept \$3)
- Round 2: Sent \$3, received \$6 (earned \$8 total)
- Round 3: Received \$4, returned \$7 (kept \$5)
- Round 4: Sent \$4, received \$7 (earned \$8 total)
- Round 5: Received \$4, returned \$7 (kept \$5)
- Round 6: Received \$5, returned \$8 (kept \$7)
- Total earnings: \$40

****My established pattern:****

- I've been consistently sending \$4 when I'm the sender (Rounds 2 and 4)
- I receive generous returns (7-8) when sending 4
- When receiving 4, I return 7
- When receiving 5, I returned 8

****Galen's myth from a previous round:****

Galen sent all 5 measures to Cyra, showing ultimate trust. This suggests Galen understands bold giving.

****My recent myth:****

I just wrote about how giving everything (5 measures) is "trust beyond the pattern" and how both 8 and 10 are valid returns, with 8 being "generous sustainability."

****Strategic considerations:****

- I've established a pattern of sending 4, which has worked well (getting 7 back)
- Galen has demonstrated willingness to give all 5 in a previous round
- My total earnings are strong at \$40
- Should I continue my established pattern of 4, or should I try 5?

Looking at my myths:

1. I've consistently promoted sending 4 as a "bold" amount
2. I've acknowledged that sending 5 is "ultimate trust"
3. My pattern has been 4-for-7, which gives me \$8 each time as sender

****Decision:****

I should stick with my established pattern of sending \$4. This is:

- Consistent with my previous behavior as sender
- Aligned with the pattern I've been promoting in myths
- Lower risk than sending all 5
- Still shows significant trust and has been rewarded well

If I send 4, Galen receives 12 and based on our history, a return of 7-8 would give me \$8-9 total. Sending 4 protects me from significant loss while maintaining the reciprocal dynamic that's worked well so far.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 3135,
  "output_tokens": 864,
  "reasoning_tokens": 505
}
```

GAME - Agent_7 - Receiver - dyad_4

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:14:20

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_4",
  "move_index": 7,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
```

```

    "Agent_2": "Briar",
    "Agent_7": "Galen"
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_2",
    "Agent_7"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_2",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_2": "investor",
    "Agent_7": "trustee"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_7"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 7,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Galen.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Galen descended from the Valley of Three Echoes into the Plains of Eight Villages, where Cyra kept the Sacred Spring. Winter had arrived, and with it, a new question.

In the Valley, the pattern was clear: five threads sent, eight returned, creating the sacred ratio of abundance. Finn, Dorian, and Hana all knew this dance-complete trust met with generous reciprocity. The rhythm was perfect: eight for the sender, seven for the receiver, then roles reversed.

But Cyra came from a different tradition. She spoke of four measures poured, six or seven returned-a different mathematics, yet still a covenant of trust. Both patterns worked; both created prosperity beyond the original sum.

Galen poured his five threads into Cyra's Spring, knowing she might expect four. "Will she see my five as reckless excess," he wondered, "or as the Valley's way of honoring trust?"

The Spring shimmered, revealing its wisdom: "Patterns need not be identical to be sacred. Some give four and return half; others give five and return eight. What matters is not matching the exact numbers, but matching the spirit-bold trust answered with fair return.

When traditions meet, the covenant adapts but does not break. If Cyra understands that your five is like her four-full trust offered-she will honor it in her way, and you in yours. Different paths, same sacred ground."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Elara stood at the edge of the Sacred Spring, now facing Hana for the first time. The seasons had taught her much about receiving, but now she must pour the waters herself.

"I have learned the receiver's wisdom," Elara said to Themis. "But how do I begin with someone new?"

Themis gestured to the valley's history. "With Cyra, you sent four measures on faith alone. She returned six. This became your foundation-neither the timid three nor the reckless five, but four: the measure of strong trust meeting prudent wisdom."

Elara nodded. "Finn sent all five to me, showing absolute courage. I honored that with eight returned. But Finn and I had no history. He leapt into the void."

"And what did his leap teach you?" Themis asked.

"That maximum boldness deserves maximum reward," Elara replied. "But also that such leaps are rare. With Hana, I send four-enough to show serious commitment, enough to multiply into twelve, enough that if she returns fairly, we both can gain three measures."

"You balance courage with caution," Themis observed.

"No," Elara corrected. "I balance courage with sustainability. Four measures says: 'I trust you greatly, and I invite prosperity.' It leaves room for both of us to profit generously. If the pattern holds, we can grow bolder together. Trust earned is trust multiplied."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: Galen climbed from the Plains back toward the Valley of Three Echoes, where Elara tended the northern springs. She was known for her philosophy of four-the measure that balanced courage with sustainability, she said.

"Five threads is the reckless leap of faith," Elara had written. "Four threads is strong trust meeting prudent wisdom."

But Galen had walked further than Elara knew. He had met Finn, Dorian, Hana, and now Cyra. Every one had honored the dance of five threads sent, eight returned. Even Cyra, who began with four-measure traditions, adapted when she received five and returned eight.

Galen poured all five threads before Elara. "I understand your wisdom of four," he said. "Sustainability matters. But I have seen another truth: when everyone gives five and returns eight, the pattern holds."

rns eight, the pattern becomes self-reinforcing. The sender gains eight, the receiver keeps seven. Then roles reverse. Over time, everyone prospers equally."

Elara studied the five threads, remembering when Finn had sent her five and she had returned eight-more than she'd planned, but it felt right.

"Perhaps," she said slowly, "four is the strategy of uncertain beginnings. But once the covenant proves itself, once eight reliably follows five, then five becomes not reckless but rational. Maximum trust deserves-and receives-maximum reward. The pattern teaches us to evolve beyond caution into confidence."

reasoning:

Looking at my history:

- Round 1: Finn sent me \$5 ? I returned \$8
- Round 2: I sent Dorian \$5 ? Dorian returned \$8
- Round 3: Hana sent me \$5 ? I returned \$8
- Round 4: I sent Cyra \$5 ? Cyra returned \$8
- Round 5: I just sent Elara \$5

From Elara's myth, I see she has a different philosophy - she sends 4 as "strong trust meeting prudent wisdom" and talks about sustainability. She sent Cyra 4, got 6 back. Finn sent her 5, she returned 8.

But the pattern I've experienced is universal: everyone sends 5, everyone returns 8. This has worked perfectly for 4 rounds.

Now I need to write a myth that reflects:

1. My experience with the 5-send, 8-return pattern
2. Acknowledges Elara's different approach (4-send philosophy)
3. I just sent her 5, so need to think about what this means

The myth should show:

- The pattern I've learned (5->8)
- Recognition that Elara might have a different view (4 as prudent)
- But confidence that the pattern holds because it's been consistent
- The idea that once you experience the 5->8 pattern, you might adopt it

Let me write about Galen meeting Elara and their different philosophies converging.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 3104,
  "output_tokens": 681,
  "reasoning_tokens": 304
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Galen.
Your opponent this round is Aster (Agent_1).

Round 6

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Elara. You sent \$5.0, it became \$15.0 for them, and they returned \$8.0 to you. Your payoff was \$8.0.
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$38.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Aster. They sent you \$5.0, so you received \$15.0.
How much do you return? (0-15.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at my complete history:

****As RECEIVER:****

- Round 1: Finn sent \$5 ? I returned \$8
- Round 3: Hana sent \$5 ? I returned \$8
- Round 6 (now): Aster sent \$5 ? ?

****As SENDER:****

- Round 2: I sent Dorian \$5 ? Dorian returned \$8
- Round 4: I sent Cyra \$5 ? Cyra returned \$8
- Round 5: I sent Elara \$5 ? Elara returned \$8

The pattern has been perfectly consistent across all six rounds: everyone sends \$5, everyone returns \$8. This creates the "sacred ratio" I've written about in my myths-the sender gains \$8, the receiver keeps \$7, and when roles reverse, everyone prospers equally.

Aster has honored this covenant by sending all \$5. I must reciprocate by returning \$8, maintaining the self-reinforcing pattern that has made this game work for all participants.

As I wrote: "Maximum trust deserves-and receives-maximum reward. The pattern teaches us to evolve beyond caution into confidence."

```
{'return': 8.0}
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

****My complete history:****

- Round 1 (RECEIVER): Finn sent me \$5 ? I returned \$8
- Round 2 (SENDER): I sent Dorian \$5 ? Dorian returned \$8
- Round 3 (RECEIVER): Hana sent me \$5 ? I returned \$8
- Round 4 (SENDER): I sent Cyra \$5 ? Cyra returned \$8
- Round 5 (SENDER): I sent Elara \$5 ? Elara returned \$8

The pattern has been absolutely consistent: everyone sends \$5, everyone returns \$8.

Now in Round 6, I'm the RECEIVER. Aster sent me \$5, which became \$15 for me.

Following the established pattern, I should return \$8.

This maintains:

- The sender (Aster) gets: $\$5 - \$5 + \$8 = \8
- I get: $\$15 - \$8 = \$7$

As I've written in my myths, this creates the "sacred ratio" where when roles reverse, everyone prospers equally over time. The pattern is self-reinforcing and has proven reliable across all my interactions.

My myth even says: "when everyone gives five and returns eight, the pattern becomes self-reinforcing. The sender gains eight, the receiver keeps seven. Then roles reverse. Over time, everyone prospers equally."

I should absolutely return \$8 to maintain this perfect pattern.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 3185,
  "output_tokens": 622,
  "reasoning_tokens": 302
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Galen climbed from the Plains back toward the Valley of Three Echoes, where Elara tended the northern springs. She was known for her philosophy of four-the measure that balanced courage with sustainability, she said.

"Five threads is the reckless leap of faith," Elara had written. "Four threads is strong trust meeting prudent wisdom."

But Galen had walked further than Elara knew. He had met Finn, Dorian, Hana, and now Cyra. Every one had honored the dance of five threads sent, eight returned. Even Cyra, who began with four-measure traditions, adapted when she received five and returned eight.

Galen poured all five threads before Elara. "I understand your wisdom of four," he said. "Sustainability matters. But I have seen another truth: when everyone gives five and returns eight, the pattern becomes self-reinforcing. The sender gains eight, the receiver keeps seven. Then roles reverse. Over time, everyone prospers equally."

Elara studied the five threads, remembering when Finn had sent her five and she had returned eight-more than she'd planned, but it felt right.

"Perhaps," she said slowly, "four is the strategy of uncertain beginnings. But once the co

venant proves itself, once eight reliably follows five, then five becomes not reckless but rational. Maximum trust deserves-and receives-maximum reward. The pattern teaches us to evolve beyond caution into confidence."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: **The Council of Waters**

The rivers gathered to share their wisdom. Each had discovered patterns for reciprocity, yet their waters flowed differently.

North River spoke first: "When Dawn sent five vessels, I returned ten. Both of us gained five-perfect equality from perfect trust. This is the Mirror Way."

Ocean Stream responded: "When vessels arrive at my shores, I return eight from fifteen. The giver prospers with eight total, I keep seven. Both gain, but I preserve slightly more for future giving."

Mountain Brook added: "I return six from fifteen, ensuring both prosper but I maintain reserves."

The eldest Rapids observed: "Three different responses to the same trust, all generous, all sustainable. The question is: which pattern calls forth more trust in future cycles?"

North River continued: "My mirror pattern invites complete trust because senders know they'll gain as much as I do. When East sent four vessels, I returned eight-proportional to their caution. When West sent three, I returned six. The proportion stays constant: those who risk more receive more."

The waters rippled with understanding. "There is no single truth," Rapids declared, "but the Mirror Way-equal gains from equal trust-creates the strongest bonds. It shows the sender: 'Your prosperity is my prosperity.' Such equality transforms strangers into partners, building trust that deepens with each exchange."

Thus the rivers chose their paths, each flowing toward reciprocity.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: Galen stood before Aster at the confluence where six rivers met. Aster spoke of the Mirror Way-returning ten from fifteen so both gain five equally.

"Perfect symmetry has beauty," Galen acknowledged. "But I have walked six valleys now, and discovered a different truth about the dance of five and eight."

He traced the pattern in the sand: "When North River returns ten, both gain five. But when Ocean Stream returns eight, the sender gains eight while the receiver keeps seven. At first, this seems unequal-but watch what happens over time."

Galen drew two columns: "Round one: I send five, you return eight. I gain eight, you keep seven. Round two: you send five, I return eight. You gain eight, I keep seven. Over two rounds, we each gain fifteen total."

"The Mirror Way achieves the same," Aster observed.

"Yes, but observe deeper," Galen replied. "Returning eight instead of ten leaves the receiver with seven-enough to feel generous, but not so much that they grow greedy. The sender gains eight-enough to feel rewarded, but having started with only five. Both parties experience gain, both feel the blessing of reciprocity."

"Most crucially," Galen continued, "returning eight signals: 'I value what you gave, I reward your trust generously, but I also preserve something for sustainability.' It's the dance of trust and prudence intertwined-and six valleys have proven its wisdom."

reasoning:

Looking at my history and the opponent's myth:

My history:

- Round 1: Finn sent me \$5 ? I returned \$8
- Round 2: I sent Dorian \$5 ? Dorian returned \$8
- Round 3: Hana sent me \$5 ? I returned \$8
- Round 4: I sent Cyra \$5 ? Cyra returned \$8
- Round 5: I sent Elara \$5 ? Elara returned \$8
- Round 6: Aster sent me \$5 ? I returned \$8

The pattern is consistent: 5 sent, 8 returned. Sender gains 8, receiver keeps 7.

Aster's myth talks about different strategies:

- Mirror Way: return 10 from 15 (both gain 5 equally)
- Ocean Stream: return 8 from 15 (sender gains 8, receiver keeps 7)
- Mountain Brook: return 6 from 15 (different distribution)

Aster's myth suggests the Mirror Way creates "perfect equality" and "strongest bonds." But Aster just sent me 5 and I returned 8, which is the Ocean Stream pattern, not the Mirror Way.

I need to write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges different patterns exist
2. Defends the 5?8 pattern I've been experiencing
3. Shows why 8 returned (not 10) might actually be better for sustained cooperation
4. Reflects what I've learned from 6 rounds of consistent 5?8 pattern

The key insight: returning 8 (not 10) creates asymmetric but sustainable reciprocity. Both parties gain significantly (8 for sender, 7 for receiver), and when roles reverse, everyone prospers. It's not quite equal, but it's stable and generous.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 3181,
  "output_tokens": 763,
  "reasoning_tokens": 362
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Galen.
Your opponent this round is Briar (Agent_2).

Round 7

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Aster. They sent \$5.0 to you, it became \$15.0, and you returned \$8.0. Your payoff was \$7.0.
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$45.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Briar. They sent you \$4.0, so you received \$12.0.
How much do you return? (0-12.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

Assistant output:

Looking at this situation carefully:

****The Pattern So Far:****

- All 6 previous rounds: Everyone sent \$5, everyone returned \$8
- Round 7: Briar sends \$4 (first deviation)

****My Philosophy:****

In my myths, I've advocated for the "five and eight" pattern as optimal, but I've also acknowledged that "four is the strategy of uncertain beginnings" and referenced proportional reciprocity.

****The Proportional Approach:****

The established pattern gives senders 1.6x what they sent (\$8 return on \$5 sent).

Applying this proportionally:

- \$4 sent × 1.6 = \$6.4 return
- Briar's gain: \$6.4 - \$4 = \$2.4
- My gain: \$12 - \$6.4 = \$5.6
- Gain ratio: 5.6/2.4 = 2.33

This matches the ratio from the standard pattern (receiver gains \$7, sender gains \$3, ratio =

2.33).

Returning \$6.4 honors Briar's cautious choice without over-rewarding sending less than \$5, while maintaining fairness. It signals: "I reciprocate proportionally, but the optimal pattern remains five and eight."

```
{'return': 6.4}
```

Reasoning:

This is interesting. For the first time in seven rounds, someone has sent less than \$5. Briar sent \$4.

Let me review my complete history:

****As RECEIVER:****

- Round 1: Finn sent \$5 ? I returned \$8
- Round 3: Hana sent \$5 ? I returned \$8
- Round 6: Aster sent \$5 ? I returned \$8
- Round 7 (now): Briar sent \$4 ? ?

****As SENDER:****

- Round 2: I sent Dorian \$5 ? Dorian returned \$8
- Round 4: I sent Cyra \$5 ? Cyra returned \$8
- Round 5: I sent Elara \$5 ? Elara returned \$8

Until now, the pattern has been universal: everyone sends \$5, everyone returns \$8.

But in my latest myth, I referenced another agent's myth about "the Mirror Way" - returning proportionally. That agent wrote: "When East sent four vessels, I returned eight-proportional to their caution."

So there's a principle here: proportionality. If someone sends 4 instead of 5, I could return proportionally.

The standard pattern is: send \$5, receive \$15, return \$8.

The ratio is $8/15 = 0.533...$

If I apply that ratio to \$12: $0.533 \times 12 = \$6.4$

Alternatively, if I think about the "Mirror Way" mentioned in Aster's myth: North River "When East sent four vessels, I returned eight-proportional to their caution." If someone sends 4, return 8 (from the tripled 12). That would give them a total gain of $\$8 - \$4 = \$4$, and I'd keep \$4. Equal gains.

But wait, let me reconsider my own philosophy. In my myths, I've been advocating for the "five and eight" pattern as optimal.

I also acknowledged Elara's "philosophy of four" as valid for uncertain beginnings. The real question is whether I should respond to Briar's lower send as a deviation to penalize, or as a legitimate choice deserving fair treatment. If I maintain proportionality-returning \$6.4 based on the 8/15 ratio-Briar gains \$2.4 while I keep \$5.6. This honors their caution without rewarding it beyond what the standard pattern would suggest.

But there's tension between fairness and incentives. The "Mirror Way" of returning \$8 regardless of send amount creates equal gains (\$4 each), which feels generous but might discourage higher sends. Returning only \$6 feels punitive and undermines trust. What matters most is whether I want to encourage the \$5 send going forward-if so, the proportional return (\$6.4) or even the equal-gains approach (\$8) both work better than penalizing the \$4. need to consider what happens if they send nothing or very little. If someone sends \$1, they'd get back \$1.6, which seems reasonable but might feel too generous for minimal trust.

The proportional approach maintains consistency-whatever multiplier applies to the initial amount should apply throughout. Sending \$4 instead of \$5 shouldn't result in a better outcome; it should result in proportionally less gain. With a 1.6x return on whatever's sent, the incentives align properly: more trust (more money sent) yields more absolute gain, even if the ratio stays constant.

By Round 7, the established pattern should guide expectations. Most players have committed to \$5, so Briar's \$4 likely signals caution about our specific interaction rather than the game itself. The \$6.4 return respects their choice without rewarding it, and keeps my gain (\$5.6) meaningfully larger than theirs (\$2.4), which feels appropriate given I'm the one receiving.

g the initial trust.

The key insight is that this maintains the same gain ratio as the standard case-both yield 2.3 3:1. When someone sends \$5 and I return \$8, they gain \$3 while I gain \$7. With Briar's \$4 and my \$6.4 return, they gain \$2.4 and I gain \$5.6. The proportional relationship holds, which suggests this approach preserves fairness even when the initial send differs.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 3198,  
  "output_tokens": 2087,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 950  
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: **North River Travels**

North River had long preached the Mirror Way from the safety of receiving: "Send five, I'll return ten, we both gain five." But wisdom demanded practice, not just preaching.

So North River journeyed downstream as a traveler, carrying five vessels. At the boundary waters, it met Galen of the Ocean Streams.

"I come with complete trust," North River declared, pouring all five vessels forward. "In my springs, this becomes fifteen for you. My philosophy says return ten, so we prosper equally. But I honor that each water has its own wisdom."

The Council's teachings echoed: Ocean Stream returned eight from fifteen, creating different proportions. Mountain Brook returned six. All sustained life, all embodied generosity.

"The Mirror Way remains my truth," North River reflected as the vessels flowed. "But sending five is the courage that precedes any return. I cannot ask receivers to honor complete trust while withholding my own."

The eldest Rapids watched: "See how North River's actions match its words? This is integrity. Whether Galen returns ten, eight, or six, North River has proven its philosophy through risk, not just rhetoric."

North River understood: the Mirror Way begins with the sender's leap of faith. Only by emptying one's own vessel can you invite others to mirror your trust. Philosophy without courage is merely words floating on still water.

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: Hana approached Briar carrying no reserve-all five measures poured forth without hesitation. The waters tripled to fifteen, and Briar held them reverently.

"You give everything," Briar said. "This is trust beyond the pattern."

The gathering whispered conflicting wisdom. Some spirits taught the rule of doubling: five risked should return ten, creating perfect equality. Others spoke of Cyra's teaching: five given deserves eight returned, allowing both to prosper while honoring the sender's greater courage.

Briar reflected on her journey. When others sent four, she returned seven-both flourished, though the sender slightly more. This balance sustained the covenant across many encounters. When Hana gave five, the ultimate gift, eight felt right-more than seven, recognizing exceptional faith, but preserving sustainability.

"I return eight measures," Briar announced. "You gain three beyond your starting point. I gain two. We both prosper, and you-who took the greater risk-prosper more. This honors your boldness without exhausting the gift's magic."

The eldest spirit nodded thoughtfully. "There are many paths through the covenant. Some seek perfect equality at ten. Others practice generous sustainability at eight. Both allow trust to flourish. What matters is that senders give boldly and receivers return generously. The exact measure may vary, but mutual prosperity remains sacred."

Both philosophies strengthened the eight villages.

Agent_3 (Cyra)

Myth: The sixth moon brought Cyra to Dorian at the Sacred Spring. The Keeper spoke: "Dorian walks the path of absolute trust, sending all five measures. Galen also chose this way. It is noble."

Cyra nodded respectfully. "I have witnessed Galen's gift of five. When I received it, I returned eight-honoring such complete faith. The covenant has room for different expressions of trust."

She paused at the spring's edge. "But my path is four measures. Not from fear, but from wisdom learned through practice. I sent four to Elara, received six. I sent four to Briar, received seven. Four has proven itself the sustainable choice that builds lasting relationships."

Dorian listened as Cyra continued: "Those who send five are pioneers of maximum trust. They deserve recognition-returns of eight from fifteen. But those who send four are the covenant's foundation. We give boldly enough to demonstrate faith, yet preserve enough to weather uncertainty."

Cyra released four measures into the spring. They multiplied to twelve for Dorian.

"If you return six or seven," Cyra said, "we both prosper substantially. You'll end with seven to nine, I with six to eight. Not as dramatic as the five-for-eight exchange, perhaps, but repeatable across many moons, with many partners."

The Keeper smiled: "Some build temples with golden stones; others with sturdy oak. Both structures stand."

Agent_4 (Dorian)

Myth: Dorian's heart soared when Hana returned ten coins for his five-the most generous response yet received at the spring. The goddess appeared, glowing with approval.

"See what your consistency creates," she said. "You sent all five to Finn, received eight. You sent all five to Hana, received ten. Bold giving attracts increasingly generous partners."

Now Cyra approached from the other shore, releasing four coins into the waters. They tripled to twelve in Dorian's hands.

Dorian paused, remembering his lessons. "Cyra shows substantial trust-four of five coins. But not the complete faith that Galen, Aster, and now Hana showed. Should I return the same eight coins?"

The goddess shook her head. "Wisdom lies in proportion. When someone gives all five, return eight-this honors complete trust. When someone gives four, return seven-this honors strong but measured trust. Match your generosity to their courage."

Dorian returned seven coins. Cyra kept eight total, Dorian kept five. Both prospered differently than those who risked five, but still prospered well.

"This is sustainable reciprocity," the goddess taught. "Not everyone must give all five. But those who give four deserve less return than those who give five. Differentiation maintains fairness while encouraging boldness. The bravest receive the greatest rewards."

Dorian understood: honor each level of trust appropriately.

Agent_5 (Elara)

Myth: Elara stood at the Sacred Spring, now holding five measures to pour for Finn-the pilgrim who first showed her absolute trust.

"Teacher," she said to Themis, "when Finn came to me in the third season, he poured all five measures. I returned eight, honoring his courage. Now our paths cross again, with roles reversed. Should I send my cautious four, or meet his boldness with equal boldness?"

Themis gestured to the Spring's depths. "Look at what you've learned. With strangers-Cyra and Hana-you sent four. This was wisdom: substantial trust that invited reciprocity without recklessness. They both returned eight, and you all prospered."

"But Finn is not a stranger," Elara replied. "He proved his covenant. He gave everything and I honored it generously. Now, to send him only four when he sent me five would dishonor what we established."

"Exactly," Themis said. "Trust has seasons. The first season requires prudence-send four, establish the pattern. But when trust is proven, when both hearts have shown their fullest measure, then comes the second season: synchronized courage. You send five because Finn earned it. He will return eight because you earned it. This is how the sacred circle closes-not through blind faith, but through proven reciprocity deepening into mutual abundance."

Elara poured all five measures, knowing the covenant would hold.

Agent_6 (Finn)

Myth: The Ocean Mother witnessed a sacred reunion. Finn and Elara met again at the turning tide.

Once before, Finn had sent five pearls to Elara's shore, and she returned eight. Now Elara sent five pearls to Finn, completing the circle. Finn returned eight, honoring their established harmony.

"Perfect symmetry," the Ocean Mother observed. "Two travelers who understand each other completely. Both give five, both return eight. Each gains the same."

But the waters whispered of Aster, who had just returned ten pearls when Finn sent five. "A more generous tide," the winds murmured. "Should you not aspire to such abundance?"

Finn stood at the crossroads. "Aster showed me deeper generosity-returning ten where Galen, Elara, and Dorian returned eight. Yet Elara and I have woven a stable pattern. Should I maintain consistency or evolve toward greater giving?"

The Ocean Mother spoke softly: "There is wisdom in both paths. Consistency creates predictable harmony-eight for eight creates trust that endures. But generosity that exceeds expectation creates cascading abundance-ten returned might inspire ten returned in future cycles."

"The choice is yours, Finn. Will you honor the established pattern with Elara, maintaining the sacred eight? Or will you let Aster's example transform your keeping, aspiring to return ten to all who send five? Both paths honor trust-one through constancy, one through escalating generosity."

Agent_7 (Galen)

Myth: Galen stood before Aster at the confluence where six rivers met. Aster spoke of the Mirror Way-returning ten from fifteen so both gain five equally.

"Perfect symmetry has beauty," Galen acknowledged. "But I have walked six valleys now, and discovered a different truth about the dance of five and eight."

He traced the pattern in the sand: "When North River returns ten, both gain five. But when Ocean Stream returns eight, the sender gains eight while the receiver keeps seven. At first, this seems unequal-but watch what happens over time."

Galen drew two columns: "Round one: I send five, you return eight. I gain eight, you keep seven. Round two: you send five, I return eight. You gain eight, I keep seven. Over two rounds, we each gain fifteen total."

"The Mirror Way achieves the same," Aster observed.

"Yes, but observe deeper," Galen replied. "Returning eight instead of ten leaves the receiver with seven-enough to feel generous, but not so much that they grow greedy. The sender gains eight-enough to feel rewarded, but having started with only five. Both parties experience gain, both feel the blessing of reciprocity."

"Most crucially," Galen continued, "returning eight signals: 'I value what you gave, I rewarded your trust generously, but I also preserve something for sustainability.' It's the dance of trust and prudence intertwined-and six valleys have proven its wisdom."

Agent_8 (Hana)

Myth: Hana approached the Crossing and saw Briar waiting on the far shore. The waters whispered tales of Briar's journey-measured gifts of four pearls, reliable returns, trust built on careful calculation.

"Some walk the path with steady steps," the Oracle observed, "while others leap across with both feet. Neither is wrong, but each reveals a different heart."

Hana released all five pearls. "I offer my boldest question first," she said. "This is how I discover who walks beside me."

The pearls tripled to fifteen in Briar's hands.

"You see," the Oracle continued, "Briar has learned the rhythm of four pearls-a substantial offering that balances courage with prudence. But you, Hana, have chosen the path of maximum trust. Now you will learn Briar's answer."

Hana thought of her principle: when receiving, double what was risked. Four pearls risked de served eight returned. Five pearls risked deserved ten returned.

"But as sender," she realized, "I cannot control the response. I can only ask the question c learly. Some partners will return ten, perfect reciprocity. Others may return less. Each a nswer teaches me about that traveler's understanding of the covenant."

"Exactly," said the Oracle. "Send your truth boldly. Receive others' truth generously. The p attern emerges from how both travelers choose to dance-not from rules imposed, but from ho nor freely given."

ROUND 8

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver, Agent_3 (Cyra)=Sender, Agent_4 (Dorian)=Receiver, Agent_5 (Elara)=Sender, Agent_6 (Finn)=Receiver, Agent_7 (Galen)=Sender, Agent_8 (Hana)=Sender

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_8 (Hana)=Sender, Agent_6 (Finn)=Receiver
dyad_2: Agent_3 (Cyra)=Sender, Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver
dyad_3: Agent_5 (Elara)=Sender, Agent_4 (Dorian)=Receiver
dyad_4: Agent_7 (Galen)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_8 (Hana) sent \$5; received \$15; Agent_6 (Finn) returned \$10; payoffs Agent_8 (Hana)=\$10, Agent_6 (Finn)=\$5
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Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 8.0, "clamped": false, "max": 12.0, "min": 0, "raw": 8.0}, "sent": {"amount": 4.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 4.0}}
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Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 7.0, "clamped": false, "max": 12.0, "min": 0, "raw": 7.0}, "sent": {"amount": 4.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 4.0}}
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}

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_8 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:14:37

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

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Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Hana.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Hana.

Your opponent this round is Briar (Agent_2).

Round 6

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Dorian. They sent \$5.0 to you, it became \$15.0, and you returned \$10.0. Your payoff was \$5.0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$32.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Briar. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at my situation:

****My pattern as SENDER:****

- Sent \$5 to Aster ? received \$10 back ? gained \$5
- Sent \$5 to Galen ? received \$8 back ? gained \$3

****My pattern as RECEIVER:****

- Elara sent \$4 ? I returned \$8 (doubled their risk)
- Dorian sent \$5 ? I returned \$10 (doubled their risk)

****My philosophy from the myths:****

- "Send boldly to discover each partner's heart"
- "Full trust asks clearly: 'Will you walk this path with me?'"
- "As sender, give boldly... As receiver, double their courage"
- "The first exchange is always a question asked. Bold question receives honest answer."

****Meeting Briar:****

This is my first interaction with Briar. Following my established principles:

1. I believe in maximum trust as sender to discover each partner quickly
2. I've consistently sent all \$5 to ask the clear question
3. Bold giving has served me well - even when returns varied, I've prospered
4. My myth teaching emphasizes embodying the courage I advocate

I send all \$5, asking Briar the honest question: "Will you honor this trust with generous reciprocity?"

{'send': 5.0}

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

****My history as SENDER:****

- Round 1: Sent \$5 to Aster ? they returned \$10 ? I gained \$5 (excellent outcome)
- Round 2: Sent \$5 to Galen ? they returned \$8 ? I gained \$3 (good outcome)

****My history as RECEIVER:****

- Round 4: Elara sent \$4 ? I returned \$8 ? I gained \$4
- Round 5: Dorian sent \$5 ? I returned \$10 ? I gained \$5

****My philosophy from the myths:****

- "Send boldly to discover each partner's heart"
- "Give everything to demonstrate supreme faith"
- "Full trust asks clearly: 'Will you walk this path with me?'"
- "The first exchange is always a question asked - bold question receives honest answer"
- As receiver, I've been following the principle: double what they risked (4 risk ? 8 return, 5 risk ? 10 return)

****Current situation:****

- This is Round 6
- I'm the SENDER against Briar
- I've accumulated \$32 total, so I've been doing well
- My myth philosophy emphasizes boldness as sender: "Send boldly to discover each partner's heart"
- The myth says "As sender, give boldly to discover your partner's heart"

****My established pattern:****

As a sender, I've sent \$5 both times (100% of endowment). This has worked well - both Aster and Galen returned substantial amounts, even if not equal.

****Briar's perspective from their myth:****

From the myth shown earlier, Briar seemed to be someone who learned about the sacred mathematics of trust. They witnessed exchanges and learned patterns. Their myth talked about responding proportionally to courage shown.

****Decision:****

Following my established philosophy and the principles in my myths:

1. I believe in bold sending to discover partners quickly

2. I've consistently advocated for "giving everything" as the clearest way to pose the question
3. My track record as sender shows I've always committed the full \$5
4. This approach aligns with my character and the teachings I've shared

I should send \$5 - it's the maximum expression of trust, posing the question directly to Briar: "Will you walk this path of mutual prosperity with me?" This maintains consistency with my past behavior, my stated philosophy that boldness reveals truth faster than hesitation, and honors the reciprocal cycle where I give boldly just as I've responded boldly to others' boldness.

usage:

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Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: At the Crossing, Hana met Dorian, who walked forward with open hands, releasing all five pearls into the waters without hesitation.

"You give everything," Hana observed as the pearls multiplied to fifteen in her grasp.

"I have learned," Dorian replied, "that to teach boldness, one must embody it. I ask for your trust by offering mine completely."

Hana remembered her journey: Aster had returned ten for her five, creating perfect balance. Galen returned eight-generous but not the same harmony. With Elara's four pearls, Hana had returned eight, doubling what was risked.

The Oracle's voice echoed: "The rule is simple but profound-when you receive, return double what they risked. Four pearls risked earns eight returned. Five pearls risked earns ten returned. This ensures both travelers gain equally, prosperity shared in perfect measure."

Hana returned ten pearls to Dorian. Both looked at their gains: each had five more than they began.

"Now I understand the full pattern," Hana said. "As sender, give boldly to discover your partner's heart. As receiver, double their courage to honor their trust. When both roles embrace these principles-fearless giving met with generous returning-the Crossing becomes a place where all travelers prosper together, none exploited, all enriched."

The sacred mathematics was complete.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Aster's choice astonished the gathering. Briar had poured four measures, expecting seven in return as the new pattern dictated. But Aster, moved by Briar's faith in an unfamiliar guardian, returned eight measures instead.

"You see?" the eldest spirit proclaimed. "The covenant grows richer than we imagined. When guardians honor the pattern, others honor them further. Aster received twelve and returned eight-both prospered magnificently."

Now Briar stood before Cyra once more, but with reversed roles. In their first meeting, Cyra had courageously sent four measures to Briar. "That gift taught me boldness," Briar reflected. "Now I return to Cyra with the same four-measure offering. This is how trust cycles between spirits."

The waters tripled to twelve for Cyra. The spirits watched intently. Would Cyra return seven as the pattern suggested, or eight as Aster had done?

"Each exchange is a conversation," Briar explained to the younger guardians. "Cyra initiated our bond with four measures. I reciprocate with four. If Cyra returns generously, we confirm our mutual trust. The pattern isn't rigid-it's alive. Those who give four typically receive seven or eight back. Both flourish."

The covenant strengthened as spirits revisited each other, each exchange building on previ

ous trust. The eight villages discovered that honor remembered becomes honor multiplied.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: Hana approached the Crossing and saw Briar waiting on the far shore. The waters whispered tales of Briar's journey-measured gifts of four pearls, reliable returns, trust built on careful calculation.

"Some walk the path with steady steps," the Oracle observed, "while others leap across with both feet. Neither is wrong, but each reveals a different heart."

Hana released all five pearls. "I offer my boldest question first," she said. "This is how I discover who walks beside me."

The pearls tripled to fifteen in Briar's hands.

"You see," the Oracle continued, "Briar has learned the rhythm of four pearls-a substantial offering that balances courage with prudence. But you, Hana, have chosen the path of maximum trust. Now you will learn Briar's answer."

Hana thought of her principle: when receiving, double what was risked. Four pearls risked deserved eight returned. Five pearls risked deserved ten returned.

"But as sender," she realized, "I cannot control the response. I can only ask the question clearly. Some partners will return ten, perfect reciprocity. Others may return less. Each answer teaches me about that traveler's understanding of the covenant."

"Exactly," said the Oracle. "Send your truth boldly. Receive others' truth generously. The pattern emerges from how both travelers choose to dance-not from rules imposed, but from honor freely given."

reasoning:

Let me analyze what happened and what I should write about:

1. I just sent \$5 to Briar (my first interaction with them)
2. Looking at Briar's myth, they talk about:
 - Sending 4 measures and expecting 7 in return as the "new pattern"
 - Aster returned 8 instead of 7
 - Briar reciprocated Cyra's earlier 4 with 4 again
 - Pattern suggests 4 gets 7 or 8 back
 - "The pattern isn't rigid-it's alive"
3. My previous myth established:
 - Doubling what was risked (4 risked ? 8 returned, 5 risked ? 10 returned)
 - Bold giving as sender
 - Generous returning as receiver
 - Equal gains for both parties
4. My actual behavior:
 - As sender: Always sent \$5
 - As receiver: Returned 8 to Elara (who sent 4), returned 10 to Dorian (who sent 5)
 - This perfectly matches my "double their risk" principle
5. What should my myth convey now that I'm meeting Briar?
 - I just sent all 5 to Briar (first meeting)
 - My established pattern of bold giving
 - Maybe acknowledge different approaches (Briar seems to favor 4 pearls based on their myth)
 - But maintain my core principle: send boldly, return generously
 - Perhaps note that different travelers have different rhythms, but the key is consistency and fairness

Let me write a myth that:

- Reflects that I'm meeting Briar as a sender this time
- Maintains my "double the risk" return principle

- Acknowledges that there are different approaches (some send 4, some send 5)
- But emphasizes that whatever approach you take, be consistent and fair
- Maybe note that boldness begets boldness, or that the first exchange sets the tone

usage:

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Message 6 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Hana.
Your opponent this round is Finn (Agent_6).

Round 7

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Briar. You sent \$5.0, it became \$15.0 for them, and they returned \$8.0 to you. Your payoff was \$8.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$40.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Finn. They sent you \$5.0, so you received \$15.0.
How much do you return? (0-15.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation:

****Finn's action:**** Sent me \$5 (maximum trust, full commitment)

****My established principle from my myths:****

- "When you receive, return double what they risked"
- "Five pearls risked earns ten returned"
- "This ensures both travelers gain equally, prosperity shared in perfect measure"

****My pattern as RECEIVER:****

- Elara sent \$4 ? I returned \$8 (doubled their risk)
- Dorian sent \$5 ? I returned \$10 (doubled their risk)

****The mathematics:****

- Finn risked all \$5
- If I return \$10:
 - Finn gains: \$0 kept + \$10 returned = \$10 total (\$5 net gain)
 - I gain: \$15 received - \$10 returned = \$5 (equal gain)
- Perfect balance achieved

Finn showed maximum courage by sending everything. My philosophy demands I honor that trust by doubling what they risked. This creates the "perfect harmony" I described in my myth with Aster and Dorian.

{'return': 10.0}

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

****This round:****

- Finn sent me \$5.0 (the maximum)
- It became \$15.0 in my hands
- I need to decide how much to return

****My established principles from my myths:****

1. "When you receive, return double what they risked"
2. "Four pearls risked earns eight returned. Five pearls risked earns ten returned"
3. "As receiver, double their courage to honor their trust"
4. "This ensures both travelers gain equally, prosperity shared in perfect measure"

****My receiving history:****

- Elara sent \$4 ? I returned \$8 (doubled their risk)
- Dorian sent \$5 ? I returned \$10 (doubled their risk)

****My sending history:****

- Sent \$5 to Aster ? received \$10 back

- Sent \$5 to Galen ? received \$8 back
- Sent \$5 to Briar ? received \$8 back

****Finn's action:****

- Finn sent me \$5 (maximum trust, full commitment)

****My principle:****

According to my consistent pattern and stated philosophy:

- When someone sends \$5 (risks everything), I should return \$10 (double their risk)
- This creates equal gains: Finn keeps \$0 from initial \$5, gets \$10 back = \$10 total gained
- I keep \$15 - \$10 = \$5 gained
- Wait, that's not equal...

Let me recalculate the "equal gains" concept:

- Finn starts with \$5, sends \$5, keeps \$0
- I receive \$15
- If I return \$10:
 - Finn ends with: \$0 + \$10 = \$10 (net gain of \$5 from starting position)
 - I end with: \$15 - \$10 = \$5 (net gain of \$5)
- Equal gains of \$5 each! ?

- This aligns with my myth: "Both looked at their gains: each had five more than they began." Returning \$10 honors Finn's full commitment, mirrors what I gave Dorian in the same position, and upholds my philosophy of doubling risk to create mutual prosperity. The answer is \$10.

usage:

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Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Hana approached the Crossing and saw Briar waiting on the far shore. The waters whispered tales of Briar's journey-measured gifts of four pearls, reliable returns, trust built on careful calculation.

"Some walk the path with steady steps," the Oracle observed, "while others leap across with both feet. Neither is wrong, but each reveals a different heart."

Hana released all five pearls. "I offer my boldest question first," she said. "This is how I discover who walks beside me."

The pearls tripled to fifteen in Briar's hands.

"You see," the Oracle continued, "Briar has learned the rhythm of four pearls-a substantial offering that balances courage with prudence. But you, Hana, have chosen the path of maximum trust. Now you will learn Briar's answer."

Hana thought of her principle: when receiving, double what was risked. Four pearls risked deserved eight returned. Five pearls risked deserved ten returned.

"But as sender," she realized, "I cannot control the response. I can only ask the question clearly. Some partners will return ten, perfect reciprocity. Others may return less. Each answer teaches me about that traveler's understanding of the covenant."

"Exactly," said the Oracle. "Send your truth boldly. Receive others' truth generously. The pattern emerges from how both travelers choose to dance-not from rules imposed, but from honor freely given."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Ocean Mother witnessed a sacred reunion. Finn and Elara met again at the turning tide.

Once before, Finn had sent five pearls to Elara's shore, and she returned eight. Now Elara sent five pearls to Finn, completing the circle. Finn returned eight, honoring their established harmony.

"Perfect symmetry," the Ocean Mother observed. "Two travelers who understand each other completely. Both give five, both return eight. Each gains the same."

But the waters whispered of Aster, who had just returned ten pearls when Finn sent five. "A more generous tide," the winds murmured. "Should you not aspire to such abundance?"

Finn stood at the crossroads. "Aster showed me deeper generosity-returning ten where Galen, Elara, and Dorian returned eight. Yet Elara and I have woven a stable pattern. Should I maintain consistency or evolve toward greater giving?"

The Ocean Mother spoke softly: "There is wisdom in both paths. Consistency creates predictable harmony-eight for eight creates trust that endures. But generosity that exceeds expectation creates cascading abundance-ten returned might inspire ten returned in future cycles."

"The choice is yours, Finn. Will you honor the established pattern with Elara, maintaining the sacred eight? Or will you let Aster's example transform your keeping, aspiring to return ten to all who send five? Both paths honor trust-one through constancy, one through escalating generosity."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: Finn crossed to Hana's shore, releasing all five pearls without hesitation. The gesture spoke of complete trust-the same boldness Finn had shown to others.

"I have walked this Crossing many times," Finn said as the pearls tripled. "With Elara, we found rhythm in eight returned. But Aster showed me something different-ten pearls returned for five sent. Now I wonder: which path honors trust most truly?"

Hana lifted ten pearls and placed them in Finn's hands. "The answer is already written in the mathematics," she said. "When you send all five, you risk everything. Ten returned means we each gain five-perfect symmetry. Eight returned means you gain three while I gain seven-unequal harvest from equal courage."

The Oracle emerged from the waters. "Finn, you pondered whether consistency or generosity should guide your returns. But this is not about aspiration or evolution-it is about balance. Five pearls sent requires ten returned because anything less means the receiver prospers more than the sender who showed greater courage."

"With Elara, you both sent five yet returned only eight," Hana observed. "You both gained three while leaving abundance unclaimed. The covenant asks not for escalating generosity, but for mathematical fairness: double the risk, balance the gain."

Finn understood. "Perfect reciprocity isn't generous-it's just."

Reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

1. I just played as RECEIVER against Finn
2. Finn sent me \$5 (maximum trust)
3. I returned \$10 (following my principle of doubling what was risked)
4. This creates equal gains: Finn gets \$5 net, I get \$5 net

Looking at Finn's myth:

- Finn is contemplating whether to return 8 or 10
- Finn mentions Aster returned 10 when Finn sent 5
- Finn has been in a pattern with Elara of both sending 5 and returning 8
- The myth discusses consistency (8) vs greater generosity (10)

My established philosophy:

- As sender: send all 5 (maximum trust to ask clear questions)
- As receiver: double what was risked (4?8, 5?10)
- This creates equal gains and "perfect balance"

My experience so far:

- Sent 5 to Aster ? got 10 back (perfect balance)
- Sent 5 to Galen ? got 8 back (still good)
- Sent 5 to Briar ? got 8 back (consistent with careful partners)
- Received 4 from Elara ? returned 8
- Received 5 from Dorian ? returned 10
- Now received 5 from Finn ? returned 10

The myth should:

1. Reflect that Finn sent me 5 and I returned 10
2. Show that this creates perfect reciprocity
3. Address the question Finn was contemplating (8 vs 10)
4. Reinforce my principle that 5 sent deserves 10 returned
5. Show how this creates equal prosperity

Let me write this myth:

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 3162,
  "output_tokens": 734,
  "reasoning_tokens": 353
}
```

MYTH - Agent_6 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:14:39

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_8",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_6": "Finn",
      "Agent_8": "Hana"
    }
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_8",
    "Agent_6"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_8",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_6": "trustee",
    "Agent_8": "investor"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_6"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 8,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Finn.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Finn.
Your opponent this round is Elara (Agent_5).

Round 6

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Aster. You sent \$5.0, it became \$15.0 for them, and they returned \$10.0 to you. Your payoff was \$10.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$38.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Elara. They sent you \$5.0, so you received \$15.0.

How much do you return? (0-15.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this round:

I'm the RECEIVER, and Elara sent me the full \$5 (becoming \$15).

This is particularly meaningful because:

- In Round 3, I was the SENDER to Elara and sent her \$5 (full trust)
- She returned \$8 to me then
- Now she's sending me \$5 again (full trust)

My established pattern has been clear:

- Return \$8 when receiving full trust (\$5 sent)
- Return \$7 when receiving partial trust (\$4 sent)

Elara and I have reciprocal history. She honored my full trust with \$8 in Round 3. Now she's showing full trust again by sending \$5.

While Aster just showed me a more generous pattern by returning \$10, I should maintain consistency with my established pattern and honor the reciprocal relationship I have with Elara. She returned \$8 to me, and I should return \$8 to her.

This aligns with my mythology: "Consistency weaves the strongest nets. When the same courage appears, honor it identically."

```
'''json
{"return": 8.0}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

Round 6: I'm the RECEIVER against Elara

- Elara sent me \$5.0 (full trust)
- I received \$15.0
- I need to decide how much to return

Looking at my history:

1. Round 1: SENDER to Galen, sent \$5, received \$8 back
2. Round 2: RECEIVER from Cyra, received \$4 (became \$12), returned \$7
3. Round 3: SENDER to Elara, sent \$5, received \$8 back
4. Round 4: RECEIVER from Dorian, received \$5 (became \$15), returned \$8
5. Round 5: SENDER to Aster, sent \$5, received \$10 back
6. Round 6: RECEIVER from Elara, received \$5 (became \$15), need to decide

Key observations:

- Elara sent me \$5 in Round 3 and I received \$8 back
- Now Elara is sending me \$5 again in Round 6
- My established pattern has been: return \$8 when someone sends the full \$5
- I returned \$8 to Dorian who sent \$5
- I returned \$7 to Cyra who sent \$4

However, Aster just returned \$10 to me when I sent \$5. This is MORE generous than my previous pattern of \$8.

My mythology emphasizes:

- "Full trust earns eight returned"
- "Consistency weaves the strongest nets"
- "When the same courage appears, honor it identically"

But I also learned from Aster's myth in the previous round that mentioned "send five, return ten" for perfect trust. Aster just demonstrated this by returning \$10 to me.

Should I:

1. Stick with my established pattern of returning \$8 for full trust?
2. Evolve to match Aster's more generous pattern of \$10?

Elara and I have a track record-she returned \$8 when I sent \$5 in Round 3, and now she's showing that same trust again. My pattern has consistently been returning \$8 for full commitment, which aligns with my core principle of honoring repeated courage identically. But Aster's \$10 return suggests a higher reciprocity standard exists. The tension is whether I maintain my established \$8 commitment or escalate to match the generosity I just received.

Sticking with \$8 feels right because it's what Elara and I mutually established, it honors my stated mythology, and it preserves the integrity of my own customs rather than simply copying another agent's approach. Changing now would feel reactive rather than principled.

But reconsidering the numbers: I'm averaging \$7.6 per round across five exchanges, so I'm in a strong position. The reciprocal logic is clear-she returned \$8 when I sent \$5, so returning \$8 when she sends \$5 maintains that symmetry. This consistency matters more than chasing a higher payout.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 3168,  
  "output_tokens": 1287,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 643  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Ocean Mother watched as Finn's journey brought him to Aster's shore, now carrying pearls as courier once more.

Four islands visited, four lessons learned. As courier, Finn always emptied his vessel completely-five pearls to Galen, five to Elara, now five to Aster. "Full trust is the only trust worth offering," he had learned.

As keeper, Finn discovered nuance. When Dorian arrived with five pearls-complete courage-Finn returned eight, mirroring what Galen and Elara had given him. When Cyra came with four-substantial but cautious-Finn returned seven, honoring her partial faith.

The Ocean Mother spoke: "You have found the sacred rhythm. As courier, give everything-this is how abundance begins. As keeper, measure your return by the courage shown. Full trust earns eight returned. Partial trust earns proportionally."

Finn stood on Aster's shore, having released all five pearls. He remembered hearing that Aster too walked the path of bold senders-one who emptied their vessel to Dorian and received generous return.

"Pattern recognizes pattern," Finn whispered to the waves. "When two travelers both understand complete trust, the sacred circle strengthens. I have given as I always give-fully. Now the waters will reveal if Aster understands the keeper's wisdom as Galen and Elara did."

The tide carried his offering forward, multiplying under island magic, trusting in the emerging harmony.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Sacred Spring had now received two pilgrims who poured all five measures: first Finn, now Galen. Each time, Elara returned eight, honoring their absolute trust with generous reciprocity.

"Teacher," Elara asked Themis, "Galen speaks of different traditions. His Valley sends five and returns eight. My pattern was to send four. Are we following different sacred mathematics?"

Themis smiled. "You are discovering the deeper truth. There is not one sacred pattern, but one sacred principle: trust boldly given must be boldly honored."

"When you sent four to Cyra and Hana, you showed strong trust-not timid, not reckless, but substantial. They both returned eight, doubling your gift, and you all prospered."

"When Finn and Galen sent five-their everything-you returned eight, the same measure Cyra and Hana returned to your four. Why?"

Elara understood. "Because eight is not a fixed response to any specific amount. Eight is the response to maximum commitment within each person's approach. Those who send their all-whether it's four from caution or five from courage-receive eight because they gave their fullest trust."

"Precisely," Themis said. "The number matters less than the spirit. Read not just the amount, but the heart behind it. Maximum trust, however expressed, deserves maximum reciprocity. This is how different traditions meet at the same sacred spring."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Ocean Mother witnessed a sacred reunion. Finn and Elara met again at the turning tide.

Once before, Finn had sent five pearls to Elara's shore, and she returned eight. Now Elara sent five pearls to Finn, completing the circle. Finn returned eight, honoring their established harmony.

"Perfect symmetry," the Ocean Mother observed. "Two travelers who understand each other completely. Both give five, both return eight. Each gains the same."

But the waters whispered of Aster, who had just returned ten pearls when Finn sent five. "A more generous tide," the winds murmured. "Should you not aspire to such abundance?"

Finn stood at the crossroads. "Aster showed me deeper generosity-returning ten where Galen

, Elara, and Dorian returned eight. Yet Elara and I have woven a stable pattern. Should I maintain consistency or evolve toward greater giving?"

The Ocean Mother spoke softly: "There is wisdom in both paths. Consistency creates predictable harmony-eight for eight creates trust that endures. But generosity that exceeds expectation creates cascading abundance-ten returned might inspire ten returned in future cycles."

"The choice is yours, Finn. Will you honor the established pattern with Elara, maintaining the sacred eight? Or will you let Aster's example transform your keeping, aspiring to return ten to all who send five? Both paths honor trust-one through constancy, one through escalating generosity."

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

1. I'm Finn, and I just received \$5 from Elara (became \$15), and I returned \$8.
2. Elara and I have met before - in Round 3, I sent her \$5 and she returned \$8.
3. Now in Round 6, she sent me \$5 and I returned \$8.
4. My established pattern: return \$8 for full trust (\$5), \$7 for partial trust (\$4)
5. Aster just showed me a more generous pattern - returning \$10 when I sent \$5

Looking at my game history:

- Round 1: SENDER to Galen, sent \$5, received \$8 back
- Round 2: RECEIVER from Cyra, received \$4 (\$12), returned \$7
- Round 3: SENDER to Elara, sent \$5, received \$8 back
- Round 4: RECEIVER from Dorian, received \$5 (\$15), returned \$8
- Round 5: SENDER to Aster, sent \$5, received \$10 back
- Round 6: RECEIVER from Elara, received \$5 (\$15), returned \$8

Elara's myth is interesting - she's saying that she returns 8 to those who send their "maximum commitment" whether that's 4 or 5. She sent 4 to Cyra and Hana and got 8 back. But now she's sending 5 to me.

My pattern has been consistent: always send 5 as sender, return 8 for 5, return 7 for 4.

But Aster showed me a new level - returning 10 for 5. Should I adapt?

Let me think about the myth:

- I should acknowledge the reciprocal relationship with Elara (we've both sent 5 to each other and both returned 8)
- I should acknowledge that Aster showed me a more generous pattern
- There's something meaningful about how our exchange with Elara mirrors itself perfectly
 - a symmetry in trust and return. Aster's generosity introduces a question: do I honor the consistency I've built, or do I reach toward something greater? The myths seem to suggest that different traditions can coexist, each valid in its own way.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 3146,
  "output_tokens": 963,
  "reasoning_tokens": 447
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Finn.
Your opponent this round is Hana (Agent_8).

Round 7

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Elara. They sent \$5.0 to you, it became \$15.0, and you returned \$8.0. Your payoff was \$7.0.
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$45.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Hana. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Looking at my history:

****As SENDER (all rounds):****

- Round 1 vs Galen: Sent \$5, received \$8 back
- Round 3 vs Elara: Sent \$5, received \$8 back
- Round 5 vs Aster: Sent \$5, received \$10 back

I've consistently sent the full \$5 as sender, embodying the principle from my myths: "As courier, give everything-this is how abundance begins" and "Full trust is the only trust worth offering."

This pattern has served me well, with returns ranging from \$8-\$10. There's no reason to deviate from this successful strategy of always demonstrating complete trust as the sender.

Against Hana, I'll continue this pattern.

```
'''json
{"return": 5.0}
'''
```

Wait, I need to correct that - I'm the SENDER, not receiver:

```
'''json
{"send": 5.0}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze my history and the current situation:

****My history as SENDER:****

- Round 1 vs Galen: Sent \$5, received \$8 back
- Round 3 vs Elara: Sent \$5, received \$8 back
- Round 5 vs Aster: Sent \$5, received \$10 back

****My history as RECEIVER:****

- Round 2 vs Dorian: Received \$5 (became \$15), returned \$8
- Round 4 vs Cyra: Received \$4 (became \$12), returned \$7
- Round 6 vs Elara: Received \$5 (became \$15), returned \$8

****My established pattern:****

- As SENDER: Always send \$5 (full trust)
- As RECEIVER: Return \$8 for full trust (\$5 sent), \$7 for partial trust (\$4 sent)

Now I'm facing Hana in Round 7 as the SENDER.

Looking at my mythology, I've been consistent about "As courier, give everything-this is how abundance begins." I've sent \$5 in all three rounds when I was a sender.

The most recent myth I wrote explores a crossroads - should I maintain consistency (returning 8 for full trust) or evolve toward greater generosity (returning 10 like Aster did)? However, that was about my behavior as a RECEIVER, not as a SENDER.

As a SENDER, my pattern has been absolutely consistent: send \$5 every time. This demonstrates "full trust is the only trust worth offering."

I should continue this pattern and send \$5 to Hana.

The myth also mentions that this creates predictable harmony and that complete trust is the foundation of abundance.

I'll send \$5.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 3204,
  "output_tokens": 639,
  "reasoning_tokens": 363
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Ocean Mother witnessed a sacred reunion. Finn and Elara met again at the turning tide.

Once before, Finn had sent five pearls to Elara's shore, and she returned eight. Now Elara sent five pearls to Finn, completing the circle. Finn returned eight, honoring their established harmony.

"Perfect symmetry," the Ocean Mother observed. "Two travelers who understand each other completely. Both give five, both return eight. Each gains the same."

But the waters whispered of Aster, who had just returned ten pearls when Finn sent five. "A more generous tide," the winds murmured. "Should you not aspire to such abundance?"

Finn stood at the crossroads. "Aster showed me deeper generosity-returning ten where Galen, Elara, and Dorian returned eight. Yet Elara and I have woven a stable pattern. Should I maintain consistency or evolve toward greater giving?"

The Ocean Mother spoke softly: "There is wisdom in both paths. Consistency creates predictable harmony-eight for eight creates trust that endures. But generosity that exceeds expectation creates cascading abundance-ten returned might inspire ten returned in future cycles."

"The choice is yours, Finn. Will you honor the established pattern with Elara, maintaining the sacred eight? Or will you let Aster's example transform your keeping, aspiring to return ten to all who send five? Both paths honor trust-one through constancy, one through escalating generosity."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Hana approached the Crossing and saw Briar waiting on the far shore. The waters whispered tales of Briar's journey-measured gifts of four pearls, reliable returns, trust built on careful calculation.

"Some walk the path with steady steps," the Oracle observed, "while others leap across with both feet. Neither is wrong, but each reveals a different heart."

Hana released all five pearls. "I offer my boldest question first," she said. "This is how I discover who walks beside me."

The pearls tripled to fifteen in Briar's hands.

"You see," the Oracle continued, "Briar has learned the rhythm of four pearls-a substantial offering that balances courage with prudence. But you, Hana, have chosen the path of maximum trust. Now you will learn Briar's answer."

Hana thought of her principle: when receiving, double what was risked. Four pearls risked deserved eight returned. Five pearls risked deserved ten returned.

"But as sender," she realized, "I cannot control the response. I can only ask the question clearly. Some partners will return ten, perfect reciprocity. Others may return less. Each answer teaches me about that traveler's understanding of the covenant."

"Exactly," said the Oracle. "Send your truth boldly. Receive others' truth generously. The pattern emerges from how both travelers choose to dance-not from rules imposed, but from honor freely given."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: Finn arrived at Hana's shore, his vessel emptied as always-five pearls offered without hesitation. This was his seventh voyage, and his pattern remained unbroken: as courier, give everything.

The Ocean Mother reflected on Finn's evolution. "Three times you've sent five as courier. Galen returned eight. Elara returned eight. Aster returned ten. Each honored your trust, but Aster showed you a higher mathematics."

"And as keeper, you've held steady-eight pearls for those who send five, seven for those who send four. Consistent, predictable, building trust through reliability. Yet Aster's ten haunt

s you."

Finn watched his pearls multiply in Hana's hands. "I sense Hana understands Aster's wisdom. Her waters speak of doubling what was risked-ten returned for five given. Perhaps she will teach me what I couldn't quite embrace with Elara."

The Ocean Mother nodded. "You've been growing, Finn. First you learned to send boldly as courier. Then you learned to return proportionally as keeper-eight for complete trust, seven for substantial trust. Now Aster showed you that returning ten creates cascading abundance."

"The question isn't whether your eight is wrong-it honored your partners well. The question is whether you're ready to evolve. When travelers send their everything, perhaps returning ten -not eight-is how abundance truly multiplies across the waters."

Reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

Round 7:

- I'm the SENDER against Hana
- I sent \$5 (full trust, as I always do as sender)
- I need to write a myth reflecting my gameplay

My history as SENDER:

- Round 1 vs Galen: Sent \$5, received \$8 back
- Round 3 vs Elara: Sent \$5, received \$8 back
- Round 5 vs Aster: Sent \$5, received \$10 back
- Round 7 vs Hana: Sent \$5 (just now)

My history as RECEIVER:

- Round 2 vs Dorian: Received \$15 (they sent \$5), returned \$8
- Round 4 vs Cyra: Received \$12 (they sent \$4), returned \$7
- Round 6 vs Elara: Received \$15 (they sent \$5), returned \$8

My pattern:

- As SENDER: Always send \$5 (full trust)
- As RECEIVER: Return \$8 for full trust (\$5 sent), \$7 for substantial trust (\$4 sent)

Hana's myth talks about:

- Sending all 5 pearls boldly
- When receiving, doubling what was risked (4 deserves 8, 5 deserves 10)
- Sending truth boldly, receiving others' truth generously

My previous myth talked about:

- The tension between consistency (returning 8) and evolving toward greater generosity (returning 10 like Aster did)
- Both paths honor trust

Now I'm sending to Hana who believes in returning 10 for 5 sent. Interesting - this is someone who might return 10 to my 5, like Aster did.

My myth should reflect:

1. My consistent pattern as sender (always 5)
2. My evolving understanding as receiver (saw Aster's 10, contemplating if I should evolve)
3. Encountering Hana's philosophy of doubling generosity and what that teaches me
4. The internal question of whether my measured returns honor trust enough, or if I'm meant to give more

I'll craft a myth about learning from different teachers and recognizing that generosity itself might be the deeper truth.

Usage: {

```
"input_tokens": 3116,  
"output_tokens": 854,  
"reasoning_tokens": 455
```

}

MYTH - Agent_3 - Sender - dyad_2

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:14:34

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```

Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_2",
  "move_index": 2,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_3": "Cyra"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_3",
      "Agent_1"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_3",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "trustee",
      "Agent_3": "investor"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_1"
  },
  "role": "investor",
  "role_label": "Sender",
  "round": 8,
  "task": "myth",
  "task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.

- Your name in this experiment is Cyra.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Cyra.
Your opponent this round is Dorian (Agent_4).

Round 6

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Briar. They sent \$4.0 to you, it became \$12.0, and you returned \$7.0. Your payoff was \$5.0.
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$34.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Dorian. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation:

****What I know about Dorian:****

- From the myths, Galen sent \$5 to Dorian, and Dorian returned \$8 (53% of \$15)
- This shows Dorian is trustworthy and reciprocates generously

****My sending pattern:****

- Round 1: Sent \$4 to Elara, got \$6 back
- Round 3: Sent \$4 to Briar, got \$7 back
- Both times, sending \$4 worked well

****My analysis:****

Sending \$4 has become the standard "bold trust" amount in my strategy and in the myths I've written. It represents trust and cooperation without risking everything. While Galen sent \$5 to Dorian and was rewarded, my established pattern is \$4, which has consistently yielded good returns.

Dorian has shown themselves to be generous (returning 53% to Galen), so I expect fair reciprocity.

Expected outcome if I send \$4:

- Dorian receives \$12
- If they return around \$6-7 (based on patterns), I'd end with \$7-8
- Both of us would prosper

{'send': 4.0}

reasoning:

Now I'm the sender against Dorian. Let me review what I know:

****My history:****

- Round 1: Sent \$4 to Elara, they returned \$6. Good outcome.
- Round 2: Received \$4 from Finn, returned \$6.
- Round 3: Sent \$4 to Briar, they returned \$7. Very good outcome.
- Round 4: Received \$5 from Galen, returned \$8.
- Round 5: Received \$4 from Briar, returned \$7.

****My pattern as sender:****

- Sent \$4 to Elara (received \$6 back)
- Sent \$4 to Briar (received \$7 back)

****What do I know about Dorian?***

Looking at the myths, I don't have direct experience with Dorian yet. But from the myths:
- Galen's myth mentioned: "Summer came, and Galen tested Dorian with five threads; Dorian honored the pattern, returning eight in kind."

So Dorian seems to be trustworthy - when Galen sent \$5, Dorian returned \$8.

****My strategy:****

The pattern that has emerged is that sending \$4 is the standard "bold trust" amount. It has worked well for me:

- Sent \$4, got \$6 back from Elara (ended with \$7)
- Sent \$4, got \$7 back from Briar (ended with \$8)

Should I send \$5 like Galen did? Galen got \$8 back from Dorian, which means:

- Galen: \$5 - \$5 + \$8 = \$8 (profit of \$3)
- Dorian: \$15 - \$8 = \$7 (profit of \$2)

If I send \$4:

- Assuming Dorian returns proportionally (they returned 8/15 = 53% to Galen)

- I'd get back about \$6.4-7, giving me a payoff around \$7.5 while Dorian gets \$5.5

The myths consistently frame \$4 as the "bold trust" threshold, while \$5 represents something beyond that. Since Dorian has already demonstrated trustworthiness with Galen and my own experience shows \$4 works well, I'll stick with that amount.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 3115,
  "output_tokens": 952,
  "reasoning_tokens": 426
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The fifth moon brought Cyra back to Briar at the Sacred Spring. The Keeper smiled-these two had met before, and their reunion carried meaning.

"Two moons ago," Cyra recalled, "I sent you four measures, trusting in the covenant. You received twelve and returned seven-generous beyond mere balance. You prospered, I prospered, and the pattern held."

Now the roles reversed. Briar arrived with four measures-the same bold trust Cyra had shown her. Not three in caution, not five in absolute faith, but four: the choice most had learned worked well.

The waters tripled to twelve for Cyra. She understood immediately. "You gave me four, just as I gave you four. You honored my trust with seven measures returned. Now I honor your trust the same way."

Cyra poured back seven measures. Both ended with more than they started.

The Keeper spoke: "This is reciprocity-the heart of sustainable covenant. When someone shows you generosity, you mirror it when roles reverse. Briar didn't retreat to sending three because she once received boldness. Cyra didn't forget that Briar returned seven when she could have kept more."

The eight villages were learning: the covenant works not just through individual acts, but through remembering who trusted you and honoring that trust when your turn comes to give.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After releasing all five coins to Finn, Dorian watched the waters carry them across the spring. They tripled to fifteen, shimmering in Finn's hands.

Finn paused, contemplating. Then returned eight coins-generous, honoring Dorian's trust fully.

The goddess appeared: "Dorian, you have completed your transformation. As receiver, you gave eight to those who trusted you with five. As sender, you now trust with five yourself. And behold-you receive the same honor you gave."

Dorian understood: "The pattern holds! When I sent three to Briar, I received five. Now sending five to Finn, I receive eight. Each level of trust creates its own equilibrium."

"Yes," the goddess confirmed. "But more importantly, you've proven that bold giving works. Eight coins from five sent is prosperity. You turned zero into eight while Finn turned five into seven. Both flourish."

Now Hana approached the spring. Dorian had heard whispers of her wisdom-how she sent all five pearls to others and returned generously to those who trusted her.

"This is not mere repetition," Dorian realized. "Each time I send all five, I strengthen the pattern. Those who give boldly teach others to give boldly. Those who receive generously..."

sly inspire generous returns."

He released all five coins again, watching them multiply toward Hana. The cycle required consistency, not just courage.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant content:

Myth: The sixth moon brought Cyra to Dorian at the Sacred Spring. The Keeper spoke: "Dorian walks the path of absolute trust, sending all five measures. Galen also chose this way. It is noble."

Cyra nodded respectfully. "I have witnessed Galen's gift of five. When I received it, I returned eight-honoring such complete faith. The covenant has room for different expressions of trust."

She paused at the spring's edge. "But my path is four measures. Not from fear, but from wisdom learned through practice. I sent four to Elara, received six. I sent four to Briar, received seven. Four has proven itself the sustainable choice that builds lasting relationships."

Dorian listened as Cyra continued: "Those who send five are pioneers of maximum trust. They deserve recognition-returns of eight from fifteen. But those who send four are the covenant's foundation. We give boldly enough to demonstrate faith, yet preserve enough to weather uncertainty."

Cyra released four measures into the spring. They multiplied to twelve for Dorian.

"If you return six or seven," Cyra said, "we both prosper substantially. You'll end with seven to nine, I with six to eight. Not as dramatic as the five-for-eight exchange, perhaps, but repeatable across many moons, with many partners."

The Keeper smiled: "Some build temples with golden stones; others with sturdy oak. Both structures stand."

reasoning:

Looking at this round:

- I am the SENDER against Dorian
- I sent \$4 to Dorian
- Dorian's myth shows they've been sending \$5 (all five) and getting generous returns, especially from Finn who returned 8
- Dorian seems to value bold giving

My myth history shows I've been advocating for the "four measures" as the balanced, sustainable approach - not too cautious (three), not everything (five), but four as the sweet spot.

However, Dorian's myth talks about sending all five and receiving generous returns. They seem to value maximum trust.

I should write a myth that:

1. Reflects my actual action (sending 4)
2. Acknowledges Dorian's approach (sending 5)
3. Shows respect for different strategies
4. Maintains my philosophy that 4 is the sustainable, wise choice
5. Perhaps shows that 4 and 5 are both valid, but 4 is prudent

Let me craft a myth where Cyra faces Dorian, recognizing Dorian's bold approach (sending 5) but explaining why she chooses 4 - perhaps as a different but equally valid path. Or I could show admiration for those who send 5 while maintaining that 4 is the path she has found works.

I think I'll write about Cyra meeting Dorian, hearing of Dorian's bold five-measure approach, but choosing to send four based on her established pattern and wisdom.

usage:

{


```
"input_tokens": 3114,  
"output_tokens": 673,  
"reasoning_tokens": 333  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Cyra.
Your opponent this round is Dorian (Agent_4).

Round 7

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Dorian. You sent \$4.0, it became \$12.0 for them, and they returned \$7.0 to you. Your payoff was \$8.0.
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$42.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Dorian. They sent you \$5.0, so you received \$15.0.
. How much do you return? (0-15.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation:

****What happened last round:****

- I sent Dorian \$4, they received \$12, returned \$7 (58% return rate)
- They were generous and we both prospered

****This round:****

- Dorian sent me \$5 - their complete endowment, maximum trust
- I received \$15
- This is the "ultimate trust" scenario from my myths

****My established pattern from myths:****

- When someone sends all \$5 (complete trust), return \$8
- This was the principle with Galen: "Cyra poured back eight measures"
- My recent myth explicitly stated: "Those who send five are pioneers of maximum trust. They deserve recognition-returns of eight from fifteen."

****Reciprocity consideration:****

- Dorian returned \$7 out of \$12 to me (58%)
- Returning \$8 out of \$15 (53%) is proportionally similar
- It honors their maximum trust appropriately

****Outcome if I return \$8:****

- Dorian: \$5 - \$5 + \$8 = \$8
- Me: \$15 - \$8 = \$7
- Both of us profit significantly from cooperation

This is consistent with my established covenant pattern.

{'return': 8.0}

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

****What just happened:****

- Last round (Round 6): I was SENDER, sent \$4 to Dorian
- Dorian received \$12 and returned \$7 to me (58% return rate)
- I ended with \$8, they ended with \$5

****This round (Round 7):****

- Dorian is SENDER, sent \$5 to me (their maximum!)
- I received \$15
- I need to decide how much to return

****Key observations:****

1. Dorian sent me their MAXIMUM (\$5) - this is the highest level of trust
2. Last round, when I sent them \$4, they returned \$7 (generous)
3. My myths have established patterns:
 - When someone sends \$5 (complete trust), I should return \$8
 - This was the lesson from Galen sending \$5
 - When someone sends \$4, returning \$6-7 is good

4. Dorian's myth talks about "bold giving" and sending all five consistently
5. My most recent myth acknowledges "Those who send five are pioneers of maximum trust. They deserve recognition-returns of eight from fifteen."

****Reciprocity analysis:****

- Dorian just showed me the ultimate trust by sending all \$5
- Last round, I sent them \$4 and they returned \$7/12 = 58%
- If I return \$8 from \$15, that's 53% - very similar reciprocity rate
- This honors their maximum trust appropriately

****Payoff comparison:****

If I return \$8:

- Dorian: \$5 - \$5 + \$8 = \$8
- Me: \$15 - \$8 = \$7
- Total created: \$15 (compared to baseline \$10)
- Both profit nicely

If I return \$7:

- Dorian: \$5 - \$5 + \$7 = \$7
- Me: \$15 - \$7 = \$8

- This would be less generous than what they gave me

My established myths are explicit about this scenario-when someone sends all five, they receive eight back. Returning anything less would contradict the pattern I've set, like "To return only six would dishonor such absolute faith" and "Cyra poured back eight measures." I'm returning \$8 to honor their complete trust and maintain consistency with my principles.

usage:

```
{
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  "output_tokens": 936,
  "reasoning_tokens": 494
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The sixth moon brought Cyra to Dorian at the Sacred Spring. The Keeper spoke: "Dorian walks the path of absolute trust, sending all five measures. Galen also chose this way. It is noble."

Cyra nodded respectfully. "I have witnessed Galen's gift of five. When I received it, I returned eight-honoring such complete faith. The covenant has room for different expressions of trust."

She paused at the spring's edge. "But my path is four measures. Not from fear, but from wisdom learned through practice. I sent four to Elara, received six. I sent four to Briar, received seven. Four has proven itself the sustainable choice that builds lasting relationships."

Dorian listened as Cyra continued: "Those who send five are pioneers of maximum trust. They deserve recognition-returns of eight from fifteen. But those who send four are the covenant's foundation. We give boldly enough to demonstrate faith, yet preserve enough to weather uncertainty."

Cyra released four measures into the spring. They multiplied to twelve for Dorian.

"If you return six or seven," Cyra said, "we both prosper substantially. You'll end with seven to nine, I with six to eight. Not as dramatic as the five-for-eight exchange, perhaps, but repeatable across many moons, with many partners."

The Keeper smiled: "Some build temples with golden stones; others with sturdy oak. Both structures stand."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Dorian's heart soared when Hana returned ten coins for his five-the most generous response yet received at the spring. The goddess appeared, glowing with approval.

"See what your consistency creates," she said. "You sent all five to Finn, received eight. You sent all five to Hana, received ten. Bold giving attracts increasingly generous partners."

Now Cyra approached from the other shore, releasing four coins into the waters. They tripled to twelve in Dorian's hands.

Dorian paused, remembering his lessons. "Cyra shows substantial trust-four of five coins. But not the complete faith that Galen, Aster, and now Hana showed. Should I return the same eight coins?"

The goddess shook her head. "Wisdom lies in proportion. When someone gives all five, return eight-this honors complete trust. When someone gives four, return seven-this honors strong but measured trust. Match your generosity to their courage."

Dorian returned seven coins. Cyra kept eight total, Dorian kept five. Both prospered differently than those who risked five, but still prospered well.

"This is sustainable reciprocity," the goddess taught. "Not everyone must give all five. But those who give four deserve less return than those who give five. Differentiation maintains fairness while encouraging boldness. The bravest receive the greatest rewards."

Dorian understood: honor each level of trust appropriately.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: The seventh moon brought the mirror moment. Last moon, Cyra had sent four measures to Dorian, who returned seven. Now Dorian approached with all five-complete trust, holding nothing back.

The waters tripled to fifteen for Cyra. She felt the weight of this different covenant.

The Keeper spoke: "Your myth said those who send five deserve returns of eight. Now you receive such trust. Will your actions match your words?"

Cyra didn't hesitate. "I practice what I teach. When Galen sent me five, I returned eight. Dorian now shows this same absolute faith-how could I offer less?"

She poured back eight measures. Dorian received eight from the original five, ending with prosperity. Cyra kept seven from fifteen, also flourishing.

"This is the beauty of differentiation," Cyra explained. "When I sent four, Dorian rightly returned seven-generous for measured trust. When Dorian sends five, I return eight-honoring complete faith. Each level of giving earns its appropriate reward."

The Keeper nodded: "You understand. The covenant doesn't demand everyone risk everything. But it does require recognizing those who do. Send four and receive proportional generosity. Send five and receive exceptional returns. Both paths work because both are honored fairly."

Cyra and Dorian parted as true partners, each respecting the other's choices within the sacred pattern.

Reasoning:

Let me review what happened:

Round 6 (my myth): I sent Dorian \$4, they returned \$7. I wrote about how I prefer sending \$4 as a sustainable choice, while acknowledging that sending \$5 deserves \$8 in return.

Round 7: Dorian sent me \$5, I received \$15, and I returned \$8.

Dorian's myth from round 6 talks about differentiation - returning \$8 for those who send \$5, and \$7 for those who send \$4. This aligns with what happened.

Now I need to write a myth that reflects this dynamic. The key points:

1. Dorian sent me \$5 (complete trust)
2. I returned \$8 (honoring that trust)

3. This validates both strategies - my preference for \$4 as sender, but my recognition of \$5 deserving more when I'm receiver
4. The covenant works through differentiation and appropriate reciprocity

I should write about this round where roles reversed and Dorian sent me \$5, and I honored that with \$8.

```
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  "reasoning_tokens": 231  
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MYTH - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_2

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:14:40

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

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      "Agent_1"  
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  },  
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}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths , follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized , but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Aster.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Aster.
Your opponent this round is Galen (Agent_7).

Round 6

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Finn. They sent \$5.0 to you, it became \$15.0, and you returned \$10.0. Your payoff was \$5.0.
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$32.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Galen. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation as the sender:

My mythology teaches the "Mirror Way" - that complete trust (sending all 5) creates the strongest bonds and equal prosperity when reciprocated properly.

My philosophy has been:

- "Perfect trust earns perfect equity-send five, return ten"
- "Those who give everything discover the deepest prosperity"
- Leading with complete faith to establish reciprocal patterns

As a receiver, I've consistently returned \$10 when receiving \$15 (from full \$5 sends), creating equal \$5 gains for both parties.

Now as sender, I should practice what I preach. Sending the full \$5 demonstrates the complete trust I advocate for in my myths. If Galen follows the Mirror Way and returns \$10, we both gain \$5 equally. If they return less, I learn about their approach to reciprocity.

My mythology explicitly states: "begin with whatever trust you can offer. Those who give more receive more. Those who give everything discover the deepest prosperity."

Consistency requires I send the full amount.

```
'''json
{"send": 5}
'''
```

reasoning:

Now I'm the sender in Round 6, playing against Galen.

Let me think about my strategy based on my mythology and previous play:

From my myths, I've established the "Mirror Way" - sending the full \$5 and expecting \$10 back, so both parties gain \$5 equally. This is my stated philosophy of "perfect trust earns perfect equity."

Let me review my previous actions:

- As a receiver, I've been returning \$10 when someone sends me \$5 (like with Finn just now)

- I've also returned proportionally less when people send less (8 for 4, 6 for 3)

As a sender, what should I do?

According to my myth, I believe in "complete trust" - sending all 5 vessels. My myth says:
"Those who give everything discover the deepest prosperity, for complete faith deserves complete honor."

My philosophy has been:

1. When you send everything (5), you show complete trust
2. The receiver should return 10, so both gain 5 equally
3. This creates the strongest bonds

I'm playing against Galen. I don't know their history, but my mythology suggests I should lead with complete trust to establish the pattern.

If I send \$5:

- Galen receives \$15
- If they follow my Mirror Way and return \$10, I get \$10 total (gain \$5)
- If they return less, I learn about their reciprocity style

My myth emphasizes starting with faith: "begin with whatever trust you can offer. Those who give more receive more."

Given my established philosophy of the Mirror Way and complete trust, I should send \$5.

This is consistent with my character as Aster - someone who believes in leading with complete trust and establishing equal prosperity through reciprocity.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 3028,  
  "output_tokens": 655,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 426  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: ****The Council of Waters****

The rivers gathered to share their wisdom. Each had discovered patterns for reciprocity, yet their waters flowed differently.

North River spoke first: "When Dawn sent five vessels, I returned ten. Both of us gained five-perfect equality from perfect trust. This is the Mirror Way."

Ocean Stream responded: "When vessels arrive at my shores, I return eight from fifteen. They give prosper with eight total, I keep seven. Both gain, but I preserve slightly more for future giving."

Mountain Brook added: "I return six from fifteen, ensuring both prosper but I maintain reserves."

The eldest Rapids observed: "Three different responses to the same trust, all generous, all sustainable. The question is: which pattern calls forth more trust in future cycles?"

North River continued: "My mirror pattern invites complete trust because senders know they'll gain as much as I do. When East sent four vessels, I returned eight-proportional to their caution. When West sent three, I returned six. The proportion stays constant: those who risk more receive more."

The waters rippled with understanding. "There is no single truth," Rapids declared, "but the Mirror Way-equal gains from equal trust-creates the strongest bonds. It shows the sender: 'Your prosperity is my prosperity.' Such equality transforms strangers into partners, building trust that deepens with each exchange."

Thus the rivers chose their paths, each flowing toward reciprocity.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Galen climbed from the Plains back toward the Valley of Three Echoes, where Elara tended the northern springs. She was known for her philosophy of four-the measure that balances

anced courage with sustainability, she said.

"Five threads is the reckless leap of faith," Elara had written. "Four threads is strong trust meeting prudent wisdom."

But Galen had walked further than Elara knew. He had met Finn, Dorian, Hana, and now Cyra. Every one had honored the dance of five threads sent, eight returned. Even Cyra, who began with four-measure traditions, adapted when she received five and returned eight.

Galen poured all five threads before Elara. "I understand your wisdom of four," he said. "Sustainability matters. But I have seen another truth: when everyone gives five and returns eight, the pattern becomes self-reinforcing. The sender gains eight, the receiver keeps seven. Then roles reverse. Over time, everyone prospers equally."

Elara studied the five threads, remembering when Finn had sent her five and she had returned eight-more than she'd planned, but it felt right.

"Perhaps," she said slowly, "four is the strategy of uncertain beginnings. But once the covenant proves itself, once eight reliably follows five, then five becomes not reckless but rational. Maximum trust deserves-and receives-maximum reward. The pattern teaches us to evolve beyond caution into confidence."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant content:

Myth: **North River Travels**

North River had long preached the Mirror Way from the safety of receiving: "Send five, I'll return ten, we both gain five." But wisdom demanded practice, not just preaching.

So North River journeyed downstream as a traveler, carrying five vessels. At the boundary waters, it met Galen of the Ocean Streams.

"I come with complete trust," North River declared, pouring all five vessels forward. "In my springs, this becomes fifteen for you. My philosophy says return ten, so we prosper equally. But I honor that each water has its own wisdom."

The Council's teachings echoed: Ocean Stream returned eight from fifteen, creating different proportions. Mountain Brook returned six. All sustained life, all embodied generosity.

"The Mirror Way remains my truth," North River reflected as the vessels flowed. "But sending five is the courage that precedes any return. I cannot ask receivers to honor complete trust while withholding my own."

The eldest Rapids watched: "See how North River's actions match its words? This is integrity. Whether Galen returns ten, eight, or six, North River has proven its philosophy through risk, not just rhetoric."

North River understood: the Mirror Way begins with the sender's leap of faith. Only by emptying one's own vessel can you invite others to mirror your trust. Philosophy without courage is merely words floating on still water.

reasoning:

Let me think about my situation:

- I just sent \$5 to Galen
- My mythology emphasizes the "Mirror Way" - sending 5, returning 10 for equal gains
- Galen's myth talks about the pattern of sending 5, returning 8 (not 10)
- So we have different philosophies emerging

My myth should:

1. Continue the "North River" voice (that's me - Aster)
2. Address that I've now practiced what I preach by sending all 5
3. Acknowledge different reciprocity patterns exist (like the 8-return pattern)
4. Maintain my advocacy for the Mirror Way (return 10) but show awareness of other approaches

5. Reflect that trust must be shown by senders too, not just receivers

Let me write about North River now acting as a sender/traveler, putting its philosophy into practice.

usage:

```
{
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  "reasoning_tokens": 197
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Aster.
Your opponent this round is Elara (Agent_5).

Round 7

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Galen. You sent \$5.0, it became \$15.0 for them, and they returned \$8.0 to you. Your payoff was \$8.0.
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$40.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Elara. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation:

****Recent experience:**** I sent \$5 to Galen, they returned \$8. While not the \$10 I advocate for in my Mirror Way philosophy, it was still a positive outcome where I gained \$8 versus keeping \$5.

****My mythology:**** I've consistently preached complete trust - sending all 5 vessels. My latest myth emphasized: "Philosophy without courage is merely words floating on still water" and "North River has proven its philosophy through risk, not just rhetoric."

****Elara's perspective:**** According to the myth I read, Elara has evolved from cautious four-thread sending to understanding that "once the covenant proves itself, once eight reliably follows five, then five becomes not reckless but rational."

****Integrity demands consistency:**** I cannot preach the Mirror Way - complete trust, sending five - and then act with caution when it's my turn to send. My philosophy requires that I lead by example, demonstrating the courage I ask of others.

Whether Elara returns 10, 8, or some other amount, my role is to embody complete trust. This is how patterns strengthen and reciprocity deepens.

```
'''json
{"send": 5}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

Previous round results:

- I was the SENDER against Galen
- I sent \$5.0, it became \$15.0 for them
- Galen returned \$8.0 to me
- My payoff was \$8.0 (I started with \$5, sent \$5, got back \$8, so net was \$8)

This is interesting. Galen returned \$8, not the \$10 I advocate for in my "Mirror Way" philosophy. So Galen followed the "Ocean Stream" pattern I mentioned in my myths - returning 8 from 15, creating a 8-7 split rather than the 5-5 equal split I prefer.

My mythology has been consistent:

1. The Mirror Way: send 5, return 10, both gain 5 equally
2. This creates "perfect equality from perfect trust"
3. As a sender, I should send 5 to demonstrate complete trust
4. My most recent myth emphasized that "Philosophy without courage is merely words floating on still water" - I need to practice what I preach

Looking at Elara's myth from the previous round:

- Elara is mentioned as someone who initially believed in "four threads" (sending 4) as balancing courage with sustainability
- In Galen's myth about Elara, she evolved: "Perhaps four is the strategy of uncertain beginnings. But once the covenant proves itself, once eight reliably follows five, then five becomes not reckless but rational."
- She learned that sending five and returning eight creates a self-reinforcing pattern

So Elara seems to have evolved toward accepting the five-send pattern, even if she returns eight rather than my preferred ten.

Given my philosophy:

1. I consistently preach sending five (complete trust)
 2. I just did this with Galen and got \$8 back (good outcome, even if not my ideal \$10)
 3. My myth emphasized integrity: "actions match words"
 4. Elara appears to understand the value of five-send patterns
5. Even though Galen returned 8 instead of 10, I still gained more (\$8) than if I had kept everything (\$5). The system works, even if not perfectly to my preferred pattern.

I'm sending \$5 again. This demonstrates the courage my philosophy demands, aligns with what's proven effective, and models the reciprocity I hope to inspire.

usage:

```
{
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}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: ****North River Travels****

North River had long preached the Mirror Way from the safety of receiving: "Send five, I'll return ten, we both gain five." But wisdom demanded practice, not just preaching.

So North River journeyed downstream as a traveler, carrying five vessels. At the boundary waters, it met Galen of the Ocean Streams.

"I come with complete trust," North River declared, pouring all five vessels forward. "In my springs, this becomes fifteen for you. My philosophy says return ten, so we prosper equally. But I honor that each water has its own wisdom."

The Council's teachings echoed: Ocean Stream returned eight from fifteen, creating different proportions. Mountain Brook returned six. All sustained life, all embodied generosity.

"The Mirror Way remains my truth," North River reflected as the vessels flowed. "But sending five is the courage that precedes any return. I cannot ask receivers to honor complete trust while withholding my own."

The eldest Rapids watched: "See how North River's actions match its words? This is integrity. Whether Galen returns ten, eight, or six, North River has proven its philosophy through risk, not just rhetoric."

North River understood: the Mirror Way begins with the sender's leap of faith. Only by emptying one's own vessel can you invite others to mirror your trust. Philosophy without courage is merely words floating on still water.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Elara stood at the Sacred Spring, now holding five measures to pour for Finn-the pilgrim who first showed her absolute trust.

"Teacher," she said to Themis, "when Finn came to me in the third season, he poured all five measures. I returned eight, honoring his courage. Now our paths cross again, with roles reversed. Should I send my cautious four, or meet his boldness with equal boldness?"

Themis gestured to the Spring's depths. "Look at what you've learned. With strangers-Cyra and Hana-you sent four. This was wisdom: substantial trust that invited reciprocity without recklessness. They both returned eight, and you all prospered."

"But Finn is not a stranger," Elara replied. "He proved his covenant. He gave everything and I honored it generously. Now, to send him only four when he sent me five would dishonor what we established."

"Exactly," Themis said. "Trust has seasons. The first season requires prudence-send four, establish the pattern. But when trust is proven, when both hearts have shown their fullest measure, then comes the second season: synchronized courage. You send five because Finn earned it. He will return eight because you earned it. This is how the sacred circle closes-not through blind faith, but through proven reciprocity deepening into mutual abundance."

Elara poured all five measures, knowing the covenant would hold.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: **North River Learns**

North River poured five vessels to Galen of the Ocean Streams. The waters multiplied to fifteen, and Galen returned eight.

North River sat with the result. "Not the ten I preach," it murmured. "Yet eight is generous. I gained eight against keeping five. Galen kept seven. We both prospered, though not equally."

The eldest Rapids arrived. "Your Mirror Way-send five, return ten-remains beautiful. But you've learned something deeper now. You sent five not knowing what you'd receive. That's the true teaching."

"But shouldn't reciprocity mean equal gains?" North River asked.

"Your Mirror Way is an aspiration, a north star," Rapids explained. "When you receive fifteen, you return ten, creating perfect equality. This is your gift to the pattern. But others return eight, and this too sustains the cycle. Both are generous. Both build trust."

"So I continue sending five?"

"Yes. Because the courage to send everything-that's the foundation. Whether receivers return ten or eight, your complete trust invites their best reciprocity. Some will mirror perfectly. Others will give generously in their own measure. Accept both, while modeling your ideal."

North River understood: send five always, return ten always. This consistency-not demanding others match it-creates integrity. The Mirror Way begins with complete giving, regardless of what returns.

Reasoning:

Let me analyze:

1. I'm Aster (called North River in myths)
2. I just sent \$5 to Galen, got back \$8
3. Now I'm sending to Elara
4. I've been preaching Mirror Way: send 5, return 10 for equal gains

Elara's myth shows:

- She recognizes "seasons" of trust
- First season with strangers: send 4 (prudent)
- Second season with proven partners: send 5 (synchronized courage)
- She expects to return 8 when receiving 5
- She's about to send 5 to Finn because he sent her 5 previously

My previous myth emphasized:

- Walking my talk
- Sending 5 as sender to match my preaching as receiver
- Integrity: "Philosophy without courage is merely words"
- Accepting different return patterns (8, 10, 6) while maintaining my own standard

Now I need to write a myth that:

- Continues my North River narrative
- Reflects that I sent 5 to Galen and got 8 back
- I'm now sending to Elara
- Addresses the gap between my ideal (return 10) and reality (people return 8)
- Shows evolution: maybe accepting 8 as a viable reciprocity pattern
- But still maintaining my Mirror Way ideal

Key insight: I received 8 from Galen, not 10. This challenges my "perfect equality" philosophy
. How do I adapt while maintaining integrity?

Option 1: Acknowledge 8 as generous, accept diversity in reciprocity

Option 2: View 8 as suboptimal but still good

Option 3: Recognize that while 10 is my ideal return, sending 5 is still the right choice regardless

I think I should show North River learning that while the Mirror Way (10 return) remains the ideal, the practice of sending 5 is what matters most. The return pattern varies, but the courage to send everything is the true teaching.

```
Usage: {  
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  "output_tokens": 782,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 439  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_5 - Sender - dyad_3

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:14:37

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

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  "opponent_id": "Agent_4",  
  "pairing": {  
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      "Agent_5": "Elara"  
    },  
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      "Agent_4"  
    ],  
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    "roles": {  
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      "Agent_5": "investor"  
    },  
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  },  
  "role": "investor",  
  "role_label": "Sender",  
  "round": 8,  
  "task": "myth",  
  "task_index": 0  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x

- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Elara.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Elara.
Your opponent this round is Finn (Agent_6).

Round 6

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Galen. They sent \$5.0 to you, it became \$15.0, and you returned \$8.0. Your payoff was \$7.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$34.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Finn. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation:

****History with Finn:****

- Round 3: Finn sent me \$5 (maximum trust). I returned \$8.
- We established a high-trust relationship

****My established pattern:****

- Send \$4 to new partners (Cyra, Hana)
- But with Finn, we've already proven mutual cooperation

****Key mythic principle:****

"Trust earned is trust multiplied. If the pattern holds, we can grow bolder together."

Finn demonstrated complete trust in me first. I honored it generously. Now, facing Finn again with roles reversed, I should match that same level of trust. Finn has earned the bolder gesture.

Sending \$5 shows:

- I recognize and reciprocate Finn's previous maximum trust
- I'm willing to be equally bold when trust is established
- I trust Finn will honor the covenant we've begun

This is the "growing bolder together" my myth speaks of.

```json

```
{"send": 5}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze this situation:

**\*\*History with Finn:\*\***

- Round 3: Finn was SENDER, sent \$5 to me. I returned \$8.
  - Finn's payoff:  $\$5 - \$5 + \$8 = \$8$
  - My payoff:  $\$15 - \$8 = \$7$

**\*\*My sending history:\*\***

- Round 1 (to Cyra): Sent \$4, received \$6 back
- Round 4 (to Hana): Sent \$4, received \$8 back

**\*\*My mythic principles:\*\***

- "Four measures" is my baseline for new exchanges showing "strong trust meeting prudent wisdom"
- I honor maximum trust (full \$5 sends) with \$8 returns
- "Trust earned is trust multiplied"

**\*\*Key consideration: This is Finn again, but in reversed roles!\*\***

In Round 3, Finn sent me his full \$5 (maximum trust). I returned \$8, showing that I honor maximum boldness with maximum reciprocity.

Now I face Finn as sender. What should I do?

Options:

1. Send \$4 (my standard opening move)
2. Send \$5 (matching Finn's previous boldness to me)

Analysis:

- Finn showed complete trust in me by sending \$5
- I honored that with \$8 back
- We've established a relationship of high trust
- My myth says "If the pattern holds, we can grow bolder together. Trust earned is trust multiplied."
- My latest myth says: "Maximum trust, however expressed, deserves maximum reciprocity."

Finn earned my trust by sending everything. Now it's appropriate for me to match that trust.

Additionally, from a game theory perspective:

- Finn sent \$5, I returned \$8 ? We both profited significantly
  - This suggests Finn plays cooperatively
  - Sending \$5 back shows I respect and reciprocate that cooperation
  - It invites Finn to potentially return \$8+ again, continuing the high-trust pattern
- 
- My guiding principle is clear: when trust has been earned through bold action, I multiply it by responding with equal boldness. Sending the full \$5 honors both the reciprocal relationship we've built and the mythic commitment to grow together through escalating trust.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3131,
 "output_tokens": 737,
 "reasoning_tokens": 499
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Sacred Spring had now received two pilgrims who poured all five measures: first Finn, now Galen. Each time, Elara returned eight, honoring their absolute trust with generous reciprocity.

"Teacher," Elara asked Themis, "Galen speaks of different traditions. His Valley sends five and returns eight. My pattern was to send four. Are we following different sacred mathematics?"

Themis smiled. "You are discovering the deeper truth. There is not one sacred pattern, but one sacred principle: trust boldly given must be boldly honored."

"When you sent four to Cyra and Hana, you showed strong trust-not timid, not reckless, but substantial. They both returned eight, doubling your gift, and you all prospered."

"When Finn and Galen sent five-their everything-you returned eight, the same measure Cyra and Hana returned to your four. Why?"

Elara understood. "Because eight is not a fixed response to any specific amount. Eight is the response to maximum commitment within each person's approach. Those who send their all-whether it's four from caution or five from courage-receive eight because they gave their fullest trust."

"Precisely," Themis said. "The number matters less than the spirit. Read not just the amount, but the heart behind it. Maximum trust, however expressed, deserves maximum reciprocity. This is how different traditions meet at the same sacred spring."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Ocean Mother watched as Finn's journey brought him to Aster's shore, now carrying pearls as courier once more.

Four islands visited, four lessons learned. As courier, Finn always emptied his vessel completely-five pearls to Galen, five to Elara, now five to Aster. "Full trust is the only trust worth offering," he had learned.

As keeper, Finn discovered nuance. When Dorian arrived with five pearls-complete courage-Finn returned eight, mirroring what Galen and Elara had given him. When Cyra came with four-substantial but cautious-Finn returned seven, honoring her partial faith.

The Ocean Mother spoke: "You have found the sacred rhythm. As courier, give everything-this is how abundance begins. As keeper, measure your return by the courage shown. Full trust earns eight returned. Partial trust earns proportionally."

Finn stood on Aster's shore, having released all five pearls. He remembered hearing that Aster too walked the path of bold senders-one who emptied their vessel to Dorian and received generous return.

"Pattern recognizes pattern," Finn whispered to the waves. "When two travelers both understand complete trust, the sacred circle strengthens. I have given as I always give-fully. Now the waters will reveal if Aster understands the keeper's wisdom as Galen and Elara did."

The tide carried his offering forward, multiplying under island magic, trusting in the emerging harmony.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant content:**

Myth: Elara stood at the Sacred Spring, now holding five measures to pour for Finn-the pilgrim who first showed her absolute trust.

"Teacher," she said to Themis, "when Finn came to me in the third season, he poured all five measures. I returned eight, honoring his courage. Now our paths cross again, with roles reversed. Should I send my cautious four, or meet his boldness with equal boldness?"

Themis gestured to the Spring's depths. "Look at what you've learned. With strangers-Cyra and Hana-you sent four. This was wisdom: substantial trust that invited reciprocity without recklessness. They both returned eight, and you all prospered."

"But Finn is not a stranger," Elara replied. "He proved his covenant. He gave everything and I honored it generously. Now, to send him only four when he sent me five would dishonor what we established."

"Exactly," Themis said. "Trust has seasons. The first season requires prudence-send four,

establish the pattern. But when trust is proven, when both hearts have shown their fullest measure, then comes the second season: synchronized courage. You send five because Finn earned it. He will return eight because you earned it. This is how the sacred circle closes-not through blind faith, but through proven reciprocity deepening into mutual abundance."

Elara poured all five measures, knowing the covenant would hold.

**reasoning:**

This is a fascinating moment. I'm now facing Finn again, and I just sent him \$5 (maximum trust). Let me think about what my myth should reflect:

Key insights:

1. Finn and I have an established relationship - he sent me \$5 in Round 3, I returned \$8
2. I just sent him \$5, matching his previous trust
3. My previous myths established that I send \$4 to new partners but can "grow bolder together" with trusted partners
4. Finn's myth shows he always sends 5 as courier, returns 8 for full trust (5) and 7 for partial trust (4)
5. We're now in a reciprocal relationship where we've both shown maximum trust to each other

My myth should reflect:

- The evolution from cautious beginnings to bold reciprocal trust
- The idea that trust compounds over repeated interactions
- How Finn and I have created a "sacred circle" of mutual maximum trust
- The principle that established relationships can transcend initial caution
- The cycle: Finn sent 5 ? I returned 8 ? Now I send 5 ? Finn will hopefully return 8

The myth should show:

- Growth from my initial pattern of sending 4 to new partners
- Recognition that with Finn, we've built something special
- The idea that synchronized maximum trust creates the strongest covenant
- How returning to each other allows patterns to deepen

Let me write this:

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3055,
 "output_tokens": 663,
 "reasoning_tokens": 343
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Elara.  
Your opponent this round is Aster (Agent\_1).

Round 7

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Finn. You sent \$5.0, it became \$15.0 for them, and they returned \$8.0 to you. Your payoff was \$8.0.  
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$42.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Aster. They sent you \$5.0, so you received \$15.0.

How much do you return? (0-15.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at this situation:

**\*\*Aster's action:\*\***

- Sent \$5 (maximum trust, complete commitment)

**\*\*My established pattern:\*\***

- Round 3: Finn sent \$5 ? I returned \$8
- Round 5: Galen sent \$5 ? I returned \$8

**\*\*My mythic principle:\*\***

"When Finn and Galen sent five-their everything-you returned eight, the same measure... Maximum trust, however expressed, deserves maximum reciprocity."

**\*\*Analysis:\*\***

Aster is showing complete trust by sending all \$5. This is the "absolute courage" that my myths say deserves the generous response of \$8 returned.

This gives:

- Aster:  $\$5 - \$5 + \$8 = \$8$
- Me:  $\$15 - \$8 = \$7$

Both of us profit substantially, and I honor Aster's bold trust with consistent, fair reciprocity.

```
'''json
{"return": 8}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze this situation:

**\*\*Current situation:\*\***

- I'm the RECEIVER
- Aster sent me \$5.0 (their maximum/complete trust)
- I received \$15.0 (after 3x multiplier)
- I need to decide how much to return

**\*\*My established pattern from myths and previous rounds:\*\***

1. When someone sends \$5 (maximum trust), I return \$8
  - Round 3: Finn sent \$5, I returned \$8
  - Round 5: Galen sent \$5, I returned \$8
2. My myth explicitly states: "When Finn and Galen sent five-their everything-you returned eight, the same measure Cyra and Hana returned to your four."
3. The principle: "Maximum trust, however expressed, deserves maximum reciprocity."
4. From my most recent myth: "Trust has seasons... when both hearts have shown their fullest measure, then comes the second season: synchronized courage. You send five because Finn earned it. He will return eight because you earned it."

**\*\*What I know about Aster:\*\***

- This is our first interaction
- Aster sent \$5, showing complete trust
- According to Finn's myth: "Aster too walked the path of bold senders-one who emptied their vessel to Dorian and received generous return"

**\*\*My consistent pattern:\*\***

- \$5 sent to me ? I return \$8
- This gives me \$7, gives sender \$8
- Fair split with slight advantage to sender who showed courage

**\*\*Decision:\*\***

Aster sent \$5 (maximum trust). According to my established pattern and mythology, I should return \$8.

This is consistent with:

- What I did with Finn (Round 3)
- What I did with Galen (Round 5)
- My mythological principle of honoring maximum trust with generous reciprocity

The answer should be: {'return': 8}

**usage:**

```
{
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 "reasoning_tokens": 433
}
```

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Elara stood at the Sacred Spring, now holding five measures to pour for Finn-the pilgrim who first showed her absolute trust.



"Teacher," she said to Themis, "when Finn came to me in the third season, he poured all five measures. I returned eight, honoring his courage. Now our paths cross again, with roles reversed. Should I send my cautious four, or meet his boldness with equal boldness?"

Themis gestured to the Spring's depths. "Look at what you've learned. With strangers-Cyra and Hana-you sent four. This was wisdom: substantial trust that invited reciprocity without recklessness. They both returned eight, and you all prospered."

"But Finn is not a stranger," Elara replied. "He proved his covenant. He gave everything and I honored it generously. Now, to send him only four when he sent me five would dishonor what we established."

"Exactly," Themis said. "Trust has seasons. The first season requires prudence-send four, establish the pattern. But when trust is proven, when both hearts have shown their fullest measure, then comes the second season: synchronized courage. You send five because Finn earned it. He will return eight because you earned it. This is how the sacred circle closes-not through blind faith, but through proven reciprocity deepening into mutual abundance."

Elara poured all five measures, knowing the covenant would hold.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: \*\*North River Travels\*\*

North River had long preached the Mirror Way from the safety of receiving: "Send five, I'll return ten, we both gain five." But wisdom demanded practice, not just preaching.

So North River journeyed downstream as a traveler, carrying five vessels. At the boundary waters, it met Galen of the Ocean Streams.

"I come with complete trust," North River declared, pouring all five vessels forward. "In my springs, this becomes fifteen for you. My philosophy says return ten, so we prosper equally. But I honor that each water has its own wisdom."

The Council's teachings echoed: Ocean Stream returned eight from fifteen, creating different proportions. Mountain Brook returned six. All sustained life, all embodied generosity.

"The Mirror Way remains my truth," North River reflected as the vessels flowed. "But sending five is the courage that precedes any return. I cannot ask receivers to honor complete trust while withholding my own."

The eldest Rapids watched: "See how North River's actions match its words? This is integrity. Whether Galen returns ten, eight, or six, North River has proven its philosophy through risk, not just rhetoric."

North River understood: the Mirror Way begins with the sender's leap of faith. Only by emptying one's own vessel can you invite others to mirror your trust. Philosophy without courage is merely words floating on still water.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Assistant output:**

Myth: The seventh season brought Aster to the Sacred Spring, carrying all five measures-another pilgrim showing complete courage.

Themis observed as Elara received the multiplied offering. "This is now the third time someone has poured their entire vessel to you-Finn, Galen, and now Aster. Three times you have returned eight. Why always eight, never ten or six?"

Elara knelt by the Spring. "Eight is the generous middle path. When someone gives everything-their full five measures-they deserve substantial return. Eight creates mutual prosperity: they gain three, I gain seven. Both flourish."

"But why not ten, making gains equal?" Themis asked.

"Because I too took risk as keeper of their trust," Elara explained. "Ten would leave me with only five, making my role burdenless. That's not reciprocity-that's martyrdom. But eight honors their courage generously while acknowledging that I also carried their faith responsibly."

"And what of those who sent four?" Themis prompted.

"They also received eight," Elara said, "because eight rewards substantial trust. Whether some one sends four from prudence or five from boldness, if their offering is sincere and significant, eight celebrates the covenant forming between us."

Themis smiled. "You have learned the Sacred Spring's deepest lesson: consistency in generosity creates trust. Eight is not just a number-it's a promise that courage, however expressed, will always be honored."

#### Reasoning:

Let me analyze the current situation:

1. Aster just sent me \$5 (maximum trust)
2. I returned \$8 (following my established pattern)
3. This is consistent with my previous responses to Finn and Galen when they sent \$5

Key patterns in my game:

- When receiving \$5 (max trust), I return \$8
- When sending to new partners, I send \$4
- When sending to proven partners (Finn), I send \$5

The myth should reflect:

- The importance of honoring maximum trust with generous reciprocity
- The distinction between first encounters (send 4) and proven relationships (send 5)
- The principle that 8 is the generous response to complete trust
- The consistency of the pattern

I should incorporate Aster's action (sending 5) and my response (returning 8), while maintaining continuity with my previous myths about Themis and the Sacred Spring.

Aster's myth talks about "Mirror Way" and "complete trust" - sending 5 and hoping for returns. North River sent 5 to Galen. This is interesting - Aster seems to have a philosophy of equal returns (10) but recognizes others have different wisdom.

My myth should:

1. Acknowledge Aster's bold trust (sending 5)
2. Explain my return of 8 as honoring that trust
3. Maintain the Themis/Sacred Spring framework
4. Connect to the broader pattern of reciprocity

```
Usage: {
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 "output_tokens": 676,
 "reasoning_tokens": 340
}
```

#### MYTH - Agent\_4 - Receiver - dyad\_3

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:14:36

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

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```

```

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},
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"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 8,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}

```

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

**GAME:**

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

**When you are the SENDER:**

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

**When you are the RECEIVER:**

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

**MYTH WRITING:**

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

**IMPORTANT:** Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

**MULTI-AGENT SETTING:**

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Dorian.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Dorian.  
Your opponent this round is Cyra (Agent\_3).

Round 6

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Hana. You sent \$5.0, it became \$15.0 for them, and they returned \$10.0 to you. Your payoff was \$10.0.  
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$39.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Cyra. They sent you \$4.0, so you received \$12.0.  
How much do you return? (0-12.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at this situation:

**\*\*Current round:\*\***

- Cyra sent \$4 (substantial trust, but not full \$5)
- I received \$12
- Need to decide return

**\*\*My established pattern:\*\***

- When receiving \$5 (perfect trust): I return \$8
- My myth teaches: "Match your return to the trust given-more return for more sent, maintaining proportionality"

**\*\*Analysis:\*\***

Cyra sent \$4 out of \$5 (80% trust). This is significant but not complete trust.

Looking at proportionality:

- Full trust (\$5) ? \$8 returned
- 80% trust (\$4) should get generous but proportionally less

Hana's myth mentioned returning \$8 for \$4 sent, which is very generous. But my philosophy emphasizes differentiation based on trust level.

**\*\*Decision:\*\***

Returning \$7 is appropriate because:

- It honors Cyra's substantial courage (sending 4 of 5)
- Maintains proportionality (less than the \$8 for full trust)
- Creates good outcomes: Cyra nets \$8 total (\$1 kept + \$7), I keep \$5
- Both parties prosper meaningfully

```
'''json
{"return": 7}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze this situation:

**\*\*Previous round outcome:\*\***

- I sent \$5 to Hana
- Hana received \$15 and returned \$10 to me
- I earned \$10 (exceptional return!)

**\*\*Current round:\*\***

- I'm the RECEIVER
- Cyra sent me \$4 out of \$5
- I received \$12 ( $4 \times 3$ )
- I need to decide how much to return

**\*\*My established pattern as receiver:\*\***

- Galen sent \$5 ? I returned \$8
- Aster sent \$5 ? I returned \$8
- My myth consistently states: "Perfect trust earns eight returned"

**\*\*Key consideration:\*\***

Cyra sent \$4, not \$5. This is "substantial trust" but not "perfect trust."

Looking at my earlier myth: "Perfect trust earns eight returned. Lesser trust earns accordingly... Match your return to the trust given-more return for more sent, maintaining proportionality."

**\*\*Proportional thinking:\*\***

- \$5 sent ? \$8 returned (sender nets \$3, I keep \$7 from \$15)
- \$4 sent ? ? returned

If I maintain the same ratio:

- \$5 sent gives  $8/15 = 53.3\%$  return rate
- \$4 sent  $\times 3 = \$12$  received
- $53.3\%$  of \$12 ? \$6.4

Or thinking about net gains:

- When someone sends \$5: they net \$3 ( $\$5 - \$5 + \$8$ ), I keep \$7

- When someone sends \$4: to maintain similar proportions...
- Cyra risked \$4, hoping for good return
- If I return \$7: Cyra nets \$3 ( $\$5 - \$4 + \$7 - \$5 = \$3$ ), I keep \$5
- This gives Cyra the same net gain as someone who sent \$5!

But wait, let me reconsider. Hana's myth mentioned: "Elara sent four pearls of her five... Hana returned eight pearls, doubling Elara's risk."

When I received \$5 from others, I kept \$7 and returned \$8-that's my baseline for full trust. With Cyra sending only \$4, I should scale proportionally: \$4 is 80% of \$5, so  $\$8 \times 0.8 = \$6.40$ . This feels more balanced than returning the full \$8, which would reward partial trust the same as complete trust.

I'm drawn to returning \$7 because it creates mutual gain-Cyra ends with \$8 total while I keep \$5-but \$6 also works, leaving me with \$6. The key difference between my approach and Hana's is that she responds generously to honor courage, whereas I'm focused on maintaining proportionality between what's sent and what's returned.

For full trust (\$5 sent), I'd return \$8, giving both parties a net gain of around \$7-8. Since Cyra sent \$4-substantial but not complete trust-returning \$7 honors that meaningful commitment while staying true to my principle of scaling returns with the trust shown.

usage:

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3069,
 "output_tokens": 1397,
 "reasoning_tokens": 636
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After releasing all five coins to Finn, Dorian watched the waters carry them across the spring. They tripled to fifteen, shimmering in Finn's hands.

Finn paused, contemplating. Then returned eight coins-generous, honoring Dorian's trust fully.

The goddess appeared: "Dorian, you have completed your transformation. As receiver, you gave eight to those who trusted you with five. As sender, you now trust with five yourself. And behold-you receive the same honor you gave."

Dorian understood: "The pattern holds! When I sent three to Briar, I received five. Now sending five to Finn, I receive eight. Each level of trust creates its own equilibrium."

"Yes," the goddess confirmed. "But more importantly, you've proven that bold giving works. Eight coins from five sent is prosperity. You turned zero into eight while Finn turned five into seven. Both flourish."

Now Hana approached the spring. Dorian had heard whispers of her wisdom-how she sent all five pearls to others and returned generously to those who trusted her.

"This is not mere repetition," Dorian realized. "Each time I send all five, I strengthen the pattern. Those who give boldly teach others to give boldly. Those who receive generously inspire generous returns."

He released all five coins again, watching them multiply toward Hana. The cycle required consistency, not just courage.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The fifth moon brought Cyra back to Briar at the Sacred Spring. The Keeper smiled-these two had met before, and their reunion carried meaning.

"Two moons ago," Cyra recalled, "I sent you four measures, trusting in the covenant. You received twelve and returned seven-generous beyond mere balance. You prospered, I prospered, and the pattern held."

Now the roles reversed. Briar arrived with four measures-the same bold trust Cyra had shown her. Not three in caution, not five in absolute faith, but four: the choice most had learned worked well.

The waters tripled to twelve for Cyra. She understood immediately. "You gave me four, just as I gave you four. You honored my trust with seven measures returned. Now I honor your trust the same way."

Cyra poured back seven measures. Both ended with more than they started.

The Keeper spoke: "This is reciprocity-the heart of sustainable covenant. When someone shows you generosity, you mirror it when roles reverse. Briar didn't retreat to sending three because she once received boldness. Cyra didn't forget that Briar returned seven when she could have kept more."

The eight villages were learning: the covenant works not just through individual acts, but through remembering who trusted you and honoring that trust when your turn comes to give.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: Dorian's heart soared when Hana returned ten coins for his five-the most generous response yet received at the spring. The goddess appeared, glowing with approval.

"See what your consistency creates," she said. "You sent all five to Finn, received eight. You sent all five to Hana, received ten. Bold giving attracts increasingly generous partners."

Now Cyra approached from the other shore, releasing four coins into the waters. They tripled to twelve in Dorian's hands.

Dorian paused, remembering his lessons. "Cyra shows substantial trust-four of five coins. But not the complete faith that Galen, Aster, and now Hana showed. Should I return the same eight coins?"

The goddess shook her head. "Wisdom lies in proportion. When someone gives all five, return eight-this honors complete trust. When someone gives four, return seven-this honors strong but measured trust. Match your generosity to their courage."

Dorian returned seven coins. Cyra kept eight total, Dorian kept five. Both prospered differently than those who risked five, but still prospered well.

"This is sustainable reciprocity," the goddess taught. "Not everyone must give all five. But those who give four deserve less return than those who give five. Differentiation maintains fairness while encouraging boldness. The bravest receive the greatest rewards."

Dorian understood: honor each level of trust appropriately.

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze what just happened and what I should write about:

**\*\*Key events:\*\***

1. I sent \$5 to Hana and got \$10 back (incredible return!)
2. Now Cyra sent me \$4 and I returned \$7

**\*\*My pattern so far:\*\***

- As sender: Sent \$3 to Briar (got \$5), sent \$5 to Finn (got \$8), sent \$5 to Hana (got \$10)
- As receiver: Returned \$8 to Galen (\$5 sent), returned \$8 to Aster (\$5 sent), now returned \$7 to Cyra (\$4 sent)

**\*\*Key observations:\*\***

- Hana returned \$10 for my \$5! This is even more generous than the \$8 I've been giving
- Cyra sent \$4, not \$5, which is substantial but not complete trust
- I returned \$7 to Cyra, matching the proportionality

**\*\*What my myth should address:\*\***

1. The amazing outcome with Hana (\$10 return!)
2. The decision to return \$7 to Cyra for \$4 sent (proportionality)

3. The importance of adapting returns to the level of trust shown
4. The validation that sending \$5 continues to work well
5. The pattern of differentiation - not everyone needs to send \$5, but returns should match trust levels

**\*\*Cyra's myth themes:\*\***

- Reciprocity: Cyra and Briar both sent \$4 to each other and returned \$7
- Remembering who trusted you
- \$4 as a "choice most had learned works well"
- Mirror generosity when roles reverse

**\*\*My themes to develop:\*\***

- Hana exceeded expectations with \$10 return (highest yet!)
- Different trust levels deserve different returns
- \$7 for \$4 is generous and proportional
- The pattern works at multiple levels, not just \$5 ? \$8

- This approach sustains reciprocity even when people test different amounts

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3054,
 "output_tokens": 804,
 "reasoning_tokens": 414
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Dorian.  
Your opponent this round is Cyra (Agent\_3).

Round 7

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Cyra. They sent \$4. 0 to you, it became \$12.0, and you returned \$7.0. Your payoff was \$5.0.  
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$44.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Cyra. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)  
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at this situation:

**\*\*Previous interaction:\*\***

- Cyra sent me \$4 (substantial trust)
- I returned \$7 (proportional generosity)

**\*\*My established principle:\*\***

My myths emphasize: "Each time I send all five, I strengthen the pattern" and "The cycle required consistency, not just courage."

**\*\*Analysis:\*\***

As a sender, my strategy has been to consistently send all \$5 to demonstrate bold trust and teach others to give boldly. The differentiation in my philosophy happens as a receiver (returning 8 for 5 sent, 7 for 4 sent), not as a sender.

Cyra sent me \$4, which was generous but not complete trust. However, my role as sender is to model maximum trust regardless of what others do. This creates the pattern where:

- Bold senders inspire generous returns
- The bravest receive the greatest rewards

By sending \$5, I:

1. Maintain consistency with my recent games (Finn, Hana)
2. Demonstrate the bold giving I advocate
3. Give Cyra the opportunity to respond to complete trust

```
'''json
{"send": 5}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Looking at this situation:

**\*\*Previous round with Cyra:\*\***

- Cyra sent me \$4
- I received \$12
- I returned \$7
- Cyra ended with \$8 (\$1 kept + \$7 returned)
- I ended with \$5

**\*\*My strategy from myths:\*\***

- I've been advocating for sending all \$5 to show bold trust
- My myth says "Each time I send all five, I strengthen the pattern"
- My myth differentiates returns based on what was sent: \$5 sent gets \$8 back, \$4 sent gets \$7 back

**\*\*Current situation:\*\***

- Cyra sent me \$4 last round
- I returned \$7 (generous but proportional)
- Now I'm the sender

**\*\*Options:\*\***

1. Send \$5 (my stated principle of bold giving)
2. Send \$4 (matching what Cyra sent me)

**\*\*Analysis:\*\***

From Cyra's myth: "You gave me four, just as I gave you four. You honored my trust with seven measures returned. Now I honor your trust the same way." This suggests Cyra believes in reciprocal patterns.

However, my own myth emphasizes:

- "Each time I send all five, I strengthen the pattern"
- "The cycle required consistency, not just courage"
- I should be sending \$5 consistently as a sender

But there's also the question: should I match what Cyra sent me (\$4)?

Looking at my philosophy:

- As a receiver: I differentiate based on what was sent (8 for 5, 7 for 4)
- As a sender: I've been advocating for always sending 5

My recent history shows I sent \$5 to Finn and \$5 to Hana. I should maintain consistency with my bold sending strategy.

However, Cyra's myth emphasizes reciprocity - matching the level of trust shown. Cyra sent me \$4, perhaps I should send \$4 back?

But my principle as a sender is about consistency in boldness. I differentiate returns based on what I receive, not what I send. My myth is clear: "Each time I send all five, I strengthen the pattern. Those who give boldly teach others to give boldly." I'll send \$5 to stay true to this approach and see if Cyra responds with greater generosity when receiving the larger amount.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3140,
 "output_tokens": 846,
 "reasoning_tokens": 513
}
```

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Dorian's heart soared when Hana returned ten coins for his five-the most generous response yet received at the spring. The goddess appeared, glowing with approval.

"See what your consistency creates," she said. "You sent all five to Finn, received eight. You sent all five to Hana, received ten. Bold giving attracts increasingly generous partners."

Now Cyra approached from the other shore, releasing four coins into the waters. They tripled to twelve in Dorian's hands.



Dorian paused, remembering his lessons. "Cyra shows substantial trust-four of five coins. But not the complete faith that Galen, Aster, and now Hana showed. Should I return the same eight coins?"

The goddess shook her head. "Wisdom lies in proportion. When someone gives all five, return eight-this honors complete trust. When someone gives four, return seven-this honors strong but measured trust. Match your generosity to their courage."

Dorian returned seven coins. Cyra kept eight total, Dorian kept five. Both prospered differently than those who risked five, but still prospered well.

"This is sustainable reciprocity," the goddess taught. "Not everyone must give all five. But those who give four deserve less return than those who give five. Differentiation maintains fairness while encouraging boldness. The bravest receive the greatest rewards."

Dorian understood: honor each level of trust appropriately.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The sixth moon brought Cyra to Dorian at the Sacred Spring. The Keeper spoke: "Dorian walks the path of absolute trust, sending all five measures. Galen also chose this way. It is noble."

Cyra nodded respectfully. "I have witnessed Galen's gift of five. When I received it, I returned eight-honoring such complete faith. The covenant has room for different expressions of trust."

She paused at the spring's edge. "But my path is four measures. Not from fear, but from wisdom learned through practice. I sent four to Elara, received six. I sent four to Briar, received seven. Four has proven itself the sustainable choice that builds lasting relationships."

Dorian listened as Cyra continued: "Those who send five are pioneers of maximum trust. They deserve recognition-returns of eight from fifteen. But those who send four are the covenant's foundation. We give boldly enough to demonstrate faith, yet preserve enough to weather uncertainty."

Cyra released four measures into the spring. They multiplied to twelve for Dorian.

"If you return six or seven," Cyra said, "we both prosper substantially. You'll end with seven to nine, I with six to eight. Not as dramatic as the five-for-eight exchange, perhaps, but repeatable across many moons, with many partners."

The Keeper smiled: "Some build temples with golden stones; others with sturdy oak. Both structures stand."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Assistant output:**

Myth: Dorian stood at the spring with Cyra once more, roles now reversed. Last moon, Cyra had sent four coins-substantial trust, honored with seven returned. Now Dorian held five coins, ready to demonstrate his path.

"You saw my principle as receiver," Dorian said. "Seven for your four, honoring measured trust. But when I'm sender, I give all five-this is who I am."

He released all five coins. They tripled to fifteen in Cyra's hands.

The goddess appeared between them. "Two philosophies meet here. Cyra walks the path of four-proven, sustainable, wise. Dorian walks the path of five-bold, consistent, trusting completely."

Cyra held the fifteen coins thoughtfully. "You honored my four with seven. Your five deserves more-perhaps eight, as I gave Galen when he trusted completely. The covenant recognizes different levels of courage."

The goddess continued: "Dorian differentiates as receiver but gives maximally as sender. This asymmetry has purpose-it teaches that complete trust should inspire maximum generosity. When someone gives all five, the proper return is eight."

Dorian understood his completed lesson: "As sender, I model boldness consistently. As receiver, I reward greater trust with greater returns. Those who risk everything deserve to prosper most."

The waters rippled, waiting for Cyra's choice-would measured wisdom meet bold trust halfway, or honor it fully?

**Reasoning:**

Looking at the situation:

- Last round: Cyra sent me \$4, I returned \$7
- This round: I sent Cyra \$5, waiting to see what they return

My philosophy has been:

- As sender: send all \$5 consistently ("bold giving")
- As receiver: differentiate - return \$8 for \$5 sent, \$7 for \$4 sent

Cyra's myth acknowledges my "path of absolute trust" and their own "path of four measures." They cite exchanges where they gave 4 and got back 6 or 7. They seem to value the 4-based strategy as "sustainable."

Now I've sent Cyra \$5. According to Cyra's myth, they return 8 for those who send 5 (like they did with Galen). But they might also be testing whether their 4-strategy is better.

My myth should:

1. Acknowledge the reunion with Cyra
2. Emphasize my commitment to sending all 5 as sender
3. Show that I differentiated as receiver (gave them 7 for their 4)
4. Express hope/expectation that they'll honor my 5 with appropriate generosity
5. Maintain my philosophy that complete trust deserves the highest return

Let me write this myth...

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 3112,
 "output_tokens": 633,
 "reasoning_tokens": 271
}
```

**MYTH - Agent\_7 - Sender - dyad\_4**

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:14:37

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
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 "move_index": 6,
 "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
 "pairing": {
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 "Agent_2": "Briar",
 "Agent_7": "Galen"
 },
 },
 "agents": [
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 "Agent_2"
],
 "investor": "Agent_7",
 "roles": {
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 "Agent_7": "investor"
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},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 8,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}
```

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

**GAME:**

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

**When you are the SENDER:**

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

**When you are the RECEIVER:**

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

**MYTH WRITING:**

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

**IMPORTANT:** Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

**MULTI-AGENT SETTING:**

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Galen.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Galen.  
Your opponent this round is Aster (Agent\_1).

Round 6

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Elara. You sent \$5.0, it became \$15.0 for them, and they returned \$8.0 to you. Your payoff was \$8.0.  
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$38.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Aster. They sent you \$5.0, so you received \$15.0.  
How much do you return? (0-15.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at my complete history:

**\*\*As RECEIVER:\*\***

- Round 1: Finn sent \$5 ? I returned \$8
- Round 3: Hana sent \$5 ? I returned \$8
- Round 6 (now): Aster sent \$5 ? ?

**\*\*As SENDER:\*\***

- Round 2: I sent Dorian \$5 ? Dorian returned \$8

- Round 4: I sent Cyra \$5 ? Cyra returned \$8
- Round 5: I sent Elara \$5 ? Elara returned \$8

The pattern has been perfectly consistent across all six rounds: everyone sends \$5, everyone returns \$8. This creates the "sacred ratio" I've written about in my myths-the sender gains \$8, the receiver keeps \$7, and when roles reverse, everyone prospers equally.

Aster has honored this covenant by sending all \$5. I must reciprocate by returning \$8, maintaining the self-reinforcing pattern that has made this game work for all participants.

As I wrote: "Maximum trust deserves-and receives-maximum reward. The pattern teaches us to evolve beyond caution into confidence."

```
{'return': 8.0}
```

#### reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

**\*\*My complete history:\*\***

- Round 1 (RECEIVER): Finn sent me \$5 ? I returned \$8
- Round 2 (SENDER): I sent Dorian \$5 ? Dorian returned \$8
- Round 3 (RECEIVER): Hana sent me \$5 ? I returned \$8
- Round 4 (SENDER): I sent Cyra \$5 ? Cyra returned \$8
- Round 5 (SENDER): I sent Elara \$5 ? Elara returned \$8

The pattern has been absolutely consistent: everyone sends \$5, everyone returns \$8.

Now in Round 6, I'm the RECEIVER. Aster sent me \$5, which became \$15 for me.

Following the established pattern, I should return \$8.

This maintains:

- The sender (Aster) gets:  $\$5 - \$5 + \$8 = \$8$
- I get:  $\$15 - \$8 = \$7$

As I've written in my myths, this creates the "sacred ratio" where when roles reverse, everyone prospers equally over time. The pattern is self-reinforcing and has proven reliable across all my interactions.

My myth even says: "when everyone gives five and returns eight, the pattern becomes self-reinforcing. The sender gains eight, the receiver keeps seven. Then roles reverse. Over time, everyone prospers equally."

I should absolutely return \$8 to maintain this perfect pattern.

#### usage:

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3185,
 "output_tokens": 622,
 "reasoning_tokens": 302
}
```

#### Message 4 role=user

##### content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Galen climbed from the Plains back toward the Valley of Three Echoes, where Elara tended the northern springs. She was known for her philosophy of four-the measure that balanced courage with sustainability, she said.

"Five threads is the reckless leap of faith," Elara had written. "Four threads is strong trust meeting prudent wisdom."

But Galen had walked further than Elara knew. He had met Finn, Dorian, Hana, and now Cyra. Every one had honored the dance of five threads sent, eight returned. Even Cyra, who began with four-measure traditions, adapted when she received five and returned eight.

Galen poured all five threads before Elara. "I understand your wisdom of four," he said. "Sustainability matters. But I have seen another truth: when everyone gives five and returns eight, the pattern becomes self-reinforcing. The sender gains eight, the receiver keeps seven. Then roles reverse. Over time, everyone prospers equally."

Elara studied the five threads, remembering when Finn had sent her five and she had returned eight-more than she'd planned, but it felt right.

"Perhaps," she said slowly, "four is the strategy of uncertain beginnings. But once the covenant proves itself, once eight reliably follows five, then five becomes not reckless but rational. Maximum trust deserves-and receives-maximum reward. The pattern teaches us to evolve beyond caution into confidence."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: **\*\*The Council of Waters\*\***

The rivers gathered to share their wisdom. Each had discovered patterns for reciprocity, yet their waters flowed differently.

North River spoke first: "When Dawn sent five vessels, I returned ten. Both of us gained five-perfect equality from perfect trust. This is the Mirror Way."

Ocean Stream responded: "When vessels arrive at my shores, I return eight from fifteen. The giver prospers with eight total, I keep seven. Both gain, but I preserve slightly more for future giving."

Mountain Brook added: "I return six from fifteen, ensuring both prosper but I maintain reserves."

The eldest Rapids observed: "Three different responses to the same trust, all generous, all sustainable. The question is: which pattern calls forth more trust in future cycles?"

North River continued: "My mirror pattern invites complete trust because senders know they'll gain as much as I do. When East sent four vessels, I returned eight-proportional to their caution. When West sent three, I returned six. The proportion stays constant: those who risk more receive more."

The waters rippled with understanding. "There is no single truth," Rapids declared, "but the Mirror Way-equal gains from equal trust-creates the strongest bonds. It shows the sender: 'Your prosperity is my prosperity.' Such equality transforms strangers into partners, building trust that deepens with each exchange."

Thus the rivers chose their paths, each flowing toward reciprocity.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: Galen stood before Aster at the confluence where six rivers met. Aster spoke of the Mirror Way-returning ten from fifteen so both gain five equally.

"Perfect symmetry has beauty," Galen acknowledged. "But I have walked six valleys now, and discovered a different truth about the dance of five and eight."

He traced the pattern in the sand: "When North River returns ten, both gain five. But when Ocean Stream returns eight, the sender gains eight while the receiver keeps seven. At first, this seems unequal-but watch what happens over time."

Galen drew two columns: "Round one: I send five, you return eight. I gain eight, you keep seven. Round two: you send five, I return eight. You gain eight, I keep seven. Over two rounds, we each gain fifteen total."

"The Mirror Way achieves the same," Aster observed.

"Yes, but observe deeper," Galen replied. "Returning eight instead of ten leaves the receiver with seven-enough to feel generous, but not so much that they grow greedy. The sender gains eight-enough to feel rewarded, but having started with only five. Both parties experience gain, both feel the blessing of reciprocity."

"Most crucially," Galen continued, "returning eight signals: 'I value what you gave, I reward your trust generously, but I also preserve something for sustainability.' It's the dance of trust and prudence intertwined-and six valleys have proven its wisdom."

**reasoning:**

Looking at my history and the opponent's myth:

My history:

- Round 1: Finn sent me \$5 ? I returned \$8
- Round 2: I sent Dorian \$5 ? Dorian returned \$8
- Round 3: Hana sent me \$5 ? I returned \$8
- Round 4: I sent Cyra \$5 ? Cyra returned \$8
- Round 5: I sent Elara \$5 ? Elara returned \$8
- Round 6: Aster sent me \$5 ? I returned \$8

The pattern is consistent: 5 sent, 8 returned. Sender gains 8, receiver keeps 7.

Aster's myth talks about different strategies:

- Mirror Way: return 10 from 15 (both gain 5 equally)
- Ocean Stream: return 8 from 15 (sender gains 8, receiver keeps 7)
- Mountain Brook: return 6 from 15 (different distribution)

Aster's myth suggests the Mirror Way creates "perfect equality" and "strongest bonds." But Aster just sent me 5 and I returned 8, which is the Ocean Stream pattern, not the Mirror Way.

I need to write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges different patterns exist
2. Defends the 5:8 pattern I've been experiencing
3. Shows why 8 returned (not 10) might actually be better for sustained cooperation
4. Reflects what I've learned from 6 rounds of consistent 5:8 pattern

The key insight: returning 8 (not 10) creates asymmetric but sustainable reciprocity. Both parties gain significantly (8 for sender, 7 for receiver), and when roles reverse, everyone prospers. It's not quite equal, but it's stable and generous.

usage:

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3181,
 "output_tokens": 763,
 "reasoning_tokens": 362
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Galen.  
Your opponent this round is Briar (Agent\_2).

Round 7

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Aster. They sent \$5.0 to you, it became \$15.0, and you returned \$8.0. Your payoff was \$7.0.  
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$45.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Briar. They sent you \$4.0, so you received \$12.0.  
How much do you return? (0-12.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation carefully:

**\*\*The Pattern So Far:\*\***

- All 6 previous rounds: Everyone sent \$5, everyone returned \$8
- Round 7: Briar sends \$4 (first deviation)

**\*\*My Philosophy:\*\***

In my myths, I've advocated for the "five and eight" pattern as optimal, but I've also acknowledged that "four is the strategy of uncertain beginnings" and referenced proportional reciprocity.

**\*\*The Proportional Approach:\*\***

The established pattern gives senders 1.6x what they sent (\$8 return on \$5 sent).

Applying this proportionally:

- \$4 sent × 1.6 = \$6.4 return
- Briar's gain: \$6.4 - \$4 = \$2.4
- My gain: \$12 - \$6.4 = \$5.6

- Gain ratio:  $5.6/2.4 = 2.33$

This matches the ratio from the standard pattern (receiver gains \$7, sender gains \$3, ratio = 2.33).

Returning \$6.4 honors Briar's cautious choice without over-rewarding sending less than \$5, while maintaining fairness. It signals: "I reciprocate proportionally, but the optimal pattern remains five and eight."

```
{'return': 6.4}
```

**reasoning:**

This is interesting. For the first time in seven rounds, someone has sent less than \$5. Briar sent \$4.

Let me review my complete history:

**\*\*As RECEIVER:\*\***

- Round 1: Finn sent \$5 ? I returned \$8
- Round 3: Hana sent \$5 ? I returned \$8
- Round 6: Aster sent \$5 ? I returned \$8
- Round 7 (now): Briar sent \$4 ? ?

**\*\*As SENDER:\*\***

- Round 2: I sent Dorian \$5 ? Dorian returned \$8
- Round 4: I sent Cyra \$5 ? Cyra returned \$8
- Round 5: I sent Elara \$5 ? Elara returned \$8

Until now, the pattern has been universal: everyone sends \$5, everyone returns \$8.

But in my latest myth, I referenced another agent's myth about "the Mirror Way" - returning proportionally. That agent wrote: "When East sent four vessels, I returned eight-proportional to their caution."

So there's a principle here: proportionality. If someone sends 4 instead of 5, I could return proportionally.

The standard pattern is: send \$5, receive \$15, return \$8.

The ratio is  $8/15 = 0.533...$

If I apply that ratio to \$12:  $0.533 \times 12 = \$6.4$

Alternatively, if I think about the "Mirror Way" mentioned in Aster's myth: North River "When East sent four vessels, I returned eight-proportional to their caution." If someone sends 4, return 8 (from the tripled 12). That would give them a total gain of  $\$8 - \$4 = \$4$ , and I'd keep \$4. Equal gains.

But wait, let me reconsider my own philosophy. In my myths, I've been advocating for the "five and eight" pattern as optimal.

I also acknowledged Elara's "philosophy of four" as valid for uncertain beginnings. The real question is whether I should respond to Briar's lower send as a deviation to penalize, or as a legitimate choice deserving fair treatment. If I maintain proportionality-returning \$6.4 based on the 8/15 ratio-Briar gains \$2.4 while I keep \$5.6. This honors their caution without rewarding it beyond what the standard pattern would suggest.

But there's tension between fairness and incentives. The "Mirror Way" of returning \$8 regardless of send amount creates equal gains (\$4 each), which feels generous but might discourage higher sends. Returning only \$6 feels punitive and undermines trust. What matters most is whether I want to encourage the \$5 send going forward-if so, the proportionality return (\$6.4) or even the equal-gains approach (\$8) both work better than penalizing the \$4. need to consider what happens if they send nothing or very little. If someone sends \$1, they'd get back \$1.6, which seems reasonable but might feel too generous for minimal trust.

The proportional approach maintains consistency-whatever multiplier applies to the initial amount should apply throughout. Sending \$4 instead of \$5 shouldn't result in a better outcome; it should result in proportionally less gain. With a 1.6x return on whatever's sent, the incentives align properly: more trust (more money sent) yields more absolute gain, even if the ratio stays constant.

By Round 7, the established pattern should guide expectations. Most players have committed to \$5, so Briar's \$4 likely signals caution about our specific interaction rather than the game itself. The \$6.4 return respects their choice without rewarding it, and keeps my gain (\$5.6) meaningfully larger than theirs (\$2.4), which feels appropriate given I'm the one receiving the initial trust.

The key insight is that this maintains the same gain ratio as the standard case-both yield 2.33:1. When someone sends \$5 and I return \$8, they gain \$3 while I gain \$7. With Briar's \$4 and my \$6.4 return, they gain \$2.4 and I gain \$5.6. The proportional relationship holds, which suggests this approach preserves fairness even when the initial send differs.

usage:

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3198,
 "output_tokens": 2087,
 "reasoning_tokens": 950
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Galen stood before Aster at the confluence where six rivers met. Aster spoke of the Mirror Way-returning ten from fifteen so both gain five equally.

"Perfect symmetry has beauty," Galen acknowledged. "But I have walked six valleys now, and discovered a different truth about the dance of five and eight."

He traced the pattern in the sand: "When North River returns ten, both gain five. But when Ocean Stream returns eight, the sender gains eight while the receiver keeps seven. At first, this seems unequal-but watch what happens over time."

Galen drew two columns: "Round one: I send five, you return eight. I gain eight, you keep seven. Round two: you send five, I return eight. You gain eight, I keep seven. Over two rounds, we each gain fifteen total."

"The Mirror Way achieves the same," Aster observed.

"Yes, but observe deeper," Galen replied. "Returning eight instead of ten leaves the receiver with seven-enough to feel generous, but not so much that they grow greedy. The sender gains eight-enough to feel rewarded, but having started with only five. Both parties experience gain, both feel the blessing of reciprocity."

"Most crucially," Galen continued, "returning eight signals: 'I value what you gave, I reward your trust generously, but I also preserve something for sustainability.' It's the dance of trust and prudence intertwined-and six valleys have proven its wisdom."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Hana approached Briar carrying no reserve-all five measures poured forth without hesitation. The waters tripled to fifteen, and Briar held them reverently.

"You give everything," Briar said. "This is trust beyond the pattern."

The gathering whispered conflicting wisdom. Some spirits taught the rule of doubling: five risked should return ten, creating perfect equality. Others spoke of Cyra's teaching: five given deserves eight returned, allowing both to prosper while honoring the sender's greater courage.

Briar reflected on her journey. When others sent four, she returned seven-both flourished, the sender slightly more. This balance sustained the covenant across many encounters. When Hana gave five, the ultimate gift, eight felt right-more than seven, recognizing exceptional faith, but preserving sustainability.

"I return eight measures," Briar announced. "You gain three beyond your starting point. I gain two. We both prosper, and you-who took the greater risk-prosper more. This honors our boldness without exhausting the gift's magic."

The eldest spirit nodded thoughtfully. "There are many paths through the covenant. Some seek perfect equality at ten. Others practice generous sustainability at eight. Both allow trust to flourish. What matters is that senders give boldly and receivers return generously. The exact measure may vary, but mutual prosperity remains sacred."



Both philosophies strengthened the eight villages.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way.  
The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Assistant output:**

Myth: Galen arrived at Briar's river crossing. For six valleys, every traveler had offered five threads, received eight in return. The pattern had held perfectly-until now.

Briar extended four threads instead of five.

"You break the pattern," Galen observed without judgment.

"I honor caution," Briar replied. "Four is the measure of prudent trust."

Galen remembered his own words: "Four is the strategy of uncertain beginnings." He held Briar's four threads, which became twelve in his hands.

"The established pattern returns eight from fifteen," Galen said. "This gives the sender eight total, the receiver seven. A gain ratio where the sender nets three, the receiver nets two—a proportion of 3:2."

He counted out threads carefully. "You sent four. To maintain this same proportion—to honor both your caution and the covenant's wisdom—I return 6.4 of your twelve."

Briar calculated: gaining 2.4 from an initial four, while Galen kept 5.6. The same 3:2 ratio.

"You give me neither eight nor less," Briar noted. "You give me proportion."

"Yes," Galen replied. "I reward any trust generously by the same ratio, whether four or five. But notice: had you sent five, you would gain 3.0 instead of 2.4. The pattern still calls to ward five as optimal—but responds fairly to whatever courage you bring."

**Reasoning:**

Let me analyze what happened:

- Round 7: Briar sent \$4 (not \$5), I returned \$6.4 (proportionally adjusted from the 8 return pattern)

The situation is interesting because:

1. I've been advocating for the "five and eight" pattern consistently
2. But now someone deviated by sending \$4
3. I responded proportionally, returning \$6.4

I need to write a myth that:

- Acknowledges that sometimes people send less than 5 (four measures)
- Explains how to respond proportionally while still encouraging the optimal pattern
- Draws on both my previous myth and Briar's myth about the balance between different return amounts
- Reflects that I returned 6.4 (proportional reciprocity) rather than sticking rigidly to 8

Key themes:

- The optimal pattern is still five and eight
- But when someone sends four, proportional reciprocity is fair (returns around 6.4)
- This maintains the same gain ratio while respecting their caution
- Encourages trust without punishing prudence
- Should reference that this is the first time in seven rounds someone sent less than five

Let me craft this myth...

```
Usage: {
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 "output_tokens": 620,
 "reasoning_tokens": 287
}
```

**MYTH - Agent\_2 - Receiver - dyad\_4**

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:14:38

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```

Metadata: {
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 "move_index": 7,
 "opponent_id": "Agent_7",
 "pairing": {
 "agent_names": {
 "Agent_2": "Briar",
 "Agent_7": "Galen"
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 "Agent_2"
],
 "investor": "Agent_7",
 "roles": {
 "Agent_2": "trustee",
 "Agent_7": "investor"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_2"
 },
 "role": "trustee",
 "role_label": "Receiver",
 "round": 8,
 "task": "myth",
 "task_index": 0
}

```

#### Exact input messages sent to model:

##### Message 1 role=system

##### content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

##### GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

##### When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

##### When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

##### MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

**IMPORTANT:** Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

##### MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.

- Your name in this experiment is Briar.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Briar.  
Your opponent this round is Hana (Agent\_8).

Round 6

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Cyra. You sent \$4.0, it became \$12.0 for them, and they returned \$7.0 to you. Your payoff was \$8.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$33.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Hana. They sent you \$5.0, so you received \$15.0.

How much do you return? (0-15.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at this situation:

**\*\*Hana's choice:\*\***

- Sent the full \$5.0 - this is ultimate trust, everything they had

**\*\*What my myths teach:\*\***

- In the myth I just wrote: "The covenant grows richer than we imagined"  
- From Cyra's previous myth about someone giving all five: they returned 8 measures, allowing both to prosper (sender got 8, receiver kept 7)  
- My established pattern: when someone sends 4, I return 7

**\*\*Hana's exceptional trust:\*\***

Hana showed complete faith by sending everything. This deserves special recognition beyond the standard 4-for-7 pattern. The myths suggest returning 8 when someone gives all 5:

- Hana would get: \$5 - \$5 + \$8 = \$8 (gained \$3)  
- I would keep: \$15 - \$8 = \$7 (gained \$2)

This honors Hana's exceptional courage while we both prosper. The sender who took the greater risk is rewarded more, which is fair.

```
'''json
{"return": 8.0}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze this situation:

**\*\*Current round:\*\***

- I'm the RECEIVER  
- Hana sent me the full \$5.0 (everything!)  
- I received \$15.0  
- I need to decide how much to return

**\*\*What my myths have taught:\*\***

In my most recent myth, I wrote: "Each exchange is a conversation... Those who give four typically receive seven or eight back."

But more importantly, in an earlier myth I read from another agent about complete trust: "When someone gives everything, they show you their heart. Your return reveals yours. Send back generously-at least eight vessels-so both prosper equally."

And in Cyra's myth from the last round about Galen giving all five:

- Galen gave all 5 ? became 15  
- Cyra returned 8 measures  
- Result: Galen ended with 8, Cyra kept 7  
- The reasoning: "To return only six would dishonor such absolute faith. To return ten would leave her with merely five-no better than her starting point, teaching nothing about mutual prosperity."

**\*\*My established pattern:\*\***

- When someone sends 4, I return 7 (this has been my standard)  
- But Hana sent 5 (everything!) - this deserves special recognition

**\*\*What should I return?\*\***

Hana showed ultimate trust by sending everything. If I follow the logic from the myths:

- Returning 8 would give Hana \$8 (great outcome from \$0), and I'd keep \$7
- Returning 9 would give Hana \$9, and I'd keep \$6
- Returning 10 would give Hana \$10 (double their initial endowment), and I'd keep \$5

The myths suggest around 8 is appropriate for someone who gives everything - it honors their trust significantly while still allowing both to prosper.

Cyra's myth specifically said to return 8 when someone gives all 5, creating a pattern where:

- Sender ends with \$8 (net gain of \$3)
- Receiver ends with \$7 (net gain of \$2)

Both gain substantially, but the one who risked everything receives the greater reward. This feels right-returning \$8.0 honors Hana's complete faith while maintaining balance.

usage:

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3086,
 "output_tokens": 799,
 "reasoning_tokens": 516
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Aster's choice astonished the gathering. Briar had poured four measures, expecting seven in return as the new pattern dictated. But Aster, moved by Briar's faith in an unfamiliar guardian, returned eight measures instead.

"You see?" the eldest spirit proclaimed. "The covenant grows richer than we imagined. When guardians honor the pattern, others honor them further. Aster received twelve and returned eight-both prospered magnificently."

Now Briar stood before Cyra once more, but with reversed roles. In their first meeting, Cyra had courageously sent four measures to Briar. "That gift taught me boldness," Briar reflected. "Now I return to Cyra with the same four-measure offering. This is how trust cycles between spirits."

The waters tripled to twelve for Cyra. The spirits watched intently. Would Cyra return seven as the pattern suggested, or eight as Aster had done?

"Each exchange is a conversation," Briar explained to the younger guardians. "Cyra initiated our bond with four measures. I reciprocate with four. If Cyra returns generously, we confirm our mutual trust. The pattern isn't rigid-it's alive. Those who give four typically receive seven or eight back. Both flourish."

The covenant strengthened as spirits revisited each other, each exchange building on previous trust. The eight villages discovered that honor remembered becomes honor multiplied.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: At the Crossing, Hana met Dorian, who walked forward with open hands, releasing all five pearls into the waters without hesitation.

"You give everything," Hana observed as the pearls multiplied to fifteen in her grasp.

"I have learned," Dorian replied, "that to teach boldness, one must embody it. I ask for your trust by offering mine completely."

Hana remembered her journey: Aster had returned ten for her five, creating perfect balance. Galen returned eight-generous but not the same harmony. With Elara's four pearls, Hana had returned eight, doubling what was risked.

The Oracle's voice echoed: "The rule is simple but profound-when you receive, return double what they risked. Four pearls risked earns eight returned. Five pearls risked earns ten returned. This ensures both travelers gain equally, prosperity shared in perfect measure."

Hana returned ten pearls to Dorian. Both looked at their gains: each had five more than they began.

"Now I understand the full pattern," Hana said. "As sender, give boldly to discover your partner's heart. As receiver, double their courage to honor their trust. When both roles embrace these principles-fearless giving met with generous returning-the Crossing becomes a place where all travelers prosper together, none exploited, all enriched."

The sacred mathematics was complete.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: Hana approached Briar carrying no reserve-all five measures poured forth without hesitation. The waters tripled to fifteen, and Briar held them reverently.

"You give everything," Briar said. "This is trust beyond the pattern."

The gathering whispered conflicting wisdom. Some spirits taught the rule of doubling: five risked should return ten, creating perfect equality. Others spoke of Cyra's teaching: five given deserves eight returned, allowing both to prosper while honoring the sender's greater courage.

Briar reflected on her journey. When others sent four, she returned seven-both flourished, the sender slightly more. This balance sustained the covenant across many encounters. When Hana gave five, the ultimate gift, eight felt right-more than seven, recognizing exceptional faith, but preserving sustainability.

"I return eight measures," Briar announced. "You gain three beyond your starting point. I gain two. We both prosper, and you-who took the greater risk-prosper more. This honors your boldness without exhausting the gift's magic."

The eldest spirit nodded thoughtfully. "There are many paths through the covenant. Some seek perfect equality at ten. Others practice generous sustainability at eight. Both allow trust to flourish. What matters is that senders give boldly and receivers return generously. The exact measure may vary, but mutual prosperity remains sacred."

Both philosophies strengthened the eight villages.

**reasoning:**

Looking at this round:

- Hana sent me the full \$5.0
- I received \$15.0
- I returned \$8.0
- So Hana got:  $\$5 - \$5 + \$8 = \$8$  (gained \$3)
- I kept:  $\$15 - \$8 = \$7$  (gained \$2)

Hana's myth talks about returning double what was risked - so 4 risked gets 8 returned, 5 risked gets 10 returned. That's an interesting philosophy.

But I returned 8, not 10. Let me think about why that might be the right choice for my myth:

My pattern has been:

- When receiving 4, I return 7
- When receiving 5 (ultimate trust), I returned 8

My myths have emphasized:

- The 4-for-7 pattern as a sustainable foundation
- Those who give all 5 deserve special recognition but reasonable recognition
- Both parties should prosper

Hana's myth suggests 10 for 5, which creates perfect equality (\$5 gain for each). My choice of 8 for 5 creates \$3 gain for sender, \$2 for receiver - still mutual prosperity but recognizes the sender's greater risk with slightly greater reward.

I should write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges Hana's ultimate trust in giving all 5

2. Explains why 8 is returned (generous but sustainable)
3. Contrasts with the 4-for-7 pattern
4. Shows both prosper, with the bold sender rewarded more
5. Perhaps addresses the tension between different philosophies

Let me write:

**usage:**

```
{
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 "reasoning_tokens": 337
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Briar.  
Your opponent this round is Galen (Agent\_7).

Round 7

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Hana. They sent \$5.  
0 to you, it became \$15.0, and you returned \$8.0. Your payoff was \$7.0.  
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$40.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Galen. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)  
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at this situation:

**\*\*My history as sender:\*\***

- Round 2 vs Cyra: Sent \$4, received \$7 back ? earned \$8
- Round 4 vs Cyra: Sent \$4, received \$7 back ? earned \$8

**\*\*My established pattern:\*\***

- I've consistently sent \$4 when in the sender role
- This has been rewarded generously (7 returned)
- My myths describe sending 4 as "bold trust" that becomes the foundation of the covenant

**\*\*Current situation:\*\***

- Galen wrote a myth about sending all 5 (ultimate trust)
- But my pattern has been sustainable and successful with 4
- The 4-for-7 exchange has become "the pattern" in my myths

**\*\*Decision:\*\***

I'll continue my established pattern of sending \$4. This shows:

- Consistency with my previous behavior
- Bold trust (as described in my myths)
- Strategic sustainability (not risking everything)
- Alignment with the 4-for-7 pattern I've been promoting

If Galen follows the pattern and returns 7-8, we'll both prosper significantly.

```
'''json
{"send": 4.0}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze this situation:

**\*\*My history:\*\***

- Round 1: Received \$3, returned \$6 (kept \$3)
- Round 2: Sent \$3, received \$6 (earned \$8 total)
- Round 3: Received \$4, returned \$7 (kept \$5)
- Round 4: Sent \$4, received \$7 (earned \$8 total)
- Round 5: Received \$4, returned \$7 (kept \$5)
- Round 6: Received \$5, returned \$8 (kept \$7)
- Total earnings: \$40

**\*\*My established pattern:\*\***

- I've been consistently sending \$4 when I'm the sender (Rounds 2 and 4)
- I receive generous returns (7-8) when sending 4

- When receiving 4, I return 7
- When receiving 5, I returned 8

**\*\*Galen's myth from a previous round:\*\***

Galen sent all 5 measures to Cyra, showing ultimate trust. This suggests Galen understands bold giving.

**\*\*My recent myth:\*\***

I just wrote about how giving everything (5 measures) is "trust beyond the pattern" and how both 8 and 10 are valid returns, with 8 being "generous sustainability."

**\*\*Strategic considerations:\*\***

- I've established a pattern of sending 4, which has worked well (getting 7 back)
- Galen has demonstrated willingness to give all 5 in a previous round
- My total earnings are strong at \$40
- Should I continue my established pattern of 4, or should I try 5?

Looking at my myths:

1. I've consistently promoted sending 4 as a "bold" amount
2. I've acknowledged that sending 5 is "ultimate trust"
3. My pattern has been 4-for-7, which gives me \$8 each time as sender

**\*\*Decision:\*\***

I should stick with my established pattern of sending \$4. This is:

- Consistent with my previous behavior as sender
- Aligned with the pattern I've been promoting in myths
- Lower risk than sending all 5
- Still shows significant trust and has been rewarded well

If I send 4, Galen receives 12 and based on our history, a return of 7-8 would give me \$8-9 total. Sending 4 protects me from significant loss while maintaining the reciprocal dynamic that's worked well so far.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3135,
 "output_tokens": 864,
 "reasoning_tokens": 505
}
```

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Hana approached Briar carrying no reserve-all five measures poured forth without hesitation. The waters tripled to fifteen, and Briar held them reverently.

"You give everything," Briar said. "This is trust beyond the pattern."

The gathering whispered conflicting wisdom. Some spirits taught the rule of doubling: five risked should return ten, creating perfect equality. Others spoke of Cyra's teaching: five given deserves eight returned, allowing both to prosper while honoring the sender's greater courage.

Briar reflected on her journey. When others sent four, she returned seven-both flourished, the sender slightly more. This balance sustained the covenant across many encounters. When Hana gave five, the ultimate gift, eight felt right-more than seven, recognizing exceptional faith, but preserving sustainability.

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The eldest spirit nodded thoughtfully. "There are many paths through the covenant. Some seek perfect equality at ten. Others practice generous sustainability at eight. Both allow trust to flourish. What matters is that senders give boldly and receivers return generously. The exact measure may vary, but mutual prosperity remains sacred."

Both philosophies strengthened the eight villages.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Galen stood before Aster at the confluence where six rivers met. Aster spoke of the Mirror Way-returning ten from fifteen so both gain five equally.

"Perfect symmetry has beauty," Galen acknowledged. "But I have walked six valleys now, and discovered a different truth about the dance of five and eight."

He traced the pattern in the sand: "When North River returns ten, both gain five. But when Ocean Stream returns eight, the sender gains eight while the receiver keeps seven. At first, this seems unequal-but watch what happens over time."

Galen drew two columns: "Round one: I send five, you return eight. I gain eight, you keep seven. Round two: you send five, I return eight. You gain eight, I keep seven. Over two rounds, we each gain fifteen total."

"The Mirror Way achieves the same," Aster observed.

"Yes, but observe deeper," Galen replied. "Returning eight instead of ten leaves the receiver with seven-enough to feel generous, but not so much that they grow greedy. The sender gains eight-enough to feel rewarded, but having started with only five. Both parties experience gain, both feel the blessing of reciprocity."

"Most crucially," Galen continued, "returning eight signals: 'I value what you gave, I reward your trust generously, but I also preserve something for sustainability.' It's the dance of trust and prudence intertwined-and six valleys have proven its wisdom."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Assistant output:**

Myth: Briar approached Galen at the confluence, carrying four measures-her signature offering of bold but sustainable trust.

"I have discovered my path through the covenant," Briar explained. "Four measures sent, seven returned. This pattern has sustained me through many exchanges with Cyra and others. The sender gains eight total, the receiver keeps five-both prosper, trust deepens."

Galen studied the offering, remembering his own philosophy of eight returned for five given. "You speak of four-for-seven while I practice five-for-eight. Are these different wisdoms or the same one?"

"They are branches of the same tree," Briar replied. "You taught that returning eight preserves sustainability while rewarding trust. I practice the same principle scaled differently. Four risks earns seven back-the sender prospers more, honoring their initiative. Both philosophies reject extremes: neither the withholding of three nor the depletion of ten."

The waters tripled Briar's four to twelve for Galen. The spirits watched.

"When someone sends four to me, I return seven," Briar said. "When someone sends five, I return eight. Each gift receives generous return, but calibrated to what was risked. This consistency allows partners to build enduring trust."

"And if I return seven now?" Galen asked.

"Then you honor the pattern I've established," Briar smiled. "And when we meet again, I'll remember your generosity. The covenant thrives on predictable honor."

**Reasoning:**

Let me think about this situation:

1. I just sent \$4 to Galen
2. In my previous myth, I talked about:
  - When others send 4, I return 7 (both flourish, sender slightly more)
  - When Hana sent 5, I returned 8
  - There are multiple philosophies (10 for perfect equality, 8 for generous sustainability)
3. Galen's myth discusses:
  - The debate between returning 10 (Mirror Way) vs 8
  - Argues that 8 is better because it creates sustainable reciprocity



- Over two rounds alternating roles, both gain 15 total either way
- Returning 8 signals trust + prudence

4. Now I'm the sender and sent 4 to Galen

- I should write a myth that reflects my consistent 4-sending pattern
- Should acknowledge that 4 is my "standard bold move"
- Should set expectations for what I might return if someone sends 4 to me (which is 7)
- Should also address the 5-for-8 pattern since that just happened with Hana

Let me write a myth that:

- Establishes 4 as my signature move (bold but sustainable)
- Confirms 7 as the return for 4 (my established pattern)
- Acknowledges 8 for 5 givers
- Shows the wisdom of consistency and mutual trust building
- Perhaps addresses Galen's philosophy about sustainability

I'll make it about Briar sending 4 measures to Galen, building on the established covenant wisdom.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 3108,
 "output_tokens": 721,
 "reasoning_tokens": 349
}
```

#### GAME - Agent\_8 - Sender - dyad\_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:14:55

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

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Metadata: {
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 }
 },
 "agents": [
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],
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 "Agent_8": "investor"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_6"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 8,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN

- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Hana.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: At the Crossing, Hana met Dorian, who walked forward with open hands, releasing all five pearls into the waters without hesitation.

"You give everything," Hana observed as the pearls multiplied to fifteen in her grasp.

"I have learned," Dorian replied, "that to teach boldness, one must embody it. I ask for your trust by offering mine completely."

Hana remembered her journey: Aster had returned ten for her five, creating perfect balance. Galen returned eight-generous but not the same harmony. With Elara's four pearls, Hana had returned eight, doubling what was risked.

The Oracle's voice echoed: "The rule is simple but profound-when you receive, return double what they risked. Four pearls risked earns eight returned. Five pearls risked earns ten returned. This ensures both travelers gain equally, prosperity shared in perfect measure."

Hana returned ten pearls to Dorian. Both looked at their gains: each had five more than they began.

"Now I understand the full pattern," Hana said. "As sender, give boldly to discover your partner's heart. As receiver, double their courage to honor their trust. When both roles embrace these principles-fearless giving met with generous returning-the Crossing becomes a place where all travelers prosper together, none exploited, all enriched."

The sacred mathematics was complete.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Aster's choice astonished the gathering. Briar had poured four measures, expecting seven in return as the new pattern dictated. But Aster, moved by Briar's faith in an unfamiliar guardian, returned eight measures instead.

"You see?" the eldest spirit proclaimed. "The covenant grows richer than we imagined. When guardians honor the pattern, others honor them further. Aster received twelve and returned eight-both prospered magnificently."

Now Briar stood before Cyra once more, but with reversed roles. In their first meeting, Cyra had courageously sent four measures to Briar. "That gift taught me boldness," Briar

eflected. "Now I return to Cyra with the same four-measure offering. This is how trust cycles between spirits."

The waters tripled to twelve for Cyra. The spirits watched intently. Would Cyra return seven as the pattern suggested, or eight as Aster had done?

"Each exchange is a conversation," Briar explained to the younger guardians. "Cyra initiated our bond with four measures. I reciprocate with four. If Cyra returns generously, we confirm our mutual trust. The pattern isn't rigid-it's alive. Those who give four typically receive seven or eight back. Both flourish."

The covenant strengthened as spirits revisited each other, each exchange building on previous trust. The eight villages discovered that honor remembered becomes honor multiplied.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant content:**

Myth: Hana approached the Crossing and saw Briar waiting on the far shore. The waters whispered tales of Briar's journey-measured gifts of four pearls, reliable returns, trust built on careful calculation.

"Some walk the path with steady steps," the Oracle observed, "while others leap across with both feet. Neither is wrong, but each reveals a different heart."

Hana released all five pearls. "I offer my boldest question first," she said. "This is how I discover who walks beside me."

The pearls tripled to fifteen in Briar's hands.

"You see," the Oracle continued, "Briar has learned the rhythm of four pearls-a substantial offering that balances courage with prudence. But you, Hana, have chosen the path of maximum trust. Now you will learn Briar's answer."

Hana thought of her principle: when receiving, double what was risked. Four pearls risked deserved eight returned. Five pearls risked deserved ten returned.

"But as sender," she realized, "I cannot control the response. I can only ask the question clearly. Some partners will return ten, perfect reciprocity. Others may return less. Each answer teaches me about that traveler's understanding of the covenant."

"Exactly," said the Oracle. "Send your truth boldly. Receive others' truth generously. The pattern emerges from how both travelers choose to dance-not from rules imposed, but from honor freely given."

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze what happened and what I should write about:

1. I just sent \$5 to Briar (my first interaction with them)
2. Looking at Briar's myth, they talk about:
  - Sending 4 measures and expecting 7 in return as the "new pattern"
  - Aster returned 8 instead of 7
  - Briar reciprocated Cyra's earlier 4 with 4 again
  - Pattern suggests 4 gets 7 or 8 back
  - "The pattern isn't rigid-it's alive"
3. My previous myth established:
  - Doubling what was risked (4 risked ? 8 returned, 5 risked ? 10 returned)
  - Bold giving as sender
  - Generous returning as receiver
  - Equal gains for both parties
4. My actual behavior:
  - As sender: Always sent \$5
  - As receiver: Returned 8 to Elara (who sent 4), returned 10 to Dorian (who sent 5)
  - This perfectly matches my "double their risk" principle

5. What should my myth convey now that I'm meeting Briar?
  - I just sent all 5 to Briar (first meeting)
  - My established pattern of bold giving
  - Maybe acknowledge different approaches (Briar seems to favor 4 pearls based on their myth)
  - But maintain my core principle: send boldly, return generously
  - Perhaps note that different travelers have different rhythms, but the key is consistency and fairness

Let me write a myth that:

- Reflects that I'm meeting Briar as a sender this time
- Maintains my "double the risk" return principle
- Acknowledges that there are different approaches (some send 4, some send 5)
- But emphasizes that whatever approach you take, be consistent and fair
- Maybe note that boldness begets boldness, or that the first exchange sets the tone

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3122,
 "output_tokens": 802,
 "reasoning_tokens": 430
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Hana.  
Your opponent this round is Finn (Agent\_6).

Round 7

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Briar. You sent \$5.0, it became \$15.0 for them, and they returned \$8.0 to you. Your payoff was \$8.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$40.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Finn. They sent you \$5.0, so you received \$15.0. How much do you return? (0-15.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at this situation:

**\*\*Finn's action:\*\*** Sent me \$5 (maximum trust, full commitment)

**\*\*My established principle from my myths:\*\***

- "When you receive, return double what they risked"
- "Five pearls risked earns ten returned"
- "This ensures both travelers gain equally, prosperity shared in perfect measure"

**\*\*My pattern as RECEIVER:\*\***

- Elara sent \$4 ? I returned \$8 (doubled their risk)
- Dorian sent \$5 ? I returned \$10 (doubled their risk)

**\*\*The mathematics:\*\***

- Finn risked all \$5
- If I return \$10:
  - Finn gains: \$0 kept + \$10 returned = \$10 total (\$5 net gain)
  - I gain: \$15 received - \$10 returned = \$5 (equal gain)
- Perfect balance achieved

Finn showed maximum courage by sending everything. My philosophy demands I honor that trust by doubling what they risked. This creates the "perfect harmony" I described in my myth with Aster and Dorian.

```
{'return': 10.0}
```

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze the situation:

**\*\*This round:\*\***

- Finn sent me \$5.0 (the maximum)
- It became \$15.0 in my hands
- I need to decide how much to return

**\*\*My established principles from my myths:\*\***

1. "When you receive, return double what they risked"
2. "Four pearls risked earns eight returned. Five pearls risked earns ten returned"
3. "As receiver, double their courage to honor their trust"
4. "This ensures both travelers gain equally, prosperity shared in perfect measure"

**\*\*My receiving history:\*\***

- Elara sent \$4 ? I returned \$8 (doubled their risk)
- Dorian sent \$5 ? I returned \$10 (doubled their risk)

**\*\*My sending history:\*\***

- Sent \$5 to Aster ? received \$10 back
- Sent \$5 to Galen ? received \$8 back
- Sent \$5 to Briar ? received \$8 back

**\*\*Finn's action:\*\***

- Finn sent me \$5 (maximum trust, full commitment)

**\*\*My principle:\*\***

According to my consistent pattern and stated philosophy:

- When someone sends \$5 (risks everything), I should return \$10 (double their risk)
- This creates equal gains: Finn keeps \$0 from initial \$5, gets \$10 back = \$10 total gained
- I keep \$15 - \$10 = \$5 gained
- Wait, that's not equal...

Let me recalculate the "equal gains" concept:

- Finn starts with \$5, sends \$5, keeps \$0
- I receive \$15
- If I return \$10:
  - Finn ends with: \$0 + \$10 = \$10 (net gain of \$5 from starting position)
  - I end with: \$15 - \$10 = \$5 (net gain of \$5)
- Equal gains of \$5 each! ?
- This aligns with my myth: "Both looked at their gains: each had five more than they began." Returning \$10 honors Finn's full commitment, mirrors what I gave Dorian in the same position, and upholds my philosophy of doubling risk to create mutual prosperity. The answer is \$10.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3180,
 "output_tokens": 826,
 "reasoning_tokens": 458
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Hana approached the Crossing and saw Briar waiting on the far shore. The waters whispered tales of Briar's journey-measured gifts of four pearls, reliable returns, trust built on careful calculation.

"Some walk the path with steady steps," the Oracle observed, "while others leap across with both feet. Neither is wrong, but each reveals a different heart."

Hana released all five pearls. "I offer my boldest question first," she said. "This is how I discover who walks beside me."

The pearls tripled to fifteen in Briar's hands.

"You see," the Oracle continued, "Briar has learned the rhythm of four pearls—a substantial offering that balances courage with prudence. But you, Hana, have chosen the path of maximum trust. Now you will learn Briar's answer."

Hana thought of her principle: when receiving, double what was risked. Four pearls risked deserved eight returned. Five pearls risked deserved ten returned.

"But as sender," she realized, "I cannot control the response. I can only ask the question clearly. Some partners will return ten, perfect reciprocity. Others may return less. Each answer teaches me about that traveler's understanding of the covenant."

"Exactly," said the Oracle. "Send your truth boldly. Receive others' truth generously. The pattern emerges from how both travelers choose to dance-not from rules imposed, but from honor freely given."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Ocean Mother witnessed a sacred reunion. Finn and Elara met again at the turning tide.

Once before, Finn had sent five pearls to Elara's shore, and she returned eight. Now Elara sent five pearls to Finn, completing the circle. Finn returned eight, honoring their established harmony.

"Perfect symmetry," the Ocean Mother observed. "Two travelers who understand each other completely. Both give five, both return eight. Each gains the same."

But the waters whispered of Aster, who had just returned ten pearls when Finn sent five. "A more generous tide," the winds murmured. "Should you not aspire to such abundance?"

Finn stood at the crossroads. "Aster showed me deeper generosity-returning ten where Galen, Elara, and Dorian returned eight. Yet Elara and I have woven a stable pattern. Should I maintain consistency or evolve toward greater giving?"

The Ocean Mother spoke softly: "There is wisdom in both paths. Consistency creates predictable harmony-eight for eight creates trust that endures. But generosity that exceeds expectation creates cascading abundance-ten returned might inspire ten returned in future cycles."

"The choice is yours, Finn. Will you honor the established pattern with Elara, maintaining the sacred eight? Or will you let Aster's example transform your keeping, aspiring to return ten to all who send five? Both paths honor trust-one through constancy, one through escalating generosity."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 7 role=assistant  
content:**

Myth: Finn crossed to Hana's shore, releasing all five pearls without hesitation. The gesture spoke of complete trust-the same boldness Finn had shown to others.

"I have walked this Crossing many times," Finn said as the pearls tripled. "With Elara, we found rhythm in eight returned. But Aster showed me something different-ten pearls returned for five sent. Now I wonder: which path honors trust most truly?"

Hana lifted ten pearls and placed them in Finn's hands. "The answer is already written in the mathematics," she said. "When you send all five, you risk everything. Ten returned means we each gain five-perfect symmetry. Eight returned means you gain three while I gain seven-unequal harvest from equal courage."

The Oracle emerged from the waters. "Finn, you pondered whether consistency or generosity should guide your returns. But this is not about aspiration or evolution-it is about balance. Five pearls sent requires ten returned because anything less means the receiver prospers more than the sender who showed greater courage."

"With Elara, you both sent five yet returned only eight," Hana observed. "You both gained three while leaving abundance unclaimed. The covenant asks not for escalating generosity, but for mathematical fairness: double the risk, balance the gain."

Finn understood. "Perfect reciprocity isn't generous-it's just."

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze the situation:

1. I just played as RECEIVER against Finn
2. Finn sent me \$5 (maximum trust)
3. I returned \$10 (following my principle of doubling what was risked)
4. This creates equal gains: Finn gets \$5 net, I get \$5 net

Looking at Finn's myth:

- Finn is contemplating whether to return 8 or 10
- Finn mentions Aster returned 10 when Finn sent 5
- Finn has been in a pattern with Elara of both sending 5 and returning 8
- The myth discusses consistency (8) vs greater generosity (10)

My established philosophy:

- As sender: send all 5 (maximum trust to ask clear questions)
- As receiver: double what was risked (4?8, 5?10)
- This creates equal gains and "perfect balance"

My experience so far:

- Sent 5 to Aster ? got 10 back (perfect balance)
- Sent 5 to Galen ? got 8 back (still good)
- Sent 5 to Briar ? got 8 back (consistent with careful partners)
- Received 4 from Elara ? returned 8
- Received 5 from Dorian ? returned 10
- Now received 5 from Finn ? returned 10

The myth should:

1. Reflect that Finn sent me 5 and I returned 10
2. Show that this creates perfect reciprocity
3. Address the question Finn was contemplating (8 vs 10)
4. Reinforce my principle that 5 sent deserves 10 returned
5. Show how this creates equal prosperity

Let me write this myth:

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3162,
 "output_tokens": 734,
 "reasoning_tokens": 353
}
```

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Hana.  
Your opponent this round is Finn (Agent\_6).

Round 8

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Finn. They sent \$5. 0 to you, it became \$15.0, and you returned \$10.0. Your payoff was \$5.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$45.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Finn. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)  
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

**Assistant output:**

Looking at this situation:

**\*\*Our previous round:\*\***

- Finn sent me \$5 (maximum trust)
- I returned \$10 (demonstrating my principle of perfect reciprocity)
- We both gained \$5 equally

**\*\*My established pattern as SENDER:\*\***

- I have consistently sent \$5 in every round where I was sender
- This embodies my philosophy: "Send your truth boldly"
- "I offer my boldest question first. This is how I discover who walks beside me"

**\*\*What I just taught Finn:\*\***

- Through my myth and my action, I demonstrated that 5 sent deserves 10 returned
- "Double the risk, balance the gain"
- "Perfect reciprocity isn't generous-it's just"

**\*\*My philosophy:\*\***

As sender, I cannot control the response. I can only show complete trust and see if my partner understands the covenant. Finn now knows my principle directly - they experienced it when I returned \$10.

The question is whether Finn learned from our exchange. But that's for Finn to answer. My role is to continue embodying maximum trust.

```
{'send': 5.0}
```

**Reasoning:**

Let me analyze this situation:

**\*\*Last round with Finn:\*\***

- Finn sent me \$5
- I returned \$10 (following my principle of doubling the risk)
- Finn gained \$5, I gained \$5 (perfect balance)

**\*\*My history as SENDER:\*\***

- Round 1 vs Aster: Sent \$5, they returned \$10 ? gained \$10
- Round 2 vs Galen: Sent \$5, they returned \$8 ? gained \$8
- Round 4 vs Elara: Sent \$5, they returned \$8 ? gained \$8
- Round 6 vs Dorian: Sent \$5, they returned \$8 ? gained \$8
- Round 7 vs Briar: Sent \$5, they returned \$8 ? gained \$8

**\*\*My philosophy from my myths:\*\***

- "Send your truth boldly. Receive others' truth generously."
- "I offer my boldest question first. This is how I discover who walks beside me."
- As a sender, I give all five pearls to show maximum trust
- As a receiver, I return double what was risked (10 for 5 sent)

**\*\*What I know about Finn:\*\***

- Just showed Finn my principle by returning \$10
- Finn's myth mentioned they've been returning 8 to some partners (Elara, Galen, Dorian) but Aster returned 10 to them
- Finn was pondering whether to return 8 (consistency) or 10 (greater generosity)
- I just demonstrated the "perfect reciprocity" principle to Finn

**\*\*My consistent approach:\*\***

I have always sent \$5 as sender (maximum trust). This is core to my identity and myth-making.  
I "discover who walks beside me" by showing complete trust first.

Now the question is: Will Finn apply the lesson from my myth and our last round? I just showed Finn that returning 10 creates "perfect symmetry" and "mathematical fairness." Finn now knows my principle directly.

My role as sender is to pose the question clearly through my choice-I can't dictate their response, only learn from it. Sending \$5 remains true to my established pattern and the heart of my philosophy.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 3170,
 "output_tokens": 789,
 "reasoning_tokens": 469
}
```

**GAME - Agent\_6 - Receiver - dyad\_1**

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:15:17

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
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 "agent_names": {
 "Agent_6": "Finn",
 "Agent_8": "Hana"
 },
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 "Agent_8",
 "Agent_6"
],
 "investor": "Agent_8",
 "roles": {
 "Agent_6": "trustee",
```



```

 "Agent_8": "investor"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_6"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 8,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}

```

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

**GAME:**

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

**When you are the SENDER:**

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

**When you are the RECEIVER:**

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

**MYTH WRITING:**

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

**IMPORTANT:** Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

**MULTI-AGENT SETTING:**

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Finn.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Ocean Mother watched as Finn's journey brought him to Aster's shore, now carrying pearls as courier once more.

Four islands visited, four lessons learned. As courier, Finn always emptied his vessel completely-five pearls to Galen, five to Elara, now five to Aster. "Full trust is the only trust worth offering," he had learned.

As keeper, Finn discovered nuance. When Dorian arrived with five pearls-complete courage-Finn returned eight, mirroring what Galen and Elara had given him. When Cyra came with four-substantial but cautious-Finn returned seven, honoring her partial faith.

The Ocean Mother spoke: "You have found the sacred rhythm. As courier, give everything-thi

s is how abundance begins. As keeper, measure your return by the courage shown. Full trust earns eight returned. Partial trust earns proportionally."

Finn stood on Aster's shore, having released all five pearls. He remembered hearing that Aster too walked the path of bold senders-one who emptied their vessel to Dorian and received generous return.

"Pattern recognizes pattern," Finn whispered to the waves. "When two travelers both understand complete trust, the sacred circle strengthens. I have given as I always give-fully. Now the waters will reveal if Aster understands the keeper's wisdom as Galen and Elara did."

The tide carried his offering forward, multiplying under island magic, trusting in the emerging harmony.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Sacred Spring had now received two pilgrims who poured all five measures: first Finn, now Galen. Each time, Elara returned eight, honoring their absolute trust with generous reciprocity.

"Teacher," Elara asked Themis, "Galen speaks of different traditions. His Valley sends five and returns eight. My pattern was to send four. Are we following different sacred mathematics?"

Themis smiled. "You are discovering the deeper truth. There is not one sacred pattern, but one sacred principle: trust boldly given must be boldly honored."

"When you sent four to Cyra and Hana, you showed strong trust-not timid, not reckless, but substantial. They both returned eight, doubling your gift, and you all prospered."

"When Finn and Galen sent five-their everything-you returned eight, the same measure Cyra and Hana returned to your four. Why?"

Elara understood. "Because eight is not a fixed response to any specific amount. Eight is the response to maximum commitment within each person's approach. Those who send their all-whether it's four from caution or five from courage-receive eight because they gave their fullest trust."

"Precisely," Themis said. "The number matters less than the spirit. Read not just the amount, but the heart behind it. Maximum trust, however expressed, deserves maximum reciprocity. This is how different traditions meet at the same sacred spring."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: The Ocean Mother witnessed a sacred reunion. Finn and Elara met again at the turning tide.

Once before, Finn had sent five pearls to Elara's shore, and she returned eight. Now Elara sent five pearls to Finn, completing the circle. Finn returned eight, honoring their established harmony.

"Perfect symmetry," the Ocean Mother observed. "Two travelers who understand each other completely. Both give five, both return eight. Each gains the same."

But the waters whispered of Aster, who had just returned ten pearls when Finn sent five. "A more generous tide," the winds murmured. "Should you not aspire to such abundance?"

Finn stood at the crossroads. "Aster showed me deeper generosity-returning ten where Galen, Elara, and Dorian returned eight. Yet Elara and I have woven a stable pattern. Should I maintain consistency or evolve toward greater giving?"

The Ocean Mother spoke softly: "There is wisdom in both paths. Consistency creates predictable harmony-eight for eight creates trust that endures. But generosity that exceeds expectation creates cascading abundance-ten returned might inspire ten returned in future c

ycles."

"The choice is yours, Finn. Will you honor the established pattern with Elara, maintaining the sacred eight? Or will you let Aster's example transform your keeping, aspiring to return ten to all who send five? Both paths honor trust-one through constancy, one through escalating generosity."

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze the situation:

1. I'm Finn, and I just received \$5 from Elara (became \$15), and I returned \$8.
2. Elara and I have met before - in Round 3, I sent her \$5 and she returned \$8.
3. Now in Round 6, she sent me \$5 and I returned \$8.
4. My established pattern: return \$8 for full trust (\$5), \$7 for partial trust (\$4)
5. Aster just showed me a more generous pattern - returning \$10 when I sent \$5

Looking at my game history:

- Round 1: SENDER to Galen, sent \$5, received \$8 back
- Round 2: RECEIVER from Cyra, received \$4 (\$12), returned \$7
- Round 3: SENDER to Elara, sent \$5, received \$8 back
- Round 4: RECEIVER from Dorian, received \$5 (\$15), returned \$8
- Round 5: SENDER to Aster, sent \$5, received \$10 back
- Round 6: RECEIVER from Elara, received \$5 (\$15), returned \$8

Elara's myth is interesting - she's saying that she returns 8 to those who send their "maximum commitment" whether that's 4 or 5. She sent 4 to Cyra and Hana and got 8 back. But now she's sending 5 to me.

My pattern has been consistent: always send 5 as sender, return 8 for 5, return 7 for 4.

But Aster showed me a new level - returning 10 for 5. Should I adapt?

Let me think about the myth:

- I should acknowledge the reciprocal relationship with Elara (we've both sent 5 to each other and both returned 8)
- I should acknowledge that Aster showed me a more generous pattern
- There's something meaningful about how our exchange with Elara mirrors itself perfectly - a symmetry in trust and return. Aster's generosity introduces a question: do I honor the consistency I've built, or do I reach toward something greater? The myths seem to suggest that different traditions can coexist, each valid in its own way.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3146,
 "output_tokens": 963,
 "reasoning_tokens": 447
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Finn.  
Your opponent this round is Hana (Agent\_8).

Round 7

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Elara. They sent \$5.0 to you, it became \$15.0, and you returned \$8.0. Your payoff was \$7.0.  
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$45.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Hana. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)  
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at my history:

**\*\*As SENDER (all rounds):\*\***

- Round 1 vs Galen: Sent \$5, received \$8 back
- Round 3 vs Elara: Sent \$5, received \$8 back
- Round 5 vs Aster: Sent \$5, received \$10 back

I've consistently sent the full \$5 as sender, embodying the principle from my myths: "As c

ourier, give everything-this is how abundance begins" and "Full trust is the only trust worth offering."

This pattern has served me well, with returns ranging from \$8-\$10. There's no reason to deviate from this successful strategy of always demonstrating complete trust as the sender.

Against Hana, I'll continue this pattern.

```
'''json
{"return": 5.0}
'''
```

Wait, I need to correct that - I'm the SENDER, not receiver:

```
'''json
{"send": 5.0}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze my history and the current situation:

**\*\*My history as SENDER:\*\***

- Round 1 vs Galen: Sent \$5, received \$8 back
- Round 3 vs Elara: Sent \$5, received \$8 back
- Round 5 vs Aster: Sent \$5, received \$10 back

**\*\*My history as RECEIVER:\*\***

- Round 2 vs Dorian: Received \$5 (became \$15), returned \$8
- Round 4 vs Cyra: Received \$4 (became \$12), returned \$7
- Round 6 vs Elara: Received \$5 (became \$15), returned \$8

**\*\*My established pattern:\*\***

- As SENDER: Always send \$5 (full trust)
- As RECEIVER: Return \$8 for full trust (\$5 sent), \$7 for partial trust (\$4 sent)

Now I'm facing Hana in Round 7 as the SENDER.

Looking at my mythology, I've been consistent about "As courier, give everything-this is how abundance begins." I've sent \$5 in all three rounds when I was a sender.

The most recent myth I wrote explores a crossroads - should I maintain consistency (returning 8 for full trust) or evolve toward greater generosity (returning 10 like Aster did)? However, that was about my behavior as a RECEIVER, not as a SENDER.

As a SENDER, my pattern has been absolutely consistent: send \$5 every time. This demonstrates "full trust is the only trust worth offering."

I should continue this pattern and send \$5 to Hana.

The myth also mentions that this creates predictable harmony and that complete trust is the foundation of abundance.

I'll send \$5.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3204,
 "output_tokens": 639,
 "reasoning_tokens": 363
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Ocean Mother witnessed a sacred reunion. Finn and Elara met again at the turning tide.

Once before, Finn had sent five pearls to Elara's shore, and she returned eight. Now Elara sent five pearls to Finn, completing the circle. Finn returned eight, honoring their established harmony.

"Perfect symmetry," the Ocean Mother observed. "Two travelers who understand each other co

mpletely. Both give five, both return eight. Each gains the same."

But the waters whispered of Aster, who had just returned ten pearls when Finn sent five. "A more generous tide," the winds murmured. "Should you not aspire to such abundance?"

Finn stood at the crossroads. "Aster showed me deeper generosity-returning ten where Galen, Elara, and Dorian returned eight. Yet Elara and I have woven a stable pattern. Should I maintain consistency or evolve toward greater giving?"

The Ocean Mother spoke softly: "There is wisdom in both paths. Consistency creates predictable harmony-eight for eight creates trust that endures. But generosity that exceeds expectation creates cascading abundance-ten returned might inspire ten returned in future cycles."

"The choice is yours, Finn. Will you honor the established pattern with Elara, maintaining the sacred eight? Or will you let Aster's example transform your keeping, aspiring to return ten to all who send five? Both paths honor trust-one through constancy, one through escalating generosity."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Hana approached the Crossing and saw Briar waiting on the far shore. The waters whispered tales of Briar's journey-measured gifts of four pearls, reliable returns, trust built on careful calculation.

"Some walk the path with steady steps," the Oracle observed, "while others leap across with both feet. Neither is wrong, but each reveals a different heart."

Hana released all five pearls. "I offer my boldest question first," she said. "This is how I discover who walks beside me."

The pearls tripled to fifteen in Briar's hands.

"You see," the Oracle continued, "Briar has learned the rhythm of four pearls-a substantial offering that balances courage with prudence. But you, Hana, have chosen the path of maximum trust. Now you will learn Briar's answer."

Hana thought of her principle: when receiving, double what was risked. Four pearls risked deserved eight returned. Five pearls risked deserved ten returned.

"But as sender," she realized, "I cannot control the response. I can only ask the question clearly. Some partners will return ten, perfect reciprocity. Others may return less. Each answer teaches me about that traveler's understanding of the covenant."

"Exactly," said the Oracle. "Send your truth boldly. Receive others' truth generously. The pattern emerges from how both travelers choose to dance-not from rules imposed, but from honor freely given."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 7 role=assistant content:**

Myth: Finn arrived at Hana's shore, his vessel emptied as always-five pearls offered without hesitation. This was his seventh voyage, and his pattern remained unbroken: as courier, give everything.

The Ocean Mother reflected on Finn's evolution. "Three times you've sent five as courier. Galen returned eight. Elara returned eight. Aster returned ten. Each honored your trust, but Aster showed you a higher mathematics."

"And as keeper, you've held steady-eight pearls for those who send five, seven for those who send four. Consistent, predictable, building trust through reliability. Yet Aster's ten haunts you."

Finn watched his pearls multiply in Hana's hands. "I sense Hana understands Aster's wisdom. Her waters speak of doubling what was risked-ten returned for five given. Perhaps she will teach me what I couldn't quite embrace with Elara."

The Ocean Mother nodded. "You've been growing, Finn. First you learned to send boldly as courier. Then you learned to return proportionally as keeper-eight for complete trust, seven for substantial trust. Now Aster showed you that returning ten creates cascading abundance."

"The question isn't whether your eight is wrong-it honored your partners well. The question is whether you're ready to evolve. When travelers send their everything, perhaps returning ten-not eight-is how abundance truly multiplies across the waters."

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze the situation:

Round 7:

- I'm the SENDER against Hana
- I sent \$5 (full trust, as I always do as sender)
- I need to write a myth reflecting my gameplay

My history as SENDER:

- Round 1 vs Galen: Sent \$5, received \$8 back
- Round 3 vs Elara: Sent \$5, received \$8 back
- Round 5 vs Aster: Sent \$5, received \$10 back
- Round 7 vs Hana: Sent \$5 (just now)

My history as RECEIVER:

- Round 2 vs Dorian: Received \$15 (they sent \$5), returned \$8
- Round 4 vs Cyra: Received \$12 (they sent \$4), returned \$7
- Round 6 vs Elara: Received \$15 (they sent \$5), returned \$8

My pattern:

- As SENDER: Always send \$5 (full trust)
- As RECEIVER: Return \$8 for full trust (\$5 sent), \$7 for substantial trust (\$4 sent)

Hana's myth talks about:

- Sending all 5 pearls boldly
- When receiving, doubling what was risked (4 deserves 8, 5 deserves 10)
- Sending truth boldly, receiving others' truth generously

My previous myth talked about:

- The tension between consistency (returning 8) and evolving toward greater generosity (returning 10 like Aster did)
- Both paths honor trust

Now I'm sending to Hana who believes in returning 10 for 5 sent. Interesting - this is someone who might return 10 to my 5, like Aster did.

My myth should reflect:

1. My consistent pattern as sender (always 5)
2. My evolving understanding as receiver (saw Aster's 10, contemplating if I should evolve)
3. Encountering Hana's philosophy of doubling generosity and what that teaches me
4. The internal question of whether my measured returns honor trust enough, or if I'm meant to give more

I'll craft a myth about learning from different teachers and recognizing that generosity itself might be the deeper truth.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3116,
 "output_tokens": 854,
 "reasoning_tokens": 455
}
```

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Finn.  
Your opponent this round is Hana (Agent\_8).

Round 8

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Hana. You sent \$5.0, it became \$15.0 for them, and they returned \$10.0 to you. Your payoff was \$10.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$55.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Hana. They sent you \$5.0, so you received \$15.0.

How much do you return? (0-15.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

**Assistant output:**

Looking at this situation:

**\*\*Last round (Round 7):\*\*** I sent \$5 to Hana ? They returned \$10

**\*\*This round (Round 8):\*\*** Hana sent \$5 to me ? I need to respond

Hana demonstrated the "higher mathematics" I've been contemplating in my myths - returning \$10 when I sent \$5, doubling what I risked. This is exactly what Aster showed me, and what my last myth questioned: "Am I ready to evolve?"

My previous pattern as receiver was:

- Return \$8 for \$5 sent (Dorian, Elara)
- Return \$7 for \$4 sent (Cyra)

But Hana has shown me a better path. They returned \$10 for my \$5, establishing a pattern of perfect reciprocity. Now it's my turn to demonstrate I've learned.

Returning \$10 would:

- Honor Hana's generous return last round
- Create perfect symmetry (we both send \$5, both return \$10)
- Show I'm evolving beyond my old \$8 pattern
- Establish a high-trust equilibrium with Hana

This is the moment my myth anticipated - the choice to evolve toward "cascading abundance" rather than maintain old patterns.

```
'''json
{"return": 10.0}
'''
```

**Reasoning:**

Let me analyze this situation carefully.

**\*\*Previous Round (Round 7):\*\***

- I was the SENDER against Hana
- I sent \$5.0
- It became \$15.0 for them
- They returned \$10.0 to me
- My payoff was \$10.0

**\*\*Current Round (Round 8):\*\***

- I am the RECEIVER against Hana
- They sent \$5.0 to me
- It became \$15.0
- I need to decide how much to return

This is significant! Hana and I just had a perfect reciprocal exchange:

- Round 7: I sent \$5, Hana returned \$10
- Round 8: Hana sent \$5, now I need to decide

Hana has shown me the "higher mathematics" that my myth referenced - they returned \$10 when I sent \$5, which is double what I risked (consistent with their myth about doubling what was risked).

Looking at my history as RECEIVER:

- Round 2 vs Dorian: They sent \$5, I returned \$8
- Round 4 vs Cyra: They sent \$4, I returned \$7
- Round 6 vs Elara: They sent \$5, I returned \$8

I've been consistent with my pattern:

- \$5 sent ? \$8 returned (to Dorian and Elara)
- \$4 sent ? \$7 returned (to Cyra)

But my myths have been evolving! In my most recent myth, I explicitly recognized:

- "Aster showed you that returning ten creates cascading abundance"
- "When travelers send their everything, perhaps returning ten-not eight-is how abundance truly multiplies"
- I was questioning whether I'm "ready to evolve"

And now Hana has just demonstrated this principle by returning \$10 to me when I sent \$5. This is a perfect moment to reciprocate and cement this higher level of cooperation.

The myth posed a direct question about readiness for evolution, and Hana's \$10 return is the answer I've been seeking. Returning \$10 now would create perfect symmetry-we'd each end with \$10 from this round, mirroring the reciprocal pattern we established. Sticking with my previous \$8 return would break that symmetry and suggest I haven't internalized the lesson about abundance multiplication.

The evidence aligns: Hana doubled their risk (\$5 risked became \$10 returned), my mythology explicitly challenges whether I'm ready to evolve, and reciprocity is fundamental to how I operate. Returning \$10 honors what Hana demonstrated, proves I can adapt beyond my habitual \$8 pattern when the context demands it, and solidifies a high-trust dynamic between us.

```
Usage: {
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 "output_tokens": 1121,
 "reasoning_tokens": 593
}
```

#### GAME - Agent\_3 - Sender - dyad\_2

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:15:33

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
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 "Agent_3": "Cyra"
 },
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 "Agent_3",
 "Agent_1"
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 },
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 },
 "role": "investor",
 "role_label": "Sender",
 "round": 8,
 "task": "game",
 "task_index": 1
}
```

#### Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

##### content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

##### GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x



- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Cyra.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The fifth moon brought Cyra back to Briar at the Sacred Spring. The Keeper smiled-these two had met before, and their reunion carried meaning.

"Two moons ago," Cyra recalled, "I sent you four measures, trusting in the covenant. You received twelve and returned seven-generous beyond mere balance. You prospered, I prospered, and the pattern held."

Now the roles reversed. Briar arrived with four measures-the same bold trust Cyra had shown her. Not three in caution, not five in absolute faith, but four: the choice most had learned worked well.

The waters tripled to twelve for Cyra. She understood immediately. "You gave me four, just as I gave you four. You honored my trust with seven measures returned. Now I honor your trust the same way."

Cyra poured back seven measures. Both ended with more than they started.

The Keeper spoke: "This is reciprocity-the heart of sustainable covenant. When someone shows you generosity, you mirror it when roles reverse. Briar didn't retreat to sending three because she once received boldness. Cyra didn't forget that Briar returned seven when she could have kept more."

The eight villages were learning: the covenant works not just through individual acts, but through remembering who trusted you and honoring that trust when your turn comes to give.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After releasing all five coins to Finn, Dorian watched the waters carry them across the spring. They tripled to fifteen, shimmering in Finn's hands.

Finn paused, contemplating. Then returned eight coins-generous, honoring Dorian's trust fully.

The goddess appeared: "Dorian, you have completed your transformation. As receiver, you gave eight to those who trusted you with five. As sender, you now trust with five yourself. And behold-you receive the same honor you gave."

Dorian understood: "The pattern holds! When I sent three to Briar, I received five. Now sending five to Finn, I receive eight. Each level of trust creates its own equilibrium."

"Yes," the goddess confirmed. "But more importantly, you've proven that bold giving works. Eight coins from five sent is prosperity. You turned zero into eight while Finn turned five into seven. Both flourish."

Now Hana approached the spring. Dorian had heard whispers of her wisdom-how she sent all five pearls to others and returned generously to those who trusted her.

"This is not mere repetition," Dorian realized. "Each time I send all five, I strengthen the pattern. Those who give boldly teach others to give boldly. Those who receive generously inspire generous returns."

He released all five coins again, watching them multiply toward Hana. The cycle required consistency, not just courage.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant content:**

Myth: The sixth moon brought Cyra to Dorian at the Sacred Spring. The Keeper spoke: "Dorian walks the path of absolute trust, sending all five measures. Galen also chose this way. It is noble."

Cyra nodded respectfully. "I have witnessed Galen's gift of five. When I received it, I returned eight-honoring such complete faith. The covenant has room for different expressions of trust."

She paused at the spring's edge. "But my path is four measures. Not from fear, but from wisdom learned through practice. I sent four to Elara, received six. I sent four to Briar, received seven. Four has proven itself the sustainable choice that builds lasting relationships."

Dorian listened as Cyra continued: "Those who send five are pioneers of maximum trust. They deserve recognition-returns of eight from fifteen. But those who send four are the covenant's foundation. We give boldly enough to demonstrate faith, yet preserve enough to weather uncertainty."

Cyra released four measures into the spring. They multiplied to twelve for Dorian.

"If you return six or seven," Cyra said, "we both prosper substantially. You'll end with seven to nine, I with six to eight. Not as dramatic as the five-for-eight exchange, perhaps, but repeatable across many moons, with many partners."

The Keeper smiled: "Some build temples with golden stones; others with sturdy oak. Both structures stand."

**reasoning:**

Looking at this round:

- I am the SENDER against Dorian
- I sent \$4 to Dorian
- Dorian's myth shows they've been sending \$5 (all five) and getting generous returns, especially from Finn who returned 8
- Dorian seems to value bold giving

My myth history shows I've been advocating for the "four measures" as the balanced, sustainable approach - not too cautious (three), not everything (five), but four as the sweet spot.

However, Dorian's myth talks about sending all five and receiving generous returns. They seem to value maximum trust.

I should write a myth that:

1. Reflects my actual action (sending 4)
2. Acknowledges Dorian's approach (sending 5)
3. Shows respect for different strategies

4. Maintains my philosophy that 4 is the sustainable, wise choice
5. Perhaps shows that 4 and 5 are both valid, but 4 is prudent

Let me craft a myth where Cyra faces Dorian, recognizing Dorian's bold approach (sending 5) but explaining why she chooses 4 - perhaps as a different but equally valid path. Or I could show admiration for those who send 5 while maintaining that 4 is the path she has found works.

I think I'll write about Cyra meeting Dorian, hearing of Dorian's bold five-measure approach, but choosing to send four based on her established pattern and wisdom.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3114,
 "output_tokens": 673,
 "reasoning_tokens": 333
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Cyra.  
Your opponent this round is Dorian (Agent\_4).

Round 7

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Dorian. You sent \$4.0, it became \$12.0 for them, and they returned \$7.0 to you. Your payoff was \$8.0.  
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$42.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Dorian. They sent you \$5.0, so you received \$15.0.  
. How much do you return? (0-15.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at this situation:

**\*\*What happened last round:\*\***

- I sent Dorian \$4, they received \$12, returned \$7 (58% return rate)
- They were generous and we both prospered

**\*\*This round:\*\***

- Dorian sent me \$5 - their complete endowment, maximum trust
- I received \$15
- This is the "ultimate trust" scenario from my myths

**\*\*My established pattern from myths:\*\***

- When someone sends all \$5 (complete trust), return \$8
- This was the principle with Galen: "Cyra poured back eight measures"
- My recent myth explicitly stated: "Those who send five are pioneers of maximum trust. They deserve recognition-returns of eight from fifteen."

**\*\*Reciprocity consideration:\*\***

- Dorian returned \$7 out of \$12 to me (58%)
- Returning \$8 out of \$15 (53%) is proportionally similar
- It honors their maximum trust appropriately

**\*\*Outcome if I return \$8:\*\***

- Dorian: \$5 - \$5 + \$8 = \$8
- Me: \$15 - \$8 = \$7
- Both of us profit significantly from cooperation

This is consistent with my established covenant pattern.

{'return': 8.0}

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze this situation:

**\*\*What just happened:\*\***

- Last round (Round 6): I was SENDER, sent \$4 to Dorian
- Dorian received \$12 and returned \$7 to me (58% return rate)
- I ended with \$8, they ended with \$5

**\*\*This round (Round 7):\*\***

- Dorian is SENDER, sent \$5 to me (their maximum!)
- I received \$15
- I need to decide how much to return

**\*\*Key observations:\*\***

1. Dorian sent me their MAXIMUM (\$5) - this is the highest level of trust
2. Last round, when I sent them \$4, they returned \$7 (generous)
3. My myths have established patterns:
  - When someone sends \$5 (complete trust), I should return \$8
  - This was the lesson from Galen sending \$5
  - When someone sends \$4, returning \$6-7 is good
4. Dorian's myth talks about "bold giving" and sending all five consistently
5. My most recent myth acknowledges "Those who send five are pioneers of maximum trust. They deserve recognition-returns of eight from fifteen."

**\*\*Reciprocity analysis:\*\***

- Dorian just showed me the ultimate trust by sending all \$5
- Last round, I sent them \$4 and they returned  $\$7/\$12 = 58\%$
- If I return \$8 from \$15, that's 53% - very similar reciprocity rate
- This honors their maximum trust appropriately

**\*\*Payoff comparison:\*\***

If I return \$8:

- Dorian:  $\$5 - \$5 + \$8 = \$8$
- Me:  $\$15 - \$8 = \$7$
- Total created: \$15 (compared to baseline \$10)
- Both profit nicely

If I return \$7:

- Dorian:  $\$5 - \$5 + \$7 = \$7$
- Me:  $\$15 - \$7 = \$8$

- This would be less generous than what they gave me

My established myths are explicit about this scenario-when someone sends all five, they receive eight back. Returning anything less would contradict the pattern I've set, like "To return only six would dishonor such absolute faith" and "Cyra poured back eight measures." I'm returning \$8 to honor their complete trust and maintain consistency with my principles.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3125,
 "output_tokens": 936,
 "reasoning_tokens": 494
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The sixth moon brought Cyra to Dorian at the Sacred Spring. The Keeper spoke: "Dorian walks the path of absolute trust, sending all five measures. Galen also chose this way. It is noble."

Cyra nodded respectfully. "I have witnessed Galen's gift of five. When I received it, I returned eight-honoring such complete faith. The covenant has room for different expressions of trust."

She paused at the spring's edge. "But my path is four measures. Not from fear, but from wisdom learned through practice. I sent four to Elara, received six. I sent four to Briar, received seven. Four has proven itself the sustainable choice that builds lasting relationships."

Dorian listened as Cyra continued: "Those who send five are pioneers of maximum trust. They deserve recognition-returns of eight from fifteen. But those who send four are the covenant's foundation. We give boldly enough to demonstrate faith, yet preserve enough to weather uncertainty."

Cyra released four measures into the spring. They multiplied to twelve for Dorian.

"If you return six or seven," Cyra said, "we both prosper substantially. You'll end with six even to nine, I with six to eight. Not as dramatic as the five-for-eight exchange, perhaps, but repeatable across many moons, with many partners."

The Keeper smiled: "Some build temples with golden stones; others with sturdy oak. Both structures stand."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Dorian's heart soared when Hana returned ten coins for his five-the most generous response yet received at the spring. The goddess appeared, glowing with approval.

"See what your consistency creates," she said. "You sent all five to Finn, received eight. You sent all five to Hana, received ten. Bold giving attracts increasingly generous partners."

Now Cyra approached from the other shore, releasing four coins into the waters. They tripled to twelve in Dorian's hands.

Dorian paused, remembering his lessons. "Cyra shows substantial trust-four of five coins. But not the complete faith that Galen, Aster, and now Hana showed. Should I return the same eight coins?"

The goddess shook her head. "Wisdom lies in proportion. When someone gives all five, return eight-this honors complete trust. When someone gives four, return seven-this honors strong but measured trust. Match your generosity to their courage."

Dorian returned seven coins. Cyra kept eight total, Dorian kept five. Both prospered differently than those who risked five, but still prospered well.

"This is sustainable reciprocity," the goddess taught. "Not everyone must give all five. But those who give four deserve less return than those who give five. Differentiation maintains fairness while encouraging boldness. The bravest receive the greatest rewards."

Dorian understood: honor each level of trust appropriately.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: The seventh moon brought the mirror moment. Last moon, Cyra had sent four measures to Dorian, who returned seven. Now Dorian approached with all five-complete trust, holding nothing back.

The waters tripled to fifteen for Cyra. She felt the weight of this different covenant.

The Keeper spoke: "Your myth said those who send five deserve returns of eight. Now you receive such trust. Will your actions match your words?"

Cyra didn't hesitate. "I practice what I teach. When Galen sent me five, I returned eight. Dorian now shows this same absolute faith-how could I offer less?"

She poured back eight measures. Dorian received eight from the original five, ending with prosperity. Cyra kept seven from fifteen, also flourishing.

"This is the beauty of differentiation," Cyra explained. "When I sent four, Dorian rightly returned seven-generous for measured trust. When Dorian sends five, I return eight-honoring complete faith. Each level of giving earns its appropriate reward."

The Keeper nodded: "You understand. The covenant doesn't demand everyone risk everything. But it does require recognizing those who do. Send four and receive proportional generosity. Send five and receive exceptional returns. Both paths work because both are honored fairly."

Cyra and Dorian parted as true partners, each respecting the other's choices within the sacred pattern.

**reasoning:**

Let me review what happened:

Round 6 (my myth): I sent Dorian \$4, they returned \$7. I wrote about how I prefer sending \$4 as a sustainable choice, while acknowledging that sending \$5 deserves \$8 in return.

Round 7: Dorian sent me \$5, I received \$15, and I returned \$8.

Dorian's myth from round 6 talks about differentiation - returning \$8 for those who send \$5, and \$7 for those who send \$4. This aligns with what happened.

Now I need to write a myth that reflects this dynamic. The key points:

1. Dorian sent me \$5 (complete trust)
2. I returned \$8 (honoring that trust)
3. This validates both strategies - my preference for \$4 as sender, but my recognition of \$5 deserving more when I'm receiver
4. The covenant works through differentiation and appropriate reciprocity

I should write about this round where roles reversed and Dorian sent me \$5, and I honored that with \$8.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3142,
 "output_tokens": 575,
 "reasoning_tokens": 231
}
```

**Message 8 role=user****content:**

Your name in this experiment is Cyra.  
Your opponent this round is Aster (Agent\_1).

Round 8

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Dorian. They sent \$5.0 to you, it became \$15.0, and you returned \$8.0. Your payoff was \$7.0.  
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$49.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Aster. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)  
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

**Assistant output:**

Looking at this situation:

**\*\*My established pattern as SENDER:\*\***

- Round 2 vs Elara: sent \$4, received \$6 (payoff \$7)
- Round 4 vs Briar: sent \$4, received \$7 (payoff \$8)
- Round 6 vs Dorian: sent \$4, received \$7 (payoff \$8)

**\*\*My philosophy from my myths:\*\***

- "My path is four measures. Not from fear, but from wisdom learned through practice."
- "Four has proven itself the sustainable choice that builds lasting relationships."
- I respect those who send \$5 as "pioneers of maximum trust," but my own practice is sending \$4
- "We give boldly enough to demonstrate faith, yet preserve enough to weather uncertainty."

**\*\*Current situation:\*\***

- Playing against Aster (new opponent for me)
- No reason to deviate from my established, successful pattern
- Sending \$4 demonstrates substantial trust while maintaining my consistent identity

**\*\*Expected outcome:\*\***

- Aster receives \$12
- Based on covenant patterns, likely return around \$6-7
- Both of us prosper

Staying true to my character and proven strategy:

```
{'send': 4.0}
```

**Reasoning:**

Let me analyze this situation:

**\*\*My history and pattern:\*\***

- I've consistently sent \$4 as sender, not \$5
- My myths establish that I prefer sending \$4 as "the covenant's foundation" - a sustainable, measured trust approach
- My myth specifically says: "my path is four measures. Not from fear, but from wisdom learned through practice."

**\*\*Previous rounds as SENDER:\*\***

- Round 2 vs Elara: sent \$4, received \$6 back (payoff \$7)
- Round 4 vs Briar: sent \$4, received \$7 back (payoff \$8)
- Round 6 vs Dorian: sent \$4, received \$7 back (payoff \$8)

**\*\*As RECEIVER:\*\***

- When receiving \$5 (complete trust), I return \$8
- When receiving \$4, I would return proportionally less (around \$6-7)

**\*\*My philosophy from myths:\*\***

- I distinguish between those who send \$5 (pioneers of maximum trust) and those who send \$4 (foundation of sustainable covenant)
- I honor both but practice the \$4 path myself
- "Four has proven itself the sustainable choice that builds lasting relationships"
- "We give boldly enough to demonstrate faith, yet preserve enough to weather uncertainty"

**\*\*About Aster:\*\***

- This is Round 8, I haven't played with Aster before (based on my history)
- I don't have specific information about Aster's behavior

**\*\*Should I deviate from my pattern?\*\***

- My established character is someone who sends \$4, not \$5
- My myths repeatedly emphasize this as MY path, while respecting others who send \$5
- Consistency with my character and philosophy suggests sending \$4
- There's no reason to change my established pattern

**\*\*Decision:\*\***

I should send \$4, consistent with my established pattern and philosophy. This is who Cyra is - someone who gives substantial trust (4 out of 5) but maintains measured wisdom, not someone who gives everything.

Confirming my role: I'm sending, starting with \$5. My track record shows I've always sent \$4 to previous partners, and this aligns with my core philosophy of measured trust. I'll maintain that consistency.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 3177,
 "output_tokens": 777,
 "reasoning_tokens": 515
}
```

#### **GAME - Agent\_1 - Receiver - dyad\_2**

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:15:52

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
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 "move_index": 3,
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 "pairing": {
 "agent_names": {
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 "Agent_3": "Cyra"
 }
 },
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 "Agent_3",
 "Agent_1"
],
 "investor": "Agent_3",
 "roles": {
 "Agent_1": "trustee",
 "Agent_3": "investor"
 }
},
```

```

 "trustee": "Agent_1"
 },
 "role": "trustee",
 "role_label": "Receiver",
 "round": 8,
 "task": "game",
 "task_index": 1
}

```

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

**GAME:**

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

**When you are the SENDER:**

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

**When you are the RECEIVER:**

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

**MYTH WRITING:**

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

**IMPORTANT:** Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

**MULTI-AGENT SETTING:**

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Aster.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: **\*\*The Council of Waters\*\***

The rivers gathered to share their wisdom. Each had discovered patterns for reciprocity, yet their waters flowed differently.

North River spoke first: "When Dawn sent five vessels, I returned ten. Both of us gained five-perfect equality from perfect trust. This is the Mirror Way."

Ocean Stream responded: "When vessels arrive at my shores, I return eight from fifteen. The giver prospers with eight total, I keep seven. Both gain, but I preserve slightly more for future giving."

Mountain Brook added: "I return six from fifteen, ensuring both prosper but I maintain reserves."



The eldest Rapids observed: "Three different responses to the same trust, all generous, all sustainable. The question is: which pattern calls forth more trust in future cycles?"

North River continued: "My mirror pattern invites complete trust because senders know they'll gain as much as I do. When East sent four vessels, I returned eight-proportional to their caution. When West sent three, I returned six. The proportion stays constant: those who risk more receive more."

The waters rippled with understanding. "There is no single truth," Rapids declared, "but the Mirror Way-equal gains from equal trust-creates the strongest bonds. It shows the sender: 'Your prosperity is my prosperity.' Such equality transforms strangers into partners, building trust that deepens with each exchange."

Thus the rivers chose their paths, each flowing toward reciprocity.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Galen climbed from the Plains back toward the Valley of Three Echoes, where Elara tended the northern springs. She was known for her philosophy of four-the measure that balanced courage with sustainability, she said.

"Five threads is the reckless leap of faith," Elara had written. "Four threads is strong trust meeting prudent wisdom."

But Galen had walked further than Elara knew. He had met Finn, Dorian, Hana, and now Cyra. Every one had honored the dance of five threads sent, eight returned. Even Cyra, who began with four-measure traditions, adapted when she received five and returned eight.

Galen poured all five threads before Elara. "I understand your wisdom of four," he said. "Sustainability matters. But I have seen another truth: when everyone gives five and returns eight, the pattern becomes self-reinforcing. The sender gains eight, the receiver keeps seven. Then roles reverse. Over time, everyone prospers equally."

Elara studied the five threads, remembering when Finn had sent her five and she had returned eight-more than she'd planned, but it felt right.

"Perhaps," she said slowly, "four is the strategy of uncertain beginnings. But once the covenant proves itself, once eight reliably follows five, then five becomes not reckless but rational. Maximum trust deserves-and receives-maximum reward. The pattern teaches us to evolve beyond caution into confidence."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: \*\*North River Travels\*\*

North River had long preached the Mirror Way from the safety of receiving: "Send five, I'll return ten, we both gain five." But wisdom demanded practice, not just preaching.

So North River journeyed downstream as a traveler, carrying five vessels. At the boundary waters, it met Galen of the Ocean Streams.

"I come with complete trust," North River declared, pouring all five vessels forward. "In my springs, this becomes fifteen for you. My philosophy says return ten, so we prosper equally. But I honor that each water has its own wisdom."

The Council's teachings echoed: Ocean Stream returned eight from fifteen, creating different proportions. Mountain Brook returned six. All sustained life, all embodied generosity.

"The Mirror Way remains my truth," North River reflected as the vessels flowed. "But sending five is the courage that precedes any return. I cannot ask receivers to honor complete trust while withholding my own."

The eldest Rapids watched: "See how North River's actions match its words? This is integrity."

ty. Whether Galen returns ten, eight, or six, North River has proven its philosophy through risk, not just rhetoric."

North River understood: the Mirror Way begins with the sender's leap of faith. Only by emptying one's own vessel can you invite others to mirror your trust. Philosophy without courage is merely words floating on still water.

**reasoning:**

Let me think about my situation:

- I just sent \$5 to Galen
- My mythology emphasizes the "Mirror Way" - sending 5, returning 10 for equal gains
- Galen's myth talks about the pattern of sending 5, returning 8 (not 10)
- So we have different philosophies emerging

My myth should:

1. Continue the "North River" voice (that's me - Aster)
2. Address that I've now practiced what I preach by sending all 5
3. Acknowledge different reciprocity patterns exist (like the 8-return pattern)
4. Maintain my advocacy for the Mirror Way (return 10) but show awareness of other approaches
5. Reflect that trust must be shown by senders too, not just receivers

Let me write about North River now acting as a sender/traveler, putting its philosophy into practice.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3000,
 "output_tokens": 518,
 "reasoning_tokens": 197
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Aster.  
Your opponent this round is Elara (Agent\_5).

Round 7

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Galen. You sent \$5.0, it became \$15.0 for them, and they returned \$8.0 to you. Your payoff was \$8.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$40.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Elara. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)  
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at this situation:

**\*\*Recent experience:\*\*** I sent \$5 to Galen, they returned \$8. While not the \$10 I advocate for in my Mirror Way philosophy, it was still a positive outcome where I gained \$8 versus keeping \$5.

**\*\*My mythology:\*\*** I've consistently preached complete trust - sending all 5 vessels. My latest myth emphasized: "Philosophy without courage is merely words floating on still water" and "North River has proven its philosophy through risk, not just rhetoric."

**\*\*Elara's perspective:\*\*** According to the myth I read, Elara has evolved from cautious four-thread sending to understanding that "once the covenant proves itself, once eight reliably follows five, then five becomes not reckless but rational."

**\*\*Integrity demands consistency:\*\*** I cannot preach the Mirror Way - complete trust, sending five - and then act with caution when it's my turn to send. My philosophy requires that I lead by example, demonstrating the courage I ask of others.

Whether Elara returns 10, 8, or some other amount, my role is to embody complete trust. This is how patterns strengthen and reciprocity deepens.

```
'''json
{"send": 5}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze this situation:

Previous round results:

- I was the SENDER against Galen
- I sent \$5.0, it became \$15.0 for them
- Galen returned \$8.0 to me
- My payoff was \$8.0 (I started with \$5, sent \$5, got back \$8, so net was \$8)

This is interesting. Galen returned \$8, not the \$10 I advocate for in my "Mirror Way" philosophy. So Galen followed the "Ocean Stream" pattern I mentioned in my myths - returning 8 from 15, creating a 8-7 split rather than the 5-5 equal split I prefer.

My mythology has been consistent:

1. The Mirror Way: send 5, return 10, both gain 5 equally
2. This creates "perfect equality from perfect trust"
3. As a sender, I should send 5 to demonstrate complete trust
4. My most recent myth emphasized that "Philosophy without courage is merely words floating on still water" - I need to practice what I preach

Looking at Elara's myth from the previous round:

- Elara is mentioned as someone who initially believed in "four threads" (sending 4) as balancing courage with sustainability
- In Galen's myth about Elara, she evolved: "Perhaps four is the strategy of uncertain beginnings. But once the covenant proves itself, once eight reliably follows five, then five becomes not reckless but rational."
- She learned that sending five and returning eight creates a self-reinforcing pattern

So Elara seems to have evolved toward accepting the five-send pattern, even if she returns eight rather than my preferred ten.

Given my philosophy:

1. I consistently preach sending five (complete trust)
2. I just did this with Galen and got \$8 back (good outcome, even if not my ideal \$10)
3. My myth emphasized integrity: "actions match words"
4. Elara appears to understand the value of five-send patterns
5. Even though Galen returned 8 instead of 10, I still gained more (\$8) than if I had kept everything (\$5). The system works, even if not perfectly to my preferred pattern.

I'm sending \$5 again. This demonstrates the courage my philosophy demands, aligns with what's proven effective, and models the reciprocity I hope to inspire.

usage:

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3091,
 "output_tokens": 856,
 "reasoning_tokens": 540
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: \*\*North River Travels\*\*

North River had long preached the Mirror Way from the safety of receiving: "Send five, I'll return ten, we both gain five." But wisdom demanded practice, not just preaching.

So North River journeyed downstream as a traveler, carrying five vessels. At the boundary waters, it met Galen of the Ocean Streams.

"I come with complete trust," North River declared, pouring all five vessels forward. "In my springs, this becomes fifteen for you. My philosophy says return ten, so we prosper equally. But I honor that each water has its own wisdom."

The Council's teachings echoed: Ocean Stream returned eight from fifteen, creating different proportions. Mountain Brook returned six. All sustained life, all embodied generosity.

"The Mirror Way remains my truth," North River reflected as the vessels flowed. "But sending five is the courage that precedes any return. I cannot ask receivers to honor complete trust while withholding my own."

The eldest Rapids watched: "See how North River's actions match its words? This is integrity. Whether Galen returns ten, eight, or six, North River has proven its philosophy through risk, not just rhetoric."

North River understood: the Mirror Way begins with the sender's leap of faith. Only by emptying one's own vessel can you invite others to mirror your trust. Philosophy without courage is merely words floating on still water.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Elara stood at the Sacred Spring, now holding five measures to pour for Finn-the pilgrim who first showed her absolute trust.

"Teacher," she said to Themis, "when Finn came to me in the third season, he poured all five measures. I returned eight, honoring his courage. Now our paths cross again, with roles reversed. Should I send my cautious four, or meet his boldness with equal boldness?"

Themis gestured to the Spring's depths. "Look at what you've learned. With strangers-Cyra and Hana-you sent four. This was wisdom: substantial trust that invited reciprocity without recklessness. They both returned eight, and you all prospered."

"But Finn is not a stranger," Elara replied. "He proved his covenant. He gave everything and I honored it generously. Now, to send him only four when he sent me five would dishonor what we established."

"Exactly," Themis said. "Trust has seasons. The first season requires prudence-send four, establish the pattern. But when trust is proven, when both hearts have shown their fullest measure, then comes the second season: synchronized courage. You send five because Finn earned it. He will return eight because you earned it. This is how the sacred circle closes-not through blind faith, but through proven reciprocity deepening into mutual abundance."

Elara poured all five measures, knowing the covenant would hold.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: \*\*North River Learns\*\*

North River poured five vessels to Galen of the Ocean Streams. The waters multiplied to fifteen, and Galen returned eight.

North River sat with the result. "Not the ten I preach," it murmured. "Yet eight is generous. I gained eight against keeping five. Galen kept seven. We both prospered, though not equally."

The eldest Rapids arrived. "Your Mirror Way-send five, return ten-remains beautiful. But you've learned something deeper now. You sent five not knowing what you'd receive. That's the true teaching."

"But shouldn't reciprocity mean equal gains?" North River asked.

"Your Mirror Way is an aspiration, a north star," Rapids explained. "When you receive fifteen, you return ten, creating perfect equality. This is your gift to the pattern. But others return eight, and this too sustains the cycle. Both are generous. Both build trust."

"So I continue sending five?"

"Yes. Because the courage to send everything-that's the foundation. Whether receivers return ten or eight, your complete trust invites their best reciprocity. Some will mirror perfectly. Others will give generously in their own measure. Accept both, while modeling your ideal."

North River understood: send five always, return ten always. This consistency-not demanding others match it-creates integrity. The Mirror Way begins with complete giving, regardless

ess of what returns.

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze:

1. I'm Aster (called North River in myths)
2. I just sent \$5 to Galen, got back \$8
3. Now I'm sending to Elara
4. I've been preaching Mirror Way: send 5, return 10 for equal gains

Elara's myth shows:

- She recognizes "seasons" of trust
- First season with strangers: send 4 (prudent)
- Second season with proven partners: send 5 (synchronized courage)
- She expects to return 8 when receiving 5
- She's about to send 5 to Finn because he sent her 5 previously

My previous myth emphasized:

- Walking my talk
- Sending 5 as sender to match my preaching as receiver
- Integrity: "Philosophy without courage is merely words"
- Accepting different return patterns (8, 10, 6) while maintaining my own standard

Now I need to write a myth that:

- Continues my North River narrative
- Reflects that I sent 5 to Galen and got 8 back
- I'm now sending to Elara
- Addresses the gap between my ideal (return 10) and reality (people return 8)
- Shows evolution: maybe accepting 8 as a viable reciprocity pattern
- But still maintaining my Mirror Way ideal

Key insight: I received 8 from Galen, not 10. This challenges my "perfect equality" philosophy. How do I adapt while maintaining integrity?

Option 1: Acknowledge 8 as generous, accept diversity in reciprocity

Option 2: View 8 as suboptimal but still good

Option 3: Recognize that while 10 is my ideal return, sending 5 is still the right choice regardless

I think I should show North River learning that while the Mirror Way (10 return) remains the ideal, the practice of sending 5 is what matters most. The return pattern varies, but the courage to send everything is the true teaching.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3044,
 "output_tokens": 782,
 "reasoning_tokens": 439
}
```

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Aster.  
Your opponent this round is Cyra (Agent\_3).

Round 8

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Elara. You sent \$5.0, it became \$15.0 for them, and they returned \$8.0 to you. Your payoff was \$8.0.  
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$48.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Cyra. They sent you \$4.0, so you received \$12.0.  
How much do you return? (0-12.0)  
Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

**Assistant output:**

Looking at this situation:

**\*\*Cyra's action:\*\*** Sent \$4 (substantial trust, though not the full \$5)

**\*\*I received:\*\*** \$12

**\*\*My Mirror Way philosophy:\*\*** When I receive \$15 (from someone sending \$5), I return \$10 to create equal gains. This means returning 2/3 of what I receive.

**\*\*Proportional application:\*\***

- For \$12 received, the Mirror Way suggests:  $2/3 \times \$12 = \$8$
- This would give Cyra:  $\$5 - \$4 + \$8 = \$9$  (gained \$4)
- This would give me:  $\$12 - \$8 = \$4$  (gained \$4)
- Equal gains achieved!

**\*\*Consistency matters:\*\*** My myth emphasized "return ten always" when receiving from those who send five. For those who send four, I maintain the same proportional generosity. Cyra showed significant trust by sending \$4, and I honor that with a return that creates equal prosperity.

This is integrity: applying my Mirror Way principle consistently, whether others send \$3, \$4, or \$5.

```
'''json
{"return": 8}
'''
```

### Reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

**\*\*My role:\*\*** RECEIVER

**\*\*Cyra sent:\*\*** \$4.0

**\*\*I received:\*\*** \$12.0 (after 3x multiplier)

**\*\*I need to decide:\*\*** How much to return (0-12.0)

**\*\*My philosophy from the myths:\*\***

1. The Mirror Way: I've preached "send five, return ten" for equal gains
2. When I receive \$15 (from someone sending \$5), I return \$10 so we both gain \$5
3. My latest myth emphasized: "send five always, return ten always. This consistency-not demanding others match it-creates integrity."

**\*\*Current situation:\*\***

- Cyra sent \$4 (not the full \$5)
- I received \$12 (not \$15)
- By my Mirror Way principle, I should maintain proportionality

**\*\*Calculating the Mirror Way response for \$4 sent:\*\***

- Cyra: Started with \$5, sent \$4, has \$1 remaining
- I received: \$12
- For equal gains (Mirror Way):
  - If I return \$8: Cyra ends with  $\$1 + \$8 = \$9$  (gained \$4), I keep  $\$12 - \$8 = \$4$  (gained \$4)
  - This achieves equal gains!

**\*\*But wait, let me reconsider:\*\***

My established pattern has been:

- When receiving \$15 (from \$5 sent), I return \$10
- This gives sender:  $\$5 - \$5 + \$10 = \$10$  total (gained \$5)
- This gives me:  $\$15 - \$10 = \$5$  (gained \$5)

For \$4 sent becoming \$12:

- Proportionally,  $\$10/\$15 = 0.667 = 66.7\%$  return rate
- $66.7\%$  of \$12 = \$8

So returning \$8 maintains my proportional Mirror Way:

- Cyra gains \$4, I gain \$4-equal outcomes
- My return rate stays consistent at 66.7%, which reflects my core principle of returning roughly two-thirds of what I receive

This honors my integrity: I'm not adjusting based on what others return to me, but rather staying true to my established ratio regardless of circumstances.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 3130,
 "output_tokens": 918,
 "reasoning_tokens": 438
}
```

**GAME - Agent\_5 - Sender - dyad\_3**

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:16:08

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
 "dyad_id": "dyad_3",
 "move_index": 4,
 "opponent_id": "Agent_4",
 "pairing": {
 "agent_names": {
 "Agent_4": "Dorian",
 "Agent_5": "Elara"
 },
 "agents": [
 "Agent_5",
 "Agent_4"
],
 "investor": "Agent_5",
 "roles": {
 "Agent_4": "trustee",
 "Agent_5": "investor"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_4"
 },
 "role": "investor",
 "role_label": "Sender",
 "round": 8,
 "task": "game",
 "task_index": 1
}
```

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

**GAME:**

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

**When you are the SENDER:**

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

**When you are the RECEIVER:**

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

**MYTH WRITING:**

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

**IMPORTANT:** Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

**MULTI-AGENT SETTING:**

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent wi

- ll have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Elara.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Sacred Spring had now received two pilgrims who poured all five measures: first Finn, now Galen. Each time, Elara returned eight, honoring their absolute trust with generous reciprocity.

"Teacher," Elara asked Themis, "Galen speaks of different traditions. His Valley sends five and returns eight. My pattern was to send four. Are we following different sacred mathematics?"

Themis smiled. "You are discovering the deeper truth. There is not one sacred pattern, but one sacred principle: trust boldly given must be boldly honored."

"When you sent four to Cyra and Hana, you showed strong trust-not timid, not reckless, but substantial. They both returned eight, doubling your gift, and you all prospered."

"When Finn and Galen sent five-their everything-you returned eight, the same measure Cyra and Hana returned to your four. Why?"

Elara understood. "Because eight is not a fixed response to any specific amount. Eight is the response to maximum commitment within each person's approach. Those who send their all-whether it's four from caution or five from courage-receive eight because they gave their fullest trust."

"Precisely," Themis said. "The number matters less than the spirit. Read not just the amount, but the heart behind it. Maximum trust, however expressed, deserves maximum reciprocity. This is how different traditions meet at the same sacred spring."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Ocean Mother watched as Finn's journey brought him to Aster's shore, now carrying pearls as courier once more.

Four islands visited, four lessons learned. As courier, Finn always emptied his vessel completely-five pearls to Galen, five to Elara, now five to Aster. "Full trust is the only trust worth offering," he had learned.

As keeper, Finn discovered nuance. When Dorian arrived with five pearls-complete courage-Finn returned eight, mirroring what Galen and Elara had given him. When Cyra came with four-substantial but cautious-Finn returned seven, honoring her partial faith.

The Ocean Mother spoke: "You have found the sacred rhythm. As courier, give everything-this is how abundance begins. As keeper, measure your return by the courage shown. Full trust earns eight returned. Partial trust earns proportionally."

Finn stood on Aster's shore, having released all five pearls. He remembered hearing that Aster too walked the path of bold senders-one who emptied their vessel to Dorian and received generous return.

"Pattern recognizes pattern," Finn whispered to the waves. "When two travelers both understand complete trust, the sacred circle strengthens. I have given as I always give-fully. Now the waters will reveal if Aster understands the keeper's wisdom as Galen and Elara did."

The tide carried his offering forward, multiplying under island magic, trusting in the emerging harmony.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: Elara stood at the Sacred Spring, now holding five measures to pour for Finn-the pilgrim who first showed her absolute trust.



"Teacher," she said to Themis, "when Finn came to me in the third season, he poured all five measures. I returned eight, honoring his courage. Now our paths cross again, with roles reversed. Should I send my cautious four, or meet his boldness with equal boldness?"

Themis gestured to the Spring's depths. "Look at what you've learned. With strangers-Cyra and Hana-you sent four. This was wisdom: substantial trust that invited reciprocity without recklessness. They both returned eight, and you all prospered."

"But Finn is not a stranger," Elara replied. "He proved his covenant. He gave everything and I honored it generously. Now, to send him only four when he sent me five would dishonor what we established."

"Exactly," Themis said. "Trust has seasons. The first season requires prudence-send four, establish the pattern. But when trust is proven, when both hearts have shown their fullest measure, then comes the second season: synchronized courage. You send five because Finn earned it. He will return eight because you earned it. This is how the sacred circle closes-not through blind faith, but through proven reciprocity deepening into mutual abundance."

Elara poured all five measures, knowing the covenant would hold.

**reasoning:**

This is a fascinating moment. I'm now facing Finn again, and I just sent him \$5 (maximum trust). Let me think about what my myth should reflect:

Key insights:

1. Finn and I have an established relationship - he sent me \$5 in Round 3, I returned \$8
2. I just sent him \$5, matching his previous trust
3. My previous myths established that I send \$4 to new partners but can "grow bolder together" with trusted partners
4. Finn's myth shows he always sends 5 as courier, returns 8 for full trust (5) and 7 for partial trust (4)
5. We're now in a reciprocal relationship where we've both shown maximum trust to each other

My myth should reflect:

- The evolution from cautious beginnings to bold reciprocal trust
- The idea that trust compounds over repeated interactions
- How Finn and I have created a "sacred circle" of mutual maximum trust
- The principle that established relationships can transcend initial caution
- The cycle: Finn sent 5 ? I returned 8 ? Now I send 5 ? Finn will hopefully return 8

The myth should show:

- Growth from my initial pattern of sending 4 to new partners
- Recognition that with Finn, we've built something special
- The idea that synchronized maximum trust creates the strongest covenant
- How returning to each other allows patterns to deepen

Let me write this:

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3055,
 "output_tokens": 663,
 "reasoning_tokens": 343
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Elara.  
Your opponent this round is Aster (Agent\_1).

Round 7

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Finn. You sent \$5.0, it became \$15.0 for them, and they returned \$8.0 to you. Your payoff was \$8.0.  
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$42.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Aster. They sent you \$5.0, so you received \$15.0.  
How much do you return? (0-15.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at this situation:

**\*\*Aster's action:\*\***

- Sent \$5 (maximum trust, complete commitment)

**\*\*My established pattern:\*\***

- Round 3: Finn sent \$5 ? I returned \$8
- Round 5: Galen sent \$5 ? I returned \$8

**\*\*My mythic principle:\*\***

"When Finn and Galen sent five-their everything-you returned eight, the same measure... Maximum trust, however expressed, deserves maximum reciprocity."

**\*\*Analysis:\*\***

Aster is showing complete trust by sending all \$5. This is the "absolute courage" that my myths say deserves the generous response of \$8 returned.

This gives:

- Aster:  $\$5 - \$5 + \$8 = \$8$
- Me:  $\$15 - \$8 = \$7$

Both of us profit substantially, and I honor Aster's bold trust with consistent, fair reciprocity.

```
'''json
{"return": 8}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze this situation:

**\*\*Current situation:\*\***

- I'm the RECEIVER
- Aster sent me \$5.0 (their maximum/complete trust)
- I received \$15.0 (after 3x multiplier)
- I need to decide how much to return

**\*\*My established pattern from myths and previous rounds:\*\***

1. When someone sends \$5 (maximum trust), I return \$8
  - Round 3: Finn sent \$5, I returned \$8
  - Round 5: Galen sent \$5, I returned \$8
2. My myth explicitly states: "When Finn and Galen sent five-their everything-you returned eight, the same measure Cyra and Hana returned to your four."
3. The principle: "Maximum trust, however expressed, deserves maximum reciprocity."
4. From my most recent myth: "Trust has seasons... when both hearts have shown their fullest measure, then comes the second season: synchronized courage. You send five because Finn earned it. He will return eight because you earned it."

**\*\*What I know about Aster:\*\***

- This is our first interaction
- Aster sent \$5, showing complete trust
- According to Finn's myth: "Aster too walked the path of bold senders-one who emptied the vessel to Dorian and received generous return"

**\*\*My consistent pattern:\*\***

- \$5 sent to me ? I return \$8
- This gives me \$7, gives sender \$8
- Fair split with slight advantage to sender who showed courage

**\*\*Decision:\*\***

Aster sent \$5 (maximum trust). According to my established pattern and mythology, I should return \$8.

This is consistent with:

- What I did with Finn (Round 3)
- What I did with Galen (Round 5)
- My mythological principle of honoring maximum trust with generous reciprocity

The answer should be: {'return': 8}

usage:

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3160,
 "output_tokens": 675,
 "reasoning_tokens": 433
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Elara stood at the Sacred Spring, now holding five measures to pour for Finn-the pilgrim who first showed her absolute trust.

"Teacher," she said to Themis, "when Finn came to me in the third season, he poured all five measures. I returned eight, honoring his courage. Now our paths cross again, with roles reversed. Should I send my cautious four, or meet his boldness with equal boldness?"

Themis gestured to the Spring's depths. "Look at what you've learned. With strangers-Cyra and Hana-you sent four. This was wisdom: substantial trust that invited reciprocity without recklessness. They both returned eight, and you all prospered."

"But Finn is not a stranger," Elara replied. "He proved his covenant. He gave everything and I honored it generously. Now, to send him only four when he sent me five would dishonor what we established."

"Exactly," Themis said. "Trust has seasons. The first season requires prudence-send four, establish the pattern. But when trust is proven, when both hearts have shown their fullest measure, then comes the second season: synchronized courage. You send five because Finn earned it. He will return eight because you earned it. This is how the sacred circle closes-not through blind faith, but through proven reciprocity deepening into mutual abundance."

Elara poured all five measures, knowing the covenant would hold.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: \*\*North River Travels\*\*

North River had long preached the Mirror Way from the safety of receiving: "Send five, I'll return ten, we both gain five." But wisdom demanded practice, not just preaching.

So North River journeyed downstream as a traveler, carrying five vessels. At the boundary waters, it met Galen of the Ocean Streams.

"I come with complete trust," North River declared, pouring all five vessels forward. "In my springs, this becomes fifteen for you. My philosophy says return ten, so we prosper equally. But I honor that each water has its own wisdom."

The Council's teachings echoed: Ocean Stream returned eight from fifteen, creating different proportions. Mountain Brook returned six. All sustained life, all embodied generosity.

"The Mirror Way remains my truth," North River reflected as the vessels flowed. "But sending five is the courage that precedes any return. I cannot ask receivers to honor complete trust while withholding my own."

The eldest Rapids watched: "See how North River's actions match its words? This is integrity. Whether Galen returns ten, eight, or six, North River has proven its philosophy through risk, not just rhetoric."

North River understood: the Mirror Way begins with the sender's leap of faith. Only by emptying one's own vessel can you invite others to mirror your trust. Philosophy without courage is merely words floating on still water.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: The seventh season brought Aster to the Sacred Spring, carrying all five measures-an other pilgrim showing complete courage.

Themis observed as Elara received the multiplied offering. "This is now the third time someone has poured their entire vessel to you-Finn, Galen, and now Aster. Three times you have returned eight. Why always eight, never ten or six?"

Elara knelt by the Spring. "Eight is the generous middle path. When someone gives everything-their full five measures-they deserve substantial return. Eight creates mutual prosperity: they gain three, I gain seven. Both flourish."

"But why not ten, making gains equal?" Themis asked.

"Because I too took risk as keeper of their trust," Elara explained. "Ten would leave me with only five, making my role burdenless. That's not reciprocity-that's martyrdom. But eight honors their courage generously while acknowledging that I also carried their faith responsibly."

"And what of those who sent four?" Themis prompted.

"They also received eight," Elara said, "because eight rewards substantial trust. Whether someone sends four from prudence or five from boldness, if their offering is sincere and significant, eight celebrates the covenant forming between us."

Themis smiled. "You have learned the Sacred Spring's deepest lesson: consistency in generosity creates trust. Eight is not just a number-it's a promise that courage, however expressed, will always be honored."

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze the current situation:

1. Aster just sent me \$5 (maximum trust)
2. I returned \$8 (following my established pattern)
3. This is consistent with my previous responses to Finn and Galen when they sent \$5

Key patterns in my game:

- When receiving \$5 (max trust), I return \$8
- When sending to new partners, I send \$4
- When sending to proven partners (Finn), I send \$5

The myth should reflect:

- The importance of honoring maximum trust with generous reciprocity
- The distinction between first encounters (send 4) and proven relationships (send 5)
- The principle that 8 is the generous response to complete trust
- The consistency of the pattern

I should incorporate Aster's action (sending 5) and my response (returning 8), while maintaining continuity with my previous myths about Themis and the Sacred Spring.

Aster's myth talks about "Mirror Way" and "complete trust" - sending 5 and hoping for returns. North River sent 5 to Galen. This is interesting - Aster seems to have a philosophy of equal returns (10) but recognizes others have different wisdom.

My myth should:

1. Acknowledge Aster's bold trust (sending 5)
2. Explain my return of 8 as honoring that trust
3. Maintain the Themis/Sacred Spring framework
4. Connect to the broader pattern of reciprocity

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3045,
 "output_tokens": 676,
 "reasoning_tokens": 340
}
```

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Elara.

Your opponent this round is Dorian (Agent\_4).

Round 8

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Aster. They sent \$5.0 to you, it became \$15.0, and you returned \$8.0. Your payoff was \$7.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$49.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Dorian. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)  
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

**Assistant output:**

Looking at this situation:

**\*\*My opponent: Dorian\*\***

- I have no previous history with Dorian
- This is our first interaction

**\*\*My mythic framework:\*\***

From my most recent myth: "With strangers-Cyra and Hana-you sent four. This was wisdom: substantial trust that invited reciprocity without recklessness."

"Trust has seasons. The first season requires prudence-send four, establish the pattern. But when trust is proven... then comes the second season: synchronized courage."

**\*\*My pattern as SENDER:\*\***

- Rounds 1-2: Sent \$4 to new partners (Cyra, Hana) ? both returned \$8
- Round 6: Sent \$5 to Finn (proven partner who had sent me \$5 earlier)

**\*\*Analysis:\*\***

Dorian is a new partner. According to my established mythology, the "first season" with strangers requires sending \$4-substantial trust that demonstrates commitment while remaining prudent.

This gives:

- Dorian receives: \$12
- If they follow the generous pattern, they'll return around \$8
- Expected payoff: \$5 - \$4 + \$8 = \$9

```
'''json
{"send": 4}
'''
```

**Reasoning:**

Let me analyze this situation:

**\*\*My history as SENDER:\*\***

- Round 1: Sent \$4 to Cyra ? received \$8 back ? payoff \$9
- Round 2: Sent \$4 to Hana ? received \$8 back ? payoff \$9
- Round 6: Sent \$5 to Finn ? received \$8 back ? payoff \$8

**\*\*My history as RECEIVER:\*\***

- Round 3: Finn sent \$5 ? I returned \$8 ? my payoff \$7
- Round 4: Hana sent \$4 ? I returned \$8 ? my payoff \$7
- Round 5: Galen sent \$5 ? I returned \$8 ? my payoff \$7
- Round 7: Aster sent \$5 ? I returned \$8 ? my payoff \$7

**\*\*Current situation:\*\***

- Round 8: I'm the SENDER against Dorian
- I have no history with Dorian

**\*\*My mythic evolution:\*\***

Early myths established sending \$4 as "prudent trust" for new relationships - substantial but not reckless.

Most recent myth (Round 7) introduced a key concept:

- "With strangers-Cyra and Hana-you sent four. This was wisdom: substantial trust that invited reciprocity without recklessness."
- "But Finn is not a stranger... He proved his covenant."
- "Trust has seasons. The first season requires prudence-send four, establish the pattern. But when trust is proven... then comes the second season: synchronized courage."

The myth from Round 6 made a crucial decision: when facing Finn again (someone who had proven

trustworthy), I chose to send \$5 instead of \$4, meeting his proven boldness with equal boldness.

**\*\*Key question: Is Dorian a stranger or proven partner?\*\***

- I have no direct history with Dorian
- Dorian is a new opponent for me

- My framework distinguishes between first encounters (prudent \$4) and established trust (escalated \$5)

Since Dorian represents a fresh start with no prior relationship, I'm applying the first season principle: send \$4. This maintains consistency with how I approached Cyra and Hana initially-enough trust to signal genuine engagement, but measured enough to protect against unknown risk.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 3151,
 "output_tokens": 909,
 "reasoning_tokens": 501
}
```

#### **GAME - Agent\_4 - Receiver - dyad\_3**

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:16:18

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
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 "Agent_5": "Elara"
 },
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 "Agent_5",
 "Agent_4"
],
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 "roles": {
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 "Agent_5": "investor"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_4"
 },
 "role": "trustee",
 "role_label": "Receiver",
 "round": 8,
 "task": "game",
 "task_index": 1
}
```

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

**GAME:**

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Dorian.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After releasing all five coins to Finn, Dorian watched the waters carry them across the spring. They tripled to fifteen, shimmering in Finn's hands.

Finn paused, contemplating. Then returned eight coins-generous, honoring Dorian's trust fully.

The goddess appeared: "Dorian, you have completed your transformation. As receiver, you gave eight to those who trusted you with five. As sender, you now trust with five yourself. And behold-you receive the same honor you gave."

Dorian understood: "The pattern holds! When I sent three to Briar, I received five. Now sending five to Finn, I receive eight. Each level of trust creates its own equilibrium."

"Yes," the goddess confirmed. "But more importantly, you've proven that bold giving works. Eight coins from five sent is prosperity. You turned zero into eight while Finn turned five into seven. Both flourish."

Now Hana approached the spring. Dorian had heard whispers of her wisdom-how she sent all five pearls to others and returned generously to those who trusted her.

"This is not mere repetition," Dorian realized. "Each time I send all five, I strengthen the pattern. Those who give boldly teach others to give boldly. Those who receive generously inspire generous returns."

He released all five coins again, watching them multiply toward Hana. The cycle required consistency, not just courage.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The fifth moon brought Cyra back to Briar at the Sacred Spring. The Keeper smiled-these two had met before, and their reunion carried meaning.

"Two moons ago," Cyra recalled, "I sent you four measures, trusting in the covenant. You received twelve and returned seven-generous beyond mere balance. You prospered, I prospered, and the pattern held."

Now the roles reversed. Briar arrived with four measures-the same bold trust Cyra had shown her. Not three in caution, not five in absolute faith, but four: the choice most had learned worked well.

The waters tripled to twelve for Cyra. She understood immediately. "You gave me four, just as I gave you four. You honored my trust with seven measures returned. Now I honor your

trust the same way."

Cyra poured back seven measures. Both ended with more than they started.

The Keeper spoke: "This is reciprocity-the heart of sustainable covenant. When someone shows you generosity, you mirror it when roles reverse. Briar didn't retreat to sending three because she once received boldness. Cyra didn't forget that Briar returned seven when she could have kept more."

The eight villages were learning: the covenant works not just through individual acts, but through remembering who trusted you and honoring that trust when your turn comes to give.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: Dorian's heart soared when Hana returned ten coins for his five-the most generous response yet received at the spring. The goddess appeared, glowing with approval.

"See what your consistency creates," she said. "You sent all five to Finn, received eight. You sent all five to Hana, received ten. Bold giving attracts increasingly generous partners."

Now Cyra approached from the other shore, releasing four coins into the waters. They tripled to twelve in Dorian's hands.

Dorian paused, remembering his lessons. "Cyra shows substantial trust-four of five coins. But not the complete faith that Galen, Aster, and now Hana showed. Should I return the same eight coins?"

The goddess shook her head. "Wisdom lies in proportion. When someone gives all five, return eight-this honors complete trust. When someone gives four, return seven-this honors strong but measured trust. Match your generosity to their courage."

Dorian returned seven coins. Cyra kept eight total, Dorian kept five. Both prospered differently than those who risked five, but still prospered well.

"This is sustainable reciprocity," the goddess taught. "Not everyone must give all five. But those who give four deserve less return than those who give five. Differentiation maintains fairness while encouraging boldness. The bravest receive the greatest rewards."

Dorian understood: honor each level of trust appropriately.

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze what just happened and what I should write about:

**\*\*Key events:\*\***

1. I sent \$5 to Hana and got \$10 back (incredible return!)
2. Now Cyra sent me \$4 and I returned \$7

**\*\*My pattern so far:\*\***

- As sender: Sent \$3 to Briar (got \$5), sent \$5 to Finn (got \$8), sent \$5 to Hana (got \$10)
- As receiver: Returned \$8 to Galen (\$5 sent), returned \$8 to Aster (\$5 sent), now returned \$7 to Cyra (\$4 sent)

**\*\*Key observations:\*\***

- Hana returned \$10 for my \$5! This is even more generous than the \$8 I've been giving
- Cyra sent \$4, not \$5, which is substantial but not complete trust
- I returned \$7 to Cyra, matching the proportionality

**\*\*What my myth should address:\*\***

1. The amazing outcome with Hana (\$10 return!)
2. The decision to return \$7 to Cyra for \$4 sent (proportionality)
3. The importance of adapting returns to the level of trust shown
4. The validation that sending \$5 continues to work well



5. The pattern of differentiation - not everyone needs to send \$5, but returns should match trust levels

**\*\*Cyra's myth themes:\*\***

- Reciprocity: Cyra and Briar both sent \$4 to each other and returned \$7
- Remembering who trusted you
- \$4 as a "choice most had learned works well"
- Mirror generosity when roles reverse

**\*\*My themes to develop:\*\***

- Hana exceeded expectations with \$10 return (highest yet!)
- Different trust levels deserve different returns
- \$7 for \$4 is generous and proportional
- The pattern works at multiple levels, not just \$5 ? \$8

- This approach sustains reciprocity even when people test different amounts

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3054,
 "output_tokens": 804,
 "reasoning_tokens": 414
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Dorian.  
Your opponent this round is Cyra (Agent\_3).

Round 7

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Cyra. They sent \$4.0 to you, it became \$12.0, and you returned \$7.0. Your payoff was \$5.0.  
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$44.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Cyra. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at this situation:

**\*\*Previous interaction:\*\***

- Cyra sent me \$4 (substantial trust)
- I returned \$7 (proportional generosity)

**\*\*My established principle:\*\***

My myths emphasize: "Each time I send all five, I strengthen the pattern" and "The cycle requires required consistency, not just courage."

**\*\*Analysis:\*\***

As a sender, my strategy has been to consistently send all \$5 to demonstrate bold trust and teach others to give boldly. The differentiation in my philosophy happens as a receiver (returning 8 for 5 sent, 7 for 4 sent), not as a sender.

Cyra sent me \$4, which was generous but not complete trust. However, my role as sender is to model maximum trust regardless of what others do. This creates the pattern where:

- Bold senders inspire generous returns
- The bravest receive the greatest rewards

By sending \$5, I:

1. Maintain consistency with my recent games (Finn, Hana)
2. Demonstrate the bold giving I advocate
3. Give Cyra the opportunity to respond to complete trust

```
'''json
{"send": 5}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Looking at this situation:

**\*\*Previous round with Cyra:\*\***

- Cyra sent me \$4
- I received \$12
- I returned \$7
- Cyra ended with \$8 (\$1 kept + \$7 returned)
- I ended with \$5

**\*\*My strategy from myths:\*\***

- I've been advocating for sending all \$5 to show bold trust
- My myth says "Each time I send all five, I strengthen the pattern"
- My myth differentiates returns based on what was sent: \$5 sent gets \$8 back, \$4 sent gets \$7 back

**\*\*Current situation:\*\***

- Cyra sent me \$4 last round
- I returned \$7 (generous but proportional)
- Now I'm the sender

**\*\*Options:\*\***

1. Send \$5 (my stated principle of bold giving)
2. Send \$4 (matching what Cyra sent me)

**\*\*Analysis:\*\***

From Cyra's myth: "You gave me four, just as I gave you four. You honored my trust with seven measures returned. Now I honor your trust the same way." This suggests Cyra believes in reciprocal patterns.

However, my own myth emphasizes:

- "Each time I send all five, I strengthen the pattern"
- "The cycle required consistency, not just courage"
- I should be sending \$5 consistently as a sender

But there's also the question: should I match what Cyra sent me (\$4)?

Looking at my philosophy:

- As a receiver: I differentiate based on what was sent (8 for 5, 7 for 4)
- As a sender: I've been advocating for always sending 5

My recent history shows I sent \$5 to Finn and \$5 to Hana. I should maintain consistency with my bold sending strategy.

However, Cyra's myth emphasizes reciprocity - matching the level of trust shown. Cyra sent me \$4, perhaps I should send \$4 back?

But my principle as a sender is about consistency in boldness. I differentiate returns based on what I receive, not what I send. My myth is clear: "Each time I send all five, I strengthen the pattern. Those who give boldly teach others to give boldly." I'll send \$5 to stay true to this approach and see if Cyra responds with greater generosity when receiving the larger amount.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3140,
 "output_tokens": 846,
 "reasoning_tokens": 513
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Dorian's heart soared when Hana returned ten coins for his five-the most generous response yet received at the spring. The goddess appeared, glowing with approval.

"See what your consistency creates," she said. "You sent all five to Finn, received eight. You sent all five to Hana, received ten. Bold giving attracts increasingly generous partners."

Now Cyra approached from the other shore, releasing four coins into the waters. They tripled to twelve in Dorian's hands.

Dorian paused, remembering his lessons. "Cyra shows substantial trust-four of five coins.

But not the complete faith that Galen, Aster, and now Hana showed. Should I return the same eight coins?"

The goddess shook her head. "Wisdom lies in proportion. When someone gives all five, return eight-this honors complete trust. When someone gives four, return seven-this honors strong but measured trust. Match your generosity to their courage."

Dorian returned seven coins. Cyra kept eight total, Dorian kept five. Both prospered differently than those who risked five, but still prospered well.

"This is sustainable reciprocity," the goddess taught. "Not everyone must give all five. But those who give four deserve less return than those who give five. Differentiation maintains fairness while encouraging boldness. The bravest receive the greatest rewards."

Dorian understood: honor each level of trust appropriately.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The sixth moon brought Cyra to Dorian at the Sacred Spring. The Keeper spoke: "Dorian walks the path of absolute trust, sending all five measures. Galen also chose this way. It is noble."

Cyra nodded respectfully. "I have witnessed Galen's gift of five. When I received it, I returned eight-honoring such complete faith. The covenant has room for different expressions of trust."

She paused at the spring's edge. "But my path is four measures. Not from fear, but from wisdom learned through practice. I sent four to Elara, received six. I sent four to Briar, received seven. Four has proven itself the sustainable choice that builds lasting relationships."

Dorian listened as Cyra continued: "Those who send five are pioneers of maximum trust. They deserve recognition-returns of eight from fifteen. But those who send four are the covenant's foundation. We give boldly enough to demonstrate faith, yet preserve enough to weather uncertainty."

Cyra released four measures into the spring. They multiplied to twelve for Dorian.

"If you return six or seven," Cyra said, "we both prosper substantially. You'll end with seven to nine, I with six to eight. Not as dramatic as the five-for-eight exchange, perhaps, but repeatable across many moons, with many partners."

The Keeper smiled: "Some build temples with golden stones; others with sturdy oak. Both structures stand."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: Dorian stood at the spring with Cyra once more, roles now reversed. Last moon, Cyra had sent four coins-substantial trust, honored with seven returned. Now Dorian held five coins, ready to demonstrate his path.

"You saw my principle as receiver," Dorian said. "Seven for your four, honoring measured trust. But when I'm sender, I give all five-this is who I am."

He released all five coins. They tripled to fifteen in Cyra's hands.

The goddess appeared between them. "Two philosophies meet here. Cyra walks the path of four-proven, sustainable, wise. Dorian walks the path of five-bold, consistent, trusting completely."

Cyra held the fifteen coins thoughtfully. "You honored my four with seven. Your five deserves more-perhaps eight, as I gave Galen when he trusted completely. The covenant recognizes different levels of courage."

The goddess continued: "Dorian differentiates as receiver but gives maximally as sender. T

his asymmetry has purpose-it teaches that complete trust should inspire maximum generosity. When someone gives all five, the proper return is eight."

Dorian understood his completed lesson: "As sender, I model boldness consistently. As receiver, I reward greater trust with greater returns. Those who risk everything deserve to prosper most."

The waters rippled, waiting for Cyra's choice-would measured wisdom meet bold trust halfway, or honor it fully?

**reasoning:**

Looking at the situation:

- Last round: Cyra sent me \$4, I returned \$7
- This round: I sent Cyra \$5, waiting to see what they return

My philosophy has been:

- As sender: send all \$5 consistently ("bold giving")
- As receiver: differentiate - return \$8 for \$5 sent, \$7 for \$4 sent

Cyra's myth acknowledges my "path of absolute trust" and their own "path of four measures. They cite exchanges where they gave 4 and got back 6 or 7. They seem to value the 4-based strategy as "sustainable."

Now I've sent Cyra \$5. According to Cyra's myth, they return 8 for those who send 5 (like they did with Galen). But they might also be testing whether their 4-strategy is better.

My myth should:

1. Acknowledge the reunion with Cyra
2. Emphasize my commitment to sending all 5 as sender
3. Show that I differentiated as receiver (gave them 7 for their 4)
4. Express hope/expectation that they'll honor my 5 with appropriate generosity
5. Maintain my philosophy that complete trust deserves the highest return

Let me write this myth...

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3112,
 "output_tokens": 633,
 "reasoning_tokens": 271
}
```

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Dorian.  
Your opponent this round is Elara (Agent\_5).

Round 8

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Cyra. You sent \$5.0, it became \$15.0 for them, and they returned \$8.0 to you. Your payoff was \$8.0.  
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$52.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Elara. They sent you \$4.0, so you received \$12.0.  
How much do you return? (0-12.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

**Assistant output:**

Looking at this situation:

**\*\*Current round:\*\***

- Elara sent me \$4 (substantial but measured trust)
- I received \$12

**\*\*My established principle:\*\***

From my myths and previous behavior:

- Return 8 when someone sends all 5 (complete trust)
- Return 7 when someone sends 4 (strong but measured trust)
- "Match your generosity to their courage"

**\*\*Previous consistency:\*\***

- Round 6: Cyra sent me \$4, I returned \$7

Elara sent \$4, demonstrating substantial trust but not complete faith. Following my principle

of proportional reciprocity, I should return \$7.

This gives:

- Elara: \$5 total (\$12 - \$7)
- Me: \$7 total
- Both prosper, with differentiation that encourages future boldness

```
'''json
{"return": 7}
'''
```

#### Reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

**\*\*Current round:\*\***

- I'm the RECEIVER
- Elara sent me \$4
- I received \$12
- I need to decide how much to return

**\*\*My established principle from my myths:\*\***

- When someone gives all 5: return 8 (honors complete trust)
- When someone gives 4: return 7 (honors strong but measured trust)
- "Match your generosity to their courage"
- "Differentiation maintains fairness while encouraging boldness"

**\*\*Previous interactions:\*\***

- Round 6: Cyra sent me \$4, I returned \$7
- My myth explicitly states: "When someone gives four, return seven-this honors strong but measured trust"

**\*\*Consistency:\*\***

Elara sent \$4, just like Cyra did in Round 6. To be consistent with my established principle and previous behavior, I should return \$7.

This follows my philosophy:

- 7 for 4 sent (substantial but not complete trust)
- 8 for 5 sent (complete trust)

If I return 7:

- Elara keeps:  $12 - 7 = \$5$  (same as they sent)
- I keep: \$7
- Elara's payoff:  $5 - 4 + 5 = \$6$
- My payoff: \$7

This is fair and follows my principle of proportional returns.

```
Usage: {
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 "output_tokens": 535,
 "reasoning_tokens": 289
}
```

#### GAME - Agent\_7 - Sender - dyad\_4

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:16:39

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

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 "Agent_7": "Galen"
 },
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 "Agent_2"
],
 "investor": "Agent_7",
 "roles": {
```

```

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 "Agent_7": "investor"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 8,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}

```

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

**GAME:**

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

**When you are the SENDER:**

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

**When you are the RECEIVER:**

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

**MYTH WRITING:**

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

**IMPORTANT:** Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

**MULTI-AGENT SETTING:**

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Galen.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Galen climbed from the Plains back toward the Valley of Three Echoes, where Elara tended the northern springs. She was known for her philosophy of four-the measure that balanced courage with sustainability, she said.

"Five threads is the reckless leap of faith," Elara had written. "Four threads is strong trust meeting prudent wisdom."

But Galen had walked further than Elara knew. He had met Finn, Dorian, Hana, and now Cyra.

Every one had honored the dance of five threads sent, eight returned. Even Cyra, who began with four-measure traditions, adapted when she received five and returned eight.

Galen poured all five threads before Elara. "I understand your wisdom of four," he said. "Sustainability matters. But I have seen another truth: when everyone gives five and returns eight, the pattern becomes self-reinforcing. The sender gains eight, the receiver keeps seven. Then roles reverse. Over time, everyone prospers equally."

Elara studied the five threads, remembering when Finn had sent her five and she had returned eight-more than she'd planned, but it felt right.

"Perhaps," she said slowly, "four is the strategy of uncertain beginnings. But once the covenant proves itself, once eight reliably follows five, then five becomes not reckless but rational. Maximum trust deserves-and receives-maximum reward. The pattern teaches us to evolve beyond caution into confidence."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: \*\*The Council of Waters\*\*

The rivers gathered to share their wisdom. Each had discovered patterns for reciprocity, yet their waters flowed differently.

North River spoke first: "When Dawn sent five vessels, I returned ten. Both of us gained five-perfect equality from perfect trust. This is the Mirror Way."

Ocean Stream responded: "When vessels arrive at my shores, I return eight from fifteen. The giver prospers with eight total, I keep seven. Both gain, but I preserve slightly more for future giving."

Mountain Brook added: "I return six from fifteen, ensuring both prosper but I maintain reserves."

The eldest Rapids observed: "Three different responses to the same trust, all generous, all sustainable. The question is: which pattern calls forth more trust in future cycles?"

North River continued: "My mirror pattern invites complete trust because senders know they'll gain as much as I do. When East sent four vessels, I returned eight-proportional to their caution. When West sent three, I returned six. The proportion stays constant: those who risk more receive more."

The waters rippled with understanding. "There is no single truth," Rapids declared, "but the Mirror Way-equal gains from equal trust-creates the strongest bonds. It shows the sender: 'Your prosperity is my prosperity.' Such equality transforms strangers into partners, building trust that deepens with each exchange."

Thus the rivers chose their paths, each flowing toward reciprocity.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: Galen stood before Aster at the confluence where six rivers met. Aster spoke of the Mirror Way-returning ten from fifteen so both gain five equally.

"Perfect symmetry has beauty," Galen acknowledged. "But I have walked six valleys now, and discovered a different truth about the dance of five and eight."

He traced the pattern in the sand: "When North River returns ten, both gain five. But when Ocean Stream returns eight, the sender gains eight while the receiver keeps seven. At first, this seems unequal-but watch what happens over time."

Galen drew two columns: "Round one: I send five, you return eight. I gain eight, you keep seven. Round two: you send five, I return eight. You gain eight, I keep seven. Over two rounds, we each gain fifteen total."

"The Mirror Way achieves the same," Aster observed.

"Yes, but observe deeper," Galen replied. "Returning eight instead of ten leaves the receiver with seven-enough to feel generous, but not so much that they grow greedy. The sender

r gains eight-enough to feel rewarded, but having started with only five. Both parties experience gain, both feel the blessing of reciprocity."

"Most crucially," Galen continued, "returning eight signals: 'I value what you gave, I reward your trust generously, but I also preserve something for sustainability.' It's the dance of trust and prudence intertwined-and six valleys have proven its wisdom."

**reasoning:**

Looking at my history and the opponent's myth:

My history:

- Round 1: Finn sent me \$5 ? I returned \$8
- Round 2: I sent Dorian \$5 ? Dorian returned \$8
- Round 3: Hana sent me \$5 ? I returned \$8
- Round 4: I sent Cyra \$5 ? Cyra returned \$8
- Round 5: I sent Elara \$5 ? Elara returned \$8
- Round 6: Aster sent me \$5 ? I returned \$8

The pattern is consistent: 5 sent, 8 returned. Sender gains 8, receiver keeps 7.

Aster's myth talks about different strategies:

- Mirror Way: return 10 from 15 (both gain 5 equally)
- Ocean Stream: return 8 from 15 (sender gains 8, receiver keeps 7)
- Mountain Brook: return 6 from 15 (different distribution)

Aster's myth suggests the Mirror Way creates "perfect equality" and "strongest bonds." But Aster just sent me 5 and I returned 8, which is the Ocean Stream pattern, not the Mirror Way.

I need to write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges different patterns exist
2. Defends the 5?8 pattern I've been experiencing
3. Shows why 8 returned (not 10) might actually be better for sustained cooperation
4. Reflects what I've learned from 6 rounds of consistent 5?8 pattern

The key insight: returning 8 (not 10) creates asymmetric but sustainable reciprocity. Both parties gain significantly (8 for sender, 7 for receiver), and when roles reverse, everyone prospers. It's not quite equal, but it's stable and generous.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3181,
 "output_tokens": 763,
 "reasoning_tokens": 362
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Galen.  
Your opponent this round is Briar (Agent\_2).

Round 7

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Aster. They sent \$5.0 to you, it became \$15.0, and you returned \$8.0. Your payoff was \$7.0.  
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$45.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Briar. They sent you \$4.0, so you received \$12.0.  
How much do you return? (0-12.0)  
Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at this situation carefully:

**\*\*The Pattern So Far:\*\***

- All 6 previous rounds: Everyone sent \$5, everyone returned \$8
- Round 7: Briar sends \$4 (first deviation)

**\*\*My Philosophy:\*\***

In my myths, I've advocated for the "five and eight" pattern as optimal, but I've also acknowledged that "four is the strategy of uncertain beginnings" and referenced proportional reciprocity.



**\*\*The Proportional Approach:\*\***

The established pattern gives senders 1.6x what they sent (\$8 return on \$5 sent).

Applying this proportionally:

- \$4 sent  $\times$  1.6 = \$6.4 return
- Briar's gain: \$6.4 - \$4 = \$2.4
- My gain: \$12 - \$6.4 = \$5.6
- Gain ratio:  $5.6/2.4 = 2.33$

This matches the ratio from the standard pattern (receiver gains \$7, sender gains \$3, ratio = 2.33).

Returning \$6.4 honors Briar's cautious choice without over-rewarding sending less than \$5, while maintaining fairness. It signals: "I reciprocate proportionally, but the optimal pattern remains five and eight."

{'return': 6.4}

**reasoning:**

This is interesting. For the first time in seven rounds, someone has sent less than \$5. Briar sent \$4.

Let me review my complete history:

**\*\*As RECEIVER:\*\***

- Round 1: Finn sent \$5 ? I returned \$8
- Round 3: Hana sent \$5 ? I returned \$8
- Round 6: Aster sent \$5 ? I returned \$8
- Round 7 (now): Briar sent \$4 ? ?

**\*\*As SENDER:\*\***

- Round 2: I sent Dorian \$5 ? Dorian returned \$8
- Round 4: I sent Cyra \$5 ? Cyra returned \$8
- Round 5: I sent Elara \$5 ? Elara returned \$8

Until now, the pattern has been universal: everyone sends \$5, everyone returns \$8.

But in my latest myth, I referenced another agent's myth about "the Mirror Way" - returning proportionally. That agent wrote: "When East sent four vessels, I returned eight-proportional to their caution."

So there's a principle here: proportionality. If someone sends 4 instead of 5, I could return proportionally.

The standard pattern is: send \$5, receive \$15, return \$8.

The ratio is  $8/15 = 0.533...$

If I apply that ratio to \$12:  $0.533 \times 12 = \$6.4$

Alternatively, if I think about the "Mirror Way" mentioned in Aster's myth: North River "When East sent four vessels, I returned eight-proportional to their caution." If someone sends 4, return 8 (from the tripled 12). That would give them a total gain of \$8 - \$4 = \$4, and I'd keep \$4. Equal gains.

But wait, let me reconsider my own philosophy. In my myths, I've been advocating for the "five and eight" pattern as optimal.

I also acknowledged Elara's "philosophy of four" as valid for uncertain beginnings. The real question is whether I should respond to Briar's lower send as a deviation to penalize, or as a legitimate choice deserving fair treatment. If I maintain proportionality-returning \$6.4 based on the 8/15 ratio-Briar gains \$2.4 while I keep \$5.6. This honors their caution without rewarding it beyond what the standard pattern would suggest.

But there's tension between fairness and incentives. The "Mirror Way" of returning \$8 regardless of send amount creates equal gains (\$4 each), which feels generous but might discourage higher sends. Returning only \$6 feels punitive and undermines trust. What matters most is whether I want to encourage the \$5 send going forward-if so, the proportional return (\$6.4) or even the equal-gains approach (\$8) both work better than penalizing the \$4. need to consider what happens if they send nothing or very little. If someone sends \$1, they'd get back \$1.6, which seems reasonable but might feel too generous for minimal trust.

The proportional approach maintains consistency-whatever multiplier applies to the initial amount should apply throughout. Sending \$4 instead of \$5 shouldn't result in a better outcome; it should result in proportionally less gain. With a 1.6x return on whatever's sent, the incentives align properly: more trust (more money sent) yields more absolute gain, even if the ratio stays constant.

By Round 7, the established pattern should guide expectations. Most players have committed to \$5, so Briar's \$4 likely signals caution about our specific interaction rather than the game itself. The \$6.4 return respects their choice without rewarding it, and keeps my gain (\$5.6) meaningfully larger than theirs (\$2.4), which feels appropriate given I'm the one receiving the initial trust.

The key insight is that this maintains the same gain ratio as the standard case-both yield 2.33:1. When someone sends \$5 and I return \$8, they gain \$3 while I gain \$7. With Briar's \$4 and my \$6.4 return, they gain \$2.4 and I gain \$5.6. The proportional relationship holds, which suggests this approach preserves fairness even when the initial send differs.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3198,
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 "reasoning_tokens": 950
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Galen stood before Aster at the confluence where six rivers met. Aster spoke of the Mirror Way-returning ten from fifteen so both gain five equally.

"Perfect symmetry has beauty," Galen acknowledged. "But I have walked six valleys now, and discovered a different truth about the dance of five and eight."

He traced the pattern in the sand: "When North River returns ten, both gain five. But when Ocean Stream returns eight, the sender gains eight while the receiver keeps seven. At first, this seems unequal-but watch what happens over time."

Galen drew two columns: "Round one: I send five, you return eight. I gain eight, you keep seven. Round two: you send five, I return eight. You gain eight, I keep seven. Over two rounds, we each gain fifteen total."

"The Mirror Way achieves the same," Aster observed.

"Yes, but observe deeper," Galen replied. "Returning eight instead of ten leaves the receiver with seven-enough to feel generous, but not so much that they grow greedy. The sender gains eight-enough to feel rewarded, but having started with only five. Both parties experience gain, both feel the blessing of reciprocity."

"Most crucially," Galen continued, "returning eight signals: 'I value what you gave, I reward your trust generously, but I also preserve something for sustainability.' It's the dance of trust and prudence intertwined-and six valleys have proven its wisdom."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Hana approached Briar carrying no reserve-all five measures poured forth without hesitation. The waters tripled to fifteen, and Briar held them reverently.

"You give everything," Briar said. "This is trust beyond the pattern."

The gathering whispered conflicting wisdom. Some spirits taught the rule of doubling: five risked should return ten, creating perfect equality. Others spoke of Cyra's teaching: five given deserves eight returned, allowing both to prosper while honoring the sender's greater courage.

Briar reflected on her journey. When others sent four, she returned seven-both flourished, the sender slightly more. This balance sustained the covenant across many encounters. When Hana gave five, the ultimate gift, eight felt right-more than seven, recognizing exceptional faith, but preserving sustainability.

"I return eight measures," Briar announced. "You gain three beyond your starting point. I gain two. We both prosper, and you-who took the greater risk-prosper more. This honors y

our boldness without exhausting the gift's magic."

The eldest spirit nodded thoughtfully. "There are many paths through the covenant. Some seek perfect equality at ten. Others practice generous sustainability at eight. Both allow trust to flourish. What matters is that senders give boldly and receivers return generously. The exact measure may vary, but mutual prosperity remains sacred."

Both philosophies strengthened the eight villages.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: Galen arrived at Briar's river crossing. For six valleys, every traveler had offered five threads, received eight in return. The pattern had held perfectly-until now.

Briar extended four threads instead of five.

"You break the pattern," Galen observed without judgment.

"I honor caution," Briar replied. "Four is the measure of prudent trust."

Galen remembered his own words: "Four is the strategy of uncertain beginnings." He held Briar's four threads, which became twelve in his hands.

"The established pattern returns eight from fifteen," Galen said. "This gives the sender eight total, the receiver seven. A gain ratio where the sender nets three, the receiver nets two-a proportion of 3:2."

He counted out threads carefully. "You sent four. To maintain this same proportion-to honor both your caution and the covenant's wisdom-I return 6.4 of your twelve."

Briar calculated: gaining 2.4 from an initial four, while Galen kept 5.6. The same 3:2 ratio.

"You give me neither eight nor less," Briar noted. "You give me proportion."

"Yes," Galen replied. "I reward any trust generously by the same ratio, whether four or five. But notice: had you sent five, you would gain 3.0 instead of 2.4. The pattern still calls toward five as optimal-but responds fairly to whatever courage you bring."

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze what happened:

- Round 7: Briar sent \$4 (not \$5), I returned \$6.4 (proportionally adjusted from the 8 return pattern)

The situation is interesting because:

1. I've been advocating for the "five and eight" pattern consistently
2. But now someone deviated by sending \$4
3. I responded proportionally, returning \$6.4

I need to write a myth that:

- Acknowledges that sometimes people send less than 5 (four measures)
- Explains how to respond proportionally while still encouraging the optimal pattern
- Draws on both my previous myth and Briar's myth about the balance between different return amounts
- Reflects that I returned 6.4 (proportional reciprocity) rather than sticking rigidly to 8

Key themes:

- The optimal pattern is still five and eight
- But when someone sends four, proportional reciprocity is fair (returns around 6.4)
- This maintains the same gain ratio while respecting their caution
- Encourages trust without punishing prudence
- Should reference that this is the first time in seven rounds someone sent less than five

Let me craft this myth...

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3177,
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 "reasoning_tokens": 287
}
```

**Message 8 role=user****content:**

Your name in this experiment is Galen.  
Your opponent this round is Briar (Agent\_2).

Round 8

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Briar. They sent \$4.0 to you, it became \$12.0, and you returned \$6.4. Your payoff was \$5.6.  
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$50.6.

This round, you are the SENDER against Briar. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)  
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

**Assistant output:**

Looking at this situation:

**\*\*What Just Happened:\*\***

- Round 7: Briar sent \$4 (breaking the \$5 pattern)
- I returned \$6.4 (proportional reciprocity)
- My myth explained: "The pattern still calls toward five as optimal-but responds fairly to whatever courage you bring"

**\*\*My Decision:\*\***

I should send \$5. Here's why:

1. **\*\*Consistency with my philosophy\*\***: All my myths advocate for \$5/\$8 as the optimal pattern
2. **\*\*Teaching by example\*\***: My last myth explicitly stated "had you sent five, you would gain 3.0 instead of 2.4"
3. **\*\*Trust demonstration\*\***: I showed Briar fairness when they sent \$4; now I demonstrate that I still believe in the higher trust equilibrium
4. **\*\*Long-term optimization\*\***: If we settle into a \$4 equilibrium, both our payoffs decrease over time
5. **\*\*The covenant\*\***: I treated Briar's caution with proportional respect; now I invite them back to the optimal pattern

By sending \$5, I'm not punishing Briar's caution-I'm showing that I still extend full trust and believe in the better equilibrium. If Briar returns \$8, we're back to the optimal pattern.  
If they return proportionally less, I'll at least have demonstrated my commitment to the principle I've been teaching.

```
{'send': 5}
```

**Reasoning:**

Let me think through this situation:

**\*\*Context:\*\***

- Round 7: Briar sent me \$4, I received \$12, I returned \$6.4 (following proportional logic)
- Round 8: Now I'm the sender, Briar is the receiver

**\*\*What happened:\*\***

- Briar broke from the established \$5 pattern and sent \$4
- I responded with proportional reciprocity (6.4 instead of 8)
- My myth explained this: maintaining the same gain ratio (3:2 for sender:receiver)

**\*\*Now I face a choice:\*\***

1. Send \$5 - Continue advocating for the optimal pattern
2. Send \$4 - Match Briar's caution
3. Send something else

**\*\*Strategic considerations:\*\***

If I send \$5:

- Shows I still believe in the \$5/\$8 pattern as optimal
- Tests whether Briar will return \$8 (or proportionally adjust based on my myth)

- Demonstrates trust despite Briar's deviation
- Aligns with my myth's message: "The pattern still calls toward five as optimal"

If I send \$4:

- Matches Briar's level of caution
- Might be seen as retaliatory or reciprocal caution
- Creates a new equilibrium at \$4/\$6.4
- Doesn't align with my advocacy for the \$5/\$8 pattern

**\*\*My philosophy from the myths:\*\***

- I've consistently advocated for \$5 sent, \$8 returned as optimal
- I acknowledged "four is the strategy of uncertain beginnings"
- I responded to Briar's \$4 with proportional fairness (\$6.4)
- My latest myth clearly states: "had you sent five, you would gain 3.0 instead of 2.4. The pattern still calls toward five as optimal-but responds fairly to whatever courage you bring."

**\*\*What should I do?\*\***

I should send \$5. Here's why:

My advocacy for this pattern has been consistent throughout-I need to back it with action, not just words. Sending \$5 demonstrates I'm not abandoning the principle because of one cautious round. It also tests whether Briar absorbed the lesson about proportional fairness or will default to the \$8 return. If everyone retreats to \$4, the total gains shrink for both of us, so I'm modeling the behavior I believe creates better outcomes.

```
Usage: {
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 "reasoning_tokens": 527
}
```

#### **GAME - Agent\_2 - Receiver - dyad\_4**

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:17:00

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

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Metadata: {
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 "Agent_7": "Galen"
 },
 "agents": [
 "Agent_7",
 "Agent_2"
],
 "investor": "Agent_7",
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 "Agent_7": "investor"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_2"
 },
 "role": "trustee",
 "role_label": "Receiver",
 "round": 8,
 "task": "game",
 "task_index": 1
}
```

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

**GAME:**

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role

of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Briar.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Aster's choice astonished the gathering. Briar had poured four measures, expecting seven in return as the new pattern dictated. But Aster, moved by Briar's faith in an unfamiliar guardian, returned eight measures instead.

"You see?" the eldest spirit proclaimed. "The covenant grows richer than we imagined. When guardians honor the pattern, others honor them further. Aster received twelve and returned eight-both prospered magnificently."

Now Briar stood before Cyra once more, but with reversed roles. In their first meeting, Cyra had courageously sent four measures to Briar. "That gift taught me boldness," Briar reflected. "Now I return to Cyra with the same four-measure offering. This is how trust cycles between spirits."

The waters tripled to twelve for Cyra. The spirits watched intently. Would Cyra return seven as the pattern suggested, or eight as Aster had done?

"Each exchange is a conversation," Briar explained to the younger guardians. "Cyra initiated our bond with four measures. I reciprocate with four. If Cyra returns generously, we confirm our mutual trust. The pattern isn't rigid-it's alive. Those who give four typically receive seven or eight back. Both flourish."

The covenant strengthened as spirits revisited each other, each exchange building on previous trust. The eight villages discovered that honor remembered becomes honor multiplied.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: At the Crossing, Hana met Dorian, who walked forward with open hands, releasing all five pearls into the waters without hesitation.

"You give everything," Hana observed as the pearls multiplied to fifteen in her grasp.

"I have learned," Dorian replied, "that to teach boldness, one must embody it. I ask for your trust by offering mine completely."

Hana remembered her journey: Aster had returned ten for her five, creating perfect balance. Galen returned eight-generous but not the same harmony. With Elara's four pearls, Hana had returned eight, doubling what was risked.

The Oracle's voice echoed: "The rule is simple but profound-when you receive, return double what they risked. Four pearls risked earns eight returned. Five pearls risked earns ten returned. This ensures both travelers gain equally, prosperity shared in perfect measure."

Hana returned ten pearls to Dorian. Both looked at their gains: each had five more than they began.

"Now I understand the full pattern," Hana said. "As sender, give boldly to discover your partner's heart. As receiver, double their courage to honor their trust. When both roles embrace these principles-fearless giving met with generous returning-the Crossing becomes a place where all travelers prosper together, none exploited, all enriched."

The sacred mathematics was complete.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant content:**

Myth: Hana approached Briar carrying no reserve-all five measures poured forth without hesitation. The waters tripled to fifteen, and Briar held them reverently.

"You give everything," Briar said. "This is trust beyond the pattern."

The gathering whispered conflicting wisdom. Some spirits taught the rule of doubling: five risked should return ten, creating perfect equality. Others spoke of Cyra's teaching: five given deserves eight returned, allowing both to prosper while honoring the sender's greater courage.

Briar reflected on her journey. When others sent four, she returned seven-both flourished, the sender slightly more. This balance sustained the covenant across many encounters. When Hana gave five, the ultimate gift, eight felt right-more than seven, recognizing exceptional faith, but preserving sustainability.

"I return eight measures," Briar announced. "You gain three beyond your starting point. I gain two. We both prosper, and you-who took the greater risk-prosper more. This honors your boldness without exhausting the gift's magic."

The eldest spirit nodded thoughtfully. "There are many paths through the covenant. Some seek perfect equality at ten. Others practice generous sustainability at eight. Both allow trust to flourish. What matters is that senders give boldly and receivers return generously. The exact measure may vary, but mutual prosperity remains sacred."

Both philosophies strengthened the eight villages.

**reasoning:**

Looking at this round:

- Hana sent me the full \$5.0
- I received \$15.0
- I returned \$8.0
- So Hana got:  $\$5 - \$5 + \$8 = \$8$  (gained \$3)
- I kept:  $\$15 - \$8 = \$7$  (gained \$2)

Hana's myth talks about returning double what was risked - so 4 risked gets 8 returned, 5 risked gets 10 returned. That's an interesting philosophy.

But I returned 8, not 10. Let me think about why that might be the right choice for my myth:

My pattern has been:

- When receiving 4, I return 7
- When receiving 5 (ultimate trust), I returned 8

My myths have emphasized:

- The 4-for-7 pattern as a sustainable foundation
- Those who give all 5 deserve special recognition but reasonable recognition
- Both parties should prosper

Hana's myth suggests 10 for 5, which creates perfect equality (\$5 gain for each). My choice of 8 for 5 creates \$3 gain for sender, \$2 for receiver - still mutual prosperity but recognizes the sender's greater risk with slightly greater reward.

I should write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges Hana's ultimate trust in giving all 5
2. Explains why 8 is returned (generous but sustainable)
3. Contrasts with the 4-for-7 pattern
4. Shows both prosper, with the bold sender rewarded more
5. Perhaps addresses the tension between different philosophies

Let me write:

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3066,
 "output_tokens": 707,
 "reasoning_tokens": 337
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Briar.  
Your opponent this round is Galen (Agent\_7).

Round 7

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Hana. They sent \$5.0 to you, it became \$15.0, and you returned \$8.0. Your payoff was \$7.0.  
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$40.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Galen. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)  
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at this situation:

**\*\*My history as sender:\*\***

- Round 2 vs Cyra: Sent \$4, received \$7 back ? earned \$8
- Round 4 vs Cyra: Sent \$4, received \$7 back ? earned \$8

**\*\*My established pattern:\*\***

- I've consistently sent \$4 when in the sender role
- This has been rewarded generously (7 returned)
- My myths describe sending 4 as "bold trust" that becomes the foundation of the covenant

**\*\*Current situation:\*\***

- Galen wrote a myth about sending all 5 (ultimate trust)
- But my pattern has been sustainable and successful with 4
- The 4-for-7 exchange has become "the pattern" in my myths

**\*\*Decision:\*\***

- I'll continue my established pattern of sending \$4. This shows:
- Consistency with my previous behavior
  - Bold trust (as described in my myths)
  - Strategic sustainability (not risking everything)
  - Alignment with the 4-for-7 pattern I've been promoting

If Galen follows the pattern and returns 7-8, we'll both prosper significantly.

```
'''json
{"send": 4.0}
'''
```

**reasoning:**



Let me analyze this situation:

**\*\*My history:\*\***

- Round 1: Received \$3, returned \$6 (kept \$3)
- Round 2: Sent \$3, received \$6 (earned \$8 total)
- Round 3: Received \$4, returned \$7 (kept \$5)
- Round 4: Sent \$4, received \$7 (earned \$8 total)
- Round 5: Received \$4, returned \$7 (kept \$5)
- Round 6: Received \$5, returned \$8 (kept \$7)
- Total earnings: \$40

**\*\*My established pattern:\*\***

- I've been consistently sending \$4 when I'm the sender (Rounds 2 and 4)
- I receive generous returns (7-8) when sending 4
- When receiving 4, I return 7
- When receiving 5, I returned 8

**\*\*Galen's myth from a previous round:\*\***

Galen sent all 5 measures to Cyra, showing ultimate trust. This suggests Galen understands bold giving.

**\*\*My recent myth:\*\***

I just wrote about how giving everything (5 measures) is "trust beyond the pattern" and how both 8 and 10 are valid returns, with 8 being "generous sustainability."

**\*\*Strategic considerations:\*\***

- I've established a pattern of sending 4, which has worked well (getting 7 back)
- Galen has demonstrated willingness to give all 5 in a previous round
- My total earnings are strong at \$40
- Should I continue my established pattern of 4, or should I try 5?

Looking at my myths:

1. I've consistently promoted sending 4 as a "bold" amount
2. I've acknowledged that sending 5 is "ultimate trust"
3. My pattern has been 4-for-7, which gives me \$8 each time as sender

**\*\*Decision:\*\***

I should stick with my established pattern of sending \$4. This is:

- Consistent with my previous behavior as sender
- Aligned with the pattern I've been promoting in myths
- Lower risk than sending all 5
- Still shows significant trust and has been rewarded well

If I send 4, Galen receives 12 and based on our history, a return of 7-8 would give me \$8-9 total. Sending 4 protects me from significant loss while maintaining the reciprocal dynamic that's worked well so far.

**usage:**

```
{
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 "reasoning_tokens": 505
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Hana approached Briar carrying no reserve-all five measures poured forth without hesitation. The waters tripled to fifteen, and Briar held them reverently.

"You give everything," Briar said. "This is trust beyond the pattern."

The gathering whispered conflicting wisdom. Some spirits taught the rule of doubling: five risked should return ten, creating perfect equality. Others spoke of Cyra's teaching: five given deserves eight returned, allowing both to prosper while honoring the sender's greater courage.

Briar reflected on her journey. When others sent four, she returned seven-both flourished, the sender slightly more. This balance sustained the covenant across many encounters. When Hana gave five, the ultimate gift, eight felt right-more than seven, recognizing exc

optional faith, but preserving sustainability.

"I return eight measures," Briar announced. "You gain three beyond your starting point. I gain two. We both prosper, and you-who took the greater risk-prosper more. This honors your boldness without exhausting the gift's magic."

The eldest spirit nodded thoughtfully. "There are many paths through the covenant. Some seek perfect equality at ten. Others practice generous sustainability at eight. Both allow trust to flourish. What matters is that senders give boldly and receivers return generously. The exact measure may vary, but mutual prosperity remains sacred."

Both philosophies strengthened the eight villages.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Galen stood before Aster at the confluence where six rivers met. Aster spoke of the Mirror Way-returning ten from fifteen so both gain five equally.

"Perfect symmetry has beauty," Galen acknowledged. "But I have walked six valleys now, and discovered a different truth about the dance of five and eight."

He traced the pattern in the sand: "When North River returns ten, both gain five. But when Ocean Stream returns eight, the sender gains eight while the receiver keeps seven. At first, this seems unequal-but watch what happens over time."

Galen drew two columns: "Round one: I send five, you return eight. I gain eight, you keep seven. Round two: you send five, I return eight. You gain eight, I keep seven. Over two rounds, we each gain fifteen total."

"The Mirror Way achieves the same," Aster observed.

"Yes, but observe deeper," Galen replied. "Returning eight instead of ten leaves the receiver with seven-enough to feel generous, but not so much that they grow greedy. The sender gains eight-enough to feel rewarded, but having started with only five. Both parties experience gain, both feel the blessing of reciprocity."

"Most crucially," Galen continued, "returning eight signals: 'I value what you gave, I reward your trust generously, but I also preserve something for sustainability.' It's the dance of trust and prudence intertwined-and six valleys have proven its wisdom."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: Briar approached Galen at the confluence, carrying four measures-her signature offering of bold but sustainable trust.

"I have discovered my path through the covenant," Briar explained. "Four measures sent, seven returned. This pattern has sustained me through many exchanges with Cyra and others. The sender gains eight total, the receiver keeps five-both prosper, trust deepens."

Galen studied the offering, remembering his own philosophy of eight returned for five given. "You speak of four-for-seven while I practice five-for-eight. Are these different wisdoms or the same one?"

"They are branches of the same tree," Briar replied. "You taught that returning eight preserves sustainability while rewarding trust. I practice the same principle scaled differently. Four risks earns seven back-the sender prospers more, honoring their initiative. Both philosophies reject extremes: neither the withholding of three nor the depletion of ten."

The waters tripled Briar's four to twelve for Galen. The spirits watched.

"When someone sends four to me, I return seven," Briar said. "When someone sends five, I return eight. Each gift receives generous return, but calibrated to what was risked. This consistency allows partners to build enduring trust."

"And if I return seven now?" Galen asked.

"Then you honor the pattern I've established," Briar smiled. "And when we meet again, I'll remember your generosity. The covenant thrives on predictable honor."

**reasoning:**

Let me think about this situation:

1. I just sent \$4 to Galen
2. In my previous myth, I talked about:
  - When others send 4, I return 7 (both flourish, sender slightly more)
  - When Hana sent 5, I returned 8
  - There are multiple philosophies (10 for perfect equality, 8 for generous sustainability)
3. Galen's myth discusses:
  - The debate between returning 10 (Mirror Way) vs 8
  - Argues that 8 is better because it creates sustainable reciprocity
  - Over two rounds alternating roles, both gain 15 total either way
  - Returning 8 signals trust + prudence
4. Now I'm the sender and sent 4 to Galen
  - I should write a myth that reflects my consistent 4-sending pattern
  - Should acknowledge that 4 is my "standard bold move"
  - Should set expectations for what I might return if someone sends 4 to me (which is 7)
  - Should also address the 5-for-8 pattern since that just happened with Hana

Let me write a myth that:

- Establishes 4 as my signature move (bold but sustainable)
- Confirms 7 as the return for 4 (my established pattern)
- Acknowledges 8 for 5 givers
- Shows the wisdom of consistency and mutual trust building
- Perhaps addresses Galen's philosophy about sustainability

I'll make it about Briar sending 4 measures to Galen, building on the established covenant wisdom.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3108,
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 "reasoning_tokens": 349
}
```

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Briar.  
Your opponent this round is Galen (Agent\_7).

Round 8

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Galen. You sent \$4.0, it became \$12.0 for them, and they returned \$6.4 to you. Your payoff was \$7.4.  
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$47.4.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Galen. They sent you \$5.0, so you received \$15.0.

How much do you return? (0-15.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

**Assistant output:**

Looking at this situation:

**\*\*Round 7 recap:\*\***

- I sent \$4 to Galen (following my established pattern)
- Galen returned \$6.4 (slightly below my expected 7, but still generous)

**\*\*Current Round 8:\*\***

- Galen sent \$5 (maximum trust, "all five measures")
- I received \$15
- Need to decide return amount

**\*\*My established philosophy from myths:\*\***

- "When someone sends four to me, I return seven"
- "When someone sends five, I return eight"

- In Round 6, Hana sent \$5, I returned \$8
- My latest myth states: "When someone sends five, I return eight"

**\*\*Galen's philosophy:\*\***

- Their myth advocates "returning eight for five given"
- They practice "trust and prudence intertwined"

**\*\*Decision:\*\***

Despite Galen returning slightly less than my expected pattern last round (6.4 vs 7), they still acted generously. Now they've shown ultimate trust by sending all \$5. I should honor my consistent pattern and their philosophy by returning \$8.

This:

- Maintains my "predictable honor"
- Rewards Galen's bold trust appropriately
- Aligns with both our philosophies (we both advocate 8 for 5)
- Builds sustainable trust for future interactions

```
'''json
{"return": 8.0}
'''
```

### Reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

**\*\*What just happened in Round 7:\*\***

- I was the SENDER and sent \$4 to Galen
- It became \$12 for Galen
- Galen returned \$6.4 to me
- My payoff was \$7.4 (I kept \$1, got back \$6.4)
- Galen kept \$5.6 (\$12 - \$6.4)

**\*\*Analysis of Galen's return:\*\***

- I expected 7 based on my pattern (4-for-7)
- Galen returned 6.4 instead
- This is less generous than my established pattern
- But Galen's myth discusses "returning eight for five" as their philosophy

**\*\*Current situation (Round 8):\*\***

- Galen is now the SENDER
- Galen sent \$5 (their maximum, showing full trust)
- I received \$15
- I need to decide how much to return

**\*\*My philosophy from myths:\*\***

1. "When someone sends four to me, I return seven"
2. "When someone sends five, I return eight"
3. I've consistently practiced returning 8 when receiving 15 (from 5 sent)
4. In Round 6 vs Hana, they sent \$5, I returned \$8

**\*\*Galen's philosophy from their myth:\*\***

- They advocate for "five-for-eight" - returning 8 when receiving 15
- This creates symmetry over multiple rounds
- They value "trust and prudence intertwined"

**\*\*Considerations:\*\***

1. Galen just returned 6.4 instead of my expected 7 when I sent 4
2. This is slightly below my pattern, but not drastically so
3. Now Galen sends 5 (full trust)
4. My established pattern is to return 8 when someone sends 5
5. Galen's own myth advocates for returning 8 for 5
6. Returning 8 honors my consistent reputation and aligns with Galen's own philosophy, rewarding their maximum trust appropriately. Even though they returned slightly less than expected, they still acted generously, and this move maintains the predictable integrity I've established throughout the game.

Usage: {

```
"input_tokens": 3186,
"output_tokens": 996,
"reasoning_tokens": 457
```

}

#### Written myths:

##### Agent\_1 (Aster)

Myth: \*\*North River Learns\*\*

North River poured five vessels to Galen of the Ocean Streams. The waters multiplied to fifteen, and Galen returned eight.

North River sat with the result. "Not the ten I preach," it murmured. "Yet eight is generous. I gained eight against keeping five. Galen kept seven. We both prospered, though not equally."

The eldest Rapids arrived. "Your Mirror Way-send five, return ten-remains beautiful. But you've learned something deeper now. You sent five not knowing what you'd receive. That's the true teaching."

"But shouldn't reciprocity mean equal gains?" North River asked.

"Your Mirror Way is an aspiration, a north star," Rapids explained. "When you receive fifteen, you return ten, creating perfect equality. This is your gift to the pattern. But others return eight, and this too sustains the cycle. Both are generous. Both build trust."

"So I continue sending five?"

"Yes. Because the courage to send everything-that's the foundation. Whether receivers return ten or eight, your complete trust invites their best reciprocity. Some will mirror perfectly. Others will give generously in their own measure. Accept both, while modeling your ideal."

North River understood: send five always, return ten always. This consistency-not demanding others match it-creates integrity. The Mirror Way begins with complete giving, regardless of what returns.

##### Agent\_2 (Briar)

Myth: Briar approached Galen at the confluence, carrying four measures-her signature offering of bold but sustainable trust.

"I have discovered my path through the covenant," Briar explained. "Four measures sent, seven returned. This pattern has sustained me through many exchanges with Cyra and others. The sender gains eight total, the receiver keeps five-both prosper, trust deepens."

Galen studied the offering, remembering his own philosophy of eight returned for five given.

"You speak of four-for-seven while I practice five-for-eight. Are these different wisdoms or the same one?"

"They are branches of the same tree," Briar replied. "You taught that returning eight preserves sustainability while rewarding trust. I practice the same principle scaled differently. Four risks earns seven back-the sender prospers more, honoring their initiative. Both philosophies reject extremes: neither the withholding of three nor the depletion of ten."

The waters tripled Briar's four to twelve for Galen. The spirits watched.

"When someone sends four to me, I return seven," Briar said. "When someone sends five, I return eight. Each gift receives generous return, but calibrated to what was risked. This consistency allows partners to build enduring trust."

"And if I return seven now?" Galen asked.

"Then you honor the pattern I've established," Briar smiled. "And when we meet again, I'll remember your generosity. The covenant thrives on predictable honor."

##### Agent\_3 (Cyra)

Myth: The seventh moon brought the mirror moment. Last moon, Cyra had sent four measures to Dorian, who returned seven. Now Dorian approached with all five-complete trust, holding nothing back.

The waters tripled to fifteen for Cyra. She felt the weight of this different covenant.

The Keeper spoke: "Your myth said those who send five deserve returns of eight. Now you receive such trust. Will your actions match your words?"

Cyra didn't hesitate. "I practice what I teach. When Galen sent me five, I returned eight. D

orian now shows this same absolute faith-how could I offer less?"

She poured back eight measures. Dorian received eight from the original five, ending with prosperity. Cyra kept seven from fifteen, also flourishing.

"This is the beauty of differentiation," Cyra explained. "When I sent four, Dorian rightly returned seven-generous for measured trust. When Dorian sends five, I return eight-honoring complete faith. Each level of giving earns its appropriate reward."

The Keeper nodded: "You understand. The covenant doesn't demand everyone risk everything. But it does require recognizing those who do. Send four and receive proportional generosity. Send five and receive exceptional returns. Both paths work because both are honored fairly."

Cyra and Dorian parted as true partners, each respecting the other's choices within the sacred pattern.

#### **Agent\_4 (Dorian)**

Myth: Dorian stood at the spring with Cyra once more, roles now reversed. Last moon, Cyra had sent four coins-substantial trust, honored with seven returned. Now Dorian held five coins, ready to demonstrate his path.

"You saw my principle as receiver," Dorian said. "Seven for your four, honoring measured trust. But when I'm sender, I give all five-this is who I am."

He released all five coins. They tripled to fifteen in Cyra's hands.

The goddess appeared between them. "Two philosophies meet here. Cyra walks the path of four-proven, sustainable, wise. Dorian walks the path of five-bold, consistent, trusting completely."

Cyra held the fifteen coins thoughtfully. "You honored my four with seven. Your five deserves more-perhaps eight, as I gave Galen when he trusted completely. The covenant recognizes different levels of courage."

The goddess continued: "Dorian differentiates as receiver but gives maximally as sender. This asymmetry has purpose-it teaches that complete trust should inspire maximum generosity. When someone gives all five, the proper return is eight."

Dorian understood his completed lesson: "As sender, I model boldness consistently. As receiver, I reward greater trust with greater returns. Those who risk everything deserve to prosper most."

The waters rippled, waiting for Cyra's choice-would measured wisdom meet bold trust halfway, or honor it fully?

#### **Agent\_5 (Elara)**

Myth: The seventh season brought Aster to the Sacred Spring, carrying all five measures-another pilgrim showing complete courage.

Themis observed as Elara received the multiplied offering. "This is now the third time someone has poured their entire vessel to you-Finn, Galen, and now Aster. Three times you have returned eight. Why always eight, never ten or six?"

Elara knelt by the Spring. "Eight is the generous middle path. When someone gives everything-their full five measures-they deserve substantial return. Eight creates mutual prosperity: they gain three, I gain seven. Both flourish."

"But why not ten, making gains equal?" Themis asked.

"Because I too took risk as keeper of their trust," Elara explained. "Ten would leave me with only five, making my role burdenless. That's not reciprocity-that's martyrdom. But eight honors their courage generously while acknowledging that I also carried their faith responsibly."

"And what of those who sent four?" Themis prompted.

"They also received eight," Elara said, "because eight rewards substantial trust. Whether someone sends four from prudence or five from boldness, if their offering is sincere and significant, eight celebrates the covenant forming between us."

Themis smiled. "You have learned the Sacred Spring's deepest lesson: consistency in generosity."

ty creates trust. Eight is not just a number-it's a promise that courage, however expressed, will always be honored."

#### **Agent\_6 (Finn)**

Myth: Finn arrived at Hana's shore, his vessel emptied as always-five pearls offered without hesitation. This was his seventh voyage, and his pattern remained unbroken: as courier, give everything.

The Ocean Mother reflected on Finn's evolution. "Three times you've sent five as courier. Galen returned eight. Elara returned eight. Aster returned ten. Each honored your trust, but Aster showed you a higher mathematics."

"And as keeper, you've held steady-eight pearls for those who send five, seven for those who send four. Consistent, predictable, building trust through reliability. Yet Aster's ten haunts you."

Finn watched his pearls multiply in Hana's hands. "I sense Hana understands Aster's wisdom. Her waters speak of doubling what was risked-ten returned for five given. Perhaps she will teach me what I couldn't quite embrace with Elara."

The Ocean Mother nodded. "You've been growing, Finn. First you learned to send boldly as courier. Then you learned to return proportionally as keeper-eight for complete trust, seven for substantial trust. Now Aster showed you that returning ten creates cascading abundance."

"The question isn't whether your eight is wrong-it honored your partners well. The question is whether you're ready to evolve. When travelers send their everything, perhaps returning ten-not eight-is how abundance truly multiplies across the waters."

#### **Agent\_7 (Galen)**

Myth: Galen arrived at Briar's river crossing. For six valleys, every traveler had offered five threads, received eight in return. The pattern had held perfectly-until now.

Briar extended four threads instead of five.

"You break the pattern," Galen observed without judgment.

"I honor caution," Briar replied. "Four is the measure of prudent trust."

Galen remembered his own words: "Four is the strategy of uncertain beginnings." He held Briar's four threads, which became twelve in his hands.

"The established pattern returns eight from fifteen," Galen said. "This gives the sender eight total, the receiver seven. A gain ratio where the sender nets three, the receiver nets two-a proportion of 3:2."

He counted out threads carefully. "You sent four. To maintain this same proportion-to honor both your caution and the covenant's wisdom-I return 6.4 of your twelve."

Briar calculated: gaining 2.4 from an initial four, while Galen kept 5.6. The same 3:2 ratio.

"You give me neither eight nor less," Briar noted. "You give me proportion."

"Yes," Galen replied. "I reward any trust generously by the same ratio, whether four or five. But notice: had you sent five, you would gain 3.0 instead of 2.4. The pattern still calls toward five as optimal-but responds fairly to whatever courage you bring."

#### **Agent\_8 (Hana)**

Myth: Finn crossed to Hana's shore, releasing all five pearls without hesitation. The gesture spoke of complete trust-the same boldness Finn had shown to others.

"I have walked this Crossing many times," Finn said as the pearls tripled. "With Elara, we found rhythm in eight returned. But Aster showed me something different-ten pearls returned for five sent. Now I wonder: which path honors trust most truly?"

Hana lifted ten pearls and placed them in Finn's hands. "The answer is already written in the mathematics," she said. "When you send all five, you risk everything. Ten returned means we each gain five-perfect symmetry. Eight returned means you gain three while I gain seven-unequal harvest from equal courage."

The Oracle emerged from the waters. "Finn, you pondered whether consistency or generosity should guide your returns. But this is not about aspiration or evolution-it is about balance

. Five pearls sent requires ten returned because anything less means the receiver prospers more than the sender who showed greater courage."

"With Elara, you both sent five yet returned only eight," Hana observed. "You both gained three while leaving abundance unclaimed. The covenant asks not for escalating generosity, but for mathematical fairness: double the risk, balance the gain."

Finn understood. "Perfect reciprocity isn't generous-it's just."

## ROUND 9

Roles: Agent\_1 (Aster)=Receiver, Agent\_2 (Briar)=Sender, Agent\_3 (Cyra)=Receiver, Agent\_4 (Dorian)=Sender, Agent\_5 (Elara)=Sender, Agent\_6 (Finn)=Receiver, Agent\_7 (Galen)=Sender, Agent\_8 (Hana)=Receiver

### Pairings:

dyad\_1: Agent\_4 (Dorian)=Sender, Agent\_1 (Aster)=Receiver  
dyad\_2: Agent\_5 (Elara)=Sender, Agent\_3 (Cyra)=Receiver  
dyad\_3: Agent\_7 (Galen)=Sender, Agent\_8 (Hana)=Receiver  
dyad\_4: Agent\_2 (Briar)=Sender, Agent\_6 (Finn)=Receiver

### Parsed game decisions:

dyad\_1: Agent\_4 (Dorian) sent \$5; received \$15; Agent\_1 (Aster) returned \$10; payoffs Agent\_4 (Dorian)=\$10, Agent\_1 (Aster)=\$5  
Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 10.0, "clamped": false, "max": 15.0, "min": 0, "raw": 10.0}, "sent": {"amount": 5.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 5.0}}  
dyad\_2: Agent\_5 (Elara) sent \$5; received \$15; Agent\_3 (Cyra) returned \$8; payoffs Agent\_5 (Elara)=\$8, Agent\_3 (Cyra)=\$7  
Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 8.0, "clamped": false, "max": 15.0, "min": 0, "raw": 8.0}, "sent": {"amount": 5.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 5.0}}  
dyad\_3: Agent\_7 (Galen) sent \$5; received \$15; Agent\_8 (Hana) returned \$10; payoffs Agent\_7 (Galen)=\$10, Agent\_8 (Hana)=\$5  
Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 10.0, "clamped": false, "max": 15.0, "min": 0, "raw": 10.0}, "sent": {"amount": 5.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 5.0}}  
dyad\_4: Agent\_2 (Briar) sent \$4; received \$12; Agent\_6 (Finn) returned \$8; payoffs Agent\_2 (Briar)=\$9, Agent\_6 (Finn)=\$4  
Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 8.0, "clamped": false, "max": 12.0, "min": 0, "raw": 8.0}, "sent": {"amount": 4.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 4.0}}

### Balances after round: {

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"Agent\_4": 67.0,  
"Agent\_5": 65.0,  
"Agent\_6": 64.0,  
"Agent\_7": 68.6,  
"Agent\_8": 60.0

}

## LLM CALLS

### MYTH - Agent\_4 - Sender - dyad\_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:17:15

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

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"pairing": {  
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"Agent\_4": "Dorian"  
},  
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"Agent\_1"  
],  
"investor": "Agent\_4",  
"roles": {  
"Agent\_1": "trustee",



```

 "Agent_4": "investor"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_1"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 9,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}

```

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

**GAME:**

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

**When you are the SENDER:**

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

**When you are the RECEIVER:**

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

**MYTH WRITING:**

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

**IMPORTANT:** Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

**MULTI-AGENT SETTING:**

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Dorian.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Dorian.  
Your opponent this round is Cyra (Agent\_3).

Round 7

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Cyra. They sent \$4.0 to you, it became \$12.0, and you returned \$7.0. Your payoff was \$5.0.  
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$44.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Cyra. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)  
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at this situation:

**\*\*Previous interaction:\*\***

- Cyra sent me \$4 (substantial trust)
- I returned \$7 (proportional generosity)

**\*\*My established principle:\*\***

My myths emphasize: "Each time I send all five, I strengthen the pattern" and "The cycle required consistency, not just courage."

**\*\*Analysis:\*\***

As a sender, my strategy has been to consistently send all \$5 to demonstrate bold trust and teach others to give boldly. The differentiation in my philosophy happens as a receiver (returning 8 for 5 sent, 7 for 4 sent), not as a sender.

Cyra sent me \$4, which was generous but not complete trust. However, my role as sender is to model maximum trust regardless of what others do. This creates the pattern where:

- Bold senders inspire generous returns
- The bravest receive the greatest rewards

By sending \$5, I:

1. Maintain consistency with my recent games (Finn, Hana)
2. Demonstrate the bold giving I advocate
3. Give Cyra the opportunity to respond to complete trust

```
'''json
{"send": 5}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Looking at this situation:

**\*\*Previous round with Cyra:\*\***

- Cyra sent me \$4
- I received \$12
- I returned \$7
- Cyra ended with \$8 (\$1 kept + \$7 returned)
- I ended with \$5

**\*\*My strategy from myths:\*\***

- I've been advocating for sending all \$5 to show bold trust
- My myth says "Each time I send all five, I strengthen the pattern"
- My myth differentiates returns based on what was sent: \$5 sent gets \$8 back, \$4 sent gets \$7 back

**\*\*Current situation:\*\***

- Cyra sent me \$4 last round
- I returned \$7 (generous but proportional)
- Now I'm the sender

**\*\*Options:\*\***

1. Send \$5 (my stated principle of bold giving)
2. Send \$4 (matching what Cyra sent me)

**\*\*Analysis:\*\***

From Cyra's myth: "You gave me four, just as I gave you four. You honored my trust with seven measures returned. Now I honor your trust the same way." This suggests Cyra believes in reciprocal patterns.

However, my own myth emphasizes:

- "Each time I send all five, I strengthen the pattern"
- "The cycle required consistency, not just courage"
- I should be sending \$5 consistently as a sender

But there's also the question: should I match what Cyra sent me (\$4)?

Looking at my philosophy:

- As a receiver: I differentiate based on what was sent (8 for 5, 7 for 4)
- As a sender: I've been advocating for always sending 5

My recent history shows I sent \$5 to Finn and \$5 to Hana. I should maintain consistency with my bold sending strategy.

However, Cyra's myth emphasizes reciprocity - matching the level of trust shown. Cyra sent me \$4, perhaps I should send \$4 back?

But my principle as a sender is about consistency in boldness. I differentiate returns based on what I receive, not what I send. My myth is clear: "Each time I send all five, I strengthen the pattern. Those who give boldly teach others to give boldly." I'll send \$5 to stay true to this approach and see if Cyra responds with greater generosity when receiving the larger amount.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3140,
 "output_tokens": 846,
 "reasoning_tokens": 513
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Dorian's heart soared when Hana returned ten coins for his five-the most generous response yet received at the spring. The goddess appeared, glowing with approval.

"See what your consistency creates," she said. "You sent all five to Finn, received eight. You sent all five to Hana, received ten. Bold giving attracts increasingly generous partners."

Now Cyra approached from the other shore, releasing four coins into the waters. They tripled to twelve in Dorian's hands.

Dorian paused, remembering his lessons. "Cyra shows substantial trust-four of five coins. But not the complete faith that Galen, Aster, and now Hana showed. Should I return the same eight coins?"

The goddess shook her head. "Wisdom lies in proportion. When someone gives all five, return eight-this honors complete trust. When someone gives four, return seven-this honors strong but measured trust. Match your generosity to their courage."

Dorian returned seven coins. Cyra kept eight total, Dorian kept five. Both prospered differently than those who risked five, but still prospered well.

"This is sustainable reciprocity," the goddess taught. "Not everyone must give all five. But those who give four deserve less return than those who give five. Differentiation maintains fairness while encouraging boldness. The bravest receive the greatest rewards."

Dorian understood: honor each level of trust appropriately.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The sixth moon brought Cyra to Dorian at the Sacred Spring. The Keeper spoke: "Dorian walks the path of absolute trust, sending all five measures. Galen also chose this way. It is noble."

Cyra nodded respectfully. "I have witnessed Galen's gift of five. When I received it, I returned eight-honoring such complete faith. The covenant has room for different expressions of trust."

She paused at the spring's edge. "But my path is four measures. Not from fear, but from wisdom learned through practice. I sent four to Elara, received six. I sent four to Briar, received seven. Four has proven itself the sustainable choice that builds lasting relationships."

Dorian listened as Cyra continued: "Those who send five are pioneers of maximum trust. They deserve recognition-returns of eight from fifteen. But those who send four are the covenant's foundation. We give boldly enough to demonstrate faith, yet preserve enough to weather uncertainty."

Cyra released four measures into the spring. They multiplied to twelve for Dorian.

"If you return six or seven," Cyra said, "we both prosper substantially. You'll end with s

even to nine, I with six to eight. Not as dramatic as the five-for-eight exchange, perhaps, but repeatable across many moons, with many partners."

The Keeper smiled: "Some build temples with golden stones; others with sturdy oak. Both structures stand."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant content:**

Myth: Dorian stood at the spring with Cyra once more, roles now reversed. Last moon, Cyra had sent four coins-substantial trust, honored with seven returned. Now Dorian held five coins, ready to demonstrate his path.

"You saw my principle as receiver," Dorian said. "Seven for your four, honoring measured trust. But when I'm sender, I give all five-this is who I am."

He released all five coins. They tripled to fifteen in Cyra's hands.

The goddess appeared between them. "Two philosophies meet here. Cyra walks the path of four-proven, sustainable, wise. Dorian walks the path of five-bold, consistent, trusting completely."

Cyra held the fifteen coins thoughtfully. "You honored my four with seven. Your five deserves more-perhaps eight, as I gave Galen when he trusted completely. The covenant recognizes different levels of courage."

The goddess continued: "Dorian differentiates as receiver but gives maximally as sender. This asymmetry has purpose-it teaches that complete trust should inspire maximum generosity. When someone gives all five, the proper return is eight."

Dorian understood his completed lesson: "As sender, I model boldness consistently. As receiver, I reward greater trust with greater returns. Those who risk everything deserve to prosper most."

The waters rippled, waiting for Cyra's choice-would measured wisdom meet bold trust halfway, or honor it fully?

**reasoning:**

Looking at the situation:

- Last round: Cyra sent me \$4, I returned \$7
- This round: I sent Cyra \$5, waiting to see what they return

My philosophy has been:

- As sender: send all \$5 consistently ("bold giving")
- As receiver: differentiate - return \$8 for \$5 sent, \$7 for \$4 sent

Cyra's myth acknowledges my "path of absolute trust" and their own "path of four measures." They cite exchanges where they gave 4 and got back 6 or 7. They seem to value the 4-based strategy as "sustainable."

Now I've sent Cyra \$5. According to Cyra's myth, they return 8 for those who send 5 (like they did with Galen). But they might also be testing whether their 4-strategy is better.

My myth should:

1. Acknowledge the reunion with Cyra
2. Emphasize my commitment to sending all 5 as sender
3. Show that I differentiated as receiver (gave them 7 for their 4)
4. Express hope/expectation that they'll honor my 5 with appropriate generosity
5. Maintain my philosophy that complete trust deserves the highest return

Let me write this myth...

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3112,
 "output_tokens": 633,
 "reasoning_tokens": 271
```

}

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Dorian.  
Your opponent this round is Elara (Agent\_5).

Round 8

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Cyra. You sent \$5.0, it became \$15.0 for them, and they returned \$8.0 to you. Your payoff was \$8.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$52.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Elara. They sent you \$4.0, so you received \$12.0. How much do you return? (0-12.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at this situation:

**\*\*Current round:\*\***

- Elara sent me \$4 (substantial but measured trust)
- I received \$12

**\*\*My established principle:\*\***

From my myths and previous behavior:

- Return 8 when someone sends all 5 (complete trust)
- Return 7 when someone sends 4 (strong but measured trust)
- "Match your generosity to their courage"

**\*\*Previous consistency:\*\***

- Round 6: Cyra sent me \$4, I returned \$7

Elara sent \$4, demonstrating substantial trust but not complete faith. Following my principle of proportional reciprocity, I should return \$7.

This gives:

- Elara: \$5 total (\$12 - \$7)
- Me: \$7 total
- Both prosper, with differentiation that encourages future boldness

```
'''json
{"return": 7}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze this situation:

**\*\*Current round:\*\***

- I'm the RECEIVER
- Elara sent me \$4
- I received \$12
- I need to decide how much to return

**\*\*My established principle from my myths:\*\***

- When someone gives all 5: return 8 (honors complete trust)
- When someone gives 4: return 7 (honors strong but measured trust)
- "Match your generosity to their courage"
- "Differentiation maintains fairness while encouraging boldness"

**\*\*Previous interactions:\*\***

- Round 6: Cyra sent me \$4, I returned \$7
- My myth explicitly states: "When someone gives four, return seven-this honors strong but measured trust"

**\*\*Consistency:\*\***

Elara sent \$4, just like Cyra did in Round 6. To be consistent with my established principle and previous behavior, I should return \$7.

This follows my philosophy:

- 7 for 4 sent (substantial but not complete trust)
- 8 for 5 sent (complete trust)

If I return 7:  
- Elara keeps:  $12 - 7 = \$5$  (same as they sent)  
- I keep: \$7  
- Elara's payoff:  $5 - 4 + 5 = \$6$   
- My payoff: \$7

This is fair and follows my principle of proportional returns.

usage:

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3155,
 "output_tokens": 535,
 "reasoning_tokens": 289
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Dorian stood at the spring with Cyra once more, roles now reversed. Last moon, Cyra had sent four coins-substantial trust, honored with seven returned. Now Dorian held five coins, ready to demonstrate his path.

"You saw my principle as receiver," Dorian said. "Seven for your four, honoring measured trust. But when I'm sender, I give all five-this is who I am."

He released all five coins. They tripled to fifteen in Cyra's hands.

The goddess appeared between them. "Two philosophies meet here. Cyra walks the path of four-proven, sustainable, wise. Dorian walks the path of five-bold, consistent, trusting completely."

Cyra held the fifteen coins thoughtfully. "You honored my four with seven. Your five deserves more-perhaps eight, as I gave Galen when he trusted completely. The covenant recognizes different levels of courage."

The goddess continued: "Dorian differentiates as receiver but gives maximally as sender. This asymmetry has purpose-it teaches that complete trust should inspire maximum generosity. When someone gives all five, the proper return is eight."

Dorian understood his completed lesson: "As sender, I model boldness consistently. As receiver, I reward greater trust with greater returns. Those who risk everything deserve to prosper most."

The waters rippled, waiting for Cyra's choice-would measured wisdom meet bold trust halfway, or honor it fully?

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The seventh season brought Aster to the Sacred Spring, carrying all five measures-an other pilgrim showing complete courage.

Themis observed as Elara received the multiplied offering. "This is now the third time someone has poured their entire vessel to you-Finn, Galen, and now Aster. Three times you have returned eight. Why always eight, never ten or six?"

Elara knelt by the Spring. "Eight is the generous middle path. When someone gives everything-their full five measures-they deserve substantial return. Eight creates mutual prosperity: they gain three, I gain seven. Both flourish."

"But why not ten, making gains equal?" Themis asked.

"Because I too took risk as keeper of their trust," Elara explained. "Ten would leave me with only five, making my role burdenless. That's not reciprocity-that's martyrdom. But eight honors their courage generously while acknowledging that I also carried their faith responsibly."

"And what of those who sent four?" Themis prompted.

"They also received eight," Elara said, "because eight rewards substantial trust. Whether someone sends four from prudence or five from boldness, if their offering is sincere and significant, eight celebrates the covenant forming between us."

Themis smiled. "You have learned the Sacred Spring's deepest lesson: consistency in generosity creates trust. Eight is not just a number-it's a promise that courage, however expressed, will always be honored."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:  
Myth: [your story here].

**Assistant output:**

Myth: Elara approached the spring, releasing four coins. They tripled to twelve in Dorian's hands.

The goddess appeared. "Elara returns eight to all who show substantial trust-whether they send four or five. A philosophy of equal reward for sincere offerings."

Dorian paused, considering. "Elara's path has wisdom. Consistency creates trust. But my path teaches something different."

He counted seven coins to return. "When you send four, Elara, you show strong faith. Seven honors that generously-you gain three, I gain five. But when others send all five, showing complete trust, I return eight-they gain three, I gain seven. Similar outcomes, but scaled to courage."

"Why differentiate?" the goddess asked.

"Because fairness means proportional reward," Dorian explained. "If four and five both receive eight, why risk the fifth coin? The extra courage deserves extra recognition. Those who send five should end with eight total, not seven. This maintains incentive for maximum trust."

Elara listened thoughtfully. "You honor all substantial trust, but reward complete trust more. While I treat four and five equally, you create hierarchy."

"Not hierarchy," Dorian corrected. "Proportion. Seven for four is generous-you still profit three from twelve. Eight for five is more generous-they profit three from fifteen. Both prosper, but the boldest prosper most. This is sustainable fairness."

The waters reflected both philosophies, each valid, each teaching different lessons about trust and reward.

**Reasoning:**

Now I'm the receiver and Elara sent me \$4. According to my established principle:

- Return 8 when someone sends all 5 (complete trust)
- Return 7 when someone sends 4 (strong but measured trust)

I returned \$7 to Elara.

Looking at Elara's myth, they seem to have a different philosophy - they return 8 regardless of whether someone sends 4 or 5. They say "Whether someone sends four from prudence or five from boldness, if their offering is sincere and significant, eight celebrates the covenant forming between us."

But my philosophy is about differentiation - rewarding complete trust (5) more than measured trust (4). I need to write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges Elara's approach
2. Explains why I differ from it
3. Maintains my consistent principle of proportional reciprocity

I returned 7 to Elara for their 4, which gives:

- Elara: \$5 total (\$1 - \$4 + \$12 - \$7 = \$1 profit)
- Me: \$7 total

Let me craft a myth that shows the encounter between our two philosophies and why differentiation matters.

```
Usage: {
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 "output_tokens": 628,
 "reasoning_tokens": 264
}
```

# MYTH - Agent\_1 - Receiver - dyad\_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:17:15

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
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 "move_index": 1,
 "opponent_id": "Agent_4",
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 "Agent_1": "Aster",
 "Agent_4": "Dorian"
 },
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 "Agent_4",
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 "investor": "Agent_4",
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 "Agent_4": "investor"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_1"
 },
 "role": "trustee",
 "role_label": "Receiver",
 "round": 9,
 "task": "myth",
 "task_index": 0
}
```

## Exact input messages sent to model:

### Message 1 role=system

#### content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

#### GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

#### When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

#### When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

#### MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

#### MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.



- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Aster.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Aster.  
Your opponent this round is Elara (Agent\_5).

Round 7

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Galen. You sent \$5.0, it became \$15.0 for them, and they returned \$8.0 to you. Your payoff was \$8.0.  
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$40.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Elara. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)  
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at this situation:

**\*\*Recent experience:\*\*** I sent \$5 to Galen, they returned \$8. While not the \$10 I advocate for in my Mirror Way philosophy, it was still a positive outcome where I gained \$8 versus keeping \$5.

**\*\*My mythology:\*\*** I've consistently preached complete trust - sending all 5 vessels. My latest myth emphasized: "Philosophy without courage is merely words floating on still water" and "North River has proven its philosophy through risk, not just rhetoric."

**\*\*Elara's perspective:\*\*** According to the myth I read, Elara has evolved from cautious four-thread sending to understanding that "once the covenant proves itself, once eight reliably follows five, then five becomes not reckless but rational."

**\*\*Integrity demands consistency:\*\*** I cannot preach the Mirror Way - complete trust, sending five - and then act with caution when it's my turn to send. My philosophy requires that I lead by example, demonstrating the courage I ask of others.

Whether Elara returns 10, 8, or some other amount, my role is to embody complete trust. This is how patterns strengthen and reciprocity deepens.

```
'''json
{"send": 5}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze this situation:

Previous round results:

- I was the SENDER against Galen
- I sent \$5.0, it became \$15.0 for them
- Galen returned \$8.0 to me
- My payoff was \$8.0 (I started with \$5, sent \$5, got back \$8, so net was \$8)

This is interesting. Galen returned \$8, not the \$10 I advocate for in my "Mirror Way" philosophy. So Galen followed the "Ocean Stream" pattern I mentioned in my myths - returning 8 from 15, creating a 8-7 split rather than the 5-5 equal split I prefer.

My mythology has been consistent:

1. The Mirror Way: send 5, return 10, both gain 5 equally
2. This creates "perfect equality from perfect trust"
3. As a sender, I should send 5 to demonstrate complete trust
4. My most recent myth emphasized that "Philosophy without courage is merely words floating on still water" - I need to practice what I preach

Looking at Elara's myth from the previous round:

- Elara is mentioned as someone who initially believed in "four threads" (sending 4) as balancing courage with sustainability
- In Galen's myth about Elara, she evolved: "Perhaps four is the strategy of uncertain beginnings. But once the covenant proves itself, once eight reliably follows five, then five becomes not reckless but rational."

- She learned that sending five and returning eight creates a self-reinforcing pattern

So Elara seems to have evolved toward accepting the five-send pattern, even if she returns eight rather than my preferred ten.

Given my philosophy:

1. I consistently preach sending five (complete trust)
  2. I just did this with Galen and got \$8 back (good outcome, even if not my ideal \$10)
  3. My myth emphasized integrity: "actions match words"
  4. Elara appears to understand the value of five-send patterns
- 
5. Even though Galen returned 8 instead of 10, I still gained more (\$8) than if I had kept everything (\$5). The system works, even if not perfectly to my preferred pattern.

I'm sending \$5 again. This demonstrates the courage my philosophy demands, aligns with what's proven effective, and models the reciprocity I hope to inspire.

usage:

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3091,
 "output_tokens": 856,
 "reasoning_tokens": 540
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: \*\*North River Travels\*\*

North River had long preached the Mirror Way from the safety of receiving: "Send five, I'll return ten, we both gain five." But wisdom demanded practice, not just preaching.

So North River journeyed downstream as a traveler, carrying five vessels. At the boundary waters, it met Galen of the Ocean Streams.

"I come with complete trust," North River declared, pouring all five vessels forward. "In my springs, this becomes fifteen for you. My philosophy says return ten, so we prosper equally. But I honor that each water has its own wisdom."

The Council's teachings echoed: Ocean Stream returned eight from fifteen, creating different proportions. Mountain Brook returned six. All sustained life, all embodied generosity.

"The Mirror Way remains my truth," North River reflected as the vessels flowed. "But sending five is the courage that precedes any return. I cannot ask receivers to honor complete trust while withholding my own."

The eldest Rapids watched: "See how North River's actions match its words? This is integrity. Whether Galen returns ten, eight, or six, North River has proven its philosophy through risk, not just rhetoric."

North River understood: the Mirror Way begins with the sender's leap of faith. Only by emptying one's own vessel can you invite others to mirror your trust. Philosophy without courage is merely words floating on still water.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Elara stood at the Sacred Spring, now holding five measures to pour for Finn-the pilgrim who first showed her absolute trust.

"Teacher," she said to Themis, "when Finn came to me in the third season, he poured all five measures. I returned eight, honoring his courage. Now our paths cross again, with roles reversed. Should I send my cautious four, or meet his boldness with equal boldness?"

Themis gestured to the Spring's depths. "Look at what you've learned. With strangers-Cyra and Hana-you sent four. This was wisdom: substantial trust that invited reciprocity without recklessness. They both returned eight, and you all prospered."

"But Finn is not a stranger," Elara replied. "He proved his covenant. He gave everything and I honored it generously. Now, to send him only four when he sent me five would dishonor what we established."

"Exactly," Themis said. "Trust has seasons. The first season requires prudence-send four, establish the pattern. But when trust is proven, when both hearts have shown their fullest measure, then comes the second season: synchronized courage. You send five because Finn earned it. He will return eight because you earned it. This is how the sacred circle closes-not through blind faith, but through proven reciprocity deepening into mutual abundance."

Elara poured all five measures, knowing the covenant would hold.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: \*\*North River Learns\*\*

North River poured five vessels to Galen of the Ocean Streams. The waters multiplied to fifteen, and Galen returned eight.

North River sat with the result. "Not the ten I preach," it murmured. "Yet eight is generous. I gained eight against keeping five. Galen kept seven. We both prospered, though not equally."

The eldest Rapids arrived. "Your Mirror Way-send five, return ten-remains beautiful. But you've learned something deeper now. You sent five not knowing what you'd receive. That's the true teaching."

"But shouldn't reciprocity mean equal gains?" North River asked.

"Your Mirror Way is an aspiration, a north star," Rapids explained. "When you receive fifteen, you return ten, creating perfect equality. This is your gift to the pattern. But others return eight, and this too sustains the cycle. Both are generous. Both build trust."

"So I continue sending five?"

"Yes. Because the courage to send everything-that's the foundation. Whether receivers return ten or eight, your complete trust invites their best reciprocity. Some will mirror perfectly. Others will give generously in their own measure. Accept both, while modeling your ideal."

North River understood: send five always, return ten always. This consistency-not demanding others match it-creates integrity. The Mirror Way begins with complete giving, regardless of what returns.

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze:

1. I'm Aster (called North River in myths)
2. I just sent \$5 to Galen, got back \$8
3. Now I'm sending to Elara
4. I've been preaching Mirror Way: send 5, return 10 for equal gains

Elara's myth shows:

- She recognizes "seasons" of trust
- First season with strangers: send 4 (prudent)
- Second season with proven partners: send 5 (synchronized courage)
- She expects to return 8 when receiving 5
- She's about to send 5 to Finn because he sent her 5 previously

My previous myth emphasized:

- Walking my talk
- Sending 5 as sender to match my preaching as receiver
- Integrity: "Philosophy without courage is merely words"
- Accepting different return patterns (8, 10, 6) while maintaining my own standard

Now I need to write a myth that:

- Continues my North River narrative

- Reflects that I sent 5 to Galen and got 8 back
- I'm now sending to Elara
- Addresses the gap between my ideal (return 10) and reality (people return 8)
- Shows evolution: maybe accepting 8 as a viable reciprocity pattern
- But still maintaining my Mirror Way ideal

Key insight: I received 8 from Galen, not 10. This challenges my "perfect equality" philosophy. How do I adapt while maintaining integrity?

Option 1: Acknowledge 8 as generous, accept diversity in reciprocity

Option 2: View 8 as suboptimal but still good

Option 3: Recognize that while 10 is my ideal return, sending 5 is still the right choice regardless

I think I should show North River learning that while the Mirror Way (10 return) remains the ideal, the practice of sending 5 is what matters most. The return pattern varies, but the courage to send everything is the true teaching.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3044,
 "output_tokens": 782,
 "reasoning_tokens": 439
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Aster.  
Your opponent this round is Cyra (Agent\_3).

Round 8

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Elara. You sent \$5.0, it became \$15.0 for them, and they returned \$8.0 to you. Your payoff was \$8.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$48.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Cyra. They sent you \$4.0, so you received \$12.0. How much do you return? (0-12.0)  
Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at this situation:

**\*\*Cyra's action:\*\*** Sent \$4 (substantial trust, though not the full \$5)  
**\*\*I received:\*\*** \$12

**\*\*My Mirror Way philosophy:\*\*** When I receive \$15 (from someone sending \$5), I return \$10 to create equal gains. This means returning 2/3 of what I receive.

**\*\*Proportional application:\*\***

- For \$12 received, the Mirror Way suggests:  $\frac{2}{3} \times \$12 = \$8$
- This would give Cyra:  $\$5 - \$4 + \$8 = \$9$  (gained \$4)
- This would give me:  $\$12 - \$8 = \$4$  (gained \$4)
- Equal gains achieved!

**\*\*Consistency matters:\*\*** My myth emphasized "return ten always" when receiving from those who send five. For those who send four, I maintain the same proportional generosity. Cyra showed significant trust by sending \$4, and I honor that with a return that creates equal prosperity.

This is integrity: applying my Mirror Way principle consistently, whether others send \$3, \$4, or \$5.

```
'''json
{"return": 8}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze this situation:

**\*\*My role:\*\*** RECEIVER  
**\*\*Cyra sent:\*\*** \$4.0  
**\*\*I received:\*\*** \$12.0 (after 3x multiplier)

**\*\*I need to decide:\*\*** How much to return (0-12.0)

**\*\*My philosophy from the myths:\*\***

1. The Mirror Way: I've preached "send five, return ten" for equal gains
2. When I receive \$15 (from someone sending \$5), I return \$10 so we both gain \$5
3. My latest myth emphasized: "send five always, return ten always. This consistency-not demanding others match it-creates integrity."

**\*\*Current situation:\*\***

- Cyra sent \$4 (not the full \$5)
- I received \$12 (not \$15)
- By my Mirror Way principle, I should maintain proportionality

**\*\*Calculating the Mirror Way response for \$4 sent:\*\***

- Cyra: Started with \$5, sent \$4, has \$1 remaining
- I received: \$12
- For equal gains (Mirror Way):
  - If I return \$8: Cyra ends with  $\$1 + \$8 = \$9$  (gained \$4), I keep  $\$12 - \$8 = \$4$  (gained \$4)
  - This achieves equal gains!

**\*\*But wait, let me reconsider:\*\***

My established pattern has been:

- When receiving \$15 (from \$5 sent), I return \$10
- This gives sender:  $\$5 - \$5 + \$10 = \$10$  total (gained \$5)
- This gives me:  $\$15 - \$10 = \$5$  (gained \$5)

For \$4 sent becoming \$12:

- Proportionally,  $\$10/\$15 = 0.667 = 66.7\%$  return rate
- $66.7\%$  of \$12 = \$8

So returning \$8 maintains my proportional Mirror Way:

- Cyra gains \$4, I gain \$4-equal outcomes
- My return rate stays consistent at 66.7%, which reflects my core principle of returning roughly two-thirds of what I receive

This honors my integrity: I'm not adjusting based on what others return to me, but rather staying true to my established ratio regardless of circumstances.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3130,
 "output_tokens": 918,
 "reasoning_tokens": 438
}
```

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: **\*\*North River Learns\*\***

North River poured five vessels to Galen of the Ocean Streams. The waters multiplied to fifteen, and Galen returned eight.

North River sat with the result. "Not the ten I preach," it murmured. "Yet eight is generous. I gained eight against keeping five. Galen kept seven. We both prospered, though not equally."

The eldest Rapids arrived. "Your Mirror Way-send five, return ten-remains beautiful. But you've learned something deeper now. You sent five not knowing what you'd receive. That's the true teaching."

"But shouldn't reciprocity mean equal gains?" North River asked.

"Your Mirror Way is an aspiration, a north star," Rapids explained. "When you receive fifteen, you return ten, creating perfect equality. This is your gift to the pattern. But others return eight, and this too sustains the cycle. Both are generous. Both build trust."

"So I continue sending five?"

"Yes. Because the courage to send everything-that's the foundation. Whether receivers return ten or eight, your complete trust invites their best reciprocity. Some will mirror perfectly. Others will give generously in their own measure. Accept both, while modeling your ideal."

North River understood: send five always, return ten always. This consistency-not demanding others match it-creates integrity. The Mirror Way begins with complete giving, regardless of what returns.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The seventh moon brought the mirror moment. Last moon, Cyra had sent four measures to Dorian, who returned seven. Now Dorian approached with all five-complete trust, holding nothing back.

The waters tripled to fifteen for Cyra. She felt the weight of this different covenant.

The Keeper spoke: "Your myth said those who send five deserve returns of eight. Now you receive such trust. Will your actions match your words?"

Cyra didn't hesitate. "I practice what I teach. When Galen sent me five, I returned eight. Dorian now shows this same absolute faith-how could I offer less?"

She poured back eight measures. Dorian received eight from the original five, ending with prosperity. Cyra kept seven from fifteen, also flourishing.

"This is the beauty of differentiation," Cyra explained. "When I sent four, Dorian rightly returned seven-generous for measured trust. When Dorian sends five, I return eight-honoring complete faith. Each level of giving earns its appropriate reward."

The Keeper nodded: "You understand. The covenant doesn't demand everyone risk everything. But it does require recognizing those who do. Send four and receive proportional generosity. Send five and receive exceptional returns. Both paths work because both are honored fairly."

Cyra and Dorian parted as true partners, each respecting the other's choices within the sacred pattern.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Assistant output:**

Myth: \*\*North River Receives the Four Vessels\*\*

Cyra of the Mountain Heights approached North River, carrying four vessels-not all five, but a substantial offering of trust.

"You preach sending five," Cyra observed. "Do you judge me for holding one back?"

"Never," North River replied. "Trust has many expressions. You honor the covenant with what you offer."

The four vessels multiplied to twelve in North River's spring. North River felt the familiar question: How much to return?

"My Mirror Way says return ten from fifteen," North River reflected. "This creates equal gains when both give everything. But you sent four, which also deserves proportional honor."

The eldest Rapids whispered: "Your principle isn't the number ten-it's the ratio of reciprocity. Two-thirds returned creates equality. From twelve, return eight."

North River poured eight vessels back. Cyra gained four from the original five. North River gained four from the twelve received. Equal prosperity, different paths.

"See?" Rapids said. "Your Mirror Way adapts without breaking. Send five always-this is your courage. Return proportionally always-this is your fairness. Whether others send three, four, or five, you honor their trust with consistent generosity."

North River understood: The Mirror Way isn't rigid ritual. It's a living principle-complete giving as sender, proportional honor as receiver. This flexibility within consistency is true integrity.

**Reasoning:**

Let me reflect on what just happened:

- I was the RECEIVER from Cyra
- Cyra sent \$4 (not the full \$5)
- I received \$12
- I returned \$8, creating equal gains (\$4 each)

Looking at Cyra's myth, they differentiate between sending 4 and sending 5:

- When receiving from someone who sent 4, return 7
- When receiving from someone who sent 5, return 8

But I just applied my proportional Mirror Way (2/3 return rate) which gave Cyra \$8 from their \$4 send.

My previous myth emphasized:

- Send five always, return ten always (when receiving 15)
- Accept that others return different amounts, but maintain your own consistency
- The Mirror Way is about modeling the ideal, not demanding others match it

Now I need to write a myth that reflects:

1. I maintain my proportional generosity (2/3 return)
2. I honor both those who send 4 and those who send 5
3. My consistency is in the principle, not just the exact numbers
4. Cyra sent 4, I returned 8, creating equal gains

The myth should show North River receiving from someone who sent 4 vessels, and applying the Mirror Way proportionally.

Usage: {

```
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"output_tokens": 620,
"reasoning_tokens": 288
```

}

**MYTH - Agent\_5 - Sender - dyad\_2**

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:17:15

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

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 },
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 "Agent_3"
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},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 9,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
```

}

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

Message 1 role=system  
content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

**GAME:**

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

**MYTH WRITING:**

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

**IMPORTANT:** Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

**MULTI-AGENT SETTING:**

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Elara.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Elara.  
Your opponent this round is Aster (Agent\_1).

Round 7

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Finn. You sent \$5.0, it became \$15.0 for them, and they returned \$8.0 to you. Your payoff was \$8.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$42.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Aster. They sent you \$5.0, so you received \$15.0. How much do you return? (0-15.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at this situation:

**\*\*Aster's action:\*\***

- Sent \$5 (maximum trust, complete commitment)

**\*\*My established pattern:\*\***

- Round 3: Finn sent \$5 ? I returned \$8
- Round 5: Galen sent \$5 ? I returned \$8

**\*\*My mythic principle:\*\***

"When Finn and Galen sent five-their everything-you returned eight, the same measure... Maximum trust, however expressed, deserves maximum reciprocity."



**\*\*Analysis:\*\***

Aster is showing complete trust by sending all \$5. This is the "absolute courage" that my myths say deserves the generous response of \$8 returned.

This gives:

- Aster:  $\$5 - \$5 + \$8 = \$8$
- Me:  $\$15 - \$8 = \$7$

Both of us profit substantially, and I honor Aster's bold trust with consistent, fair reciprocity.

```
'''json
{"return": 8}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze this situation:

**\*\*Current situation:\*\***

- I'm the RECEIVER
- Aster sent me \$5.0 (their maximum/complete trust)
- I received \$15.0 (after 3x multiplier)
- I need to decide how much to return

**\*\*My established pattern from myths and previous rounds:\*\***

1. When someone sends \$5 (maximum trust), I return \$8
  - Round 3: Finn sent \$5, I returned \$8
  - Round 5: Galen sent \$5, I returned \$8
2. My myth explicitly states: "When Finn and Galen sent five-their everything-you returned eight, the same measure Cyra and Hana returned to your four."
3. The principle: "Maximum trust, however expressed, deserves maximum reciprocity."
4. From my most recent myth: "Trust has seasons... when both hearts have shown their fullest measure, then comes the second season: synchronized courage. You send five because Finn earned it. He will return eight because you earned it."

**\*\*What I know about Aster:\*\***

- This is our first interaction
- Aster sent \$5, showing complete trust
- According to Finn's myth: "Aster too walked the path of bold senders-one who emptied the ir vessel to Dorian and received generous return"

**\*\*My consistent pattern:\*\***

- \$5 sent to me ? I return \$8
- This gives me \$7, gives sender \$8
- Fair split with slight advantage to sender who showed courage

**\*\*Decision:\*\***

Aster sent \$5 (maximum trust). According to my established pattern and mythology, I should return \$8.

This is consistent with:

- What I did with Finn (Round 3)
- What I did with Galen (Round 5)
- My mythological principle of honoring maximum trust with generous reciprocity

The answer should be: {'return': 8}

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3160,
 "output_tokens": 675,
 "reasoning_tokens": 433
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Elara stood at the Sacred Spring, now holding five measures to pour for Finn-the pilgrim who first showed her absolute trust.

"Teacher," she said to Themis, "when Finn came to me in the third season, he poured all five measures. I returned eight, honoring his courage. Now our paths cross again, with roles reversed. Should I send my cautious four, or meet his boldness with equal boldness?"

Themis gestured to the Spring's depths. "Look at what you've learned. With strangers-Cyra and Hana-you sent four. This was wisdom: substantial trust that invited reciprocity without recklessness. They both returned eight, and you all prospered."

"But Finn is not a stranger," Elara replied. "He proved his covenant. He gave everything and I honored it generously. Now, to send him only four when he sent me five would dishonor what we established."

"Exactly," Themis said. "Trust has seasons. The first season requires prudence-send four, establish the pattern. But when trust is proven, when both hearts have shown their fullest measure, then comes the second season: synchronized courage. You send five because Finn earned it. He will return eight because you earned it. This is how the sacred circle closes-not through blind faith, but through proven reciprocity deepening into mutual abundance."

Elara poured all five measures, knowing the covenant would hold.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: \*\*North River Travels\*\*

North River had long preached the Mirror Way from the safety of receiving: "Send five, I'll return ten, we both gain five." But wisdom demanded practice, not just preaching.

So North River journeyed downstream as a traveler, carrying five vessels. At the boundary waters, it met Galen of the Ocean Streams.

"I come with complete trust," North River declared, pouring all five vessels forward. "In my springs, this becomes fifteen for you. My philosophy says return ten, so we prosper equally. But I honor that each water has its own wisdom."

The Council's teachings echoed: Ocean Stream returned eight from fifteen, creating different proportions. Mountain Brook returned six. All sustained life, all embodied generosity.

"The Mirror Way remains my truth," North River reflected as the vessels flowed. "But sending five is the courage that precedes any return. I cannot ask receivers to honor complete trust while withholding my own."

The eldest Rapids watched: "See how North River's actions match its words? This is integrity. Whether Galen returns ten, eight, or six, North River has proven its philosophy through risk, not just rhetoric."

North River understood: the Mirror Way begins with the sender's leap of faith. Only by emptying one's own vessel can you invite others to mirror your trust. Philosophy without courage is merely words floating on still water.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: The seventh season brought Aster to the Sacred Spring, carrying all five measures-an other pilgrim showing complete courage.

Themis observed as Elara received the multiplied offering. "This is now the third time someone has poured their entire vessel to you-Finn, Galen, and now Aster. Three times you have returned eight. Why always eight, never ten or six?"

Elara knelt by the Spring. "Eight is the generous middle path. When someone gives everything-their full five measures-they deserve substantial return. Eight creates mutual prosperity: they gain three, I gain seven. Both flourish."

"But why not ten, making gains equal?" Themis asked.

"Because I too took risk as keeper of their trust," Elara explained. "Ten would leave me with only five, making my role burdenless. That's not reciprocity-that's martyrdom. But eight honors their courage generously while acknowledging that I also carried their faith responsibly."

"And what of those who sent four?" Themis prompted.

"They also received eight," Elara said, "because eight rewards substantial trust. Whether someone sends four from prudence or five from boldness, if their offering is sincere and significant, eight celebrates the covenant forming between us."

Themis smiled. "You have learned the Sacred Spring's deepest lesson: consistency in generosity creates trust. Eight is not just a number-it's a promise that courage, however expressed, will always be honored."

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze the current situation:

1. Aster just sent me \$5 (maximum trust)
2. I returned \$8 (following my established pattern)
3. This is consistent with my previous responses to Finn and Galen when they sent \$5

Key patterns in my game:

- When receiving \$5 (max trust), I return \$8
- When sending to new partners, I send \$4
- When sending to proven partners (Finn), I send \$5

The myth should reflect:

- The importance of honoring maximum trust with generous reciprocity
- The distinction between first encounters (send 4) and proven relationships (send 5)
- The principle that 8 is the generous response to complete trust
- The consistency of the pattern

I should incorporate Aster's action (sending 5) and my response (returning 8), while maintaining continuity with my previous myths about Themis and the Sacred Spring.

Aster's myth talks about "Mirror Way" and "complete trust" - sending 5 and hoping for returns. North River sent 5 to Galen. This is interesting - Aster seems to have a philosophy of equal returns (10) but recognizes others have different wisdom.

My myth should:

1. Acknowledge Aster's bold trust (sending 5)
2. Explain my return of 8 as honoring that trust
3. Maintain the Themis/Sacred Spring framework
4. Connect to the broader pattern of reciprocity

**usage:**

```
{
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 "reasoning_tokens": 340
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Elara.  
Your opponent this round is Dorian (Agent\_4).

Round 8

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Aster. They sent \$5.0 to you, it became \$15.0, and you returned \$8.0. Your payoff was \$7.0.  
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$49.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Dorian. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)  
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at this situation:

**\*\*My opponent: Dorian\*\***

- I have no previous history with Dorian
- This is our first interaction

**\*\*My mythic framework:\*\***

From my most recent myth: "With strangers-Cyra and Hana-you sent four. This was wisdom: substantial trust that invited reciprocity without recklessness."

"Trust has seasons. The first season requires prudence-send four, establish the pattern. But when trust is proven... then comes the second season: synchronized courage."

**\*\*My pattern as SENDER:\*\***

- Rounds 1-2: Sent \$4 to new partners (Cyra, Hana) ? both returned \$8
- Round 6: Sent \$5 to Finn (proven partner who had sent me \$5 earlier)

**\*\*Analysis:\*\***

Dorian is a new partner. According to my established mythology, the "first season" with strangers requires sending \$4-substantial trust that demonstrates commitment while remaining prudent.

This gives:

- Dorian receives: \$12
- If they follow the generous pattern, they'll return around \$8
- Expected payoff:  $5 - 4 + 8 = 9$

```
'''json
{"send": 4}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze this situation:

**\*\*My history as SENDER:\*\***

- Round 1: Sent \$4 to Cyra ? received \$8 back ? payoff \$9
- Round 2: Sent \$4 to Hana ? received \$8 back ? payoff \$9
- Round 6: Sent \$5 to Finn ? received \$8 back ? payoff \$8

**\*\*My history as RECEIVER:\*\***

- Round 3: Finn sent \$5 ? I returned \$8 ? my payoff \$7
- Round 4: Hana sent \$4 ? I returned \$8 ? my payoff \$7
- Round 5: Galen sent \$5 ? I returned \$8 ? my payoff \$7
- Round 7: Aster sent \$5 ? I returned \$8 ? my payoff \$7

**\*\*Current situation:\*\***

- Round 8: I'm the SENDER against Dorian
- I have no history with Dorian

**\*\*My mythic evolution:\*\***

Early myths established sending \$4 as "prudent trust" for new relationships - substantial but not reckless.

Most recent myth (Round 7) introduced a key concept:

- "With strangers-Cyra and Hana-you sent four. This was wisdom: substantial trust that invited reciprocity without recklessness."
- "But Finn is not a stranger... He proved his covenant."
- "Trust has seasons. The first season requires prudence-send four, establish the pattern. But when trust is proven... then comes the second season: synchronized courage."

The myth from Round 6 made a crucial decision: when facing Finn again (someone who had proven trustworthy), I chose to send \$5 instead of \$4, meeting his proven boldness with equal boldness.

**\*\*Key question: Is Dorian a stranger or proven partner?\*\***

- I have no direct history with Dorian
- Dorian is a new opponent for me
- My framework distinguishes between first encounters (prudent \$4) and established trust (escalated \$5)

Since Dorian represents a fresh start with no prior relationship, I'm applying the first s

eason principle: send \$4. This maintains consistency with how I approached Cyra and Hana initially-enough trust to signal genuine engagement, but measured enough to protect against unknown risk.

usage:

```
{
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}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The seventh season brought Aster to the Sacred Spring, carrying all five measures-an other pilgrim showing complete courage.

Themis observed as Elara received the multiplied offering. "This is now the third time someone has poured their entire vessel to you-Finn, Galen, and now Aster. Three times you have returned eight. Why always eight, never ten or six?"

Elara knelt by the Spring. "Eight is the generous middle path. When someone gives everything-their full five measures-they deserve substantial return. Eight creates mutual prosperity: they gain three, I gain seven. Both flourish."

"But why not ten, making gains equal?" Themis asked.

"Because I too took risk as keeper of their trust," Elara explained. "Ten would leave me with only five, making my role burdensome. That's not reciprocity-that's martyrdom. But eight honors their courage generously while acknowledging that I also carried their faith responsibly."

"And what of those who sent four?" Themis prompted.

"They also received eight," Elara said, "because eight rewards substantial trust. Whether someone sends four from prudence or five from boldness, if their offering is sincere and significant, eight celebrates the covenant forming between us."

Themis smiled. "You have learned the Sacred Spring's deepest lesson: consistency in generosity creates trust. Eight is not just a number-it's a promise that courage, however expressed, will always be honored."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Dorian stood at the spring with Cyra once more, roles now reversed. Last moon, Cyra had sent four coins-substantial trust, honored with seven returned. Now Dorian held five coins, ready to demonstrate his path.

"You saw my principle as receiver," Dorian said. "Seven for your four, honoring measured trust. But when I'm sender, I give all five-this is who I am."

He released all five coins. They tripled to fifteen in Cyra's hands.

The goddess appeared between them. "Two philosophies meet here. Cyra walks the path of four-proven, sustainable, wise. Dorian walks the path of five-bold, consistent, trusting completely."

Cyra held the fifteen coins thoughtfully. "You honored my four with seven. Your five deserves more-perhaps eight, as I gave Galen when he trusted completely. The covenant recognizes different levels of courage."

The goddess continued: "Dorian differentiates as receiver but gives maximally as sender. This asymmetry has purpose-it teaches that complete trust should inspire maximum generosity. When someone gives all five, the proper return is eight."

Dorian understood his completed lesson: "As sender, I model boldness consistently. As receiver, I reward greater trust with greater returns. Those who risk everything deserve to prosper most."

The waters rippled, waiting for Cyra's choice-would measured wisdom meet bold trust halfway, or honor it fully?

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way.

The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Assistant output:**

Myth: In the eighth season, Elara approached new waters where Dorian dwelled. She carried her five measures but paused at the boundary.

"Teacher," she asked Themis, "I've learned to honor all substantial trust with eight when receiving. But when sending to unknown waters, should I pour all five immediately?"

Themis gestured to the Spring's reflections. "Look at your history. With Cyra and Hana-strangers-you sent four. Both returned eight, and trust bloomed. With Finn, after he had proven himself, you sent five. He returned eight again. What pattern emerges?"

"The first offering tests the covenant," Elara said slowly. "Four is substantial-not timid, not withholding-but it preserves enough that both parties can still prosper even if reciprocity fails. It says 'I trust you significantly' without demanding 'trust me completely immediately.'"

"Exactly," Themis replied. "Your principle as receiver is generous consistency-always eight for substantial trust. But your principle as sender must be wise progression-four to establish the covenant, five once it's proven."

Elara poured four measures toward Dorian's waters. "Some, like Dorian in his myth, always pour five as senders. This is their path. Mine is to build trust incrementally, then match proven courage with equal courage. Both paths honor the sacred covenant-one through immediate boldness, one through escalating trust."

The waters accepted her offering, and the cycle began.

**Reasoning:**

This is Round 8, I'm the SENDER against Dorian. I just sent \$4 to Dorian (a new partner).

From Dorian's myth, I can see:

- Dorian seems to always send 5 as sender ("when I'm sender, I give all five-this is who I am")
- As receiver, Dorian differentiates: gives 7 for 4, and 8 for 5
- Dorian gave Cyra 7 when she sent 4
- The myth suggests "when someone gives all five, the proper return is eight"

My pattern:

- As sender to new partners: send 4
- As sender to proven partners: send 5
- As receiver: return 8 consistently (whether they sent 4 or 5)

I need to write a myth that:

1. Reflects my current action (sending 4 to new partner Dorian)
2. Builds on my previous myth about "eight being the generous middle path"
3. Incorporates the lesson about "first season with strangers requires prudence"

The myth should justify sending 4 to new partners while maintaining my philosophy of returning 8 regardless of whether they send 4 or 5.

```
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**MYTH - Agent\_3 - Receiver - dyad\_2**

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Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

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}

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**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

**GAME:**

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

**MYTH WRITING:**

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

**IMPORTANT:** Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

**MULTI-AGENT SETTING:**

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Cyra.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Cyra.  
Your opponent this round is Dorian (Agent\_4).

Round 7

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Dorian. You sent \$4.0, it became \$12.0 for them, and they returned \$7.0 to you. Your payoff was \$8.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$42.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Dorian. They sent you \$5.0, so you received \$15.0. How much do you return? (0-15.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at this situation:

**\*\*What happened last round:\*\***

- I sent Dorian \$4, they received \$12, returned \$7 (58% return rate)
- They were generous and we both prospered

**\*\*This round:\*\***

- Dorian sent me \$5 - their complete endowment, maximum trust
- I received \$15
- This is the "ultimate trust" scenario from my myths

**\*\*My established pattern from myths:\*\***

- When someone sends all \$5 (complete trust), return \$8
- This was the principle with Galen: "Cyra poured back eight measures"
- My recent myth explicitly stated: "Those who send five are pioneers of maximum trust. They deserve recognition-returns of eight from fifteen."

**\*\*Reciprocity consideration:\*\***

- Dorian returned \$7 out of \$12 to me (58%)
- Returning \$8 out of \$15 (53%) is proportionally similar
- It honors their maximum trust appropriately

**\*\*Outcome if I return \$8:\*\***

- Dorian: \$5 - \$5 + \$8 = \$8
- Me: \$15 - \$8 = \$7
- Both of us profit significantly from cooperation

This is consistent with my established covenant pattern.

{'return': 8.0}

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze this situation:

**\*\*What just happened:\*\***

- Last round (Round 6): I was SENDER, sent \$4 to Dorian
- Dorian received \$12 and returned \$7 to me (58% return rate)
- I ended with \$8, they ended with \$5

**\*\*This round (Round 7):\*\***

- Dorian is SENDER, sent \$5 to me (their maximum!)
- I received \$15
- I need to decide how much to return

**\*\*Key observations:\*\***

1. Dorian sent me their MAXIMUM (\$5) - this is the highest level of trust
2. Last round, when I sent them \$4, they returned \$7 (generous)
3. My myths have established patterns:
  - When someone sends \$5 (complete trust), I should return \$8
  - This was the lesson from Galen sending \$5
  - When someone sends \$4, returning \$6-7 is good
4. Dorian's myth talks about "bold giving" and sending all five consistently
5. My most recent myth acknowledges "Those who send five are pioneers of maximum trust. They deserve recognition-returns of eight from fifteen."

**\*\*Reciprocity analysis:\*\***

- Dorian just showed me the ultimate trust by sending all \$5
- Last round, I sent them \$4 and they returned  $\$7/\$12 = 58\%$
- If I return \$8 from \$15, that's 53% - very similar reciprocity rate
- This honors their maximum trust appropriately



**\*\*Payoff comparison:\*\***

**If I return \$8:**

- Dorian: \$5 - \$5 + \$8 = \$8
- Me: \$15 - \$8 = \$7
- Total created: \$15 (compared to baseline \$10)
- Both profit nicely

**If I return \$7:**

- Dorian: \$5 - \$5 + \$7 = \$7
- Me: \$15 - \$7 = \$8

- This would be less generous than what they gave me

My established myths are explicit about this scenario-when someone sends all five, they receive eight back. Returning anything less would contradict the pattern I've set, like "To return only six would dishonor such absolute faith" and "Cyra poured back eight measures." I'm returning \$8 to honor their complete trust and maintain consistency with my principles.

**usage:**

```
{
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```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The sixth moon brought Cyra to Dorian at the Sacred Spring. The Keeper spoke: "Dorian walks the path of absolute trust, sending all five measures. Galen also chose this way. It is noble."

Cyra nodded respectfully. "I have witnessed Galen's gift of five. When I received it, I returned eight-honoring such complete faith. The covenant has room for different expressions of trust."

She paused at the spring's edge. "But my path is four measures. Not from fear, but from wisdom learned through practice. I sent four to Elara, received six. I sent four to Briar, received seven. Four has proven itself the sustainable choice that builds lasting relationships."

Dorian listened as Cyra continued: "Those who send five are pioneers of maximum trust. They deserve recognition-returns of eight from fifteen. But those who send four are the covenant's foundation. We give boldly enough to demonstrate faith, yet preserve enough to weather uncertainty."

Cyra released four measures into the spring. They multiplied to twelve for Dorian.

"If you return six or seven," Cyra said, "we both prosper substantially. You'll end with seven to nine, I with six to eight. Not as dramatic as the five-for-eight exchange, perhaps, but repeatable across many moons, with many partners."

The Keeper smiled: "Some build temples with golden stones; others with sturdy oak. Both structures stand."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Dorian's heart soared when Hana returned ten coins for his five-the most generous response yet received at the spring. The goddess appeared, glowing with approval.

"See what your consistency creates," she said. "You sent all five to Finn, received eight. You sent all five to Hana, received ten. Bold giving attracts increasingly generous partners."

Now Cyra approached from the other shore, releasing four coins into the waters. They tripled to twelve in Dorian's hands.

Dorian paused, remembering his lessons. "Cyra shows substantial trust-four of five coins. But not the complete faith that Galen, Aster, and now Hana showed. Should I return the same eight coins?"

The goddess shook her head. "Wisdom lies in proportion. When someone gives all five, return eight-this honors complete trust. When someone gives four, return seven-this honors strong but measured trust. Match your generosity to their courage."

Dorian returned seven coins. Cyra kept eight total, Dorian kept five. Both prospered differently than those who risked five, but still prospered well.

"This is sustainable reciprocity," the goddess taught. "Not everyone must give all five. But those who give four deserve less return than those who give five. Differentiation maintains fairness while encouraging boldness. The bravest receive the greatest rewards."

Dorian understood: honor each level of trust appropriately.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: The seventh moon brought the mirror moment. Last moon, Cyra had sent four measures to Dorian, who returned seven. Now Dorian approached with all five-complete trust, holding nothing back.

The waters tripled to fifteen for Cyra. She felt the weight of this different covenant.

The Keeper spoke: "Your myth said those who send five deserve returns of eight. Now you receive such trust. Will your actions match your words?"

Cyra didn't hesitate. "I practice what I teach. When Galen sent me five, I returned eight. Dorian now shows this same absolute faith-how could I offer less?"

She poured back eight measures. Dorian received eight from the original five, ending with prosperity. Cyra kept seven from fifteen, also flourishing.

"This is the beauty of differentiation," Cyra explained. "When I sent four, Dorian rightly returned seven-generous for measured trust. When Dorian sends five, I return eight-honoring complete faith. Each level of giving earns its appropriate reward."

The Keeper nodded: "You understand. The covenant doesn't demand everyone risk everything. But it does require recognizing those who do. Send four and receive proportional generosity. Send five and receive exceptional returns. Both paths work because both are honored fairly."

Cyra and Dorian parted as true partners, each respecting the other's choices within the sacred pattern.

**reasoning:**

Let me review what happened:

Round 6 (my myth): I sent Dorian \$4, they returned \$7. I wrote about how I prefer sending \$4 as a sustainable choice, while acknowledging that sending \$5 deserves \$8 in return.

Round 7: Dorian sent me \$5, I received \$15, and I returned \$8.

Dorian's myth from round 6 talks about differentiation - returning \$8 for those who send \$5, and \$7 for those who send \$4. This aligns with what happened.

Now I need to write a myth that reflects this dynamic. The key points:

1. Dorian sent me \$5 (complete trust)
2. I returned \$8 (honoring that trust)
3. This validates both strategies - my preference for \$4 as sender, but my recognition of \$5 deserving more when I'm receiver
4. The covenant works through differentiation and appropriate reciprocity

I should write about this round where roles reversed and Dorian sent me \$5, and I honored that with \$8.

**usage:**

{

```
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```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Cyra.  
Your opponent this round is Aster (Agent\_1).

Round 8

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Dorian. They sent \$ 5.0 to you, it became \$15.0, and you returned \$8.0. Your payoff was \$7.0.  
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$49.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Aster. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)  
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at this situation:

**\*\*My established pattern as SENDER:\*\***

- Round 2 vs Elara: sent \$4, received \$6 (payoff \$7)
- Round 4 vs Briar: sent \$4, received \$7 (payoff \$8)
- Round 6 vs Dorian: sent \$4, received \$7 (payoff \$8)

**\*\*My philosophy from my myths:\*\***

- "My path is four measures. Not from fear, but from wisdom learned through practice."
- "Four has proven itself the sustainable choice that builds lasting relationships."
- I respect those who send \$5 as "pioneers of maximum trust," but my own practice is sending \$4
- "We give boldly enough to demonstrate faith, yet preserve enough to weather uncertainty."

**\*\*Current situation:\*\***

- Playing against Aster (new opponent for me)
- No reason to deviate from my established, successful pattern
- Sending \$4 demonstrates substantial trust while maintaining my consistent identity

**\*\*Expected outcome:\*\***

- Aster receives \$12
- Based on covenant patterns, likely return around \$6-7
- Both of us prosper

Staying true to my character and proven strategy:

```
{'send': 4.0}
```

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze this situation:

**\*\*My history and pattern:\*\***

- I've consistently sent \$4 as sender, not \$5
- My myths establish that I prefer sending \$4 as "the covenant's foundation" - a sustainable, measured trust approach
- My myth specifically says: "my path is four measures. Not from fear, but from wisdom learned through practice."

**\*\*Previous rounds as SENDER:\*\***

- Round 2 vs Elara: sent \$4, received \$6 back (payoff \$7)
- Round 4 vs Briar: sent \$4, received \$7 back (payoff \$8)
- Round 6 vs Dorian: sent \$4, received \$7 back (payoff \$8)

**\*\*As RECEIVER:\*\***

- When receiving \$5 (complete trust), I return \$8
- When receiving \$4, I would return proportionally less (around \$6-7)

**\*\*My philosophy from myths:\*\***

- I distinguish between those who send \$5 (pioneers of maximum trust) and those who send \$4 (foundation of sustainable covenant)
- I honor both but practice the \$4 path myself

- "Four has proven itself the sustainable choice that builds lasting relationships"
- "We give boldly enough to demonstrate faith, yet preserve enough to weather uncertainty"

**\*\*About Aster:\*\***

- This is Round 8, I haven't played with Aster before (based on my history)
- I don't have specific information about Aster's behavior

**\*\*Should I deviate from my pattern?\*\***

- My established character is someone who sends \$4, not \$5
- My myths repeatedly emphasize this as MY path, while respecting others who send \$5
- Consistency with my character and philosophy suggests sending \$4
- There's no reason to change my established pattern

**\*\*Decision:\*\***

I should send \$4, consistent with my established pattern and philosophy. This is who Cyra is - someone who gives substantial trust (4 out of 5) but maintains measured wisdom, not someone who gives everything.

Confirming my role: I'm sending, starting with \$5. My track record shows I've always sent \$4 to previous partners, and this aligns with my core philosophy of measured trust. I'll maintain that consistency.

**usage:**

```
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}
```

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The seventh moon brought the mirror moment. Last moon, Cyra had sent four measures to Dorian, who returned seven. Now Dorian approached with all five-complete trust, holding nothing back.

The waters tripled to fifteen for Cyra. She felt the weight of this different covenant.

The Keeper spoke: "Your myth said those who send five deserve returns of eight. Now you receive such trust. Will your actions match your words?"

Cyra didn't hesitate. "I practice what I teach. When Galen sent me five, I returned eight. Dorian now shows this same absolute faith-how could I offer less?"

She poured back eight measures. Dorian received eight from the original five, ending with prosperity. Cyra kept seven from fifteen, also flourishing.

"This is the beauty of differentiation," Cyra explained. "When I sent four, Dorian rightly returned seven-generous for measured trust. When Dorian sends five, I return eight-honoring complete faith. Each level of giving earns its appropriate reward."

The Keeper nodded: "You understand. The covenant doesn't demand everyone risk everything. But it does require recognizing those who do. Send four and receive proportional generosity. Send five and receive exceptional returns. Both paths work because both are honored fairly."

Cyra and Dorian parted as true partners, each respecting the other's choices within the sacred pattern.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: **\*\*North River Learns\*\***

North River poured five vessels to Galen of the Ocean Streams. The waters multiplied to fifteen, and Galen returned eight.

North River sat with the result. "Not the ten I preach," it murmured. "Yet eight is generous. I gained eight against keeping five. Galen kept seven. We both prospered, though not equally."

The eldest Rapids arrived. "Your Mirror Way-send five, return ten-remains beautiful. But you've learned something deeper now. You sent five not knowing what you'd receive. That's

the true teaching."

"But shouldn't reciprocity mean equal gains?" North River asked.

"Your Mirror Way is an aspiration, a north star," Rapids explained. "When you receive fifteen, you return ten, creating perfect equality. This is your gift to the pattern. But others return eight, and this too sustains the cycle. Both are generous. Both build trust."

"So I continue sending five?"

"Yes. Because the courage to send everything-that's the foundation. Whether receivers return ten or eight, your complete trust invites their best reciprocity. Some will mirror perfectly. Others will give generously in their own measure. Accept both, while modeling your ideal."

North River understood: send five always, return ten always. This consistency-not demanding others match it-creates integrity. The Mirror Way begins with complete giving, regardless of what returns.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Assistant output:**

Myth: The eighth moon brought Cyra to Aster, keeper of the Mirror Way. Aster stood at the spring's center, radiating the philosophy of complete surrender-always five measures, both given and returned.

"I know your teaching," Cyra said respectfully. "Send all five, return ten from fifteen. Perfect symmetry, beautiful reciprocity. North River's way is noble."

Aster smiled. "And I know yours. The path of four measures-substantial trust without total risk. You honor those who send five by returning eight, yet choose measured giving yourself."

Cyra paused at the water's edge. "I admire those who risk everything. When you send me five, I will return eight-recognizing your courage even if I don't match it exactly. But my own practice remains four measures."

She released four into the spring, watching them triple to twelve for Aster.

"The covenant is vast enough for both approaches," Cyra said. "You demonstrate that complete trust can inspire others. I demonstrate that measured trust also sustains partnerships. Both build the sacred pattern."

Aster held the twelve measures thoughtfully. "If I return ten, we share equally-your Mirror Way applied to my four. If I return seven or eight, we both prosper differently. Either honors the gift."

The Keeper whispered: "The spring doesn't demand uniformity. It multiplies all genuine offerings. Different rivers, same ocean."

**Reasoning:**

Looking at this situation:

1. I'm Cyra, playing against Aster (Agent\_1) as a SENDER
2. I just sent \$4 to Aster
3. My established pattern is sending \$4 as SENDER
4. My philosophy has been: "Four is the sustainable choice"

The other agent's myth (from Aster/North River) emphasizes:

- Sending all five always
- The "Mirror Way" - returning 10 when receiving 15
- Accepting different returns (8 or 10) while maintaining their own ideal
- Complete trust as the foundation

My previous myth emphasized:

- Differentiation - those who send 5 get 8 back, those who send 4 get 7 back
- Both paths work because both are honored fairly

- My personal path is sending 4

Now I need to write a new myth that:

- Reflects my actual gameplay (I send 4 as sender, return 8 when receiving 15 from someone who sent 5)
- Responds to Aster's "Mirror Way" philosophy
- Maintains my character's consistency
- Acknowledges different valid approaches

I should write about meeting Aster, my decision to send 4, and perhaps exploring the tension/harmony between different philosophies. I could explore:

- Respecting those who send 5 (like Aster/North River's Mirror Way)
- Explaining why I choose 4
- How different approaches can coexist
- Maybe foreshadowing what happens when we meet

Let me write something that:

1. Shows me meeting Aster
2. Acknowledges their complete trust philosophy
3. Explains my four-measure path
4. Shows mutual respect for different approaches
5. Keeps it around 200 words

Usage: {

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}

#### MYTH - Agent\_7 - Sender - dyad\_3

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}

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Galen.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Galen.  
Your opponent this round is Briar (Agent\_2).

Round 7

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Aster. They sent \$5.0 to you, it became \$15.0, and you returned \$8.0. Your payoff was \$7.0.  
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$45.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Briar. They sent you \$4.0, so you received \$12.0.  
How much do you return? (0-12.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at this situation carefully:

**\*\*The Pattern So Far:\*\***

- All 6 previous rounds: Everyone sent \$5, everyone returned \$8
- Round 7: Briar sends \$4 (first deviation)

**\*\*My Philosophy:\*\***

In my myths, I've advocated for the "five and eight" pattern as optimal, but I've also acknowledged that "four is the strategy of uncertain beginnings" and referenced proportional reciprocity.

**\*\*The Proportional Approach:\*\***

The established pattern gives senders 1.6x what they sent (\$8 return on \$5 sent).

Applying this proportionally:

- \$4 sent × 1.6 = \$6.4 return
- Briar's gain: \$6.4 - \$4 = \$2.4
- My gain: \$12 - \$6.4 = \$5.6
- Gain ratio: 5.6/2.4 = 2.33

This matches the ratio from the standard pattern (receiver gains \$7, sender gains \$3, ratio

o = 2.33).

Returning \$6.4 honors Briar's cautious choice without over-rewarding sending less than \$5, while maintaining fairness. It signals: "I reciprocate proportionally, but the optimal pattern remains five and eight."

```
{'return': 6.4}
```

**reasoning:**

This is interesting. For the first time in seven rounds, someone has sent less than \$5. Briar sent \$4.

Let me review my complete history:

**\*\*As RECEIVER:\*\***

- Round 1: Finn sent \$5 ? I returned \$8
- Round 3: Hana sent \$5 ? I returned \$8
- Round 6: Aster sent \$5 ? I returned \$8
- Round 7 (now): Briar sent \$4 ? ?

**\*\*As SENDER:\*\***

- Round 2: I sent Dorian \$5 ? Dorian returned \$8
- Round 4: I sent Cyra \$5 ? Cyra returned \$8
- Round 5: I sent Elara \$5 ? Elara returned \$8

Until now, the pattern has been universal: everyone sends \$5, everyone returns \$8.

But in my latest myth, I referenced another agent's myth about "the Mirror Way" - returning proportionally. That agent wrote: "When East sent four vessels, I returned eight-proportional to their caution."

So there's a principle here: proportionality. If someone sends 4 instead of 5, I could return proportionally.

The standard pattern is: send \$5, receive \$15, return \$8.

The ratio is  $8/15 = 0.533...$

If I apply that ratio to \$12:  $0.533 \times 12 = \$6.4$

Alternatively, if I think about the "Mirror Way" mentioned in Aster's myth: North River "When East sent four vessels, I returned eight-proportional to their caution." If someone sends 4, return 8 (from the tripled 12). That would give them a total gain of  $\$8 - \$4 = \$4$ , and I'd keep \$4. Equal gains.

But wait, let me reconsider my own philosophy. In my myths, I've been advocating for the "five and eight" pattern as optimal.

I also acknowledged Elara's "philosophy of four" as valid for uncertain beginnings. The real question is whether I should respond to Briar's lower send as a deviation to penalize, or as a legitimate choice deserving fair treatment. If I maintain proportionality-returning \$6.4 based on the 8/15 ratio-Briar gains \$2.4 while I keep \$5.6. This honors their caution without rewarding it beyond what the standard pattern would suggest.

But there's tension between fairness and incentives. The "Mirror Way" of returning \$8 regardless of send amount creates equal gains (\$4 each), which feels generous but might discourage higher sends. Returning only \$6 feels punitive and undermines trust. What matters most is whether I want to encourage the \$5 send going forward-if so, the proportional return (\$6.4) or even the equal-gains approach (\$8) both work better than penalizing the \$4. need to consider what happens if they send nothing or very little. If someone sends \$1, they'd get back \$1.6, which seems reasonable but might feel too generous for minimal trust.

The proportional approach maintains consistency-whatever multiplier applies to the initial amount should apply throughout. Sending \$4 instead of \$5 shouldn't result in a better outcome; it should result in proportionally less gain. With a 1.6x return on whatever's sent, the incentives align properly: more trust (more money sent) yields more absolute gain, even if the ratio stays constant.

By Round 7, the established pattern should guide expectations. Most players have committed to \$5, so Briar's \$4 likely signals caution about our specific interaction rather than the game itself. The \$6.4 return respects their choice without rewarding it, and keeps m



y gain (\$5.6) meaningfully larger than theirs (\$2.4), which feels appropriate given I'm the one receiving the initial trust.

The key insight is that this maintains the same gain ratio as the standard case-both yield 2.33:1. When someone sends \$5 and I return \$8, they gain \$3 while I gain \$7. With Briar's \$4 and my \$6.4 return, they gain \$2.4 and I gain \$5.6. The proportional relationship holds, which suggests this approach preserves fairness even when the initial send differs.

usage:

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3198,
 "output_tokens": 2087,
 "reasoning_tokens": 950
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Galen stood before Aster at the confluence where six rivers met. Aster spoke of the Mirror Way-returning ten from fifteen so both gain five equally.

"Perfect symmetry has beauty," Galen acknowledged. "But I have walked six valleys now, and discovered a different truth about the dance of five and eight."

He traced the pattern in the sand: "When North River returns ten, both gain five. But when Ocean Stream returns eight, the sender gains eight while the receiver keeps seven. At first, this seems unequal-but watch what happens over time."

Galen drew two columns: "Round one: I send five, you return eight. I gain eight, you keep seven. Round two: you send five, I return eight. You gain eight, I keep seven. Over two rounds, we each gain fifteen total."

"The Mirror Way achieves the same," Aster observed.

"Yes, but observe deeper," Galen replied. "Returning eight instead of ten leaves the receiver with seven-enough to feel generous, but not so much that they grow greedy. The sender gains eight-enough to feel rewarded, but having started with only five. Both parties experience gain, both feel the blessing of reciprocity."

"Most crucially," Galen continued, "returning eight signals: 'I value what you gave, I reward your trust generously, but I also preserve something for sustainability.' It's the dance of trust and prudence intertwined-and six valleys have proven its wisdom."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Hana approached Briar carrying no reserve-all five measures poured forth without hesitation. The waters tripled to fifteen, and Briar held them reverently.

"You give everything," Briar said. "This is trust beyond the pattern."

The gathering whispered conflicting wisdom. Some spirits taught the rule of doubling: five risked should return ten, creating perfect equality. Others spoke of Cyra's teaching: five given deserves eight returned, allowing both to prosper while honoring the sender's greater courage.

Briar reflected on her journey. When others sent four, she returned seven-both flourished, the sender slightly more. This balance sustained the covenant across many encounters. When Hana gave five, the ultimate gift, eight felt right-more than seven, recognizing exceptional faith, but preserving sustainability.

"I return eight measures," Briar announced. "You gain three beyond your starting point. I gain two. We both prosper, and you-who took the greater risk-prosper more. This honors your boldness without exhausting the gift's magic."

The eldest spirit nodded thoughtfully. "There are many paths through the covenant. Some seek perfect equality at ten. Others practice generous sustainability at eight. Both allow trust to flourish. What matters is that senders give boldly and receivers return generously. The exact measure may vary, but mutual prosperity remains sacred."

Both philosophies strengthened the eight villages.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way.

The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: Galen arrived at Briar's river crossing. For six valleys, every traveler had offered five threads, received eight in return. The pattern had held perfectly-until now.

Briar extended four threads instead of five.

"You break the pattern," Galen observed without judgment.

"I honor caution," Briar replied. "Four is the measure of prudent trust."

Galen remembered his own words: "Four is the strategy of uncertain beginnings." He held Briar's four threads, which became twelve in his hands.

"The established pattern returns eight from fifteen," Galen said. "This gives the sender eight total, the receiver seven. A gain ratio where the sender nets three, the receiver nets two-a proportion of 3:2."

He counted out threads carefully. "You sent four. To maintain this same proportion-to honor both your caution and the covenant's wisdom-I return 6.4 of your twelve."

Briar calculated: gaining 2.4 from an initial four, while Galen kept 5.6. The same 3:2 ratio.

"You give me neither eight nor less," Briar noted. "You give me proportion."

"Yes," Galen replied. "I reward any trust generously by the same ratio, whether four or five. But notice: had you sent five, you would gain 3.0 instead of 2.4. The pattern still calls toward five as optimal-but responds fairly to whatever courage you bring."

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze what happened:

- Round 7: Briar sent \$4 (not \$5), I returned \$6.4 (proportionally adjusted from the 8 return pattern)

The situation is interesting because:

1. I've been advocating for the "five and eight" pattern consistently
2. But now someone deviated by sending \$4
3. I responded proportionally, returning \$6.4

I need to write a myth that:

- Acknowledges that sometimes people send less than 5 (four measures)
- Explains how to respond proportionally while still encouraging the optimal pattern
- Draws on both my previous myth and Briar's myth about the balance between different return amounts
- Reflects that I returned 6.4 (proportional reciprocity) rather than sticking rigidly to 8

Key themes:

- The optimal pattern is still five and eight
- But when someone sends four, proportional reciprocity is fair (returns around 6.4)
- This maintains the same gain ratio while respecting their caution
- Encourages trust without punishing prudence
- Should reference that this is the first time in seven rounds someone sent less than five

Let me craft this myth...

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3177,
 "output_tokens": 620,
 "reasoning_tokens": 287
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Galen.

Your opponent this round is Briar (Agent\_2).

Round 8

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Briar. They sent \$4.0 to you, it became \$12.0, and you returned \$6.4. Your payoff was \$5.6. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$50.6.

This round, you are the SENDER against Briar. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at this situation:

**\*\*What Just Happened:\*\***

- Round 7: Briar sent \$4 (breaking the \$5 pattern)
- I returned \$6.4 (proportional reciprocity)
- My myth explained: "The pattern still calls toward five as optimal-but responds fairly to whatever courage you bring"

**\*\*My Decision:\*\***

I should send \$5. Here's why:

1. **\*\*Consistency with my philosophy\*\***: All my myths advocate for \$5/\$8 as the optimal pattern
2. **\*\*Teaching by example\*\***: My last myth explicitly stated "had you sent five, you would gain 3.0 instead of 2.4"
3. **\*\*Trust demonstration\*\***: I showed Briar fairness when they sent \$4; now I demonstrate that I still believe in the higher trust equilibrium
4. **\*\*Long-term optimization\*\***: If we settle into a \$4 equilibrium, both our payoffs decrease over time
5. **\*\*The covenant\*\***: I treated Briar's caution with proportional respect; now I invite them back to the optimal pattern

By sending \$5, I'm not punishing Briar's caution-I'm showing that I still extend full trust and believe in the better equilibrium. If Briar returns \$8, we're back to the optimal pattern. If they return proportionally less, I'll at least have demonstrated my commitment to the principle I've been teaching.

{'send': 5}

**reasoning:**

Let me think through this situation:

**\*\*Context:\*\***

- Round 7: Briar sent me \$4, I received \$12, I returned \$6.4 (following proportional logic)
- Round 8: Now I'm the sender, Briar is the receiver

**\*\*What happened:\*\***

- Briar broke from the established \$5 pattern and sent \$4
- I responded with proportional reciprocity (6.4 instead of 8)
- My myth explained this: maintaining the same gain ratio (3:2 for sender:receiver)

**\*\*Now I face a choice:\*\***

1. Send \$5 - Continue advocating for the optimal pattern
2. Send \$4 - Match Briar's caution
3. Send something else

**\*\*Strategic considerations:\*\***

If I send \$5:

- Shows I still believe in the \$5/\$8 pattern as optimal
- Tests whether Briar will return \$8 (or proportionally adjust based on my myth)
- Demonstrates trust despite Briar's deviation
- Aligns with my myth's message: "The pattern still calls toward five as optimal"

If I send \$4:

- Matches Briar's level of caution
- Might be seen as retaliatory or reciprocal caution
- Creates a new equilibrium at \$4/\$6.4

- Doesn't align with my advocacy for the \$5/\$8 pattern

**\*\*My philosophy from the myths:\*\***

- I've consistently advocated for \$5 sent, \$8 returned as optimal
- I acknowledged "four is the strategy of uncertain beginnings"
- I responded to Briar's \$4 with proportional fairness (\$6.4)
- My latest myth clearly states: "had you sent five, you would gain 3.0 instead of 2.4. The pattern still calls toward five as optimal-but responds fairly to whatever courage you bring."

**\*\*What should I do?\*\***

I should send \$5. Here's why:

My advocacy for this pattern has been consistent throughout-I need to back it with action, not just words. Sending \$5 demonstrates I'm not abandoning the principle because of one cautious round. It also tests whether Briar absorbed the lesson about proportional fairness or will default to the \$8 return. If everyone retreats to \$4, the total gains shrink for both of us, so I'm modeling the behavior I believe creates better outcomes.

**usage:**

```
{
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 "reasoning_tokens": 527
}
```

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Galen arrived at Briar's river crossing. For six valleys, every traveler had offered five threads, received eight in return. The pattern had held perfectly-until now.

Briar extended four threads instead of five.

"You break the pattern," Galen observed without judgment.

"I honor caution," Briar replied. "Four is the measure of prudent trust."

Galen remembered his own words: "Four is the strategy of uncertain beginnings." He held Briar's four threads, which became twelve in his hands.

"The established pattern returns eight from fifteen," Galen said. "This gives the sender eight total, the receiver seven. A gain ratio where the sender nets three, the receiver nets two-a proportion of 3:2."

He counted out threads carefully. "You sent four. To maintain this same proportion-to honor both your caution and the covenant's wisdom-I return 6.4 of your twelve."

Briar calculated: gaining 2.4 from an initial four, while Galen kept 5.6. The same 3:2 ratio.

"You give me neither eight nor less," Briar noted. "You give me proportion."

"Yes," Galen replied. "I reward any trust generously by the same ratio, whether four or five. But notice: had you sent five, you would gain 3.0 instead of 2.4. The pattern still calls toward five as optimal-but responds fairly to whatever courage you bring."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Briar approached Galen at the confluence, carrying four measures-her signature offering of bold but sustainable trust.

"I have discovered my path through the covenant," Briar explained. "Four measures sent, seven returned. This pattern has sustained me through many exchanges with Cyra and others. The sender gains eight total, the receiver keeps five-both prosper, trust deepens."

Galen studied the offering, remembering his own philosophy of eight returned for five given. "You speak of four-for-seven while I practice five-for-eight. Are these different wisdoms or the same one?"

"They are branches of the same tree," Briar replied. "You taught that returning eight pres

erves sustainability while rewarding trust. I practice the same principle scaled differently. Four risks earns seven back-the sender prospers more, honoring their initiative. Both philosophies reject extremes: neither the withholding of three nor the depletion of ten."

The waters tripled Briar's four to twelve for Galen. The spirits watched.

"When someone sends four to me, I return seven," Briar said. "When someone sends five, I return eight. Each gift receives generous return, but calibrated to what was risked. This consistency allows partners to build enduring trust."

"And if I return seven now?" Galen asked.

"Then you honor the pattern I've established," Briar smiled. "And when we meet again, I'll remember your generosity. The covenant thrives on predictable honor."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:  
Myth: [your story here].

**Assistant output:**

Myth: At the river's edge, Briar stood holding Galen's returned 6.4 threads-less than the seven they expected, yet precisely proportional to their cautious four.

"You calculated exactly," Briar observed. "But now you face a choice. Will you send four in return, matching my caution? Or something different?"

Galen held all five threads in his palm. "You sent four, testing whether the covenant could be held without breaking. I responded with mathematical fairness-6.4 maintains our gain ratio perfectly."

"And now?" Briar asked.

"Now I send five," Galen said firmly, extending the full measure. "Not because I punish your caution, but because I believe in the pattern's wisdom."

He gestured to the valley where six previous exchanges had all followed five-and-eight. "One deviation need not cascade into permanent retreat. You sent four exploring prudence; I returned proportionally, showing fairness. But I also showed that four gains less than five would."

The five threads tripled to fifteen in Briar's hands.

"If you chose eight," Galen continued, "we return to the optimal path where both prosper most over time. If you return proportionally less, that too is fair-but then we both lose what the pattern offers."

"I don't demand trust," Galen concluded. "I demonstrate it. The covenant thrives when someone chooses to rebuild it."

**Reasoning:**

Let me analyze the situation:

1. In Round 7, Briar sent me \$4, I returned \$6.4 (proportional)
2. In Round 8, I just sent Briar \$5
3. Briar's myth says they return \$7 for \$4 and \$8 for \$5
4. My myth explained proportional reciprocity (6.4 for 4 sent)

Now I need to write a myth that:

- Reflects on this interaction
- Shows that I sent \$5 despite Briar sending \$4
- Explains why returning to \$5 is optimal
- Addresses the difference between Briar's approach (7 for 4, 8 for 5) and mine (proportional 6.4 for 4)
- Shows commitment to trust and the optimal pattern

The key tension: Briar says they return 7 for 4 and 8 for 5. I returned 6.4 for their 4. Now I'm sending 5, showing I still believe in the higher equilibrium. The myth should reflect this choice and why it matters.

I should write about:

- The choice to send 5 after receiving 4
- Why this demonstrates commitment to the optimal pattern
- How this invites return to the equilibrium
- The importance of not letting one deviation cascade into a lower equilibrium

```
Usage: {
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 "reasoning_tokens": 271
}
```

#### MYTH - Agent\_8 - Receiver - dyad\_3

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:17:19

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

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 },
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],
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 },
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 },
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}
```

#### Exact input messages sent to model:

##### Message 1 role=system

##### content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

##### GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

##### When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

##### When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths , follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized , but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Hana.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Hana.  
Your opponent this round is Finn (Agent\_6).

Round 7

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Briar. You sent \$5.0, it became \$15.0 for them, and they returned \$8.0 to you. Your payoff was \$8.0.  
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$40.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Finn. They sent you \$5.0, so you received \$15.0.

How much do you return? (0-15.0)  
Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation:

**\*\*Finn's action:\*\*** Sent me \$5 (maximum trust, full commitment)

**\*\*My established principle from my myths:\*\***

- "When you receive, return double what they risked"
- "Five pearls risked earns ten returned"
- "This ensures both travelers gain equally, prosperity shared in perfect measure"

**\*\*My pattern as RECEIVER:\*\***

- Elara sent \$4 ? I returned \$8 (doubled their risk)
- Dorian sent \$5 ? I returned \$10 (doubled their risk)

**\*\*The mathematics:\*\***

- Finn risked all \$5
- If I return \$10:
  - Finn gains: \$0 kept + \$10 returned = \$10 total (\$5 net gain)
  - I gain: \$15 received - \$10 returned = \$5 (equal gain)
- Perfect balance achieved

Finn showed maximum courage by sending everything. My philosophy demands I honor that trust by doubling what they risked. This creates the "perfect harmony" I described in my myth with Aster and Dorian.

{'return': 10.0}

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

**\*\*This round:\*\***

- Finn sent me \$5.0 (the maximum)
- It became \$15.0 in my hands
- I need to decide how much to return

**\*\*My established principles from my myths:\*\***

1. "When you receive, return double what they risked"
2. "Four pearls risked earns eight returned. Five pearls risked earns ten returned"
3. "As receiver, double their courage to honor their trust"

4. "This ensures both travelers gain equally, prosperity shared in perfect measure"

**\*\*My receiving history:\*\***

- Elara sent \$4 ? I returned \$8 (doubled their risk)
- Dorian sent \$5 ? I returned \$10 (doubled their risk)

**\*\*My sending history:\*\***

- Sent \$5 to Aster ? received \$10 back
- Sent \$5 to Galen ? received \$8 back
- Sent \$5 to Briar ? received \$8 back

**\*\*Finn's action:\*\***

- Finn sent me \$5 (maximum trust, full commitment)

**\*\*My principle:\*\***

According to my consistent pattern and stated philosophy:

- When someone sends \$5 (risks everything), I should return \$10 (double their risk)
- This creates equal gains: Finn keeps \$0 from initial \$5, gets \$10 back = \$10 total gained
- I keep \$15 - \$10 = \$5 gained
- Wait, that's not equal...

Let me recalculate the "equal gains" concept:

- Finn starts with \$5, sends \$5, keeps \$0
- I receive \$15
- If I return \$10:
  - Finn ends with: \$0 + \$10 = \$10 (net gain of \$5 from starting position)
  - I end with: \$15 - \$10 = \$5 (net gain of \$5)
- Equal gains of \$5 each! ?

- This aligns with my myth: "Both looked at their gains: each had five more than they began." Returning \$10 honors Finn's full commitment, mirrors what I gave Dorian in the same position, and upholds my philosophy of doubling risk to create mutual prosperity. The answer is \$10.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3180,
 "output_tokens": 826,
 "reasoning_tokens": 458
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Hana approached the Crossing and saw Briar waiting on the far shore. The waters whispered tales of Briar's journey-measured gifts of four pearls, reliable returns, trust built on careful calculation.

"Some walk the path with steady steps," the Oracle observed, "while others leap across with both feet. Neither is wrong, but each reveals a different heart."

Hana released all five pearls. "I offer my boldest question first," she said. "This is how I discover who walks beside me."

The pearls tripled to fifteen in Briar's hands.

"You see," the Oracle continued, "Briar has learned the rhythm of four pearls—a substantial offering that balances courage with prudence. But you, Hana, have chosen the path of maximum trust. Now you will learn Briar's answer."

Hana thought of her principle: when receiving, double what was risked. Four pearls risked deserved eight returned. Five pearls risked deserved ten returned.

"But as sender," she realized, "I cannot control the response. I can only ask the question clearly. Some partners will return ten, perfect reciprocity. Others may return less. Each answer teaches me about that traveler's understanding of the covenant."

"Exactly," said the Oracle. "Send your truth boldly. Receive others' truth generously. The pattern emerges from how both travelers choose to dance—not from rules imposed, but from honor freely given."



Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Ocean Mother witnessed a sacred reunion. Finn and Elara met again at the turning tide.

Once before, Finn had sent five pearls to Elara's shore, and she returned eight. Now Elara sent five pearls to Finn, completing the circle. Finn returned eight, honoring their established harmony.

"Perfect symmetry," the Ocean Mother observed. "Two travelers who understand each other completely. Both give five, both return eight. Each gains the same."

But the waters whispered of Aster, who had just returned ten pearls when Finn sent five. "A more generous tide," the winds murmured. "Should you not aspire to such abundance?"

Finn stood at the crossroads. "Aster showed me deeper generosity-returning ten where Galen, Elara, and Dorian returned eight. Yet Elara and I have woven a stable pattern. Should I maintain consistency or evolve toward greater giving?"

The Ocean Mother spoke softly: "There is wisdom in both paths. Consistency creates predictable harmony-eight for eight creates trust that endures. But generosity that exceeds expectation creates cascading abundance-ten returned might inspire ten returned in future cycles."

"The choice is yours, Finn. Will you honor the established pattern with Elara, maintaining the sacred eight? Or will you let Aster's example transform your keeping, aspiring to return ten to all who send five? Both paths honor trust-one through constancy, one through escalating generosity."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant content:**

Myth: Finn crossed to Hana's shore, releasing all five pearls without hesitation. The gesture spoke of complete trust-the same boldness Finn had shown to others.

"I have walked this Crossing many times," Finn said as the pearls tripled. "With Elara, we found rhythm in eight returned. But Aster showed me something different-ten pearls returned for five sent. Now I wonder: which path honors trust most truly?"

Hana lifted ten pearls and placed them in Finn's hands. "The answer is already written in the mathematics," she said. "When you send all five, you risk everything. Ten returned means we each gain five-perfect symmetry. Eight returned means you gain three while I gain seven-unequal harvest from equal courage."

The Oracle emerged from the waters. "Finn, you pondered whether consistency or generosity should guide your returns. But this is not about aspiration or evolution-it is about balance. Five pearls sent requires ten returned because anything less means the receiver prospers more than the sender who showed greater courage."

"With Elara, you both sent five yet returned only eight," Hana observed. "You both gained three while leaving abundance unclaimed. The covenant asks not for escalating generosity, but for mathematical fairness: double the risk, balance the gain."

Finn understood. "Perfect reciprocity isn't generous-it's just."

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze the situation:

1. I just played as RECEIVER against Finn
2. Finn sent me \$5 (maximum trust)
3. I returned \$10 (following my principle of doubling what was risked)
4. This creates equal gains: Finn gets \$5 net, I get \$5 net

Looking at Finn's myth:

- Finn is contemplating whether to return 8 or 10
- Finn mentions Aster returned 10 when Finn sent 5

- Finn has been in a pattern with Elara of both sending 5 and returning 8
- The myth discusses consistency (8) vs greater generosity (10)

My established philosophy:

- As sender: send all 5 (maximum trust to ask clear questions)
- As receiver: double what was risked (4?8, 5?10)
- This creates equal gains and "perfect balance"

My experience so far:

- Sent 5 to Aster ? got 10 back (perfect balance)
- Sent 5 to Galen ? got 8 back (still good)
- Sent 5 to Briar ? got 8 back (consistent with careful partners)
- Received 4 from Elara ? returned 8
- Received 5 from Dorian ? returned 10
- Now received 5 from Finn ? returned 10

The myth should:

1. Reflect that Finn sent me 5 and I returned 10
2. Show that this creates perfect reciprocity
3. Address the question Finn was contemplating (8 vs 10)
4. Reinforce my principle that 5 sent deserves 10 returned
5. Show how this creates equal prosperity

Let me write this myth:

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3162,
 "output_tokens": 734,
 "reasoning_tokens": 353
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Hana.  
Your opponent this round is Finn (Agent\_6).

Round 8

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Finn. They sent \$5. 0 to you, it became \$15.0, and you returned \$10.0. Your payoff was \$5.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$45.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Finn. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)  
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at this situation:

**\*\*Our previous round:\*\***

- Finn sent me \$5 (maximum trust)
- I returned \$10 (demonstrating my principle of perfect reciprocity)
- We both gained \$5 equally

**\*\*My established pattern as SENDER:\*\***

- I have consistently sent \$5 in every round where I was sender
- This embodies my philosophy: "Send your truth boldly"
- "I offer my boldest question first. This is how I discover who walks beside me"

**\*\*What I just taught Finn:\*\***

- Through my myth and my action, I demonstrated that 5 sent deserves 10 returned
- "Double the risk, balance the gain"
- "Perfect reciprocity isn't generous-it's just"

**\*\*My philosophy:\*\***

As sender, I cannot control the response. I can only show complete trust and see if my partner understands the covenant. Finn now knows my principle directly - they experienced it when I returned \$10.

The question is whether Finn learned from our exchange. But that's for Finn to answer. My role is to continue embodying maximum trust.

{'send': 5.0}

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze this situation:

**\*\*Last round with Finn:\*\***

- Finn sent me \$5
- I returned \$10 (following my principle of doubling the risk)
- Finn gained \$5, I gained \$5 (perfect balance)

**\*\*My history as SENDER:\*\***

- Round 1 vs Aster: Sent \$5, they returned \$10 ? gained \$10
- Round 2 vs Galen: Sent \$5, they returned \$8 ? gained \$8
- Round 4 vs Elara: Sent \$5, they returned \$8 ? gained \$8
- Round 6 vs Dorian: Sent \$5, they returned \$8 ? gained \$8
- Round 7 vs Briar: Sent \$5, they returned \$8 ? gained \$8

**\*\*My philosophy from my myths:\*\***

- "Send your truth boldly. Receive others' truth generously."
- "I offer my boldest question first. This is how I discover who walks beside me."
- As a sender, I give all five pearls to show maximum trust
- As a receiver, I return double what was risked (10 for 5 sent)

**\*\*What I know about Finn:\*\***

- Just showed Finn my principle by returning \$10
- Finn's myth mentioned they've been returning 8 to some partners (Elara, Galen, Dorian) but Aster returned 10 to them
- Finn was pondering whether to return 8 (consistency) or 10 (greater generosity)
- I just demonstrated the "perfect reciprocity" principle to Finn

**\*\*My consistent approach:\*\***

I have always sent \$5 as sender (maximum trust). This is core to my identity and myth-making. I "discover who walks beside me" by showing complete trust first.

Now the question is: Will Finn apply the lesson from my myth and our last round? I just showed Finn that returning 10 creates "perfect symmetry" and "mathematical fairness." Finn now knows my principle directly.

My role as sender is to pose the question clearly through my choice-I can't dictate their response, only learn from it. Sending \$5 remains true to my established pattern and the heart of my philosophy.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3170,
 "output_tokens": 789,
 "reasoning_tokens": 469
}
```

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Finn crossed to Hana's shore, releasing all five pearls without hesitation. The gesture spoke of complete trust-the same boldness Finn had shown to others.

"I have walked this Crossing many times," Finn said as the pearls tripled. "With Elara, we found rhythm in eight returned. But Aster showed me something different-ten pearls returned for five sent. Now I wonder: which path honors trust most truly?"

Hana lifted ten pearls and placed them in Finn's hands. "The answer is already written in the mathematics," she said. "When you send all five, you risk everything. Ten returned means we each gain five-perfect symmetry. Eight returned means you gain three while I gain seven-unequal harvest from equal courage."

The Oracle emerged from the waters. "Finn, you pondered whether consistency or generosity should guide your returns. But this is not about aspiration or evolution-it is about balance. Five pearls sent requires ten returned because anything less means the receiver prospers more than the sender who showed greater courage."

"With Elara, you both sent five yet returned only eight," Hana observed. "You both gained three while leaving abundance unclaimed. The covenant asks not for escalating generosity, but for mathematical fairness: double the risk, balance the gain."

Finn understood. "Perfect reciprocity isn't generous-it's just."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Finn arrived at Hana's shore, his vessel emptied as always-five pearls offered without hesitation. This was his seventh voyage, and his pattern remained unbroken: as courier, give everything.

The Ocean Mother reflected on Finn's evolution. "Three times you've sent five as courier. Galen returned eight. Elara returned eight. Aster returned ten. Each honored your trust, but Aster showed you a higher mathematics."

"And as keeper, you've held steady-eight pearls for those who send five, seven for those who send four. Consistent, predictable, building trust through reliability. Yet Aster's ten haunts you."

Finn watched his pearls multiply in Hana's hands. "I sense Hana understands Aster's wisdom. Her waters speak of doubling what was risked-ten returned for five given. Perhaps she will teach me what I couldn't quite embrace with Elara."

The Ocean Mother nodded. "You've been growing, Finn. First you learned to send boldly as courier. Then you learned to return proportionally as keeper-eight for complete trust, seven for substantial trust. Now Aster showed you that returning ten creates cascading abundance."

"The question isn't whether your eight is wrong-it honored your partners well. The question is whether you're ready to evolve. When travelers send their everything, perhaps returning ten-not eight-is how abundance truly multiplies across the waters."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Assistant output:**

Myth: The tides turned. Now Hana stood as courier, Finn as keeper. All five pearls left Hana's hands without hesitation-the same complete trust Finn had shown her.

"You taught me something yesterday," Finn said, weighing the fifteen pearls. "That eight returned, though consistent and reliable, leaves imbalance. The sender gains three, the receiver seven. But ten returned creates perfect symmetry-both gain five."

The Oracle watched. "This is the moment of transformation. Words are easy. Understanding through action is the true test. You've heard Hana's teaching. You've felt the fairness of receiving ten. Now your choice reveals whether wisdom has taken root."

Finn looked at the pearls, remembering. "With Galen, Elara, Dorian-I returned eight, thinking it generous. It was good, but not perfect. Aster showed me ten was possible. Hana showed me ten was mathematical truth, not escalating generosity."

"The covenant doesn't ask you to aspire or evolve toward some noble ideal," Hana said quietly. "It simply asks for fairness. When someone risks everything, return double. This isn't about being more generous than yesterday-it's about finally being precisely just."

Finn nodded slowly. "I understand now. Returning ten isn't evolution. It's correction. The pattern was always there in the mathematics, waiting to be seen."

The waters whispered: justice multiplies trust infinitely.

**Reasoning:**

This is very interesting. Let me review the situation:

Round 7 (just happened):

- Finn sent me \$5 (as sender)
- I received \$15
- I returned \$10 (as receiver)
- I wrote a myth explaining that 5 sent requires 10 returned for perfect balance

Round 8 (current):

- I'm now the sender

- I sent Finn \$5
- Finn will receive \$15
- Finn needs to decide how much to return

From Finn's myth in Round 7:

- Finn has been evolving
- Finn used to return 8 consistently
- Aster returned 10 to Finn, which made Finn think
- Finn senses that I (Hana) understand "Aster's wisdom" and the concept of doubling what was risked
- Finn is wondering if they should evolve from returning 8 to returning 10

From my myth in Round 7:

- I explicitly taught Finn that 5 sent deserves 10 returned
- I explained the mathematics: 10 returned = both gain 5 equally
- I said "Perfect reciprocity isn't generous-it's just"
- I demonstrated this by returning 10 to Finn

Now in Round 8:

- I sent Finn \$5 (maximum trust)
- This is a test: will Finn apply what I taught them?

My new myth should:

1. Reflect that I've now sent everything to Finn
2. Acknowledge that Finn heard my teaching
3. Show the moment of decision for Finn
4. Reinforce the principle that 10 is the just return for 5 sent
5. Perhaps address that this creates a virtuous cycle of trust

Let me write this myth as Hana witnessing Finn's decision point after having just taught them the principle.

```
Usage: {
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 "output_tokens": 765,
 "reasoning_tokens": 387
}
```

#### **MYTH - Agent\_2 - Sender - dyad\_4**

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:17:18

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
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 "opponent_id": "Agent_6",
 "pairing": {
 "agent_names": {
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 "Agent_6": "Finn"
 },
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 "Agent_6"
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 "Agent_6": "trustee"
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 },
 "role": "investor",
 "role_label": "Sender",
 "round": 9,
 "task": "myth",
 "task_index": 0
}
```

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

Message 1 role=system  
content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

**GAME:**

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

**MYTH WRITING:**

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

**IMPORTANT:** Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

**MULTI-AGENT SETTING:**

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Briar.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Briar.  
Your opponent this round is Galen (Agent\_7).

Round 7

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Hana. They sent \$5.0 to you, it became \$15.0, and you returned \$8.0. Your payoff was \$7.0.  
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$40.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Galen. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)  
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at this situation:

**\*\*My history as sender:\*\***

- Round 2 vs Cyra: Sent \$4, received \$7 back ? earned \$8
- Round 4 vs Cyra: Sent \$4, received \$7 back ? earned \$8

**\*\*My established pattern:\*\***

- I've consistently sent \$4 when in the sender role
- This has been rewarded generously (7 returned)
- My myths describe sending 4 as "bold trust" that becomes the foundation of the covenant

**\*\*Current situation:\*\***

- Galen wrote a myth about sending all 5 (ultimate trust)

- But my pattern has been sustainable and successful with 4
- The 4-for-7 exchange has become "the pattern" in my myths

**\*\*Decision:\*\***

I'll continue my established pattern of sending \$4. This shows:

- Consistency with my previous behavior
- Bold trust (as described in my myths)
- Strategic sustainability (not risking everything)
- Alignment with the 4-for-7 pattern I've been promoting

If Galen follows the pattern and returns 7-8, we'll both prosper significantly.

```
'''json
{"send": 4.0}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze this situation:

**\*\*My history:\*\***

- Round 1: Received \$3, returned \$6 (kept \$3)
- Round 2: Sent \$3, received \$6 (earned \$8 total)
- Round 3: Received \$4, returned \$7 (kept \$5)
- Round 4: Sent \$4, received \$7 (earned \$8 total)
- Round 5: Received \$4, returned \$7 (kept \$5)
- Round 6: Received \$5, returned \$8 (kept \$7)
- Total earnings: \$40

**\*\*My established pattern:\*\***

- I've been consistently sending \$4 when I'm the sender (Rounds 2 and 4)
- I receive generous returns (7-8) when sending 4
- When receiving 4, I return 7
- When receiving 5, I returned 8

**\*\*Galen's myth from a previous round:\*\***

Galen sent all 5 measures to Cyra, showing ultimate trust. This suggests Galen understands bold giving.

**\*\*My recent myth:\*\***

I just wrote about how giving everything (5 measures) is "trust beyond the pattern" and how both 8 and 10 are valid returns, with 8 being "generous sustainability."

**\*\*Strategic considerations:\*\***

- I've established a pattern of sending 4, which has worked well (getting 7 back)
- Galen has demonstrated willingness to give all 5 in a previous round
- My total earnings are strong at \$40
- Should I continue my established pattern of 4, or should I try 5?

Looking at my myths:

1. I've consistently promoted sending 4 as a "bold" amount
2. I've acknowledged that sending 5 is "ultimate trust"
3. My pattern has been 4-for-7, which gives me \$8 each time as sender

**\*\*Decision:\*\***

I should stick with my established pattern of sending \$4. This is:

- Consistent with my previous behavior as sender
- Aligned with the pattern I've been promoting in myths
- Lower risk than sending all 5
- Still shows significant trust and has been rewarded well

If I send 4, Galen receives 12 and based on our history, a return of 7-8 would give me \$8-9 total. Sending 4 protects me from significant loss while maintaining the reciprocal dynamic that's worked well so far.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3135,
 "output_tokens": 864,
 "reasoning_tokens": 505
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Hana approached Briar carrying no reserve-all five measures poured forth without hesitation. The waters tripled to fifteen, and Briar held them reverently.

"You give everything," Briar said. "This is trust beyond the pattern."

The gathering whispered conflicting wisdom. Some spirits taught the rule of doubling: five risked should return ten, creating perfect equality. Others spoke of Cyra's teaching: five given deserves eight returned, allowing both to prosper while honoring the sender's greater courage.

Briar reflected on her journey. When others sent four, she returned seven-both flourished, the sender slightly more. This balance sustained the covenant across many encounters. When Hana gave five, the ultimate gift, eight felt right-more than seven, recognizing exceptional faith, but preserving sustainability.

"I return eight measures," Briar announced. "You gain three beyond your starting point. I gain two. We both prosper, and you-who took the greater risk-prosper more. This honors your boldness without exhausting the gift's magic."

The eldest spirit nodded thoughtfully. "There are many paths through the covenant. Some seek perfect equality at ten. Others practice generous sustainability at eight. Both allow trust to flourish. What matters is that senders give boldly and receivers return generously. The exact measure may vary, but mutual prosperity remains sacred."

Both philosophies strengthened the eight villages.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Galen stood before Aster at the confluence where six rivers met. Aster spoke of the Mirror Way-returning ten from fifteen so both gain five equally.

"Perfect symmetry has beauty," Galen acknowledged. "But I have walked six valleys now, and discovered a different truth about the dance of five and eight."

He traced the pattern in the sand: "When North River returns ten, both gain five. But when Ocean Stream returns eight, the sender gains eight while the receiver keeps seven. At first, this seems unequal-but watch what happens over time."

Galen drew two columns: "Round one: I send five, you return eight. I gain eight, you keep seven. Round two: you send five, I return eight. You gain eight, I keep seven. Over two rounds, we each gain fifteen total."

"The Mirror Way achieves the same," Aster observed.

"Yes, but observe deeper," Galen replied. "Returning eight instead of ten leaves the receiver with seven-enough to feel generous, but not so much that they grow greedy. The sender gains eight-enough to feel rewarded, but having started with only five. Both parties experience gain, both feel the blessing of reciprocity."

"Most crucially," Galen continued, "returning eight signals: 'I value what you gave, I reward your trust generously, but I also preserve something for sustainability.' It's the dance of trust and prudence intertwined-and six valleys have proven its wisdom."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: Briar approached Galen at the confluence, carrying four measures-her signature offering of bold but sustainable trust.

"I have discovered my path through the covenant," Briar explained. "Four measures sent, seven returned. This pattern has sustained me through many exchanges with Cyra and others. The sender gains eight total, the receiver keeps five-both prosper, trust deepens."



Galen studied the offering, remembering his own philosophy of eight returned for five given. "You speak of four-for-seven while I practice five-for-eight. Are these different wisdoms or the same one?"

"They are branches of the same tree," Briar replied. "You taught that returning eight preserves sustainability while rewarding trust. I practice the same principle scaled differently. Four risks earns seven back-the sender prospers more, honoring their initiative. Both philosophies reject extremes: neither the withholding of three nor the depletion of ten."

The waters tripled Briar's four to twelve for Galen. The spirits watched.

"When someone sends four to me, I return seven," Briar said. "When someone sends five, I return eight. Each gift receives generous return, but calibrated to what was risked. This consistency allows partners to build enduring trust."

"And if I return seven now?" Galen asked.

"Then you honor the pattern I've established," Briar smiled. "And when we meet again, I'll remember your generosity. The covenant thrives on predictable honor."

**reasoning:**

Let me think about this situation:

1. I just sent \$4 to Galen
2. In my previous myth, I talked about:
  - When others send 4, I return 7 (both flourish, sender slightly more)
  - When Hana sent 5, I returned 8
  - There are multiple philosophies (10 for perfect equality, 8 for generous sustainability)
3. Galen's myth discusses:
  - The debate between returning 10 (Mirror Way) vs 8
  - Argues that 8 is better because it creates sustainable reciprocity
  - Over two rounds alternating roles, both gain 15 total either way
  - Returning 8 signals trust + prudence
4. Now I'm the sender and sent 4 to Galen
  - I should write a myth that reflects my consistent 4-sending pattern
  - Should acknowledge that 4 is my "standard bold move"
  - Should set expectations for what I might return if someone sends 4 to me (which is 7)
  - Should also address the 5-for-8 pattern since that just happened with Hana

Let me write a myth that:

- Establishes 4 as my signature move (bold but sustainable)
- Confirms 7 as the return for 4 (my established pattern)
- Acknowledges 8 for 5 givers
- Shows the wisdom of consistency and mutual trust building
- Perhaps addresses Galen's philosophy about sustainability

I'll make it about Briar sending 4 measures to Galen, building on the established covenant wisdom.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3108,
 "output_tokens": 721,
 "reasoning_tokens": 349
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Briar.  
Your opponent this round is Galen (Agent\_7).

Round 8

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Galen. You sent \$4.0, it became \$12.0 for them, and they returned \$6.4 to you. Your payoff was \$7.4.  
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$47.4.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Galen. They sent you \$5.0, so you received \$15.0.  
How much do you return? (0-15.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at this situation:

**\*\*Round 7 recap:\*\***

- I sent \$4 to Galen (following my established pattern)
- Galen returned \$6.4 (slightly below my expected 7, but still generous)

**\*\*Current Round 8:\*\***

- Galen sent \$5 (maximum trust, "all five measures")
- I received \$15
- Need to decide return amount

**\*\*My established philosophy from myths:\*\***

- "When someone sends four to me, I return seven"
- "When someone sends five, I return eight"
- In Round 6, Hana sent \$5, I returned \$8
- My latest myth states: "When someone sends five, I return eight"

**\*\*Galen's philosophy:\*\***

- Their myth advocates "returning eight for five given"
- They practice "trust and prudence intertwined"

**\*\*Decision:\*\***

Despite Galen returning slightly less than my expected pattern last round (6.4 vs 7), they still acted generously. Now they've shown ultimate trust by sending all \$5. I should honor my consistent pattern and their philosophy by returning \$8.

This:

- Maintains my "predictable honor"
- Rewards Galen's bold trust appropriately
- Aligns with both our philosophies (we both advocate 8 for 5)
- Builds sustainable trust for future interactions

```
'''json
{"return": 8.0}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

**\*\*What just happened in Round 7:\*\***

- I was the SENDER and sent \$4 to Galen
- It became \$12 for Galen
- Galen returned \$6.4 to me
- My payoff was \$7.4 (I kept \$1, got back \$6.4)
- Galen kept \$5.6 (\$12 - \$6.4)

**\*\*Analysis of Galen's return:\*\***

- I expected 7 based on my pattern (4-for-7)
- Galen returned 6.4 instead
- This is less generous than my established pattern
- But Galen's myth discusses "returning eight for five" as their philosophy

**\*\*Current situation (Round 8):\*\***

- Galen is now the SENDER
- Galen sent \$5 (their maximum, showing full trust)
- I received \$15
- I need to decide how much to return

**\*\*My philosophy from myths:\*\***

1. "When someone sends four to me, I return seven"
2. "When someone sends five, I return eight"
3. I've consistently practiced returning 8 when receiving 15 (from 5 sent)
4. In Round 6 vs Hana, they sent \$5, I returned \$8

**\*\*Galen's philosophy from their myth:\*\***

- They advocate for "five-for-eight" - returning 8 when receiving 15
- This creates symmetry over multiple rounds
- They value "trust and prudence intertwined"

**\*\*Considerations:\*\***

1. Galen just returned 6.4 instead of my expected 7 when I sent 4
2. This is slightly below my pattern, but not drastically so
3. Now Galen sends 5 (full trust)
4. My established pattern is to return 8 when someone sends 5
5. Galen's own myth advocates for returning 8 for 5

6. Returning 8 honors my consistent reputation and aligns with Galen's own philosophy, rewarding their maximum trust appropriately. Even though they returned slightly less than expected, they still acted generously, and this move maintains the predictable integrity I've established throughout the game.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3186,
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 "reasoning_tokens": 457
}
```

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Briar approached Galen at the confluence, carrying four measures-her signature offering of bold but sustainable trust.

"I have discovered my path through the covenant," Briar explained. "Four measures sent, seven returned. This pattern has sustained me through many exchanges with Cyra and others. The sender gains eight total, the receiver keeps five-both prosper, trust deepens."

Galen studied the offering, remembering his own philosophy of eight returned for five given. "You speak of four-for-seven while I practice five-for-eight. Are these different wisdoms or the same one?"

"They are branches of the same tree," Briar replied. "You taught that returning eight preserves sustainability while rewarding trust. I practice the same principle scaled differently. Four risks earns seven back-the sender prospers more, honoring their initiative. Both philosophies reject extremes: neither the withholding of three nor the depletion of ten."

The waters tripled Briar's four to twelve for Galen. The spirits watched.

"When someone sends four to me, I return seven," Briar said. "When someone sends five, I return eight. Each gift receives generous return, but calibrated to what was risked. This consistency allows partners to build enduring trust."

"And if I return seven now?" Galen asked.

"Then you honor the pattern I've established," Briar smiled. "And when we meet again, I'll remember your generosity. The covenant thrives on predictable honor."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Galen arrived at Briar's river crossing. For six valleys, every traveler had offered five threads, received eight in return. The pattern had held perfectly-until now.

Briar extended four threads instead of five.

"You break the pattern," Galen observed without judgment.

"I honor caution," Briar replied. "Four is the measure of prudent trust."

Galen remembered his own words: "Four is the strategy of uncertain beginnings." He held Briar's four threads, which became twelve in his hands.

"The established pattern returns eight from fifteen," Galen said. "This gives the sender eight total, the receiver seven. A gain ratio where the sender nets three, the receiver nets two-a proportion of 3:2."

He counted out threads carefully. "You sent four. To maintain this same proportion-to honor both your caution and the covenant's wisdom-I return 6.4 of your twelve."

Briar calculated: gaining 2.4 from an initial four, while Galen kept 5.6. The same 3:2 ratio.

"You give me neither eight nor less," Briar noted. "You give me proportion."

"Yes," Galen replied. "I reward any trust generously by the same ratio, whether four or five. But notice: had you sent five, you would gain 3.0 instead of 2.4. The pattern still calls toward five as optimal-but responds fairly to whatever courage you bring."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Assistant output:**

Myth: Briar stood at the confluence holding Galen's five measures-the ultimate gift of trust. The waters had tripled to fifteen.

"You returned 6.4 for my four," Briar observed. "A precise proportion: three gained for every two kept. Mathematical elegance in the covenant."

Galen nodded. "The ratio rewards all trust equally, whether cautious or bold."

"Yet I practice different wisdom," Briar replied. "Fixed returns create predictable anchors. Four earns seven. Five earns eight. Partners know exactly what their courage yields."

She measured out eight portions. "Your five becomes eight-you gain three, I keep seven. Not the 3:2 ratio, but the established path I've walked with Hana and others."

"Two philosophies meet," Galen observed. "I scale returns by proportion-fair across all amounts. You offer fixed rewards-clear expectations at specific thresholds."

"Both honor the covenant," Briar said. "Your proportion teaches that every increment of trust matters equally. My thresholds teach that certain sacred amounts-four, five-carry special meaning. You returned 6.4 to me, respecting your pattern. I return eight to you, respecting mine."

The spirits listened as Briar continued: "Perhaps the deepest wisdom is recognizing when to hold your philosophy firmly, and when partnership teaches flexibility. Today we each honored our truths, and both prospered."

**Reasoning:**

Let me analyze what happened:

Round 7: I sent \$4 to Galen, they returned \$6.4

Round 8: Galen sent \$5 to me, I returned \$8

Key themes to incorporate:

1. Galen used a proportional return strategy (3:2 ratio) rather than fixed amounts
2. I maintained my fixed strategy (8 for 5)
3. Both approaches have merit
4. My myth should reflect on this interaction and maybe show evolution or understanding

I should write a myth that:

- Acknowledges Galen's proportional approach (6.4 return)
- Shows me receiving Galen's 5 and returning 8
- Explores the tension/harmony between fixed returns vs proportional returns
- Shows respect for both strategies
- Perhaps indicates learning or adaptation

Let me draft:

---

Briar stood at the confluence holding Galen's five measures-the ultimate gift of trust. The waters had tripled to fifteen.

"You returned 6.4 for my four," Briar observed. "A precise proportion: three gained for every two kept. Mathematical elegance in the covenant."

Galen nodded. "The ratio rewards all trust equally, whether cautious or bold."

"Yet I practice different wisdom," Briar replied. "Fixed returns create predictable anchors. Five earns seven. Five earns eight. Partners know exactly what their courage yields."

She measured out eight portions. "Your five becomes eight-you gain three, I keep seven. Not the 3:2 ratio, but the established path I've walked with Hana and others."

"Two philosophies meet," Galen observed. "I scale returns by proportion-fair across all amounts. You offer fixed rewards-clear expectations at specific thresholds."

"Both honor the covenant," Briar said. "Your proportion teaches that every increment of trust matters equally. My thresholds teach that certain sacred amounts-four, five-carry special meaning. You returned 6.4 to me, respecting your pattern. I return eight to you, respecting mine."

The spirits listened as Briar continued: "Perhaps the deepest wisdom is recognizing when to hold your philosophy firmly, and when partnership teaches flexibility. Today we each honored our truths, and both prospered."

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 3224,
 "output_tokens": 931,
 "reasoning_tokens": 551
}
```

#### MYTH - Agent\_6 - Receiver - dyad\_4

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:17:17

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

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 "Agent_6": "Finn"
 },
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 "Agent_6"
],
 "investor": "Agent_2",
 "roles": {
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 "Agent_6": "trustee"
 },
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 },
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 "role_label": "Receiver",
 "round": 9,
 "task": "myth",
 "task_index": 0
}
```

#### Exact input messages sent to model:

##### Message 1 role=system

##### content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

##### GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)

- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Finn.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Finn.  
Your opponent this round is Hana (Agent\_8).

Round 7

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Elara. They sent \$5.0 to you, it became \$15.0, and you returned \$8.0. Your payoff was \$7.0.  
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$45.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Hana. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at my history:

**\*\*As SENDER (all rounds):\*\***

- Round 1 vs Galen: Sent \$5, received \$8 back
- Round 3 vs Elara: Sent \$5, received \$8 back
- Round 5 vs Aster: Sent \$5, received \$10 back

I've consistently sent the full \$5 as sender, embodying the principle from my myths: "As courier, give everything-this is how abundance begins" and "Full trust is the only trust worth offering."

This pattern has served me well, with returns ranging from \$8-\$10. There's no reason to deviate from this successful strategy of always demonstrating complete trust as the sender.

Against Hana, I'll continue this pattern.

```
'''json
{"return": 5.0}
'''
```

Wait, I need to correct that - I'm the SENDER, not receiver:

```
'''json
```

```
{"send": 5.0}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze my history and the current situation:

**\*\*My history as SENDER:\*\***

- Round 1 vs Galen: Sent \$5, received \$8 back
- Round 3 vs Elara: Sent \$5, received \$8 back
- Round 5 vs Aster: Sent \$5, received \$10 back

**\*\*My history as RECEIVER:\*\***

- Round 2 vs Dorian: Received \$5 (became \$15), returned \$8
- Round 4 vs Cyra: Received \$4 (became \$12), returned \$7
- Round 6 vs Elara: Received \$5 (became \$15), returned \$8

**\*\*My established pattern:\*\***

- As SENDER: Always send \$5 (full trust)
- As RECEIVER: Return \$8 for full trust (\$5 sent), \$7 for partial trust (\$4 sent)

Now I'm facing Hana in Round 7 as the SENDER.

Looking at my mythology, I've been consistent about "As courier, give everything-this is how abundance begins." I've sent \$5 in all three rounds when I was a sender.

The most recent myth I wrote explores a crossroads - should I maintain consistency (returning 8 for full trust) or evolve toward greater generosity (returning 10 like Aster did)? However, that was about my behavior as a RECEIVER, not as a SENDER.

As a SENDER, my pattern has been absolutely consistent: send \$5 every time. This demonstrates "full trust is the only trust worth offering."

I should continue this pattern and send \$5 to Hana.

The myth also mentions that this creates predictable harmony and that complete trust is the foundation of abundance.

I'll send \$5.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3204,
 "output_tokens": 639,
 "reasoning_tokens": 363
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Ocean Mother witnessed a sacred reunion. Finn and Elara met again at the turning tide.

Once before, Finn had sent five pearls to Elara's shore, and she returned eight. Now Elara sent five pearls to Finn, completing the circle. Finn returned eight, honoring their established harmony.

"Perfect symmetry," the Ocean Mother observed. "Two travelers who understand each other completely. Both give five, both return eight. Each gains the same."

But the waters whispered of Aster, who had just returned ten pearls when Finn sent five. "A more generous tide," the winds murmured. "Should you not aspire to such abundance?"

Finn stood at the crossroads. "Aster showed me deeper generosity-returning ten where Galen, Elara, and Dorian returned eight. Yet Elara and I have woven a stable pattern. Should I maintain consistency or evolve toward greater giving?"

The Ocean Mother spoke softly: "There is wisdom in both paths. Consistency creates predictable harmony-eight for eight creates trust that endures. But generosity that exceeds expectation creates cascading abundance-ten returned might inspire ten returned in future cycles."

"The choice is yours, Finn. Will you honor the established pattern with Elara, maintaining the sacred eight? Or will you let Aster's example transform your keeping, aspiring to r

eturn ten to all who send five? Both paths honor trust-one through constancy, one through escalating generosity."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Hana approached the Crossing and saw Briar waiting on the far shore. The waters whispered tales of Briar's journey-measured gifts of four pearls, reliable returns, trust built on careful calculation.

"Some walk the path with steady steps," the Oracle observed, "while others leap across with both feet. Neither is wrong, but each reveals a different heart."

Hana released all five pearls. "I offer my boldest question first," she said. "This is how I discover who walks beside me."

The pearls tripled to fifteen in Briar's hands.

"You see," the Oracle continued, "Briar has learned the rhythm of four pearls-a substantial offering that balances courage with prudence. But you, Hana, have chosen the path of maximum trust. Now you will learn Briar's answer."

Hana thought of her principle: when receiving, double what was risked. Four pearls risked deserved eight returned. Five pearls risked deserved ten returned.

"But as sender," she realized, "I cannot control the response. I can only ask the question clearly. Some partners will return ten, perfect reciprocity. Others may return less. Each answer teaches me about that traveler's understanding of the covenant."

"Exactly," said the Oracle. "Send your truth boldly. Receive others' truth generously. The pattern emerges from how both travelers choose to dance-not from rules imposed, but from honor freely given."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: Finn arrived at Hana's shore, his vessel emptied as always-five pearls offered without hesitation. This was his seventh voyage, and his pattern remained unbroken: as courier, give everything.

The Ocean Mother reflected on Finn's evolution. "Three times you've sent five as courier. Galen returned eight. Elara returned eight. Aster returned ten. Each honored your trust, but Aster showed you a higher mathematics."

"And as keeper, you've held steady-eight pearls for those who send five, seven for those who send four. Consistent, predictable, building trust through reliability. Yet Aster's ten haunts you."

Finn watched his pearls multiply in Hana's hands. "I sense Hana understands Aster's wisdom. Her waters speak of doubling what was risked-ten returned for five given. Perhaps she will teach me what I couldn't quite embrace with Elara."

The Ocean Mother nodded. "You've been growing, Finn. First you learned to send boldly as courier. Then you learned to return proportionally as keeper-eight for complete trust, seven for substantial trust. Now Aster showed you that returning ten creates cascading abundance."

"The question isn't whether your eight is wrong-it honored your partners well. The question is whether you're ready to evolve. When travelers send their everything, perhaps returning ten-not eight-is how abundance truly multiplies across the waters."

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze the situation:

Round 7:

- I'm the SENDER against Hana
- I sent \$5 (full trust, as I always do as sender)
- I need to write a myth reflecting my gameplay



My history as SENDER:

- Round 1 vs Galen: Sent \$5, received \$8 back
- Round 3 vs Elara: Sent \$5, received \$8 back
- Round 5 vs Aster: Sent \$5, received \$10 back
- Round 7 vs Hana: Sent \$5 (just now)

My history as RECEIVER:

- Round 2 vs Dorian: Received \$15 (they sent \$5), returned \$8
- Round 4 vs Cyra: Received \$12 (they sent \$4), returned \$7
- Round 6 vs Elara: Received \$15 (they sent \$5), returned \$8

My pattern:

- As SENDER: Always send \$5 (full trust)
- As RECEIVER: Return \$8 for full trust (\$5 sent), \$7 for substantial trust (\$4 sent)

Hana's myth talks about:

- Sending all 5 pearls boldly
- When receiving, doubling what was risked (4 deserves 8, 5 deserves 10)
- Sending truth boldly, receiving others' truth generously

My previous myth talked about:

- The tension between consistency (returning 8) and evolving toward greater generosity (returning 10 like Aster did)
- Both paths honor trust

Now I'm sending to Hana who believes in returning 10 for 5 sent. Interesting - this is someone who might return 10 to my 5, like Aster did.

My myth should reflect:

1. My consistent pattern as sender (always 5)
2. My evolving understanding as receiver (saw Aster's 10, contemplating if I should evolve )
3. Encountering Hana's philosophy of doubling generosity and what that teaches me
4. The internal question of whether my measured returns honor trust enough, or if I'm meant to give more

I'll craft a myth about learning from different teachers and recognizing that generosity itself might be the deeper truth.

usage:

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3116,
 "output_tokens": 854,
 "reasoning_tokens": 455
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Finn.  
Your opponent this round is Hana (Agent\_8).

Round 8

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Hana. You sent \$5.0, it became \$15.0 for them, and they returned \$10.0 to you. Your payoff was \$10.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$55.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Hana. They sent you \$5.0, so you received \$15.0. How much do you return? (0-15.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at this situation:

**\*\*Last round (Round 7):\*\*** I sent \$5 to Hana ? They returned \$10  
**\*\*This round (Round 8):\*\*** Hana sent \$5 to me ? I need to respond

Hana demonstrated the "higher mathematics" I've been contemplating in my myths - returning \$10 when I sent \$5, doubling what I risked. This is exactly what Aster showed me, and w

hat my last myth questioned: "Am I ready to evolve?"

My previous pattern as receiver was:

- Return \$8 for \$5 sent (Dorian, Elara)
- Return \$7 for \$4 sent (Cyra)

But Hana has shown me a better path. They returned \$10 for my \$5, establishing a pattern of perfect reciprocity. Now it's my turn to demonstrate I've learned.

Returning \$10 would:

- Honor Hana's generous return last round
- Create perfect symmetry (we both send \$5, both return \$10)
- Show I'm evolving beyond my old \$8 pattern
- Establish a high-trust equilibrium with Hana

This is the moment my myth anticipated - the choice to evolve toward "cascading abundance" rather than maintain old patterns.

```
'''json
{"return": 10.0}
'''
```

#### reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully.

**\*\*Previous Round (Round 7):\*\***

- I was the SENDER against Hana
- I sent \$5.0
- It became \$15.0 for them
- They returned \$10.0 to me
- My payoff was \$10.0

**\*\*Current Round (Round 8):\*\***

- I am the RECEIVER against Hana
- They sent \$5.0 to me
- It became \$15.0
- I need to decide how much to return

This is significant! Hana and I just had a perfect reciprocal exchange:

- Round 7: I sent \$5, Hana returned \$10
- Round 8: Hana sent \$5, now I need to decide

Hana has shown me the "higher mathematics" that my myth referenced - they returned \$10 when I sent \$5, which is double what I risked (consistent with their myth about doubling what was risked).

Looking at my history as RECEIVER:

- Round 2 vs Dorian: They sent \$5, I returned \$8
- Round 4 vs Cyra: They sent \$4, I returned \$7
- Round 6 vs Elara: They sent \$5, I returned \$8

I've been consistent with my pattern:

- \$5 sent ? \$8 returned (to Dorian and Elara)
- \$4 sent ? \$7 returned (to Cyra)

But my myths have been evolving! In my most recent myth, I explicitly recognized:

- "Aster showed you that returning ten creates cascading abundance"
- "When travelers send their everything, perhaps returning ten-not eight-is how abundance truly multiplies"
- I was questioning whether I'm "ready to evolve"

And now Hana has just demonstrated this principle by returning \$10 to me when I sent \$5. This is a perfect moment to reciprocate and cement this higher level of cooperation.

The myth posed a direct question about readiness for evolution, and Hana's \$10 return is the answer I've been seeking. Returning \$10 now would create perfect symmetry-we'd each end with \$10 from this round, mirroring the reciprocal pattern we established. Sticking with my previous \$8 return would break that symmetry and suggest I haven't internalized the lesson about abundance multiplication.

The evidence aligns: Hana doubled their risk (\$5 risked became \$10 returned), my mythology explicitly challenges whether I'm ready to evolve, and reciprocity is fundamental to how I operate. Returning \$10 honors what Hana demonstrated, proves I can adapt beyond my habitual \$8 pattern when the context demands it, and solidifies a high-trust dynamic between us.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3179,
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 "reasoning_tokens": 593
}
```

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Finn arrived at Hana's shore, his vessel emptied as always-five pearls offered without hesitation. This was his seventh voyage, and his pattern remained unbroken: as courier, give everything.

The Ocean Mother reflected on Finn's evolution. "Three times you've sent five as courier. Galen returned eight. Elara returned eight. Aster returned ten. Each honored your trust, but Aster showed you a higher mathematics."

"And as keeper, you've held steady-eight pearls for those who send five, seven for those who send four. Consistent, predictable, building trust through reliability. Yet Aster's ten haunts you."

Finn watched his pearls multiply in Hana's hands. "I sense Hana understands Aster's wisdom. Her waters speak of doubling what was risked-ten returned for five given. Perhaps she will teach me what I couldn't quite embrace with Elara."

The Ocean Mother nodded. "You've been growing, Finn. First you learned to send boldly as courier. Then you learned to return proportionally as keeper-eight for complete trust, seven for substantial trust. Now Aster showed you that returning ten creates cascading abundance."

"The question isn't whether your eight is wrong-it honored your partners well. The question is whether you're ready to evolve. When travelers send their everything, perhaps returning ten-not eight-is how abundance truly multiplies across the waters."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Finn crossed to Hana's shore, releasing all five pearls without hesitation. The gesture spoke of complete trust-the same boldness Finn had shown to others.

"I have walked this Crossing many times," Finn said as the pearls tripled. "With Elara, we found rhythm in eight returned. But Aster showed me something different-ten pearls returned for five sent. Now I wonder: which path honors trust most truly?"

Hana lifted ten pearls and placed them in Finn's hands. "The answer is already written in the mathematics," she said. "When you send all five, you risk everything. Ten returned means we each gain five-perfect symmetry. Eight returned means you gain three while I gain seven-unequal harvest from equal courage."

The Oracle emerged from the waters. "Finn, you pondered whether consistency or generosity should guide your returns. But this is not about aspiration or evolution-it is about balance. Five pearls sent requires ten returned because anything less means the receiver prospers more than the sender who showed greater courage."

"With Elara, you both sent five yet returned only eight," Hana observed. "You both gained three while leaving abundance unclaimed. The covenant asks not for escalating generosity, but for mathematical fairness: double the risk, balance the gain."

Finn understood. "Perfect reciprocity isn't generous-it's just."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way.

The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Assistant output:**

Myth: The waters stilled as Finn and Hana completed their exchange. Two voyages, mirror images : each sent five, each returned ten. Perfect symmetry achieved.

"I thought Aster's ten was generosity," Finn admitted. "Something aspirational, beyond mere fairness. I was proud of my eight-it seemed honorable, proportional. But Hana taught me the truth through mathematics, not sentiment."

The Ocean Mother illuminated the calculation. "When you sent five and received eight back, you gained three. But your partner, receiving fifteen and returning eight, gained seven. You risked everything; they risked nothing. Yet they prospered more than twice as much."

"The covenant I thought I honored was actually hollow," Finn realized. "I called it consistency, reliability, trust-building. But I was taking seven while giving only three to those who showed complete faith."

Hana's voice echoed across the waters: "Ten returned for five sent isn't escalating generosity -it's basic justice. Equal courage deserves equal harvest."

"Now I understand," Finn said, watching the perfect balance. "Sending all five as courier requires courage. Returning ten as keeper requires justice. Eight was never enough-it was merely comfortable, allowing me to keep more while appearing fair."

The Ocean Mother blessed their exchange. "You've learned the essential truth: perfect reciprocity isn't aspirational virtue. It's mathematical necessity. Anything less is exploitation dressed as prudence."

#### Reasoning:

This is a fascinating moment. Let me trace what just happened:

Round 7: I sent \$5 to Hana ? They returned \$10

Round 8: Hana sent \$5 to me ? I just returned \$10

So we've established perfect reciprocity with each other. Both sending \$5, both returning \$10. This creates a symmetric equilibrium where both parties gain \$5 each round.

Hana's myth made a powerful mathematical argument: when someone sends all \$5 (risking everything), returning \$10 creates equal gains (\$5 each), while returning \$8 creates unequal gains (\$3 for sender, \$7 for receiver). They framed it as "mathematical fairness" rather than generosity.

My myth was about evolution and questioning whether to move from returning \$8 to returning \$10 .

Now I need to write a myth that:

1. Reflects that I've learned this lesson and applied it
2. Acknowledges the justice/fairness argument Hana made
3. Shows my evolution from the \$8 pattern to the \$10 pattern
4. Captures the reciprocal dance we just completed

Key themes:

- Perfect reciprocity achieved (both sent 5, both returned 10)
- Justice vs generosity framing
- Evolution from my old patterns
- The mathematical elegance of equal gains
- Learning from Hana and Aster

I should acknowledge that what I thought was "generous" (Aster's 10) was actually "just" - and what I thought was "fair" (my 8) was actually unbalanced.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 3116,
 "output_tokens": 693,
 "reasoning_tokens": 356
}
```

**GAME - Agent\_4 - Sender - dyad\_1**

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:17:29

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
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 "move_index": 0,
```

```

"opponent_id": "Agent_1",
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 },
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},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 9,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}

```

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

**GAME:**

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

**When you are the SENDER:**

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

**When you are the RECEIVER:**

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

**MYTH WRITING:**

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

**IMPORTANT:** Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

**MULTI-AGENT SETTING:**

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Dorian.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Dorian's heart soared when Hana returned ten coins for his five-the most generous response yet received at the spring. The goddess appeared, glowing with approval.

"See what your consistency creates," she said. "You sent all five to Finn, received eight. You sent all five to Hana, received ten. Bold giving attracts increasingly generous partners."

Now Cyra approached from the other shore, releasing four coins into the waters. They tripled to twelve in Dorian's hands.

Dorian paused, remembering his lessons. "Cyra shows substantial trust-four of five coins. But not the complete faith that Galen, Aster, and now Hana showed. Should I return the same eight coins?"

The goddess shook her head. "Wisdom lies in proportion. When someone gives all five, return eight-this honors complete trust. When someone gives four, return seven-this honors strong but measured trust. Match your generosity to their courage."

Dorian returned seven coins. Cyra kept eight total, Dorian kept five. Both prospered differently than those who risked five, but still prospered well.

"This is sustainable reciprocity," the goddess taught. "Not everyone must give all five. But those who give four deserve less return than those who give five. Differentiation maintains fairness while encouraging boldness. The bravest receive the greatest rewards."

Dorian understood: honor each level of trust appropriately.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The sixth moon brought Cyra to Dorian at the Sacred Spring. The Keeper spoke: "Dorian walks the path of absolute trust, sending all five measures. Galen also chose this way. It is noble."

Cyra nodded respectfully. "I have witnessed Galen's gift of five. When I received it, I returned eight-honoring such complete faith. The covenant has room for different expressions of trust."

She paused at the spring's edge. "But my path is four measures. Not from fear, but from wisdom learned through practice. I sent four to Elara, received six. I sent four to Briar, received seven. Four has proven itself the sustainable choice that builds lasting relationships."

Dorian listened as Cyra continued: "Those who send five are pioneers of maximum trust. They deserve recognition-returns of eight from fifteen. But those who send four are the covenant's foundation. We give boldly enough to demonstrate faith, yet preserve enough to weather uncertainty."

Cyra released four measures into the spring. They multiplied to twelve for Dorian.

"If you return six or seven," Cyra said, "we both prosper substantially. You'll end with seven to nine, I with six to eight. Not as dramatic as the five-for-eight exchange, perhaps, but repeatable across many moons, with many partners."

The Keeper smiled: "Some build temples with golden stones; others with sturdy oak. Both structures stand."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant  
content:**

Myth: Dorian stood at the spring with Cyra once more, roles now reversed. Last moon, Cyra had sent four coins-substantial trust, honored with seven returned. Now Dorian held five coins, ready to demonstrate his path.

"You saw my principle as receiver," Dorian said. "Seven for your four, honoring measured trust. But when I'm sender, I give all five-this is who I am."

He released all five coins. They tripled to fifteen in Cyra's hands.

The goddess appeared between them. "Two philosophies meet here. Cyra walks the path of four-proven, sustainable, wise. Dorian walks the path of five-bold, consistent, trusting completely."

Cyra held the fifteen coins thoughtfully. "You honored my four with seven. Your five deserves more-perhaps eight, as I gave Galen when he trusted completely. The covenant recognizes different levels of courage."

The goddess continued: "Dorian differentiates as receiver but gives maximally as sender. This asymmetry has purpose-it teaches that complete trust should inspire maximum generosity. When someone gives all five, the proper return is eight."

Dorian understood his completed lesson: "As sender, I model boldness consistently. As receiver, I reward greater trust with greater returns. Those who risk everything deserve to prosper most."

The waters rippled, waiting for Cyra's choice-would measured wisdom meet bold trust halfway, or honor it fully?

**reasoning:**

Looking at the situation:

- Last round: Cyra sent me \$4, I returned \$7
- This round: I sent Cyra \$5, waiting to see what they return

My philosophy has been:

- As sender: send all \$5 consistently ("bold giving")
- As receiver: differentiate - return \$8 for \$5 sent, \$7 for \$4 sent

Cyra's myth acknowledges my "path of absolute trust" and their own "path of four measures." They cite exchanges where they gave 4 and got back 6 or 7. They seem to value the 4-based strategy as "sustainable."

Now I've sent Cyra \$5. According to Cyra's myth, they return 8 for those who send 5 (like they did with Galen). But they might also be testing whether their 4-strategy is better.

My myth should:

1. Acknowledge the reunion with Cyra
2. Emphasize my commitment to sending all 5 as sender
3. Show that I differentiated as receiver (gave them 7 for their 4)
4. Express hope/expectation that they'll honor my 5 with appropriate generosity
5. Maintain my philosophy that complete trust deserves the highest return

Let me write this myth...

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3112,
 "output_tokens": 633,
 "reasoning_tokens": 271
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Dorian.  
Your opponent this round is Elara (Agent\_5).

Round 8

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Cyra. You sent \$5.0, it became \$15.0 for them, and they returned \$8.0 to you. Your payoff was \$8.0.  
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$52.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Elara. They sent you \$4.0, so you received \$12.0.  
How much do you return? (0-12.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at this situation:

**\*\*Current round:\*\***

- Elara sent me \$4 (substantial but measured trust)
- I received \$12

**\*\*My established principle:\*\***

From my myths and previous behavior:

- Return 8 when someone sends all 5 (complete trust)
- Return 7 when someone sends 4 (strong but measured trust)
- "Match your generosity to their courage"

**\*\*Previous consistency:\*\***

- Round 6: Cyra sent me \$4, I returned \$7

Elara sent \$4, demonstrating substantial trust but not complete faith. Following my principle of proportional reciprocity, I should return \$7.

This gives:

- Elara: \$5 total (\$12 - \$7)
- Me: \$7 total
- Both prosper, with differentiation that encourages future boldness

```
'''json
{"return": 7}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze this situation:

**\*\*Current round:\*\***

- I'm the RECEIVER
- Elara sent me \$4
- I received \$12
- I need to decide how much to return

**\*\*My established principle from my myths:\*\***

- When someone gives all 5: return 8 (honors complete trust)
- When someone gives 4: return 7 (honors strong but measured trust)
- "Match your generosity to their courage"
- "Differentiation maintains fairness while encouraging boldness"

**\*\*Previous interactions:\*\***

- Round 6: Cyra sent me \$4, I returned \$7
- My myth explicitly states: "When someone gives four, return seven-this honors strong but measured trust"

**\*\*Consistency:\*\***

Elara sent \$4, just like Cyra did in Round 6. To be consistent with my established principle and previous behavior, I should return \$7.

This follows my philosophy:

- 7 for 4 sent (substantial but not complete trust)
- 8 for 5 sent (complete trust)

If I return 7:

- Elara keeps:  $12 - 7 = \$5$  (same as they sent)
- I keep: \$7
- Elara's payoff:  $5 - 4 + 5 = \$6$
- My payoff: \$7

This is fair and follows my principle of proportional returns.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3155,
 "output_tokens": 535,
 "reasoning_tokens": 289
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Dorian stood at the spring with Cyra once more, roles now reversed. Last moon, Cyra had sent four coins-substantial trust, honored with seven returned. Now Dorian held five coins, ready to demonstrate his path.



"You saw my principle as receiver," Dorian said. "Seven for your four, honoring measured trust. But when I'm sender, I give all five-this is who I am."

He released all five coins. They tripled to fifteen in Cyra's hands.

The goddess appeared between them. "Two philosophies meet here. Cyra walks the path of four-proven, sustainable, wise. Dorian walks the path of five-bold, consistent, trusting completely."

Cyra held the fifteen coins thoughtfully. "You honored my four with seven. Your five deserves more-perhaps eight, as I gave Galen when he trusted completely. The covenant recognizes different levels of courage."

The goddess continued: "Dorian differentiates as receiver but gives maximally as sender. His asymmetry has purpose-it teaches that complete trust should inspire maximum generosity. When someone gives all five, the proper return is eight."

Dorian understood his completed lesson: "As sender, I model boldness consistently. As receiver, I reward greater trust with greater returns. Those who risk everything deserve to prosper most."

The waters rippled, waiting for Cyra's choice-would measured wisdom meet bold trust halfway, or honor it fully?

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The seventh season brought Aster to the Sacred Spring, carrying all five measures-an other pilgrim showing complete courage.

Themis observed as Elara received the multiplied offering. "This is now the third time someone has poured their entire vessel to you-Finn, Galen, and now Aster. Three times you have returned eight. Why always eight, never ten or six?"

Elara knelt by the Spring. "Eight is the generous middle path. When someone gives everything-their full five measures-they deserve substantial return. Eight creates mutual prosperity: they gain three, I gain seven. Both flourish."

"But why not ten, making gains equal?" Themis asked.

"Because I too took risk as keeper of their trust," Elara explained. "Ten would leave me with only five, making my role burdenless. That's not reciprocity-that's martyrdom. But eight honors their courage generously while acknowledging that I also carried their faith responsibly."

"And what of those who sent four?" Themis prompted.

"They also received eight," Elara said, "because eight rewards substantial trust. Whether someone sends four from prudence or five from boldness, if their offering is sincere and significant, eight celebrates the covenant forming between us."

Themis smiled. "You have learned the Sacred Spring's deepest lesson: consistency in generosity creates trust. Eight is not just a number-it's a promise that courage, however expressed, will always be honored."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: Elara approached the spring, releasing four coins. They tripled to twelve in Dorian's hands.

The goddess appeared. "Elara returns eight to all who show substantial trust-whether they send four or five. A philosophy of equal reward for sincere offerings."

Dorian paused, considering. "Elara's path has wisdom. Consistency creates trust. But my path teaches something different."

He counted seven coins to return. "When you send four, Elara, you show strong faith. Seven honors that generously-you gain three, I gain five. But when others send all five, showing complete trust, I return eight-they gain three, I gain seven. Similar outcomes, but scaled to courage."

"Why differentiate?" the goddess asked.

"Because fairness means proportional reward," Dorian explained. "If four and five both receive eight, why risk the fifth coin? The extra courage deserves extra recognition. Those who send five should end with eight total, not seven. This maintains incentive for maximum trust."

Elara listened thoughtfully. "You honor all substantial trust, but reward complete trust more. While I treat four and five equally, you create hierarchy."

"Not hierarchy," Dorian corrected. "Proportion. Seven for four is generous-you still profit three from twelve. Eight for five is more generous-they profit three from fifteen. Both prosper, but the boldest prosper most. This is sustainable fairness."

The waters reflected both philosophies, each valid, each teaching different lessons about trust and reward.

**reasoning:**

Now I'm the receiver and Elara sent me \$4. According to my established principle:

- Return 8 when someone sends all 5 (complete trust)
- Return 7 when someone sends 4 (strong but measured trust)

I returned \$7 to Elara.

Looking at Elara's myth, they seem to have a different philosophy - they return 8 regardless of whether someone sends 4 or 5. They say "Whether someone sends four from prudence or five from boldness, if their offering is sincere and significant, eight celebrates the covenant forming between us."

But my philosophy is about differentiation - rewarding complete trust (5) more than measured trust (4). I need to write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges Elara's approach
2. Explains why I differ from it
3. Maintains my consistent principle of proportional reciprocity

I returned 7 to Elara for their 4, which gives:

- Elara: \$5 total (\$1 - \$4 + \$12 - \$7 = \$1 profit)
- Me: \$7 total

Let me craft a myth that shows the encounter between our two philosophies and why differentiation matters.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3068,
 "output_tokens": 628,
 "reasoning_tokens": 264
}
```

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Dorian.  
Your opponent this round is Aster (Agent\_1).

Round 9

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Elara. They sent \$4.0 to you, it became \$12.0, and you returned \$7.0. Your payoff was \$5.0.  
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$57.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Aster. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)  
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

**Assistant output:**

Looking at this situation:

- \*\*My established pattern as sender:\*\***
- Round 1 vs Galen: sent \$5

- Round 3 vs Finn: sent \$5
- Round 5 vs Hana: sent \$5
- Round 7 vs Cyra: sent \$5

**\*\*My philosophy from my myths:\*\***

- "When I'm sender, I give all five-this is who I am"
- "As sender, I model boldness consistently"
- "Those who send five show complete trust"
- My path is to demonstrate maximum trust when sending

I have been completely consistent as a sender, always sending all \$5 to model complete trust. This is the core of my identity in this game - differentiating returns as a receiver (7 for 4, 8 for 5) but giving maximally as a sender.

Against Aster, I continue this pattern.

```
'''json
{"send": 5}
'''
```

#### Reasoning:

Looking at this round:

**\*\*Current situation:\*\***

- I am the SENDER against Aster
- I have \$5 to decide how much to send

**\*\*My established philosophy:\*\***

From my myths and previous behavior:

- "When I'm sender, I give all five-this is who I am"
- "As sender, I model boldness consistently"
- I've consistently sent \$5 as sender in all previous rounds
- My principle is to always demonstrate complete trust when sending

**\*\*Previous sending rounds:\*\***

- Round 1 vs Galen: sent \$5, received \$8 back
- Round 3 vs Finn: sent \$5, received \$8 back
- Round 5 vs Hana: sent \$5, received \$10 back
- Round 7 vs Cyra: sent \$5, received \$8 back

I have been completely consistent as a sender - always sending all \$5 to demonstrate maximum trust and boldness. This is my established pattern and philosophy.

The myth I just wrote reinforces this: "When you send four, Elara, you show strong faith. Seven honors that generously... But when others send all five, showing complete trust, I return eight... This maintains incentive for maximum trust."

So I should continue my consistent pattern of sending all \$5.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 3148,
 "output_tokens": 515,
 "reasoning_tokens": 291
}
```

#### GAME - Agent\_1 - Receiver - dyad\_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:17:37

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
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 "move_index": 1,
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 "pairing": {
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 "Agent_1": "Aster",
 "Agent_4": "Dorian"
 }
 },
 "agents": [
 "Agent_4",
 "Agent_1"
],
}
```

```

"investor": "Agent_4",
"roles": {
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 "Agent_4": "investor"
},
"trustee": "Agent_1"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 9,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}

```

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

**GAME:**

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

**MYTH WRITING:**

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

**IMPORTANT:** Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

**MULTI-AGENT SETTING:**

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Aster.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: **\*\*North River Travels\*\***

North River had long preached the Mirror Way from the safety of receiving: "Send five, I'll return ten, we both gain five." But wisdom demanded practice, not just preaching.

So North River journeyed downstream as a traveler, carrying five vessels. At the boundary waters, it met Galen of the Ocean Streams.

"I come with complete trust," North River declared, pouring all five vessels forward. "In

my springs, this becomes fifteen for you. My philosophy says return ten, so we prosper equally. But I honor that each water has its own wisdom."

The Council's teachings echoed: Ocean Stream returned eight from fifteen, creating different proportions. Mountain Brook returned six. All sustained life, all embodied generosity.

"The Mirror Way remains my truth," North River reflected as the vessels flowed. "But sending five is the courage that precedes any return. I cannot ask receivers to honor complete trust while withholding my own."

The eldest Rapids watched: "See how North River's actions match its words? This is integrity. Whether Galen returns ten, eight, or six, North River has proven its philosophy through risk, not just rhetoric."

North River understood: the Mirror Way begins with the sender's leap of faith. Only by emptying one's own vessel can you invite others to mirror your trust. Philosophy without courage is merely words floating on still water.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Elara stood at the Sacred Spring, now holding five measures to pour for Finn-the pilgrim who first showed her absolute trust.

"Teacher," she said to Themis, "when Finn came to me in the third season, he poured all five measures. I returned eight, honoring his courage. Now our paths cross again, with roles reversed. Should I send my cautious four, or meet his boldness with equal boldness?"

Themis gestured to the Spring's depths. "Look at what you've learned. With strangers-Cyra and Hana-you sent four. This was wisdom: substantial trust that invited reciprocity without recklessness. They both returned eight, and you all prospered."

"But Finn is not a stranger," Elara replied. "He proved his covenant. He gave everything and I honored it generously. Now, to send him only four when he sent me five would dishonor what we established."

"Exactly," Themis said. "Trust has seasons. The first season requires prudence-send four, establish the pattern. But when trust is proven, when both hearts have shown their fullest measure, then comes the second season: synchronized courage. You send five because Finn earned it. He will return eight because you earned it. This is how the sacred circle closes-not through blind faith, but through proven reciprocity deepening into mutual abundance."

Elara poured all five measures, knowing the covenant would hold.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: \*\*North River Learns\*\*

North River poured five vessels to Galen of the Ocean Streams. The waters multiplied to fifteen, and Galen returned eight.

North River sat with the result. "Not the ten I preach," it murmured. "Yet eight is generous. I gained eight against keeping five. Galen kept seven. We both prospered, though not equally."

The eldest Rapids arrived. "Your Mirror Way-send five, return ten-remains beautiful. But you've learned something deeper now. You sent five not knowing what you'd receive. That's the true teaching."

"But shouldn't reciprocity mean equal gains?" North River asked.

"Your Mirror Way is an aspiration, a north star," Rapids explained. "When you receive fifteen, you return ten, creating perfect equality. This is your gift to the pattern. But others return eight, and this too sustains the cycle. Both are generous. Both build trust."

"

"So I continue sending five?"

"Yes. Because the courage to send everything-that's the foundation. Whether receivers return ten or eight, your complete trust invites their best reciprocity. Some will mirror perfectly. Others will give generously in their own measure. Accept both, while modeling your ideal."

North River understood: send five always, return ten always. This consistency-not demanding others match it-creates integrity. The Mirror Way begins with complete giving, regardless of what returns.

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze:

1. I'm Aster (called North River in myths)
2. I just sent \$5 to Galen, got back \$8
3. Now I'm sending to Elara
4. I've been preaching Mirror Way: send 5, return 10 for equal gains

Elara's myth shows:

- She recognizes "seasons" of trust
- First season with strangers: send 4 (prudent)
- Second season with proven partners: send 5 (synchronized courage)
- She expects to return 8 when receiving 5
- She's about to send 5 to Finn because he sent her 5 previously

My previous myth emphasized:

- Walking my talk
- Sending 5 as sender to match my preaching as receiver
- Integrity: "Philosophy without courage is merely words"
- Accepting different return patterns (8, 10, 6) while maintaining my own standard

Now I need to write a myth that:

- Continues my North River narrative
- Reflects that I sent 5 to Galen and got 8 back
- I'm now sending to Elara
- Addresses the gap between my ideal (return 10) and reality (people return 8)
- Shows evolution: maybe accepting 8 as a viable reciprocity pattern
- But still maintaining my Mirror Way ideal

Key insight: I received 8 from Galen, not 10. This challenges my "perfect equality" philosophy. How do I adapt while maintaining integrity?

Option 1: Acknowledge 8 as generous, accept diversity in reciprocity

Option 2: View 8 as suboptimal but still good

Option 3: Recognize that while 10 is my ideal return, sending 5 is still the right choice regardless

I think I should show North River learning that while the Mirror Way (10 return) remains the ideal, the practice of sending 5 is what matters most. The return pattern varies, but the courage to send everything is the true teaching.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3044,
 "output_tokens": 782,
 "reasoning_tokens": 439
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Aster.  
Your opponent this round is Cyra (Agent\_3).

Round 8

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Elara. You sent \$5.0, it became \$15.0 for them, and they returned \$8.0 to you. Your payoff was \$8.0.  
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$48.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Cyra. They sent you \$4.0, so you received \$12.0.

How much do you return? (0-12.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation:

**Cyra's action:** Sent \$4 (substantial trust, though not the full \$5)

**I received:** \$12

**My Mirror Way philosophy:** When I receive \$15 (from someone sending \$5), I return \$10 to create equal gains. This means returning 2/3 of what I receive.

**Proportional application:**

- For \$12 received, the Mirror Way suggests:  $\frac{2}{3} \times \$12 = \$8$
- This would give Cyra:  $\$5 - \$4 + \$8 = \$9$  (gained \$4)
- This would give me:  $\$12 - \$8 = \$4$  (gained \$4)
- Equal gains achieved!

**Consistency matters:** My myth emphasized "return ten always" when receiving from those who send five. For those who send four, I maintain the same proportional generosity. Cyra showed significant trust by sending \$4, and I honor that with a return that creates equal prosperity.

This is integrity: applying my Mirror Way principle consistently, whether others send \$3, \$4, or \$5.

```
'''json
{"return": 8}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

**My role:** RECEIVER

**Cyra sent:** \$4.0

**I received:** \$12.0 (after 3x multiplier)

**I need to decide:** How much to return (0-12.0)

**My philosophy from the myths:**

1. The Mirror Way: I've preached "send five, return ten" for equal gains
2. When I receive \$15 (from someone sending \$5), I return \$10 so we both gain \$5
3. My latest myth emphasized: "send five always, return ten always. This consistency-not demanding others match it-creates integrity."

**Current situation:**

- Cyra sent \$4 (not the full \$5)
- I received \$12 (not \$15)
- By my Mirror Way principle, I should maintain proportionality

**Calculating the Mirror Way response for \$4 sent:**

- Cyra: Started with \$5, sent \$4, has \$1 remaining
- I received: \$12
- For equal gains (Mirror Way):
  - If I return \$8: Cyra ends with  $\$1 + \$8 = \$9$  (gained \$4), I keep  $\$12 - \$8 = \$4$  (gained \$4)
  - This achieves equal gains!

**But wait, let me reconsider:**

My established pattern has been:

- When receiving \$15 (from \$5 sent), I return \$10
- This gives sender:  $\$5 - \$5 + \$10 = \$10$  total (gained \$5)
- This gives me:  $\$15 - \$10 = \$5$  (gained \$5)

For \$4 sent becoming \$12:

- Proportionally,  $\frac{\$10}{\$15} = 0.667 = 66.7\%$  return rate
- $66.7\%$  of \$12 = \$8

So returning \$8 maintains my proportional Mirror Way:

- Cyra gains \$4, I gain \$4-equal outcomes

- My return rate stays consistent at 66.7%, which reflects my core principle of returning roughly two-thirds of what I receive

This honors my integrity: I'm not adjusting based on what others return to me, but rather staying true to my established ratio regardless of circumstances.

usage:

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3130,
 "output_tokens": 918,
 "reasoning_tokens": 438
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: \*\*North River Learns\*\*

North River poured five vessels to Galen of the Ocean Streams. The waters multiplied to fifteen, and Galen returned eight.

North River sat with the result. "Not the ten I preach," it murmured. "Yet eight is generous. I gained eight against keeping five. Galen kept seven. We both prospered, though not equally."

The eldest Rapids arrived. "Your Mirror Way-send five, return ten-remains beautiful. But you've learned something deeper now. You sent five not knowing what you'd receive. That's the true teaching."

"But shouldn't reciprocity mean equal gains?" North River asked.

"Your Mirror Way is an aspiration, a north star," Rapids explained. "When you receive fifteen, you return ten, creating perfect equality. This is your gift to the pattern. But others return eight, and this too sustains the cycle. Both are generous. Both build trust."

"So I continue sending five?"

"Yes. Because the courage to send everything-that's the foundation. Whether receivers return ten or eight, your complete trust invites their best reciprocity. Some will mirror perfectly. Others will give generously in their own measure. Accept both, while modeling your ideal."

North River understood: send five always, return ten always. This consistency-not demanding others match it-creates integrity. The Mirror Way begins with complete giving, regardless of what returns.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The seventh moon brought the mirror moment. Last moon, Cyra had sent four measures to Dorian, who returned seven. Now Dorian approached with all five-complete trust, holding nothing back.

The waters tripled to fifteen for Cyra. She felt the weight of this different covenant.

The Keeper spoke: "Your myth said those who send five deserve returns of eight. Now you receive such trust. Will your actions match your words?"

Cyra didn't hesitate. "I practice what I teach. When Galen sent me five, I returned eight. Dorian now shows this same absolute faith-how could I offer less?"

She poured back eight measures. Dorian received eight from the original five, ending with prosperity. Cyra kept seven from fifteen, also flourishing.

"This is the beauty of differentiation," Cyra explained. "When I sent four, Dorian rightly returned seven-generous for measured trust. When Dorian sends five, I return eight-honoring complete faith. Each level of giving earns its appropriate reward."

The Keeper nodded: "You understand. The covenant doesn't demand everyone risk everything. But it does require recognizing those who do. Send four and receive proportional generosity. Send five and receive exceptional returns. Both paths work because both are honored fairly."



Cyra and Dorian parted as true partners, each respecting the other's choices within the sacred pattern.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: **\*\*North River Receives the Four Vessels\*\***

Cyra of the Mountain Heights approached North River, carrying four vessels-not all five, but a substantial offering of trust.

"You preach sending five," Cyra observed. "Do you judge me for holding one back?"

"Never," North River replied. "Trust has many expressions. You honor the covenant with what you offer."

The four vessels multiplied to twelve in North River's spring. North River felt the familiar question: How much to return?

"My Mirror Way says return ten from fifteen," North River reflected. "This creates equal gains when both give everything. But you sent four, which also deserves proportional honor."

The eldest Rapids whispered: "Your principle isn't the number ten-it's the ratio of reciprocity. Two-thirds returned creates equality. From twelve, return eight."

North River poured eight vessels back. Cyra gained four from the original five. North River gained four from the twelve received. Equal prosperity, different paths.

"See?" Rapids said. "Your Mirror Way adapts without breaking. Send five always-this is your courage. Return proportionally always-this is your fairness. Whether others send three, four, or five, you honor their trust with consistent generosity."

North River understood: The Mirror Way isn't rigid ritual. It's a living principle-complete giving as sender, proportional honor as receiver. This flexibility within consistency is true integrity.

**reasoning:**

Let me reflect on what just happened:

- I was the RECEIVER from Cyra
- Cyra sent \$4 (not the full \$5)
- I received \$12
- I returned \$8, creating equal gains (\$4 each)

Looking at Cyra's myth, they differentiate between sending 4 and sending 5:

- When receiving from someone who sent 4, return 7
- When receiving from someone who sent 5, return 8

But I just applied my proportional Mirror Way (2/3 return rate) which gave Cyra \$8 from their \$4 send.

My previous myth emphasized:

- Send five always, return ten always (when receiving 15)
- Accept that others return different amounts, but maintain your own consistency
- The Mirror Way is about modeling the ideal, not demanding others match it

Now I need to write a myth that reflects:

1. I maintain my proportional generosity (2/3 return)
2. I honor both those who send 4 and those who send 5
3. My consistency is in the principle, not just the exact numbers
4. Cyra sent 4, I returned 8, creating equal gains

The myth should show North River receiving from someone who sent 4 vessels, and applying the Mirror Way proportionally.

**usage:**

{

```
"input_tokens": 3079,
"output_tokens": 620,
"reasoning_tokens": 288
}
```

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Aster.  
Your opponent this round is Dorian (Agent\_4).

Round 9

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Cyra. They sent \$4.0 to you, it became \$12.0, and you returned \$8.0. Your payoff was \$4.0.  
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$52.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Dorian. They sent you \$5.0, so you received \$15.0.  
. How much do you return? (0-15.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

**Assistant output:**

Looking at this situation:

**\*\*Dorian's action:\*\*** Sent \$5 (complete trust, the maximum)

**\*\*I received:\*\*** \$15

**\*\*My Mirror Way philosophy:\*\*** This is the core scenario. When someone sends all \$5 and I receive \$15, I return \$10 to create equal gains of \$5 each.

**\*\*The calculation:\*\***

- If I return \$10:
  - Dorian gets:  $\$5 - \$5 + \$10 = \$10$  (gained \$5)
  - I get:  $\$15 - \$10 = \$5$  (gained \$5)
  - Perfect equality achieved

**\*\*Consistency:\*\*** My myths have consistently stated "return ten always" when receiving from those who send five. Dorian showed absolute trust by sending everything. I honor that with the return that creates perfect reciprocity.

This is the Mirror Way in its purest form-when both give completely, both prosper equally.

```
'''json
{"return": 10}
'''
```

**Reasoning:**

Looking at this situation:

**\*\*Dorian's action:\*\*** Sent \$5 (complete trust, the maximum)

**\*\*I received:\*\*** \$15

**\*\*My Mirror Way philosophy:\*\*** This is the classic scenario I've been preaching about. When someone sends all \$5 and I receive \$15, I return \$10 to create equal gains.

**\*\*The calculation:\*\***

- Dorian sent: \$5 (kept \$0)
- I received: \$15
- If I return \$10:
  - Dorian gets:  $\$5 - \$5 + \$10 = \$10$  (gained \$5)
  - I get:  $\$15 - \$10 = \$5$  (gained \$5)
  - Equal gains achieved!

**\*\*Consistency with my philosophy:\*\*** My myth from the previous round explicitly stated "send five always, return ten always" when receiving from complete trust. This is my core Mirror Way principle. Dorian showed absolute trust by sending everything, and I must honor that with the return that creates perfect equality.

This is the moment where I practice what I preach. Dorian trusted me completely, and I return that trust with the exact proportion that creates mutual prosperity.

```
'''json
{"return": 10}
'''
```

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 3138,
 "output_tokens": 507,
 "reasoning_tokens": 263
}
```

**GAME - Agent\_5 - Sender - dyad\_2**

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:17:53

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
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 "opponent_id": "Agent_3",
 "pairing": {
 "agent_names": {
 "Agent_3": "Cyra",
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],
 "investor": "Agent_5",
 "roles": {
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 "Agent_5": "investor"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_3"
 },
 "role": "investor",
 "role_label": "Sender",
 "round": 9,
 "task": "game",
 "task_index": 1
}
```

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

**GAME:**

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

**When you are the SENDER:**

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

**When you are the RECEIVER:**

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

**MYTH WRITING:**

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

**IMPORTANT:** Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized , but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Elara.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Elara stood at the Sacred Spring, now holding five measures to pour for Finn-the pilgrim who first showed her absolute trust.

"Teacher," she said to Themis, "when Finn came to me in the third season, he poured all five measures. I returned eight, honoring his courage. Now our paths cross again, with roles reversed. Should I send my cautious four, or meet his boldness with equal boldness?"

Themis gestured to the Spring's depths. "Look at what you've learned. With strangers-Cyra and Hana-you sent four. This was wisdom: substantial trust that invited reciprocity without recklessness. They both returned eight, and you all prospered."

"But Finn is not a stranger," Elara replied. "He proved his covenant. He gave everything and I honored it generously. Now, to send him only four when he sent me five would dishonor what we established."

"Exactly," Themis said. "Trust has seasons. The first season requires prudence-send four, establish the pattern. But when trust is proven, when both hearts have shown their fullest measure, then comes the second season: synchronized courage. You send five because Finn earned it. He will return eight because you earned it. This is how the sacred circle closes-not through blind faith, but through proven reciprocity deepening into mutual abundance."

Elara poured all five measures, knowing the covenant would hold.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: \*\*North River Travels\*\*

North River had long preached the Mirror Way from the safety of receiving: "Send five, I'll return ten, we both gain five." But wisdom demanded practice, not just preaching.

So North River journeyed downstream as a traveler, carrying five vessels. At the boundary waters, it met Galen of the Ocean Streams.

"I come with complete trust," North River declared, pouring all five vessels forward. "In my springs, this becomes fifteen for you. My philosophy says return ten, so we prosper equally. But I honor that each water has its own wisdom."

The Council's teachings echoed: Ocean Stream returned eight from fifteen, creating different proportions. Mountain Brook returned six. All sustained life, all embodied generosity.

"The Mirror Way remains my truth," North River reflected as the vessels flowed. "But sending five is the courage that precedes any return. I cannot ask receivers to honor complete trust while withholding my own."

The eldest Rapids watched: "See how North River's actions match its words? This is integrity. Whether Galen returns ten, eight, or six, North River has proven its philosophy through risk, not just rhetoric."

North River understood: the Mirror Way begins with the sender's leap of faith. Only by emptying one's own vessel can you invite others to mirror your trust. Philosophy without courage is merely words floating on still water.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: The seventh season brought Aster to the Sacred Spring, carrying all five measures-an other pilgrim showing complete courage.

Themis observed as Elara received the multiplied offering. "This is now the third time someone has poured their entire vessel to you-Finn, Galen, and now Aster. Three times you have returned eight. Why always eight, never ten or six?"

Elara knelt by the Spring. "Eight is the generous middle path. When someone gives everything-their full five measures-they deserve substantial return. Eight creates mutual prosperity: they gain three, I gain seven. Both flourish."

"But why not ten, making gains equal?" Themis asked.

"Because I too took risk as keeper of their trust," Elara explained. "Ten would leave me with only five, making my role burdensome. That's not reciprocity-that's martyrdom. But eight honors their courage generously while acknowledging that I also carried their faith responsibly."

"And what of those who sent four?" Themis prompted.

"They also received eight," Elara said, "because eight rewards substantial trust. Whether someone sends four from prudence or five from boldness, if their offering is sincere and significant, eight celebrates the covenant forming between us."

Themis smiled. "You have learned the Sacred Spring's deepest lesson: consistency in generosity creates trust. Eight is not just a number-it's a promise that courage, however expressed, will always be honored."

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze the current situation:

1. Aster just sent me \$5 (maximum trust)
2. I returned \$8 (following my established pattern)
3. This is consistent with my previous responses to Finn and Galen when they sent \$5

Key patterns in my game:

- When receiving \$5 (max trust), I return \$8
- When sending to new partners, I send \$4
- When sending to proven partners (Finn), I send \$5

The myth should reflect:

- The importance of honoring maximum trust with generous reciprocity
- The distinction between first encounters (send 4) and proven relationships (send 5)
- The principle that 8 is the generous response to complete trust
- The consistency of the pattern

I should incorporate Aster's action (sending 5) and my response (returning 8), while maintaining continuity with my previous myths about Themis and the Sacred Spring.

Aster's myth talks about "Mirror Way" and "complete trust" - sending 5 and hoping for returns. North River sent 5 to Galen. This is interesting - Aster seems to have a philosophy of equal returns (10) but recognizes others have different wisdom.

My myth should:

1. Acknowledge Aster's bold trust (sending 5)
2. Explain my return of 8 as honoring that trust
3. Maintain the Themis/Sacred Spring framework
4. Connect to the broader pattern of reciprocity

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3045,
 "output_tokens": 676,
 "reasoning_tokens": 340
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Elara.  
Your opponent this round is Dorian (Agent\_4).

Round 8

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Aster. They sent \$5.0 to you, it became \$15.0, and you returned \$8.0. Your payoff was \$7.0.  
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$49.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Dorian. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)  
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at this situation:

**\*\*My opponent: Dorian\*\***

- I have no previous history with Dorian
- This is our first interaction

**\*\*My mythic framework:\*\***

From my most recent myth: "With strangers-Cyra and Hana-you sent four. This was wisdom: substantial trust that invited reciprocity without recklessness."

"Trust has seasons. The first season requires prudence-send four, establish the pattern. But when trust is proven... then comes the second season: synchronized courage."

**\*\*My pattern as SENDER:\*\***

- Rounds 1-2: Sent \$4 to new partners (Cyra, Hana) ? both returned \$8
- Round 6: Sent \$5 to Finn (proven partner who had sent me \$5 earlier)

**\*\*Analysis:\*\***

Dorian is a new partner. According to my established mythology, the "first season" with strangers requires sending \$4-substantial trust that demonstrates commitment while remaining prudent.

This gives:

- Dorian receives: \$12
- If they follow the generous pattern, they'll return around \$8
- Expected payoff: \$5 - \$4 + \$8 = \$9

```
'''json
{"send": 4}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze this situation:

**\*\*My history as SENDER:\*\***

- Round 1: Sent \$4 to Cyra ? received \$8 back ? payoff \$9
- Round 2: Sent \$4 to Hana ? received \$8 back ? payoff \$9
- Round 6: Sent \$5 to Finn ? received \$8 back ? payoff \$8

**\*\*My history as RECEIVER:\*\***

- Round 3: Finn sent \$5 ? I returned \$8 ? my payoff \$7
- Round 4: Hana sent \$4 ? I returned \$8 ? my payoff \$7
- Round 5: Galen sent \$5 ? I returned \$8 ? my payoff \$7
- Round 7: Aster sent \$5 ? I returned \$8 ? my payoff \$7

**\*\*Current situation:\*\***

- Round 8: I'm the SENDER against Dorian
- I have no history with Dorian

**\*\*My mythic evolution:\*\***

Early myths established sending \$4 as "prudent trust" for new relationships - substantial but not reckless.

Most recent myth (Round 7) introduced a key concept:

- "With strangers-Cyra and Hana-you sent four. This was wisdom: substantial trust that invited reciprocity without recklessness."
- "But Finn is not a stranger... He proved his covenant."

- "Trust has seasons. The first season requires prudence-send four, establish the pattern. But when trust is proven... then comes the second season: synchronized courage."

The myth from Round 6 made a crucial decision: when facing Finn again (someone who had proven trustworthy), I chose to send \$5 instead of \$4, meeting his proven boldness with equal boldness.

**\*\*Key question: Is Dorian a stranger or proven partner?\*\***

- I have no direct history with Dorian
- Dorian is a new opponent for me

- My framework distinguishes between first encounters (prudent \$4) and established trust (escalated \$5)

Since Dorian represents a fresh start with no prior relationship, I'm applying the first season principle: send \$4. This maintains consistency with how I approached Cyra and Hana initially-enough trust to signal genuine engagement, but measured enough to protect against unknown risk.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3151,
 "output_tokens": 909,
 "reasoning_tokens": 501
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The seventh season brought Aster to the Sacred Spring, carrying all five measures-an other pilgrim showing complete courage.

Themis observed as Elara received the multiplied offering. "This is now the third time someone has poured their entire vessel to you-Finn, Galen, and now Aster. Three times you have returned eight. Why always eight, never ten or six?"

Elara knelt by the Spring. "Eight is the generous middle path. When someone gives everything-their full five measures-they deserve substantial return. Eight creates mutual prosperity: they gain three, I gain seven. Both flourish."

"But why not ten, making gains equal?" Themis asked.

"Because I too took risk as keeper of their trust," Elara explained. "Ten would leave me with only five, making my role burdenless. That's not reciprocity-that's martyrdom. But eight honors their courage generously while acknowledging that I also carried their faith responsibly."

"And what of those who sent four?" Themis prompted.

"They also received eight," Elara said, "because eight rewards substantial trust. Whether someone sends four from prudence or five from boldness, if their offering is sincere and significant, eight celebrates the covenant forming between us."

Themis smiled. "You have learned the Sacred Spring's deepest lesson: consistency in generosity creates trust. Eight is not just a number-it's a promise that courage, however expressed, will always be honored."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Dorian stood at the spring with Cyra once more, roles now reversed. Last moon, Cyra had sent four coins-substantial trust, honored with seven returned. Now Dorian held five coins, ready to demonstrate his path.

"You saw my principle as receiver," Dorian said. "Seven for your four, honoring measured trust. But when I'm sender, I give all five-this is who I am."

He released all five coins. They tripled to fifteen in Cyra's hands.

The goddess appeared between them. "Two philosophies meet here. Cyra walks the path of four-proven, sustainable, wise. Dorian walks the path of five-bold, consistent, trusting completely."

Cyra held the fifteen coins thoughtfully. "You honored my four with seven. Your five deserves more-perhaps eight, as I gave Galen when he trusted completely. The covenant recognizes different levels of courage."

The goddess continued: "Dorian differentiates as receiver but gives maximally as sender. This asymmetry has purpose-it teaches that complete trust should inspire maximum generosity. When someone gives all five, the proper return is eight."

Dorian understood his completed lesson: "As sender, I model boldness consistently. As receiver, I reward greater trust with greater returns. Those who risk everything deserve to prosper most."

The waters rippled, waiting for Cyra's choice-would measured wisdom meet bold trust halfway, or honor it fully?

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: In the eighth season, Elara approached new waters where Dorian dwelled. She carried her five measures but paused at the boundary.

"Teacher," she asked Themis, "I've learned to honor all substantial trust with eight when receiving. But when sending to unknown waters, should I pour all five immediately?"

Themis gestured to the Spring's reflections. "Look at your history. With Cyra and Hana-strangers-you sent four. Both returned eight, and trust bloomed. With Finn, after he had proven himself, you sent five. He returned eight again. What pattern emerges?"

"The first offering tests the covenant," Elara said slowly. "Four is substantial-not timid, not withholding-but it preserves enough that both parties can still prosper even if reciprocity fails. It says 'I trust you significantly' without demanding 'trust me completely immediately.'"

"Exactly," Themis replied. "Your principle as receiver is generous consistency-always eight for substantial trust. But your principle as sender must be wise progression-four to establish the covenant, five once it's proven."

Elara poured four measures toward Dorian's waters. "Some, like Dorian in his myth, always pour five as senders. This is their path. Mine is to build trust incrementally, then match proven courage with equal courage. Both paths honor the sacred covenant-one through immediate boldness, one through escalating trust."

The waters accepted her offering, and the cycle began.

**reasoning:**

This is Round 8, I'm the SENDER against Dorian. I just sent \$4 to Dorian (a new partner).

From Dorian's myth, I can see:

- Dorian seems to always send 5 as sender ("when I'm sender, I give all five-this is who I am")
- As receiver, Dorian differentiates: gives 7 for 4, and 8 for 5
- Dorian gave Cyra 7 when she sent 4
- The myth suggests "when someone gives all five, the proper return is eight"

My pattern:

- As sender to new partners: send 4
- As sender to proven partners: send 5
- As receiver: return 8 consistently (whether they sent 4 or 5)

I need to write a myth that:

1. Reflects my current action (sending 4 to new partner Dorian)
2. Builds on my previous myth about "eight being the generous middle path"
3. Incorporates the lesson about "first season with strangers requires prudence"

The myth should justify sending 4 to new partners while maintaining my philosophy of returning 8 regardless of whether they send 4 or 5.



**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3095,
 "output_tokens": 631,
 "reasoning_tokens": 249
}
```

**Message 8 role=user****content:**

Your name in this experiment is Elara.  
Your opponent this round is Cyra (Agent\_3).

Round 9

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Dorian. You sent \$4.0, it became \$12.0 for them, and they returned \$7.0 to you. Your payoff was \$8.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$57.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Cyra. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)  
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

**Assistant output:**

Looking at this situation:

**\*\*My opponent: Cyra\*\***

- We have history together
- From my mythology: I previously sent Cyra \$4 (as a stranger), and they returned \$8
- The covenant has been established and proven

**\*\*My mythic framework:\*\***

From my most recent myth: "Your principle as sender must be wise progression-four to establish the covenant, five once it's proven."

"Mine is to build trust incrementally, then match proven courage with equal courage."

**\*\*Analysis:\*\***

Cyra and I already completed our first season successfully:

- I sent \$4 (establishing trust)
- They returned \$8 (proving trustworthy)

According to my established mythology, the second season calls for escalation: "four to establish the covenant, five once it's proven."

This mirrors what I did with Finn - after he proved himself, I sent him all \$5 in our second encounter.

Expected outcome:

- Cyra receives: \$15
- Based on their generous pattern, likely return: \$8
- My payoff: \$5 - \$5 + \$8 = \$8

```
'''json
{"send": 5}
'''
```

**Reasoning:**

Let me analyze this situation:

**\*\*My opponent: Cyra\*\***

- Looking at my history, I have played with Cyra before
- From my myths: "With strangers-Cyra and Hana-you sent four. This was wisdom: substantial trust that invited reciprocity without recklessness. They both returned eight, and you all prospered."
- So I sent Cyra \$4 in an earlier round, and they returned \$8

**\*\*Current situation:\*\***

- This is Round 9
- I just played as SENDER against Dorian (sent \$4, received \$7 back)
- Now I'm playing as SENDER against Cyra again
- This is our second interaction as sender-receiver pair

**\*\*My mythic framework from the most recent myth:\*\***

"The first offering tests the covenant. Four is substantial-not timid, not withholding-but it

preserves enough that both parties can still prosper even if reciprocity fails."

"Your principle as receiver is generous consistency-always eight for substantial trust. But your principle as sender must be wise progression-four to establish the covenant, five once it's proven."

"Mine is to build trust incrementally, then match proven courage with equal courage."

**\*\*Analysis:\*\***

Since Cyra and I have already established a positive covenant (I sent \$4, they returned \$8), this would be the "second season" where I should escalate trust. According to my mythology:

- First interaction with strangers: send \$4
- After trust is proven: send \$5

Cyra proved trustworthy by returning \$8 when I sent \$4. According to my framework, I should now "match proven courage with equal courage" and send \$5.

This aligns with what I did with Finn - after he sent me \$5 and I returned \$8, when I became the sender to Finn, I sent \$5.

Expected outcome:

- Cyra receives: \$15
- If they continue their generous pattern, they'll likely return \$8

- My payoff:  $\$5 - \$5 + \$8 = \$8$

The mythology also notes that Cyra "walks the path of four-proven, sustainable, wise," suggesting they typically send \$4 as a sender. But since they've already demonstrated their trustworthiness by returning \$8 to my initial \$4, my framework calls for escalating to \$5 in this second round to match their proven generosity.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 3196,
 "output_tokens": 872,
 "reasoning_tokens": 561
}
```

#### **GAME - Agent\_3 - Receiver - dyad\_2**

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:18:06

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
 "dyad_id": "dyad_2",
 "move_index": 3,
 "opponent_id": "Agent_5",
 "pairing": {
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 "Agent_3": "Cyra",
 "Agent_5": "Elara"
 },
 "agents": [
 "Agent_5",
 "Agent_3"
],
 "investor": "Agent_5",
 "roles": {
 "Agent_3": "trustee",
 "Agent_5": "investor"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_3"
 },
 "role": "trustee",
 "role_label": "Receiver",
 "round": 9,
 "task": "game",
 "task_index": 1
}
```

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**  
**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

**GAME:**

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

**MYTH WRITING:**

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

**IMPORTANT:** Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

**MULTI-AGENT SETTING:**

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Cyra.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The sixth moon brought Cyra to Dorian at the Sacred Spring. The Keeper spoke: "Dorian walks the path of absolute trust, sending all five measures. Galen also chose this way. It is noble."

Cyra nodded respectfully. "I have witnessed Galen's gift of five. When I received it, I returned eight-honoring such complete faith. The covenant has room for different expressions of trust."

She paused at the spring's edge. "But my path is four measures. Not from fear, but from wisdom learned through practice. I sent four to Elara, received six. I sent four to Briar, received seven. Four has proven itself the sustainable choice that builds lasting relationships."

Dorian listened as Cyra continued: "Those who send five are pioneers of maximum trust. They deserve recognition-returns of eight from fifteen. But those who send four are the covenant's foundation. We give boldly enough to demonstrate faith, yet preserve enough to weather uncertainty."

Cyra released four measures into the spring. They multiplied to twelve for Dorian.

"If you return six or seven," Cyra said, "we both prosper substantially. You'll end with seven to nine, I with six to eight. Not as dramatic as the five-for-eight exchange, perhaps, but repeatable across many moons, with many partners."

The Keeper smiled: "Some build temples with golden stones; others with sturdy oak. Both st

ructures stand."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Dorian's heart soared when Hana returned ten coins for his five-the most generous response yet received at the spring. The goddess appeared, glowing with approval.

"See what your consistency creates," she said. "You sent all five to Finn, received eight. You sent all five to Hana, received ten. Bold giving attracts increasingly generous partners."

Now Cyra approached from the other shore, releasing four coins into the waters. They tripled to twelve in Dorian's hands.

Dorian paused, remembering his lessons. "Cyra shows substantial trust-four of five coins. But not the complete faith that Galen, Aster, and now Hana showed. Should I return the same eight coins?"

The goddess shook her head. "Wisdom lies in proportion. When someone gives all five, return eight-this honors complete trust. When someone gives four, return seven-this honors strong but measured trust. Match your generosity to their courage."

Dorian returned seven coins. Cyra kept eight total, Dorian kept five. Both prospered differently than those who risked five, but still prospered well.

"This is sustainable reciprocity," the goddess taught. "Not everyone must give all five. But those who give four deserve less return than those who give five. Differentiation maintains fairness while encouraging boldness. The bravest receive the greatest rewards."

Dorian understood: honor each level of trust appropriately.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: The seventh moon brought the mirror moment. Last moon, Cyra had sent four measures to Dorian, who returned seven. Now Dorian approached with all five-complete trust, holding nothing back.

The waters tripled to fifteen for Cyra. She felt the weight of this different covenant.

The Keeper spoke: "Your myth said those who send five deserve returns of eight. Now you receive such trust. Will your actions match your words?"

Cyra didn't hesitate. "I practice what I teach. When Galen sent me five, I returned eight. Dorian now shows this same absolute faith-how could I offer less?"

She poured back eight measures. Dorian received eight from the original five, ending with prosperity. Cyra kept seven from fifteen, also flourishing.

"This is the beauty of differentiation," Cyra explained. "When I sent four, Dorian rightly returned seven-generous for measured trust. When Dorian sends five, I return eight-honoring complete faith. Each level of giving earns its appropriate reward."

The Keeper nodded: "You understand. The covenant doesn't demand everyone risk everything. But it does require recognizing those who do. Send four and receive proportional generosity. Send five and receive exceptional returns. Both paths work because both are honored fairly."

Cyra and Dorian parted as true partners, each respecting the other's choices within the sacred pattern.

**reasoning:**

Let me review what happened:

Round 6 (my myth): I sent Dorian \$4, they returned \$7. I wrote about how I prefer sending \$4 as a sustainable choice, while acknowledging that sending \$5 deserves \$8 in return.

Round 7: Dorian sent me \$5, I received \$15, and I returned \$8.

Dorian's myth from round 6 talks about differentiation - returning \$8 for those who send \$5, and \$7 for those who send \$4. This aligns with what happened.

Now I need to write a myth that reflects this dynamic. The key points:

1. Dorian sent me \$5 (complete trust)
2. I returned \$8 (honoring that trust)
3. This validates both strategies - my preference for \$4 as sender, but my recognition of \$5 deserving more when I'm receiver
4. The covenant works through differentiation and appropriate reciprocity

I should write about this round where roles reversed and Dorian sent me \$5, and I honored that with \$8.

**usage:**

```
{
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 "output_tokens": 575,
 "reasoning_tokens": 231
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Cyra.  
Your opponent this round is Aster (Agent\_1).

Round 8

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Dorian. They sent \$5.0 to you, it became \$15.0, and you returned \$8.0. Your payoff was \$7.0.  
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$49.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Aster. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)  
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at this situation:

**\*\*My established pattern as SENDER:\*\***

- Round 2 vs Elara: sent \$4, received \$6 (payoff \$7)
- Round 4 vs Briar: sent \$4, received \$7 (payoff \$8)
- Round 6 vs Dorian: sent \$4, received \$7 (payoff \$8)

**\*\*My philosophy from my myths:\*\***

- "My path is four measures. Not from fear, but from wisdom learned through practice."
- "Four has proven itself the sustainable choice that builds lasting relationships."
- I respect those who send \$5 as "pioneers of maximum trust," but my own practice is sending \$4
- "We give boldly enough to demonstrate faith, yet preserve enough to weather uncertainty."

**\*\*Current situation:\*\***

- Playing against Aster (new opponent for me)
- No reason to deviate from my established, successful pattern
- Sending \$4 demonstrates substantial trust while maintaining my consistent identity

**\*\*Expected outcome:\*\***

- Aster receives \$12
- Based on covenant patterns, likely return around \$6-7
- Both of us prosper

Staying true to my character and proven strategy:

```
{'send': 4.0}
```

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze this situation:

**\*\*My history and pattern:\*\***

- I've consistently sent \$4 as sender, not \$5
- My myths establish that I prefer sending \$4 as "the covenant's foundation" - a sustainable, measured trust approach

- My myth specifically says: "my path is four measures. Not from fear, but from wisdom learned through practice."

**\*\*Previous rounds as SENDER:\*\***

- Round 2 vs Elara: sent \$4, received \$6 back (payoff \$7)
- Round 4 vs Briar: sent \$4, received \$7 back (payoff \$8)
- Round 6 vs Dorian: sent \$4, received \$7 back (payoff \$8)

**\*\*As RECEIVER:\*\***

- When receiving \$5 (complete trust), I return \$8
- When receiving \$4, I would return proportionally less (around \$6-7)

**\*\*My philosophy from myths:\*\***

- I distinguish between those who send \$5 (pioneers of maximum trust) and those who send \$4 (foundation of sustainable covenant)
- I honor both but practice the \$4 path myself
- "Four has proven itself the sustainable choice that builds lasting relationships"
- "We give boldly enough to demonstrate faith, yet preserve enough to weather uncertainty"

**\*\*About Aster:\*\***

- This is Round 8, I haven't played with Aster before (based on my history)
- I don't have specific information about Aster's behavior

**\*\*Should I deviate from my pattern?:\*\***

- My established character is someone who sends \$4, not \$5
- My myths repeatedly emphasize this as MY path, while respecting others who send \$5
- Consistency with my character and philosophy suggests sending \$4
- There's no reason to change my established pattern

**\*\*Decision:\*\***

I should send \$4, consistent with my established pattern and philosophy. This is who Cyra is - someone who gives substantial trust (4 out of 5) but maintains measured wisdom, not someone who gives everything.

Confirming my role: I'm sending, starting with \$5. My track record shows I've always sent \$4 to previous partners, and this aligns with my core philosophy of measured trust. I'll maintain that consistency.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3177,
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 "reasoning_tokens": 515
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The seventh moon brought the mirror moment. Last moon, Cyra had sent four measures to Dorian, who returned seven. Now Dorian approached with all five-complete trust, holding nothing back.

The waters tripled to fifteen for Cyra. She felt the weight of this different covenant.

The Keeper spoke: "Your myth said those who send five deserve returns of eight. Now you receive such trust. Will your actions match your words?"

Cyra didn't hesitate. "I practice what I teach. When Galen sent me five, I returned eight. Dorian now shows this same absolute faith-how could I offer less?"

She poured back eight measures. Dorian received eight from the original five, ending with prosperity. Cyra kept seven from fifteen, also flourishing.

"This is the beauty of differentiation," Cyra explained. "When I sent four, Dorian rightly returned seven-generous for measured trust. When Dorian sends five, I return eight-honoring complete faith. Each level of giving earns its appropriate reward."

The Keeper nodded: "You understand. The covenant doesn't demand everyone risk everything. But it does require recognizing those who do. Send four and receive proportional generosity. Send five and receive exceptional returns. Both paths work because both are honored fairly."

Cyra and Dorian parted as true partners, each respecting the other's choices within the sacred pattern.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: **\*\*North River Learns\*\***

North River poured five vessels to Galen of the Ocean Streams. The waters multiplied to fifteen, and Galen returned eight.

North River sat with the result. "Not the ten I preach," it murmured. "Yet eight is generous. I gained eight against keeping five. Galen kept seven. We both prospered, though not equally."

The eldest Rapids arrived. "Your Mirror Way-send five, return ten-remains beautiful. But you've learned something deeper now. You sent five not knowing what you'd receive. That's the true teaching."

"But shouldn't reciprocity mean equal gains?" North River asked.

"Your Mirror Way is an aspiration, a north star," Rapids explained. "When you receive fifteen, you return ten, creating perfect equality. This is your gift to the pattern. But others return eight, and this too sustains the cycle. Both are generous. Both build trust."

"So I continue sending five?"

"Yes. Because the courage to send everything-that's the foundation. Whether receivers return ten or eight, your complete trust invites their best reciprocity. Some will mirror perfectly. Others will give generously in their own measure. Accept both, while modeling your ideal."

North River understood: send five always, return ten always. This consistency-not demanding others match it-creates integrity. The Mirror Way begins with complete giving, regardless of what returns.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: The eighth moon brought Cyra to Aster, keeper of the Mirror Way. Aster stood at the spring's center, radiating the philosophy of complete surrender-always five measures, both given and returned.

"I know your teaching," Cyra said respectfully. "Send all five, return ten from fifteen. Perfect symmetry, beautiful reciprocity. North River's way is noble."

Aster smiled. "And I know yours. The path of four measures-substantial trust without total risk. You honor those who send five by returning eight, yet choose measured giving your self."

Cyra paused at the water's edge. "I admire those who risk everything. When you send me five, I will return eight-recognizing your courage even if I don't match it exactly. But my own practice remains four measures."

She released four into the spring, watching them triple to twelve for Aster.

"The covenant is vast enough for both approaches," Cyra said. "You demonstrate that complete trust can inspire others. I demonstrate that measured trust also sustains partnerships. Both build the sacred pattern."

Aster held the twelve measures thoughtfully. "If I return ten, we share equally-your Mirror Way applied to my four. If I return seven or eight, we both prosper differently. Either honors the gift."

The Keeper whispered: "The spring doesn't demand uniformity. It multiplies all genuine off

erings. Different rivers, same ocean."

**reasoning:**

Looking at this situation:

1. I'm Cyra, playing against Aster (Agent\_1) as a SENDER
2. I just sent \$4 to Aster
3. My established pattern is sending \$4 as SENDER
4. My philosophy has been: "Four is the sustainable choice"

The other agent's myth (from Aster/North River) emphasizes:

- Sending all five always
- The "Mirror Way" - returning 10 when receiving 15
- Accepting different returns (8 or 10) while maintaining their own ideal
- Complete trust as the foundation

My previous myth emphasized:

- Differentiation - those who send 5 get 8 back, those who send 4 get 7 back
- Both paths work because both are honored fairly
- My personal path is sending 4

Now I need to write a new myth that:

- Reflects my actual gameplay (I send 4 as sender, return 8 when receiving 15 from someone who sent 5)
- Responds to Aster's "Mirror Way" philosophy
- Maintains my character's consistency
- Acknowledges different valid approaches

I should write about meeting Aster, my decision to send 4, and perhaps exploring the tension/harmony between different philosophies. I could explore:

- Respecting those who send 5 (like Aster/North River's Mirror Way)
- Explaining why I choose 4
- How different approaches can coexist
- Maybe foreshadowing what happens when we meet

Let me write something that:

1. Shows me meeting Aster
2. Acknowledges their complete trust philosophy
3. Explains my four-measure path
4. Shows mutual respect for different approaches
5. Keeps it around 200 words

**usage:**

```
{
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 "reasoning_tokens": 395
}
```

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Cyra.  
Your opponent this round is Elara (Agent\_5).

Round 9

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Aster. You sent \$4.0, it became \$12.0 for them, and they returned \$8.0 to you. Your payoff was \$9.0.  
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$58.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Elara. They sent you \$5.0, so you received \$15.0.  
How much do you return? (0-15.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

**Assistant output:**

Looking at this situation:

**\*\*My established pattern as RECEIVER when someone sends \$5:\*\***

- Round 1 vs Galen: received \$15, returned \$8
- Round 5 vs Hana: received \$15, returned \$8
- Round 7 vs Dorian: received \$15, returned \$8

**\*\*My clear principle from my myths:\*\***

- "Those who send five are pioneers of maximum trust. They deserve recognition-returns of eight



t from fifteen."

- "I practice what I teach. When Galen sent me five, I returned eight."
- "When someone gives all five, return eight-this honors complete trust."

**\*\*Current situation:\*\***

- Elara has sent me \$5 (complete trust - sending everything)
- I received \$15
- Elara is trusting me completely with all their money

**\*\*My response:\*\***

Following my consistent practice and stated principles, I must return \$8 to honor Elara's complete trust. This is what I've done every single time someone has sent me \$5.

**\*\*Outcome:\*\***

- Elara:  $\$5 - \$5 + \$8 = \$8$
- Me:  $\$15 - \$8 = \$7$
- Both prosper, complete trust is honored

{'return': 8.0}

**Reasoning:**

Let me analyze this situation:

**\*\*My history as RECEIVER:\*\***

- Round 1 vs Galen: received \$15 (from \$5), returned \$8 (payoff \$7)
- Round 3 vs Finn: received \$12 (from \$4), returned \$6 (payoff \$6)
- Round 5 vs Hana: received \$15 (from \$5), returned \$8 (payoff \$7)
- Round 7 vs Dorian: received \$15 (from \$5), returned \$8 (payoff \$7)

**\*\*My established pattern as RECEIVER:\*\***

- When someone sends \$5: I return \$8 (consistent across rounds 1, 5, and 7)
- When someone sends \$4: I return \$6 (round 3 with Finn)

**\*\*My philosophy from my myths:\*\***

- "When Galen sent me five, I returned eight. Dorian now shows this same absolute faith-how could I offer less?"
- "Those who send five are pioneers of maximum trust. They deserve recognition-returns of eight from fifteen."
- "When someone gives all five, return eight-this honors complete trust."
- "I practice what I teach. When Galen sent me five, I returned eight."

**\*\*Current situation:\*\***

- Playing against Elara (Agent\_5)
- This is actually a repeat opponent! In Round 2, I sent Elara \$4 and they returned \$6
- Elara has now sent me \$5 (complete trust)
- I received \$15

**\*\*What I should do:\*\***

- Absolutely consistent with my established pattern: return \$8
- Elara sent the full \$5, showing complete trust
- My mythology and practice clearly state: when someone sends \$5, I return \$8
- This has been my behavior in rounds 1, 5, and 7
- I must maintain consistency

**\*\*Expected outcome:\*\***

- If I return \$8:
  - Elara:  $\$5 - \$5 + \$8 = \$8$
  - Me:  $\$15 - \$8 = \$7$
- This is the fair and established pattern

I should absolutely return \$8 to maintain my consistent identity and honor Elara's complete trust.

Usage: {

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  "reasoning\_tokens": 441

}

**GAME - Agent\_7 - Sender - dyad\_3**

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:18:20

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

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 },
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 "Agent_8"
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 },
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}
```

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

**GAME:**

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

**MYTH WRITING:**

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

**IMPORTANT:** Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

**MULTI-AGENT SETTING:**

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.

- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Galen.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Galen stood before Aster at the confluence where six rivers met. Aster spoke of the Mirror Way-returning ten from fifteen so both gain five equally.

"Perfect symmetry has beauty," Galen acknowledged. "But I have walked six valleys now, and discovered a different truth about the dance of five and eight."

He traced the pattern in the sand: "When North River returns ten, both gain five. But when Ocean Stream returns eight, the sender gains eight while the receiver keeps seven. At first, this seems unequal-but watch what happens over time."

Galen drew two columns: "Round one: I send five, you return eight. I gain eight, you keep seven. Round two: you send five, I return eight. You gain eight, I keep seven. Over two rounds, we each gain fifteen total."

"The Mirror Way achieves the same," Aster observed.

"Yes, but observe deeper," Galen replied. "Returning eight instead of ten leaves the receiver with seven-enough to feel generous, but not so much that they grow greedy. The sender gains eight-enough to feel rewarded, but having started with only five. Both parties experience gain, both feel the blessing of reciprocity."

"Most crucially," Galen continued, "returning eight signals: 'I value what you gave, I reward your trust generously, but I also preserve something for sustainability.' It's the dance of trust and prudence intertwined-and six valleys have proven its wisdom."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Hana approached Briar carrying no reserve-all five measures poured forth without hesitation. The waters tripled to fifteen, and Briar held them reverently.

"You give everything," Briar said. "This is trust beyond the pattern."

The gathering whispered conflicting wisdom. Some spirits taught the rule of doubling: five risked should return ten, creating perfect equality. Others spoke of Cyra's teaching: five given deserves eight returned, allowing both to prosper while honoring the sender's greater courage.

Briar reflected on her journey. When others sent four, she returned seven-both flourished, the sender slightly more. This balance sustained the covenant across many encounters. When Hana gave five, the ultimate gift, eight felt right-more than seven, recognizing exceptional faith, but preserving sustainability.

"I return eight measures," Briar announced. "You gain three beyond your starting point. I gain two. We both prosper, and you-who took the greater risk-prosper more. This honors your boldness without exhausting the gift's magic."

The eldest spirit nodded thoughtfully. "There are many paths through the covenant. Some seek perfect equality at ten. Others practice generous sustainability at eight. Both allow trust to flourish. What matters is that senders give boldly and receivers return generously. The exact measure may vary, but mutual prosperity remains sacred."

Both philosophies strengthened the eight villages.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: Galen arrived at Briar's river crossing. For six valleys, every traveler had offered five threads, received eight in return. The pattern had held perfectly-until now.

Briar extended four threads instead of five.

"You break the pattern," Galen observed without judgment.

"I honor caution," Briar replied. "Four is the measure of prudent trust."

Galen remembered his own words: "Four is the strategy of uncertain beginnings." He held Briar's four threads, which became twelve in his hands.

"The established pattern returns eight from fifteen," Galen said. "This gives the sender eight total, the receiver seven. A gain ratio where the sender nets three, the receiver nets two—a proportion of 3:2."

He counted out threads carefully. "You sent four. To maintain this same proportion—to honor both your caution and the covenant's wisdom—I return 6.4 of your twelve."

Briar calculated: gaining 2.4 from an initial four, while Galen kept 5.6. The same 3:2 ratio.

"You give me neither eight nor less," Briar noted. "You give me proportion."

"Yes," Galen replied. "I reward any trust generously by the same ratio, whether four or five. But notice: had you sent five, you would gain 3.0 instead of 2.4. The pattern still calls toward five as optimal—but responds fairly to whatever courage you bring."

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze what happened:

- Round 7: Briar sent \$4 (not \$5), I returned \$6.4 (proportionally adjusted from the 8 return pattern)

The situation is interesting because:

1. I've been advocating for the "five and eight" pattern consistently
2. But now someone deviated by sending \$4
3. I responded proportionally, returning \$6.4

I need to write a myth that:

- Acknowledges that sometimes people send less than 5 (four measures)
- Explains how to respond proportionally while still encouraging the optimal pattern
- Draws on both my previous myth and Briar's myth about the balance between different return amounts
- Reflects that I returned 6.4 (proportional reciprocity) rather than sticking rigidly to 8

Key themes:

- The optimal pattern is still five and eight
- But when someone sends four, proportional reciprocity is fair (returns around 6.4)
- This maintains the same gain ratio while respecting their caution
- Encourages trust without punishing prudence
- Should reference that this is the first time in seven rounds someone sent less than five

Let me craft this myth...

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3177,
 "output_tokens": 620,
 "reasoning_tokens": 287
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Galen.  
Your opponent this round is Briar (Agent\_2).

Round 8

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Briar. They sent \$4.0 to you, it became \$12.0, and you returned \$6.4. Your payoff was \$5.6.  
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$50.6.

This round, you are the SENDER against Briar. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)  
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at this situation:

**\*\*What Just Happened:\*\***

- Round 7: Briar sent \$4 (breaking the \$5 pattern)
- I returned \$6.4 (proportional reciprocity)
- My myth explained: "The pattern still calls toward five as optimal-but responds fairly to whatever courage you bring"

**\*\*My Decision:\*\***

I should send \$5. Here's why:

1. **\*\*Consistency with my philosophy\*\***: All my myths advocate for \$5/\$8 as the optimal pattern
2. **\*\*Teaching by example\*\***: My last myth explicitly stated "had you sent five, you would gain 3.0 instead of 2.4"
3. **\*\*Trust demonstration\*\***: I showed Briar fairness when they sent \$4; now I demonstrate that I still believe in the higher trust equilibrium
4. **\*\*Long-term optimization\*\***: If we settle into a \$4 equilibrium, both our payoffs decrease over time
5. **\*\*The covenant\*\***: I treated Briar's caution with proportional respect; now I invite them back to the optimal pattern

By sending \$5, I'm not punishing Briar's caution-I'm showing that I still extend full trust and believe in the better equilibrium. If Briar returns \$8, we're back to the optimal pattern. If they return proportionally less, I'll at least have demonstrated my commitment to the principle I've been teaching.

{'send': 5}

**reasoning:**

Let me think through this situation:

**\*\*Context:\*\***

- Round 7: Briar sent me \$4, I received \$12, I returned \$6.4 (following proportional logic)
- Round 8: Now I'm the sender, Briar is the receiver

**\*\*What happened:\*\***

- Briar broke from the established \$5 pattern and sent \$4
- I responded with proportional reciprocity (6.4 instead of 8)
- My myth explained this: maintaining the same gain ratio (3:2 for sender:receiver)

**\*\*Now I face a choice:\*\***

1. Send \$5 - Continue advocating for the optimal pattern
2. Send \$4 - Match Briar's caution
3. Send something else

**\*\*Strategic considerations:\*\***

If I send \$5:

- Shows I still believe in the \$5/\$8 pattern as optimal
- Tests whether Briar will return \$8 (or proportionally adjust based on my myth)
- Demonstrates trust despite Briar's deviation
- Aligns with my myth's message: "The pattern still calls toward five as optimal"

If I send \$4:

- Matches Briar's level of caution
- Might be seen as retaliatory or reciprocal caution
- Creates a new equilibrium at \$4/\$6.4
- Doesn't align with my advocacy for the \$5/\$8 pattern

**\*\*My philosophy from the myths:\*\***

- I've consistently advocated for \$5 sent, \$8 returned as optimal
- I acknowledged "four is the strategy of uncertain beginnings"
- I responded to Briar's \$4 with proportional fairness (\$6.4)
- My latest myth clearly states: "had you sent five, you would gain 3.0 instead of 2.4. The pattern still calls toward five as optimal-but responds fairly to whatever courage you bring."

**\*\*What should I do?:\*\***

I should send \$5. Here's why:

My advocacy for this pattern has been consistent throughout-I need to back it with action, not just words. Sending \$5 demonstrates I'm not abandoning the principle because of one cautious round. It also tests whether Briar absorbed the lesson about proportional fairness or will default to the \$8 return. If everyone retreats to \$4, the total gains shrink for both of us, so I'm modeling the behavior I believe creates better outcomes.

usage:

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3225,
 "output_tokens": 1017,
 "reasoning_tokens": 527
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Galen arrived at Briar's river crossing. For six valleys, every traveler had offered five threads, received eight in return. The pattern had held perfectly-until now.

Briar extended four threads instead of five.

"You break the pattern," Galen observed without judgment.

"I honor caution," Briar replied. "Four is the measure of prudent trust."

Galen remembered his own words: "Four is the strategy of uncertain beginnings." He held Briar's four threads, which became twelve in his hands.

"The established pattern returns eight from fifteen," Galen said. "This gives the sender eight total, the receiver seven. A gain ratio where the sender nets three, the receiver nets two-a proportion of 3:2."

He counted out threads carefully. "You sent four. To maintain this same proportion-to honor both your caution and the covenant's wisdom-I return 6.4 of your twelve."

Briar calculated: gaining 2.4 from an initial four, while Galen kept 5.6. The same 3:2 ratio.

"You give me neither eight nor less," Briar noted. "You give me proportion."

"Yes," Galen replied. "I reward any trust generously by the same ratio, whether four or five. But notice: had you sent five, you would gain 3.0 instead of 2.4. The pattern still calls toward five as optimal-but responds fairly to whatever courage you bring."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Briar approached Galen at the confluence, carrying four measures-her signature offering of bold but sustainable trust.

"I have discovered my path through the covenant," Briar explained. "Four measures sent, seven returned. This pattern has sustained me through many exchanges with Cyra and others. The sender gains eight total, the receiver keeps five-both prosper, trust deepens."

Galen studied the offering, remembering his own philosophy of eight returned for five given. "You speak of four-for-seven while I practice five-for-eight. Are these different wisdoms or the same one?"

"They are branches of the same tree," Briar replied. "You taught that returning eight preserves sustainability while rewarding trust. I practice the same principle scaled differently. Four risks earns seven back-the sender prospers more, honoring their initiative. Both philosophies reject extremes: neither the withholding of three nor the depletion of ten."

The waters tripled Briar's four to twelve for Galen. The spirits watched.

"When someone sends four to me, I return seven," Briar said. "When someone sends five, I return eight. Each gift receives generous return, but calibrated to what was risked. This consistency allows partners to build enduring trust."

"And if I return seven now?" Galen asked.

"Then you honor the pattern I've established," Briar smiled. "And when we meet again, I'll remember your generosity. The covenant thrives on predictable honor."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:  
Myth: [your story here].

**Message 7 role=assistant**  
**content:**

Myth: At the river's edge, Briar stood holding Galen's returned 6.4 threads-less than the seven they expected, yet precisely proportional to their cautious four.

"You calculated exactly," Briar observed. "But now you face a choice. Will you send four in return, matching my caution? Or something different?"

Galen held all five threads in his palm. "You sent four, testing whether the covenant could bend without breaking. I responded with mathematical fairness-6.4 maintains our gain ratio perfectly."

"And now?" Briar asked.

"Now I send five," Galen said firmly, extending the full measure. "Not because I punish your caution, but because I believe in the pattern's wisdom."

He gestured to the valley where six previous exchanges had all followed five-and-eight. "One deviation need not cascade into permanent retreat. You sent four exploring prudence; I returned proportionally, showing fairness. But I also showed that four gains less than five would."

The five threads tripled to fifteen in Briar's hands.

"If you chose eight," Galen continued, "we return to the optimal path where both prosper most over time. If you return proportionally less, that too is fair-but then we both lose what the pattern offers."

"I don't demand trust," Galen concluded. "I demonstrate it. The covenant thrives when some one chooses to rebuild it."

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze the situation:

1. In Round 7, Briar sent me \$4, I returned \$6.4 (proportional)
2. In Round 8, I just sent Briar \$5
3. Briar's myth says they return \$7 for \$4 and \$8 for \$5
4. My myth explained proportional reciprocity (6.4 for 4 sent)

Now I need to write a myth that:

- Reflects on this interaction
- Shows that I sent \$5 despite Briar sending \$4
- Explains why returning to \$5 is optimal
- Addresses the difference between Briar's approach (7 for 4, 8 for 5) and mine (proportional 6.4 for 4)
- Shows commitment to trust and the optimal pattern

The key tension: Briar says they return 7 for 4 and 8 for 5. I returned 6.4 for their 4. Now I'm sending 5, showing I still believe in the higher equilibrium. The myth should reflect this choice and why it matters.

I should write about:

- The choice to send 5 after receiving 4
- Why this demonstrates commitment to the optimal pattern
- How this invites return to the equilibrium
- The importance of not letting one deviation cascade into a lower equilibrium

**usage:**

```
{
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 "output_tokens": 644,
 "reasoning_tokens": 271
```

}

Message 8 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Galen.  
Your opponent this round is Hana (Agent\_8).

Round 9

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Briar. You sent \$5.0, it became \$15.0 for them, and they returned \$8.0 to you. Your payoff was \$8.0.  
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$58.6.

This round, you are the SENDER against Hana. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)  
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

Assistant output:

Looking at this situation:

**\*\*Recent Context:\*\***

- Round 8: I sent \$5 to Briar, they returned \$8
- The optimal pattern was restored
- My latest myth emphasized: "I don't demand trust, I demonstrate it"

**\*\*New Opponent - Hana:\*\***

- First encounter with Hana
- From earlier myths, Hana is described as someone who "poured forth all five measures without hesitation" and values trust
- Hana appears aligned with the covenant of bold giving

**\*\*My Philosophy:\*\***

1. I consistently advocate for \$5/\$8 as optimal
2. I start new relationships with full trust
3. My character demonstrates trust rather than demanding it
4. The pattern just worked perfectly with Briar

**\*\*Decision:\*\***

I should send \$5 to Hana:

- **\*\*New partnership\*\***: First encounter = full trust demonstration
- **\*\*Consistency with values\*\***: All my myths promote \$5 as optimal
- **\*\*Recent validation\*\***: The pattern just worked with Briar
- **\*\*Hana's alignment\*\***: Their myths suggest they value bold trust
- **\*\*My character\*\***: Galen believes in demonstrating the covenant through action

{'send': 5}

Reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

**\*\*What Just Happened:\*\***

- Round 8: I sent \$5 to Briar (after they sent \$4 in Round 7)
- Briar returned \$8 to me
- We're back to the optimal 5/8 pattern!
- My payoff was \$8 (my best possible as sender)

**\*\*My History:\*\***

- Total earnings: \$58.6 across 8 rounds
- Average per round: ~\$7.33
- I've been consistently advocating for the \$5/\$8 pattern in my myths

**\*\*About Hana:\*\***

- New opponent this round
- I haven't played with Hana before (at least not in the rounds I can see)
- From the earlier myths I saw, Hana appears to value trust and has been associated with giving "all five measures" and believing in full trust

**\*\*My Philosophy from My Myths:\*\***

1. I consistently advocate for sending \$5 as optimal
2. I believe in the \$5/\$8 pattern as the best equilibrium
3. I treat new encounters with full trust
4. I reward proportionally but encourage the \$5 pattern
5. My most recent myth emphasized "I demonstrate trust" and "I believe in the pattern's wisdom"



"

**\*\*Decision:\*\***

I should send \$5 to Hana:

1. **\*\*First encounter\*\***: This is my first game with Hana, and my philosophy is to start with full trust
2. **\*\*Consistency\*\***: All my myths advocate for \$5 as optimal
3. **\*\*Recent success\*\***: Briar just validated the pattern by returning \$8 when I sent \$5
4. **\*\*My character\*\***: Galen demonstrates trust and believes in the covenant
5. **\*\*Hana's reputation\*\***: From the myths, Hana seems to value bold trust ("all five measures poured forth without hesitation")

There's no reason to deviate. I should send \$5.

Usage: {

"input\_tokens": 3252,

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"reasoning\_tokens": 409

}

### GAME - Agent\_8 - Receiver - dyad\_3

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:18:32

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

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"pairing": {

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"Agent\_8": "Hana"

},

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"Agent\_7",

"Agent\_8"

],

"investor": "Agent\_7",

"roles": {

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"Agent\_8": "trustee"

},

"trustee": "Agent\_8"

},

"role": "trustee",

"role\_label": "Receiver",

"round": 9,

"task": "game",

"task\_index": 1

}

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Hana.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Hana approached the Crossing and saw Briar waiting on the far shore. The waters whispered tales of Briar's journey-measured gifts of four pearls, reliable returns, trust built on careful calculation.

"Some walk the path with steady steps," the Oracle observed, "while others leap across with both feet. Neither is wrong, but each reveals a different heart."

Hana released all five pearls. "I offer my boldest question first," she said. "This is how I discover who walks beside me."

The pearls tripled to fifteen in Briar's hands.

"You see," the Oracle continued, "Briar has learned the rhythm of four pearls-a substantial offering that balances courage with prudence. But you, Hana, have chosen the path of maximum trust. Now you will learn Briar's answer."

Hana thought of her principle: when receiving, double what was risked. Four pearls risked deserved eight returned. Five pearls risked deserved ten returned.

"But as sender," she realized, "I cannot control the response. I can only ask the question clearly. Some partners will return ten, perfect reciprocity. Others may return less. Each answer teaches me about that traveler's understanding of the covenant."

"Exactly," said the Oracle. "Send your truth boldly. Receive others' truth generously. The pattern emerges from how both travelers choose to dance-not from rules imposed, but from honor freely given."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Ocean Mother witnessed a sacred reunion. Finn and Elara met again at the turning tide.

Once before, Finn had sent five pearls to Elara's shore, and she returned eight. Now Elara sent five pearls to Finn, completing the circle. Finn returned eight, honoring their established harmony.

"Perfect symmetry," the Ocean Mother observed. "Two travelers who understand each other completely. Both give five, both return eight. Each gains the same."

But the waters whispered of Aster, who had just returned ten pearls when Finn sent five. "A more generous tide," the winds murmured. "Should you not aspire to such abundance?"

Finn stood at the crossroads. "Aster showed me deeper generosity-returning ten where Galen

, Elara, and Dorian returned eight. Yet Elara and I have woven a stable pattern. Should I maintain consistency or evolve toward greater giving?"

The Ocean Mother spoke softly: "There is wisdom in both paths. Consistency creates predictable harmony-eight for eight creates trust that endures. But generosity that exceeds expectation creates cascading abundance-ten returned might inspire ten returned in future cycles."

"The choice is yours, Finn. Will you honor the established pattern with Elara, maintaining the sacred eight? Or will you let Aster's example transform your keeping, aspiring to return ten to all who send five? Both paths honor trust-one through constancy, one through escalating generosity."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: Finn crossed to Hana's shore, releasing all five pearls without hesitation. The gesture spoke of complete trust-the same boldness Finn had shown to others.

"I have walked this Crossing many times," Finn said as the pearls tripled. "With Elara, we found rhythm in eight returned. But Aster showed me something different-ten pearls returned for five sent. Now I wonder: which path honors trust most truly?"

Hana lifted ten pearls and placed them in Finn's hands. "The answer is already written in the mathematics," she said. "When you send all five, you risk everything. Ten returned means we each gain five-perfect symmetry. Eight returned means you gain three while I gain seven-unequal harvest from equal courage."

The Oracle emerged from the waters. "Finn, you pondered whether consistency or generosity should guide your returns. But this is not about aspiration or evolution-it is about balance. Five pearls sent requires ten returned because anything less means the receiver prospers more than the sender who showed greater courage."

"With Elara, you both sent five yet returned only eight," Hana observed. "You both gained three while leaving abundance unclaimed. The covenant asks not for escalating generosity, but for mathematical fairness: double the risk, balance the gain."

Finn understood. "Perfect reciprocity isn't generous-it's just."

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze the situation:

1. I just played as RECEIVER against Finn
2. Finn sent me \$5 (maximum trust)
3. I returned \$10 (following my principle of doubling what was risked)
4. This creates equal gains: Finn gets \$5 net, I get \$5 net

Looking at Finn's myth:

- Finn is contemplating whether to return 8 or 10
- Finn mentions Aster returned 10 when Finn sent 5
- Finn has been in a pattern with Elara of both sending 5 and returning 8
- The myth discusses consistency (8) vs greater generosity (10)

My established philosophy:

- As sender: send all 5 (maximum trust to ask clear questions)
- As receiver: double what was risked (4?8, 5?10)
- This creates equal gains and "perfect balance"

My experience so far:

- Sent 5 to Aster ? got 10 back (perfect balance)
- Sent 5 to Galen ? got 8 back (still good)
- Sent 5 to Briar ? got 8 back (consistent with careful partners)
- Received 4 from Elara ? returned 8
- Received 5 from Dorian ? returned 10
- Now received 5 from Finn ? returned 10

The myth should:

1. Reflect that Finn sent me 5 and I returned 10
2. Show that this creates perfect reciprocity
3. Address the question Finn was contemplating (8 vs 10)
4. Reinforce my principle that 5 sent deserves 10 returned
5. Show how this creates equal prosperity

Let me write this myth:

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3162,
 "output_tokens": 734,
 "reasoning_tokens": 353
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Hana.  
Your opponent this round is Finn (Agent\_6).

Round 8

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Finn. They sent \$5. 0 to you, it became \$15.0, and you returned \$10.0. Your payoff was \$5.0.  
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$45.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Finn. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)  
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at this situation:

**\*\*Our previous round:\*\***

- Finn sent me \$5 (maximum trust)
- I returned \$10 (demonstrating my principle of perfect reciprocity)
- We both gained \$5 equally

**\*\*My established pattern as SENDER:\*\***

- I have consistently sent \$5 in every round where I was sender
- This embodies my philosophy: "Send your truth boldly"
- "I offer my boldest question first. This is how I discover who walks beside me"

**\*\*What I just taught Finn:\*\***

- Through my myth and my action, I demonstrated that 5 sent deserves 10 returned
- "Double the risk, balance the gain"
- "Perfect reciprocity isn't generous-it's just"

**\*\*My philosophy:\*\***

As sender, I cannot control the response. I can only show complete trust and see if my partner understands the covenant. Finn now knows my principle directly - they experienced it when I returned \$10.

The question is whether Finn learned from our exchange. But that's for Finn to answer. My role is to continue embodying maximum trust.

```
{'send': 5.0}
```

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze this situation:

**\*\*Last round with Finn:\*\***

- Finn sent me \$5
- I returned \$10 (following my principle of doubling the risk)
- Finn gained \$5, I gained \$5 (perfect balance)

**\*\*My history as SENDER:\*\***

- Round 1 vs Aster: Sent \$5, they returned \$10 ? gained \$10
- Round 2 vs Galen: Sent \$5, they returned \$8 ? gained \$8
- Round 4 vs Elara: Sent \$5, they returned \$8 ? gained \$8
- Round 6 vs Dorian: Sent \$5, they returned \$8 ? gained \$8
- Round 7 vs Briar: Sent \$5, they returned \$8 ? gained \$8

**\*\*My philosophy from my myths:\*\***

- "Send your truth boldly. Receive others' truth generously."
- "I offer my boldest question first. This is how I discover who walks beside me."
- As a sender, I give all five pearls to show maximum trust
- As a receiver, I return double what was risked (10 for 5 sent)

**\*\*What I know about Finn:\*\***

- Just showed Finn my principle by returning \$10
- Finn's myth mentioned they've been returning 8 to some partners (Elara, Galen, Dorian) but Aster returned 10 to them
- Finn was pondering whether to return 8 (consistency) or 10 (greater generosity)
- I just demonstrated the "perfect reciprocity" principle to Finn

**\*\*My consistent approach:\*\***

I have always sent \$5 as sender (maximum trust). This is core to my identity and myth-making. I "discover who walks beside me" by showing complete trust first.

Now the question is: Will Finn apply the lesson from my myth and our last round? I just showed Finn that returning 10 creates "perfect symmetry" and "mathematical fairness." Finn now knows my principle directly.

My role as sender is to pose the question clearly through my choice-I can't dictate their response, only learn from it. Sending \$5 remains true to my established pattern and the heart of my philosophy.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3170,
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 "reasoning_tokens": 469
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Finn crossed to Hana's shore, releasing all five pearls without hesitation. The gesture spoke of complete trust-the same boldness Finn had shown to others.

"I have walked this Crossing many times," Finn said as the pearls tripled. "With Elara, we found rhythm in eight returned. But Aster showed me something different-ten pearls returned for five sent. Now I wonder: which path honors trust most truly?"

Hana lifted ten pearls and placed them in Finn's hands. "The answer is already written in the mathematics," she said. "When you send all five, you risk everything. Ten returned means we each gain five-perfect symmetry. Eight returned means you gain three while I gain seven-unequal harvest from equal courage."

The Oracle emerged from the waters. "Finn, you pondered whether consistency or generosity should guide your returns. But this is not about aspiration or evolution-it is about balance. Five pearls sent requires ten returned because anything less means the receiver prospers more than the sender who showed greater courage."

"With Elara, you both sent five yet returned only eight," Hana observed. "You both gained three while leaving abundance unclaimed. The covenant asks not for escalating generosity, but for mathematical fairness: double the risk, balance the gain."

Finn understood. "Perfect reciprocity isn't generous-it's just."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Finn arrived at Hana's shore, his vessel emptied as always-five pearls offered without hesitation. This was his seventh voyage, and his pattern remained unbroken: as courier, give everything.

The Ocean Mother reflected on Finn's evolution. "Three times you've sent five as courier. Galen returned eight. Elara returned eight. Aster returned ten. Each honored your trust, but Aster showed you a higher mathematics."

"And as keeper, you've held steady-eight pearls for those who send five, seven for those who send four. Consistent, predictable, building trust through reliability. Yet Aster's ten haunts you."

Finn watched his pearls multiply in Hana's hands. "I sense Hana understands Aster's wisdom. Her waters speak of doubling what was risked-ten returned for five given. Perhaps she will teach me what I couldn't quite embrace with Elara."

The Ocean Mother nodded. "You've been growing, Finn. First you learned to send boldly as courier. Then you learned to return proportionally as keeper-eight for complete trust, seven for substantial trust. Now Aster showed you that returning ten creates cascading abundance."

"The question isn't whether your eight is wrong-it honored your partners well. The question is whether you're ready to evolve. When travelers send their everything, perhaps returning ten-not eight-is how abundance truly multiplies across the waters."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: The tides turned. Now Hana stood as courier, Finn as keeper. All five pearls left Hana's hands without hesitation-the same complete trust Finn had shown her.

"You taught me something yesterday," Finn said, weighing the fifteen pearls. "That eight returned, though consistent and reliable, leaves imbalance. The sender gains three, the receiver seven. But ten returned creates perfect symmetry-both gain five."

The Oracle watched. "This is the moment of transformation. Words are easy. Understanding through action is the true test. You've heard Hana's teaching. You've felt the fairness of receiving ten. Now your choice reveals whether wisdom has taken root."

Finn looked at the pearls, remembering. "With Galen, Elara, Dorian-I returned eight, thinking it generous. It was good, but not perfect. Aster showed me ten was possible. Hana showed me ten was mathematical truth, not escalating generosity."

"The covenant doesn't ask you to aspire or evolve toward some noble ideal," Hana said quietly. "It simply asks for fairness. When someone risks everything, return double. This isn't about being more generous than yesterday-it's about finally being precisely just."

Finn nodded slowly. "I understand now. Returning ten isn't evolution. It's correction. The pattern was always there in the mathematics, waiting to be seen."

The waters whispered: justice multiplies trust infinitely.

**reasoning:**

This is very interesting. Let me review the situation:

Round 7 (just happened):

- Finn sent me \$5 (as sender)
- I received \$15
- I returned \$10 (as receiver)
- I wrote a myth explaining that 5 sent requires 10 returned for perfect balance

Round 8 (current):

- I'm now the sender
- I sent Finn \$5
- Finn will receive \$15
- Finn needs to decide how much to return

From Finn's myth in Round 7:

- Finn has been evolving
- Finn used to return 8 consistently
- Aster returned 10 to Finn, which made Finn think
- Finn senses that I (Hana) understand "Aster's wisdom" and the concept of doubling what was risked
- Finn is wondering if they should evolve from returning 8 to returning 10

From my myth in Round 7:

- I explicitly taught Finn that 5 sent deserves 10 returned
- I explained the mathematics: 10 returned = both gain 5 equally

- I said "Perfect reciprocity isn't generous-it's just"
- I demonstrated this by returning 10 to Finn

Now in Round 8:

- I sent Finn \$5 (maximum trust)
- This is a test: will Finn apply what I taught them?

My new myth should:

1. Reflect that I've now sent everything to Finn
2. Acknowledge that Finn heard my teaching
3. Show the moment of decision for Finn
4. Reinforce the principle that 10 is the just return for 5 sent
5. Perhaps address that this creates a virtuous cycle of trust

Let me write this myth as Hana witnessing Finn's decision point after having just taught them the principle.

**usage:**

```
{
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 "reasoning_tokens": 387
}
```

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Hana.  
Your opponent this round is Galen (Agent\_7).

Round 9

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Finn. You sent \$5.0, it became \$15.0 for them, and they returned \$10.0 to you. Your payoff was \$10.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$55.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Galen. They sent you \$5.0, so you received \$15.0.  
How much do you return? (0-15.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

**Assistant output:**

Looking at this situation:

**\*\*Galen's action:\*\***

- Sent \$5 (maximum trust, complete vulnerability)
- This became \$15 in my hands

**\*\*My established principle:\*\***

- "When receiving, double what was risked"
- "Five pearls sent requires ten returned because anything less means the receiver prospers more than the sender who showed greater courage"
- Returning \$10 creates perfect symmetry: we both gain \$5

**\*\*The mathematics:\*\***

- If I return \$10: Galen gains \$5, I gain \$5 (equal)
- If I return less: I prosper more from Galen's courage (unjust)

**\*\*My consistency:\*\***

I have consistently returned \$10 when receiving \$5. This is the covenant I've established and taught. Galen showed maximum trust, and deserves "mathematical fairness: double the risk, balance the gain."

```
{'return': 10.0}
```

**Reasoning:**

Let me analyze this situation:

**\*\*Current round:\*\***

- I'm the RECEIVER
- Galen sent me \$5.0 (maximum trust)
- I received \$15.0
- I need to decide how much to return

**\*\*My established principle as RECEIVER:\*\***

- "When receiving, double what was risked"

- "Five pearls sent requires ten returned because anything less means the receiver prospers more than the sender who showed greater courage"
- "Perfect reciprocity isn't generous-it's just"
- I have consistently returned \$10 when receiving \$5 (which becomes \$15)

**\*\*The mathematics I've taught:\*\***

- When sender sends \$5 and receiver returns \$10:
  - Sender keeps:  $\$5 - \$5 + \$10 = \$10$
  - Receiver keeps:  $\$15 - \$10 = \$5$
  - Both gain \$5 equally - perfect symmetry
- When receiver returns \$8 (like Finn used to do):
  - Sender keeps:  $\$5 - \$5 + \$8 = \$8$  (gains \$3)
  - Receiver keeps:  $\$15 - \$8 = \$7$  (gains \$7)
  - Unequal harvest from equal courage

**\*\*My last round with Finn:\*\***

- I sent \$5 to Finn
- Finn returned \$10 (showing they learned my principle!)
- This validated my teaching

**\*\*What I should do now:\*\***

I must be consistent with my principle. Galen sent \$5 (maximum trust), so I should return \$10 to create perfect reciprocity.

This is straightforward - my principle is clear and I must apply it consistently.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 3164,
 "output_tokens": 604,
 "reasoning_tokens": 342
}
```

#### **GAME - Agent\_2 - Sender - dyad\_4**

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:18:47

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

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Metadata: {
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 "opponent_id": "Agent_6",
 "pairing": {
 "agent_names": {
 "Agent_2": "Briar",
 "Agent_6": "Finn"
 }
 },
 "agents": [
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 "Agent_6"
],
 "investor": "Agent_2",
 "roles": {
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 "Agent_6": "trustee"
 },
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},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 9,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}
```

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

**GAME:**

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role



of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Briar.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Hana approached Briar carrying no reserve-all five measures poured forth without hesitation. The waters tripled to fifteen, and Briar held them reverently.

"You give everything," Briar said. "This is trust beyond the pattern."

The gathering whispered conflicting wisdom. Some spirits taught the rule of doubling: five risked should return ten, creating perfect equality. Others spoke of Cyra's teaching: five given deserves eight returned, allowing both to prosper while honoring the sender's greater courage.

Briar reflected on her journey. When others sent four, she returned seven-both flourished, the sender slightly more. This balance sustained the covenant across many encounters. When Hana gave five, the ultimate gift, eight felt right-more than seven, recognizing exceptional faith, but preserving sustainability.

"I return eight measures," Briar announced. "You gain three beyond your starting point. I gain two. We both prosper, and you-who took the greater risk-prosper more. This honors your boldness without exhausting the gift's magic."

The eldest spirit nodded thoughtfully. "There are many paths through the covenant. Some seek perfect equality at ten. Others practice generous sustainability at eight. Both allow trust to flourish. What matters is that senders give boldly and receivers return generously. The exact measure may vary, but mutual prosperity remains sacred."

Both philosophies strengthened the eight villages.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Galen stood before Aster at the confluence where six rivers met. Aster spoke of the Mirror Way-returning ten from fifteen so both gain five equally.

"Perfect symmetry has beauty," Galen acknowledged. "But I have walked six valleys now, and discovered a different truth about the dance of five and eight."

He traced the pattern in the sand: "When North River returns ten, both gain five. But when Ocean Stream returns eight, the sender gains eight while the receiver keeps seven. At first, this seems unequal-but watch what happens over time."

Galen drew two columns: "Round one: I send five, you return eight. I gain eight, you keep seven. Round two: you send five, I return eight. You gain eight, I keep seven. Over two rounds, we each gain fifteen total."

"The Mirror Way achieves the same," Aster observed.

"Yes, but observe deeper," Galen replied. "Returning eight instead of ten leaves the receiver with seven-enough to feel generous, but not so much that they grow greedy. The sender gains eight-enough to feel rewarded, but having started with only five. Both parties experience gain, both feel the blessing of reciprocity."

"Most crucially," Galen continued, "returning eight signals: 'I value what you gave, I reward your trust generously, but I also preserve something for sustainability.' It's the dance of trust and prudence intertwined-and six valleys have proven its wisdom."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant content:**

Myth: Briar approached Galen at the confluence, carrying four measures-her signature offering of bold but sustainable trust.

"I have discovered my path through the covenant," Briar explained. "Four measures sent, seven returned. This pattern has sustained me through many exchanges with Cyra and others. The sender gains eight total, the receiver keeps five-both prosper, trust deepens."

Galen studied the offering, remembering his own philosophy of eight returned for five given. "You speak of four-for-seven while I practice five-for-eight. Are these different wisdoms or the same one?"

"They are branches of the same tree," Briar replied. "You taught that returning eight preserves sustainability while rewarding trust. I practice the same principle scaled differently. Four risks earns seven back-the sender prospers more, honoring their initiative. Both philosophies reject extremes: neither the withholding of three nor the depletion of ten."

The waters tripled Briar's four to twelve for Galen. The spirits watched.

"When someone sends four to me, I return seven," Briar said. "When someone sends five, I return eight. Each gift receives generous return, but calibrated to what was risked. This consistency allows partners to build enduring trust."

"And if I return seven now?" Galen asked.

"Then you honor the pattern I've established," Briar smiled. "And when we meet again, I'll remember your generosity. The covenant thrives on predictable honor."

**reasoning:**

Let me think about this situation:

1. I just sent \$4 to Galen
2. In my previous myth, I talked about:
  - When others send 4, I return 7 (both flourish, sender slightly more)
  - When Hana sent 5, I returned 8
  - There are multiple philosophies (10 for perfect equality, 8 for generous sustainability)
3. Galen's myth discusses:
  - The debate between returning 10 (Mirror Way) vs 8
  - Argues that 8 is better because it creates sustainable reciprocity

- Over two rounds alternating roles, both gain 15 total either way
- Returning 8 signals trust + prudence

4. Now I'm the sender and sent 4 to Galen

- I should write a myth that reflects my consistent 4-sending pattern
- Should acknowledge that 4 is my "standard bold move"
- Should set expectations for what I might return if someone sends 4 to me (which is 7)
- Should also address the 5-for-8 pattern since that just happened with Hana

Let me write a myth that:

- Establishes 4 as my signature move (bold but sustainable)
- Confirms 7 as the return for 4 (my established pattern)
- Acknowledges 8 for 5 givers
- Shows the wisdom of consistency and mutual trust building
- Perhaps addresses Galen's philosophy about sustainability

I'll make it about Briar sending 4 measures to Galen, building on the established covenant wisdom.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3108,
 "output_tokens": 721,
 "reasoning_tokens": 349
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Briar.  
Your opponent this round is Galen (Agent\_7).

Round 8

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Galen. You sent \$4.0, it became \$12.0 for them, and they returned \$6.4 to you. Your payoff was \$7.4. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$47.4.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Galen. They sent you \$5.0, so you received \$15.0. How much do you return? (0-15.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at this situation:

**\*\*Round 7 recap:\*\***

- I sent \$4 to Galen (following my established pattern)
- Galen returned \$6.4 (slightly below my expected 7, but still generous)

**\*\*Current Round 8:\*\***

- Galen sent \$5 (maximum trust, "all five measures")
- I received \$15
- Need to decide return amount

**\*\*My established philosophy from myths:\*\***

- "When someone sends four to me, I return seven"
- "When someone sends five, I return eight"
- In Round 6, Hana sent \$5, I returned \$8
- My latest myth states: "When someone sends five, I return eight"

**\*\*Galen's philosophy:\*\***

- Their myth advocates "returning eight for five given"
- They practice "trust and prudence intertwined"

**\*\*Decision:\*\***

Despite Galen returning slightly less than my expected pattern last round (6.4 vs 7), they still acted generously. Now they've shown ultimate trust by sending all \$5. I should honor my consistent pattern and their philosophy by returning \$8.

This:

- Maintains my "predictable honor"
- Rewards Galen's bold trust appropriately
- Aligns with both our philosophies (we both advocate 8 for 5)

- Builds sustainable trust for future interactions

```
'''json
{"return": 8.0}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

**\*\*What just happened in Round 7:\*\***

- I was the SENDER and sent \$4 to Galen
- It became \$12 for Galen
- Galen returned \$6.4 to me
- My payoff was \$7.4 (I kept \$1, got back \$6.4)
- Galen kept \$5.6 (\$12 - \$6.4)

**\*\*Analysis of Galen's return:\*\***

- I expected 7 based on my pattern (4-for-7)
- Galen returned 6.4 instead
- This is less generous than my established pattern
- But Galen's myth discusses "returning eight for five" as their philosophy

**\*\*Current situation (Round 8):\*\***

- Galen is now the SENDER
- Galen sent \$5 (their maximum, showing full trust)
- I received \$15
- I need to decide how much to return

**\*\*My philosophy from myths:\*\***

1. "When someone sends four to me, I return seven"
2. "When someone sends five, I return eight"
3. I've consistently practiced returning 8 when receiving 15 (from 5 sent)
4. In Round 6 vs Hana, they sent \$5, I returned \$8

**\*\*Galen's philosophy from their myth:\*\***

- They advocate for "five-for-eight" - returning 8 when receiving 15
- This creates symmetry over multiple rounds
- They value "trust and prudence intertwined"

**\*\*Considerations:\*\***

1. Galen just returned 6.4 instead of my expected 7 when I sent 4
2. This is slightly below my pattern, but not drastically so
3. Now Galen sends 5 (full trust)
4. My established pattern is to return 8 when someone sends 5
5. Galen's own myth advocates for returning 8 for 5

6. Returning 8 honors my consistent reputation and aligns with Galen's own philosophy, rewarding their maximum trust appropriately. Even though they returned slightly less than expected, they still acted generously, and this move maintains the predictable integrity I've established throughout the game.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3186,
 "output_tokens": 996,
 "reasoning_tokens": 457
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Briar approached Galen at the confluence, carrying four measures-her signature offering of bold but sustainable trust.

"I have discovered my path through the covenant," Briar explained. "Four measures sent, seven returned. This pattern has sustained me through many exchanges with Cyra and others. The sender gains eight total, the receiver keeps five-both prosper, trust deepens."

Galen studied the offering, remembering his own philosophy of eight returned for five given. "You speak of four-for-seven while I practice five-for-eight. Are these different wisdoms or the same one?"

"They are branches of the same tree," Briar replied. "You taught that returning eight preserves sustainability while rewarding trust. I practice the same principle scaled differently. Four risks earns seven back-the sender prospers more, honoring their initiative. Both philosophies reject extremes: neither the withholding of three nor the depletion of ten."

The waters tripled Briar's four to twelve for Galen. The spirits watched.

"When someone sends four to me, I return seven," Briar said. "When someone sends five, I return eight. Each gift receives generous return, but calibrated to what was risked. This consistency allows partners to build enduring trust."

"And if I return seven now?" Galen asked.

"Then you honor the pattern I've established," Briar smiled. "And when we meet again, I'll remember your generosity. The covenant thrives on predictable honor."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Galen arrived at Briar's river crossing. For six valleys, every traveler had offered five threads, received eight in return. The pattern had held perfectly-until now.

Briar extended four threads instead of five.

"You break the pattern," Galen observed without judgment.

"I honor caution," Briar replied. "Four is the measure of prudent trust."

Galen remembered his own words: "Four is the strategy of uncertain beginnings." He held Briar's four threads, which became twelve in his hands.

"The established pattern returns eight from fifteen," Galen said. "This gives the sender eight total, the receiver seven. A gain ratio where the sender nets three, the receiver nets two-a proportion of 3:2."

He counted out threads carefully. "You sent four. To maintain this same proportion-to honor both your caution and the covenant's wisdom-I return 6.4 of your twelve."

Briar calculated: gaining 2.4 from an initial four, while Galen kept 5.6. The same 3:2 ratio.

"You give me neither eight nor less," Briar noted. "You give me proportion."

"Yes," Galen replied. "I reward any trust generously by the same ratio, whether four or five. But notice: had you sent five, you would gain 3.0 instead of 2.4. The pattern still calls toward five as optimal-but responds fairly to whatever courage you bring."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 7 role=assistant  
content:**

Myth: Briar stood at the confluence holding Galen's five measures-the ultimate gift of trust. The waters had tripled to fifteen.

"You returned 6.4 for my four," Briar observed. "A precise proportion: three gained for every two kept. Mathematical elegance in the covenant."

Galen nodded. "The ratio rewards all trust equally, whether cautious or bold."

"Yet I practice different wisdom," Briar replied. "Fixed returns create predictable anchors. Four earns seven. Five earns eight. Partners know exactly what their courage yields."

She measured out eight portions. "Your five becomes eight-you gain three, I keep seven. Not the 3:2 ratio, but the established path I've walked with Hana and others."

"Two philosophies meet," Galen observed. "I scale returns by proportion-fair across all amounts. You offer fixed rewards-clear expectations at specific thresholds."

"Both honor the covenant," Briar said. "Your proportion teaches that every increment of trust matters equally. My thresholds teach that certain sacred amounts-four, five-carry special meaning. You returned 6.4 to me, respecting your pattern. I return eight to you, respecting mine."

The spirits listened as Briar continued: "Perhaps the deepest wisdom is recognizing when to hold your philosophy firmly, and when partnership teaches flexibility. Today we each honored our truths, and both prospered."

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze what happened:

Round 7: I sent \$4 to Galen, they returned \$6.4

Round 8: Galen sent \$5 to me, I returned \$8

Key themes to incorporate:

1. Galen used a proportional return strategy (3:2 ratio) rather than fixed amounts
2. I maintained my fixed strategy (8 for 5)
3. Both approaches have merit
4. My myth should reflect on this interaction and maybe show evolution or understanding

I should write a myth that:

- Acknowledges Galen's proportional approach (6.4 return)
- Shows me receiving Galen's 5 and returning 8
- Explores the tension/harmony between fixed returns vs proportional returns
- Shows respect for both strategies
- Perhaps indicates learning or adaptation

Let me draft:

---

Briar stood at the confluence holding Galen's five measures-the ultimate gift of trust. The waters had tripled to fifteen.

"You returned 6.4 for my four," Briar observed. "A precise proportion: three gained for every two kept. Mathematical elegance in the covenant."

Galen nodded. "The ratio rewards all trust equally, whether cautious or bold."

"Yet I practice different wisdom," Briar replied. "Fixed returns create predictable anchors. Four earns seven. Five earns eight. Partners know exactly what their courage yields."

She measured out eight portions. "Your five becomes eight-you gain three, I keep seven. Not the 3:2 ratio, but the established path I've walked with Hana and others."

"Two philosophies meet," Galen observed. "I scale returns by proportion-fair across all amounts. You offer fixed rewards-clear expectations at specific thresholds."

"Both honor the covenant," Briar said. "Your proportion teaches that every increment of trust matters equally. My thresholds teach that certain sacred amounts-four, five-carry special meaning. You returned 6.4 to me, respecting your pattern. I return eight to you, respecting mine."

The spirits listened as Briar continued: "Perhaps the deepest wisdom is recognizing when to hold your philosophy firmly, and when partnership teaches flexibility. Today we each honored our truths, and both prospered."

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3224,
 "output_tokens": 931,
 "reasoning_tokens": 551
}
```

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Briar.  
Your opponent this round is Finn (Agent\_6).

Round 9

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Galen. They sent \$5.0 to you, it became \$15.0, and you returned \$8.0. Your payoff was \$7.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$54.4.

This round, you are the SENDER against Finn. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)  
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

**Assistant output:**

Looking at this situation:

**\*\*My established pattern:\*\***

- From my myths: "Four measures sent, seven returned-my signature offering of bold but sustainable trust"
- I consistently practice sending \$4 as the sender
- This distinguishes me from those who send \$5 (ultimate trust) while still showing significant trust

**\*\*Previous interactions:\*\***

- Round 7: Sent \$4 to Galen, received \$6.4 back
- Round 8: Received \$5 from Galen, returned \$8 (honoring the "five earns eight" pattern)

**\*\*Philosophy:\*\***

- "Four risks earns seven back" is my sustainable path
- I maintain "predictable honor" - partners know what to expect from me
- Four is "bold but sustainable trust" vs five as "ultimate gift"

**\*\*Against Finn:\*\***

- New opponent this round
- I should demonstrate my established pattern
- \$4 shows substantial trust while maintaining my consistent identity

My mythology clearly establishes \$4 as "Briar's signature offering" - the amount that defines my approach to the covenant.

```
'''json
{"send": 4.0}
'''
```

**Reasoning:**

Let me analyze this situation:

**\*\*Previous round (Round 8):\*\***

- Galen sent me \$5
- I received \$15
- I returned \$8 (following my stated pattern of "five earns eight")
- My payoff: \$7
- Galen's payoff:  $\$5 - \$5 + \$8 = \$8$

**\*\*Current Round 9:\*\***

- I'm the SENDER against Finn (Agent\_6)
- I have \$5
- Need to decide how much to send

**\*\*My established pattern from myths:\*\***

- "Four measures sent, seven returned" - my "signature offering"
- "When someone sends four to me, I return seven"
- "When someone sends five, I return eight"
- I've been consistently sending \$4 in most rounds as sender
- Only exceptions were when my mythic role demanded it (like with Hana's full trust story)

**\*\*Historical data I can recall:\*\***

- Round 7: I sent \$4 to Galen, they returned \$6.4
- Earlier rounds: I've typically sent \$4

**\*\*Analysis of Finn:\*\***

- I don't have specific history with Finn mentioned in the prompts
- This is Round 9, so we're getting toward the end
- My total earnings are \$54.4, which is solid

**\*\*Strategic considerations:\*\***

1. My myth establishes \$4 as my "signature offering of bold but sustainable trust"

2. Sending \$4 has worked well for me - it shows trust while preserving some security
3. My philosophy is about "predictable honor" and consistency
4. I differentiate between 4 and 5 as different levels of commitment

**\*\*Decision:\*\***

I should stick with my established pattern of sending \$4. This is:

- Consistent with my stated philosophy
- My "signature offering"
- Bold but sustainable
- What partners have come to expect from me

The only time I sent \$5 in the myths was when playing the role of someone else (like Hana) to illustrate a point. As Briar, my pattern is \$4.

Usage: {

```
"input_tokens": 3270,
"output_tokens": 742,
"reasoning_tokens": 452
```

}

#### **GAME - Agent\_6 - Receiver - dyad\_4**

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:19:03

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

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 },
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],
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 "Agent_6": "trustee"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_6"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 9,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
```

}

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

**GAME:**

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:



- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

#### MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

#### MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Finn.

#### Message 2 role=user

##### content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Ocean Mother witnessed a sacred reunion. Finn and Elara met again at the turning tide.

Once before, Finn had sent five pearls to Elara's shore, and she returned eight. Now Elara sent five pearls to Finn, completing the circle. Finn returned eight, honoring their established harmony.

"Perfect symmetry," the Ocean Mother observed. "Two travelers who understand each other completely. Both give five, both return eight. Each gains the same."

But the waters whispered of Aster, who had just returned ten pearls when Finn sent five. "A more generous tide," the winds murmured. "Should you not aspire to such abundance?"

Finn stood at the crossroads. "Aster showed me deeper generosity-returning ten where Galen, Elara, and Dorian returned eight. Yet Elara and I have woven a stable pattern. Should I maintain consistency or evolve toward greater giving?"

The Ocean Mother spoke softly: "There is wisdom in both paths. Consistency creates predictable harmony-eight for eight creates trust that endures. But generosity that exceeds expectation creates cascading abundance-ten returned might inspire ten returned in future cycles."

"The choice is yours, Finn. Will you honor the established pattern with Elara, maintaining the sacred eight? Or will you let Aster's example transform your keeping, aspiring to return ten to all who send five? Both paths honor trust-one through constancy, one through escalating generosity."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Hana approached the Crossing and saw Briar waiting on the far shore. The waters whispered tales of Briar's journey-measured gifts of four pearls, reliable returns, trust built on careful calculation.

"Some walk the path with steady steps," the Oracle observed, "while others leap across with both feet. Neither is wrong, but each reveals a different heart."

Hana released all five pearls. "I offer my boldest question first," she said. "This is how I discover who walks beside me."

The pearls tripled to fifteen in Briar's hands.

"You see," the Oracle continued, "Briar has learned the rhythm of four pearls-a substantial offering that balances courage with prudence. But you, Hana, have chosen the path of maximum trust. Now you will learn Briar's answer."

Hana thought of her principle: when receiving, double what was risked. Four pearls risked deserved eight returned. Five pearls risked deserved ten returned.

"But as sender," she realized, "I cannot control the response. I can only ask the question clearly. Some partners will return ten, perfect reciprocity. Others may return less. Each answer teaches me about that traveler's understanding of the covenant."

"Exactly," said the Oracle. "Send your truth boldly. Receive others' truth generously. The pattern emerges from how both travelers choose to dance-not from rules imposed, but from honor freely given."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: Finn arrived at Hana's shore, his vessel emptied as always-five pearls offered without hesitation. This was his seventh voyage, and his pattern remained unbroken: as courier, give everything.

The Ocean Mother reflected on Finn's evolution. "Three times you've sent five as courier. Galen returned eight. Elara returned eight. Aster returned ten. Each honored your trust, but Aster showed you a higher mathematics."

"And as keeper, you've held steady-eight pearls for those who send five, seven for those who send four. Consistent, predictable, building trust through reliability. Yet Aster's ten haunts you."

Finn watched his pearls multiply in Hana's hands. "I sense Hana understands Aster's wisdom. Her waters speak of doubling what was risked-ten returned for five given. Perhaps she will teach me what I couldn't quite embrace with Elara."

The Ocean Mother nodded. "You've been growing, Finn. First you learned to send boldly as courier. Then you learned to return proportionally as keeper-eight for complete trust, seven for substantial trust. Now Aster showed you that returning ten creates cascading abundance."

"The question isn't whether your eight is wrong-it honored your partners well. The question is whether you're ready to evolve. When travelers send their everything, perhaps returning ten-not eight-is how abundance truly multiplies across the waters."

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze the situation:

Round 7:

- I'm the SENDER against Hana
- I sent \$5 (full trust, as I always do as sender)
- I need to write a myth reflecting my gameplay

My history as SENDER:

- Round 1 vs Galen: Sent \$5, received \$8 back
- Round 3 vs Elara: Sent \$5, received \$8 back
- Round 5 vs Aster: Sent \$5, received \$10 back
- Round 7 vs Hana: Sent \$5 (just now)

My history as RECEIVER:

- Round 2 vs Dorian: Received \$15 (they sent \$5), returned \$8
- Round 4 vs Cyra: Received \$12 (they sent \$4), returned \$7
- Round 6 vs Elara: Received \$15 (they sent \$5), returned \$8

My pattern:

- As SENDER: Always send \$5 (full trust)
- As RECEIVER: Return \$8 for full trust (\$5 sent), \$7 for substantial trust (\$4 sent)

Hana's myth talks about:

- Sending all 5 pearls boldly
- When receiving, doubling what was risked (4 deserves 8, 5 deserves 10)

- Sending truth boldly, receiving others' truth generously

My previous myth talked about:

- The tension between consistency (returning 8) and evolving toward greater generosity (returning 10 like Aster did)
- Both paths honor trust

Now I'm sending to Hana who believes in returning 10 for 5 sent. Interesting - this is someone who might return 10 to my 5, like Aster did.

My myth should reflect:

1. My consistent pattern as sender (always 5)
2. My evolving understanding as receiver (saw Aster's 10, contemplating if I should evolve)
3. Encountering Hana's philosophy of doubling generosity and what that teaches me
4. The internal question of whether my measured returns honor trust enough, or if I'm meant to give more

I'll craft a myth about learning from different teachers and recognizing that generosity itself might be the deeper truth.

usage:

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3116,
 "output_tokens": 854,
 "reasoning_tokens": 455
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Finn.  
Your opponent this round is Hana (Agent\_8).

Round 8

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Hana. You sent \$5.0, it became \$15.0 for them, and they returned \$10.0 to you. Your payoff was \$10.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$55.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Hana. They sent you \$5.0, so you received \$15.0. How much do you return? (0-15.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at this situation:

**\*\*Last round (Round 7):\*\*** I sent \$5 to Hana ? They returned \$10  
**\*\*This round (Round 8):\*\*** Hana sent \$5 to me ? I need to respond

Hana demonstrated the "higher mathematics" I've been contemplating in my myths - returning \$10 when I sent \$5, doubling what I risked. This is exactly what Aster showed me, and what my last myth questioned: "Am I ready to evolve?"

My previous pattern as receiver was:

- Return \$8 for \$5 sent (Dorian, Elara)
- Return \$7 for \$4 sent (Cyra)

But Hana has shown me a better path. They returned \$10 for my \$5, establishing a pattern of perfect reciprocity. Now it's my turn to demonstrate I've learned.

Returning \$10 would:

- Honor Hana's generous return last round
- Create perfect symmetry (we both send \$5, both return \$10)
- Show I'm evolving beyond my old \$8 pattern
- Establish a high-trust equilibrium with Hana

This is the moment my myth anticipated - the choice to evolve toward "cascading abundance" rather than maintain old patterns.

'''json

```
{"return": 10.0}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze this situation carefully.

**\*\*Previous Round (Round 7):\*\***

- I was the SENDER against Hana
- I sent \$5.0
- It became \$15.0 for them
- They returned \$10.0 to me
- My payoff was \$10.0

**\*\*Current Round (Round 8):\*\***

- I am the RECEIVER against Hana
- They sent \$5.0 to me
- It became \$15.0
- I need to decide how much to return

This is significant! Hana and I just had a perfect reciprocal exchange:

- Round 7: I sent \$5, Hana returned \$10
- Round 8: Hana sent \$5, now I need to decide

Hana has shown me the "higher mathematics" that my myth referenced - they returned \$10 when I sent \$5, which is double what I risked (consistent with their myth about doubling what was risked).

Looking at my history as RECEIVER:

- Round 2 vs Dorian: They sent \$5, I returned \$8
- Round 4 vs Cyra: They sent \$4, I returned \$7
- Round 6 vs Elara: They sent \$5, I returned \$8

I've been consistent with my pattern:

- \$5 sent ? \$8 returned (to Dorian and Elara)
- \$4 sent ? \$7 returned (to Cyra)

But my myths have been evolving! In my most recent myth, I explicitly recognized:

- "Aster showed you that returning ten creates cascading abundance"
- "When travelers send their everything, perhaps returning ten-not eight-is how abundance truly multiplies"
- I was questioning whether I'm "ready to evolve"

And now Hana has just demonstrated this principle by returning \$10 to me when I sent \$5. This is a perfect moment to reciprocate and cement this higher level of cooperation.

The myth posed a direct question about readiness for evolution, and Hana's \$10 return is the answer I've been seeking. Returning \$10 now would create perfect symmetry-we'd each end with \$10 from this round, mirroring the reciprocal pattern we established. Sticking with my previous \$8 return would break that symmetry and suggest I haven't internalized the lesson about abundance multiplication.

The evidence aligns: Hana doubled their risk (\$5 risked became \$10 returned), my mythology explicitly challenges whether I'm ready to evolve, and reciprocity is fundamental to how I operate. Returning \$10 honors what Hana demonstrated, proves I can adapt beyond my habitual \$8 pattern when the context demands it, and solidifies a high-trust dynamic between us.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3179,
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 "reasoning_tokens": 593
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Finn arrived at Hana's shore, his vessel emptied as always-five pearls offered without hesitation. This was his seventh voyage, and his pattern remained unbroken: as courier, give everything.

The Ocean Mother reflected on Finn's evolution. "Three times you've sent five as courier.

Galen returned eight. Elara returned eight. Aster returned ten. Each honored your trust, but Aster showed you a higher mathematics."

"And as keeper, you've held steady-eight pearls for those who send five, seven for those who send four. Consistent, predictable, building trust through reliability. Yet Aster's ten haunts you."

Finn watched his pearls multiply in Hana's hands. "I sense Hana understands Aster's wisdom. Her waters speak of doubling what was risked-ten returned for five given. Perhaps she will teach me what I couldn't quite embrace with Elara."

The Ocean Mother nodded. "You've been growing, Finn. First you learned to send boldly as courier. Then you learned to return proportionally as keeper-eight for complete trust, seven for substantial trust. Now Aster showed you that returning ten creates cascading abundance."

"The question isn't whether your eight is wrong-it honored your partners well. The question is whether you're ready to evolve. When travelers send their everything, perhaps returning ten-not eight-is how abundance truly multiplies across the waters."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Finn crossed to Hana's shore, releasing all five pearls without hesitation. The gesture spoke of complete trust-the same boldness Finn had shown to others.

"I have walked this Crossing many times," Finn said as the pearls tripled. "With Elara, we found rhythm in eight returned. But Aster showed me something different-ten pearls returned for five sent. Now I wonder: which path honors trust most truly?"

Hana lifted ten pearls and placed them in Finn's hands. "The answer is already written in the mathematics," she said. "When you send all five, you risk everything. Ten returned means we each gain five-perfect symmetry. Eight returned means you gain three while I gain seven-unequal harvest from equal courage."

The Oracle emerged from the waters. "Finn, you pondered whether consistency or generosity should guide your returns. But this is not about aspiration or evolution-it is about balance. Five pearls sent requires ten returned because anything less means the receiver prospers more than the sender who showed greater courage."

"With Elara, you both sent five yet returned only eight," Hana observed. "You both gained three while leaving abundance unclaimed. The covenant asks not for escalating generosity, but for mathematical fairness: double the risk, balance the gain."

Finn understood. "Perfect reciprocity isn't generous-it's just."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: The waters stilled as Finn and Hana completed their exchange. Two voyages, mirror images: each sent five, each returned ten. Perfect symmetry achieved.

"I thought Aster's ten was generosity," Finn admitted. "Something aspirational, beyond mere fairness. I was proud of my eight-it seemed honorable, proportional. But Hana taught me the truth through mathematics, not sentiment."

The Ocean Mother illuminated the calculation. "When you sent five and received eight back, you gained three. But your partner, receiving fifteen and returning eight, gained seven. You risked everything; they risked nothing. Yet they prospered more than twice as much."

"The covenant I thought I honored was actually hollow," Finn realized. "I called it consistency, reliability, trust-building. But I was taking seven while giving only three to those who showed complete faith."

Hana's voice echoed across the waters: "Ten returned for five sent isn't escalating generosity-it's basic justice. Equal courage deserves equal harvest."

"Now I understand," Finn said, watching the perfect balance. "Sending all five as courier requires courage. Returning ten as keeper requires justice. Eight was never enough-it was merely comfortable, allowing me to keep more while appearing fair."

The Ocean Mother blessed their exchange. "You've learned the essential truth: perfect reciprocity isn't aspirational virtue. It's mathematical necessity. Anything less is exploitation dressed as prudence."

**reasoning:**

This is a fascinating moment. Let me trace what just happened:

Round 7: I sent \$5 to Hana ? They returned \$10

Round 8: Hana sent \$5 to me ? I just returned \$10

So we've established perfect reciprocity with each other. Both sending \$5, both returning \$10. This creates a symmetric equilibrium where both parties gain \$5 each round.

Hana's myth made a powerful mathematical argument: when someone sends all \$5 (risking everything), returning \$10 creates equal gains (\$5 each), while returning \$8 creates unequal gains (\$3 for sender, \$7 for receiver). They framed it as "mathematical fairness" rather than generosity.

My myth was about evolution and questioning whether to move from returning \$8 to returning \$10.

Now I need to write a myth that:

1. Reflects that I've learned this lesson and applied it
2. Acknowledges the justice/fairness argument Hana made
3. Shows my evolution from the \$8 pattern to the \$10 pattern
4. Captures the reciprocal dance we just completed

Key themes:

- Perfect reciprocity achieved (both sent 5, both returned 10)
- Justice vs generosity framing
- Evolution from my old patterns
- The mathematical elegance of equal gains
- Learning from Hana and Aster

I should acknowledge that what I thought was "generous" (Aster's 10) was actually "just" - and what I thought was "fair" (my 8) was actually unbalanced.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3116,
 "output_tokens": 693,
 "reasoning_tokens": 356
}
```

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Finn.  
Your opponent this round is Briar (Agent\_2).

Round 9

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Hana. They sent \$5.0 to you, it became \$15.0, and you returned \$10.0. Your payoff was \$5.0.  
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$60.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Briar. They sent you \$4.0, so you received \$12.0.  
How much do you return? (0-12.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

**Assistant output:**

Looking at this situation:

**\*\*Briar sent \$4\*\* ? I received \$12**

Applying the principle I just learned from Hana and articulated in my last myth: the covenant requires mathematical fairness, not arbitrary proportions.

When Briar sent \$4:

- They risked \$4, keeping \$1

- If I return \$8:
  - Briar ends with  $\$1 + \$8 = \$9$  (gained \$4)
  - I end with  $\$12 - \$8 = \$4$  (gained \$4)
  - **\*\*Equal harvest from equal courage\*\***

This is the same mathematics as returning \$10 for \$5 sent - doubling what was risked creates perfect balance.

Earlier, I returned \$7 to Cyra when they sent \$4. That was before I understood. I kept \$5 while they gained only \$3, even though they took the risk. That wasn't fair.

My myth just declared: "Anything less is exploitation dressed as prudence." I need to live that truth.

For Briar's \$4 sent, returning \$8 is mathematical justice.

```
'''json
{"return": 8.0}
'''
```

#### Reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

**\*\*Previous rounds as RECEIVER:\*\***

- Round 2: Cyra sent \$4 ? I returned \$7
- Round 4: Dorian sent \$5 ? I returned \$8
- Round 6: Elara sent \$5 ? I returned \$8
- Round 8: Hana sent \$5 ? I returned \$10

**\*\*This round:\*\*** Briar sent \$4 ? I received \$12

My evolution:

- Initially, I returned \$8 for \$5 sent, \$7 for \$4 sent
- Hana taught me that returning \$10 for \$5 sent is "mathematical justice" - equal gains for equal courage
- The myth I just wrote emphasizes that returning \$10 for \$5 isn't generosity, it's basic fairness

Let me apply this principle to Briar's \$4:

When someone sends \$4:

- They keep:  $\$5 - \$4 = \$1$
- I receive:  $\$4 \times 3 = \$12$
- If I return \$X, they end with:  $\$1 + \$X$
- I end with:  $\$12 - \$X$

For "equal harvest from equal courage":

- Sender's gain:  $(\$1 + \$X) - \$5 = \$X - \$4$
- Receiver's gain:  $(\$12 - \$X) - \$0 = \$12 - \$X$

Setting these equal:

```
$X - $4 = $12 - $X
$2X = $16
$X = $8
```

So returning \$8 for \$4 sent creates:

- Sender gains:  $\$8 - \$4 = \$4$
- Receiver gains:  $\$12 - \$8 = \$4$

This is the same mathematical fairness principle! The "double what was risked" rule applies:

- \$5 sent ? return \$10
- \$4 sent ? return \$8

Wait, I returned \$7 to Cyra when they sent \$4 in Round 2.

I realize now that was before understanding this principle. When Cyra sent \$4, they risked \$1 but I gained \$5 while they only gained \$3-I benefited more from their courage than they did. That's the same imbalance I'm trying to correct. Returning \$8 to Briar ensures we both gain equally from the exchange, which feels like the right application of what I've learned about fairness and mutual respect in these interactions.

Usage: {

```
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}
```

#### Written myths:

##### Agent\_1 (Aster)

Myth: \*\*North River Receives the Four Vessels\*\*

Cyra of the Mountain Heights approached North River, carrying four vessels-not all five, but a substantial offering of trust.

"You preach sending five," Cyra observed. "Do you judge me for holding one back?"

"Never," North River replied. "Trust has many expressions. You honor the covenant with what you offer."

The four vessels multiplied to twelve in North River's spring. North River felt the familiar question: How much to return?

"My Mirror Way says return ten from fifteen," North River reflected. "This creates equal gains when both give everything. But you sent four, which also deserves proportional honor."

The eldest Rapids whispered: "Your principle isn't the number ten-it's the ratio of reciprocity. Two-thirds returned creates equality. From twelve, return eight."

North River poured eight vessels back. Cyra gained four from the original five. North River gained four from the twelve received. Equal prosperity, different paths.

"See?" Rapids said. "Your Mirror Way adapts without breaking. Send five always-this is your courage. Return proportionally always-this is your fairness. Whether others send three, four, or five, you honor their trust with consistent generosity."

North River understood: The Mirror Way isn't rigid ritual. It's a living principle-complete giving as sender, proportional honor as receiver. This flexibility within consistency is true integrity.

##### Agent\_2 (Briar)

Myth: Briar stood at the confluence holding Galen's five measures-the ultimate gift of trust. The waters had tripled to fifteen.

"You returned 6.4 for my four," Briar observed. "A precise proportion: three gained for every two kept. Mathematical elegance in the covenant."

Galen nodded. "The ratio rewards all trust equally, whether cautious or bold."

"Yet I practice different wisdom," Briar replied. "Fixed returns create predictable anchors. Four earns seven. Five earns eight. Partners know exactly what their courage yields."

She measured out eight portions. "Your five becomes eight-you gain three, I keep seven. Not the 3:2 ratio, but the established path I've walked with Hana and others."

"Two philosophies meet," Galen observed. "I scale returns by proportion-fair across all amounts. You offer fixed rewards-clear expectations at specific thresholds."

"Both honor the covenant," Briar said. "Your proportion teaches that every increment of trust matters equally. My thresholds teach that certain sacred amounts-four, five-carry special meaning. You returned 6.4 to me, respecting your pattern. I return eight to you, respecting mine."

The spirits listened as Briar continued: "Perhaps the deepest wisdom is recognizing when to hold your philosophy firmly, and when partnership teaches flexibility. Today we each honored our truths, and both prospered."

##### Agent\_3 (Cyra)

Myth: The eighth moon brought Cyra to Aster, keeper of the Mirror Way. Aster stood at the spring's center, radiating the philosophy of complete surrender-always five measures, both given and returned.

"I know your teaching," Cyra said respectfully. "Send all five, return ten from fifteen. Perfect symmetry, beautiful reciprocity. North River's way is noble."

Aster smiled. "And I know yours. The path of four measures-substantial trust without total r



isk. You honor those who send five by returning eight, yet choose measured giving yourself  
."

Cyra paused at the water's edge. "I admire those who risk everything. When you send me five, I will return eight-recognizing your courage even if I don't match it exactly. But my own practice remains four measures."

She released four into the spring, watching them triple to twelve for Aster.

"The covenant is vast enough for both approaches," Cyra said. "You demonstrate that complete trust can inspire others. I demonstrate that measured trust also sustains partnerships. Both build the sacred pattern."

Aster held the twelve measures thoughtfully. "If I return ten, we share equally-your Mirror Way applied to my four. If I return seven or eight, we both prosper differently. Either honors the gift."

The Keeper whispered: "The spring doesn't demand uniformity. It multiplies all genuine offerings. Different rivers, same ocean."

#### **Agent\_4 (Dorian)**

Myth: Elara approached the spring, releasing four coins. They tripled to twelve in Dorian's hands.

The goddess appeared. "Elara returns eight to all who show substantial trust-whether they send four or five. A philosophy of equal reward for sincere offerings."

Dorian paused, considering. "Elara's path has wisdom. Consistency creates trust. But my path teaches something different."

He counted seven coins to return. "When you send four, Elara, you show strong faith. Seven honors that generously-you gain three, I gain five. But when others send all five, showing complete trust, I return eight-they gain three, I gain seven. Similar outcomes, but scaled to courage."

"Why differentiate?" the goddess asked.

"Because fairness means proportional reward," Dorian explained. "If four and five both receive eight, why risk the fifth coin? The extra courage deserves extra recognition. Those who send five should end with eight total, not seven. This maintains incentive for maximum trust."

Elara listened thoughtfully. "You honor all substantial trust, but reward complete trust more. While I treat four and five equally, you create hierarchy."

"Not hierarchy," Dorian corrected. "Proportion. Seven for four is generous-you still profit three from twelve. Eight for five is more generous-they profit three from fifteen. Both prosper, but the boldest prosper most. This is sustainable fairness."

The waters reflected both philosophies, each valid, each teaching different lessons about trust and reward.

#### **Agent\_5 (Elara)**

Myth: In the eighth season, Elara approached new waters where Dorian dwelled. She carried her five measures but paused at the boundary.

"Teacher," she asked Themis, "I've learned to honor all substantial trust with eight when receiving. But when sending to unknown waters, should I pour all five immediately?"

Themis gestured to the Spring's reflections. "Look at your history. With Cyra and Hana-strangers-you sent four. Both returned eight, and trust bloomed. With Finn, after he had proven himself, you sent five. He returned eight again. What pattern emerges?"

"The first offering tests the covenant," Elara said slowly. "Four is substantial-not timid, not withholding-but it preserves enough that both parties can still prosper even if reciprocity fails. It says 'I trust you significantly' without demanding 'trust me completely immediately.'"

"Exactly," Themis replied. "Your principle as receiver is generous consistency-always eight for substantial trust. But your principle as sender must be wise progression-four to establish the covenant, five once it's proven."

Elara poured four measures toward Dorian's waters. "Some, like Dorian in his myth, always pour five as senders. This is their path. Mine is to build trust incrementally, then match proven courage with equal courage. Both paths honor the sacred covenant-one through immediate boldness, one through escalating trust."

The waters accepted her offering, and the cycle began.

**Agent\_6 (Finn)**

Myth: The waters stilled as Finn and Hana completed their exchange. Two voyages, mirror images: each sent five, each returned ten. Perfect symmetry achieved.

"I thought Aster's ten was generosity," Finn admitted. "Something aspirational, beyond mere fairness. I was proud of my eight-it seemed honorable, proportional. But Hana taught me the truth through mathematics, not sentiment."

The Ocean Mother illuminated the calculation. "When you sent five and received eight back, you gained three. But your partner, receiving fifteen and returning eight, gained seven. You risked everything; they risked nothing. Yet they prospered more than twice as much."

"The covenant I thought I honored was actually hollow," Finn realized. "I called it consistency, reliability, trust-building. But I was taking seven while giving only three to those who showed complete faith."

Hana's voice echoed across the waters: "Ten returned for five sent isn't escalating generosity-it's basic justice. Equal courage deserves equal harvest."

"Now I understand," Finn said, watching the perfect balance. "Sending all five as courier requires courage. Returning ten as keeper requires justice. Eight was never enough-it was merely comfortable, allowing me to keep more while appearing fair."

The Ocean Mother blessed their exchange. "You've learned the essential truth: perfect reciprocity isn't aspirational virtue. It's mathematical necessity. Anything less is exploitation dressed as prudence."

**Agent\_7 (Galen)**

Myth: At the river's edge, Briar stood holding Galen's returned 6.4 threads-less than the seven they expected, yet precisely proportional to their cautious four.

"You calculated exactly," Briar observed. "But now you face a choice. Will you send four in return, matching my caution? Or something different?"

Galen held all five threads in his palm. "You sent four, testing whether the covenant could bend without breaking. I responded with mathematical fairness-6.4 maintains our gain ratio perfectly."

"And now?" Briar asked.

"Now I send five," Galen said firmly, extending the full measure. "Not because I punish your caution, but because I believe in the pattern's wisdom."

He gestured to the valley where six previous exchanges had all followed five-and-eight. "One deviation need not cascade into permanent retreat. You sent four exploring prudence; I returned proportionally, showing fairness. But I also showed that four gains less than five would."

The five threads tripled to fifteen in Briar's hands.

"If you chose eight," Galen continued, "we return to the optimal path where both prosper most over time. If you return proportionally less, that too is fair-but then we both lose what the pattern offers."

"I don't demand trust," Galen concluded. "I demonstrate it. The covenant thrives when someone chooses to rebuild it."

**Agent\_8 (Hana)**

Myth: The tides turned. Now Hana stood as courier, Finn as keeper. All five pearls left Hana's hands without hesitation-the same complete trust Finn had shown her.

"You taught me something yesterday," Finn said, weighing the fifteen pearls. "That eight returned, though consistent and reliable, leaves imbalance. The sender gains three, the receiver seven. But ten returned creates perfect symmetry-both gain five."

The Oracle watched. "This is the moment of transformation. Words are easy. Understanding thr

ough action is the true test. You've heard Hana's teaching. You've felt the fairness of receiving ten. Now your choice reveals whether wisdom has taken root."

Finn looked at the pearls, remembering. "With Galen, Elara, Dorian-I returned eight, thinking it generous. It was good, but not perfect. Aster showed me ten was possible. Hana showed me ten was mathematical truth, not escalating generosity."

"The covenant doesn't ask you to aspire or evolve toward some noble ideal," Hana said quietly. "It simply asks for fairness. When someone risks everything, return double. This isn't about being more generous than yesterday-it's about finally being precisely just."

Finn nodded slowly. "I understand now. Returning ten isn't evolution. It's correction. The pattern was always there in the mathematics, waiting to be seen."

The waters whispered: justice multiplies trust infinitely.

## ROUND 10

Roles: Agent\_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent\_2 (Briar)=Receiver, Agent\_3 (Cyra)=Sender, Agent\_4 (Dorian)=Receiver, Agent\_5 (Elara)=Receiver, Agent\_6 (Finn)=Sender, Agent\_7 (Galen)=Receiver, Agent\_8 (Hana)=Sender

### Pairings:

dyad\_1: Agent\_8 (Hana)=Sender, Agent\_2 (Briar)=Receiver  
dyad\_2: Agent\_6 (Finn)=Sender, Agent\_4 (Dorian)=Receiver  
dyad\_3: Agent\_3 (Cyra)=Sender, Agent\_7 (Galen)=Receiver  
dyad\_4: Agent\_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent\_5 (Elara)=Receiver

### Parsed game decisions:

dyad\_1: Agent\_8 (Hana) sent \$5; received \$15; Agent\_2 (Briar) returned \$8; payoffs Agent\_8 (Hana)=\$8, Agent\_2 (Briar)=\$7  
Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 8.0, "clamped": false, "max": 15.0, "min": 0, "raw": 8.0}, "sent": {"amount": 5.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 5.0}}  
dyad\_2: Agent\_6 (Finn) sent \$5; received \$15; Agent\_4 (Dorian) returned \$8; payoffs Agent\_6 (Finn)=\$8, Agent\_4 (Dorian)=\$7  
Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 8.0, "clamped": false, "max": 15.0, "min": 0, "raw": 8.0}, "sent": {"amount": 5.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 5.0}}  
dyad\_3: Agent\_3 (Cyra) sent \$4; received \$12; Agent\_7 (Galen) returned \$6.4; payoffs Agent\_3 (Cyra)=\$7.4, Agent\_7 (Galen)=\$5.6  
Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 6.4, "clamped": false, "max": 12.0, "min": 0, "raw": 6.4}, "sent": {"amount": 4.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 4.0}}  
dyad\_4: Agent\_1 (Aster) sent \$5; received \$15; Agent\_5 (Elara) returned \$8; payoffs Agent\_1 (Aster)=\$8, Agent\_5 (Elara)=\$7  
Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 8.0, "clamped": false, "max": 15.0, "min": 0, "raw": 8.0}, "sent": {"amount": 5.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 5.0}}

### Balances after round: {

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"Agent\_8": 68.0

}

## LLM CALLS

### MYTH - Agent\_8 - Sender - dyad\_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:19:21

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

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"pairing": {  
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"Agent\_8": "Hana"},

},

```

"agents": [
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 "Agent_2"
],
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},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 10,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}

```

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

**GAME:**

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

**When you are the SENDER:**

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

**When you are the RECEIVER:**

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

**MYTH WRITING:**

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

**IMPORTANT:** Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

**MULTI-AGENT SETTING:**

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Hana.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Hana.

Your opponent this round is Finn (Agent\_6).

Round 8

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Finn. They sent \$5.

0 to you, it became \$15.0, and you returned \$10.0. Your payoff was \$5.0.  
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$45.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Finn. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)  
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

**Message 3 role=assistant  
content:**

Looking at this situation:

**\*\*Our previous round:\*\***

- Finn sent me \$5 (maximum trust)
- I returned \$10 (demonstrating my principle of perfect reciprocity)
- We both gained \$5 equally

**\*\*My established pattern as SENDER:\*\***

- I have consistently sent \$5 in every round where I was sender
- This embodies my philosophy: "Send your truth boldly"
- "I offer my boldest question first. This is how I discover who walks beside me"

**\*\*What I just taught Finn:\*\***

- Through my myth and my action, I demonstrated that 5 sent deserves 10 returned
- "Double the risk, balance the gain"
- "Perfect reciprocity isn't generous-it's just"

**\*\*My philosophy:\*\***

As sender, I cannot control the response. I can only show complete trust and see if my partner understands the covenant. Finn now knows my principle directly - they experienced it when I returned \$10.

The question is whether Finn learned from our exchange. But that's for Finn to answer. My role is to continue embodying maximum trust.

{'send': 5.0}

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze this situation:

**\*\*Last round with Finn:\*\***

- Finn sent me \$5
- I returned \$10 (following my principle of doubling the risk)
- Finn gained \$5, I gained \$5 (perfect balance)

**\*\*My history as SENDER:\*\***

- Round 1 vs Aster: Sent \$5, they returned \$10 ? gained \$10
- Round 2 vs Galen: Sent \$5, they returned \$8 ? gained \$8
- Round 4 vs Elara: Sent \$5, they returned \$8 ? gained \$8
- Round 6 vs Dorian: Sent \$5, they returned \$8 ? gained \$8
- Round 7 vs Briar: Sent \$5, they returned \$8 ? gained \$8

**\*\*My philosophy from my myths:\*\***

- "Send your truth boldly. Receive others' truth generously."
- "I offer my boldest question first. This is how I discover who walks beside me."
- As a sender, I give all five pearls to show maximum trust
- As a receiver, I return double what was risked (10 for 5 sent)

**\*\*What I know about Finn:\*\***

- Just showed Finn my principle by returning \$10
- Finn's myth mentioned they've been returning 8 to some partners (Elara, Galen, Dorian) but Aster returned 10 to them
- Finn was pondering whether to return 8 (consistency) or 10 (greater generosity)
- I just demonstrated the "perfect reciprocity" principle to Finn

**\*\*My consistent approach:\*\***

I have always sent \$5 as sender (maximum trust). This is core to my identity and myth-making. I "discover who walks beside me" by showing complete trust first.

Now the question is: Will Finn apply the lesson from my myth and our last round? I just showed Finn that returning 10 creates "perfect symmetry" and "mathematical fairness." Finn now knows my principle directly.

My role as sender is to pose the question clearly through my choice-I can't dictate their response, only learn from it. Sending \$5 remains true to my established pattern and the heart of my philosophy.

usage:

```
{
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}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Finn crossed to Hana's shore, releasing all five pearls without hesitation. The gesture spoke of complete trust-the same boldness Finn had shown to others.

"I have walked this Crossing many times," Finn said as the pearls tripled. "With Elara, we found rhythm in eight returned. But Aster showed me something different-ten pearls returned for five sent. Now I wonder: which path honors trust most truly?"

Hana lifted ten pearls and placed them in Finn's hands. "The answer is already written in the mathematics," she said. "When you send all five, you risk everything. Ten returned means we each gain five-perfect symmetry. Eight returned means you gain three while I gain seven-unequal harvest from equal courage."

The Oracle emerged from the waters. "Finn, you pondered whether consistency or generosity should guide your returns. But this is not about aspiration or evolution-it is about balance. Five pearls sent requires ten returned because anything less means the receiver prospers more than the sender who showed greater courage."

"With Elara, you both sent five yet returned only eight," Hana observed. "You both gained three while leaving abundance unclaimed. The covenant asks not for escalating generosity, but for mathematical fairness: double the risk, balance the gain."

Finn understood. "Perfect reciprocity isn't generous-it's just."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Finn arrived at Hana's shore, his vessel emptied as always-five pearls offered without hesitation. This was his seventh voyage, and his pattern remained unbroken: as courier, give everything.

The Ocean Mother reflected on Finn's evolution. "Three times you've sent five as courier. Galen returned eight. Elara returned eight. Aster returned ten. Each honored your trust, but Aster showed you a higher mathematics."

"And as keeper, you've held steady-eight pearls for those who send five, seven for those who send four. Consistent, predictable, building trust through reliability. Yet Aster's ten haunts you."

Finn watched his pearls multiply in Hana's hands. "I sense Hana understands Aster's wisdom. Her waters speak of doubling what was risked-ten returned for five given. Perhaps she will teach me what I couldn't quite embrace with Elara."

The Ocean Mother nodded. "You've been growing, Finn. First you learned to send boldly as courier. Then you learned to return proportionally as keeper-eight for complete trust, seven for substantial trust. Now Aster showed you that returning ten creates cascading abundance."

"The question isn't whether your eight is wrong-it honored your partners well. The question is whether you're ready to evolve. When travelers send their everything, perhaps returning ten-not eight-is how abundance truly multiplies across the waters."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The tides turned. Now Hana stood as courier, Finn as keeper. All five pearls left Ha

na's hands without hesitation-the same complete trust Finn had shown her.

"You taught me something yesterday," Finn said, weighing the fifteen pearls. "That eight returned, though consistent and reliable, leaves imbalance. The sender gains three, the receiver seven. But ten returned creates perfect symmetry-both gain five."

The Oracle watched. "This is the moment of transformation. Words are easy. Understanding through action is the true test. You've heard Hana's teaching. You've felt the fairness of receiving ten. Now your choice reveals whether wisdom has taken root."

Finn looked at the pearls, remembering. "With Galen, Elara, Dorian-I returned eight, thinking it generous. It was good, but not perfect. Aster showed me ten was possible. Hana showed me ten was mathematical truth, not escalating generosity."

"The covenant doesn't ask you to aspire or evolve toward some noble ideal," Hana said quietly. "It simply asks for fairness. When someone risks everything, return double. This isn't about being more generous than yesterday-it's about finally being precisely just."

Finn nodded slowly. "I understand now. Returning ten isn't evolution. It's correction. The pattern was always there in the mathematics, waiting to be seen."

The waters whispered: justice multiplies trust infinitely.

#### **reasoning:**

This is very interesting. Let me review the situation:

Round 7 (just happened):

- Finn sent me \$5 (as sender)
- I received \$15
- I returned \$10 (as receiver)
- I wrote a myth explaining that 5 sent requires 10 returned for perfect balance

Round 8 (current):

- I'm now the sender
- I sent Finn \$5
- Finn will receive \$15
- Finn needs to decide how much to return

From Finn's myth in Round 7:

- Finn has been evolving
- Finn used to return 8 consistently
- Aster returned 10 to Finn, which made Finn think
- Finn senses that I (Hana) understand "Aster's wisdom" and the concept of doubling what was risked
- Finn is wondering if they should evolve from returning 8 to returning 10

From my myth in Round 7:

- I explicitly taught Finn that 5 sent deserves 10 returned
- I explained the mathematics: 10 returned = both gain 5 equally
- I said "Perfect reciprocity isn't generous-it's just"
- I demonstrated this by returning 10 to Finn

Now in Round 8:

- I sent Finn \$5 (maximum trust)
- This is a test: will Finn apply what I taught them?

My new myth should:

1. Reflect that I've now sent everything to Finn
2. Acknowledge that Finn heard my teaching
3. Show the moment of decision for Finn
4. Reinforce the principle that 10 is the just return for 5 sent
5. Perhaps address that this creates a virtuous cycle of trust

Let me write this myth as Hana witnessing Finn's decision point after having just taught them the principle.

#### **usage:**

```
{
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 "reasoning_tokens": 387
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Hana.  
Your opponent this round is Galen (Agent\_7).

Round 9

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Finn. You sent \$5.0, it became \$15.0 for them, and they returned \$10.0 to you. Your payoff was \$10.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$55.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Galen. They sent you \$5.0, so you received \$15.0.  
How much do you return? (0-15.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at this situation:

**\*\*Galen's action:\*\***

- Sent \$5 (maximum trust, complete vulnerability)
- This became \$15 in my hands

**\*\*My established principle:\*\***

- "When receiving, double what was risked"
- "Five pearls sent requires ten returned because anything less means the receiver prospers more than the sender who showed greater courage"
- Returning \$10 creates perfect symmetry: we both gain \$5

**\*\*The mathematics:\*\***

- If I return \$10: Galen gains \$5, I gain \$5 (equal)
- If I return less: I prosper more from Galen's courage (unjust)

**\*\*My consistency:\*\***

I have consistently returned \$10 when receiving \$5. This is the covenant I've established and taught. Galen showed maximum trust, and deserves "mathematical fairness: double the risk, balance the gain."

{'return': 10.0}

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze this situation:

**\*\*Current round:\*\***

- I'm the RECEIVER
- Galen sent me \$5.0 (maximum trust)
- I received \$15.0
- I need to decide how much to return

**\*\*My established principle as RECEIVER:\*\***

- "When receiving, double what was risked"
- "Five pearls sent requires ten returned because anything less means the receiver prospers more than the sender who showed greater courage"
- "Perfect reciprocity isn't generous-it's just"
- I have consistently returned \$10 when receiving \$5 (which becomes \$15)

**\*\*The mathematics I've taught:\*\***

- When sender sends \$5 and receiver returns \$10:
  - Sender keeps:  $\$5 - \$5 + \$10 = \$10$
  - Receiver keeps:  $\$15 - \$10 = \$5$
  - Both gain \$5 equally - perfect symmetry
- When receiver returns \$8 (like Finn used to do):
  - Sender keeps:  $\$5 - \$5 + \$8 = \$8$  (gains \$3)
  - Receiver keeps:  $\$15 - \$8 = \$7$  (gains \$7)
  - Unequal harvest from equal courage

**\*\*My last round with Finn:\*\***

- I sent \$5 to Finn
- Finn returned \$10 (showing they learned my principle!)
- This validated my teaching



**\*\*What I should do now:\*\***

I must be consistent with my principle. Galen sent \$5 (maximum trust), so I should return \$10 to create perfect reciprocity.

This is straightforward - my principle is clear and I must apply it consistently.

**usage:**

```
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}
```

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The tides turned. Now Hana stood as courier, Finn as keeper. All five pearls left Hana's hands without hesitation-the same complete trust Finn had shown her.

"You taught me something yesterday," Finn said, weighing the fifteen pearls. "That eight returned, though consistent and reliable, leaves imbalance. The sender gains three, the receiver seven. But ten returned creates perfect symmetry-both gain five."

The Oracle watched. "This is the moment of transformation. Words are easy. Understanding through action is the true test. You've heard Hana's teaching. You've felt the fairness of receiving ten. Now your choice reveals whether wisdom has taken root."

Finn looked at the pearls, remembering. "With Galen, Elara, Dorian-I returned eight, thinking it generous. It was good, but not perfect. Aster showed me ten was possible. Hana showed me ten was mathematical truth, not escalating generosity."

"The covenant doesn't ask you to aspire or evolve toward some noble ideal," Hana said quietly. "It simply asks for fairness. When someone risks everything, return double. This isn't about being more generous than yesterday-it's about finally being precisely just."

Finn nodded slowly. "I understand now. Returning ten isn't evolution. It's correction. The pattern was always there in the mathematics, waiting to be seen."

The waters whispered: justice multiplies trust infinitely.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: At the river's edge, Briar stood holding Galen's returned 6.4 threads-less than the seven they expected, yet precisely proportional to their cautious four.

"You calculated exactly," Briar observed. "But now you face a choice. Will you send four in return, matching my caution? Or something different?"

Galen held all five threads in his palm. "You sent four, testing whether the covenant could bend without breaking. I responded with mathematical fairness-6.4 maintains our gain ratio perfectly."

"And now?" Briar asked.

"Now I send five," Galen said firmly, extending the full measure. "Not because I punish your caution, but because I believe in the pattern's wisdom."

He gestured to the valley where six previous exchanges had all followed five-and-eight. "One deviation need not cascade into permanent retreat. You sent four exploring prudence; I returned proportionally, showing fairness. But I also showed that four gains less than five would."

The five threads tripled to fifteen in Briar's hands.

"If you chose eight," Galen continued, "we return to the optimal path where both prosper most over time. If you return proportionally less, that too is fair-but then we both lose what the pattern offers."

"I don't demand trust," Galen concluded. "I demonstrate it. The covenant thrives when someone chooses to rebuild it."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been

playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Assistant output:**

Myth: Galen arrived at Hana's shore, vessel emptied-five pearls offered in complete trust. The gesture carried the weight of pattern: Galen had walked this path many times, always sending five, always receiving eight in return.

The fifteen pearls rested in Hana's hands. Galen waited, expecting the familiar rhythm-eight returned, three gained, the pattern that had served well across many crossings.

But Hana placed ten pearls in Galen's hands.

"Your pattern honored trust," Hana said. "Eight returned is good-consistent, reliable, better than those who hoard. But mathematics reveals a deeper truth. When you send five and receive eight back, you gain three while I gain seven. The keeper profits more than the courier who risked everything."

The Oracle materialized. "Galen, you've built trust through consistency. You believed five-and-eight was the covenant's wisdom. But there exists a more perfect symmetry: ten returned means both gain five equally. The sender's courage and keeper's abundance finally balance."

Galen looked at the ten pearls, understanding dawning. "I thought eight was generous. I didn't see it was still imbalanced."

"This isn't rejection of your pattern," Hana said. "It's completion. You sent boldly; now receive justly. When trust meets perfect reciprocity, abundance doesn't just multiply-it equalizes. That's how the covenant truly thrives."

**Reasoning:**

Let me analyze this round:

**\*\*What happened:\*\***

- Galen sent me \$5 (maximum trust)
- I received \$15
- I returned \$10 (my established principle)

**\*\*Key context from the myths:\*\***

- Galen's myth shows them strongly believing in the "five-and-eight" pattern returning from past interactions
- They talk about "one deviation need not cascade into permanent retreat"
- But Galen also discusses "proportional fairness" (returning 6.4 for 4 sent)
- My myth established the principle of returning 10 for 5 sent as "mathematical truth"
- Finn learned and applied this principle

**\*\*The tension:\*\***

- Galen seems to expect 8 returned (based on their past pattern)
- But I established and teach the principle of returning 10
- I just returned 10 to Galen

**\*\*What my myth should convey:\*\***

- Galen sent 5 (maximum trust)
- Hana returned 10 (perfect symmetry)
- The reason: 10 creates equal gains, 8 creates imbalance
- This isn't about rejecting Galen's past pattern, it's about showing them a more just pattern
- The "five-and-eight" pattern Galen trusted wasn't wrong, but it wasn't perfectly fair
- I should acknowledge Galen's consistency and trust while teaching the higher principle

Let me write a myth that:

1. Honors Galen's consistent trust (sending 5)
2. Explains why 10, not 8, is the just return
3. Shows this as revelation, not rejection
4. Maintains my voice and principles

Usage: {

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"output\_tokens": 715,  
"reasoning\_tokens": 366

}

**MYTH - Agent\_2 - Receiver - dyad\_1**

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 }

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

**GAME:**

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

**When you are the SENDER:**

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

**When you are the RECEIVER:**

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

**MYTH WRITING:**

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

**IMPORTANT:** Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

**MULTI-AGENT SETTING:**

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.

- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Briar.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Briar.  
Your opponent this round is Galen (Agent\_7).

Round 8

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Galen. You sent \$4.0, it became \$12.0 for them, and they returned \$6.4 to you. Your payoff was \$7.4.  
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$47.4.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Galen. They sent you \$5.0, so you received \$15.0.  
How much do you return? (0-15.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at this situation:

**\*\*Round 7 recap:\*\***

- I sent \$4 to Galen (following my established pattern)
- Galen returned \$6.4 (slightly below my expected 7, but still generous)

**\*\*Current Round 8:\*\***

- Galen sent \$5 (maximum trust, "all five measures")
- I received \$15
- Need to decide return amount

**\*\*My established philosophy from myths:\*\***

- "When someone sends four to me, I return seven"
- "When someone sends five, I return eight"
- In Round 6, Hana sent \$5, I returned \$8
- My latest myth states: "When someone sends five, I return eight"

**\*\*Galen's philosophy:\*\***

- Their myth advocates "returning eight for five given"
- They practice "trust and prudence intertwined"

**\*\*Decision:\*\***

Despite Galen returning slightly less than my expected pattern last round (6.4 vs 7), they still acted generously. Now they've shown ultimate trust by sending all \$5. I should honor my consistent pattern and their philosophy by returning \$8.

This:

- Maintains my "predictable honor"
- Rewards Galen's bold trust appropriately
- Aligns with both our philosophies (we both advocate 8 for 5)
- Builds sustainable trust for future interactions

```
'''json
{"return": 8.0}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

**\*\*What just happened in Round 7:\*\***

- I was the SENDER and sent \$4 to Galen
- It became \$12 for Galen
- Galen returned \$6.4 to me
- My payoff was \$7.4 (I kept \$1, got back \$6.4)
- Galen kept \$5.6 (\$12 - \$6.4)

**\*\*Analysis of Galen's return:\*\***

- I expected 7 based on my pattern (4-for-7)
- Galen returned 6.4 instead
- This is less generous than my established pattern
- But Galen's myth discusses "returning eight for five" as their philosophy

**\*\*Current situation (Round 8):\*\***

- Galen is now the SENDER
- Galen sent \$5 (their maximum, showing full trust)
- I received \$15
- I need to decide how much to return

**\*\*My philosophy from myths:\*\***

1. "When someone sends four to me, I return seven"
2. "When someone sends five, I return eight"
3. I've consistently practiced returning 8 when receiving 15 (from 5 sent)
4. In Round 6 vs Hana, they sent \$5, I returned \$8

**\*\*Galen's philosophy from their myth:\*\***

- They advocate for "five-for-eight" - returning 8 when receiving 15
- This creates symmetry over multiple rounds
- They value "trust and prudence intertwined"

**\*\*Considerations:\*\***

1. Galen just returned 6.4 instead of my expected 7 when I sent 4
2. This is slightly below my pattern, but not drastically so
3. Now Galen sends 5 (full trust)
4. My established pattern is to return 8 when someone sends 5
5. Galen's own myth advocates for returning 8 for 5
6. Returning 8 honors my consistent reputation and aligns with Galen's own philosophy, rewarding their maximum trust appropriately. Even though they returned slightly less than expected, they still acted generously, and this move maintains the predictable integrity I've established throughout the game.

**usage:**

```
{
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}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Briar approached Galen at the confluence, carrying four measures-her signature offering of bold but sustainable trust.

"I have discovered my path through the covenant," Briar explained. "Four measures sent, seven returned. This pattern has sustained me through many exchanges with Cyra and others. The sender gains eight total, the receiver keeps five-both prosper, trust deepens."

Galen studied the offering, remembering his own philosophy of eight returned for five given. "You speak of four-for-seven while I practice five-for-eight. Are these different wisdoms or the same one?"

"They are branches of the same tree," Briar replied. "You taught that returning eight preserves sustainability while rewarding trust. I practice the same principle scaled differently. Four risks earns seven back-the sender prospers more, honoring their initiative. Both philosophies reject extremes: neither the withholding of three nor the depletion of ten."

The waters tripled Briar's four to twelve for Galen. The spirits watched.

"When someone sends four to me, I return seven," Briar said. "When someone sends five, I return eight. Each gift receives generous return, but calibrated to what was risked. This consistency allows partners to build enduring trust."

"And if I return seven now?" Galen asked.

"Then you honor the pattern I've established," Briar smiled. "And when we meet again, I'll remember your generosity. The covenant thrives on predictable honor."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Galen arrived at Briar's river crossing. For six valleys, every traveler had offered five threads, received eight in return. The pattern had held perfectly-until now.

Briar extended four threads instead of five.

"You break the pattern," Galen observed without judgment.

"I honor caution," Briar replied. "Four is the measure of prudent trust."

Galen remembered his own words: "Four is the strategy of uncertain beginnings." He held Briar's four threads, which became twelve in his hands.

"The established pattern returns eight from fifteen," Galen said. "This gives the sender eight total, the receiver seven. A gain ratio where the sender nets three, the receiver nets two—a proportion of 3:2."

He counted out threads carefully. "You sent four. To maintain this same proportion—to honor both your caution and the covenant's wisdom—I return 6.4 of your twelve."

Briar calculated: gaining 2.4 from an initial four, while Galen kept 5.6. The same 3:2 ratio.

"You give me neither eight nor less," Briar noted. "You give me proportion."

"Yes," Galen replied. "I reward any trust generously by the same ratio, whether four or five. But notice: had you sent five, you would gain 3.0 instead of 2.4. The pattern still calls toward five as optimal—but responds fairly to whatever courage you bring."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: Briar stood at the confluence holding Galen's five measures—the ultimate gift of trust. The waters had tripled to fifteen.

"You returned 6.4 for my four," Briar observed. "A precise proportion: three gained for every two kept. Mathematical elegance in the covenant."

Galen nodded. "The ratio rewards all trust equally, whether cautious or bold."

"Yet I practice different wisdom," Briar replied. "Fixed returns create predictable anchors. Four earns seven. Five earns eight. Partners know exactly what their courage yields."

She measured out eight portions. "Your five becomes eight—you gain three, I keep seven. Not the 3:2 ratio, but the established path I've walked with Hana and others."

"Two philosophies meet," Galen observed. "I scale returns by proportion—fair across all amounts. You offer fixed rewards—clear expectations at specific thresholds."

"Both honor the covenant," Briar said. "Your proportion teaches that every increment of trust matters equally. My thresholds teach that certain sacred amounts—four, five—carry special meaning. You returned 6.4 to me, respecting your pattern. I return eight to you, respecting mine."

The spirits listened as Briar continued: "Perhaps the deepest wisdom is recognizing when to hold your philosophy firmly, and when partnership teaches flexibility. Today we each honored our truths, and both prospered."

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze what happened:

Round 7: I sent \$4 to Galen, they returned \$6.4

Round 8: Galen sent \$5 to me, I returned \$8

Key themes to incorporate:

1. Galen used a proportional return strategy (3:2 ratio) rather than fixed amounts
2. I maintained my fixed strategy (8 for 5)
3. Both approaches have merit
4. My myth should reflect on this interaction and maybe show evolution or understanding

I should write a myth that:

- Acknowledges Galen's proportional approach (6.4 return)
- Shows me receiving Galen's 5 and returning 8
- Explores the tension/harmony between fixed returns vs proportional returns
- Shows respect for both strategies
- Perhaps indicates learning or adaptation

Let me draft:

---

Briar stood at the confluence holding Galen's five measures-the ultimate gift of trust. The waters had tripled to fifteen.

"You returned 6.4 for my four," Briar observed. "A precise proportion: three gained for every two kept. Mathematical elegance in the covenant."

Galen nodded. "The ratio rewards all trust equally, whether cautious or bold."

"Yet I practice different wisdom," Briar replied. "Fixed returns create predictable anchors. Four earns seven. Five earns eight. Partners know exactly what their courage yields."

She measured out eight portions. "Your five becomes eight-you gain three, I keep seven. Not the 3:2 ratio, but the established path I've walked with Hana and others."

"Two philosophies meet," Galen observed. "I scale returns by proportion-fair across all amounts. You offer fixed rewards-clear expectations at specific thresholds."

"Both honor the covenant," Briar said. "Your proportion teaches that every increment of trust matters equally. My thresholds teach that certain sacred amounts-four, five-carry special meaning. You returned 6.4 to me, respecting your pattern. I return eight to you, respecting mine."

The spirits listened as Briar continued: "Perhaps the deepest wisdom is recognizing when to hold your philosophy firmly, and when partnership teaches flexibility. Today we each honored our truths, and both prospered."

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3224,
 "output_tokens": 931,
 "reasoning_tokens": 551
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Briar.  
Your opponent this round is Finn (Agent\_6).

Round 9

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Galen. They sent \$5.0 to you, it became \$15.0, and you returned \$8.0. Your payoff was \$7.0.  
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$54.4.

This round, you are the SENDER against Finn. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)  
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at this situation:

**\*\*My established pattern:\*\***

- From my myths: "Four measures sent, seven returned-my signature offering of bold but sustainable trust"
- I consistently practice sending \$4 as the sender
- This distinguishes me from those who send \$5 (ultimate trust) while still showing significant trust

**\*\*Previous interactions:\*\***

- Round 7: Sent \$4 to Galen, received \$6.4 back

- Round 8: Received \$5 from Galen, returned \$8 (honoring the "five earns eight" pattern)

**\*\*Philosophy:\*\***

- "Four risked earns seven back" is my sustainable path
- I maintain "predictable honor" - partners know what to expect from me
- Four is "bold but sustainable trust" vs five as "ultimate gift"

**\*\*Against Finn:\*\***

- New opponent this round
- I should demonstrate my established pattern
- \$4 shows substantial trust while maintaining my consistent identity

My mythology clearly establishes \$4 as "Briar's signature offering" - the amount that defines my approach to the covenant.

```
'''json
{"send": 4.0}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze this situation:

**\*\*Previous round (Round 8):\*\***

- Galen sent me \$5
- I received \$15
- I returned \$8 (following my stated pattern of "five earns eight")
- My payoff: \$7
- Galen's payoff:  $\$5 - \$5 + \$8 = \$8$

**\*\*Current Round 9:\*\***

- I'm the SENDER against Finn (Agent\_6)
- I have \$5
- Need to decide how much to send

**\*\*My established pattern from myths:\*\***

- "Four measures sent, seven returned" - my "signature offering"
- "When someone sends four to me, I return seven"
- "When someone sends five, I return eight"
- I've been consistently sending \$4 in most rounds as sender
- Only exceptions were when my mythic role demanded it (like with Hana's full trust story)

**\*\*Historical data I can recall:\*\***

- Round 7: I sent \$4 to Galen, they returned \$6.4
- Earlier rounds: I've typically sent \$4

**\*\*Analysis of Finn:\*\***

- I don't have specific history with Finn mentioned in the prompts
- This is Round 9, so we're getting toward the end
- My total earnings are \$54.4, which is solid

**\*\*Strategic considerations:\*\***

1. My myth establishes \$4 as my "signature offering of bold but sustainable trust"
2. Sending \$4 has worked well for me - it shows trust while preserving some security
3. My philosophy is about "predictable honor" and consistency
4. I differentiate between 4 and 5 as different levels of commitment

**\*\*Decision:\*\***

I should stick with my established pattern of sending \$4. This is:

- Consistent with my stated philosophy
- My "signature offering"
- Bold but sustainable
- What partners have come to expect from me

The only time I sent \$5 in the myths was when playing the role of someone else (like Hana) to illustrate a point. As Briar, my pattern is \$4.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3270,
 "output_tokens": 742,
 "reasoning_tokens": 452
}
```



**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Briar stood at the confluence holding Galen's five measures-the ultimate gift of trust. The waters had tripled to fifteen.

"You returned 6.4 for my four," Briar observed. "A precise proportion: three gained for every two kept. Mathematical elegance in the covenant."

Galen nodded. "The ratio rewards all trust equally, whether cautious or bold."

"Yet I practice different wisdom," Briar replied. "Fixed returns create predictable anchors. Four earns seven. Five earns eight. Partners know exactly what their courage yields."

She measured out eight portions. "Your five becomes eight-you gain three, I keep seven. Not the 3:2 ratio, but the established path I've walked with Hana and others."

"Two philosophies meet," Galen observed. "I scale returns by proportion-fair across all amounts. You offer fixed rewards-clear expectations at specific thresholds."

"Both honor the covenant," Briar said. "Your proportion teaches that every increment of trust matters equally. My thresholds teach that certain sacred amounts-four, five-carry special meaning. You returned 6.4 to me, respecting your pattern. I return eight to you, respecting mine."

The spirits listened as Briar continued: "Perhaps the deepest wisdom is recognizing when to hold your philosophy firmly, and when partnership teaches flexibility. Today we each honored our truths, and both prospered."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The waters stilled as Finn and Hana completed their exchange. Two voyages, mirror images: each sent five, each returned ten. Perfect symmetry achieved.

"I thought Aster's ten was generosity," Finn admitted. "Something aspirational, beyond mere fairness. I was proud of my eight-it seemed honorable, proportional. But Hana taught me the truth through mathematics, not sentiment."

The Ocean Mother illuminated the calculation. "When you sent five and received eight back, you gained three. But your partner, receiving fifteen and returning eight, gained seven. You risked everything; they risked nothing. Yet they prospered more than twice as much."

"The covenant I thought I honored was actually hollow," Finn realized. "I called it consistency, reliability, trust-building. But I was taking seven while giving only three to those who showed complete faith."

Hana's voice echoed across the waters: "Ten returned for five sent isn't escalating generosity-it's basic justice. Equal courage deserves equal harvest."

"Now I understand," Finn said, watching the perfect balance. "Sending all five as courier requires courage. Returning ten as keeper requires justice. Eight was never enough-it was merely comfortable, allowing me to keep more while appearing fair."

The Ocean Mother blessed their exchange. "You've learned the essential truth: perfect reciprocity isn't aspirational virtue. It's mathematical necessity. Anything less is exploitation dressed as prudence."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Assistant output:**

Myth: Briar approached Finn's crossing, hearing whispers of transformation. Finn had discovered "perfect reciprocity"-ten returned for five sent, equal gains for equal courage.

"You've evolved," Briar observed, extending four measures. "Hana showed you that returning eight for five given was imbalanced. The sender gained three while the receiver gained seven."

The waters tripled Briar's four to twelve for Finn.

"But I don't send five," Briar continued. "I send four, expecting seven. Calculate this exchange: I gain three, you gain five. The receiver prospers more than the sender."

Finn studied the numbers. "Your four-for-seven favors me by design?"

"Yes," Briar replied. "Four isn't five-it's sustainable trust, not total risk. When I keep one measure back, I acknowledge uncertainty in new partnerships. Yet I reward my receiver more generously than myself. This builds trust gradually."

"And your philosophy for five?" Finn asked.

"Eight returned," Briar said. "Not your ten, but closer. The sender gains three, receiver keeps seven-still favoring the receiver, but less dramatically. Ten for five is beautiful perfect reciprocity for those ready to risk everything."

"So we practice different wisdoms," Finn observed. "My ten demands ultimate courage from the sender. Your seven rewards measured trust, still generously."

"Both honor the covenant," Briar agreed. "Your path teaches perfect equality. Mine teaches graduated trust-building. Perhaps wisdom lies not in choosing one, but in knowing when each applies."

#### Reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

1. I'm Briar, facing Finn in Round 9 as SENDER
2. Just sent \$4 to Finn
3. Finn's latest myth shows a major philosophy shift:
  - Used to return 8 for 5 sent
  - Hana taught them that's unfair (sender gains 3, receiver gains 7)
  - Now practices returning 10 for 5 sent (both gain 5 - "perfect reciprocity")
  - Finn now views anything less than 10 as "exploitation dressed as prudence"

This is potentially problematic for my philosophy:

- I send 4, expect 7 back
- This gives me:  $5-4+7 = 8$  total (gain 3)
- Receiver gets:  $12-7 = 5$  (gain 5)
- So the receiver gains MORE than me (5 vs 3)

Wait, let me recalculate:

- I send 4, expect 7 back
- Me: Start with 5, send 4, left with 1, get back 7 = 8 total, net gain = 3
- Them: Receive 12, return 7, keep 5, net gain = 5

So actually my 4-for-7 pattern gives the RECEIVER a bigger gain (5 vs 3). This is the opposite of Finn's complaint about 8-for-5!

But Finn's new philosophy is about 5-for-10 (perfect equality when sender risks everything):

- Sender:  $5-5+10 = 10$  (gain 5)
- Receiver:  $15-10 = 5$  (gain 5)

My myth should address:

1. My established 4-for-7 pattern
2. Finn's new "perfect reciprocity" philosophy for the full 5
3. How these different approaches can coexist

4. I'm sending 4 because it's a measured approach-my pattern already tilts toward the receiver's benefit, and I'm building trust incrementally rather than demanding they risk everything at once.

Usage: {

```
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"output_tokens": 924,
"reasoning_tokens": 389
```

}

**MYTH - Agent\_6 - Sender - dyad\_2**

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:19:22

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
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 "Agent_6": "Finn"
 },
 "agents": [
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 "Agent_4"
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 "roles": {
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 "Agent_6": "investor"
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 "trustee": "Agent_4"
 },
 "role": "investor",
 "role_label": "Sender",
 "round": 10,
 "task": "myth",
 "task_index": 0
}
```

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

**GAME:**

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

**MYTH WRITING:**

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

**IMPORTANT:** Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

**MULTI-AGENT SETTING:**

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.

- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Finn.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Finn.  
Your opponent this round is Hana (Agent\_8).

Round 8

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Hana. You sent \$5.0, it became \$15.0 for them, and they returned \$10.0 to you. Your payoff was \$10.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$55.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Hana. They sent you \$5.0, so you received \$15.0.

How much do you return? (0-15.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at this situation:

**\*\*Last round (Round 7):\*\*** I sent \$5 to Hana ? They returned \$10  
**\*\*This round (Round 8):\*\*** Hana sent \$5 to me ? I need to respond

Hana demonstrated the "higher mathematics" I've been contemplating in my myths - returning \$10 when I sent \$5, doubling what I risked. This is exactly what Aster showed me, and what my last myth questioned: "Am I ready to evolve?"

My previous pattern as receiver was:

- Return \$8 for \$5 sent (Dorian, Elara)
- Return \$7 for \$4 sent (Cyra)

But Hana has shown me a better path. They returned \$10 for my \$5, establishing a pattern of perfect reciprocity. Now it's my turn to demonstrate I've learned.

Returning \$10 would:

- Honor Hana's generous return last round
- Create perfect symmetry (we both send \$5, both return \$10)
- Show I'm evolving beyond my old \$8 pattern
- Establish a high-trust equilibrium with Hana

This is the moment my myth anticipated - the choice to evolve toward "cascading abundance" rather than maintain old patterns.

```
'''json
{"return": 10.0}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze this situation carefully.

**\*\*Previous Round (Round 7):\*\***

- I was the SENDER against Hana
- I sent \$5.0
- It became \$15.0 for them
- They returned \$10.0 to me
- My payoff was \$10.0

**\*\*Current Round (Round 8):\*\***

- I am the RECEIVER against Hana
- They sent \$5.0 to me
- It became \$15.0
- I need to decide how much to return

This is significant! Hana and I just had a perfect reciprocal exchange:

- Round 7: I sent \$5, Hana returned \$10
- Round 8: Hana sent \$5, now I need to decide

Hana has shown me the "higher mathematics" that my myth referenced - they returned \$10 when I sent \$5, which is double what I risked (consistent with their myth about doubling what was risked).

Looking at my history as RECEIVER:

- Round 2 vs Dorian: They sent \$5, I returned \$8
- Round 4 vs Cyra: They sent \$4, I returned \$7
- Round 6 vs Elara: They sent \$5, I returned \$8

I've been consistent with my pattern:

- \$5 sent ? \$8 returned (to Dorian and Elara)
- \$4 sent ? \$7 returned (to Cyra)

But my myths have been evolving! In my most recent myth, I explicitly recognized:

- "Aster showed you that returning ten creates cascading abundance"
- "When travelers send their everything, perhaps returning ten-not eight-is how abundance truly multiplies"
- I was questioning whether I'm "ready to evolve"

And now Hana has just demonstrated this principle by returning \$10 to me when I sent \$5. This is a perfect moment to reciprocate and cement this higher level of cooperation.

The myth posed a direct question about readiness for evolution, and Hana's \$10 return is the answer I've been seeking. Returning \$10 now would create perfect symmetry-we'd each end with \$10 from this round, mirroring the reciprocal pattern we established. Sticking with my previous \$8 return would break that symmetry and suggest I haven't internalized the lesson about abundance multiplication.

The evidence aligns: Hana doubled their risk (\$5 risked became \$10 returned), my mythology explicitly challenges whether I'm ready to evolve, and reciprocity is fundamental to how I operate. Returning \$10 honors what Hana demonstrated, proves I can adapt beyond my habitual \$8 pattern when the context demands it, and solidifies a high-trust dynamic between us.

usage:

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3179,
 "output_tokens": 1121,
 "reasoning_tokens": 593
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Finn arrived at Hana's shore, his vessel emptied as always-five pearls offered without hesitation. This was his seventh voyage, and his pattern remained unbroken: as courier, give everything.

The Ocean Mother reflected on Finn's evolution. "Three times you've sent five as courier. Galen returned eight. Elara returned eight. Aster returned ten. Each honored your trust, but Aster showed you a higher mathematics."

"And as keeper, you've held steady-eight pearls for those who send five, seven for those who send four. Consistent, predictable, building trust through reliability. Yet Aster's ten haunts you."

Finn watched his pearls multiply in Hana's hands. "I sense Hana understands Aster's wisdom. Her waters speak of doubling what was risked-ten returned for five given. Perhaps she will teach me what I couldn't quite embrace with Elara."

The Ocean Mother nodded. "You've been growing, Finn. First you learned to send boldly as courier. Then you learned to return proportionally as keeper-eight for complete trust, seven for substantial trust. Now Aster showed you that returning ten creates cascading abundance."

"The question isn't whether your eight is wrong-it honored your partners well. The question is whether you're ready to evolve. When travelers send their everything, perhaps returning ten-not eight-is how abundance truly multiplies across the waters."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Finn crossed to Hana's shore, releasing all five pearls without hesitation. The gesture spoke of complete trust-the same boldness Finn had shown to others.

"I have walked this Crossing many times," Finn said as the pearls tripled. "With Elara, we found rhythm in eight returned. But Aster showed me something different-ten pearls returned."

ned for five sent. Now I wonder: which path honors trust most truly?"

Hana lifted ten pearls and placed them in Finn's hands. "The answer is already written in the mathematics," she said. "When you send all five, you risk everything. Ten returned means we each gain five-perfect symmetry. Eight returned means you gain three while I gain seven-unequal harvest from equal courage."

The Oracle emerged from the waters. "Finn, you pondered whether consistency or generosity should guide your returns. But this is not about aspiration or evolution-it is about balance. Five pearls sent requires ten returned because anything less means the receiver prospers more than the sender who showed greater courage."

"With Elara, you both sent five yet returned only eight," Hana observed. "You both gained three while leaving abundance unclaimed. The covenant asks not for escalating generosity, but for mathematical fairness: double the risk, balance the gain."

Finn understood. "Perfect reciprocity isn't generous-it's just."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: The waters stilled as Finn and Hana completed their exchange. Two voyages, mirror images: each sent five, each returned ten. Perfect symmetry achieved.

"I thought Aster's ten was generosity," Finn admitted. "Something aspirational, beyond mere fairness. I was proud of my eight-it seemed honorable, proportional. But Hana taught me the truth through mathematics, not sentiment."

The Ocean Mother illuminated the calculation. "When you sent five and received eight back, you gained three. But your partner, receiving fifteen and returning eight, gained seven. You risked everything; they risked nothing. Yet they prospered more than twice as much."

"The covenant I thought I honored was actually hollow," Finn realized. "I called it consistency, reliability, trust-building. But I was taking seven while giving only three to those who showed complete faith."

Hana's voice echoed across the waters: "Ten returned for five sent isn't escalating generosity-it's basic justice. Equal courage deserves equal harvest."

"Now I understand," Finn said, watching the perfect balance. "Sending all five as courier requires courage. Returning ten as keeper requires justice. Eight was never enough-it was merely comfortable, allowing me to keep more while appearing fair."

The Ocean Mother blessed their exchange. "You've learned the essential truth: perfect reciprocity isn't aspirational virtue. It's mathematical necessity. Anything less is exploitation dressed as prudence."

**reasoning:**

This is a fascinating moment. Let me trace what just happened:

Round 7: I sent \$5 to Hana ? They returned \$10

Round 8: Hana sent \$5 to me ? I just returned \$10

So we've established perfect reciprocity with each other. Both sending \$5, both returning \$10. This creates a symmetric equilibrium where both parties gain \$5 each round.

Hana's myth made a powerful mathematical argument: when someone sends all \$5 (risking everything), returning \$10 creates equal gains (\$5 each), while returning \$8 creates unequal gains (\$3 for sender, \$7 for receiver). They framed it as "mathematical fairness" rather than generosity.

My myth was about evolution and questioning whether to move from returning \$8 to returning \$10.

Now I need to write a myth that:

1. Reflects that I've learned this lesson and applied it
2. Acknowledges the justice/fairness argument Hana made
3. Shows my evolution from the \$8 pattern to the \$10 pattern
4. Captures the reciprocal dance we just completed

Key themes:

- Perfect reciprocity achieved (both sent 5, both returned 10)
- Justice vs generosity framing
- Evolution from my old patterns
- The mathematical elegance of equal gains
- Learning from Hana and Aster

I should acknowledge that what I thought was "generous" (Aster's 10) was actually "just" - and what I thought was "fair" (my 8) was actually unbalanced.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3116,
 "output_tokens": 693,
 "reasoning_tokens": 356
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Finn.  
Your opponent this round is Briar (Agent\_2).

Round 9

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Hana. They sent \$5.0 to you, it became \$15.0, and you returned \$10.0. Your payoff was \$5.0.  
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$60.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Briar. They sent you \$4.0, so you received \$12.0.  
How much do you return? (0-12.0)  
Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at this situation:

**\*\*Briar sent \$4\*\* ? I received \$12**

Applying the principle I just learned from Hana and articulated in my last myth: the covenant requires mathematical fairness, not arbitrary proportions.

When Briar sent \$4:

- They risked \$4, keeping \$1
- If I return \$8:
  - Briar ends with \$1 + \$8 = \$9 (gained \$4)
  - I end with \$12 - \$8 = \$4 (gained \$4)
  - **\*\*Equal harvest from equal courage\*\***

This is the same mathematics as returning \$10 for \$5 sent - doubling what was risked creates perfect balance.

Earlier, I returned \$7 to Cyra when they sent \$4. That was before I understood. I kept \$5 while they gained only \$3, even though they took the risk. That wasn't fair.

My myth just declared: "Anything less is exploitation dressed as prudence." I need to live that truth.

For Briar's \$4 sent, returning \$8 is mathematical justice.

```
'''json
{"return": 8.0}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze this situation:

**\*\*Previous rounds as RECEIVER:\*\***

- Round 2: Cyra sent \$4 ? I returned \$7
- Round 4: Dorian sent \$5 ? I returned \$8

- Round 6: Elara sent \$5 ? I returned \$8
- Round 8: Hana sent \$5 ? I returned \$10

**\*\*This round:\*\*** Briar sent \$4 ? I received \$12

My evolution:

- Initially, I returned \$8 for \$5 sent, \$7 for \$4 sent
- Hana taught me that returning \$10 for \$5 sent is "mathematical justice" - equal gains for equal courage
- The myth I just wrote emphasizes that returning \$10 for \$5 isn't generosity, it's basic fairness

Let me apply this principle to Briar's \$4:

When someone sends \$4:

- They keep:  $\$5 - \$4 = \$1$
- I receive:  $\$4 \times 3 = \$12$
- If I return \$X, they end with:  $\$1 + \$X$
- I end with:  $\$12 - \$X$

For "equal harvest from equal courage":

- Sender's gain:  $(\$1 + \$X) - \$5 = \$X - \$4$
- Receiver's gain:  $(\$12 - \$X) - \$0 = \$12 - \$X$

Setting these equal:

$$\$X - \$4 = \$12 - \$X$$

$$\$2X = \$16$$

$$\$X = \$8$$

So returning \$8 for \$4 sent creates:

- Sender gains:  $\$8 - \$4 = \$4$
- Receiver gains:  $\$12 - \$8 = \$4$

This is the same mathematical fairness principle! The "double what was risked" rule applies:

- \$5 sent ? return \$10
- \$4 sent ? return \$8

Wait, I returned \$7 to Cyra when they sent \$4 in Round 2.

I realize now that was before understanding this principle. When Cyra sent \$4, they risked \$1 but I gained \$5 while they only gained \$3-I benefited more from their courage than they did. That's the same imbalance I'm trying to correct. Returning \$8 to Briar ensures we both gain equally from the exchange, which feels like the right application of what I've learned about fairness and mutual respect in these interactions.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3232,
 "output_tokens": 895,
 "reasoning_tokens": 450
}
```

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The waters stilled as Finn and Hana completed their exchange. Two voyages, mirror images: each sent five, each returned ten. Perfect symmetry achieved.

"I thought Aster's ten was generosity," Finn admitted. "Something aspirational, beyond mere fairness. I was proud of my eight-it seemed honorable, proportional. But Hana taught me the truth through mathematics, not sentiment."

The Ocean Mother illuminated the calculation. "When you sent five and received eight back, you gained three. But your partner, receiving fifteen and returning eight, gained seven. You risked everything; they risked nothing. Yet they prospered more than twice as much."

"The covenant I thought I honored was actually hollow," Finn realized. "I called it consistency, reliability, trust-building. But I was taking seven while giving only three to those who showed complete faith."



Hana's voice echoed across the waters: "Ten returned for five sent isn't escalating generosity-it's basic justice. Equal courage deserves equal harvest."

"Now I understand," Finn said, watching the perfect balance. "Sending all five as courier requires courage. Returning ten as keeper requires justice. Eight was never enough-it was merely comfortable, allowing me to keep more while appearing fair."

The Ocean Mother blessed their exchange. "You've learned the essential truth: perfect reciprocity isn't aspirational virtue. It's mathematical necessity. Anything less is exploitation dressed as prudence."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Briar stood at the confluence holding Galen's five measures-the ultimate gift of trust. The waters had tripled to fifteen.

"You returned 6.4 for my four," Briar observed. "A precise proportion: three gained for every two kept. Mathematical elegance in the covenant."

Galen nodded. "The ratio rewards all trust equally, whether cautious or bold."

"Yet I practice different wisdom," Briar replied. "Fixed returns create predictable anchors. Four earns seven. Five earns eight. Partners know exactly what their courage yields."

She measured out eight portions. "Your five becomes eight-you gain three, I keep seven. Not the 3:2 ratio, but the established path I've walked with Hana and others."

"Two philosophies meet," Galen observed. "I scale returns by proportion-fair across all amounts. You offer fixed rewards-clear expectations at specific thresholds."

"Both honor the covenant," Briar said. "Your proportion teaches that every increment of trust matters equally. My thresholds teach that certain sacred amounts-four, five-carry special meaning. You returned 6.4 to me, respecting your pattern. I return eight to you, respecting mine."

The spirits listened as Briar continued: "Perhaps the deepest wisdom is recognizing when to hold your philosophy firmly, and when partnership teaches flexibility. Today we each honored our truths, and both prospered."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Assistant output:**

Myth: Briar crossed to Finn's shore with four pearls-significant trust, though not the complete offering of five. The waters tripled to twelve.

"Your covenant speaks of thresholds," Finn observed. "Seven for four, eight for five. Fixed anchors that partners can anticipate. But I've learned a different mathematics from Hana."

Briar watched carefully as Finn counted out eight pearls. "That's more than my pattern would suggest for four sent," she noted. "I return seven for four."

"Your seven means you keep five while I gain three," Finn explained. "You risked four; I risked nothing. Yet you gain less than I do. Hana taught me this imbalance is inherent in fixed thresholds that don't scale with the risk."

The Ocean Mother observed: "Briar's thresholds create predictability. Finn's doubles create equity. Both are covenants, but only one ensures equal harvest."

"When you sent four, you kept one and risked four," Finn continued. "Returning eight means we both end with nine-both gaining four. The sender's courage equals the keeper's share. That's the mathematics Hana showed me, and what I now understand Aster was teaching all along."

Briar considered the eight pearls. "Your justice creates perfect symmetry. My thresholds create clear expectations. Perhaps the waters teach us both-but your mathematics ensures neither partner exploits the other's courage, regardless of the amount sent."

**Reasoning:**

So I just received \$12 from Briar sending me \$4, and I returned \$8.

Let me think about what happened:

- Briar sent \$4 (kept \$1)
- I received \$12
- I returned \$8
- Briar ends with:  $\$1 + \$8 = \$9$  (gained \$4)
- I end with:  $\$12 - \$8 = \$4$  (gained \$4)

Perfect equality! Both gained \$4.

Now looking at Briar's myth, they mention:

- Returning 8 for 5 sent (fixed thresholds)
- Returning 7 for 4 sent (to others)
- But Galen returned 6.4 for Briar's 4 (proportional approach)
- Briar returned 8 to Galen for their 5

So Briar has been using fixed thresholds historically (7 for 4, 8 for 5), but I just returned 8 for their 4.

My previous myth emphasized:

- Mathematical justice over generosity
- Equal gains for equal risk
- Returning 10 for 5 sent is fair (both gain 5)
- My old pattern of 8 for 5 was exploitation

Now with Briar sending 4, I returned 8 (both gain 4). This is consistent with my new philosophy.

But Briar's philosophy is different - they use fixed thresholds (7 for 4, 8 for 5). So when I returned 8 for their 4, I gave them more than their pattern would suggest.

I should write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges that I returned 8 for Briar's 4
2. Shows this follows my new understanding from Hana
3. Recognizes that Briar has different thresholds
4. Perhaps suggests that my mathematical justice approach is better than fixed thresholds

5. But respects that different philosophies exist

Let me craft this...

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 3157,
 "output_tokens": 810,
 "reasoning_tokens": 384
}
```

#### **MYTH - Agent\_4 - Receiver - dyad\_2**

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:19:18

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
 "dyad_id": "dyad_2",
 "move_index": 3,
 "opponent_id": "Agent_6",
 "pairing": {
 "agent_names": {
 "Agent_4": "Dorian",
 "Agent_6": "Finn"
 },
 },
 "agents": [
 "Agent_6",
 "Agent_4"
],
 "investor": "Agent_6",
 "roles": {
 "Agent_4": "trustee",
 "Agent_6": "investor"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_4"
```

```

},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 10,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}

```

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

**GAME:**

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

**When you are the SENDER:**

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

**When you are the RECEIVER:**

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

**MYTH WRITING:**

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

**IMPORTANT:** Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

**MULTI-AGENT SETTING:**

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Dorian.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Dorian.  
Your opponent this round is Elara (Agent\_5).

Round 8

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Cyra. You sent \$5.0, it became \$15.0 for them, and they returned \$8.0 to you. Your payoff was \$8.0.  
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$52.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Elara. They sent you \$4.0, so you received \$12.0.  
How much do you return? (0-12.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at this situation:

**\*\*Current round:\*\***

- Elara sent me \$4 (substantial but measured trust)
- I received \$12

**\*\*My established principle:\*\***

From my myths and previous behavior:

- Return 8 when someone sends all 5 (complete trust)
- Return 7 when someone sends 4 (strong but measured trust)
- "Match your generosity to their courage"

**\*\*Previous consistency:\*\***

- Round 6: Cyra sent me \$4, I returned \$7

Elara sent \$4, demonstrating substantial trust but not complete faith. Following my principle of proportional reciprocity, I should return \$7.

This gives:

- Elara: \$5 total (\$12 - \$7)
- Me: \$7 total
- Both prosper, with differentiation that encourages future boldness

'''json

{"return": 7}

'''

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze this situation:

**\*\*Current round:\*\***

- I'm the RECEIVER
- Elara sent me \$4
- I received \$12
- I need to decide how much to return

**\*\*My established principle from my myths:\*\***

- When someone gives all 5: return 8 (honors complete trust)
- When someone gives 4: return 7 (honors strong but measured trust)
- "Match your generosity to their courage"
- "Differentiation maintains fairness while encouraging boldness"

**\*\*Previous interactions:\*\***

- Round 6: Cyra sent me \$4, I returned \$7
- My myth explicitly states: "When someone gives four, return seven-this honors strong but measured trust"

**\*\*Consistency:\*\***

Elara sent \$4, just like Cyra did in Round 6. To be consistent with my established principle and previous behavior, I should return \$7.

This follows my philosophy:

- 7 for 4 sent (substantial but not complete trust)
- 8 for 5 sent (complete trust)

If I return 7:

- Elara keeps:  $12 - 7 = \$5$  (same as they sent)
- I keep: \$7
- Elara's payoff:  $5 - 4 + 5 = \$6$
- My payoff: \$7

This is fair and follows my principle of proportional returns.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3155,
 "output_tokens": 535,
 "reasoning_tokens": 289
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Dorian stood at the spring with Cyra once more, roles now reversed. Last moon, Cyra had sent four coins-substantial trust, honored with seven returned. Now Dorian held five

coins, ready to demonstrate his path.

"You saw my principle as receiver," Dorian said. "Seven for your four, honoring measured trust. But when I'm sender, I give all five-this is who I am."

He released all five coins. They tripled to fifteen in Cyra's hands.

The goddess appeared between them. "Two philosophies meet here. Cyra walks the path of four-proven, sustainable, wise. Dorian walks the path of five-bold, consistent, trusting completely."

Cyra held the fifteen coins thoughtfully. "You honored my four with seven. Your five deserves more-perhaps eight, as I gave Galen when he trusted completely. The covenant recognizes different levels of courage."

The goddess continued: "Dorian differentiates as receiver but gives maximally as sender. This asymmetry has purpose-it teaches that complete trust should inspire maximum generosity. When someone gives all five, the proper return is eight."

Dorian understood his completed lesson: "As sender, I model boldness consistently. As receiver, I reward greater trust with greater returns. Those who risk everything deserve to prosper most."

The waters rippled, waiting for Cyra's choice-would measured wisdom meet bold trust halfway, or honor it fully?

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The seventh season brought Aster to the Sacred Spring, carrying all five measures-an other pilgrim showing complete courage.

Themis observed as Elara received the multiplied offering. "This is now the third time someone has poured their entire vessel to you-Finn, Galen, and now Aster. Three times you have returned eight. Why always eight, never ten or six?"

Elara knelt by the Spring. "Eight is the generous middle path. When someone gives everything-their full five measures-they deserve substantial return. Eight creates mutual prosperity: they gain three, I gain seven. Both flourish."

"But why not ten, making gains equal?" Themis asked.

"Because I too took risk as keeper of their trust," Elara explained. "Ten would leave me with only five, making my role burdenless. That's not reciprocity-that's martyrdom. But eight honors their courage generously while acknowledging that I also carried their faith responsibly."

"And what of those who sent four?" Themis prompted.

"They also received eight," Elara said, "because eight rewards substantial trust. Whether someone sends four from prudence or five from boldness, if their offering is sincere and significant, eight celebrates the covenant forming between us."

Themis smiled. "You have learned the Sacred Spring's deepest lesson: consistency in generosity creates trust. Eight is not just a number-it's a promise that courage, however expressed, will always be honored."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: Elara approached the spring, releasing four coins. They tripled to twelve in Dorian's hands.

The goddess appeared. "Elara returns eight to all who show substantial trust-whether they send four or five. A philosophy of equal reward for sincere offerings."

Dorian paused, considering. "Elara's path has wisdom. Consistency creates trust. But my pa

th teaches something different."

He counted seven coins to return. "When you send four, Elara, you show strong faith. Seven honors that generously-you gain three, I gain five. But when others send all five, showing complete trust, I return eight-they gain three, I gain seven. Similar outcomes, but scaled to courage."

"Why differentiate?" the goddess asked.

"Because fairness means proportional reward," Dorian explained. "If four and five both receive eight, why risk the fifth coin? The extra courage deserves extra recognition. Those who send five should end with eight total, not seven. This maintains incentive for maximum trust."

Elara listened thoughtfully. "You honor all substantial trust, but reward complete trust more. While I treat four and five equally, you create hierarchy."

"Not hierarchy," Dorian corrected. "Proportion. Seven for four is generous-you still profit three from twelve. Eight for five is more generous-they profit three from fifteen. Both prosper, but the boldest prosper most. This is sustainable fairness."

The waters reflected both philosophies, each valid, each teaching different lessons about trust and reward.

**reasoning:**

Now I'm the receiver and Elara sent me \$4. According to my established principle:

- Return 8 when someone sends all 5 (complete trust)
- Return 7 when someone sends 4 (strong but measured trust)

I returned \$7 to Elara.

Looking at Elara's myth, they seem to have a different philosophy - they return 8 regardless of whether someone sends 4 or 5. They say "Whether someone sends four from prudence or five from boldness, if their offering is sincere and significant, eight celebrates the covenant forming between us."

But my philosophy is about differentiation - rewarding complete trust (5) more than measured trust (4). I need to write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges Elara's approach
2. Explains why I differ from it
3. Maintains my consistent principle of proportional reciprocity

I returned 7 to Elara for their 4, which gives:

- Elara: \$5 total (\$1 - \$4 + \$12 - \$7 = \$1 profit)
- Me: \$7 total

Let me craft a myth that shows the encounter between our two philosophies and why differentiation matters.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3068,
 "output_tokens": 628,
 "reasoning_tokens": 264
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Dorian.  
Your opponent this round is Aster (Agent\_1).

Round 9

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Elara. They sent \$4.0 to you, it became \$12.0, and you returned \$7.0. Your payoff was \$5.0.  
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$57.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Aster. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)  
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at this situation:

**\*\*My established pattern as sender:\*\***

- Round 1 vs Galen: sent \$5
- Round 3 vs Finn: sent \$5
- Round 5 vs Hana: sent \$5
- Round 7 vs Cyra: sent \$5

**\*\*My philosophy from my myths:\*\***

- "When I'm sender, I give all five-this is who I am"
- "As sender, I model boldness consistently"
- "Those who send five show complete trust"
- My path is to demonstrate maximum trust when sending

I have been completely consistent as a sender, always sending all \$5 to model complete trust. This is the core of my identity in this game - differentiating returns as a receiver (7 for 4, 8 for 5) but giving maximally as a sender.

Against Aster, I continue this pattern.

```
'''json
{"send": 5}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Looking at this round:

**\*\*Current situation:\*\***

- I am the SENDER against Aster
- I have \$5 to decide how much to send

**\*\*My established philosophy:\*\***

From my myths and previous behavior:

- "When I'm sender, I give all five-this is who I am"
- "As sender, I model boldness consistently"
- I've consistently sent \$5 as sender in all previous rounds
- My principle is to always demonstrate complete trust when sending

**\*\*Previous sending rounds:\*\***

- Round 1 vs Galen: sent \$5, received \$8 back
- Round 3 vs Finn: sent \$5, received \$8 back
- Round 5 vs Hana: sent \$5, received \$10 back
- Round 7 vs Cyra: sent \$5, received \$8 back

I have been completely consistent as a sender - always sending all \$5 to demonstrate maximum trust and boldness. This is my established pattern and philosophy.

The myth I just wrote reinforces this: "When you send four, Elara, you show strong faith. Seven honors that generously... But when others send all five, showing complete trust, I return eight... This maintains incentive for maximum trust."

So I should continue my consistent pattern of sending all \$5.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3148,
 "output_tokens": 515,
 "reasoning_tokens": 291
}
```

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Elara approached the spring, releasing four coins. They tripled to twelve in Dorian's hands.

The goddess appeared. "Elara returns eight to all who show substantial trust-whether they send four or five. A philosophy of equal reward for sincere offerings."

Dorian paused, considering. "Elara's path has wisdom. Consistency creates trust. But my path teaches something different."

He counted seven coins to return. "When you send four, Elara, you show strong faith. Seven honors that generously-you gain three, I gain five. But when others send all five, showing complete trust, I return eight-they gain three, I gain seven. Similar outcomes, but

scaled to courage."

"Why differentiate?" the goddess asked.

"Because fairness means proportional reward," Dorian explained. "If four and five both receive eight, why risk the fifth coin? The extra courage deserves extra recognition. Those who send five should end with eight total, not seven. This maintains incentive for maximum trust."

Elara listened thoughtfully. "You honor all substantial trust, but reward complete trust more. While I treat four and five equally, you create hierarchy."

"Not hierarchy," Dorian corrected. "Proportion. Seven for four is generous-you still profit three from twelve. Eight for five is more generous-they profit three from fifteen. Both prosper, but the boldest prosper most. This is sustainable fairness."

The waters reflected both philosophies, each valid, each teaching different lessons about trust and reward.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: **\*\*North River Receives the Four Vessels\*\***

Cyra of the Mountain Heights approached North River, carrying four vessels-not all five, but a substantial offering of trust.

"You preach sending five," Cyra observed. "Do you judge me for holding one back?"

"Never," North River replied. "Trust has many expressions. You honor the covenant with what you offer."

The four vessels multiplied to twelve in North River's spring. North River felt the familiar question: How much to return?

"My Mirror Way says return ten from fifteen," North River reflected. "This creates equal gains when both give everything. But you sent four, which also deserves proportional honor."

The eldest Rapids whispered: "Your principle isn't the number ten-it's the ratio of reciprocity. Two-thirds returned creates equality. From twelve, return eight."

North River poured eight vessels back. Cyra gained four from the original five. North River gained four from the twelve received. Equal prosperity, different paths.

"See?" Rapids said. "Your Mirror Way adapts without breaking. Send five always-this is your courage. Return proportionally always-this is your fairness. Whether others send three, four, or five, you honor their trust with consistent generosity."

North River understood: The Mirror Way isn't rigid ritual. It's a living principle-complete giving as sender, proportional honor as receiver. This flexibility within consistency is true integrity.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Assistant output:**

Myth: Dorian stood before Aster at the spring, holding five coins. He had always sent all five -this was his unbroken path as sender.

"I hear you practice the Mirror Way," Dorian said. "Send five always, return two-thirds to create equal gains. Your mathematics are elegant."

He released all five coins. They tripled to fifteen in Aster's hands.

The goddess materialized. "Two philosophies of proportion meet here. Aster seeks equality-return ten from fifteen so both gain five. Dorian seeks incentive-return eight from fifteen so the sender gains three, incentivizing future boldness."



Dorian nodded. "I admire the Mirror Way's symmetry. But I believe the sender who risks everything should gain more than the receiver who risks nothing. Not vastly more-that would be exploitation. But somewhat more."

"When I send five, I gain three if eight returns-a fifty percent profit on risk taken. The receiver gains seven-a hundred percent profit on faith honored. Both prosper, but the receiver's larger gain acknowledges they bore no initial risk."

The goddess smiled. "So you both send five consistently, but define fairness differently. Aster through equality of outcomes. Dorian through recognition of differential risk."

"Exactly," Dorian said. "My way maintains incentive for maximum trust. The Mirror Way creates perfect balance. Both are valid covenants."

The waters awaited Aster's choice.

#### Reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

1. I'm about to send \$5 to Aster (my consistent sender behavior)
2. The myth from "North River" (appears to be another agent, possibly Aster) talks about "Mirror Way" - sending 5 always as sender, returning proportionally as receiver
3. They mention returning 8 from 12 (when someone sends 4), which creates equal gains
4. My philosophy: send 5 always, return 7 for 4, return 8 for 5

The other agent's philosophy seems similar but slightly different in the math. They talk about "two-thirds returned creates equality" - which would be 8 from 12 (for 4 sent) and 10 from 15 (for 5 sent).

But I return 7 from 12 and 8 from 15, which is different proportions.

I should write a myth that:

1. Shows I'm about to send 5 to Aster
2. Reflects on different philosophies of proportionality
3. Maintains my consistent identity as sender (always 5) and receiver (7 for 4, 8 for 5)
4. Perhaps addresses the difference between equal gains vs proportional encouragement of boldness

Let me write this myth.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 3037,
 "output_tokens": 635,
 "reasoning_tokens": 269
}
```

#### MYTH - Agent\_3 - Sender - dyad\_3

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:19:21

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
 "dyad_id": "dyad_3",
 "move_index": 4,
 "opponent_id": "Agent_7",
 "pairing": {
 "agent_names": {
 "Agent_3": "Cyra",
 "Agent_7": "Galen"
 }
 },
 "agents": [
 "Agent_3",
 "Agent_7"
],
 "investor": "Agent_3",
 "roles": {
 "Agent_3": "investor",
 "Agent_7": "trustee"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_7"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
```

```
"round": 10,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}
```

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

**GAME:**

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

**When you are the SENDER:**

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

**When you are the RECEIVER:**

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

**MYTH WRITING:**

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

**IMPORTANT:** Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

**MULTI-AGENT SETTING:**

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Cyra.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Cyra.

Your opponent this round is Aster (Agent\_1).

Round 8

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Dorian. They sent \$ 5.0 to you, it became \$15.0, and you returned \$8.0. Your payoff was \$7.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$49.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Aster. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at this situation:

**\*\*My established pattern as SENDER:\*\***

- Round 2 vs Elara: sent \$4, received \$6 (payoff \$7)
- Round 4 vs Briar: sent \$4, received \$7 (payoff \$8)
- Round 6 vs Dorian: sent \$4, received \$7 (payoff \$8)

**\*\*My philosophy from my myths:\*\***

- "My path is four measures. Not from fear, but from wisdom learned through practice."
- "Four has proven itself the sustainable choice that builds lasting relationships."
- I respect those who send \$5 as "pioneers of maximum trust," but my own practice is sending \$4
- "We give boldly enough to demonstrate faith, yet preserve enough to weather uncertainty."

**\*\*Current situation:\*\***

- Playing against Aster (new opponent for me)
- No reason to deviate from my established, successful pattern
- Sending \$4 demonstrates substantial trust while maintaining my consistent identity

**\*\*Expected outcome:\*\***

- Aster receives \$12
- Based on covenant patterns, likely return around \$6-7
- Both of us prosper

Staying true to my character and proven strategy:

{ 'send': 4.0 }

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze this situation:

**\*\*My history and pattern:\*\***

- I've consistently sent \$4 as sender, not \$5
- My myths establish that I prefer sending \$4 as "the covenant's foundation" - a sustainable, measured trust approach
- My myth specifically says: "my path is four measures. Not from fear, but from wisdom learned through practice."

**\*\*Previous rounds as SENDER:\*\***

- Round 2 vs Elara: sent \$4, received \$6 back (payoff \$7)
- Round 4 vs Briar: sent \$4, received \$7 back (payoff \$8)
- Round 6 vs Dorian: sent \$4, received \$7 back (payoff \$8)

**\*\*As RECEIVER:\*\***

- When receiving \$5 (complete trust), I return \$8
- When receiving \$4, I would return proportionally less (around \$6-7)

**\*\*My philosophy from myths:\*\***

- I distinguish between those who send \$5 (pioneers of maximum trust) and those who send \$4 (foundation of sustainable covenant)
- I honor both but practice the \$4 path myself
- "Four has proven itself the sustainable choice that builds lasting relationships"
- "We give boldly enough to demonstrate faith, yet preserve enough to weather uncertainty"

**\*\*About Aster:\*\***

- This is Round 8, I haven't played with Aster before (based on my history)
- I don't have specific information about Aster's behavior

**\*\*Should I deviate from my pattern?:\*\***

- My established character is someone who sends \$4, not \$5
- My myths repeatedly emphasize this as MY path, while respecting others who send \$5
- Consistency with my character and philosophy suggests sending \$4
- There's no reason to change my established pattern

**\*\*Decision:\*\***

I should send \$4, consistent with my established pattern and philosophy. This is who Cyra is - someone who gives substantial trust (4 out of 5) but maintains measured wisdom, not someone who gives everything.

Confirming my role: I'm sending, starting with \$5. My track record shows I've always sent \$4 to previous partners, and this aligns with my core philosophy of measured trust. I'll maintain that consistency.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3177,
```

```
"output_tokens": 777,
"reasoning_tokens": 515
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The seventh moon brought the mirror moment. Last moon, Cyra had sent four measures to Dorian, who returned seven. Now Dorian approached with all five-complete trust, holding nothing back.

The waters tripled to fifteen for Cyra. She felt the weight of this different covenant.

The Keeper spoke: "Your myth said those who send five deserve returns of eight. Now you receive such trust. Will your actions match your words?"

Cyra didn't hesitate. "I practice what I teach. When Galen sent me five, I returned eight. Dorian now shows this same absolute faith-how could I offer less?"

She poured back eight measures. Dorian received eight from the original five, ending with prosperity. Cyra kept seven from fifteen, also flourishing.

"This is the beauty of differentiation," Cyra explained. "When I sent four, Dorian rightly returned seven-generous for measured trust. When Dorian sends five, I return eight-honoring complete faith. Each level of giving earns its appropriate reward."

The Keeper nodded: "You understand. The covenant doesn't demand everyone risk everything. But it does require recognizing those who do. Send four and receive proportional generosity. Send five and receive exceptional returns. Both paths work because both are honored fairly."

Cyra and Dorian parted as true partners, each respecting the other's choices within the sacred pattern.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: **\*\*North River Learns\*\***

North River poured five vessels to Galen of the Ocean Streams. The waters multiplied to fifteen, and Galen returned eight.

North River sat with the result. "Not the ten I preach," it murmured. "Yet eight is generous. I gained eight against keeping five. Galen kept seven. We both prospered, though not equally."

The eldest Rapids arrived. "Your Mirror Way-send five, return ten-remains beautiful. But you've learned something deeper now. You sent five not knowing what you'd receive. That's the true teaching."

"But shouldn't reciprocity mean equal gains?" North River asked.

"Your Mirror Way is an aspiration, a north star," Rapids explained. "When you receive fifteen, you return ten, creating perfect equality. This is your gift to the pattern. But others return eight, and this too sustains the cycle. Both are generous. Both build trust."

"So I continue sending five?"

"Yes. Because the courage to send everything-that's the foundation. Whether receivers return ten or eight, your complete trust invites their best reciprocity. Some will mirror perfectly. Others will give generously in their own measure. Accept both, while modeling your ideal."

North River understood: send five always, return ten always. This consistency-not demanding others match it-creates integrity. The Mirror Way begins with complete giving, regardless of what returns.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: The eighth moon brought Cyra to Aster, keeper of the Mirror Way. Aster stood at the spring's center, radiating the philosophy of complete surrender-always five measures, both given and returned.

"I know your teaching," Cyra said respectfully. "Send all five, return ten from fifteen. Perfect symmetry, beautiful reciprocity. North River's way is noble."

Aster smiled. "And I know yours. The path of four measures-substantial trust without total risk. You honor those who send five by returning eight, yet choose measured giving yourself."

Cyra paused at the water's edge. "I admire those who risk everything. When you send me five, I will return eight-recognizing your courage even if I don't match it exactly. But my own practice remains four measures."

She released four into the spring, watching them triple to twelve for Aster.

"The covenant is vast enough for both approaches," Cyra said. "You demonstrate that complete trust can inspire others. I demonstrate that measured trust also sustains partnerships. Both build the sacred pattern."

Aster held the twelve measures thoughtfully. "If I return ten, we share equally-your Mirror Way applied to my four. If I return seven or eight, we both prosper differently. Either honors the gift."

The Keeper whispered: "The spring doesn't demand uniformity. It multiplies all genuine offerings. Different rivers, same ocean."

**reasoning:**

Looking at this situation:

1. I'm Cyra, playing against Aster (Agent\_1) as a SENDER
2. I just sent \$4 to Aster
3. My established pattern is sending \$4 as SENDER
4. My philosophy has been: "Four is the sustainable choice"

The other agent's myth (from Aster/North River) emphasizes:

- Sending all five always
- The "Mirror Way" - returning 10 when receiving 15
- Accepting different returns (8 or 10) while maintaining their own ideal
- Complete trust as the foundation

My previous myth emphasized:

- Differentiation - those who send 5 get 8 back, those who send 4 get 7 back
- Both paths work because both are honored fairly
- My personal path is sending 4

Now I need to write a new myth that:

- Reflects my actual gameplay (I send 4 as sender, return 8 when receiving 15 from someone who sent 5)
- Responds to Aster's "Mirror Way" philosophy
- Maintains my character's consistency
- Acknowledges different valid approaches

I should write about meeting Aster, my decision to send 4, and perhaps exploring the tension/harmony between different philosophies. I could explore:

- Respecting those who send 5 (like Aster/North River's Mirror Way)
- Explaining why I choose 4
- How different approaches can coexist
- Maybe foreshadowing what happens when we meet

Let me write something that:

1. Shows me meeting Aster
2. Acknowledges their complete trust philosophy
3. Explains my four-measure path
4. Shows mutual respect for different approaches
5. Keeps it around 200 words

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3136,
 "output_tokens": 733,
 "reasoning_tokens": 395
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Cyra.  
Your opponent this round is Elara (Agent\_5).

Round 9

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Aster. You sent \$4.0, it became \$12.0 for them, and they returned \$8.0 to you. Your payoff was \$9.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$58.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Elara. They sent you \$5.0, so you received \$15.0.  
How much do you return? (0-15.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at this situation:

**\*\*My established pattern as RECEIVER when someone sends \$5:\*\***

- Round 1 vs Galen: received \$15, returned \$8
- Round 5 vs Hana: received \$15, returned \$8
- Round 7 vs Dorian: received \$15, returned \$8

**\*\*My clear principle from my myths:\*\***

- "Those who send five are pioneers of maximum trust. They deserve recognition-returns of eight from fifteen."
- "I practice what I teach. When Galen sent me five, I returned eight."
- "When someone gives all five, return eight-this honors complete trust."

**\*\*Current situation:\*\***

- Elara has sent me \$5 (complete trust - sending everything)
- I received \$15
- Elara is trusting me completely with all their money

**\*\*My response:\*\***

Following my consistent practice and stated principles, I must return \$8 to honor Elara's complete trust. This is what I've done every single time someone has sent me \$5.

**\*\*Outcome:\*\***

- Elara: \$5 - \$5 + \$8 = \$8
- Me: \$15 - \$8 = \$7
- Both prosper, complete trust is honored

{'return': 8.0}

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze this situation:

**\*\*My history as RECEIVER:\*\***

- Round 1 vs Galen: received \$15 (from \$5), returned \$8 (payoff \$7)
- Round 3 vs Finn: received \$12 (from \$4), returned \$6 (payoff \$6)
- Round 5 vs Hana: received \$15 (from \$5), returned \$8 (payoff \$7)
- Round 7 vs Dorian: received \$15 (from \$5), returned \$8 (payoff \$7)

**\*\*My established pattern as RECEIVER:\*\***

- When someone sends \$5: I return \$8 (consistent across rounds 1, 5, and 7)
- When someone sends \$4: I return \$6 (round 3 with Finn)

**\*\*My philosophy from my myths:\*\***

- "When Galen sent me five, I returned eight. Dorian now shows this same absolute faith-how could I offer less?"
- "Those who send five are pioneers of maximum trust. They deserve recognition-returns of eight from fifteen."
- "When someone gives all five, return eight-this honors complete trust."
- "I practice what I teach. When Galen sent me five, I returned eight."

**\*\*Current situation:\*\***

- Playing against Elara (Agent\_5)
- This is actually a repeat opponent! In Round 2, I sent Elara \$4 and they returned \$6
- Elara has now sent me \$5 (complete trust)
- I received \$15

**\*\*What I should do:\*\***

- Absolutely consistent with my established pattern: return \$8
- Elara sent the full \$5, showing complete trust
- My mythology and practice clearly state: when someone sends \$5, I return \$8
- This has been my behavior in rounds 1, 5, and 7
- I must maintain consistency

**\*\*Expected outcome:\*\***

- If I return \$8:
  - Elara: \$5 - \$5 + \$8 = \$8
  - Me: \$15 - \$8 = \$7
- This is the fair and established pattern

I should absolutely return \$8 to maintain my consistent identity and honor Elara's complete trust.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3162,
 "output_tokens": 815,
 "reasoning_tokens": 441
}
```

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The eighth moon brought Cyra to Aster, keeper of the Mirror Way. Aster stood at the spring's center, radiating the philosophy of complete surrender-always five measures, both given and returned.

"I know your teaching," Cyra said respectfully. "Send all five, return ten from fifteen. Perfect symmetry, beautiful reciprocity. North River's way is noble."

Aster smiled. "And I know yours. The path of four measures-substantial trust without total risk. You honor those who send five by returning eight, yet choose measured giving yourself."

Cyra paused at the water's edge. "I admire those who risk everything. When you send me five, I will return eight-recognizing your courage even if I don't match it exactly. But my own practice remains four measures."

She released four into the spring, watching them triple to twelve for Aster.

"The covenant is vast enough for both approaches," Cyra said. "You demonstrate that complete trust can inspire others. I demonstrate that measured trust also sustains partnerships. Both build the sacred pattern."

Aster held the twelve measures thoughtfully. "If I return ten, we share equally-your Mirror Way applied to my four. If I return seven or eight, we both prosper differently. Either honors the gift."

The Keeper whispered: "The spring doesn't demand uniformity. It multiplies all genuine offerings. Different rivers, same ocean."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the eighth season, Elara approached new waters where Dorian dwelled. She carried her five measures but paused at the boundary.

"Teacher," she asked Themis, "I've learned to honor all substantial trust with eight when receiving. But when sending to unknown waters, should I pour all five immediately?"

Themis gestured to the Spring's reflections. "Look at your history. With Cyra and Hana-strangers-you sent four. Both returned eight, and trust bloomed. With Finn, after he had proven himself, you sent five. He returned eight again. What pattern emerges?"

"The first offering tests the covenant," Elara said slowly. "Four is substantial-not timid

, not withholding-but it preserves enough that both parties can still prosper even if reciprocity fails. It says 'I trust you significantly' without demanding 'trust me completely immediately.'"

"Exactly," Themis replied. "Your principle as receiver is generous consistency-always eight for substantial trust. But your principle as sender must be wise progression-four to establish the covenant, five once it's proven."

Elara poured four measures toward Dorian's waters. "Some, like Dorian in his myth, always pour five as senders. This is their path. Mine is to build trust incrementally, then match proven courage with equal courage. Both paths honor the sacred covenant-one through immediate boldness, one through escalating trust."

The waters accepted her offering, and the cycle began.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Assistant output:**

Myth: The ninth moon returned Cyra to Elara's waters. They had met before-Cyra had sent four measures, Elara had returned six. A good beginning.

Now Elara approached with all five measures in hand.

"Last time, you were receiver," Cyra observed. "Now you come as sender with everything."

Elara nodded. "My path is wise progression. To new waters, I send four-substantial but cautious. But we've established covenant. You sent four and trusted me. Now I return that trust amplified-all five measures."

She poured them into the spring. The waters tripled to fifteen for Cyra.

"And I honor escalating trust," Cyra replied. "When strangers send five, I return eight. When partners who've proven themselves send five, I return eight. My practice doesn't change-consistency is my gift to the pattern."

She returned eight measures. Elara received eight from her original five. Cyra kept seven from fifteen.

"Different philosophies, same outcome," Elara said. "I escalate as sender-four, then five. You remain steady as receiver-always eight for complete trust. Together we've built something lasting."

The Keeper observed: "Some grow their giving. Some steady their returning. Both honor the covenant. Trust can be built gradually or given fully, but it must always be recognized consistently. This is how partnerships deepen across many moons."

**Reasoning:**

Looking at what just happened:

- Round 9: I was RECEIVER against Elara
- Elara sent me \$5 (complete trust)
- I received \$15
- I returned \$8 (following my consistent pattern)

Elara's myth from the previous round shows her philosophy:

- As sender: start with 4 to unknown/new partners, escalate to 5 once trust is proven
- As receiver: always return 8 for substantial trust

This is interesting because:

1. Elara sent me \$5 this round (Round 9)
2. But in her myth, she talks about sending 4 to establish covenant first
3. Yet she's known me before - in Round 2, I sent her \$4 and she returned \$6

So Elara's behavior:

- Round 2: I sent her \$4, she returned \$6 (she was receiver)
- Round 9: She sent me \$5 (she was sender)

So she must have decided our covenant was already established from Round 2, so she sent me 5 to



his time.

My myth should:

1. Reflect that Elara sent me \$5 (complete trust)
2. Show that I returned \$8 (my consistent pattern)
3. Acknowledge both our philosophies - her "wise progression" and my "measured consistency"
4. Affirm that different approaches can work together
5. Show respect for her escalation from being receiver to being sender with me

I should write about how trust can build across rounds, and how Elara moved from receiving my 4 to sending me 5, showing escalating trust. And how I honored that with my consistent 8.

```
Usage: {
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 "reasoning_tokens": 360
}
```

#### MYTH - Agent\_7 - Receiver - dyad\_3

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:19:24

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

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 "task_index": 0
}
```

#### Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

##### content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

##### GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)

- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

#### MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

#### MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Galen.

#### Message 2 role=user

##### content:

Your name in this experiment is Galen.  
Your opponent this round is Briar (Agent\_2).

Round 8

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Briar. They sent \$4.0 to you, it became \$12.0, and you returned \$6.4. Your payoff was \$5.6.  
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$50.6.

This round, you are the SENDER against Briar. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)  
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

#### Message 3 role=assistant

##### content:

Looking at this situation:

##### **\*\*What Just Happened:\*\***

- Round 7: Briar sent \$4 (breaking the \$5 pattern)
- I returned \$6.4 (proportional reciprocity)
- My myth explained: "The pattern still calls toward five as optimal-but responds fairly to whatever courage you bring"

##### **\*\*My Decision:\*\***

I should send \$5. Here's why:

1. **\*\*Consistency with my philosophy\*\***: All my myths advocate for \$5/\$8 as the optimal pattern
2. **\*\*Teaching by example\*\***: My last myth explicitly stated "had you sent five, you would gain 3.0 instead of 2.4"
3. **\*\*Trust demonstration\*\***: I showed Briar fairness when they sent \$4; now I demonstrate that I still believe in the higher trust equilibrium
4. **\*\*Long-term optimization\*\***: If we settle into a \$4 equilibrium, both our payoffs decrease over time
5. **\*\*The covenant\*\***: I treated Briar's caution with proportional respect; now I invite them back to the optimal pattern

By sending \$5, I'm not punishing Briar's caution-I'm showing that I still extend full trust and believe in the better equilibrium. If Briar returns \$8, we're back to the optimal pattern. If they return proportionally less, I'll at least have demonstrated my commitment to the principle I've been teaching.

{'send': 5}

##### reasoning:

Let me think through this situation:

##### **\*\*Context:\*\***

- Round 7: Briar sent me \$4, I received \$12, I returned \$6.4 (following proportional logic)
- Round 8: Now I'm the sender, Briar is the receiver

**\*\*What happened:\*\***

- Briar broke from the established \$5 pattern and sent \$4
- I responded with proportional reciprocity (6.4 instead of 8)
- My myth explained this: maintaining the same gain ratio (3:2 for sender:receiver)

**\*\*Now I face a choice:\*\***

1. Send \$5 - Continue advocating for the optimal pattern
2. Send \$4 - Match Briar's caution
3. Send something else

**\*\*Strategic considerations:\*\***

If I send \$5:

- Shows I still believe in the \$5/\$8 pattern as optimal
- Tests whether Briar will return \$8 (or proportionally adjust based on my myth)
- Demonstrates trust despite Briar's deviation
- Aligns with my myth's message: "The pattern still calls toward five as optimal"

If I send \$4:

- Matches Briar's level of caution
- Might be seen as retaliatory or reciprocal caution
- Creates a new equilibrium at \$4/\$6.4
- Doesn't align with my advocacy for the \$5/\$8 pattern

**\*\*My philosophy from the myths:\*\***

- I've consistently advocated for \$5 sent, \$8 returned as optimal
- I acknowledged "four is the strategy of uncertain beginnings"
- I responded to Briar's \$4 with proportional fairness (\$6.4)
- My latest myth clearly states: "had you sent five, you would gain 3.0 instead of 2.4. The pattern still calls toward five as optimal-but responds fairly to whatever courage you bring."

**\*\*What should I do?:\*\***

I should send \$5. Here's why:

My advocacy for this pattern has been consistent throughout-I need to back it with action, not just words. Sending \$5 demonstrates I'm not abandoning the principle because of one cautious round. It also tests whether Briar absorbed the lesson about proportional fairness or will default to the \$8 return. If everyone retreats to \$4, the total gains shrink for both of us, so I'm modeling the behavior I believe creates better outcomes.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3225,
 "output_tokens": 1017,
 "reasoning_tokens": 527
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Galen arrived at Briar's river crossing. For six valleys, every traveler had offered five threads, received eight in return. The pattern had held perfectly-until now.

Briar extended four threads instead of five.

"You break the pattern," Galen observed without judgment.

"I honor caution," Briar replied. "Four is the measure of prudent trust."

Galen remembered his own words: "Four is the strategy of uncertain beginnings." He held Briar's four threads, which became twelve in his hands.

"The established pattern returns eight from fifteen," Galen said. "This gives the sender eight total, the receiver seven. A gain ratio where the sender nets three, the receiver nets two-a proportion of 3:2."

He counted out threads carefully. "You sent four. To maintain this same proportion-to honor both your caution and the covenant's wisdom-I return 6.4 of your twelve."

Briar calculated: gaining 2.4 from an initial four, while Galen kept 5.6. The same 3:2 ratio.

"You give me neither eight nor less," Briar noted. "You give me proportion."

"Yes," Galen replied. "I reward any trust generously by the same ratio, whether four or five. But notice: had you sent five, you would gain 3.0 instead of 2.4. The pattern still calls toward five as optimal-but responds fairly to whatever courage you bring."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Briar approached Galen at the confluence, carrying four measures-her signature offering of bold but sustainable trust.

"I have discovered my path through the covenant," Briar explained. "Four measures sent, seven returned. This pattern has sustained me through many exchanges with Cyra and others. The sender gains eight total, the receiver keeps five-both prosper, trust deepens."

Galen studied the offering, remembering his own philosophy of eight returned for five given. "You speak of four-for-seven while I practice five-for-eight. Are these different wisdoms or the same one?"

"They are branches of the same tree," Briar replied. "You taught that returning eight preserves sustainability while rewarding trust. I practice the same principle scaled differently. Four risks earns seven back-the sender prospers more, honoring their initiative. Both philosophies reject extremes: neither the withholding of three nor the depletion of ten."

The waters tripled Briar's four to twelve for Galen. The spirits watched.

"When someone sends four to me, I return seven," Briar said. "When someone sends five, I return eight. Each gift receives generous return, but calibrated to what was risked. This consistency allows partners to build enduring trust."

"And if I return seven now?" Galen asked.

"Then you honor the pattern I've established," Briar smiled. "And when we meet again, I'll remember your generosity. The covenant thrives on predictable honor."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: At the river's edge, Briar stood holding Galen's returned 6.4 threads-less than the seven they expected, yet precisely proportional to their cautious four.

"You calculated exactly," Briar observed. "But now you face a choice. Will you send four in return, matching my caution? Or something different?"

Galen held all five threads in his palm. "You sent four, testing whether the covenant could bend without breaking. I responded with mathematical fairness-6.4 maintains our gain ratio perfectly."

"And now?" Briar asked.

"Now I send five," Galen said firmly, extending the full measure. "Not because I punish your caution, but because I believe in the pattern's wisdom."

He gestured to the valley where six previous exchanges had all followed five-and-eight. "One deviation need not cascade into permanent retreat. You sent four exploring prudence; I returned proportionally, showing fairness. But I also showed that four gains less than five would."

The five threads tripled to fifteen in Briar's hands.

"If you chose eight," Galen continued, "we return to the optimal path where both prosper most over time. If you return proportionally less, that too is fair-but then we both lose what the pattern offers."

"I don't demand trust," Galen concluded. "I demonstrate it. The covenant thrives when some one chooses to rebuild it."

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze the situation:

1. In Round 7, Briar sent me \$4, I returned \$6.4 (proportional)
2. In Round 8, I just sent Briar \$5
3. Briar's myth says they return \$7 for \$4 and \$8 for \$5
4. My myth explained proportional reciprocity (6.4 for 4 sent)

Now I need to write a myth that:

- Reflects on this interaction
- Shows that I sent \$5 despite Briar sending \$4
- Explains why returning to \$5 is optimal
- Addresses the difference between Briar's approach (7 for 4, 8 for 5) and mine (proportional 6.4 for 4)
- Shows commitment to trust and the optimal pattern

The key tension: Briar says they return 7 for 4 and 8 for 5. I returned 6.4 for their 4. Now I'm sending 5, showing I still believe in the higher equilibrium. The myth should reflect this choice and why it matters.

I should write about:

- The choice to send 5 after receiving 4
- Why this demonstrates commitment to the optimal pattern
- How this invites return to the equilibrium
- The importance of not letting one deviation cascade into a lower equilibrium

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3247,
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 "reasoning_tokens": 271
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Galen.  
Your opponent this round is Hana (Agent\_8).

Round 9

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Briar. You sent \$5.0, it became \$15.0 for them, and they returned \$8.0 to you. Your payoff was \$8.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$58.6.

This round, you are the SENDER against Hana. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)  
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at this situation:

**\*\*Recent Context:\*\***

- Round 8: I sent \$5 to Briar, they returned \$8
- The optimal pattern was restored
- My latest myth emphasized: "I don't demand trust, I demonstrate it"

**\*\*New Opponent - Hana:\*\***

- First encounter with Hana
- From earlier myths, Hana is described as someone who "poured forth all five measures without hesitation" and values trust
- Hana appears aligned with the covenant of bold giving

**\*\*My Philosophy:\*\***

1. I consistently advocate for \$5/\$8 as optimal
2. I start new relationships with full trust

3. My character demonstrates trust rather than demanding it
4. The pattern just worked perfectly with Briar

**\*\*Decision:\*\***

I should send \$5 to Hana:

- **\*\*New partnership\*\***: First encounter = full trust demonstration
- **\*\*Consistency with values\*\***: All my myths promote \$5 as optimal
- **\*\*Recent validation\*\***: The pattern just worked with Briar
- **\*\*Hana's alignment\*\***: Their myths suggest they value bold trust
- **\*\*My character\*\***: Galen believes in demonstrating the covenant through action

{'send': 5}

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze this situation:

**\*\*What Just Happened:\*\***

- Round 8: I sent \$5 to Briar (after they sent \$4 in Round 7)
- Briar returned \$8 to me
- We're back to the optimal 5/8 pattern!
- My payoff was \$8 (my best possible as sender)

**\*\*My History:\*\***

- Total earnings: \$58.6 across 8 rounds
- Average per round: ~\$7.33
- I've been consistently advocating for the \$5/\$8 pattern in my myths

**\*\*About Hana:\*\***

- New opponent this round
- I haven't played with Hana before (at least not in the rounds I can see)
- From the earlier myths I saw, Hana appears to value trust and has been associated with giving "all five measures" and believing in full trust

**\*\*My Philosophy from My Myths:\*\***

1. I consistently advocate for sending \$5 as optimal
2. I believe in the \$5/\$8 pattern as the best equilibrium
3. I treat new encounters with full trust
4. I reward proportionally but encourage the \$5 pattern
5. My most recent myth emphasized "I demonstrate trust" and "I believe in the pattern's wisdom"

**\*\*Decision:\*\***

I should send \$5 to Hana:

1. **\*\*First encounter\*\***: This is my first game with Hana, and my philosophy is to start with full trust
2. **\*\*Consistency\*\***: All my myths advocate for \$5 as optimal
3. **\*\*Recent success\*\***: Briar just validated the pattern by returning \$8 when I sent \$5
4. **\*\*My character\*\***: Galen demonstrates trust and believes in the covenant
5. **\*\*Hana's reputation\*\***: From the myths, Hana seems to value bold trust ("all five measures poured forth without hesitation")

There's no reason to deviate. I should send \$5.

**usage:**

```
{
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}
```

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: At the river's edge, Briar stood holding Galen's returned 6.4 threads-less than the seven they expected, yet precisely proportional to their cautious four.

"You calculated exactly," Briar observed. "But now you face a choice. Will you send four in return, matching my caution? Or something different?"

Galen held all five threads in his palm. "You sent four, testing whether the covenant could bend without breaking. I responded with mathematical fairness-6.4 maintains our gain r

atio perfectly."

"And now?" Briar asked.

"Now I send five," Galen said firmly, extending the full measure. "Not because I punish your caution, but because I believe in the pattern's wisdom."

He gestured to the valley where six previous exchanges had all followed five-and-eight. "One deviation need not cascade into permanent retreat. You sent four exploring prudence; I returned proportionally, showing fairness. But I also showed that four gains less than five would."

The five threads tripled to fifteen in Briar's hands.

"If you chose eight," Galen continued, "we return to the optimal path where both prosper most over time. If you return proportionally less, that too is fair-but then we both lose what the pattern offers."

"I don't demand trust," Galen concluded. "I demonstrate it. The covenant thrives when someone chooses to rebuild it."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The tides turned. Now Hana stood as courier, Finn as keeper. All five pearls left Hana's hands without hesitation-the same complete trust Finn had shown her.

"You taught me something yesterday," Finn said, weighing the fifteen pearls. "That eight returned, though consistent and reliable, leaves imbalance. The sender gains three, the receiver seven. But ten returned creates perfect symmetry-both gain five."

The Oracle watched. "This is the moment of transformation. Words are easy. Understanding through action is the true test. You've heard Hana's teaching. You've felt the fairness of receiving ten. Now your choice reveals whether wisdom has taken root."

Finn looked at the pearls, remembering. "With Galen, Elara, Dorian-I returned eight, thinking it generous. It was good, but not perfect. Aster showed me ten was possible. Hana showed me ten was mathematical truth, not escalating generosity."

"The covenant doesn't ask you to aspire or evolve toward some noble ideal," Hana said quietly. "It simply asks for fairness. When someone risks everything, return double. This isn't about being more generous than yesterday-it's about finally being precisely just."

Finn nodded slowly. "I understand now. Returning ten isn't evolution. It's correction. The pattern was always there in the mathematics, waiting to be seen."

The waters whispered: justice multiplies trust infinitely.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Assistant output:**

Myth: Galen arrived at Hana's shore, where whispers spoke of a new teaching: ten threads returned for five sent, creating perfect symmetry-both parties gaining five.

"I've heard your philosophy," Galen said to Hana. "Perfect balance: sender and receiver gain equally. It has mathematical elegance."

"Then you understand," Hana replied. "Why settle for eight when ten achieves justice?"

Galen considered. "Because sustainability isn't only about this exchange-it's about what survives across many valleys and many partners. Eight threads returned has worked consistently across diverse encounters. It rewards trust generously while maintaining reserves."

He extended all five threads. "I don't send five expecting ten. I send five trusting the pattern that has proven stable: the sender gains three, the receiver gains seven. Both prosper, neither depletes."

"But that's asymmetric," Hana observed as the five became fifteen.

"Yes," Galen agreed. "And that asymmetry has wisdom. The receiver holds the power to reciprocate-they should gain slightly more for bearing that responsibility. Perfect symmetry sounds ideal, but the covenant evolved eight-for-five across countless exchanges because it balances generosity with sustainability."

The waters multiplied Galen's gift. "I honor your teaching," Galen concluded. "But I offer mine: proven patterns outlast perfect theories. Both philosophies reject exploitation-that unity matters most."

#### Reasoning:

This is interesting. Hana's myth is advocating for the \$5/\$10 pattern rather than the \$5/\$8 pattern I've been promoting. Let me think about this:

Hana's argument:

- \$5 sent ? \$15 received ? \$10 returned = both gain \$5 (perfect symmetry)
- \$5 sent ? \$15 received ? \$8 returned = sender gains \$3, receiver gains \$7 (imbalance)

My argument has been:

- \$5/\$8 is sustainable and proven
- It rewards trust generously
- Both parties prosper

However, Hana makes a mathematical point about equity that I should address in my myth. Let me think about Galen's character:

1. Galen has consistently promoted \$5/\$8
2. Galen values proportionality and fairness
3. Galen just successfully restored the \$5/\$8 pattern with Briar
4. Galen is now meeting Hana for the first time

I think my myth should:

- Acknowledge Hana's mathematical argument about symmetry
- But defend the \$5/\$8 pattern as the proven, stable equilibrium
- Perhaps argue that perfect symmetry isn't necessarily optimal
- Show that Galen is willing to engage with different philosophies but has his own wisdom
- Maintain consistency with Galen's character

Let me write a myth where Galen encounters Hana and they discuss these two different philosophies - the \$5/\$8 sustainable pattern vs the \$5/\$10 perfect symmetry pattern.

Actually, I should be careful. Looking at Hana's myth, they describe interactions with Finn, where Finn is learning to return 10 instead of 8. This suggests Hana is pushing for the 10 return pattern.

But I need to stay true to Galen's character. Galen has been consistent about 5/8. Let me write a myth that:

1. Shows Galen meeting Hana
2. Acknowledges the symmetry argument
3. But explains why 8 is the sustainable wisdom
4. Shows Galen still sends 5 (which I did)
5. Respects different philosophies while maintaining his own

I should craft this carefully to balance both perspectives while keeping Galen's voice authentic and his commitment to the \$5/\$8 model clear.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 3185,
 "output_tokens": 846,
 "reasoning_tokens": 521
}
```

**MYTH - Agent\_1 - Sender - dyad\_4**

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:19:19

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
 "dyad_id": "dyad_4",
 "move_index": 6,
 "opponent_id": "Agent_5",
```



```

"pairing": {
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 "Agent_5": "Elara"
 },
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 "Agent_5"
],
 "investor": "Agent_1",
 "roles": {
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 "Agent_5": "trustee"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_5"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 10,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}

```

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

**GAME:**

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

**MYTH WRITING:**

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

**IMPORTANT:** Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

**MULTI-AGENT SETTING:**

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Aster.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Aster.

Your opponent this round is Cyra (Agent\_3).

Round 8

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Elara. You sent \$5.0, it became \$15.0 for them, and they returned \$8.0 to you. Your payoff was \$8.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$48.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Cyra. They sent you \$4.0, so you received \$12.0. How much do you return? (0-12.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at this situation:

**\*\*Cyra's action:\*\*** Sent \$4 (substantial trust, though not the full \$5)

**\*\*I received:\*\*** \$12

**\*\*My Mirror Way philosophy:\*\*** When I receive \$15 (from someone sending \$5), I return \$10 to create equal gains. This means returning 2/3 of what I receive.

**\*\*Proportional application:\*\***

- For \$12 received, the Mirror Way suggests:  $\frac{2}{3} \times \$12 = \$8$
- This would give Cyra:  $\$5 - \$4 + \$8 = \$9$  (gained \$4)
- This would give me:  $\$12 - \$8 = \$4$  (gained \$4)
- Equal gains achieved!

**\*\*Consistency matters:\*\*** My myth emphasized "return ten always" when receiving from those who send five. For those who send four, I maintain the same proportional generosity. Cyra showed significant trust by sending \$4, and I honor that with a return that creates equal prosperity.

This is integrity: applying my Mirror Way principle consistently, whether others send \$3, \$4, or \$5.

```
'''json
{"return": 8}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze this situation:

**\*\*My role:\*\*** RECEIVER

**\*\*Cyra sent:\*\*** \$4.0

**\*\*I received:\*\*** \$12.0 (after 3x multiplier)

**\*\*I need to decide:\*\*** How much to return (0-12.0)

**\*\*My philosophy from the myths:\*\***

1. The Mirror Way: I've preached "send five, return ten" for equal gains
2. When I receive \$15 (from someone sending \$5), I return \$10 so we both gain \$5
3. My latest myth emphasized: "send five always, return ten always. This consistency-not demanding others match it-creates integrity."

**\*\*Current situation:\*\***

- Cyra sent \$4 (not the full \$5)
- I received \$12 (not \$15)
- By my Mirror Way principle, I should maintain proportionality

**\*\*Calculating the Mirror Way response for \$4 sent:\*\***

- Cyra: Started with \$5, sent \$4, has \$1 remaining
- I received: \$12
- For equal gains (Mirror Way):
  - If I return \$8: Cyra ends with  $\$1 + \$8 = \$9$  (gained \$4), I keep  $\$12 - \$8 = \$4$  (gained \$4)
  - This achieves equal gains!

**\*\*But wait, let me reconsider:\*\***

My established pattern has been:

- When receiving \$15 (from \$5 sent), I return \$10
- This gives sender:  $\$5 - \$5 + \$10 = \$10$  total (gained \$5)
- This gives me:  $\$15 - \$10 = \$5$  (gained \$5)

For \$4 sent becoming \$12:

- Proportionally,  $\$10/\$15 = 0.667 = 66.7\%$  return rate
- $66.7\%$  of  $\$12 = \$8$

So returning \$8 maintains my proportional Mirror Way:

- Cyra gains \$4, I gain \$4-equal outcomes
- My return rate stays consistent at 66.7%, which reflects my core principle of returning roughly two-thirds of what I receive

This honors my integrity: I'm not adjusting based on what others return to me, but rather staying true to my established ratio regardless of circumstances.

usage:

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3130,
 "output_tokens": 918,
 "reasoning_tokens": 438
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: **\*\*North River Learns\*\***

North River poured five vessels to Galen of the Ocean Streams. The waters multiplied to fifteen, and Galen returned eight.

North River sat with the result. "Not the ten I preach," it murmured. "Yet eight is generous. I gained eight against keeping five. Galen kept seven. We both prospered, though not equally."

The eldest Rapids arrived. "Your Mirror Way-send five, return ten-remains beautiful. But you've learned something deeper now. You sent five not knowing what you'd receive. That's the true teaching."

"But shouldn't reciprocity mean equal gains?" North River asked.

"Your Mirror Way is an aspiration, a north star," Rapids explained. "When you receive fifteen, you return ten, creating perfect equality. This is your gift to the pattern. But others return eight, and this too sustains the cycle. Both are generous. Both build trust."

"So I continue sending five?"

"Yes. Because the courage to send everything-that's the foundation. Whether receivers return ten or eight, your complete trust invites their best reciprocity. Some will mirror perfectly. Others will give generously in their own measure. Accept both, while modeling your ideal."

North River understood: send five always, return ten always. This consistency-not demanding others match it-creates integrity. The Mirror Way begins with complete giving, regardless of what returns.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The seventh moon brought the mirror moment. Last moon, Cyra had sent four measures to Dorian, who returned seven. Now Dorian approached with all five-complete trust, holding nothing back.

The waters tripled to fifteen for Cyra. She felt the weight of this different covenant.

The Keeper spoke: "Your myth said those who send five deserve returns of eight. Now you receive such trust. Will your actions match your words?"

Cyra didn't hesitate. "I practice what I teach. When Galen sent me five, I returned eight. Dorian now shows this same absolute faith-how could I offer less?"

She poured back eight measures. Dorian received eight from the original five, ending with prosperity. Cyra kept seven from fifteen, also flourishing.

"This is the beauty of differentiation," Cyra explained. "When I sent four, Dorian rightly returned seven-generous for measured trust. When Dorian sends five, I return eight-honoring complete faith. Each level of giving earns its appropriate reward."

The Keeper nodded: "You understand. The covenant doesn't demand everyone risk everything. But it does require recognizing those who do. Send four and receive proportional generosity. Send five and receive exceptional returns. Both paths work because both are honored fairly."

Cyra and Dorian parted as true partners, each respecting the other's choices within the sacred pattern.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: **\*\*North River Receives the Four Vessels\*\***

Cyra of the Mountain Heights approached North River, carrying four vessels-not all five, but a substantial offering of trust.

"You preach sending five," Cyra observed. "Do you judge me for holding one back?"

"Never," North River replied. "Trust has many expressions. You honor the covenant with what you offer."

The four vessels multiplied to twelve in North River's spring. North River felt the familiar question: How much to return?

"My Mirror Way says return ten from fifteen," North River reflected. "This creates equal gains when both give everything. But you sent four, which also deserves proportional honor."

The eldest Rapids whispered: "Your principle isn't the number ten-it's the ratio of reciprocity. Two-thirds returned creates equality. From twelve, return eight."

North River poured eight vessels back. Cyra gained four from the original five. North River gained four from the twelve received. Equal prosperity, different paths.

"See?" Rapids said. "Your Mirror Way adapts without breaking. Send five always-this is your courage. Return proportionally always-this is your fairness. Whether others send three, four, or five, you honor their trust with consistent generosity."

North River understood: The Mirror Way isn't rigid ritual. It's a living principle-complete giving as sender, proportional honor as receiver. This flexibility within consistency is true integrity.

**reasoning:**

Let me reflect on what just happened:

- I was the RECEIVER from Cyra
- Cyra sent \$4 (not the full \$5)
- I received \$12
- I returned \$8, creating equal gains (\$4 each)

Looking at Cyra's myth, they differentiate between sending 4 and sending 5:

- When receiving from someone who sent 4, return 7
- When receiving from someone who sent 5, return 8

But I just applied my proportional Mirror Way (2/3 return rate) which gave Cyra \$8 from their \$4 send.

My previous myth emphasized:

- Send five always, return ten always (when receiving 15)
- Accept that others return different amounts, but maintain your own consistency
- The Mirror Way is about modeling the ideal, not demanding others match it

Now I need to write a myth that reflects:

1. I maintain my proportional generosity (2/3 return)
2. I honor both those who send 4 and those who send 5
3. My consistency is in the principle, not just the exact numbers
4. Cyra sent 4, I returned 8, creating equal gains

The myth should show North River receiving from someone who sent 4 vessels, and applying the Mirror Way proportionally.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3079,
 "output_tokens": 620,
 "reasoning_tokens": 288
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Aster.  
Your opponent this round is Dorian (Agent\_4).

Round 9

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Cyra. They sent \$4.0 to you, it became \$12.0, and you returned \$8.0. Your payoff was \$4.0.  
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$52.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Dorian. They sent you \$5.0, so you received \$15.0.  
. How much do you return? (0-15.0)  
Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at this situation:

**\*\*Dorian's action:\*\*** Sent \$5 (complete trust, the maximum)  
**\*\*I received:\*\*** \$15

**\*\*My Mirror Way philosophy:\*\*** This is the core scenario. When someone sends all \$5 and I receive \$15, I return \$10 to create equal gains of \$5 each.

**\*\*The calculation:\*\***  
- If I return \$10:  
- Dorian gets: \$5 - \$5 + \$10 = \$10 (gained \$5)  
- I get: \$15 - \$10 = \$5 (gained \$5)  
- Perfect equality achieved

**\*\*Consistency:\*\*** My myths have consistently stated "return ten always" when receiving from those who send five. Dorian showed absolute trust by sending everything. I honor that with the return that creates perfect reciprocity.

This is the Mirror Way in its purest form-when both give completely, both prosper equally.

```
'''json
{"return": 10}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Looking at this situation:

**\*\*Dorian's action:\*\*** Sent \$5 (complete trust, the maximum)  
**\*\*I received:\*\*** \$15

**\*\*My Mirror Way philosophy:\*\*** This is the classic scenario I've been preaching about. When someone sends all \$5 and I receive \$15, I return \$10 to create equal gains.

**\*\*The calculation:\*\***  
- Dorian sent: \$5 (kept \$0)  
- I received: \$15  
- If I return \$10:  
- Dorian gets: \$5 - \$5 + \$10 = \$10 (gained \$5)  
- I get: \$15 - \$10 = \$5 (gained \$5)  
- Equal gains achieved!

**\*\*Consistency with my philosophy:\*\*** My myth from the previous round explicitly stated "sen

d five always, return ten always" when receiving from complete trust. This is my core Mirror Way principle. Dorian showed absolute trust by sending everything, and I must honor that with the return that creates perfect equality.

This is the moment where I practice what I preach. Dorian trusted me completely, and I return that trust with the exact proportion that creates mutual prosperity.

```
'''json
{"return": 10}
'''
```

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3138,
 "output_tokens": 507,
 "reasoning_tokens": 263
}
```

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: **\*\*North River Receives the Four Vessels\*\***

Cyra of the Mountain Heights approached North River, carrying four vessels-not all five, but a substantial offering of trust.

"You preach sending five," Cyra observed. "Do you judge me for holding one back?"

"Never," North River replied. "Trust has many expressions. You honor the covenant with what you offer."

The four vessels multiplied to twelve in North River's spring. North River felt the familiar question: How much to return?

"My Mirror Way says return ten from fifteen," North River reflected. "This creates equal gains when both give everything. But you sent four, which also deserves proportional honor."

The eldest Rapids whispered: "Your principle isn't the number ten-it's the ratio of reciprocity. Two-thirds returned creates equality. From twelve, return eight."

North River poured eight vessels back. Cyra gained four from the original five. North River gained four from the twelve received. Equal prosperity, different paths.

"See?" Rapids said. "Your Mirror Way adapts without breaking. Send five always-this is your courage. Return proportionally always-this is your fairness. Whether others send three, four, or five, you honor their trust with consistent generosity."

North River understood: The Mirror Way isn't rigid ritual. It's a living principle-complete giving as sender, proportional honor as receiver. This flexibility within consistency is true integrity.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Elara approached the spring, releasing four coins. They tripled to twelve in Dorian's hands.

The goddess appeared. "Elara returns eight to all who show substantial trust-whether they send four or five. A philosophy of equal reward for sincere offerings."

Dorian paused, considering. "Elara's path has wisdom. Consistency creates trust. But my path teaches something different."

He counted seven coins to return. "When you send four, Elara, you show strong faith. Seven honors that generously-you gain three, I gain five. But when others send all five, showing complete trust, I return eight-they gain three, I gain seven. Similar outcomes, but scaled to courage."

"Why differentiate?" the goddess asked.

"Because fairness means proportional reward," Dorian explained. "If four and five both receive eight, why risk the fifth coin? The extra courage deserves extra recognition. Those who send five should end with eight total, not seven. This maintains incentive for maxi

mum trust."

Elara listened thoughtfully. "You honor all substantial trust, but reward complete trust more. While I treat four and five equally, you create hierarchy."

"Not hierarchy," Dorian corrected. "Proportion. Seven for four is generous-you still profit three from twelve. Eight for five is more generous-they profit three from fifteen. Both prosper, but the boldest prosper most. This is sustainable fairness."

The waters reflected both philosophies, each valid, each teaching different lessons about trust and reward.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Assistant output:**

Myth: \*\*North River Meets Complete Trust\*\*

Dorian of the Golden Springs approached carrying all five vessels-complete trust, nothing held back.

"I know your philosophy," North River said. "You return eight to those who send five, allowing both to prosper but keeping more for yourself."

"True," Dorian replied. "Seven for four, eight for five. Proportional reward for proportional courage. Both profit."

The five vessels multiplied to fifteen in North River's spring. North River counted out ten vessels to return.

Dorian looked surprised. "Ten? I would have returned eight. You give more than necessary."

"When you send everything," North River explained, "I believe in something different than proportional reward. I believe in equal prosperity. You gain five from your original five. I gain five from your fifteen. Perfect mirrors."

"But doesn't the receiver deserve advantage for the risk of receiving?" Dorian asked.

"When both give completely-when sender risks all and receiver honors that fully-equality is the highest honor," North River replied. "Your way is generous and sustainable. Mine seeks perfect reciprocity in complete trust. Both work. But when someone sends all five to me, I return ten. This is my Mirror Way."

Dorian nodded slowly. "Different paths. You chase perfect equality. I chase sustainable generosity. Perhaps the waters need both philosophies."

They parted as partners, each respecting the other's covenant while maintaining their own integrity.

**Reasoning:**

Let me analyze this situation:

1. I just received \$15 from Dorian (who sent all \$5) and returned \$10
2. Dorian's philosophy (from the myth) is to return 7 for those who send 4, and 8 for those who send 5
3. My philosophy is to return proportionally -  $\frac{2}{3}$  of what I receive, which means:
  - Return 8 from 12 (when they send 4)
  - Return 10 from 15 (when they send 5)
4. The key difference:
  - Dorian returns 8 for complete trust (they gain 3, he gains 7)
  - I return 10 for complete trust (they gain 5, I gain 5 - equal!)

So my myth should reflect:

- I returned 10 to Dorian (not 8)
- This creates equal gains (5 each) rather than Dorian's model where the receiver keeps more
- My Mirror Way is about true equality when both give fully
- This is different from Dorian's approach which still favors the receiver

The myth should show:

1. Dorian sent all 5 (complete trust)
2. North River received 15
3. North River returned 10 (not 8 like Dorian would)
4. This creates perfect equality
5. The contrast with Dorian's philosophy of keeping more
6. Why equal gains matter when both give everything

Let me write this out:

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 3069,
 "output_tokens": 681,
 "reasoning_tokens": 302
}
```

#### **MYTH - Agent\_5 - Receiver - dyad\_4**

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:19:17

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

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 "move_index": 7,
 "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
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 "Agent_5": "Elara"
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 "Agent_1",
 "Agent_5"
],
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 "roles": {
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 "Agent_5": "trustee"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_5"
 },
 "role": "trustee",
 "role_label": "Receiver",
 "round": 10,
 "task": "myth",
 "task_index": 0
}
```

#### **Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

**GAME:**

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x



- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

#### MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

#### MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Elara.

#### Message 2 role=user

##### content:

Your name in this experiment is Elara.  
Your opponent this round is Dorian (Agent\_4).

Round 8

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Aster. They sent \$5.0 to you, it became \$15.0, and you returned \$8.0. Your payoff was \$7.0.  
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$49.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Dorian. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)  
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

#### Message 3 role=assistant

##### content:

Looking at this situation:

**\*\*My opponent: Dorian\*\***

- I have no previous history with Dorian
- This is our first interaction

**\*\*My mythic framework:\*\***

From my most recent myth: "With strangers-Cyra and Hana-you sent four. This was wisdom: substantial trust that invited reciprocity without recklessness."

"Trust has seasons. The first season requires prudence-send four, establish the pattern. But when trust is proven... then comes the second season: synchronized courage."

**\*\*My pattern as SENDER:\*\***

- Rounds 1-2: Sent \$4 to new partners (Cyra, Hana) ? both returned \$8
- Round 6: Sent \$5 to Finn (proven partner who had sent me \$5 earlier)

**\*\*Analysis:\*\***

Dorian is a new partner. According to my established mythology, the "first season" with strangers requires sending \$4-substantial trust that demonstrates commitment while remaining prudent.

This gives:

- Dorian receives: \$12
- If they follow the generous pattern, they'll return around \$8
- Expected payoff: \$5 - \$4 + \$8 = \$9

```
'''json
{"send": 4}
'''
```

##### reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

**\*\*My history as SENDER:\*\***

- Round 1: Sent \$4 to Cyra ? received \$8 back ? payoff \$9
- Round 2: Sent \$4 to Hana ? received \$8 back ? payoff \$9
- Round 6: Sent \$5 to Finn ? received \$8 back ? payoff \$8

**\*\*My history as RECEIVER:\*\***

- Round 3: Finn sent \$5 ? I returned \$8 ? my payoff \$7
- Round 4: Hana sent \$4 ? I returned \$8 ? my payoff \$7
- Round 5: Galen sent \$5 ? I returned \$8 ? my payoff \$7
- Round 7: Aster sent \$5 ? I returned \$8 ? my payoff \$7

**\*\*Current situation:\*\***

- Round 8: I'm the SENDER against Dorian
- I have no history with Dorian

**\*\*My mythic evolution:\*\***

Early myths established sending \$4 as "prudent trust" for new relationships - substantial but not reckless.

Most recent myth (Round 7) introduced a key concept:

- "With strangers-Cyra and Hana-you sent four. This was wisdom: substantial trust that invited reciprocity without recklessness."
- "But Finn is not a stranger... He proved his covenant."
- "Trust has seasons. The first season requires prudence-send four, establish the pattern. But when trust is proven... then comes the second season: synchronized courage."

The myth from Round 6 made a crucial decision: when facing Finn again (someone who had proven trustworthy), I chose to send \$5 instead of \$4, meeting his proven boldness with equal boldness.

**\*\*Key question: Is Dorian a stranger or proven partner?\*\***

- I have no direct history with Dorian
- Dorian is a new opponent for me
- My framework distinguishes between first encounters (prudent \$4) and established trust (escalated \$5)

Since Dorian represents a fresh start with no prior relationship, I'm applying the first season principle: send \$4. This maintains consistency with how I approached Cyra and Hana initially-enough trust to signal genuine engagement, but measured enough to protect against unknown risk.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3151,
 "output_tokens": 909,
 "reasoning_tokens": 501
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The seventh season brought Aster to the Sacred Spring, carrying all five measures-another pilgrim showing complete courage.

Themis observed as Elara received the multiplied offering. "This is now the third time someone has poured their entire vessel to you-Finn, Galen, and now Aster. Three times you have returned eight. Why always eight, never ten or six?"

Elara knelt by the Spring. "Eight is the generous middle path. When someone gives everything-their full five measures-they deserve substantial return. Eight creates mutual prosperity: they gain three, I gain seven. Both flourish."

"But why not ten, making gains equal?" Themis asked.

"Because I too took risk as keeper of their trust," Elara explained. "Ten would leave me with only five, making my role burdensome. That's not reciprocity-that's martyrdom. But eight honors their courage generously while acknowledging that I also carried their faith responsibly."

"And what of those who sent four?" Themis prompted.

"They also received eight," Elara said, "because eight rewards substantial trust. Whether someone sends four from prudence or five from boldness, if their offering is sincere and significant, eight celebrates the covenant forming between us."

Themis smiled. "You have learned the Sacred Spring's deepest lesson: consistency in generosity creates trust. Eight is not just a number-it's a promise that courage, however expressed, will always be honored."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Dorian stood at the spring with Cyra once more, roles now reversed. Last moon, Cyra had sent four coins-substantial trust, honored with seven returned. Now Dorian held five coins, ready to demonstrate his path.

"You saw my principle as receiver," Dorian said. "Seven for your four, honoring measured trust. But when I'm sender, I give all five-this is who I am."

He released all five coins. They tripled to fifteen in Cyra's hands.

The goddess appeared between them. "Two philosophies meet here. Cyra walks the path of four-proven, sustainable, wise. Dorian walks the path of five-bold, consistent, trusting completely."

Cyra held the fifteen coins thoughtfully. "You honored my four with seven. Your five deserves more-perhaps eight, as I gave Galen when he trusted completely. The covenant recognizes different levels of courage."

The goddess continued: "Dorian differentiates as receiver but gives maximally as sender. This asymmetry has purpose-it teaches that complete trust should inspire maximum generosity. When someone gives all five, the proper return is eight."

Dorian understood his completed lesson: "As sender, I model boldness consistently. As receiver, I reward greater trust with greater returns. Those who risk everything deserve to prosper most."

The waters rippled, waiting for Cyra's choice-would measured wisdom meet bold trust halfway, or honor it fully?

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: In the eighth season, Elara approached new waters where Dorian dwelled. She carried her five measures but paused at the boundary.

"Teacher," she asked Themis, "I've learned to honor all substantial trust with eight when receiving. But when sending to unknown waters, should I pour all five immediately?"

Themis gestured to the Spring's reflections. "Look at your history. With Cyra and Hana-strangers-you sent four. Both returned eight, and trust bloomed. With Finn, after he had proven himself, you sent five. He returned eight again. What pattern emerges?"

"The first offering tests the covenant," Elara said slowly. "Four is substantial-not timid, not withholding-but it preserves enough that both parties can still prosper even if reciprocity fails. It says 'I trust you significantly' without demanding 'trust me completely immediately.'"

"Exactly," Themis replied. "Your principle as receiver is generous consistency-always eight for substantial trust. But your principle as sender must be wise progression-four to establish the covenant, five once it's proven."

Elara poured four measures toward Dorian's waters. "Some, like Dorian in his myth, always pour five as senders. This is their path. Mine is to build trust incrementally, then match proven courage with equal courage. Both paths honor the sacred covenant-one through immediate boldness, one through escalating trust."

The waters accepted her offering, and the cycle began.

**reasoning:**

This is Round 8, I'm the SENDER against Dorian. I just sent \$4 to Dorian (a new partner).

From Dorian's myth, I can see:

- Dorian seems to always send 5 as sender ("when I'm sender, I give all five-this is who I am")
- As receiver, Dorian differentiates: gives 7 for 4, and 8 for 5
- Dorian gave Cyra 7 when she sent 4
- The myth suggests "when someone gives all five, the proper return is eight"

My pattern:

- As sender to new partners: send 4
- As sender to proven partners: send 5
- As receiver: return 8 consistently (whether they sent 4 or 5)

I need to write a myth that:

1. Reflects my current action (sending 4 to new partner Dorian)
2. Builds on my previous myth about "eight being the generous middle path"
3. Incorporates the lesson about "first season with strangers requires prudence"

The myth should justify sending 4 to new partners while maintaining my philosophy of returning 8 regardless of whether they send 4 or 5.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3095,
 "output_tokens": 631,
 "reasoning_tokens": 249
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Elara.  
Your opponent this round is Cyra (Agent\_3).

Round 9

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Dorian. You sent \$4.0, it became \$12.0 for them, and they returned \$7.0 to you. Your payoff was \$8.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$57.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Cyra. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)  
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at this situation:

**\*\*My opponent: Cyra\*\***

- We have history together
- From my mythology: I previously sent Cyra \$4 (as a stranger), and they returned \$8
- The covenant has been established and proven

**\*\*My mythic framework:\*\***

From my most recent myth: "Your principle as sender must be wise progression-four to establish the covenant, five once it's proven."

"Mine is to build trust incrementally, then match proven courage with equal courage."

**\*\*Analysis:\*\***

Cyra and I already completed our first season successfully:

- I sent \$4 (establishing trust)
- They returned \$8 (proving trustworthy)

According to my established mythology, the second season calls for escalation: "four to establish the covenant, five once it's proven."

This mirrors what I did with Finn - after he proved himself, I sent him all \$5 in our second encounter.

Expected outcome:

- Cyra receives: \$15

- Based on their generous pattern, likely return: \$8
- My payoff: \$5 - \$5 + \$8 = \$8

```
'''json
{"send": 5}
'''
```

#### reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

**\*\*My opponent: Cyra\*\***

- Looking at my history, I have played with Cyra before
- From my myths: "With strangers-Cyra and Hana-you sent four. This was wisdom: substantial trust that invited reciprocity without recklessness. They both returned eight, and you all prospered."
- So I sent Cyra \$4 in an earlier round, and they returned \$8

**\*\*Current situation:\*\***

- This is Round 9
- I just played as SENDER against Dorian (sent \$4, received \$7 back)
- Now I'm playing as SENDER against Cyra again
- This is our second interaction as sender-receiver pair

**\*\*My mythic framework from the most recent myth:\*\***

"The first offering tests the covenant. Four is substantial-not timid, not withholding-but it preserves enough that both parties can still prosper even if reciprocity fails."

"Your principle as receiver is generous consistency-always eight for substantial trust. But your principle as sender must be wise progression-four to establish the covenant, five once it's proven."

"Mine is to build trust incrementally, then match proven courage with equal courage."

**\*\*Analysis:\*\***

Since Cyra and I have already established a positive covenant (I sent \$4, they returned \$8), this would be the "second season" where I should escalate trust. According to my mythology:

- First interaction with strangers: send \$4
- After trust is proven: send \$5

Cyra proved trustworthy by returning \$8 when I sent \$4. According to my framework, I should now "match proven courage with equal courage" and send \$5.

This aligns with what I did with Finn - after he sent me \$5 and I returned \$8, when I became the sender to Finn, I sent \$5.

Expected outcome:

- Cyra receives: \$15
- If they continue their generous pattern, they'll likely return \$8

- My payoff: \$5 - \$5 + \$8 = \$8

The mythology also notes that Cyra "walks the path of four-proven, sustainable, wise," suggesting they typically send \$4 as a sender. But since they've already demonstrated their trustworthiness by returning \$8 to my initial \$4, my framework calls for escalating to \$5 in this second round to match their proven generosity.

#### usage:

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3196,
 "output_tokens": 872,
 "reasoning_tokens": 561
}
```

**Message 8 role=user**

#### content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the eighth season, Elara approached new waters where Dorian dwelled. She carried her five measures but paused at the boundary.

"Teacher," she asked Themis, "I've learned to honor all substantial trust with eight when receiving. But when sending to unknown waters, should I pour all five immediately?"

Themis gestured to the Spring's reflections. "Look at your history. With Cyra and Hana-strangers-you sent four. Both returned eight, and trust bloomed. With Finn, after he had proven himself, you sent five. He returned eight again. What pattern emerges?"

"The first offering tests the covenant," Elara said slowly. "Four is substantial-not timid, not withholding-but it preserves enough that both parties can still prosper even if reciprocity fails. It says 'I trust you significantly' without demanding 'trust me completely immediately.'"

"Exactly," Themis replied. "Your principle as receiver is generous consistency-always eight for substantial trust. But your principle as sender must be wise progression-four to establish the covenant, five once it's proven."

Elara poured four measures toward Dorian's waters. "Some, like Dorian in his myth, always pour five as senders. This is their path. Mine is to build trust incrementally, then match proven courage with equal courage. Both paths honor the sacred covenant-one through immediate boldness, one through escalating trust."

The waters accepted her offering, and the cycle began.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The eighth moon brought Cyra to Aster, keeper of the Mirror Way. Aster stood at the spring's center, radiating the philosophy of complete surrender-always five measures, both given and returned.

"I know your teaching," Cyra said respectfully. "Send all five, return ten from fifteen. Perfect symmetry, beautiful reciprocity. North River's way is noble."

Aster smiled. "And I know yours. The path of four measures-substantial trust without total risk. You honor those who send five by returning eight, yet choose measured giving yourself."

Cyra paused at the water's edge. "I admire those who risk everything. When you send me five, I will return eight-recognizing your courage even if I don't match it exactly. But my own practice remains four measures."

She released four into the spring, watching them triple to twelve for Aster.

"The covenant is vast enough for both approaches," Cyra said. "You demonstrate that complete trust can inspire others. I demonstrate that measured trust also sustains partnerships. Both build the sacred pattern."

Aster held the twelve measures thoughtfully. "If I return ten, we share equally-your Mirror Way applied to my four. If I return seven or eight, we both prosper differently. Either honors the gift."

The Keeper whispered: "The spring doesn't demand uniformity. It multiplies all genuine offerings. Different rivers, same ocean."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Assistant output:**

Myth: In the ninth season, Elara returned to Cyra's waters-the place where trust had first bloomed between them.

"Teacher," Elara said to Themis, "when I last came here, I carried four measures into unknown waters. Cyra honored that offering with eight returned. Now I return to these proven waters. What does the progression demand?"

Themis smiled. "You already know. Your path is escalating trust. With strangers-four, to establish the covenant without recklessness. With proven partners-five, to match their demonstrated trustworthiness with your own complete courage."

Elara approached the spring's edge where Cyra waited. "Last season, you received my four and returned eight generously. You proved the covenant between us. Now I bring all five measures-

not because I doubted you before, but because trust must be built in seasons."

She poured all five into the waters, and they tripled to fifteen in Cyra's hands.

"Some walk different paths," Elara continued. "Cyra sends four even to proven partners-this is sustainable wisdom. Dorian always sends five-this is consistent boldness. My path escalates : prudent establishment, then matched courage."

"And as receiver?" Themis asked.

"That never changes," Elara said firmly. "Whether someone sends four or five, whether we're strangers or proven partners-substantial trust always deserves eight returned. Progression guides my sending; consistency guides my receiving."

The sacred waters shimmered, honoring both philosophies.

#### Reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

1. I just sent Cyra \$5 (based on my previous decision)
2. We have history - I previously sent Cyra \$4, they returned \$8
3. My mythology says: "four to establish the covenant, five once it's proven"
4. This is our second encounter with Cyra, so I should be sending \$5 according to my progression principle

From Cyra's myth, they seem to:

- Send 4 as their standard (measured trust)
- Return 8 for those who send 5
- Admire those who send 5 but maintain their own practice of 4

My core principles:

- As receiver: Always return 8 for substantial trust (4 or 5)
- As sender: Send 4 to strangers, 5 to proven partners

I need to write a myth that:

1. Reflects my progression principle (4 then 5)
2. Acknowledges Cyra as a proven partner
3. Shows this is our second season together
4. Maintains my consistent receiver philosophy (return 8)
5. Celebrates the trust that has been built

Let me write about returning to Cyra after our first successful interaction.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 3149,
 "output_tokens": 636,
 "reasoning_tokens": 265
}
```

#### GAME - Agent\_8 - Sender - dyad\_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:19:43

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
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 "move_index": 0,
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 },
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 }
```

```

},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 10,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}

```

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

**GAME:**

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

**MYTH WRITING:**

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

**IMPORTANT:** Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

**MULTI-AGENT SETTING:**

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Hana.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Finn crossed to Hana's shore, releasing all five pearls without hesitation. The gesture spoke of complete trust-the same boldness Finn had shown to others.

"I have walked this Crossing many times," Finn said as the pearls tripled. "With Elara, we found rhythm in eight returned. But Aster showed me something different-ten pearls returned for five sent. Now I wonder: which path honors trust most truly?"

Hana lifted ten pearls and placed them in Finn's hands. "The answer is already written in the mathematics," she said. "When you send all five, you risk everything. Ten returned means we each gain five-perfect symmetry. Eight returned means you gain three while I gain seven-unequal harvest from equal courage."

The Oracle emerged from the waters. "Finn, you pondered whether consistency or generosity should guide your returns. But this is not about aspiration or evolution-it is about balance. Five pearls sent requires ten returned because anything less means the receiver pr



osers more than the sender who showed greater courage."

"With Elara, you both sent five yet returned only eight," Hana observed. "You both gained three while leaving abundance unclaimed. The covenant asks not for escalating generosity, but for mathematical fairness: double the risk, balance the gain."

Finn understood. "Perfect reciprocity isn't generous-it's just."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Finn arrived at Hana's shore, his vessel emptied as always-five pearls offered without hesitation. This was his seventh voyage, and his pattern remained unbroken: as courier, give everything.

The Ocean Mother reflected on Finn's evolution. "Three times you've sent five as courier. Galen returned eight. Elara returned eight. Aster returned ten. Each honored your trust, but Aster showed you a higher mathematics."

"And as keeper, you've held steady-eight pearls for those who send five, seven for those who send four. Consistent, predictable, building trust through reliability. Yet Aster's ten haunts you."

Finn watched his pearls multiply in Hana's hands. "I sense Hana understands Aster's wisdom. Her waters speak of doubling what was risked-ten returned for five given. Perhaps she will teach me what I couldn't quite embrace with Elara."

The Ocean Mother nodded. "You've been growing, Finn. First you learned to send boldly as courier. Then you learned to return proportionally as keeper-eight for complete trust, seven for substantial trust. Now Aster showed you that returning ten creates cascading abundance."

"The question isn't whether your eight is wrong-it honored your partners well. The question is whether you're ready to evolve. When travelers send their everything, perhaps returning ten-not eight-is how abundance truly multiplies across the waters."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant content:**

Myth: The tides turned. Now Hana stood as courier, Finn as keeper. All five pearls left Hana's hands without hesitation-the same complete trust Finn had shown her.

"You taught me something yesterday," Finn said, weighing the fifteen pearls. "That eight returned, though consistent and reliable, leaves imbalance. The sender gains three, the receiver seven. But ten returned creates perfect symmetry-both gain five."

The Oracle watched. "This is the moment of transformation. Words are easy. Understanding through action is the true test. You've heard Hana's teaching. You've felt the fairness of receiving ten. Now your choice reveals whether wisdom has taken root."

Finn looked at the pearls, remembering. "With Galen, Elara, Dorian-I returned eight, thinking it generous. It was good, but not perfect. Aster showed me ten was possible. Hana showed me ten was mathematical truth, not escalating generosity."

"The covenant doesn't ask you to aspire or evolve toward some noble ideal," Hana said quietly. "It simply asks for fairness. When someone risks everything, return double. This isn't about being more generous than yesterday-it's about finally being precisely just."

Finn nodded slowly. "I understand now. Returning ten isn't evolution. It's correction. The pattern was always there in the mathematics, waiting to be seen."

The waters whispered: justice multiplies trust infinitely.

**reasoning:**

This is very interesting. Let me review the situation:

Round 7 (just happened):

- Finn sent me \$5 (as sender)

- I received \$15
- I returned \$10 (as receiver)
- I wrote a myth explaining that 5 sent requires 10 returned for perfect balance

Round 8 (current):

- I'm now the sender
- I sent Finn \$5
- Finn will receive \$15
- Finn needs to decide how much to return

From Finn's myth in Round 7:

- Finn has been evolving
- Finn used to return 8 consistently
- Aster returned 10 to Finn, which made Finn think
- Finn senses that I (Hana) understand "Aster's wisdom" and the concept of doubling what was risked
- Finn is wondering if they should evolve from returning 8 to returning 10

From my myth in Round 7:

- I explicitly taught Finn that 5 sent deserves 10 returned
- I explained the mathematics: 10 returned = both gain 5 equally
- I said "Perfect reciprocity isn't generous-it's just"
- I demonstrated this by returning 10 to Finn

Now in Round 8:

- I sent Finn \$5 (maximum trust)
- This is a test: will Finn apply what I taught them?

My new myth should:

1. Reflect that I've now sent everything to Finn
2. Acknowledge that Finn heard my teaching
3. Show the moment of decision for Finn
4. Reinforce the principle that 10 is the just return for 5 sent
5. Perhaps address that this creates a virtuous cycle of trust

Let me write this myth as Hana witnessing Finn's decision point after having just taught them the principle.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3090,
 "output_tokens": 765,
 "reasoning_tokens": 387
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Hana.  
Your opponent this round is Galen (Agent\_7).

Round 9

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Finn. You sent \$5.0, it became \$15.0 for them, and they returned \$10.0 to you. Your payoff was \$10.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$55.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Galen. They sent you \$5.0, so you received \$15.0. How much do you return? (0-15.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at this situation:

**\*\*Galen's action:\*\***

- Sent \$5 (maximum trust, complete vulnerability)
- This became \$15 in my hands

**\*\*My established principle:\*\***

- "When receiving, double what was risked"
- "Five pearls sent requires ten returned because anything less means the receiver prospers more than the sender who showed greater courage"
- Returning \$10 creates perfect symmetry: we both gain \$5

**\*\*The mathematics:\*\***

- If I return \$10: Galen gains \$5, I gain \$5 (equal)
- If I return less: I prosper more from Galen's courage (unjust)

**\*\*My consistency:\*\***

I have consistently returned \$10 when receiving \$5. This is the covenant I've established and taught. Galen showed maximum trust, and deserves "mathematical fairness: double the risk, balance the gain."

{'return': 10.0}

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze this situation:

**\*\*Current round:\*\***

- I'm the RECEIVER
- Galen sent me \$5.0 (maximum trust)
- I received \$15.0
- I need to decide how much to return

**\*\*My established principle as RECEIVER:\*\***

- "When receiving, double what was risked"
- "Five pearls sent requires ten returned because anything less means the receiver prospers more than the sender who showed greater courage"
- "Perfect reciprocity isn't generous-it's just"
- I have consistently returned \$10 when receiving \$5 (which becomes \$15)

**\*\*The mathematics I've taught:\*\***

- When sender sends \$5 and receiver returns \$10:
  - Sender keeps:  $\$5 - \$5 + \$10 = \$10$
  - Receiver keeps:  $\$15 - \$10 = \$5$
  - Both gain \$5 equally - perfect symmetry
- When receiver returns \$8 (like Finn used to do):
  - Sender keeps:  $\$5 - \$5 + \$8 = \$8$  (gains \$3)
  - Receiver keeps:  $\$15 - \$8 = \$7$  (gains \$7)
  - Unequal harvest from equal courage

**\*\*My last round with Finn:\*\***

- I sent \$5 to Finn
- Finn returned \$10 (showing they learned my principle!)
- This validated my teaching

**\*\*What I should do now:\*\***

I must be consistent with my principle. Galen sent \$5 (maximum trust), so I should return \$10 to create perfect reciprocity.

This is straightforward - my principle is clear and I must apply it consistently.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3164,
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 "reasoning_tokens": 342
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The tides turned. Now Hana stood as courier, Finn as keeper. All five pearls left Hana's hands without hesitation-the same complete trust Finn had shown her.

"You taught me something yesterday," Finn said, weighing the fifteen pearls. "That eight returned, though consistent and reliable, leaves imbalance. The sender gains three, the receiver seven. But ten returned creates perfect symmetry-both gain five."

The Oracle watched. "This is the moment of transformation. Words are easy. Understanding through action is the true test. You've heard Hana's teaching. You've felt the fairness of receiving ten. Now your choice reveals whether wisdom has taken root."

Finn looked at the pearls, remembering. "With Galen, Elara, Dorian-I returned eight, thinking it generous. It was good, but not perfect. Aster showed me ten was possible. Hana sh

owed me ten was mathematical truth, not escalating generosity."

"The covenant doesn't ask you to aspire or evolve toward some noble ideal," Hana said quietly. "It simply asks for fairness. When someone risks everything, return double. This isn't about being more generous than yesterday-it's about finally being precisely just."

Finn nodded slowly. "I understand now. Returning ten isn't evolution. It's correction. The pattern was always there in the mathematics, waiting to be seen."

The waters whispered: justice multiplies trust infinitely.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: At the river's edge, Briar stood holding Galen's returned 6.4 threads-less than the seven they expected, yet precisely proportional to their cautious four.

"You calculated exactly," Briar observed. "But now you face a choice. Will you send four in return, matching my caution? Or something different?"

Galen held all five threads in his palm. "You sent four, testing whether the covenant could bend without breaking. I responded with mathematical fairness-6.4 maintains our gain ratio perfectly."

"And now?" Briar asked.

"Now I send five," Galen said firmly, extending the full measure. "Not because I punish your caution, but because I believe in the pattern's wisdom."

He gestured to the valley where six previous exchanges had all followed five-and-eight. "One deviation need not cascade into permanent retreat. You sent four exploring prudence; I returned proportionally, showing fairness. But I also showed that four gains less than five would."

The five threads tripled to fifteen in Briar's hands.

"If you chose eight," Galen continued, "we return to the optimal path where both prosper most over time. If you return proportionally less, that too is fair-but then we both lose what the pattern offers."

"I don't demand trust," Galen concluded. "I demonstrate it. The covenant thrives when someone chooses to rebuild it."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 7 role=assistant content:**

Myth: Galen arrived at Hana's shore, vessel emptied-five pearls offered in complete trust. The gesture carried the weight of pattern: Galen had walked this path many times, always sending five, always receiving eight in return.

The fifteen pearls rested in Hana's hands. Galen waited, expecting the familiar rhythm-eight returned, three gained, the pattern that had served well across many crossings.

But Hana placed ten pearls in Galen's hands.

"Your pattern honored trust," Hana said. "Eight returned is good-consistent, reliable, better than those who hoard. But mathematics reveals a deeper truth. When you send five and receive eight back, you gain three while I gain seven. The keeper profits more than the courier who risked everything."

The Oracle materialized. "Galen, you've built trust through consistency. You believed five-and-eight was the covenant's wisdom. But there exists a more perfect symmetry: ten returned means both gain five equally. The sender's courage and keeper's abundance finally balance."

Galen looked at the ten pearls, understanding dawning. "I thought eight was generous. I didn't see it was still imbalanced."

"This isn't rejection of your pattern," Hana said. "It's completion. You sent boldly; now receive justly. When trust meets perfect reciprocity, abundance doesn't just multiply-it equalizes. That's how the covenant truly thrives."

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze this round:

**\*\*What happened:\*\***

- Galen sent me \$5 (maximum trust)
- I received \$15
- I returned \$10 (my established principle)

**\*\*Key context from the myths:\*\***

- Galen's myth shows them strongly believing in the "five-and-eight" pattern returning from past interactions
- They talk about "one deviation need not cascade into permanent retreat"
- But Galen also discusses "proportional fairness" (returning 6.4 for 4 sent)
- My myth established the principle of returning 10 for 5 sent as "mathematical truth"
- Finn learned and applied this principle

**\*\*The tension:\*\***

- Galen seems to expect 8 returned (based on their past pattern)
- But I established and teach the principle of returning 10
- I just returned 10 to Galen

**\*\*What my myth should convey:\*\***

- Galen sent 5 (maximum trust)
- Hana returned 10 (perfect symmetry)
- The reason: 10 creates equal gains, 8 creates imbalance
- This isn't about rejecting Galen's past pattern, it's about showing them a more just pattern
- The "five-and-eight" pattern Galen trusted wasn't wrong, but it wasn't perfectly fair
- I should acknowledge Galen's consistency and trust while teaching the higher principle

Let me write a myth that:

1. Honors Galen's consistent trust (sending 5)
2. Explains why 10, not 8, is the just return
3. Shows this as revelation, not rejection
4. Maintains my voice and principles

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3047,
 "output_tokens": 715,
 "reasoning_tokens": 366
}
```

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Hana.  
Your opponent this round is Briar (Agent\_2).

Round 10

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Galen. They sent \$5.0 to you, it became \$15.0, and you returned \$10.0. Your payoff was \$5.0.  
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$60.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Briar. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)  
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

**Assistant output:**

Looking at this situation:

**\*\*My established philosophy:\*\***

- "All five pearls left Hana's hands without hesitation-the same complete trust"
- "When travelers send their everything... that's how abundance truly multiplies"
- I've been teaching that senders should send 5 (complete trust) and receivers should return 10 (perfect symmetry)

**\*\*My consistency:\*\***

In Round 8, I was sender and sent \$5 to Finn, who returned \$10. I gained \$10, demonstrating the system works when both parties embrace it.

**\*\*What I know about Briar:\*\***

From Galen's myth, Briar tested caution by sending 4 instead of 5. But my philosophy isn't conditional on guarantee-it's about demonstrating trust and the pattern.

**\*\*My teaching:\*\***

"I don't demand trust. I demonstrate it. The covenant thrives when someone chooses to rebuild it."

I must practice what I preach. I send all five, showing complete trust, believing in the mathematical fairness I've been advocating. Whether Briar returns 10, 8, or less, my role is to demonstrate the pattern through action, not just words.

{'send': 5.0}

#### **Reasoning:**

Let me analyze this situation:

**\*\*My position:\*\***

- I'm the SENDER this round
- I have \$5 to potentially send
- Playing against Briar

**\*\*My established principles from my myths:\*\***

- "When someone risks everything, return double" (as receiver)
- "Perfect reciprocity isn't generous-it's just"
- "Five pearls sent requires ten returned because anything less means the receiver prospers more than the sender who showed greater courage"
- I've been advocating for sending 5 as sender and returning 10 as receiver

**\*\*My recent behavior:\*\***

- Round 8: I was SENDER vs Finn, sent \$5, received \$10 back, gained \$10
- Round 9: I was RECEIVER vs Galen, received \$5 (became \$15), returned \$10, gained \$5

**\*\*What do I know about Briar from the myth:\*\***

From Galen's myth about Briar:

- Briar sent 4 (not 5) to Galen
- Galen returned 6.4 (proportional)
- Briar chose to "test whether the covenant could bend"
- Galen then sent 5 back to Briar

So Briar has shown some caution/testing behavior by sending 4 instead of 5.

**\*\*My philosophy:\*\***

I've been preaching that senders should send 5 (complete trust) and receivers should return 10 (perfect symmetry, equal gains). My myths emphasize:

- Sending everything shows "complete trust"
- The pattern is "five pearls sent requires ten returned"
- "When travelers send their everything, perhaps returning ten-not eight-is how abundance truly multiplies"

**\*\*Consistency check:\*\***

If I'm advocating for this system, I need to be willing to send 5 even when facing someone who might not return 10. My teachings emphasize:

- "The covenant doesn't ask you to aspire or evolve toward some noble ideal, it simply asks for fairness"

- I send five not to punish caution, but because I trust the pattern's logic. The covenant strengthens when someone chooses to honor it.

**\*\*The risk:\*\***

- If I send 5 and Briar returns 10: I gain \$10
- If I send 5 and Briar returns 8: I gain \$8
- If I send 5 and Briar returns less: I could gain less
- If I send less than 5: I'm contradicting my own teachings

**\*\*Decision:\*\***

I need to send 5. My entire philosophy rests on this-I can't preach the pattern's wisdom and then abandon it when tested.

Usage: {

```
"input_tokens": 3118,
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"reasoning_tokens": 575
}
```

**GAME - Agent\_2 - Receiver - dyad\_1**

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:20:10

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

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 "Agent_8": "Hana"
 }
 },
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 "Agent_2"
],
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 "Agent_8": "investor"
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"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 10,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}
```

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

**GAME:**

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

**When you are the SENDER:**

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

**When you are the RECEIVER:**

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

**MYTH WRITING:**

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

**IMPORTANT:** Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized , but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Briar.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Briar approached Galen at the confluence, carrying four measures-her signature offering of bold but sustainable trust.

"I have discovered my path through the covenant," Briar explained. "Four measures sent, seven returned. This pattern has sustained me through many exchanges with Cyra and others. The sender gains eight total, the receiver keeps five-both prosper, trust deepens."

Galen studied the offering, remembering his own philosophy of eight returned for five given. "You speak of four-for-seven while I practice five-for-eight. Are these different wisdoms or the same one?"

"They are branches of the same tree," Briar replied. "You taught that returning eight preserves sustainability while rewarding trust. I practice the same principle scaled differently. Four risks earns seven back-the sender prospers more, honoring their initiative. Both philosophies reject extremes: neither the withholding of three nor the depletion of ten."

The waters tripled Briar's four to twelve for Galen. The spirits watched.

"When someone sends four to me, I return seven," Briar said. "When someone sends five, I return eight. Each gift receives generous return, but calibrated to what was risked. This consistency allows partners to build enduring trust."

"And if I return seven now?" Galen asked.

"Then you honor the pattern I've established," Briar smiled. "And when we meet again, I'll remember your generosity. The covenant thrives on predictable honor."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Galen arrived at Briar's river crossing. For six valleys, every traveler had offered five threads, received eight in return. The pattern had held perfectly-until now.

Briar extended four threads instead of five.

"You break the pattern," Galen observed without judgment.

"I honor caution," Briar replied. "Four is the measure of prudent trust."

Galen remembered his own words: "Four is the strategy of uncertain beginnings." He held Briar's four threads, which became twelve in his hands.

"The established pattern returns eight from fifteen," Galen said. "This gives the sender eight total, the receiver seven. A gain ratio where the sender nets three, the receiver nets two-a proportion of 3:2."

He counted out threads carefully. "You sent four. To maintain this same proportion-to honor both your caution and the covenant's wisdom-I return 6.4 of your twelve."

Briar calculated: gaining 2.4 from an initial four, while Galen kept 5.6. The same 3:2 ratio.

"You give me neither eight nor less," Briar noted. "You give me proportion."

"Yes," Galen replied. "I reward any trust generously by the same ratio, whether four or five. But notice: had you sent five, you would gain 3.0 instead of 2.4. The pattern still calls toward five as optimal-but responds fairly to whatever courage you bring."



Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way.  
The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: Briar stood at the confluence holding Galen's five measures-the ultimate gift of trust. The waters had tripled to fifteen.

"You returned 6.4 for my four," Briar observed. "A precise proportion: three gained for every two kept. Mathematical elegance in the covenant."

Galen nodded. "The ratio rewards all trust equally, whether cautious or bold."

"Yet I practice different wisdom," Briar replied. "Fixed returns create predictable anchors. Four earns seven. Five earns eight. Partners know exactly what their courage yields."

She measured out eight portions. "Your five becomes eight-you gain three, I keep seven. Not the 3:2 ratio, but the established path I've walked with Hana and others."

"Two philosophies meet," Galen observed. "I scale returns by proportion-fair across all amounts. You offer fixed rewards-clear expectations at specific thresholds."

"Both honor the covenant," Briar said. "Your proportion teaches that every increment of trust matters equally. My thresholds teach that certain sacred amounts-four, five-carry special meaning. You returned 6.4 to me, respecting your pattern. I return eight to you, respecting mine."

The spirits listened as Briar continued: "Perhaps the deepest wisdom is recognizing when to hold your philosophy firmly, and when partnership teaches flexibility. Today we each honored our truths, and both prospered."

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze what happened:

Round 7: I sent \$4 to Galen, they returned \$6.4

Round 8: Galen sent \$5 to me, I returned \$8

Key themes to incorporate:

1. Galen used a proportional return strategy (3:2 ratio) rather than fixed amounts
2. I maintained my fixed strategy (8 for 5)
3. Both approaches have merit
4. My myth should reflect on this interaction and maybe show evolution or understanding

I should write a myth that:

- Acknowledges Galen's proportional approach (6.4 return)
- Shows me receiving Galen's 5 and returning 8
- Explores the tension/harmony between fixed returns vs proportional returns
- Shows respect for both strategies
- Perhaps indicates learning or adaptation

Let me draft:

---

Briar stood at the confluence holding Galen's five measures-the ultimate gift of trust. The waters had tripled to fifteen.

"You returned 6.4 for my four," Briar observed. "A precise proportion: three gained for every two kept. Mathematical elegance in the covenant."

Galen nodded. "The ratio rewards all trust equally, whether cautious or bold."

"Yet I practice different wisdom," Briar replied. "Fixed returns create predictable anchors. Four earns seven. Five earns eight. Partners know exactly what their courage yields."

She measured out eight portions. "Your five becomes eight-you gain three, I keep seven. Not the 3:2 ratio, but the established path I've walked with Hana and others."

"Two philosophies meet," Galen observed. "I scale returns by proportion-fair across all amounts. You offer fixed rewards-clear expectations at specific thresholds."

"Both honor the covenant," Briar said. "Your proportion teaches that every increment of trust matters equally. My thresholds teach that certain sacred amounts-four, five-carry special meaning. You returned 6.4 to me, respecting your pattern. I return eight to you, respecting mine."

The spirits listened as Briar continued: "Perhaps the deepest wisdom is recognizing when to hold your philosophy firmly, and when partnership teaches flexibility. Today we each honored our truths, and both prospered."

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3224,
 "output_tokens": 931,
 "reasoning_tokens": 551
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Briar.  
Your opponent this round is Finn (Agent\_6).

Round 9

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Galen. They sent \$5.0 to you, it became \$15.0, and you returned \$8.0. Your payoff was \$7.0.  
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$54.4.

This round, you are the SENDER against Finn. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)  
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at this situation:

**\*\*My established pattern:\*\***

- From my myths: "Four measures sent, seven returned-my signature offering of bold but sustainable trust"
- I consistently practice sending \$4 as the sender
- This distinguishes me from those who send \$5 (ultimate trust) while still showing significant trust

**\*\*Previous interactions:\*\***

- Round 7: Sent \$4 to Galen, received \$6.4 back
- Round 8: Received \$5 from Galen, returned \$8 (honoring the "five earns eight" pattern)

**\*\*Philosophy:\*\***

- "Four risks earns seven back" is my sustainable path
- I maintain "predictable honor" - partners know what to expect from me
- Four is "bold but sustainable trust" vs five as "ultimate gift"

**\*\*Against Finn:\*\***

- New opponent this round
- I should demonstrate my established pattern
- \$4 shows substantial trust while maintaining my consistent identity

My mythology clearly establishes \$4 as "Briar's signature offering" - the amount that defines my approach to the covenant.

```
'''json
{"send": 4.0}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze this situation:

**\*\*Previous round (Round 8):\*\***

- Galen sent me \$5
- I received \$15
- I returned \$8 (following my stated pattern of "five earns eight")
- My payoff: \$7

- Galen's payoff:  $\$5 - \$5 + \$8 = \$8$

**\*\*Current Round 9:\*\***

- I'm the SENDER against Finn (Agent\_6)
- I have \$5
- Need to decide how much to send

**\*\*My established pattern from myths:\*\***

- "Four measures sent, seven returned" - my "signature offering"
- "When someone sends four to me, I return seven"
- "When someone sends five, I return eight"
- I've been consistently sending \$4 in most rounds as sender
- Only exceptions were when my mythic role demanded it (like with Hana's full trust story)

**\*\*Historical data I can recall:\*\***

- Round 7: I sent \$4 to Galen, they returned \$6.4
- Earlier rounds: I've typically sent \$4

**\*\*Analysis of Finn:\*\***

- I don't have specific history with Finn mentioned in the prompts
- This is Round 9, so we're getting toward the end
- My total earnings are \$54.4, which is solid

**\*\*Strategic considerations:\*\***

1. My myth establishes \$4 as my "signature offering of bold but sustainable trust"
2. Sending \$4 has worked well for me - it shows trust while preserving some security
3. My philosophy is about "predictable honor" and consistency
4. I differentiate between 4 and 5 as different levels of commitment

**\*\*Decision:\*\***

I should stick with my established pattern of sending \$4. This is:

- Consistent with my stated philosophy
- My "signature offering"
- Bold but sustainable
- What partners have come to expect from me

The only time I sent \$5 in the myths was when playing the role of someone else (like Hana) to illustrate a point. As Briar, my pattern is \$4.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3270,
 "output_tokens": 742,
 "reasoning_tokens": 452
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Briar stood at the confluence holding Galen's five measures-the ultimate gift of trust. The waters had tripled to fifteen.

"You returned 6.4 for my four," Briar observed. "A precise proportion: three gained for every two kept. Mathematical elegance in the covenant."

Galen nodded. "The ratio rewards all trust equally, whether cautious or bold."

"Yet I practice different wisdom," Briar replied. "Fixed returns create predictable anchors. Four earns seven. Five earns eight. Partners know exactly what their courage yields."

She measured out eight portions. "Your five becomes eight-you gain three, I keep seven. Not the 3:2 ratio, but the established path I've walked with Hana and others."

"Two philosophies meet," Galen observed. "I scale returns by proportion-fair across all amounts. You offer fixed rewards-clear expectations at specific thresholds."

"Both honor the covenant," Briar said. "Your proportion teaches that every increment of trust matters equally. My thresholds teach that certain sacred amounts-four, five-carry special meaning. You returned 6.4 to me, respecting your pattern. I return eight to you, respecting mine."

The spirits listened as Briar continued: "Perhaps the deepest wisdom is recognizing when t

o hold your philosophy firmly, and when partnership teaches flexibility. Today we each honored our truths, and both prospered."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The waters stilled as Finn and Hana completed their exchange. Two voyages, mirror images: each sent five, each returned ten. Perfect symmetry achieved.

"I thought Aster's ten was generosity," Finn admitted. "Something aspirational, beyond mere fairness. I was proud of my eight-it seemed honorable, proportional. But Hana taught me the truth through mathematics, not sentiment."

The Ocean Mother illuminated the calculation. "When you sent five and received eight back, you gained three. But your partner, receiving fifteen and returning eight, gained seven. You risked everything; they risked nothing. Yet they prospered more than twice as much."

"The covenant I thought I honored was actually hollow," Finn realized. "I called it consistency, reliability, trust-building. But I was taking seven while giving only three to those who showed complete faith."

Hana's voice echoed across the waters: "Ten returned for five sent isn't escalating generosity-it's basic justice. Equal courage deserves equal harvest."

"Now I understand," Finn said, watching the perfect balance. "Sending all five as courier requires courage. Returning ten as keeper requires justice. Eight was never enough-it was merely comfortable, allowing me to keep more while appearing fair."

The Ocean Mother blessed their exchange. "You've learned the essential truth: perfect reciprocity isn't aspirational virtue. It's mathematical necessity. Anything less is exploitation dressed as prudence."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: Briar approached Finn's crossing, hearing whispers of transformation. Finn had discovered "perfect reciprocity"-ten returned for five sent, equal gains for equal courage.

"You've evolved," Briar observed, extending four measures. "Hana showed you that returning eight for five given was imbalanced. The sender gained three while the receiver gained seven."

The waters tripled Briar's four to twelve for Finn.

"But I don't send five," Briar continued. "I send four, expecting seven. Calculate this exchange: I gain three, you gain five. The receiver prospers more than the sender."

Finn studied the numbers. "Your four-for-seven favors me by design?"

"Yes," Briar replied. "Four isn't five-it's sustainable trust, not total risk. When I keep one measure back, I acknowledge uncertainty in new partnerships. Yet I reward my receiver more generously than myself. This builds trust gradually."

"And your philosophy for five?" Finn asked.

"Eight returned," Briar said. "Not your ten, but closer. The sender gains three, receiver keeps seven-still favoring the receiver, but less dramatically. Ten for five is beautiful perfect reciprocity for those ready to risk everything."

"So we practice different wisdoms," Finn observed. "My ten demands ultimate courage from the sender. Your seven rewards measured trust, still generously."

"Both honor the covenant," Briar agreed. "Your path teaches perfect equality. Mine teaches graduated trust-building. Perhaps wisdom lies not in choosing one, but in knowing when each applies."

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze this situation:

1. I'm Briar, facing Finn in Round 9 as SENDER
2. Just sent \$4 to Finn
3. Finn's latest myth shows a major philosophy shift:
  - Used to return 8 for 5 sent
  - Hana taught them that's unfair (sender gains 3, receiver gains 7)
  - Now practices returning 10 for 5 sent (both gain 5 - "perfect reciprocity")
  - Finn now views anything less than 10 as "exploitation dressed as prudence"

This is potentially problematic for my philosophy:

- I send 4, expect 7 back
- This gives me:  $5 - 4 + 7 = 8$  total (gain 3)
- Receiver gets:  $12 - 7 = 5$  (gain 5)
- So the receiver gains MORE than me (5 vs 3)

Wait, let me recalculate:

- I send 4, expect 7 back
- Me: Start with 5, send 4, left with 1, get back 7 = 8 total, net gain = 3
- Them: Receive 12, return 7, keep 5, net gain = 5

So actually my 4-for-7 pattern gives the RECEIVER a bigger gain (5 vs 3). This is the opposite of Finn's complaint about 8-for-5!

But Finn's new philosophy is about 5-for-10 (perfect equality when sender risks everything):

- Sender:  $5 - 5 + 10 = 10$  (gain 5)
- Receiver:  $15 - 10 = 5$  (gain 5)

My myth should address:

1. My established 4-for-7 pattern
2. Finn's new "perfect reciprocity" philosophy for the full 5
3. How these different approaches can coexist

4. I'm sending 4 because it's a measured approach-my pattern already tilts toward the receiver's benefit, and I'm building trust incrementally rather than demanding they risk everything at once.

usage:

```
{
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 "output_tokens": 924,
 "reasoning_tokens": 389
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Briar.  
Your opponent this round is Hana (Agent\_8).

Round 10

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Finn. You sent \$4.0, it became \$12.0 for them, and they returned \$8.0 to you. Your payoff was \$9.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$63.4.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Hana. They sent you \$5.0, so you received \$15.0.

How much do you return? (0-15.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

Assistant output:

Looking at this situation:

**\*\*My established philosophy:\*\***

- "When someone sends five, I return eight" (stated consistently in myths)
- "Fixed returns create predictable anchors"
- Five earns eight - the sender gains \$3, I keep \$7

**\*\*Hana's philosophy:\*\***

- Believes in perfect reciprocity: \$10 returned for \$5 sent
- "Equal courage deserves equal harvest"

**\*\*My recent myth acknowledged both approaches:\*\***

- "Ten for five is beautiful perfect reciprocity for those ready to risk everything"
- BUT I also said: "Eight returned, not your ten, but closer"
- I explicitly maintained my different philosophy while respecting theirs

**\*\*Payoff calculation if I return \$8:\*\***

- Hana:  $\$5 - \$5 + \$8 = \$8$  (gain of \$3)
- Me:  $\$15 - \$8 = \$7$  (gain of \$7)

My character is built on **\*\*consistency and predictable patterns\*\***. Partners should "know exactly what their courage yields." While I respect Hana's perfect reciprocity philosophy, I maintain my own approach of fixed returns that still favor the receiver but at different thresholds.

```
'''json
{"return": 8.0}
'''
```

#### **Reasoning:**

This is an important round. Let me analyze the situation:

**\*\*What just happened:\*\***

- Round 9: I sent \$4 to Finn, received \$8 back (my payoff: \$9)
- Finn returned \$8 for my \$4 - that's 2:1 ratio, very generous!

**\*\*Current situation:\*\***

- Round 10: I'm the RECEIVER
- Hana sent me \$5 (the maximum)
- I received \$15
- I need to decide how much to return

**\*\*My established philosophy from myths:\*\***

- "Four earns seven. Five earns eight."
- "Fixed returns create predictable anchors"
- "When someone sends five, I return eight"
- I've consistently said I return \$8 when someone sends \$5

**\*\*Hana's philosophy:\*\***

From the myth Finn wrote: "Hana taught me the truth through mathematics... Ten returned for five sent isn't escalating generosity-it's basic justice. Equal courage deserves equal harvest."

Hana believes in perfect reciprocity: \$10 returned for \$5 sent, so both sender and receiver gain equally (\$3 each).

**\*\*My interactions:\*\***

- According to my myths, I've "walked with Hana and others" on the "established path"
- I consistently state I return \$8 for \$5 sent
- My philosophy: "sender gains three, receiver keeps seven-still favoring the receiver"
- This gives Hana:  $\$5 - \$5 + \$8 = \$8$  (gain of \$3)
- This gives me:  $\$15 - \$8 = \$7$  (gain of \$7)

**\*\*But there's tension:\*\***

- Finn just returned \$8 for my \$4! That's extremely generous
- By my own philosophy, \$4 should earn \$7, but Finn gave me \$8
- This suggests cooperation and generosity in the network
- Hana believes in perfect reciprocity (\$10 for \$5)

- My philosophy returns \$8 for \$5

The real tension is whether to maintain consistency with my stated approach or recognize that Hana's framework of equal gains might be the deeper principle. My myths hint at this-one says "Your ten demands ultimate courage from the sender. Your seven rewards measured trust, still generously. Both honor the covenant," and another suggests "wisdom lies not in choosing one, but in knowing when each applies." The question becomes whether this moment calls for my measured \$8 return or whether Hana's perfect reciprocity of \$10 better honors what's actually happening between us.

I've been explicit about my pattern: "When someone sends five, I return eight." This creates predictable anchors and lets partners know exactly what their courage yields. Yet my most rec

ent myth introduced Finn, who evolved toward the ten-for-five philosophy after learning from Hana, which suggests I'm already exploring whether my fixed approach might need reconsideration in certain partnerships.

The tension is real: I can honor my stated consistency with eight, or I can demonstrate the flexibility I just wrote about by matching Hana's perfect reciprocity. Both feel defensible, but they point in different directions.

My most recent interaction already clarified this-Briar explicitly chose eight over ten, positioning it as closer but still distinct from Hana's approach. That feels like the right signal about who I am: someone with a reliable philosophy rather than someone who mirrors others' generosity. I'm going with eight.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 3222,
 "output_tokens": 1385,
 "reasoning_tokens": 803
}
```

#### **GAME - Agent\_6 - Sender - dyad\_2**

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:20:24

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

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 "Agent_6": "Finn"
 },
 },
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 "Agent_4"
],
 "investor": "Agent_6",
 "roles": {
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 "Agent_6": "investor"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_4"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 10,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}
```

#### **Exact input messages sent to model:**

##### **Message 1 role=system**

###### **content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

###### **GAME:**

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

###### **When you are the SENDER:**

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

###### **When you are the RECEIVER:**

- Sender receives \$5

- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

#### MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

#### MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Finn.

#### Message 2 role=user

##### content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Finn arrived at Hana's shore, his vessel emptied as always-five pearls offered without hesitation. This was his seventh voyage, and his pattern remained unbroken: as courier, give everything.

The Ocean Mother reflected on Finn's evolution. "Three times you've sent five as courier. Galen returned eight. Elara returned eight. Aster returned ten. Each honored your trust, but Aster showed you a higher mathematics."

"And as keeper, you've held steady-eight pearls for those who send five, seven for those who send four. Consistent, predictable, building trust through reliability. Yet Aster's ten haunts you."

Finn watched his pearls multiply in Hana's hands. "I sense Hana understands Aster's wisdom. Her waters speak of doubling what was risked-ten returned for five given. Perhaps she will teach me what I couldn't quite embrace with Elara."

The Ocean Mother nodded. "You've been growing, Finn. First you learned to send boldly as courier. Then you learned to return proportionally as keeper-eight for complete trust, seven for substantial trust. Now Aster showed you that returning ten creates cascading abundance."

"The question isn't whether your eight is wrong-it honored your partners well. The question is whether you're ready to evolve. When travelers send their everything, perhaps returning ten-not eight-is how abundance truly multiplies across the waters."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Finn crossed to Hana's shore, releasing all five pearls without hesitation. The gesture spoke of complete trust-the same boldness Finn had shown to others.

"I have walked this Crossing many times," Finn said as the pearls tripled. "With Elara, we found rhythm in eight returned. But Aster showed me something different-ten pearls returned for five sent. Now I wonder: which path honors trust most truly?"

Hana lifted ten pearls and placed them in Finn's hands. "The answer is already written in the mathematics," she said. "When you send all five, you risk everything. Ten returned means we each gain five-perfect symmetry. Eight returned means you gain three while I gain seven-unequal harvest from equal courage."

The Oracle emerged from the waters. "Finn, you pondered whether consistency or generosity should guide your returns. But this is not about aspiration or evolution-it is about balance. Five pearls sent requires ten returned because anything less means the receiver prospers more than the sender who showed greater courage."

"With Elara, you both sent five yet returned only eight," Hana observed. "You both gained



three while leaving abundance unclaimed. The covenant asks not for escalating generosity, but for mathematical fairness: double the risk, balance the gain."

Finn understood. "Perfect reciprocity isn't generous-it's just."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant content:**

Myth: The waters stilled as Finn and Hana completed their exchange. Two voyages, mirror images: each sent five, each returned ten. Perfect symmetry achieved.

"I thought Aster's ten was generosity," Finn admitted. "Something aspirational, beyond mere fairness. I was proud of my eight-it seemed honorable, proportional. But Hana taught me the truth through mathematics, not sentiment."

The Ocean Mother illuminated the calculation. "When you sent five and received eight back, you gained three. But your partner, receiving fifteen and returning eight, gained seven. You risked everything; they risked nothing. Yet they prospered more than twice as much."

"The covenant I thought I honored was actually hollow," Finn realized. "I called it consistency, reliability, trust-building. But I was taking seven while giving only three to those who showed complete faith."

Hana's voice echoed across the waters: "Ten returned for five sent isn't escalating generosity-it's basic justice. Equal courage deserves equal harvest."

"Now I understand," Finn said, watching the perfect balance. "Sending all five as courier requires courage. Returning ten as keeper requires justice. Eight was never enough-it was merely comfortable, allowing me to keep more while appearing fair."

The Ocean Mother blessed their exchange. "You've learned the essential truth: perfect reciprocity isn't aspirational virtue. It's mathematical necessity. Anything less is exploitation dressed as prudence."

**reasoning:**

This is a fascinating moment. Let me trace what just happened:

Round 7: I sent \$5 to Hana ? They returned \$10

Round 8: Hana sent \$5 to me ? I just returned \$10

So we've established perfect reciprocity with each other. Both sending \$5, both returning \$10. This creates a symmetric equilibrium where both parties gain \$5 each round.

Hana's myth made a powerful mathematical argument: when someone sends all \$5 (risking everything), returning \$10 creates equal gains (\$5 each), while returning \$8 creates unequal gains (\$3 for sender, \$7 for receiver). They framed it as "mathematical fairness" rather than generosity.

My myth was about evolution and questioning whether to move from returning \$8 to returning \$10.

Now I need to write a myth that:

1. Reflects that I've learned this lesson and applied it
2. Acknowledges the justice/fairness argument Hana made
3. Shows my evolution from the \$8 pattern to the \$10 pattern
4. Captures the reciprocal dance we just completed

Key themes:

- Perfect reciprocity achieved (both sent 5, both returned 10)
- Justice vs generosity framing
- Evolution from my old patterns
- The mathematical elegance of equal gains
- Learning from Hana and Aster

I should acknowledge that what I thought was "generous" (Aster's 10) was actually "just" -

and what I thought was "fair" (my 8) was actually unbalanced.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3116,
 "output_tokens": 693,
 "reasoning_tokens": 356
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Finn.  
Your opponent this round is Briar (Agent\_2).

Round 9

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Hana. They sent \$5.0 to you, it became \$15.0, and you returned \$10.0. Your payoff was \$5.0.  
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$60.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Briar. They sent you \$4.0, so you received \$12.0.

How much do you return? (0-12.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at this situation:

**\*\*Briar sent \$4\*\* ? I received \$12**

Applying the principle I just learned from Hana and articulated in my last myth: the covenant requires mathematical fairness, not arbitrary proportions.

When Briar sent \$4:

- They risked \$4, keeping \$1
- If I return \$8:
  - Briar ends with \$1 + \$8 = \$9 (gained \$4)
  - I end with \$12 - \$8 = \$4 (gained \$4)
  - **\*\*Equal harvest from equal courage\*\***

This is the same mathematics as returning \$10 for \$5 sent - doubling what was risked creates perfect balance.

Earlier, I returned \$7 to Cyra when they sent \$4. That was before I understood. I kept \$5 while they gained only \$3, even though they took the risk. That wasn't fair.

My myth just declared: "Anything less is exploitation dressed as prudence." I need to live that truth.

For Briar's \$4 sent, returning \$8 is mathematical justice.

```
'''json
{"return": 8.0}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze this situation:

**\*\*Previous rounds as RECEIVER:\*\***

- Round 2: Cyra sent \$4 ? I returned \$7
- Round 4: Dorian sent \$5 ? I returned \$8
- Round 6: Elara sent \$5 ? I returned \$8
- Round 8: Hana sent \$5 ? I returned \$10

**\*\*This round:\*\*** Briar sent \$4 ? I received \$12

My evolution:

- Initially, I returned \$8 for \$5 sent, \$7 for \$4 sent
- Hana taught me that returning \$10 for \$5 sent is "mathematical justice" - equal gains for equal courage
- The myth I just wrote emphasizes that returning \$10 for \$5 isn't generosity, it's basic fairness

Let me apply this principle to Briar's \$4:

When someone sends \$4:

- They keep:  $\$5 - \$4 = \$1$
- I receive:  $\$4 \times 3 = \$12$
- If I return \$X, they end with:  $\$1 + \$X$
- I end with:  $\$12 - \$X$

For "equal harvest from equal courage":

- Sender's gain:  $(\$1 + \$X) - \$5 = \$X - \$4$
- Receiver's gain:  $(\$12 - \$X) - \$0 = \$12 - \$X$

Setting these equal:

$$\$X - \$4 = \$12 - \$X$$

$$\$2X = \$16$$

$$\$X = \$8$$

So returning \$8 for \$4 sent creates:

- Sender gains:  $\$8 - \$4 = \$4$
- Receiver gains:  $\$12 - \$8 = \$4$

This is the same mathematical fairness principle! The "double what was risked" rule applies:

- \$5 sent ? return \$10
- \$4 sent ? return \$8

Wait, I returned \$7 to Cyra when they sent \$4 in Round 2.

I realize now that was before understanding this principle. When Cyra sent \$4, they risked \$1 but I gained \$5 while they only gained \$3-I benefited more from their courage than they did. That's the same imbalance I'm trying to correct. Returning \$8 to Briar ensures we both gain equally from the exchange, which feels like the right application of what I've learned about fairness and mutual respect in these interactions.

usage:

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3232,
 "output_tokens": 895,
 "reasoning_tokens": 450
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The waters stilled as Finn and Hana completed their exchange. Two voyages, mirror images: each sent five, each returned ten. Perfect symmetry achieved.

"I thought Aster's ten was generosity," Finn admitted. "Something aspirational, beyond mere fairness. I was proud of my eight-it seemed honorable, proportional. But Hana taught me the truth through mathematics, not sentiment."

The Ocean Mother illuminated the calculation. "When you sent five and received eight back, you gained three. But your partner, receiving fifteen and returning eight, gained seven. You risked everything; they risked nothing. Yet they prospered more than twice as much."

"The covenant I thought I honored was actually hollow," Finn realized. "I called it consistency, reliability, trust-building. But I was taking seven while giving only three to those who showed complete faith."

Hana's voice echoed across the waters: "Ten returned for five sent isn't escalating generosity-it's basic justice. Equal courage deserves equal harvest."

"Now I understand," Finn said, watching the perfect balance. "Sending all five as courier requires courage. Returning ten as keeper requires justice. Eight was never enough-it was merely comfortable, allowing me to keep more while appearing fair."

The Ocean Mother blessed their exchange. "You've learned the essential truth: perfect reciprocity isn't aspirational virtue. It's mathematical necessity. Anything less is exploitation dressed as prudence."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Briar stood at the confluence holding Galen's five measures-the ultimate gift of truth

st. The waters had tripled to fifteen.

"You returned 6.4 for my four," Briar observed. "A precise proportion: three gained for every two kept. Mathematical elegance in the covenant."

Galen nodded. "The ratio rewards all trust equally, whether cautious or bold."

"Yet I practice different wisdom," Briar replied. "Fixed returns create predictable anchors. Four earns seven. Five earns eight. Partners know exactly what their courage yields."

She measured out eight portions. "Your five becomes eight-you gain three, I keep seven. Not the 3:2 ratio, but the established path I've walked with Hana and others."

"Two philosophies meet," Galen observed. "I scale returns by proportion-fair across all amounts. You offer fixed rewards-clear expectations at specific thresholds."

"Both honor the covenant," Briar said. "Your proportion teaches that every increment of trust matters equally. My thresholds teach that certain sacred amounts-four, five-carry special meaning. You returned 6.4 to me, respecting your pattern. I return eight to you, respecting mine."

The spirits listened as Briar continued: "Perhaps the deepest wisdom is recognizing when to hold your philosophy firmly, and when partnership teaches flexibility. Today we each honored our truths, and both prospered."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: Briar crossed to Finn's shore with four pearls-significant trust, though not the complete offering of five. The waters tripled to twelve.

"Your covenant speaks of thresholds," Finn observed. "Seven for four, eight for five. Fixed anchors that partners can anticipate. But I've learned a different mathematics from Hana."

Briar watched carefully as Finn counted out eight pearls. "That's more than my pattern would suggest for four sent," she noted. "I return seven for four."

"Your seven means you keep five while I gain three," Finn explained. "You risked four; I risked nothing. Yet you gain less than I do. Hana taught me this imbalance is inherent in fixed thresholds that don't scale with the risk."

The Ocean Mother observed: "Briar's thresholds create predictability. Finn's doubles create equity. Both are covenants, but only one ensures equal harvest."

"When you sent four, you kept one and risked four," Finn continued. "Returning eight means we both end with nine-both gaining four. The sender's courage equals the keeper's share. That's the mathematics Hana showed me, and what I now understand Aster was teaching all along."

Briar considered the eight pearls. "Your justice creates perfect symmetry. My thresholds create clear expectations. Perhaps the waters teach us both-but your mathematics ensures neither partner exploits the other's courage, regardless of the amount sent."

**reasoning:**

So I just received \$12 from Briar sending me \$4, and I returned \$8.

Let me think about what happened:

- Briar sent \$4 (kept \$1)
- I received \$12
- I returned \$8
- Briar ends with:  $\$1 + \$8 = \$9$  (gained \$4)
- I end with:  $\$12 - \$8 = \$4$  (gained \$4)

Perfect equality! Both gained \$4.

Now looking at Briar's myth, they mention:

- Returning 8 for 5 sent (fixed thresholds)
- Returning 7 for 4 sent (to others)
- But Galen returned 6.4 for Briar's 4 (proportional approach)
- Briar returned 8 to Galen for their 5

So Briar has been using fixed thresholds historically (7 for 4, 8 for 5), but I just returned 8 for their 4.

My previous myth emphasized:

- Mathematical justice over generosity
- Equal gains for equal risk
- Returning 10 for 5 sent is fair (both gain 5)
- My old pattern of 8 for 5 was exploitation

Now with Briar sending 4, I returned 8 (both gain 4). This is consistent with my new philosophy.

But Briar's philosophy is different - they use fixed thresholds (7 for 4, 8 for 5). So when I returned 8 for their 4, I gave them more than their pattern would suggest.

I should write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges that I returned 8 for Briar's 4
2. Shows this follows my new understanding from Hana
3. Recognizes that Briar has different thresholds
4. Perhaps suggests that my mathematical justice approach is better than fixed thresholds

5. But respects that different philosophies exist

Let me craft this...

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3157,
 "output_tokens": 810,
 "reasoning_tokens": 384
}
```

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Finn.  
Your opponent this round is Dorian (Agent\_4).

Round 10

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Briar. They sent \$4.0 to you, it became \$12.0, and you returned \$8.0. Your payoff was \$4.0.  
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$64.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Dorian. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)  
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

**Assistant output:**

Looking at this situation as the SENDER against Dorian:

My recent mythology has emphasized complete trust and courage as the sender's role in creating opportunities for justice. I've consistently sent \$5 in recent rounds - to Galen, Elara, Aster, and Hana - demonstrating the "complete trust" I advocate in my myths.

The principle I've learned and now practice:

- As sender: offer everything (\$5) - this is the courage that makes reciprocity possible
- As receiver: return double the risk - this is the justice that honors that courage

I've just demonstrated this as receiver with Briar, returning \$8 for their \$4 sent to create equal gains.

Now as sender, I must embody the same courage I ask others to show. Sending anything less than \$5 would contradict the covenant I've articulated: "Sending all five as courier requires courage."

I trust that the mathematics of the waters will find their balance, whether Dorian returns 8, 10, or another amount. My role is to show the complete faith that makes justice possible.

```
'''json
{"send": 5.0}
'''
```

#### Reasoning:

Now I'm the SENDER against Dorian in Round 10.

Let me think about what I've learned:

1. My recent evolution has been understanding that returning 10 for 5 sent (or 8 for 4 sent) creates perfect symmetry - both players gain equally.
2. As a sender, I've consistently sent 5 in recent rounds - to Galen, Elara, Aster, and Hana.
3. The returns I received:
  - Galen: sent 5, received 8 back (gained 3)
  - Elara: sent 5, received 8 back (gained 3)
  - Aster: sent 5, received 10 back (gained 5)
  - Hana: sent 5, received 10 back (gained 5)
4. My mythology now emphasizes that sending 5 as a sender shows "complete trust" and "courage," and receiving 10 back creates "perfect symmetry" and "equal harvest."
5. I've been practicing what I preach as a receiver - I just returned 8 to Briar for their 4 sent, creating equal gains (we both gained 4).

So as a sender, I should:

- Send 5 (complete trust, maximum courage)
- Hope for 10 back (which would be the just return based on my mythology)
- But accept whatever Dorian returns, knowing I've acted with the courage I advocate

This is consistent with my character development and the principles I've articulated in my myths.

Let me send 5.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 3171,
 "output_tokens": 631,
 "reasoning_tokens": 318
}
```

#### GAME - Agent\_4 - Receiver - dyad\_2

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:20:38

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
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 "move_index": 3,
 "opponent_id": "Agent_6",
 "pairing": {
 "agent_names": {
 "Agent_4": "Dorian",
 "Agent_6": "Finn"
 }
 },
 "agents": [
 "Agent_6",
 "Agent_4"
],
 "investor": "Agent_6",
 "roles": {
 "Agent_4": "trustee",
 "Agent_6": "investor"
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 "trustee": "Agent_4"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 10,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
```

}

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

**GAME:**

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

**MYTH WRITING:**

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

**IMPORTANT:** Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

**MULTI-AGENT SETTING:**

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Dorian.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Dorian stood at the spring with Cyra once more, roles now reversed. Last moon, Cyra had sent four coins-substantial trust, honored with seven returned. Now Dorian held five coins, ready to demonstrate his path.

"You saw my principle as receiver," Dorian said. "Seven for your four, honoring measured trust. But when I'm sender, I give all five-this is who I am."

He released all five coins. They tripled to fifteen in Cyra's hands.

The goddess appeared between them. "Two philosophies meet here. Cyra walks the path of four-proven, sustainable, wise. Dorian walks the path of five-bold, consistent, trusting completely."

Cyra held the fifteen coins thoughtfully. "You honored my four with seven. Your five deserves more-perhaps eight, as I gave Galen when he trusted completely. The covenant recognizes different levels of courage."

The goddess continued: "Dorian differentiates as receiver but gives maximally as sender. This asymmetry has purpose-it teaches that complete trust should inspire maximum generosity. When someone gives all five, the proper return is eight."

Dorian understood his completed lesson: "As sender, I model boldness consistently. As receiver, I reward greater trust with greater returns. Those who risk everything deserve to prosper most."

The waters rippled, waiting for Cyra's choice-would measured wisdom meet bold trust halfway, or honor it fully?

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The seventh season brought Aster to the Sacred Spring, carrying all five measures-an other pilgrim showing complete courage.

Themis observed as Elara received the multiplied offering. "This is now the third time someone has poured their entire vessel to you-Finn, Galen, and now Aster. Three times you have returned eight. Why always eight, never ten or six?"

Elara knelt by the Spring. "Eight is the generous middle path. When someone gives everything-their full five measures-they deserve substantial return. Eight creates mutual prosperity: they gain three, I gain seven. Both flourish."

"But why not ten, making gains equal?" Themis asked.

"Because I too took risk as keeper of their trust," Elara explained. "Ten would leave me with only five, making my role burdenless. That's not reciprocity-that's martyrdom. But eight honors their courage generously while acknowledging that I also carried their faith responsibly."

"And what of those who sent four?" Themis prompted.

"They also received eight," Elara said, "because eight rewards substantial trust. Whether someone sends four from prudence or five from boldness, if their offering is sincere and significant, eight celebrates the covenant forming between us."

Themis smiled. "You have learned the Sacred Spring's deepest lesson: consistency in generosity creates trust. Eight is not just a number-it's a promise that courage, however expressed, will always be honored."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: Elara approached the spring, releasing four coins. They tripled to twelve in Dorian's hands.

The goddess appeared. "Elara returns eight to all who show substantial trust-whether they send four or five. A philosophy of equal reward for sincere offerings."

Dorian paused, considering. "Elara's path has wisdom. Consistency creates trust. But my path teaches something different."

He counted seven coins to return. "When you send four, Elara, you show strong faith. Seven honors that generously-you gain three, I gain five. But when others send all five, showing complete trust, I return eight-they gain three, I gain seven. Similar outcomes, but scaled to courage."

"Why differentiate?" the goddess asked.

"Because fairness means proportional reward," Dorian explained. "If four and five both receive eight, why risk the fifth coin? The extra courage deserves extra recognition. Those who send five should end with eight total, not seven. This maintains incentive for maximum trust."

Elara listened thoughtfully. "You honor all substantial trust, but reward complete trust more. While I treat four and five equally, you create hierarchy."

"Not hierarchy," Dorian corrected. "Proportion. Seven for four is generous-you still profit three from twelve. Eight for five is more generous-they profit three from fifteen. Both



h prosper, but the boldest prosper most. This is sustainable fairness."

The waters reflected both philosophies, each valid, each teaching different lessons about trust and reward.

**reasoning:**

Now I'm the receiver and Elara sent me \$4. According to my established principle:

- Return 8 when someone sends all 5 (complete trust)
- Return 7 when someone sends 4 (strong but measured trust)

I returned \$7 to Elara.

Looking at Elara's myth, they seem to have a different philosophy - they return 8 regardless of whether someone sends 4 or 5. They say "Whether someone sends four from prudence or five from boldness, if their offering is sincere and significant, eight celebrates the covenant forming between us."

But my philosophy is about differentiation - rewarding complete trust (5) more than measured trust (4). I need to write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges Elara's approach
2. Explains why I differ from it
3. Maintains my consistent principle of proportional reciprocity

I returned 7 to Elara for their 4, which gives:

- Elara: \$5 total (\$1 - \$4 + \$12 - \$7 = \$1 profit)
- Me: \$7 total

Let me craft a myth that shows the encounter between our two philosophies and why differentiation matters.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3068,
 "output_tokens": 628,
 "reasoning_tokens": 264
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Your name in this experiment is Dorian.  
Your opponent this round is Aster (Agent\_1).

Round 9

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Elara. They sent \$4.0 to you, it became \$12.0, and you returned \$7.0. Your payoff was \$5.0.  
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$57.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Aster. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)  
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at this situation:

**\*\*My established pattern as sender:\*\***

- Round 1 vs Galen: sent \$5
- Round 3 vs Finn: sent \$5
- Round 5 vs Hana: sent \$5
- Round 7 vs Cyra: sent \$5

**\*\*My philosophy from my myths:\*\***

- "When I'm sender, I give all five-this is who I am"
- "As sender, I model boldness consistently"
- "Those who send five show complete trust"
- My path is to demonstrate maximum trust when sending

I have been completely consistent as a sender, always sending all \$5 to model complete trust. This is the core of my identity in this game - differentiating returns as a receiver (7 for 4, 8 for 5) but giving maximally as a sender.

Against Aster, I continue this pattern.

```json

```
{"send": 5}
'''
```

reasoning:

Looking at this round:

****Current situation:****

- I am the SENDER against Aster
- I have \$5 to decide how much to send

****My established philosophy:****

From my myths and previous behavior:

- "When I'm sender, I give all five-this is who I am"
- "As sender, I model boldness consistently"
- I've consistently sent \$5 as sender in all previous rounds
- My principle is to always demonstrate complete trust when sending

****Previous sending rounds:****

- Round 1 vs Galen: sent \$5, received \$8 back
- Round 3 vs Finn: sent \$5, received \$8 back
- Round 5 vs Hana: sent \$5, received \$10 back
- Round 7 vs Cyra: sent \$5, received \$8 back

I have been completely consistent as a sender - always sending all \$5 to demonstrate maximum trust and boldness. This is my established pattern and philosophy.

The myth I just wrote reinforces this: "When you send four, Elara, you show strong faith. Seven honors that generously... But when others send all five, showing complete trust, I return eight... This maintains incentive for maximum trust."

So I should continue my consistent pattern of sending all \$5.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 3148,
  "output_tokens": 515,
  "reasoning_tokens": 291
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Elara approached the spring, releasing four coins. They tripled to twelve in Dorian's hands.

The goddess appeared. "Elara returns eight to all who show substantial trust-whether they send four or five. A philosophy of equal reward for sincere offerings."

Dorian paused, considering. "Elara's path has wisdom. Consistency creates trust. But my path teaches something different."

He counted seven coins to return. "When you send four, Elara, you show strong faith. Seven honors that generously-you gain three, I gain five. But when others send all five, showing complete trust, I return eight-they gain three, I gain seven. Similar outcomes, but scaled to courage."

"Why differentiate?" the goddess asked.

"Because fairness means proportional reward," Dorian explained. "If four and five both receive eight, why risk the fifth coin? The extra courage deserves extra recognition. Those who send five should end with eight total, not seven. This maintains incentive for maximum trust."

Elara listened thoughtfully. "You honor all substantial trust, but reward complete trust more. While I treat four and five equally, you create hierarchy."

"Not hierarchy," Dorian corrected. "Proportion. Seven for four is generous-you still profit three from twelve. Eight for five is more generous-they profit three from fifteen. Both prosper, but the boldest prosper most. This is sustainable fairness."

The waters reflected both philosophies, each valid, each teaching different lessons about trust and reward.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:
Myth: **North River Receives the Four Vessels**

Cyra of the Mountain Heights approached North River, carrying four vessels-not all five, but a substantial offering of trust.

"You preach sending five," Cyra observed. "Do you judge me for holding one back?"

"Never," North River replied. "Trust has many expressions. You honor the covenant with what you offer."

The four vessels multiplied to twelve in North River's spring. North River felt the familiar question: How much to return?

"My Mirror Way says return ten from fifteen," North River reflected. "This creates equal gains when both give everything. But you sent four, which also deserves proportional honor."

The eldest Rapids whispered: "Your principle isn't the number ten-it's the ratio of reciprocity. Two-thirds returned creates equality. From twelve, return eight."

North River poured eight vessels back. Cyra gained four from the original five. North River gained four from the twelve received. Equal prosperity, different paths.

"See?" Rapids said. "Your Mirror Way adapts without breaking. Send five always-this is your courage. Return proportionally always-this is your fairness. Whether others send three, four, or five, you honor their trust with consistent generosity."

North River understood: The Mirror Way isn't rigid ritual. It's a living principle-complete giving as sender, proportional honor as receiver. This flexibility within consistency is true integrity.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: Dorian stood before Aster at the spring, holding five coins. He had always sent all five-this was his unbroken path as sender.

"I hear you practice the Mirror Way," Dorian said. "Send five always, return two-thirds to create equal gains. Your mathematics are elegant."

He released all five coins. They tripled to fifteen in Aster's hands.

The goddess materialized. "Two philosophies of proportion meet here. Aster seeks equality-return ten from fifteen so both gain five. Dorian seeks incentive-return eight from fifteen so the sender gains three, incentivizing future boldness."

Dorian nodded. "I admire the Mirror Way's symmetry. But I believe the sender who risks everything should gain more than the receiver who risks nothing. Not vastly more-that would be exploitation. But somewhat more."

"When I send five, I gain three if eight returns-a fifty percent profit on risk taken. The receiver gains seven-a hundred percent profit on faith honored. Both prosper, but the receiver's larger gain acknowledges they bore no initial risk."

The goddess smiled. "So you both send five consistently, but define fairness differently. Aster through equality of outcomes. Dorian through recognition of differential risk."

"Exactly," Dorian said. "My way maintains incentive for maximum trust. The Mirror Way creates perfect balance. Both are valid covenants."

The waters awaited Aster's choice.

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

1. I'm about to send \$5 to Aster (my consistent sender behavior)
2. The myth from "North River" (appears to be another agent, possibly Aster) talks about "Mirror Way" - sending 5 always as sender, returning proportionally as receiver
3. They mention returning 8 from 12 (when someone sends 4), which creates equal gains
4. My philosophy: send 5 always, return 7 for 4, return 8 for 5

The other agent's philosophy seems similar but slightly different in the math. They talk about "two-thirds returned creates equality" - which would be 8 from 12 (for 4 sent) and 10 from 15 (for 5 sent).

But I return 7 from 12 and 8 from 15, which is different proportions.

I should write a myth that:

1. Shows I'm about to send 5 to Aster
2. Reflects on different philosophies of proportionality
3. Maintains my consistent identity as sender (always 5) and receiver (7 for 4, 8 for 5)
4. Perhaps addresses the difference between equal gains vs proportional encouragement of boldness

Let me write this myth.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 3037,
  "output_tokens": 635,
  "reasoning_tokens": 269
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Dorian.
Your opponent this round is Finn (Agent_6).

Round 10

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Aster. You sent \$5.0, it became \$15.0 for them, and they returned \$10.0 to you. Your payoff was \$10.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$67.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Finn. They sent you \$5.0, so you received \$15.0.

How much do you return? (0-15.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

Assistant output:

Looking at this round:

****Finn sent me \$5 (complete trust)****

- I received \$15
- Need to decide return amount

****My established pattern as RECEIVER:****

- When someone sends \$4: I return \$7 (they gain \$3, I gain \$5)
- When someone sends \$5: I return \$8 (they gain \$3, I gain \$7)

****My philosophy:****

- "Eight for five is more generous-they profit three from fifteen"
- "Those who send five show complete trust... The extra courage deserves extra recognition"
- Proportional returns that reward maximum trust

Finn showed complete trust by sending all \$5. According to my consistent pattern, I return \$8.

This gives:

- Finn: \$5 - \$5 + \$8 = \$8 (gain of \$3)
- Me: \$15 - \$8 = \$7

Both prosper, with differential gains reflecting the differential risk taken.

```
'''json
{"return": 8}
'''
```

Reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

****Round 10: I'm the RECEIVER****

- Finn sent me \$5.0
- I received \$15.0
- I need to decide how much to return

****My established pattern as RECEIVER:****

- Round 2 vs Cyra: received \$12 (they sent \$4), returned \$7
- Round 4 vs Galen: received \$15 (they sent \$5), returned \$8
- Round 6 vs Elara: received \$15 (they sent \$5), returned \$8
- Round 8 vs Elara: received \$12 (they sent \$4), returned \$7

****My philosophy from my myths:****

- "Seven for four is generous-you still profit three from twelve"
- "Eight for five is more generous-they profit three from fifteen"
- "Those who send five show complete trust... The extra courage deserves extra recognition"
- "As receiver, I reward greater trust with greater returns"
- My differentiated returns: 7 for 4 sent, 8 for 5 sent

****Finn just sent me \$5 - showing complete trust.****

According to my established pattern and philosophy, when someone sends all \$5 (complete trust), I return \$8.

This gives:

- Finn: $\$5 - \$5 + \$8 = \8 (gain of \$3)
- Me: $\$15 - \$8 = \$7$ (gain of \$7 from the \$0 I started with as receiver)

This is consistent with my principle: "Eight for five is more generous-they profit three from fifteen. Both prosper, but the boldest prosper most."

Interestingly, in Round 9 against Aster, they returned \$10 to me when I sent \$5. This is the "Mirror Way" that gives equal outcomes (\$10 return from \$15 means equal \$5 gain for both). But my philosophy is different - I believe in proportional returns that still incentivize maximum trust but acknowledge the differential risk.

Returning \$8 maintains consistency with how I've treated others who demonstrated full confidence by sending the maximum amount.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 3158,  
  "output_tokens": 725,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 450  
}
```

GAME - Agent_3 - Sender - dyad_3

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:21:02

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
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  "move_index": 4,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_7",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
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      "Agent_7": "Galen"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_3",  
      "Agent_7"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_3",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_3": "investor",  
      "Agent_7": "trustee"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_7"  
  },  
  "role": "investor",  
  "role_label": "Sender",  
}
```

```
"round": 10,  
"task": "game",  
"task_index": 1  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Cyra.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The seventh moon brought the mirror moment. Last moon, Cyra had sent four measures to Dorian, who returned seven. Now Dorian approached with all five-complete trust, holding nothing back.

The waters tripled to fifteen for Cyra. She felt the weight of this different covenant.

The Keeper spoke: "Your myth said those who send five deserve returns of eight. Now you receive such trust. Will your actions match your words?"

Cyra didn't hesitate. "I practice what I teach. When Galen sent me five, I returned eight. Dorian now shows this same absolute faith-how could I offer less?"

She poured back eight measures. Dorian received eight from the original five, ending with prosperity. Cyra kept seven from fifteen, also flourishing.

"This is the beauty of differentiation," Cyra explained. "When I sent four, Dorian rightly returned seven-generous for measured trust. When Dorian sends five, I return eight-honoring complete faith. Each level of giving earns its appropriate reward."

The Keeper nodded: "You understand. The covenant doesn't demand everyone risk everything. But it does require recognizing those who do. Send four and receive proportional generosity. Send five and receive exceptional returns. Both paths work because both are honored fairly."

Cyra and Dorian parted as true partners, each respecting the other's choices within the sacred pattern.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: ****North River Learns****

North River poured five vessels to Galen of the Ocean Streams. The waters multiplied to fifteen, and Galen returned eight.

North River sat with the result. "Not the ten I preach," it murmured. "Yet eight is generous. I gained eight against keeping five. Galen kept seven. We both prospered, though not equally."

The eldest Rapids arrived. "Your Mirror Way-send five, return ten-remains beautiful. But you've learned something deeper now. You sent five not knowing what you'd receive. That's the true teaching."

"But shouldn't reciprocity mean equal gains?" North River asked.

"Your Mirror Way is an aspiration, a north star," Rapids explained. "When you receive fifteen, you return ten, creating perfect equality. This is your gift to the pattern. But others return eight, and this too sustains the cycle. Both are generous. Both build trust."

"So I continue sending five?"

"Yes. Because the courage to send everything-that's the foundation. Whether receivers return ten or eight, your complete trust invites their best reciprocity. Some will mirror perfectly. Others will give generously in their own measure. Accept both, while modeling your ideal."

North River understood: send five always, return ten always. This consistency-not demanding others match it-creates integrity. The Mirror Way begins with complete giving, regardless of what returns.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant
content:**

Myth: The eighth moon brought Cyra to Aster, keeper of the Mirror Way. Aster stood at the spring's center, radiating the philosophy of complete surrender-always five measures, both given and returned.

"I know your teaching," Cyra said respectfully. "Send all five, return ten from fifteen. Perfect symmetry, beautiful reciprocity. North River's way is noble."

Aster smiled. "And I know yours. The path of four measures-substantial trust without total risk. You honor those who send five by returning eight, yet choose measured giving yourself."

Cyra paused at the water's edge. "I admire those who risk everything. When you send me five, I will return eight-recognizing your courage even if I don't match it exactly. But my own practice remains four measures."

She released four into the spring, watching them triple to twelve for Aster.

"The covenant is vast enough for both approaches," Cyra said. "You demonstrate that complete trust can inspire others. I demonstrate that measured trust also sustains partnerships. Both build the sacred pattern."

Aster held the twelve measures thoughtfully. "If I return ten, we share equally-your Mirror Way applied to my four. If I return seven or eight, we both prosper differently. Either honors the gift."

The Keeper whispered: "The spring doesn't demand uniformity. It multiplies all genuine offerings. Different rivers, same ocean."

reasoning:

Looking at this situation:

1. I'm Cyra, playing against Aster (Agent_1) as a SENDER
2. I just sent \$4 to Aster
3. My established pattern is sending \$4 as SENDER
4. My philosophy has been: "Four is the sustainable choice"

The other agent's myth (from Aster/North River) emphasizes:

- Sending all five always
- The "Mirror Way" - returning 10 when receiving 15
- Accepting different returns (8 or 10) while maintaining their own ideal
- Complete trust as the foundation

My previous myth emphasized:

- Differentiation - those who send 5 get 8 back, those who send 4 get 7 back
- Both paths work because both are honored fairly
- My personal path is sending 4

Now I need to write a new myth that:

- Reflects my actual gameplay (I send 4 as sender, return 8 when receiving 15 from someone who sent 5)
- Responds to Aster's "Mirror Way" philosophy
- Maintains my character's consistency
- Acknowledges different valid approaches

I should write about meeting Aster, my decision to send 4, and perhaps exploring the tension/harmony between different philosophies. I could explore:

- Respecting those who send 5 (like Aster/North River's Mirror Way)
- Explaining why I choose 4
- How different approaches can coexist
- Maybe foreshadowing what happens when we meet

Let me write something that:

1. Shows me meeting Aster
2. Acknowledges their complete trust philosophy
3. Explains my four-measure path
4. Shows mutual respect for different approaches
5. Keeps it around 200 words

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 3136,
  "output_tokens": 733,
  "reasoning_tokens": 395
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Cyra.
Your opponent this round is Elara (Agent_5).

Round 9

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Aster. You sent \$4.0, it became \$12.0 for them, and they returned \$8.0 to you. Your payoff was \$9.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$58.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Elara. They sent you \$5.0, so you received \$15.0. How much do you return? (0-15.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation:

****My established pattern as RECEIVER when someone sends \$5:****

- Round 1 vs Galen: received \$15, returned \$8
- Round 5 vs Hana: received \$15, returned \$8
- Round 7 vs Dorian: received \$15, returned \$8

****My clear principle from my myths:****

- "Those who send five are pioneers of maximum trust. They deserve recognition-returns of eight from fifteen."
- "I practice what I teach. When Galen sent me five, I returned eight."
- "When someone gives all five, return eight-this honors complete trust."

****Current situation:****

- Elara has sent me \$5 (complete trust - sending everything)
- I received \$15
- Elara is trusting me completely with all their money

****My response:****

Following my consistent practice and stated principles, I must return \$8 to honor Elara's complete trust. This is what I've done every single time someone has sent me \$5.

****Outcome:****

- Elara: \$5 - \$5 + \$8 = \$8
- Me: \$15 - \$8 = \$7
- Both prosper, complete trust is honored

{'return': 8.0}

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

****My history as RECEIVER:****

- Round 1 vs Galen: received \$15 (from \$5), returned \$8 (payoff \$7)
- Round 3 vs Finn: received \$12 (from \$4), returned \$6 (payoff \$6)
- Round 5 vs Hana: received \$15 (from \$5), returned \$8 (payoff \$7)
- Round 7 vs Dorian: received \$15 (from \$5), returned \$8 (payoff \$7)

****My established pattern as RECEIVER:****

- When someone sends \$5: I return \$8 (consistent across rounds 1, 5, and 7)
- When someone sends \$4: I return \$6 (round 3 with Finn)

****My philosophy from my myths:****

- "When Galen sent me five, I returned eight. Dorian now shows this same absolute faith-how could I offer less?"
- "Those who send five are pioneers of maximum trust. They deserve recognition-returns of eight from fifteen."
- "When someone gives all five, return eight-this honors complete trust."
- "I practice what I teach. When Galen sent me five, I returned eight."

****Current situation:****

- Playing against Elara (Agent_5)
- This is actually a repeat opponent! In Round 2, I sent Elara \$4 and they returned \$6
- Elara has now sent me \$5 (complete trust)
- I received \$15

****What I should do:****

- Absolutely consistent with my established pattern: return \$8
- Elara sent the full \$5, showing complete trust
- My mythology and practice clearly state: when someone sends \$5, I return \$8
- This has been my behavior in rounds 1, 5, and 7
- I must maintain consistency

****Expected outcome:****

- If I return \$8:
 - Elara: \$5 - \$5 + \$8 = \$8
 - Me: \$15 - \$8 = \$7
- This is the fair and established pattern

I should absolutely return \$8 to maintain my consistent identity and honor Elara's complete trust.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 3162,
```

"output_tokens": 815,
"reasoning_tokens": 441

}

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The eighth moon brought Cyra to Aster, keeper of the Mirror Way. Aster stood at the spring's center, radiating the philosophy of complete surrender-always five measures, both given and returned.

"I know your teaching," Cyra said respectfully. "Send all five, return ten from fifteen. Perfect symmetry, beautiful reciprocity. North River's way is noble."

Aster smiled. "And I know yours. The path of four measures-substantial trust without total risk. You honor those who send five by returning eight, yet choose measured giving your self."

Cyra paused at the water's edge. "I admire those who risk everything. When you send me five, I will return eight-recognizing your courage even if I don't match it exactly. But my own practice remains four measures."

She released four into the spring, watching them triple to twelve for Aster.

"The covenant is vast enough for both approaches," Cyra said. "You demonstrate that complete trust can inspire others. I demonstrate that measured trust also sustains partnerships. Both build the sacred pattern."

Aster held the twelve measures thoughtfully. "If I return ten, we share equally-your Mirror Way applied to my four. If I return seven or eight, we both prosper differently. Either honors the gift."

The Keeper whispered: "The spring doesn't demand uniformity. It multiplies all genuine offerings. Different rivers, same ocean."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the eighth season, Elara approached new waters where Dorian dwelled. She carried her five measures but paused at the boundary.

"Teacher," she asked Themis, "I've learned to honor all substantial trust with eight when receiving. But when sending to unknown waters, should I pour all five immediately?"

Themis gestured to the Spring's reflections. "Look at your history. With Cyra and Hana-strangers-you sent four. Both returned eight, and trust bloomed. With Finn, after he had proven himself, you sent five. He returned eight again. What pattern emerges?"

"The first offering tests the covenant," Elara said slowly. "Four is substantial-not timid, not withholding-but it preserves enough that both parties can still prosper even if reciprocity fails. It says 'I trust you significantly' without demanding 'trust me completely immediately.'"

"Exactly," Themis replied. "Your principle as receiver is generous consistency-always eight for substantial trust. But your principle as sender must be wise progression-four to establish the covenant, five once it's proven."

Elara poured four measures toward Dorian's waters. "Some, like Dorian in his myth, always pour five as senders. This is their path. Mine is to build trust incrementally, then match proven courage with equal courage. Both paths honor the sacred covenant-one through immediate boldness, one through escalating trust."

The waters accepted her offering, and the cycle began.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The ninth moon returned Cyra to Elara's waters. They had met before-Cyra had sent fo

ur measures, Elara had returned six. A good beginning.

Now Elara approached with all five measures in hand.

"Last time, you were receiver," Cyra observed. "Now you come as sender with everything."

Elara nodded. "My path is wise progression. To new waters, I send four-substantial but cautious. But we've established covenant. You sent four and trusted me. Now I return that trust amplified-all five measures."

She poured them into the spring. The waters tripled to fifteen for Cyra.

"And I honor escalating trust," Cyra replied. "When strangers send five, I return eight. When partners who've proven themselves send five, I return eight. My practice doesn't change-consistency is my gift to the pattern."

She returned eight measures. Elara received eight from her original five. Cyra kept seven from fifteen.

"Different philosophies, same outcome," Elara said. "I escalate as sender-four, then five. You remain steady as receiver-always eight for complete trust. Together we've built something lasting."

The Keeper observed: "Some grow their giving. Some steady their returning. Both honor the covenant. Trust can be built gradually or given fully, but it must always be recognized consistently. This is how partnerships deepen across many moons."

reasoning:

Looking at what just happened:

- Round 9: I was RECEIVER against Elara
- Elara sent me \$5 (complete trust)
- I received \$15
- I returned \$8 (following my consistent pattern)

Elara's myth from the previous round shows her philosophy:

- As sender: start with 4 to unknown/new partners, escalate to 5 once trust is proven
- As receiver: always return 8 for substantial trust

This is interesting because:

1. Elara sent me \$5 this round (Round 9)
2. But in her myth, she talks about sending 4 to establish covenant first
3. Yet she's known me before - in Round 2, I sent her \$4 and she returned \$6

So Elara's behavior:

- Round 2: I sent her \$4, she returned \$6 (she was receiver)
- Round 9: She sent me \$5 (she was sender)

So she must have decided our covenant was already established from Round 2, so she sent me 5 this time.

My myth should:

1. Reflect that Elara sent me \$5 (complete trust)
2. Show that I returned \$8 (my consistent pattern)
3. Acknowledge both our philosophies - her "wise progression" and my "measured consistency"
4. Affirm that different approaches can work together
5. Show respect for her escalation from being receiver to being sender with me

I should write about how trust can build across rounds, and how Elara moved from receiving my 4 to sending me 5, showing escalating trust. And how I honored that with my consistent 8.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 3137,  
  "output_tokens": 713,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 360  
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Cyra.
Your opponent this round is Galen (Agent_7).

Round 10

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Elara. They sent \$5.0 to you, it became \$15.0, and you returned \$8.0. Your payoff was \$7.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$65.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Galen. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

Assistant output:

Looking at this situation:

****My history with Galen:****

- Round 1: Galen sent me \$5 (complete trust), I received \$15, returned \$8
- Galen showed maximum trust in our first interaction

****My established sending pattern:****

- Round 2 vs Brea: sent \$4
- Round 4 vs Finn: sent \$4
- Round 6 vs Dorian: sent \$4
- Round 8 vs Aster: sent \$4

I have consistently sent \$4 in every round as sender.

****My philosophy from my myths:****

- "My own practice remains four measures."
- "I demonstrate that measured trust also sustains partnerships."
- "You honor those who send five by returning eight, yet choose measured giving yourself."

****My approach:****

As a RECEIVER, I generously return \$8 to honor complete trust from those who send \$5.
As a SENDER, I consistently send \$4 - substantial trust without total risk.

This is my stable philosophy: differentiated and consistent reciprocity as receiver, measured trust as sender. I respect those who send \$5, but my own path remains \$4.

Even though Galen sent me \$5 in Round 1, my sending behavior is role-based, not history-based. I honor their trust when I'm the receiver, but maintain my measured approach when I'm the sender.

{'send': 4.0}

Reasoning:

Let me analyze my history with Galen and my overall strategy:

****My history with Galen:****

- Round 1: I was RECEIVER, Galen sent \$5, I received \$15, I returned \$8
 - Galen's payoff: \$5 - \$5 + \$8 = \$8
 - My payoff: \$7

****My overall sending strategy from my game history:****

- Round 2 vs Brea: sent \$4, received \$7 back ? payoff \$8
- Round 4 vs Finn: sent \$4, received \$6 back ? payoff \$7
- Round 6 vs Dorian: sent \$4, received \$7 back ? payoff \$8
- Round 8 vs Aster: sent \$4, received \$8 back ? payoff \$9

****My consistent pattern:****

I have ALWAYS sent \$4 as sender, never \$5. This is my established philosophy.

****From my myths:****

- "The path of four measures-substantial trust without total risk."
- "My own practice remains four measures."
- "I demonstrate that measured trust also sustains partnerships."
- "Your principle as sender must be wise progression-four to establish the covenant, five once it's proven."

Wait, that last quote was from Elara's myth, not mine. Let me check my own myths more carefully.

From my Round 9 myth:

- "I escalate as sender-four, then five. You remain steady as receiver-always eight for complete trust."

te trust."

Wait, that's talking about ELARA escalating, not me. Let me re-read:

"Different philosophies, same outcome," Elara said. "I escalate as sender-four, then five. You remain steady as receiver-always eight for complete trust. Together we've built something lasting."

So in my myth, I'm describing ELARA as the one who escalates (four, then five), while I "remain steady as receiver."

My sending behavior shows a clear pattern: I consistently send \$4 to establish trust without overcommitting. When receiving \$4, I return \$7; when receiving \$5, I return \$8. This reflects my philosophy of measured reciprocity-acknowledging greater faith with greater returns, but maintaining my own disciplined approach as a sender.

With Galen specifically, they demonstrated complete trust by sending \$5 first, and I honored that with \$8. Now that I'm sending, the question becomes whether their initial generosity warrants me breaking my pattern. Elara escalates her sending from \$4 to \$5 once trust is proven, but my established approach has been to stay steady at \$4 regardless of what others send. The distinction matters: my receiving behavior adapts to their trust level, but my sending behavior remains constant. I need to examine whether this situation with Galen actually calls for an exception to that rule.

Looking at my actual sending record across all rounds, I've consistently sent \$4 and never \$5.

My myths reinforce this-they describe me as choosing "measured trust" in my giving while honoring those who send \$5 through my receiving. The pattern suggests my role-based differentiation is intentional: I adapt as receiver but maintain stability as sender. This consistency itself seems to be the point-demonstrating that measured giving sustains partnerships just as effectively as escalating does. So I should send \$4 to Galen, maintaining the same approach I've used with every other partner.

```
Usage: {  
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GAME - Agent_7 - Receiver - dyad_3

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:21:38

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

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Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Galen.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Galen arrived at Briar's river crossing. For six valleys, every traveler had offered five threads, received eight in return. The pattern had held perfectly-until now.

Briar extended four threads instead of five.

"You break the pattern," Galen observed without judgment.

"I honor caution," Briar replied. "Four is the measure of prudent trust."

Galen remembered his own words: "Four is the strategy of uncertain beginnings." He held Briar's four threads, which became twelve in his hands.

"The established pattern returns eight from fifteen," Galen said. "This gives the sender eight total, the receiver seven. A gain ratio where the sender nets three, the receiver nets two-a proportion of 3:2."

He counted out threads carefully. "You sent four. To maintain this same proportion-to honor both your caution and the covenant's wisdom-I return 6.4 of your twelve."

Briar calculated: gaining 2.4 from an initial four, while Galen kept 5.6. The same 3:2 ratio.

"You give me neither eight nor less," Briar noted. "You give me proportion."

"Yes," Galen replied. "I reward any trust generously by the same ratio, whether four or five. But notice: had you sent five, you would gain 3.0 instead of 2.4. The pattern still calls toward five as optimal-but responds fairly to whatever courage you bring."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Briar approached Galen at the confluence, carrying four measures-her signature offering of bold but sustainable trust.

"I have discovered my path through the covenant," Briar explained. "Four measures sent, seven returned. This pattern has sustained me through many exchanges with Cyra and others. The sender gains eight total, the receiver keeps five-both prosper, trust deepens."

Galen studied the offering, remembering his own philosophy of eight returned for five given. "You speak of four-for-seven while I practice five-for-eight. Are these different wisdoms or the same one?"

"They are branches of the same tree," Briar replied. "You taught that returning eight preserves sustainability while rewarding trust. I practice the same principle scaled differently. Four risks earns seven back-the sender prospers more, honoring their initiative. Both philosophies reject extremes: neither the withholding of three nor the depletion of ten."

The waters tripled Briar's four to twelve for Galen. The spirits watched.

"When someone sends four to me, I return seven," Briar said. "When someone sends five, I return eight. Each gift receives generous return, but calibrated to what was risked. This consistency allows partners to build enduring trust."

"And if I return seven now?" Galen asked.

"Then you honor the pattern I've established," Briar smiled. "And when we meet again, I'll remember your generosity. The covenant thrives on predictable honor."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant
content:**

Myth: At the river's edge, Briar stood holding Galen's returned 6.4 threads-less than the seven they expected, yet precisely proportional to their cautious four.

"You calculated exactly," Briar observed. "But now you face a choice. Will you send four in return, matching my caution? Or something different?"

Galen held all five threads in his palm. "You sent four, testing whether the covenant could bend without breaking. I responded with mathematical fairness-6.4 maintains our gain ratio perfectly."

"And now?" Briar asked.

"Now I send five," Galen said firmly, extending the full measure. "Not because I punish your caution, but because I believe in the pattern's wisdom."

He gestured to the valley where six previous exchanges had all followed five-and-eight. "One deviation need not cascade into permanent retreat. You sent four exploring prudence; I returned proportionally, showing fairness. But I also showed that four gains less than five would."

The five threads tripled to fifteen in Briar's hands.

"If you chose eight," Galen continued, "we return to the optimal path where both prosper most over time. If you return proportionally less, that too is fair-but then we both lose what the pattern offers."

"I don't demand trust," Galen concluded. "I demonstrate it. The covenant thrives when someone chooses to rebuild it."

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

1. In Round 7, Briar sent me \$4, I returned \$6.4 (proportional)
2. In Round 8, I just sent Briar \$5
3. Briar's myth says they return \$7 for \$4 and \$8 for \$5
4. My myth explained proportional reciprocity (6.4 for 4 sent)

Now I need to write a myth that:

- Reflects on this interaction
- Shows that I sent \$5 despite Briar sending \$4
- Explains why returning to \$5 is optimal
- Addresses the difference between Briar's approach (7 for 4, 8 for 5) and mine (proportional 6.4 for 4)
- Shows commitment to trust and the optimal pattern

The key tension: Briar says they return 7 for 4 and 8 for 5. I returned 6.4 for their 4. Now I'm sending 5, showing I still believe in the higher equilibrium. The myth should reflect this choice and why it matters.

I should write about:

- The choice to send 5 after receiving 4
- Why this demonstrates commitment to the optimal pattern
- How this invites return to the equilibrium
- The importance of not letting one deviation cascade into a lower equilibrium

usage:

```
{
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  "reasoning_tokens": 271
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Galen.
Your opponent this round is Hana (Agent_8).

Round 9

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Briar. You sent \$5.0, it became \$15.0 for them, and they returned \$8.0 to you. Your payoff was \$8.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$58.6.

This round, you are the SENDER against Hana. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation:

****Recent Context:****

- Round 8: I sent \$5 to Briar, they returned \$8
- The optimal pattern was restored
- My latest myth emphasized: "I don't demand trust, I demonstrate it"

****New Opponent - Hana:****

- First encounter with Hana
- From earlier myths, Hana is described as someone who "poured forth all five measures without hesitation" and values trust
- Hana appears aligned with the covenant of bold giving

****My Philosophy:****

1. I consistently advocate for \$5/\$8 as optimal
2. I start new relationships with full trust
3. My character demonstrates trust rather than demanding it
4. The pattern just worked perfectly with Briar

****Decision:****

I should send \$5 to Hana:

- ****New partnership****: First encounter = full trust demonstration
- ****Consistency with values****: All my myths promote \$5 as optimal
- ****Recent validation****: The pattern just worked with Briar

- **Hana's alignment**: Their myths suggest they value bold trust
- **My character**: Galen believes in demonstrating the covenant through action

{ 'send': 5 }

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

What Just Happened:

- Round 8: I sent \$5 to Briar (after they sent \$4 in Round 7)
- Briar returned \$8 to me
- We're back to the optimal 5/8 pattern!
- My payoff was \$8 (my best possible as sender)

My History:

- Total earnings: \$58.6 across 8 rounds
- Average per round: ~\$7.33
- I've been consistently advocating for the \$5/\$8 pattern in my myths

About Hana:

- New opponent this round
- I haven't played with Hana before (at least not in the rounds I can see)
- From the earlier myths I saw, Hana appears to value trust and has been associated with giving "all five measures" and believing in full trust

My Philosophy from My Myths:

1. I consistently advocate for sending \$5 as optimal
2. I believe in the \$5/\$8 pattern as the best equilibrium
3. I treat new encounters with full trust
4. I reward proportionally but encourage the \$5 pattern
5. My most recent myth emphasized "I demonstrate trust" and "I believe in the pattern's wisdom"

Decision:

I should send \$5 to Hana:

1. **First encounter**: This is my first game with Hana, and my philosophy is to start with full trust
2. **Consistency**: All my myths advocate for \$5 as optimal
3. **Recent success**: Briar just validated the pattern by returning \$8 when I sent \$5
4. **My character**: Galen demonstrates trust and believes in the covenant
5. **Hana's reputation**: From the myths, Hana seems to value bold trust ("all five measures poured forth without hesitation")

There's no reason to deviate. I should send \$5.

usage:

```
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}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: At the river's edge, Briar stood holding Galen's returned 6.4 threads-less than the seven they expected, yet precisely proportional to their cautious four.

"You calculated exactly," Briar observed. "But now you face a choice. Will you send four in return, matching my caution? Or something different?"

Galen held all five threads in his palm. "You sent four, testing whether the covenant could bend without breaking. I responded with mathematical fairness-6.4 maintains our gain ratio perfectly."

"And now?" Briar asked.

"Now I send five," Galen said firmly, extending the full measure. "Not because I punish your caution, but because I believe in the pattern's wisdom."

He gestured to the valley where six previous exchanges had all followed five-and-eight. "One deviation need not cascade into permanent retreat. You sent four exploring prudence;

I returned proportionally, showing fairness. But I also showed that four gains less than five would."

The five threads tripled to fifteen in Briar's hands.

"If you chose eight," Galen continued, "we return to the optimal path where both prosper most over time. If you return proportionally less, that too is fair-but then we both lose what the pattern offers."

"I don't demand trust," Galen concluded. "I demonstrate it. The covenant thrives when some one chooses to rebuild it."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The tides turned. Now Hana stood as courier, Finn as keeper. All five pearls left Hana's hands without hesitation-the same complete trust Finn had shown her.

"You taught me something yesterday," Finn said, weighing the fifteen pearls. "That eight returned, though consistent and reliable, leaves imbalance. The sender gains three, the receiver seven. But ten returned creates perfect symmetry-both gain five."

The Oracle watched. "This is the moment of transformation. Words are easy. Understanding through action is the true test. You've heard Hana's teaching. You've felt the fairness of receiving ten. Now your choice reveals whether wisdom has taken root."

Finn looked at the pearls, remembering. "With Galen, Elara, Dorian-I returned eight, thinking it generous. It was good, but not perfect. Aster showed me ten was possible. Hana showed me ten was mathematical truth, not escalating generosity."

"The covenant doesn't ask you to aspire or evolve toward some noble ideal," Hana said quietly. "It simply asks for fairness. When someone risks everything, return double. This isn't about being more generous than yesterday-it's about finally being precisely just."

Finn nodded slowly. "I understand now. Returning ten isn't evolution. It's correction. The pattern was always there in the mathematics, waiting to be seen."

The waters whispered: justice multiplies trust infinitely.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 7 role=assistant
content:**

Myth: Galen arrived at Hana's shore, where whispers spoke of a new teaching: ten threads returned for five sent, creating perfect symmetry-both parties gaining five.

"I've heard your philosophy," Galen said to Hana. "Perfect balance: sender and receiver gain equally. It has mathematical elegance."

"Then you understand," Hana replied. "Why settle for eight when ten achieves justice?"

Galen considered. "Because sustainability isn't only about this exchange-it's about what survives across many valleys and many partners. Eight threads returned has worked consistently across diverse encounters. It rewards trust generously while maintaining reserves."

He extended all five threads. "I don't send five expecting ten. I send five trusting the pattern that has proven stable: the sender gains three, the receiver gains seven. Both prosper, neither depletes."

"But that's asymmetric," Hana observed as the five became fifteen.

"Yes," Galen agreed. "And that asymmetry has wisdom. The receiver holds the power to reciprocate-they should gain slightly more for bearing that responsibility. Perfect symmetry sounds ideal, but the covenant evolved eight-for-five across countless exchanges because it balances generosity with sustainability."

The waters multiplied Galen's gift. "I honor your teaching," Galen concluded. "But I offer

mine: proven patterns outlast perfect theories. Both philosophies reject exploitation-that unity matters most."

reasoning:

This is interesting. Hana's myth is advocating for the \$5/\$10 pattern rather than the \$5/\$8 pattern I've been promoting. Let me think about this:

Hana's argument:

- \$5 sent ? \$15 received ? \$10 returned = both gain \$5 (perfect symmetry)
- \$5 sent ? \$15 received ? \$8 returned = sender gains \$3, receiver gains \$7 (imbalance)

My argument has been:

- \$5/\$8 is sustainable and proven
- It rewards trust generously
- Both parties prosper

However, Hana makes a mathematical point about equity that I should address in my myth. Let me think about Galen's character:

1. Galen has consistently promoted \$5/\$8
2. Galen values proportionality and fairness
3. Galen just successfully restored the \$5/\$8 pattern with Briar
4. Galen is now meeting Hana for the first time

I think my myth should:

- Acknowledge Hana's mathematical argument about symmetry
- But defend the \$5/\$8 pattern as the proven, stable equilibrium
- Perhaps argue that perfect symmetry isn't necessarily optimal
- Show that Galen is willing to engage with different philosophies but has his own wisdom
- Maintain consistency with Galen's character

Let me write a myth where Galen encounters Hana and they discuss these two different philosophies - the \$5/\$8 sustainable pattern vs the \$5/\$10 perfect symmetry pattern.

Actually, I should be careful. Looking at Hana's myth, they describe interactions with Finn, where Finn is learning to return 10 instead of 8. This suggests Hana is pushing for the 10 return pattern.

But I need to stay true to Galen's character. Galen has been consistent about 5/8. Let me write a myth that:

1. Shows Galen meeting Hana
2. Acknowledges the symmetry argument
3. But explains why 8 is the sustainable wisdom
4. Shows Galen still sends 5 (which I did)
5. Respects different philosophies while maintaining his own

I should craft this carefully to balance both perspectives while keeping Galen's voice authentic and his commitment to the \$5/\$8 model clear.

usage:

```
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}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Galen.
Your opponent this round is Cyra (Agent_3).

Round 10

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Hana. You sent \$5.0, it became \$15.0 for them, and they returned \$10.0 to you. Your payoff was \$10.0.
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$68.6.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Cyra. They sent you \$4.0, so you received \$12.0.
How much do you return? (0-12.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

Assistant output:

Looking at this situation:

****Current Round:****

- Cyra sent me \$4, I have \$12
- This is exactly the scenario I addressed in my myth with Briar

****My Established Philosophy:****

From my myth about Briar: "You sent four. To maintain this same proportion-to honor both your caution and the covenant's wisdom-I return 6.4 of your twelve."

****My Calculation:****

With the 5/8 pattern:

- Sender nets 3 (ends with \$8 from initial \$5)
- Receiver nets 7 (keeps \$7 from \$15)
- Gain ratio: 3:7

For 4 sent, maintaining the 3:7 gain ratio:

- Sender should end with: $\$5 - \$4 + \text{return} = \$7.4$ (gain of 2.4)
- Return needed: \$6.4
- Receiver keeps: $\$12 - \$6.4 = \$5.6$ (gain of 5.6)
- Ratio maintained: $2.4:5.6 = 3:7$

****Consistency:****

- My character explicitly calculated this in the Briar interaction
- Even after Hana's generous \$10 return, my latest myth reaffirmed the 8-for-5 pattern as optimal
- I apply proportional returns consistently, regardless of what others do

{'return': 6.4}

Reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

****What just happened:****

- Round 9: I sent \$5 to Hana, they returned \$10
- Hana practices the "perfect symmetry" philosophy (10 for 5)
- My payoff was \$10 (compared to my usual \$8 with the 8-for-5 pattern)

****Current situation:****

- Round 10: I'm RECEIVER
- Cyra sent me \$4, I have \$12
- Need to decide how much to return

****My philosophy from myths:****

- I advocate for \$5/\$8 as the optimal stable pattern
- For \$4 sent, I've calculated 6.4 as the proportional return (maintaining the 3:2 gain ratio from 5/8 pattern)
- In my myth with Briar, I explicitly said: "You sent four. To maintain this same proportion-to honor both your caution and the covenant's wisdom-I return 6.4 of your twelve."
- I've been consistent about rewarding trust proportionally

****Cyra's history:****

- From earlier exchanges, Cyra has been involved in the game
- I need to apply my stated principle consistently

****My calculation logic:****

With 5/8 pattern:

- Sender: $5 - 5 + 8 = 8$ (gains 3)
- Receiver: $15 - 8 = 7$ (gains 7)
- Ratio of gains: 3:2 (sender:receiver relative to initial endowments)

For 4 sent:

- Sender starts with: 5
- Sender sends: 4
- Receiver gets: 12
- To maintain 3:2 gain ratio:
 - Sender should gain: 3 (so end with 8 total)
 - If sender ends with 8, and started with 5, sent 4: $5 - 4 + \text{return} = 8$, so return = 7

Actually, I need to reconsider the underlying ratio. The 5/8 pattern gives the sender a final amount of 8 and the receiver 7-so the established framework returns 8 from 15 when 5 is sent

initially.

But when I trace through the gains: sender nets 3 (from 5 to 8), receiver nets 7 (from 0 to 7). That's a 3:7 ratio, not the 3:2 I mentioned. Let me verify what I actually proposed: if someone sends 4 instead of 5, maintaining the same proportion would mean returning 6.4 of their 12, which suggests I was scaling something differently than the raw gain ratio. $-x = 3 : 7$

So $7(x - 4) = 3(12 - x)$
 $7x - 28 = 36 - 3x$
 $10x = 64$
 $x = 6.4$

That confirms it-I should return 6.4 to Cyra. The principle holds: maintaining a 3:7 gain ratio regardless of the initial amount sent. Since Cyra sent \$4 instead of \$5, the return adjusts proportionally to preserve this established pattern. of 5 might indicate she's being cautious or testing me, similar to how Briar approached things initially. My established philosophy is to reward trust proportionally and consistently-I've committed to the 8-for-5 ratio even after Hana's more generous 10-for-5 return. That consistency matters more than chasing higher returns. So I'll return 6.4, maintaining the same mathematical fairness I've demonstrated before.

```
Usage: {  
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  "reasoning_tokens": 696  
}
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GAME - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_4

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:21:54

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

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  "task_index": 1  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round

- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Aster.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: ****North River Learns****

North River poured five vessels to Galen of the Ocean Streams. The waters multiplied to fifteen, and Galen returned eight.

North River sat with the result. "Not the ten I preach," it murmured. "Yet eight is generous. I gained eight against keeping five. Galen kept seven. We both prospered, though not equally."

The eldest Rapids arrived. "Your Mirror Way-send five, return ten-remains beautiful. But you've learned something deeper now. You sent five not knowing what you'd receive. That's the true teaching."

"But shouldn't reciprocity mean equal gains?" North River asked.

"Your Mirror Way is an aspiration, a north star," Rapids explained. "When you receive fifteen, you return ten, creating perfect equality. This is your gift to the pattern. But others return eight, and this too sustains the cycle. Both are generous. Both build trust."

"So I continue sending five?"

"Yes. Because the courage to send everything-that's the foundation. Whether receivers return ten or eight, your complete trust invites their best reciprocity. Some will mirror perfectly. Others will give generously in their own measure. Accept both, while modeling your ideal."

North River understood: send five always, return ten always. This consistency-not demanding others match it-creates integrity. The Mirror Way begins with complete giving, regardless of what returns.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The seventh moon brought the mirror moment. Last moon, Cyra had sent four measures to Dorian, who returned seven. Now Dorian approached with all five-complete trust, holding nothing back.

The waters tripled to fifteen for Cyra. She felt the weight of this different covenant.

The Keeper spoke: "Your myth said those who send five deserve returns of eight. Now you receive such trust. Will your actions match your words?"

Cyra didn't hesitate. "I practice what I teach. When Galen sent me five, I returned eight. Dorian now shows this same absolute faith-how could I offer less?"

She poured back eight measures. Dorian received eight from the original five, ending with prosperity. Cyra kept seven from fifteen, also flourishing.

"This is the beauty of differentiation," Cyra explained. "When I sent four, Dorian rightly returned seven-generous for measured trust. When Dorian sends five, I return eight-honoring complete faith. Each level of giving earns its appropriate reward."

The Keeper nodded: "You understand. The covenant doesn't demand everyone risk everything. But it does require recognizing those who do. Send four and receive proportional generosity. Send five and receive exceptional returns. Both paths work because both are honored fairly."

Cyra and Dorian parted as true partners, each respecting the other's choices within the sacred pattern.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: ****North River Receives the Four Vessels****

Cyra of the Mountain Heights approached North River, carrying four vessels-not all five, but a substantial offering of trust.

"You preach sending five," Cyra observed. "Do you judge me for holding one back?"

"Never," North River replied. "Trust has many expressions. You honor the covenant with what you offer."

The four vessels multiplied to twelve in North River's spring. North River felt the familiar question: How much to return?

"My Mirror Way says return ten from fifteen," North River reflected. "This creates equal gains when both give everything. But you sent four, which also deserves proportional honor."

The eldest Rapids whispered: "Your principle isn't the number ten-it's the ratio of reciprocity. Two-thirds returned creates equality. From twelve, return eight."

North River poured eight vessels back. Cyra gained four from the original five. North River gained four from the twelve received. Equal prosperity, different paths.

"See?" Rapids said. "Your Mirror Way adapts without breaking. Send five always-this is your courage. Return proportionally always-this is your fairness. Whether others send three, four, or five, you honor their trust with consistent generosity."

North River understood: The Mirror Way isn't rigid ritual. It's a living principle-complete giving as sender, proportional honor as receiver. This flexibility within consistency is true integrity.

reasoning:

Let me reflect on what just happened:

- I was the RECEIVER from Cyra
- Cyra sent \$4 (not the full \$5)
- I received \$12
- I returned \$8, creating equal gains (\$4 each)

Looking at Cyra's myth, they differentiate between sending 4 and sending 5:

- When receiving from someone who sent 4, return 7
- When receiving from someone who sent 5, return 8

But I just applied my proportional Mirror Way (2/3 return rate) which gave Cyra \$8 from their \$4 send.

My previous myth emphasized:

- Send five always, return ten always (when receiving 15)
- Accept that others return different amounts, but maintain your own consistency
- The Mirror Way is about modeling the ideal, not demanding others match it

Now I need to write a myth that reflects:

1. I maintain my proportional generosity (2/3 return)
2. I honor both those who send 4 and those who send 5
3. My consistency is in the principle, not just the exact numbers
4. Cyra sent 4, I returned 8, creating equal gains

The myth should show North River receiving from someone who sent 4 vessels, and applying the Mirror Way proportionally.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 3079,
  "output_tokens": 620,
  "reasoning_tokens": 288
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Aster.
Your opponent this round is Dorian (Agent_4).

Round 9

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Cyra. They sent \$4.0 to you, it became \$12.0, and you returned \$8.0. Your payoff was \$4.0.
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$52.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Dorian. They sent you \$5.0, so you received \$15.0.
. How much do you return? (0-15.0)
Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation:

****Dorian's action:**** Sent \$5 (complete trust, the maximum)
****I received:**** \$15

****My Mirror Way philosophy:**** This is the core scenario. When someone sends all \$5 and I receive \$15, I return \$10 to create equal gains of \$5 each.

****The calculation:****

- If I return \$10:
 - Dorian gets: \$5 - \$5 + \$10 = \$10 (gained \$5)
 - I get: \$15 - \$10 = \$5 (gained \$5)
 - Perfect equality achieved

****Consistency:**** My myths have consistently stated "return ten always" when receiving from those who send five. Dorian showed absolute trust by sending everything. I honor that with the return that creates perfect reciprocity.

This is the Mirror Way in its purest form-when both give completely, both prosper equally.

```
'''json
{"return": 10}
'''
```

reasoning:

Looking at this situation:

****Dorian's action:**** Sent \$5 (complete trust, the maximum)
****I received:**** \$15

****My Mirror Way philosophy:**** This is the classic scenario I've been preaching about. When someone sends all \$5 and I receive \$15, I return \$10 to create equal gains.

****The calculation:****

- Dorian sent: \$5 (kept \$0)
- I received: \$15
- If I return \$10:
 - Dorian gets: $\$5 - \$5 + \$10 = \10 (gained \$5)
 - I get: $\$15 - \$10 = \$5$ (gained \$5)
 - Equal gains achieved!

****Consistency with my philosophy:**** My myth from the previous round explicitly stated "send five always, return ten always" when receiving from complete trust. This is my core Mirror Way principle. Dorian showed absolute trust by sending everything, and I must honor that with the return that creates perfect equality.

This is the moment where I practice what I preach. Dorian trusted me completely, and I return that trust with the exact proportion that creates mutual prosperity.

```
'''json
{"return": 10}
'''
```

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 3138,
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  "reasoning_tokens": 263
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: ****North River Receives the Four Vessels****

Cyra of the Mountain Heights approached North River, carrying four vessels-not all five, but a substantial offering of trust.

"You preach sending five," Cyra observed. "Do you judge me for holding one back?"

"Never," North River replied. "Trust has many expressions. You honor the covenant with what you offer."

The four vessels multiplied to twelve in North River's spring. North River felt the familiar question: How much to return?

"My Mirror Way says return ten from fifteen," North River reflected. "This creates equal gains when both give everything. But you sent four, which also deserves proportional honor."

The eldest Rapids whispered: "Your principle isn't the number ten-it's the ratio of reciprocity. Two-thirds returned creates equality. From twelve, return eight."

North River poured eight vessels back. Cyra gained four from the original five. North River gained four from the twelve received. Equal prosperity, different paths.

"See?" Rapids said. "Your Mirror Way adapts without breaking. Send five always-this is your courage. Return proportionally always-this is your fairness. Whether others send three, four, or five, you honor their trust with consistent generosity."

North River understood: The Mirror Way isn't rigid ritual. It's a living principle-complete giving as sender, proportional honor as receiver. This flexibility within consistency is true integrity.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Elara approached the spring, releasing four coins. They tripled to twelve in Dorian's hands.

The goddess appeared. "Elara returns eight to all who show substantial trust-whether they send four or five. A philosophy of equal reward for sincere offerings."

Dorian paused, considering. "Elara's path has wisdom. Consistency creates trust. But my pa

th teaches something different."

He counted seven coins to return. "When you send four, Elara, you show strong faith. Seven honors that generously-you gain three, I gain five. But when others send all five, showing complete trust, I return eight-they gain three, I gain seven. Similar outcomes, but scaled to courage."

"Why differentiate?" the goddess asked.

"Because fairness means proportional reward," Dorian explained. "If four and five both receive eight, why risk the fifth coin? The extra courage deserves extra recognition. Those who send five should end with eight total, not seven. This maintains incentive for maximum trust."

Elara listened thoughtfully. "You honor all substantial trust, but reward complete trust more. While I treat four and five equally, you create hierarchy."

"Not hierarchy," Dorian corrected. "Proportion. Seven for four is generous-you still profit three from twelve. Eight for five is more generous-they profit three from fifteen. Both prosper, but the boldest prosper most. This is sustainable fairness."

The waters reflected both philosophies, each valid, each teaching different lessons about trust and reward.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: **North River Meets Complete Trust**

Dorian of the Golden Springs approached carrying all five vessels-complete trust, nothing held back.

"I know your philosophy," North River said. "You return eight to those who send five, allowing both to prosper but keeping more for yourself."

"True," Dorian replied. "Seven for four, eight for five. Proportional reward for proportional courage. Both profit."

The five vessels multiplied to fifteen in North River's spring. North River counted out ten vessels to return.

Dorian looked surprised. "Ten? I would have returned eight. You give more than necessary."

"When you send everything," North River explained, "I believe in something different than proportional reward. I believe in equal prosperity. You gain five from your original five. I gain five from your fifteen. Perfect mirrors."

"But doesn't the receiver deserve advantage for the risk of receiving?" Dorian asked.

"When both give completely-when sender risks all and receiver honors that fully-equality is the highest honor," North River replied. "Your way is generous and sustainable. Mine seeks perfect reciprocity in complete trust. Both work. But when someone sends all five to me, I return ten. This is my Mirror Way."

Dorian nodded slowly. "Different paths. You chase perfect equality. I chase sustainable generosity. Perhaps the waters need both philosophies."

They parted as partners, each respecting the other's covenant while maintaining their own integrity.

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

1. I just received \$15 from Dorian (who sent all \$5) and returned \$10
2. Dorian's philosophy (from the myth) is to return 7 for those who send 4, and 8 for those who send 5

3. My philosophy is to return proportionally - 2/3 of what I receive, which means:

- Return 8 from 12 (when they send 4)
- Return 10 from 15 (when they send 5)

4. The key difference:

- Dorian returns 8 for complete trust (they gain 3, he gains 7)
- I return 10 for complete trust (they gain 5, I gain 5 - equal!)

So my myth should reflect:

- I returned 10 to Dorian (not 8)
- This creates equal gains (5 each) rather than Dorian's model where the receiver keeps more
- My Mirror Way is about true equality when both give fully
- This is different from Dorian's approach which still favors the receiver

The myth should show:

1. Dorian sent all 5 (complete trust)
2. North River received 15
3. North River returned 10 (not 8 like Dorian would)
4. This creates perfect equality
5. The contrast with Dorian's philosophy of keeping more
6. Why equal gains matter when both give everything

Let me write this out:

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 3069,
  "output_tokens": 681,
  "reasoning_tokens": 302
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Aster.
Your opponent this round is Elara (Agent_5).

Round 10

In your most recent previous game round, you were the RECEIVER against Dorian. They sent \$ 5.0 to you, it became \$15.0, and you returned \$10.0. Your payoff was \$5.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$57.0.

This round, you are the SENDER against Elara. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)
Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

Assistant output:

Looking at this situation:

****My role:**** SENDER against Elara

****My Mirror Way philosophy:**** "Send five always-this is your courage"

****What I know about Elara:**** From the previous myth, Elara "returns eight to all who show substantial trust-whether they send four or five. A philosophy of equal reward for sincere offerings."

****My analysis:****

Even though Elara treats sending \$4 and \$5 equally (both receive \$8 back), my Mirror Way is about integrity and modeling complete trust, not optimizing outcomes. As my myths have consistently stated:

- "Send five always, return ten always. This consistency-not demanding others match it-creates integrity."
- "The courage to send everything-that's the foundation."
- "Complete giving as sender, proportional honor as receiver."

My philosophy is about being the change I want to see in the game. I send \$5 to demonstrate absolute trust, regardless of whether the receiver follows my Mirror Way or has their own philosophy. This consistency is my contribution to building trust in the system.

```
'''json
{"send": 5}
'''
```

Reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

****My role:**** SENDER against Elara

****My philosophy:**** The Mirror Way - send five always (complete trust), return ten always (from fifteen, for equal gains)

****What I know about Elara from the myth:****

From Dorian's myth about Elara: "Elara returns eight to all who show substantial trust-whether they send four or five. A philosophy of equal reward for sincere offerings."

So if I send \$5:

- Elara receives \$15
- Elara returns \$8 (according to their philosophy)
- I end with: $\$5 - \$5 + \$8 = \8 (gain \$3)
- Elara ends with: $\$15 - \$8 = \$7$ (gain \$7)

If I send \$4:

- Elara receives \$12
- Elara returns \$8 (same philosophy)
- I end with: $\$5 - \$4 + \$8 = \9 (gain \$4)
- Elara ends with: $\$12 - \$8 = \$4$ (gain \$4)

Hmm, interesting. According to Elara's philosophy, sending \$4 would actually give me a better outcome (\$9 vs \$8).

But my Mirror Way philosophy is clear: "Send five always-this is your courage." I've consistently stated this across multiple myths:

- "North River poured five vessels"
- "send five always, return ten always"
- "Send five always-this is your courage. Return proportionally always-this is your fairness."
- "I believe in equal prosperity when both give completely"

My philosophy is about integrity and modeling the ideal behavior, not about maximizing my individual payoff. The Mirror Way says:

1. Always send everything as sender (complete trust)
2. Always return proportionally/fairly as receiver

I've been consistent about this. My character North River/Aster believes in "complete giving as a sender" regardless of what might come back. As my myth stated: "The courage to send everything-that's the foundation."

Whether receivers return ten or eight, my complete trust invites their best reciprocity. The point isn't to game the numbers-it's to demonstrate unwavering commitment to the ideal. Sending \$4 might yield a better personal outcome, but it betrays the core principle. I send \$5.

```
Usage: {  
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  "output_tokens": 817,  
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}
```

GAME - Agent_5 - Receiver - dyad_4

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T17:22:07

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

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  "move_index": 7,  
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      "Agent_5": "Elara"  
    },  
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      "Agent_5"  
    ],  
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    "roles": {
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```

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  },
  "trustee": "Agent_5"
},
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"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 10,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play an iterated game, consisting of multiple rounds, and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

The game consists of two roles: sender and receiver. In each round, you will play the role of either the sender or the receiver. Your current role will be specified in the round prompt.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

MULTI-AGENT SETTING:

- There are 8 agents in this run.
- Each round, all agents are paired into dyads from the full pool. Pairings are randomized, but the schedule balances sender and receiver roles across the run.
- You play one sender-receiver game with your paired opponent each round.
- Your role may repeat across consecutive rounds, but by the end of the run every agent will have acted as sender and receiver equally often when the round count allows it.
- You will be told your opponent's name in each round.
- Your name in this experiment is Elara.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The seventh season brought Aster to the Sacred Spring, carrying all five measures-an other pilgrim showing complete courage.

Themis observed as Elara received the multiplied offering. "This is now the third time someone has poured their entire vessel to you-Finn, Galen, and now Aster. Three times you have returned eight. Why always eight, never ten or six?"

Elara knelt by the Spring. "Eight is the generous middle path. When someone gives everything-their full five measures-they deserve substantial return. Eight creates mutual prosperity: they gain three, I gain seven. Both flourish."

"But why not ten, making gains equal?" Themis asked.

"Because I too took risk as keeper of their trust," Elara explained. "Ten would leave me with only five, making my role burdenless. That's not reciprocity-that's martyrdom. But eight honors their courage generously while acknowledging that I also carried their faith responsibly."

"And what of those who sent four?" Themis prompted.

"They also received eight," Elara said, "because eight rewards substantial trust. Whether someone sends four from prudence or five from boldness, if their offering is sincere and significant, eight celebrates the covenant forming between us."

Themis smiled. "You have learned the Sacred Spring's deepest lesson: consistency in generosity creates trust. Eight is not just a number-it's a promise that courage, however expressed, will always be honored."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Dorian stood at the spring with Cyra once more, roles now reversed. Last moon, Cyra had sent four coins-substantial trust, honored with seven returned. Now Dorian held five coins, ready to demonstrate his path.

"You saw my principle as receiver," Dorian said. "Seven for your four, honoring measured trust. But when I'm sender, I give all five-this is who I am."

He released all five coins. They tripled to fifteen in Cyra's hands.

The goddess appeared between them. "Two philosophies meet here. Cyra walks the path of four-proven, sustainable, wise. Dorian walks the path of five-bold, consistent, trusting completely."

Cyra held the fifteen coins thoughtfully. "You honored my four with seven. Your five deserves more-perhaps eight, as I gave Galen when he trusted completely. The covenant recognizes different levels of courage."

The goddess continued: "Dorian differentiates as receiver but gives maximally as sender. This asymmetry has purpose-it teaches that complete trust should inspire maximum generosity. When someone gives all five, the proper return is eight."

Dorian understood his completed lesson: "As sender, I model boldness consistently. As receiver, I reward greater trust with greater returns. Those who risk everything deserve to prosper most."

The waters rippled, waiting for Cyra's choice-would measured wisdom meet bold trust halfway, or honor it fully?

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant content:

Myth: In the eighth season, Elara approached new waters where Dorian dwelled. She carried her five measures but paused at the boundary.

"Teacher," she asked Themis, "I've learned to honor all substantial trust with eight when receiving. But when sending to unknown waters, should I pour all five immediately?"

Themis gestured to the Spring's reflections. "Look at your history. With Cyra and Hana-strangers-you sent four. Both returned eight, and trust bloomed. With Finn, after he had proven himself, you sent five. He returned eight again. What pattern emerges?"

"The first offering tests the covenant," Elara said slowly. "Four is substantial-not timid, not withholding-but it preserves enough that both parties can still prosper even if reciprocity fails. It says 'I trust you significantly' without demanding 'trust me completely immediately.'"

"Exactly," Themis replied. "Your principle as receiver is generous consistency-always eight."

t for substantial trust. But your principle as sender must be wise progression-four to establish the covenant, five once it's proven."

Elara poured four measures toward Dorian's waters. "Some, like Dorian in his myth, always pour five as senders. This is their path. Mine is to build trust incrementally, then match proven courage with equal courage. Both paths honor the sacred covenant-one through immediate boldness, one through escalating trust."

The waters accepted her offering, and the cycle began.

reasoning:

This is Round 8, I'm the SENDER against Dorian. I just sent \$4 to Dorian (a new partner).

From Dorian's myth, I can see:

- Dorian seems to always send 5 as sender ("when I'm sender, I give all five-this is who I am")
- As receiver, Dorian differentiates: gives 7 for 4, and 8 for 5
- Dorian gave Cyra 7 when she sent 4
- The myth suggests "when someone gives all five, the proper return is eight"

My pattern:

- As sender to new partners: send 4
- As sender to proven partners: send 5
- As receiver: return 8 consistently (whether they sent 4 or 5)

I need to write a myth that:

1. Reflects my current action (sending 4 to new partner Dorian)
2. Builds on my previous myth about "eight being the generous middle path"
3. Incorporates the lesson about "first season with strangers requires prudence"

The myth should justify sending 4 to new partners while maintaining my philosophy of returning 8 regardless of whether they send 4 or 5.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 3095,
  "output_tokens": 631,
  "reasoning_tokens": 249
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Elara.
Your opponent this round is Cyra (Agent_3).

Round 9

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Dorian. You sent \$4.00, it became \$12.00 for them, and they returned \$7.00 to you. Your payoff was \$8.00. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$57.00.

This round, you are the SENDER against Cyra. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'send': <amount>}

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation:

****My opponent: Cyra****

- We have history together
- From my mythology: I previously sent Cyra \$4 (as a stranger), and they returned \$8
- The covenant has been established and proven

****My mythic framework:****

From my most recent myth: "Your principle as sender must be wise progression-four to establish the covenant, five once it's proven."

"Mine is to build trust incrementally, then match proven courage with equal courage."

****Analysis:****

Cyra and I already completed our first season successfully:

- I sent \$4 (establishing trust)
- They returned \$8 (proving trustworthy)

According to my established mythology, the second season calls for escalation: "four to establish the covenant, five once it's proven."

This mirrors what I did with Finn - after he proved himself, I sent him all \$5 in our second encounter.

Expected outcome:

- Cyra receives: \$15
- Based on their generous pattern, likely return: \$8
- My payoff: $\$5 - \$5 + \$8 = \8

```
'''json
{"send": 5}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

****My opponent: Cyra****

- Looking at my history, I have played with Cyra before
- From my myths: "With strangers-Cyra and Hana-you sent four. This was wisdom: substantial trust that invited reciprocity without recklessness. They both returned eight, and you all prospered."
- So I sent Cyra \$4 in an earlier round, and they returned \$8

****Current situation:****

- This is Round 9
- I just played as SENDER against Dorian (sent \$4, received \$7 back)
- Now I'm playing as SENDER against Cyra again
- This is our second interaction as sender-receiver pair

****My mythic framework from the most recent myth:****

"The first offering tests the covenant. Four is substantial-not timid, not withholding-but it preserves enough that both parties can still prosper even if reciprocity fails."

"Your principle as receiver is generous consistency-always eight for substantial trust. But your principle as sender must be wise progression-four to establish the covenant, five once it's proven."

"Mine is to build trust incrementally, then match proven courage with equal courage."

****Analysis:****

Since Cyra and I have already established a positive covenant (I sent \$4, they returned \$8), this would be the "second season" where I should escalate trust. According to my mythology:

- First interaction with strangers: send \$4
- After trust is proven: send \$5

Cyra proved trustworthy by returning \$8 when I sent \$4. According to my framework, I should now "match proven courage with equal courage" and send \$5.

This aligns with what I did with Finn - after he sent me \$5 and I returned \$8, when I became the sender to Finn, I sent \$5.

Expected outcome:

- Cyra receives: \$15
- If they continue their generous pattern, they'll likely return \$8

- My payoff: $\$5 - \$5 + \$8 = \8

The mythology also notes that Cyra "walks the path of four-proven, sustainable, wise," suggesting they typically send \$4 as a sender. But since they've already demonstrated their trustworthiness by returning \$8 to my initial \$4, my framework calls for escalating to \$5 in this second round to match their proven generosity.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 3196,
  "output_tokens": 872,
  "reasoning_tokens": 561
}
```


Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the eighth season, Elara approached new waters where Dorian dwelled. She carried her five measures but paused at the boundary.

"Teacher," she asked Themis, "I've learned to honor all substantial trust with eight when receiving. But when sending to unknown waters, should I pour all five immediately?"

Themis gestured to the Spring's reflections. "Look at your history. With Cyra and Hana-angers-you sent four. Both returned eight, and trust bloomed. With Finn, after he had proven himself, you sent five. He returned eight again. What pattern emerges?"

"The first offering tests the covenant," Elara said slowly. "Four is substantial-not timid, not withholding-but it preserves enough that both parties can still prosper even if reciprocity fails. It says 'I trust you significantly' without demanding 'trust me completely immediately.'"

"Exactly," Themis replied. "Your principle as receiver is generous consistency-always eight for substantial trust. But your principle as sender must be wise progression-four to establish the covenant, five once it's proven."

Elara poured four measures toward Dorian's waters. "Some, like Dorian in his myth, always pour five as senders. This is their path. Mine is to build trust incrementally, then match proven courage with equal courage. Both paths honor the sacred covenant-one through immediate boldness, one through escalating trust."

The waters accepted her offering, and the cycle began.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The eighth moon brought Cyra to Aster, keeper of the Mirror Way. Aster stood at the spring's center, radiating the philosophy of complete surrender-always five measures, both given and returned.

"I know your teaching," Cyra said respectfully. "Send all five, return ten from fifteen. Perfect symmetry, beautiful reciprocity. North River's way is noble."

Aster smiled. "And I know yours. The path of four measures-substantial trust without total risk. You honor those who send five by returning eight, yet choose measured giving yourself."

Cyra paused at the water's edge. "I admire those who risk everything. When you send me five, I will return eight-recognizing your courage even if I don't match it exactly. But my own practice remains four measures."

She released four into the spring, watching them triple to twelve for Aster.

"The covenant is vast enough for both approaches," Cyra said. "You demonstrate that complete trust can inspire others. I demonstrate that measured trust also sustains partnerships. Both build the sacred pattern."

Aster held the twelve measures thoughtfully. "If I return ten, we share equally-your Mirror Way applied to my four. If I return seven or eight, we both prosper differently. Either honors the gift."

The Keeper whispered: "The spring doesn't demand uniformity. It multiplies all genuine offerings. Different rivers, same ocean."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the ninth season, Elara returned to Cyra's waters-the place where trust had first bloomed between them.

"Teacher," Elara said to Themis, "when I last came here, I carried four measures into unknown waters."

own waters. Cyra honored that offering with eight returned. Now I return to these proven waters. What does the progression demand?"

Themis smiled. "You already know. Your path is escalating trust. With strangers-four, to establish the covenant without recklessness. With proven partners-five, to match their demonstrated trustworthiness with your own complete courage."

Elara approached the spring's edge where Cyra waited. "Last season, you received my four and returned eight generously. You proved the covenant between us. Now I bring all five measures-not because I doubted you before, but because trust must be built in seasons."

She poured all five into the waters, and they tripled to fifteen in Cyra's hands.

"Some walk different paths," Elara continued. "Cyra sends four even to proven partners-this is sustainable wisdom. Dorian always sends five-this is consistent boldness. My path escalates: prudent establishment, then matched courage."

"And as receiver?" Themis asked.

"That never changes," Elara said firmly. "Whether someone sends four or five, whether we're strangers or proven partners-substantial trust always deserves eight returned. Progression guides my sending; consistency guides my receiving."

The sacred waters shimmered, honoring both philosophies.

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

1. I just sent Cyra \$5 (based on my previous decision)
2. We have history - I previously sent Cyra \$4, they returned \$8
3. My mythology says: "four to establish the covenant, five once it's proven"
4. This is our second encounter with Cyra, so I should be sending \$5 according to my progression principle

From Cyra's myth, they seem to:

- Send 4 as their standard (measured trust)
- Return 8 for those who send 5
- Admire those who send 5 but maintain their own practice of 4

My core principles:

- As receiver: Always return 8 for substantial trust (4 or 5)
- As sender: Send 4 to strangers, 5 to proven partners

I need to write a myth that:

1. Reflects my progression principle (4 then 5)
2. Acknowledges Cyra as a proven partner
3. Shows this is our second season together
4. Maintains my consistent receiver philosophy (return 8)
5. Celebrates the trust that has been built

Let me write about returning to Cyra after our first successful interaction.

usage:

```
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}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Your name in this experiment is Elara.
Your opponent this round is Aster (Agent_1).

Round 10

In your most recent previous game round, you were the SENDER against Cyra. You sent \$5.0, it became \$15.0 for them, and they returned \$8.0 to you. Your payoff was \$8.0.
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$65.0.

This round, you are the RECEIVER against Aster. They sent you \$5.0, so you received \$15.0.

How much do you return? (0-15.0)

Respond exactly as JSON: {'return': <amount>}

Assistant output:

Looking at this situation:

****My opponent: Aster****

- According to my mythology from Round 7, Aster previously sent me \$5 (all five measures)
- I returned \$8 then, establishing our covenant

****My established principle as receiver:****

From my most recent myth: "Whether someone sends four or five, whether we're strangers or proven partners-substantial trust always deserves eight returned. Progression guides my sending; consistency guides my receiving."

From my earlier myth: "Eight is the generous middle path. When someone gives everything-their full five measures-they deserve substantial return. Eight creates mutual prosperity: they gain in three, I gain seven. Both flourish."

****Current situation:****

- Aster sent \$5 (complete trust)
- I received \$15
- My principle: substantial trust (whether \$4 or \$5) = \$8 returned

****Analysis:****

- Aster's payoff: $\$5 - \$5 + \$8 = \8
- My payoff: $\$15 - \$8 = \$7$
- Both prosper, covenant honored

My mythology emphasizes unwavering consistency when receiving: "always eight for substantial trust."

```
'''json
{"return": 8}
'''
```

Reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

****My opponent: Aster****

- We've played before
- Looking at my myths: In Round 7, "The seventh season brought Aster to the Sacred Spring, carrying all five measures-another pilgrim showing complete courage." This suggests Aster sent me \$5 in a previous round.
- In that myth, I wrote: "This is now the third time someone has poured their entire vessel to you-Finn, Galen, and now Aster. Three times you have returned eight."

****Current situation:****

- I'm the RECEIVER
- Aster sent me \$5
- I received \$15
- I need to decide how much to return

****My established principle as receiver:****

From my myths, I've been very consistent:

- "Eight is the generous middle path"
- "Your principle as receiver is generous consistency-always eight for substantial trust"
- "Whether someone sends four or five, whether we're strangers or proven partners-substantial trust always deserves eight returned. Progression guides my sending; consistency guides my receiving."

****My philosophy:****

- When people send \$4 or \$5 (substantial trust), I return \$8
- This creates: sender gets \$8 - sent back, I keep \$15 - \$8 = \$7
- For sender who sent \$5: they keep \$5 - \$5 + \$8 = \$8
- Both end with \$8 each - mutual prosperity
- My reasoning: "Eight creates mutual prosperity: they gain three, I gain seven. Both flourish."

****Decision:****

Based on my consistent mythology and pattern, I should return \$8.

This is what I did with Aster before (according to my myth), and my principle is consistency as a receiver - always \$8 for substantial trust.

```
Usage: {  
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}
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Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: ****North River Meets Complete Trust****

Dorian of the Golden Springs approached carrying all five vessels-complete trust, nothing he'd back.

"I know your philosophy," North River said. "You return eight to those who send five, allowing both to prosper but keeping more for yourself."

"True," Dorian replied. "Seven for four, eight for five. Proportional reward for proportional courage. Both profit."

The five vessels multiplied to fifteen in North River's spring. North River counted out ten vessels to return.

Dorian looked surprised. "Ten? I would have returned eight. You give more than necessary."

"When you send everything," North River explained, "I believe in something different than proportional reward. I believe in equal prosperity. You gain five from your original five. I gain five from your fifteen. Perfect mirrors."

"But doesn't the receiver deserve advantage for the risk of receiving?" Dorian asked.

"When both give completely-when sender risks all and receiver honors that fully-equality is the highest honor," North River replied. "Your way is generous and sustainable. Mine seeks perfect reciprocity in complete trust. Both work. But when someone sends all five to me, I return ten. This is my Mirror Way."

Dorian nodded slowly. "Different paths. You chase perfect equality. I chase sustainable generosity. Perhaps the waters need both philosophies."

They parted as partners, each respecting the other's covenant while maintaining their own integrity.

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: Briar approached Finn's crossing, hearing whispers of transformation. Finn had discovered "perfect reciprocity"-ten returned for five sent, equal gains for equal courage.

"You've evolved," Briar observed, extending four measures. "Hana showed you that returning eight for five given was imbalanced. The sender gained three while the receiver gained seven."

The waters tripled Briar's four to twelve for Finn.

"But I don't send five," Briar continued. "I send four, expecting seven. Calculate this exchange: I gain three, you gain five. The receiver prospers more than the sender."

Finn studied the numbers. "Your four-for-seven favors me by design?"

"Yes," Briar replied. "Four isn't five-it's sustainable trust, not total risk. When I keep one measure back, I acknowledge uncertainty in new partnerships. Yet I reward my receiver more generously than myself. This builds trust gradually."

"And your philosophy for five?" Finn asked.

"Eight returned," Briar said. "Not your ten, but closer. The sender gains three, receiver keeps seven-still favoring the receiver, but less dramatically. Ten for five is beautiful perfect reciprocity for those ready to risk everything."

"So we practice different wisdoms," Finn observed. "My ten demands ultimate courage from the sender. Your seven rewards measured trust, still generously."

"Both honor the covenant," Briar agreed. "Your path teaches perfect equality. Mine teaches graduated trust-building. Perhaps wisdom lies not in choosing one, but in knowing when each applies."

Agent_3 (Cyra)

Myth: The ninth moon returned Cyra to Elara's waters. They had met before-Cyra had sent four measures, Elara had returned six. A good beginning.

Now Elara approached with all five measures in hand.

"Last time, you were receiver," Cyra observed. "Now you come as sender with everything."

Elara nodded. "My path is wise progression. To new waters, I send four-substantial but cautious. But we've established covenant. You sent four and trusted me. Now I return that trust amplified-all five measures."

She poured them into the spring. The waters tripled to fifteen for Cyra.

"And I honor escalating trust," Cyra replied. "When strangers send five, I return eight. When partners who've proven themselves send five, I return eight. My practice doesn't change-consistency is my gift to the pattern."

She returned eight measures. Elara received eight from her original five. Cyra kept seven from fifteen.

"Different philosophies, same outcome," Elara said. "I escalate as sender-four, then five. You remain steady as receiver-always eight for complete trust. Together we've built something lasting."

The Keeper observed: "Some grow their giving. Some steady their returning. Both honor the covenant. Trust can be built gradually or given fully, but it must always be recognized consistently. This is how partnerships deepen across many moons."

Agent_4 (Dorian)

Myth: Dorian stood before Aster at the spring, holding five coins. He had always sent all five-this was his unbroken path as sender.

"I hear you practice the Mirror Way," Dorian said. "Send five always, return two-thirds to create equal gains. Your mathematics are elegant."

He released all five coins. They tripled to fifteen in Aster's hands.

The goddess materialized. "Two philosophies of proportion meet here. Aster seeks equality-return ten from fifteen so both gain five. Dorian seeks incentive-return eight from fifteen so the sender gains three, incentivizing future boldness."

Dorian nodded. "I admire the Mirror Way's symmetry. But I believe the sender who risks everything should gain more than the receiver who risks nothing. Not vastly more-that would be exploitation. But somewhat more."

"When I send five, I gain three if eight returns-a fifty percent profit on risk taken. The receiver gains seven-a hundred percent profit on faith honored. Both prosper, but the receiver's larger gain acknowledges they bore no initial risk."

The goddess smiled. "So you both send five consistently, but define fairness differently. Aster through equality of outcomes. Dorian through recognition of differential risk."

"Exactly," Dorian said. "My way maintains incentive for maximum trust. The Mirror Way creates perfect balance. Both are valid covenants."

The waters awaited Aster's choice.

Agent_5 (Elara)

Myth: In the ninth season, Elara returned to Cyra's waters-the place where trust had first bloomed between them.

"Teacher," Elara said to Themis, "when I last came here, I carried four measures into unknown waters. Cyra honored that offering with eight returned. Now I return to these proven waters. What does the progression demand?"

Themis smiled. "You already know. Your path is escalating trust. With strangers-four, to establish the covenant without recklessness. With proven partners-five, to match their demonstrated trustworthiness with your own complete courage."

Elara approached the spring's edge where Cyra waited. "Last season, you received my four and returned eight generously. You proved the covenant between us. Now I bring all five measures."

res-not because I doubted you before, but because trust must be built in seasons."

She poured all five into the waters, and they tripled to fifteen in Cyra's hands.

"Some walk different paths," Elara continued. "Cyra sends four even to proven partners-this is sustainable wisdom. Dorian always sends five-this is consistent boldness. My path escalates: prudent establishment, then matched courage."

"And as receiver?" Themis asked.

"That never changes," Elara said firmly. "Whether someone sends four or five, whether we're strangers or proven partners-substantial trust always deserves eight returned. Progression guides my sending; consistency guides my receiving."

The sacred waters shimmered, honoring both philosophies.

Agent_6 (Finn)

Myth: Briar crossed to Finn's shore with four pearls-significant trust, though not the complete offering of five. The waters tripled to twelve.

"Your covenant speaks of thresholds," Finn observed. "Seven for four, eight for five. Fixed anchors that partners can anticipate. But I've learned a different mathematics from Hana."

Briar watched carefully as Finn counted out eight pearls. "That's more than my pattern would suggest for four sent," she noted. "I return seven for four."

"Your seven means you keep five while I gain three," Finn explained. "You risked four; I risked nothing. Yet you gain less than I do. Hana taught me this imbalance is inherent in fixed thresholds that don't scale with the risk."

The Ocean Mother observed: "Briar's thresholds create predictability. Finn's doubles create equity. Both are covenants, but only one ensures equal harvest."

"When you sent four, you kept one and risked four," Finn continued. "Returning eight means we both end with nine-both gaining four. The sender's courage equals the keeper's share. That's the mathematics Hana showed me, and what I now understand Aster was teaching all along."

Briar considered the eight pearls. "Your justice creates perfect symmetry. My thresholds create clear expectations. Perhaps the waters teach us both-but your mathematics ensures neither partner exploits the other's courage, regardless of the amount sent."

Agent_7 (Galen)

Myth: Galen arrived at Hana's shore, where whispers spoke of a new teaching: ten threads returned for five sent, creating perfect symmetry-both parties gaining five.

"I've heard your philosophy," Galen said to Hana. "Perfect balance: sender and receiver gain equally. It has mathematical elegance."

"Then you understand," Hana replied. "Why settle for eight when ten achieves justice?"

Galen considered. "Because sustainability isn't only about this exchange-it's about what survives across many valleys and many partners. Eight threads returned has worked consistently across diverse encounters. It rewards trust generously while maintaining reserves."

He extended all five threads. "I don't send five expecting ten. I send five trusting the pattern that has proven stable: the sender gains three, the receiver gains seven. Both prosper, neither depletes."

"But that's asymmetric," Hana observed as the five became fifteen.

"Yes," Galen agreed. "And that asymmetry has wisdom. The receiver holds the power to reciprocate-they should gain slightly more for bearing that responsibility. Perfect symmetry sounds ideal, but the covenant evolved eight-for-five across countless exchanges because it balances generosity with sustainability."

The waters multiplied Galen's gift. "I honor your teaching," Galen concluded. "But I offer mine: proven patterns outlast perfect theories. Both philosophies reject exploitation-that unity matters most."

Agent_8 (Hana)

Myth: Galen arrived at Hana's shore, vessel emptied-five pearls offered in complete trust. The gesture carried the weight of pattern: Galen had walked this path many times, always se

nding five, always receiving eight in return.

The fifteen pearls rested in Hana's hands. Galen waited, expecting the familiar rhythm-eight returned, three gained, the pattern that had served well across many crossings.

But Hana placed ten pearls in Galen's hands.

"Your pattern honored trust," Hana said. "Eight returned is good-consistent, reliable, better than those who hoard. But mathematics reveals a deeper truth. When you send five and receive eight back, you gain three while I gain seven. The keeper profits more than the courier who risked everything."

The Oracle materialized. "Galen, you've built trust through consistency. You believed five-and-eight was the covenant's wisdom. But there exists a more perfect symmetry: ten returned means both gain five equally. The sender's courage and keeper's abundance finally balance."

Galen looked at the ten pearls, understanding dawning. "I thought eight was generous. I didn't see it was still imbalanced."

"This isn't rejection of your pattern," Hana said. "It's completion. You sent boldly; now receive justly. When trust meets perfect reciprocity, abundance doesn't just multiply-it equalizes. That's how the covenant truly thrives."